tonight will be the night (that i will fall for you)

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by Moonlit_Catra, sherassword

Summary

"Let me tell you what I think," Adora says, leaning her head forward so she was nearly touching Catra's to her own, "I think you like this little game of ours. You like my attention on you, you don't even care that practically everyone, including your friends, have been staring at us since you took my hand." It's a shot in the dark but Adora is trying to get a read on where Catra actually is, because this feels... intense, in a way Adora hasn't experienced before, and it doesn't fully feel like it's because they're so-called 'enemies'.

"A game? You think this is a game?" Catra raises her eyebrows at Adora's words. "I'm here to keep an eye on you, and that's it. Truly you need to get over yourself and bring that big ego of yours down a notch. It's pretty damn close to getting as big as your forehead." She bites back, a smirk on her lips.

AKA HORDE LORD ADORA AU (she's really sexy)

Notes

Oh boy, oh boy, oh boy. FINALLY we put this fic into words, it has been a long time coming and we absolutely ADORE this AU and want to share it with all of y'all. Horde Lord Adora is just too sexy to keep to ourselves. I hope you all enjoy reading as much as we enjoyed writing.

A quick warning, this fic is rated EXPLICIT for a reason and, as you can see by the tags, there WILL be smut (quite regularly actually) so please be mindful of this before you choose to read. Any potential triggering topics will be warned in the notes of chapters.

How/Why Adora became the Horde Lord will be explained in the future and Catra is a Princess in this AU. Adora never met Bow and Glimmer in the woods but she is still She-Ra and has her sword, she returned back to the Fright Zone and she never met Catra until she started going into the field.

Anyway, chapter 2 will be posted tomorrow, because it is already written but was too long to have with his chapter, and chapter 3 is already partially written with a start on chapter 4. We REALLY REALLY hope y'all enjoy and I won't keep you any longer!

See the end of the work for more notes

Princess Prom

This must be the fifth plan that her so-called *tactician* has suggested to her and that Adora has shot down. She wonders why she even bothers? She might as well make her own plans and not even bother asking for advice or help if all her soldiers are *this* useless. The soldier, Adora doesn't even know their name, is running out of ideas and she can tell they are. She's tuned them out, busying herself with cadet reports from her Force Captains and other busybody paperwork. *Maybe sixth time will be the charm?*

"Maybe if we used She-Ra-" Adora takes a sharp breath in. *So much for the sixth time being the charm.*

"Absolutely *not* ." Adora brings her fists down on the table in front of her, a growl of rage escaping her throat as the sword, holstered to her side, seems to grow heavy. "I told you to *never* suggest that again."

"B-But Lord Adora, if you used She-Ra, you could crush the Rebellion in days."

"I am not-" She lets out a sharp exhale of exasperation. " *She-Ra* ," Adora spits that name. "is a Princess, her power is too strong, I cannot control her and I won't use her. I have told you this before and I am growing tired of your ignorance." She stands up again, straightening her back almost painfully upright while folding her arms behind her back. "Come up with another plan, or I'll simply find someone else who can." The soldier is practically shaking in their boots and Adora huffs. Sometimes she wonders how they've gained so much territory when it seems like all her soldiers are afraid.

"Lord Adora!" Adora groans. She runs a hand through her bangs, pushing them back atop her head as she dismisses the strategist with the flick of her wrist.

"Scorpia, what is it?" Adora asks. She snaps her fingers as a signal for Scorpia to follow her as she walks towards her throne.

"So, these letters arrived by a courier today, they're our invitations to the All Princess Ball." Scorpia explains. Adora frowns. She pauses at the base of her throne and turns on her heel before she sits in it.

"Princess Ball? Sounds dull." Adora says, reaching her hand out for the scroll. Scorpia places the scroll in her palm and Adora looks at it with distaste.

"Every Princess will be there! They host it every ten years, this year it's Princess Frosta's turn to host, she's neutral to the Horde and the Rebellion."

"Wait, so the Rebellion just... invited us? Are they stupid?" Adora asks as she unfastens the scroll. She watches in disbelief as the thing falls open and rolls, and rolls, and *rolls* . "They've sent me this to torture me, I'm sure of it."

She tosses the end of her scroll across towards Kyle who was standing nearby. “Kyle, read it to me.” Meanwhile, she leans back in her throne and closes her eyes. It’s a busy day in the Fright Zone, she doesn’t normally have so many people hanging around her, she likes solitude usually, and they’re beginning to give her a headache with their constant yapping.

Kyle’s voice becomes like background noise to her as she thinks this over. If every Princess was going to be there, that would be a perfect opportunity to do… *something* . Adora just doesn’t know exactly what that something will be. “Kyle, shut up for a second,” Adora demands and he silences immediately. “Scorpia, why did they even invite me? You, I get, you’re a Princess, but me?”

“Well… She-Ra is kind of an honorary Princess, I guess? And Frosta is neutral in the war with the Rebellion so… you know, they have the whole neutral ground rule, it’d be against the spirit of the ball to *not* invite us.”

“ *Ugh* , Princesses, they’re so self-righteous, I feel nauseous just thinking about it.” Adora groans, running her fingers through her hair. Scorpia was currently knocking her pincers together nervously. “Kyle. Resume.” Adora orders, relaxing back into her throne. “This is Catra’s idea. I just know it.” Adora says, mostly to herself, though her words were more than loud enough for Scorpia to hear them.

“You know, I’m thinking… it’s not?” Scorpia says. Adora opens one of her eyes and looks at the woman while raising an eyebrow in question. “The Princess Ball is a tradition, I got sent an invitation to the last one and, well, you didn’t have your sword then but, I’m sure they would’ve sent you one too. Catra’s got… nothing to do, with *any* of this.” Scorpia explains.

“It’s her, I know it is, she’s the only one out of all the Princesses who has any sort of intelligence. She’s their strategist, this is one of her games.” Adora argues. Scorpia holds her claws up in surrender and Adora groans again. Kyle was still rattling off the invitation details, and he was only about *halfway* through the scroll.

“What’s your deal with her anyways?” Scorpia asks. When Adora scowls at her, she quickly backtracks on her question. “I just mean, you seem to have a focus on Catra over all the other Princesses.”

“She’s the worst one! She’s - *ughhhh* - she’s so annoying! Every plan I come up with, there she is! Countering my plans! Can you believe that?! She has the *audacity* to go toe to toe with *me* . “ *Pfffft*... you know,” Adora grins. “maybe this Ball isn’t such a bad idea... You know what, maybe it’s *exactly* the opportunity I’ve been looking for.”

“Uh,” Scorpia glances at Kyle, then back to Adora. “does this mean we’re going?”

“Oh, we’re going,” Adora stands, her cape swishing dramatically with her motion. “and we’re gonna teach Catra, and those rebels, that they can’t outthink the Lord of the Horde.” Adora places her hands on her hips before she frowns. “Kyle! Did I say stop reading?” The boy scrambles to go back to his reading and Adora grins. Now she just had to find an outfit for this stupid event, something that would distract her enemies so she could pull off her plan.

No way Catra could plan for what Adora was about to pull off.

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The Princess Ball is just as obnoxiously bright as Adora thought it would be. People look at her like she has a second head or something - which is fair when Adora considers that she’s

practically public enemy number one - but Scorpia had said that the Ball was neutral ground and she trusted her. She had left her sword at home, she didn't really need it for her plan and, besides, this thing had a no weapons rule (boring and dumb if you ask Adora).

Adora had never been to a 'Ball' in her life and she hadn't exactly planned on it. She'd had to get an outfit made by the department that made the Horde uniforms and, she had to admit, they had a lot of skill. Turns out, if you can make multiple Horde uniforms you might be considered a tailor, or seamstress, or whatever the fuck (Adora doesn't know), but they can make some fancy clothes that aren't uniform.

Scorpia was wearing some sleek black dress that, Adora had to admit, did her back a glorious justice. She wonders how Scorpia got all those muscles - and here she thought she was the muscle of this op. Lonnie was wearing a three piece suit that looked pretty good actually and the red matched Scorpia perfectly. Kyle, because they couldn't bring Rogelio, since cold and lizard are never a good combination, was in a simple red suit - white shirt and red tie. Adora wonders how he always manages to look like a teenage boy, scrawny and skinny, even at the age of twenty-two - he seriously hadn't changed since their cadet days.

Adora herself was dressed in a black turtleneck, that was skin tight, and she wore a fitted red blazer over the top with some black harness thing that gave it 'flavour' and she had fitted red pants on. Their colour scheme was definitely red and black, the colours of the Horde basically, and they stood out like sore thumbs among the bright pinks and blues of the Rebellion members around them. Whatever, Adora didn't come to win any fashion shows, but they sure as shit did look *good* .

"Is everyone clear on the plan? *Kyle* ?" Adora mumbles, fixing her eyes sternly on the boy. He seems to cower a little under her intense gaze. Kyle is afraid of her which should be strange, considering he'd seen Adora's awkward teenage years, but, also, Kyle is afraid of pretty much everyone with authority, even Scorpia - *Scorpia* !

They all nod to signal they knew the plan and what they had to do. "Good, this has to go perfectly, I mean it, Kyle, I'm serious."

"Will you lay off him?" Lonnie asks and Adora rolls her eyes at her. "He gets it, Adora." Adora scowls.

“It’s *Lord* Adora.” Adora reminds her, Lonnie shakes her head.

“You forget we used to bunk together, we saw you in your tighty whities, you’ll always be Adora to us.” Adora smiles a little at that. Her squad were her ‘inner circle’ so to speak, the only other person who hadn’t been in her squad, and who Adora trusted unconditionally, was Scorpia.

She concedes to Lonnie and gently slaps Kyle on his back, which almost sends him flying. “Whoops, sorry about that.” Adora says.

They pause at the doors of the Ice Castle while two guards go to open the much too large doors. “Let's just… get this over wi-” Whatever Adora was about to say dies in her throat as the doors to the castle are thrown open and her eyes immediately land on a *certain* woman. She’s standing in the centre of the hall, chatting to the Sparkle Princess, she’s *smiling* too and Adora’s stomach suddenly flip-flops.

Catra is dressed like a traditional Magicat, they tend to wear robes, though Adora normally sees Catra in battles and robes are *not* practical in battles. When Adora sees Catra, she’s usually in some tight vest shirt that exposes her arms in all their glory, with a little window on her chest that has a little tuft of hair that sticks up out of it - and it’s really cute. She usually has a belt around her waist with a little winged pin on it, tight - *very tight* - leggings, that are ripped in places that Adora is sure she made with her claws. She never wears shoes, and Adora doesn’t know how she hasn’t hurt her feet yet, but it makes her *deadly* in a fight - especially if she pounces on you with those things. Typically, her hair is drawn back into a low ponytail, her bangs falling wherever they please really, and she has a golden brace on one of her arms.

Usually she’s dressed for battle and, no, Adora has definitely *not* spent a long time closely examining her whenever she saw her. But tonight. Tonight she was dressed like she wasn’t expecting a fight. She was dressed in traditional Magicat clothing that Adora had seen some of the civilians wear, but Catra is a *Princess,* and clearly her clothes were of the highest quality.

The robes were intricate and folded in a way that Adora could never figure out, the colours had clearly been chosen carefully to pair well together with the different cloths. Adora couldn't figure out if they were different, or just a bunch of colours on one fabric, and pinned

and tucked and god knows what else, to give the effect they were giving right now, but Catra looked downright exquisite, royal, *beautiful* .

She was dressed more brightly than her friends, even if her outfit was technically more muted colours, the accenting of the bright gold made her practically *shine* under the lights. Her hair was down and a little wild, the only sign of Catra's more… fierce attitude, and framing her face was one of the Magicat royal crowns. Sometimes, Adora forgets that Catra is a Princess, but her regal presence is completely *undeniable* right now. She still wasn't wearing shoes.

Adora sees the exact moment Catra notices her because her smile falls almost immediately and she looks confused before she looks downright pissed. Adora wipes off whatever look she was giving Catra - maybe she was drooling a little, she honestly doesn't know - and fixes Catra with her trademark smug smirk. Catra scowls and Adora's smirk only grows. She sees the woman start to make her way towards her but Adora quickly slips into the nearby crowd.

No way she was talking to Catra before she talked to Frosta first. Adora had done her research; she knew what she had to do, she couldn't let Catra distract her - yet. "After we greet Frosta, you all go execute the plan, I'll keep Catra busy." Adora reminds them.

They climb the steps to the throne and stop at the top where Frosta was sitting on her ice throne. Adora bows a little and her soldiers follow suit. "Princess Frosta, revered hostess, we were so happy to receive your invitation to the Ball." Adora greets charmingly. Frosta just blinks at her, which throws Adora little if she's honest. *Is it possible to be intimidated by an eleven year old?*

"Princess Scorpia, Adora," Frosta says, and Adora doesn't know if she likes hearing her name so close to the title Princess. "You are welcome, please enjoy the Ball-" If Frosta was about to say more it gets cut off by a certain someone.

"You invited *her* ?!" Catra asks, gesturing at Adora vaguely. Although she was talking to Princess Frosta, she had her blue and gold eyes trained intensely on Adora. Adora would be lying if she said she didn't enjoy having the Magicat's full attention on her.

"Scorpia is a Princess, she gets an invitation," Frosta replies and, for an eleven year old, she speaks like she's been leading for a long time - Adora's almost impressed, when she was eleven she was just mastering how to fight with a staff. "She-Ra is an honorary Princess, she

also gets an invitation. The Kingdom of Snows has remained neutral in the fight against the Horde and the purpose of the Princess Ball is that it's neutral ground for *everyone* . They're Princesses, they get their plus ones, they stay."

"Yeah Catra." Adora chimes in.

"She- You-" Adora grins as she sees Catra go from obvious anger to exasperation in the matter of a few seconds. "She's from the Horde! She's the Horde *Lord* ! She's *evil* !" Catra protests.

"My decision is final." Frosta says and Adora winks at Catra as she bows respectfully to Frosta and makes her way down the steps. Her squad splits off from her when she reaches the bottom. She hears Catra following quickly behind her and she smirks to herself before she's ambushed by the woman at the bottom of the long staircase.

"Whatever you're planning, I won't let you get away with it." Catra growls. Adora places her hand to her chest and gives Catra a mock hurt look.

"Well now you're just hurting my feelings."

"You don't have feelings." Adora huffs before she looks around her surroundings. "I'm going to follow you all night, wherever you go, I go."

"Well if you're interested in me Kitty you could just say so, stalking isn't really my thing." Adora says nonchalantly, while examining her nails. She looks up to see a pretty pink colouring the cheeks of the Magicat.

"Don't call me Kitty," She bites back, "and I'm *not* stalking you, I'm making sure you don't do anything… evil."

"You assume I'm up to evil? *Ah* !" Adora grips her chest in an exaggerated way. "You wound my heart… *Kitten* ." Catra narrows her eyes and Adora laughs.

She brushes past Catra and heads towards the table where there was a spread of very *Rebellion* looking food. "Why are you here, really?" Catra asks, turning her back to the table she leans up against it.

"Oh, you've cracked me, let me spill my evil plans to you."

"So you admit you have evil plans?" Catra asks, raising a brow. Adora glances at her before she rolls her eyes.

"Aren't you Princess types supposed to see the best in other people?" Adora questions as she examines a piece of food curiously.

"In you? Impossible." Catra says and Adora actually finds herself smiling. Catra has a sharp tongue, Adora knows this from their many exchanges on the battlefield, and she appreciates a woman who is just as witty as she is, and doesn't take any shit from anyone - it's actually insanely attractive to her, which is why she's flirted with Catra on multiple occasions during battles.

Catra is always so serious while fighting, Adora used the flirting to throw her off balance, but Catra took it in stride. She only half means the flirting she's directed at Catra… the Half-Moon Princess is extremely attractive, Adora isn't blind, but the likelihood of *that* happening was next to none.

Catra clearly doesn't plan to take her eyes off of Adora at any point during this Ball and that is exactly what Adora wants. She was counting on the fact that she is the Horde Lord and Catra would assume she was up to something and try to get to the bottom of it.

Truthfully, Catra seemed almost amused by Adora's teasing, even if she wouldn't admit to that. There was always this energy between them when they interacted, and Catra couldn't hide that little spark in her eyes. Still, Adora hadn't expected her to focus on her all night quite as strongly as she was. "You're really going to act as if you have nothing in mind?" Catra asks, looking at Adora in utter disbelief.

Adora regards Catra fleetingly, she knew it annoyed Catra to no end to be ignored and if there was anything she liked to do, it was annoying Catra. "Oh, I have plenty of things in mind, would you like to hear some of them?"

"I would like to hear what evil plan you have." Catra clarifies, probably knowing that Adora would take the unspecified question and run with it.

Adora pouts at Catra nipping her opportunity to have some fun in the bud. She turns to her, seeing her mismatched eyes essentially glare holes into her. "You're obsessed with me Kitten, can't I just be out here to enjoy the Princess Ball? I have an invite you know?"

"First of all, I'm not obsessed. Second of all, no you're not. Both you and I know that you're not here to simply enjoy Princess Prom." Catra rolls her eyes at Adora. She opens her mouth, clearly about to say something else, but is interrupted by Frosta making the announcement that the first dance of the night was starting. "Of fucking course..." Catra grumbles.

Adora half smirks when she hears the announcement, she turns fully to Catra and extends her hand. "Care to dance, Princess?"

"...Fine. But only to keep an eye on you." Catra places her hand in Adora's and maybe it was a trick of the light, but Adora could've *sworn* Catra was blushing.

Adora leads Catra onto the dance floor, easily making her way through the crowd who seemingly parted to let her through - probably had something to do with her status as Horde Lord. She sees more than a few people glaring at her, but no sign of Scorpia, Lonnie or Kyle. *Good. They must be getting on with the plan while all eyes are on her* - plus she'd seen the Sparkle Princess arguing with her friend before, too distracted to pay attention to Scorpia or the others. Rookie mistake. Adora feels confident in her plan. Reassured. And she has *all* of Catra's attention right on her.

She stops in the middle of the dance floor and turns to face Catra. In the light that had dimmed somewhat at the announcement of the dance, Catra looked even more stunning than when Adora had seen her upon entering this place. The lights caught the gold threaded into her outfit perfectly and her eyes were glowing slightly in the dark.

Adora smiles and lays her hands on Catra's hips. "You know, the Horde teaches its cadets ballroom dancing. Supposed to be good for coordination and such. Can you believe that? A bunch of Horde soldiers learning to dance? But it's true." Adora wanted to get more inappropriate with her touching but she opts to instead run her hand down Catra's arm before she takes her hand in her own, to lead the dance. "I used to have two left feet, I had to practice every day, or I paid the price."

"You'd pay the price? For being unable to dance?" Catra asks. She slaps Adora's hands when they get a little too low for her liking. "I mean, it does help with endurance and coordination. Dancing is actually one of my favourite hobbies. Though it is kind of hard to imagine you having two left feet since you're leading the dance right now. Rather well, actually, though I hate to admit it."

"You dance, Catra?"

"How do you think I became so quick on my feet, idiot?"

"Figured you learned that running away from me in battles." Adora shrugs as she pulls Catra a little closer, her large hand feels almost too comfortable against the small of Catra's back.

"Running away from you? You mean like you ran away from me four days ago?" Catra rolls her eyes.

"Excuse me? I did *not* run away from you."

"So what was it that you did then?" Catra grins, knowing that she had hit one of Adora’s nerves.

" *Obviously* I was performing a sound tactical plan and seeing if you'd watch my ass as I ran away," Adora says simply, trying not to laugh at Catra's surprised expression. "Pretty sure it worked."

"As if. I was *not* looking at your ass. I was too busy laughing as you ran with your tail between your legs." Catra scoffs. Adora's pretty sure she's lying, but what are you going to do? "But, sure, call it what you want. We both know you ran away because the Rebellion was winning." Catra probes her, trying to get another rise out of her to combat Adora's previous attempts to make Catra seem like the coward between the two of them.

"I could crush the Rebellion in seconds if I wanted to."

"So why haven't you, *Lord Adora* ?"

"Because unleashing She-Ra would go against everything I stand for," Adora moves closer to Catra's face, so close that she could pick up the scent of the perfume she was wearing, "and maybe I want to give you guys a fighting chance."

"And here I thought that you would do everything possible to win. You all aren't afraid to fight dirty, so I don't see why you wouldn't use She-Ra." Catra points out. She glares at Adora but, for a moment, Adora swears that she sees *something* there before Catra refocuses her attention into a scowl.

"... I'm protecting you from her."

"Protecting *me* ?" Catra looks at her, clearly confused *who* exactly Adora meant when she said she was protecting someone.

"Protecting *everyone* ." Adora states. She can feel herself slipping a little, feel her mask of confidence and bravado giving way to her anger and her... Adora looks away. "You wouldn't understand."

"...Then help me understand."

Adora shakes her head. She couldn't possibly explain this to Catra, she's a Princess herself after all, she'd *never* understand. Instead, she moves her hand lower and gives Catra a teasing

grin again. "I'm sure I can make you understand a lot of things, if you gave me the chance." Adora whispers, suggestively, aiming to fluster Catra more than anything. The attempt seems to work, to an extent.

Catra's cheeks fluster slightly and she frowns at Adora. "And what exactly are you trying to make me understand?"

"How about the fact," Adora says quietly. She moves her lips to Catra's ears, moving inches from her face, she could feel Catra's heat pressed up against her that it almost had Adora herself blushing, "that you seem to find me *so* distracting. All your attention is on me, Kitten."

Catra shivers as Adora's warm breath caresses her ears. Her hands, which had come to rest on Adora's neck, shook, just a little. "My attention is on you because you're planning something." Catra hisses, though her soft blush takes much of the bite from her words.

"That sounds a lot like an excuse." Adora says quietly but, truth be told, she's enjoying being close to Catra and dancing with her.

"It's not. It's the truth." Catra frowns deeply, staring straight into Adora's eyes. "...what are you planning?"

"You keep asking me that."

"And I'll keep asking until you answer me."

Adora groans and then she spins Catra away from her before pulling her back in. Her arms wrap around Catra's waist and her front presses to Catra's back as she sways to the beat of the music. She hooks her chin over Catra's shoulder. "I already told you. I'm not planning anything. Princess Frosta didn't seem to have a problem with it, why do you?"

"Because I don't *trust* you. You haven't given me any *reason* to trust you." Adora knew that Catra was being affected by being pushed up against Adora, in her warm embrace, it was obvious from the way she was blushing, to the slight tension in her body. Catra was trying so hard to resist her, rather than giving in to her temptation.

Adora laughs a little at Catra's response. She trails her fingers down her hips, *suggestively* , before she turns Catra back around. She takes her arms in her hands and guides them to rest on her broad shoulders while she rests her own hands on Catra's back. "Okay, fine, maybe I am planning something."

"What is it then?" Catra narrows her eyes, obviously waiting for Adora to answer her question. Her cheeks were still flushed from when Adora had had herself pressed up against her back, and they seemed only more flushed with the way Adora's hands had rested on her hips. "Come on, tall, blonde and handsome. Why don't you tell me?"

"Where's the fun in that, Kitten?"

"Don't call me Kitten, asshole." Catra hisses, though this time, there seems to be a mixture of annoyance and almost fondness in her voice - if Adora wasn't mistaken.

"Let me tell you what I think," Adora says, leaning her head forward so she was nearly touching Catra's to her own, "I think you *like* this little game of ours. You *like* my attention on you, you don't even care that practically everyone, including your friends, have been staring at us since you took my hand." It's a shot in the dark but Adora is trying to get a read on where Catra actually is, because this feels... intense, in a way Adora hasn't experienced before, and it doesn't fully feel like it's because they're so-called 'enemies'.

" *A game* ? You think this is a game?" Catra raises her eyebrows at Adora's words. "I'm here to keep an eye on you, and that's it. Truly you need to get over yourself and bring that big ego of yours down a notch. It's pretty damn close to getting as big as your forehead." She bites back, a smirk on her lips.

Adora scowls and leans back a little. If she's honest, that did kind of sting. "Ouch... that was just plain mean." Adora points out. "Thought you princesses were uppity about your moral ethics, and here you are attacking someone who has come to *neutral* ground and done *nothing* to hurt you. I mean, really Catra? That is *low* ."

"As if you haven't gone much lower than that, Blondie." Catra rolls her eyes at her. "And you basically admitted that you're planning something. The question now is, what?"

"Maybe I'm planning on seducing you so you'll sleep with me and then I'll have your undying loyalty, who knows?" Adora jokes, knowing full well that Catra would blow a gasket.

" *Ha* ! You're crazy if you think that's gonna happen."

"I don't know Kitten, your eyes have been *all* over me."

"Oh please. Stop flattering yourself." Catra huffs, letting Adora dip her down as the dance continues. "Like I've said for the millionth time now, I'm keeping an eye on you because I know you're planning something."

Adora holds Catra in the dip before pulling her back up and spinning her out at arms length. "Yeah, you're right. I am." Adora steps back, releasing Catra's hand, she glances down at her watch before looking back at Catra with a smug smirk. "Any minute now."

Catra's eyes widen. "What do you mean any minute n-" She was interrupted by an explosion going off, sending everything shaking and even throwing her off balance. "What the fuck?!"

Adora laughs, unfastening her blazer.

"Guess not even *you* saw that one coming, huh Catra? Maybe you're not as smart as I thought you were." Another explosion rocks the castle. "While you were so busy keeping your eyes on *me* , Lonnie, Kyle and Scorpia were planting heat bombs around the castle."

"Are you *serious* ?! Oh, I am *so* going to kick your ass!"

"Not if you want to save your precious people." Adora winks as another explosion goes off, causing debris to fall from the ceiling. She could hear Frosta yelling for people to remain

calm over the general panic in the room of people screaming in fear. "Anyway, I gotta run Kitten." Adora says as she turns away from her slightly. "Guess you have to choose what's more important to you? Catching me? Or saving everyone at this ball?"

* * *

"Guess you have to choose what's more important to you? Catching me? Or saving everyone at this ball?" Adora grins and Catra feels her blood boil. *That stupid fucking- Why is the Horde Lord so stupidly attractive?* Catra growls as she sees the woman turn tail and run, she's half tempted to run after her, but she can't.

"Go after her! I'll help here!" Glimmer appears out of nowhere, like she often does, and gives Catra a confident nod that makes Catra reassured that she will keep her word. She begins sprinting after the Horde Lord, it's a little hard since her current clothing isn't made for running, nor is it made for fighting, but she's fast, all Magicats are, and Adora seemingly almost enjoys the chase.

They come face to face at the back of the Palace, Adora with her hands in her trouser pockets looking casual and cool and fucking *relaxed* . It's infuriating. " *Adora* ." Catra says firmly and Adora does that stupid smirk of hers.

"I'm flattered that I'm more important to you than those Princesses at that dumb Ball." Adora says smugly and Catra raises a brow.

"Glimmer has that covered." Catra responds coolly. She knows Adora finds it irritating when her teasing is thwarted, and she does see her pause before the woman snorts.

"Please, Glimmer?" Adora raises an eyebrow in a mocking way. "What's she going to do? Sparkle at it?"

Catra extends her claws. "I'm bringing you in."

"Oh yeah? You and what army, Kitten?" There's that *godawful* nickname again. Catra wants to scratch her eye out for even daring to continue to use that. Like, *seriously* ?!

"I don't need an army to beat you." Catra says dismissively. "Your plan already failed, Lord Adora."

" *Pffft* ," Adora scoffs. Catra isn't blind, she's well aware of how attractive the Lord of the Horde is, and she is - she is *extremely* attractive - but she's also, you know, *evil* , technically speaking. Still, what a shame someone so hot is the leader of something so *bad* . "I did not fail. I *never* fail."

"Really? Because you've lost a bunch of battles before." Catra almost laughs when she sees Adora scowl at her in disapproval. "Why are you doing this?" Catra asks. "Hurting innocent people? Why? Is your heart so cold that you don't care about anyone other than yourself?" Adora scoffs again at that.

"Innocent people? This is Princess Prom, Kitten, no one here is innocent, *especially* Princesses." Catra could scream. She was *that* frustrated with Adora's answer. And she means it. Catra can tell that she means it.

Catra shakes her head. "What about all those towns and villages that got caught in *your* rampage, huh? Princesses aren't innocent but *you* are?" Catra sees Adora's hands ball into fists and her eyes flash with anger. Catra gets the impression, as much of a smug asshole she is, Adora has some *serious* anger control issues.

"That's-! *Ugh* ! We're at *war* , besides, you rebels always evacuate towns when my armies roll through." Catra shakes her head in utter disbelief.

"You think we always manage to get there on time?! We don't, and sometimes people get *hurt* . Civilians. People who aren't princesses and have *nothing* to do with the war!" Catra tears up in frustration, her teary eyes looking at Adora.

For a moment, Adora's anger dissipates and she looks, to Catra at least, like a different person. She turns her head to the side in slight curiosity. "What do you want from me Catra?

Princesses... they're violent instigators who can't control their powers, I- I know that myself, why do you think I never transform? She-Ra is too powerful, too out of control, but me? I can control myself, the Horde's mission has always been to bring order, that's all I'm trying to do."

Catra freezes for a moment. It is so easy to forget that Adora was once a Horde soldier. She was raised like any other Horde soldier, brought up on false truths, taught to *believe* , to follow orders without question. She is a soldier. From birth to now. She hasn't known anything else. And that... that softens Catra. She's helped plenty of defecting Horde soldiers to know that deep down, even as the Lord of the Horde, Adora is just like them. She's the same scared soldier as any of them, and maybe she deserves some sympathy for not realising the things she was taught from *birth* are all a lie.

Catra walks up to Adora and places her hands on her shoulders. "Do you hear yourself? *Us* ? Violent instigators? We never attacked you until you invaded Rebellion towns and villages, causing harm and damage. You're calling *us* violent instigators and yet here *you* are blowing up the castle of an eleven year old. *You* . You're causing violence and chaos, not the Princesses." Catra can see the fear, the confusion, the utter refusal to believe what she's hearing, reflected in those... *beautiful* blue eyes.

"The princesses are dangerous." Adora repeats. "They can't control their powers. I want to protect Etheria."

Catra sneers. " *Protect* ?! You're *destroying* Etheria!" Adora's face smooths back out, a perfect mask of stoicism. "You can't even think on your own... you're just saying whatever crap they taught you." Catra's ear twitches as Adora's lip turns up at the corner in a lopsided smirk.

"Sorry Kitten, but you really should be more careful about who you get close to... and also who might be standing behind you." Catra opens her mouth to ask what the hell she means by that when she feels a sudden *sting* in her back. She instantly feels woozy and drops... right into Adora's arms.

Her vision starts to darken at the edges but she sees Adora's right hand woman, Scorpia, looking slightly concerned down at her. "Gosh, she's just so small, Boss, maybe my venom was too much?" Scorpia asks.

"She’s fine." Adora says dismissively.

Catra's ears wiggle when she catches the noise of what she assumes is a drop ship. *Shit*. She's being taken. *They're taking her. Fuck*. She's paralysed and losing consciousness *fast*. There's no way out of this. The last thing she sees before she's pulled under is Adora's bright baby blue eyes looking at her with, what Catra thinks is, a shred of concern, and her silky voice saying: "Guess my plan didn't fail after all, Kitten."

Entangled with the Enemy

Chapter Summary

Catra feels like shit. That's the best way to put it really. Her head is pounding, her mouth feels like it's been shoved with cotton pads, her ears are ringing, it's like a hangover times one thousand. She sits up and instantly regrets that decision. She feels dizzy and disoriented. Her senses are beginning to kick back in and her natural instinct of fight or flight activates without her permission. Unfamiliar. Bad. Wrong. Metal is such a shitty design choice, does the Fright Zone not have an interior decorator? Catra is shocked (she's not).

She snorts at the joke before she realises what that means. She’s in the Fright Zone.

Chapter Notes

You're about to find out why this fic is rated explicit. The WIP title of this chapter was Sin City, so that should really tell you everything that you need to know ;) Enjoy!

Warning, NSFW ahead.

See the end of the chapter for more notes

Catra feels like shit. That's the best way to put it really. Her head is pounding, her mouth feels like it's been shoved with cotton pads, her ears are ringing, it's like a hangover times one thousand. She sits up and instantly regrets that decision. She feels dizzy and disoriented. Her senses are beginning to kick back in and her natural instinct of fight or flight activates without her permission. *Unfamiliar. Bad. Wrong. Metal is such a shitty design choice, does the Fright Zone not have an interior decorator?* Catra is shocked (she's not).

She snorts at the joke before she realises what that means. She’s in the *Fright Zone.* Her fur bristles, standing on end, as adrenaline starts to take its effect. She groans and then lays back down on the metal floor, taking relief in the cool metal. Maybe metal wasn't such a bad design choice after all.

Catra stays like that for a while before she smooths the fur on her tail down, and her other fur, and pushes herself up to her knees. She's more alert now, the more she's conscious the more

she feels less like death. She spots a cup on the little sink in her cell and grabs it, filling it with water. She hesitates. She doesn't exactly know if the Horde lace their water with stuff but it would explain how most of those soldiers are brainwashed. Catra decides to risk it and downs the water, far too parched to care.

She wonders what time it is, what day it is, how long she's been here, how to escape. She feels a little more sluggish than usual but the water is helping and she's sure whatever venom she was injected with is being burnt up by her highly effective Magicat immune system.

Her mind instantly kicks into gear. She needs to escape. Find a way out. All the walls are sealed. No windows. She turns to the door, which is some kind of green forcefield, and then- Catra's fur bristles all over again, and she drops her empty cup to the ground when she sees a familiar person standing at that forcefield. Adora. *Lord* Adora.

Though maybe Adora is a better way to describe her because she looks different. She's dressed casual, though casual for Horde soldiers is still semi-uniformed. She's wearing a white t-shirt, sporting a small Horde symbol in red on the left side and with red patterns cut out of the sleeve and down the front - Catra imagines there's an even bigger symbol on her back - it’s tucked into some cargo pants that are just loose enough to be considered casual yet tight enough that Catra can make out the muscles of Adora's thighs quite effectively.

She stands with her hands behind her back and her hair is down, though half up in a bun still to keep the hair from her face - she still has that stupid hair poof though. Catra wonders if Adora is always such a soldier. Not a hair is out of place on her uniform, she stands so straight Catra would be concerned for the recurring back pain that would cause but that would mean actually caring about Adora. Still... it's different to see the Horde Lord unarmoured, casual, more Adora than Lord.

Her blue eyes look amused, even through the headache-inducing green of the forcefield. Catra suddenly feels embarrassed. "Did you just... did you just see all that?" Catra asks, gesturing vaguely to the floor.

"You mean you patting your fur down on your tail and moaning and groaning? It was very cute." Adora responds with a teasing note in her voice. Catra's cheeks burn with embarrassment but also... she's a little flustered by Adora calling her cute. It's not her fault her senses told her that she was in danger - and also Magicats have the natural instinct to groom themselves when they first wake up.

Adora looks... softer, more open, that's probably some ploy to get Catra to open up. It's not going to work. Still, Adora is the only thing standing between her and her freedom. "Any chance that you'll let me go?" Catra asks hopefully. She can see Adora laugh through the forcefield. She brings her hand up and presses it to something and suddenly the green wall separating them is gone.

Adora is beautiful. Seriously. Catra wishes she wasn't the leader of the Horde, if she weren't, Catra may have even taken a shot. She's She-Ra, Catra is reminded. A Princess. A *brainwashed* Princess. Adora had said how she didn't use She-Ra, too afraid of her power, and Catra believed that wholly. Adora was afraid of She-Ra, like the scared Horde soldier she was.

"Ah yes, because my plan was to kidnap you and then immediately let you go." *Oh. The Horde Lord has jokes apparently.* Catra rolls her eyes and dusts herself down. Her clothes are practically ruined after the ordeal she's been through.

"Is it? Because that would be *so* fantastic." Catra responds sarcastically. "It was worth a shot. I imagine you want something from me? Since you put all the effort into nearly destroying an 11-year-old's castle to get me. So out with it. What do you want from me?" Catra watches the Horde Lord shift and roll her eyes - clearly her guilt trip didn't work.

"I don't want anything from you."

"Sure, because I am totally going to believe that." Catra raises an eyebrow, crossing her arms over her chest. "You want to make this easier for us both and tell me why you kidnapped me? Aside from obviously wanting to be a pain in my ass."

"You have an attitude, you know that? Most people wouldn't mouth off to their abductor." Despite that, Adora did seem to find it somewhat amusing - if the way her lips were quirked up a little at the edges was anything to go by. "I kidnapped you because you're the Rebellion's tactician, are you not? So I don't want or need anything from *you* , I just need to keep you away from the Rebellion."

Catra shakes her head, stretching a little to regain more feeling in her muscles. "Who knows. Maybe I am, maybe I'm not. That being said, what can I do to get you to release me?" Adora narrows her eyes. She looks around for a moment before she shakes her head with a little laugh.

"Nothing. What could you possibly offer me that gets me to release you? You have nothing I want, nor anything that I need." Catra turns her head to the side. The Horde Lord has obnoxiously flirted with her in the past... she wonders how deep that infatuation goes and maybe if she can use that to her advantage now.

"Nothing? Not even... *me?* " Catra asks suggestively. The Lord's reaction is almost immediate and Catra fights back a laugh. Her eyes widen almost comically and she looks almost scandalised for a half second. She clearly struggles for words, opening and closing her mouth several times before she responds.

"... What?" Catra's ears perk up slightly as she notices that she has clearly captured the Horde Lord's attention with her words.

"I noticed that you were quite... *flirty* during the Ball. Not only that, you were also… pretty bold with your hands while we were dancing." She pauses for a moment to consider her next words. "Tell you what... I spend one night with you... us together in any way that you like, and you let me go. No strings attached and no sneaky attacks. What do you say?"

Adora blinks in disbelief. "Are you... are you serious?" Catra chuckles a little. Honestly, Adora is kind of... cute.

"Only if you let me go afterwards." The letting her go part is very important to this after all. She can justify giving herself to the Horde Lord if it's to escape... *right* ?

"No way, I can't... I'm not going to sleep with you, that's like... *insane* ... and also probably some kind of crime." Catra sees Adora blush at her words before she clears her throat. "Anyway... no."

"You act as if you haven't already committed a crime by kidnapping me, Lord Adora. Plus, I'm giving you my consent." Catra licks her lips as she steps closer to the blonde. "You're blushing... I do have to say... you are pretty cute." Catra doesn't know why she confesses that last part, only that she can tell she's making Adora flustered, which she really thinks is some kind of achievement. Usually Adora is so obnoxiously cocky, sometimes that cockiness really works for her, other times, Catra finds it extremely annoying. She finds she rather likes seeing the Horde Lord *squirm* .

Adora narrows her eyes a little. "Kidnapping you and sleeping with you are two very different things." That's true at least. Catra moves her tail to purposely tease at Adora's leg and the blonde swats at it. Catra is having a great time actually. Making Adora flustered might become her new favourite activity if she wasn't careful.

"Maybe." Catra concedes. "But at least sleeping with me would be consensual." Because Catra certainly didn't choose to be *kidnapped* . She rolls her shoulders, stretching her muscles more. Now that she was awake, talking, moving, she was feeling a lot better, a lot more alert. This was a good plan, if Adora agreed to it. Adora looks... unsure, a little conflicted, but considering it at the very least.

"You really want to sleep with me? *Me* ? Lord Adora." Adora bites her lip for a moment. "How do I not know you'll stab me in the back during or something?" Catra almost laughs at that question.

"You mean like how you did to me at Princess Prom when I didn't even attack you? You don't." Catra admits. "But I don't go back on my promises once I make them. So I promise you that I won't try to hurt you so long as you keep your agreement that after, you let me go." Catra shrugs. It's a risk, for both of them. Catra could easily hurt Adora with her claws, especially if her pants are around her ankles, but Catra could also sleep with Adora only for her to imprison her later.

She can see Adora thinking it over. Probably thinking about all the effort she went through only to release Catra however many days later it's been. If it's even been days? Catra has no idea. She should really ask that at some point.

"No." Adora says simply. "I can't do that, you having sex with me so I'll let you go, even if you give me your consent... I don't like it. So... you can go. Sleep with me or not. Whatever. You can go. If you still want to do it, then... I'll let you go after too." Now that was

interesting. Catra hadn't really expected that. Not only was Adora willing to let her go with no sex, after everything she did to get her hands on Catra, she was also willing to sleep with Catra and still let her go after.

Catra knows what option she should take but... there's something about Adora. Maybe one night won't hurt? Maybe she just needs to get her out of her system. There's always this weird sexual tension whenever they face off on the battlefield. Maybe this would relieve that and they could go back to hating each other later.

Curiosity killed the cat.

"... Where should we go?"

But, hey, *satisfaction* brought it back.

Adora lets out a breathy laugh of surprise as she regards Catra curiously. "My throne room." *That shouldn't be as sexy as it is.*

"Okay, show me the way." Catra holds out her hand, waiting for Adora to take her and lead her out of the cell. She stares at her hand for a moment and then looks back to Catra.

"Are you... sure?" Adora asks, and it's kind of sweet if you ask Catra but she isn't about to say that to Adora's face.

"Lord Adora, I was the one who suggested it first. I'm sure. You have to admit... you're curious too. Are you not?"

"Obviously I'm curious." Adora takes her hand. "You sure you can handle me, Kitten?"

Catra smirks softly at the question. "I'm sure I can handle you just fine. Just like I do every time we're out on the battlefield."

Adora scoffs as she tugs on Catra's arm, pulling her along towards her throne room. "Please. You do not *'handle'* me on the battlefield." Catra rolls her eyes. Adora sure does have a big ass ego. She's lucky it's kind of hot.

"Is that why you had to oh-so *urgently* pull me away from the Rebellion?" She teases, looking around as they walk along. The halls were empty, only the humming noise of machinery surrounding them, combined with the sound of their footsteps. It must be nighttime, that would explain the lack of activity. Say what you want about the Horde but they're still people. They have to sleep sometime.

The Fright Zone... it's dark and stuffy, the air almost doesn't feel real, but also Catra hasn't seen a single window so she wonders if they ever let fresh air into this place or if it's just like this all the time. It’s harsh, and sharp, and hard, and metal, and... depressing. The Fright Zone is depressing. It's a long way off the bright colours of Bright Moon or the lavish castle of her home Half-Moon.

Adora hums as she slows down a little and Catra looks back to her rather than at her surroundings. "You're smart, I'll give you that. Fast. You give me a good run for my money. But I'm still better than you hand-to-hand." Catra gets the impression that Adora has some obsessive need to show off, to prove she's better than everyone else.

"That's only because you use that thick ass armour that doesn't let my claws go all the way through. Otherwise, I would *totally* kick your ass." She squeezes Adora's hand, laughing at the almost offended expression on Adora's face. "You are a pretty good fighter though." Just because she doesn't want Adora to go back on her word if Catra overstepped. Not at all because she likes her. She absolutely *does not* like the Lord of the Horde. She is totally *not* having a reasonably good time with her and she is totally *not* enjoying her company. Catra looks at Adora and then looks away quickly.

Fuck .

"That sounded dangerously close to a compliment, Princess." Catra can't help but laugh at that. Adora. She's something else, that's for sure.

"Maybe it was intended to be a compliment, *Lord* ." Catra responds casually. She watches as Adora turns her head away and she could have sworn she saw the appearance of a smile on her lips.

They arrive at the throne room, finally, and Adora drops Catra's hand when the soldiers at the door straighten up and salute at her. "My Lord." They greet her and Catra can see Adora puff out her chest proudly at their respectful greeting - Catra's already figuring out Adora's kinks from one simple interaction.

"At ease." The soldiers relax immediately. "I'm taking Princess Catra inside for an uh... interrogation. No one is to disturb me until I say so, is that clear? *No one.* " The soldiers nod quickly in understanding. "No matter what you hear, *do not* enter. Am I making myself clear enough?"

"Yes, Lord Adora, understood, sir." They bow and Catra makes a gagging noise that she plays off as a cough when Adora glares at her. Catra smiles innocently when she sees the blonde's narrowed blue eyes. She grabs Catra by her wrist and pulls her into the throne room, making sure the door is closed behind them.

"So... *interrogation* , huh?" Catra asks with a smirk.

"Figured you'd probably be begging and that would explain that." Adora shrugs nonchalantly as she walks further into the throne room. Catra almost chokes. She looks at the blonde, scandalised.

"You seem so sure of yourself and your ability to make me beg." She follows Adora into the room, hands on her hips. The throne room is remarkably similar to what Catra has already seen, except with more Horde symbol banners than any other decor. This place is entirely too green if you ask her. Green and metal, that's the Fright Zone's aesthetic - if you can even call it that.

Catra walks up the many, *many* , steps to the throne and takes a seat on it. It's not a very *kind* seat, if she's honest. "You should probably put a plush seat insert on here or something. Wouldn't want that sexy ass of yours to get flat from this hard metal." Adora blinks and stops whatever it was that she was doing.

"Did you just... call my ass sexy?"

"Yup. Sure did. It's the truth." And it really is. Adora has a *fantastic* ass and those tight yet loose pants are doing her a wonderful justice. In fact, all of Adora is kind of sexy, from the way her biceps strain against the fabric of her shirt, to the way her golden blonde locks fall over her shoulders and the way her baby blue eyes sparkle even in the dim lighting of the Fright Zone. She almost seems too beautiful to be in this setting. Adora has a scar on her left eye, it splits her eyebrow in half and travels just below her eye, whatever or whoever did that was lucky not to blind her. Catra almost wants to ask the story behind it but maybe that's too personal. She wonders if Adora has more scars.

"You're certainly making yourself at home there." Adora comments, bringing Catra back to their present situation at hand.

Catra grins and purrs at the other. "You're not telling me to get off, or shoving me off. So either you're not mad or you like that I'm sitting here." Catra points out. Adora looks down at her, her blue eyes appearing thoughtful.

"No, not mad. My throne is *perfect* for what I have in mind for you."

"And what exactly is it that you have in mind for me, *my Lord* ?" Catra asks and she sees the way Adora responds to her name being said like that. The blonde shudders, obviously pleased to have her title thrown at her like that.

"Your Lord..." Adora mumbles. *Yup* . Catra *definitely* had at least one of Adora's turn on's figured out.

Adora swallows, *hard* , and then lowers herself down so she's inches from Catra's face. Catra looks at her curiously as the blonde tilts her head up by her chin, gently. "First, tell me if you're having second thoughts." Catra looks directly into Adora's eyes, surprised by the gentleness that the Horde Lord was displaying. She smiles softly and pushes herself up slightly, arms wrapping around the blonde's shoulders and bringing her in until their lips touched. That was her answer, and she hoped that that would communicate it to her partner.

* * *

Kissed . She's being kissed.

Adora hasn't been kissed in so long she almost forgot what it was like. She hasn't been touched or held in years, even Scorpia, a hugger, doesn't touch her. Lonely. Maybe she isn't alone, she's surrounded by people, but, she realises, with the warmth of Catra's arms around her shoulders, she's been lonely for a long time. Touch starved, definitely. She shakes a little with the sudden intimacy of being touched and it not being in the fighting sense.

She reaches her arms out and wraps them around Catra's waist, pulling her closer. She kisses her softly at first, taking Catra's kiss as her answer, before the kiss grows more heated with each passing second. Now that Adora has felt the warmth of Catra's touch, she wants to feel *more* . She doesn’t want to be lonely, even if it's only for one night.

Catra is small, which makes Adora's positioning a little awkward to kiss her - especially when she has to lean down to kiss her since she's sitting on her throne. So Adora sinks down to her knees to better kiss Catra at a much more comfortable angle.

Her hands push at the edge of Catra's shirt and she slips them below, running her fingers along her fine fur and skin. Touching. Feeling. *Warmth* . "Not how I expected this kidnapping to go." Adora jokes between kisses. Because it is not *at all* how she saw this ending. She's questioned the ethics of this but this was entirely Catra's choice, she gave her the option to leave with no sex and she *chose* to stay.

Catra lets out a breathy laugh, and Adora swears she hears a slight purr tickling at her throat. Her hands wander along Adora's biceps before sliding down her chest - which, by the way, Adora worked very hard for and appreciates that Catra noticed. "I didn't expect for it to go like this either but I have to say... I'm not mad about it." Catra leans back in, kissing Adora's lips again and gently nipping at them to deepen the kiss. Adora's mildly surprised at how bold Catra is, she already seems like she's forgotten *who* she's kissing.

Catra only pulls away when Adora squeezes her hands at her sides to ask her to remove her shirt. Catra sighs and lifts her arms up, letting Adora take away one of the barriers that was

stopping their skins from touching. She was eager to feel Catra, *really* feel her.

"I think it's only fair if you remove yours too... Don't you?" Catra whispers, her lips just barely hovering over Adora's before closing the space between them again. "By the way... you're a really good kisser." Adora can't help but beam at Catra when she hears that. She's always been susceptible to praise, she supposes.

"A good kisser, huh?" Adora moves her lips to Catra's jaw, pressing kisses along it and down to her throat. "Maybe I should add that to my title? Lord Adora, Really Good Kisser. What do you think?"

"I don't know if that's a valid title to have, Adora..." Catra's breath hitches and she moans softly as she tilts her head back in response to Adora's lips having their way with her throat. "Though I imagine that would be quite the questionable addition to make..."

Adora laughs into the crook of Catra's neck. "If you want my shirt off Kitten," She rises up and leans in close to Catra's ear. "take it off."

"Mm... am I allowed to claw it off, *sir* ?" Catra tests out, ears perked up to listen for Adora’s response.

"Call me that again, and you can do anything you want to me."

"Hm..." Catra grins and her fangs are sharp. Adora tries to not be turned on by how sharp those fangs are but she fails miserably. Catra bites down on her neck, playfully, sending a shock of pleasure shooting right through Adora's body. Her claws shred through her shirt but barely graze Adora's skin. "Yes, *sir* ."

"Fuck..." Adora lets out a soft moan at both the title and the feeling of Catra's sharp claws cutting away at her shirt. Truthfully, Catra could easily slice Adora up right now - maybe that danger was a little bit of a turn on for her. Even so, she didn't think Catra would go any deeper than skin level unless Adora asked her to.

Adora grabs her shredded shirt and pulls the fabric off of her, ripping it even further when it snags in a couple of places. "You owe me a new shirt." That gets Catra to laugh and it is an *amazing* sound. Adora decides, right then and there, she wants to keep on hearing that sound.

Catra presses her lips to Adora's neck and then her cheek, catching her off guard. "You can totally get another one made. Plus, you let me do it and you *liked* it." She whispers in a sultry tone, her warm breath caresses Adora's ear and she gently nips at it.

Well... if Adora wasn't turned on before.

She feels herself blush, though she'd totally blame it on the heat if Catra pointed it out. She wasn't wrong, she had found the claws shredding her shirt thing hot as hell. "I do have to say... you are seriously so fucking sexy." Catra cups Adora's cheek, looking her in the eyes as she shamelessly utters that compliment to her. *Fuck*. Adora is so gay. Like... *so gay* it should be considered a hazard. "I think your pants need to come off too, don't you?" Adora raises an eyebrow at Catra. She may be gay, but she also likes to think she has game.

"No, not until you've taken yours off first at least."

"Pretty sure that's your job to do." Catra lets Adora go from her grip and she stands up from the throne. "Go for it."

Adora looks up at Catra before she shrugs. She wiggles her fingers under the waistband of her pants and then tightens them into a strong grip before she tugs, *hard* . She hears a pretty loud ripping noise. "... whoops?" *Yup* . She *definitely* broke Catra's pants, that was her bad, she'll hold her hands up to that.

"... You owe me new pants, and you do realise that I actually have to go home after this, right?" Catra shakes her head and Adora gives her a small smile to say sorry for ripping her pants. She could tell though, by the way Catra's pupils had dilated, that Adora's show of strength had turned her on.

Adora watches as she sits back down on the throne. She grabs Adora's head by the root of her hair and pulls her in. "Asshole..." She murmurs before capturing Adora's lips in a rough, deep

kiss, her claws digging in ever so slightly. The roughness of Catra pulling her in like that surprises Adora pleasantly and she kisses her eagerly, laughing a little at her words.

"Sorry," She mumbles through kisses. "You can borrow some clothes, just tell your princess friends they made you change." Adora likes to think she's smart, at least sometimes.

"Sounds good... it was hot though." Catra admits, surprising Adora yet again. Catra's lips move to press against Adora's once more and Adora sighs happily. "Seeing you rip my pants off with such ease... has me really... bothered down there."

Adora smirks and wiggles her eyebrows. "Yeah?" She asks, pressing hot kisses down Catra's neck. "You want me to touch you, Kitten?"

"If you think you're getting me to beg so soon, you are so wrong, *sir* ." Catra responds, though Adora isn't convinced. That is her plan actually. To make Catra beg for her to fuck her.

Catra lifts her legs and secures them around Adora's waist, dragging her closer. and Adora's smirk only grows. "Then I'm not going to touch you. Not yet." Adora responds as she kisses from Catra's neck down to her chest. "I think I can work you up enough that you *will* beg me."

"You can try, that's for sure..." Catra moans quietly and her eyes flutter shut as Adora kisses softly down her chest.

"Those claws of yours, don't be afraid to use them." Adora laughs a little when Catra's eyes open and she looks at her with a somewhat surprised expression. "The Horde Lord is into a little sexual torture, is that so surprising?"

"Well... it's more because it technically goes against our agreement. You sure you want me to use my claws?" Catra asks. Actually, Adora has never been more sure of anything in her life. Pain and pleasure... she enjoys that mixture far more than she probably should. Part of her wants to hurt Catra, a dark part of her, and part of her wants to be hurt *by* Catra. She

supposes, growing up in the Horde means she's what people would call 'messed up', and maybe she has masochistic tendencies but so can anyone.

"I don't want you to maul me so badly I can't walk, but yeah... whenever you feel like using them, don't be afraid." Maybe Adora *does* want to be mauled until she can't walk. *Nope. Don't be an idiot Adora.*

"Okay... thanks for letting me know." Catra nods, she does seem a little unsure but Adora imagines it's probably somewhat of a relief to not have to be so mindful of those sharp claws. "Also, I thought you said you were gonna make me beg."

"You-" Adora rolls her eyes but leans up to press a kiss to Catra's lips. "I am. Listen, you say red, I'll stop whatever I'm doing immediately, you need a breather, let me know. That being said, are you ready?"

"I'm ready." Catra expectantly looks at Adora and it makes Adora feel a little nervous. "I'll let you know if I need a breather or if I need to stop. I promise." Adora feels a little better after Catra says that. She knows sometimes she can be a little rough, it's always better to set up a safe word before engaging in any kind of sexual activity.

She nods and then realises she's still in her pants. She wiggles out of those and moves them to one side, out of the way. She returns back to Catra, kissing her on the lips softly. "Well... we've seen each other naked now, I guess there's no going back."

"Hey... you'll let me know if you need to stop too, right?" Catra asks softly, pecking Adora on her lips. The question catches her off guard but... it's almost sweet of Catra to ask. Still, she has a reputation to keep, she isn't about to confess to Catra about how sweet she found that.

Instead, Adora snorts, moving her lips back to Catra's throat. She sucks softly on her pulse point, making sure not to leave marks but teetering close to the edge. She's not an idiot, she knows she can't leave hickies on Catra - not on her neck anyway. "Oh, I will not need to stop." Adora says against Catra's neck.

She moves down, nipping and biting at skin more harshly the lower she gets, knowing it was unlikely the princesses would see those. She kisses between Catra's breasts and rubs her own thighs together in anticipation of getting to spend as much time as she pleases there. "Fuck, you're perfect..." Adora whispers as she brings her hand up to palm softly at Catra's right breast while she lets her mouth work her left.

Catra's response is almost immediate. She arches into Adora's touch, gasping as Adora squeezes and sucks her breasts simultaneously. Adora could practically *feel* the heat between Catra's legs, her core pressed up against her hard stomach, wetness grazing over her skin, begging for Adora to give her what she wanted so much. Catra's eyes slide close and her claws dig into Adora's back as she holds her against her. "You... you flatter me, babe... I... fuck, Adora... Keep doing that..." Adora laughs softly but does as Catra requests.

She marks Catra up good, sucking and licking with her tongue, no one would see but *Adora* would know and *maybe* Catra would look at them later when she finally left and remember her. She moves to her right breast and repeats the action, marking her again, while her hand moves down her back and she scratches softly at the base of her tail. A loud moan leaves Catra's lips, echoing against the walls of the throne room. Adora grins. *Oh yeah, Magicats have that spot at the base of their tails.*

A bright blush covers Catra's cheeks as she seemingly realises the sound that she had just made. Adora holds Catra's gaze for a moment as she continues giving attention to her boobs. Truthfully, Adora could spend forever there and feel satisfied. Catra's body felt hot and she rocked against Adora, telling her how she was aching to be taken by Adora in every possible way. Adora wanted to give her that, but Catra, Catra was stubborn. Adora knew she wasn't going to break quite so easily. Still, the way her claws dragged over Adora's skin, the way she practically squirmed under Adora's touches, Adora was *determined* to *break* her.

Adora moves down Catra's body, kissing her stomach and looking up at her with her blue eyes. She removes her hands from Catra's back to grab her hips, hard enough to leave marks. She pulls Catra forward, closer to the edge of the throne, positioning her legs onto her shoulders. She doesn't go to where she knows Catra wants her the most but instead begins kissing her inner thigh. She smirks a little as she looks up at Catra. "Hmm... look at you Kitten..." Adora uses her best sultry tone as she kisses, sucking on her skin and marking her inner thigh. "All mine for the taking." She moves, her breath brushing against Catra's core before she moves to her other thigh and begins pressing kisses there. "All mine."

"Now you're just being mean." Catra whines out, her voice soft and breathy. Her hips twitch and Adora knows, without a doubt, that she was turning Catra on. "Who said I was yours?"

She asks, still trying to be defiant in an attempt to regain control. Adora couldn't have that.

"Hm, I think I just did." Adora says with a grin. "All mine, Kitten." Adora presses a kiss to the inside of Catra's knee. "I'm going to *make* you mine."

"Then what are you waiting for? I'm sitting here, completely unclaimed, and yet here you are trying to say I'm yours." Catra leans back into the throne, sighing. "I'd say... you're taking too long, *sir* ." Catra was good, Adora would give her that, she knew exactly how to get to Adora. Adora was tempted to do as she said and take her, but she'd already committed herself to making Catra beg her to fuck her before they'd even reached the throne room.

Adora looks up at Catra and raises a brow. "Oh, so you're a *brat* ." She sits up a little. "You know, I think, maybe, I'm not finished with your boobs. Yeah, I should go back to those." A growl escapes Catra as she reaches her hand out to grab at Adora's hair and push her back down.

"No." Adora feels her cheeks redden a little at Catra's stern tone and being pushed back into place. She never really thought she'd be into that but that... kind of awakened something in her. Still, that reaction from offering to suck on her boobs some more? She looks up at Catra and then grins cockily.

"Are you going to beg for me, Kitten?"

"I told you, you could try to make me beg but I'm not going to." Catra hisses, though her redden cheeks really take off some of the edge from her hiss. Adora sees Catra’s eyes light up a little, which makes her extremely suspicious. She knows that look. Catra has an idea.

A smirk crosses Catra's features. She leans back into the throne again, her hands release Adora and she moves one down to her pussy lips, Adora's eyes tracking their every move. "Hey Adora." She moans, eyes half-lidded and all seductive as she showed off her glistening folds to Adora.

Adora really is *super* gay.

"Oh... you play a dirty game, Princess." It takes all of Adora's strength not to dive head first between Catra's legs. Instead, she grabs Catra's wrist, which was currently playing with herself, and pulls her hand to her mouth.

Adora takes her fingers in her mouth, making sure to make eye contact with Catra as she let her tongue do all the work. She pulls away for a moment to speak to Catra. " *Please* , Lord Adora, *fuck me.* " Adora grins and releases Catra's hand. "That's all you have to say Kitten."

"Fuck..." Catra's breath was ragged and laboured and Adora was proud of herself for that move, she won't lie. "Please, fuck me, Lord Adora." She begs, finally giving into Adora. That move that Adora had pulled was so dirty and Catra was clearly too horny to hold herself back any longer. "Make me yours, Adora."

"See, was that really that hard?" Adora asks. Her ego practically fills the throne room when she hears Catra beg for her.

Catra groans and grabs Adora by her face, pulling her up and slamming their lips together - Adora knows Catra sometimes finds her ego somewhat annoying. "Adora... I need you..." She gasps softly against Adora's lips. Catra kisses her one more time and tangles her fingers in her hair.

And who was Adora to deny her?

"Need me, huh?" Adora asks as she moves her hand between Catra's thighs. She had been planning on using her mouth but she was enjoying hearing Catra's soft moans so close to her ear - and there wasn't a reason she couldn't have multiple fun.

She slips a finger into Catra easily, almost too easily, and she can't stop the gasp that escapes her lips. "Fuck, Catra, you're so fucking *wet* ." She adds a second finger almost immediately, enjoying the feel of Catra wrapped around her slender fingers. She moves slowly, just enough to stimulate Catra but not nearly enough to scratch that itch she probably had.

" *Mmm ... ahnn* ... Adora, please..." Catra wiggles her hips as Adora makes her way inside of Catra with her fingers. Catra's lips find their way to Adora once more. Adora swallows her soft moans with kisses until Catra pulls away again. "Faster... it's not enough..."

"Faster... what?"

"You're being mean."

Adora curls her fingers and grins. "Faster...?"

Catra whines, her eyes close and her hips jerk up to get more friction from Adora's fingers. "Fuck me faster, sir... *please* ."

"That's a good Kitten," Adora enjoys teasing but she isn't cruel. She gives in to Catra's demands and speeds her thrusts, curling her fingers just right to scratch that spot deep inside of Catra. "My Kitten..." Adora mumbles. "Think you can take another?"

"Yes, give me another!" Catra moans wantonly as Adora's fingers reach deep inside of her. It's kind of amazing actually. Adora could die right now and she would have zero regrets.

Catra uses the armrests of Adora's throne to prop herself up so she could meet Adora's thrusts with her hips, clearly trying to get *more* from Adora. " *Adora* ... Adora, you're so good. Please don't stop." Adora shudders at the praise. She could hear her name spill from Catra's lips all day.

Her eyes widen a little at Catra's desperate pleas and she easily adds a third finger, stretching Catra wonderfully. She does wonder, for a moment, if her soldiers will question why Catra is saying such things if Adora is supposedly 'interrogating' her, but she doesn't care much when she can feel Catra literally *spilling* into the palm of her hand.

Adora presses the heel of her hand to Catra's clit to provide her with that *extra* stimulation while keeping up her thrusts, making sure to curl, mentally mapping out the shape of Catra's

insides for what she wanted to do to her later. Adora watches Catra nearly scream out, stifling her loud moan by biting her lip when Adora's palm rubs her clit. Adora can feel her walls clenching more rapidly around her slender fingers at the stimulation. Catra attempts to stop her moans by biting her lips but, Adora knows, when she speeds up her thrusts, it's pretty much a lost cause.

Catra's head rolls back, her claws digging into the armrests of the throne that held her steady and she lets out a loud, lewd cry of Adora's name. She whimpers for more, the words falling from her lips soon become a mess of pleas and a mix of Adora's name and cries of pleasure.

Adora turns her head, breathing a little heavily from her effort to keep up her fast and steady thrusts. She feels only encouraged by Catra to keep doing what she was doing, even going *harder* , *faster* , whatever she wanted. " *Mine* ." Adora whispers into Catra's ear. "Who do you belong to?"

"You..." Catra pants quietly, turning her head towards Adora. Adora raises her eyebrows curiously as Catra cups her cheek and brings her in, kissing Adora deeply as Adora felt the tightening of her walls growing more and more by the second. She was close, *so close* . "I'm yours, sir." Catra breathes against Adora's lips. She tenses up and cries out loudly as her first orgasm of the night washes over her.

Warmth gushes out, dripping onto Adora's hand to show her she had done her job well. Adora moves her fingers a few more times, curling occasionally, guiding Catra carefully through her orgasm. She presses soft kisses to Catra's jaw as she comes down and pulls her hand away when she's satisfied Catra is done. She lifts her hand and laughs a little at what she sees. "Wow... you made a mess..."

"Shut up..." Catra replies with a quiet giggle. Adora watches as she tries to regain her breathing after that - Adora did that! *She did!* "That was great, just give me a minute." Catra smiles and sits herself up. Her lips graze over Adora's with a soft purr. "You really got me to beg, huh?"

Adora contemplates what to do with her hand before she decides to wipe it on Catra's inner thigh. She had debated licking her fingers clean, but she preferred to drink from the source so to speak. "I sure did get you to beg," Adora says with a cocky grin. "Did you really think I wouldn't?"

"I was really trying to hold out to get you to do it without me needing to beg. But you are too much of a tease." Catra rolls her eyes, her hand against Adora's cheek while her thumb gently caressed her cheekbone. Adora knows that already. She could tell by Catra's reaction, and she'd almost won too, with that whole show of shoving her hand between her thighs, but Adora is stubborn too and she likes to win. "It really was good though." Catra admits which only serves to inflate Adora's ego more, if she's honest.

"Good, huh? I think it was a little better than good." Adora says with a teasing grin. Catra grins back at her mischievously.

"How about you beg me to tell you how good it was?" Adora snorts and laughs. She doesn't think she's laughed this much in her life as much she has in the past hour.

"Don't need to, Kitten, evidence is all over my throne."

"Hm, true. But isn't it more fun to hear it directly from the source?" Catra asks. Catra reaches her hands up and grabs Adora's shoulders, bringing her close and leaving kisses on her cheek and temple. Adora finds it... she likes it. "I'm good if you want to go again." Adora lets out a soft breath.

"Yeah, I'm definitely good to go again... You wanna beg again?" Adora asks with a cheeky grin.

"I was actually thinking... I could make you feel good?"

"Me?" Adora raises a brow. She hadn't really considered that, she was so used to giving but not receiving. "How exactly would you do that?" Catra purrs and lifts her hand. Adora watches as she gives her breast a soft, but firm, squeeze.

"I'd get down on my knees... and make my way between your thighs, and use my tongue on you in every way you'd want me to."

"Well... fuck... I do love to see Princesses on their knees, submitting to me." Adora mumbles. Catra grins and places a kiss to Adora's jaw.

"Then how about you make your way onto this throne and I go down on my knees for you? You can tell me what you want and where you want it." Adora smiles a little and lifts Catra effortlessly, switching their positions and having Catra in her lap momentarily.

"There's... something I want to try, later... After."

"Wow..." Adora smirks at the fact her effortlessly lifting Catra up was obviously a turn on for her. "What is it? You have me curious now." Catra raises an eyebrow at her, though Adora notices her eyes wandering along her firm arms and gorgeous breasts. "...you're beautiful, you know that right?" Catra asks. That catches Adora completely off guard.

"I have a soldier's body," Adora says dismissively. "That's as much a weapon as my sword." She pauses for a moment. "Speaking of my sword... you know I can transform it into anything I want, right?"

"You're beautiful, Adora." Catra repeats for emphasis, her hands coming up to cup Adora's face tenderly. She smiles and Adora almost wants to believe her. "Can you? Anything? That's a really cool thing to have." Talking about her sword. Adora can do that. Talking about her being beautiful? She can't do that.

" *Anything* , Catra." Adora holds her gaze for a moment, trying to see if Catra would take the hint or not.

"... Is that what you want to use later?"

".... Yes."

"Oh... and you have complete control over it?"

"Completely." Adora whispers. She plays absently with Catra's tail. "Could be fun." Adora shrugs. Catra hums as she closes her eyes and purrs as she allows for Adora to keep playing with her tail.

"I think I'd be down to try that later." She whispers and she gives Adora a kiss, purring. Adora doesn't really know what purring means exactly but she likes it and she thinks it means Catra is happy. Her tail is soft too and Adora finds she quite likes playing with it.

"Okay Catra," Adora says as she kisses the woman on her jaw. "I'm ready." Adora watches Catra closely, her hand buries its way into her hair, scratching just behind her ear. Truthfully, she was a little nervous. Catra was a *Princess* , Adora has no idea why she agreed to this to begin with - other than curiosity and the fact that Catra was willing and wanting herself. She couldn't deny that they had been having exceptional fun so far and she wasn't going to let her paranoia get the best of her. Maybe Catra was a Princess but, if anything, that just reassured Adora she wouldn't break her word - that was a Horde thing.

* * *

Catra grins and turns her head to give Adora another kiss on her lips. She runs her hands along her thighs, showering her in kisses as she slowly and teasingly makes her way down from the other's lips to her chest and further south. Her eyes never look away from those soft blues that stare at her in interest. Catra wasn't really sure what Adora was thinking but her goal was to make her feel good.

"Hey..." Catra whispers softly against Adora's navel, lips pressed to her skin. "Where do you want me? You never told me." She reminds her, moving down to her thighs, grinning before biting down on the supple skin just enough to leave a mark and to draw a noise out of Adora. "Mmm, so... where do you want me?" Adora was a teaser but Catra could play at that game too. Adora was amazing actually. She wasn't sure how she expected the Horde Lord to be in bed but it certainly hadn't been that - Adora had *wildly* exceeded all of Catra's expectations.

Adora visibly clears her throat and she tugs a little on Catra's hair. "Your tongue. Use your tongue."

"Hmm, I think you need to be more specific, babe."

Adora scowls down at her. "Use my title and maybe I will be."

Catra giggles, biting down on Adora's thigh again. "Now... why would I do that?"

"Because..." Adora looks far away as she speaks, like she isn't certain where she is, it's kind of really cute actually - the *mighty* Horde Lord gay panics. "Because I am your Lord... you should show some respect." Catra purrs softly, her tongue gliding against the bitten skin.

"But you're mine. I think I'm allowed to call you my baby..."

"Yours?" Adora raises an eyebrow, looking down at Catra. "No. You're *mine* . I don't belong to anyone." Catra pouts softly up at the blonde.

"I don't think that's very fair, babe." She whispers as she brings her lips so close to Adora's centre before trailing back up until their lips are almost touching. "Don't you want to be mine, *sir* ? Don't you want to belong to your kitten as well?" Adora leans forward and presses their lips together, completing Catra's wish, though she seems to be thinking.

When she leans back from the kiss after a moment, she gives Catra a half smirk. "Catra," She gently, yet firmly, places her hands on Catra's shoulders and begins to push her down. "get back on your knees." She wraps her hand around the back of Catra's head, her fingers tangling with her luscious long locks. "If you want me to be yours, then I guess you'll have to *make* me yours." That... that was entirely too hot.

Catra has said this before, but it really is a shame that Adora is the leader of the Horde. She is Catra's type in pretty much every way possible: tall, sinfully gorgeous, her muscles are big yet lean, her blue eyes are like the sky on a clear summer's day and her blonde hair is golden like the sun. She is quite literally, drop dead gorgeous. She's like forbidden fruit. Catra shouldn't be taking a bite (literally) but she can't seem to find the willpower to say no.

"You want me to make you mine? Why didn't you just say so?" Catra grins, letting Adora push her back down because, hey, she's already here, she might as well savour the taste of that forbidden fruit. She grabs hold of Adora's legs, bringing them over her shoulders and kissing her clit once she was able to access it. "You're gorgeous. I can't wait to taste you." Adora bites her lip in what Catra is sure is an attempt to keep from moaning out, and fixes Catra with a disapproving look.

"You talk too much. Maybe you should put your tongue to *actual* use?"

"Say please." The look on the Horde Lord's face is the best thing Catra has ever seen in her entire existence.

Adora lets out a huff of laughter. "You can't be serious."

"Why would I be joking?" Catra grins, kissing just above Adora's clit. "Come on, baby. Say it for me." Two can play at the teasing game.

Adora lifts her hips a little in response to Catra's words and in an attempt to bring Catra's mouth closer to her. "I am *not* saying please."

"Nope. You have to say it. Otherwise, I'm not giving you what you so badly want." Catra presses a kiss to Adora's inner thigh, resting her head on it to wait. "Well?"

Adora narrows her eyes, probably trying to see if Catra was being serious or not. She pauses for a long moment, and Catra sees it in her blue eyes when that stupidly hot Horde soldier realises that Catra really is being serious. "Why do you need me to say it so badly? Isn't it enough that I'm willing and wanting?"

"Because I'd find it *really* sexy if you said please to me." Catra trails her claws along Adora's thigh, turning her head to press her lips against the inner side. "But if you really don't feel comfortable saying it, I won't force you, okay?" She reassures her partner, smiling up at her. "Just let me know if I'm pushing too far at any point." Catra isn't an asshole. Sure, she wants

to hear Adora beg, just a little, like she made her beg, but if Adora isn't comfortable with that then she won't force her to do it - and Catra definitely gets the sense that Adora is uncomfortable with it.

Her reluctance doesn't seem to be stubbornness or brattiness; she seems genuinely uncomfortable with confessing to Catra how much she wants her. Maybe her words are a little soft for what they're doing, this is a one night stand after all, but consent and making sure your partner is feeling good and comfortable are important no matter who they are - even if they are the Horde Lord.

Maybe Adora feels like saying that makes her almost too vulnerable, which is dangerous, the last thing they need is to feel vulnerable around each other, and yet Catra can see her considering it. Maybe they can't trust each other on the battlefield, but they can at least trust each other in the bedroom (throne room?) sense. Catra wouldn't mind Adora being vulnerable here, just like she doesn't mind it either, she almost *wants* it which is scary. Adora... makes her feel a lot of things that should be concerning considering who she is.

"What if instead I tell you that I want you?" Adora interrupts Catra's thoughts with her words before she pauses. "I want your tongue on me, in me, pleasuring me. I would like that a lot, if you would like to give me that." Catra almost chokes at how hot Adora's words were, her heart skipping a beat in her chest.

She nods, grabbing Adora's legs again and securing them over her shoulders before diving in, tongue first, into the wetness which flooded the blonde's core. She moans as it coats her tongue, lapping slowly at first, occasionally pushing into Adora's entrance to earn a gasp from her. Catra can hear Adora moaning softly and gasping though she can tell she's obviously holding herself back. Why Adora can't just let herself loosen up and be vocal Catra doesn't know, but she's far too distracted with her mouth to call her out on it.

Catra's tongue works her expertly. She feels Adora push her closer with her large hand and she begins to move her hips a little, grinding against Catra's face. "F-Fuck... you feel so good..." Catra glances up to see Adora's mouth has fallen open a little and the blonde lets out a louder moan this time when Catra presses her tongue into her entrance. "Right *there* , Kitten..."

Catra's claws dig into Adora's thighs, telling her to keep still while her tongue did the work. The sounds that Adora was releasing were travelling straight down, leaving herself dripping.

But that didn't matter, her focus was on getting those pretty sounds to continue coming out of her lover. She speeds up her movements, leaning in further and wrapping her lips around Adora's clit, sucking on it to further pleasure her.

She works to alternate between lapping the blonde's juices and sucking at the tender bud that called for her. Catra was enjoying everything about this, the taste, the sounds. All of it was amazing, and she loved that she was the one to do this for Adora. Adora's breath hitches and Catra's pretty sure it's in response to her claws digging ever so slightly into her hips.

"How are you..." Whatever Adora was about to say is interrupted by a sudden moan that escapes her lips when Catra sucks on her clit *just right* . She clearly forgets whatever question she was about to ask and finally seems to relax, letting Catra pleasure her relentlessly. "My Kitten..."

"Mm... yours." Catra murmurs against her pussy before continuing to work eagerly to push Adora off the edge. She could feel how her lover's hips shook beneath her hands, and how her walls tensed around her tongue, the more she sped up. "Delicious..."

"Catra, *fuck* , I-" Adora ignores Catra's message to stay still from before and beings moving her hips again, clearly too desperate to chase her release than listen to Catra. Catra could tell she was close, she could feel her walls clenching around her tongue. Maybe it was a little fast, but Catra gets the impression it's been a while since Adora did anything close to this. Catra also knows her tongue is pretty amazing: warm, hot, dexterous and *wonderfully* textured. "Keep going." Adora pleads.

Catra purrs and does as Adora instructs her to do. She wasn't going to stop until the blonde gushed on her tongue and cried out her name. That was a promise she was making to herself and to Adora. She knew that the blonde just needed a little push to get her there.

She wraps her lips around the other's clit, sucking on it and letting her tongue massage the sensitive bud, eyes up to keep track of Adora's reactions. Adora falls backwards, unable to keep herself upright as Catra works her over. She rests on her elbows to look down at Catra, holding her intense gaze. Catra feels Adora push her even closer, grinding her hips harder and faster against her face in an attempt to reach that peak she was chasing. "Dig your claws into me a little... *please* ."

Catra nods and digs her claws into Adora's thighs deep enough to draw blood, moaning against her core and continuing to lick her juices. Adora practically melts into a puddle, moaning Catra's name - Catra could get used to that. Almost instantly, Catra feels Adora's release when she digs her claws into her thick thighs. Adora yells Catra's name so loudly it echoes off of the metal walls of the throne room. She pants above Catra as Catra moans and laps at Adora's flowing juices, taking as much as the blonde was giving her before slowly pulling away.

She gives the blonde kisses to her thighs once more, massaging them to calm her down. "How was that?"

Adora lifts her thumb in a thumbs up, a dopey smile on her face. "You're pretty good..."

Catra laughs at her reaction, beaming up at her. *Dork.* She was almost proud of the fact that she had left the Horde Lord a useless puddle on her own throne. Also, the being told she was good at something didn't hurt. "Good to know that I made you feel good. You okay?"

"I am *so* okay." Adora grabs Catra by her wrist and pulls her up, adjusting so Catra can climb into her lap. Adora begins to kiss her along her jaw. "Have you done this before?" Catra purrs at the kisses, wrapping her arms around the blonde and enjoying the attention thoroughly.

"A few times."

"A few times..." Adora hums curiously as she gently runs her hands over Catra. "Hm... yeah? They any good?"

"I have to admit, I don't think anything could top what we just did." Catra confesses, because she *really* doesn't. Nothing she has ever done with anyone else has ever been *that* good.

"Unsurprising, I'm the best at everything I do."

"I think you might need to calm your ego down just a little bit."

Adora grins. "Unlikely."

"Asshole." Catra laughs and kisses her lips. "So..."

"So..." Adora agrees. She seems more relaxed, boneless even, maybe a little more open than she had been before. She strokes Catra's back gently, running her fingers through her short fur and soft skin. Catra smiles at the softness in which Adora was treating her with. She purrs happily, shifting a bit to get more comfortable before laying against Adora's chest.

"This is pretty great... didn't think this would be how things would turn out." Catra admits, again.

Adora hums as she presses kisses down Catra's neck. "Me neither... almost forgot you were a Princess." Adora teases with a grin. "I can get my sword, or I'd really enjoy tasting you too?"

"Whichever you'd prefer. I told you, I'm yours for this evening." Catra blushes a little when she says that, but it's true. Adora looks thoughtful for a moment.

"How about both?" Adora asks. "Can't exactly use my sword if you're not worked up enough to take me."

"Mmm, well, Adora... getting to see you all worked up, got me worked up." Catra admits, comfortably snuggled against the other. She's practically a waterfall down there if she's honest.

"Oh *really* ?" Adora digs her fingers into Catra's hips a little, tickling her. "Is that so?" Catra giggles and wiggles her hips at the ticklish sensation.

"Yeah, your sounds were… really nice." Adora blushes a little, which Catra finds adorable, and then sits up. She lifts Catra and places her down on her throne again before standing up straight. She wanders off a little to go retrieve her sword.

* * *

Adora returns to Catra with her sword in her hand. She frowns in concentration, transforming it into what she desired, along with a harness. She stops for a moment and looks at her hips which had red angry lines down them. "Wow... you scratched me up real good, Kitten." Adora comments. She steps into the harness and tightens it until the toy was in the perfect position that she knew would pleasure both of them.

Adora turns and sees Catra's breath get caught in her throat for the second time that night as she watches Adora slide on the strap. Her eyes drop to the scratches and Adora doesn't even try to hide her smirk. "Yeah... I did... it looks sexy." Catra says, slightly distracted. Also stings, Adora likes that about it.

"It felt good." Adora confesses. "I liked it." She drops on her knees in front of Catra, opening her legs as she does so. "Now, I plan to have my way with you again. I think I'll taste you first before I use my sword."

"Yeah?"

"Yeah." Adora grins and then lifts Catra's legs around her shoulders. She wastes no time, diving in with her tongue like she needed to taste Catra *right now* lest she die.

Catra wasn't wrong, she was clearly already worked up by the already flowing juices Adora tastes with just a single swipe of her tongue. She moans happily, flattening her tongue to Catra's pussy and humming in satisfaction. She teases her entrance, pushing in a little before travelling up to suck on Catra's clit instead. "You taste so good, Kitten..." Adora says between sucking. She uses her teeth a little, trying to draw as much pleasure out of Catra as she possibly could.

Adora glances up to see Catra bringing her hand up to her mouth to bite down on it to muffle the loud cry that Adora could hear being strangled in her throat. Catra moves her legs so that her heels are pressed against Adora's shoulders, bringing Adora closer to her pussy as her claws dig into the metal of the throne in an attempt to keep herself grounded. Adora doesn't want to brag but, *she did that* .

"Fuck *yes* , *Adora* ..." Catra gasps as she closes her eyes and lets her body fall back into the throne for support. "Baby, yes... just like that..." Adora would be lying if she said Catra saying those things to her didn't seriously turn her on.

Adora smirks into her pussy but does as Catra says, more than happy to taste Catra and explore her with her tongue - though her intention was to not push her over the edge. Since she'd already cum once earlier, Adora was sure Catra was sensitive enough as it was, despite having had some time to cool down, that it would take no time. Adora's hot tongue was working her up so easily, Adora could tell from the way her body was responding to each of her strokes. " *Fuck* ..." She moans out, Adora wonders if Catra has ever cursed this much in her life. *Do Princesses even curse?*

Adora can tell Catra is getting close from the noises she's making and the way her body is tensing. Adora pushes her *right* to that edge, before she stops. She leans back and looks up at Catra, licking her lips and humming happily. "You taste *amazing* ." The sound that Catra lets out when Adora pulls away is pitiful but Adora finds it cute.

Catra pouts up at Adora and reaches up for her, to pull her close again. "Don't stop... *please* ."

"I don't want you to cum yet, Kitten." Adora murmurs as she kisses her on the jaw. She moves her hand between Catra's thighs and presses her fingers into her. She curls them and works them into her a little more before she pulls them out again, her fingers coated in *Catra* . She uses Catra's juices to coat her strap. The sword meant that it was warm, and kind of buzzed with energy. There was something ironic about the fact that Adora didn't use her sword to transform herself but she had no issues using it like this.

Catra whines and Adora looks up at her to see her eyes locked wherever Adora's hands went. Adora tries to not look smug about that. "Adora, please... mmm..." *Unprompted begging, progress.*

Adora could practically read Catra's thoughts from the heat of her gaze. She knows Catra wants her strap, wants Adora to fill her up and fuck her, she also clearly knew Adora was teasing her with the edging, and the using of her fluids to coat her strap, but Adora loved it so much; seeing how *wet,* and *needy,* and how Catra almost looked like she was about to take what she wanted, maybe push Adora down onto the throne and ride Adora until her release, was so fucking hot.

"You want to be a good girl for me, don't you Kitten?" Adora asks and Catra nods her head quickly. "Want me to fuck you?" Catra lets out a mewl and Adora shudders. *Fuck. Yeah.* Adora wanted that too.

Adora thinks about how she wants Catra and comes up with a whole host of positions she would *love* to have Catra in. "What do you want, Catra? Hm? How do you want me? Bent over my throne?"

" *Yes* ! T-That, and to ride... ride you." Catra confesses, moving her hips up to try to tempt Adora to push inside. Adora shivers. Catra wants her so much Adora can practically *feel* her burning desire from where she's kneeling. Adora's own desire burns just as hot.

"You want to ride me?" Adora asks. She likes that idea, *a lot* . "Both, we can definitely do both." She stands and flips Catra over, wrapping her arm around her waist to hold her up and in position. She grabs Catra's tail with her other hand to stop it from moving around and getting in the way.

She pushes into Catra, slowly, she's aware that her sword is a lot thicker than her fingers, but Catra was already significantly worked up enough to take her easily. Once she's buried to the hilt she pauses, focusing for a moment to shift the sword to fit Catra's insides perfectly so it would hit *every* spot inside Catra. "You ready Kitten?" A loud moan fills the air around them as Adora settles flush against Catra.

" *Adora* !" She cries out. She pushes her hips further back against Adora.

"Gonna take that as a yes." Adora chuckles a little as she begins moving her hips back and forth, slowly at first and building with each stroke. She moves Catra with her arm in time

with her thrusts so she could hit her as *deep* and *hard* as possible.

Catra doesn't hold back. She screams when Adora manages to hit the deepest parts of her. Catra's pussy squeezes tightly around Adora's warm strap, as though trying to milk it as much as possible, it feels *incredible* . " *Please... please...* " Catra repeats those words like a prayer, turning her head back to look at Adora with glassy eyes and flushed cheeks. *She's beautiful.* A loud purr echoes from the brunette as Adora continues to pleasure her.

Adora increases her thrusts at Catra's pleading. The sounds echoing around the throne room are just downright *sinful* at this point and her guards probably know that whatever is happening in here is not an interrogation. Adora doesn't care. Catra feels amazing wrapped around her strap. With each thrust, pleasure runs through Adora's veins like liquid gold. She feels hot, almost on fire, and she's loving every second of it. Catra's moans are only challenged by the volume of the sounds coming from her pussy, and the sound of skin slapping together. Adora is sweating with her effort, her abdominal muscles straining and her hips moving at impossible speeds, but she can't stop, doesn't *want* to stop, not until Catra screams out her name and cums all over her throne.

With the speed in which Adora was thrusting into Catra, she could tell Catra was really close to becoming a puddle on that throne. The strap inside of Catra was warm and Adora knew it was probably heating her in all the right places - especially when she adjusted it *specifically* to hit all those places inside of Catra. Adora was fucking her perfectly, she was at least semi-confident of that.

Catra's walls were quickly beginning to tighten around the strap, the grip of them probably making Catra feel the thrusts even more, and so did Adora. The strap rubs her perfectly and the more resistance the more pleasurable it is for the *both* of them. Adora has no idea how many times Catra has screamed her name, how much her claws have scratched into the throne beneath them, but it's *a lot* . Adora doesn't really care anyway; she's there to try and hit Catra at just the right angle, at just the right speed, at just the-

Right there.

Catra screams Adora's name so loudly that her voice goes mute, her pussy clenches tightly around the strap as she squirts onto the throne. Wetness flows down Catra's thighs and coats Adora's strap that still grinds inside of her. Adora continues to fuck her despite the fact Catra was already cumming.

Adora is well aware that Catra has cum, but she doesn’t stop. She keeps going despite that fact, chasing her own high but also determined to drag another one out of Catra. She moves with speed and precision, *in and out* , holding sometimes when Catra mewls, and then dragging out of her, only to ram back in. Catra surely would've fallen into the seat of the throne if Adora didn't have her arm secured around her waist to support her.

Adora could feel her own pleasure increasing, she was so close too, right on the edge, but she wasn't going to let herself fall over until she got Catra to cum again. "That all you got Kitten?" Adora grunts. "I want to see you cum for me again." Adora grabs Catra's hair, pulling a little but not too hard to hurt her. Her hips really don't quit. All that Horde endurance training really paid off. "Come on Catra, *again* ." Catra screams again as her legs shake and soon she's cumming for the third time that night. Catra collapses, the only thing holding her up was Adora's strong arm.

Adora feels herself fall over the edge at the same time Catra collapses against the throne with a loud moan. Adora rocks her hips a few more times against Catra, before she over-stimulates herself and pulls out. She lets go of Catra gently and steps back, looking at the mess they made. Her strap is completely covered in cum and her throne doesn't look much cleaner. Catra looks... out of it, to say the least.

She makes her way back over to Catra and lifts her up into her arms, bridal style. "You still with me Kitten?" Catra mewls, barely conscious at that point, though she begins to wiggle her hips in Adora's arms. Her eyelids flutter for a moment but remain closed as she whines. Adora snorts and places a kiss to Catra's nose - she doubts Catra knows she did that anyway. "You are... so adorable." Adora murmurs. "I think you're done for tonight." Adora says. "I'm taking you to bed."

Catra purrs, managing to open one eye to look at Adora. "Snuggles?" She requests, her voice is hoarse from being overused but still sexy as hell.

"Lucky for you, my room isn't too far away." In fact, her room is literally attached to the throne room. She carries Catra there and places her down onto the mattress of her bed.

Her room was bigger than most officer's chambers, she even had a private bathroom, long gone were her cadet days of showering in groups. Her room was also neatly organised, a

habit she's never been able to break and a habit that she thinks is actually a good habit. Military upbringing and all means everything Adora does is pristine and carefully ordered - plus the order makes her feel in control, which is reassuring. She leaves Catra on her bed to go retrieve some items from the bathroom.

She cleans herself up, running the water of her sink. She steps out of her harness and tosses it, transforming it into her sword again. At least *that* was self cleaning. She takes her necessary supplies from the bathroom and returns to the bedroom.

She sets the items to one side and grabs a shirt to pull on and sleep shorts so she is at least modestly covered. She grabs a t-shirt for Catra too before crossing back over to her with all of the supplies.

She begins washing Catra gently, wiping away the evidence of what they did together - at least the things that weren't a little more permanent. Once she's done cleaning her, she sits her up and pulls the clean shirt on over her head. It's long enough that it covers a lot of Catra's frame and keeps her mostly covered up - plus Adora's pants didn’t exactly have holes for tails, so the bottomless shirt was perfect. Catra lays back down on the bed and Adora hesitates for a half second before she joins her.

Adora grabs the blanket and pulls it over their waists, she leans her front against Catra's back, pulling her in and wrapping her securely in her strong arms, spooning her from behind. "Comfortable?" Adora asks curiously.

"Mhmm... very..." Catra smiles up at Adora and Adora... she'd never admit this, but she feels *something* , something in her chest that is *warm,* and a little gooey, and soft, but, like she said, she'd never admit to that.

Catra turns her head around and leans in to kiss Adora on her cheek, it brings a smile to Adora's lips. "Thank you for cleaning me up, Adora." Catra whispers gratefully. She wiggles around and wraps her arms around Adora, embracing her waist before she buries her face in her chest. Adora freezes for a half second before she melts into the warm embrace. "That was... amazing. I don't know if I'm gonna be able to walk for a bit after that." Adora laughs and finds she rather enjoys Catra's embrace.

"You didn't even get to ride me." Adora points out with a grin. "Maybe... you could stay... for another night... I'll still let you go after we're done. You have my word."

"... Okay."

"Okay?"

Catra nods, purring quietly. "I mean... I'm already here... might as well make the most of it before I have to go back home."

Adora smiles and closes her eyes for a moment before blinking them open again. She was tired too after that... 'interrogation'. "Yeah... that's true." She mumbles. "I would *love* to do that again."

"We have tomorrow." Catra whispers and gives Adora a kiss on her lips. "We have all day tomorrow... I'll stay until night..."

"Okay... not sure you'll be able to stand after a whole day, but okay."

"We are going *slow* tomorrow. I need to get back home sometime soon, Adora." Catra says with a laugh.

Adora chuckles. "*Sure* Catra, whatever you say." She pauses, before she sighs. "Goodnight, Catra."

"Goodnight, Adora." Catra smiles, caressing Adora's cheek while looking her in the eyes. Adora leans in to place a kiss to Catra's lips, probably their softest kiss they'd shared all night. She pulls away and settles down against the bed, feeling exhaustion pull her under.

Chapter End Notes

Now you know why my name is sherassword :P

This was gay -M

This chapter was already written but we felt it was far too long to be combined with Chapter 1, hence the speedy upload, we can't promise the other updates will be quite so fast but we will try!

Denial is Bliss

Chapter Summary

The night turns to day, though one can hardly tell with smog that covered the Fright Zone. Catra's internal clock caused her to stir awake around nine, a soft purr coming from her as she squeezed her pillow and snuggled further against its warmth. Except, her pillow wasn't her pillow, and it was breathing. She finds herself panicking for a moment before she remembers where she was and what had happened. The only thing she found herself able to say was "Oh".

Chapter Notes

We're back with Chapter 3 of Horde Lord Adora AU! I don't want to spoil anything but we had a LOT of fun writing this chapter and so we hope you enjoy!

Warning, NSFW ahead

See the end of the chapter for more notes

The night turns to day, though one can hardly tell with smog that covered the Fright Zone. Catra's internal clock caused her to stir awake around nine, a soft purr coming from her as she squeezed her pillow and snuggled further against its warmth. Except, her pillow wasn't her pillow, and it was *breathing* . She finds herself panicking for a moment before she remembers where she was and what had happened. The only thing she found herself able to say was "Oh".

* * *

Adora stirs in her sleep, pulling the warm person she was currently cuddling closer to her, snuggling against her. "Five more minutes..."

"You're really cute when you're all sleepy." Adora opens a single eye to see Catra smiling at her before she kisses Adora's jaw. Adora blinks both of her eyes open after the kiss.

"Why are you awake? *How* are you awake? Did I not exhaust you enough?"

"I mean, sleep helps me recover. Plus, Magicat recovery periods are shorter, which helps a lot." Catra shrugs.

"... Magicats recover faster?" Adora did not know this but that would explain a lot about Catra - like how she always seemed to be at every battle, even if she had been injured at the last.

"Yes, we do. It's really useful in many aspects." Catra responds.

Adora sighs and rolls over so she has Catra beneath her. She kisses her jaw and her neck before kissing her lips. "Good to know," Adora says. "Are you hungry? We have ration bars, or ration bars."

"Mm... I guess I'll take ration bars." Catra giggles and kisses Adora again, grinning up at her. "I do have to say, you should keep your hair down more often."

"That is impractical in battle." Adora deadpans.

"It looks really freaking sexy though." Adora laughs softly and kisses Catra's jaw again before she pushes herself up.

"If it distracts you, I suppose I'll consider it." Adora grabs her com-pad that was on her desk and dials Scorpia's extension.

"Hey Boss! Good morning!" Scorpia greets cheerily as soon as she answers. Adora rubs her face. "Oh... did you just wake up? Are you sick? Oh no, I'll bring you some soup-"

"I'm not sick! ... Scorpia, we don't have soup." Surely Scorpia misheard her.

"Ration soup... it's like... watery ration bars."

"That is so unbelievably disgusting, if I am ever sick, *never* bring me that." Adora grimaces at the thought. "I'm not sick, okay, but I do need you to bring me breakfast times two."

"Times two?"

Adora sighs and glances at Catra briefly. "Yes, okay... I have a... guest. They need food."

"Oh..." And then her eyes light up with realisation. " *Oh* ! Of course, Lord Adora, I will get you your breakfast times two, for you and your guest." Scorpia winks and Adora groans.

"Thank you, Scorpia..." Adora says. "I'll see you in a minute." Scorpia salutes on the screen and Adora hangs up, turning back to Catra. "Food is on its way."

"I heard. She seems nice, you know, for someone who stung me." Catra sits up. "So I'm a guest?"

"Well you're not a prisoner... I let you go... even if you're still here."

"True. It's just nice to hear. Now, I don't know about you, but I think some kissing is in order while we wait for our food."

"Hm..." Adora turns her head to the side. "Do you?"

"I do. What do you think?"

"I think... maybe... an *appetiser* before breakfast?"

"Yeah? An appetiser you say?" Catra asks. Her eyebrow is cocked and she’s giving Adora a *look* .

Adora hums as she rolls Catra onto her back, lifting the blanket up and disappearing below. "Got to say, my decision not to put pants on you was an excellent decision." Adora's voice comes out a little muffled as she pushes the shirt up and begins kissing the inside of Catra's thighs.

"Mmm... oh yeah... I can see that." Catra giggles and Adora feels her hand reach to grab her head, running her fingers through Adora’s hair. "How long do we have till Scorpia gets here?"

"Unclear, didn't give me a time frame, guess I'll have to be quick." Adora answers.

"Guess so. Better hurry up before she bursts in here."

Adora laughs softly and follows Catra's orders. It was too early for her to tease too much anyway. She explores with her tongue, not really sure where she was, given how dark it was under the covers, but she feels her way around. She decides to focus on Catra's clit, sucking between hard and soft strokes that she feels has Catra *squirming* under her mouth.

"I seriously don't know how you figured out where to touch me so quickly- *hnnn* ." Catra giggles, though it mixes with a quiet moan as Adora applies suction around her clit. Adora pulls her mouth back with a pop.

"I'm a fast learner." Adora answers. She gently caresses Catra's hips, pushing her fingers between Catra's back and the mattress. She scratches there softly as she goes back to work with her mouth. Catra moans while tugging at Adora's hair to bring her closer to her pussy - which Adora *totally* smirks at. Catra gasps and sighs, squirming beneath Adora's touch and her mouth as Adora slowly worked her up.

"I s-see that." She groans quietly. The way that Catra was responding to Adora made it sound as though she was already on the edge. "You're doing amazing..."

"Amazing..." Adora mumbles. She moves her mouth down to Catra's entrance. She pushes her tongue in and moves one of her hands from Catra's back to her clit instead, stimulating that while using her tongue at the same time. Catra moans in need and Adora can hear her panting, even through the fabric of the blanket, as she grows closer to cumming.

"Fuck, fuck... *fuck* , Adora." Adora doubles down in her efforts, rolling Catra's clit between her knuckles and moving her jaw at almost painful speeds, moving her tongue as much as she could in order to pleasure Catra. She hums, hoping the vibrations would provide the extra stimulation she needed.

Catra's walls quiver around Adora's tongue before warmth gushes from her. She cries out Adora's name as she cums, gently tugging at Adora's hair to steady herself. "Ha... orgasm one of the day." Catra giggles breathlessly. Adora smiles as she catches Catra's juices in her mouth, moaning softly at the taste that floods her senses.

She stays there for a moment, making sure to clean all of Catra up, before she lifts up and kisses Catra, allowing her to taste herself on her tongue. She pulls away after a moment. "Orgasm one of x amount." Adora confirms. "That was... Nice..." Catra grins and kisses Adora back eagerly.

"It was pretty damn good, yes." She kisses Adora's cheek and then the other. "How was your appetiser, sir?"

"Perfect." Adora says, without missing a beat. "You really do taste amazing... better than ration bars at least." Adora says playfully.

Catra snorts and kisses her again. "Seriously? Pussy tastes better than ration bars? Are you guys okay?"

"I'm sorry, but pussy tastes better than *anything,* I'm pretty sure."

"Hmm, I mean, yours did taste pretty nice. That's for sure."

"Pretty nice?" Adora gives her a mock offended look. "I think you mean, the *best* thing you've ever tasted and, 'thank you, Lord Adora, for letting me go down on you'."

"See, someone needs to keep your ego in check though. So I'm not giving you all of that." Adora opens her mouth to retort when her door suddenly opens.

She yelps and grabs her pillow, covering Catra's face as she turns to look with a death glare at whoever just entered her room without her permission. Her scold dies in her throat, however, when she sees who it is. "Scorpia!" She yells in surprise. "Maybe knock next time! I told you I had a guest!"

"Are you... trying to suffocate her?"

"What? *No* !" Though Adora doesn't remove the pillow. "Just... put the food on my desk?" Catra whines and laughs under the pillow, grabbing the blanket to cover them.

"I'm fine!" Catra calls out to Scorpia, reassuring her from beneath the pillow. Adora smiles a little awkwardly. Scorpia just looks confused, and mildly concerned, before placing four ration bars on the table.

"There you go, Boss. Sorry about that. There was a line to get breakfast." Adora sits up a little.

"Did you get the grey kind?" Scorpia knows they're her favourite so she's almost positive she did. "Also, I need you to take over my duties for the day."

"I did! Your favourite, as usual." Scorpia looks surprised to hear Adora's order. "Are you feeling okay, Boss? Is it because of your guest? Can I meet them?"

"Uh, I think you might wanna wait until Adora and I are fully dressed before that happens, Scorpia." Catra comments, pillow still on top of her face, which is mildly amusing to Adora.

"You say that like we're going to get dressed today." Adora comments lightheartedly.

"True, but I don't think Scorpia needs to see all of our bits today."

Scorpia looks curiously at the two, not having left the room yet. "Boss... your guest sounds really familiar."

"Can I take the pillow off of my face now, Adora?" Catra asks.

"Does she sound familiar?" Adora asks. "I think the pillow look suits you, Kitten."

"Kitten..." Scorpia says, before her eyes widen. "You only call one person that..." Adora winces.

"Can I take the pillow off *now* ?" Adora sighs and takes the pillow off of Catra's face - which is accompanied by a big dramatic gasp from across her room.

" *Princess Catra* ?!"

"Hi Scorpia." Catra says with a wave, holding the blanket up to her chest to make sure her body was fully covered - Adora really wishes she wouldn't if she's honest. "Thank you for bringing us food. That was really kind of you."

"Of course!" Scorpia beams happily. "Adora gets grumpy when she hasn't eaten, *grumpier* , but you didn't hear that from me." Scorpia laughs joyfully and winks in an obvious and exaggerated way.

"I can literally hear you." Adora says, rolling her eyes. She stands up and approaches her desk to grab the ration bars. "You can tell Catra is a Princess, can't you?"

"You mean... because she has a Kingdom?" Scorpia asks.

"No... well... yes, but also, she covers herself up." Adora smirks as she turns to look back at Catra. "Such modesty, Horde soldiers are raised with *zero* privacy, we're not too shy with being naked around each other." Catra raises an eyebrow at her and hums.

"And here I thought you'd want to be the only one to see me naked." She says teasingly, sticking her tongue out at Adora. Adora can't deny that that's... kind of true, but she's under no illusions about their relationship to one another.

Catra looks to Scorpia, smiling at her. "Yeah, I've realised she's a little grumpy, but I think she's pretty nice when she's not as grumpy as usual."

"She is nice!" Scorpia responds enthusiastically. Adora huffs. "Not a lot of people see that side of her, but we're best friends, right Adora?" Scorpia smacks Adora's shoulder and almost sends her flying.

"I told you to stop hitting me like that." Adora grumbles - it bruises her ego *and* her shoulder. "We're... comrades." Adora says awkwardly. She's always been bad at confessing when people are important to her. That comes with the territory of being a Horde soldier, she supposes. She has been taught since birth that feelings make you weak and vulnerable and it is a habit that is hard to break or disprove. Adora remembers all too well when she allowed her personal feelings to be taken advantage of which resulted in her being hurt and her… hurting people. Scorpia *is* her friend, but Adora can't say that out loud so she awkwardly sidesteps it instead.

"Aw, that's a nice way to say best friends." Adora shakes her head. Clearly, Scorpia had no issues like that - Shadow Weaver was clearly *not* her superior officer.

Adora goes back to her bed with the food. "So yeah, I need you to cover my duties, it should be a slow day anyway, we didn't have anything planned." Adora says.

"Understood, Boss." Scorpia beams and salutes Adora. "I'll leave you two to enjoy your day. Don't have too much fun. It was nice meeting you properly, Catra!" Catra giggles and waves at Scorpia as she leaves.

"Nice meeting you properly, or as properly as this situation is, too Scorpia. Have a good day."

Adora rolls her eyes as Scorpia leaves the room, her door closing behind her. "She's... something."

"Hey, she's nice for someone who stung me. She seems like a sweetheart." Catra laughs softly, shaking her head and, well, Scorpia *did* sting Catra, so Adora figures that's fair. "I can't believe you shoved a pillow into my face though."

"I panicked!"

"I noticed."

"Whatever, eat your ration bars." Adora says. "Scorpia... is about the only person I trust completely. Not that I'd ever tell her that out loud."

"Aww, you should let her know. That actually encourages people." Catra grabs the ration bar and Adora watches her carefully. Catra looks at it curiously before taking a small bite. She coughs and almost gags at the taste. "This... is what you guys are expected to eat?" Adora laughs.

"It's not so bad. They're made to give you all the nutrients you need, not to taste good." Adora happily munches away on her own ration bars.

"They... taste pretty gross, Adora."

"Be thankful they're not the brown kind."

"The brown kind is worse?!" Adora snorts and nods her head.

"Oh yeah... one time, when I did something I wasn't supposed to do, Shadow Weaver made me eat only the brown kind for like... two weeks." Adora frowns a little at the memory. That had been a terrible week, she'd almost wished Shadow Weaver had taken her food away from her than made her eat the *brown* ration bars.

"That... that's a horrible punishment. Next time we see each other, I'm handing you a bag of snacks or something because this is... something else."

"Next time we see each other? Are you planning on throwing a bag of food at me in battle?" Adora teases.

"I genuinely just might be considering that." Catra lifts up the ration bar. "Anything in particular you want me to throw at you?"

"Not really." Adora shrugs. "Hey, those ration bars gave me these." She flexes her biceps for show. Catra looks at her for a moment, only to roll her eyes.

"Which are lovely. But I promise you, food can taste *so much* better and still give you all of this. If not, more."

"What's the point? We only have ration bars here because the Fright Zone... can't support life," Adora shrugs. "We have no economy, we're literally all soldiers, so outside trade never happens, and ration bars are easy."

"Oh..." Catra looks almost sad for a moment, which Adora doesn't fully understand, and then her expression shifts to thoughtful. "Do... you have engineers here? What if you created artificial indoor farming?" Adora narrows her eyes a little in suspicion.

"Yes, we have engineers, but we don't exactly have farmers, and I'm not planning on committing troops to learning how to plant potatoes." *Was Catra trying to trick her into weakening her army? Farming? Of all the tactics? ... surely not.*

"You say that, but you have no idea how far good food can go." Catra hums quietly. "Plus, farming can actually help with the smog situation that you have outside since plants help filter the air."

"Why do you care?"

"Huh?"

"Why do you care about us eating 'good food' and helping the 'smog situation'? You realise we're supposed to be enemies, right?" Adora asks because Catra sounds like she might actually care. *Princesses and their bleeding hearts.* Something about it wasn't sitting right with Adora, it was rubbing her the wrong way.

"Just because we're enemies doesn't mean that you, and everyone here, doesn't deserve to have good food and air that isn't threatening to suffocate them." Catra flops back down on the bed after putting her ration bar aside. "Being enemies doesn't make you all any less of a being that is equal to me." Adora doesn't believe what she's hearing.

Adora lets out a sound close to a laugh, though maybe it's more of a scoff. "You're a Princess, Catra." No way Princesses consider themselves equal to people when they're in their stupid castles and with their dumb powers. *They think they're high and mighty, and they're full of themselves, and they're dangerous, and-* Adora was spiraling.

"And? What's your point? I'd still think the same way even if I wasn't a princess." Catra turns to look at Adora. "You all deserve proper food and clean air. Nothing you say to me will change my mind about that."

"Think whatever you want to think." Adora shrugs. "We're used to it. Don't fix what isn't broken."

"Okay, fine..." Catra pouts while she looks up at the ceiling. "... should I not have a bag of snacks with me for next time I see you then?"

"You can do whatever you want to do." Adora says ambiguously. "You should eat your ration bars though, we don't waste in the Fright Zone. You'd get in trouble for that if you were a cadet... also... you take every meal you can get when Shadow Weaver is your commanding officer." Shadow Weaver. If Adora missed dinner and happened to mess up in training, she could go hungry for days. Adora doubts Catra has ever gone hungry in her life, or been withheld food as punishment.

"Can't I just give it to you?" Catra suggests. Adora shakes her head. *Princesses. Catra can't even stomach a ration bar.* "Shadow Weaver sounds like a bitch. That's for sure."

Adora frowns. "She... was complicated." She dislikes talking about Shadow Weaver because her emotions about it all conflict her. She's not even sure she knows how she feels about Shadow Weaver. Shadow Weaver was the closest thing she had to a mother and she… Adora wasn't going to think about that.

"Seems like it. Do you want my ration bar though?" Catra asks.

"Well, if you're not going to eat it." Adora finishes off eating and moves the empty plates away, back to her desk. "Now, what do you want to do Princess?"

"Cuddles while you let your food settle?" Adora snorts but agrees, settling down beside Catra.

"I really enjoyed going down on you this morning." That, at least is true, Adora wasn't sure she would ever get tired of going down on Catra.

"I enjoyed having you go down on me, that's for sure. It's... going to be weird going back home after this." Adora frowns a little at that.

"Is it?" Adora asks as she pulls Catra to her chest in order to snuggle closer to her.

"Yeah... we've... kind of been acting completely different to how we have in the past." Catra points out, curling up against Adora.

"Maybe..." Adora trails off for a moment. "We've never had sex in the past."

"That's true. But you're being way less of a pain in my ass than before." Catra is *teasing* her, Adora smiles a little at it. Catra moves her lips to Adora's neck and starts kissing her there. "It is going to be weird to go back to fighting, thinking about how you completely wrecked me with your sword." Adora laughs.

"I can still be a pain in your ass but I don't think I'm into that." She teases. "It's only weird if you make it weird."

"You're telling me you're not gonna see me on the battlefield and immediately remember all of this?" Catra asks. Honestly? Adora hadn't really thought that far ahead.

"I never said that, I will *definitely* remember going down on you, but this is... separate." Right now they're not the Lord of the Horde or Princess Catra. For all intents and purposes, they *are* different people now. When they see each on the battlefield, Adora is sure they can keep their entanglement separate.

"...I guess it is." Catra seems... *off* when she says that. Adora examines her closely. She looks like she usually does... Adora doesn't know if she's expressed how beautiful Catra is but she is, she is probably the most beautiful person in existence. Her lips are plump and perfect for kissing (*Adora can attest to this*), her mismatched eyes are striking, they even glow in the dark, and shine in the light, her long hair is held back in a low ponytail with her bangs falling over her forehead. Her ears are downright adorable and her tail is cute too, and that's not even

mentioning her body. Adora was never going to forget. She was intimately familiar with Catra's body now, from her legs to abdominal muscles and biceps. She knew how soft Catra was in places, like her thighs, her fur and how it was thinner in certain places and thicker in others. She's probably what all those people mean when they say perfect.

Adora notices Catra's mood change and gently nudges her. "Hey... I just mean... you know... here we're not at war, or anything. We're just... us..."

"Yeah... we're just us." Catra smiles slightly and closes her eyes. "I... like how that sounds."

"Scorpia is right... not a lot of people see my nice side." Adora admits. *Is that really her fault though? Some people seriously are the most irritating people to deal with.*

"Yeah? Well, you're... really sweet. Though very playful."

"Playful? Is that a bad thing?"

"Not at all. It's cute, actually." *Did Catra just call her cute? Adora? Lord Adora?*

"You're not as stuck up as I thought you'd be for a Princess." That actually *is* a compliment, though Adora doesn't know if it comes off that way. Catra seems unphased by it, however.

"Yeah? How stuck up did you think I was, babe?"

"I don't know, most Princesses seem to have sticks up their asses... I definitely didn't see you agreeing to sleep with me though." Adora admits and she means it. The Princesses thinking they're better than everyone else didn't come from nowhere. Catra likes to say Adora's ego is big, but Adora has seen Glimmer before.

"I was literally the one who offered... I just didn't think we'd end up like this." Catra whispers, her fingertips trailing along Adora's exposed bicep.

"Like this?" Adora repeats curiously.

"Cuddled up the following morning."

Adora sighs and buries her nose against the side of Catra's face. "Yeah... that was all you, by the way."

"I don't hear you complaining." Catra purrs and giggles, Adora's nuzzles probably tickling her slightly. "I could go now if you want me to."

Adora raises her brows. "Unless you mean another round, I don't think you need to leave just yet."

"Good to know." Catra hums and closes her eyes again. "Nah, let's just relax for a minute. You have the day off, I'm here. Might as well take a bit of time off, and then we can have more fun later."

"I am more than okay with that... although... I wish you had eaten more." Adora says with a frown. "You know... there is contraband in the Fright Zone... I never... had any but... it exists, if you're hungry." Adora is *only* offering because she knows how one can be on an empty stomach - not at all because she cares.

"You sure?" Catra looks up at Adora. "Do you want to try it together?"

" *Pffft* , no..." Adora says. "For you only. I don't eat Princess food."

"It's not Princess food. Everyone out there eats it too." Catra stands up, holding out her hand. "You wanna go get it? Or do you have it somewhere here?" Adora lets her eyes trail down Catra's body, drinking in the sight of her. She takes her hand, only to pull her back down into the sheets which causes Catra to squeak.

"No offence Catra, but you're naked, and I ripped your pants. Stay here." Adora stands up and makes herself look presentable. "I have a whole bunch that's been confiscated. Anything in particular I should be looking for?" Catra laughs as Adora stands up to get dressed.

"You should also bring me a pair of pants for later. But really, anything is fine. Just, different things." Adora rolls her eyes playfully.

"I don't know, I happen to *really* like the pant-less thing you've got going."

"I said they were for later, dummy. Now get your cute butt moving." Adora makes a show of sticking her ass out playfully and winking before exiting the room to go hunt down that contraband.

Adora hurries across the throne room, she knows that no one was around but her anxiety of being seen so... civilian looking, had her on edge - she couldn't have her soldiers knowing she was a real person after all.

She makes her way to the room where all confiscated goods are brought. Most are actually illegal weapons, Rebellion weapons or goods, but by far the biggest is the food. Maybe Catra had a point when she said that the ration bars were disgusting. Adora grabs an empty box and starts grabbing a bunch of random food, not really sure what the hell she was grabbing but hoping something would appeal to Catra.

Once she's satisfied with her box she starts to head back to her room. On her way, she stops in her tracks when she sees someone who looks an awful lot like her looking at her. Adora is about to ask how the hell they got into her throne room but she is all too aware of how they did that when *they look like her* . “Double Trouble,” Adora scowls. “I told you to stop doing that.” They start to shift out of Adora’s form and into their regular one. “What are you doing here?” Adora asks.

“All business no pleasure.” DT says with a pout and Adora scowls deeper at them. “Relax, I came to give you a report.” Truthfully, Adora had almost forgotten that she even had DT active in the field.

She glances towards her bedroom door, worrying her lip between her teeth. “Can we do this later? I’m a little busy.” Adora points out.

“Princess Prom? Oh I heard and *saw* it all, darling,” Double Trouble was so dramatic, even more so than Adora was herself. “Quite the show, I must say, *dramatic,* disappointed you didn’t invite me for the fun.” DT pouts as they circle Adora curiously. When they come back around the front of Adora, they’ve shifted into Catra. “Want me to fill in the place of Princess Catra?” They ask. “I could learn so much about the Rebellion as her, and it would be the role of a *lifetime* .”

“No.” Adora deadpans and looks away. DT may look and sound like Catra but it is all *off* if you ask her - which is weird when Adora thinks about it, she doesn’t even know Catra that well but… DT’s voice is just a little off. “Catra… escaped.” Adora lies. DT turns back to their usual self, which Adora is relieved about.

“Well that’s no fun,” They say and Adora wonders why she employs people like DT, people who care more about the fun than the actual job they were hired for. “How’d the kitty-cat escape?” They ask curiously.

“Someone dropped the ball, look, DT, don’t worry about the mission okay?”

“Don’t worry about…” They trail off. “Darling, what on Etheria are you talking about? I am the best you’ve ever had.”

“You didn’t need to phrase it like *that* .” Adora points out, scrunching up her nose.

“I *am* the best you have.” That’s true at least. DT’s special talents to shift into anyone really comes in handy - though Adora had given them specific instructions *not* to throw a limelight on themselves, which they so often did.

“Fine, you can… continue your mission but… just… be careful.” Adora says. DT looks at her sceptically, which Adora bristles a little at, before they shrug.

“Very well darling, I am curious what you’re doing with all that… Rebellion food, is it a cheat day?”

“What? No, I… Dismissed, Double Trouble.” Adora says firmly.

“So grumpy, okay, okay, I’m going.” DT spins on their heel and bows as they move towards the throne room doors. Adora pinches the bridge of her nose before she carries on towards her bedroom.

* * *

Catra laughs, grabbing the blanket and wrapping it around herself. She stands up from the bed, finally getting to take a look around Adora's room. "It's... cold, surprisingly." She murmurs to herself, though she wonders if she truly felt cold or if it was because she wasn't cuddled up to Adora anymore.

She had been given the opportunity to get a brief look at the Fright Zone when Adora had brought her over to the throne room, and then her bedroom, but the jitters from knowing that she was about to go to bed with the Horde Lord didn’t allow her to focus on the looks. Now that she could look on her own time, everything just seems… cold and lonely. It was nothing like her room back home. There were no pictures, hardly any colour, except for the cold greens and metallic greys, it felt more like the cell she had been in just a day before instead of a personal bedroom.

Curiosity gets the best of her and she continues exploring the room a little more. There isn’t much after all, all that was there was a small closet, that held Adora’s clothes, a chest of drawers, a entrance to a bathroom, a small vanity, a little desk and the bed. How Adora could call the Fright Zone *home* was beyond Catra - this place seemed about the furthest from a home as one could get.

Catra looks up from where she was brushing her hair with a comb she had found. She hoped that the blonde didn't mind, but the last thing she wanted was for her hair to be matted. She hears the door open behind her and she turns. "Welcome back, Adora." Catra welcomes, purring as she sees the blonde carrying a rather large box. "Oh! What did you find?"

"I am Lord Adora, I provide for my people... and also one Princess apparently." Adora presents the box dramatically and then places it down on the bed for Catra to examine. *What a huge fucking dork. Seriously.* Catra can hardly believe this is the same woman who burns down and destroys towns and villages.

Catra giggles and ignores the box for a moment, placing her hands on Adora's shoulders and pulling her down to kiss her lips in gratitude. "Thank you, that was sweet of you to do." She whispers and purrs graciously before turning her attention to the food. "Now, let's see what we have here. Oh! These are pretty good. They're vanilla. And I love these, they're donuts! Seems they were brought recently too. Wanna try some?" She asks, with a big smile on her face and her eyes sparkling.

Adora smiles a little, that cute half lopsided smile she has. "... I don't know..." Adora eyes the food suspiciously. "I've never had anything other than ration bars."

"I promise they taste really good. Here, I can take a bite first if it makes you feel more comfortable in trying them." Catra opens the wrapping of a creme donut, purring happily at the sight of the treat. She takes a large bite, moaning softly and closing her eyes. "Man... I love these donuts, they're some of my favorites. Want to try it?"

Adora raises an eyebrow and smirks a little. "I recognise that moan." She teases. "...Feed me?"

Catra blushes slightly and licks her lips as she holds the half-bitten donut up to Adora's lips. "Here..." Adora grabs hold of Catra's wrist softly, probably to keep Catra’s hand steady, before she leans forward to take a bite of the donut. She makes an obvious attempt to make it kind of sexy, by grazing her lips over Catra's fingers, but, really, she fails miserably - it is, however, *incredibly* endearing.

Her blue eyes light up and she looks at Catra with surprise. "Whis wis rweally gwood!" Adora exclaims, mouth still full. Catra beams and giggles at Adora's reaction. *She couldn’t even wait to swallow before she said that, dork.*

"I know right! Like I said, they're some of my favourite donuts to eat. You want to try something else?" Catra asks curiously because Adora's reaction was entirely too cute *not* to see again.

Adora actually swallows before she speaks again and she nods. "If they taste as good as that, absolutely."

"I told you you'd like them, dummy." Catra nuzzles her cheek, gesturing for Adora to sit down on the bed and settling in her lap as she reaches to look through what else was in the box. "Wanna try something salty?"

"I don't know what that is but yes." Catra grabs a bag of crisps, opening the packet and taking a chip out, holding it up to Adora's mouth. "Try this then." Adora wraps her arms around Catra and takes the offered food into her mouth, crunching. She seems to take a moment to let the taste settle before she makes a decision on if she likes it or not.

"I like it... it's different to the... the donut."

"Yeah, like I said, it's salty. Though these are what we call junk food. They're usually prepackaged and not as nutritious as home cooked food." She explains softly, nibbling on a chip herself.

"Junk food?" Adora frowns. "Food that comes from trash?"

"No! No! That's not why it's called junk food at all." Catra shakes her head, biting her lip to not laugh out loud. *Oh Adora. Beautiful, naive, Adora.* "The reason why it's called junk food is because it's not the greatest thing to put in your body in large quantities, since it's not the healthiest. But in moderation, it's okay."

"That is a stupid name." Adora says with a frown. "But I think all of the contraband is... junk food."

"That's okay. It's just to try it out. It's not like you're planning to eat it everyday." Adora snorts.

"Maybe I will now. You've corrupted me. Before now, I only knew ration bars and pussy." Catra cackles and can't help but poke Adora's forehead. That is an extremely *Adora* thing to say.

"Yeah? I mean, I still suggest trying to do that whole artificial farming thing."

"You don't quit with that do you?" Catra could tell Adora felt… irritated by her suggestion before. She knows Adora's ego is big, she's probably awful at taking criticism or suggestions, so she's not too surprised that she appears reluctant, to say the least, to do something Catra, a Princess, has suggested. The *proud* Horde Lord. Still, it really is a good idea if you ask her.

"It's just a suggestion, Adora." Catra kisses her forehead to placate her. "You don't have to do it if you don't want to. But your reaction to *actual* food was enough for me to want to encourage it more."

"I don't have the supplies to commit to that any time soon. We are in the middle of a war."

"That's… true..." Catra frowns slightly at the reminder of just who she was bedding and what situation they were in. She sighs. "You wanna pick anything from the box that seems interesting? I'll tell you what it is." Adora laughs a little and kisses Catra's jaw which makes her feel slightly better.

"I brought this food so *you* could eat."

"You can still try it out." Catra points out with a pout.

"I know, but I ate my ration bars *plus* yours, you've barely eaten." Adora peers into the box curiously. "I just want you to... you know... I don't want you to be hungry." Catra's gaze

softens and her heart flutters in her chest at Adora's concern. She hadn’t expected Adora to actually care about that.

"You... wow." Catra doesn’t really know what else to say. Adora shuffles, visibly uncomfortable under Catra's soft gaze.

"No need to get sappy on me..." She grumbles. "I just want you to be well fed."

"It's really cute." Catra says with a smile.

"Careful Catra, I might start to think you *actually* like me."

"Shush, asshole." Catra rolls her eyes and wiggles off of Adora's lap, grabbing another bag of chips to snack on. She *doesn’t* like Adora. Catra watches as Adora sighs and lies back on her bed.

"Starting to think you enjoy calling me that."

"You haven't corrected me anytime I've said it to you." Catra comments as she nibbles on the chips, putting another one near Adora's mouth for her to take. Adora takes the chip gratefully, humming as she eats it.

"I am a bit of an asshole." That’s a bit of an understatement if you asked Glimmer. In fact, Catra has heard an entire dictionary of bad words from Glimmer when she has talked about the Horde Lord in the past. Still… Catra can’t help but feel maybe, *just maybe* , Adora isn’t as big of an asshole as they all thought her to be, that maybe there’s something there that they had all failed to see due to distance and refusal to see the Horde Lord as anything other than evil.

"Just a little bit. But..." Catra stops, not finishing her statement, instead choosing to continue eating her chips. Adora sits up to look at Catra. She raises her eyebrows at her in question.

"But what?" Catra really wishes she hadn’t opened the door for that question.

"Nothing, just thinking." She says dismissively.

"Thinking about what?" *Dammit Adora.*

"That you're very different to who I always thought you'd be."

"Yeah?" Adora asks. "I guess I probably am."

"You are..." *She is.*

"How am I different?" *Stop asking her questions.*

"You're... really nice." And she is. Adora, *The Lord of the Horde,* is cute, and nice, and caring. She isn’t at all who Catra had perceived her as being.

Adora looks at Catra for a long moment, Catra wonders what she’s thinking as those baby blues gaze at her, and then she laughs, smiling mischievously. "Nice? Really?"

"Okay, you can't tell me that you didn't think I was kind of a bitch before we did all of this."

"A bitch? No." Adora says. "I actually thought you were pretty funny, I like a woman who gives as good as she gets. I know you found me obnoxious." *That* is an understatement. But… *Did Adora just give her a compliment?*

"I did. But you can't blame me. Your jokes were not the greatest, plus you were... um... *are* , my enemy... and that was the only thing you were, until yesterday."

"What am I now?" Adora asks curiously. Catra looks over at Adora before glancing away. Why does Adora keep asking her questions like that? Questions she doesn't know how to answer and doesn't *want* to answer.

"I guess... *technically* you'd be considered a one night stand. Though I doubt that's even accurate when I'm still here when I should have left last night." *That's all this is right? Sex.*

"A one night stand." Adora hums. "I guess I am. Not a lot of people can say they've had a one night stand with the Lord of the Horde, you know that?" Catra shouldn't be surprised Adora took that so easily. *Is it even called a one night stand when you have gone several rounds and also it's now the next day and you're still hanging around each other?*

"Really? And here I thought you were a *womaniser* with all of your flirtatious attitude." Catra says exaggeratedly.

"Oh, in my cadet days, I was, but since I became Lord? ... Not so much." Adora shrugs. "That would be... inappropriate... you though, you were fair game. I'd flirt with you to annoy you mostly but I mean... you're... I mean... I'm not blind." Adora almost sounds flustered.

"I'm what?" Catra teases, a big grin on her face. "Please do tell me." Adora doesn't look at her, she simply shoves her playfully.

"Just eat your food Catra." She responds. Catra laughs. She's having almost too much fun with Adora… she feels... conflicted now. She should've left the first night yet here she is: sharing jokes with the Horde Lord, calling her pet names, covered in marks left by her, she's *tasted* her… Catra can't help but feel like something has changed, and she's not so sure it's a good thing.

They settle down, talking away, Catra feeds Adora and herself, they sleep together again, of course, continuously. Time flows nicely with Adora and it's hard for Catra to see her as the Lord of the Horde - especially when she smiles like that, or makes dumb dorky jokes. Adora

is a *person* . And she is a *good* person. Under the trauma the Horde has inflicted upon her, Adora is soft, and gentle, and funny, and- Catra couldn't go there right now. She just wanted to spend time with Adora.

* * *

Three days.

Catra has been with the Horde for *three days* .

Well, three *conscious* days after Princess Prom but it hardly feels like that. Adora is sleeping. Scorpia's surprise that she was still sleeping the previous day tells Catra that maybe that isn't normal. Adora does seem like the type to be an early riser but she's been sleeping like a rock with Catra.

She trails her finger lightly over the blonde's back. She had several scars there, some were burns, others were more clean, like claw wounds. Catra didn't know if those were from her or someone else. Adora's breaths were steady and even in her sleep, and she was lying on her stomach, arms tucked under her pillow. Catra feels pleasantly sore, all over. Adora may be about the most capable lover Catra has ever had, no one has *ever* made her feel this way.

Talk about satisfaction bringing the cat back.

Adora stirs and Catra finds it strange that she always seems to sense when Catra has awoken. "Morning sleepyhead." Catra says softly as Adora blinks open those beautiful blue eyes of her's.

The blonde shifts, moving her arm from under the pillow to around Catra's waist, she turns on her side and pulls Catra's front against her. Adora is naked by the way, she hadn't bothered putting any more clothes on last night, Catra was also naked. So they're naked cuddling. Catra is now intimately familiar with Adora's naked body.

Next time she faces Adora on the battlefield, she wonders if she's going to be able to look at her without blushing - especially at her sword. She's never going to be able to forget what the Horde Lord can do with that tongue, the way she *curls* her fingers, fucks Catra so *good,* and so- Catra huffs. She really hopes these… feelings, and thoughts, will go away when she sees Adora go back to the person she was before all this. Except… this *is* Adora. This is the *real* Adora. This isn't the facade she puts on when she's doing her egotistical Horde Lord bit. Adora is *actually* soft, and gentle, and smart, and caring, and loving, and… Catra wishes she hadn't been so messed up by the Horde's meddling.

Adora is also like… she's like some kind of goddess, Catra swears. Her lean muscles make more sense now that Catra realises she's been raised on those awful ration bars; if she'd had access to proper food she'd be *buff* buff. Still, she's undeniably beautiful. Figures Catra would find the perfect woman and her be her enemy.

"You're beautiful." Catra mumbles and Adora opens one of her blue eyes that she had closed again while Catra was busy thinking. She blushes, which is really cute, before she buries her face in Catra's chest.

"It's too early." Adora groans and Catra laughs softly. She lets her hands wander all over Adora's torso, her skin is soft and silky and just as perfect as everything else about her - plus, Adora had told her how she enjoyed feeling Catra's fur brush up against her skin.

"Do you not like me calling you beautiful?" Catra questions. Adora stays still for a moment before she sighs. "Do you prefer handsome?" Catra pinches her cheek playfully and Adora rolls her eyes.

"I don't mind any compliment, honestly, I just…" Adora is incredibly awkward sometimes, but it just adds to her *endearing* character. "I can't take them."

"Compliments?" Catra questions and Adora nods. She chuckles a little. "I don't think anyone, in the history of anyone, has ever been good at taking compliments, Adora." Catra says.

"No, but I mean," Adora sits up a little. "I like being praised," Catra knew that by the way. "Like… I like being told I'm good at something, and stuff, I just… I don't know… when it comes to my appearance I… I don't know." Adora shrugs half heartedly but Catra, weirdly, knows exactly what she means.

"My point still stands," Catra says. She starts kissing Adora because she just can't help herself. She kisses along her sharp and strong jawbone, moving closer to her. She moves her mouth down to her neck and parts her lips. Just because Adora couldn't mark her neck, doesn't mean Catra couldn't mark *Adora's* .

She bites her neck with her sharp fangs and hears Adora take a sharp breath in. Catra had figured out pretty quickly that Adora enjoyed being marked and she enjoyed the *pain* of being marked. She liked whenever Catra dug her claws into her soft skin, whenever Catra used her fangs on her, she knows Adora had said she was into sexual torture but she hadn't expected her to be *into* sexual torture. She wants to know all of the Horde Lord's *dirty* fantasies.

But, this is the last of their time together. Catra *has* to go home today.

Catra bites hard and she feels Adora's hand flatten against her stomach. "Someone woke up horny." Adora says and her hand slides down, and down, and *oh* . Catra moans against Adora's neck when she feels her slightly calloused fingers begin teasing her clit. She throws a leg over Adora's waist to give her better access. Adora knows how to touch her so well it's almost annoying.

She feels Adora press her fingers inside of her, tentatively, slowly, building gently and Catra appreciates it. She is sore from their activities and she needs a slow gentle wake up before she can try anything too hard. Adora moves slowly, gently fucking Catra and it feels almost as good as when she goes hard and fast.

She rolls her hips in time with Adora's thrusts, enjoying the feeling of her long slender fingers inside of her. Catra runs her claws along Adora's bare back and gently licks her tongue over the mark her fangs had made on her neck. She digs her nails in, just a little, and hears Adora let out a soft whine. Catra almost wants to laugh at how something so little can turn Adora on.

"Fuck…" Catra moans quietly, burying her nose against Adora's neck. Her scent has become so familiar and… Catra kind of loves it. She smells of sweat - because of what they've been doing - otherwise, she usually smells of burnt sandalwood but with a twist of something

sweet like vanilla. It's a scent that Catra can't seem to get enough of, and she kind of… *really* likes. "You're *so good,* Adora."

"I know." She replies cockily and Catra laughs. *That fucking cockiness. It should be annoying but it's often quite charming.* Still, Catra wants to take her down a peg.

She moves her mouth to Adora's ear, moaning softly as she nibbles on her earlobe and then she lowers her voice as she whispers to her. "I want to ride you, *my Lord* ." Adora immediately freezes. Catra whimpers a little at the fact she was no longer being stimulated, but pulling one over on Adora is almost just as good. She pulls back a little.

"You want to… to ride me?" Adora asks. Catra smiles a little and then she nods. Adora pulls her fingers from Catra and Catra mewls. Maybe she made a mistake, she *really* wants Adora back inside of her. She rolls over and away from Catra for a moment and grabs the handle of her sword, transforming it.

"Are you… are you serious?" Catra asks with a little chuckle. Adora was already spreading Catra's wetness over the strap with concentration. *How the hell does someone make that look endearing?*

"What?" Adora asks and Catra shakes her head.

"Nothing, give it here, let me put it on you." Adora looks at her curiously but hands the strap over to her. "The only thing bigger than your ego is your fucking strap, I swear to the Gods." Catra comments. Adora grins at her, making Catra roll her eyes as she starts to pull the strap onto Adora.

Catra slides the harness up Adora's long legs. Adora has her hands on her neck, her thumb caressing her jaw as she kisses Catra on her sideburns. Catra laughs a little. Adora is so affectionate, even if she doesn't realise she's being so. She tightens the strap in place, hearing Adora let out a little grunt as she does so. "Adora," Catra says and Adora hums. "You're being very touchy." Catra says with a chuckle.

"Sorry..." Adora mumbles and she leans back. She leans against the headboard of her bed and beams. *Gods*... Catra... she can't see Adora like *this* . She shoves her face, gently, laughing as Adora makes a noise of protest, her face all squished.

"What did I do?" Adora asks.

"You're looking at me weird."

"I was just looking at you normally!" Catra rolls her eyes.

"Shut up," Catra says dismissively. "Don't you want me to ride you?" The way Adora snaps to attention at that question is far too adorable.

"Obviously I want that." Adora says. "Can you… I mean… will you… you know… it would make it easier if you… sucked… on it…" Catra blinks. Adora seriously fluctuates from cocky and confident, and a little bit of an asshole, to shy and awkward, and it can happen in the blink of an eye, and every time it does… it only serves to make her more likable, more *human*... and cute.

"You realise you just coated that in my… whatever, right?" Catra asks with a raised brow.

"Well aware of that, Kitten." Adora responds casually.

"You-" Catra can't believe what she's hearing. "Oh, you are a *dirty* Horde Lord." Adora blushes a little at that. Catra's more than happy to do it anyway. If Adora wants her to taste herself on her strap… now that Catra thinks about it, she really wants to do that too.

She settles between Adora's spread legs and places her hands around the strap. She loves that Adora's strap is her sword, if only because it literally *buzzes* with the power and energy it stores. Catra is curious about She-Ra, it's almost impossible not to be, but she's not about to ask Adora to transform into her when the blonde finds that… uncomfortable, to say the least.

The strap is also wonderfully warm; it feels nice in her hands and even better when it warms her insides.

Adora grabs her wrists. "You're going to wipe it off." Adora says and Catra looks at her face. Her voice has taken that *edge* , the commanding one, and it makes Catra shudder. She has submitted to Lord Adora more than she ever thought possible. "If you need a breather, tap me, anywhere, twice," Adora says and Catra's breath quickens with the thoughts racing through her mind. "touch yourself while you do it."

Fuck. Fuck, fuck, fuck.

Catra nods her head to show she understood but Adora gives her a disapproving look. "Y-Yes, Sir." Catra stutters, way too aroused to form sentences. Adora smiles, a little lopsided, and then she gets *that look* .

"Then what are you waiting for Kitten?" She asks as she wraps her big palm behind Catra's neck. Catra lowers herself down and looks up at Adora before she opens her mouth.

Adora is not gentle and Catra doesn't *want* her to be. She almost gags when the strap touches the back of her throat. Adora lessens her grip slightly but Catra makes no attempt to tap out. Adora takes that as a signal to tighten her grip in the hair at the back of Catra's neck. Catra bobs up and down. She tastes herself on Adora's strap, sweet and heady.

"Touch yourself." Adora commands and Catra follows her Lord's instructions. She begins touching herself, whimpering and moaning while Adora thrusts her hips up off of the bed. "Good Kitten," Adora praises and Catra presses her clit *just right* at the same time Adora says that. She feels the coil in her stomach become tight and hot. She never really thought about how much of a turn on it would be to have her face fucked but it really fucking is.

Adora moves Catra's head, bobbing her up and down at the same time she rams her hips up. Catra's jaw kind of hurts from the action and her throat *burns* , bringing tears to her eyes, but she's enjoying this a little too much. Why does she enjoy being used so roughly by the Horde Lord? She should be ashamed of it, and maybe… maybe she is, but the shame and humiliation is also kind of a turn on.

She takes Adora for as long as she can take her before she taps her on the arm twice. Adora immediately releases her hold and Catra brings her head up, gasping a little for breath and looking at the strap that was covered with her own saliva. She stops touching herself, knowing she was already on the brink of falling over the edge. " *Fuck*... " Catra says as she feels herself wiggle a little.

Adora reaches her hands out and gently strokes her hands over her cheeks. "You did so good Kitten, you're a good Kitten." Adora praises gently, leaning forward to kiss Catra along her jaw. Catra appreciates how gentle Adora is being with her, but that *really* turned her on, and now she just wants to take her strap - especially after all the effort she put into preparing it for herself.

Catra shoves Adora back against the headboard and moves towards her. She rubs the strap against her folds, hearing Adora gasp at the action. "Hm…" Catra hums softly. "Yeah… you're ready for me, aren't you?" Catra asks. She practically glides over the strap and, she knows for a fact, she could get off on that alone.

Adora seems passive now but Catra can tell she's wound up - no way you fuck someone's face like *that* and not be into it. "Catra…" Adora says quietly and Catra could listen to her name fall from Lord Adora's lips all day. “Ride me.” She doesn't phrase it as a question, it is a *demand* , and Catra is in no position to deny her.

She lifts herself up, using Adora’s shoulders to keep her steady and then she carefully begins to lower herself down onto Adora's strap. She meant it when she said that the only thing bigger than Adora’s ego was her strap but the thing was perfectly suited to her, literally, apparently the sword of protection (*strap of protection*) knows *exactly* what makes Magicats *tick* .

Once she's buried to the hilt, Catra uses her grip on Adora’s shoulders to begin moving up and down. She moves slowly at first, whimpering at the wonderful stretch and how *full* she feels before she picks up her pace. “Fuck… Adora… you’re so big.” Catra bites her lip to silence a particularly loud moan escaping her throat. Adora just smirks proudly at her, and… she's so attractive it's almost not fair.

The blonde reaches her hands out to grab Catra by her hips. She begins thrusting upwards, giving Catra more stimulation. " *Yes* ! Right there… you're so fucking *good* Adora." Adora

growls and Catra doesn't hold back with her moans anymore. Hearing the pure *aggression* of that growl results in Catra coating the strap in even more fluids.

Catra moves fast and hard, grinding down onto Adora's dick all the while being slammed down by Adora herself. Adora is *amazing,* Catra has never been fucked like this in her *life.* Catra is sensitive from their almost continuous activities, and she knows she won't last long, and, from the look on Adora's face, neither will she.

Catra loves to see the unbridled pleasure in Adora's features. She doesn't hold back as much as she did their first time together, she allows herself to fuck and be fucked and she does it so well. "Good girl, Adora." Catra purrs and Adora shudders under her touch. Like Catra said, Adora loves to be praised. Catra drags her claws down her back and that seems to *awaken* something in Adora.

She moves so quickly Catra barely has time to register their positions have changed until Adora is *slamming* into her, she had flipped Catra onto her back, trapping her between the mattress and Adora's imposing frame. Catra no longer had control over the pace and the way that Adora was absolutely *driving* into her was sending Catra hurtling towards the edge.

So much for fucking her gently.

Catra cums so powerfully she almost passes out, she screams Adora's name, marks her with her claws, practically sees stars behind her eyes and Adora only stops the erratic movement of her hips when she reaches her own peak. She chokes out Catra's name, her hips freezing mid thrust and jerking once, twice, before she collapses on top of Catra. Adora is *heavy,* thanks to all of her muscle mass, but Catra doesn't mind being crushed under her if she's honest. Catra was just fucked within an inch of her life, in fact, maybe she even lost one of her mythical nine lives.

When Adora comes to her senses she pulls out of Catra slowly, making her whimper before she rolls off of her. "Fuck…" Adora pants. "Did I mention how glad I am you offered to do this?" Adora asks and Catra snorts. She hits her shoulder playfully.

"Cuddle me tall, blonde and handsome." Catra demands. Adora shifts and grabs her blanket. Catra turns on her side, allowing Adora wrap herself around her, spooning her while she places the blanket over the top of them. Catra sighs as she closes her eyes.

“I have to go home today Adora.” Catra whispers but she knows the blonde hears her. Adora presses her palm against Catra’s stomach and sighs, her breath tickling the back of Catra’s neck.

“I know,” Adora almost sounds… sad? But Catra couldn’t say for sure - Catra doesn’t really know Adora well enough to assume how she feels from the way she says things. “But, for now, just sleep, Kitten.” Catra is more than willing to do that. She’s exhausted anyway. Morning sex that is that rough and hot and- Yeah, Catra should just sleep and not over think it. She settles against the mattress and feels her breaths even out in sleep as soon as she relaxes.

* * *

Adora is rambling, and she's energetic, and she's making Catra *laugh* of all the things. She's demonstrating some story from her cadet days, dressed in a loose fitted tank top and boxer shorts and *socks* . *She is such a big fucking dork.* "So anyway, Kyle, he always messes up, but that's kind of his charm, you know?" Adora asks and Catra does not know, actually, but Adora is talking to her like they've been friends for years, never mind a few days of fucking. "He got hit by a training bot's lazer and Lonnie said, *'Seriously Kyle?'* , anyway, we still managed to get the fastest time because of yours truly." Adora points at herself with her thumbs, proudly.

Catra cackles, swinging her legs behind her, grinning at the blonde. She was lying on Adora's bed, flat on her stomach and watching Adora from across the room. "Good job, Blondie. I can see why your ego got so big. You are quite skilled if you managed to bring your team to victory even after that disaster that Kyle accidentally cost." She smiles as she looks at Adora with a soft gaze that she never thought she would be giving the *Horde Lord* . But it's impossible to be harsh to her when she was being so... *her* .

"My ego is not *that* big." Adora says dismissively.

"Uh huh." Catra raises a brow and grins. "And I'm not gay." Adora laughs at that and rolls her eyes.

"Yeah, yeah, so maybe my ego is a *little* big, but I think we've established that you like it."

"Hm... maybe a little bit." Catra looks off to the side, biting back a smile. She did kind of like Adora's ego when it didn't get in the way. It suited her, weirdly enough.

"What about you?" Adora asks curiously. "I mean, I was raised a soldier, but when did you learn to fight? Or decide to join the Rebellion?"

"I learned to fight from my moms, after asking them to teach me. They didn't exactly want me to learn how to fight at first, since they wanted to keep me away from the battlefield, but I insisted. So here we go. I joined the Rebellion because..." Catra hesitates for a moment. "I wanted to keep the people I cared about safe..."

Adora drops her hands, ceasing her exaggerated movements and comes towards Catra, sitting down in front of her. "I can understand that," She says with a small smile. "... so what are your moms like?"

"My moms? Well, they honestly couldn't be more different from each other. C'yra, my mama, she is short-tempered and incredibly stubborn. But she cares about people and does her best to help. My mom Luna mellows her out, she's the softer of the two and she's very caring and patient."

"Oh," Adora says. "so you're like both of them then."

"Huh?" Catra looks up, mildly surprised.

"I mean, you're incredibly stubborn too, like, *incredibly* stubborn, and short tempered sometimes. I mean, you've *definitely* been short tempered with me before," Adora explains. "But, you're also soft hearted." Adora pokes Catra's chest playfully. "You care a lot about people."

Catra huffs, but smiles when Adora pokes her chest. "I suppose that's true... you really think that?"

"Uh, yeah," Adora says, like it was obvious. "You care *too* much about people. You weren't going to chase after me at Princess Prom until Glimmer told you to."

"... Good thing I did, otherwise we wouldn't even be here right now."

"You consider us being here good." Adora notes with a smile. "Interesting."

"I mean... I'd say it was a... pretty good experience." Catra shifts in her seat, smiling shyly at Adora. She blushes a little. She didn't think Adora would pick up on her saying where they were was good. Adora is actually incredibly perceptive and, though Catra calls her an idiot affectionately, she is actually quite intelligent. You don't run an entire system like the Horde on zero brains.

"Pretty good experience?" Adora asks. She leans back on her hands and looks at Catra with a smug expression. "Only pretty good Kitten? Not mind-blowing? Or... Etheria-shattering, good?" Catra rolls her eyes fondly, rolling over onto her back on the bed.

"I told you, someone has to keep your ego in check. You're getting a pretty good experience, so take it or leave it."

"Pretty sure I *already* took it." Adora points out. She moves towards Catra and starts playing with her tail in her hands. "You are a pretty good experience, I'll give you that." Catra can't help but purr, shifting a little to put her tail in Adora's hands more.

She had no idea why she was trusting the Horde Lord with one of the most sensitive spots on her body, but Adora hadn't done anything so far since they had made their agreement to spend the night together. "Only pretty good?" She throws back, winking at the blonde. "So you mean to tell me you weren't shoving my face between your legs earlier?" *Catra can have an ego too.*

"Your tongue is amazing." Adora admits. She moves her hands along Catra's tail up to the base of it where she scratches, knowing that was a spot that Catra liked to be scratched the most. Again, it should really be a crime that Adora knows where Catra likes to be touched the most - even in non-sexual places. "But pretty sure you're the only one who begged between us." Catra scoffs.

"Only because you refused to and I respected that, dork." Catra hums, closing her eyes and melting into Adora's touch. She seriously felt so relaxed in that moment. More than she had ever felt for the last few years. She sees Adora smile, seemingly happy to keep touching Catra.

"I was tempted." Adora admits. "But... I couldn't."

"And that's okay..." Catra purrs softly, opening an eye to look at Adora. "I told you, your comfort meant more to me than you begging." Adora worries her lip between her teeth, she looks pensive for a moment before she shifts the subject.

"Your tail is really soft."

"Yeah? You seem to like playing with it quite a bit." Catra hums, closing her eyes again. She had noticed Adora changing the topic but, since it had been a sensitive topic while they were being intimate, she wasn't going to push it.

"It feels nice... and I like to keep my hands busy."

"So I've noticed. Does it relax you?" Catra wiggles her tail around, making Adora lose her grip on it for a moment before bopping the blonde on her nose. Adora's eyes try to track Catra's tail, and she goes cross eyed as it bops her on the nose. She scrunches up her nose in response, which is really cute if you ask Catra, and then she manages to catch her tail again.

"It does relax me." She says. "And you seem to like it too." Catra giggles and wiggles around in the bed for a moment.

"I do... it's calming to me."

"Can I ask you something?" *Uh-oh.* Catra doesn't like how that's phrased.

"What is it?" She asks.

"Why do you purr? Or... I mean... is that offensive? I just mean... what does it mean?" Catra almost laughs. Of all the questions she thought Adora might ask her, she was not expecting *that.* Cocky and confident to shy and awkward, in the blink of an eye. *Endearing.*

"Oh!" Catra sits up and smiles at the question. "It's not offensive at all! Purring actually means that I'm content and happy, usually. Or that I'm really comfortable. Very rarely, Magicats will purr when someone they care about is injured, or if they're injured themselves, since it helps with healing."

"Follow up question," Adora smiles and tackles Catra to the bed. "Why is it the cutest thing I've ever heard and seen?" Catra squeals when Adora jumps on her and laughs, hugging her close.

"That can't possibly be the cutest thing." She presses her lips softly to Adora's cheek.

"It is." Adora says, without a doubt. "You do it during sex too, it's adorable."

"... Thanks for the compliment, *Adorka* ."

"Oh no..." Adora makes a face at Catra. "Oh no, that was so... *bad* ." She grabs her nearby pillow and playfully hits Catra with it. "Get out of my room with jokes like that."

" *Hey* ! Don't hit me with the pillow, asshole!" Catra laughs, grabbing the pillow and throwing it back at Adora's face. Adora full-on laughs, clutching her stomach, tears shining in her eyes and she *snorts - literally snorts* - and Catra doesn't know what to do with this

knowledge. Adora has one of the best laughs - *the Horde Lord laughs like that.* "How about you kiss me instead, huh?"

"A kiss? After that *lame* joke? No, I don't think so." Catra rolls her eyes. Adora really is playful, and she is funny, Catra can concede to that.

"Aww, and here I thought you wanted me to purr more." Catra teases.

"Does me kissing you make you purr?" Catra grins.

"Why don't you find out?"

Adora rolls her eyes but leans down to kiss Catra anyway. She kisses her softly, cupping her jaw with her hand as she moves her lips against Catra's. Catra really does begin to purr when Adora's lips meet her own. Her arms wrap around the other's waist, and bring her in closer, as their lips move softly against one another.

She hums, pulling away for a moment, before she leans back in, angle shifted slightly, to get more comfortable, as she kisses Adora again. Her hands grip the blonde's tank top to keep her within reach.The kiss is nice and soft and definitely different to the many they've shared over the course of the last few days. Adora moans softly when Catra shifts to kiss her at a different angle. Catra can *feel* Adora's lips lifting up at the corners at Catra's purr. She pulls away after a moment.

"Guess me kissing you makes you happy, huh?" Adora asks with a grin.

"Maybe a little." Catra whispers softly, holding her lover as close to her as possible. Adora sighs and presses her nose to the side of Catra's face.

"You have to go..."

"... Right." Catra whispers back, suddenly feeling... *something* in her chest. "I... still need pants... since you ripped mine yesterday." Adora laughs.

"Really? I thought you were planning on going commando back to the Rebellion."

"That would be a bad idea and we both know it." Catra shakes her head in amusement, poking Adora's forehead. "In all seriousness though, I do need pants to get home."

"You want to wear my clothes, Kitten?" Adora asks with a little... *edge* to her tone. Catra knows Adora has a thing for being… possessive. It's kind of hot actually, but she's not going to vocalise that to Adora when her ego is already sky high.

"Do you want to give them to me?" Catra stands up, Adora's shirt falling back down and barely stopping below her mid-thigh. "Because I definitely can't go back in this... as much as I see you staring." And she *is* staring. Catra likes it. Being *desired* . Adora isn't afraid to let that desire show on her face.

"But you look so sexy like that." Adora comments, turning over onto her back. She puts her hands behind her head and watches Catra, her eyes running up and down her body.

"And as sexy as I may look in it, I don't think the Rebellion would appreciate me coming back without clothes... and with hickeys on my thighs." Adora snorts.

"I don't know, I think that'd be pretty funny."

"My mom may actually come here and murder you, idiot."

"Ha, like she'd be able to." Adora sits and then stands, brushing past Catra and bumping her hip on her way. Catra shakes her head at her playfulness. The blonde goes to her drawers and begins rooting through them, looking for clothes for Catra to wear. "I don't exactly own clothes with tail holes in them but I'm assuming your claws will do the trick for that." Adora holds up a pair of pants curiously.

"Yeah, I should be able to fix it just fine. Thanks, dork." Catra walks up to her, taking the pants that Adora held up. She smiles up at her, biting her lip for a moment. She wanted to say something, but she wasn't sure what. "Uh... I had fun..."

"I had fun too." Adora replies. "I should walk you out though, so you don't get ambushed by any Horde soldiers, not that you couldn't handle yourself."

Catra fidgets around with the pants, carefully cutting a hole into them for her tail and putting them on. "I... uh..." She presses her lips together, unsure what to say next. Something just... *Something* was making it hard for her to go. *All the sex probably got to her head.*

Adora raises a brow and then kneels down in front of Catra, startling her. She starts rolling up the bottom of the pants' legs, since they were a little long and then she stands to tuck her shirt into the waistband. "Hm... better. Wait there." Catra's eyes had widened for a moment when Adora had suddenly knelt down, confusion pretty evident on her face, but Adora didn't look even slightly concerned. Catra mumbles a thanks to her as Adora goes about doing whatever she was doing.

Catra watches as she grabs another pair of pants and pulls them on herself before she grabs one of her Horde issued uniform shirts. She pulls the tank off and then pulls the shirt on, tucking it in - *such a soldier* . She goes to the corner of the room and grabs her cape, attaching it to the shoulder guards to keep it in place. She then grabs her boots and pulls them on, looking smart and uniformed enough to be seen and help guide Catra out of the Fright Zone. "Should we... really just be walking out like this? Won't your soldiers... get upset?" Catra asks nervously.

"Upset about what exactly?" Adora asks. Catra thought her question was pretty clear.

"About you... you know... letting me go?"

"No." Adora answers simply. "They follow me unquestionably."

"Oh."

"If I'm letting you go, they'll probably believe I have some kind of plan." Adora shrugs. "I don't but... they don't know that."

"Yeah... I guess that's true. Thanks, by the way... for keeping your word." Catra adds. It's a small thanks but she does appreciate it. She didn't really think Adora would go back on her word after everything, she seemed to be a woman of her word, even for a Horde soldier - that was probably an *Adora* thing.

"You didn't think I'd imprison you after all that, did you?" Adora asks. "Besides, you didn't slice me up... well... not *too badly* anyway." Catra smiles.

"Who knows? I'm just grateful that you kept your word... and, hey, you told me I could use them."

"Yes I did." Adora grins. "And I stand by my decision, now," Adora extends her elbow. "If you will." Catra grins back at her and takes Adora's offered arm, leaning into her and purring.

"Lead the way, my Lord." She says with a playful tone.

"I thought you were leaving but it sounds like you're trying to turn me on again." Adora says. *Of course Adora says something like that* .

"As much as I would like to, it really is getting late and if I want to make it back by morning... I'll need to go soon." Catra mentions again, alerting Adora once more of their time together coming to a close.

"Not even a quickie?" Adora asks lightheartedly. It was intended to be a joke… for the most part. But there was a sliver of hope that Catra would agree to give her one last go.

"...I don't think our sessions could ever be *quickies* , Adora."

"Fine, fine, figured you might want one last spin."

Catra clicks her tongue against the roof of her mouth. "...one more time and then I really need to go."

"Wait." Adora stops. "Really?"

"Yes, really. Just don't rip the pants again."

Adora laughs and pushes Catra backwards until her back hits the door. "I would *never* rip *my* pants."

"So you'd only rip up mine? How rude." Catra laughs and brings Adora back down towards her, hands tangled in those blonde tresses as their lips meet.

Adora clearly meant it when she said a quickie. She unbuttons Catra's pants hastily as she kisses her, and pulls them down ever so slightly, so she could push her hand into them, and uses her other hand to scratch at that spot at Catra's lower back. Catra thinks it's almost *cruel* just how well the Horde Lord knows how to touch her. "Hmm... how fast do you think I can make you cum Kitten?"

"Hnn... five minutes, maybe?" Catra answers, her voice low as she kisses Adora's neck, sucking on it as she holds her close.

"Five minutes?" Adora asks as she expertly teases Catra's clit. "Challenge accepted." Adora lifts Catra and Catra wraps her legs around her waist so she's trapped between the door and Adora. Adora keeps her upright and steady.

Adora removes her hand briefly from Catra's pants to push her fingers into her mouth, a clear instruction for Catra to suck on them. "Can't go in dry." Adora says simply. Catra moans around her fingers, eyes locked with Adora's as she sucks on the fingers in her mouth. She swirls her tongue around them, coating them with saliva as much as she could, to make sure that it was wet enough. Adora shudders as she does it. "Why is that so hot, fuck..." She murmurs. "I'm going to miss fucking you Catra."

Catra pulls her mouth away from Adora's fingers, strings of saliva connecting them for a moment before the brunette licks her lips clean. "I'm going to miss this too..." She admits, gasping softly. "What are you waiting for?" Adora chuckles, only a little, before she does as Catra asks.

She buries those *long slender* fingers into Catra, two right away, before she starts thrusting. She curls and strokes Catra's inner walls with precision, well aware, by now, how Catra likes it. *It should be a crime really, who gave the Horde Lord the right to have such perfect fucking hands?* (*Ha, fucking hands. Concentrate Catra!*)

Adora leans forward to whisper in Catra's ear. "Never forget who you belong to, Kitten." Catra groans and shivers when Adora's warm breath and silky voice touch her ear. She bites her lips and knows that her walls have just clenched around her lover's fingers from hearing her say that.

"Yours..." She breathes, eyes closed as another moan slips her lips when Adora rubs *exactly* where she likes it. Adora uses her free hand, clearly confident in her strength that she wouldn't drop Catra, to pin her wrists to the door above her head. The action causes the heat that was building in Catra to become a raging fire.

"That's right, you're *mine* ." She curls her fingers and speeds her thrusts. "You have my marks, and even when they fade, you'll still remember, won't you Kitten?" Catra shouldn't be giving into her desires like this. She knows this is the last time she'll be able to feel this. She knows that Adora is supposed to be her enemy. But right now, in that moment, she wasn't. Adora is hers in that moment. Her gorgeous, *skilled,* lover, that was a fucking goddess at making her feel good.

" *Mmm, fuck* ... I'll remember... I'm yours, *Adora* ."

"Mine..." Adora repeats. Catra can feel her walls tightening around Adora's fingers already. "And I'm yours..." Adora says that a little unsurely, like she wasn't sure how she felt about that. It's not like it was untrue, Catra had had her several times in the course of a few days but saying it out loud, where Catra's Magicat ears were unlikely to miss it, was different. And Catra knowing that and hearing it? That was different too. Very different.

Catra's eyes widen hearing Adora say those words. Adora was being a little more vulnerable with her. Her cheeks become beautifully flustered and she dives in, bringing the blonde in for a deep kiss. "Mine... *mine* ..." Catra gasps softly against her lips before closing the space between them. That had very easily gotten Catra riled up, her pussy clenching and spilling more juices.

Adora goes harder and faster before working a third finger into Catra. Her breaths are harder and more laboured with effort. "Yours... I'm yours." She curls and scratches with all *three* fingers *at once* and, gods, Adora must know how those words affect Catra, combined with her know-how of how to touch Catra *just right* , Catra wasn't going to last. "Cum for me Kitten..." Adora kisses her jaw. "Tell me that I'm yours."

"You're *mine* ... no one else's." Catra moans louder, her claws digging into Adora's back as she moves in to kiss her jaw, nipping at it as she tries to grind down onto Adora's hand. "Close... babe, I'm so close. Fuck..." Adora knows exactly what to do to get Catra *there* . She stretches her thumb and places it to her clit, rubbing *hard* while still moving her hand at impossible speeds.

Catra yelps at the change of speed but in a matter of seconds becomes a puddle in Adora's arms. Her mouth falls open as her lover's name spills from her lips just like the liquid that coats those skilled fingers. She clings to Adora, the only thing that is holding her stable and keeping her grounded, as her high is drawn out by those long, *perfect,* fingers before they slowly pull out of her. She pants softly in Adora's ear, giggling as she nuzzles and presses a kiss on her neck. "Mine..." Catra whispers, her breathy and shaky voice showing that she needed a moment to catch her breath.

Adora keeps her fingers in Catra's pants but pulls them out of her. She was practically leaning all her weight against Catra, trapping her against the door, as she too calmed herself from the experience. Catra likes seeing that Adora is just as affected by whatever is going on between them as much as she is. Adora kisses Catra on her jaw, her breath a little laboured. "Was that five minutes?"

"I have no idea..." Catra giggles, turning her head to press her lips to Adora's. "I didn't time it."

"Well, for the sake of my ego, I'm going to say it was *less* than five minutes." Catra rolls her eyes fondly at that.

"Pretty sure it was, hot stuff. It felt pretty fast." Adora laughs a little and kisses Catra again. She pulls her hands out of her pants and licks her fingers clean, right in front of Catra, making a humming noise like she was savouring the taste, before she wipes them on Catra's shirt with a mischievous smile. *That-* Adora helps her back down to the ground, carefully, and then fastens up her pants. "Something to remember me by." *Adora is... unbelievable sometimes.*

"You-" Catra looks at her in disbelief before laughing. "Asshole." She says, a common insult she had used for Adora in the past, but this time it was certainly spoken with fondness and not a hint of annoyance like it used to be said with. "I... I'll miss you..." Catra clears her throat, blushing slightly. "I mean... I'll miss this." Adora blinks in surprise.

"I uh... yeah... me too..."

"Yeah... um... could we... clean up a bit though? Before I go?"

"Sure, I mean... the bathroom is... right there." Adora says awkwardly.

"Thanks..." Catra replies, just as awkwardly as Adora had answered.

She excuses herself, heading to the bathroom, stripping herself of the borrowed clothes before heading in the shower and turning on the water. She squeaks for a moment when cold water hits her skin before she sighs and relaxes, grabbing the soap to clean herself up. "What the fuck was that?" She asks herself, biting her lip as she scrubs her body clean. "Okay... it's just the heat of the moment... when you get home, you'll go back to hating her, just like you always have. You got all the attraction out of your system. Surely it's gone."

Catra takes a while, allowing the cold water to wash away her thoughts and cool her down from what she had just done. She sighs and closes her eyes for a moment, just breathing in and out before deciding to turn off the water and get out of the shower.

Stealing Adora's towel, she dries off as much as possible before putting her clothes back on, purring softly as she's entrapped in Adora's scent once again as she steps out of the bathroom. Adora stands from her bed. She had fixed her uniform, clearly, since Catra had been in the bathroom. "... Ready?" Catra asks.

"Yeah, yeah... I'm ready." She walks towards her door before she stops. "Hey uh... I..." Adora just kind of... stops. She looks like she's trying to think of something and then decides against it - she kind of reminds Catra of a fish out of water. She clearly doesn't know what she wanted to say, or maybe she changed her mind, Catra doesn't know. "Listen I... we had a good time but... let's just go."

"I... okay, yeah. Lead the way. I still don't know the layout of this place. It's confusing. So you'll have to guide me." Adora clears her throat awkwardly - like she hadn't just told Catra she was hers literally only moments ago. She opens the door to her room and gestures for Catra to follow her.

Catra feels awkward and she *rarely* feels awkward. There's this… weird feeling between them since Adora pinned her to her bedroom door and fucked her for the last time. "So..." Catra starts as she follows Adora through the mostly empty hallways. She wonders if everyone who lived in the Fright Zone just typically avoided the throne room area. "I guess... I'll see you out there?"

"Sure you can still fight with that limp, Catra?" Adora asks, she's not looking at her but her voice is light, *teasing* . Catra smiles a little. *This* is comfortable.

"I sure damn can, and I'll still kick your ass, even with a limp." Adora snorts.

"No you won't."

"Yes I will." Catra raises an eyebrow, slapping Adora's arm.

"No, I don't think you will."

"Yeah? And what are you gonna do about that, sir?" Adora shudders from the title being thrown at her and she shoves Catra lightly. *Sometimes, Adora is just so easy to make horny.*

"That was a low blow." Adora grumbles. "But, hey, maybe I'll just drag you off somewhere *private* ."

"Yeah?" Catra asks, feeling her heart skip a beat at the insinuation.

" *Maybe* ." Adora responds. "Guess we'll have to wait to find out, won't we?"

"I guess we will." Adora grins and carries on walking.

They don't really pass that many people and, those that they do pass, a quick glare from Adora stops whatever protests they might have. Catra feels safe with Adora. *Which is weird, right?* She's supposed to be her enemy, Catra shouldn't feel safe around her but... she does.

They arrive at one of the hanger bases and Adora grabs a random key off of a board housing a bunch of similar looking ones. She climbs up onto a skiff and turns it on, tapping away on its controls before she hops down and hands Catra the key. "I've programmed it to take you to the edge of the Whispering Woods, it won't be able to go through the woods but at least you won't have to walk all the way through the Fright Zone." Adora explains. "Just press that button when you're ready to go." Adora looks at Catra and smiles softly. Her blue eyes look... thoughtful maybe even a little sad. She wonders if Adora is even aware of her own feelings; if, maybe, like Catra, Adora is all too aware that this is the *last time* they're going to see each other - or see each other like *this* anyway.

"Thank you, Adora..." Catra whispers softly as she takes the key, looking down at it for a few seconds. "Can I... can you..." She bites her lip, trying to push down what she was feeling. It was dumb of her to ask Adora for anything else when she knew that as soon as she stepped onto that skiff, that they would be enemies again.

"Um... see you on the battlefield?" Catra sees Adora clench her jaw and then the blonde reaches out for her, grabbing her by the fabric of her shirt, roughly. She lifts her cape at the same time, blocking them from the view of any potentially prying eyes before she crashes their lips together in one final *intense* kiss goodbye. Catra lets herself be pulled in, closing her eyes just as their lips meet in the middle. Her heart squeezes in her chest as she reaches up to cup Adora's cheeks, trying to make the kiss last as long as possible.

Slowly... *hesitantly,* she pulls away, letting Adora go and her hands drop down to her sides. "Goodbye... Lord Adora." She whispers as she takes a step back before turning her back on the blonde and getting onto the skiff. She puts the keys in the ignition before stating the vehicle. Catra glances back one last time, nodding at the other before focusing her attention on the road before her and pressing the button like Adora had instructed.

She watches Adora and Adora watches her, even as she becomes a mere spec on the horizon, they watch each other. They were enemies, and then they were lovers, and now they have to go back to being enemies all over again.

Chapter End Notes

I hope you enjoy this softness that ends on an awkwardly gay note as we enjoyed writing it -M

Bet y'all didn't expect to see us update so soon but chapter 3 was already mostly written and it is a chunky boi so we figured we'd upload it and allow people to digest it before chapter 4. Thank you all so much for the comment/kudos etc. We try to reply to as many as possible. I must say, we're having a blast with this AU and it has been a much beloved AU to us for a while, so we're just super happy to be putting it out there and that y'all get to enjoy these two gay disasters and how sexy Horde Lord Adora is too. See y'all next time with chapter 4 ;) -S

Also, quick note, we co-write this a lot, it's very 50/50, but one of us is American English and the other is British English so if you spot interchanging words like favourite/favorite it's just us mixing it up, it's still right and often we don't even notice, but if it happens it happens, sorry!

Seeing You Again

Chapter Summary

> "We can't do that again, idiot... we're supposed to be enemies, okay?" She repeats, though she had to admit that she was tempted to go back, even if it was just for a night... But she couldn't, shouldn't, be wanting to go back with the enemy. It was wrong.
>
> "Come on Catra," Adora moves closer to her. "you said you'd miss me."
>
> "You... you misheard me."

Chapter Notes

> And chapter 4 is here! Just a quick update to how we're going to post these chapters, we have a few chapters written but they're unedited and it takes hours to edit chapters and due to upcoming uni deadlines and, well, life we're going to commit to updating at least once a week (Fridays) but if we have the time this may increase (no promises though).
>
> Anyway, I hope y'all enjoy this chapter and thank you for reading!

See the end of the chapter for more notes

Truly, it would have taken Catra nearly another day to get back home had Adora not provided her with a skiff to drive to the edge of the Whispering Woods. From there, it was relatively easy to make her way back to Bright Moon - the Woods were kind to her and had decided not to twist around and make her get lost on her journey. After several hours of travelling, she finally makes it to the front steps of Bright Moon, the guards look shocked to see her and watch in silence as she enters the castle after Catra nods to them in greeting.

Catra knew that by that point, the members of the Rebellion were likely gathered in the War Room to discuss plans regarding the war against the Horde and how to rescue her from the Fright Zone as well. She had missed Bright Moon - she's starting to understand *why* it's called Bright Moon now, it really is *bright* , especially after being subjected to the dim, dark, dreary, Fright Zone. She's glad to be back home, even if she is sore from… well… from fucking the Horde Lord. Catra still couldn't quite believe that had happened. And yet, she couldn't stop thinking about Adora. Her touch was essentially *burned* into her memory, *into her skin* . Catra sighs. She needs to get Adora off of her mind - sooner rather than later.

Catra's suspicions about the planning are confirmed true when she enters the War Room, everyone too focused on throwing ideas to plan a rescue mission to notice her. It makes Catra laugh a little to see them trying so hard to figure out a plan to rescue the person standing right behind them. "We can't charge in there without a back-up plan in case the rescue goes wrong, *Glimmah* !" Queen Angella cries out, looking firmly at her daughter.

"But *mom* ! It's been nearly a week since Princess Prom! If we wait any longer, we might not even be able to rescue her!" Glimmer yells back, throwing her arms up in the air in pure frustration.

"Rescue who?" Catra asks, alerting everyone in the room of her presence, though no one had fully realised just who had entered the room.

"Catra, *obviously* ." It was Mermista who had answered the question, her voice dripping with her characteristic sarcasm and frankness, before she freezes - as does everyone else.

Everyone in the room slowly turns to Catra, who was standing right in front of the entrance. "Wait a minute… *Catra* ?!" The words were shouted loud enough to practically shake the castle's walls. Catra flinches, unprepared for the loudness of the sound, and she presses her ears against her head to try to muffle the noise.

"Hi? So what's happening here?" Catra asks. She is slightly amused if she's honest, they clearly hadn't been expecting her to just… show up.

" *You're okay* ?!" Glimmer yells. All the Princesses were staring at Catra in complete surprise, even Catra's moms were staring at her in a state of shock. Catra could do without the *yelling* .

The first one to move is Bow, who stands up, runs, and gives Catra a big bear hug. Catra laughs happily. Glimmer teleports to wrap her in a hug too before Luna and C'yra, her moms, stand, enveloping Catra in a big, *suffocating* , group hug. The other Princesses surely would've joined too if there had been room for them.

"Ugh, you guys are squishing me! I missed you all too. But seriously, my circulation is gonna end up cut off if you don't let me go." Catra manages to squeak before the group finally releases her.

"We were planning to rescue you! You've been gone for like… four days!" Bow cries out, tears of relief in his eyes. Catra blinks.

"Four days? Wow. Well, I'm back and I'm okay. Just tired and kind of sore... from fighting." She quickly adds at the end, clearing her throat. *Yup. Definitely sore from all that fighting* . "Can I go rest in one of the guests rooms?" Catra asks. She actually is tired after her long trip through the woods - and three days of what was essentially continuous fucking - she just needs to lie down.

C'yra examines Catra closely, it makes her a little nervous if Catra is honest. C'yra is a lot like her, Adora wasn't wrong, she has a strong will and she takes no shit. C'yra also *looks* a lot like Catra, like *a lot* , they even have the same eyes - apparently that was a royal Magicat trait. C'yra is a little taller than Catra, and she's obviously older, her hair streaked with grey, though she's aged significantly well - most Magicats do. C'yra was also intimidating, imposing, like a *Queen,* which she is. "We saw *everything* at the Princess Ball. We figured the Horde Lord was planning something... we didn't want to interrupt you, you seemed to be... well... she was getting very close to you and you were *letting* her. We figured you were trying to suss out her plan. We didn't expect you to get kidnapped or I would've stepped in immediately."

"Believe me. I didn't expect to get kidnapped either. Getting stung with venom that knocks you out hurts like hell." Catra winces at the memory and rubs her back where she had been stung. Ironically, Scorpia was about the nicest person Catra has ever met. "I was trying to keep an eye on her because I knew she had been planning something. I didn't notice the others that had come with her disappearing, and Glimmer had been keeping an eye on Scorpia." Catra explains calmly. She's aware how *close* she had gotten to Adora at the Ball.

Catra's eyes flicker to Glimmer who blushes a little and winces. "I uh... I lost sight of her..." Bow shuffles a little, beside her.

"We're so sorry we got distracted, we were *bad friends* and let you get taken!" He wails, like, *literally* wails. He's clearly upset and his eyes are glassy with tears.

"Hey! It's okay. What matters is that I'm back safely and relatively unharmed." Catra reassures them, hugging her friends tightly. She *especially* didn't want them to feel bad about

her being taken when she had been… *doing things* with the Horde Lord. "Was everyone else uninjured though? That explosion was really bad." Catra shifts the attention off of herself, feeling herself grow restless under the spotlight.

Glimmer snorts. "Frosta was really cool and she repaired the castle," Frosta looks smug from her seat at the table. "No one was hurt... except you. And, hey, the Horde Lord did us a favour. She alienated the one person who was neutral in the war, Frosta joined the Rebellion." Glimmer grins, wide. *Huh.* Well, Adora inadvertently giving a win to the Rebellion *was* pretty ironic. As was Adora sleeping with a Princess. Guess this whole thing had been a fest of irony.

Bow sighs softly and places a gentle hand to Catra's back. "Are you really okay?" He asks softly.

"What happened to your arm?" C'yra lifts Catra's arm, examining a very *hand* looking bruise.

"I'm fine!" Catra looks at her arm and then at the bruise, her brain running a mile a minute to try to figure out an answer to how she got that bruise. "Oh, that was from me escaping. Someone almost dragged me back but I managed to get out alright. Nothing that a few days of rest won't heal." She lies quickly. She mentally curses Adora for leaving such a noticeable bruise on her. *She's such an idiot.*

C'yra purses her lips but drops Catra's arm anyway. Luna, Catra's other mom, wraps her in another hug, nuzzling her and purring softly. Luna was more grey than C'yra and herself, she had been her whole life, her eyes were green and striking, a little intense, but she also had laugh lines at the edges of her eyes, showing her more gentle nature. "We're just happy you're back in one piece."

Catra purrs and nuzzles her mom back, smiling at her. "Thank you, mom... I missed you all."

"We missed you too." Luna purrs back. There's a pause in the room which is filled with obvious relief, though C'yra was still giving Catra a questioning gaze. Catra tries to avoid those eyes of hers. She didn't enjoy lying to her friends and her moms but there was *no way* she was about to tell them what she had *really* been doing.

"So what did she do?" Glimmer asks. *Oh boy. Here we go.*

"She stuck me in a jail cell. But I managed to trick her when she came to do her whole egotistical spiel about how she managed to disarm the Rebellion by stealing away their tactician. She really needs to work on her ego, obviously it's not doing her any good." Catra laughs, managing to come up with a lie on the fly. She hadn't really thought to consider all the questions that her friends and family would ask her once she had come home. She really hoped that they believed her and that she wouldn't have to continue twisting a tale to them. It wasn't a complete lie anyway, Adora's ego was huge and she may even have been there to brag before Catra made her that offer.

"Where are your clothes?" C'yra questions. Catra freezes.

"I... had to steal some on the way out. The ones that I had were really hard to fight in and very easy to grab me from. So I had to sneak around and steal these to make it easier to defend myself." Catra prays to every god that her moms and the others buy her stories.

"Were they the Horde Lord's?" C'yra asks her. "Because you *stink* of her." *Fuck. Magicat senses. Damn you biology!*

"Possibly? I didn't check who they belonged to. I just grabbed them, changed, and ran as soon as I could. Who they belonged to was the last thing on my mind, mama." Catra was so used to Adora's scent, after three days, she barely even registered that it clung to her. Now that her mother had brought it up, she did *stink* of Adora.

"Hm." C'yra says simply. Catra doesn't know if that's a good thing or a bad thing.

"Who cares?" Glimmer asks. "You're back! We were about to come rescue you." *Thank the Gods for Glimmer.*

"Thankfully, no need to put anyone at risk to get me back. I'm home, safe and sound. Just really freaking tired." Catra yawns as she allows herself to relax. "Seriously, can I go rest

now? Making the trip from the Fright Zone and through the Whispering Woods, on foot, without supplies, is hard enough as is without being mildly injured."

"Take those Horde clothes off and *burn* them." C'yra says as she walks back to the table and sits down.

"Wait," Glimmer says. "Did you learn anything? Like... are the Horde planning anything? Or... what's Lord Adora like? Did you talk to her at all?"

"Will do, mama." Catra says before focusing her attention back on Glimmer. "Honestly, not much, aside from the fact that their living conditions aren't exactly great. But we kind of already knew that from the previous defectors we've welcomed. Seeing it in person though... is a whole other story."

"They're that bad?" Glimmer asks.

"No sunlight, air quality is poor, their food is hardly even food!" Catra frowns deeply, thinking back to everything bad about the Fright Zone - aside from Adora. "They don't even have windows from what I was able to see on the way out."

"Yikes, no wonder Lord Adora is so grumpy if she lives like that." Glimmer comments. "I'm honestly shocked they didn't... torture you... are you sure you're okay?"

"I'm okay... really." Catra smiles and takes Glimmer's hands. "It was mostly Lord Adora being an asshole and rubbing her victory in my face, which is torturous enough by itself." Glimmer laughs, squeezes Catra's hands and rolls her eyes. Catra smiles at the action. She really missed her friends.

"That sounds like her." She admits, she drops Catra's hands before she goes and takes her seat back at the War Room table. Bow too retreats back to the table, leaving Luna the only one standing near Catra, still nuzzling her and also *marking* her with *her* scent.

"You smell... strange... but I imagine you've been under a lot of stress, and you've been in an unfamiliar place, and... you're *definitely* wearing Lord Adora's clothes, I recognise her scent." Luna says, though it is clear that she says it out of concern and not suspicion. Catra can't say the same about C'yra.

Catra purrs at the nuzzles, smiling up at her mom. "I'm sure that'll go away once I take off these clothes and take a proper shower. It's sorely needed."

"Again, take off those clothes and burn them." C'yra says. Luna rolls her eyes.

"Ignore that grumpy cat," Luna says. "You *should* go rest though, Little One."

"Yeah," Glimmer says. "You can take your usual room, and... we can wait a few days before we make another move on the Horde, you know, to let you recover."

"Thanks, I really appreciate that, Glim. Thank you all for planning to rescue me. I think I'm gonna head to my room now to bathe and get some rest. See you all later." Catra smiles at all of them, turning around and heading out of the room with a small limp that no one else had noticed until that moment - much too focused on the fact that Catra was home safe after nearly a week of being away.

The brunette waits until she is out of sight of everyone else there and sighs in relief, thankful that most of them hadn't asked any questions. Though she was worried about her mama being suspicious about what went down between her and the Horde Lord. She just had to play it cool and continue to treat Adora like she had before, as her enemy.

That would be easy.. . right?

* * *

It takes a few days for Catra to recover to an extent that was acceptable to her moms. But from that point, Catra had been told that she would be staying back during battles as the lead

strategist. She knew that it was because the Rebellion wanted to make sure that she would be safe and that she wouldn't be a sole target of the Horde's attacks. Her moms, and the rest of the princesses, figured that if the Horde was willing to destroy Frosta's castle to get her the first time, that they would be willing to do something of the same scale to get her back again. Which is why Catra was sitting, perched up on a rock where she was mostly hidden but able to keep an eye on everyone on the battlefield. A communication pad rested in her hand, allowing her to further keep track of everyone that was on the Rebellion side.

* * *

Adora looks out across the battlefield, sighing as her soldiers engage the rebels while she remains back with her officers. It was a pretty typical battle, all things considered, and pretty evenly matched, no Princesses had shown up to spice things up - yet.

"Scorpia," Adora says. "Why did you insist I come to this battle? Nothing is even-" Adora's words die in her throat as she sees her. *Catra* . She feels her heart pick up and blood pump through her veins with renewed excitement and adrenaline. Adora doesn't even bother to say anything else, she simply takes off, her cape swooshing behind her as she goes.

The Rebellion forces avoid her, making it easy for her to catch up to Catra, who currently had her back to her. Adora stops, puts her best and sexiest smirk on her face, before she opens her mouth to greet her. " *Hey Catra~* "

* * *

She had been tracking everything as much as possible with her com-pad, communicating through her earpiece, before she heard the familiar voice that sends heat running through her. Catra turns around, eyes wide and cheeks warming up at the sight of the Horde Lord. "Lord Adora... what are you doing here?" She asks, trying to maintain the neutral expression on her face - though seeing the blonde seemed to set off something inside of her that she hadn't been prepared to deal with.

"Oh, you know, sightseeing." Adora responds casually. "What are you doing here?" *Of course Adora would say that.*

"Monitoring the squad that was sent out." Catra replies, looking away for a moment and placing her com-pad in her lap. She turns to grab a bag beside her, bringing it over and holding it up for Adora. "Here." Adora raises an eyebrow at her and then takes the offered bag.

"Is this... some kind of... trick?" She asks curiously. Catra bites back a comment about how *if* it *was* a trick, Adora took the bag so easily and with no protests and that was pretty dumb of her.

"It's snacks... I told you I'd give you some next time I saw you… and I keep my word if I say I'll do something." Catra reminds her, grabbing her com-pad again. "I had time to cook since everyone wanted me to stand back from the battlefield for a while. They didn't want me to get kidnapped again. Seems they missed you passing through somehow."

Adora stashes the bag away and then looks at Catra again. "So... are you not going to attack me?"

"I mean... you haven't attacked me so..." Catra knows that she really should put the com-pad down and start fighting off the Horde Lord, or at least alert someone of the blonde's presence since she was staying back to be protected. But seeing Adora alone, while everyone else was somewhere where they couldn't see the two, made her choose not to. "Not really a point in fighting when we're alone. Plus, I have to keep track of where the Rebellion soldiers are in case anyone needs backup."

"Unlikely," Adora admits. "my soldiers' performance in this battle is... severely lacking."

"Really? Huh... and what about you?"

"I think you know my performance is *never* lacking."

Catra snorts and rolls her eyes. Catra wonders sometimes if Adora practices her stupid innuendo jokes in the mirror. "I meant, why aren't you fighting?"

"Oh..." Adora shifts a little. "Same," She shrugs. "no one can see us and... you're not attacking me."

"Hm... good to know... so what are you doing here?"

"I saw you and I..." Adora trails off. "Can I kidnap you again?"

" *Huh* ?!" Catra cries out, scandalised at the question that Adora just asked her in the middle of a battle. Also, *who asks someone if they can kidnap you?! Isn't that counterproductive?*

"I just mean... well... you know... I mean... we had so much fun last time and..." Adora clearly doesn't know what she's saying anymore. Catra decides to rescue her.

"Lord Adora... you... you do realise that was supposed to be a one time thing, right?" Catra asks. If she was honest, she was tempted, and she has to catch herself just before she slips up and agrees to Adora's request.

"You know, usually the Lord Adora thing was an insult from you, but now it just reminds me of you begging me to fuck you." Catra's back straightens up, her cheeks softly flushed at those words. She hadn't been expecting *that, at all.* Adora is crass sometimes, but still… she'd managed to catch Catra off guard.

"I told you... it was supposed to be a one time thing... we're enemies, asshole." Catra responds.

"Asshole," Adora sing-songs. "that became an endearing nickname too. Now, it sounds to me like you're *more* than willing to go a second round. ... Even though, technically, we have gone many, *many* , more rounds in the span of three days." Catra takes a deep breath, sighing and massaging her forehead. *Adora can't be serious, surely?*

"We can't do that again, idiot... we're supposed to be enemies, okay?" She repeats, though she had to admit that she was tempted to go back, even if it was just for a night... But she

couldn't, *shouldn't* , be wanting to go back with the enemy. It was wrong.

"Come on Catra," Adora moves closer to her. "you said you'd miss me."

"You... you misheard me." Catra deflects, her cheeks warming at remembering how *awkward* that had been.

"No, I didn't, I remember it quite vividly actually." Adora reaches her hand out, grabbing Catra by her wrist, gently, though if anyone saw them it looked just enough threatening to be considered a normal interaction between them - still, she was taking a risk just to make a little bit of contact with Catra. "You said you'd miss me and then you got really *weird* about it."

"Because I shouldn't be missing you." Catra stops for a moment. "And I don't." She quickly adds. "We can't do that again, Lord Adora. It was a *one time* thing, an agreement for you to release me. I gave you something you wanted in exchange for you letting me go." She says, trying to convince herself of those words. *Even if I was also curious and had the choice to not do it.*

Adora's blue eyes flash for a moment with what looks like hurt but she quickly fixes her expression that Catra can't say for sure. She lets Catra go from her grip and straightens herself up. "Right, a one time agreement. Except, you also said *one night* , but that didn't happen, did it, *Catra* ?" Catra bites the inside of her cheek, looking away for a moment.

Catra moves her eyes, looking around, trying to find anyone else that might see them, before she stands up and grabs Adora's cape. Just as Adora had done before she had left the Fright Zone, she lifts the cape up so they're just out of view and gives Adora a soft kiss on the lips. Adora tenses a little as Catra kisses her before she melts into the soft kiss. "I'll... consider it... for next time we meet. For now... enjoy the snacks."

Catra goes to pull away but Adora's hands quickly grab her by the waist, pulling her back in for another heated kiss. She tightens her hands around Catra, squeezing softly as she kisses her, she licks her way into Catra's mouth, smiling when Catra lets out a soft moan of surprise.

Before things can get *too* good, Adora steps back. "Hm, I will enjoy the snacks. Why don't you enjoy the memory of that kiss?" She winks.

"I... I think I will." Catra whispers, looking up into the soft blues of Adora's eyes. "You should probably get back before someone else sees you... think you can call off the attack for today so everyone can go home?"

"Maybe." Adora says with a small smile.

She steps back, keeping Catra's gaze before she turns her back on her. She whistles loudly, signalling to her troops to fall back and retreat. She takes off back towards wherever it was that she had come from. Catra watches in surprise as Adora does that. She hadn't expected for the blonde to actually go and *listen* to her request. But, then again, she hadn't expected for her to kiss Adora and for Adora to pull her into another kiss afterwards.

And… *had she just told the Horde Lord that she'd consider sleeping with her again? Oh boy, she needed to get those thoughts out of her head now* . Adora was the enemy... but she was sweet, and liked food (other than ration bars), which was why Catra had even cooked something for her in the first place...

Nope, enemy, Catra! Stop being stupid. She reminds herself before turning her attention back to the com-pad and keeping track of the Rebellion soldiers that were beginning to return.

* * *

Scorpia looks curiously at Adora as she whistles and orders for them to retreat. She turns to the soldiers, being Adora's second-in-command, and orders them to return to the Fright Zone in case they hadn't heard. As soon as she was done, and that everyone had been accounted for, she turned and walked over to Adora, standing beside her. "Hey Boss... why are we retreating?

"We weren't making any progress." Adora answers simply. She was *not* about to reveal that she'd done it because Catra had asked her to. No. It was *one hundred percent* her decision. Not *at all* anything to do with Catra. "I don't see the point in wasting energy on a battle that'll

just... not resolve itself." Adora is great at hiding her true motivations to people, and hardly anyone ever questions her - if they do, they're met with a swift reprimand. Scorpia though... she's different. She just hopes Scorpia buys it.

Scorpia beams and nods. "I see! That's a really good strategy, Boss! Saving our energy and resources for when we truly need them! So smart! But..." She pauses, "Where did you get that?" She asks and points at the bag in Adora's hand.

Adora blushes and brushes past Scorpia, climbing up onto her skiff. She takes a long moment to respond, staring at the bag for a long period. "Catra gave me it." She mumbles quietly, hoping Scorpia would miss it.

"She did?" Scorpia asks curiously. *Dammit.* "Wait... you saw her and you didn't come back injured..."

"What's your point?" Adora asks with a scowl. She dislikes people probing her, and her... business.

"No, nothing, Boss. Just amazed. Catra's claws are really sharp after all."

Adora sighs. "... We didn't fight."

"You didn't?"

"No," Adora says, sitting down. She sighs and places the bag between her feet. "She gave me the bag and we... talked..." Adora hates that she feels her cheeks heating up as she remembers the kiss. "Anyway, outstanding orders for any battle, if you know Catra is going to be there, I want to know." Scorpia looks curiously at Adora, obviously seeing the blush on her cheeks but being wise enough to not comment on it.

"Understood, Boss! Should I let the other soldiers know?"

"Yeah," Adora pauses. "listen, *no one* is to harm Catra, under *any* circumstances." Why Adora is giving that order, she chooses not to confront. Catra is her enemy but... Adora flexes her hands. *Nope. Not going to think about that right now.* Adora justifies it as just protecting the chance to be with Catra again. Sex is easier for her to understand than anything else that might be under the surface.

"Yes, Boss! I'll let the soldiers know! Anything else you need for us to do when we get back to the Fright Zone?" Scorpia asks.

"That's everything." Adora says. "And you should drive, I need a minute."

Scorpia nods and takes over the steering of the skiff, leaving Adora to her own devices. Adora looks at the bag and wonders if she should open it now. Catra had said they were snacks. *Should she even trust snacks from the enemy?* What if they were laced with poison or something? Maybe she should let Kyle eat it first. "Hey, uh, Scorp? Do you think it's safe to eat food from a Princess?"

"A Princess? Wait, is that what's in the bag from Catra?" Scorpia asks curiously. "I mean... she doesn't seem like the type to do something as underhanded as to give bad food to someone. She gave you food?"

"Yes, she gave me food, *jeez* , you're acting like she proposed." Turns out, Adora *may* be easily flustered when people point out things to her that Catra has done for her.

"It's just... it's a really nice thing she did. What did she send you? Do you know?"

"I have no idea...." Adora opens the bag to see a handwritten note at the top. She pulls it out to read it:

Hey Adora,

Guess we did end up seeing each other again. Like I said before, I don't go back on my word, so I filled this bag with as many snacks as I could for you to try out. I hope that you enjoy them. I also made you something earlier today, so please try to eat it as soon as possible so that it doesn't go bad.

I hope you enjoy it!

Catra

Right next to Catra's name was a little drawing of herself with a mischievous grin. *It's really cute.* Adora snorts at the note and hands it to Scorpia for her to read. "Princesses are so weird." And yet, Adora couldn't deny that her chest felt... *warm* at Catra's gesture.

"Aww, this was really nice of her to do." Scorpia smiles as she finishes reading the note and hands it back to Adora. "I hope that you enjoy it, Boss."

"I mean... we can share it? If I'm going to die from poison at least you'd die with me, right?" Adora half jokes. She's still not convinced that the food *isn't* poisoned.

"I don't think Catra would poison you, Boss."

"Yeah? Why do you think that?"

"She doesn't seem like the type to do something like that. Plus... when you two were... you know... she could have easily taken advantage of your... state and attacked you when your guard was down. But she didn't." Scorpia explains her thoughts. Scorpia had a point, Catra could've easily done something to her during their little… sexcapade but she didn't.

"Yeah, but I mean... we had an agreement then. That ended when she left." Adora points out. She wonders if Catra ever has thoughts like: *what if the person I had a three day sex fest with has poisoned my food?* Or if that is firmly a messed up, paranoid, Horde soldier thing.

"That's true, but wouldn't she have attacked you now if that was the case?"

"Who knows? Maybe she's still recovering from my sword." Adora laughs at her own joke. Catra totally would've poked her forehead and called her an idiot for that. Scorpia just looks taken aback, blushing at the image that Adora had just brought up.

"Uh... no offence, Boss... but I think a week is more than enough time to recover..."

" *You've* never had my sword." Adora protests. "What is with people trying to beat my ego down with a stick?"

"I wasn't trying to do that!" Scorpia defends, but keeps her claws on the steering stick. "I was just saying that it's possible that Catra could have recovered quickly. Magicats heal quickly, don't they?"

"Yeah... apparently they do." Adora recalls Catra telling her that before. "Let's just go home. I'll eat the food when we get back." Scorpia nods and continues driving to the Fright Zone.

It takes a while for everyone to navigate through the Whispering Woods but thankfully almost everyone makes it back in one piece. "Boss, we're here. I'll deal with the post mission briefing of the soldiers. You go ahead and relax, okay?" Adora nods and takes off to her throne room, knowing no one would disturb her there.

She sits on her throne with the bag and pauses. She runs her finger along the scratches on the armrest of her throne. "Man... really wish she'd taken me up on that offer." Adora mumbles. Catra seemed like she had been tempted. *Maybe not today but maybe another day...*

Adora opens the bag again and starts pulling out the food. She was slightly paranoid but she wasn't about to let it get the better of her. Still, if she was going to die, sex would've been a nice way to go out over poisoned food.

Adora takes a bite of the first item of food and her eyes light up. She doesn't care if it's poisoned, this is the *best* thing she has ever tasted in her *life* (excluding Catra, of course). She starts stuffing her face with food, leaving some when she remembers Scorpia, not wanting to keep this all to herself, but to share it. She laughs a little. This was technically contraband, yet she knew she was going to eat it all anyway. She guesses, Catra has made her somewhat into a rebel.

She knows then that she will absolutely have Catra back in her bed.

Scorpia comes into the throne room a few minutes later after finally dismissing the soldiers to go recuperate after that battle, Adora presumes. "Boss, soldiers have been dismissed and have returned to their duties as per usual."

"Mmm...gwood." Adora swallows the food she had in her mouth and extends the bag to Scorpia. "Scorp, you gotta taste this, it tastes *so good* , I don't even care if I die from it."

"Oh! You're letting me taste it?" Scorpia asks, stepping up towards Adora and taking one of the food items inside. "Thank you, Boss. That was nice of you."

"Man..." Adora says. "When is the next battle?"

"Uh... I think we need to plan it first."

" *Ugh* ... probably."

"Should... we start planning it? Or do you want to finish your food first?"

"No... we can plan it some other time." Adora says dismissively. "... Do you think Catra will be at the next one?" Is Adora being too obvious? She just wants to see Catra again. Sue her.

"I'm not sure, Boss. She was standing pretty far away this time. So I can't really say if she'll be at the next battle." Adora's face falls a little.

"Right... yeah... that makes sense." *Is it bad that Adora is a little disappointed by that?* She shouldn't really be wishing Catra was at battles just because she… she doesn't even know what she really wants, just to *see* Catra at the very least. With how often Adora actually shows emotions around her soldiers (almost never), it was probably really easy for Scorpia to notice how her expression had fallen.

"But... maybe she will be. She's not one to back down." Scorpia says to try to cheer her up.

"That's true at least." Adora says. Catra is most definitely not one to sit back while everyone else does the work. She's almost always usually in the thick of the battle, the Rebellion were being cautious after Adora had kidnapped her, but that wouldn't last forever. Adora sighs. "You can have the rest of the food." Adora stands from her throne and dusts herself down. "I need to rest after the battle..."

"Are you sure?! Catra gave this to you as a gift. I can't just take all of it." Scorpia looks shocked but quickly shakes her head.

"It's no problem," Adora says dismissively. "Really, I'm sure Catra would actually be happy I *shared* something." Scorpia's eyes sparkle and she nods gratefully, taking the leftover food.

"Thank you, Boss. I hope you get some good rest."

"Uh... yeah..." Adora says - because she was definitely *not* going to do *something else* while thinking of Catra. "You too."

"Thank you!" Scorpia nods and excuses herself from the throne room, making sure to hide the bag as much as possible before heading to her own room, leaving Adora alone once again.

Adora turns to her throne for a moment. She runs her finger along the claw marks on the armrest of her throne as Scorpia's footsteps fade into the background. She's brought back to the evening that Catra left and what Catra had said to her. That had been... weird. Catra had said she'd miss her before backtracking on it. Adora had admitted she'd miss fucking her, but missing someone and missing being fucked by them are completely different things... maybe Catra didn't mean it like that. .. *yeah...* there was no way Catra was actually going to miss her... *right?*

But then… Adora couldn't stop thinking about Catra. She hadn't been touched like that in a very long time and she… *shit* , maybe she did miss it. Not Catra. But the *intimacy* , the touching, not feeling lonely… Catra had been great company at least, she seemed genuinely interested in hearing whatever Adora had to say and, between all the sex, they'd had conversations like… well, almost like *friends* . Which was confusing.

Adora could do sex, she could do pleasure, but she couldn't do friendship or feelings - or anything close to that. She's pretty sure she's entirely broken in that area anyway. She has never been loved by anyone, and she's pretty certain she can never love anyone, or anything, after… She balls her hand into a fist. *Unloveable. Unloving.* Not that Catra was in love with her, or Adora with her, no, they were more in *lust* if anything, but, still, there was *something* about Catra - Adora almost didn't care that Catra was a Princess. That was slightly terrifying.

She retreats back to her quarters and touches herself to the thought of Catra. She cums calling the Princess' name and she wonders, not for the first time, if something had changed that she just couldn't see yet.

Chapter End Notes

These bitches gay, good for them. Hope you all enjoyed the softness! This was a really cute and gay chapter to write because pining. Love these gay babes. -M

Guess Adora is expanding her taste beyond just pussy and ration bars ;) Thank y'all for reading and I'm really excited for you all to read chapter 5 (spoiler, it can only get gayer) -S

P.S. C'yra is Catra's mom based on the 80's She-Ra (C'yra of D'riluth III) Luna is Catra's other mom that we named ourselves :) Yes Catra has two moms because we said so.

Enemies with Benefits

Chapter Summary

"The last time?" Adora frowns. "No... I don't think it will be."

"And why exactly do you say that? I told you, this was risky enough as it is the first time."

"Easy," Adora grins. "I'm irresistible."

"No, you're not."

"Ouch, you hurt my feelings."

"Oh, stop whining, you baby."

Chapter Notes

Happy Friday Everyone :)! Coming at y'all with another update, this is another chunky boi and we hope you all enjoy.

Warning, NSFW ahead and implied/referenced child abuse

See the end of the chapter for more notes

Scorpia had noticed that her boss looked… more sour than usual - though it only seemed to happen when she thought that no one was looking at her. However, being Adora's right hand, she was able to see her reactions to things first hand and it was making her sad to see her best friend look so down.

She considers what could possibly be causing her to be so upset before it strikes her! *The reason why her best friend was so sad was because Princess Catra wasn't here with her!* She had been told by the other soldiers about how they had noticed Lord Adora escorting Catra as though she was someone incredibly close to her, and that they were spotted on the outside cameras, being covered by her boss' cape, doing *something* before Catra left on a skiff.

A big smile began to form on her face. She knew *exactly* what she needed to do to get Adora's frown to turn upside down. She needed to bring Catra back to see her. But how would she do that? Catra was with the Rebellion after all. It wasn't as though she could simply walk to Bright Moon, or Half-Moon, and ask Catra to come with her. That would be a surefire way for her to get captured by the Rebellion and then her best friend would be down a right-hand woman!

"I got it!" Scorpia whisper-yells to herself. She had the perfect idea, inspired by Adora's own previous plan. She would need to kidnap Catra again for Adora! All she needed was a few willing and brave Horde soldiers to help her out.

Adora may not want to admit it, but Scorpia *knows* that she's missing Catra. Scorpia just wanted Adora to feel better and if that meant kidnapping Catra (again) then she was more than willing to do it. Besides, Adora had been more relaxed after spending time with Catra, she was slowly slipping back into a snippy attitude and snapping at the troops. This would be good for morale for everyone, not just Adora. Scorpia was also semi-confident that Catra would be more than okay with being kidnapped given the fact that she had given Adora a bag of treats.

*Yeah, this was a **great** pan.*

* * *

Catra sighs. Another battle against the Horde. The Rebellion were still keeping her in reserve, like Catra couldn't handle herself. She loves her friends and family but sometimes their caring borders on being overbearing. Yes, she had been kidnapped but… she hadn't exactly been a prisoner. Lying was starting to make her feel bad. All of her friends cared *so much* , her moms had been worried beyond belief and, to top it all off, she'd been mandated *therapy* to deal with any PTSD she may have from the event - like Catra hadn't spent her three days as a 'prisoner' of the Horde fucking their Lord. *How the hell do you tell your therapist that you spent three days fucking the Horde Lord? You don't.* It didn't help that Perfuma was trying to get her to 'meditate' because all that meant was that Catra thought about Adora.

That was another issue that Catra had. She couldn't *stop* thinking about Adora. She couldn't stop thinking about her offer either, her offer to 'kidnap' her again and for them to spend time together, *again.* Her friends and family would flip if she was taken but… Catra was *beyond* tempted. She'd spent a lot of time thinking about it. Not just the being with Adora part - although she had thought about that *a lot* - but she'd also thought about how they could keep seeing each other and it *not* be suspicious. Catra could get 'kidnapped' and return soon so

that her friends didn't come storming the castle so to speak. But then the issue was that someone was bound to notice if Catra kept getting 'kidnapped'.

Have you ever done something you knew was wrong but just you couldn't stop yourself from still doing it?

That's what Adora is to Catra. She's Catra's dirty little secret. She's like a guilty *pleasure* . Catra knows she shouldn't keep seeing her yet she just can't seem to help herself. The sex is pretty amazing if Catra was being honest and Adora… Adora isn't at all who Catra thought she was. In fact, Catra even *liked* her. She was kind, and beautiful, and funny, and soft, and a huge fucking dork. She wasn't like anything Catra had thought she was.

Catra was so deep in her thoughts she hadn't even noticed the Horde soldiers who had somehow surrounded her. Her ears twitch and she looks up from her com-pad to see about five Horde soldiers surrounding her. She sighs and sets the pad to one side. "I'd really prefer not fighting you guys." Catra complains.

"We have orders to capture you and bring you back to the Fright Zone." *Orders? Adora?? Surely Adora would have come herself if that were true.*

"Yeah, no, I don't think so." The soldiers rush her and Catra curses them. If Adora wanted to kidnap her again so badly she could at least give a girl a warning. Catra struggles a little, Adora's soldiers are a little heavy handed for her liking but ultimately… She wants to see Adora too.

A soldier ties her wrists a little *too* tight and Catra hisses. Her ears press back against her head and she extends her claws in warning. The soldiers seem to take that as a threat and one of them pulls a stun baton on her. *Okay! She is about to kick these guys' ass, Adora be damned.*

"Hey!" Catra's growling ceases and her ears perk up at the familiar voice she hears come through one of the soldier's earpiece. "Lord Adora gave strict orders not to harm Catra and so did I!"

“Force Captain Scorpia.” One of the soldiers says. “The Princess has been secured, we’re beginning the extraction now.”

“Good, take her right to Lord Adora’s throne room when you get here, understood? She wants to see Catra.” *So this **was** Adora’s plan?*

“Yes, ma’am.” The soldier says. Catra frowns but she allows herself to be taken by the soldiers only so she can see her Horde Lord again. Catra sighs. She really was in the thick of it now.

* * *

Adora sighs dramatically, she knew her troops were out fighting a battle currently which meant there wasn’t much for her to be doing. She didn’t go to every battle, though she did attempt to attend as many as possible, if Adora wasn’t willing to risk herself for the Horde’s mission, then why should she expect her men to do the same? The only negative about sitting a battle out now was that Adora didn’t get to see Catra.

She hadn’t stopped thinking about Catra since she last saw her. Sure, she could think about their time together while she was having… a private session, but it just wasn’t the same. She didn’t miss Catra, no, but she did miss having sex with her - *definitely*. They were really good together like that. Adora trails her finger along the claw marks on her throne. She wishes Catra were here now.

"Hey Adora." Catra walks into the throne room, wrists tied together, and Adora’s head snaps up. "What am I doing here?" *What **was** she doing here?* Adora hadn’t ordered this and, even if she had just been thinking about Catra, she doubts she has the imagination to just… conjure Catra from thin air. She hadn’t been expecting to hear that voice *at all* , and her obvious surprise is clear to see on her face. She sits up on her throne a little.

" *Catra* ?! What... who... how...?"

"You didn't plan this?" Catra asks. *Fuck. She looks so good.* Catra has always looked good but there’s something about her that just… *calls* to Adora. She is incapable of *not* noticing

Catra - even at a crowded Princess Ball. They're like opposite ends of a magnet - Adora's attraction to Catra was as strong as that - they always seemed to find each other.

"No!" Adora pauses. "I mean... not really, not *now* , I planned on *maybe* 'kidnapping' you again in the future." Adora had been thinking about that a lot actually. She had been dying to get in some extra alone time with Catra, away from the prying eyes of everyone, but she hadn't planned *this*. She was a little thrown if she was honest, she disliked being caught off guard, but if it meant she got to see Catra and spend time with her? Adora could forgive being in the dark on this.

"So... you didn't plan this? Because your soldiers just kind of tossed me in here and I really thought it was you. Also... can you get me out of this?" Catra lifts her hands up, holding out her tied up wrists. Adora sits back in her throne with a smirk - Adora had mastered the art of 'man-spreading' too.

"I don't know Kitten, I rather like seeing you tied up."

"Look, I get that you're being kinky. But whoever tied this, tied it too tight. Pretty sure my wrists are bruised now." Catra grumbles. "So get this off please." Adora could stand to see Catra tied up a little more, but she didn't like to cause her unnecessary pain.

"Come here," Adora pats her thigh in invitation. Catra walks over to her and sits down on her lap. She extends her wrists to Adora.

"Off."

"So demanding," Adora responds playfully. She begins untying Catra's wrists, rubbing them gently before pressing soft kisses to them. "Better?" She asks. Catra blushes at her and looks at Adora softly before she nods a little.

"Yeah... thanks..." She murmurs before she nuzzles Adora's cheek in greeting. "Well... I'm already here..." Adora laughs.

"Yeah? Figured you got yourself caught on purpose. Did you miss me Kitten?" Adora teases.

"I did *not* get myself caught on purpose, thank you very much." Catra pouts. "I got ambushed."

"Really? Did they hurt you?" Adora's voice drops a little, with an *edge* to it. Low, like whatever Catra said next could trigger a whole host of responses.

"Not too bad. Just some bruising."

"I told them not to hurt you *at all* ." Adora frowns, deeply. She was going to have to have a 'talk' with Catra's 'kidnappers'. No one disobeyed their Lord and, if they did, they should be punished - *especially* if they hurt *Catra* . Adora focuses her attention back on the woman.

"It was an accident. I'm okay. I think they were just worried that I would end up fighting back and running off." Catra shrugs. Adora purses her lips. Beyond the irritation to her wrists, she did look unharmed if a little ruffled. Adora gently rubs her thumb against Catra's wrist absentmindedly.

"Why didn't you?" Adora questions. Catra is *fast* , Adora knows from experience. If she didn't want to be captured she wouldn't be here right now. The only reason Adora had been able to capture Catra at Princess Prom was her use of Scorpia and her venom: not to mention a very tactical plan, a huge distraction and luring Catra to chase her. *So much effort for one Princess.* Still, that had gotten her *here* and Adora wasn't about to complain about that.

"I figured since they said Scorpia ordered it that it had something to do with you." Catra says. Adora freezes.

"Wait." Adora blinks. "Scorpia ordered it?"

"Yeah. She said that you wanted to see me." Adora's mouth falls open a little. *Why would Scorpia expose her like that? Was this what betrayal felt like? No, Adora has experienced*

betrayal before and it didn't feel like this . Still, she would have to have a talk with Scorpia about keeping their private conversations *private* .

"She *what* ?!" Adora just couldn't help but express her shock at the fact that Scorpia had exposed her like that.

"That's what she said... did you not?" Catra asks. Adora looks at her. Catra looks… like if Adora says no, then that would probably hurt her. She looks hopeful. Pensive? Adora has never been good at pinning down how someone feels.

"Well... I..." Adora looks away for a moment. "I wouldn't mind getting some time in between your legs."

"You... you are such a dork."

"A dork you've slept with, *repeatedly* ." Adora pauses. "And I am *not* a dork." She's aware that she admitted to being a dork and then denied it but that is neither here nor there. Adora stops pouting when she hears that *cute* laugh of Catra's.

"You really are. Now, are you gonna carry me off to your room or not? Also, did you enjoy the food?" Catra smiles while looking curiously at Adora.

"Why go to my room when my throne is perfectly fine for what we have in mind?" Adora shrugs. She wouldn't mind expanding her claw collection on her throne. "And I did... I thought you might have poisoned it, yet here I am."

"Poisoned? You really thought I would do that?" Catra frowns. "I'm not that mean."

"You can't blame me for being paranoid. I grew up in the *Horde* . Honestly, I wouldn't put it past Shadow Weaver to poison my food and make it some sort of mission to find the antidote before I died." She really wouldn't put that past Shadow Weaver. She used to love pushing Adora to her extremes - trying to *break* her.

"That's... really fucked up." Catra looks horrified, frowning deeply. "I'm sorry you had to go through that..."

Adora looks away for a moment. She supposes, to someone like Catra, that would seem bad. Her hands squeeze Catra softly. "It wasn't as bad as it sounds."

"That's really bad, Adora..."

"Ha. To *you* , maybe." Adora says dismissively. "You're a Princess."

"That's bad to anyone! You shouldn't have to be wary of being poisoned!" Catra cries out, clearly upset. Adora doesn't understand why it's so upsetting, it's just how things are growing up in the Horde. Well… that's not exactly true. Adora doubts every Horde soldier had the pleasure of being Shadow Weaver's *special* project.

"Shadow Weaver was my superior officer, she had to make sure I was... ready." Adora explains. "She'd attack me in the middle of the night so I was always prepared for battle... led to a habit of sleep fighting actually. It doesn't matter anyway, Shadow Weaver is... not a problem anymore." Sometimes Adora *still* wakes up in the middle of the night, her fight or flight mode activated and herself covered in a sheen of sweat. The first time Shadow Weaver had done it, Adora had failed miserably, she made sure to never fail again after that.

"That's so fucked up, Adora." Catra whispers, hugging the blonde gently. "I'm sorry that you had to go through that." Again, Adora doesn't understand why Catra is so upset. Maybe Shadow Weaver's methods were… heavy handed but it got her *here* : leader of the Horde. Not that Adora was under the misguided impression that Shadow Weaver cared about her. She had thought she had, at one point, thought she loved her like a mom should love their kid, but all Adora was to Shadow Weaver was a pawn. She used her strength, her *power* , for herself and Adora realised that too late.

"... I don't know why you're sorry. It prepared me for... life." Adora says dismissively, trying (unsuccessfully) to stop thinking about Shadow Weaver.

"No... it didn't." Adora frowns and looks at Catra, perplexed.

"Yes it did. I'm a soldier. I was raised to be one." That, at least, is true. Adora is a soldier through and through, she was raised to be and she *was* .

"It literally just made you paranoid, but okay..." Adora frowns at that.

"I prefer the term *cautious* ." Even Adora knew that Catra was right. She *was* paranoid. Cautious was just another word for that. Sometimes she got wildly irrational paranoid thoughts like: what if Catra was just using her to spy on the Horde? Or such things like that. She couldn't help it, if Shadow Weaver knew she was sleeping with Catra, and was still here to do something about it, Adora would probably get a 'time out' - meaning she'd probably be locked in a Horde solitude cell. Adora shudders.

"I suppose..." Catra sighs and shakes her head. "Do you... want to just sit here for a while?"

"And do what? Talk?" Adora asks.

"Sure. Anything you wanna talk about?"

"No." Adora states. "You?" Adora is aware she's coming off like a little bit of an asshole but Shadow Weaver always makes her feel a little… *weird? Off? Conflicted? All of the above?* She just needs to relax a little and let *Catra* take the distaste Shadow Weaver left in her mouth away.

"You didn't tell me if you enjoyed the food I made. Or rather... How much did you enjoy it?"

"I enjoyed it. It was nice... different... Thank you." Adora doesn't really do thank yous but it comes out naturally anyway.

"I'm glad... you're welcome." Catra smiles and purrs softly. "So... how was your day today?"

"... why are you asking me things? Aren't you just here for sex?" *A little blunt there Adora* . But she is confused. Usually they're already tearing each other's clothes off by now. They're *enemies,* Adora didn't exactly think they'd just… *talk* like this - Adora doesn't even do that with people who *aren't Catra* .

"I mean... I'm here, we have some time." Catra responds. Adora can't tell if her question pissed Catra off or not. Adora doesn't really get it but she shrugs and answers Catra anyway.

"It was fine. Slow. I wasn't expecting you. How was your day?" Adora asks. Things feel a little awkward suddenly and Adora isn't sure why.

"It was okay, until I got tackled. But good now that we're kind of snuggling." Adora shifts and moves, wiggling her holster for her sword off. She moves it to one side so she can pull Catra closer and more comfortably against her.

"You're nice to cuddle, I'll admit that." Adora confesses.

"You like cuddling me?" Catra asks and purrs softly, closing her eyes. It's cute. Catra is probably the cutest person on Etheria if Adora is honest. "You're actually pretty comfortable, even with all this armour." Adora smiles a little at that.

"You have soft fur, you purr and you're super warm. Of course I like cuddling you." Adora says and she means all of that. Catra's soft fur and warmth makes her amazing to cuddle and sometimes the purring tickles but Adora loves it.

"That's gay." Catra responds with a sly grin.

"Wh-" Adora stutters. "You-" Adora rolls her eyes. She feels that *thing* in her chest again and she does what she always does when she's confused or confronted by it: she distracts herself with sex.

She kisses Catra on her neck and uses her *teeth* . Usually, Adora is careful not to leave marks on Catra's neck, but this time, she sucks a little *too* hard, right on Catra's pulse point. Catra moans softly and pinches Adora's arm. "Hey... don't do that, idiot. You're gonna leave a mark that I'm gonna have to explain."

"It's not fair I can't mark you where others can see it." Adora pouts, though she soothes Catra's skin where she sucked a little too hard.

"That's because I technically shouldn't even be here right now, Adora." She huffs, poking Adora on her cheek. "So no marks anywhere people can see."

"Do you not have any *other* lovers, you can blame it on?" Adora is fishing, she admits.

"I don't. I don't exactly have time for lovers like that. Mainly because of you, dummy." Catra replies. Adora has to admit that something about being Catra's *only* lover is extremely satisfying to her.

"Because of me?" Adora asks. "I'm surprised you don't have any others." Adora mumbles as she puts her lips back to Catra's throat, careful not to mark her this time.

"Mmm... yeah? Why?" Catra melts into Adora as soon as her lips touch her skin again. "Like I said... I don't have time... too busy, you know... putting all my attention into countering you, dummy."

"Countering me, huh?" Adora leans back with a smug grin. Catra hasn't really been 'countering' Adora recently - unless you count them ending up in the same bed as countering. "And... you're a Princess, do you not get courted by other dumb Princesses?" Catra rolls her eyes at that and sticks her tongue out.

"I'm not saying I don't. I just never had the time to deal with them... nor did I really want to."

"There's no way any of them are a match for me." Adora wasn't jealous, she was just the best - she figured Catra should know that no one other than her was a match for her.

"Hmm... you do realise you aren't courting me, right? I just don't have enough time for marriage and relationships. Not until this... the whole war ends, at least."

"I'm not courting you." Adora says, her eyes widening a little at the mere thought of that. *Adora? Courting? That's a dumb Princess thing.* "But still, they couldn't match me." Adora moves her fingers along Catra's arm and presses her lips to her jaw. "No one could ever know what makes you *tick* like me." Adora says, voice low. "No one could *satisfy* you like I do."

"I know you're not courting me, idiot..." Catra rolls her eyes. "I'm saying... that their intentions are for marriage purposes. Not like this... what we're doing now. I don't have time for what they want." She presses her lips together. "Shut your cocky ass up, Adora." Adora laughs. Adora *is* cocky but it works for her… most of the time.

"Marriage?" Adora asks, ignoring the cocky comment. "I don't even know what that is."

"It's... how do I explain this... marriage is the officiating of a relationship between two or more people. Sometimes it can be because those people are in love and sometimes it's for political purposes... does that make sense?" Now, if you asked Adora, that sounded pretty *dumb* to her but marriage isn't exactly a *thing* in the Fright Zone so she supposes that that's not unexpected.

Adora frowns. "Wait so... why aren't you married to that Sparkle Princess?"

" *Huh* ?! To *Glimmer* ?!" Catra cackles. "Gosh no, that would be weird. She's like family."

"Yeah but… you said it doesn't have to be about love." Adora says, blushing a little. *Why are you blushing? Get a grip Adora.* "Isn't Glimmer like... a Princess of one of the biggest Kingdoms, along with yours? Wouldn't that make good political sense?" It makes sense to Adora. Bright Moon and Half-Moon are two of the biggest Kingdoms, it would make sense for them to have a friendship confirmed in marriage as Catra had said.

"As if. Glimmer's mom is basically my aunt. So it wouldn't be necessary." Catra grins. "Why? Are you jealous?" She teases.

"*No*! Why would I be jealous?! Of Sparkle Princess? Please." Adora huffs. *She's not jealous. Absolutely not. Definitely not. Totally… completely… **not**. Adora doesn't even know what jealousy is. Ha! Her? Jealous?*

"Awww, if it makes you feel any better, I've never done any of *this* with Glimmer." Catra says.

"Really? Never?" Adora can hear her happiness in her voice at finding out that piece of information and is sure Catra won't have missed it either. Adora is also kind of surprised if she's honest, she kind of figured Catra *may* have been with Glimmer before.

"Yup. Really." Catra pops the 'p' on her yup.

"Have you ever done this with *any* other Princess?" Adora asks. She doesn't know why, she doesn't even know if she really wants to *know* the answer to that question or not, but she asks it anyway.

"Hmm...you mean as far as we've gone?"

"Doing anything..."

"Hmm… Maybe I have." Catra looks at her claws, picking at them. Adora's jaw almost hits the ground at that.

" *Maybe* ?! Who?"

"And why do you need to know that?" Adora falters at the question. It’s not that she’s jealous, it’s just that she *needs* (*wants?*) to know.

“Because… because… I want to know?” Adora replies, though it sounds more like a question than an answer.

"Uh huh... I don't think you need to know that, sir." Catra purrs, giggling at Adora’s fumbling. Adora does love that Catra calls her sir, so she’ll forgive her for giggling at her.

Adora rolls her eyes and plays with the waistband of Catra's pants. "I guess I'm wondering who my competition is." Adora says. "I mean," She slips her hand below the waistband of Catra's pants. "can they touch you like *I* touch you?" Adora wiggles her eyebrows playfully as she presses her fingers over Catra’s underwear.

"I told you... I don't have time for any of that because of you, dumbass..." Catra grumbles fondly, biting her lip when Adora's hand slips inside her pants. "You're going pretty fast there, Blondie."

"My hand is cold." Adora says with a mischievous smile. "You don't have time to... have sex?"

"I don't have time for relationships... in general. Even if my moms want me to find someone." Catra says with an eye roll. "Technically no, but I'm already here with your hand down my pants, might as well keep going."

"Your moms want you to find someone?" Adora raises a brow. *What the hell did that mean?*

"It's a traditional thing... but yeah."

"What do you mean 'traditional thing'?"

"Well... Magicats tend to choose mates when they start getting into their twenties and… I've been delaying as much as possible... but they want me to find someone before I take over as Queen one day so I can have the support I need." Catra shrugs.

"That's so... dumb." Adora says.

"Maybe... it's with good intentions though. Being Queen is a stressful job, so they want me to have someone that can help me when I'm overwhelmed. I just... don't think it's the time for me to be thinking about that with everything that's going on." Catra explains. Adora pulls a face. That doesn't make any sense to her.

"Being Lord of the Horde is stressful, you don't see me shacking up with someone."

"Oh shush, it's not the same."

"How is it not the same? I mean, I'm no Princess, but the Fright Zone is basically my Kingdom." Adora argues. Maybe she just doesn't like the idea of Catra getting… married.

"Adora..." Catra sighs and pinches the bridge of her nose. "You... it's a lot more complicated because we deal with more people than you have here and have to deal with Inter-Kingdom relations."

"Again, sounds dumb."

"Of course you think that."

"It is," Adora argues. "Why do you need to care about other kingdoms? They shouldn't matter. And more people? You should try the fear tactic, that way, people don't get uppity."

"The reason why we care is because we want things to be peaceful. We have to be careful to not overstep and start an argument. Fear is not the same as allyship and loyalty." Adora rolls

her eyes.

"It's stupid and inefficient, how can you even be considered a Queen if you're worrying about upsetting people?" Adora asks. She's pretty sure she's right on this but Catra is giving Adora *that look.*

"Because I need to make sure that my people are safe, and okay, and can live happy lives in my Kingdom." Catra frowns, looking directly into Adora's eyes. "Look, can we just change the subject? Because obviously we're not gonna see eye to eye on any of this. You only want me for sex anyways." Adora balks at that.

"You only want me for sex too." Adora points out. "You want to know why people here fear me so much?"

"Why? *Please* do share why anyone would be afraid of your dorky ass." Catra raises an eyebrow, crossing her arms as she waits for Adora's answer. Adora shakes her head fondly and then a shadow crosses her features.

She hadn't been expecting to reveal this to Catra, especially after they'd only *technically* spent one night together - even if it had been over the course of three days. But she also… she *enjoyed* talking to Catra, even if they were bickering, or simply just existing around each other, she felt a *connection* to her. She figures she might as well tell her.

"Because I took Hordak out. Killed him. Not that I meant to... it was the first time I transformed as She-Ra. I couldn't control her... Shadow Weaver... she'd told me to do it, told me... horrible things Hordak had done." Adora swallows. "She made me use her... and... I lost control. Sometimes, when I get angry, I can feel her, itching under my skin… *She-Ra* . And then Shadow Weaver, when I realised she lied to me, I... I removed her. As me. As Adora. That's how I got my scar on my eye, it was from her." Adora looks grim as she takes a little breath. "So people are afraid of me. And I have *never* used She-Ra ever again." Adora looks to Catra who was studying her very carefully. Adora would give anything to hear what she was thinking.

She hadn't meant to kill Hordak. She had been a fresh eighteen year old and recently discovered she was a Princess and she had some magic sword that, *whoosh,* put her in a tiara. Shadow Weaver had told Adora that Hordak was a bad leader, that he got cadets killed and

that he was the reason Adora had ended up where she was - she blamed Hordak for everything. And Adora was inclined to believe that to be true.

Ever since she took over as Horde Lord, the Horde has improved not just in battle but also in overall soldier wellness. Adora is never unnecessarily cruel, she can be hard, and she can be irritable, but she would never punish cadets like Shadow Weaver and Hordak did. Her cadets are afraid of her, sure, it's easier for Adora to keep her distance that way, but there was a reason that defectors were so rare under Adora than under Hordak. She actually cared. Any Force Captains like Shadow Weaver or Octavia were removed, *never* innocent cadets who were suffering at the hands of abusive superiors. The Horde wasn't perfect, Adora knew that, and she couldn't manage *everything* , which was why she had people she trusted like Scorpia, but she was *nothing* like Hordak or Shadow Weaver. Yes, her goal was the same, and she believed what Hordak had told her about the Princesses, but she didn't believe that her soldiers were just expendable - she *cared.*

"... They're afraid of you because you took out the person that caused the most damage to Etheria in the entirety of the Horde's existence? Really?" Catra asks, looking at Adora completely *unafraid* . "If anything, that makes you a better person for getting rid of him. He was seriously horrible. And I'm sorry that Shadow Weaver tricked you... it's a bad thing in itself. But at least you get to make your own choices now and run things your own way." Catra nuzzles Adora's cheek to try to soothe her, trying to get her to relax - *it works.* “I imagine your soldiers were actually grateful to no longer have to deal with Hordak or Shadow Weaver..."

Adora laughs, relaxing a little. Catra wasn’t afraid of her, that’s all that mattered to her. She nuzzles Catra back. "I guess I might be different to Hordak and Shadow Weaver. Apparently to Scorpia, I'm simply grumpy and broody."

"Yeah, I can see it. You were quite grumpy when we first met. I remember that." Catra teases, kissing Adora's forehead. "I also remember you getting quite grumpy when I insulted your ego at Princess Prom." Adora scowls a little - only a little, and it’s accompanied by a small amused smile.

"You were mean."

"And you were being an asshole, as you usually are." Catra fires back.

"Yeah, well, an asshole with a great ass according to you."

"Hmm... I did say that. You really do have a great ass." Catra laughs, squeezing Adora on her thigh.

"My ass *is* pretty great." Adora says with a wide grin. "Your *everything* is great."

"You think so?" Catra grins, purring softly. Adora licks her lips.

"Yeah, although... I do really like your boobs." She does. She *loves* Catra's boobs. She could die right between those bad boys and be happy and satisfied. She liked boobs, sue her. All boobs are good boobs. And Catra's were perfect, in fact, her mouth was watering even just thinking about them.

"I did notice you wanted to pay an extensive amount of attention to my boobs last time I was here, yes." Catra says with an eye roll.

"They're amazing." Adora responds and she really does mean it.

"You wanna show me how amazing they are?" Catra raises an eyebrow, looking expectantly at the blonde.

Adora smiles and moves her hand that was still in Catra's pants. She wiggles her eyebrows playfully. "I mean, I do enjoy being buried inside of you too."

"I've also noticed that." Catra hums. She grabs Adora's wrist and carefully guides her hand out of her pants. Adora resists the urge to pout. "So... bedroom?"

"Bedroom?" Adora asks. "Don't want to use my throne?"

"I think, for the sake of my back, your bed might be better. Plus we can cuddle afterwards."

"Is cuddling important to you?"

"I... enjoy it. And you seemed to enjoy it too last time I was here..." Adora kisses Catra on her forehead. She does enjoy cuddling Catra (like she mentioned before: fur, warmth, purr) so she is more than willing to take Catra to her bed.

Adora grabs her sword and then gives it to Catra. "Hold onto that for me." She stands with Catra in her arms and then takes off towards her room.

Catra holds her sword and purrs at the gentle kiss Adora gives her. She giggles as Adora lifts her up with ease. Catra always did like it when she lifted her but… Catra is looking at her… a little differently? Adora isn't sure how to explain it.

When they get to Adora's room, Adora places Catra down on her bed. She takes her sword back and places it by the bedside and then joins Catra on the bed. "Remember the last time you were in here and I got you to cum in under five minutes?"

"I remember that pretty damn clearly..."

"You inflate my ego more than you put it down." Adora mumbles. She presses a finger to the hickey on Catra's neck. "... You're gonna have to explain that." Catra's eyes widen and she lifts a hand to her neck.

"You left a mark?" Adora gives Catra a little apologetic smile.

"... Just one..."

"Oh geez... and don't give me that face." Catra facepalms. "This is gonna be fun explaining when I go home."

"Do they know you've been... kidnapped?"

"Uh... I think so."

Adora snorts. "Wow... good luck explaining that then." Adora says. She slips her hands under Catra's shirt and runs them up her sides. She lowers her voice. " *The Horde Lord* gave it to me." She winks a little as she turns her hands, digging her fingers in Catra's shirt before she pulls it up and off.

"I can't ever say that…" Catra whispers. She grabs Adora's hair and pulls out the tie holding her ponytail up. "Stop being an idiot." She pushes Adora down onto the bed, straddling her hips. She leans down, lips attaching to Adora's throat and she kisses softly where Adora's pulse was. She purrs against the curve of Adora's neck before sucking and leaving a mark of her own. Adora is *thoroughly* turned on by the whole thing. " *Mine* ... isn't that right, sir?"

Adora's eyes had widened as she had landed with her back against the mattress. Catra manhandling her like that had… seriously done something for her. She rests her hands on Catra's thighs, her thumbs caressing her hips. Adora laughs as Catra's purr tickles her throat. "Yours? You're *mine* ."

"And you're mine. You said so yourself, babe."

"That was an error in judgement." Adora says, pushing herself up a little. "Again, I belong to no one. But you, you belong to *me* ."

"Nope. You said it, you can't take it back now." Catra pouts, sitting up in Adora's lap. "Otherwise I won't be yours either." Adora wraps her arms around Catra's waist and flips their positions.

"Are we really fighting in the bedroom?" Adora laughs a little. *Of course* they have to fight for dominance even when they're not on the battlefield.

“Yup, we're fighting until you admit you're also mine."

"Do you want me to be yours, Kitten?" Adora asks as she lowers herself down to Catra's chest. She starts kissing Catra’s exposed skin, sucking and nibbling in places. Catra's breath hitches and she arches into Adora's touch. Adora will never get tired of how Catra reacts to her soft lips touching her skin - it made them both feel as though they were being set aflame in the best of ways.

Catra wraps her arms around Adora's head, bringing her in, clearly wanting her closer, and Adora is more than eager to comply. "Yes... you're mine, Adora..."

"We're going to have to agree to disagree." Adora hums against Catra's skin. "You are so fucking hot... whoever you marry will be... extremely lucky." Adora says that… begrudgingly. Catra is the most beautiful person Adora has ever laid eyes on, but she dislikes the idea of her being with other people - it leaves a sour taste in her mouth.

"Sure..." Catra sighs and relaxes against Adora. "I'm probably not gonna get married..."

"Why's that?" Adora asks, pausing.

"Just... haven't found the one. Even with my moms' attempts to set me up." Adora laughs.

"Aw... you're *such* a Princess."

"No shit. Pretty sure I was a Princess last time I checked." Catra lets out an exasperated laugh. "You're annoying, Lord Dork." Adora really doesn’t know why people suddenly feel like she’s a dork? She has *never* been a dork.

"I just mean, *'the one'* ? Really?" Adora asks, a little teasingly but also… tensely. She hopes 'the one' stays away until they've had their fill of each other - though Adora isn't sure she'd enjoy sucking on someone else's boobs, or tasting someone else's pussy, more than Catra's.

"Or at least someone I... can actually see myself loving one day."

"And you haven't met them yet?" Adora asks curiously.

"I don't know... probably not."

"You don't know?" Adora asks. She brings her hand up to gently squeeze at Catra's right breast.

" *Hnn* ... no... I don't know... I've never... found someone that made me feel like I've... *clicked* with them, if that makes sense."

"I've never really thought about it before." Adora confesses as she takes Catra's breast in her mouth. She sucks softly on her nipple, her hot tongue pressed to the sensitive area while her eyes gaze up at Catra. Although Adora's eyes were blue, they were *burning* with desire.

She wasn't lying when she said she hadn't really thought about that stuff before, she hadn't, she wasn't one to believe in love at first sight, and other fairytale nonsense, but she did often think about being between Catra's legs like she was right now.

Catra moans, tangling her fingers in Adora's hair, she pulls Adora in to encourage her to keep going - she's more than happy to. "I love it when you do that..." She whispers, her voice low and breathy - it's incredibly *sexy* . "Adora... keep going... get me wet and then remind me who I belong to..." Adora smirks against Catra.

Most of the marks Adora had left had faded, if not completely disappeared, which she just couldn't have. She sets about her rigorous routine of marking Catra's torso, focusing especially on her boobs. Again, it was her favourite place to be. Sure, she enjoyed being

between Catra's legs, and buried inside of her with her tongue, fingers, or sword, but her boobs... Adora was a boob gal, who could blame her? Maybe they were on the smaller side, but they were perky and soft and Adora could bury her face there and die for all she cared - she really couldn't stress more just how much she loved Catra's boobs.

Once she's done with one side, she moves to the other; meticulous and precise, everything Adora does is that - even in the bedroom. Once she's done with Catra's boobs (although, *is she ever really done with them?*) she moves to her stomach, kissing her and biting. She drags her blunt nails down her sides to add extra stimulation. She repeats *'mine'* over and over again between kisses and sucking and biting.

"Yours..." Catra breathes out, her claws dig into Adora's shirt and shred the fabric to pieces. "Off... I want this off. Let me *feel* you too." She orders. She grabs Adora by her face and pulls her into a heated kiss as her claws finish the job of destroying Adora's shirt, lightly scratching her skin - Adora shudders at their sharpness. " *Mine* ." Catra growls. She bites Adora's lip, to deepen the kiss, and slides her tongue inside to fight for dominance. Adora moans softly when Catra bites her lip. It's times like this she wishes she put her strap on *before* she started making out with Catra.

Instead, she slides a thigh between Catra's legs and begins rocking slowly. She fights Catra for dominance, unwilling to relent her lead she had, and hoping the pressure between her legs would distract her enough for Adora to gain the upper hand. It very nearly was. Except, Catra's tail manages to slide between them and tease Adora through her pants, making it equal ground.

Catra pulls away, grinning softly as she goes straight for Adora's neck again, sucking to leave another mark. "Adora... who do you belong to?"

" *Fuck* ..." Adora gasps when she feels Catra's sharp fangs on her neck, and her sucking hard enough to mark her, but she wasn't about to give in that easily. She catches Catra's tail in her hand and tugs, very gently, but enough for Catra to *feel* something - she recalls Catra telling her it was one of the most sensitive parts of her body, and she didn't want to hurt her. "If you're not careful Kitten, I'll be tying those hands of yours up again." Adora was panting with arousal as she pressed harder against Catra's core. "I don't belong to *anyone* ." Adora smirks in her defiance.

Catra hisses at Adora pulling her tail, a soft mewl following soon after. "You can try... you still belong to me though, sir. You belong to your Kitten."

" *My* Kitten." Adora confirms. "What do you want, Catra?"

"Bring out your strap... I wanna ride you." Adora's eyebrows lift up. She *had* enjoyed that very much last time.

She grabs the hilt of her sword, which was leaning against the bed, and transforms it. She rolls over onto her back. Realising she was still in her pants, she looks at Catra. "Want to help me with these?"

"Should I rip them off as well? Or do you need them?" Catra asks with a playful grin.

"You didn't think to ask that question about my shirt." Adora points out with mild amusement.

"You didn't complain."

"Just take my pants off, however you see fit." Adora is a *little* impatient.

Catra hums and sits up to grab the waistband of Adora's pants. She begins to pull her pants down *painfully* slow, a shit-eating grin, clear as day, on her face as she looks up at Adora. Adora frowns and sits up. She reaches for Catra's face, roughly tilting her head up to look her in the eye. "You're being a brat Catra, brats get *punished* ." Catra's eyes widen and her reaction is so clear for even Adora to see. Her tail lashes back and forth behind her as she licks her lips - Adora is willing to bet that a certain someone is *extremely* wet down there. Adora smirks a little. *Oh yeah, Catra found that incredibly hot and she's ready for Adora now.*

"Do they, sir? But I was taking off your pants just like you asked me to. You said, 'however I saw fit'." Catra replies in a cheeky tone. Adora huffs. Catra is using her own words against

her.

"You were going slowly *on purpose* , can't let you get away with being... rebellious. Like I said, brats get punished." Adora moves to the side of the bed and takes her pants off herself. "Stand up."

"Make me."

Adora laughs a little and shakes her head. She pauses for a moment before she grabs Catra by her arm and pulls her towards her. She doesn't bother standing Catra up but, instead, just immediately bends her over her lap. She yanks Catra's pants down her legs, exposing her. "Remember your safe word Kitten?" Catra blushes, wiggling around in Adora's lap to get a little more comfortable, her tail twitching erratically for a few seconds before settling down. Adora could get used to this sight: Catra bent over her knee like this.

"I... Remind me what that safe word is again?"

"Red." Adora states and then, because she feels like it, she brings her hand down across Catra's ass. Catra lets out a loud moan and Adora grins: that clearly got her going.

"Is that all you got?" Catra challenges. She lifts her head up and looks at Adora with a smirk.

"That was a warm up Kitten." Adora says and then she grabs her chin and moves her face back to the ground. Catra is practically *begging* for Adora to punish her now. "I'm going to hit you, for being a bad Kitten, and you're going to count and say thank you sir, after each one. Got it?"

"Hmm, I don't think I quite heard you."

"You really are a stubborn brat." Adora says in her best disapproving tone, but she is slightly amused; Catra *definitely* heard her - Magicat hearing and all.

Adora grabs Catra by her hair, pulling her up to make her look at her. She moves her other hand down, pushing her fingers into Catra's wetness. *Yep. Catra was definitely turned on by this.* She gives a few, agonisingly slow, thrusts before she speaks again. "You heard me Kitten. Don't you want to be a good girl for me?" Catra whimpers and bites her lip when Adora's fingers slide inside of her. Her walls clench around Adora's fingers, trying to suck them in further, and Adora thinks that this is one of the best feelings in all of Etheria.

"Yes, sir..." Catra moans softly, trying to stand on her toes and push her hips back to get Adora to press just where she needed it. Adora grins and presses her fingers inside of Catra just a *little* more, when she feels Catra moving back to try to take her deeper. Adora doesn't move for a moment and then she pulls out of her.

"Good girl." Adora praises. "Remember to count and thank your Horde Lord, Kitten." Catra whines when she's left empty but nods at Adora's instructions nonetheless.

"Yes, sir." Adora would be lying if she said she wasn't turned the fuck on right now but she said she was going to punish Catra and that's what she's going to do - she could worry about the slickness between her own thighs later.

She starts slow at first, she can't just outright hit Catra, the point is to combine pain and *pleasure* - she wants Catra to *want* her to hit her. So she warms her up, her hits are spread evenly to each cheek and she slowly increases the harshness of the strikes with each swing. Catra does as Adora had instructed her and thanks her after each hit and keeps count.

Once Adora is confident that Catra can take harder hits she doesn't hold back. Her hits are hard and firm and they make a loud *crack* echo off the walls of her bedroom; followed by the noises Catra was making and her thanks and counting. Adora thinks maybe she could get off on that alone. She pauses briefly to give Catra a small reprieve. "Remember when you said I was a pain in your ass?" Adora asks as she massages her palm against Catra's *literal* ass. "Guess you weren't wrong."

Catra, at that point, was dripping wet. Adora could feel it just from ghosting her fingers between her thighs. It made sense, after each smack Catra would moan softly, her hands digging into Adora's leg to try to keep herself from going off the edge too soon. At least Adora could see that Catra was thoroughly enjoying herself.

"Red..." Catra pants out softly, her hips shaking a bit. "Need a minute..." Adora stops immediately. She looks at Catra's ass, which was red from Adora's strikes and she feels her own arousal increase tenfold. If Adora had to hazard a guess, Catra's ass probably stung, but in a pleasant way, and, judging from how *wet* she was, she was feeling overwhelmed - too much sensation.

"Okay." Adora says. She helps Catra turn over and then scoops her up in arms, holding her close. "You did so good Kitten, I'm so proud of you." Adora says softly. She kisses her nose gently. "I think I've punished you enough, will you be a good girl for me now?" Catra purrs softly, content to be held by Adora - she clearly needed the gentleness in that moment, the softness of being held and cared for, and it was Adora's job to provide it.

"Thank you... I'll be a good girl, sir." Adora smiles, even if Catra's words had turned her on again, but she knows Catra still needs a minute before they do anything further.

She gently scratches below Catra's chin and peppers kisses along her jaw. Adora knew, once they were done, she'd have to give Catra the best aftercare she possibly could. "Just tell me when you're ready to continue Kitten." Catra's purring intensifies with each gentle kiss that Adora gives her - clearly loving the attention and relaxing rather quickly with the caring attention.

"Okay... okay, I'm good to continue, sir." Catra gives a smile and Adora is inclined to believe her.

"What do you want?" Adora asks. "If you lay back, I can use the strap?" Catra pouts and shakes her head. "No?" Adora laughs. "You still want to ride me?"

"Mhmm." Catra grins and kisses Adora's jaw. "Yes I do. Am I allowed?" Adora's breath hitches a little and she swallows at Catra *asking* for permission. She guesses, sometimes punishment does work.

"Yes, you're *definitely* allowed to do that."

"So... put on your strap and let me ride you then." Catra whispers and gently nips Adora's earlobe. "Okay, sir?" Adora isn't about to say no to that. She stands up from the bed, gently setting Catra aside for the time being.

"Where do you want to ride me?" Adora asks as she does as Catra had said. She holds the shaft of her strap for a moment and glances at Catra to see her eyes staring at where Adora's hand was. Adora smirks but decides not to comment on it. "The edge of the bed or...?"

"Hmm... I think the edge might be best. More stable for your legs, no?" Adora laughs a little.

"I guess that's true." She sits down on the edge of the bed, planting her feet either side to keep her steady and to support Catra. "Lucky for you, I never skip leg day." Adora winks and waits for Catra to climb into her lap again. Catra laughs at Adora's joke, which warms Adora's heart a little if she's honest, Catra leans over and kisses her cheek before straddling her legs. She grasps Adora's chin, pulling a gasp from her while Adora stared at her beautiful eyes.

"Look at me... don't take your eyes off of me, sir." She orders in a soft voice. Adora feels inclined to follow that command despite her usual reluctance to do so. Catra takes the strap, aligning the tip of it with her entrance, and Adora's hips twitch, just a little. "Mine..." Catra says again. "This belongs to me... doesn't it, sir?" She asks as she slowly slides down, taking Adora's strap *inch* by *inch* . It's really fucking hot, and Adora couldn't imagine a better sight in the whole of Etheria than this.

Adora shudders and her eyes flicker shut for only a moment before she fixes her gaze back on Catra. She figures Catra deserves a reward for taking her punishment so well. "Yours," Adora confirms. "Only belongs to you, no one else." Adora has never done *this* with anyone else before and she doesn't want to - her strap really does only belong to Catra.

Those words clearly affect Catra, setting her on fire with desire, Adora can see it in her eyes, she's been *waiting* for Adora to say those words. Catra sinks flush against Adora's thighs and Adora groans happily at being buried hilt deep in *Catra* .

Catra rocks her hips around, moaning softly as she pleasures herself *and* Adora with those movements. "Mine... mine." She moans, before starting to lift herself up and drop herself down in steady motions.

"Fuck... Catra... you feel *so good* ..." Adora gasps. She places her hands on Catra's waist and rocks her hips slowly in time with the other woman. She kisses her jaw. "Go faster for me Kitten." Catra nods and turns her head to catch Adora's lips against her own again, speeding up as Adora had told her to. Adora swallows Catra's moans in their kisses.

Catra's ass bounces as she rides Adora rapidly and it is *incredible* . Adora highly recommends getting your… whatever, to ride your strap. It is *amazing* . "Like... like that, sir?" Catra asks after pulling away for a moment. Her lips were puffy and glistened from being kissed and Adora wanted only to keep kissing them more.

Adora's jaw was slack a little in pleasure at Catra's fast movements - she half wonders how she even manages to maintain that speed. "Just like that," Adora confirms. "You're so *good* ." Adora moans as she uses her leverage on Catra's waist to slam her back down onto her strap, causing both of them to cry out in pleasure. There's a chorus of a mixture of their names mingling together as they both thoroughly enjoy themselves.

"You're *so* fucking *hot* Catra," Adora chokes on a moan. She makes sure to grind into Catra to make her feel *every* inch of her strap. The noises coming from Catra's pussy were only serving to make Adora more aroused and, with the way Catra was currently riding her, she wasn't sure she would be able to last as long as she would have liked to.

" *Hnnn* , right there... right there. *Adora* . *Fuck* , you're so *deep* ." Catra's moans combine with Adora's easily. Her hands dig into Adora's broad shoulders and her claws scratch Adora's skin as she tries to stabilise herself to continue the rhythm that she was going at. "Adora... Adora… I'm close." Adora's eyes widen a little as she *feels* Catra's claws on her back but they're just short of actually puncturing her skin.

"Scratch me Catra." She urges. Wrapping her arm around Catra's waist, she drives deep into her, meeting her thrusts more than half way, fucking her *hard* and *rough* and *determined* . Catra doesn't seem to register what Adora had said because, as soon as Adora slammed back into her, a few more times, her back arches and a scream of Adora's name echoes off the walls of the bedroom. Her claws drag down Adora's back, though thankfully not too deeply, leaving shallow wounds in their wake. Catra squeals as Adora continues to grind against her to reach her own end and Adora could tell Catra was close to the edge *again* .

The feeling of Catra's claws down her back feels *wonderful* and Adora carries on moving her hips relentlessly. She feels Catra cum, feels her walls around her strap *clench* and feels her wetness coat it, *hears* it as Adora continued to drive into her. The sensation of Catra digging her claws into her back, the way her strap rubs her *just right* , combined with pretty much *everything* . Adora tumbles over the edge not soon after Catra. She freezes and a loud moan escaped her lips as she buries her face in Catra's neck to try to muffle it.

She moves her hips only a few more times before she wraps her arms around Catra and falls backwards on her bed, completely spent. She still has her strap buried in Catra, and her chest rises and falls with both exertion and her high, but she needs a minute to collect herself. Adora doesn't think she's ever cum so hard in her life - at least not with anyone else. There's something about Catra, something that makes whatever they do together the best damn thing Adora has ever experienced. Catra collapses on top of Adora, panting softly. Adora feels her wiggle her hips a little, a soft squeak leaving her - which is adorable if you ask Adora. Adora could tell Catra was ready for that aftercare.

"Adora..." Catra murmurs, nuzzling Adora while giving her soft kisses on her cheeks to relax her. "You did so good... it felt amazing, babe..." She praises, purring in satisfaction. Adora shudders at the praise. She wraps her arms around Catra and turns them over. She slowly pulls out of Catra before she pauses, hovering above her. She kisses down Catra's jaw and nuzzles her softly.

" *You* were amazing." Adora mumbles. "I think cuddles are in order now." Adora wiggles out of her harness and tosses it to one side. She lies down on her bed, hissing a little when the scratches on her back are irritated by the bed sheets. She extends her arms, waiting for Catra to come join her.

"Cuddles are definitely in order..." Catra purrs happily as she moves to curl up in Adora's arms. Adora has read up a little on Magicats, so she’s pretty sure that Catra *scents* her, at least a little - *Catra’s indeed* . "Can we take a shower after some cuddles please?" Catra asks, fingers tracing small circles on Adora’s arm.

Adora's eyes flutter shut for a moment and she hums, enjoying Catra's warmth and weight on her. "Why? Are you... sticky?" Adora teases lightly.

"Mhmm and I don't think letting it dry on my thighs would be very fun." Adora wants to argue that point but she's too tired.

"We can shower." Adora mumbles. She runs her hands up and down Catra's back soothingly. "You did good... was that... was that okay for you?"

"It was pretty damn great... also please keep doing that." Catra wiggles again, purring at the rubbing of her back and closing her eyes. Adora's hands seem to know exactly where to touch to make Catra become a puddle against her. She scratches her fingers along the stripes on Catra's back and kisses her shoulder.

"Yeah? Even the spanking? ... That was… new."

"It was... I liked it though." Catra admits, albeit a bit flustered - probably at the fact that she just said she had *liked* the *Horde Lord* spanking her.

"Noted." Adora says with a small smile. She pauses for a moment, her hands stilling. "So are we... is this a *thing* now? Are we like... fuck buddies?"

Catra presses her lips together. "We....shouldn't keep doing this..." She whispers, stopping her finger drawings on Adora's arm. "We're supposed to be enemies, Adora. Remember?"

"Yeah but I mean... What's the harm? I'm not using this to get information on the Rebellion, and you're not using it to spy on the Horde, it's just... stress relief." Adora tickles Catra's back with her fingertips. "I don't see the issue of continuing our... sessions."

"The issue is... if we get caught, everything falls down on me and nothing happens to you." Catra sighs, pulling away from Adora and sitting up. "Right now, it's okay because the others genuinely saw me get ambushed and taken away. But this being a thing? There's no damn way that they won't figure it out and I get the short end of the stick in the end." She wraps her arms around herself, sighing softly. "You wouldn't understand..."

Adora turns on her side, facing Catra's back. She sighs and wraps her arms around Catra's waist. She's not an idiot, she knows Catra stands to lose a lot more than she does if they were

ever found out. "So I'll just keep doing that, you know, 'kidnapping' you. No one will know what we're really doing."

"You really think it's not gonna be obvious? A person can only get kidnapped so much before something rings an alarm, Adora." Catra sighs, an exhausted look on her face. The happy, post-coital glow that had been there was entirely gone now. Adora felt a little bad about taking that away by bringing this up. "They were planning to rescue me... when I returned home, they were literally in the middle of planning a rescue to get me back. Who's to say that they won't do it again? My mom was already sketchy because I was dressed in your clothes, covered in your scent and I had to lie to my own family and friends, and tell them that my clothes got ripped in a fight, and don't try to make a joke right now."

Adora huffs and turns onto her stomach, flopping her head against her pillow, her chance to lighten the mood squashed. "Then we'll do it at intervals." Adora says. "And I won't rip your clothes again, shower and you won't smell of me."

"Why do you want me to come back so desperately that you're willing to go through all this *bullshit* to get me here?" Catra asks curiously, glancing back towards Adora.

"I..." Adora frowns. "We have fun..." She shrugs.

"Ah... okay." Catra sighs, rubbing her temple. "Look, I'll... think about it. But this... we may not be able to keep doing this."

"Okay." Adora replies simply. She has to admit, she doesn't want this to be the last time she's with Catra. "You want to take that shower?"

"Yeah... please."

"Does the cold water of the Fright Zone not bother you?" Adora asks curiously.

"It... startles me, but not really."

"Why don't you go on ahead and I'll join you in a minute?" Catra nods and stands up, pulling away from Adora's embrace. Adora watches as she carefully wobbles over to the bathroom on shaky legs. She hears her use the toilet before the sound of the shower switching on drifts into the bedroom.

Adora lets out a long breath. It shouldn't bother her as much as it does that Catra may want to discontinue their little... situation. She sits up and grabs her sword, transforming it back. She stares down at her reflection in the blade's shiny surface. For a moment, she wonders what it would have been like if she had left the Horde when she found her sword instead of returning and telling Shadow Weaver. *Where would she be now?* She shakes her head.

"Why me?" Adora asks. "I never asked for a magical sword, never wanted it." If she hadn't... Hordak would still be Lord and she'd just be some random Force Captain. She places her sword against her bed frame and heads to the bathroom.

Adora walks to the sink and leans her hands on it, staring at herself in the mirror. She looks different with her hair down, it usually makes her uncomfortable, it's impractical, plus her ears get hot, but when she sees it ruffled from sex and sweat, her overgrown bangs curling at the edges, that's not uncomfortable at all. If anything, it shows she did her job correctly. She trails her finger over the scar down her eye, remembering how she got it and *who* she got it from.

She turns to Catra. Catra, who is... *perfect* . In every sense of the word. Adora's almost surprised how relaxed they are about being around each other - and *naked* at that. Maybe opposites really do attract. "Need some help Kitten?" Catra looks up, smiling slightly at Adora and holding out her hand to grab her and guide her into the shower.

"I wouldn't mind the help." She rests her hand on Adora's cheek, bringing their lips together. "You know... didn't we just say that the bathing was for me to get rid of your scent?"

"That's what soap is for, Kitten."

"Mm... I don't know if it'll work if we're in here together."

"Then I guess you'll just have to bathe when you get back to the Rebellion." Adora murmurs. "Because I *definitely* plan on bathing you myself right now." Catra giggles and grabs the shampoo, pouring some on her hand.

"Turn around. I'll wash your hair for you."

"Did you miss the part where I said I was going to bathe *you* ?" Adora asks with a smile, but she follows Catra's request anyway.

"Shhh, we can take turns, dummy." Catra kisses her shoulder before gently washing Adora's hair. Catra is slow and takes her time to massage Adora's scalp - Adora's pretty sure it's in an attempt not to hurt her with her sharp claws. "How does that feel?" Adora hums quietly, her eyes had closed in response to Catra's touch.

"Nice..." Adora mumbles. "Actually... *really* nice... *super good*." In fact, she could feel sparks running up and down her spine at the massaging of her scalp.

"Mhmm... I know what you mean. I like when my hair is played with too." Catra whispers softly, continuing to do what she was doing. "I do have to rinse it off soon, okay?"

" *Mmkay* ..." Adora hums, leaning further into Catra's touch. Catra smiles and kisses Adora's shoulder again.

"Almost done..." She whispers, scrubbing for a few more seconds before pulling her hands away. "You can rinse the shampoo off now."

Adora huffs a little when Catra stops but then she steps under the water, rinsing the shampoo out of her hair. She looks at Catra and then grins. She grabs her by her wrist and pulls her towards her, under the water, and kisses her softly. She wraps her arms around Catra's back and kisses along her jaw before returning back to her lips. "It's like we're kissing in the rain." Adora says with a big goofy smile, bangs in her eyes.

"That... I never thought I would hear you say something like that." Catra says with a shocked expression on her face. "It was almost... almost *romantic*... for an asshole." She snickers and kisses Adora back. "Seriously though, you're so handsy. Not that I mind, but it's really surprising sometimes."

"Is it surprising?" Adora asks.

"For sure. You're usually so aloof and so... closed off. I never would have thought that you would be so hands-on." Adora contemplates that for a moment.

"It's a defence mechanism... keeping people at arms length means that they can't hurt me... and I can't hurt them." She guesses the only catch to that is that she *really* likes touching Catra.

"Oh... that makes sense." Catra grabs a washcloth, getting some soap on it and beginning to wash Adora's body. "It does sound like the easier route to take."

"Hm." Adora hums. "Plus, you're incredibly *sexy* , how do you expect me to keep my hands to myself?"

"Ah, so you're just horny then." Adora snorts.

"Always."

"Of course you are."

"Like you're not?"

"Always horny? No, I'm not."

"You are for me, it's okay, you can admit it." Adora grins.

"Huh? I see your ego is peeking through again." Catra rolls her eyes, pinching Adora on her side. "Keep it in check, Blondie."

"But you find my ego attractive." Adora argues.

"Sometimes, when it doesn't get bigger than your forehead."

" *Ugh* , my forehead is not *that* big, besides, yours is just as big as mine when I do this." Adora pushes Catra's bangs back atop her head, the water making her hair stick there. Adora laughs. "Wow, you might just be the cutest person alive."

"My forehead isn't as big as yours!" Catra grumbles and hurriedly fixes her hair back to normal. "And yes, yours is *that* big."

"Uh-huh, *sure* Catra." Adora rolls her eyes. "Are you done? Because I want to wash you and I prefer a much more *hands - on* approach."

"Yeah, yeah. I'm done. It's your turn now."

Adora grins and then grabs the soap, lathering up her hands. She pushes Catra up against the wall of the shower and starts rubbing her hands *all* over Catra's body. She starts at her stomach first, scraping her blunt nails through her short fur and soaping her up good. She drags her hands down and around Catra's hips and then grabs her ass, squeezing it. "Does your ass hurt Kitten?" Adora asks with a cocky grin.

"It feels sore, but not too badly." She answers with a roll of her eyes. "You're an idiot. If you wanted to touch my ass, you could have just asked."

"I don't want to touch *just* your ass. I want to touch *all* of you." Adora says. "Including your ass." She pauses for a moment. "Do you wash your tail?"

"Yes, I do. You want to do it?"

"Hell yeah I want to do that."

"What's with you and my tail?"

"... I deny to answer that."

"Uh huh..."

"I just think it's cute, and the way you react when I touch it is... adorable." Catra snickers.

"You really are so gay." Adora rolls her eyes and turns Catra around, pressing her front up against the wall.

"Isn't that lucky for you, imagine if I was a straight girl?" Adora shudders at the thought as she grabs hold of Catra's tail. She starts soaping it up. If Catra washed it, that made sense why it was so soft.

"You? Straight? I can't even imagine that." Catra's tail wiggles around in Adora's hand - the soft cleaning motions must be tickling her. "Make sure to get the tip, please."

"Ha, that's what she said."

"You are such an idiot."

"I think it's a sensory thing," Adora says, ignoring Catra. "You know? Like... it feels nice in my hands and relaxes me. The fact that you don't mind, and even like it, is a bonus."

"Mmm... I guess it's a good thing for both of us then." Adora smiles a little and runs her hand along the length of Catra's tail, making sure to get the tip of it as Catra had instructed.

Once she's done with her tail she moves on to her back, running her hands up along it. From there, she turns Catra around again and soaps up her arms. Her hands linger on her stripes for a moment. "I love your stripes."

"You seem to love everything that makes me a Magicat." Catra looks back at her, purring softly.

"Well, now that you mention it, I do love your purring too."

"Again, it's a very obvious thing to notice, Adora."

"Is that a bad thing? I just find you cute."

"It's not a bad thing, it's just funny to witness it."

"Is it?" Catra nods.

"It really is. You just didn't seem like the type at first..."

"The type to what?" Adora scrunches up her nose a little at Catra’s words.

"The type to admit something, or someone, is cute." *Well*...

"I'm not." Adora pauses for a moment. "I guess you're just *too* cute." Adora moves her hands down and smirks as her hand presses between Catra's thighs and she holds her gaze. She massages her fingers into her skin. "You made a mess down there."

"You mean *you* made a mess down there." Catra bites back with a grin, arms positioned against the wall. "You gonna clean me up there?"

"With soap, yeah, unless you're into shower sex."

"... I think I'm a little too sore for that." Catra says, after some contemplation.

"Understandable," Adora zones out for a moment, remembering what they had just done together only moments ago. Even if they can't do this again (Adora really hopes that they can) the memories of what they've done together is burned into her mind forever - she wasn't going to forget it any time soon.

She washes between Catra's thighs, teasing her a little. She leans in and up against Catra. "Good girl." She whispers in her ear and winks at her.

"You..." Catra shivers and moves back against Adora's hand before stopping herself. "Nope, no naughty moves in here. I have to go home soon." Adora snorts and then pulls Catra under the shower head to rinse the soap off of her.

"The fact I even tempted you is enough for me."

"Get that smug look off of your face." Adora does *not* get that smug look off of her face.

She rinses Catra down and then grabs the shampoo. "Now your hair Kitten." She squeezes it into her palms and then begins working it into Catra's hair which was a lot thicker than

Adora's. "Your hair is so... Nice." Adora says as she scratches softly at Catra's scalp.

"Mmm... oh yeah... it feels really nice when you do that." Catra sighs blissfully, closing her eyes and relaxing into Adora's hands. "Don't forget the ears, but be gentle please." Adora's eyes sparkle a little at Catra's invitation to touch her ears.

She moves her hands to them and begins to rub them softly and gently, being sure not to be too rough with them. They were *soft* and Adora may have found something she enjoyed touching more than Catra's tail. Catra purrs loudly, her tail swishing left and right slowly in content. Her ears twitch, just a little, splashing off some of the shampoo in her hair. "Nice... I think you can wash it out now." Catra says.

"But... *your ears* ."

"... Seriously?"

"They're *so cute*." Adora pouts.

"Again, *seriously* ?"

".... I am *extremely* serious right now."

"...wow."

"I think I'm allowed to find you cute." Adora says defensively. Catra is hot and cute, it's almost unfair. Like, *give other people a chance, right?*

"Hm, maybe you are… *for now* ." Adora rolls her eyes at Catra reminding her of who they are to each other - who they *really* are to each other.

She rinses the shampoo from Catra's hair, running her fingers through her locks until the soap is all gone. "Too bad you're this clean and then you'll probably have to roll around in the woods to get my scent completely off of you."

"Probably... this will probably be the last time, anyways..." Catra whispers - she almost sounds sad?

"The last time?" Adora frowns. "No... I don't think it will be."

"And why exactly do you say that? I told you, this was risky enough as it is the first time."

"Easy," Adora grins. "I'm *irresistible* ."

"No, you're not."

"Ouch, you hurt my feelings."

"Oh, stop whining, you baby."

"I don't know why you think we can't do this again," Adora says, more seriously. "I mean, the last thing your rebel friends will be thinking when you've been 'kidnapped' is that we're sleeping together."

"Say that to the damn hickey that I have to cover before I get home." Catra frowns and turns around, facing Adora. "I told you, it would seem suspicious if I just went off and got kidnapped again and again. Don't you understand that?"

"Well I don't think it would be." Adora protests. "Especially if it looks believable every time."

"Why do you want to keep fucking me so badly, Adora? We said this was a *one time* thing, then Scorpia brings me back by kidnapping me and you want to keep going?" Catra groans. "What's the reason? Can't you find someone else to fuck that isn't supposed to be your enemy?"

"I-" Catra's words fluster Adora and she turns away. She steps out of the shower and grabs a towel. "I don't... No, I can't, okay? You're the only person that I can."

"But *why* ?"

"A whole bunch of reasons!" Adora yells. "I'm the *Lord* of the *Horde* , I can't go around sleeping with my soldiers, that's kind of really fucking gross. And... I like having sex with you, is that so bad? The no strings, and stuff, and it... it just works really well."

"You literally said the first time that I offered to sleep together that it was probably a crime! I don't see how this is any different!" Catra yells back, turning off the water and grabbing a towel as she gets out. "Look, if things were different it wouldn't be so bad, us having... multiple one night stands. But we are in the middle of a *war* where both of us are on *opposite* sides, *leading* said sides!"

"It's not a crime if you want it too." Adora says. "You're not my prisoner Catra. We can keep it separate, can't we? When we're together I can just be Adora, no Lord, and you can just be Catra, no Princess."

"Don't you get it! If we get caught, it *is* a crime! Mainly for me!" Catra rubs her face. "I'm not saying I'm your prisoner, Adora. Obviously I stopped being your prisoner when you agreed to... what we did the first time. But things are so complicated... because of the war. You seriously want me to keep risking everything just to have *sex* with you?"

"I guess that's your choice to make since you have *so much* to risk." Adora says while walking out of the bathroom to her bedroom. She hears Catra sigh tiredly behind her.

"... Any chance I can wash my clothes before I have to go?" She asks as she walks back into the bedroom.

"Uh... I guess." Adora responds. She's… wound up - and not in a good way.

"Thanks." Catra nods. "Where... do I go to wash them?" Adora sighs.

"You can't walk around the Fright Zone naked or in a towel. Put some of my clothes on."

"Then that makes the entire point of me showering pointless. Can you go take the clothes and get them washed? Please?"

"Fine," Adora stands, she throws on some of her more casual uniformed clothes and then takes Catra's clothes from her hands. "Stay here."

"I will."

Adora pauses at her door. She contemplates if she should really leave Catra *alone* but ultimately decides that she probably won't go anywhere when she has no clothes. She exits her room and heads towards the laundry room facilities.

When Adora reaches the laundry room she hands Catra's clothes off to a soldier there who doesn't question why exactly she has a Rebellion soldier's clothes. She sits down as she waits, thinking about her current situation. She didn't know why she was so bothered by the idea of never sleeping with Catra again. Adora had gone years without sex, she hardly needed it to live, like food, but... there was just *something* about Catra. She didn't *want* to stop seeing her. And yet, Catra was right, continuous kidnappings would probably be suspicious, and Catra did have a lot on the line if they were ever caught, but also... Adora couldn't help but think it would be *worth* it. Of course, if they did get caught, Adora stood to lose nothing - except maybe Catra. Catra was technically committing treason by seeing Adora...

Adora sighs.

Maybe she shouldn't push it, she should just let what happens happen. Sex with Catra is amazing but Catra's also right that, if she tried hard enough, she could probably find someone else to fuck. But... they wouldn't be *Catra* , and something about that feels... wrong.

The soldier comes back to her a half hour later, handing her the clothes back and Adora thanks them. They salute her as she turns her back on them and starts back to her room. *Yeah, she'd just let happen whatever happens. That was the best option. If Catra wanted to have more sex, great, if she wanted to stop, that was fine too.* They'd said from the beginning it was no strings, and it was still no strings.

* * *

Catra doesn't go anywhere, instead she sits on the bed to wait for Adora. She uses that time to contemplate everything about the situation. Her first mistake had been agreeing to sleep with Adora despite the blonde saying that she'd let her go even *without* them sleeping together. The second was... becoming *infatuated* with her. The sex really had been amazing, every time, and surely that was the reason why she wanted to keep coming back. But she knew that sex wouldn't be worth the risk of losing the trust of everyone that she cares about... Yet Adora herself had said that they could make the choice to keep the war separate from themselves. They would just be Catra and Adora... not a Princess or the Horde Lord. It was a hard choice, one that she really shouldn't even be thinking about, because her answer should automatically be no, but she was considering it…

Catra had been so focused on her own thoughts, her eyes closed as she thought things through. It was a hard decision to make but... maybe she had gotten addicted now. She didn't hear Adora come in at all, too stuck in her thoughts to do so. "I can hear you thinking from here, Kitten." Catra jumps a little and looks up to see Adora with her eyebrow raised and an amused smile on her lips. *Shit.*

"Shut up... how... how often do you think you could.. pick me up without it being suspicious?" Adora looks dumbfounded for a moment - it’s pretty cute actually.

"I uh... I don't know... like... twice a month? Once a month? Twice a month, miss a month?"

"I... maybe it has to be more erratic... so that they can't tell that a pattern is taking place."

"Okay, so I'll surprise you." Adora wiggles a little before she stops herself from getting too excited. Catra hadn't agreed to anything yet but seeing Adora *wiggle* in excitement was making Catra *want* to agree to *something* .

"... I'd need to leave some identical clothes here that aren't covered in your scent for when I need to go back home."

"How would we keep them from having my scent on them if they're here?"

"Uh... washing and drying them before I go?" Catra suggests, but she’s not entirely sure if she’s honest.

"I'll figure it out, but Catra..." Adora sets Catra's clothes down on her desk. "Are you... do you want to keep doing this?" *Here it goes.*

"I... I want to..."

"Yeah?" Adora sits down beside Catra, keeping her distance so as to not rub her scent on her which makes Catra smile a little. Adora is sometimes… unconsciously sweet, and gentle, and *caring.* "You know, the scent thing is only an issue for your moms, right? Why don't you stay in Bright Moon a couple days after our... you know... and bathe and... that should be okay, right?" Catra shakes her head.

"It wouldn't work. My moms would go to Bright Moon immediately to check to make sure that I'm okay and unharmed." *Curse her caring mothers.*

"Just make sure you really soak before they get to you." Adora says and Catra snorts.

"Dork... okay, I'll try it out."

"Yeah?" Adora grins. "Do you have any... rules?"

"No marks anywhere that can't be covered with clothes. Like this one here." Catra points at the mark that Adora had left earlier. "Got it?"

"That was an accident." Adora says defensively with a pout. "Done, deal, anything else?"

"And… we're going to need to pretend to fight, okay? When we're out there..."

"I can do that." Adora says. "That'll be hard for you, huh Kitten? You know, because you *like* me so much." Catra wants to protest but… well… it's pretty clear she does *like* Adora - she wouldn't be agreeing to this if she didn't. "I have a rule of my own." Adora says.

"Yeah? And what rule is that?"

"No strings still, and... if any one of us wants to stop, at any point, we stop. Clean break." Catra doesn't know why but that… she's not sure she likes that idea.

"I... okay, that sounds like a very fair rule." Catra nods in agreement anyway. Adora extends her hand, offering it to Catra for her to shake. Catra smiles and places her hand in Adora's, shaking it. "No strings... and if one of us wants to stop, we stop."

"Now, your clean clothes are on my desk, you should go before I'm tempted to rub my scent *all over* you again."

"I'm going, I'm going." Catra laughs, standing up and getting dressed. "I guess... I'll see you... whenever?"

"Not to worry Kitten," Adora grins. "I'll keep you and the Rebellion guessing." Catra giggles, her heart skipping a beat in her chest at that grin.

"Yeah, yeah... I really should go now. This... was nice though."

"Yeah, it was nice." Adora agrees. "I'm always going to enjoy dicking you down." Catra sighs, shaking her head.

"Of course you have to go and say it like that." Catra says with a small smile. "Escort me out?"

"Can't have you wandering the Fright Zone unattended." Catra laughs again and gestures for Adora to lead the way.

The pair step out of the bedroom and then out of the throne room. Each step that they had to take, seeming so fast and yet so slow as they grew closer and closer to the exit. "See you... Lord Adora." Catra whispers as they finally make it to the exit. Catra waves at her a little awkwardly. Catra gets the sense that Adora would have kissed her had they not gone through so much effort to rid Adora's scent from her.

"Yeah, I'll see you later, Catra." Catra nods and bites her lip, taking a step back.

"Yeah... later..." Adora smiles and Catra swears her heart jumps a little in her chest. Now she had to go home and lie her ass off again, but she knew she'd more than likely end up back in the Fright Zone and lying more in the future. Catra is hooked on Adora. There was no going back from the moment Adora agreed the first time.

Enemies with benefits.

What the hell had Catra gotten herself into?

Chapter End Notes

Enjoy it while it lasts -M :)

Thank you all for reading and for the comments on the previous chapters, we both love reading them and we try to respond to as many of them as possible too. Cannot wait to hit you guys with future chapters and I hope you're all in love with Lord Adorka as we are. -S

Embraced with a Side of Guilt

Chapter Summary

"Sit down." C'yra says sternly, "we're not finished talking."

"What else could we possibly need to talk about?"

"What happened when you were taken by the Horde?"

Catra looks taken aback. Her mom had completely blindsided her with that question. Catra quickly recovers, stopping her tail from twitching - or any other tells that might expose her. "I got ambushed by soldiers and dragged off to the Fright Zone but managed to escape. I had to roam around the Whispering Woods for a while. They were really trying to keep me from coming back."

"No," C'yra says. "the first time, when you stunk of the Horde Lord?"

Chapter Notes

Happy Friday! Another instalment of sexy Horde Lord Adora for y'all. We wanted to give a shout out to @mondtiefling because we saw their WIP art on Twitter and we screamed because it was so good and so gay!

Anyway, we hope you all enjoy this chapter! A quick note: Catra's name is also C'yra but only her moms call her that! She is Catra to everyone else. Luna will use Cy when talking about her wife (unless mad) and call Catra C'yra and C'yra will also call Catra C'yra.

Warning, NSFW ahead

See the end of the chapter for more notes

Catra had managed to return home without much complications. She lied, once again, telling her parents that she had managed to trick the guards but had to stay hidden for a while before making her escape back to Half-Moon safely. And without Adora's scent covering her, it was very easy for her mothers to believe her.

It hurt to have to lie to her moms, but she knew that they would flip if they were to find out that she was sleeping with the Horde Lord, their enemy. *Their* ... since when had Catra started

to think of Adora as anything *other* than her enemy too? She supposes, seeing the different sides of Adora helped with that, but it didn't change the fact that the two of them were on opposite sides of a war and were still fighting against each other.

Her thoughts would have continued bouncing around in her head had her moms not called for her to meet in the meeting room. Catra was a little worried about the fact her moms suddenly wanted to meet but she wasn't about to arouse their suspicions when they hadn't really given Catra any indication that they *were* suspicious.

Catra rounds the corner of the meeting room, smoothing out the fur on her tail as she goes. She still ached a little from her time with Adora, even if it had been some time ago - she *had* enjoyed that shower with her. "Mama, mom. You asked to see me?" She looks curiously at the two, seeing the serious looks in their eyes. *Shit. Maybe she should've been more weary of this so-called 'meeting'.*

"C'yra," Luna begins, smiling softly at her daughter. That puts Catra more at ease. Luna was always the calmer one of her two moms, someone who was just kind, nothing else, so her smile was a welcome sight. "We don't want to rush you into anything but... have you considered anymore about choosing a mate?"

Catra sighs, taking a seat. "Mom, we're in the middle of a war. Taking a mate is not my priority." Maybe the topic wasn't *Adora* but it was still an unfortunate topic nonetheless.

C'yra and Luna share a look as they take a seat themselves, across from Catra. "We know, but... sweetie, the war has been going on for years, if Cy had said the same thing, we never would have wed and you wouldn't exist. You can't put your life on hold because of the war."

"Why are you two so adamant on me having a mate?" Catra looks at them, upset. "It's not putting my life on hold. No one that I've met so far has been the one, okay?" And they hadn't. Catra had no interest in *any* of them and she wasn't planning on courting anyone. Maybe Adora was right, maybe this whole thing was *dumb* , maybe she didn't need a Queen, a *mate* , to help support her like her moms kept suggesting - maybe she could rule however she damn pleased without the obnoxious interruptions of someone else.

C'yra sighs, running her fingers through her hair and Catra looks at her. "You haven't even given them a chance." C'yra points out. "You rarely even meet them and, when you do, you

leave within five minutes."

"Because they're not it!" Catra sighs, burying her hands in her face. She doesn't know how else to tell her parents this, they're just not *clicking.* Why couldn't Catra be like Glimmer and find someone and get her parents off her back? "Because they never make me feel like I can just be *me* , you know? They all expect me to be something that I'm not and I don't want that." Catra sits up and looks at her claws instead of her moms.

"What do you mean?" Luna asks gently. "C'yra, what do they expect you to be?"

"Look, you keep trying to step me up with other Princesses and noble women that aren't involved in the war. They don't understand that I'm not gonna be a *sophisticated* Lady. I'm a fighter, a soldier, even if I am a Princess. They want me to be something I am not, and I can assure you, most of them expect me to immediately step down from fighting even though I'm doing it to protect my people and the people of Etheria." Adora… Adora would understand that about her… She's a soldier too. Maybe they are on opposite sides but they understand each other on that level at the very least. Adora wouldn't step down from being Lord for 'love' anymore than Catra would step down from fighting with the Rebellion for a mate. They're soldiers. None of the suitors her parents have presented her with seem to understand that aspect of Catra.

Catra looks back to her mothers to see C'yra looking at Luna, her tail whipping back and forth before she focuses her attention on Catra again. C'yra narrows her eyes and Catra holds her mismatched gaze. "Maybe they're right." She states.

"But guess what? That's not their decision to make." Catra frowns deeply, her tail lashing out. "I'm *not* stepping down."

"You shouldn't have joined in the first place."

"It's my *duty* as a Princess to do what I can to keep my people safe. What were you expecting of me, huh mama?" Catra asks, narrowing her eyes. She and C'yra are almost entirely too alike. It's why they often clash so much. They're just as stubborn as each other anyway.

Luna lays a hand down on her wife's arm and squeezes softly. "Will you two cut it out?" Luna chastises. "What Cy is *trying* to say, is that she's worried for your safety, and, also, it's hypocritical of her to say that since she fought with the Rebellion as a Princess too." Luna glares softly at C'yra who huffs as she looks away from her.

"At least I also chose a mate."

"Ah, I see. So you want me to be you. Well guess what, mama? I'm my own person who can make my own decisions and choose my own path." Catra stands up. "You can continue trying to set me up if you want, but know that it is unlikely that I will choose any of them."

"Sit down." C'yra says sternly, "we're not finished talking."

"What else could we possibly need to talk about?"

"What happened when you were taken by the Horde?"

Catra looks taken aback. Her mom had completely blindsided her with that question. Catra quickly recovers, stopping her tail from twitching - or any other tells that might expose her. "I got ambushed by soldiers and dragged off to the Fright Zone but managed to escape. I had to roam around the Whispering Woods for a while. They were really trying to keep me from coming back."

"No," C'yra says. "the first time, when you *stunk* of the Horde Lord?" Luna rubs her face and sighs.

"Do we have to bring this back up?" Luna asks. Catra completely agrees with Luna at least.

"What is Lord Adora's obsession with you? I don't get it. We *saw* her at Princess Prom. She's taken you twice now. What's up with that?" C'yra asks. Catra doesn't like being cornered and she especially doesn't like this line of questioning.

"I literally explained it to you when I came back the first time." Catra looks at C'yra, annoyed. "She wants to keep me away because I'm the Rebellion's main strategist and the one that keeps countering her plans most of the time. Her own words when she spoke to me through the jail cell to rub it in my face."

"Well I think it's more than that." C'yra says, "I don't like it. She's *obsessed* with you, C'yra. We thought... we were worried she might have... hurt you." Catra softens when she sees the worried look on her mom's face. Catra forgets herself. She knows what Adora is *really* like but her moms? They only know Adora as the big bad Horde Lord, of course they're cautious of her and worried about what happened to Catra while she was taken.

"I promise nothing bad happened, mama... aside from the usual fighting, of course. I had to rip up my prom clothes because they didn't let me fight properly and had to change to whatever I found first." Not a complete lie. Her clothes were ripped up, to be fair, and she did have to change them. Fighting, however… that was a lie.

C'yra frowns a little. "I still don't like it." She says. "She always singles you out, I've seen it and I do *not* trust her. Nothing is too low for the Horde. They will do *anything* to win, including... including discarding the Rebellion's strategist."

"As if she could." Catra snorts softly. "I promise that I'll be careful, mama. I've always been pretty good at kicking her ass anyways." C'yra doesn't look convinced, but she chooses to drop the subject anyway.

"Will you at least consider meeting more suitors?" She asks. Catra looks at her moms. They both look so hopeful, Catra doesn't want to let them down. She groans and decides it really won't kill her to just *meet* a few noble women.

"... Fine. But if I don't like them, then I'm walking out on them."

"You're definitely Cy's daughter." Luna comments.

" *Hey* !"

"So it seems. Am I allowed to go now? Or are you suddenly going to drop on me that you have suitors visiting today?" Catra asks, mostly rhetorically.

"Well... now that you mention it..." Luna looks half guilty.

"... You're kidding, right?" Catra looks at her moms in disbelief.

"We think you'll like her." C'yra says dismissively. *They **are** serious!* Catra can't believe this. She groans and rubs her face. She wasn't exactly ready to meet any suitors today.

"She's from a lesser noble house, like me." Luna says softly. "You know, not as stuck up as you royals."

"Hey, you *married* a royal." C'yra says and Luna laughs. She kisses her wife on the cheek and purrs softly. Sometimes, Catra looks at her moms and she wishes she could find what they have. They so clearly love each other, even just small gestures, like looking at each other, show just how in love they are with each other.

"Yes, I suppose I did." Luna responds. She looks back to Catra. "Just give her a chance?

"... Who is she?" Catra sighs, looking at her moms tiredly. "Is she here now?"

"She should be in the throne room." C'yra says, "I believe her name was... what was it, honey?"

"Hm? I believe her name was Azar." Luna answers. "Just... go see her and we'll respect whatever decision you make."

"Alright, alright. I'm going." Catra sighs. "Excuse me then." She says before leaving the meeting room and heading to the throne room.

Catra was slightly annoyed if she was honest, which was probably not the best mood to be in when meeting a potential suitor, but she felt… *uneasy* meeting suitors. Maybe she should just be a Queen that doesn't take a mate. She could totally do that… *right?* It's not like her moms could force her and she really hadn't found that person that she just *clicked* with.

The throne room isn't far from the meeting room and Catra arrives within minutes. She always did love the Half-Moon throne room. There were her moms' thrones next to each other, and then there was Catra's, the biggest and central throne belonged to C'yra and one day, Catra would sit there. *One day.* Half-Moon's throne room wasn't as bright as Bright Moon, it was much warmer in it's colour scheme, earthly tones, and it suited Catra's vision far better then the, sometimes obnoxious, pinks and pastel colours of Bright Moon. "Lady Azar?" Catra calls out as she enters the room.

The Lady turns from the thrones at Catra's voice. Catra had to admit, she was very beautiful. She gives a soft smile and Catra can tell she's probably *kind* . She's about Catra's height, not as tall as Adora. … *Why are you comparing her to Adora?* Catra shakes her head. "Princess C'yra," The Lady says and she bows respectfully. "I wasn't sure you would show."

"I do have to apologise. My mothers informed me of this meeting rather last minute. Sorry to keep you waiting." Catra says, genuinely apologetic as she bows out of respect. She feels a little bad for this Lady if she's honest - especially since Catra's giving a bad first impression with her tardiness. "I hope you found your journey to Half-Moon alright?"

The Lady smiles softly and comes closer to Catra. "It wasn't too bad." She admits, "I have to say, I was a little surprised I was invited here as a potential... suitor."

"Is that so? And may I ask what made you agree to come to this meeting?" Catra always does wonder how her moms get these suitors here. Do they set out ads in the paper? Catra honestly has no idea; Catra didn't even realise Half-Moon had so many nobles until this whole suitors situation came about.

"Well," She says. "you don't exactly refuse the Queens of Half-Moon." She jokes lightly. "And... well... I've noticed you've refused quite a few proposals and I guess I was... curious."

She leans in a little, sniffing at Catra's scent.

"Curious?" Catra steps back at the Lady trying to catch her scent. Something about that… doesn't feel right to her. She plays it off by smoothing back her hair from her face and fixing her shirt.

"Of why you keep refusing," She answers. "I mean, I know there's a war, you have a lot going on, but your mom courted while at war, right?"

"Ah, so curiosity is the reason why you're here." Catra hums, looking up at the ceiling in thought. A weird reason to come all this way but Catra isn't one to judge. "I don't think I'm ready for marriage right now... I don't think I've found the person I want to be with... if you must really know the answer to why I've been refusing."

"Oh..." She looks a little disappointed at that. "I mean, I'm not proposing right now, isn't that the point of courting? To get to know someone and then decide if you want to marry them?"

"I... just feel as though I would know if I've met the person I'm meant to be with. You get me? Guess, I'm a bit of a believer in the 'love at first sight' idea. As cheesy as it is." Catra smiles sheepishly. She knows for a fact that Adora would make fun of her for that. *Stupid dummy.* Catra has to stop a fond smile pulling at her lips. Azar laughs softly.

"So you're a romantic?" She asks. "I wish that were true... I'm not sure it is, however." There's a long pause before she speaks again. "It's not me, right? I can tell you're trying to figure out a way to let me down gently." *Smart **and** pretty.* But she was right. There just… there wasn't that *spark* that Catra was looking for.

"... No, it's not you. I'm sorry." Catra rubs the back of her head, looking at Azar apologetically. "But thank you... for being truthful to me and kind about it."

"Can I ask something?"

"Of course. What is it?" Catra asks politely.

"Well, I guess it's more... what I think." Azar says, biting her lip for a moment. "I guess... we don't always have a *'you're the one'* moment, I think it's called falling in love for a reason. Sometimes it's slow, and sometimes it's fast, sometimes it's all at once, or sometimes it's a mix of all of those things. Just... don't restrict yourself to thinking there has to be some... instant spark, okay?"

"Thanks... for the advice, Lady Azar." Catra whispers and nods a bit. "I... wouldn't mind being friends with you though. You seem nice." She beams which makes Catra genuinely smile.

"Thank you, Princess C'yra." She gently squeezes Catra's shoulder on her way past her to the door. "Maybe I'll see you around, and I wish you luck finding 'the one'."

"Thank you, Lady Azar. And you can just call me Catra." Catra smiles back at her. "I hope you find your ‘one’, one day too. You seem lovely."

"You're too kind... Catra." She says. "Be careful too, we all want you to be safe while fighting the Horde."

"I promise I'll be safe. You stay safe out there as well with everything that's going on." Catra nods. "May I excuse myself?"

"You're more than excused, Princess." Catra laughs a little.

Catra bows again before exiting the throne room with a wave. She walks down the hallway, passing the meeting room and seeing her moms were still inside. "You... do know you two can leave now, right?"

"C'yra," Luna straightens, her ears perking up. "you're done already?" She frowns softly. "I was so sure Lady Azar was perfect for you. She's so nice and soft." Catra raises an eyebrow.

"You're the one that asked for Lady Azar to come here?" Catra asks curiously. Luna nods.

"Of course, her family knew my family before I... well... before I married Cy." Luna answers.

"Ah... she's... nice." Catra says awkwardly. She is nice but she wasn't… there was something *missing.*

"... Nice..." Luna says, disappointed, and C'yra has to stifle her laugh which has her wife glaring at her.

"I'm sorry, Love, I am, but that was a long shot." C'yra regards her daughter again. "C'yra, if you're not comfortable... I mean, I know some people don't experience... some people don't want relationships, you can tell us, you know? We'll stop pushing if it makes you uncomfortable."

"It's not that. I just... like I explained to Azar... I guess I'm a bit of a romantic and believe in the 'love at first sight' thing. It might not even be possible but... I feel like when I meet the person that I'm meant to be with that we'd just... click." Catra explains, bringing her hands together to demonstrate what she meant.

"It's definitely possible, Little One." Luna says softly. "Cy can tell you about it."

"Oh my-" C'yra sighs. "Your mom loves to point out how I'm the one who chased *her* and *she* was the one reluctant to court me."

"Really?" Catra was a little surprised by that given how in love her moms were with each other - she had just assumed they'd been more than willing to court each other. "You were the one to pursue mom? Why is that so hard to believe?"

"C'yra was a bit of a rebel, isn't that right, Love?" Luna teases. C'yra grumbles. "You see, I was from a lesser noble house, I shouldn't have even been considered as a suitor, but C'yra hurt herself one day and my father was a healer, he taught me too, but obviously C'yra was the *Princess* , she required only the *best* , which was my father. She saw me and it was... well..." Luna clicks her fingers. "Like you said, it can happen like that, we know what you mean."

"But it isn't always like that." C'yra adds.

"We were sort of star-crossed lovers, C'yra wasn't technically allowed to court me, but it didn't stop her." Luna says.

"And I get that, but... I just know that that's how I'll find them..." Catra whispers, looking off to the side dreamily. "They're out there... I just know it."

"Dear Gods, how many fairy tales did you read our daughter growing up?" C'yra asks her wife.

"Shut up you," Luna says dismissively. "That's fine sweetie but we want to help you, that's why we introduce you to different suitors."

"I know, it's just... no one I've been set up to meet has been it."

"So we'll keep trying, they're out there somewhere, right?" Luna asks.

"Unless you have someone in mind already?" C'yra asks, raising a brow. *What was that supposed to mean?*

Catra shakes her head. "I don't. Believe me, if I had someone in mind, I would have told you. But no one has been *it* for me."

"Just... the way you talk, it's like you might have a certain... infatuation for someone, that's all."

"As if." Catra laughs and sits back down in a chair. "I told you both. Relationships are the last thing on my mind right now. Only reason I'm even bringing this up is because you two brought it up first."

"Who said anything about relationships?" C'yra asks curiously. "I said infatuation, I doubt you'd tell us if you were seeing someone in an unofficial sense. We've both been your age before, we're well aware of what you get up to." Catra rolls her eyes.

"Relationships, infatuation. Whatever you want to call it. I don't have the time and it's the last thing on my mind." She repeats, though she knew that she was lying to herself and her moms at that point - *what the hell would you call **Adora** if not an infatuation or an affair at the very least* ? "My focus is on making sure that my people are safe."

"Ugh, who let you grow up?" C'yra replies. "Heavy lies the crown, believe me, I know. Except, C'yra, you're not the only one who has that burden. We're still here, and your... future mate, they'll support you to do that too."

Catra smiles and laughs at her mom's words. "What can I say? I was raised by wise moms." She lets her smile drop a little. "I know I'm not the only one carrying the burden. That much is obvious, but I still want to do my best for my people to make sure they're safe."

"We're proud of you kitten." Luna purrs softly. "No matter what."

"I know, mom... thank you." Catra swallows thickly. She wonders how proud of her they would be if they knew who her recent and new bedmate was - and that Catra had given herself over to the Horde Lord in a way that they probably could never imagine. Catra has to push that thought away before she can spiral.

"Well, I guess we can go to dinner." C'yra says. "Oh, C'yra, Glimmer left a message, something about the Horde preparing for something new and needing you for the next battle."

"I thought I was being put on the sidelines for strategy for a while?" Catra reminds her moms, looking curiously at the two.

"You seem fine," C'yra replies. "The medics gave you the all clear and... we figured you were probably getting restless being sidelined. Better to let you do something with permission instead of going out and doing it anyway." Catra grins at her mom and nods.

"You are absolutely right. It's better that I have permission instead of me running off." Catra is the kind of person who would rather ask for forgiveness than permission, so it's probably better that her moms gave her permission to save Catra asking for that forgiveness - the sidelined thing was never going to last anyway.

"Then you have our permission. Now, seriously, I'm starved." C'yra rises and then exits, Luna following after her. Both of them gently squeeze Catra's shoulder on their passing.

Catra smiles and watches them step out of the room before letting herself relax and sighing. Moments like that really made her wonder if continuing her... (s)e(x)scapades with Adora were a good idea. She sighs softly before following her moms to the dining hall to get something to eat. The question would be something that would be stuck on her mind until the next time where she would have to face Adora again.

* * *

Adora growls in frustration. "If you want something done right, do it yourself." She grumbles as she grabs the Horde soldier by their armour. "This battle isn't over yet soldier, get your ass back in."

"Y-Yes, Lord Adora." They salute before they run off back into battle. Adora clenches her jaw. She knew this was Catra's doing. *That beautiful brain of her's* . She doubted she was here, the rebels had been keeping her behind the front line recently, but this had her tactics written all over it. Catra must be aware of *some* Horde spies in the Rebellion because they'd been fed false information from one that had led to this *humiliating* ambush.

Now here Adora was, in the thick of it, fighting off Rebellion forces with her soldiers. They weren't doing too bad in all fairness. They were holding their own at the very least - probably because Adora was helping. Adora hadn't exactly expected a battle but, expected or not, she wasn't going to let the Rebellion pull one over on her.

Adora grabs a Rebellion soldier and practically throws them across the plain. "... Whoops." She winces a little. “Sorry about that!” She was about to bring out her sword when she heard a *familiar* voice behind her.

" *Hey Adora~* " Adora completely freezes, she fumbles with her sword and drops it before she quickly picks it up, whirling around to face *her* . And there she was indeed. *Catra* . Beautiful as ever and clearly smug with herself.

" *Catra* ." Catra smirks, hands on her hips as she stands confidently before Adora - *confidence really is sexy* . Adora can tell that Catra was smug about catching her off guard like that - not to mention her *dropping* her sword at her voice.

"What are you doing here?" She asks, eyebrow raised as she steps closer, claws out and circling Adora to make sure that she wouldn't seem suspicious. "You're looking quite angry there. Has your plan been ruined?"

"You know it has." Adora scowls and lifts her sword, getting into a defensive position to throw off suspicion too. "What am *I* doing here? What are *you* doing here? I thought the Rebellion had you on babysitting duty." This was pretty usual banter if Adora was honest. They were acting *perfectly* natural.

"Turns out, they figured I'd end up running into battle anyways." She laughs, throwing a punch at Adora, which she easily dodges. "And they decided that it was better for me to have their permission to be out here, in case of anything, instead of me just showing up and throwing everyone off."

"You do like to... *rebel* against orders." Adora smirks a little and deflects Catra's half-hearted attempt to claw her. She was referring to their little spanking session but the only sign that Catra shows of her picking up on that is a brief roll of her eyes, a tail twitch and her ears twitch too.

"Exactly. So I might as well have a little fun kicking your ass while I'm out here." She teases as she takes another slow enough swipe at Adora that she easily manages to dodge again. Catra glances around for a moment, seemingly making sure they weren't within earshot of anyone and piquing Adora's attention, before speaking just loud enough for Adora to hear. "I can't go with you today... my mom thinks you're obsessed with me and if I go missing, she'll head straight there. But... we can have a few minutes alone if you want."

"I only need a few minutes, Kitten." Adora moves her head in the direction of the treeline, in a silent question. Catra growls, acting angry, but gives Adora a subtle nod in response.

"You won't get away with this!" Catra cries out, just in case anyone was within distance to hear her, before she chases after Adora. Adora's impressed, if she's honest, at Catra's stellar performance. Adora smirks and runs off into the treeline to simulate a chase between them.

Catra runs and runs after Adora, Adora can hear her hot on her tail, until Adora comes to a stop as Catra does as well - *she thinks they're far enough away* . Catra turns around, sniffing the air to make sure that no one has followed them, before sighing and relaxing - Adora takes that as a good sign. "Hey Dummy..."

Adora doesn't waste any time. She rushes at Catra and picks her up, Catra wrapping her legs around her waist. Adora pushes Catra up against a nearby tree and *kisses* her, *hard* . She pulls back after a moment and smirks. "Hey Catra." Catra grins back at her, kissing her deeply as soon as Adora pulls away from their first kiss - probably to wipe the smirk plastered on Adora's face off.

"Hey Adora... I see you've missed me quite a bit."

"Sure," Adora says, rolling her eyes. "Let's call it that." She kisses Catra again. "You really kicked my ass today."

"Mmm... I did... your panicked expression was really cute, you know that right?" Catra whispers teasingly against Adora's lips before biting down on them gently. Adora *just* might be into getting her ass kicked and then her lips kissed, *who knew?* "My Lord, upset that I'm

kicking your ass like I told you I would?" Adora moans softly and tries to push herself closer to Catra.

"I guess," She pants softly. "I should let you guys win *sometimes* ." Adora takes a deep breath. "How have you been, Kitten?"

"I've been fine." Catra kisses Adora's jaw, humming softly. "My moms tried setting me up with another noble when I came back from the Fright Zone and got cleared by the medics." Adora pauses. She leans back to look at Catra.

"Set you up..." Adora feels... *weird* ... suddenly.

"Yeah... they're still stuck on the idea of wanting me to find a mate, but not as much as before after I explained my reasons." Catra shrugs, looking curiously at Adora. "What's wrong?"

"Wrong?" Adora asks. "Nothing is wrong." Adora moves her lips back to Catra, kissing her along her jaw. "I guess I just... didn't realise you'd be meeting one after being with me..."

"It wasn't my choice, idiot... my moms suddenly sprung it on me." Catra explains, turning her head and pecking Adora on her lips. "If it were up to me, I wouldn't have even had the meeting to begin with and it hardly lasted ten minutes."

"Yeah?" Adora asks. She places Catra onto her feet so she can run her fingers along her hips suggestively. "Did you like her?"

"And why is that any of your business, My Lord?"

"I'm just... curious." Adora says but, if she's honest, she's not entirely sure why she asks Catra that. She feels... almost threatened? Which she doesn't fully understand. She pushes her hand into the waistband of Catra's pants. "You only met for ten minutes?"

"Probably less... I knew she wasn't it." Catra looks up at Adora. "She understood that. We decided to just be friends though."

"Sounds like an unproductive meeting, I could've made you cum about... five times in those ten minutes." Adora comments flippantly.

"Five times? I do recall you making me cum only *once* in five minutes."

"Still more than what they did." *Is Adora being petty?* ***Maybe****.*

"The meeting wasn't intended to be sexual with them." Catra snorts. "I swear, you only think with your strap sometimes."

"Right now I'm thinking with my mouth." Adora wiggles her eyebrows. "Hm? How about I show you what I can do in only a few minutes, I can guarantee it's a lot more than what they can do. They don't have anything on me."

"You are so jealous for someone that is only fucking me... it's kind of cute." Catra grins, biting her lip. "Go ahead... show me."

"I'm *not* jealous." Adora protests. She hooks her fingers into Catra's pants anyway and yanks them down. "I'm simply proving to you that I'm *the best* ." Catra lets out an adorably squeaky laugh.

"Yeah, yeah... then *prove* it to me."

Adora kisses Catra on her lips and then her jaw and down to her neck. She was tempted to mark her but remembers one of their rules that they'd agreed to. Adora sinks down onto her knees and pulls Catra's pants down further, past her knees. She was determined, more than she ever had been before, to make Catra come *undone* . "Hm..." Adora presses her lips to the inside of Catra's thighs. "Keep your cute little ears peeled."

Catra nods in understanding. She bites her lip as she looks down at Adora in anticipation. Catra's hips move forward slightly and Adora smirks. She can tell Catra is excited, can *see* that she's excited. Adora is a little worried that she'll be *too* distracting to Catra, especially on her knees like this, for her to pay attention in case anyone came looking for them. But Adora knows that Catra would never let that happen - she *will* pay attention. Adora moves to tease Catra and she sees the woman move her hand up to her mouth in order to muffle the sounds that threaten on spilling from her lips.

Adora thinks about how strange this is. Despite her protests, she was a little jealous. At least... she thinks she was. Catra seeing someone else makes Adora feel... uncomfortable. She rationalises it in her brain as being because that would mean Catra would want to end this and this ending would mean an end to *great* sex. But as she marks Catra's thighs, as though someone might see them, she thinks about what they've said to each other. Adora wants those suitors to *back off* and if any got anywhere near where Adora was right now, they'd know that she was *claimed* .

Mine. All Mine.

Adora dives into Catra's pussy, not wanting to waste anymore time on the buildup and wanting to show Catra what she would be missing. No one's tongue can please Catra as good as Adora's. No one is Adora. And Adora is going to prove to Catra that whatever it is that they're doing is worth prolonging and *way* better than being courted by some flowery noble.

She focuses on Catra's clit, knowing that that was the fastest way to get Catra worked up. She takes Catra's clit into her mouth, sucking *hard* and using her tongue to stroke at it while also moaning softly at the taste that floods her mouth. She pulls away a little. "You're already wet Kitten," Adora swipes her tongue through Catra's folds. "Were you expecting something?" Adora asks, looking up with a smug smile.

Catra manages to open her eyes to look down at Adora which only makes Adora smirk more. She takes her hand off of her mouth and grins down at Adora. "Maybe seeing you on your knees for me was so hot that it instantly got me all heated." She lifts one of her legs, using the tree behind her to balance herself and to throw that leg over Adora's shoulder, using her heel to push Adora back towards her centre. "Now... I believe you were in the middle of something?"

If they were in Adora's bed, and if they had the time, Adora would have absolutely spanked Catra for that. But, as it is, Adora doesn't have the time to discipline Catra. So she rewards Catra's brattiness with a hard bite to the inside of her thigh before she goes back to work with her mouth. She continues sucking on Catra's clit before she moves down and pushes her tongue into her entrance. She alternates between fast and hard strokes and slow and precise swipes. She hums and glances up with her eyes to take in Catra's reaction.

Catra throws her head back in pleasure. Adora loves that she was able to figure Catra out so fast, what she likes, what she wants. Adora always seemed to leave her satisfied every time that they had met and Adora enjoyed getting Catra off. She enjoyed it more than even getting herself off, watching Catra squirm under her mouth, drag her in, every strangled moan she let out. It was *incredible.*

Catra moans loudly, though quickly brings her hand back up against her mouth to muffle the noise. Adora pushes her tongue inside of Catra and sucks on her clit immediately after which had Catra shaking at the knees. "Keep going..." Catra gasps out, partially opening her eyes to stare at Adora. Adora meets her gaze. "You're doing so *good* , sir."

To Catra's credit, she knows exactly how to motivate Adora. She doubles in her efforts and then inserts two fingers into Catra, immediately curling and *scratching* . She pulls her mouth back for a moment but continues her thrusts with her fingers. "Bet those suitors would love to know you already belong to *me* ." Adora says cockily before she puts her mouth back to use.

" *Hnnn* ... I bet they would." Catra laughs breathlessly, the sentence quickly ending with a moan. "What an outrage that would be..." She says in wonder as Adora sucks on her clit again. "Princess Catra... belonging to the Horde Lord... and the Horde Lord belonging to a Princess..."

Adora was a little busy with her mouth, otherwise, she would have protested that point. She moves her fingers more rapidly and scrapes her teeth over Catra's clit. Adora wonders what Catra's friends would say if they could see this - you know, beyond them *murdering* Adora first. Adora smirks a little at the thought. *Why does the idea of her taking Catra where her little Rebellion friends can see, or hear them, turn her on?*

Adora grabs Catra by her other leg and then, very carefully, and in a way that takes a tremendous amount of her strength, Adora manages to pull Catra down, laying her on her back - though she has to remove her fingers to do it. Adora spreads Catra's legs more,

keeping them straight up in the air with her hands as she dives back in. The new angle allows her tongue to reach deeper and she laps at Catra like her life may depend on it. She pulls away a little. "Fuck, Catra, I want to feel you on me." Which is true but Adora is also *really* enjoying tasting Catra too.

"Y-yeah? Use it... I think we have enough time." Catra moans, her claws digging into the tree behind her - how Adora wishes that was her back. "Use your sword... Adora, *please* ."

Adora pulls away and pulls at her clothes. She rolls her shirt up a little, exposing her abdomen. She shoves her trousers down. She curses her dumb armour for her not being able to strip all the way but taking it all off and putting it back on would take far too long. Adora ignores her sword for the time being, wanting to feel Catra on her *right now* . She presses her hard stomach to Catra's core and encourages Catra to rock against her.

" *Ahnn ... Adora* !" Catra moans, digging her claws into Adora's *armour* and scratching it. " *Harder ...*" She begs, kissing Adora's jaw and pulling her in more. Adora lets out a breathy laugh but she obliges, pressing harder against Catra and moving her own hips.

"You scratched my armour, Kitten."

"It's fine... it's fine..." Catra moans and kisses Adora deeply. "We... we need it to look like we fought anyways." She scratches at the armor again, looking at Adora lustfully. Adora’s breath gets caught in her throat.

"I wish that was my skin." Adora mumbles. She rises up a little and grabs her sword/strap. Unfortunately, Adora didn't consider how awkward a strap is to put on when your pants are half-way down your legs.

Adora growls in frustration and decides to pull her pants *up* rather than take them off - her boots and everything would make it take longer than just keeping her pants on. Even over her pants, Adora can feel the strap rub her in just the right place, though a little less than usual - she supposes she just has to go *hard* to get the usual level of contact she would normally have.

She returns to Catra but doesn't immediately dive in. She rubs the strap through her folds, rubbing her wetness along the length of it. Adora was enjoying the way that Catra was reacting to her doing that. "What do you want Kitten?" Adora pants into Catra's ear.

"I want you to fuck me, sir." Catra bites her lip. "You are so fucking hot, I need you to *fuck me, hard*. I'm yours, Adora."

"You want me to fuck you, Kitten?" Adora lines herself up and presses just the tip inside of Catra. "How badly do you want me?"

"So badly... I've missed you so much." Catra admits, pushing her hips up and kissing Adora again. "I need you to fill me up... I... I've missed your touch."

"You've missed me, hm?" Adora asks as she slowly sinks into Catra. "Tell me Catra, do you think about me when we're not together? Do you... touch yourself as you think about me?"

"I... maybe..." She tries to leave the answer up in the air, not looking directly into Adora's eyes when she says it, but Adora knows the answer. She imagines Catra back in her castle in Half-Moon, in her big Princess bed, *touching* herself to the thought of *Adora.* She wonders if Catra is ashamed of that.

"Maybe..." Adora repeats. Little does Catra know, she's done that too. Instead of admitting that, Adora *rams* herself into Catra. Catra is *definitely* going to get dirty with her back on the ground but, if anything, it'll sell their 'fighting' story.

Adora isn't gentle but, in all fairness, Catra asked Adora to fuck her hard and she *was* fucking her *hard* . Adora somehow finds the fact that they're half dressed even hotter, like they couldn't even wait to fuck each other.

Catra begs for more into Adora's ear, wrapping her arms tightly around her shoulders. Her ears were perked up in attention, which was actually kind of cute, impressive and funny all at once, to Adora. Catra was clearly still trying her best to focus on listening out for someone while still enjoying being fucked within an inch of her life by Adora. "You're so good

Kitten," Adora breathes. " *My* Kitten... *All. Mine.* " Adora punctuates those words with hard thrusts of her hips. "No one else's."

"Yours.... yours." Catra's pussy was gripping tightly at Adora's strap that was inside of her, wanting to keep it in as much as possible, and it felt *amazing* to Adora. Catra was groaning and grunting and moaning, making noises that Adora was pretty confident she had never made with anyone else before - especially not those suitors. " *Fuck* ! Kiss me... Kiss me, baby..."

Adora obliges Catra and kisses her, biting softly on her lip before Catra roughly shoves her tongue in her mouth anyway. Adora would've laughed at that if her mouth wasn't currently *full* . Her underwear was going to be ruined by the end of this session and she was going to have an uncomfortable journey home.

Catra cums harshly, her muscles tensing before her hips spasm against Adora's thrusts. Her moans are (thankfully) muffled by Adora's lips, otherwise Adora was sure that someone would have found them in a compromising position - namely Adora fucking Catra into the ground essentially.

Catra hits a second and, Adora thinks, a third orgasm as Adora continues to move against her in an attempt to reach her own release. Adora was close, *very* close, her once calculated thrusts were becoming sporadic and desperate. Catra pulls away from their kiss, moving her mouth to rest against Adora's ear and moans directly into it. "Cum for me, sir... cum for your Kitten that you fucked so *well* ..." Adora lets out a pitiful whine, that she has *never* made in her life before, at Catra's words.

The praise, the rough movement of her hips, the way her strap was hitting her *just right,* combined with Catra. *Catra, Catra, Catra* . Adora manages to push Catra into multiple orgasms but she isn't far behind her. She tumbles right over the edge because of that perfect cocktail. " *Catra* !" Maybe Adora should be quieter but she finds herself unable to stifle her words.

"Adora..." Catra whines and peppers kisses on Adora's face. Her fingers gently scratch the back of Adora's neck to bring them both back down to Etheria. "You did amazing, babe..." Adora laughs a little. She feels boneless and satisfied. She nuzzles her nose into the crook of Catra's neck.

"See if those suitors of yours can beat that." She mumbles quietly. "I think my underwear is ruined."

"You are so dumb..." Catra giggles, hugging Adora close. "None of my suitors touch me like this anyways. It's usually my first time meeting them." She hums softly before she nudges Adora. Adora wants to point out the fact that *they* fucked despite not knowing each other well, but she doesn't feel like bringing up justifications for Catra to have sex with *other* people that aren't herself. "We should clean up a bit and fix ourselves... and make it look like we've fought."

"Can we just... wait a minute?" Adora asks. She's reluctant to get up off of Catra if she's honest.

"... Just for a minute and then we should really go back... otherwise someone might be suspicious if we don't look like we've fought and I'm all covered in your scent." Adora presses soft kisses to Catra's jaw and neck. She pauses for a moment.

"Did anyone say anything about the hickey?"

"I managed to hide it... so no one saw it. Otherwise, I have no idea how I could have answered that." Adora hums and then slowly pulls out of Catra. She rolls off of her and onto her back, looking up at the sky.

"That was… *amazing* ." Adora sighs dreamily.

"It was..." Catra turns to her side, smiling at Adora. "It was pretty great, yeah..." She sighs and stands to her feet. Adora watches her wiggle her hips a little and a small smug smile pulls at the corner of Adora's lips - she so does enjoy making Catra feel *pleasantly* sore. Plus the wiggling post sex thing was apparently a Magicat thing, Adora had read that in a book.

Catra dusts herself down and then grabs her pants, pulling them up. Adora's almost disappointed that her *great view* was taken from her. Catra settles back down beside her, lying

next to her and Adora looks at her. They're lying side-by-side, face-to-face, in the soft grass of the forested area after a rough fuck and yet it still feels weirdly… intimate. Catra's eyes sparkle a little and Adora reaches a hand out to gently brush some stray hairs from Catra's face. "You good?" She asks. Adora grins.

"Good? I'm *great* !" She says enthusiastically. "Shame I can't carry you off."

"Not today, unfortunately." Catra laughs. "Come here, I need to scratch your armour a little more before we pretend that I was chasing you back."

"Scratch my armour? This is *quality* armour." Adora says, wafting Catra's claws away playfully. "Don't I get to rough you up a little too? Or is the fact your hair has leaves in it, and your back is dirty, enough?"

"I think you'll probably need to rough me up a little more." Catra shoves Adora in return. "To make it as believable as possible. I'm covered in your scent right now. So we seriously need to make it seem as though we fucked each other up... in a not sexy way."

"I definitely *fucked you* up." Adora says with a grin.

"I said in a *not* sexy way, idiot!" Catra shoves Adora again, laughing. "Stop thinking with your strap for once."

"I'm still *in* my strap, so excuse me for thinking with it."

"Asshole..." The nickname comes up affectionately. "But really though... we need to make sure there's no suspicion to why we're covered in each other's scents, otherwise my mom may just murder you."

"Please, I'm not scared of your mom Catra." Adora wiggles out of her harness and transforms her sword back to its original form. She places it to one side and then looks at Catra.

She pauses and then pounces on her, tackling her and rolling them a few feet. She lands on top of her, pinning her. "Ah-ha! I got you! Rebel scum!" Adora winks playfully and her wide smile takes all bite out of her words.

"Goddess!" Catra laughs and pushes her off with a grin. "Get off, you idiot! I'll kick your ass!" She tackles Adora as well, the two of them rolling around in the dirt and getting little cuts from the wooden pieces on the ground.

"Kick my ass? I think you mean *kiss* it." Adora teases.

"We're supposed to be acting like enemies, Adora. You're making it hard."

"Making it hard how?" Adora asks, pinning Catra to the ground. "We're *one hundred percent* enemies, I don't know what you mean. Enemies that sleep together." Adora quite enjoys her current position above Catra and she keeps their faces inches apart.

"You're not acting like we're enemies, idiot... you're looking at me like you want to go down on me again." Catra huffs beneath her.

"I do want to go down on you again."

"Not right now. I told you, we're supposed to act like enemies right now."

" *Ugh* , fine." Adora groans. "Do your thing. Do *not* rip my cape."

"I happen to love that cape on you. So no worries." Catra extends her claws and begins scratching at Adora's armour in random places.

"Am I your scratching post now?"

"Maybe a little." Catra gently scratches Adora's cheek, kissing the small lines to remind Adora that she was sorry for scratching her there - it does make Adora feel a little better and it only stings a little. "Okay, your turn."

Adora finds herself reluctant to hurt Catra, in any sense, which should be alarming to her but it’s not. "I uh... what should I do?"

"Anything that isn't debilitating. I'll be okay."

Adora debates, she doesn't exactly have claws that she can mark Catra's clothes up with. She reaches for her sword and makes slices in Catra's clothes that *barely* touch her skin and she rips with her hands too. "Good enough?"

"Uh... I think so? I'll probably get some bruising from being against the tree later anyways." Adora snorts.

"Are people going to see your back?"

"Possibly." Catra laughs. "Maybe the medic will."

"So long as bruising is an option," Adora grabs Catra's wrist and squeezes hard enough to bruise. She then stands, grabbing Catra by her shirt and lifting her up off of the ground easily. "Perfect."

"I-" Catra squeaks as she's pulled up by Adora with ease. "...why is that so hot?"

"Because you're thinking of all the ways I can use my strength to *please* you." Adora teases as she grabs her sword from the ground. She holsters the blade to her side.

"Yeah... yeah, I think that's it." Catra coughs, clearing her throat. "Do you... want to start running first?"

"Me?" Adora asks. "Why would *I* ever run from *you* ?"

“To make it seem as though I'm chasing you?"

"Yeah, but why would you ever chase me? I'd never run away from *you* first."

"You *have* done that before. And, you look like you've taken more damage than me at the moment. You do realise that, right?" She fights back with an exasperated sigh. Adora likes to be difficult, *what can she say?* "The longer we take, the more suspicious we look. Get moving, dumbass."

"You don't want to go another round real quick?" Adora asks teasingly.

"Nope. Not falling for it this time, hot stuff. Start running." Catra says as she slaps Adora's ass. *Huh.* Adora wasn't opposed to what just occurred."Get moving."

Adora rolls her eyes. She gives Catra a kiss on the lips one last time before she takes off running through the treeline, back towards the battle.

* * *

Catra lets Adora have a few seconds before she roars as though angry and chases after her. She continues making sounds of anger as she runs after the blonde, trying hard not to laugh because she could already imagine Adora doing the same. Things had changed between them, even if Adora had emphasised that they were enemies still, neither of them could really treat the other as though they were really on opposite sides.

Adora does her best to appear pissed off, which probably isn't too hard for her actually - although, Catra's willing to bet what must be an uncomfortable feeling in her underwear may help in that regard. She orders her troops into retreat and turns around to look at Catra. "You may have won this time, but I wouldn't count on it next time, *Catra* !"

"I won't *ever* let you win, Lord Adora!" Catra yells back in fake fury. "Get your ass out of here before I mince you to pieces!" She glares directly at the blonde, but allows her gaze to soften for a moment - and she mouths a 'see you later' - before she looks angry again. "You better watch out next time. I won't go easy on you."

"Easy?" Adora asks with a smug grin. "That's not how I like it, Kitten." Adora winks before she takes off running with her retreating soldiers, leaving Catra, and this battle, behind.

"Ugh, she's so gross!" Catra calls out - as though Adora hadn't been strap deep inside of her just minutes prior. "I'm so gonna shred her to bits next time I see her."

Once the Horde had started to retreat, the battle was over for both sides. Neither side usually chased the other down and, as much as Catra hated to admit it, they were often evenly matched in battles. It was a chance of strategy, and whoever was present at said battle, that usually swayed the results. Today's had been so successful because Catra had managed to ambush the Horde. Now Catra *definitely* knew there were Horde spies in the Rebellion, now she had to flush them out - she could probably ask for the help of Ex-Horde soldiers in that respect.

She was limping, once again, as she walked back with the Rebellion soldiers. She didn't know what to think when soldiers asked her if she was okay with so much concern. What would they think of her if they knew the reason Catra had a limp, and was so roughed up, was not because she'd actually *fought* the Horde Lord but because she'd been *fucked* by her? *Hard* . Catra felt a little guilty if she was honest, but Adora was like a drug. One night together and Catra was *hooked* , caught in the spider's web so to speak. At least people believed she'd been fighting with the Horde Lord and nothing else.

* * *

She was back at Bright Moon now, in the war room. Everyone had gathered for the post-battle debriefing which Catra always, personally, found a little unnecessary. She was still in

her tattered uniform, she was sore and she couldn't *wait* to have a bath. "Catra?" Catra is brought back to the present situation when she hears her name being called. "Do you want to explain how the battle went?" Angella asks softly, spurring Catra from her thoughts. She's able to quickly regain her composure before nodding and speaking.

"Yes, your Majesty. I would like to say that this battle was rather successful overall. We had no casualties and the injuries that were sustained were not severe for the most part. The soldiers that were injured more extensively were provided immediate treatment by the Bright Moon medics." Catra hums, taking out her com-pad. "However, there is something of concern that I wish to address with only the leaders of the Rebellion. If that is alright?"

Angella turns her head to the side and then gestures with her hand for those who were not Princesses that they should leave them be. Once they've all left, she focuses back on Catra. "What did you find?" She asks.

"We have a Horde spy on the inside." Catra whispers, once she's sure that only the Princesses and Queens were in the room. "There is a reason why I planned our battle strategy the way that I did. I didn't give the real battle plans to the soldiers until right before the battle because I figured someone may have been feeding the Horde information without our knowing. Hence why I requested to have our best fighters to join us for this battle. I knew they would be able to adapt to the sudden change in strategy and it would lead to the Horde being ambushed."

Angella's brow furrows, obviously troubled by this information while the room breaks out into whispers. "Well... that is... concerning." Angella admits. "Any ideas how we flush them out?"

"My main assumption is to possibly keep an eye on members of the Rebellion that joined more recently. Most of our older members are genuinely trying to help make Etheria a better place, but it could be that someone in the newer recruits may be the spy. I would think it would be a singular person to avoid being suspicious, but the question is... who?" Catra says as she contemplates the answer. "I would imagine it would be someone we'd least expect, no?"

Glimmer snorts. "Is Lord Adora even smart enough for that? She doesn't scream tactical genius to me."

"I doubt she's the one who thought about it. But you do realize that Adora has other strategists on her side, right?" Catra replies, not noticing her slip-up. Spinneralla and Netossa glance at each other, questioning looks in their eyes.

"I do feel inclined to agree with Catra here. *Lord* Adora does have other strategists that can help create a plan to work against us." Netossa emphasises, watching Catra's expression. Catra frowns a little at Netossa's gaze.

"Thank you, Netossa. We need to figure out exactly who Adora sent to spy on us and how exactly they managed to walk in right beneath our noses." Catra says, showing genuine concern about having a spy. For a moment, it makes her wonder if Adora had just been distracting her to sneak someone into the Rebellion to bring them down from the inside. But something tells her that wasn't the case.

"Spies aren't new." Angella admits. "The Horde have special soldiers trained for spying specifically, and sometimes they just hire mercenaries. A few of the older defectors who were a part of that program tell some... horrible stories about their training. I doubt Lord Adora even knows who the spies are, *if* she even knows they're active at all. She'll probably have Force Captains specific to managing their espionage operatives, and she goes off whatever plans are proposed to her." Angella sighs and taps her fingers on the War Room table.

"Then we may have to ask the older defectors to come in and see who they think might be the spy... they might be able to tell from the way they act." Catra nods at Angella.

Netossa and Spinnerella were still examining Catra closely. "Are you okay Catra?" Netossa asks. "We saw Lord Adora chase after you in the battle, we would've come to help but we got held up." Catra turns to them.

"Me? I'm fine. Just tired and in need of a bath. She chased me but I got her back and kicked her ass!"

"Hell yeah you did!" Glimmer exclaims. "That's our girl!" Glimmer and Bow high five enthusiastically and Bow throws Catra a thumbs up.

"Lord Adora seems..." Netossa trails off for a second. "She seems... a little distracted lately."

"Distracted?" Catra snorts softly. "She was probably flustered from her plan getting foiled, *again* . She can be so vain about losing, as you might have been able to tell from the yelling fest we had."

"No, she's been... way more passive lately."

"Passive?" Catra raises an eyebrow at Netossa, waiting for her to explain further.

"Yeah, she's retreated from a bunch of recent battles, and her ordering of them has been... less than usual." Netossa says.

"Do you think she's planning something big?" Angella questions with concern.

"Maybe." Netossa shrugs. "I mean, if she's capable of blowing up an eleven year old's castle, she's capable of anything."

"Why don't *we* spy on the Horde?" Glimmer asks.

"Because we're *not* the Horde, we don't spy, *duh* ." Mermista answers.

"I doubt that would work anyways. The Horde probably has a log of every soldier that they have." Catra shrugs. "That has been happening though, hasn't it?" She looks thoughtfully at Netossa. "I kind of doubt Adora is planning something big, she likes to rub things in our face way too much for that to happen."

Netossa and Spinnerella share a look that Catra doesn’t quite understand - they almost look *suspicious* . "Have you learnt anything on *Lord* Adora? Like, from anywhere? You know, the

whole, know your enemy thing. We could use an edge over her."

"Aside from the fact that she's a cocky asshole, not really. I don't exactly spend time with her over tea getting to know her." Catra bites the inside of her cheek. It was the truth, she didn't spend time with her *over tea* - it was usually over snacks and being fucked into her bed and in the shower. Catra clears her throat. "I think our best bet is to continue using our current strategy to minimise accurate information being given to the Horde until we are able to figure out who the spy is."

"My daughter is right," C'yra speaks up. "That's the best strategy until we find the spy."

"Guess that's why you're our strategist, huh Catra?" Glimmer asks.

"I think we can adjourn this meeting. The Horde will need to recuperate, spy or not, we can meet again later to discuss future plans." Angella says, dismissing the meeting.

Catra nods in agreement and smiles. "Someone's got to make the plans." She laughs before grabbing her com-pad and excusing herself to go to start heading to her guest room to take a shower.

"Catra, wait up!" Glimmer calls. Catra smiles softly at her friend’s voice.

"Yes, Glim?" Catra asks as she stops walking, turning around to look at her friend.

"I was thinking... After you've cleaned up and stuff, maybe we could have a sleepover? We haven't really had a lot of time together between, you know, you getting kidnapped... twice... and battles, and you being at Half-Moon." Glimmer says. "I know Bow would love some Best Friend Squad time."

"Yeah, sure... let me clean up, head to the medic to get rid of all these cuts and bruises, and I'll be at your room later, yeah?"

"Awesome! You can tell me about how you kicked the Horde Lord's ass." Glimmer grins and then she teleports away - probably to go find Bow.

Catra smiles and laughs softly to herself. Her friends really were so dorky. It... kind of hurt remembering that she would have to lie to them about what really happened. Catra lets her smile drop, turning back around to go head towards the infirmary.

"So, Catra, do you have any idea on who the Horde spy might be?" Catra stops once again when she hears another voice ask her a question. She sees that it's Spinnerella and Netossa and a small smile crosses her features again.

"Hi Spinny, Hi ‘Tossa. Unfortunately, no... I really don't know who it could possibly be. I kind of figured out that the spy recently joined our ranks because of the last few battles. But I really have no idea who."

"And you don't think it's one of the Princesses?" Netossa asks, narrowing her eyes a little.

"You think it's one of the Princesses?" Catra asks, looking genuinely concerned. "But... that wouldn't make sense. If that had been the case, our battle strategy earlier wouldn't have worked at all, since only the Princesses knew about it to help pass the information to the soldiers right before the battle." Netossa hums.

"I guess," She says. "But Lord Adora still managed to get away in one piece and she didn't even suffer that big of a loss." Netossa looks at Spinnerella for a moment before she looks back to Catra. "We just think that maybe loyalties can change." Why does Catra get the impression that they might *actually* be suspicious of her? Whatever the case, Catra is *not* a spy. She may be sleeping with the Horde Lord but she is *not* feeding Adora any sort of information that would give the Horde an unfair advantage over the Rebellion.

"Thankfully, both sides managed to get away in one piece for the most part." Catra sighs in relief. "I highly doubt that. There's not really anything that the Horde can offer someone out here that would make them go. Horde conditions... are pretty bad." Catra has *seen* them. It wouldn’t make sense for someone who *wasn’t* either being paid by the Horde, or raised by the

Horde, to help them. *Why would a Princess possibly help Adora? What would they gain?* That just wouldn't make any sense. It *has* to be a Horde soldier within the Rebellion.

"I'm sure Lord Adora can offer a few things," Netossa says cryptically, raising a brow. "All it takes is for her to wiggle her way into their heads and poison their mind and morals."

"You really think she'd be able to do that?" Catra blinks a few times. "How would she even do that?"

"Charm? Who knows. She could do it any way, just make someone trust her when they *shouldn't* ."

"I doubt that would happen, 'Tossa. But it is a valid reason for concern." Adora is charming in her own way but, like Glimmer said before… Adora is smart, and she's tactical, but she wouldn't be able to… *What? Seduce a Princess to do her bidding?* She lacks… Adora is not a patient person, and she *hates* Princesses, even if Catra is an exception, there is *no way* she would *ever* do that.

"Why do you doubt it? I wouldn't put anything past Lord Adora." Netossa comments.

"Simply because she hates us Princesses. So I kind of doubt she'd want to 'charm' any of us." Catra explains her thoughts. She does wonder why Netossa is being so… cryptic and slightly hostile. Catra took every precaution to conceal her… relationship with the Horde Lord, she just had to play it cool.

"Well... that's... true..." Netossa looks off to the side for a moment. "She seems to like you though." *There it is. Gods be damned Adora.*

"As if. She likes *annoying* me. She can't stand me on most days." Catra lies through her teeth. She had learned that that wasn't entirely true when Adora had kidnapped her the first time. Turns out, Adora can stand her *very* much.

"She flirts with you every chance she gets." Netossa points out. "We've all seen it."

"She literally does it because she knows it annoys me, ‘Tossa.” Catra argues back. Also, not a lie, Adora told her that herself.

"Maybe." Netossa concedes. "I just think you should be careful Catra. She's kidnapped you twice, she seems to have an... *interest* in you."

"I appreciate your concern, really. But I'll be okay. She wants to keep me away because I'm the Rebellion's main strategist.” Catra couldn’t count how many times she’s given this excuse to both her moms and the various Princesses.

"How do you feel about her?" Netossa asks suddenly.

"Feel about her?" Catra repeats, keeping her expression as neutral as possible. Though she had been caught off guard and she’s pretty sure she lets that slip.

"Yeah, how do you feel about Lord Adora?"

"She's annoying and gets on my nerves to no end. But I don’t see how this is relevant to our conversation?" Catra asks, feeling defensive. Her tail swishes back and forth behind her in irritation. She’s not liking this line of questioning, it’s putting her on the edge.

"Hm." Netossa says.

"Whatever the case, we'll let you get cleaned up and see the medic." Spinnerella says softly. "We can work to find the spy together."

"Sounds good." Catra nods and smiles, glad to have people on board to try to find whoever was feeding the Horde information and that they were dropping *that* subject. "You guys did great out there today, from what I was able to see, by the way."

" *You're* the one who chased down the Horde Lord." Spinnerella brings up.

"Still! Just because I was the one chasing her doesn't mean everyone else didn't have a big part in the fight."

"Let's just hope Lord Adora doesn't suddenly want to use She-Ra, I doubt we want to find out why she's the *Princess of Power* ." Netossa says, looking troubled at the idea of that ever happening.

"She won't." Catra slips up, biting the inside of her cheek as she realizes what she just said. "She explained it to me once, when she tried to tell me that she could easily destroy the Rebellion if she wanted to. She said she wouldn’t use it because she didn’t want to be like us Princesses. Violent and out of control."

Netossa looks offended. "I'll show her-"

" *Okay* !" Spinnerella interrupts her wife. "We're keeping Catra from the medic. We'll just see how things go."

"Okay... I'll see you two later. I seriously need a shower." Catra waves at them before turning around and walking off.

* * *

Spinerella looks concerned as Catra walks away before turning to her wife and whispering. "You really think Catra... is a spy?"

"It's a possibility. You heard her Spinny, she called Lord Adora, *Adora* , repeatedly, and she disappeared with her today at the battle. Catra's been acting... different... towards Lord Adora since she came back from being kidnapped."

"She looked just as surprised and concerned about the spy like any of us... Plus she's the one who brought it up. Why would she raise the flag on herself?" Spinnerella points out.

"To take the suspicion off of herself? I don't know, but *something* is up. Let's just... keep an eye on her." Netossa narrows her eyes a little. Spinnerella looks conflicted but nods nonetheless. Something was definitely up. *Everyone* , including Catra before recently, called Lord Adora, *Lord* Adora, never *just* Adora.

"Okay... and if she really is the... the spy?" Spinnerella asks.

"We confront her."

"And if she's not?"

"Then good, no one has to know."

"... And what if something else is going on?" Spinnerella looks back in the direction where Catra had gone off to. "If she's not the spy... why is she acting differently all of a sudden?"

"Something else? Like what?" Netossa asks with a frown.

"... What happened when she was taken the first time?" Spinnerella asks cautiously.

"What do you mean?" Netossa's frown deepens. "She said Lord Adora kidnapped her because she was our strategist and then she said she escaped."

"Come with me. We need to go to our room here to continue this conversation." Spinnerella suggests, taking her wife's hand and pulling her through the corridors before they get to their bedroom. "There just... seems to be some gaps in that story..."

"You're going to have to fill me in here Spinny. What are you saying?" Spinerella feels and looks uncomfortable for a moment as she tries to find the words to say what she wanted to.

"I'm saying, and I know this sounds crazy, but... what if something is going on between Catra and Lord Adora?"

"... You mean... *romantically* ?!" Netossa yells.

"Catra's been calling Lord Adora by her name, has been chasing after her every time they've seen each other, and the two times she's been kidnapped, plus this battle, she's come back limping. Something has to be going on." Spinnerella rubs her wife's hand. "I don't know if it's sexually or romantically, but it just doesn't make sense for Catra to escape twice, practically unharmed, but limping, every time..."

"You think she's having sex with the Horde Lord?" Netossa looks horrified. "No way. ... She wouldn't... would she?"

"I don't know... but the likelihood of her fighting against the Horde Lord and getting injured in the same location where she can't walk correctly... is pretty low, darling." Spinnerella looks at her wife, a frown on her face. "What do you think?"

Netossa looks thoughtful for a moment. "I don't think we should do anything unless we're sure but... *something* is going on, that much is clear. If we keep an eye on her then maybe we can confront her about it."

"... And what do we do if she really is... sleeping with the Horde Lord?"

"We'll cross that bridge *if* we come to it."

"Okay... if we come to it." Spinnerella repeats and sighs. "This war just got a lot more complicated, didn't it?"

"If Catra is *actually* sleeping with the Horde Lord... yeah." Silence befalls them as they sit together, thinking about how to approach this dilemma.

* * *

Meanwhile, Catra had already taken a shower and gone to the medic to get the injuries healed up. She feels flustered when she realises that the soreness in her hips, that she has come to like, also fades away as soon as the medic uses a healing spell - leaving her yearning for that ache again. She shakes her head, reminding herself that she needs to focus and go to Glimmer's room to have the sleepover that her best friend had asked her to have.

She walks over to Glimmer's room, knocking and waiting for the other to answer. "Yo, Glim! I'm here!" She calls out from outside of the room. Glimmer opens the door to her room and grabs Catra by her wrist and pulls her inside without even saying hello. " *Wow* !" Catra yelps as she's pulled inside, almost tripping over her own feet. "A little warning would have been nice!"

"Sorry," Glimmer says, but she doesn't sound the least bit sorry. "Bow and I were just talking about you." Glimmer crosses back over to Bow and sits down beside him, cross-legged.

"Really?" Catra asks as she sits down across from them. "What about exactly?"

"About how you keep kicking Lord Adora's ass," Glimmer says with a grin. "I mean, you've escaped her kidnapping *twice* and you beat her at the most recent battle. She must be really pissed off with you." Catra's guilt made itself known as soon as Glimmer spoke. She forces herself to keep a realistic smile on her face for her friends before sighing.

"Oh, she is. She really thinks she's gonna be able to win next time. But I won't let her!" Catra feels… weird… really weird. Talking about Adora like she was an actual foe was strange now, especially after sharing such intimate moments with her. Something about it just felt so unbelievably… *fake* . She just hoped she was a good enough actress to convince her friends.

"Her ego is too big for her own good." *That* Catra could agree with.

"Very much so. I swear, one day her ego is gonna cause her head to explode.” Glimmer snorts.

"I wish." She pauses for a moment. "You know, if we got rid of Lord Adora we'd defeat the Horde. I mean, everyone knows she took Hordak and Shadow Weaver out, she's literally the *only one* who can lead. If we take her out... the Horde would be like a headless chicken." For some reason, the idea of taking out Adora crushes Catra's heart a little and she frowns.

"I... kind of doubt that. The Horde might just go into a power struggle. That being said, even if we were to take out A- Lord Adora... she has a right-hand and probably has others that could take over if she's ever taken out." Catra argues.

"You mean Scorpia? Please. I've fought her before, she's *way* too nice to lead the Horde." Glimmer says dismissively. "I'm telling you, we get rid of Lord Adora, we win the war."

"I mean," Bow interrupts. "that makes sense in theory but Catra's right. Plus... Adora is She-Ra, I think we can still get through to her if we just talked to her." Bow has always been so kind. That is his biggest strength. Sometimes Catra wonders how Bow can have such a big heart, for *everyone* .

"That's because you see the best in everyone Bow." Glimmer says and she's teasing, a little, but she gets a soft look in her eyes as she looks at him. Catra watches them closely. Glimmer is right, however, Bow really does see the best in everyone. "Lord Adora would stab us before we got anywhere near her." Catra shrugs.

"I doubt that. She'd have to give her whole speech first before that happens." She says with a playful grin. "But who knows... could you imagine if talking to her really was the solution?"

"There's no *talking* to her." Glimmer frowns. "She's literally just evil, and a cocky bastard. The only talking she does is about how much better she is than everyone else."

Except she's not evil... just misled .

Catra hums softly. "Probably. But I'm saying it would be funny if that really had been the answer all this time."

"You have a weird sense of humour," Glimmer says. "Lord Adora... the Horde... they've destroyed so many people's lives. There's no reasoning with evil."

"You're right..." Catra whispers as she lays back on the floor. "But let's stray from this topic before the mood for this sleepover goes down. Did you two bring snacks?" Catra could feel the whisper of guilt, telling her that she's living a lie from both sides. It was hard to call Adora evil once she had gotten to know her and it was hard lying to her best friends and the people she had known since she was younger.

Glimmer scoffs. "Obviously. Bright Moon's finest." Glimmer stands and brings a platter over, setting it in the middle between them. " *Ta-da* ."

Catra beams and purrs as she sees the food. "Nice." She reaches for one of the snacks, downing it and watching her friends do the same. *Is sleeping with Adora worth risking all of this?* She hears the voice of guilt whispering. *Yes... being with Adora... getting to call her mine is worth it.* She responds, wondering if her answer would really hold true in the future and why she even had *that* answer *now* .

"Hey," Glimmer says. "how's your search for a mate going?"

"Ugh, don't even remind me about that." Catra groans.

"Still haven't found the one?" Glimmer asks with a laugh.

"And not planning to do so anytime soon."

"I'm sure you'll find them, Catra." Bow encourages. "You're awesome. Anyone would be lucky to have you." Catra laughs softly.

"Thanks, guys. I just don't feel like it's the right time, nor have I found the right person."

"The right person is important." Glimmer admits. "The right time though..." She pulls a face. "There's always going to be a reason it's not the right time, but you shouldn't let it stop you."

"I'll let you know when I've found the right person for me then... if that ever happens."

" *Anyway* , after today, I think we all deserve some time to relax." Bow says with a genuine smile. Bow has one of the best smiles.

"Oh, for sure." Catra closes her eyes and let's herself relax. She hopes things don't get too complicated in the future.

Chapter End Notes

These two dorks need to learn to be sneaky but are too focused on each other to realise that. I hope y'all enjoyed -M

Hm... Idk y'all... Seems like Adora might have been a little jealous there ;) See you next time with these two gay disasters! -S

Shadows of the Past

Chapter Summary

The Fright Zone is home, it always has been and it always will be.

Chapter Notes

Happy Friday y'all! Coming at you with a new update! We hope you all enjoy!!

Warning, Implied/Referenced Child Abuse (because Shadow Weaver is trash)

See the end of the chapter for more notes

Adora can't sleep and it's driving her *crazy* . She keeps tossing and turning and she keeps calculating how many hours of sleep she will get if she just falls asleep *now* but it doesn't work. She almost wishes Catra was here, if not to cuddle, to at least exhaust herself with her. She groans and grabs her pillow, throwing it over her face. It's no use. It's just one of *those* nights.

She sits up, her pillow falling from her face. She had a few ideas of what could help her sleep but zero energy to really commit to it. There was always the option of exercising but she didn't feel like it. She sighs and crosses her legs as she thinks. She thinks about Catra, about how beautiful she is, how she felt with her below her, how her eyes sparkle in low light, how her laugh is the cutest sound Adora has ever heard. Just *Catra, Catra, Catra.* Adora feels more calm when she blinks open her eyes but still restless.

She swings her feet over the side of her bed and pulls her boots on that lay there. Always prepared for an attack even while asleep. Shadow Weaver taught her that. She used to attack Adora in the middle of the night to make sure she was prepared at any moment, even while sleeping. *Shadow Weaver.* That is a name that Adora hasn't heard or thought about in a while. Well, that's not so true. She always thinks about Shadow Weaver, and has even thought about her more now that she's been spending time with Catra, but they're not *good* thoughts. No, they're *very bad* thoughts.

She stands up from her bed and paces back and forth. She feels pent up and with no release. Thinking about Catra makes her spiral. She was jealous, honest to the gods *jealous* , when Catra had told her of her suitors and she had no right to be. They are fuck buddies at best, enemies at worst. Adora shouldn't be getting jealous but... she dislikes the idea of Catra seeing others - especially with the intention of possibly marrying that other person. She doesn't know why she feels that way, only that she does.

She takes off without really thinking about it, which is probably her worst idea yet, but she's wound up and she wants to... she wants to do *something* . She's frustrated and angry and upset. That's why she can't sleep and she may be wrong but she thinks this *may* help.

She's probably wrong.

She walks through the Fright Zone, it's the early hours of the morning and the only people awake are the night shift, a skeleton crew, they salute her as she passes by. She knows Catra hadn't been fond of the Fright Zone's... *decoration? Atmosphere? Whatever.* But Adora finds it oddly calming - probably because she grew up here. The buzzing machinery is practically a lullaby to her. Adora feels most comfortable in the Fright Zone, she supposes it is home - even if Catra protests that anything like this could be a home. Despite all the bad that Adora has been through here, she honestly couldn't see herself being anywhere else. Being Lord felt like where she was supposed to be. She can't ignore the comfort she feels being in these metal walls.

The Fright Zone *is* home, it always has been and it always will be.

Adora makes it to the cells easily. No one questions what she's doing there, and no one *would* question her. Why would they? She is their *Lord* and she can do whatever the hell she wants to do. She pauses briefly at the cell that had held Catra, before all of *this* had started, before she carries on. *Who would ever have thought they'd end up here after that night?*

She makes her way to the darkest depths, past multiple security doors until she reaches her destination. It's just as gloomy as Adora remembers it, the only light is from the single bulb about six metres from the cell where the green force-field buzzed. Adora stops directly in front of it, her boots making a heavy thud against the metal.

"Shadow Weaver." Adora greets flatly, *emotionless* .

" *Adora* ." Shadow Weaver drools, a sarcastic twinge to her voice. "It's such a pleasure to see you again. Tell me, to what do I owe this visit to?" Her tone was condescending, working to push all of Adora's buttons from the moment she came into view.

Adora's jaw clenches and she feels her back straighten. It's an automatic response to being in Shadow Weaver's presence, she only half resists the urge to salute her. *Always the perfect soldier,* ***Shadow Weaver's*** *perfect soldier.* She wasn't. Not anymore. She didn't have to worry about her uniform being out of place, or anything, in front of Shadow Weaver anymore. She is the *Lord of the Horde* , she is not some skinny scared cadet anymore. But… Adora guesses she will always feel that way whenever she is in the presence of Shadow Weaver. Just one more fucked up thing about her to add to her list.

"Thought coming to see how miserable of a state you're in would make me feel better." Adora responds coolly. If there is anyone Adora is unnecessarily cruel to, it's Shadow Weaver - but she'd earned that treatment, trust her.

"I see." Shadow Weaver stands up in her cell, hands clasped together in front of her. Adora straightens up even further. "Is that truly the reason that you came to see me, Adora? Surely you're simply here to tell me that you've been succeeding without me, am I right?" Shadow Weaver hums. "You must understand, without me you were nothing. Had it not been for me, you wouldn't be standing where you are today. Everything that you are is *because* of me." Adora feels a flash of anger.

"I'm standing here *in spite* of you!" Adora yells. If there's anyone who can pull an... emotional response from Adora, with little effort, it's Shadow Weaver. "I've never done better than when I got rid of you."

"So you say and yet here you are." Shadow Weaver shakes her head in disappointment. "You know that I'm right, Adora. I made you *strong* . Without me, you wouldn't have been able to take down Hordak. You *need* me." *No. Don't listen to her.*

"You tricked me! And you made me use She-Ra..." Adora's hands shake a little before she balls them into fists. "I *don't* need you. *You* needed *me* . The Horde is doing way better under me then it *ever* did under you or Hordak."

"I simply encouraged you to use the power you had at your disposal." Shadow Weaver corrects. "You made the choice to use it. A necessary one if you ask me. And yet, you refuse to use her again." Adora scoffs in disbelief.

"Why would I *ever* use her again?" Adora asks, caught off guard. "She's a Princess, aren't they supposed to be bad? Not to mention... she's... I can't control her."

"And why would you need to? You can easily end the Rebellion and take control of Etheria within hours. Yet, you refuse to use the power that you have and continue to fight this... useless war." Adora shakes her head. *Useless war? A war that Adora was raised to fight for? Useless?* Adora feels hot, her anger spreads through her veins like hot lava.

"I can't believe you." She runs her hands down her pants. "I *will* win against the Rebellion, *without* using She-Ra." Adora says, stepping closer to the force-field. *How could she say that? After everything Adora has done for the Horde?* Adora runs her fingers through her bangs, setting them back atop her head. The scar over her eye seemed to ache every time she looked at Shadow Weaver.

"Let me know if you ever manage to do that. Especially with your... *infatuation* with a certain Princess." Shadow Weaver knew *exactly* where to push. Adora balks and stutters at that.

"What? I... I don't know what you're talking about." *How the hell would Shadow Weaver know about that? She is **literally** in the most secure Horde prison that there is? No one comes down here…*

"So you say, and yet I see quite the marks on your neck and arms." Adora blushes and lifts her hand to her neck briefly before she drops her hand again.

"That's... that's none of your business!"

"You're getting distracted by a *Princess* . Pitiful. Truly pitiful." Shadow Weaver spits out, shaking her head. It hits Adora hard. She hates it. She hates that Shadow Weaver still has so much power over her. "I thought I taught you better than that and yet you're allowing yourself to be swayed by the enemy."

"I am *not* distracted! Nor am I being swayed by *anyone* ." Adora protests angrily. "You want to talk pitiful? How about you take a look at *yourself* ."

"There it is... your need to remind yourself that you're better than everyone else." Adora can only assume, from her tone of voice, that Shadow Weaver rolls her eyes behind that mask of her's. "You really do need to work on that."

"Better than everyone else? Maybe not, but definitely better than *you* ." Shadow Weaver waves her off dismissively and Adora narrows her eyes.

"So you tell yourself. Now run along, go fuck that little slut of a Magicat. But don't come crying to me when she tricks you." Adora freezes as she registers Shadow Weaver's words. She feels like someone just poured freezing water over her. And then, she feels *anger* . Hot, unrestrained, anger. She wants to punch something (or, more accurately, she wants to punch Shadow Weaver).

"Don't... Don't you *dare* talk about her like that!" Adora growls. "As if I'd ever come crawling to *you* . You're weak, and powerless and you couldn't even hurt a fly!"

"Ah..." Shadow Weaver laughs. "I see, you are much too obvious, Adora. You've caught feelings for the Magicat, haven't you?" She tuts. "You're really letting the words of a whore Princess grip you like this? What a shame."

"Stop! Stop it!" Adora covers her ears for a moment, to shut out Shadow Weaver's words, before she pulls them away again. "I mean it. Or I'll shut you up *myself* . You're wrong."

"You know I'm right. But remember, you're not lovable. You're a *soldier* , Adora. You're not meant for love." Adora laughs bitterly.

"I'm well aware of that." She takes a breath as she leans her hand against the force-field. "Who said anything about love or feelings anyway? You're a delusional old woman. I should've known you'd just talk a bunch of bullshit."

"Say what you will. You'll find out soon enough when you get your heart broken."

"Unlikely." Adora says as she turns her back to Shadow Weaver. "Can't break my heart when I don't have one to break." Shadow Weaver tuts again before sitting back down in her jail cell without a word. Adora's pretty sure she won that argument.

"... I suppose that is true." Shadow Weaver says.

Adora waits for a moment. She hates that she still craves Shadow Weaver's approval even after all she's done. She's not sure that will ever go away. She has some innate need to prove herself to Shadow Weaver, no matter what. "How did you... how did you know it was Catra?"

"Please, the Horde has ears everywhere."

"What the hell does *that* mean?"

"I'll leave you to figure that out." Adora shakes her head, she doesn't know if Shadow Weaver is purposely trying to make her paranoid or not, but, considering she knew it was Catra, something about what she said unsettles her.

"Maybe I'm just using Catra's... infatuation... with me to... to my advantage." Adora turns back to her.

"Then why do you grow angry when I call her what she really is? A slut." Shadow Weaver questions. Her glowing eyes focus on Adora and Adora knows she's watching for her reaction. Adora schools her expression into a passive one.

"Maybe I just don't think we should call women sluts. I mean, *really* Shadow Weaver? You spent too much time with Hordak."

"As if. She's your enemy. You shouldn't be defending her yet here you are. All because she opened her legs for you."

"She *is* my enemy." Adora brushes off. "I'm using whatever advantage I have. Catra hasn't tried to attack me since we... you know." Adora felt... bad, when she said it like that. Even just implying this was some tactic to gain Catra's trust, to turn on her later, felt uncomfortable but... she couldn't have Shadow Weaver thinking she just let Catra into her bed without a second thought.

"And yet you continue to defend her."

"I'm *not* defending her." Adora bristles. "I'm calling you out on your misogynistic *bullshit* ."

"Sure, Adora. Keep telling yourself that. Now, run along, child. I grow tired of your babbling." Shadow Weaver waves her off. Adora feels that familiar anger at Shadow Weaver's words.

"I'm not a *child* . You talk a big game, Shadow Weaver, but I *know* you're afraid of me." Adora has *seen* her be afraid of her.

"Oh, you're still here running your mouth." Shadow Weaver ignores everything that Adora had just spoken. "Don't you have somewhere else to be?"

Adora takes a deep breath and then starts marching out of the cell room. She slams the door behind her and bites her clenched knuckle in anger. She really needs to hit something now.

She's not going to get any rest tonight.

* * *

Adora was in a mood all day after that. She'd had next to no sleep and her 'talk' with Shadow Weaver had left a sour taste in her mouth all day. She'd yelled multiple times at her troops, made a few of them literally tremble in their boots, even Scorpia was avoiding her. She was having a rotten day. Her knuckles were sore from punching her punching bag too hard and for too long. So when it finally came to going to bed, Adora was more than ready to end this terrible day.

She was just getting ready to climb into bed when her com-pad went off with an incoming video call. Adora pauses. The only person who called her was usually Scorpia, and she was likely already sleeping, and she didn't recognise the extension calling her. She picks up her com-pad and answers the mysterious caller.

"Hey Adora." A soft, familiar voice rings through the com-pad. "I heard from a certain scorpion gal that you needed some cheering up." Catra whispers softly and waves at Adora through the screen. Adora almost drops her com-pad on the ground but she recovers fast enough that she manages to catch it.

"Catra? What- How? ... Scorpia has *got* to stop surprising me with you." *Seriously! This is becoming a habit.* Still, seeing Catra… Adora already feels significantly better than she did about five minutes ago.

"Awww, you don't like the surprise?" Catra teases gently with a wink. "She told me that you were looking upset earlier. Are you okay?"

"I'm..." Adora sighs and sits down on her bed. "I'm fine... just... tired, that's all." In all fairness, that is true. Adora is *extremely* tired. Getting no sleep will do that to a person, but she couldn't tell Catra about talking to Shadow Weaver, she couldn't even *begin* to explain that to her.

"Tired?" Catra asks, looking at Adora with worry. "Is there anything I can do to cheer you up?" Adora smiles a little at the soft gesture. Catra looks genuine and she's clearly in bed because Adora can make out her bed sheets and pillow behind her. She looks like she's ready for bed too, her hair is out of its ponytail and she isn't in her usual fighting clothes.

"Why don't you tell me about your day?" Adora asks, wanting to shift the focus from herself to Catra. She wanted to hear Catra talk, not herself, and she was curious what Catra had been

up to.

"My day? It's been alright. We're kind of on break for a few days, aside from planning, you know... in case you decide to be a dork."

"A dork?" Adora raises an eyebrow. Funny that Catra describes Adora's tactical battle attacks as just her being a 'dork'. "I don't have any plans," Adora admits. "I gave my Force Captains a good... yelling... after they messed up on the last battle."

"Hey, it wasn't their fault. I just happened to be a little smarter than you this time." She teases, giggling softly. Adora grumbles. Catra was always smarter than her. There were rare occasions that Adora was actually able to outsmart Catra. They're both pretty evenly matched, but Catra's brain is her biggest power, it's like she was born to be a war strategist, it comes so naturally to her - Adora actually has to put *effort* into coming up with plans. "But anyways, I had some chocolate chip cookies earlier. They were really good."

"Subtle brag Catra." Adora says, rolling her eyes. She's not sure if she's talking about the fact that Catra is telling Adora about how she ate something *other* than ration bars, or the fact that she outsmarted Adora.

"You like it." Catra grins and winks. "So... wanna talk about what has you grumpier than usual?"

"Not really..." Adora mumbles.

"Okay, fair enough." Catra nods, changing the topic. Adora appreciates that, she really does. She doesn't think she has the energy to talk about Shadow Weaver on a *good* day. "Should I cut my hair?"

" *What* ?! Why?" Adora's eyes widen.

"Just asking. I was thinking about going for something shorter? You know, try something new." Catra responds, ruffling her own hair. Adora finds it adorable if she's honest. Sometimes she wonders how lucky she is that this… Princess likes having sex with her - Catra is *seriously* beautiful. "Figured I'd ask you for your opinion since we're here."

"I... uh..." Adora frowns in thought. "I like your hair now, but I'd like it short too... less to hold onto though." She adds with a smirk. Catra snorts and rolls her eyes.

"Dummy... I'll consider it. I was actually thinking of going for a short cut. Like just below the ears and then to let it grow out." She snickers. "When I was younger, I hated my hair being touched, so I never fully took proper care of it, hence the kind of fluffy limpness to it. But my hair is supposed to be wavy, which is another reason I wanted to cut it. To let it regrow back healthier."

"Yeah?" Adora won't lie, she's not exactly that well versed in hair care; so all of that pretty much just flew over her head. Her hair was washed and cut regularly so she could keep it pulled back in a tight ponytail and keep it out of her face. She didn't really think about the technicalities of looking after it. "Maybe don't cut your own hair like I did," Adora says fondly. "unless you also want to rock the hair poof look." Adora laughs a little at the memory. A dare from Lonnie to cut her hair had resulted in horribly uneven bangs that Adora had hid most of her life in her hair poof. Her bangs had grown since then but to keep them out of her face she continued to pin them back.

"The hair poof suits you though." Catra whispers, a soft look in her eyes. That might be the first time anyone has ever said that about The Hair Poof. "Though, you really do look so nice with your hair down too."

"So you've told me, I recall you saying it was *sexy* ." Adora teases and then she rolls over on her bed, grabbing her pillow to rest her chin on more comfortably. "I wish you were here right now." Catra purrs and it's audible enough for the microphone on the com-pad to catch it.

"Do you? Do you miss me?" Adora buries her nose in her pillow and takes a deep breath, trying to see if she could pick up any trace of Catra that may still be lingering, but she hadn't been in her room for a while now and all Adora can smell is her own natural musk.

"Sure," Adora admits. "I could use..." She trails off. She’s not sure if that confession is *too* soft.

"Mm... you could use...?" Catra smiles, urging Adora to continue. "I wish I was there too... would you believe me if I said I've slept better over there than in my own bed?"

"I believe you," Adora sighs - she certainly could’ve used Catra last night. "I... didn't sleep well last night."

"You didn't?"

"No." Adora admits. "I couldn't sleep so I- I went on a walk, that didn't help." It did the *opposite* in fact.

"Do... you want me to stay on the call with you?" Catra asks softly. Adora can see her getting comfortable in her own bed. "Maybe it'll help us both?"

"You think so?" Adora asks. She swallows a little. This is different and questionable territory. The time they've spent together has been sexual but this... this isn't sexual.

"Maybe... I mean... it's worth the try if we can both get a good night's sleep, right?" Adora is too tired and too exhausted to explain to Catra why it's probably not a good idea - and she's also too tired to try and turn it sexual.

"Yeah, okay..." Adora concedes, setting her com-pad up so she wouldn’t have to awkwardly hold it anymore. Now it was like Catra was there next to her, even if it were on a screen.

"Mmm..." Catra hums, adjusting her own com-pad to make sure she was comfortable and that Adora could see her. "Do you want me to sing to you?"

"Sing?"

"Do... you not know what singing is?"

"I... well... no I do, Scorpia does it sometimes, but... you don't really hear singing around the Fright Zone." Scorpia does it a lot actually. It used to annoy Adora but now she's used to it and she doesn't like being mean to Scorpia - plus she has a pretty good voice.

"I can imagine... do you want me to?"

"Sure, why not?"

Catra pauses for a moment and Adora can see her pondering about what song she should sing. "*... It's been days and weeks and months... it's been forever since I saw you...* " She starts off, softly but her voice was still loud enough for Adora to hear the melody. Adora relaxes as Catra begins singing, her voice soft and comforting. She pays attention to the words she's singing and wonders if Catra had chosen that song purposely.

"*... All I can imagine is being in your arms... I want you to know, I don't need anything fancy...* " Catra continues singing. Adora notices her cheeks turning pink slightly at the lines and she thinks Catra *really* might have picked this song purposely. Instead of continuing to sing the lyrics, Catra turns to humming instead - which is equally as soothing as the gentle singing.

"You have a really nice voice." Adora murmurs.

"Thank you..." Catra smiles back. Catra seems relaxed and calmed by Adora's presence which is nice to witness. "Want me to keep going?"

"If you want to keep going, I'll keep listening." Adora responds. Catra giggles and continues humming, closing her eyes as she curls up more under her blanket.

"Hey Adora..."

"Are you flirting with me?" Adora asks playfully, her lip curling up at one corner while she peeks an eye open to look at Catra.

"Is it flirting if I just say your name?" She smiles, glancing at Adora through half-lidded eyes. "That's gay..."

"It's flirting when you say it like *that* ."

"And how did I say it?"

"Like you want me in your bed with you."

"... Maybe I do."

"Maybe I'd be there, if I could."

"Yeah?" Something about Catra's voice is a little different - almost like they were treading dangerous waters with this conversation. "... Why?"

"Why?" Adora asks.

"Yeah... why?"

"Why what?" Adora asks with a little confusion.

"... Nothing, don't worry about it." Catra sounds almost disappointed and Adora *hates* disappointing people. She wants Catra to feel like she can tell her things, no matter what it may be.

"No, ask me," Adora encourages gently.

"... Why do you want to be here... in bed... with me?" Catra asks. Adora hadn't been expecting *that* question.

"I uh..." Adora frowns a little. "You know... for things..."

"For things…?" Catra asks with a raised brow.

"You know... like... sex and things..." Adora blushes a little as she looks away for a moment. She isn't sure what exactly Catra was wanting to hear there.

"Ah... yeah, that makes sense..." Catra sighs and closes her eyes. "... So you wouldn't let me give you snacks?"

"I do enjoy it when you feed me but... I think I'd rather just... have you in my arms right now." Adora confesses. She'd love to just hold Catra close and cuddle her, melt into her warmth, inhale her scent, just… have her *here* .

"Me too... I wish I was there..." Catra says longingly. "Can I see you sometime soon?" Adora raises an eyebrow.

"I would like that a lot." Adora responds and she really means it. She misses having Catra with her and while she appreciated getting to talk to her, even just virtually, she wanted to be with her *physically* . "Hm... maybe I could 'kidnap' you again in a week or so?"

"Make that two... just to be cautious, okay?"

"That's so *long* ," Adora pouts and then she sighs. "but you're probably right. Did you enjoy our little... tryst in the woods?" Catra blushes slightly and clears her throat. *Oh yeah, she definitely did.*

"I did... I really did... it... made me kind of sad that the feeling of you left when the medic healed me." Adora frowns a little.

"Well, I can't have that, next time I'll have to make sure you can still feel me after." Catra bites her lip in response to Adora's words, biting back a grin.

"I don't know if that'll be possible... but I'd love to see you try. Just make sure I can walk afterwards."

"Aw, you have to be able to walk after?" Adora asks with a pout.

"Duh... I need to get home at some point, or they'll burst in and try to take me home." Adora knows that is true but also she'd *love* to fuck Catra until she couldn't walk.

"You couldn't stay the night?" Adora asks.

"Maybe one night but not more than that..." Adora grins and turns over, rolling onto her back.

"Good, then I would wreck you and you could rest and leave later the next day."

"Idiot..." Catra giggles quietly, yawning a bit. "I don't even know what time it is..."

"Late." Adora answers. She's enjoying just talking with Catra. They did that before, between sex, but this was different, this was talking in the absolute *absence* of sex. Adora had been

reading a lot of books recently, books that were technically contraband, since they were Rebellion books, but they were… romance books. Adora was learning a lot of new things, like what makes a perfect first date.

Adora looks back to Catra. "Hey uh..." She pauses for a second. "Shadow Weaver... she said... she said I should use She-Ra..."

"... She did?" Catra looks curiously at Adora, though she looks half asleep. Adora smiles softly at the sight. "You could, technically."

"Use She-Ra? Why would I ever use her again? I told you what she did... what *I* did..."

"I know what you did. I'm saying that you *could* but, you chose not to." Adora laughs a little.

"Go to sleep Kitten, you look tired."

"Mm... you should try to sleep too though." Catra murmurs with a small yawn.

"I wonder what your Princess bed feels like, is it all soft and springy?"

"Very soft and plush like."

"Too bad I'll never get to experience that." Adora's not sure if she wants to if she's honest. She rather likes her own bed, firm mattress and all.

"Mmm... unfortunately. I wish you could."

"I wish I could too." Adora admits, if only to be with Catra right now. "Not sure I'd like it however."

"Not even..." Catra yawns, "if we could snuggle?"

"I was actually thinking about how hot it would be for you to sneak me into your room and for me to wreck you in your room not far from the other Princesses." Adora teases.

"You are so horny, I swear." Catra laughs sleepily.

"Do you not think that would be hot?" Adora asks playfully. "I'd love to see Sparkles' expression if she ever caught us, she'd have a meltdown."

"She'd literally slap you with sparkles and then probably punch me in the face."

"Don't think she'd ask to join?"

"Hell no." Catra snorts and laughs. "She'd murder us both first." Adora laughs and lays against her covers. She pauses for a long moment before she decides to speak.

"Thank you... for calling me." Adora doesn't really do thanks or apologies but she needed this. She just wishes she could stop thinking about what Shadow Weaver said to her. *Is* she distracted by Catra?

"You're welcome... I'm happy to help out if I can." Catra smiles back at her, purring happily. "Feel comfortable enough to go to sleep, Adora?" She clearly hadn’t noticed Adora's conflict running around in her head.

"I think I do." Which is bad. *Right* ? *What does it mean that they've... they've talked to each other and there was no sex? Was Shadow Weaver right? Was she catching feelings? No... that wasn't possible...* Adora had a *mission* , she couldn't afford to catch feelings, was *incapable* of catching feelings probably. She just enjoyed Catra's company, she was allowed to enjoy

people's company, she enjoyed Scorpia's, sure, it wasn't exactly the same, but it was proof at least. Adora could separate her duty as Horde Lord from Catra.

Maybe she wasn't using Catra like she'd implied to Shadow Weaver but they are still enemies, she couldn't allow herself to become... disillusioned to who she was and what she was trying to do. Catra was a *Princess* and eventually they wouldn't be able to do this anymore. She might as well make the most of it. "Good night, Princess."

"Good night... dummy..." Catra murmurs as she slowly falls asleep, com-pad positioned against another pillow so that Adora could still see her. She looked comfortable, soft, like, even though Adora wasn't there, she could still feel Adora's presence and it was nice for Adora to witness.

Adora watches as Catra falls asleep. She feels... she doesn't know *how* she feels. She needs to do as Shadow Weaver said and focus on her goal, she's never going to win if she keeps purposely throwing battles, or retreating from them in order to please Catra, but at the same time... Catra wouldn't like it if Adora *did* win. *Would she even keep seeing her?*

Adora sighs, she shouldn't care about what Catra wants or doesn't want, she is Lord of the Horde. The Princesses are dangerous, these are facts that she knows... but it's still hard for her to do anything knowing it would upset someone she... she was having rough, *hard* , *great* , sex with. Adora is frustrated with herself. They're enemies that fuck. That's all they are. She needs to get over herself.

She settles back into her bed, tucking her arms under her pillow, she turns her head to look at the com-pad. She hates that Shadow Weaver got into her head, but she did. They're enemies. Adora *has* to remember that. Even when they're having sex they will *always* be on opposite sides of a war. Even still, Adora drifts off with the image of Catra beside her sleeping and a warmth in her chest at imagining her sleeping there beside her for real.

Chapter End Notes

Shadow Weaver needs to get punched in the face. -M

This chapter is a little shorter than the others but important to Adora's character we think (and perhaps future events). Catra and Adora stay being gay af -S

She-Ra's Heart

Chapter Summary

Adora smiles as she wraps her arms around Catra and stretches, practically crushing Catra against her in her arms, letting out a sigh of relief as she does so. Catra laughs again, choosing to also stretch and wiggle around in Adora's arms. "So much stretching." Catra comments.

"Yeah, I guess I could stretch you myself but seeing you wiggle around is adorable."

"That sounded so unnecessarily sexual somehow." Catra replies with a chuckle.

Chapter Notes

Happy Friday!! Another update for y'all. This is another long chunky boi but we hope you all enjoy!! We'll reply to as many comments as we can and we want to say we love and appreciate every reader and those who comment and leave kudos, you guys rock! Thank you!!

Warning, NSFW ahead

See the end of the chapter for more notes

Catra has missed Adora dearly. Getting to talk to her during their time apart really did help. It was nice to hear her voice, and to get to tease her, and just *be* with her - even if they weren't in person.

She knew that she shouldn't be looking for Adora so early on, since the battle hadn't even fully started, but she wanted to find her. She wanted her to carry her off so that they could spend time together again.

Catra spots her first before Adora sees her.

* * *

Adora is looking for *Catra* . She *knows* that Catra will be at this battle, she told her so herself, and after the last battle, she's *determined* to see Catra first. It had been two weeks since they had that video call, as Catra had requested, and Adora was excited to be *physically* close to her again. They had started video chatting more actually, it became a *thing* . One time, Sparkles actually teleported in while they were talking; Adora has never seen anyone move as quickly as when Catra hid that com-pad - Adora had laughed and teased her about it later.

It helped with the distance to talk to Catra when she couldn't 'kidnap' her. But if only she could find Catra *now* .

Adora doesn’t even have time to find Catra before she’s tackled to the ground by someone. Adora’s eyes widen. *Catra* . Catra makes it look as though she’s attacking her before she giggles in Adora’s ear and gives her a kiss on the cheek out of view of everyone else. " *Hey Adora.* "

"Catra." Adora sits up a little, beaming. She says Catra's name unlike she used to but soft and happy now. "Fancy seeing you here."

"That's what I was gonna say." She laughs softly - Adora loves it. "See anyone around us from the Rebellion that can try to save me if you kidnap me?" She whispers softly.

"Sure," Adora says as she grabs her cuffs from behind her. "But none of them are fast enough to catch me." Adora clips the handcuffs around Catra's wrists, grinning at her, and then stands up, throwing Catra over her shoulder. She takes off in a sprint towards her skiff. Catra pretends to struggle but Adora's grip was firm on her waist and prevented her from jumping off. Catra growls in fake anger, continuing her fake struggle until Adora had boarded the skiff and they were out of sight from the battlefield - it was quite the performance.

"Okay... I think we're in the clear." Adora turns to her nearby soldiers. "You know the drill, distract until we're out of here and then retreat."

"Yes, sir!" They salute Adora and she turns her attention back to Catra.

"What Kitten? You don't like the handcuffs?" Adora stands and heads to the controls of the skiff. She fires the skiff up and then points it towards the Fright Zone before gunning it.

"You know I never like the handcuffs." Catra snickers. Adora laughs a little. "How was your day so far?" Catra asks as she nuzzles into Adora, her eyes watching the Whispering Woods go by as Adora drives.

"Better now that you're here." Adora admits. She removes the handcuffs from Catra's wrists and kisses them. "You *never* like handcuffs?" Adora asks with a sly grin. Catra purrs at the kisses, turning her head and giving Adora a kiss on the *lips* .

"Mm... maybe a little." She replies teasingly. "Not today though."

"You have something in mind?" Adora asks.

"I wanted to ask you something... if that's okay?" Catra asks.

"Uh..." Adora laughs nervously. In her experience, those words are never good and a sure trigger for her anxiety. "Okay?"

"I was wondering, and you can say no, but... I was wondering if you'd feel comfortable... trying She-Ra out." Adora chokes on thin air, if she had been drinking, it would have gone everywhere.

"S- *She-Ra* ? You want... why would you... huh?"

"I was just... curious. But, again, you can say no."

"Catra..." Adora purses her lips. She doesn't understand where this sudden curiosity is coming from. *Maybe Catra has a secret death wish?* "I don't... I don't want to hurt you."

"You won't." Catra responds and smiles at her softly. "I know... I know that you can control her, Adora. I believe in you."

"You believe in me?" Something about that feels… good. Adora has never had someone believe in her before. Pair that with her desire to please… pretty much everyone, Adora was on the verge of making a very stupid decision.

"I do..." Catra replies. Adora bites her lip as she thinks about it. She hasn't transformed in years, never thought she would *ever* do that again, but it is *Catra* asking her... and Adora doesn't want to let her down.

"What if... what if I can't control her?" Adora asks. The last time she used She-Ra… Adora didn't like thinking about that. There was a reason that she hadn't used She-Ra ever again. It wasn't just that she hurt Hordak, if she was honest, he kind of deserved it… it was the way She-Ra made Adora feel. Powerful… *Out of control.* Adora likes everything to be under her control and She-Ra is none of that. She is nothing but raw power, her magic is so strong it was almost like Adora was *possessed* when she used her.

"Hey... if you can't, then I'll do everything that I can to stop you if that happens... I know it won't though." Catra caresses Adora's cheek, kissing her nose. Adora isn't so sure about that. "You don't have to do it if you don't want to. I really don't mind." Adora thinks about it. If she's honest… she's not really sold on the idea. She really doesn't want to hurt Catra, she *never* wants to hurt Catra anymore, but… Adora is curious too. The last time she had used She-Ra she had been angry, her emotional state had been out of control as *Adora* and that had translated over to She-Ra. Maybe she could try…

"... I... I would like to try." Adora answers.

"Are you sure?" Catra asks.

"No," Adora laughs a little. "but... last time I was... angry... I think She-Ra... she reacts to my emotions. If I'm ever calm... it's when I'm around you." Adora admits. Catra purrs softly and looks at Adora. She moves towards her and hugs her, snuggling into her chest - Adora finds it extremely comforting.

"Okay... if you feel at any point it becomes too much, you can let me know and we'll stop, yeah?"

"I'll tell you," Adora promises. She wraps her hand around Catra's tail and then scratches at her lower back. "Now, how was *your* day?"

"It's been pretty great. No meetings today, aside from the brief one this morning before the battle... not like any strategy was really needed though since... well... you know."

"Since this was a ploy so I could steal you away?" Adora asks with amusement.

“Yup. Exactly." Catra responds with a smile.

"We really made a beeline for each other and then took off." Adora laughs at that. "Easiest kidnapping ever."

"We did... I... I missed you." Catra admits shyly.

"Really? You talked to me last night." Adora teases, gently poking Catra on her hip.

"It's not the same." Catra pouts up at Adora. "And you know that."

"No..." Adora gently lifts Catra's chin up with her hand before she presses a kiss to Catra's lips. "It's not, you're right." Adora feels Catra smile into the kiss, leaning back in for a second one which Adora happily reciprocates. It really wasn’t the same only seeing Catra over a screen.

"It's not... and you should focus on the road before we crash." Catra comments.

"Pffft," Adora rolls her eyes. "I'm a *perfect* driver." She quickly moves the steering stick before they hit a tree and then she gives Catra an innocent smile and a nervous laugh. "Whoops..." Catra laughs and shakes her head fondly.

"It's fine. As long as we don't crush, dummy."

"You're the one who kissed me."

"You kissed me too, shush."

"Mhmm..." Adora turns her head to the side a little and sees an opening. She brings her hand back and smacks Catra on her ass. Adora was nothing if not an opportunist, plus, she really likes Catra's ass - who could blame her?

"I- Did you really just...?" Catra laughs in disbelief before returning the favour. She gives a firm slap to Adora's ass, purring as she does it. "Nice."

"I can't believe you did it back." Adora says with an amused grin and a fond shake of her head - she wasn't opposed to what just occurred. "How did things with Sparkles go after you hung up on me abruptly?"

"Of course I did it back. I love watching it jiggle." Catra says playfully. "She thankfully didn't notice I was talking to you and just told me about the small meeting tomorrow. That was all."

"Shame, would've been pretty funny to see her reaction to you calling me." Adora says. Even if Glimmer would have teleported to the Fright Zone to punch Adora in the face.

"She'd absolutely flip her shit." Catra scoffs.

"Probably." Adora confirms fondly. "At least we weren't having phone sex. She normally teleport into your room like that? Doesn't she know how to knock?"

"Well, it depends. But usually no."

"... your friends sound *great* ." Adora says sarcastically. "There are things called *boundaries* , want me to teach them?"

"No, no. It's fine. I've scolded her about it already." Catra replies. Adora snorts.

"Not very well apparently." She whispers under her breath.

"After she came into the room, Adora." *Damn, Magicat hearing.*

"Uh huh," Adora says dismissively, she focuses on steering the skiff in the right direction and *not* into trees.

“Dork... don't be mad just because I had to put the com-pad down."

"I'm *not* mad." Adora pouts.

"You're pouting, babe. "

"I don't know what you're talking about." Adora says as she speeds up the skiff. They were getting closer to the Fright Zone and the closer they got, the more nervous Adora felt about... using She-Ra.

"Uh huh. It's okay. You're cute when you pout." Catra says. Adora wants to protest that. She’s the Horde Lord, she’s not *cute* .

"Now, if it *had* been phone sex, maybe I'd be more mad." Adora says thoughtfully. The idea of Glimmer walking in on them having phone sex was kind of hilarious to her.

Catra laughs. "You are so horny, I swear."

"You're the one who keeps having sex with me. You're enabling me." Adora responds playfully.

"So what I'm hearing is, I should stop enabling you?"

" *No* !" Adora yelps. "No, absolutely not."

"Wow, that was fast... and forceful."

"I just mean," Adora pauses before she shrugs. "We have pretty great sex." Adora smiles at the memories. ***Great*** *sex.* ***Fantastic*** *sex.* The thought of them stopping was… Adora didn't want to stop.

"We do have very good sex." Catra purrs and grins. "You really like it?"

"Of course I like it." Adora almost couldn't believe Catra had asked that question. They went through so much effort just so that they could have sex with each other.

"What do you like about it?"

"About having sex with you?" Adora frowns a little. "What's not to like about it?"

"Just curious." Catra says casually. Adora looks over at her. So long as Adora was being honest…

"I... I like being with you..." Adora shrugs. "I think we... work pretty well together. And... I like the way you say my name, how you feel under me... how you feel wrapped around my fingers, or my strap... the way you kiss me... I like it all." Catra bites her lip and blushes at Adora's words. Adora watches Catra glance out at the path before them before she looks back at Adora.

"Stop the skiff." Catra states.

"Wh... okay?" Adora does as Catra requests and she stops the skiff, looking over at her curiously. "You okay?" Catra grabs Adora's face and pulls her in, bringing their lips together.

" *Mmph-* " Adora grunts in surprise at the kiss before she melts against Catra. She wraps her arms around her waist and pulls her flush against her. She kisses her softly yet passionately, enjoying her warmth being pressed up against her chest. Adora flickers her eyes open to look at Catra and her breath gets caught in her lungs. She's still not quite used to just how beautiful Catra is. Adora feels like... like Catra could *mean* something to her... which... is a scary thought, and one she represses profusely.

Instead, she nips Catra's bottom lip and smirks as she hears a tiny moan escape from Catra. "What you said... is really fucking sexy." Catra moans quietly against Adora's lips, pulling her in for another kiss. Adora laughs a little.

"Do you want to fuck me on the skiff now?" She asks playfully.

"No, I just really had to kiss you."

"Yeah?" Adora asks as she kisses Catra on her nose gently. "You wanna tell me what *you* like about us having sex?"

"Mhmm... I really like it when you hold me... when you go slow and hard and make me feel like I'm melting. I like it when you kiss me and leave me breathless." Catra lists softly, cheeks flushing while she speaks.

"Yeah?" Adora smiles as she kisses Catra again. "Not sure you'll get slow with She-Ra, but you'll definitely get hard."

"You really wanna?" Catra asks, giving Adora even more kisses. "I only want to if you feel comfortable enough." Honestly, She-Ra terrifies Adora, but Catra makes her feel... comfortable, and safe... so she's willing to try at the very least.

"Guess it's time someone finally saw her."

"You sure?" Catra asks, probably wanting Adora to be completely certain. "Remember... we can stop whenever you want. "

"I'm sure," Adora kisses Catra one more time before starting the skiff back up again. "She-Ra is a you exclusive though... I can't... trust her... anywhere else." Catra gets this… soft look on her face at Adora's words and she starts purring yet again.

"That... means a lot."

"Don't get sappy about it." Adora grumbles. "There's always the possibility she'll try to kill you."

"I don't think she will."

"We'll see..." Adora says.

They settle into a comfortable silence as they drive back to the Fright Zone. Adora smiles at Catra as she goes about grooming herself. Adora doesn't even think she realises she's doing it

but hearing Catra purr while smoothing her fur down on various parts of herself is about one of the cutest things Adora has *ever* witnessed.

* * *

Once they arrive, Adora helps Catra down from the skiff and hands off the keys to some soldier for them to park the vehicle. No one even blinks an eye at Catra anymore, they're all aware of her and Adora's... relationship (if you can even call it that). Should they be used to a Princess wandering the halls? Probably not, but Adora doesn't really care when that Princess is Catra and she's almost always accompanied by her.

They walk to her throne room, Adora gives her usual spiel about not being disturbed to her door guards before they enter together - she makes sure the door is closed behind them. Adora has... she's missed Catra, more than she probably should have, and as soon as they're alone her hands are immediately on her.

Catra was right, talking virtually was nothing like having Catra actually present and in her hands.

"What do you want to do first Kitten?" Adora asks as she kisses Catra's lips once, twice, three times, in quick succession.

"I... want you to keep kissing me." Catra whispers in between kisses. She purrs happily, hands rested on Adora's back to bring her closer. "My gorgeous... sexy... Adora." She beams as she pulls away from the kiss before bringing Adora back in and kissing her deeply this time. "I don't know about you, but can we snuggle for a bit and take a nap first?" Adora's eyebrows raise but she smiles.

"Your gorgeous sexy Adora, huh?" She asks with a big grin. Sometimes Catra just inflated her ego. She sweeps Catra up into her arms. "Whatever my Princess wants, she shall have." Catra giggles and purrs, she wraps her arms around Adora and kisses her on the cheek. A happy hum escapes Catra, Adora was pretty sure Catra enjoyed being carried by her.

"I missed you, dummy."

"Did you?" Adora questions as she walks towards her bedroom, carrying Catra in her arms.

"Mhmm, I did."

"Maybe I... missed you too." Adora admits.

"You did?"

"Maybe." Adora repeats. She opens her door, a little awkwardly with Catra in her arms, and enters her bedroom. She places Catra down on her feet and closes said door. "Talking on the com-pad has been nice though..." Catra giggles and goes to take off her clothes, changing them into Adora's pajamas instead and setting her own clothes aside. Adora watches her the entire time.

"Yeah... it has been nice. It's relaxing."

"You find me relaxing, huh?" Adora asks with a smug smile. She lays her hands on Catra's hips. She likes Catra wearing her clothes, it makes her warm in a way she didn't think she could experience. "Are you sure you don't secretly like me Catra?" Adora teases.

"Shush you." Catra grins at her. She makes a face that Adora has never seen on her before and shakes her head. "I don't like you." She replies just as she leans up to bring their lips together again. Adora laughs into the kiss.

"Your kisses say otherwise, Kitten."

"You want me to stop?"

"I didn't say that," Adora protests. "can I pet your ears please?"

"Mhmm, go ahead. Thank you for asking." Catra leans forward, giving Adora more access to her ears. Adora lights up and reaches her hands up, she begins gently caressing Catra's ears, scratching softly at the base of them before moving her hands up. Catra's ears are soft, like her tail, the fur feels nice and it's pleasing for Adora to touch. She hasn't stopped thinking about touching them since she did the first time she had when they showered together.

"You're so fucking cute it's almost unbelievable." Adora says with sparkling eyes. Catra purrs loudly, closing her eyes and relaxing into Adora's touch.

"I'm not that cute, idiot..." She murmurs, clearly a little too focused on Adora petting her ears to argue too much.

"You *are* cute, you're *so* cute." Adora protests. "Cute yet deadly."

"Cute yet deadly... that sounds kind of cool. I'll allow it." Adora laughs in amusement and then removes her hands.

"Bed?"

"Yeah, time for snuggles and a nap." Catra giggles softly, grabbing Adora by her hand and pulling her close. "There we go... better."

"Snuggles..." Adora says with a grin. She gently pushes Catra back onto her bed, landing on top of her. "I think we could make out first, no?"

"We can do that later." Catra whines softly. "I... I wanted to just sleep here... for a few minutes... with you..." She murmurs shyly. Adora blinks.

"Oh..." Adora rolls off of Catra. She kicks her boots off, leaving her in her socks. She sits up and unclasps her cape from her shoulder guards. She strips off her other pieces of armour, the

ones on her arms, and upper body where her cape had been attached, she leaves them on the ground, which kills her a little - she liked things clean and tidy - but she didn't want to abandon Catra for too long. She turns back to her as she grabs the buckle of her belt and pulls it off. She wiggles out of her pants and tosses them to one side and then grabs the hem of her skin tight Horde branded uniform shirt.

Once she's done, she's left in boxer shorts, socks and a sports bra. "Okay, I can cuddle now." Catra smiles and makes grabby hands at Adora - having already laid down on the bed - and it is *extremely* adorable.

"Come here, dork." She calls out. Catra sighs blissfully when Adora comes to lay in her arms, she purrs and kisses Adora's forehead before she nuzzles her face. "Nap time..." Adora smiles and kisses Catra on her cheek. She doesn't know why Catra wants to nap with her when they can sleep later, *after* , but she isn't going to complain. Catra is incredibly nice to cuddle, she's warm, and soft, and she *purrs* . You can't get better than that.

"... This is nice." Catra mewls quietly and cuddles more into Adora. "You're really comfortable... you always are."

"Really? I think you're more comfortable."

"Yeah?"

"Yeah, you're soft, like a big fluffy pillow." Adora answers.

"A big fluffy pillow... how funny." Catra hums. "I'm smaller than you though."

"Just means you fit perfectly."

"Yeah... I guess we do fit together pretty perfectly..." The way Catra says that sounds… thoughtful. Adora looks at her, trying to figure out what she was thinking about but, alas, not being able to decipher the look on her face.

"What're you thinking?" Adora asks, this time it's her who pokes Catra's forehead, right between her eyes.

" *Hey* !" Catra laughs softly. "Nothing, really... it's nice."

"Well... I agree with that." Adora concedes. She leans further into Catra. She slips her hands under her shirt and runs them up her back soothingly. "I like it when you wear my clothes."

"Mmm... I know... I like wearing it too." Catra noses Adora's neck, purring. "I really like just being here... in your arms, like this..." Something tells Adora that maybe Catra shouldn't feel that way about her but she doesn't have the energy to remind her of that when she's being snuggled and Catra is nuzzling her.

"I like holding you." Adora confesses. Catra purrs more, smiling sleepily as she looks up at Adora.

"Kiss me?" She requests quietly, shifting around a bit so that she’s closer to Adora's face. Adora gazes into Catra's mismatched eyes for a moment. She lifts her hand up to cup her jaw gently, caressing it with her fingers for a moment as she smiles softly at her. She leans in and presses her lips to Catra's, kissing her tenderly, fulfilling Catra's wish. Catra smiles into the kiss, pulling away and giving Adora a kiss on her cheek before lying down.

"Nap time... I'm about to fall asleep..." Catra says and Adora laughs - she could stand to kiss Catra more.

"Are you that tired?" Adora asks playfully. "What have you been doing Catra?" Adora adds a little *edge* of teasing to her voice, enough to be *suggestive* .

"Been losing sleep from not being held by you." Catra admits. "I got used to sleeping with you... and it's not the same to sleep alone."

"Oh..." Adora frowns a little. "Me too... when you called that night I... I hadn't slept the night before, like, at all."

"I'm glad I'm not the only one that feels that way... that's why I suggested we napped first."

"Need the energy?" Adora asks lightly.

"Mm... maybe."

"Fine by me Kitten," Adora says. "Sleep away." Catra nods, her tail comes around Adora's waist and rests on Adora's hip. She closes her eyes and relaxes back into Adora. It's nice and Adora enjoys having Catra in her arms. It doesn't take very long for Catra to fall asleep.

Adora gently strokes Catra's tail that rests on her hip in a soothing pattern. She completely relaxes against Catra, sinking into her warmth. She grabs the blanket and lays it over them so they wouldn't get cold in their sleep before Adora feels sleep clawing at her. She falls asleep after Catra but just as easily as she had too, happy to be so close to... *her* .

* * *

Unsurprisingly, Catra is the one to wake up first, having been the first one to fall asleep. She smiles softly and purrs, her eyelids fluttering open and her eyes landing on the sleeping blonde that was holding her protectively against her chest. She smiles, still sleepy and curls up more against Adora, purring again as she snuggles into her chest. "So warm..." Adora stirs a little in her sleep and pulls the warm body beside her closer to her instinctively, mumbling something in the space between being awake but still being asleep. "Dork..." Catra whispers and kisses her cheek. "You can sleep a little longer if you need to."

"Mmm... no... I'm good..." Adora mumbles. "Just... give me a few minutes to wake up."

"That's fine... take your time." Adora smiles a little and then presses a sleepy kiss to the side of Catra's face. "Did you sleep well Kitten?"

"Mhmm, very well." Catra responds with a happy smile. "What about you?"

"Good." Adora says. She starts stretching, while still cuddling Catra, letting out a groan as her muscles wake up again. Catra laughs a little at her.

"You could just let me go to stretch, dummy. I don't think that'll work."

"It'll work just fine if you don't mind being crushed." Adora responds.

"I don't mind too much." Catra replies. There is something about Adora that a lot of people won't know: she is *incredibly* goofy. A big playful *puppy* .

Adora smiles as she wraps her arms around Catra and stretches, practically crushing Catra against her in her arms, letting out a sigh of relief as she does so. Catra laughs again, choosing to also stretch and wiggle around in Adora's arms. "So much stretching." Catra comments.

"Yeah, I guess I could stretch you myself but seeing you wiggle around is adorable."

"That sounded so unnecessarily sexual somehow." Catra replies with a chuckle.

"Get your mind out of the gutter Catra, wow." Adora says, though her shit-eating grin really takes away from her words.

"As if yours isn't always in the gutter." Catra rolls her eyes. Seriously, Adora's mind is about as dirty as they come. Sometimes Catra wonders if she will *ever* run out of dumb innuendos.

"You hurt my feelings, my mind isn't *always* in the gutter... just most of the time." Adora protests.

"I don't believe that." Catra says immediately, raising an eyebrow in question.

"You don't believe it?"

"That you don't *always* have your head in the gutter? It is pretty hard to believe, Adora." Catra deadpans because it simply is not true. Lucky for Adora, her dumb jokes are appreciated by Catra.

"I'm offended, my head is not *always* in the gutter." Adora denies.

"Uh huh..." Catra says, unconvinced.

"I think about other things."

Catra hums softly. "And what is it that you think about?"

"Well..." Adora hesitates. "I mean... I'm not going to say I *don't* think about... having sex with you, but I think of other things too. Like kissing you, and cuddling you, and... eating food with you... and... conquering Etheria, you know, normal stuff." *Normal stuff,* she says. Catra snorts and rolls her eyes. She isn't going to win this argument so she may as well give it to Adora.

"Okay, that's fair." Catra nods and kisses Adora again. "Do you wanna get up now?"

"Yes I do," Adora says. "but first..." Adora grins mischievously and Catra's ears perk up at the sight before Adora digs her fingers into Catra's side, tickling her. Catra squeaks loudly and tries to scramble out from where she was under Adora.

"Adora, no! *Hahaha!* I don't like being tickled!"

"But your giggles are so cute!" Adora responds, her grin only growing as she carries on tickling Catra. She sticks her tongue out at her and winks.

"Stop it, you dummy!" Catra laughs again, shoving Adora off of her and giggling for a little longer. "So mean, my goodness." Adora descends into her own fit of laughter, holding her stomach as Catra shoves her away - she was *crying* , she was laughing that hard.

"You're so... cute..." Adora breathes out between laughter.

"I'm not that cute. Shut up." Catra's words sound mean but her tone was definitely playful. "Stop laughing, dummy." Catra hits her dumb face with the pillow. Adora snorts and rubs her face as a few more giggles escape her before she manages to pull herself together. Catra watches as she stretches again - now that she was off of Catra - and lets out a long groan of pleasure. She stands, hopping a little when she gets to her feet.

"To the throne room, Princess?" Adora asks.

"But of course, My Lord." Catra stands, bowing jokingly to Adora before winking. "Lead the way." She offers her hand and grins when Adora takes it. "What do you wanna do in your throne room today?"

"I *am* your Lord." Adora says, her eyes darkening a little. "You wanted to use She-Ra, right? I figured I'd warm you up a little first." Catra swallows thickly, excitement evident in her eyes as she looks at Adora.

"Warmed up? And how do you plan to do that, My Lord?"

"Wouldn't you like to know?" Adora says cryptically. She leads Catra to her throne room and to her throne, sitting her down on it. "This reminds me of something very familiar." Adora says cheekily.

"You mean our first time together?" Catra leans back into the throne, her fingers touching the claw marks that were never repaired.

"Our first time together, yeah." Adora replies with a wistful look in her eyes. "You ever think you'd keep coming back?" Catra grabs Adora's hand, playing with her fingers.

"Not really... I didn't think that would happen at all. I certainly hadn't planned for that to happen after the *first* time. Then again... I didn't plan for me to stay three days rather than just one night either so I suppose that nothing about this went according to how I originally intended for it to go."

"I'm glad it didn't." Adora says. "I mean... I'm glad... we kept doing... stuff." Adora shuffles a little awkwardly and then she drops to her knees in front of Catra. Catra watches her carefully. "I feel like... you're the only Princess who won't hurt me." Catra's eyes soften and she cups Adora's cheeks gently.

"Come here, you..." She whispers and wraps her arms around the blonde, hugging her gently. "I'm glad that we kept doing stuff too... it's nice to just... be ourselves when we're alone." Adora buries her nose into the side of Catra's hair and takes a deep breath. Catra would love to know what it is that she was thinking.

"Yeah, me too." She says quietly. "No war when we're alone."

"No war when we're alone..." Catra whispers softly, pressing her lips to Adora's temple. "Just us... being absolute dorks." She giggles sweetly in Adora's ear. "It's really nice though... like… *really* nice."

"Isn't there some saying?" Adora asks. She lifts her hand to Catra's jaw and peppers the otherside with kisses. "All is fair in love and war, or something?" Adora ponders. "Hm... all is fair in sex and war..."

"Mhmm, the saying is, all is fair in love and war, but yeah... I get what you mean." Catra corrects gently, purring at the soft kisses. "Though, I guess the true impact of that statement depends on the person in reality."

"What do you mean?"

"Some people are willing to go further than others. What they think is fair might be different to what other people think is fair. You get me?" Catra asks.

"You're so..." Adora trails off and kisses Catra on her lips. "I get what you're saying, yes."

"I'm so...?" Catra asks, curious about what Adora was going to say.

"Smart? Philosophical? Whatever... your brain is your biggest power, huh?"

"Maybe. I try my best." Catra was the Rebellion’s strategist for a reason. Adora laughs softly and pecks Catra on her lips again.

"I wanted to warm you up... what would you prefer I do?" Adora asks.

"Honestly, anything is fine. I'll let you know if there's something I don't like." Catra replies. Adora nods and leans her forehead against Catra's which is *nice* . She moves her hand down and slips it under the waistband of Catra's pants and underwear. She begins rubbing her clit, gently, pressing kisses to Catra as she does so. It feels... weirdly intimate, or more intimate than they have been before anyway.

Catra hums softly, smiling at the kisses and moving closer to Adora to make it easier for her. She uses her legs to bring the blonde a little closer, wanting to *feel* her. "Just like that..." She gasps quietly, closing her eyes. "Mhmm... you're doing great, baby..." Adora presses a little harder as she moves her fingers against Catra's clit.

"You're so beautiful Catra..." Adora seems to choke on her words a little, almost as though she had more to say but no way to express it properly. The blonde reaches her free hand up

and gently strokes at Catra's hair. Catra opens her eyes, feeling the soft caresses of her hair and blushes at the gentleness. She leans in, pressing her lips to Adora's and sighs softly.

They were going slow. It was... sweet. Sweeter than Catra ever thought would be possible for them, and yet Adora was making her feel as though she was so... so *cared* for and valued. It was making her heart skip a beat and her stomach feel full of butterflies. "Adora..." She whispers, her voice silky and holding an emotion that she couldn't even figure out herself. "You're gorgeous… *so* gorgeous... so beautiful..." Adora gasps a little at Catra's words.

Catra can feel how she responds to Adora's words from before by the slickness she feels gathering on Adora's fingers. "Catra..." Adora whispers as she presses her fingers into her, slowly, gently. She presses her nose to the side of Catra's head. "You're... amazing..." Catra whines quietly at the compliment, biting her lip and turning her head to kiss Adora's jaw.

"Adora... Adora..." She breathes out her name, closing her eyes again. Everything felt more intense than usual, for some reason, but it felt intense in a good way - a *really* good way. She wanted... no, *needed* the blonde closer; to feel her, to touch her, to kiss her. "Adora... can you... shirt... clothes off... please?" Adora seems reluctant, probably because that would mean having to remove her fingers from Catra, she does it anyway.

Adora removes her hand and rolls Catra's shirt up. It gets stuck on her head for a moment, on her hair, and Adora laughs softly, even though Catra can't *see* her, she can *hear* her and her ears twitch, before Adora manages to un-snag it and free Catra. She kisses Catra again, once she's out of the shirt, both of them smiling and laughing. Adora's laugh is pretty infectious actually. Catra thinks… she thinks she could listen to Adora's laugh on constant repeat. Adora starts to remove Catra's pants, slowly pulling them down Catra's toned legs before they're off along with her underwear. Adora turns to undressing herself, which doesn't take her long at all - sports bra, boxers, socks.

Once they're both bare, Adora returns back to Catra and kisses her softly yet passionately. Adora seems to pour everything she has into that kiss before she resumes her later position: burying two fingers inside of Catra. "You're so good Kitten..."

"Mmm... wanna be a good kitten for you..." Catra smiles softly, her gaze tender as she looks at the blonde. "Go a little deeper please..." She requests, her hands cupping Adora's face as she moans softly. "Yeah... that's perfect... keep doing that, babe." Adora does as Catra requests, going deeper and *curling* her fingers. From her current speed, it's just not *quite*

enough to get Catra off, so, like Adora knew that, the blonde stretches her thumb, pressing it to Catra's clit to provide that *extra* stimulation.

Adora kisses down Catra's jaw, to her neck, down her chest. "You are..." Adora says. She pauses again. Adora keeps doing that, she keeps trailing off mid-sentence, as though she wasn't entirely sure what she was trying to say. "You're my Kitten..."

"I am... and you're my... my Adora." Catra grins and captures Adora's lips again. The kiss was soft, slow, and passionate. Very different from their previous kisses during their intimate relations - which were usually hot and heavy. She arches her back, lifting her hips to try to get more friction, loving the slow pace but needing just a little more.

Adora adds a third finger, stretching Catra more. She gives a few hard and fast thrusts, curling her fingers for that added stimulation and it's almost *too* perfect. "Good girl, Catra..." Adora pants softly. Catra won't lie, that really worked for her. Adora kisses Catra on her neck, moving up to her jaw and then to her lips again, swallowing Catra's whimpers. She pulls back an inch.

"Your Adora." She admits freely and without protest. Catra moans and laughs happily when she hears Adora say it back. She runs her fingers through those blonde locks, bringing her back in and kissing her again.

"Let me ride your fingers... please baby..."

"Y-Yeah..." Adora swallows thickly. "You can *definitely* do that." Catra nods and gently pushes Adora away, switching their positions so that Adora was the one sitting on the throne instead.

She bites her lip, smiling down at the blonde and waiting for her to adjust her hand before placing herself on top and letting her lover's fingers slide inside of her. "Fuck... *yes* ...." She hisses softly, grinding into Adora's hand slowly. " *Adora* ... you feel so *good* ..."

"Fuck..." Adora groans. " *You* feel so good." Adora watches with wide eyes and Catra smirks. Adora is obviously turned on, and her concentration is attentively on her fingers, and Catra

riding them, it’s almost cute. She wraps an arm around Catra's waist to keep her steady while she leans her head forward to kiss Catra's chest. "I... you're... keep going Kitten."

"Yes, sir." Catra nods, wrapping her arms around Adora's head, showing her she likes her kissing her chest. She continues to grind down against Adora's hand, soft cries of the blonde's name filling the air around them as the two work Catra into slowly building up her orgasm. "Sir... I'm close..." She moans in Adora's ear, biting her lip when she feels her lover's lips wrap around her nipple before she sucks on the sensitive buds. Adora hums around Catra's nipple and pulls her head back just a touch.

"Cum for me Kitten." Adora encourages as she flattens her tongue back to Catra’s breast while she looks up at her. "I got you." She promises. Adora curls her fingers, sucks Catra’s nipple and flicks her thumb over Catra’s clit *just right.* Catra's lips part and a loud moan of her lover's name fills the air around them. Her pussy clenches tightly around Adora's fingers, juice sliding down and wetting them. She flops against Adora's chest, panting softly and sighing.

"Mmm... that was great, babe." She grins, kissing the other's shoulder. Adora laughs softly, moving her fingers a little more until Catra becomes too sensitive and makes a noise of protest. She stills her fingers but keeps them buried inside of her.

"You did most of the work." Adora says playfully. She kisses wherever she can reach Catra. "That was really fucking hot." And *intense,* Catra adds mentally. Catra isn't sure she's ever had sex like that before - or Adora for that matter.

"It was still great though." Catra giggles. She hums, enjoying the kisses coming from Adora. "Glad to know you thought it was hot. How are you feeling?"

"I feel great!" Adora beams. "Making you feel good, makes me feel good."

"Mmm, yeah? That makes me happy to hear." Catra smiles back. "So..." Catra trails off.

"So." Adora repeats back to her. She pulls her fingers out of Catra, her fingers *coated* . She holds them up. "Want a taste?" Catra looks at Adora's hand before grinning and licking the

blonde’s fingers. She hums, tasting herself on her tongue before wrapping her lips around Adora's fingers and *sucking* , her eyes directly locked onto Adora's as she does so.

"Fuck me..." Adora's breath gets stuck in her throat. "I can't... believe this is real." Catra chuckles as she pulls away, giving Adora’s fingers a final lick before grinning.

"Is it really that hard to believe?" Catra asks.

"If you had told me we'd be here a few months ago, I would've called you insane." Adora says. "Now I can't imagine *not* being here."

"I know what you mean... if you had said to me we'd be doing this a few months ago, I would have absolutely slapped you."

"I'm pretty sure I did once and you did, in fact, slap me." Adora jokes lightly as she trails her hands over Catra's soft body. Catra did in fact slap Adora once when she had been obnoxiously flirting with her during a battle.

Catra sighs and looks at Adora. Adora looks happy and peaceful, and *satisfied,* despite the fact she hasn’t even cum yet - Catra thinks maybe Adora wasn’t lying when she said making Catra feel good, made her feel good. Catra doesn't know if she should bring up how that sex felt *different* or if she should keep her mouth shut.

"I guess enemies with benefits are hard to imagine." Adora says, distracting Catra from her current train of thought.

"It is a lot harder to imagine... but at the same time... it's so easy to see when we're here." Catra responds, laughing softly. "It just... works, I guess.”

"Works.” Adora hums in agreement, seemingly knowing exactly what Catra was trying to say. They did work when they probably shouldn't. Maybe that was an Adora and Catra thing, working when things are against them. "Was that good for you?" Adora asks softly.

"It was great... I meant it when I said it earlier." Catra smiles. "I wouldn't say something if I didn't mean it, dummy."

"Still want to use She-Ra?"

"Only if you want to." Adora looks a little nervous but she nods. Truthfully, Catra had expected Adora to refuse, she'd asked out of curiosity more than anything - *who wouldn't be a little curious about She-Ra?* - but it was more than that. Adora had a bad experience with She-Ra, a *trauma* , Catra wanted to give her a *good* experience - she wanted to *help* her.

Adora carefully lifts Catra up and walks down the steps to where she had placed her sword on entering. She picks it up and looks at Catra. "I uh... are you ready? In case... you know... I can't control her..." Catra nods, preparing her claws.

"Go for it. I'm ready to defend myself if I need to, okay?" She reassures her with a smile. "Whenever you're ready, okay?" Adora clears her throat and then extends her sword out. She screws her eyes closed and then... She opens an eye, looking at Catra. Catra sees her relax instantly. Catra softens at the sight. Adora won't hurt her, she would *never* hurt her, not as She-Ra and not as Adora. And then, Adora speaks the words she probably hasn't spoken in an extremely long time.

" *For the honour of Grayskull!* "

Catra is blinded by the bright light that encases Adora, needing to look away for a moment as the other's form changes. She only looks when the glow has *finally* dimmed and her eyes can look without needing sunglasses. Her eyes widen immediately as she looks at her lover up and down. "Wow..."

Adora laughs. The blonde looks down at herself and clearly sees that she's clothed now, she pulls at the fabric. "Ugh," Adora complains. "White? The worst colour for anyone to wear *ever* , seriously?"

"It looks good on you though." Catra points out, her eyes sparkling as she looks at the giant that is Adora now. "Like... really good. Sexy..." Adora lifts her sword to look at her reflection. Catra was doing the same only with her own eyes which were running up and down Adora's frame. She-Ra has a whole glowing thing going for her, even Adora's eyes seem to glow and a golden crown frames her face.

After a moment, Adora looks back to Catra and pauses briefly. "Have you always been this small?"

"Adora... you're taller than normal right now." Catra looks her up and down again. "Like... *way* taller." She stands up, actually standing up on the *throne* so that she could grab Adora's crown and carefully take it off of her head. "I can't believe I'm standing on this and I'm still slightly shorter than you." Adora laughs fondly.

"Maybe you're just unusually short." Adora teases. She takes Catra's hands and looks at the crown in them. "Kind of reminds me of your Magicat crown..."

"Hey! I'm not that short. I'm 5'2!" She pouts, looking back down at the crown she had just taken off of Adora's head. She smiles and places it on her own head, modeling. "How do I look?"

"Like… a huge dork." Adora deadpans, a smile tugging at the corners of her lips. Catra laughs and takes the crown off of her head.

"That's not fair... it actually looks really good on you, you meanie."

"You looked... good." Adora says honestly. "You looked good in your Magicat crown too, it suits you."

"Yeah? You liked it?"

"Yes I did..." Adora holds her hand up for Catra to place her own against her *huge* palm. Catra looks at their hands, surprised at the difference.

"My hand is so tiny..." Catra notes, examining their hands. Adora's hands have always been on the large side, her fingers are usually long and nimble, *perfectly* slender - Catra's getting wet just thinking about those fingers - but She-Ra? Her fingers are much thicker than Adora's, though still long but *longer* than Adora's normal fingers - much longer.

"Not sure my fingers will fit." Adora jokes, although she does laugh a little nervously.

"Honestly... if you go slowly, they just might." Catra says - yes she *really* wants to take all inches of She-Ra's fingers.

"This is weird... but... not as bad as I was picturing." Adora admits.

"What did you picture?" Catra asks curiously.

"Honestly?" Adora asks. "Well... The first time I ever transformed, I was angry... the power of She-Ra felt... unstable, out of control... I'm not even sure I was fully aware... and then I... when I came back... Hordak was dead." Adora lifts her large hands to cup Catra's face. "I was afraid I'd hurt you."

"I... you want me to be honest with you right now?" Catra asks, resting her hands on top of Adora's while she nuzzled her.

"... yes?"

"I... I actually trust you... to never hurt me." Catra admits. "It's probably dumb, but... but you... you literally haven't done anything to hurt me since we've... started this arrangement."

"Haven't hurt you without *consent* first," Adora corrects, remembering the spanking. She smiles a little. She clearly doesn't want to hurt Catra, not anymore. "I wouldn't hurt you... but I wasn't sure about She-Ra..."

"Well... I think you're in pretty good control of her right now. Don't you think?" Catra purrs and grins. "I don't think you'd hurt me... even with She-Ra."

"How are we going to do this?" Adora asks. "... you're so small..."

"We... take our time and go slow?" Adora gives Catra a lopsided smile.

"Can I... use my sword? I mean... it feels good normally but as She-Ra... it might feel better?" The idea of She-Ra fucking her with her strap? Catra wants that more than anything.

"Of course, just take your time with everything, okay?" Catra says softly, caressing Adora's cheek. Adora leans into the touch and then kisses the palm of Catra's hand.

"First things first, you want to help me out of this stupid Princess outfit?"

"Hell yeah I do." Catra grins and carefully grabs hold of the fabric, shredding it with her claws while being careful with Adora's skin. "Nice... I was wondering if the outfit would magically fix itself... guess not."

"What if it had?" Adora asks with a chuckle. "Would you ma- have sex with me... in this silly outfit still?"

"Yes." Catra doesn't even hesitate. It may have looked silly to Adora, but dear goddesses above, the way the white and gold clung to every curve of Adora's body sent heat all throughout Catra's body. Adora softens a little and kisses Catra on her lips.

"You answered pretty quickly there Kitten." She teases. "You like what you see?"

"Adora... you have no idea how godly you look right now."

"Kiss me like you mean it, Catra." Catra grins and throws herself at Adora. She kisses her deeply, moaning as she feels the other's body against her own. Even with the difference in body, they somehow seemed to fit pretty damn perfectly together Catra notes. She doesn't pull away, reaching up and undoing Adora's long ponytail, tangling her fingers in those long blonde tresses to hold her in.

Adora matches Catra's eagerness easily, kissing her back with just as much passion. She picks Catra up, even easier than she could as Adora, and carries her over to a nearby table. She sits her down on it and continues kissing her before she pulls away, both of their lungs burning with the lack of oxygen. "Wow..." Catra's eyes widen when they focus back on Adora. The blonde glances down to see that she was *glowing* . She looks back up at Catra and blushes sheepishly at her.

"I... She-Ra seems to react to how I feel..."

"It's really quite... you're *literally* glowing." Catra smiles, pointing at Adora's chest. "Pretty..." She whispers before leaning in and pressing a kiss on the glowing area. "You're beautiful, Adora..." And she is. The glowing is… amazing. She-Ra still looks a lot like Adora, if anything, it was Adora supercharged. Just a taller, buffer, blonder, version of Adora.

"I'm not Adora right now." Adora mumbles as she kisses the base of Catra's ear.

"Do you want me to call you She-Ra? I do prefer calling you Adora though..." Catra isn't sure she would like calling Adora She-Ra.

" *No* ! No. Adora." Adora presses her face to the side of Catra's face. "Please, just Adora. I'm always just Adora to you." For some reason, those words warm Catra's heart.

"Okay... Adora... My Adora." Catra whispers, pulling back for a moment to smile directly at the blonde. "I meant it when I said you look gorgeous... it doesn't matter if you're transformed

or not... you're beautiful to me." Adora blushes and averts her eyes shyly before she looks back to Catra.

"What about you? You're... probably the most beautiful woman I have ever set my eyes on."

"Adora... do you really mean that?" Catra asks. Her heart was hammering in her chest at the admission.

"Of course I do?" Adora says, a little confused. "Have you seen you?"

"Well, yes, but... it's different hearing it from you..." Catra blushes slightly, looking away, feeling bashful. Adora cups Catra's face, turning her to look her in the eye.

"You are... beyond words..." Adora looks at Catra like she has so much more to say but she can't seem to find her voice. Like she feels them on the tip of her tongue but she doesn't understand what they are or what they even mean, so she just kisses Catra instead, pecking her lips. Catra wonders what it is she's actually thinking. "I... I count myself lucky I get to see *all* of you."

"I get what you mean... you're the only one that's ever seen all of me... like... fully." Catra informs her, blushing shyly. "I feel lucky too... that you're trusting me with... this."

"I'm the only one?" Adora asks, a little surprised. "You said you'd done... this... a few times before with other people."

"I have, but... partially clothed usually. It was always a quick thing... not like this... not like... us."

"Oh..." Adora blinks. She clearly hadn't known that. "You... I mean... partially clothed can be hot..." Adora looks awkward suddenly and Catra wonders if she should have told Adora that. Adora is the only one who has *ever* seen Catra like this and Catra couldn't imagine… if she was honest, she couldn't imagine anyone else seeing her like this other than Adora.

"Yeah... none of them really felt like this though..." Catra confesses.

"Felt like this?" Adora asks curiously.

"Like... fully comfortable?" Catra struggles to find the right words for how she feels around Adora and ends up with those. Adora's gaze softens.

"You feel fully comfortable with me?" Catra blushes slightly, nodding a bit.

"Yeah... was it not obvious?"

"I... I don't know..." Adora says. "I mean, we haven't exactly been shy around each other I guess."

"Exactly... I don't really go around and let just anyone call me Kitten... or me call them sir while... being intimate." Catra replies and Adora laughs a little.

"If I recall, you hated that nickname at first."

"I did... but it stuck on me."

"I guess I stuck on you too, huh?" Adora wiggles her eyebrows playfully.

"I knew you would do that!" Catra laughs loudly, playfully pushing Adora. Adora smiles and, not for the first, Catra is struck with just how much she enjoys Adora’s company.

"Hey, you stuck on me too." Adora comes back and wraps her arms around Catra. "It's not like I let any other Princesses into my bed."

"Is that so, babe?"

"What if I told you Sparkles and I had a secret affair?"

"I would never believe that considering Glimmer can't stand your ass."

"Neither could you."

"So what you're telling me is that my best friend has been in your bed?" Catra grumbles.

"Wow..." Adora laughs. "Oh wow... you're *jealous* ."

"I am not!" Catra huffs, biting the inside of her cheek and turning away from Adora. She just didn't like the idea, or thought, that Adora was presenting to her; not even that it was just Glimmer but the thought of *anyone* sharing Adora's bed was… she didn't like it. *Adora is mine, no one else's.* Catra rubs her cheek against the blonde's chest to mark her.

"Please, Sparkles is so *not* my type, and you're right, she would've beheaded me before I got anywhere near touching her." Catra pouts softly.

"I guess." She responds.

"The only Princess I've had, and are *having* , a secret affair with, is *you* ." Adora pokes her side. "So stop pouting."

"Make me..." Catra challenges.

"Make you?" Adora asks with a soft laugh. She kisses Catra again. "Okay Kitten, let me fetch my sword." Catra purrs when Adora kisses her again and she hums.

"Sounds good... I'm ready when you are."

* * *

Adora retrieves her sword, she can already tell it's different than when she's Adora. She transforms it as she usually does and steps into the harness, securing it in place. Adora's not entirely sure how to describe it but the sword... her connection to it is stronger as She-Ra, she can *feel* it. She feels... different but *not* out of control. She feels *powerful,* like her entire being is *buzzing* .

She comes back over to Catra and wraps her arms around her, moving between her legs. "I'll go... gentle and slow," Adora says carefully. "I don't want to hurt you by underestimating She-Ra's strength." Plus, Adora kind of liked whatever it was that they did before and she was more than happy to do it again. Catra nods and kisses Adora's forehead to reassure her that she would be okay.

"I know... I'll let you know if I need you to stop at any point, okay?" Catra says, patting Adora’s cheek and kissing her lips. As soon as Adora began to push the strap in, Catra started to squirm."F-fuck... that makes a difference... slowly... I don't know if it'll all fit, Adora..."

"It'll fit," Adora says gently yet firmly. She rocks her hips a little and presses her lips to Catra's jaw. "You want to take all of me, right Kitten?" Adora asks. Truth be told, it felt different too. Usually Adora got sensation from the rubbing, but this time? She could feel *everything* . "I'll go slow, I promise."

"Yes... yes I want to take all of you." Catra bites her lip, closing her eyes as she focuses on her breathing. Adora really does take it slow for Catra’s sake, giving her soft kisses and only pushing deeper when Catra gave a small squeeze of her bicep. It didn't take very long before Adora's hips were fully flush against Catra’s and Catra was full of the warmth of She-Ra and her strap inside of her. "Wow... wow... Adora... is it all inside?"

Adora almost misses Catra's question, her brain going a mile a minute as she tried to focus on not moving too hard. She stays pushed up against Catra and doesn't move. "Y-yeah..." Adora grunts. "You did so good Kitten." Adora praises. She's never used She-Ra like this but honestly? She could kind of get used to it - especially when it feels this *amazing* to be buried inside of Catra.

"Good... you can move now... slowly..." Adora gives a little jolt of her hips and her eyes widen when Catra lets out a *whine* . That wasn't even a *fraction* of the strength Adora could feel pulsing through her muscles. She moves slower, dragging out carefully and then moving back in just a touch faster but being very cautious with her thrusts. She presses herself up against Catra, kissing her and whispering soft reassurances to her. Catra grasps at Adora, holding onto her whichever way that she could. Adora being gentle and sweet just seemed to make Catra all the more aroused, her juices dripping down the strap and coating it more with each thrust.

"Adora..." She calls out. "You can see it..."

"See wh-"

"Look..." Catra points down at her abdomen. "You can see it... when you move..."

"Oh..." Adora moves her hips again and she watches with shock as Catra is right. She moves her hands from Catra to the table and she grips it, but under She-Ra's strength, it crumples like tissue below her hands rather than metal.

"Fuck..."Catra moans at the next thrusts, her eyes widening as she sees the table simply crumble beneath She-Ra's touch. Catra *gushes* onto Adora’s strap. "That's really hot, holy fuck, Adora."

"Of course you're turned on by that." Adora laughs. "I broke my table!"

"You can get a new one after you finish fucking me against it!" Adora rolls her eyes fondly and buries her head in the crook of Catra's neck. She places a large hand (like literally the size of Catra's head nearly) to Catra's jaw, holding her face as she gives not fast thrusts but *hard* thrusts. Even just a quarter of She-Ra's strength is about triple of Adora's and she can hear how *wet* Catra is with each thrust. She kisses her jaw.

"Catra..." She moans. "I think… I might be able to do more with this thing now that I'm She-Ra..."

" *Ahnnn* ... yeah? And what... what might that be?" Catra asks curiously - Adora swears she can *hear* Catra's rapid heartbeat. "What can you do?"

"I think..." Adora pauses her movements. "I think I can... make this thing cum... inside of you..."

"... Seriously?"

"... Yeah?" Adora looks at Catra. "I won't do it if you don't want me to, obviously, I just... I can feel it a lot more as She-Ra." Catra moans, looking directly into Adora's eyes.

"... Do it."

"Wh- Are you sure?"

"I'm sure... I'm sure it'll be fine..." Catra smiles. "You can do it... I wanna see how it feels." Adora kisses her on the nose and then, now knowing her strength and that she was *in control* , she winds her hips back and just *goes* for it.

She doesn't hold back for a second now. She moves her hands off of Catra and grips at the table instead, denting the metal with her strength. She starts to glow again as she feels her push herself towards the edge. "Catra..." Adora moans, so lost in the ecstasy of her rapid hip movements. The table creaks and she thanks whoever the fuck decided tables should be

bolted down in the Fright Zone or the thing surely would've moved by now. "Fuck, Catra, I- I never want to stop being inside you, you feel so good."

"Adora, *yes* ... Please *don't stop* . You feel so good when you're fucking me like this..." Catra moans out, hands gripping onto Adora's arms, her claws digging into her skin as she's fucked into oblivion by Adora. Catra could hardly stop to catch her breath with how much she was moaning. Catra looked as though she were thoroughly enjoying herself and Adora moved her hips faster, *harder* . Adora was drawing orgasm after orgasm from Catra - though Adora hardly noticed, instead, continuing to fuck Catra at a rapid, steady pace.

" *Adora* ! Adora, please!" *Please* ." Something inside of Adora wakes up and her thrusts turn from controlled to rapid. Everything felt so *good* , from Catra's claws digging into her skin, to the feeling of her being strap deep inside of Catra - not to mention Catra calling her name. Adora unleashes She-Ra, just a little. She uses her strength to drive into Catra at an unrelenting pace, she didn't even feel out of breath, She-Ra was like some fucking machine and Adora was determined to drag as many orgasms as she possibly could from the brunette.

"Good girl, Catra... you're taking me so well... my Kitten." All that was leaving Catra's lips were heavy pants and weak cries of Adora's name. Another orgasm washes over her and her eyes roll back in her head as she moans Adora's name again. "Adora... Adora, please... you're making me..."

"I'm making you *mine* ." Adora growls. The only sounds in the room was Catra's moans and the calling of Adora's name, along with the slapping of skin and the sound of wetness with each drag out and ramming back in with her sword that Adora did. As She-Ra she was practically unstoppable and yet... Adora felt *in control* , she didn't feel like She-Ra was out of her control and she had a good enough grip on her to use her added power, speed and strength to drive Catra over the edge numerous times without even breaking a sweat.

Catra looked as though she was pretty damn close to passing out from how many times she'd cum at that point. Wetness was coating the table beneath her and more continued to spill with each of Adora's thrusts. Catra throws her head back, her voice cracking as she cums for what must be the millionth time. Her walls clenched tightly around Adora's strap before relaxing and contracting rapidly. Adora was so close to the edge, all she needed was just a little-

Right there.

" *Catra* !" Adora tenses up, her hips freeze on their thrust in and her sword becomes *hot* - it takes Adora a moment to realise the sword isn't hot but the liquid (the cum?) leaking from the tip is hot and spilling into Catra. Adora shudders and feels like she just might cum again off the thought of filling Catra up. She'd *definitely* broken her table.

Catra's eyes widen as she cums hard (again) as the heat of She-Ra's sword spills deep inside of her. Her claws drag along Adora's arms, thankfully not digging too deeply but enough to show that she had lost control of herself from how intense everything felt, Adora *loved* it.

Catra moans loudly, her sounds nearly coming out as a scream but muting from how loud they were. Adora was still shallowly thrusting into her, the hot cum was spilling out from around the strap inside of Catra. Adora could stay there forever. "Adora…" Catra pants quietly, looking at Adora with half-lidded eyes.

Adora moves her eyes from her strap to Catra. She lowers herself down, allowing Catra to wrap her arms around her neck as she kisses her along her jaw. "We made a mess Kitten." Adora says with a little chuckle. "But that was *really* fucking hot."

"Yeah... it was really fucking hot..." Catra whispers back softly, kissing Adora's lips. "We made such a mess... it'll get more messy when you pull out..." Adora swallows thickly. Now she *really* wants to pull out.

"We broke my table." Adora mumbles.

"You mean *you* broke the table." Catra teases gently. "I just laid here looking pretty while getting fucked by a very sexy woman." Adora rolls her eyes and gently noses at Catra's jaw.

"Fine, *I* broke the table." Adora grumbles. "Ready for me to pull out?"

"Yeah... go slowly though..." Adora nods, she begins to pull out slowly, inching out of Catra. She watches, feeling another spike of arousal as she sees the hot sticky cum spilling out of

Catra. It looked so real, Adora didn't even know her sword could do that but now that she did? She was never going to get tired of doing it.

"Fuck..." Catra whimpers, biting her lip as her hips jerk up when Adora fully pops out. "...you came... *a lot* ."

"Yeah..." Adora says. She buries her fingers into Catra briefly, Catra gasps and her eyes widen when Adora pulls her fingers out coated in white. The stuff was sticky and its consistency was so similar to what Adora knows cum looks like. She looks at Catra and smirks. "Want a taste?"

"... Adora... come closer." Adora raises a brow but does as Catra says and draws closer to her. Catra grabs Adora's hand, taking her fingers into her mouth and sucking the cum off. She stares directly into Adora's eyes with a heated gaze, not looking away for one second, and Adora shudders, a shiver running right up her spine like she's being shocked with an electric current.

"Kitten... if I was sure you could take more, I'd already be knuckle deep in you right now." Adora speaks in a low voice that was dripping with her obvious spike of arousal from Catra's actions. Adora *so* wanted to cum inside of Catra again.

"Maybe later... if you keep going, I'm really not going to be able to walk for like a week." Catra laughs softly. "I can hardly feel my hips." Adora draws her fingers back and then presses her hand gently on Catra's stomach.

"She-Ra really did a number on you." Speaking of which... Adora concentrates and then transforms back to her usual self. She sighs. Maybe as She-Ra she had unlimited stamina, and as Adora she liked to think her stamina was above average, but Adora is human and she feels like she could just collapse against Catra and sleep forever right about now. "Will you stay tonight?"

"I'd like that... I'd like that a lot, actually..."Adora smiles and helps Catra up - and by up she means to sit up and wrap her arms and legs around her so Adora could carry her.

"No offence Kitten, but you're literally *leaking* . I don't want She-Ra cum on my bed sheets."

"So bath time first?" Catra grins, kissing Adora on her cheek and then her neck.

Adora smiles but doesn't answer. She carries Catra to her room and then directly to her bathroom. She places her down on the toilet while she runs the shower. "You want to clean up together? Can you even stand?" Adora asks with a frown.

"Uh... probably not?" Catra rubs the back of her head sheepishly. "I told you, I can hardly feel my hips. My legs are basically noodles right now."

"Okay... so hang onto me then," Adora says, her back to Catra at the moment to give her a little privacy. Once she's sure Catra's done doing whatever she was doing she turns back to her. "Just a quick shower before I put you back into my clothes and we snuggle for the night."

"Sounds good." Catra purrs softly, giving Adora a tired but pleased smile. "Can I get some water after this please?" Adora laughs a little.

"Of course, anything for you." She helps Catra up and then carries her into the shower. It's a little awkward but Adora succeeds in *not* dropping Catra - which she views as a resounding success. She makes sure to pay extra attention to her inner thighs and such to make sure that their... messy time together, wouldn't dry onto Catra's thighs. Adora wasn't really sure what to do about the whole leaking thing but it did seem to be slowing down now that Catra was upright and the water was washing it away.

"I've never done that before." Adora says after the shower, drying a sitting Catra down with her towel - she looks fluffy and adorable.

"I know... it was new to me too." Catra purrs as she's dried off - *so fucking cute* . "I liked it though. It felt good... and obviously it felt good to you too."

"It felt *amazing* ." Adora says. She stands from her crouched position, fills a cup with water from her tap and hands it to Catra. "Stay here while I go get you some clean clothes."

"Will do, babe." Catra takes the cup of water gratefully, taking a sip. Catra's voice had become pretty croaky, probably sore from all the crying out. "That really was amazing, wow..."

Adora returns with clean clothes, she pulls the shorts up Catra's legs, setting the waistband just below her tail and then pulls a Horde shirt over her head. She scoops Catra up once she's done drinking and carries her to her bed.

She settles beside Catra and they go about their usual cuddling routine - Catra curling up only after she's done her post-sex wiggles. Adora has been expanding her readings; apparently the wiggling was to increase fertility, which was why Magicats did it after sex. Whatever the case, Catra looked absolutely adorable while doing it - Adora thinks it should be a crime how *cute* Catra is.

Adora spoons Catra from behind and holds her close. "You know... that was nice... the slowness and then... then the hardness... different." Adora confesses in a whisper. Catra smiles and brings Adora's head to rest against her chest before she snuggles her.

"It was incredible... it definitely felt different, but different in a really nice way." Catra smiles and places a kiss in Adora's hair. "It felt... real."

"Real?" Adora questions. "Did it not feel real the last... however many times we've done this?"

"That's not what I meant!" Catra quickly replies - and Catra calls *Adora* a dork. "What I mean is... the whole sword thing... felt real..."

"Oh... yeah... I guess it did." Adora replies, snuggling closer to Catra. "I'm... glad you suggested using She-Ra." Catra purrs softly, nuzzling Adora.

"Yeah? You were okay? Not too overwhelming?"

"No..." Adora mumbles. Adora was drifting dangerously towards the state of sleep and exhaustion where she says stupid things. "You... I'd only trust *you* with her."

"Thank you... for trusting me with this. It means a lot." Catra whispers softly - probably not wanting to disturb Adora too much. "Sleep well, Adora." Adora pulls Catra closer and presses a soft kiss to her head.

"Mine..." She murmurs, feeling relaxed and calm and *warm* . "Goodnight Catra."

"Good night... my Adora." Catra murmurs back.

* * *

The debriefing after she had been kidnapped ends and Catra sighs. These things were starting to become a regular occurrence and yet no one seemed to think they were even a little bit suspicious. They all seemed to have bought the story that Adora's unsuccessful kidnapping of her was owed to her incompetence and Catra's skill - and that the reason she kept trying to capture her was because Catra was the Rebellion's tactician, even if Adora did appear to have a slight unhealthy obsession with Catra. It was *working* and that was all that mattered.

Catra was exhausted, especially after taking *She-Ra* , and couldn't wait to dive into bed, but she was stopped by a voice. "Catra, can we talk to you, in *private* ." That was Netossa, and she didn't sound the least bit pleased. Catra forces herself to not tense up. She had not been prepared for anyone to stop her, or for them to ask to see her in private.

She turns around, keeping a calm expression on her face. "Of course. Is something wrong?" She asks, wondering exactly what Netossa was upset about.

"Follow us please." Netossa says simply. Spinnerella smiles, a little nervously, before they start walking towards where Netossa and Spinnerella stayed while visiting Bright Moon.

They enter the bedroom and Netossa ensures the door is closed behind them before she turns to her wife. "You want to ask?" She asks cryptically. Spinnerella shakes her head and Netossa sighs - Netossa tends to be far less subtle than Spinnerella. "Are you fucking the Horde Lord?" Catra's jaw drops and her eyes widen in complete and utter shock at the question.

" *Huh* ?!" She couldn't believe that Netossa had just asked her *that* . *FUCK!* "What in the world?! Why would I do that?" She asks them, trying her best to push the suspicion off of herself.

"How about the fact you keep getting kidnapped?" Netossa asks, completely un-phased by Catra's shock. "The fact you keep calling her *Adora* instead of *Lord* Adora."

"You also..." Spinnerella hesitates for a moment. "You come back unharmed yet limping... and with marks in relatively the same places." Catra doesn't know what to say or do to get out of this situation. She knew that going back with Adora multiple times would risk her getting caught, but she didn't think it would happen that quickly.

She stands there, thinking about what she should do, before sighing, her shoulders drooping in defeat. "...okay."

" *Okay* ?!" Netossa yells in anger and a little exasperation. "You're actually... you're *literally* sleeping with the enemy?!"

"What did you want me to do? Deny it?" Catra frowns. "That would just probably make you hate me more than what you probably already do right now."

"We don't hate you." Spinnerella objects.

"We're seriously *worried* about you." Netossa adds. "I can't believe you'd do something like this... are you... are you the spy?"

"What? *No* . Goddess, no. Adora and I don't even talk about the war when we're together." Catra shakes her head. "It was just... we just get to be us, if that makes sense."

"That makes no sense." Netossa deadpans. "You're really having sex with Lord Adora?"

"...yes."

"And why shouldn't we tell the rest of the Rebellion? Not to mention your mothers?!"

"Please don't do that…" Catra pleads softly. "I... look..." She bites her lip. "I just... it wasn't something I planned, okay? The whole... sleeping with her repeatedly." This is the worst case scenario. At least they hadn't told anyone else.

"How many times has this happened?"

"... A couple."

"Be honest, Catra."

"I... lost count." Netossa pinches the bridge of her nose and looks away in exasperation. Spinnerella lays a gentle hand on her wife's shoulder.

"Catra... we're worried about... what this means." Spinnerella says. "Are you two... a couple?"

"It's not that! We're just... fuck buddies, I think." Catra scratches her cheek. "We're not a couple. Just... enemies that sleep together sometimes."

"Do you even hear that?" Netossa asks in disbelief. "You could've been fuck buddies with *anyone* , and you chose *her* ?!"

"Catra, even if it's just sex... sex almost always leads to feelings, trust us."

"I told you, I hadn't planned it to end up like that!" Catra responds, rubbing her face. "And that's... not gonna happen, okay? I know she's my enemy. She knows that too."

" *Do* you know that?" Netossa asks. "Because you keep calling her Adora and you've even defended her publicly to your friends."

"Maybe because I've actually gotten to know her outside of the battlefield?" Catra points out. "Look... she's... different than what I've always thought she'd be. And I know that she's my enemy but I guess... seeing her just be her without the armour on and her walls up helps me understand her reasons to why she does things. Obviously I don't agree with them in any way, but... the Horde has fucked her up too."

"Catra..." Spinnerella says carefully. "I think you need to be careful."

"The sex is getting to your head." Netossa says. "So what if she's secretly nice under all that armour? It doesn't change what she's done and *continues* to do."

"Except... it kind of has... how do I explain it." Catra rubs the back of her neck thoughtfully. "When she... 'kidnaps' me... battles always tend to end as soon as she's gotten a hold of me... she retreats... and the battles have started getting shorter and less... harmful for both sides. Plus, they added measures to make sure civilians don't get caught in the crossfire anymore." Netossa pauses. All of that may be true but Catra is aware that it was circumstantial at best to someone who wasn't her.

"So what...? You're *changing* the Horde Lord by bedding her?"

"I don't know if you could call it... changing her. But at the very least... I'm getting her to understand that there are lines that shouldn't be crossed, and she's actually getting it."

"You're playing a dangerous game." Netossa says, shaking her head. "Spending time with her makes you susceptible to her words, she's already got you thinking she's anything *but* the Lord of the Horde."

"For goddess' sake. I know she's the Lord of the Horde. I'm not saying she's not, and I'm not saying that what she did should be excused without punishment or anything. What I'm saying is that there's a lot that we didn't know from her point of view, and the point of view of many Horde soldiers in general, you get me?" Honestly? Adora is a lot more than just the Horde Lord to Catra but she can't exactly say that right now.

"No, I don't 'get you'. Why would you sleep with her to begin with?" Netossa asks. Catra shuffles a little. She knows what she's about to say isn't going to go down well with either Netossa or Spinnerella.

"The first time was how I escaped." Catra answers.

"... You're kidding."

"I'm not."

"You slept with her to let you go?" Netossa asks in mild distress. "I can't even begin to describe how *wrong* that is." Catra pinches the bridge of her nose.

"First of all, I was the one who offered to do it in the first place because I saw how flirty she had been before and I thought I could take advantage." Catra explains. She admits, that still sounds somewhat concerning. "Second of all, she initially said no and that she wouldn't do anything I wasn't comfortable doing. She said she'd let me go regardless... I was just… curious..." *Curiosity killed the cat, but satisfaction brought it back.* Catra is more than happy her curiosity had gotten the better of her that day.

"Catra," Spinnerella says gently. "how do you feel about Adora? You can be completely honest with us."

"She's... nicer than I thought she'd be..." Catra admits. In fact, Adora is a lot of things Catra wasn't expecting.

"Is that it? You don't think anything else?"

"And she's... kind of sweet. She's a giant dork for that matter, and she's grumpy before she eats." Catra begins to smile unknowingly.

"Mhmm... more?"

"More?"

"How do you feel when you're with her?"

"She's... fun to be around." Catra says awkwardly. She doesn't understand why Spinnerella is asking her these questions.

"You're being weirdly vague." Netossa points out. Catra grumbles softly.

"Okay, fine. She's actually really nice and caring. Only reason she doesn't show that is because the person that was supposed to raise her was an asshole and made her feel as though that was weakness. She loves hugs and kisses, and likes when we just lay down and snuggle after... you know… and she likes it when I play with her hair, and it's really sweet and so different from how she acted when we faced each other on the battlefield at first." In fact, Adora is completely different. She is… Catra *likes* her. A lot. Part of her thinks they work *too* well. Like they just cli- Catra's brain completely crashes at that thought and she quickly brushes it off.

"... you have feelings for her." That isn't a question. That is a *statement* . And it *freaks* Catra out.

"I don't!" Catra protests. She feels… hot, and panicked. Her heart is pounding in her chest and in her ears.

"Catra, why do you keep rejecting suitors? And don't give us the war excuse, or it not being the right time or whatever. It's because whatever you have going on with Adora will be forced to end, isn't it?"

"No! It's literally because I haven't found the person that I want to be with, okay? I haven't found the person that I click with..." *Click.* The thing that Catra was about to describe herself feeling like she and Adora did.

"Do you feel like you click with Adora?" Spinnerella asks.

"Why are you asking me all of this for? I've been rejecting suitors since *before* I was even kidnapped the first time." That's true, and Catra is aware that she is grasping at straws here, but she *cannot* have feelings for the Horde Lord. Their agreement is literally no strings attached sex! Not to mention she's the ***HORDE LORD!***

"Yeah, but you rejecting suitors because you're waiting to find a mate and you rejecting them because you already feel like you *have* a mate, are two very different things." Catra's eyes almost pop out of her head at the 'm' word being used and applied to *Adora.*

"She's *not* my mate!" Catra denies. There is no way in hell that Adora is her mate. *Zero. Absolutely not.*

"You sure about that? Spinny is right, sex almost always leads to feelings." Netossa says.

"I'm sure." She wasn't, even though she *should* be sure.. "It's *just* sex."

"So when it comes down to her or the Rebellion, you'll choose the Rebellion?"

"... Yes." Netossa and Spinnerella both look unconvinced by Catra's answer but they concede.

"Fine, if you're sure, and if your loyalty remains with the Rebellion... then we won't tell the others. But if your feelings for Lord Adora put anyone at risk... we won't hold back what we know." Netossa says.

"Okay... yeah, that's fair. But I do want to say that I'm seriously *not* the spy... I'm trying to figure out who it is as much as you all are." Catra whispers, biting her lip. "And I know that you're probably hesitant to believe me, and I don't blame you... but I'm telling you the truth."

"Can't you just ask Adora who the spy is?" Netossa asks. Catra shakes her head.

"We promised each other that we wouldn't talk about anything war related that would give the other any advantage." Which was true and one of the main reasons Catra was okay carrying on her affair with Adora. When they were alone, there was no war, they were just Adora and Catra. They agreed not to talk about the war for that reason. That complicated things too much.

"But you're in the Fright Zone, surely you must be learning things?" Netossa asks with a little confusion.

"Aside from the fact that Adora has anger issues that she's learning to work through, not really. I told you, any talk that's war related isn't allowed. From me, or her, or anyone else while I'm there for that matter." The Princesses share a look.

"... Fair enough..." Netossa says.

"Catra, be careful." Spinnerella reminds her. "I don't just mean of Adora, I mean of your own feelings. Falling for the Horde Lord... I'm afraid that would only hurt you." Catra wants to scoff. She *isn't* going to fall for Adora… she *can't.*

"Thanks for your concern, Spinny. But I'll be okay." Catra smiles to reassure them despite the way she was currently feeling. "I'll be careful, I promise."

"You need to be more careful about your stories too, clearly they're not as conniving as you think they are - especially when you go running off with the Horde Lord mid-battle." Netossa points out which is a fair point. Catra had been worried about being too obvious and clearly she *had* been.

"Uh... yeah, good idea..." Catra sweat drops, laughing nervously. "I'm surprised it took this long for anyone to figure it out..."

"Lucky for you, people really just think Adora has an obsession with you... maybe she even does." Adora isn't obsessed with Catra… not anymore than Catra is obsessed with Adora anyway - and she is *not* obsessed with Adora.

"Who knows... it's kind of making things look up a little though. Less fighting, less injuries, she's learning that what she's doing is wrong, and less civilians are being harmed." Adora has become softer… sweeter. She is retreating from battles more, she's not as scary as she used to be. She's just… Adora. People get so hung up on the Lord, they forget that there is a person under all that armour.

"Are you not worried that she's... using you?" Netossa asks. Catra scowls a little at the mere suggestion.

"Not really... I mean... I did consider that, but we quite literally don't talk about anything war related when we're together... and I don't see what other thing she could be using me for."

"Gaining your trust to use it against you later?" Netossa suggests.

"I seriously doubt that considering it's just sex. Obviously if I ever have to fight her in the future, I will. But she hasn't given me a reason to think that that's what she's doing." Catra really doesn't believe that Adora would ever use her like that - *ever.*

"If you *ever* have to fight her in the future?" Netossa asks. "Catra... you can't possibly think you'll *never* have to fight Adora again."

"I'm not saying I won't have to!" Catra protests. "I will fight Adora *if* or *when* I have to." *But no sooner than that.*

"Why her? Why risk everything just to have sex with *her* ?" Netossa asks.

"... I don't know." Catra trails off, looking away to the right.

"You don't know?"

"I guess... it's just..." Catra sighs. "I don't know..."

"Is she that good of a lay?"

"Yes... yes she is." And she *really* is. Adora is *incredible* . Whatever they are doing, Catra has *never* felt that way with anyone ever before. Adora is an *extremely* skilled lover.

"Wow... really?" Netossa asks.

" *Oh yeah* ..."

"I mean, judging from your limp, that's pretty clear."

"... She used She-Ra." Catra smiles a little at the memory. She-Ra… Catra definitely wanted to take her again. She… she looked a lot like Adora. Adora views herself and She-Ra as entirely different beings but Catra just sees Adora. Her eyes may be bluer, and her hair is less

golden and more platinum, but the way she sounds, the way she laughs, the way she touches Catra… that is all *Adora* .

Both Netossa and Spinnerella's eyes widen at Catra’s words. " *She-Ra* ?!"

"Mhmm..." Catra grins. "She did, and *wow* ."

"We've only heard stories about She-Ra... she's supposed to be... very strong..."

"Oh, she is." Catra bites her lip at the memory of Adora, She-Ra, whatever, thrusting into her. She could tell that Adora had been holding back, that She-Ra’s strength was… immeasurable.

"How are you standing?" Netossa asks with her mouth agape.

"Magicat healing... and a day of rest... and massages." Catra asks. She only half-stops herself from purring. Adora is very good not just at fucking but at aftercare and Catra appreciates it - aftercare was just as important as Adora thoroughly fucking her.

"... Just... be careful." Netossa repeats.

"And also, make sure you're both being safe." Spinnerella adds with a little concern.

"We are!" Catra has to fight a blush and she loses. Her cheeks are rosy at the fact that Spinnerella just gave her a somewhat sex talk.

"Good..." Spinnerella says happily. "Then... we won't tell people." Catra nods gratefully.

"Thanks, you guys... I really appreciate it." And she does. The fact that Spinnerella and Netossa hadn't ratted her out? She was beyond grateful for that. Maybe she could even… use that to her advantage.

"I still think you should end it sooner rather than later. We were serious about sex and feelings." Netossa says. Catra… doesn't want to do anything but she does want to at least appease Spinnerella and Netossa. They were already doing her a service by keeping her affair with Adora a secret, if she convinced them that she had plans to end it with the blonde then maybe they'd be more inclined to trust Catra despite her relationship with the Horde Lord.

"I will…" Catra had no plans to actually follow through on that - at least, not any time soon.

"Then I guess that's everything." Netossa says.

"What do you think it means that she was She-Ra around you?" Spinnerella asks thoughtfully.

"I... guess she feels comfortable around me?" Catra shrugs. Adora had said She-Ra was exclusive to Catra and Catra believed her. There was no way Adora was going to use She-Ra anywhere else - or with *anyone* else.

"I mean, correct me if I'm wrong, but Adora is almost deathly afraid of She-Ra... yet she used her in an intimate moment with *you* ..."

"Yeah... I guess she did." Catra isn't sure she likes this line of questioning if she's honest.

"Do you not think that's a big deal?"

"I mean, I suppose so?" Catra is aware that she is playing this down quite a lot. It was a *big* deal, both to Catra and Adora. Adora had been so nervous and hesitant and yet she had still done it simply because she felt comfortable and confident with Catra.

Spinnerella looks thoughtful and Netossa shrugs. "Who knows why Adora does anything." Netossa states and Catra laughs.

"That's true. Well... is that all you needed to talk about?"

"So long as you're not... spying on us, and Adora isn't taking advantage of you... and you claim this is strictly sex, then... that's it. But you *need* to end it or come clean soon. There's no way this will end well."

"... I know. I'll... have to talk to Adora about it." Catra sighs, looking contemplative. She didn't want to end it at all. Not a single bit.

"You said Adora has anger issues," Spinerella says. "... just... be safe."

"Oh! She's never done anything to me when she's angry. I... actually calm her down." Catra meant what she said before to Adora. She never feels as though Adora would ever hurt her.

"You calm her down?" Spinnerella asks.

"Yeah..." Catra answers. Netossa and Spinnerella glance at each other.

"And you said it's only sex?"

"Yes?"

"You don't think it's weird that Adora has used She-Ra around you *and* you calm her anger?"

"... Why do you ask?" Catra *really* isn't sure she likes where this is going.

"Adora doesn't seem like the most expressive person but... those feel like *big* things." Spinnerella explains and Catra has to admit that Spinnerellla has a point there.

"... Maybe, but what are you trying to say?" Catra narrows her eyes suspiciously.

"That maybe your 'just sex' agreement has drifted into something else and neither of you have noticed it, or you're both in denial because of what that could mean." Catra's jaw falls open a little at Spinnerella's bluntness - usually she's the less blunt out of the two.

"You seriously think Adora caught feelings?" Catra scoffs. There is absolutely *no way* that Adora has *feelings* for Catra.

"I'm saying it's possible."

"I doubt that..."

"What if Adora told you that she *had* caught feelings?"

"I-" Catra pauses, not knowing what to say. "I don't know..." And she really doesn't know. Would she be happy? Would she break off their agreement? How the fuck does Catra even feel about Adora? She doesn't know any of the answers to any of these questions.

"Maybe you should think about that." Spinnerella says ominously.

"... And if she has? I mean, I doubt it..." Catra asks curiously. There is zero chance that anyone would accept Adora as Catra's… what? Girlfriend? The Lord Horde is her girlfriend? *Yeah, that'll go over perfectly, not.*

"That's a you problem." Netossa responds and Catra frowns.

"... Yeah, I suppose it would be a me problem."

"Well, not entirely," Spinnerella frowns at her wife. "Adora having feelings for you... would potentially change everything."

"... How?" Catra asks.

"... How? Catra... if Adora has feelings for you, do you really think she'll still want to fight a war against you?" That is a good question but another that Catra cannot answer.

"I... I don't know the answer to that either, guys. You can't just expect me to believe that Adora has feelings for me all of a sudden." Because *she doesn't.* It's *just* sex.

"Well... it is hypothetical," Netossa admits. "but the situation you're in... it's a very *possible* hypothetical."

"I doubt it's very possible, 'Tossa." Catra does doubt it, Adora herself had said there was no feelings, only sex in this arrangement.

"Fine." Netossa says, but she doesn't sound very convinced. "Just... keep what we've said in mind."

"I will... can I go now?" Despite having somewhat rested Catra was still exhausted after taking She-Ra, she wanted to lay down ASAP, she was half convinced she was still leaking her cum.

"... You can go. *For now* . But we're serious." Netossa says. "You can't keep fucking the Horde Lord forever."

"I know. I heard you the first two times." Catra narrows her eyes and Netossa narrows her eyes right back at Catra.

"Don't give me an attitude young lady." Spinnerella laughs a little at her wife, resting her hand on her shoulder.

"Look, Catra, forgetting the fact that she's the Lord of the Horde, we are happy that you've found someone who you... seem to like."

"Spinnerella, you're making it sound like I've found someone... I *haven't* she's just a fuck buddy." Catra clarifies, reassuring the others as well as herself. "But thanks... I think." It's not like she's dating Adora, or courting her, or *anything.* They've firmly established themselves as enemies with benefits, no strings. Catra is *not* going to get caught in those strings - she's not… *is she?*

"Who's gonna tell her that's what we were?" Netossa whispers and Spinnerella elbows her wife on her side. Catra pretends she didn't hear what Netossa had just said. She hums softly.

"May I go now?" She asks.

"Yeah, yeah, go get some rest, sounds like you need it."

"Thanks... see you two around." Catra nods at them before heading out to go back to her guest room.

* * *

Spinnerella waits until she's sure that Catra's no longer within hearing range and gently slaps her wife's arm. "You do realise she has sensitive hearing, right?" Netossa pauses before she winces.

"Right... Magicat..." Spinnerella cannot believe her wife forgot that.

"... Could it really be possible that the Horde Lord has feelings for Catra?" Spinnerella asks.

"Lord Adora?" Netossa snorts. "I don't think she has feelings for anything other than her passion for destroying Etheria. But Catra obviously has feelings, even if she refuses to see them."

"Well, yeah... but..." Spinnerella presses her lips together. "You did make a good point earlier."

"I make lots of good points, you'll have to be more specific."

"She used She-Ra while with Catra in an intimate setting... the Horde Lord has *never* used She-Ra in battle before." Spinnerella found that incredible yet Catra had played it off as no big deal - *that was a **huge** deal!*

"Yeah..." Netossa frowns. "That... was unexpected. No one even knows what She-Ra looks like. Except... I guess… Catra now."

"Exactly. And you remember what Catra said last time? When we mentioned She-Ra in our previous conversation? She said that Lord Adora didn't use her because she didn't want to be like a Princess... she was afraid of using She-Ra."

"What are you... suggesting?" Netossa asks. Spinnerella places a hand on her wife's shoulder.

"That... there is a real possibility that the Horde Lord may be catching feelings for Catra."

"What? Are you serious? *Lord Adora* ? Spinny... that's crazy."

"I know, but for her to use something... that she was afraid to use before, in an *intimate* setting... it makes sense." Spinnerella says, looking at her wife. "What if... what if that really is what is happening? What if it's mutual?"

"Then I think we have a huge fucking problem."

"Oh boy..." Spinnerella says. Catra may be in denial but her feelings for Adora are so obvious. Even if they agreed to a fuck buddy situation that almost never works out. Sex, being vulnerable with someone like that, being intimate… it does lead to *feelings* all too often.

"I mean... Best case, Adora surrenders. Worst case, she breaks Catra's heart because she's incapable of processing her emotions." Netossa comments which does *not* make Spinnerella feel any better.

"... Let's hope for the best case scenario, but I have a feeling that this might end in heartbreak for Catra regardless... there's no way that the others will want to... *not* end Lord Adora if she surrenders."

"Kill her?" Netossa ponders that. "Yeah... they probably would want the most severe punishment for her, can't say I'd blame them."

"I... really hope Catra hasn't caught feelings, but with how she's been acting..." Spinnerella frowns, clearly worried about the Magicat princess.

"There is absolutely no way C'yra would *ever* accept Adora as Catra's mate."

"No... there isn't, which is why I'm worried if Catra already chose her."

"How do you know if a Magicat has chosen a mate?"

"They just... bond. Magicats can tell better than we can. The only way we'd be able to tell is if..." Spinnerella bites the inside of her cheek.

"If...?"

"Is if the Magicat loses their mate... and they go into grieving." Spinnerella answers gravely. Grieving is a very *bad* experience for Magicats, it can even lead to their *death* - death by a broken heart.

"... So what? We'd only know if Catra for some reason lost Adora?"

"Or unless Catra realises it and tells us..." Spinnerella shrugs slightly. "But who knows when that will happen... or *if* it even actually happened."

"Well, as they say, dear wife, only time will tell."

Chapter End Notes

I did warn earlier that you should get ready. Here it comes! ;) -M

I just wanna say that Adora looks like S5 She-Ra because S5 She-Ra is so sexy. Seems like things are starting to... shift... ;) -S

Fine Line

Chapter Summary

> “Enjoy the show?” Adora asks with a little smirk. That little shit! Catra rolls her eyes and then makes herself at home in Adora’s bed.
>
> “Shut up idiot, go yell at your soldiers.” Adora laughs and Catra sees her tying her hair up in the corner of her eye. She sees her stash her sword in its holster on her left hip before leaning down to kiss Catra gently atop her head.
>
> “I won’t be long Kitten.” She whispers and Catra grabs her by her shirt.
>
> “Is that a promise?” Catra asks.

Chapter Notes

> Happy Friday y'all! New update coming at you, and this one really is CHUNKY. I apologise for how long this chapter is but splitting it up feels counter-productive and it kind of all fits into one space within the fic and the plan we have as a whole. I hope you all enjoy this monster of an update anyway :)! Thank you for reading!!
>
> Warning, NSFW ahead (and light BDSM), also Implied/Referenced Child Abuse (because the Horde is... yikes)

See the end of the chapter for more notes

They were enjoying each other's company. Something Catra had discovered was that she could enjoy Adora's company whatever they were doing, whether it was sex, talking, walking the Fright Zone together, or Adora being a dork, and this. They could just be quiet and enjoy one another's company. They could just *exist* around each other and it not be awkward. It made Catra feel *warm* .

Adora was spread out on her stomach atop her bed, her head on her pillow and her arms tucked under it. She was in boxer shorts but she wore nothing on her top half which meant her back was exposed. Catra was tracing her finger over her soft skin, mapping out the scars that lay there mentally. Adora is beautiful, scars and all. Her back is also wonderfully muscular and her shoulders are *broad . Is it possible to find backs so attractive?*

"You can ask about them, I know you're curious." Adora mumbles which startles Catra somewhat - she had thought that Adora was asleep. Catra pauses and her finger stills. Adora doesn't move, she looks rather comfortable actually. Catra flattens her hand to Adora's back.

"How'd you... do you remember how you got them?" Catra asks curiously.

“Depends which ones you’re talking about.” Adora replies lazily. Catra hums curiously, indicating for Adora to expand on what she was saying. “Some are burns, those are from training as a cadet - lasers burn like a bitch,” Adora explains. “Some are off blades, common Rebellion weapons, some are from Shadow Weaver,” Adora moves one of her hands behind her and indicates to an almost lightning strike scar along her side. “When I did something wrong, or failed… or… didn’t meet her expectations.” Catra’s heart skips a few beats. *What kind of monster abuses a child for mistakes? For not meeting impossible expectations that she has set for them?*

“I was trained in the espionage route because Shadow Weaver wanted me to be… prepared for anything. The training for that is… intense.” Adora says. Catra flattens her hand to Adora’s back again and then kisses her bare shoulder. She’s almost half afraid to ask Adora what exactly that training includes. In the end, she doesn’t have to, Adora just tells her.

“The Horde believed that the Rebellion tortured any spies it found, which meant all spies had to be trained to resist all torture methods, which means…” Adora trails off for a second. “We were tortured for about two weeks straight and if we broke our loyalty to the Horde it started all over again.”

“Dear Goddesses above…” Catra couldn’t believe what she was hearing right now. Her ears droop and press back against her head. “How old were you?”

“Sixteen?” Adora answers, unsure. “Hence why not a lot of spies are Horde soldiers and the few that are… they’re valued.” Adora turns over so she’s facing Catra. “Often we hire mercenaries and they’re given limited information on the Horde. That way, if they were ever caught, they wouldn’t have sensitive information.”

“You realise the Rebellion could just use a truth spell on your soldiers, right?” Catra asks. Adora smiles a little.

“Yes, we’re trained to resist those.”

“But that’s… *excruciating* .” Catra says. Resisting a truth spell apparently feels like being burnt from the inside out.

“It doesn’t work,” Adora admits. “They’re impossible to resist, but we’re taught to resist until we find a way to… silence ourselves.”

“Fuck me…” Catra stares at Adora in complete shock. She was sixteen… *Sixteen* ! And she was raised to have unwavering loyalty to the Horde, to *die* to protect the Horde. No wonder Adora’s brainwashing goes deeper than any other Horde soldier Catra has ever met - and that’s not even considering the fact she was clearly some special project to Shadow Weaver.

Catra cups her beautiful face. Adora has been brainwashed and abused her entire life, even if she doesn’t realise it, even if she just thinks that’s how life is, it doesn’t change that she has *suffered* at the behest of the Horde her entire life. And Adora is… despite the years of abuse and torment… she is *kind* and she has a… *warmth* within her. Right at her core. Adora has a *good* heart.

“You realise all of that is… *horrific*... right?” Catra asks. Adora sits up and kisses Catra gently on her lips. Catra purrs and wraps her tail around Adora’s wrist.

“The Horde… is hard… but it raised me to be a soldier…”

“When you were sixteen you were *literally* being tortured.” Catra says with disbelief. “When I was sixteen, I was worrying about royal dinners.”

“We come from very different lives,” Adora says, kissing Catra again. “but we both grew up in the middle of a war.”

“That’s true at least.” Catra says thoughtfully. Adora looks like she’s about to say something else when the door to her room opens - and Adora was lecturing *Catra* on her friends and privacy. Adora doesn’t even seem to care that she's half naked.

“Boss, we need you.” Scorpia says as she enters Adora’s bedroom. Catra pulls Adora’s blanket up to her chest.

“I asked to not be disturbed,” Adora groans. “Someone better be dying.”

“Uh… no, Boss, but… someone is… it’s… the squad you wanted to reprimand for… you know what…” Scorpia glances at Catra nervously. Adora sighs.

“I’ll be right there,” Adora responds. “Give me a moment to get dressed.” Scorpia bows and then turns and walks out, closing the door behind her. “Duty calls Kitten,” Adora says as she sits up.

Adora stands and Catra watches her as she gets dressed. Adora has started to fill out a little more recently, and Catra doesn’t know if it’s the fact that Catra has been bringing her food or if it’s because of something else, but her skinny muscles are becoming seriously *buff* muscles. Catra watches her with great interest, her tail lifting almost automatically and swishing behind her.

Adora pulls on her Horde issued sports bra and Catra watches the way her abdominal muscles contract and relax with her movement. Adora stretches a little and Catra wonders if she’s doing this purposely or not. She grabs her shirt first, her ‘proper’ shirt, it’s a skin tight almost turtle neck that’s black. On the back of it is the Horde insignia, a stark blood red symbol, and she has two red cutouts on her biceps for some reason.

Next are her pants which are typical Horde issued trousers but believe Catra when she says they make Adora’s ass look *fantastic* . She fastens her belt in place. The buckle had a badge with the Horde insignia on it - Catra figured that was probably Adora’s Force Captain badge from whenever she was promoted, it was interesting that she kept it still. Next she pulls on her heavy boots, which were black and red, matching her uniform pretty perfectly. She makes sure her uniform is perfect before she pulls on her Lord armour.

First she pulled the shoulder pieces on, then she had a chest piece that covered about half of her chest with the Horde symbol sat square in the middle of it, then her arm armour that covered her arms, with the straps coming around her forearms but stopping at the elbow joint. Last, but *definitely* not least, and clearly the most important component to Adora, was the scarlet red cape that she attached to her shoulder guards; on the back of it was the black symbol of the Horde. Whenever Adora was dressed in her full Lord get-up she seemed taller, more authoritative, confident… she was a *leader* , commanding attention - and she was so fucking *hot* .

“Enjoy the show?” Adora asks with a little smirk. *That little shit!* Catra rolls her eyes and then makes herself at home in Adora’s bed.

“Shut up idiot, go yell at your soldiers.” Adora laughs and Catra sees her tying her hair up in the corner of her eye. She sees her stash her sword in its holster on her left hip before leaning down to kiss Catra gently atop her head.

“I won’t be long Kitten.” She whispers and Catra grabs her by her shirt.

“Is that a promise?” Catra asks.

“Yes it is.” Adora replies.

“I’ll hold you to it then.” Catra replies. Adora kisses her again and, just before Adora walks away, Catra pulls her back down. It distresses her, allowing Adora to walk around *un-* marked by her scent, so Catra rubs her cheek against her, purring as she does so. Adora laughs as she always does whenever Catra marks her but she stays put until Catra is satisfied and allows her to go.

Catra sighs. She wants to be with Adora always and, recently, because of Spinnerella and Netossa, Catra has been able to spend significantly more time in the Fright Zone. Whenever they don’t have the whole kidnapping story, Catra can stay as long as she wants with Adora - within reason of course. Spinnerella and Netossa help cover for her by telling the rest of the Rebellion she’s either on scouting missions or she’s with them - when really she’s getting fucked into oblivion by Adora.

She hadn't told Adora that two of the Princesses knew, she figured Adora would probably freak out if she told her, so she just told her that she had figured out a way to cover for her absence from the Rebellion that was reasonable and allowed them to spend time together. Adora had looked perplexed but she'd quickly just accepted it.

They had used She-Ra more than once now and *especially* that thing that Adora had discovered she could do with her sword. Catra couldn't even count (on both hands) how many times she'd had She-Ra's cum inside of her. All in all, Catra was having an *incredible* time and she was being fucked *fantastically* .

The only issue? This weird… attachment she was starting to develop.

She found it… *hard* being apart from Adora, she often found herself daydreaming about her during Rebellion meetings. Battles had stopped between their planned kidnapping rouses and… Catra just really *liked* Adora. After becoming aware of her little slips of calling Adora by her name, and not *Lord* Adora, Catra had stopped; whenever someone made a comment that Catra felt protesting, she simply kept quiet. It was necessary. She was a little worried that Spinnerella and Netossa may be right. She isn't entirely sure she views Adora as her enemy anymore…

Catra's stomach makes a sound of protest and she sits up. She was hungry and, maybe Adora had only been gone for a little while, but Catra was *bored* . She stands up and grabs some of Adora's clothes, cutting a hole in some of her tight pants and pulling them on. Unfortunately, Adora is taller than her and Catra has to rock the *cuffed* leggings look. She pulls on a tank and then a hoodie. She smiles happily at the scent of Adora all around her. She loves scenting Adora but she also enjoys having the blonde's scent on her too. Catra turns her attention to the throne room and on going to disturb whatever it was that Adora was doing.

Catra opens Adora's bedroom door, a small hop in her step as she steps into the throne room. She really should have been prepared for anything, but she hadn't been ready to hear the angry yells that were echoing throughout the room. She had to admit to herself, she had forgotten how Adora could get when someone did not follow directions outside of their bedroom walls... *Their* ? No, *Adora's* .

She shakes her head, glancing between Adora and the guards who were standing there shaking in their boots. With a soft sigh, she walks over to the blonde, heading up the steps of the throne and purring. "Oh, Adora!" Catra practically sings, pressing her cheek against the blonde's as she plops down onto her lap without a care in the world. "What happened?"

Adora’s yells die in her throat as soon as Catra sits in her lap. She blushes bright red and her eyes widen to an almost comical size. Her soldiers in front of her seem just as shocked as Adora looked. She looks at Catra, and then her men, and then Catra again. She clearly doesn’t know what to say, her brain is failing her. “I uh...” Adora says. “Just reprimanding some *incompetent* soldiers. Kitten... I thought you were waiting... you know... *in my room* .”

"I got bored." She answers, as though it was obvious. "Plus, I was hungry... for food." She specifies, winking mischievously. "And maybe for you later." Catra turns to look at the soldiers and then back at Adora. "What did they do though?" Adora swallows - probably at Catra’s comment about possibly being hungry for her later.

Adora gestures with her free hand, that was not holding Catra, to the soldiers. “Catra, these are Blue Squad, they’re responsible for...” Adora trails off for a moment, seemingly trying to decide if she should divulge that information or not. “They’re in charge of confiscating illegal tech in the Fright Zone, *Rebellion* tech, weapons, isn’t that right soldiers?” They all nod quickly at Adora’s words. “Except *someone* got their hands on a piece of tech that they just couldn’t resist figuring out and it blew up an *entire block* in *my* Fright Zone, isn’t that right? Luckily you *boneheads* had the decency to do it *away* from where people were, and that the tech doesn’t harm those who use it, otherwise I’d be talking to a *pile of ashes* right about now!” Adora’s voice had slowly started to raise in her explanation until she was yelling again by the end and scowling in disapproval and anger at her men.

"So, no one was harmed by the tech?" Catra asks softly, placing her finger under Adora's chin. "Then why don't you have them gather any material that survived the blast and that can be reused? And any metals that are damaged can be remelted to reinforce the walls. They can fix what they destroyed, no?" She hums. "And they might have gotten a damaged piece of tech which is why it backfired."

Adora huffs and looks at Catra. She leans closer to her and lowers her voice so she can whisper to her and not be heard by the soldiers. “Babe, you’re undermining my authority.” Catra purrs and turns her head, pressing her lips softly against Adora's.

"It's just a suggestion. But I think you got your point across about them being more careful when checking for tech. They were *shaking* when I came in, Adora." She whispers back, glancing over at the soldiers. "Make them work with the person that brought the tech here to repair the damage that they caused, since it was their slip up too. But you'll have to have a backup for them if you want a team to continue checking for tech, since they'll probably be tired from repairs. What do you think?"

" *Or* , I make them do all of that stuff *and* their usual duties too."

"Not if you want it to be done properly. Exhaustion can make people miss things they're supposed to look for." She answers back. "But again, it's your choice."

"No... you're right." Adora grumbles. She glances at her men and then she sighs. "I trust that this idiotic slip in judgement will never happen again?"

"N-No sir, we're very sorry, sir." A soldier stutters.

"Next time you find strange Rebellion tech, what will you do with it?" Adora asks.

"Take it to the containment field, sir, and dispose of it away from the populated places of the Fright Zone, sir." Another soldier answers.

"Why on Etheria you didn't do that this time, I have no idea." Adora sighs in exasperation and then looks at Catra. "I've been convinced to allow you all the chance to make up for your mistakes. You'll help repair the damage you did with the person who brought the illegal tech here in the first place. In the meantime, your services will be substituted by another squad. Do I make myself clear?"

"Yes sir!" They all say in unison, saluting and bowing to Adora.

"Good. Now get out of my sight before I change my mind." Catra smiles in relief and shifts in Adora's lap, kissing her cheek.

"Thank you, baby." She focuses her attention to the soldiers and waves at them. "Make sure to actually get some rest! Stop over training." She calls out to them after she sees the movements of heavy limbs and overused muscles. "You'll just cause muscle damage if you push yourself too hard."

“... Are you... telling my soldiers to stop training?” Adora asks.

"Not to stop training *entirely* . But I doubt you want for them to end up hurt and not be able to perform at their best." Catra looks back at Adora, completely unafraid in comparison to the soldiers. "Like I said, if you overwork your body, you cause more harm than good." Adora clicks her fingers and points at the commander of the squad.

“You, are your men overworked from training and, if so, why?” Adora asks.

“W-We’ve been... under a lot of stress, my Lord.” They answer. “After we messed up we were... worried, and it’s been... hard… thinking about having to face you, sir.” They say and Adora frowns.

“So it’s *my* fault you’re overworked?” Adora asks, raising a brow. “I don’t oversee every squad, if you’re over training your men under your command, *you’re* an ineffective commander, do not try to blame *me* for *your* shortcomings.” Catra gently pinches Adora's arm to get her attention. She leans into her ear, whispering softly.

"I think they mean that the stress of having to face you made them push themselves harder because they didn't want to disappoint you. I don't think they're trying to blame you. They're just telling you why they were pushing harder than they should have." She explains, pulling back a bit and smiling at the soldiers kindly. "Try not to overwork yourself next time, okay?" Catra says, nodding at them. "While training can be a good way to relieve stress, it's not good to not give your body a break at all when you've already scheduled training into your day, okay? Maybe next time you're stressed, try and find something else that isn't training to help you unwind."

“Uh, yes, Princess C’yra,” They say. “Sorry, Lord Adora.” Catra smiles and nods.

"Are they allowed to go, Adora?" Catra shifts a little, placing her hand on top of the blonde's that was holding her securely.

“Yes,” Adora says after a moment. “Scorpia will give you further instructions on where to start with repairing the damage you caused. Now, please, get out of my sight before I change my mind.”

"Yes, sir!" They salute her before hurrying out of the throne room. Catra watches them as they leave before turning back to Adora.

"Hey there." Adora sits back in her throne and lets out a soft sigh.

“What was that?” Adora asks.

"What was what?"

“ *You* ! Sitting in my *lap* !”

"Did you... not want me to sit in your lap?” Catra asks.

“I was kind of in the middle of something.” Adora says indignantly. Catra hums.

"So I heard, based off of the screaming when I opened the door to the bedroom."

“I was not *screaming* , I was *yelling* .”

"Yelling, screaming. Same thing." Catra waves it off dismissively. "For someone that's complaining about me sitting in your lap, you were pretty quick to put your hand on my ass." Adora smirks a little.

“Lucky we had company or my hands would’ve been somewhere else.” Catra laughs at Adora’s comment - she meant it when she said that Adora is about the most horny person in existence.

"Oh, I'm fully aware." Catra grins back, pressing herself up against Adora. "But I was serious when I said that I was hungry." Adora kisses Catra on her lips.

“Hungry... you don’t want anything *other* than food for your appetite?” Catra swears Adora is insatiable sometimes.

"Heh... maybe later, once I've eaten and have my stamina up." She boops Adora on her nose. "I'm still pretty fucking full from earlier, if you know what I mean." Catra grins, remembering their little session before this.

“Fine Kitten,” Adora says, her hands caressing Catra’s sides. “Why don’t you go ahead? I just have to sort a few things and then I’ll be right there.”

"Aww... fine." Catra pouts, whining softly. She wiggles off of Adora's lap, leaning down to give her one more kiss. "See you in the cafeteria?"

“Of course,” Adora says, sitting up to kiss Catra again. “I promise I won’t be long. Just paperwork I need to sign and to tell Scorpia a few things.”

"Don't take too long." Catra purrs as Adora pulls away. "See you in a few." Catra smiles, blowing a kiss at Adora and winking before heading out of the throne room.

Having come to the Fright Zone so many times now, Catra found it relatively easy to make her way around - though the hallways were usually empty when she and Adora were out and

about, since they were... distracted… during the day. Catra makes her way to the cafeteria, stopping before she heads inside to wait for Adora. She really hoped that the blonde wouldn't take too long to get there since she didn't like the idea of eating alone.

“Hey!” A Horde soldier pushes their way towards Catra. “You’re a Princess!” Catra looks up.

"Yes? I'm waiting for Adora. We were gonna have lunch together." Catra doesn’t like how aggressive this soldier is being. Most of the soldiers were used to Catra by now, but this soldier seemed… not happy with her being here.

“Adora?” They ask. “You mean *Lord* Adora?” They laugh. People around them were starting to take notice and a few people were glancing over at the loud voice. “Yeah right! You’re here to spy!” They grab Catra by her wrist in an attempt to detain her.

"Hey! Let me go!" Catra yells, tugging her wrist back. "You really think I would just stand in plain sight if I was trying to spy? How in Etheria does that make *any* type of sense?"

“Princesses are dangerous! You don’t belong here! You expect us to believe you’re with the Horde Lord? No way! You *have* to be spying!” They go to grab the stun baton at their waist while the other soldiers around them freeze, and grow silent at the scene in front of them.

"Wow, hold on!" Catra holds her hands up to show she wasn't trying to fight anyone. *Maybe it really had been a dumb idea to come here without Adora.* "I'm not here to fight anyone. Please put the baton away. Adora knows I'm here."

“Yeah right!” They lift their arm and are about to bring it down when their hand stops mid-motion in the air.

Standing beside them was Adora, her hand wrapped tightly around the soldier’s wrist. Her blue eyes, despite being blue like the sky, looked *fiery* and intense. She was standing completely still, her lips pressed into a tight line and slightly turned down at the edges in a deep frown. “What do you think you’re doing?” Adora asks. She seems calm but it’s a *scary* calm, a calm before the storm so to speak.

“Sir! I caught a Princess tying to-“

“What Princess is this?” Adora cuts them off and she *squeezes* her hand around their wrist tighter. Catra’s eyes widen.

“S-Sir...!” They gasp in pain and drop their baton in response.

“Answer my question, soldier!” Adora grits out, squeezing *harder* .

“C-Catra, sir! Princess Catra!”

“And what order did I give, *soldier* ?”

“Not to harm Catra under any circumstances!” They yelp, still completely trapped in Adora’s strong grip that was *crushing* their wrist. As sexy as Adora looked right now, Catra didn’t want anyone getting hurt over what was a misunderstanding.

"Adora! *Enough* !" Catra calls out, placing her hand over Adora's. "Let them go." She looks up at the blonde pleadingly. "They were just trying to keep the Fright Zone safe, okay? They thought I was spying or something." Adora ignores Catra.

“Under *any* circumstances.” She repeats. “You disobeyed my *direct* order, what punishment should I give you for that?” Adora asks rhetorically, her eyes were steely as she looked down at the whimpering soldier. Everyone around them was staring, silence had fallen over the entire mess hall.

“I’m sorry, my Lord. I won’t do it again, I swear!” They yell.

“You shouldn’t have done it in the *first* place!” Adora yells. She looks *furious* . Sometimes Catra forgets about this side to Adora, the side that is capable of such anger.

Catra bites her lip before her eyes widen as she thinks of what to do. She stands on the tip of her toes, grabbing Adora's face, and kisses her to get her to calm down. She understood why the soldier had done what they had, she didn't blame them for being suspicious. But Adora seemed ready to burn them to the ground, despite Catra's initial protest, and this was the fastest way that she could think of to get the blonde to calm down. She hoped it worked.

Adora’s attention on the horde soldier seems to instantly dissolve as Catra kisses her. She drops the soldier, who falls to the ground, and instead brings her hands up to Catra’s face. She lets out a small, low, happy noise to be kissing Catra and her hands gently cup Catra’s jaw, lifting her face so Catra could kiss her at a more comfortable angle.

Catra slowly pulls away after a few more seconds, looking into Adora's eyes. "Deep breath, baby." She whispers, leaning into Adora's touch. "I'm fine... they were just trying to keep the Fright Zone safe, okay? It's not like we gave anyone a warning that I would be here." Adora scowls.

“That doesn’t matter,” She looks at the soldier on the ground. “I have withstanding orders, *orders* that *shouldn’t* be disobeyed! It doesn’t matter that you were here, there are orders that you shouldn’t be harmed! Under *any* circumstances! So why,” Adora was visibly getting angry again. “ *oh why* , were *you* disobeying them?!” Adora yells. The soldier holds their hands up as they cower.

“I-I wasn’t going to hurt her my Lord-“

“What the *fuck* do you think a stun baton does?! Do I need to send you back to basic training?!” Catra presses her lips together, moving in front of the soldier to get Adora's attention. She looks her directly in her eyes.

"I'm *fine* . Adora, you've scared them enough, plus, you've probably sprained their wrist." She says firmly. "You came and stopped them before anything really happened. That's what matters." She says softly. "They won't do it again, right?" She turns around, kneeling beside the soldier and helping them up. "Is your wrist alright?"

“No...” They say, wincing when Catra applies pressure. Adora scoffs and looks around the mess hall at everyone who was staring.

“What are you all staring at?! Get back to eating or whatever!” The soldiers watching them quickly go back about their business. ”A sprained wrist is the least they deserve.” Adora says.

"You should probably get some ice or something cold on that. It helps with the swelling and lessens bruising." Catra smiles at them. "Think you can get those things by yourself?" She asks. She glances up at Adora, sighing softly. "I disagree with you on that considering I hardly have a bruise on me. I think the sprained wrist is punishment enough."

“Catra... they almost hit you with a *stun baton* . If I hadn’t been here, they *would* have.”

"You act as if I wouldn't have been able to dodge. And, like I told you earlier, they did it because they thought that I was spying. It's not everyday that a random Princess appears in the Fright Zone, Adora."

“That’s not the point!” Adora says angrily.

“C-Can I go, my Lord?”

“Apologise to Catra, then *maybe* you can go.”

"I'm sorry, Princess Catra." They say, looking small. Catra shakes her head and waves her hands in front of her, excusing them.

"Thank you, and don't worry. I know you were just trying to do what you thought was right. Make sure to get that wrist taken care of, okay?"

“I will...” They say, cradling their wrist to their chest. They look at Adora who stays silent, glaring at them in silent rage. Catra looks at Adora and sighs, frowning at her.

"Adora." She calls out, giving her a look and then glancing at the soldier and back at her. Adora sighs.

“Fine, don’t let it happen again. Understood?” The soldier nods quickly. “Dismissed.” The soldier quickly scurries away from their angry Horde Lord. Catra relaxes and smiles at Adora, hugging her and purring.

"Thank you for protecting me." She says, placing an appreciative kiss on her lips.

”I’m losing my authority.” Adora says. “People are disobeying my orders... what’s next? A coup?”

"You're not losing your authority, dummy. Relax." Catra reassures her. "The first one was an accident. It can happen to anyone. This one was because they were afraid, okay? You were raised being told Princesses are evil. Can you really blame them for panicking after seeing me? The only place they've ever really seen me before has been on the battlefield."

“People are thinking I’ve gone soft...” Adora says worriedly. Catra rolls her eyes. Adora has to be blind to not see that her soldiers respect her, that they find her… intimidating. Adora is an anxious person but it amazes Catra a little bit that she can go from ‘I’m going to kill you’ to anxious dork in the matter of seconds.

"I doubt that. You were literally ready to smack that soldier into the ground." Catra points out.

“Yeah, well, they’re lucky I didn’t *snap* their wrist.”

"Exactly. I doubt anyone thinks that you've gone soft, okay?" Catra reassures.

"Are you okay?" Adora asks, lifting her hands to Catra's face. Her blue eyes scan her body top to bottom for any signs of injury. Catra purrs softly, giving Adora a soft kiss on the cheek.

"I'm fine but thank you." She smiles. "Do you wanna go for a walk or back to your room? After we get food, I mean."

"I could use a walk," Adora says, straightening up to look around the mess hall. "Unless you have plans for me in the bedroom?"

"Hmm, depends. Did you have something in mind?"

"I have *a lot* of things in mind when it comes to you, like... so many." Adora says with a grin. "Turns out, contraband isn't just food but also sex books." Catra lets out a laugh, getting flustered.

"Food first and then you can show me what you had in mind, okay?" Catra asks.

"Okay, not really sure if you bend that way though." Adora says with a sly smirk as she extends her elbow for Catra to take. Catra raises an eyebrow, taking the offer and grinning.

"I am quite flexible though." Catra points out - it's a Magicat thing.

"Yes you are, and it's extremely... it's very *hot* ." Adora admits as she makes her way to the front of the line to retrieve food with Catra on her arm. Soldiers throw them glances but none of them would dare speak out against their Lord and they all quickly look away if they happen to meet Adora's icy gaze. After what just happened, Catra thinks it's safe to say that no more Horde soldiers will be bothering her any time soon. "Pretty sure you stretch in front of me sometimes just to tease me."

"Maybe I do... guess you'll never know." Catra says with a sly grin. She absolutely *does* stretch in front of Adora to tease her. One time, she bent over, reaching her hands flat to the floor and Adora was behind her in seconds - that had been an *amazing* session.

"That's an answer in itself." Adora points out, poking Catra in her side. Catra giggles.

"Uh huh..." Catra responds. Adora rolls her eyes and takes a couple of ration bars for them to eat, the cook bowing respectively behind the counter.

"Really wish I could tell you about that position, I think you'd like it, maybe you've heard of it? I think the book called it a... a mating press?" Catra's cheeks look as though they're on fire at that moment, she almost chokes on air. She bites her lip, eating her ration bar and looking away - she'd learnt to tolerate the bars.

"You... do know what that's typically used for, right?" Catra asks.

"Should I?" Adora asks curiously, taking a bite of her food. Catra can't believe Adora sometimes.

"... Did you actually read the book or did you just see the drawing?" Catra asks, raising a brow. Adora is exactly the person who looks at pictures instead of reading the accompanying words.

"Uh... Ha..." Adora clears her throat. "I mean... I read a little but... mostly I just looked at the pictures because there were *so many* words." Catra really nailed that one on the head. She laughs a little. Maybe she knows Adora too well.

"Adora, you dork." Catra flicks her with her tail playfully.

"Are you going to tell me what it's typically used for or are you just going to call me names?" Adora asks. Catra blushes, ears pressed against her head as she looks away from Adora.

"It's... usually used by couples... wanting a baby..." Catra explains.

"Oh..." Adora clears her throat. "I mean, I did consider... I mean... you know... She-Ra and the thing I do... with my sword... I thought that could be... hot..."

"You... you really... I'm surprised... kind of." Catra shakes her head.

"You're surprised?" Adora asks, raising an eyebrow at Catra "By what? My charm? My raw sexual attractiveness?" *She is literally the biggest fucking dork.* Catra was seriously considering asking if Adora's parents were golden retrievers.

"I'm surprised by the fact that you're into that." Catra clarifies.

"Really? You're surprised? I thought that'd be pretty obvious."

"I'm surprised that you even know about it." Catra mumbles.

"I told you, I read it in a book," Adora shoves Catra playfully - Catra must have been distracted by the fact that Adora asked her to do a *mating press* . "Guess the question is, are *you* into it?" Catra really was not expecting this question today. She thinks about it. About Adora being She-Ra? Doing that thing she does with her sword where it cums inside of her? *Oh yeah,* Catra is *into* that.

"I'm not opposed to it..."

"Oh really?" Adora smirks knowingly - *cocky bastard* .

"Maybe."

"Your blush from before told me *everything* I need to know, Kitten."

"Oh, stop being so cocky, you asshole." She shoves Adora fondly. Adora laughs and snorts in response.

"I know you're thinking about it Catra," Adora teases.

"And what am I thinking, Adora?" Catra asks.

"You're thinking about me, strap deep, your legs hooked around my thighs as I drive into you until I cum inside of you." Catra almost chokes at those words, her eyes wide.

"I- *well shit* ." Catra breathes out, processing everything Adora had just said.

"Anyway, you want to go on that walk?" Adora asks with a shit-eating grin.

"You're an asshole." Catra rolls her eyes, throwing away her food container. "Where did you have in mind?"

"I actually..." Adora trails off. "I have somewhere in mind..."

"You do? And where is that?" Catra asks curiously.

"If you'll follow me?" Catra smiles at her lover, grabbing her hand and lacing their fingers together.

"Of course..." Adora smiles as she finishes up her ration bar. She drags Catra through the halls of the Fright Zone, the two of them giggling about *something* . It was busier than usual, since it was midday, but the soldiers milling around didn't pay them too much mind.

Adora leads Catra to a tall tower and gestures to it. "It's kind of a hard climb... think you're up for it Princess?"

"You really think I can't make it up there? Race you to the top!" Catra calls out, jumping up and beginning to climb. Adora's eyes widen.

"Hey! Wait! No fair! Your Magicat genes give you an unfair advantage!" Adora yells as she begins climbing after Catra.

"You're the one that was saying it was a hard climb!" Catra yells back, laughing as she makes it to the top first. Adora grumbles as she pulls herself up to the top. She looks at Catra and sticks her tongue out.

"You cheated."

"No, I didn't." Catra grins, wrapping her arms around Adora and hugging her close. "You started it." Adora rolls her eyes playfully and then takes Catra's hand, dragging her towards the edge of the ledge of the tower.

"Ta-da," Adora gestures with her free hand. "The Fright Zone. I used to come up here when I was a cadet."

"Wow..." Catra had never known that the Fright Zone was that big. It always seemed much more bunched up when she was on the other side. "This is where you used to come when you were younger?"

"Sure did," Adora grins. "Whenever I needed a break from Shadow Weaver's overbearing nature. I used to wonder what was out there... That's how I found my sword."

"Oh... and you wanted to show this to me?" Catra asks, her eyes soft as she looks up at Adora.

"Yeah," Adora shrugs a little. "I think the Fright Zone is pretty, in its own way... you know?"

"Yeah... I can see what you mean..." Catra looks out at the Fright Zone. It could be pretty, it had a certain charm.

"Are you talking about me?" Adora teases, poking Catra. "Am I pretty in my own way, Catra?" Catra smiles softly, her eyes genuinely filled with an emotion neither of them could really express.

"You're beautiful in your own way, yes..." Catra whispers.

"Yeah? Well you're just plain beautiful."

"You really mean that, Adora?"

"Yes..." Adora says quietly. She turns to Catra and leans down to kiss her, softly cupping her jaw with her hand. "You're the most beautiful person I've ever seen."

"Adora..." Catra whispers, her eyes fluttering shut as she stands on her tiptoes to meet Adora's lips. "Dork... that was really sweet of you to say that and to show me this... thank you."

"You're welcome." Adora whispers. "Although, I could make it dirty if you prefer?" Adora asks with a cheeky grin and a wink.

"Nah... I think we can just enjoy the view this time..." Catra whispers, stepping a little closer to Adora and resting her head on her chest, watching the rest of the Fright Zone.

"Yeah... I guess we can." Adora leads Catra to the edge as she sits down, hanging her feet over the ledge. "At least up here we're above the smog."

"Yeah... it really is different when the smog isn't covering it all up." Catra hums, sitting down beside Adora and snuggling into her. She thinks about a little Adora sitting up here on this ledge and it brings a smile to her lips. Catra is willing to bet that Adora was a cute kid.

"Can you imagine if we had grown up here together?" Adora asks curiously. "How different things could be?"

"How do you imagine things would have gone down?" Catra asks, looking at the blonde.

"If you were in the Horde?" Adora pauses for a moment. She looks as though she's considering her answer. "I'm glad you weren't." Adora says, biting the inside of her cheek. "The Fright Zone is my home but... growing up here was *hard* . And I'd never want you to have to... go through whatever torture Shadow Weaver could think up."

"I wish we could have grown up together somewhere safe." Catra whispers, yearning evident in her voice. "I wish this war didn't exist... where we could all be happy..." Adora doesn't say anything, she just looks out over the Fright Zone. Catra gets the impression that Adora doesn't really know what to say to that - she's kind of the reason there *is* a war.

Catra sighs quietly, closing her eyes and just taking in the moment. She purrs as she wraps her tail around Adora's ankle, nosing her neck, scenting her unconsciously. "Thank you... for bringing me up here. For showing me something that was... was yours."

"I guess it's *ours* now." Adora says, leaning against Catra more.

"Yeah... ours." Catra smiles sweetly, turning and kissing Adora's cheek. She grabs the blonde's hand, lacing their fingers together affectionately. Adora smiles and kisses Catra's hand. She leans her chin on her shoulder, giving her a soft smile.

"Why don't you tell me something you've never told anyone before?"

"Something I've never told before to anyone?" Catra hums. "Sometimes I'm afraid that I'll never find someone who will love me for *me,* and instead just wants to be with me for the status and the power they get."

"Yeah?" Adora asks softly. "Maybe I'm biased but you're too good for... pretty much all those suitors you meet."

"I think you would be considered biased, Adora." Catra laughs, nudging the blonde with her shoulder. "You've been having relations with me for months now." Although, Catra does find what she said kind of endearing.

"Ooo, *relations* , fancy way of saying fuck buddies Catra."

"Fine, fuck buddies. You happy?" Catra asks. She huffs a little, reminded of who they *really* are to each other.

"I'm sure you'll find someone who loves you for you." Adora says softly.

"With how many people I've met up with to see if we'd click... I doubt it." Catra bites her lip, trying to not think about how she feels like she *maybe* clicks with *Adora* .

"At least you're not doomed to be alone forever." Adora comments. Catra frowns.

"I'm sure you'll find someone too." Catra says. Adora laughs and nudges Catra's shoulder affectionately.

"Extremely unlikely," She says. "Who wants to be with the Horde Lord?" *I do.*

"Maybe if you show your softer side a lot of people would. You're... pretty amazing, Adora." Catra says, meaning it completely.

"I've never wanted anything more," Adora says, lying back. "I've never felt... whatever... with anyone before. I've never slept with anyone more than once... other than you. Marriage and true love, that's for Princesses." Catra frowns a little at that.

"Not really." Catra lays back with Adora, resting her head on top of her chest. "Marriage and true love is for anyone... even you, Adora."

"Not likely." Adora says. "I don't know if I'm capable of love and I... I doubt anyone could love me."

"I'm sure you are and I'm sure someone will." Catra assures her, closing her eyes and purring softly. "Don't give up hope." Adora pauses for a moment and Catra rubs her cheek against her chest. Adora is… Catra just *knows* that she can love and be loved.

"What about you anyway? This person you're waiting to click with? What's your type? You know, aside from tall, blonde and buff ladies?" Catra rolls her eyes. Now that Adora mentioned it… she did have a thing for Adora. She didn't really think she had a 'type' but there must be a reason she couldn't resist the Horde Lord beyond her initial reasoning of using Adora's attraction towards her to her advantage. Maybe Catra did have a type…

"I... I've never thought about it. I don't care what she looks like... I just want to know that I can love her and that she loves me..." Adora hums.

"Sounds like a very Princess thing to say."

"Maybe it is, but it's what I hope to have one day." Catra replies. She doesn't really understand why Adora seems to believe that these things are exclusive to the Princesses, they're not, but she doesn't want to push her.

"I hope you get to have it too." Adora says, genuinely.

"Thank you." Catra looks up at Adora. She keeps feeling like maybe, *just maybe* , she may have already found that person. But that is a terrifying thought and one she is not willing to confront currently.

"... We should totally have sex up here sometime." *Leave it to Adora to sufficiently change the subject and break a moment.*

"Maybe one day, but not right now." Catra snorts. "I don't know how stable this is and I don't feel like falling with you strap deep in me." Adora laughs and kisses Catra on the cheek.

"Can I make out with you instead?"

"You know what... yeah, let's do it." Catra responds. She giggles as Adora grins and rolls over so Catra was on the ground with Adora above her where she could kiss Catra properly. Catra has a problem, and her problem is that she *really likes* kissing Adora.

Catra giggles against Adora's lips, sliding her fingers into the blonde's hair and pulling her close. "I really do like it when you kiss me..."

"You read my mind," Adora says, grinning between kisses. "I really like kissing you too."

"Mm... I can see that very clearly." Truth be told, Adora has been that way since day one. She's somewhat of a kiss and cuddle monster, but so is Catra.

"Catra..." Adora trails off, seemingly not sure what it was that she wanted to say, before she starts kissing Catra again. "You're so unbelievably beautiful..." Adora mumbles as she moves her lips to Catra's jaw and presses several hot kisses to the bone. "No offence but... I really hope you don't find a suitor soon, because that would mean we'd have to end this..."

"You really don't want to end this, do you?" Catra bites her lip, taking a sharp breath in. "I doubt I'll find someone at this rate." She isn't sure she *wants* to if she's honest.

"Do *you* want to end it?" Adora asks.

"... No, not right now." Adora looks at Catra for a long moment. Catra wonders what it is that she needs to find that she considers it 'clicking' - she wonders if that's Adora not for the first time. As soon as she thinks it, she dismisses the thought.

"Good... because I don't want this to end either. Not yet." *Not ever.* Catra keeps having dangerous thoughts when it comes to the Horde Lord.

"Not yet..." Catra confirms. They stay up there chatting, making out, laughing until the moon sets.

* * *

Catra laughs at the joke that Adora just said, her eyes closing from how widely she was smiling. "Did you really just say that?" She asks, hand covering her mouth to keep herself from laughing too loudly.

"What?" Adora grins at Catra. Catra knows that Adora likes making her laugh, she gets this look in her eyes that says it all. "I didn't know ration bars were that flammable... we put those in our *bodies* ."

"I'm not surprised they're that flammable. Those things are dense. I still wonder what exactly they're made of that they can burn for that long." Catra responds fondly.

"I'd ask but I'm kind of afraid." Adora admits. "You'd be happy to know we're introducing more... foods... to the Fright Zone menu." Catra grins at the news.

"You are? What have you added to the menu?"

"Well," Adora squints. "I don't really know, contraband isn't being restricted anymore and the cooks have taken to adding things to the menu." Adora explains. "You know I don't usually venture out of my throne room, but Scorpia brings me food."

"Yeah?" Catra smiles. "Maybe next time I go I can help the cooks figure out what flavors work best together." She suggests, purring softly. "Gotta make sure my Lord is well fed after all."

"Oh, you *definitely* make sure I'm well fed." Adora winks playfully - *what an idiot* .

"I cannot believe you just made that joke, you giant dork." Catra laughs, rolling her eyes fondly.

"I am *not* a dork." Adora protests but it's only halfheartedly. "I actually..." Adora starts talking about something. Catra's ear twitches as she swears she hears some kind of movement but when she looks up, nothing is different. "Kyle actually stood up for himself to a Force Captain the other day, I was impressed... he looked like he was going to faint though, which was funny." Catra's eyes return back to the screen of her com-pad.

"Really? Kyle stood up for himself against a Force Captain?" Catra was surprised to hear that. "That's actually pretty amazing. I'm proud of him for doing that. Even if he did look as though he was about to faint. Try to be a little nicer to him, he's really smart if you let him talk. He's not made for the battlefield, *at all* , but he likes taking care of the people he cares for. Even I can see that."

"You're being nice about *Kyle* ... wow... you really have been spending too much time here." Adora jokes lightly.

"You act as if you don't like my being there." Catra teases.

"Obviously I like you being here, I wish you were here now. We *have* been spending more time together..." Adora trails off for a moment. "It's nice." Catra softens. That makes her feel warm, that Adora likes spending time with her? Her tail starts swishing happily behind her and her ears perk up happily.

"I know... it's nice being with you too..." She whispers, giving Adora a sweet smile. "Soon though. Make sure to not be too mean to the others, okay?"

"I'm not mean, I'm very nice."

"Adora, you can get a little grumpy towards others sometimes." Catra corrects gently. "Both of us know that."

"Other people that aren't *you* , I suppose." Catra laughs and smiles.

"True... all you like to do is kiss me... and maybe plant face first into my chest."

"Kissing you, cuddling you, definitely having my face in your chest, having se-"

"Catra," Catra jumps, sitting up and letting out a panicked noise as she slams her com-pad down onto the bed.

"Who- Oh. Hi Netossa, hi Spinnerella. What's up?" They glance at the com-pad but don't comment on it.

"You're needed in the War Room, we thought we'd come get you."

"Right. I'll be there in just a moment. Thank you for letting me know." Catra nods at them and smiles.

"Uh huh..." Netossa says, narrowing her eyes a little. "Say bye to your... *friend* ..." Catra's cheeks flush and she nods, picking up the com-pad, looking mildly embarrassed.

"Hey, I have to go, okay? Talk to you later, dork."

"Fine, fine," Adora says. "You okay there Catra? You look a little flushed." She teases.

"Not the time, Adorka. Talk to you later." Catra subtly blows a kiss to the blonde before hanging up the call and putting her com-pad down. "Okay, ready to go.'

"... Just sex you say?" Netossa asks.

"... Yes."

"Adora seemed different talking to you." Spinnerella says.

"Did she?" Catra asks as she grabs her notepad where she had written out her battle plans. "She didn't seem different to me."

"Well she seemed less Horde Lord like..." Netossa admits. "Less like she wants to conquer Etheria, and talking about... normal things."

"Hmm... yeah, she's like that when we talk." Because Catra does *not* want to talk to Adora about her plans for Etheria, they never talk about that stuff.

"It's... weird to hear." Netossa says. "She almost sounds like a person."

"She *is* a person, ‘Tossa. Just... misled." Catra frowns a little. She forgets sometimes that not everyone knows the side of Adora that Catra knows. Adora is… she has a depth to her that not a lot of people get to see, even Horde soldiers. Only those closest to her truly know the real Adora.

"That remains to be seen." Netossa comments.

"If that's what you believe." Catra sighs, laughing softly. "You said we had a meeting?"

"In the War Room, you're lucky Glimmer didn't come teleporting in here."

"Yeah... that would have been catastrophic." Catra winces a little at the mere thought. Although Catra's reflexes were like no other, she’d likely be able to hide her com-pad before Glimmer saw. She imagines either Adora didn’t notice that Netossa and Spinnerella clearly knew about them, or she’d assumed that they had just presumed Catra really was talking to a friend and not *Lord* Adora.

"Hearing you talk to the Horde Lord like you're *fond* of her? Yes it would have."

"Yeah..."

"Are you planning on visiting Adora soon?" Netossa asks. "We can only cover for you so much. Your moms will get suspicious of why you keep coming to stay with us when you're really with Lord Adora."

"Not too soon... I have to figure out when it’s best. But I'll let you know, okay?"

"Very well," Netossa says. "Let's get this meeting over with."

"Let's go." Catra says in agreement, following the pair to the War Room.

* * *

Catra shouldn't be letting the Horde Lord do what she's doing right now. There's a lot of things Catra probably shouldn't have let Adora do, but tie up her hands and restrain her is probably one of the biggest. Catra was watching Adora, who was currently talking to a Horde soldier, as though Catra wasn't tied up and sitting on her throne - at least she was clothed. Adora... sometimes Adora is a gentle lover, and then there are times she likes to be in control. In fact, she likes to be in control most of the time but *especially* sometimes she likes Catra's complete submission. Catra tugs on her restraints and sighs. Her arms were above her head and attached to the top of the throne and they were starting to ache. She was just waiting for her lover to *finally* touch her.

The Horde soldier salutes and leaves and then Adora turns to Catra. She has that *look* , the look she always gets whenever she's in *dom mode* - it already has Catra's pussy dripping. When Adora is in reach, Catra wraps her legs around her waist and pulls her in. "Adora will you... fucking... *touch* me. *Now* ." Catra begs and the fact she's already begging, when Adora hasn't even done anything yet, says a lot. Adora smirks and Catra wants to groan.

"Such a needy kitten," Adora murmurs as she presses her lips to Catra's jaw. Catra sighs. Having Adora close to her in any capacity was calming and nice. She nuzzles her neck, rubbing her scent all over her. "I think you need to be punished." Adora whispers. Catra's breath gets stuck in her throat. She licks her lips as she pulls away to look at Adora.

"Oh yeah?" Catra asks, raising an eyebrow. "What punishment do you have in mind, my Lord?" Catra didn't really think she'd be into this kind of thing, she never really enjoyed inflicting pain onto others, or herself for that matter, but there's just... something about Adora. Something about her awakens something within Catra, a darker part of herself. She *likes* being under her control, she *likes* taking her punishments, it turns her on to almost painful extremes whenever Adora gets that look in her eyes and her voice takes *that* tone. Their sex recently has been... different... so sometimes Catra finds comfort in their ability to go back to *this* kind of sex.

Catra is also aware that these kinds of activities require immeasurable trust in each other. Catra *trusts* Adora to look after her when they finish, she trusts her not to hurt her outside of this space, she trusts her not to want to hurt her to extreme lengths and she trusts her to listen whenever Catra says their safe word. Catra maybe shouldn't be placing so much trust in the *Horde Lord* but she does. She trusts Adora and she enjoys it just as much as Adora does. So she is *more than happy* to engage in a little play with the blonde.

Catra realises that Adora hasn't said anything and she looks up at her curiously. "... I want to hit you." Adora says and Catra gasps. Something about the way Adora says it like that... Catra jogs her hips a couple of times, trying to grind against Adora for some relief, but she's rewarded with Adora grabbing her hips and pinning her to the throne with a growl - that really only turned Catra on more.

"Hit me Adora, sir, *punish* me." Catra whispers to Adora, whose face was currently inches from her own. To Catra's surprise, Adora's face softens a little - breaking character.

"Are you sure Kitten?" Adora asks and she's serious, no heat behind her words just genuine concern and worry for Catra's consent. Catra smiles and she wishes her hands were not currently tied up so she could wrap that dork in a hug.

"I'm sure Adora," Catra responds, leaning forward to kiss the blonde on the nose. "I want it, okay? I have my safe word and, if you ask, we can navigate it just fine." Catra has a lot of theories about why Adora is in to this kind of thing, but she's not about to therapist her m-her... fuck buddy? Somehow that doesn't seem fitting for what Adora actually is to her.

"What were you planning?" Catra asks, focusing her attention back onto the situation at hand. Adora stands back up and then she moves her cape to one side. Usually, Adora's sword was at her waist at all times but this time it was a flogger. Catra's eyes widen and she looks up at Adora's face which was a little flushed. She looked adorable in spite of what she was proposing.

So when Adora said she wanted to hit Catra, she wanted to *hit* her.

"I... I didn't even know the Fright Zone had those... are there sex clubs here that I don't know about?" Catra jokes a little. Adora does that half smile she so often does, the cute one, and then she pulls the flogger from her belt.

"Well, no, no sex clubs, but people *do* have sex here." Adora says. "And... a lot of Horde soldiers are..."

"Sadists and masochists?" Catra asks. Adora laughs a little.

"Yeah." She says with a half shrug. "But a lot of people who aren't Horde soldiers also enjoy that." Catra was one of those people if she was being honest with herself.

"Uh-huh." Catra says, tugging on her restraints. "So the enjoying me being tied up thing... what's that about?"

"Oh, you know, I like having you tied up..." Adora says and as she says it she strokes her fingers along the strands of the flogger. Catra's eyes track the movement - *did she do that purposely?*

"Yeah? And do you like having me tied up in front of an audience?" Catra questions, referring to the horde soldier who had seen Catra's position on the throne. Adora smirks.

"Maybe I do." She responds. Catra swallows thickly as she watches those long *slender* fingers trail along the leather strands. *Fuck* . Catra notices something… Adora… *Adora turned her sword into a flogger for this?! Of course she did.*

"Adora... will you *please* fuck me already." Catra demands, no question. Adora laughs and places the flogger back at her waist.

"Okay, but first, I need to get you out of those clothes." Adora comes back to Catra and then, because she must be feeling especially bold, she just *rips* Catra's clothes, *literally* , off of her. Catra's eyes widen. Sometimes she forgets how *strong* Adora is. She's also an idiot. She's glad that she started stashing clothes in the Fright Zone for when Adora was feeling especially... cocky - it's lucky she did, otherwise she'd have to venture back in Adora's clothes yet again. Catra does find Adora's manhandling a little hot if she's honest; Adora's strength is one of her biggest turn-ons.

"I need your ass up and turned around." Adora states and Catra feels wetness coating the inside of her thighs.

"Adora, I'm-" Adora grabs her and Catra's words die in her throat.

" *Sir* ." Adora corrects and Catra swallows. She takes a moment before she reformulates her words.

"Sir… I'm tied up, how will you do that?" Catra asks.

"Easy." Adora turns Catra around, a little roughly, pushing her *up* the throne. Catra uses her restraints to keep herself upright and balanced, tightening her hands around the rope while Adora positioned her ass in the appropriate way.

"I have a rule Kitten," Adora says and her voice has that *sexy* lilt to it. "You're not allowed to cum until I say, understood? No matter how close you are, you're not allowed to cum without my *permission* , is that clear?" Catra whimpers at that. Usually Adora pushes her to multiple orgasms without even trying and now she won't let Catra cum without her permission? Catra tightens her hands around the rope. She could do that... *right?*

"Yes sir." Catra agrees and Adora... Catra's ears twitch as she hears Adora get closer. She feels something rub against her pussy and Catra gasps. *Was that...?* Catra looks over her shoulder to see Adora rubbing the hilt of the flogger against Catra's pussy, her blue eyes *shining* with amazement.

"You’re already so fucking *wet* for me Kitten," Adora says in amazement, she positions the strap of the flogger to Catra's entrance and teases her. Catra's hips move automatically and she begins to fuck herself against it.

"Adora..." She pants. Adora moves her free hand to rub at Catra's clit.

"Such a good Kitten," Adora coos. "Aren't you Catra? Who do you belong to?"

" *You* !" Catra gasps, her stomach feels fluttery already. *What is it about Adora that gets Catra like this?* " *Fuck* , I belong to you my Lord."

"Yes you do, you're all *mine* ." Adora says possessively as she fucks Catra shallowly.

"Adora, *please* , I-" Catra's words get cut off by Adora's sudden withdrawal. She *literally* whimpers aloud at being denied that pleasure anymore.

She opens her eyes to see Adora grinning at her, the handle of the flogger is covered in wet slick and Adora licks it clean as well as her fingers. "You don't have my permission yet Kitten." Adora says. Catra wants to scream in frustration but she concedes to Adora.

"Yes sir," She says - although the lack of *anything* filling her up right now is disappointing. "I'll be a good kitten for my Lord." Catra promises. "I'll take your punishment." Adora nods and, gently, she raises her hand to pet softly at the base of Catra's ears. Catra purrs loudly at the action, Adora's affection is *always* appreciated in situations like these.

"Okay, I'm going to start hitting you now Kitten, if you want me stop, say red and I will stop *immediately* ." Adora stresses and Catra nods. She trusts Adora with this and she has *never* trusted anyone with this kind of thing before. "Use your words Kitten." Adora says, her fingers tangling their way nicely into Catra's hair. She purrs louder, arching into the soft petting.

"Yes my Lord, I understand." Catra responds. Adora pulls her hand away and Catra misses the attention almost immediately. That thought completely escapes her, however, when she feels Adora massaging her ass.

"Your ass is so nice." Adora comments and then she places two slaps to it in succession. Catra jolts at the sudden sensation and lets out an embarrassingly loud moan. She's practically dripping at this rate, Catra's half worried she'll get off on zero touch or penetration, just Adora hitting her and talking dirty to her.

"Yeah?" Catra asks after regaining her breath. "Are you going to use that thing or just play with it?" Catra asks, moving her ass up and raising her eyebrows at Adora over her shoulder. Adora laughs and then steps back. She starts giving a few swipes through the air and Catra's breath catches. If Adora doesn't start hitting her *soon,* she might just combust.

"Good kittens take their punishments without the sarcastic comments." Adora notes and Catra rolls her eyes. Catra may be on the bottom but she's by no means an easy submission. She likes to make Adora work for it a bit.

"Yeah? Well good *Lords* actually punish their kittens instead of getting off on the build up and not doing anything." Catra bites back. Adora pauses mid-swing and looks at Catra with a frown.

"Are you talking back to me?" Adora asks. Catra gulps. There is something about Adora that changes during these sessions, and it is *always* a turn on.

"Maybe I am? What are you going to do about it?" Catra challenges. Adora lets out a breath of amusement and then she *finally* starts taking up her position.

She starts gently, which Catra appreciates, the flogger was designed to inflict pain but it was probably the least painful toy Adora could have chosen. It still stings like a bitch and Catra feels every strand of it hit her ass. Adora starts slow and gentle and builds her strikes up. Catra was already on the edge and with each stroke she was only getting closer, her legs were *covered* in wetness.

Adora pauses between strikes to allow Catra time to recover and then she stops for a moment. "You ready for a rapid fire here, Kitten?" Adora asks and Catra moans.

"Mmm... yeah... give it to me sir, I can take it." Catra says while lowering her front down, pressing her cheek into the back of the throne and her ass even more into the air. There's a moment of nothing and then Catra *feels* it.

CRACK. CRACK. CRACK. CRACK.

Catra lets out a loud moan of pleasure and pain at the strikes. Her hands grip the rope to support herself and keep her upright. She breathes for a moment. "Y-Yellow." Catra gasps, trying to regain her breath. Adora stops and comes up behind her, pressing her palms to Catra's ass, she gently starts massaging.

"You're doing so good Kitten, so good, just a few more and then I'll relieve you, I promise." Catra mewls at Adora's soft words and massaging. Her ears press against her head briefly. She wants Adora in her *now* . But she said she'd take her punishment and she'll take it dammit.

Catra can smell her arousal in the air, the throne below her must be *soaking,* but she can also smell it on Adora - she's enjoying this and Catra is enjoying being hit by her too. "Yes sir..." Catra pants, positioning herself back again. "Green, keep going, punish me, sir." Adora's breath stutters.

She moves away again and begins her warm up routine - though it's much shorter now since Catra was already pretty *fantastically* warmed up. *God, when is she going to make me cum, I can't take it.* Catra was feeling *so much,* all at once, she was almost *painfully* turned on.

Adora doesn't hold back anymore, she *hits* Catra hard and it feels *incredible* . Catra's pretty sure she won't be able to sit properly for about a week after this. Catra wants to take *all* of Adora's punishment, she surrenders completely to her, vanishing into that floaty equilibrium of subspace. She is Adora’s and Adora is her mate, and she wants to take whatever Adora will give her.

Adora finishes with one final strike across both of Catra's asscheeks and then she comes up behind Catra and gently massages her ass again. It takes Catra a moment to realise Adora is speaking to her that entire time. "Such a good Kitten, you did so well, come back to me." Catra lets out a purr and Adora slowly turns her around again.

Catra hisses as her ass hits the throne but she sighs once the stinging becomes a pleasant ache. "Thank you sir," Catra says dreamily. She looks down to see the throne absolutely coated in her slick. Adora moves the flogger and trails it up from Catra's pussy, up over her stomach and then to her breasts.

Fuck, that shouldn't be that hot .

"Can I..." Adora trails off momentarily. "I'll be gentle, but, can I hit your breasts and your pussy?" Catra gasps and looks at Adora with wide eyes. Adora seems to know what she's doing, and that really does sound like a turn on... *fuck it,* Catra will always try something at least once.

"If you're careful, then yes." Catra gives her permission. Adora grins. She does as she said she would and she is gentle, the strands barely even touch Catra but the sensation is still pleasant - especially against her pussy. She moans Adora's name and she can see just how turned on Adora is.

Once Adora is satisfied, she discards the flogger to the ground and she leans over the throne, using one of her hands to brace herself. Catra was about to ask her what she was doing when she sees her shove her free hand down her pants. Catra's eyes widen and she tugs on her restraints. She wants to do that *for* Adora.

Adora smirks down at Catra as she clearly teases her clit. Catra's eyes are locked on Adora's fingers that are currently in her pants. "I'm going to fuck myself before I fuck you." Adora states and Catra thinks that's a tiny bit cruel. At this rate, as soon as Adora inserts a single finger inside of her, Catra is going to instantly topple over the edge.

Catra watches Adora's hand in a trance, she knows exactly how *good* Adora is with her fingers and how *well* she must be fucking herself right now below the fabric of those pants. Catra decides to claw back some power and she smirks, pushing up so she can whisper hot words into Adora's ear. "Who's a good girl Adora?" Catra praises in a purr and Adora *whimpers* . Catra decides to turn what Adora had said to her before onto her. "Do you do this while you're alone?" Catra asks. "I bet you do... you touch yourself while thinking about me, don't you? Just like I touch myself thinking about you."

" *Catra* !" Adora's hand moves faster and her breaths are becoming uneven. The punishment session had clearly already pushed her close to the edge, she just needed that *little* bit more.

Truthfully, Catra doesn't know if she should confess this to Adora, she'd been kind of ashamed to touch herself thinking about the Horde Lord, but now? Now... she doesn't touch herself to the thought of the Horde Lord, she touches herself to the thought of *Adora* .

Catra purrs again and nuzzles her cheek against Adora. *Mine* . She's scenting Adora unconsciously, staking a claim to her that not even Adora would know exists but other Magicats, and those with better noses than Etherians, would know. Adora *belongs* to Catra. *My mate.* The thought makes Catra feel *warm* even if she shouldn't think it. Adora isn't her mate... *is she? No.* She can't be... *Can she?*

Catra's crisis disappears when she hears Adora let out a series of moans and gasps of Catra's name. "I'm so close, fuck..." Adora kisses Catra hotly and Catra feels her tense. The blonde's lips fall open in a silent moan and Catra takes that opportunity to stick her tongue into Adora's mouth. Adora's hand stills and she moans softly into Catra's mouth. Catra can tell the orgasm that crashed over her was strong by the way she leans all of her weight against the throne and her rapid breathing.

Adora pulls back from the kiss and she presses her nose to the side of Catra's face. Catra purrs happily, rubbing her cheek against Adora's face in a gentle nuzzle. "... You're amazing." Adora murmurs and Catra smiles. Catra doesn't know why she believes Adora when she compliments her like that, there's plenty of times she hasn't believed that, but she believes Adora.

"Yeah?" Catra asks, kissing Adora on her jaw, close to her ear. "Feel like touching *me,* my Lord?" Catra questions playfully. Adora leans back, pushing herself upright. She pulls her fingers from her pants and brings them to Catra's mouth. Catra happily takes Adora's fingers into her mouth, keeping her gaze heatedly on Adora the whole time. Adora tastes *amazing* . Catra's not really sure how to explain it, if she's honest, but she tastes *good* she can say that much.

"Hm... I think you deserve a reward, isn't that right Kitten?" Adora asks. Catra nods eagerly. Adora pulls her fingers out of Catra's mouth and reaches up and unclips Catra's hands from the top of the throne. She gently runs her hands along them to wake them up after being stuck in such a position for so long. Catra smiles at the action and then Adora lifts her up and sits down in the (wet) throne with Catra on her lap. Catra's hands were still bound together but at least they were no longer suspended.

Adora shuffles Catra forward a second and does... *something,* that Catra can't see, behind her. Once she's done doing whatever it was that she was doing, she pulls Catra back. "Brace your feet on my armrests Kitten." Adora whispers. Catra nods and does as Adora instructs, bending her legs and spreading them apart, using the armrests of the throne to keep them spread apart. Adora brings her fingers around the front and Catra's eyes see that they're wet. *Did... did Adora just gather more of her own wetness and coat her fingers in it? Fuck... that is... that's* ***so*** *fucking* ***hot*** . Adora works her fingers into Catra and she sighs happily at finally - *finally* - being touched.

Adora's breath is hot against the back of her neck and Catra clenches around her fingers at the thought of Adora's slick being *inside* of her. She's already painfully on the edge, worked up by Adora, Catra knows she probably won't last long. "No cumming without my permission Kitten." Adora reminds and Catra chokes on a moan.

Adora fucks her. *Hard* . Her long slender fingers are *wonderful* and every thrust and curl hits Catra like a ton of bricks. Adora can easily reach her g-spot with those fingers of hers, and she does it *every* single time, scratching that spot *perfectly* that has Catra seeing stars.

"Touch yourself." Adora orders. Catra has a feeling Adora would do that if she didn't have her other hand wrapped around Catra's thigh to keep her legs spread open. Catra does as Adora tells her to do, taking her bound hands down to her pussy and stimulating her clit. Catra lets out a high pitched mewl as she feels herself getting closer. Adora is driving *three* fingers into her, stimulating her *perfectly* .

"Fuck... *Adora* !" Catra cries out. "Please, let me cum, sir, *please* ." She begs and Adora goes faster, *harder* .

"Not yet Kitten, hold it, but *don't* stop touching yourself." Adora is insane if she thinks Catra will be able to do that - especially when Adora isn't slowing her thrusts. Catra determines herself to *trying* her best to hold back. She feels... almost like she needs to pee... which is weird... Catra has never felt that way during sex before.

"Adora, please, I can't." Adora pauses her thrusts for one second.

"Okay, cum for me Kitten." Adora whispers and then she *curls* her fingers, scratching that spot *just right* . Catra crashes over the edge all at once. She has *never* felt so completely

wiped out by a climax before, but this shoots through her like she's been struck by lightning. It feels... different than usual, more intense... wetter...

Once Catra has calmed down a touch, she blinks her eyes open to see Adora's fingers still buried inside of her and the throne (and Adora's thighs) completely covered in... *Holy shit... did she just-*

"Did you just...?" Adora trails off and Catra feels her cheeks redden. She has never done that before. She just fucking *squirted* all over Adora and the seat of her throne.

"I..." Catra doesn't know what to say. Adora pulls her coated hand from Catra's pussy. There's a silence before Adora speaks again.

"That was... so fucking *hot* ." Catra snorts and leans back against Adora's chest. She was completely exhausted now.

"I'm glad you think so," And she is. Catra was a little embarrassed by that development, but if Adora enjoyed it... "Can you untie my hands please?" Catra asks. Adora reaches around and undoes the restraints on Catra's wrists and Catra sighs in relief. "I'm exhausted..." Catra admits. "I don't think I can go again." Adora laughs a little behind her.

"I wasn't going to ask you to." She replies. "Now I take care of you." Catra adjusts herself so she was across Adora's lap rather than resting her back against her front so she could *see* her.

"Fuck... you really made me squirt." Catra comments.

"Yeah... you really made a *mess,* Kitten."

"Shut up." Catra says and Adora smiles. The blonde begins kissing Catra on her jaw, her hands gently kneading her and Catra feels a purr bubble in her throat.

"You want to take this to the bedroom?" Adora asks.

"If you mean to sleep, then fuck yeah." Adora chuckles and stands, carrying Catra bridal style. Catra wraps her arms around Adora's neck as she begins walking towards her bedroom.

When they reach Adora's bedroom, Adora goes right for her bathroom. She sits Catra down on the toilet and she relieves herself happily as Adora exits to go retrieve Catra some clothes. Catra realises, as she watches that *incredible* ass exit the bathroom, that Adora was still pretty much entirely clothed. Her pants would be ruined, Catra had... *released* , all over them.

Adora returns a little later, she had changed out of her Horde Lord get-up for her usual sleeping clothes: boxer shorts. In fact, Adora often liked to sleep topless and Catra wasn't about to complain - Adora's boobs are *fantastic* and a lot bigger than people might expect if the woman didn't deceive people with her armour and sports bras.

Catra watches as Adora heads to the sink and grabs a washcloth, wetting it to clean Catra's inner thighs. She kneels down in front of her. "Wow... you really came a lot, Kitten." Adora notes and Catra rolls her eyes, hitting her upside her head playfully.

"Stop thinking about it dummy."

"I can't, I want to do that again." She says and Catra laughs. Of course Adora wanted to do that again.

"Maybe when I can actually stand, hot stuff." Catra replies lightly. Adora nods and then discards the wash cloth. She grabs the clean shirt - Adora's shirt - and then pulls it over Catra's head. She scoops her up again and takes her to her bed where she places her down and then climbs in beside her.

Catra purrs and starts scenting Adora yet again. She practically lies on top of the blonde, pinning her to the mattress to do it. Adora laughs in that wonderful way that she does laugh - the little giggle-snort that is entirely too endearing and not at all what you'd expect the Horde Lord to laugh like. "What is that?" Adora asks curiously.

"It's called scenting," Catra explains, "it’s something Magicats do." Catra doesn't dare say more than that. Adora looks up at her with wide eyes.

"... You're making me smell like you?" Adora asks.

"Is that... is there a problem with that?" Catra asks. Her tail swishes back and forth behind her in weariness. Adora seems to consider that.

"No... no problem. I just... it's cute that you do it by rubbing your cheeks against me."

"I am *not* cute." Catra protests before she rolls off of Adora and lies down beside her instead. Adora rolls over to wrap her in a cuddle. Catra really felt... safe and comfortable in that embrace.

"Goodnight Catra." Adora whispers as she kisses her neck gently. "You did so good today, Kitten." Catra was exhausted but those words made her feel warm in her chest.

"Goodnight Adora..." Catra whispers back before she's dragged under into unconsciousness.

* * *

Adora sighs and sits up. As much as she'd love to keep cuddling Catra she had to at least show her face *once* to her soldiers - plus her legs could use the stretch. She kisses Catra on her cheek, wrapping her arm around her waist. "I don't know if you're awake, or if you can hear me... but I'm going for a walk. I'll be back later." Adora whispers. She turns and hops out of the bed, heading to her drawers in order to put on *actual* clothes. She doesn't bother with her full armoured look, favouring a more casual uniform. She decides to leave Catra a note just in case she happened to wake up while she was gone.

She exits her bedroom and the throne room. Her guards at the door salute her respectfully and Adora nods in acknowledgement. It was nice just to walk the Fright Zone halls. They're familiar and comforting - if a little repetitive. Adora pauses at a window (despite Catra's belief, they *do* have them) and looks out at the Fright Zone. She remembers Shadow Weaver standing her by this very window, promoting her to Force Captain and telling her about her ‘destined’ greatness. Adora shakes her head. That all seemed so far away now.

She moves on, passing by the cadet barracks and ending up at the training rooms. Adora passes by one and then stops, recognising the voices from inside. She backtracks slightly and stops in the doorway to see Lonnie, Kyle and Rogelio sparring. It brings a smile to her face. Adora doesn't know when she got so nostalgic. "Lonnie, you're holding your staff wrong."

"Would you look who it is?" Lonnie starts off sarcastically, bowing in a dramatic way. "Welcome, my Lord. To what do we owe this sudden visit? Also, I'm not holding it wrong, this position is easier on my wrist." Lonnie corrects before she chuckles. "You finally come out of your cave? Here I thought you'd be sucking face with the Princess for the rest of the day." Adora rolls her eyes and pushes off of the door frame and into the room.

"Ha-ha, how funny," Adora says sarcastically. "Don't make me kick your butt."

"As if you could." Lonnie points the staff at Adora before grabbing another one and tossing it at her. "Wanna spar? For old time's sake? I won't take too much of your time, since I'm sure you want to go back to your pretty Princess *lover* soon."

Adora catches the staff. She ignores Lonnie for a moment. She kind of missed fighting with a staff, it just felt... *right* . Maybe she should consider transforming her sword into a staff more often. She tests the weight of it, spinning it in her hands a few times before she looks back at Lonnie. "First of all, prepare for that ass kicking." Adora says with a grin. "Second of all, she is *not* my 'pretty Princess lover'." Adora puts air quotes around those. Lonnie snorts at her, raising an eyebrow as she moves quickly with her staff to knock Adora off of her feet.

"Uh huh. You know that no one believes that, right? That Princess has you fully wrapped around her finger and you don't even realize it. Then again, you seemed to have done the same to her." Adora deflects Lonnie's attacks and scowls at her.

"She... she does not have me wrapped around her finger at all."

"Literally everyone in the Fright Zone, aside from you, knows that's bullshit. Not that we mind much. Princess C'yra is actually nice to us when you let her roam around." Lonnie jumps back for a moment, trying to rush in to kick Adora. Adora meets Lonnie in the middle, their staffs clashing together. If Adora was honest, Lonnie was a good fighter and she was strong, she gave Adora a good run for her money.

"Catra and I... are just... friends." Adora grunts out. Lonnie jumps back again, putting her staff down and laughing.

"Adora, did you really just say that?" Lonnie looks at her with a mix of disbelief and laughter. "You're literally *sleeping* with her… like every month, sometimes more often now that she comes to visit without you kidnapping her." Lonnie's laughter only gets louder. "Last time I checked, friends don't kiss and fuck each other, Adora."

"I disagree," Adora stands up straight, using the staff to lean against. "Lots of friends kiss and fuck each other." Lonnie should *definitely* know that considering her whole… *thing* she had going with Rogelio.

"Not the way you two do." Lonnie places a hand on her hip. "You treat her differently than any other person you've ever slept with. And I've seen who you've slept with and how you acted with them. With the Princess, you're actually *soft* with her." Adora scoffs and laughs.

"S-Soft? I am *not* soft. With anyone." Adora protests. "And... you don't know what I'm like with people I've slept with...." Lonnie scoffs, shaking her head at her.

"We both know that's bullshit. And yes, we do know, because we could all fucking *hear* it. You literally jumped from one girl to the next in a single day and yet she's been here for months. You literally always have your hand somewhere on her body. You carry her around because she wants you to. You let her kiss you and you initiate kisses in front of *everyone* . What's not clicking?"

"That's not..." Adora pauses and rubs the back of her neck. Lonnie was kind of right, Adora *did* have a lot of... flings... when she was a cadet and such. "That was different." Adora defends. "I had more... I could do that when I wasn't Lord, and Catra... So what if we do kiss?

Or I carry her around? That doesn't *mean* anything." Lonnie raises an eyebrow, looking at Kyle and Rogelio with a look that says ' *do you hear this shit?* ' - Adora doesn't appreciate that. Lonnie turns her focus back to Adora.

"You sure, Adora? You know, no one would be against it if... it *did* mean something. Like I said before, Catra's chill. She actually treats us all with dignity and like we're people." She says with Kyle and Rogelio nodding behind her.

"It's true! Did you know when you caught a cold last week, she actually managed to make soup for everyone?" Kyle says, remembering the delicious meal that they were able to have. "She didn't have to, but she did anyway."

"Catra is a Princess, of course she cares about stuff like that." Adora says dismissively, swiping her hand through the air. "Do you guys even remember that we're... you know... at *war* with the Rebellion? Catra and I are just sleeping together, we're in agreement that we're still enemies."

"She is a Princess, but certainly none of the other Princesses have ever treated us like that." Lonnie shrugs. "And yes, we remember that. We're just saying that no one here would be opposed to you two... doing whatever you're doing." Lonnie sighs, turning her staff in her hand. "You should totally pay attention to how you treat Catra next time though."

"How I treat her?" Adora turns her head to the side. "You guys are seeing things. How would Catra and I *ever* be more than what we are now anyway? Pretty sure the odds of that happening are zero."

"Whatever you say, Adora." Lonnie says, holding her staff up. "You wanna continue sparring or you wanna go back to your girl?"

"She is *not* ‘my girl’." Adora grumbles, lifting her staff. "I'm going to kick your ass and then I'm going to go back to my room."

"She's totally your girl, but sure. Keep telling yourself otherwise." Lonnie grins, lifting her staff up and commencing the fight once more. Adora scowls. Here she was considering

taking it easy on Lonnie.

There was a reason that Adora was the top cadet in their squad, however, Lonnie was good, and they had their different strengths, but Adora had been drilled by Shadow Weaver that anything less than perfection was a failure. As a result, Adora makes it a point to *never* lose one-on-one. The fight ends when Lonnie hits the mat.

Adora laughs a little, wiping sweat from her brow and reaches her hand out to help Lonnie to her feet. She drops her staff once Lonnie is upright. "Now, if you'll excuse me, Catra is in my room and I really should be going." Lonnie rolls her eyes, dusting herself off and grabbing the staff Adora just dropped to the floor.

"Yeah, yeah. Get out of here already. Tell your girl we said hello."

"She's not my girl!" Adora yells over her shoulder as she flips Lonnie off.

She begins the trek back to her room, thinking about what Lonnie had said. She was wrong... *right* ? Sure, Adora kissed Catra... and she really liked it... she enjoyed being with her, and... she liked Catra, *a lot* , but... they were enemies with benefits, that's what their entire relationship was. *Right* ? They weren't dating, that would be ridiculous! Maybe they were... kind of friends... Adora didn't really feel any... hatred towards Catra, but that didn't mean anything... *Did it?* Adora sighs and pushes those thoughts to one side.

She arrives back in her room, a little sweaty from her activities, to see Catra curled up in her bed. Adora instantly smiles at the sight. Catra was... adorable, especially when she slept. With Adora gone, Catra had taken to spooning a pillow instead - which was endlessly cute. She was also hogging the blankets which, by the way, Catra did even while Adora was *in* the bed with her - Adora had kind of gotten used to that.

Adora pauses. *Used to it...* Maybe Lonnie was right. Catra has become *familiar* , they spend so much time together. Adora knows her likes and dislikes, she knows about her moms, she knows how Catra likes to cuddle and kiss, she knows... she knows *Catra* . Adora shifts a little, kicking her boots off. Catra makes her feel warm and... content...

Adora shakes her head and decides to disturb Catra to rid her mind of those thoughts. She climbs on top of Catra, snuggling her into the mattress. Catra whines softly, opening an eye and wiggling a bit. "Adora... you're sweaty and you stink." She murmurs sleepily. She giggles when she notices the mildly offended look on Adora's face. "Where were you anyways? I missed you."

"You missed me?" Adora asks with a grin. "And I stink? I'm offended and feel the need to correct you." Adora lowers herself down and then rubs her cheek against Catra's. " *We* stink."

"Hey! *Gross* !" Catra laughs, pushing Adora away before sitting up. "I did. You weren't here when I woke up so I went back to sleep."

"I was sparring a little," Adora answers. She stares at Catra for a moment before she wraps her arms around her and pulls her back down onto the bed. "I'm not done rubbing myself against you." Catra laughs, playfully shoving Adora away, though her purrs showed just how much she enjoyed it.

"I knew I shouldn't have told you about the scenting thing!"

"Don't you want to smell like me Catra?" Adora asks with a wide grin as they tussle on the bed. "Huh? Do I smell bad?"

"Now you're just purposely being a jackass." Laughter fills the bedroom, the sheets rustling beneath them as they push each other around. "Nah... I was just messing with you. I like how you smell." Catra whispers once they calm down, settling against each other.

"Hm..." Adora hums as she kisses Catra on her lips. "I probably do smell after... sparring." Adora admits. "How are you feeling after last night?" Catra smiles, grabbing Adora's chin and bringing her back in for another kiss.

"You don't smell bad... you are sweaty though." She teases a bit. "I'm feeling pretty great. Sore, but it's a welcomed feeling."

"I imagine you are feeling sore after... that." Adora says. "Anyone ever tell you you're adorable when you're sleeping?"

"You were watching me sleep? Weirdo." Adora scoffs.

"Like you don't watch me sleep?"

"You have no evidence." Catra sticks her tongue out and Adora rolls her eyes, smiling at Catra.

"That's evidence enough." Adora teases. "You also steal my blanket by the way. Why do I put up with you?"

"Because you're like a heater and you're warm anyways?"

"I guess... and I *do* like to cuddle you." Adora admits and Catra purrs.

"That I am fully aware of."

"Care to join me in the shower?" Adora asks as she trails her hands up along Catra's sides.

"Maybe later... stay with me for a while?"

"It's your nose's funeral." Catra laughs.

"You don't smell that bad! I was just kidding. I like how you smell, dummy." Adora knows that Catra calls her dummy affectionately, she *never* calls her it in a mean way - same with idiot.

"You like how I smell, huh?" Adora raises an eyebrow.

"I do..."

"Isn't that important to Magicats? I've been doing some reading."

"You've... been reading about Magicats? Why?" Catra looks at her, pleasantly surprised.

"Well... I've been... I mean..." Adora pauses for a moment. "I'm sorry to tell you this Catra, but I've kind of been seeing a Magicat. I know that might be a shock to you." Catra wheezes a little.

"You... are such a *dork* , I swear." Catra hits her gently and Adora smiles.

"I figured I could learn some things, like... did you know you guys have this spot right at the base of your tail," Adora ghosts her fingers over the spot. "if you hit it *just right* it's supposed to feel *real good* . I mean, I already figured that out on my own, but the science behind it is very interesting."

"Of course I knew that, Adora. I had to take biology growing up." Catra smiles back. She was clearly happy to see that Adora was learning about Magicats. "What else did you learn so far?"

"Uh..." Adora thinks for a moment. "... you guys have real good vision in the dark, which I am low-key jealous of."

"That we do have. It’s very useful when you're half asleep and need to get something in the middle of the night." Catra smiles. "Though, sometimes you see some things that you don't want to see."

"Okay, wait... now you *have* to tell me something you saw you didn't want to." Adora sits up a little so she can look at Catra and Catra giggles at her.

"Have you ever walked in on someone in the bathroom because they left the door unlocked?"

"Well, the Fright Zone has public bathrooms, but I'm terrified of what you mean by that." Adora snorts. "At least you didn't walk in on someone having sex."

"You did?!" Adora laughs and leans up, resting her head on her hand.

"The Fright Zone has basically no privacy, Lonnie brought up my cadet flings today... reminds me of the fact I used to have semi-public sex..."

"I-" Catra stops. "Actually, that's not surprising after someone walked in with me tied up on your throne." Adora smiles and then she hooks her leg over Catra, pulling her to her chest and basically smothering her in her embrace.

"I also learnt that Magicats dislike water and also you guys apparently mate for life?" Catra purrs happily, nuzzling Adora.

"We dislike being in *deep* water usually. We tolerate showers. And yeah... we do mate for life. It's a whole soul bonding moment, as romantic and cheesy as that sounds."

"So you... really?" Adora asks.

"Mhmm. It's really cheesy. But it’s what happens..." Catra hums as she closes her eyes and breathes in Adora's scent. "It's really sweet, I think."

"How does that even happen?" Adora asks. "The whole soul bond thing? How do you even know?"

"You just... know… I guess. It's different for everyone from what I heard." Catra shrugs. "I wouldn't know. I haven't found my mate anyways."

"Right... yeah..." Adora doesn't know why that stings.

"Don't pout."

"I'm not pouting I just..." Adora trails off. "It's just... the inevitably of our relationship. I don't want to bum you out."

"I know."

"Anyway..." Adora says. "We can nap some more before you have to go?"

"I'd really like that."

"Me too..."

"Then it's time for a nap." Catra says. Adora sighs and settles against Catra. She waits for a moment.

"Can I actually scent you or is that only a Magicat thing?" She asks curiously.

"You're able to scent me too."

"Really?" Adora raises an eyebrow. "I mean... I know you shower and stuff so my scent isn't on you but I figured that was just because we had sex and time constraint of seeing your

moms after being with me would tip them off."

“Yes really. It’s something that anybody can do, but it’s not something that everybody can sense because not everyone has the sense of smell Magicats have. So other Magicats, and some others, would smell your scent on me, and some would smell my scent on you, but not everyone.” Catra smiles. “The first time my mom smelled you on me, she wanted to murder you and wanted me to burn the clothes that I was wearing because they were yours.”

"You burnt my clothes?"

“I had to, I couldn’t just keep them, someone could have found them.”

"I wanted those back..." Catra looks at Adora a little guiltily.

“I’m sorry. It was the only way to get my mom off my back. “

"It's okay," Adora says with a smile. "... maybe you could keep this shirt without having to destroy it." Adora says, tugging on the hem of her shirt that Catra was wearing.

“I… I don't know if I would be able to keep it. Someone will probably ask where I got it from." Adora sighs and cuddles into Catra.

"Okay, we can shower later. I just… I want to be with you... is that okay?" Adora asks.

"That's perfectly fine.” Catra replies. Adora doesn't say anything in response, she kisses Catra's collarbone and then allows herself to drift off into a peaceful sleep - she can’t help but wonder about what Lonnie said.

* * *

Adora was waiting. Catra had told her that she could sneak away from the Rebellion for a time and come see her - which meant that Catra could see her without them having to worry about the Rebellion thinking that Catra had been kidnapped by Adora. In fact, Catra had been able to do that more recently, which Adora was curious as to *how* but she didn't want to pry. If Catra wanted to tell her, she would.

Adora taps her fingers against the armrest of her throne. That's when the woman of the hour strolls through the throne room's front doors. Adora is up in a flash and down the stairs just as quickly to plant a kiss to Catra's forehead in greeting. "You're here, good." Adora smiles and then offers her hand. "Come on, I have a surprise for you." Catra smiles, placing her hand in Adora's and pulling her back in to give her another kiss.

"Yeah? What is it? You know you don't have to give me any surprises, right?"

"I don't *have* to but I *want* to." Adora says, tugging Catra back out into the hallways of the Fright Zone. Adora was so distracted leading Catra that she accidentally backs up into a Horde soldier.

"Hey! Watch where-!" The soldier's words die on their tongue as they see who they were about to mouth off to. They straighten up and salute. Usually, Adora would be beyond angry, but her mood had been significantly lifted the second Catra had stepped foot into her throne room. "Lord Adora, sir, I'm- I'm sorry my Lordship, I had-"

"Relax," Adora says dismissively. "carry on walking and we'll forget this happened." The soldier is visibly surprised and they glance at Catra briefly before they bow and scurry off.

"Now... where was I?" Adora asks as she pulls Catra along. "Oh yeah, I want to give you things."

"What things exactly?" Catra asks curiously, purring as she lets Adora lead her along. "You're making me really excited to see what you have for me."

"Nothing fancy," Adora says. "The Fright Zone doesn't really have a lot to offer, but I did what I could."

"Even so. The fact that you put in the effort to plan a surprise for me is sweet enough as it is." Catra stops Adora with a gentle tug of her hand, smiling as she cups her cheek and pulls her down so their lips could meet. "Thank you." Adora smiles into the kiss and wraps her arms around Catra's waist to pull her closer and kiss her deeper.

Pretty much everyone in the Fright Zone knows about them now, it's about the *worst* kept secret, so Adora has no issues kissing Catra right smack bang in the middle of the Fright Zone's halls. She pulls back after a moment. "Well, I figured you deserved something for putting up with me." Adora jokes lightly.

"Putting up with you?" Catra asks teasingly, leaning back in to kiss Adora again. "Hmm, I suppose I should get a reward for dealing with your big ego, dork." She laughs before calming down and smiling. "I really do enjoy spending time with you though... it's the best part of my day."

"Wow... and you call *me* gay?"

"You are."

"So are you." Adora says, rolling her eyes. She playfully shoves Catra and then carries on walking down the hall.

"Duh." Catra laughs, shoving Adora back. "So, where are we going?"

"Remember that spot I showed you?" Adora asks.

"Of course. That's where we're going?"

"Yes it is," Adora replies. "If you're up for the climb again."

"I'm up for it. Like I said, you've got me really curious." Adora hums as she carries on walking.

"So," She says. "How are things with you? You know, generally speaking or whatever."

"They're pretty okay. Not too much going on now. Had a lot of free time so I came to see you." Catra purrs, nudging Adora's shoulder. "What about you?"

"The same mostly," Adora shrugs. "I only plan battles to kidnap you now." That was a joke but it was also... a true joke.

"Hey, less work for us both." Catra giggles. "And more fun times for us."

"Fun times," Adora echoes. "I do enjoy our fun times together."

"I enjoy them too... a lot."

"I know, I've *heard* your enjoyment." Catra laughs and shoves Adora playfully.

"Shush, you. As if you haven't made your own enjoyment loud and clear."

"You're still the loudest one between us." Adora teases.

"And you love it."

"Yeah..." Adora gets a dreamy look on her face as she thinks about it. "Yes I do..."

"Hey, bring it back. I don't want you falling off while we're climbing." Adora snorts.

"That'd be a pretty funny way to go," She says. "How did the Horde Lord die? Oh, you know, she was thinking about how *loud* Princess Catra is when they're fucking, and then fell to her death." Catra rolls her eyes which Adora grins at.

"And that is honestly the last way I would like for you to go. So actually pay attention, please."

"The last way? What's the first way?" Adora asks jokingly. If Adora is honest, she'd happily die while making- *huh.* While having *sex* with Catra.

"I haven't really thought about it." Catra shrugs and Adora looks at her suspiciously.

"Really?" Adora asks. "No fantasies about how you want me to die?"

"No... Not anymore at least." Catra laughs. "Not like before we first... did anything."

"Implying that you *used* to," Adora raises a brow. "How romantic."

"Hey, you used to get on my nerves royally. You'd purposely push my buttons whenever you could, even before you kidnapped me at Princess Prom."

"Enough that you wanted to kill me?" Adora asks with a laugh. "Or enough that you wanted to kiss me so bad?"

"Maybe a bit of both and maybe you should remind me why I really wanted to do the latter one."

"You mean, aside from my good looks and charm?"

"Aside from that, yes." Catra raises an eyebrow. "What are you waiting for?"

"Patience is a virtue, Kitten." Adora chastises playfully. She leads Catra to the tower and they climb up as they had before.

When they reach the top, Adora extends her hand. "Ta-da," She says as she gestures to the things she had laid out. It was a blanket with a picnic of sorts (as much of a picnic as Adora could get in the Fright Zone), there were even candles. "This is... this is it." Catra's eyes widened at the sight of everything that was on the platform.

"You did all of this for… *me* ?" She asks, clearly touched by the entire thing. "Adora, this..."

"It's not that big of a deal." Adora finishes for Catra as she blushes a little. "I just thought... it might be nice."

"Adora... this is *amazing* ." Adora grabs Catra's hands and leads her over to the blanket, pulling her down to sit on it.

"I have another surprise."

"There's more?" Catra's eyes sparkle a little in the setting moonlight - they're so pretty. "What is it?" Adora points to a building not too far away.

" *That* is the designated artificial farming building." Adora says proudly. "I decided to take your advice, I guess."

"You... you actually did it!" Catra laughs happily and throws her arms around Adora. "I'm so proud of you!"

"Wow..." Adora laughs as she wraps her arms around Catra fondly. "If I'd known a bunch of plants would get this reaction from you, I would've done it sooner." Catra purrs happily, nuzzling into Adora's arms and grinning up at her.

"This was incredibly sweet, Adora. I know I sound repetitive saying this, but wow… I really don't know what else to say."

"How about you kiss me?"

"Mm... I think that sounds like a really good idea." Catra hums as she grabs Adora's shoulder and kisses her gently. Adora makes a happy sound and guides Catra down onto the blanket.

"I'm planning on wining and dining you, so to speak, and then we can spend the night together." Adora says. "That sound good to you, *Lover* ?" Catra blushes slightly and nods.

"Sounds perfect... lover." She whispers, settling down against Adora and closing her eyes. "Seriously... I really appreciate you going through all of this effort for me."

"It was my pleasure," Adora replies. And it really was. Catra was *worth* it. "I made sure to get fresh food."

"Did you now? You didn't have to do all of this. Just some snacks and juice would have been fine. But thank you." Catra turns her head, pecking Adora's cheek. "What did you get?"

"Okay, so," Adora starts. "The cooks made sandwiches... tuna I think? We mostly have canned stuff in the Fright Zone..."

"I love tuna. That sounds great, babe."

"And donuts, which remind me of you." Adora says with a little smirk.

"You really went and said that joke, huh?" Catra looks at Adora, mildly amused.

"What? They're filled with cream, I thought it was very fitting." Especially after their *many* sessions with She-Ra and her sword.

"You really did. Oh my goodness, Adora." She snickers. "One night without an innuendo? Is that too much to ask for?"

"You ask too much of me." Adora jokes leaning in to peck Catra on her lips. "Fine, fine, no more innuendos for the night. ... I shouldn't say things I know I'm not going to do." Catra rolls her eyes, grabbing a donut and taking a bite.

"It isn't that hard, you dork."

"Mhmm... do me a favour and squeeze that donut." Adora wiggles her eyebrows playfully.

"How about no?" Catra shakes her head but she was smiling fondly. Adora picks up her own donut and takes a bite from it. She then purposely, in view of Catra, dips her fingers into the cream and then licks them clean.

"Oh yeah... this is *definitely* like you." It even tasted sweet.

"You are so damn horny, I swear." Catra places her donut down on the plate, grabbing Adora's chin and bringing their lips together. Her tongue teasingly licks away the remaining cream and Adora’s pupils blow wide. "Yum..."

"I am pretty horny," Adora admits and then she forgets about her donut when Catra kisses her again. She pulls her back in for another kiss, deepening it almost instantly. She moans softly as her tongue enters Catra's mouth, her hand comes up to cup Catra's jaw and she scratches

her blunt nails against the back of the fabric of Catra's shirt. After a while, Adora pulls back, panting a little. "Wow..."

"Yeah..." Catra gasps quietly as their lips finally part. A lopsided smile on her face as she looks up at Adora with a soft gaze. "That was good." Adora gives Catra a butterfly kiss.

"It was pretty damn good."

"You can say that again."

"I like kissing you." Adora says. "Almost as good as the sex."

"Wow, you must hold kissing me very highly." Catra comments. Adora holds her hand out.

"Sex with you." She moves her hand down. "Kissing you." She moves her hand a little lower. "Cuddling you."

"Is that the order you have them in?" Catra raises an eyebrow, moving in closer to Adora.

"Yes..." Adora swallows a little at the sudden closeness of Catra.

"I see... interesting."

"How would you rank it?"

"Hmm... cuddles first."

"Cuddles first?" Adora raises an eyebrow. "You're saying *cuddles* beat *sex* ?"

"Sex is a close second." Catra laughs. "But yes, I actually do prefer cuddles."

"... Our whole relationship is based on sex?"

"Shhh, let me have my cuddles."

"Fine." Adora rolls her eyes. "Eat up, Kitten." Catra grabs one of the tuna sandwiches and takes a bite out of it, nodding.

"It's good. I like it." She says and she seems like she means it. "Seriously, thank you for doing this."

"You can thank me later." Adora says with a smirk as she eats her own food.

"I will."

"I look forward to that..." Adora pauses. "But I... I just wanted to do something for you..."

"I know... thank you, Adora."

"And... against my better judgement... I... like you."

"Huh?" Catra's eyes widened, clearly having not expected that - not that Adora had expected to *say* that either.

"I like you," Adora says again. "You know? Spending time with you, and stuff... I like it."

"Oh... I like you too..." Catra pauses before she nods. *That was kind of weird, Adora. Time to move on.*

"So are you ever going to tell me about these Princesses you've done stuff with or am I not allowed to know?" Adora asks.

"You still remember that?"

"Of course I still remember that." In fact, sometimes it keeps Adora awake at night. Catra ruled out Glimmer but it could be any other Princess and maybe it shouldn't bother her but it *does.* She *needs* to know. She was going crazy just thinking about Catra hanging out with the Princesses, or rolling around with one of them where Adora wasn't, where Adora could *never* be. So she wanted to know, for peace of mind, no other reason.

"Does it really matter though?" Catra asks.

"It matters to me."

"But... why?" Adora pouts at Catra.

"Because I want to know."

"But why?"

"Was it the flower Princess?" Adora asks, ignoring Catra's question.

"No, it wasn't." Catra lays back on the blanket. "Why do you want to know so badly?"

"The water one?"

"Why do you want to know? It really doesn't matter."

"It was the water one, wasn't it?"

" *Adora* , why do you want to know?" Catra repeats. "It doesn't matter anyway."

"It matters because... forget it." Adora huffs as she looks away.

"You can't just ask me like, I don't know how many times, and then just tell me to forget it."

"You didn't answer me." Adora points out.

" *You* didn't tell me why you wanted to know to begin with." Adora sighs and bites her lip, looking out at the Fright Zone.

"... I just... I want to know, is that not a good enough reason?"

"Not really." Catra replies after contemplating it for a moment.

"Fine, I want... I guess... I can't exactly be with you all the time like the Princesses can... and I guess… I'm wondering who you've been with that wasn't me and why you're not with them now *instead* of me." Adora confesses.

"Ah... well... for the Princess, we figured that we were better off as friends and not overstepping that boundary."

"But who was it?" Adora encourages.

"I literally don't understand why that matters now? It's been like… two years? Nearly three." Now Adora *really* wants to know.

"Why don't you want to tell me?" Adora asks. She's getting a little… not forceful but frustrated, and she can tell Catra is too.

"Because I don't see why it even matters now when I haven't done anything with that person in years, Adora." Catra argues. Adora lets out a fed up sigh and looks away from Catra, crossing her arms over her chest.

"Fine, forget it, like I said." She grumbles.

"... Fine." Catra sighs, going back to nibbling on her tuna sandwich in silence. Adora works her jaw from side to side as she thinks. She doesn't understand why Catra won't tell her who it was but she's not about to force her to tell her either.

"I'm... sorry..." Adora says after a moment.

"Thank you."

"I suppose I can be... a little... possessive..." Catra smiles a bit at Adora's words.

"I've noticed."

"I mean... yeah... I guess I have been less than subtle about that." Adora laughs a little. "You know, if I say something stupid, feel free to punch me."

"It's not stupid. Obviously I have a thing for being a little possessive too... as you might have been able to tell."

"Do you?"

"... Could you not tell?"

"Well you... you do like to call me your Lord, and say my strap belongs only to you... you know... now that I'm saying it out loud, maybe we both do have a thing for being possessive." Adora hadn't really thought of it that way before.

"No shit." Catra snorts.

"You also like to bite my neck."

"And *you* like to bite *mine* ... and everywhere else."

"I don't bite your *neck* , I'm pretty sure you banned me from doing that." Adora reminds her, referring to the rule Catra had made.

"As if you don't do it anyways." That's not strictly true but Adora half smiles and laughs anyway.

"Yeah, okay, but I mostly mark where people won't see."

" *Mostly* ..." Catra hums, finishing her sandwich before purring. "That was tasty... so... what would you like to do?"

Adora looks out over the Fright Zone, enjoying the way the orange moon doused them in a warm orange glow. "Can I ask you something?"

"Yeah, what's up?" Adora stands and dusts herself down. She then extends her hand to Catra.

"Dance with me?" Catra smiles softly as she places her hand in Adora's. Their hands seemed to fit together so perfectly as Adora helped Catra to her feet.

"I'd love to."

Adora pulls Catra close, wrapping an arm around her waist and holding her hand in her other as she swayed them to no music in particular. Adora was inches away from Catra's face and the atmosphere was suddenly thick with *something* . Catra's eyes never look away from Adora, her cheeks flush a bit and Adora can tell she also feels the air around them change. Even though there was no music, everything just felt... *perfect* .

Catra gives Adora a smile, she steps closer to her and rests her cheek against Adora’s shoulder as she quietly begins to sing as they sway. Adora feels endlessly *warm* . "This is nice," Adora says as she holds Catra close. She moves her hand up, happy to just *feel* Catra and be in the moment with her. "You have a really nice voice."

"Thank you." She responds, pausing her singing for a moment before continuing. Catra really does have a very nice voice. Adora loves listening to her, no matter what she’s doing, from singing softly like this, to talking quietly in their bed together. Adora pauses at that thought. Technically not *their* bed but… close enough.

Catra purrs softly, her eyes close and she looks to be enjoying the moment. Adora sighs softly as she sways from side to side. Catra makes Adora feel *so much* just by being near her. She leans forward to kiss the side of Catra's head. "This is really nice. Thank you for this. I really love it." Catra whispers, like she was confessing some big secret.

"I guess this is as close to a date as we can get." Adora responds fondly. This feels… *intimate* , even more intimate then their nights together have been.

"Mmm... if this was intended to be a date. It was a pretty amazing one."

"It was..." Adora admits. "I know we can't risk being seen outside of the Fright Zone, but I wanted to do… something *special* ." That's the least Catra deserved in Adora's opinion. She… doesn't know how she feels about Catra anymore, it's more than Adora ever thought herself capable of feeling, that's for one. Whatever it is… she wants nothing more than to be with her right here, right now.

Catra purrs loudly, interrupting Adora's thoughts, as she lifts her head up to look at Adora, their eyes meet. "It is special... you went through all of this effort to do something special for us."

"I know there are certain things I can't give you Catra... but I find myself wanting to."

"And what are those things, Adora?"

"Dates... outside of the Fright Zone, for one." Adora admits sheepishly.

"Aw, you want to take me on dates? How gay." Catra teases.

" *Ugh* , you're insufferable, forget I said anything." Adora pouts a little and rolls her eyes as she continues to waltz with Catra. Catra laughs softly, bringing a smile to Adora's lips. She turns Adora's head towards her and brings their foreheads together.

"I find that really romantic, Adora."

"Yeah?" Adora whispers. "I guess I might be a little romantic."

"You're pretty damn romantic..."

"You think so?"

"I do." Catra whispers, bringing their lips together. "Today has been... *spectacular* ." Adora sighs. She really loves kissing Catra.

"I like... being with you..." Adora admits. "When we're not here together... I... want to be with you... what do you think that means?" Adora asks because she genuinely doesn't know what that means. She finds it interesting that they sleep together regularly, that they kiss, they cuddle, they have rough sex, or soft sex, and yet… Adora still isn't sure she knows what they are. She has the feeling that lines have been crossed, she just doesn't know what lines those are. They're supposed to be enemies with benefits, and that is all, but they haven't felt like enemies since that first night together.

"I... don't know, Adora. But I like being with you too..." Catra hums softly. "I like getting to be together with you..."

"So we like being together." Adora states.

"We do..." Maybe Adora has to make peace with that. She likes spending time and being with a *Princess*. Catra is the only person Adora has ever shown She-Ra to. She is the only person Adora trusts (beyond Scorpia and her squad) and yet she is the last person she should *ever* trust. *What the hell does all that mean?* She stops those thoughts in their tracks before she can spiral too much.

Adora closes her eyes and leans her head forward to rest against Catra's. "You want to continue this spectacular night in my room?"

"Mhmm... that sounds like a great course of action to me..."

"Who would've thought? The Horde Lord and a Princess." Adora says with a little amusement. The answer to that question is no one.

"I don't think we even thought that we'd be out here, *dancing* after a nice little picnic." Adora smiles and steps back.

"Come on, last one down is a loser!" Adora shoves Catra playfully before she turns and starts sprinting to start climbing down the tower.

"Hey! No fair! You started first!" Catra yells as she hurries behind Adora, laughing loudly as she scrambles to climb down, using her claws to speed past Adora.

"Hey! You're cheating!" Adora yells though she laughs which takes all the bite from her words.

"You were cheating first! You ran off with a head start!" Adora looks at Catra and then she looks at the distance off of the ground. *Not too far.* There was only one way Adora was going to win this race. Adora lets go and falls.

* * *

Catra hears the thud and skids to a stop almost immediately. She turns around, looking at Adora and heading back towards her in worry. "Adora, are you okay? You didn't land weirdly right? Any injuries?" Catra's eyes scan over the blonde but she didn't seem to be *bleeding* at the very least.

"Ow..." Adora complains, rubbing the top of her head. She looks up at Catra and then grabs her, tackling her to the ground. "I'm fine, but you're still totally going to lose." Adora winks and then tickles Catra before standing up and running again - *that little shit!*

"I- *hey* ! That was mean!" Catra grumbles, pushing herself up and jumping onto Adora's back, clinging onto her. "You're an asshole, why would you do that?"

"Hey! Did you just jump on my back?" Adora asks, laughing as she catches Catra and starts giving her what is basically a piggy back. "Horde tactics Kitten." *Horde tactics,* of course that was Adora's excuse.

"Of course I jumped on your back. You literally tricked me." Catra pouts, wiggling a bit until she's comfortable in Adora's hold. "I was actually worried about you..."

"Aw, you were worried about me?" Adora asks as she walks along the Fright Zone hallways, her big heavy boots thud. Adora really is… athletically inclined. Even if she could potentially build more of those defined muscles she's been getting lately by eating more than just ration bars - even before that, she had had lean bulky muscles. She's *strong* and it's sexy as all hell.

"Of course I was. I literally heard the thud of you falling." Catra responds.

"That did hurt... but I'm quite sturdy."

"I was still worried." Catra huffs, pinching Adora's arm before kissing her cheek. "I'm glad you're okay though." Adora laughs and hurries along the hallways of the Fright Zone towards the throne room. Catra didn't really care about the soldiers that were staring at them, she had become somewhat of a regular sight to them.

"You're too fast, it isn't fair." Adora complains.

"What can I say? I'm light on my feet, Adorka."

"I'm going to make you regret that nickname as soon as we're in my room."

"Make me regret it, huh? You can try." Catra smirks. She wonders if Adora has another one of those 'punishment' sessions planned or if she's doing her usual Lord bit where she spews a bunch of big talk. Adora grins as she quickens her steps.

They enter the throne room and make a beeline right for Adora’s bedroom. "So I guess we're both winners, or we're both losers." Adora says lightly.

"I think we can say that we're both winners." Catra says fondly as Adora deposits her down onto her bed.

"You said you liked cuddles more than sex?" Adora asks. "Do you just want to cuddle?"

"Yes, please. Thank you for asking." Catra would *love* to have another session with Adora but a part of her just wants to… she just wants to snuggle with the blonde.

"Okay, do you want to get comfortable?"

"Mhmm, I'm borrowing your pyjamas." Catra says, already heading to Adora drawers and pulling out a shirt and a pair of shorts. Adora leans against her desk and watches Catra change.

"You seem to like wearing my clothes."

"If I didn't, I wouldn’t steal them every time that I'm here." Catra laughs as she pulls the shirt over her head.

"You look cute in them." Adora says. "Even if they are a little big for you."

"They're very comfortable. Just like the person who they belong to." Catra giggles, doing a spin. "How do I look?" She playfully strikes a pose.

"I think you look like you *belong* ." Adora says with a smile. Adora changes her own clothes herself and then tackles Catra to the bed.

"That I belong?" Catra asks curiously.

"Like you belong in my clothes and in my bed."

"Of course you'd say that." Catra snorts a little.

"Should I... not say that?" Adora asks.

"It's dorky, that's all I'm saying." Adora rolls her eyes at Catra.

"How do you want to cuddle?" She asks. Catra considers that question for a moment.

"Lay down on top of me today." Adora raises an eyebrow but she doesn't protest. She adjusts Catra's position and then lies between her legs and atop Catra, effectively pinning her to the mattress. Catra purrs happily, holding Adora close and grinning down at her. "Comfy?"

"Extremely." Adora says, snuggling closer. "You're warm."

"You always say that."

"You're also sexy." Catra laughs and shakes her head in amusement.

"So you've told me, quite a few times." Catra pokes her cheek and Adora smiles.

"Can you... stroke my hair?" The blonde asks. Catra purrs and nods, doing as Adora requested of her.

"I really do enjoy playing with your hair too... just getting to be like this... it's nice." Catra admits.

"What... what do you think we'd be like if we weren't... you know... enemies or whatever?" Adora asks. Catra wasn't really expecting that question if she was honest. She sighs as she moves her other hand down Adora's back, gently stroking her in a soothing pattern. Adora smiles up at her in a sleepy haze and Catra feels her heart contract painfully at the sight. Her heart has been doing all kinds of things around Adora recently that it *shouldn't* .

"If we weren't enemies?" Catra asks, trying to focus on the question Adora just asked her. "We'd probably be... going on dates every week."

Adora snorts. "Really?" She asks. "Careful Catra, you sound like you'd like to court me."

"Keep telling yourself that." Catra hums quietly. If she's honest, she hesitated to answer that.

"How do your suitors even court you? You said it wasn't sexual... so what? Flowers and chocolate?" Adora asks.

"Not really, it's just... meetings." Catra shrugs.

"Sounds dull," Adora sighs as she presses her head against Catra's chest. "and... clinical... How'd you ever find someone you click with in such a formal setting?"

"I haven't, and it *is* dull as hell."

"Hm..." Adora hums. "Call me old fashioned, but you can't force things like that. They usually happen naturally."

"I know, it just never happened with anyone that my moms tried to set me up with."

"You'll tell me when it does?"

"... I would." *Though I doubt that'll ever happen considering I keep coming back to see **you** .* Catra doesn't say it but she certainly thinks it. How can she ever hope to fall for someone who isn't Adora if she's always with her?

"Good..." Adora mumbles. She was clearly comfortable and slowly drifting off to sleep. Catra imagines she's in that floaty and not fully conscious state of sleep where Adora isn't entirely aware of what she is saying. "... I care about you Catra."

"I... care about you too, Adora." Catra whispers back gently.

"Goodnight Kitten." Adora mumbles. She kisses Catra's chest a couple of times before she settles back down, wrapping her arms around Catra and scratching at her back for a moment. "I... *mmm* ..." Adora drops off her sentence in her sleep which is kind of the cutest thing Catra has ever seen. Catra turns her head to the side at the sight. Adora is beautiful, she is… *everything* . And they *click.* They just… *work* , even if maybe they shouldn't.

In that moment, Catra knew that she was *fucked* . She couldn't believe it. She had caught *feelings* for *Adora* .

"Fuck. I'm in love with the Lord of the Horde."

Chapter End Notes

These bitches really are gay, good for them! We actually have had this fic idea for close to a year now (we first started talking about it post S5 in May last year). S and I have a lot of AU ideas but we ALWAYS came back to Lord Adora AU. We're glad we're putting her out there and hope you're all having a good gay time reading it as we do writing it. We actually had about 4 different versions and routes we could take this AU but we decided on the original route. Thank you for reading! -M

Yeah, what M said. We also usually build the fic around the dialogue of the characters. I'm glad y'all seem to be loving Lord Adora as much as we love her. This update really was long but honestly? It was kind of one of my favourites to write. See y'all next Friday!! -S

War of Hearts

Chapter Summary

> "It almost feels like... we're friends..." Adora clears her throat as she looks away from Catra.
>
> "Just... just friends?" Catra murmurs. "I didn't know friends kissed each other." Adora laughs a little.
>
> "Fine, friends with benefits." Catra looks disappointed at Adora's words for a moment before she smiles again and buries her face in her chest.
>
> "Right... friends with benefits."

Chapter Notes

> Happy Friday (again)!! Another update for y'all!! And it's another chunky chapter too. We hope you enjoy reading :)!
>
> Also, I feel this is an appropriate time to remind y'all of the tags of this fic :)

See the end of the chapter for more notes

Catra sighs as she enters the Fright Zone. This could go one of two ways: either Adora reciprocated Catra's feelings, or she didn't. The last option made Catra's heart ache in her chest. She couldn't even begin to fathom the idea of being without Adora now. How had Catra been so stupid? Not only bad she fallen for the Horde Lord but she had *mated* with her too. Scenting Adora... That should've been a huge red flag to her.

Yet she couldn't bring herself to acknowledge it at the time. She enjoyed spending time with Adora - dare she say that she *loved* getting to be with her in a way that others had never had the chance to be with her. Something about being the only person Adora had ever been like that with was satisfying to her. It felt like maybe what they had was *special,* not just to her but also to Adora. She had blinded herself to her feelings because she was afraid that she would have to make the choice to end things. In her mind, she had somehow come to the conclusion that her and Adora could continue to be together despite the war - half of her had forgotten Adora was even supposed to be her *enemy* . It took Spinnerella and Netossa finding out to bring her back to reality. It was going to be hard enough knowing that if Adora *did*

reciprocate her feelings, there would be countless obstacles making it practically *impossible* for them to be together. If she didn't... Catra bites her tongue. It was hard to finish the statement, even in her own mind.

Being with Adora had always felt *right* to her, since the very first night. She could still remember when she had to leave, the way that she had struggled to. She remembers how Adora hesitated in saying goodbye to her. She remembers how the Horde Lord had taken her into her arms, her cape hiding them away from the rest of the world, as their lips met for the first time outside of her bedroom.

Catra laughs to herself, her eyes filled with worry. She really was blind. She should have known that things had changed between them when Adora had pulled her back in for a kiss that day. It hadn't felt final. It had felt... hungry, passionate, and soft. It had felt like a *beginning,* not an ending. It left her feeling wanted and enamored. She had thought that maybe she was running on adrenaline from the nights before, but clearly that hadn't been the case. She thinks about what Azar had told her. Sometimes you fall in love slowly and then all at once. That's what it had felt like with Adora. Every kiss, every cuddle, embrace, whispered sweet nothings, every night together. Catra had fallen in love with Adora a little more each time. She hadn't had a ' *you're the one'* moment instantly with Adora. Sure, she had felt a connection, almost an addiction, but she hadn't allowed herself to think it was anything more than just lust. How wrong she had been.

She shakes her head, bringing herself out of her thoughts once she stepped inside of the throne room. She hadn't even realised that she had gotten there. Her body had instinctively guided her there because that's where her Adora usually was, waiting for her... *Her* Adora. *Wow, she really had been blind* .

Adora was standing at her desk, papers in one hand and the other resting against her chin. She wasn't in her armour, just her regular Horde issued shirt and pants - she had her heavy boots on and her cape was still attached to her shoulders though. Adora is always dressed immaculately, most likely a habit from her military upbringing, sat at her hip was her sword and her hair was pulled back in her usual ponytail, bangs pinned up. She looked to be in deep thought before she notices Catra's presence.

"Catra." Adora places the paper she was holding down and comes towards Catra. She places a soft kiss to her forehead in greeting. "Are you okay?" Catra purrs weakly, leaning into Adora's lips and wrapping her arms around her lover.

"I'm... thinking." She finally says, after trying to figure out what exactly to say to her. The kiss gave her hope, so much *hope,* that she probably shouldn't allow herself to have. "I'm okay though." She quickly reassures, wanting to get the concerned look off of Adora's face. "How are you? Has your day been okay?"

Adora looks unconvinced but she smiles a little after a moment. She takes Catra's wrists in her hands and pulls her towards the table that had a multitude of papers lying on it. "Actually," She says. "I could use your help." She hands Catra the papers she had been looking at before. "The Fright Zone is looking to expand. What do you think our next project should be after that whole artificial farming idea you had?" Catra grabs the papers, her eyes and heart soft as she reads through the paperwork.

"Removing any hazardous metals that are located around the Fright Zone, and re-purposing them by melting them down to create additional buildings to expand housing so that everyone can have their own private room. Privacy and comfort can go a really long way." Adora turns around and sits on the edge of the table, looking up at Catra.

"Well, I know the privacy of my room is nice," Adora gestures with her hand towards the location of her bedroom. "Force Captains get their own rooms..." She pauses as she thinks. "I'll look into that. You're full of ideas, huh?" Catra smiles at her.

"I try my best, especially if it can help everyone here have a better life." She means that from the bottom of her heart. During her time here, she has gotten to know the people of the Fright Zone. Originally, they were just as cautious around her as Adora had been, but then they slowly grew to understand that she never intended any harm to them while she was there and they warmed up to her. "Speaking of, maybe you can try planting cotton plants here too. You can make fabric out of it." Adora raises an eyebrow.

"At the rate you shred my clothes, we may need that." Catra laughs.

"As if I haven't had to bring spare clothes here because you rip mine."

"Touché." Adora concedes. She reaches her hands out and pulls Catra towards her, resting her chin against her stomach, looking up at her, while she loops her arms around her waist. "Did you miss me?"

"I did..." Catra whispers, running her fingers through Adora's hair - Adora has *no idea* how much. "I missed you very much, babe. Did you miss me?" Adora hums and she presses kisses up Catra's stomach before essentially cuddling her waist.

"I did." Adora never bothers to deny that anymore which is curious to Catra. "How are things in the Rebellion?"

"They're... okay. Could be better." Catra says softly, her heart fluttering in her chest at the sight of Adora kissing her stomach. She had no idea why, but she found it so adorable and it made her want to hold her closer. "How about here? How is everyone taking the changes with the farming and the like?"

"Could be better?" Adora questions. "I think people are enjoying the fact that there have been less battles as of late. Kyle's really good at farming as it turns out."

"I imagine, it's been nice not having to fight as much anymore." Catra agrees, purring happily as she continues to play with Adora's hair. "Kyle has always been smart, he was just out of his element when it came to fighting. But I'm glad that everyone is doing okay."

"Oh! That reminds me," Adora stands. "I have something for you."

"Something for me?" Catra questions. Adora heads to the other side of the table, bends down and roots around for a moment. When she stands back up she's holding a little pot with a tiny green sprout potted in it.

"Ta-Da," She says with a big grin. "One of the first plants that the Fright Zone has *ever* produced, and it's all thanks to you." Adora presents Catra proudly with the plant. "I wanted to give it to you." Catra blinks, taking the pot carefully. For someone so oblivious to their feelings, Adora sure does a lot of *romantic* gestures. Catra looks at the plant, petting the sprout before giggling.

"Babe... you dug out one of the *first* plants you've *ever* managed to grow?" Catra asks with great amusement.

"... Yes... Yes I did."

"Dork. You're supposed to let it stay in the dirt to grow." She smiles. "I love it though. How about we go replant it to make sure that it has the best chance of survival?"

"You want to replant it?" Adora asks, looking at the plant. "You don't want to keep it?"

"It's not that I don't want to keep it! I do, but I also want to make sure it survives, babe." Catra didn't want to hurt Adora's feelings by making it seem like she was ungrateful. She was *very* grateful, she also wanted the plant to *live* and, other than asking Perfuma to bail her out, Catra really would end up killing one of the *first* plants the *Fright Zone* has *ever* been able to grow - that seems like a crime or something. Replanting it ensures it will live. "Plus, I really wouldn't know where to put it once it starts getting bigger."

"Okay... we can replant it." Adora confirms with a gentle smile. Catra smiles, placing the potted plant on the desk and kissing Adora.

"I love it though. It was a really cute surprise." Adora smiles and picks Catra up by wrapping her arms around her waist.

"My dear Princess," Adora begins. "What would you like to do?"

"I... I just want to spend time with you." Catra says softly, caressing Adora's cheek. "I just want you to hold me." Adora kisses Catra's neck and then her jaw.

"I think I'd like that a lot." She whispers. Catra giggles, adjusting her head so that she could bring hers and Adora's lips together again.

"Me too."

"You said things could be better at the Rebellion," Adora says, setting Catra down. "What did you mean?"

"Don't worry about it, dork." Catra says quickly, not wanting to bring up the issue just yet. "Just a... discussion that was had."

"A discussion," Adora says. She looks at Catra for a long moment, seemingly analysing her expression before she shrugs. "How about we go to my room?"

"That sounds perfect." Catra nods, wrapping her arms around Adora and purring. "Carry me?"

"But of course Princess, anything for you." Adora scoops Catra up in her strong arms easily and starts walking towards her room. Catra sighs softly, melting in Adora's arms as she tries to ingrain the feeling of her warmth in her mind. She was afraid that she would lose this, so she needed to take as much of it as she could get before she brought up what she was worried about.

When they get to Adora's room, Adora sets Catra down on her feet. Catra knew that Adora could tell that something was off about herself but she also knew that Adora was unlikely to pressure Catra to speak about it unless she decided to speak about it on her own terms. "Make yourself at home." Adora says as she removes her cape from her shoulders. Catra smiles, she grabs Adora's cape and pulls it around herself. She takes in her scent, releasing a pleased purr.

"Thank you..." Catra says happily. Not only did she have Adora’s scent around her, she had *Adora* around her.

"You're welcome." Adora says with a smile - Adora’s smile almost made Catra feel like all was right in the world. She pulls her boots off and then sits down on the edge of her bed. "Feel like napping or something?"

"Not napping. Like I said, I just want to be here with you and for you to hold me." Catra says softly with a smile. "I... just want to enjoy time together today." *The time they have left together.* Adora frowns softly at Catra, probably at her choice of words, but nods her head nevertheless.

"Come here then." Catra moves towards Adora, cape still around her as she flops into her arms with a loud purr. She takes in a deep breath, enjoying her mate's scent and rubbing her face against Adora's throat. Adora giggles a little at Catra's soft hair and fur that tickles her at the rubbing. Adora pulls her down onto the bed, making sure they were thoroughly wrapped up in each other so that you couldn't tell where one started or one ended. "You know, when I finished sparring with Lonnie that one day, she made me realise something."

"What did she make you realise?" Catra asks through her purrs.

"I trust... only a handful of people." Adora begins. "The squad, because I grew up with them... they're like a family... Scorpia because, well, she's *Scorpia* ." Adora looks at Catra with a little amusement in her eyes. "And... you... I don't know how or when it happened but... I do, I trust you. I'm not even afraid to let you wander the Fright Zone and, in fact, my soldiers kind of adore you. And... I trust She-Ra around you and only you."

"Oh." Catra looks up at Adora with adoring eyes. Her cheeks had warmed slightly, flattered by Adora's trust in her. But... learning that today was going to make things much harder for her if Adora didn't feel the same way.

"It almost feels like... we're friends..." Adora clears her throat as she looks away from Catra.

"Just... just friends?" Catra murmurs. "I didn't know friends kissed each other." Adora laughs a little.

"Fine, friends with benefits." Catra looks disappointed at Adora's words for a moment before she smiles again and buries her face in her chest.

"Right... friends with benefits." She murmurs, turning her head and resting her ear right where she could hear Adora's heart beat. She didn't understand why it was so hard for Adora to admit that they were more than that. Despite her argument, *friends* do not do what they do - Adora literally took her on a *date!* Catra sighs. She thinks maybe Adora will *never* figure herself out.

Adora presses kisses to Catra's face, bringing her hand up to gently caresses at her jaw. "I really love this. Getting to be with you like this." Catra confesses. Maybe she shouldn't, but she just can't help herself.

"Yeah?" Adora asks. "You *love* it?" Catra nods, blushing a bit.

"Yeah, it makes me happy."

"It makes me happy too." Catra's eyes widen a little at Adora's response, her heart hammering with *hope* once again.

"Really?" Catra asks.

"Of course, I always enjoy spending time with you." Catra purrs loudly at Adora's words, lifting her head up from Adora's chest to give her a soft kiss.

"I... that makes me happy to hear." Catra whispers.

"Well, I'm glad I can make you feel happy." Adora hums. "You seem... is something wrong Catra?"

"... No." She answers, though she does hesitate to do so. She wants to yell at Adora, to *scream* at her, that she's in love with her. To tell her that hearing her call them 'just friends' tore her heart apart. But she doesn't. She *can't.* Not yet. She keeps her composure and simply hugs Adora tighter.

"Okay..." Adora clearly isn't convinced but she also clearly doesn't want to push Catra. So Catra was having a bad day? Adora must have had plenty of those herself. All Catra wanted was to be cuddled by her mate and Adora was providing her with those cuddles. Adora holds Catra closer and tighter, kissing her along her jaw. Catra sighs, enjoying those kisses to the fullest.

"Adora, how was your day?" Adora laughs and slips her hands below Catra's shirt, not for anything sexual, just so she could gently run her hands up and down her back. Adora is very touchy and not always in a sexual way - she likes to keep her hands busy.

"My day? It's been good, better now that you're here." Adora says confidently. "How was your day?"

"Better now that you're holding me." Catra purrs, closing her eyes. "Do you want me to cook something for you today? I remember you saying you managed to get more ingredients in the kitchen."

"You don't have to cook for me."

"I *want* to... it's just nice to spend time with you. Plus, your reactions are really cute." Catra pulls back slightly to look at Adora and Adora smiles.

"Then... I'd like that." Adora drags her blunt nails gently over Catra's back and the feeling is comforting but also very relaxing. "I really like touching you."

"And I really like you touching me. Your hands are always warm." Catra responds. Adora's touch just feels… *right* . Catra always loves Adora touching her, sexually or not. Adora looks at Catra and holds her intense gaze.

"You... I..." Adora stops her words in their tracks and then kisses Catra on her lips. "You are... so beautiful..." Catra blushes as Adora pulls away from the kiss, her sweet words sending her heart fluttering and making her stomach feel full of butterflies.

"Thank you. You're really gorgeous too, Adora." She whispers, finishing her statement with a kiss as the blonde had done.

"I am nowhere near as gorgeous as *you* ."

"You are." Catra sometimes wonders how Adora perceives herself because it’s not always clear. She doesn’t seem to take compliments too well but, then again, neither does Catra. And yet, Adora’s ego is often as big as her throne room.

"I disagree but... I appreciate it." Adora replies.

"We can agree to disagree then." Catra says, poking Adora's cheek fondly.

"We agree to disagree on a lot of things."

"Yeah? Like what?"

"Like... how to rule... and stuff."

"That's... true." Catra frowns a little. She remembers that conversation, the one that they were never going to agree on. Adora thought fear was an effective tactic to ruling, Catra thought otherwise.

"So what are you thinking of cooking me?" Adora asks curiously, changing the topic.

"Anything you want in particular?" Catra asks.

"Anything you can make with me cuddling you from behind." Adora states and Catra snickers and nods.

"Okay, that narrows things down. Something that doesn't require too much movement. Got it." Catra laughs a little. Adora isn't really clingy… or maybe she is… Catra is probably just as clingy as her if she's honest. It's not often that they *don't* have their hands on each other, but Adora is being… *attentive* of her clinginess.

"I'm not letting you go, you seem like you need it." Catra stops laughing, looking at Adora for a moment, deep in thought.

"Am I that easy to read?" Catra asks. Adora shrugs a little.

"To me." She says simply. "I don't know... it's a feeling." Catra hums.

"You've really learned to read me, huh?" Catra can hardly believe this. Adora can *feel* how Catra is not on her game. She *knows* something is wrong and yet she isn't pressuring Catra to talk about it. She's *waiting* . She's being *supportive.* She's willing to give Catra non-stop cuddles just to make Catra feel better when she doesn't even know what's wrong. *Why is she such a fucking idiot? Why can't she just* ***see*** *how she feels?*

"We have spent a lot of time together." Adora points out.

"We have, yes."

"I *know you*, Catra." Catra purrs softly at that.

"You do... you do know me." She whispers. "Maybe a little more than the others, in an odd way."

"You mean because I've been inside of you?" Catra almost laughs at that - trust Adora to say *that.*

"There's that, and there's certain things I've said and done with you that I haven't with anyone else before." She murmurs. And she's the first person Catra has ever *loved,* not that she can tell Adora that.

"Yeah?" Adora asks gently. "Like what?"

"Well, you're definitely the first person that I've let cuddle while I cook."

"I certainly hope so." Adora grumbles. Catra rolls her eyes.

"Jealous, babe?"

"I just don't think you should be letting other women, who are not me, cuddle you." Adora says simply. Catra raises an eyebrow at her.

"And why is that?"

"Because... you shouldn't."

"But *why* ?" Catra pouts up at her.

"Because you're *mine* , to cuddle, and... everything else in between." Catra softens at Adora's words. She gently caresses her face and pecks those soft lips of hers.

"Yeah?" Catra asks. She still doesn't understand how Adora doesn't *see* it. Maybe she really doesn't feel the same way. Maybe Catra is reading into things too much.

"Yes. I thought we'd established this? You're mine." Adora says, like it was obvious. *I am.* Catra thinks to herself. She *is* Adora's, in a way that Adora, and no one else for that matter, will *ever* understand. She wants to tell Adora that. Instead, all she does is take Adora's hand and kiss her knuckles.

"And what's everything in between?" Catra asks curiously.

"To kiss," Adora says, turning Catra over so she was on her back. She kisses her on the lips and then trails her lips down, kissing Catra over her clothes. She trails her hands down Catra's sides before she pauses them over her stomach. "Only I get to see you naked," Adora announces proudly. "Cuddle, as I said, joke with, tell things to... just... *be* with." Catra bites back a smile, reaching up and wrapping her arms around Adora tightly. Everything she had just said was true and she wished that the blonde would understand the reason *why* she was the only one.

"You're right..." Catra confirms. There's more, Adora is her *mate* which means she is *bonded* to her in a way that Catra will never be able to get over. She knows what having Adora as her mate means. It means that, if Adora didn't feel the same way, Catra would be *hurt,* hurt more than any other pain a person could imagine. But then Adora looks up at Catra with a *soft* smile and Catra thinks maybe being hurt by her might not be so bad if it meant she got to *love* her, even just for a little bit.

"Can I touch your ears?" Adora asks and Catra snorts.

"Go for it." Catra nods. She kind of loves it when Adora touches her ears and her tail, it's relaxing, and, maybe Adora doesn't know this but, it also shows how much Catra *trusts* her. Her ears and her tail are vulnerable spots that could cripple her if hurt in *any* way - she trusts Adora not to hurt her.

Adora reaches her hands up and gently begins massaging Catra's ears, smiling at the purring Catra lets out in response. "Catra..." *Conflicted* . That's how Adora looks. Catra leans into Adora's touch, closing her eyes and purring softly.

"Mm... yes?" She asks. The sensations she feels rolling over her is distracting, and her purring is almost uncontrollable, but she's still listening to the blonde carefully.

"I feel like I'm a different person around you." Adora whispers so quietly that Catra almost misses it.

"I don't think that's the case." Catra replies.

"You don't?" Adora asks with surprise and Catra shakes her head.

"I don't think you're a different person, I just think we've... *grown* a little more from when we were first together." She understands *why* Adora might think that she's a different person but she isn't. She's just become more comfortable, she's become more like *herself* if anything.

"I... yeah, I guess we have." Adora says. "You make me soft and mushy, that almost never happened in the past." Catra giggles at her.

"Is that such a bad thing?" Catra asks with a little teasing lilt to her tone.

"Not when it's with you, no." Catra beams and smooches Adora's cheek.

"Are you hungry now? Or do you want to keep snuggling here in bed?" Catra asks.

"Honestly? I'm good with either. Whichever you prefer, Kitten."

"Then let's stay here for a few more minutes and then we can go make something to eat." Catra just wants to snuggle Adora for as long as humanly possible before she potentially loses that forever.

"Okay," Adora nods and then she lies down beside Catra. Catra lets her hands reach for Adora, pulling her close and inhaling deeply.

"Adora..." Catra says longingly, burying her nose in her chest. Adora pauses.

"Is... do you... want to talk about something?"

"No, no. Just... enjoying the moment." Catra knows she sounds redundant, but she's afraid to even bring up the conversation that could possibly take all of this away from her.

"Hm... okay..." Catra allows herself to relax when Adora doesn't push for an answer. She wasn't sure what she would have said had the other kept asking her. Catra could feel the words sitting in her chest, right on the tip of her tongue. But she forces them down so as to not break the quiet peace surrounding them.

"I..." Adora stops mid-sentence. Catra is sure that Adora can feel Catra's apprehension, and she's sure that Adora is wondering why she isn't telling her why or what she's so wound up about - Catra finds it frustrating that Adora doesn't already know. "What do you want right now, right this second, that I can give you?" Adora asks. Catra smiles a little. It's an attempt to make her feel better.

"Kisses." Catra answers her.

"Kisses." Adora repeats with a smile. "Done, deal, absolutely." Adora leans down to kiss Catra on her lips, softly and gently. Catra smiles as soon as their lips meet. Adora's kisses always left her with a warm, fuzzy feeling, and that *definitely* hadn't changed.

"That's nice..." Catra says once their lips part.

"Yeah? Do you like kissing me?" Adora questions.

"Mhmm." Catra has never liked kissing anyone as much as she likes kissing Adora.

"Why don't you kiss *me* , huh? Like you mean it." Adora says with a playful wink. Catra looks directly into Adora's eyes before giving her a heated look. She grabs hold of Adora's head, one of her hands securely sliding into her hair as she brings the blonde down towards her. She kisses her *deeply* , as passionately as she possibly can. She kisses her in an attempt to convey all of the feelings that she has locked inside of her that were just *waiting* to spill out of her.

Adora's eyes widen before she melts into the kiss, her eyes flutter shut and she relaxes - clearly more than happy to let Catra lead the kiss. When Catra leans back, Adora chases after her lips before she gets a dopey smile. " *Wow* ..." Adora breathes out, her eyes still closed.

"Yeah..." Catra blushes, smiling back and bringing Adora back towards her to hide her face in her shoulder. "That was... nice."

"I would've called it *fantastic* but, sure, nice works too." Adora wraps her arms around Catra, cuddling her and Catra laughs, kissing Adora's neck. "It was amazing, *breathtaking* ." Adora adds. "Are you trying to seduce me?" Adora asks playfully.

"Maybe. Just a little." Catra says with amusement.

"Yeah? Maybe it's working." Adora responds. Catra grins.

"Good to know." She purrs, pecking Adora's lips again.

"You can do anything to me." Adora says.

"Anything?" Catra raises a brow.

" *Anything* ."

"Dork." Catra smiles. "I appreciate that, but all I want is for you to be you."

"For me to be me?" Adora asks with a lopsided smile - the smile that Catra *loves* . "I want *you* to be you."

"Your smile... it's so cute." Catra confesses, lifting her hand to gently trace her fingers down Adora's face. Seriously, Adora's smile is *wonderful* .

"It is?" Adora asks. Catra nods.

"It is. I love it... your smile." Catra felt dangerously *close* there. Close to confessing what else she loved about Adora - and how she simply loved *her.*

"I like it when you smile too... and your fangs." Adora confesses and Catra laughs, showing off those fangs that Adora loved so much.

"Of course you'd emphasise my fangs."

"Your fangs are pretty cool, and they give you a really cute accent sometimes."

"Accent? That's the first I've heard of this." Catra turns her head to the side in question.

"Like... a little lisp on certain letters and words, it's cute." Adora clarifies.

"You seem to think that everything I do is cute." Catra raises an eyebrow.

"Everything you do *is* cute." Adora scrunches up her nose as she looks at Catra.

"Lies." Catra grumbles softly. Adora really seems to find everything Catra does *adorable* which is endearing but that doesn't mean Catra believes those words herself.

"What? That's not a lie, you are *adorable* ." Adora protests. Catra smiles at how she basically predicted Adora's response.

"But not *everything* I do is cute."

"I protest that."

"And I protest your protest." Catra deadpans. Adora huffs and digs Catra in her side.

"You're not allowed." Adora says. Catra squirms a little at her fingers digging into her side.

"And why is that?" Catra asks.

"You're in the Fright Zone, I'm the Lord and you have to do what I say." Catra snorts, sitting up and ruffling Adora's hair. Her bangs come loose and Catra is reminded of how *beautiful* Adora is.

"Is that the case?" Catra asks, her voice dripping with amusement.

"Yes," Adora puffs her chest up a little. "I am Lord Adora, my word is law, and I say everything you do is cute."

"Bullshit." Catra pokes Adora's forehead and Adora pouts at her - *so much for that high and mighty Lord speech* .

"Why don't you believe me?" Adora asks as she fixes her hair.

"Because it's not true."

"It *is* true." Adora fires back. Catra puffs her cheeks out. They're just as stubborn as each other.

"It's not."

"Why are you so against my opinion here?" Adora almost sounds offended which is kind of funny to Catra. This is what she loves about Adora. She loves their banter, she loves how *easy* everything feels, and is, around her. She feels completely at *home* with the blonde.

"Because it's not true." Catra murmurs as she pecks Adora's lips. Adora scowls and then *pins* Catra to the bed.

"I'll prove it to you." Adora says sternly. Catra squeals, caught off guard by Adora's voice and her pinning her to the bed. She looks up at Adora.

"How?" Catra asks, a *challenge* in her tone.

"By..." Adora leans in with a grin before she starts moving her fingers against Catra's sides. "Tickling you!"

" *H-Hey* !" Catra squeals, wiggling around and trying to get away. "No tickles!"

"Admit you're cute!" Adora says, not stopping her tickling.

"No way!"

"Admit it!"

" *No* !"

"Catra," Adora says, laughing at the sounds of Catra's giggles. "It'll stop as soon as you admit it." Catra sticks her tongue out at her.

"No way!" Catra shakes her head. Adora stops and then gazes down at Catra.

"You *are* cute, in every single way... you're *incredible* , and I- ... I think you're perfect."

"I'm not..." Catra blushes, looking away in embarrassment from Adora's praise. "I'm nowhere near perfect."

"You are to me." Adora lowers herself down so she's practically crushing Catra to the bed beneath her. Catra purrs loudly, hugging the blonde close to her.

"Dork... that's sweet of you to say." Catra says, rubbing her cheek against her.

"I can be sweet sometimes." Adora says with a smile.

"I know... I'm fully aware of that." And Catra *is* . Adora has been sweet a number of times. Catra no longer sees her as the *Horde Lord,* she *can't.* She is just *Adora* to her.

They fall into a gentle silence before Adora speaks again. "Catra... whatever it is... we can handle it. Together." Catra bites her lip. She wishes that what Adora had said was true, but she wasn't sure it would be.

"Let's... let's head to the kitchen. I'm actually kind of hungry right now." Catra says, avoiding the subject. Adora sits back and nods. She puts her boots back on and then offers Catra her hand to help her out of the bed. Catra takes Adora's hand, letting the blonde pull her up. She stops her just as she is about to walk off, pulling her in and kissing her.

Adora sighs happily into the kiss and places a few more to Catra's lips before she pulls away. "You keep kissing me like that, I might get used to it." *There's that smile again.*

"I can't help but want to kiss you..." Catra breathes, her thumb gently caressing Adora's cheekbone. "The feeling of your lips against mine... makes my chest feel full and warm..." Adora blinks but leans into Catra's touch. It takes her a second but she smiles at Catra again.

"Me too."

"Really?" Catra asks softly, her eyes looking upon Adora lovingly.

"Yeah, I feel warm and... happy... with you too." Catra kisses her again.

"Me too." Catra repeats Adora's words from before.

"But you are kind of acting like one of us is dying." Adora jokes lightly.

"Am... am I?" Catra bites her lip a little. She doesn't mean to, she just wants to make the most of this time with Adora as much as possible. Maybe she is acting like it might be their last time together, but that's only because it might *actually* be their last time together.

"Well... *something* is different." Adora says, grabbing Catra's hand and pulling her out of the bedroom and towards the kitchens. "It's not that you're not usually touchy, but today it feels... bigger than that." Catra licks her lips nervously, squeezing Adora's hand.

"Oh, bigger than that?" Catra asks.

"Like... more important than our last few times together. I don't know..." Adora trails off and shrugs her shoulders.

"I see." Catra hums, bringing Adora's hand to her lips. "Sorry, I'm... really in an odd mood today."

"You're being... *affectionate* ." Adora says. "I wouldn't call that odd. I'm just... I'm worried something happened and you don't want to tell me." Adora really was reading her like an open book. She was afraid to bring up what had happened, but maybe she could make a start.

"We... two of the Princesses know... They promised not to say anything, but... they know." She whispers with hesitation. Adora freezes.

“... What?”

"Two of the Princesses figured out that all of those times you kidnapped me were for us to sleep together." Catra repeats, looking down at her feet. Adora frowns and taps her fingers against her thigh.

“They said they wouldn’t say anything?” She asks.

"Yes, they said they won't say anything." Catra confirms.

“... Okay then.” Catra glances up.

"That... that's all you have to say?"

“What else should I say? If they promised not to say anything then... it’s okay... right?” Adora asks. Catra really thought Adora was going to have a bigger reaction to that revelation.

"Yeah..." Catra says, her ear twitches. Adora smiles reassuringly, though it doesn't quite reach those blue eyes of her’s.

"Good... then... we can eat." Adora turns and begins walking away, dropping Catra's hand as she does so. Catra stops in her tracks, looking down at her hand when Adora drops it from her grasp. It felt... *cold* . Adora's smile hadn't reached her eyes either. If this conversation was enough to make Adora lose the shine in her eyes... she was afraid of even bringing up the next thing that was concerning her.

"Come on slowpoke, some of us have empires to run." Adora calls over her shoulder. Catra looks up and nods slowly.

"Right. I'm coming." She says, walking over to Adora, staying a few steps behind. She examines Adora closely - who was currently frowning to herself. She thought it was somewhat funny (in a sad way) that Catra came here to Adora for comfort and Adora... had withdrawn from Catra upon learning about the two Princesses. Adora clearly wasn't sure how to feel - she was confused - and Catra was frustrated that she wouldn’t *talk* to her.

Catra notices that they make it to the kitchen first. She stops Adora from walking off while distracted but, instead of grabbing her hand like she usually would, she grabs her sleeve. "We're here." She whispers, her ears slightly drooped downward when she notices Adora's withdrawn state.

She walks over to the cook, giving them a small smile before heading over to see what ingredients had been brought in that were available. "I can make some soup today?"

"Sounds good." Adora says, leaning against a counter, her chin in her hand. Catra glances up at Adora and slowly nods. She turns her attention back to the ingredients, talking to the chefs for a little while to let them know that she'd take over cooking today. She grabs the big pots, washing them and gathering all of the ingredients she had available before beginning to prep them without another word.

Adora *watches* Catra. Catra can *feel* her eyes on her. She knows sometimes that Adora can feel awkward and out of place, *especially* when it comes to feelings, she also knows that

Adora likes their arrangement because it's clearly defined to her - she understands that their relationship is *sex* - and Catra *understands* that but she still wishes that Adora could recognise that their relationship has clearly become *more.* Sometimes actions speak louder than words, and part of Catra thinks maybe Adora does know all of these things, her actions certainly suggest she does, but she also knows Adora has been raised in an environment where love and relationships are not the norm, and she doesn't know how to define it in her head, so she simply refuses to - she sticks to what she knows.

Adora twitches a little, a movement Catra catches in the corner of her eye. She imagines that Adora probably doesn't know what to do. Despite what people may think, Adora is capable of great empathy, she already picked up on Catra's mood way before she even *hinted* that something was wrong, and Catra knows she probably wants to help but that she doesn't know *how* to, so she isn't doing anything. Catra isn't exactly being subtle, she is clearly anxious from the way her ears are pinned back against her head, and the way her tail is twitching, but Adora just watches silently.

"You... if you're tired, you can go rest, Adora." Catra starts up as she cuts some potatoes - she wants to give Adora an out, if she wants it. "I can ask Scorpia to come get you once the soup is done."

"I'm not tired."

"Oh, okay." Catra says. Adora sighs and comes over to her.

"I'm sorry... can I help?"

"I... I got it. I'm just cutting up veggies for the soup." Catra answers softly, focusing on slicing through more potatoes and getting the carrots ready to chop as well. Adora raises a brow and leans against the counter, turning so she was facing Catra.

"You don't want help with anything?" She asks.

"Just trying to focus so I don't accidentally cut myself."

"I think you'll be fine, your reflexes are too quick."

"Better safe than sorry."

"So you just want me to stand here and look pretty?" Catra smiles just a bit at the joke - Adora is… so many things, and she makes Catra's heart feel *full* .

"If that's what you feel would be best." Catra says, reaching her hand up to pat Adora on her cheek. Adora smiles and then leans over the counter, resting her chin in her hand while watching Catra cut vegetables. Catra hums softly, focusing on getting all of the ingredients in a pot with some boiling water to start making the broth. She doesn't look at Adora too much, finding herself afraid to glance over and see a frown on her face again.

"Do you cook a lot at home too?" Adora asks curiously.

"Not usually. I do it mainly for fun." Catra says as she grabs some chicken, happy that they had begun to get more ingredients in the Fright Zone for them to use.

"You find cooking... fun?"

"I do, it's relaxing to me. And it's nice to make something people enjoy."

"It's a chore. I'd rather just eat." Catra snorts at Adora's response.

"It's different for everyone." Catra shrugs. "Not everyone enjoys the same things, so that makes sense."

"Not everyone enjoys the same things..."

"Yeah."

"We seem to enjoy a lot of the same things in a *certain* area." Adora says suggestively and Catra hums.

"Yeah?"

"Uh, *yeah* , or are you forgetting the things we've done in my throne room?"

"I haven't forgotten." She whispers. "I don't think I could ever." Literally. Magicats have *exceptional* memories - plus Adora is her *mate* , so of course she'd *never* forget.

"Good." Adora responds. Catra smiles a little.

"And in your bedroom, and the bathroom." Catra lists. She loved showers with Adora and, while they'd had *plenty* of fun in Adora's throne room, they'd also had lots in her bed too. Adora laughs and rests her hand on Catra's stomach, moving so she was holding Catra from behind.

"And in your *dreams* , right?" Adora whispers seductively. Catra blushes slightly and nods.

"Almost every night I'm not with you." Catra confesses.

"Really?" Adora asks quietly in Catra's ear. Catra nods again.

"Yeah. I've ... Being in your arms is the place where I feel at peace. Where I feel happy. It's cheesy, I know. But it's the truth."

"You're right... it is cheesy."

"Yeah..."

"But cute."

"What about you?" Catra asks.

"What about me?"

"Do you... dream of me?" Catra asks quietly. She isn't sure she can bear to hear Adora say no to that but she asks her anyway.

"Oh..." Adora hesitates for a moment. "I... don't really dream a lot, but when I do... it's usually of you."

"Really?" Catra looks up at the blonde.

"Sure. Not certain I can share them out loud though." Adora says with a small smirk.

"No?"

"Not unless you want everyone to know our business." Catra rolls her eyes. Of course Adora was referencing sex dreams, *why wouldn't she?*

"As if they don't already know." Catra argues.

"They don't know the *specifics* ." Adora whispers in Catra's ear as her fingers purposely ghost over the waistband of Catra’s pants.

"No, I suppose they don't... kind of." The Fright Zone *definitely* knows about them. They’ve kissed publicly, held hands, they’re not exactly subtle, and she *knows* Adora’s door guards to the throne room *must* have heard them - they’re not exactly quiet - so the Fright Zone does know about them. But Adora is right, they probably don’t know the fact that Catra often cums around Adora’s sword which is her *strap.*

"I mean, I'd happily show them." Adora says and Catra snorts.

"Not happening. I'm cooking anyway."

"There's always the pantry."

"Nope, keep it in your pants, lo-" Catra bites her tongue, catching her slip-up. "Lo...rd horny butt." Adora laughs, missing Catra's slip entirely.

"Fine, but one of these days I'll convince you." Adora resigns herself to cuddling Catra instead. Catra purrs weakly, closing her eyes for a moment to take in the feeling of her mate pressed against her back.

"Maybe." Catra says dreamily. She allows herself a moment of bliss. Of imagining them as not the Lord of the Horde, or Princess Catra, but as civilians, living their lives in the woods, in their own little cottage, allowed to have sex anywhere and everywhere they pleased. Adora kisses Catra's neck, obviously not caring in the slightest that they were in *public* . Catra bites her lip, her breath stuttering at the feeling. " *Adora* , we're in the kitchen."

"So we are." Adora murmurs as she kisses Catra's neck more.

"With lots of things that are boiling." Catra reminds her, biting her lip to keep herself from moaning. "Where people can *see* us..."

"All amazing points." Adora says, distracted with her *tongue* that was grazing over Catra's *neck* .

"Adora, stop being a horny idiot." Catra scolds, she sees Adora pout.

"But you like it when I'm a horny idiot." Catra sighs.

"I do, but not when I'm in the middle of cooking something that can easily burn us."

"I doubt it would burn us," Adora says. "Besides, I'm used to the feeling."

"That... that's not a good thing to be used to." Catra frowns. Adora shrugs.

“Maybe not.”

“It’s not.”

"Says you."

"I do say so." Catra pokes her in the hip. Adora was being annoying, and a little bratty.

"Well, you're a Princess. Any Horde member would agree with me." Adora points out. Catra doesn’t understand how Adora doesn’t seem to see how that stuff is *not* a good thing.

"I would hope not, but you're probably right." Adora sighs at her.

"Catra why..." Adora trails off. "Nevermind." Catra tenses up a little. She doesn't want to have that conversation *now* - not in public definitely.

"What's wrong?' Catra asks tensely.

"Nothing..."

"Are you sure?"

"This... isn't the place." Catra is kind of relieved if she's honest and she slowly nods.

"Okay... later?" She asks.

"Yeah, later..." Adora confirms.

"Okay." Catra agrees. Adora leans back and returns to just standing against a counter, quietly watching.

Catra can't help but to whine a little when Adora pulls away. She was enjoying being held. Adora laughs softly at her. "Wow... you really like being cuddled that much?" She asks.

"Yes." *Of course.* Whenever Adora holds her, Catra feels like the world could end and she'd be okay with it because she was in the arms of the woman that she loves.

"Finish cooking and then we can cuddle in my bed."

"Fine, it's gonna take a while though."

"For *soup* ?" Adora pouts. "We should've just starved."

"Nope, it needs to cook. That's why it takes a while." Adora groans and sighs dramatically. Catra laughs at her antics. "I don't have to do much else aside from letting it sit though."

"So why aren't you kissing me?" Adora asks.

"You didn't ask for kisses, last time I checked." Catra responds, not looking up from the pot she was currently stirring.

"Well I'm asking now." Adora says. Catra grins.

"Hmm, say please." Catra turns around to look at her.

"... You made a joke, cute." Adora replies. She raises an eyebrow and crosses her arms over her chest - Catra watches those biceps *strain* . She wonders if it’s too late to ask Adora to rail her against the kitchen counter or not.

"Who said I was joking?" Catra asks.

"I'm *not* saying please." Adora refuses. Catra looks off to the side.

"Guess no kisses then." Adora sighs and scuffs her boot against the floor.

"... Pl... Plea... can you kiss me, *please* ?" Catra's eyes sparkle and she grabs hold of Adora's shirt, pulling her in and kissing her. Adora lets out a small sound of surprise when Catra drags her in for the kiss but she sighs happily. Adora had *finally* said please, so Catra figured she deserved the best kiss that she could give her. Catra purrs and grins as she pulls away, peppering Adora's lips with kisses.

"Good girl." Catra whispers as she places one final kiss to Adora’s lips.

"I-" Adora almost chokes and Catra smirks at her reaction. "You play dirty."

"You like it when I do." Catra winks and hits her playfully with her tail.

"I like anything you do." Adora says with a smile and Catra smiles right back at her.

"I like *you* , dork." Catra confesses.

"I like you too."

"You do?" Catra's eyes brighten, her ears perking up.

"Yeah, I mean, I wouldn't spend time with you if I didn't..." *Oh. That made sense.*

"Still, it makes me happy to hear you say it." Catra admits before she focuses back on her soup making. Adora smiles a little.

"I can see that." Adora almost sing-songs.

"Can you?" Catra asks, half-distracted.

"Your ears and your eyes." Adora clarifies. "And you said you weren't cute."

"Shush, I'm not." Catra huffs. Adora looks around and then grabs a nearby soldier, wrapping her arm around their shoulder.

"Say, soldier, don't you think Catra is the cutest person alive?" Adora asks, gesturing to Catra.

"Y-Yes Sir!" They reply.

"That's not fair!" Catra laughs. "You know that your soldiers automatically agree with you."

"Because I'm always right, isn't that right soldier?" Adora says.

"Yes sir, always right."

"Damn right I am."

"Okay, you know that this conversation is totally biased to your side, right?" Catra crosses her arms, looking at the soldier and smiling. "Sorry about dragging you into this. You can go. Please tell the others that there's soup for dinner today." Adora drops her arm and the soldier bows respectfully at Catra.

"Yes, Princess Catra, of course." They say. "My Lord." They bow again and then scurry away.

" *Princess Catra* ," Adora parrots dramatically. Catra rolls her eyes, bowing playfully.

" *My Lord* ." She sticks her tongue out and winks. "I keep telling them to just call me Catra."

"Soldiers don't do only first names unless they're close." Adora says. "Usually, it's rank, then name. I kept telling Lonnie and the others that it was Lord Adora, and she just told me I'd always be Adora to them."

"I mean, you did grow up with them." Catra says casually. "It makes sense for them to just call you Adora. But them calling me Princess Catra makes things so tense. At least they're calling me Catra and not C'yra, like how it was when they first met me."

"I forget that's your real name." Adora admits, drifting over to the pan to peer inside.

"I think most people do. Chose the nickname so that people don't confuse me with my mom. Though I chose it when I was a kid so... it's a bit on the nose." She's aware that she looks a lot like C'yra, and they share the same name, it would have been confusing. Now she's basically known by all as Catra except by her mothers.

" *Cat* ra, no kidding." Adora says with amusement. "I like it though."

"Me too." Catra pauses before bursting into giggles. "Oh gosh, you've basically been moaning my nickname this entire time."

"I-" Adora looks at Catra with a blush colouring her cheeks. "Would you prefer I moan C'yra instead?"

"Heck no." Catra's pretty sure that would be *weird.*

"Would that be like I'm moaning your mom's name?"

"Yes, yes it would, since the only people that call me by that name are my moms... and maybe some royal guests."

"C'yra... harder... faster... right there... good C'yra." Adora mumbles under her breath. Catra chokes before bursting out into loud laughter.

"Adora, what the fuck?!"

"... What?"

"You really had to do that?"

"I just wanted to test it out. I think I prefer Catra."

"I prefer you use Catra too." She sniffs, trying to keep her laughter down. Sometimes Adora has zero filters on but she's still cute.

"I think C'yra might be weird, especially if your mom was to ever hear that." Adora comments. Catra rubs the back of her neck.

"I think if my mom ever heard that, she'd break the door down."

"Probably. She seems like an angry person."

"She's... *protective* is all. She can be a huge softie, but she tends to be very stuck in her ways sometimes." C'yra can be incredibly stubborn, and Catra knows she just wants to protect her, but sometimes she can be a little… *overbearing* . Strict. Don't get her wrong, C'yra is a great mom, but sometimes Catra thinks she lets her emotions blind her to things. She forgets that Catra is plenty able to look after herself, and make her own choices, that she isn't some helpless kitten who needs protecting all the time anymore.

"Yeah? Well I've met her a few times, and she might look like you, but she hates my guts." Catra laughs nervously at that. C'yra *hates* Adora. She hated Hordak too.

"Yeah because the Horde caused a lot of damage... even before you were in charge."

"I know Hordak did a lot of shit."

"He did."

"So… why do you keep seeing me?" Adora asks. Catra is taken aback by the sudden line of questioning. She wasn't expecting Adora to ask her that so suddenly and especially not *here* where anyone could hear them.

"Why do you?" Catra decides to deflect.

"I asked you first."

"I asked you second." Adora rolls her eyes at her.

"I don't have anything to lose." Adora shrugs. "You do." Catra bites her lip.

"I like being with you." Catra confesses softly.

"That's it?" Adora asks with a frown. "You just like being with me?"

"There's... more to it, but I don't know how you'd react." Catra turns around, checking on the soup and stirring it a few times again. She can't confess her love here, right now, it's not the time nor the place for such a thing.

"What does that mean?" Adora asks. "Are you... Are you using me?"

"What?! No! That's not the reason at all!" Catra's eyes almost bug out of her head at that question. *Why in Etheria would Adora think that?* Catra thought that Adora had gotten over her paranoia with her. Maybe she was wrong. Catra's stomach twists uncomfortably. She

feels sick, the thought that Adora even considered that might be a *possibility* made Catra feel… *not good* to say the least.

"Oh, then, good." Adora says and Catra frowns at her.

"What even made you think that was the reason, Adora?" Catra tries to not sound offended but she *is* offended. The fact that Adora could think that Catra was *using* her, *still,* after everything they'd done together? That was offensive.

"You said you didn't know how I'd react. I just thought of the worst case." Adora answers. "And... it had been suggested to me as a possibility by someone before."

"That's not the case at all." Catra sighs in disbelief but she feels a little calmer now that Adora had explained her reasons. "I love spending time with you, Adora. You always brighten up my day, and just getting to be with you, to hold you, and to kiss you, makes me smile."

"Sounds like you enjoy the things that aren't strictly sexual." She responds.

"Well yeah. Do you not?" Catra asks. This was treading dangerous waters, Catra was aware. Adora had the potential to hurt her, a lot, with her next answer.

"I... Of course I do, I just... the way you said it..." Adora shrugs and looks away.

"The way I said it?" Catra presses.

"It sounded like... it... *meant* something to you." Catra freezes for a second, biting her lip. *It does.* She thinks to herself. She wishes it meant something to Adora too.

"Uh, the soup is almost ready." She quickly changes the topic, hoping that Adora wouldn't try to continue the conversation.

"Oh..." Adora clearly wasn't finished but Catra knows she can recognise a topic changer when she hears one. "Good. I'm hungry."

"Just two more minutes and it can be served." Catra says awkwardly.

"Do you want to eat here or...?" Adora asks.

"We can. Unless you want to go somewhere else?"

"I don't typically eat with my soldiers but I guess here is fine."

"I wouldn't mind going elsewhere if it makes you more comfortable." Catra assures.

"Here is fine." Adora repeats. "I promise." Catra looks at Adora before nodding and purring softly.

"Let me get two bowls and I'll serve us. The cooks should be okay with serving the others." She says, grabbing the bowls and doing as she said she would. Adora accepts the bowl gratefully and then begins eating. Adora makes a pleased sound. Catra knows that Adora can't deny that the soup is good - Catra can hardly believe that she lived off of ration bars for nearly *twenty-three years* of her life.

"Perfect." Adora mumbles between sips.

"Wildcat!" Adora almost drops her bowl at the loud intruding voice. "Wow! I heard we had a guest chef, I didn't think it would be you!" Scorpia picks Catra up - *literally* - from the ground, which Adora frowns at. Catra smiles and pats Scorpia's shoulder.

"Hi there, Scorpia. I made enough for everyone as you can tell. Used all the big pots. Feel free to serve yourself if you don't wanna wait in line." She smiles as she's put back down. "Like I told Adora, cooking is fun for me, and you got new ingredients in, so I wanted to make something yummy for all of you."

"Uh huh," Scorpia says, grabbing herself a bowl. She pauses as she looks at Adora's expression. "Oh, cheer up Boss," Scorpia beams at her and then playfully elbows Catra. "Is she being extra grumpy today?" Scorpia asks Catra.

"I'm not grumpy." Adora deadpans. *That didn't exactly sell it.* Catra laughs a little.

"Not grumpy. Today's been a weird day. That's all." Catra smiles, reassuring the scorpion gal - that might be an understatement if Catra was honest. "I hope you enjoy the soup though."

"Oh, I will, very much." Scorpia says enthusiastically. "... Was I interrupting? Oh geez, I'm sorry guys, I'll leave you two to it."

"You weren't interrupting. We just got our food a minute ago. But thank you." Catra waves her hand in front of her. "Don't worry about it."

"Oh, good!" She says happily. "I'll still leave you two alone, I know how the Boss likes to eat alone. Or alone except for you."

"Thanks. Have a good meal. Tell the others there's food if they haven't heard already." Catra says.

"Will do, Boss' significant other." Scorpia says, like she hadn't just lit a match and walked away. Adora watches her walk away and then she looks at Catra.

Catra blushes at Scorpia's words, not correcting her even though she probably should have. It had been nice to hear her say that and it's not as though Adora had corrected her either. "Ha... Scorpia sure does... say... some crazy things." Adora says awkwardly.

"Y-Yeah, crazy..." Catra says just as awkwardly back.

"Your soup is good." Adora says, sidestepping the sudden awkwardness. "Better than ration bar soup I'm guessing," Adora shudders. "I *never* want to know what ration soup tastes like."

"I think the idea of ration soup is not great just from hearing about it." She cringes a bit. Adora practically *inhales* her soup.

"This is really good." Adora says happily. Catra's heart warms at the sight and she purrs.

"I'm glad you like it." She says as she sips her own soup at a much slower pace.

"You'd probably make a good wife, huh?" Catra almost chokes on her soup at Adora's words but she manages to play it off.

"You... You think so?" Catra asks.

"Sure, maybe you should tell those suitors of yours about your culinary skills." Catra looks disappointed, sipping her soup to distract herself. *What was she thinking anyway? That Adora was suddenly going to ask her to be her wife? Get a grip Catra.*

"Nah..." Catra says after a while.

"No?" Adora asks, sounding a little confused.

"No."

"Okay..." Catra sighs, wishing Adora wasn't so *blind* .

"I usually only cook for special occasions, or to practice by myself." Catra clarifies.

"So why do you cook here?" Catra is frustrated by that question but she decides to just power on through.

"Being here with you *is* a special occasion to me." Catra says.

"Sap." Adora comments as she finishes off her bowl of soup. Catra pouts at her.

"Maybe I am. What's wrong with that?"

"Nothing’s wrong with it."

"Good."

"Just that you're a sap."

"And your point is?"

"My point is," Adora pokes Catra's stomach gently. " *Sap* ." Catra grumbles.

"You make it sound like it's a bad thing." Catra says.

"I'm only teasing." Adora responds, setting her bowl to one side. "Although..."

"Although?" Catra raises a brow.

"Although, I just... Nevermind." Adora says. "Are you ready to go back to my room?"

"Almost done." Catra says, placing her spoon down and grabbing the bowl. She places it to her lips and tilts it back to get the remaining soup.

"How is everything you do extremely sexy to me?" Catra snorts, almost getting soup up her nose as she places the bowl down.

"I'm eating soup, Adora."

"You're eating soup and it's turning me on."

"How?" Catra asks in disbelief.

"I don't know..." Adora says. "Your neck."

"My neck?" Catra's eyebrows go up.

"Yeah..." Adora says. "Maybe... Or maybe it's just you."

"Maybe." Catra smiles and nods, placing their bowls in the sink. "Let's go, hot stuff."

"Good," Adora says, turning on her heel. "I'm ready to sleep off this... weird energy." Catra takes in a deep breath, wanting to say *so much* to that comment but restraining herself.

"I guess we're gonna go to sleep for a little while?" Catra asks.

"Want to do something else?" Adora asks, rolling her shoulders. "I don't think I'm in the *mood* ." Neither is Catra. She thinks if she were to have sex with Adora right now she might have a break down and cry in the middle, and crying in the middle of sex? That's surprisingly *unsexy* to most people. That being said, she wants *conscious* moments with Adora, for as long as she can get them.

"I wouldn't mind doing something else. What do you want to do?" Catra asks.

"I don't know... things feel... off..." Adora comments. Catra can't exactly deny that that's not true. Things have felt kind of off ever since Catra told Adora about Spinnerella and Netossa and even before that. It's her fault. She's the one with the secret, the one who fell for the Horde Lord in their *no strings attached* arrangement.

"Today has been a little weird." Catra mumbles, fidgeting with her fingers. Adora slows down her steps.

"I know you told me that two of the Princesses know about us but..." Adora pauses. "I feel like you're keeping something else from me." *That I caught feelings for you and accidentally mated with you, but I'm afraid that if I tell you, you won't feel the same and I'm also afraid that I'll have to end things between us.*

Catra sighs, shaking her head. "It's nothing." She says, even though inside she's screaming at herself for doing so.

"Right. Nothing." Adora says, and she sounds a little disappointed. "Which is why I suggested we sleep."

"Or, do you want to go up to your place?" Catra suggests.

"... *Our* place." Adora corrects and Catra smiles softly.

"Our place. Do you want to?"

"Sure, why not?" Catra takes Adora's hand, lacing their fingers together and purring as she leads the way. She has a small bounce in her step, happy to spend time with the blonde. She wishes she could find the courage to tell Adora how she feels soon, but the fear seems to overwhelm that courage every single time.

"Adora, how do you feel about this? About... *us* ?" Catra asks hesitantly. Maybe if she could figure out where Adora stood, she could start working up the courage for that confession. Of course, that had the danger of backfiring too.

"How do I feel?" Adora asks, confusion in her voice. Catra hums in confirmation of the question. "Why are you asking me that?"

"I'm... curious." Catra says cryptically.

"I..." Adora shrugs. "I like spending time with you, is that not enough?" Catra presses her lips together. That wasn't the answer that she had wanted.

"It is. I was just curious, like I said." Catra says dismissively.

"Uh huh... curious..." Catra can practically hear the narrowing of Adora's eyes in her tone of voice alone.

"Yeah." Catra walks along the familiar path, Adora close behind. "You gave a pretty straight forward answer."

"Did you want a gay forward answer?"

"Did you really just make that pun?" Catra asks in disbelief but she laughs despite herself.

"Come on! That was good!" Adora protests.

"It was dorky." Catra retorts with an eye roll.

"Speaking of dorky," Adora says. "I saw what you did to one of my posters."

"I have no idea what you're talking about." Catra says, biting back a grin.

"Property of Catra, huh?"

"It's true though."

"Is it?" Adora asks as she starts climbing.

"It is." Catra should probably clarify. Spread around the Fright Zone are posters of Adora. She looks so serious in all of them, her face in a frown, her disapproving gaze, arms crossed over her chest, in her whole Horde Lord get-up. So Catra decided to *maybe* graffiti one of those posters near the throne room. She turned Adora's frown upside down, she wrote 'Catra waz here' in the corner, 'dork' across her forehead and then 'PROPERTY OF CATRA' across her body. Catra had been highly amused by that, if she was honest, and it was all true - to a certain extent. She'd also written something on the back, out of view, but that was a secret she wasn't willing to share yet.

Adora helps Catra up and then walks to the edge of the tower. "Maybe." Catra walks over to her, resting her head against her shoulder and sighing.

"Maybe." Catra repeats. Adora stays silent, staring out over the Fright Zone. Moments like this are what let Catra think about how she caught feelings for Adora. It was so easy. It was bound to happen, even if she didn't know it. Her and Adora truly just *click.* Even when things feel off or weird, Adora is there.

Adora feels like the sun. Warm, and bright, and a light in the dark. Of course Catra got caught in her gravitational pull. They were *inevitable.* "Adora, do you... ever think about how we would have been had we not been on different sides?" Catra ponders.

"Sometimes." Adora admits.

"Really? And what did you come up with?"

"Well, my soldiers love you. If you had been here, you'd probably be my Queen or whatever. Maybe we'd be ruling Etheria together."

"Your Queen?"

"I... uh... yeah? I guess... maybe..." Adora stumbles over her words a little - it’s kind of endearing.

"Maybe? Why me though?" Catra asks.

"Why not you?"

"I wanna know why you chose me, in that hypothetical reality, to be your Queen." Because Adora could have said *anyone* . She wants Adora to open her eyes and *see* .

"I don't know," Adora frowns. "It's... hypothetical."

"You haven't thought about that?" Catra prods further.

"About what?"

"About why you'd choose *me* as your Queen in the hypothetical reality?"

"I guess..." Adora gets a conflicted expression on her face. Catra can see her mind struggling to comprehend the reality of their relationship, maybe she's even afraid to tell Catra the truth - Catra can sympathise with that. But one of them has to take that leap. One of them has to be *brave* , eventually. "I don't know, we'd probably have our little friends with benefits thing going and people really like you?"

"Oh..." Catra purses her lips. "Yeah, probably."

"What about you? Ever think about what we would be like if we weren't on opposite sides?" Catra nods. She had *definitely* thought about it. There were times in which she wished that that's the way things had been because then she wouldn't have to worry about her heart being broken.

"I have."

"Yeah? What'd you think?"

"You'd probably chase all of my suitors away." Catra smiles, giggling at the thought. Adora already marked her up in case a suitor was anywhere near where Adora had been. If they had grown up together? If Adora had been a Princess? Catra would have chosen her as her top suitor immediately, and without hesitation, and Adora would have scared everyone else away - Catra is certain. "We'd have sleepovers in my room..."

"Chase your suitors away?" Adora asks with a little amusement. "Maybe."

"You totally would." Catra laughs. "You'd probably stomp into the meetings and throw me over your shoulder."

"You'd want me to court you like a Princess?"

"Would you?" Catra asks as she looks up at Adora. "Honestly, I feel like we would have grown up friends, courting wouldn't have really been necessary."

"You think we'd grow up as friends?"

"Yeah, or at least we'd become friends later on in life."

"Not growing up in the Horde..." Adora looks out at the Fright Zone. "You know, most of my memories here are bad, but... it's still my home. I do have *some* good memories."

"I'm glad you were able to get some good memories despite everything." Catra purrs a little, her tail coiling around Adora in a comforting way.

"Lately I've felt... aimless..." Adora confesses and Catra's eyebrows stitch together in confusion.

"Aimless?" She asks.

"Distracted... confused..." Adora answers. "Like... I've forgotten my basic training... my goal... it's... all just... fuzzy." Catra hums as she looks at the Horde Lord. Adora may be the Lord but she's just following the motions. She's following the mission that was set out for her, she's not following her own wants and wishes. Now that she's been sleeping with a Princess, Catra's kind of glad that Adora is so confused, it means Catra is right about her being misled - about her being a soldier on auto-pilot.

"Maybe we should all just aim to do what makes us happy." Catra suggests tentatively.

"I don't know what that is anymore."

"Then maybe your goal can be to explore and learn what it is?"

"I'm a soldier, soldiers don't 'explore', we follow orders." Adora shakes her head though her eyes never leave the horizon of the Fright Zone. Catra looks out across it. In the dying moonlight, the Fright Zone is a sea of yellow mixed into its usual green and red. Soldiers were probably either eating dinner, finishing up drills, switching shifts, or going to bed. This is where Adora grew up, she doesn't really know anything beyond the Fright Zone.

"You're a soldier to *who* ?" Catra asks. She turns Adora's head towards her and looks her directly in the eyes. "You do realise *you're* the one that's leading now, right? You get to choose, Adora."

"I..." Adora looks away. "I... Hordak may have been an ass, but he was right about the Princesses."

"Was he?" Catra challenges. Catra is a Princess, yet Adora has confessed that she trusts her, that she likes spending time with her. There's no way Adora actually believes what the Horde told her. She clings onto it like a safety blanket because accepting that the people who raised her, who taught her everything that she knows, lied to her is impossible. She *has* to believe what the Horde told her because the only other option is that they were wrong, which means Adora is wrong, and Catra knows that Adora can't have everything she's done be in vain. It's kind of the perfect mix between brainwashed soldier and stubborn belief.

"I've seen things." Adora responds.

"Could you tell me what you've seen?" Catra asks.

"You do realise your little sparkly friend has almost killed me more than once, right?" Adora asks.

"Ah, Glimmer... she's intense."

"That's putting it lightly," Adora scoffs. "All the Princesses hate me, and they hate the Horde, they think everyone here is scum, they don't even think we're *people* . If you're Horde, you're evil, it's black or it's white to them."

"Not... exactly." Catra sighs. "Maybe a little, but, unlike you, Hordak didn't give a flying fuck about innocent people getting caught in the crossfire - which is why many of the Rebellion members have such a harsh image of the Horde. And... Glimmer's father was killed by Hordak when he was in power."

"Killed?"

"Yes, he was one of the first casualties of the war." And also one of the main reasons that Catra knew Glimmer was going to take this relationship so personally if she ever found out. Adora sighs.

"It's war, people die."

"I know. But what I'm saying is, for Glimmer it was especially personal. Her mom lost her husband and she lost her father. So whenever she thinks of the Horde, she thinks of everything she's lost. You get me?" Catra explains. Honestly, the only parental figure Adora has had is *Shadow Weaver* . So maybe Adora didn’t fully understand the pain that came from the loss of a parent but, then again, Adora hadn’t been able to kill Shadow Weaver - probably because of that weird sense of loyalty she has to her. Catra knows Adora did love Shadow Weaver, even if it was a messed up love that resulted in Shadow Weaver abusing her power and position over the blonde.

"When I think about the Princesses, I think about all the hurt they've caused." Adora says.

"It goes both ways." Catra replies softly, a sad expression on her face. "Even though you're not the one to blame for Micah's death, Glimmer sees the leader of the Horde and nothing

else. Just like you think of all the hurt you've experienced by a handful of the Princesses, you can't see much else, and you think they're all out to get you."

"I guess..." Adora concedes. " *You* see the Horde differently."

" *Now* ." Catra looks up at Adora. "It took spending time with you, with *them,* to really see that we aren't that different. I just wish that we could all come to terms peacefully."

"Like that'll ever happen." Adora says. "I'll roll over in my grave before it does."

"Don't say that." Catra frowns, she doesn't like to think about Adora dying - or anything close to that. "I mean, come on, we didn't get along before either, and yet here we are."

"I can't sleep with every Princess, Catra." Adora says, laughing a little. "I mean, I'm good, but that sounds *exhausting* ."

"That's not what I meant and you know it." Catra shoves Adora, unamused with her little comment.

"We're here because we slept together." Adora points out with a laugh - Catra's tail whips around in irritation. *Why does Adora say the most ignorant things sometimes?*

"I know, but it kind of took a little more than just sleeping together. Even the first time." Catra grumbles, shaking her head. She crosses her arms over her chest and avoids looking at Adora.

"Did it?" Adora asks, raising a brow. "Isn't our entire relationship based on sex?"

"I don't think everything we do is based on sex, Adora." Catra states.

"You don't?" Catra shakes her head and looks to the ground at the question.

"You *do* ?" Catra asks. She bites her lip. She’s afraid to hear Adora’s next words but she needs to know if this really is just sex to Adora or not.

"Well... I just mean... why do you keep coming here if not for the sex?" Adora asks.

"... For *you* ." Catra answers hesitantly.

"Right, sex, with *me* ." Catra almost slaps her own forehead in exasperation.

"Not just sex. I like spending time with you in general, idiot." Catra clarifies.

"I like spending time with you too." Adora says and Catra looks over at her.

"... Just for sex?"

"The sex is pretty great, but no. I like spending time with you in general too. I told you that." Catra smiles at her.

"Just making sure. So why do you think our relationship is entirely based on sex?" Catra asks. She needs clarification because Adora came dangerously close to stabbing her in the heart there.

"Because it *was* , at first," Adora explains. "Even you can't deny that. I mean, sure, we talked, but the only reason we kept seeing each other was for the sex. We literally called ourselves enemies with benefits."

"In the beginning, yeah... in the very beginning. That changed pretty quickly, don't you think?" Catra is fishing here, she’s trying to establish where Adora is and how deeply in denial she is.

"Uh... did it?" Adora asks.

"Do you not think so?"

"I don't know... things... started changing when... you started calling me. That day, when I had a bad day, it was after I had talked to Shadow Weaver." Adora confesses.

"Oh..." Catra presses her lips together softly and she gently hugs Adora. "Did talking help at least?"

"It did... but she... called you *horrible* things. I know it was just to get a rise out of me, and it *worked* ." Adora’s hands ball into fists before she releases them again. Catra sighs.

"You got worked up over what she said about *me* ?" That’s kind of sweet in a way, that Adora was defending her to *Shadow Weaver* feels kind of important. Adora is protective, she’s shown that on many occasions, she just refuses to understand *why* she’s protective. At least she had admitted to Catra that she was important to her and that she cared.

"Yeah, she called you a slut, and a whore Princess, and it upset me."

"Do you think what she said was true?"

" *No* !" Adora exclaims, her eyes widening as she whips her head in Catra’s direction. "No, *of course not* ! I would *never* think that about you."

"Thank you, for being protective of my honour." Catra smiles softly and kisses Adora on her cheek. She was relieved not only because Adora clearly didn’t think that was true about Catra

but that she didn’t *always* believe everything that Shadow Weaver told her.

"But she was right about one thing," Adora says. "I'm distracted from my mission. I keep retreating from battles, I barely even perform them anymore unless it's to kidnap you. I'm... basically purposely forfeiting."

"I mean, is it so bad if no one is getting hurt as a result?" Catra asks. "With the battles cut so short, there hasn't been any major injuries on either side."

"It's bad if I *fail* !" Adora says with alarm and… *fear* .

"Fail?" Catra probes, wanting to get to the bottom of Adora’s anxiety.

"Fail my mission!" Adora answers. "Failing is bad, I *can't* fail. But that's inevitable if I keep retreating." Ah, that was Adora’s worry. Catra knows that Shadow Weaver used to punish Adora whenever she ‘failed’ whatever impossible standard she had set for her. It wasn’t fair to Adora at all that she still had to feel like that.

"What's your mission, Adora?" Catra asks gently.

"My mission?"

“Yeah. What's your mission?"

"My mission... is to... stop the Princesses... at any cost. To crush the Rebellion, to... to make Etheria... safe... and orderly." She answers.

"Okay, why?"

"W-Why?" Adora clearly hadn’t been expecting that question.

"Why is that your mission?" Catra asks her softly, looking directly into her eyes. She needs Adora to understand that she’s just following some order that she was set as a cadet, that this isn’t really what she *wants*.

"You wouldn't understand." Adora says dismissively.

"Then help me. Explain it to me."

"It's what I was raised to believe." Adora says. "The Princesses... everything the Horde taught me... I could *never* trust a Princess not to hurt me, and they *have* hurt me. And She-Ra... I can control her sometimes, but when I can't?" Adora pauses. "Her power is *destructive* , it's too strong, Princesses shouldn't have that kind of power."

"I see..." Catra hums. Adora doesn’t seem to realise the contradictions in her words.

"You see?" Adora asks. Catra looks up at Adora.

"Yeah, it's hard to trust someone that you've been told is evil since you were little. I get that, even more so since you grew up in the midst of the war just like I did."

"And you're... okay with that?"

"Not... exactly. But I understand your reasoning behind it." Catra says, moving away from Adora for a moment to sit down. "It’s like how on our side we saw people we knew and cared about being hurt and even killed by the Horde, so we automatically believe that the Horde is evil, but we tend to forget that there's a lot more that we can't exactly see on the battlefield."

"Maybe." Adora says, sitting down beside Catra. "I am a Princess, I understand them more than you might think."

"Not really." Catra says quickly. "The way in which you see Princesses, you see us as harmful beings that want to destroy everything and use our powers doing it. Except that's not the case at all." Adora sighs.

"This entire war is older than both of us."

"I know, it is older than both of us." Catra looks up into the sky. "This used to be a Kingdom, you know? The Queens were killed by Hordak and the land was taken over." Adora frowns a little.

"That's not what we were told, that's not what Scorpia says."

"What were you told?" Catra asks, looking at the blonde.

"That Hordak crash landed here, that the Princesses didn't like him from the beginning, that they turned him away and the only people who accepted him were the Scorpions. That Scorpia's parents surrendered their Kingdom *willingly* because they'd always been looked down on by the Princesses for being different, because that's what the Princesses do. They see people who don't fit their perfect little world and they cast them out. They did it to Scorpia's parents, they did it to Hordak, and they did it to me. They do it to *everyone* here." Adora says, her eyes a little darker than usual. "Say what you want about the Horde, but we *never* look down on others. Everyone in the Horde is an outcast, but we're outcasts *together* ."

"Adora... that's not at all what happened." Catra whispers. "Scorpia is a little older than us, but probably not old enough to remember. Hordak captured the Queens, he took over the Scorpion Kingdom. This was one of the first battles that ever took place against the Horde, the battle where Micah died." She frowns. "We don't cast people aside, Adora. We've had people from the Horde come to us, wanting to live a normal life, and we've *welcomed* them."

"You're lying." Catra does *not* like being called a liar but she can appreciate that Adora is being told that pretty much everything she knows is wrong.

"Adora, look at me." She whispers, placing her hand on top of the other's. "I don't have any reason to lie to you about that. I've actually been one of the people that helps make sure Ex-Horde soldiers settle in okay to their new life." She explains. "Ava, Jasper, Rais and many more of them."

"People don't leave the Horde, Catra, and if they ever dared to try... they're sent to Beast Island." Adora shudders a little.

"People *have* , Adora." Catra whispers. "And they've made it to us safely."

"No..." Adora shakes her head. "That *can't* be true." Catra lifts Adora's hand.

"I can show you." Catra suggests. She doesn't think Adora will believe her without at least *some* proof.

"Show me?"

"Mhmm." Catra smiles at her. "I can call one of them. I keep in contact with them to make sure they're doing well."

"Wouldn't that out our relationship?" Adora asks.

"Hm, I mean, I could call and you can just listen in and look enough to see their face but for them to not see you?"

"... Okay." She agrees.

"Okay, shall we go back to your room then?" Catra asks.

"Probably," Adora stands and helps Catra to her feet.

"Thank you." Catra says, beginning to climb back down. "Do you want me to call anyone in particular? Do you remember any names?"

"Well, there was a guy in our squad. Shadow Weaver said that they were sent to Beast Island for betraying the Horde..."

"What was their name?"

"Uh... I think their name was... Jax?"

"Oh! Jax! Yeah, I can call them!"

"Wait... they... actually got out?" Catra beams and nods at the blonde. "Huh... interesting."

"Interesting?" Catra asks.

"Well yeah, I thought they got sent to Beast Island. If you're not lying then... that's something else Shadow Weaver lied to me about." Catra hums softly as they make it to Adora's bedroom.

Catra grabs her com-pad, sitting down somewhere where it didn't look too much like the Fright Zone. "Okay, let me see... Jax... Jax... there we are." She gestures for Adora to sit down with her as she dials the number. Adora sits beside Catra, her hand playing gently with Catra's hip, fingers ghosting over her. It’s nice, relaxing, Catra almost starts purring.

The com-pad rings a few times before someone on the other end picks up. "Hello?" Catra smiles.

"Jax, hi! How are you doing?" They grin and wave at the brunette.

"Catra! How are you? I'm doing great! I was helping bring some produce into the shop before you called. What's up?" Catra shakes her head.

"Not much, just wanted to see how you were doing since it's been awhile since we've talked."

"Oh! I'm doing good." They reply happily. "I'm pretty settled in here." Adora's eyes widen as she sees them and she looks at Catra. Catra almost laughs at her expression.

"That's good. You let me know if you ever need anything at all, okay?" Catra reminds them. "No one has been giving you any trouble, right?"

"No..." They reply. "That was only an issue when I first came here."

"Just wanted to make sure." Catra purrs softly. "I'm glad that you're settled in okay. I'll let you go for now, since you're at work."

"Of course! Thank you, Catra, for your call, and everything else. I hope you're doing well too."

"I am, thank you for asking. Good luck at work today! I'll pass by one of these days if I can." Catra smiles and waves at Jax through the camera, exchanging goodbyes before hanging up.

"Wow... you weren't lying." Adora says, sitting back a little.

"I had no reason to lie to you, Adora." Adora sighs, she takes the com-pad from Catra's hands and sets it to one side. She then pulls Catra down on the bed.

"I..." Adora pauses. "Well... you are part of the Rebellion, so... I figured you *did* have a reason to lie."

"I wouldn't have lied to you, not about that. I have no reason to lie to you *at all* , Adora." She whispers, grabbing her hand and playing with her fingers. "They're safe."

"I guess the Horde lied..." Adora says, trailing her fingers over Catra.

"Yeah." Catra peers at her, trying to see if Adora is okay, but she's sometimes extremely hard to read and Catra just isn't sure how exactly she's feeling or what she's thinking.

"Can I kiss you?" Adora asks and Catra lets out a soft sigh, a smile crossing her lips.

"Please do." Adora smiles and kisses Catra slowly, lifting her hand to cup her jaw. Catra's heart begins beating in her chest, *hard* , as Adora kisses her. Maybe today has been weird between them but Catra always feels better when kissing Adora. Maybe she could tell her *now.*

Catra sighs softly, tangling her fingers in Adora's hair, she purrs as their lips meet again. "My Adora..."

"Your Adora." Adora whispers back between kisses.

"Are you okay?" Catra asks, because she wants to know *exactly* how Adora is feeling.

"Am I okay?" Adora asks with a chuckle. "Do I seem like I'm not?" Catra noses her cheek gently.

"I want to make sure you're alright, it's probably a lot."

"I'm okay," Adora answers. "You're here. I just... I want to kiss you and hold you."

"Okay, if that's what my... my Adora wants."

"My Kitten." Adora says back, kissing her again.

"Yours." Catra purrs softly in agreement.

Now they were just enjoying each other's company, which wasn't unusual but something about it was... different. Catra was exhausted already but she's reminded of what Netossa and Spinnerella said about how maybe Adora had caught feelings, and Catra *needed* to know, because she *loves* her. She knows that now. She loves Adora *so much*. She never stood a chance. She didn't view her as her enemy anymore, and when she looked at her... her heart softened rather than hardened.

She swallows as Adora runs her hand down her arm gently. Adora's usually more open after having sex, which they haven't had, but they *are* cuddling, maybe now was the time she finally had that talk that Spinnerella and Netossa had told her to have. It was now or never.

"I can see you thinking Catra," Adora says, her voice coloured with amusement. She leans in and kisses Catra's forehead. "What's going on in that brain of yours?" Adora laces their fingers together and kisses her fingers. Her actions are so soft and… *loving* . Catra hopes against all hope that Adora feels the same way.

"I was... thinking… about us." Catra whispers softly, her eyes lighting up with Adora's sweet gesture. She could feel her heart squeeze ever so slightly at the thought of the conversation that she would need to start. "About... everything." There was a lot running through her mind, making it race with words that she would have to communicate. There was no going back. Not anymore.

"About us?" Adora asks curiously. Her brows furrow a little, probably form the nerves that Catra could feel bubbling in her chest and making her fur stand on end. "What do you mean?"

"Have you... noticed that things... have felt different than when we first started?" Catra phrases her words carefully, watching for Adora's reaction. She knows she's already brought this up, but this time she has a completely different goal in mind. "It hasn't been the same since we first started seeing each other."

"Well, I mean..." Adora shuffles a little. "I guess it has been a little different? But... we didn't really... know each other like we do now."

"That is true, but I mean... with our sessions too, and how we spend time while I'm here." Catra sighs. "It's changed, *a lot* , actually."

"I don't know what you mean." Adora takes her hand away from Catra. Catra's heart contracts painfully in her chest. There Adora goes again, withdrawing. "We're just... nothing's changed."

"You really think that nothing has changed?" Catra doesn't understand how Adora can say one thing at one time and then turn around and deny it the next. Catra thinks she's afraid, she's afraid of how she feels, and she's confused, and she keeps contradicting herself, but it *hurts* Catra whenever she does.

"I..." Adora diverts her gaze. "I mean... no? Our agreement still stands?" Catra sighs, upset at Adora as she sits up on the bed.

"Guess I'm the only one who thought something was different." Adora won't even acknowledge that the sex they've been having is different she's so deep in denial. Catra can't keep doing this. Netossa and Spinnerella are right, she has to either end this or she has to know Adora feels the same.

"Come on Catra," Adora sits up, crossing her legs. "what did you think was different?" Adora asks, genuinely.

"We've hardly been going rough anymore. We cuddle all the time. We kiss every chance that we get... You really want to say that nothing has changed for you?" Catra frowns deeply, looking away from the blonde.

She regrets starting this conversation now but knows that it's necessary even if it is painful. A part of her wishes that Spinnerella and Netossa hadn't brought the need for this conversation to be had at all, Catra was enjoying her ignorance of her feelings blissfully, but this was something that she *needed* to do. Either she'd need to see if Adora felt the difference as well, or if she would have to entirely cut her out of her life for good before she got more attached than she already was.

"I... I guess that's true..." Adora plays with a loose thread on her pants. "Do you want to go rough?"

"That's not what I'm talking about! That wasn't the point of me pointing that out, Adora!" Catra buries her face in her hands, frustrated at Adora's avoidance of the situation. She always does this. She always manages to completely miss the point. Catra smooths the fur on her tail down.

"Then what *is* your point?" Adora asks. Catra can tell she's… *frustrated* but not angry - not yet. "Can you just tell me? Yes we've changed how we have sex. So what? Things like that change all the time." Catra can't believe Adora. She scratches the back of her head.

"Look... fuck buddies don't normally act like *this* , Adora. *Especially* not fuck buddies that are supposed to be *enemies* . So what's going on?"

"We're not- I mean... we *are* fuck buddies and... we are enemies... technically, but I mean... when we're alone we're just... us?" Adora fiddles with her fingers. "Does that make sense?"

"And what is *us* ? What *are* we?" Catra asks Adora, waiting for an answer. "We... I... I need to know..." Catra sighs. "We... I need to know what you think about us... what you want out of this, because I need to figure out what to do."

"What do you mean what to do? I didn't realise there were things you had to do?" Adora sounds... angry and she's clearly *getting* angry, because when she doesn't understand, or doesn't know, or when she's questioned, she gets angry - she always has.

"Adora... we... I got caught..."

"You got caught?" Adora shrugs. "You already told me that."

"Yes, I did, but I got *caught* . Why don't you understand what that means? Why I'm trying to figure out this- *us* . Why I *need* to." Catra looks tired as she meets Adora's gaze. "Only two of the Princesses know, I had to explain the situation to them, and they haven't told anyone, but... I need to know where we stand, Adora."

"Why does that change anything? Where we stand?" Adora asks, looking away from Catra. "We got caught. So what? Do you want to end things? It's not like we can continue, right?" Catra looks at Adora's reaction, or lack thereof, and feels her heart shattering. Maybe this was just sex to Adora after all.

"... So that's it? This really meant *nothing* to you? At all?" Catra asks. Adora works her jaw from side to side. Adora is *exceptionally* good at ignoring her feelings, and pushing them down, but Catra is *begging* her to just let herself *feel,* just for once, for her to not push Catra away because she's afraid of letting herself *love* . She doesn't look at Catra.

"Did it mean something to you beyond the fact that you got to fuck the Horde Lord?" Catra lets out a bitter laugh of disbelief.

"You are *such* an *idiot* ! Why are you acting like this, Adora?!" Catra yells at her, eyes shimmering with tears of frustration.

"Acting like what?!"

"Like… like this doesn't mean anything to you!"

"No? I'm acting like I always do? You've never had a problem with it before?!" Catra runs her fingers through her hair, grunting in irritation.

"So what? We're just gonna pretend that this entire time it's been sex and fucking, nothing else? Are you kidding?" Adora already told her that it wasn't. Catra doesn't understand. She feels… a pain in her chest. A dull ache that has the potential to rip through Catra and leave her *empty* .

"I-" Adora freezes. "That's... that's... exactly what we agreed to?" Catra shakes her head at that answer. *Why is it so hard for Adora to* ***see*** *the truth? Why won't she just* ***admit it.***

"We agreed to fucking, not everything else in between!" Catra explodes.

"What are you talking about? Everything else in between?" Catra buries her face in her hands.

"We agreed to *sex* ! Not anything else! No cuddles, no kisses, no softness, no stories, not anything else we've done outside of sex!"

"Okay, well... do you not want to do that stuff anymore?"

"Are you- Are you *serious* right now?!" Catra pinches the bridge of her nose. *How can one person be so smart, and say the things Adora has said, and* ***still*** *not* ***get it*** ?!

"Obviously I'm serious! Catra... I don't understand? We agreed to sex, no strings attached."

"I just want to know if any of that meant anything to you..."

"I... I..." Adora struggles to find her words. "I thought this was just... sex..." Catra looks dejected. Maybe Adora didn't think it was *just sex* but she clearly didn't feel the way Catra felt. Maybe she thought of Catra as a friend. Whatever it was, it was clear that Adora was *not* in love with her. Catra was *crushed.*

"It stopped being just sex a long time ago, Adora. That's why I'm asking if everything else meant anything to you."

"I..." Adora swallows thickly before she frowns a little. "Is this because of your Princess friends?"

"Can you just answer the question please?"

"I don't know Catra! It was... nice... I didn't realise it was supposed to mean something to me? How do you even know if something *does* mean something to you?"

"Because... because you *feel* different than what you ever have before." Catra says. She knows Adora feels different, she *has* to.

"... I don't... Why does this even matter?" Catra groans and rubs her face before pushing her bangs back.

"Because I caught feelings for you!" She yells back, all the stress of the situation prompting her to say it. She freezes when she realises what she's just done. "I... I need to go." Adora shakes her head at the sudden admission.

"Wait, Catra... you... what?" She reaches out and grabs Catra by her arm.

"Nothing... just forget about it." Catra can't bring herself to look up at Adora. Tears were threatening to spill from her eyes at that point. "Maybe... maybe we should call this off..."

"What? No! Maybe you should come back to bed and we can talk about this?"

"Talk about what? It doesn't matter, Adora! It's not like talking about this will make a difference!"

"I don't understand, it's not like anything has changed?"

"I... are you kidding me, Adora? Did you really just say that?"

"... Yes?" Adora shrugs. "We... we can keep doing what we're doing." Catra takes a deep breath in and tugs her hand away from Adora's grip.

"Don't you get it? I've caught feelings for you... I'm in *love* with you! I'm in love with someone I can never have! This changes *everything* ! We... we need to stop..."

"You... you're... you're in *love* with me?!" Adora's eyes widen and, if this had been any other situation, Catra may have laughed. But this isn't funny. Catra can think of nothing less funny than having her heart being stamped on.

"What the hell did you think 'caught feelings for you' meant?!" Catra shoves Adora away.

"I don't know! But I'm... I'm the *Lord of the Horde* ... how... you *love* me?!" Catra laughs in disbelief.

"Because the Lord of the Horde isn't all you are, idiot! You're *Adora* , the girl that loves kisses and likes to be held! The one that likes when her hair is played with. The one that likes it when I sing to her before bed. You're the one that gives me forehead kisses to say hello, and carries me around because you like me being close. The one who makes sure I have food while I'm here, and that no one ever hurts me. The one who's been so gentle with me outside of the bedroom that you literally won my heart, you idiot!"

"Catra..." Adora stands and walks to where Catra was standing. "Why don't you... why don't you stay?"

"Why should I?! It's not like you'll ever feel the same anyway." Catra wipes her tears away quickly. She can cry elsewhere, later.

"If you stay with me, then we... we can take down the Rebellion... together." Adora says and Catra looks at her with utter disbelief.

"I- *no* !"

"No?" Adora frowns. "So you love me but you won't stay with me?"

"Adora... you..." Catra pinches the bridge of her nose. "Adora... I can't choose between you and all of my family and friends. I love and care about them too."

"You love and care about them *more* ."

"That's not true! Adora, are you really doing this?! Are you really trying to use my feelings for you against them?" Catra looks at Adora, *devastated* . "Maybe telling you was a mistake... if I had known you'd try to manipulate me like this..."

"Admit it Catra, I'm just a project to you." Adora remains calm but it’s her scary calm - her angry calm. "Why else would you sleep with the Horde Lord? Hm? Did you hope you could *change* me?"

"Of course not! For fuck's sake, Adora! This was supposed to be a *one time* thing, remember?! You seriously think I planned to fall in love with you?!" Catra yells back, tears streaming down her cheeks. "You were never a project to me..." Her yells go down to a whisper, her voice cracking from the sheer emotion she spoke with.

"I never intended to change you... I was just happy *being* with you... getting to see sides of you that I would have never known existed. I slept with you because you made me *feel* something... something that I never felt with anyone else. Every person I ever met, I never felt like we clicked, but with you... it was different." Catra lets out a teary laugh. "I guess I'm fucking stupid for falling in love with my enemy. I shouldn't have said anything. I'm sorry if I ever made you feel like I was trying to change you because that was *never* my intention. Please excuse me." Catra's voice breaks as a sob rips through her as she turns around, beginning to walk away from Adora.

Something must *break* inside of Adora because she stops Catra before she can get too far; hugging her around her waist, her knees hit the floor and her head presses to Catra's back. "Please don't leave me Catra, *please* ."

"What do you want me to do then?" Catra asks weakly. "You're asking me to stay with you and help you hurt my friends and family, and when I tell you no, you get angry at me and say I love them more than you. I don't even know how you feel. Why are you going this far for someone you don't even have feelings for?"

"I..." Adora lets Catra go and slumps down, looking dejected. "I don't know how I feel... but I... you're the only person I've ever... I was *She-Ra* with you." Catra turns around, kneeling down in front of Adora.

"You need to figure out what you want, what matters most to you, because, until you do, we can't try to figure any of this out, Adora." She whispers, kissing Adora's forehead. "Because what you say makes the difference on how everything goes right now." Adora takes a shaky breath in and then looks up at Catra. Her blue eyes almost seem bluer. She balls her hands into fists and steels those blue eyes of her's, she schools her expression into a harder one. Catra's stomach swoops uncomfortably at the expression. It is *entirely* too emotionless to mean anything good.

"It doesn't matter anyway. I'm the Horde Lord and you're... you're a *Princess* , this was never going to work out anyway. We always had an expiration date." Catra looks heartbroken but she finds strength within herself to nod, forcing a smile.

"Okay… Okay." Her breath stutters. "I... then you can just forget everything I said, yeah? You can pretend we never were... anything. We can go back to being enemies." Catra bites the inside of her cheek as she stands up. "Goodbye, Horde Lord." She breathes, looking away

from Adora and forcing herself to walk away quickly, heading out of the throne room for the last time and out of the Fright Zone.

Catra makes it out of the Fright Zone and into the Whispering Woods before she finally breaks down. She curls up against a tree, crying her eyes out. Her heart hurt and she was in distress. She cries for a while, her wails somehow not alerting any nearby creatures - though maybe the Woods were being kind upon seeing her suffer. She forces herself to stand, walking forward and not heading to Bright Moon or Half-Moon. Instead, she heads towards where Spinnerella and Netossa live, the two of them having been her only support system in this entire situation.

Adora didn't love her. She'd *lost* her *mate* .

* * *

Adora sits. And she sits. And she sits. It's hours before she finds the strength to pull herself up from the ground and into her bed. The sound of Catra calling her Horde Lord on repeat in her mind.

She isn't sure how long passes before she crawls out of her bed again. She feels numb. She was confused and… hurt. Catra was important to her and now she was gone. She left her. Adora thought it had been for the best. When Catra had told her to figure out how she felt… Adora had thought it would be better to break Catra's heart a little now, rather than a lot later when they were on the battlefield. They were *enemies* and Adora had allowed herself to become *distracted* - like Shadow Weaver said.

There was more, try as she might to push the doubt away, Adora was still certain that no one could love her. It didn't make sense. How could Catra love someone like her? Part of her wondered if this had all been some trick to betray her all along, that maybe Catra didn't love her at all. Not that it mattered anymore anyway.

Adora walks to her throne room and stops at the foot of her throne. Her eyes scan over the claw marks there. She feels this blinding hot anger, right at the centre of her chest. Adora has *never* been good at keeping her temper under wraps. As a kid, and a cadet, she used to get into a lot of fights, she'd get frustrated with people, someone would do something she didn't like, or she'd get overwhelmed, and it made her *angry* . Shadow Weaver used to punish her

for it, she told her to harness her anger and focus it on putting it to use. Adora, however, never fully grew out of her lashing out in anger.

She pulls her sword from her side and begins hitting her throne, over, and over, and over, again. Her sword leaves sharp lines in the metal. She turns and sees the potted plant still sitting on her table. She picks it up and throws it, the pot shatters and soil goes *everywhere* . Adora is a tornado, and she rips through her throne room, taking her anger out on anything and everything that comes into her path. By the time she feels calmer, her throne room is a *mess.*

Someone enters and she turns, her bangs fall over her face and the soldier completely freezes in their path. " *GET OUT!* " Adora screams and the soldier scrambles out of the room before Adora can do much else. She stands up straight, panting and exhausted. She fixes her uniform and lets out a deranged laugh as she flips her bangs back out of her face. "Horde Lord." She murmurs as she looks at her throne and the Horde symbol. Catra didn't love her. *She didn't* . She would still be here if she did, she wouldn't have left, she was *lying* . She was going to show them *exactly* who the Horde Lord was. "Oh Catra…. Look what you made me do Kitten."

Chapter End Notes

Well, I did warn you all to enjoy it while it lasts... -M

The angst tag is right there!! Don't worry too much... I will say, I relate a LOT to Adora in this chapter, feelings are hard to figure out >:(See y'all next time!! -S

Also, we appreciate all of y'all's comments and kudos, thank you for all the support on this fic!!

Loss and Grief

Chapter Summary

> "You don't think that Catra... That the Horde Lord is her mate?" Spinnerella asks.
>
> "I mean, she's really upset... destroyed even." Netossa says. "And given everything she told us before, I think she may have unconsciously mated with her."
>
> "Oh fuck."

Chapter Notes

> Happy Friday to y'all!! Another update and this one isn't as chunky as the last two chapters :P We hope that you enjoy reading and we will see you all again next week with another update! Thank you!!

See the end of the chapter for more notes

Catra could hardly keep herself standing by the time she knocked on Spinnerella and Netossa's door. She was tired physically and emotionally and all she wanted to do was cry. She felt *empty* . As though a piece of her had been taken out, leaving her hollow. Her glassy eyes showed that clearly to anyone who could see her.

"Honey?" Catra's ears twitch when she hears the muffled voice behind the door before they press back against her head again.

"I got it!" Catra hears Netossa's footsteps as she walks to the door and opens it to see Catra standing there. She's sure she looks a *mess.* She hadn't been able to stop herself from breaking down in the Whispering Woods and she had barely managed to drag herself all this way to Spinnerella and Netossa.

Netossa opens her mouth, as though she were about to ask Catra what she was doing there, but when she takes in Catra's appearance the words die in her throat. "Catra? Are you okay?"

"It's over." Catra whispers, her voice hoarse from crying in the forest. "I've lost her." She says quietly, eyes glancing up to look directly at Netossa. She was *heartbroken.* Catra couldn't even begin to describe the amount of *pain* she was in. Pain so bad that it stabbed her right in the heart. It felt like someone had their hand wrapped around her heart and *just kept squeezing* .

"Oh, Catra..." Netossa softens and helps her inside, closing the door behind her. "You ended it?" Catra nods weakly in response. She doesn't talk much, eyes now back down on the floor as she shrinks into herself. Even just speaking hurt her. She couldn't… She just *couldn't.*

"'Tossa? Who-" Spinnerella stops in her tracks as soon as she sees Catra standing at the door. "Catra? Sweetie, are... are you okay?" Netossa shoots her wife a look. "You want to tell us what happened?" Spinnerella presses on. Catra sniffles a bit, shaking her head.

"Not really." She didn't want to. It would just rub salt on the wounds of her heart. She thinks about the emotionless face Adora gave her as she told her ' *we always had an expiration date* '. Catra almost feels like she might collapse again.

"Did she hurt you?" Netossa asks. "Because, I *swear,* I will go to the Fright Zone *right now* and kick her ass." Netossa looks like she really means those words but Catra doesn't even think she wants that. Adora may have broken her heart, but she didn't want Adora to be hurt. Catra almost wants to slap herself for being so stuipid. She's *never* going to be able to hurt Adora *ever* again - not even in battle - it goes against her every instinct now that she's bonded to her as her mate. She's *fucked* .

"I ended things... that's it." Catra answers simply. She doesn't think she has the energy to explain the dirty details to Spinnerella and Netossa. She doesn't have the *strength* to relive it. Netossa and Spinnerella share a look.

"Do you want some hot chocolate, or tea, or... anything else?" Spinnerella asks.

"Tea please." Catra whispers, settling down on the nearby couch and curling up into a ball. Spinnerella disappears into the kitchen to make the tea and Netossa sits down across from Catra.

"Catra, I know it's rough but… you told us this was only about sex?" Catra curls up tighter, hiding her face in her knees.

"I was wrong. I'm so *stupid* , Netossa. I fell in love with someone I can *never* have." Her shoulders shake as she begins to cry. She's lost Adora forever. Netossa clearly doesn't know what to say, so she just sits down beside Catra and lays a hand to her back to try to comfort her.

"Hey, I mean, you're probably better off, right? The Horde Lord? I mean she's- Shoot, Spinny is always better at this kind of thing." Catra sighs at Netossa's attempt to make her feel better about the breakup.

"She's not just that. She... she's *so much* more than that." Catra gives a weak smile before crying again. "It doesn't matter. Not anymore." Netossa remains silent, probably because she really doesn't want to say she told Catra so - but she really *did* tell Catra so. Netossa warned her to be careful but Catra didn't *listen* . She had allowed herself to fall in love with *Adora* . Let herself *hope.* It was a *mistake.*

Netossa sighs and offers Catra the comfort of a cuddle. "Look, that's Adora's loss, right? Fuck her. She would be lucky to have you."

"Even if she felt the same, it's not like I could ever have her." Catra whispers. "My moms would *never* approve, all of my friends would hate me, they'd never understand. And... I've lost her." Her heart squeezes in her chest, her eyes spilling more tears. "I've lost her and I'm never getting her back."

"Catra..." Netossa pauses for a moment, clearly considering her next words carefully. "Look, I mean, she... *You* seem to think Adora was a good person. Maybe she'll change her mind about you, and the war, and everything..."

"She doesn't feel the same, Netossa! She said we... That it didn't mean anything to her! I told her that I *loved* her! I told her, like an idiot," She lets out a teary laugh. "And she didn't feel the same. I'm so fucking *stupid* ."

"Did she *say* she didn't feel the same?"

"She might as well have. She wanted me to choose between the Rebellion, my friends, my *family* , and *her,* if I was to prove my love to her. It didn't matter to her. We had an expiry date... it would have... could have *never* been. She said so herself." Catra whispers. "I wonder if she really meant anything that she did and said..." She bites her lip thinking about all the moments they shared. She wonders if Adora had been playing her all along, if she ever really cared. Had all the times Adora kissed her, and held her, and *been* with her, a lie? Catra was sure she hadn't imagined the way Adora had been with her wrong. She was soft, and gentle, and kind, and she… she said that Catra was *important* to her! How did she go from that to this?

Catra had half the mind to be angry, and maybe a part of her was. She was understanding of Adora's upbringing, of her emotional constipation, of *everything* , but where do you draw the line? How much of yourself do you give before it's too much? There *has* to be a limit. And Catra ignored all of the signs. She had given too much. She had fallen in love with someone who-

Catra closes her eyes.

No . Adora could love, she just didn't know it. She was not about to brand Adora as unlovable like Shadow Weaver had, that was the cause of all of this. Still, she wished that Adora knew how *incredible* she was, how *lovable* she is, because she is. She needs to figure herself out before she becomes someone she was never meant to be.

"Well, maybe she said it wrong?" Netossa suggests. "When she wanted you to choose between her and us, maybe she was pointing out how... Well... How would you be with her? If Adora had told you that she felt the same, how would you two be together?"

"We probably wouldn't have. It would never have worked, but at least we could have *trie* d."

"From what you told us, it really seemed like she had feelings for you. At least, Spinny said that."

"Well she was wrong." Catra frowns deeply, looking away from Netossa. "I'm tired." Catra didn't want to talk about Adora anymore. It hurt too much. She couldn't believe she *mated* with her. She just had to go ahead and make a stupid, dumb, *mistake,* like that.

Spinnerella re-enters the room with a tray that had steaming hot tea and some snacks on the side. "Here, this is just what you need." Catra mumbles a quiet thanks to her but doesn't even move from her curled up position. She really meant it when she said she was tired.

"We need to tell your moms that you're here." Netossa says.

"No! I... I need to shower first." Catra says, her ears somehow move further back against her head and her heart pounds in her chest in anxiety. She was *not* about to expose her relationship with Adora to her moms when it had a) ended so badly and b) she had mated with the *Horde Lord* and c) there was no relationship to tell them about anymore anyway. If they smelt Adora on her when she was supposedly out on a scouting mission, combined with… her scent of sadness and grief, it would be game over.

"They won't come right away," Netossa says, seemingly instantly understanding what Catra meant and choosing not to comment on it. "I'll tell them that you're okay and resting. They'll have to travel from Half-Moon to here, we have time." Catra nods silently. She doesn't need to say much else. If she was being honest with herself, the last people that she wanted to see were her moms - because they'd just ask a million questions that Catra *couldn't* answer.

Spinnerella looks at her wife and then at Catra and then back at her wife, clearly worried. She makes a motion with her head to go somewhere private before gently rubbing Catra's back. "Catra, honey, we'll be right back, okay? Please drink the tea and eat something, okay?" Catra shrugs, not giving Spinnerella much else to go off of, she didn't have the energy. She really felt like someone had ripped her heart right out of her chest.

* * *

Spinnerella gestures for Netossa to follow her to their bedroom and closes the door. "Catra's never acted like this before." Spinnerella was beyond worried for the Magicat.

"Well, she's never had a breakup before." Netossa points out. "Even if it is the Lord of the Horde." Spinnerella rolls her eyes at her wife. It didn't really matter that Adora was the Lord of the Horde. What mattered was that, to Catra, Adora was someone *special* and now she was gone.

"Netossa, she doesn't even want to move from where she's at right now. I'm *worried* ." Catra had looked heartbroken, her usually lively tail had hung lifelessly with the occasional flick, her ears were practically permanently pinned back and her eyes seemed dim and distant, like she wasn't fully there.

"What can we do?" Netossa asks. "I haven't had a breakup since I was a teen."

"The best we can do is just be there for her. She really seems to be beating herself up over their... arrangement ending." Spinnerella whispers, eyebrows furrowed in concern. Spinnerella had known that it was deeper than 'just sex' but now she was starting to realise that maybe it was a lot *deeper* than she first suspected it to be. Maybe this wasn't about their 'enemies with benefits' arrangement ending, maybe this was about *more.*

"Didn't you say something about... you know... the Magicat thing? Mating?" Netossa questions. Usually, Spinnerella would find her wife's puzzlement cute but this was not amusing. If Catra had mated with Adora then…

"You don't think that Catra... That the Horde Lord is her mate?" Spinnerella asks.

"I mean, she's really upset... *destroyed* even." Netossa says. "And given everything she told us before, I think she may have unconsciously mated with her."

"Oh fuck." Spinnerella was distressed by that. She knew that Netossa had a point but still, if Catra had mated with Adora, there was no way that that would end well for either of them. "This... This just got *way* more complicated than we thought it could have."

"Did it?" Spinnerella sighs, pinching the bridge of her nose at her wife's question.

"Netossa, if Catra really is mated to the Horde Lord, what she's doing right now is *grieving* . Do you know how bad that can be for Magicats?" Spinnerella asks her wife with wide eyes.

"... No?"

"'Tossa... You really don't know?"

"I'm not a Magicat Spinny, how do you know all this stuff?"

"I always liked learning about different cultures, dear. You know that." Spinnerella gives her a brief smile before frowning again. "But when Magicats become bonded with their mate, their souls become one. So when a Magicat loses their mate, they're left feeling as though a part of themselves is gone and it impacts them *really* badly." She pauses, biting her lip. "When a Magicat goes into grieving, it's really hard to get them out of it. That's why, in history, Magicats that were mated, and then lost their mate, soon follow after."

" *What* ?!" Netossa's eyes widen in alarm. "You're saying Catra could *die* ?!"

"I'm not sure if it will be the same way, since her mate is still alive, but... it is a possibility." Spinnerella looks sad as she speaks those words. Catra probably didn't even mean to, which almost makes it worse. She had fallen in love with Adora and bonded with her in a way that was infinitely more intimate than anything known to Etherians who were not Magicats. She is one with Adora in mind, body and soul, and then Adora told her that she didn't feel the same. Maybe Adora didn't die, but Catra *lost* her all the same.

"Maybe her moms can help? You know? There's nothing like motherly love. Even if Catra can't tell them who her mate is- was..." Netossa pauses for a moment before she gets a look that Spinnerella recognises as her worried look. "I'm not convinced that this meant nothing to Adora and, if it *did* mean something to her, she's probably... you know... upset. And Catra told us about her anger issues. Things have been less... The Horde hasn't really made a real move in a while, but if Adora is angry and upset... What if she lashes out?"

"I'm worried that C'yra and Luna may not approach this situation carefully enough. I don't think any parent would be ready for their daughter to be possibly dying." Spinnerella bites the

inside of her cheek. "If she lashes out, we'll have to push back to make sure no one gets hurt. It's the only thing that we can do. Let's just hope that she doesn't lash out." Spinnerella frowns at the thought. Adora is smart. She is a tactical and highly trained Horde soldier, she's won her fair share of battles and that was while refusing to use She-Ra's powers. Spinnerella assumes, since Catra told them that she had… *spent time* with She-Ra, that Adora was more comfortable using her. She hoped more than anything that Adora wasn't considering using She-Ra to her advantage.

No one has seen She-Ra in thousands of years, but there remain stories of the legendary Princess. She was the Princess of *Power* for a reason. Spinnerella shudders when she thinks about the possibility of having to fight against the Princess. She-Ra legends tell of her healing ability, her strength in battle, she could lift things more than twice her weight and smash through rocks. She-Ra was probably *unstoppable.* Adora is stoppable, she's just a person, She-Ra is almost like a goddess. It sends a chill down Spinnerella's spine to think about having to face her. She-Ra was supposed to *protect* Etheria, but what happens when the person who wields her sword believes that she is protecting Etheria by *removing* the Princesses? They were toast.

"C'yra, probably, but Luna? She's a softie, like you." Netossa brings Spinnerella back to the problem at hand.

"Here's hoping that you're right." Spinnerella sighs. "We should probably call them, but what do we say? Do we tell them that Catra might be mated? That she's grieving? Do we just ask them to come?" Spinnerella lists all of their options, trying to figure out what the best step to take was.

"I... I don't know... What do you think?"

"I'm not sure either." Spinnerella admits.

"Maybe we could just start with that Catra is here?" Netossa suggests and Spinnerella nods in agreement.

"Yeah, I think that would be a good place to start. Do you want to call them or should I?"

"I think it's probably better if you do it."

"Right..." Spinnerella grabs her com-pad, looking for Luna's contact. "Darling, maybe you should stay with Catra so that she isn't alone while I call her moms, okay?"

"Okay," Netossa kisses her wife on the cheek before she walks away to go back to Catra. Spinnerella sighs. *Here we go.*

Spinnerella dials Luna's com-pad, waiting for her to pick it up. It takes a few minutes but the woman soon answers her call. "Luna, hi. Do you have a minute? Is C'yra with you?"

"Spinnerella," Luna greets warmly with a smile. "Cy is in the meeting room, I'm not too far away, what's up?" Luna was always so nice. Catra certainly took after C'yra in her looks but she could see the gentleness of Catra's personality reflected in Luna's gentle nature. She was always the most open between Catra's moms.

"Catra's here..." Spinnerella says. Luna stops for a moment and her ears twitch a little on the screen.

"Catra is there? Is she okay?" Luna asks and Spinnerella can detect the anxiety in her tone.

"She's... She's unharmed." Spinnerella says *carefully* . Luna seems to relax a fraction but Spinnerella could make out the rapid movement of her tail behind her on the screen, showing her anxiousness still.

"Unharmed? That's good but... I wasn't born yesterday, why did you phrase it like that?"

"You… might want to sit down."

"Spinny," Luna's voice had lost all warmth and her usual joyfulness was gone, replaced by cold dread. "what has happened to my daughter?"

"We believe that she... may be grieving." Spinnerella whispers softly, sitting down on the bed in the room. She hadn't been sure if she should bring this up but it was probably the best course of action - Catra's moms would probably be able to tell the second they were in the same room as Catra anyway. "We're not too sure, but the signs are there." Spinnerella adds. Despite her knowledge, she *isn't* a Magicat, she can't know for sure if Catra is truly in grieving or not.

"Grieving ?" Luna asks. By this point she had gone stock still and, though she looked slightly confused, she was clearly concerned and alarmed too. "What happened? Did someone die? Glimmer?"

"She didn't tell us exactly what happened. But she isn't acting like herself at all." Spinnerella lies, trying not to give away Catra's secret. "We can't confirm it like you can, but it's only right that you know so that you can come and see her. I don't think she can handle travel at the moment." Luna releases a long breath and leans against the wall at Spinnerella's words.

"This is... bad..." Luna says, clearly worried. "I've been in grieving before, back when Cy got injured a long time ago in a battle, I couldn't go to her for a while and it sent me into distress. My Little One is experiencing that..." Luna looks clearly and visibly upset and worried - like any parent would be - but she was also making a low almost purring sound of distress. "We'll be there as soon as we can."

"Okay, we'll see you soon, Luna. We'll keep you updated if Catra's state changes." Spinnerella nods at Luna one last time before hanging up the call. She places her com-pad down, heading back out to the living room.

"Hey dear, how's she doing?" Spinnerella asks. Netossa places a finger to her lips.

"She fell asleep. She's... purring?"

Spinnerella nods, whispering softly. "I don't know if that's a good thing or a bad thing right now. The only ones that would be able to tell are other Magicats. Did she eat anything? Drink the tea?"

"No," Netossa sighs. "I tried to encourage her to but she wouldn't move from her curled up spot."

"Oh dear... I told Luna. They said they'd come here as soon as they could."

"Can you imagine falling in love with the Horde Lord?" Netossa asks and Spinnerella gives her an odd look.

"Obviously not."

"No, but I mean... *Lord Adora* , of *all* the people. I didn't think anyone could love her."

"I don't think any of us did, possibly not even Catra herself at first." Spinnerella looks at the brunette, petting her head gently. "Poor Catra." It was sad. That Catra had fallen for someone like Adora not just in the sense that it was the Lord of the Horde but Adora as a person. Spinnerella can imagine loving Lord Adora is messy, and complicated, and *hard,* yet here Catra was: loving Lord Adora.

"Adora told Catra they always had an expiration date." Spinnerella looks up, obviously confused as to why Netossa suddenly brought that up.

"Yes?"

"I don't know, it just seems like, if she really believed that, she wouldn't have let it go as far as she did."

"You really think Adora has feelings for Catra?" Normally Spinnerella would agree with her wife, but that all just sounded… impossible - especially after this recent development. Spinnerella doesn't know Adora, so she could never really say how or what Adora felt for

Catra, but she had meant it when she said that it seemed important that she had been She-Ra around Catra - she had clearly *trusted* Catra at the very least.

"We told Catra that sex almost always leads to feelings and, while I don't consider Lord Adora a *person* , Catra seems to think she is. That means that the likelihood is that it meant more to her than she was willing to admit to Catra." Netossa explains. Spinnerella does agree with her wife there at the very least. Spinnerella doesn't know why Adora didn't just admit that. "Is there any way we can even fix this? Or at least make this easier for Catra?" Netossa asks. Spinnerella looks around the room, deep in thought.

"We should have Catra take a shower as soon as she wakes up. I don't know when C'yra and Luna will be here and we'll need to clean the couch too."

"I don't know if taking the scent away of her potential mate would be a good idea." Netossa points out - which is a very concerning and valid point to make. Spinnerella doesn't know that either, but leaving it clinging to Catra for her moms to smell is *not* a good idea.

"But if C'yra and Luna smell it, they're going to know and they might not react well." Might is an understatement if Spinnerella is honest.

"Oh, they *definitely* won't react well." Netossa speaks exactly what Spinnerella was thinking

"Which may just make Catra feel worse." Spinnerella sighs. "So we need to make sure that we can make things as easy as possible for Catra."

"I wonder if she has something of Adora that she can use instead of being covered in her scent?"

"I doubt it, C'yra likely made her burn it all."

"Probably..." Netossa sighs sadly. "Let's leave her to sleep for now."

"Yeah..." Spinnerella looks at Catra one more time, worried for her sake.

* * *

When Catra wakes up, she's gently ushered by Spinnerella and Netossa to go to the bathroom to shower once she's handed her clothes over to them to get rid of *her* scent. It breaks her heart a little more knowing that she'd lose that little piece of Adora that she had left, but she knew it was necessary.

When she comes out of the shower, her scent is just her own combined with soap. No lingering scent of Adora clings to her anymore like it used to. Catra sighs. She misses Adora so much. She's almost tempted to go running back to the Fright Zone, to tell Adora that she'll stay with her even if it'll break her heart to turn her back on everyone else - she thinks that heartbreak would be easier than her current one. She feels like someone honest to god reached their hand into her chest and ripped her heart out before they repeatedly stabbed her in the chest over, and over, and *over,* again.

"Spinny, 'Tossa, I finished showering!" Catra calls out weakly after getting dressed in the comfortable set of leggings and t-shirt that the couple had offered to loan her while they washed her clothes.

"Your moms are on the way. Do you want to try eating something before they get here?" Spinnerella asks gently.

"Not really. Can I have some water please?" Catra asks. She had a feeling that if she tried to eat something she'd probably just throw it right back up - in fact, her stomach had churned uncomfortably at the mere suggestion.

"Some water? Of course sweetie." Spinnerella disappears briefly and then returns with a glass of water. "I know you can't tell your moms about Adora... but you can tell *us* if you need to."

"Thanks." Catra says for both the water and the offer to talk about Adora, but she can't. Every time she thinks about that beautiful blonde *idiot* she feels like she might be physically dying.

"You really should eat something, you might feel better." Netossa says.

"I'm not hungry." Catra doesn't want to eat. She doesn't want to do *anything* . She wants to curl into a ball and then just stop existing, anything to stop this *pain.*

"Catra..." Spinnerella looks like she's debating the pros and cons of saying whatever it is that she has to say before she shakes her head. "This is a rough time for anyone. If there's *anything* we can do, just let us know, okay?"

"Yeah, okay." Catra murmurs, curling back up on the couch just like before. She slowly sips the water that Spinnerella gave her, sighing softly as it cools her aching throat. She wanted to cry more but she couldn't physically cry anymore. She had broken down in the Woods, and she had cried in the shower, and she had cried to Netossa. She didn't think she had any more tears left.

She finishes off her glass of water before she grabs hold of her tail and brings it up to her face, gently stroking her fingers along it. Adora used to do this and Catra had found it relaxing, now it makes her heart throb in her chest. She can't even stroke her own damn tail without getting misty eyed and feeling like she's had her insides scooped out with a spoon.

They wait anxiously for Luna and C'yra to arrive with Spinnerella and Netossa occasionally fussing over Catra who rarely moves from her curled up position other than to reposition her tail when she gets pins and needles. When they arrive, Luna is immediately beside Catra, a purr coming from her instinctively to try and comfort her. "What happened, Little One?" The purr, however, barely provides Catra with any comfort. Catra glances at her mom for a moment before she looks away and whines in distress.

"Oh... kitten..." Luna wraps her in a hug, trying her best to comfort Catra but it simply isn't working. Catra thinks the only thing that could possibly comfort her right now is being held by *Adora* - or having her scent, just… *Adora.* Catra knows purring isn't always when a Magicat is happy, they sometimes do it to comfort other wounded Magicats (or mates) and sometimes there is distressed purring, which Catra had been doing every time she thought

about Adora. Luna's purr was to help soothe Catra's obvious distress and usually it would work but it's not *working* .

"Mom..." Catra murmurs. She curls up into Luna and closes her eyes, beginning to cry again. She is happy to have her mom with her. The women who raised her, who kissed her when she hurt herself as a young kit, who taught her love, and kindness, and… Catra feels another wave of stress wash over her as she thinks about her mate, about how her moms would never be okay with who she was. *Her mothers would never accept Adora.* Not that that mattered now anyway, but she couldn't even *tell them about her.*

C'yra looks at Catra in distress, biting her lip. "Kitten... What's wrong? Talk to us."

"Lost her." Catra whispers quietly - she can't seem to bring herself to say much more than that in explanation. Being awake hurts too much, *everything* hurts too much.

"Lost who?" Luna asks gently. She takes a long inhale of Catra's scent and Catra knows she can smell it on her - the *grief* . "You lost your mate?" Catra nods weakly before breaking down again. She clings to Luna, burying her face against her mother's chest. She can barely catch her breath between sobs.

"Is that… Is that why you've been rej-" C'yra starts, but stops immediately when Catra feels Luna shake her head.

Luna gently strokes down Catra's back, trying to soothe her. "Did she... Did she pass away?" She asks softly. Catra sniffles but doesn't reply, instead burying her face more in her mom's chest and crying. Luna sighs softly and purrs, trying her best to comfort Catra's distress. "I know how it feels, it's terrible... I wish I could save you from the pain."

"I miss her, mom." Catra says weakly, crying once again - *guess she was wrong about being out of tears.* "I miss her..."

"It's okay." Luna shushes gently. C'yra comes over and wraps both of them up in her arms, probably hoping to help comfort Catra too. It works and it doesn't. Catra still feels a gaping hole in her chest but she loves her moms so much that their scent is familiar and comforting.

For the first few months of a Magicat kitten’s life they can’t see too well, so their main tool for recognising people is by scent. Catra has known her moms’ scents since she was born, it will always bring her some sense of comfort - even now when she feels beyond the comfort of *anything* .

"Can... Can we go home?" Catra asks, curling into the warmth of her mothers.

"Of course we can go home. You'd probably feel better in your own bed, huh?" Luna asks.

"Yeah." Catra sniffs.

"Not sure I can carry you anymore, Little One, but I'll try." Luna says with a chuckle - that almost gets Catra to smile, *almost* .

"Can't we just ask Glimmer to teleport us or something?" Catra suggests. She doesn't think she has the energy to walk and her mom obviously can’t carry her all the way to Half-Moon.

"I... guess we could ask her." Catra nods, murmuring a ‘please’ before curling back up in her mom's chest. C'yra gives Luna a look and walks away to contact Glimmer, leaving Luna and Catra alone for the moment.

Luna keeps up her purring and cuddling of Catra. "Do you want to tell me about her, Little One?" Catra shakes her head. She wishes she could talk about Adora to her mom - oh how she *wishes* . She wishes she could tell them how sweet and loving Adora had been to her. She wishes she could tell them that she had found *the one* . But she could never do that. Not ever. All she has is a broken heart and a one-sided love that she can't even ask her moms to comfort her through because it was with the fucking *Lord* of the *Horde* .

"What do you need C'yra?"

"I just wanna go home."

"Okay." Luna whispers, cuddling Catra close.

C'yra returns a moment later. "Glimmer said-"

"Hey!" Glimmer's loud and cheerful voice is completely out of place in the current situation. "... What's... going on...?" Catra can hear the confusion in Glimmer's tone.

"Glimmer, could you please teleport us back to Half-Moon?" Luna asks, still cuddling Catra. Catra manages to peer around Luna to see Glimmer look between her, Luna, and C'yra. She was clearly confused about what was going on but nods nonetheless.

"Yeah, I just recharged before coming here. I should be able to get you all there." Glimmer comes over and places her hands on them so she could teleport them all. She was obviously concerned about Catra (they were best friends after all) but she also wasn't really sure what was going on - Catra doubted that C'yra told her much. Still, Glimmer was perceptive, she probably knew something was very wrong.

She teleports them to Half-Moon.

"Thank you Glimmer," Luna thanks, still holding onto Catra.

"No problem. Are you... Is Catra okay? Did the Horde do something to her?" Glimmer sounds alarmed at the thought and Catra finds that suggestion almost ironic.

"Luna, take C'yra to her room. I'll talk with Glimmer." C'yra says to her wife. Luna nods and then Catra is being guided towards her room with the support of her mother.

* * *

C’yra turns back to Glimmer, sighing tiredly. "It turns out that C’yra *did* have a mate, but she's lost her, so C’yra’s grieving right now."

"Grieving? Wait... She had a mate? Who? You'd think that would be something she'd tell her best friends about..." Glimmer frowns and C’yra pats her shoulder gently. C’yra found this whole thing strange - the fact that *Glimmer* didn’t know that Catra had a mate is even stranger.

"We didn't know either until Spinnerella and Netossa told us. They found her and said that she was showing signs of grieving." C'yra bites the inside of her cheek before continuing to speak. "She's... very delicate right now, Glimmer. I need you to let everyone else know to be very gentle with her when they see her."

"O-Of course, I mean, maybe she could use some time with Bow? He's the gentlest person I know." Glimmer suggests. It’s a cute suggestion, but C’yra knows better.

"I doubt that'll be enough. But maybe she will find comfort in having a friend around." C'yra nods gratefully at Glimmer for the idea. She knows Glimmer could never comprehend the pain a Magicat feels when they are grieving. As unbelievable, and cheesy, as it sounds, it is entirely possible for a Magicat to die of a broken heart - that was essentially what grieving was. "Thank you for bringing us back. We appreciate it."

"Do you have any idea who her mate is?" Glimmer asks.

"No. She never told us anything."

"That is so... *strange* . I feel like she would've said something, you know?" C’yra has to agree with Glimmer there but it is what it is.

"You would think so. Maybe she felt pressured by our efforts to find her a mate and wanted to go at her own pace... but why didn't she just say so..." C'yra sighs and shakes her head. "That doesn't really matter right now though. That's not what's important to focus on. My daughter is my priority." C’yra could very well lose Catra to this and that thought alone was a distressing one.

"Yeah, of course. If Catra needs anything, you can just ask us." Glimmer says.

"Thank you." C'yra gives her a smile. "I should go check up on my wife and my daughter."

"Just give us a call if you need anything." Glimmer smiles before she teleports away - though she looks worriedly towards Catra's room for a moment.

C'yra turns back to Catra's room, opening the door and heading inside. She could smell the grief coming from her daughter and it hurt her so much to see that her daughter was in so much pain. "Kitten... is there anything we can do to make you feel better?"

* * *

Catra was curled up under her comforter when she hears C'yra come into her room. She shakes her head no at her question - there is *nothing* that could *possibly* make her feel better right now. She doesn't say anything else, but she does peek at her moms with teary eyes. "Cy, why don't you go fetch some tea?" Luna suggests. C'yra nods and exits to go fetch the tea.

Luna was lying beside Catra on her bed and her purring had hardly ceased since seeing her again - Catra must really be in a bad way. "Is there anything that will soothe you, Little One? Anything? Stupid stories?"

"Stupid stories?" Catra asks curiously. Her ears, for the first time since she left the Fright Zone, perk *up* .

"Sure, I have tons of stupid stories," Luna hums. "Like... hm... remember how you used to be afraid of mice? Cy is exactly the same, she climbs me, *literally,* like a tree whenever she sees one."

"Still?" Catra asks softly, giving her mom a weak smile. Catra used to be afraid of mice, she probably inherited it from her mom. "I thought mama said she got over that."

" *Psh* , please, she's still terrified of them." Luna rolls her eyes fondly. "She acts all tough, but she's a softie really." Catra hums, snuggling into her comforter more.

"What else?"

"What else... hm..." Luna hums softly as her tail swishes behind her. "Did I ever tell you about the time we found out we were pregnant with you?"

"No, you haven't. I don't think you or mama ever told me."

"Hm... C'yra carried you, maybe that's why you're both so alike, but she wanted to do it despite the fact she was Queen and had... so many responsibilities. She wanted to carry our kitten." Luna explains. "When we found out, the whole Kingdom threw a party in honour of finding out about their new Princess."

"A whole party? Really?" Catra asks in disbelief.

“For a week straight."

"A *week* ?" Catra was surprised if she was honest, she had no idea her Kingdom loved her so much. Luna laughs softly.

"For a week. They were happy that they had a new Princess." Luna pauses for a moment. "We had considered having more kids before we had you but... you were our *everything* , we didn't need or want anything more."

"Oh..." Catra smiles, covering her face a little before sighing softly. She wonders if she'd still continue to be their everything after they found out who she had slept with, who she had

mated with that didn't want her anymore. She sniffles, smile falling from her face as she hides her entire head under the comforter. Her moms would probably *hate* her, and her Kingdom. She can’t even imagine what they’d call her.

C'yra returns with the tea and sets it on the bedside table. "How about we do what we did when you were little?" C'yra suggests, nudging Catra under her comforter. "Whenever you had a nightmare and would sneak into our bed?"

"Okay." Catra says though her voice comes out muffled thanks to the thick blanket over her head.

"Then scooch over, Little One." C'yra says, nudging Catra over towards Luna. She climbs in beside her so Catra was trapped between her two moms who snuggle up to her. They both purr softly, trying to soothe their daughter, and Catra mewls softly in thanks.

She closes her eyes and attempts to focus her attention on the purrs surrounding her. "Thanks, mama, mom, I love you both." Catra confesses feeling herself purr in response to them.

"We love you too." Luna responds, both of them nuzzling Catra. "Try to get some rest." Catra hums and closes her eyes, letting a wave of sleep wash over her with the help of her moms' soothing purrs.

She dreams about Adora, pain inescapable even in sleep. Catra doesn’t know if she can bear it. She can’t fight Adora, she can’t be with her, she can’t live without her either. Catra was completely at the mercy of Adora, in every single way. For better or for worse.

* * *

“Lord Adora?”

“Should we call Force Captain Scorpia?”

“I don’t know…”

Adora moves her chin in the direction of the soldiers and they both instantly stop talking, straightening their backs up to salute her in respect. Adora doesn’t say anything, she simply walks past them and further into the artificial farm. “Your Lordship, everything is running accordingly here, we can assure you.” Adora holds her hand up.

Silence.

Then the sound of Adora drawing her sword.

“My Lord-”

“You’re being reassigned.” Adora cuts the soldier off before they can speak again. “This farm was a distraction that is no longer needed. I need all of my soldiers for the war effort against the Princesses.” Adora sighs as she lifts her sword. “The Horde will live off of ration bars, like we always have.”

"Princess Catra-”

“Do *not* speak her name to me.” Adora turns to the soldier sharply, her eyes glowing with anger. She didn’t yell yet the soldier seems obviously and visibly afraid of her demeanour. “Now, if you’ll excuse me, I have some redecorating I need to do.”

Adora takes a deep breath and then transforms into She-Ra. Her soldiers gasp at the sight of her but they quickly hurry out of the room when Adora sets her eyes on the farm, obvious destruction in her eyes. She-Ra was better for this. She could destroy this farm without even breaking a sweat.

She-Ra is *powerful.* She is strong. And she is *unstoppable.*

Interesting.

Chapter End Notes

I would say that I'm sorry, but I did warn all of you to prepare for the angst. You should go grab the tissue box now. Enjoy the upcoming chapter! -M

The next few chapters are some of my favourites. See you all next chapter! Also, I've seen some fan art on Twitter for this AU and I literally sob when I see it, I'm so glad y'all are loving Lord Adora as much as we are!! -S

New and Old Beginnings

Chapter Summary

"I'm not suggesting we send Glimmer, maybe something else?" C'yra suggests.

"The only person who has inside information about the Horde is... Catra." Glimmer says hesitantly. That is true, the amount of times Catra has been kidnapped by the Horde Lord is almost a concerning amount. Luna had been worried that Lord Adora's intentions for her daughter had been less than honourable but Catra had never said anything to the contrary, just that when she was kidnapped it usually took her a little while to figure out an escape route but she always ended up finding a way out - eventually. Still… it was weird how many times Catra had been snatched by the Horde Lord.

Chapter Notes

Happy Friday everyone!! This update is kinda lengthy but I advise y'all to take it all in. Next few chapters are gonna get *real*. Thank you for reading!! We hope you enjoy the update :)

Warning, NSFW ahead

See the end of the chapter for more notes

Catra groans as she stirs awake, pushing herself up and rushing to the bathroom as a wave of nausea hits her. She was already not feeling well from everything else and then she suddenly grew more sick on top of that. She felt horrible, and tired, and she wished she could just fall asleep and not have to deal with her broken heart *and* her sickness.

She makes it to the toilet, barely having the time to pull the seat up before she empties the little bit of food that she had been pushed to consume the day before. She felt gross, and the taste in her mouth was vile as she coughed out the remnants of the vomit she had expelled. She groans as she sits down beside the toilet, resting her head against the seat. Of course she was getting sick on top of her current situation. It wasn't enough that she was in mourning but her body hated her so much that she was sick too. Truthfully, Catra had kind of been having these sickness spells for the past few weeks but she'd figured it was some kind of stomach bug that kept coming to kick her ass every now and again.

Catra could hardly focus on anything as another wave of nausea crashed into her so she didn't hear the door of her bedroom open - she was way too busy throwing up her stomach to do so. "C'yra?" Luna appears behind her, her green eyes taking in the sight of Catra curled up by the toilet. "Are you okay?" She asks, coming over to her and kneeling down beside her.

"No..." Catra mumbles, holding herself up by the toilet seat. Figures her mom would come and see her *now* . "I don't think I can... My stomach can't handle food right now." Catra knew her mom had probably come to give her some food, or something, but she really wasn't feeling up to it. In her grief she hadn't felt up to eating food as it was and that was *without* the vomiting.

"Hm," Luna reaches her hand out and presses it to Catra's forehead. "You don't feel hot... a little clammy." Luna frowns. "We got a message from Glimmer asking if you maybe felt like helping out back in Bright Moon, but if you're sick, you should probably stay here."

"Yeah, probably. What did Glimmer need help with anyway?" Catra asks, sighing in relief as most of the nausea finally fades away and she's able to relax a bit. "Is it urgent?" Catra's ears perk up in concern as her eyes focus on Luna.

"Something about Lord Adora, it can wait until you feel better."

"You sure?" Catra asks, biting the inside of her cheek at Adora's name. It hurts her to hear her mate's name and not be able to see her. The way the Rebellion casually brings Adora's name up stabs her in the heart every time, but Catra can't exactly ask them to stop. "I can probably go." Catra says as she pushes herself up before stumbling for a moment, catching herself on the wall. "... Maybe not."

Luna reaches her hands out when Catra manages to catch herself. She sighs, perplexed. "This isn't typical of the grieving process. You need to go see our doctor." Catra ignores her mom for the moment to instead brush her teeth to get the awful aftertaste out of her mouth. She splashes her face with some water and runs her claws through her hair before she turns back to her mom.

"It's not?" Catra asks softly, taking her mom's hands to hold herself up as she's guided out of the bathroom. Catra's room was dark. She'd kind of blocked out every source of light, favouring sulking under her blankets instead. She hadn't really left her bedroom ever since

her moms brought her back home. Catra was a *mess* and she had little energy to deal with anyone who wasn't her mothers. "I'm sure that I'll be fine after some rest, mom."

"I'm worried that your grieving scent is masking a more serious one," Luna says, helping Catra to her bed. "My dad was a doctor, and he taught me a lot, but I don't know everything - and it's been a while since I practised." Luna gently moves Catra's hair back, tying it away from her face and Catra purrs happily. Luna kisses her on the forehead gently. "I'd prefer to be safe than sorry."

"Fine, if it'll help you not worry as much." Catra gives her mom a small smile before allowing her to take her out of her bedroom and towards the medical room to get checked up. Catra figured her mom was probably overreacting but she supposed it wouldn't hurt to be checked up.

The past couple of weeks have been *hard,* to say the least. Catra missed Adora like she missed a limb. She knew it would hurt if Adora hadn't felt the same but she had never imagined it would be this intense - so intense it was making her *physically* sick? Even if that wasn't the cause of her sickness, it still hurt her a whole lot. Catra doesn't even know how to explain it. She feels like half of a person. Like she has half of a soul, and she's slowly dying. It hurts. That's the only way she can describe it.

They make it to the Royal Doctor's quarters. Catra had come here a lot as a kid. She used to be pretty… active - a.k.a she used to get into all kinds of trouble as a kitten. The place was exactly as she remembered it, just some bed pushed into the corner, it smelt sterile and there were cupboards holding various medical supplies along the other wall with the old doctor sitting at his stool. He was an old Magicat, his glasses sat on the bridge of his nose and the majority of his hair and fur was grey with age, but Catra knew he was a kind and gentle man. "What do you think it could be, mom?" Catra asks curiously as she sits down on one of the beds, letting the doctor get to work.

"I'm not sure..." Luna rests her chin in her hand. "What other symptoms have you been having, Little One?"

"Just... tired... some nausea... not much." Catra admits. She figured some of that was related to her heartbreak but the sickness had kind of been recurring and it had been… irregular.

"Hm... That could be a number of things." Luna admits. Catra could tell she was thinking it over and she could also tell her mom was anxious by the way her tail kept flicking back and forth behind her.

"I need to ask you a few questions Princess C'yra, would you prefer to answer them privately? That is your right, as an adult." The doctor asks. "I tend to notice people are more honest when their parents aren't present." Catra appreciates the offer but she honestly doesn't care.

"It's fine, you can ask them with my mom here." Catra answers, giving a nod of confirmation to the doctor. The doctor nods and hesitates for only a moment.

"I can smell the grief on you. When was the last time you were with your mate?"

"I don't know..." Catra admits, her head dropping down. She had lost track of time already, she could hardly tell how many days had passed since she last saw Adora, she was certain it had been a few weeks, maybe a little less, maybe a little more.

"Were you," The doctor clears his throat. "sexually active with your partner?" Catra pauses at the question. Her ears press back against her head. The curse of being a Magicat is having a pretty dang good memory that Catra can recall every moment she shared with Adora with such clarity that it's painful to think about her because Catra remembers it *all.* She also doesn't know why the doctor is asking her *that.*

"Yes, I was." Catra answers with a little confusion. Her tail starts twitching without her permission and she feels *tense* suddenly though she doesn't know *why.* Luna looks at the doctor.

"You don't think..." She trails off.

"Nausea, no fever, fatigue." The doctor looks at Catra. "I'd like to run a pregnancy test on you, just to check."

"A… A *pregnancy* test?!" Catra asks, hardly believing her ears. *There was no way... was there?!* She almost laughs at the doctor. There was absolutely no way she was pregnant, this doctor was crazy if that's what he thought. "Okay... if you think it's something that needs to be ruled out, doctor." Catra agrees. *There was no way. No way. She couldn't be, could she? The only person she had been with was… **Adora** .*

"Great," The doctor smiles reassuringly. "I'll need to take some blood, plus we can run some other tests in case that one comes back negative, is that okay?"

"Okay, yeah, okay. Whatever you need to do." Catra nods, holding her arm out for the doctor to be able to draw some blood. "I... I don't think it's really possible, but I guess we can rule it out." The doctor nods and goes to retrieve the items that he needed to draw the blood.

Luna paces a little on the spot, it kind of makes Catra feel anxious herself, before Luna comes and sits down beside her on the bed. It's... tense... the only sound is the sound of the doctor gathering their materials. Catra doesn't like the silence so she figures she can fill it. "How... How long until you get the results?" She asks.

"Not long," The doctor answers. "A couple of hours at most." Luna looks at Catra and sighs softly.

"I guess it makes sense that you would be... *intimate* with your mate in order to form that close of a bond to her. I just... I didn't think you'd be *pregnant* ." Luna says.

"We don't know that she's pregnant," The doctor says, sitting back down in front of Catra. They begin cleaning the site and preparing the needle. "Why don't we wait for the results first?"

"I don't think I'm pregnant either, mom." Catra says, looking directly at Luna. "There's just no way."

"Well, maybe, if magic were involved, or other methods."

"Other methods?" Catra asks with a frown.

"Depending on who your partner is- *was* ..." Luna winces a little and Catra has to admit her slip stings a little. Adora is both her mate and not. Her tail swishes behind her slowly and her ears go *down.*

"You might feel a sharp scratch here, Princess C'yra." The doctor warns.

"Okay." Catra nods, turning away from her mom. If it was possible that she could be pregnant from magic being involved then... it *was* possible. Catra thinks about She-Ra… the thing she did with her sword… *Shit. Fuck.*

The doctor takes the blood and then places a cotton pad over the top of the needle site. They then take the blood sample and walk towards the door. "We'll test this right away and let you know." They say before exiting the room, leaving Catra and her mom alone.

They fall into a tense silence again, Luna clearly doesn't really know what to say. Catra hadn't talked about Adora - her mate - ever since she'd come home. She knew that her mom was curious but they hadn't pushed her to talk about her either which Catra very much appreciated. Thinking about Adora hurt her so much, she hated to think about having to vocalise her feelings about the blonde. "You know, it might be nice to have a little kitten running around the halls of Half-Moon again." Luna says. It's an attempt to try and make Catra feel better but she isn't really sure *how* that makes her feel.

"Yeah." Catra whispers, placing a hand on her abdomen. If she really was pregnant with Adora's child, she wouldn't be able to believe it. She'd get to have a little kitten that was a part of her and her mate. She'd always have a part of her with her. Plus babies are cute… right? But then she'd have to have a baby *without* Adora, and something about that feels… wrong. "Maybe it would be nice..." Catra says, distracted.

"Do you want to tell me about her?" Luna asks softly. It brings Catra back to the present and out of her thoughts. Catra shakes her head slowly, the small shine that had been in her eyes at the possibility of having a piece of Adora around again instantly fades away at the question. She wishes she could tell her moms all about the Adora that she knew. The one who cared, and was kind, and sweet, and a giant *dork* . But she would never get to do that.

Luna looks hurt by the fact that Catra didn't want to confide in her but she also clearly doesn't want to push her. Catra feels kind of bad if she's honest but if she told her moms and the rest of her friends and family and they all rejected her? That would probably push her the rest of the way off of the edge. "Okay," Luna says softly. "Well, you may not have her anymore but, if you *are* pregnant, you'll have a little kitten that is half of her and half of you."

"I know." She rubs her stomach, biting her lip. She worries about her family and friends finding out just who the other parent of her kitten is if she really *is* pregnant - the child of the *Horde Lord* - that probably wouldn't end well. Catra sighs. They really do think Adora is evil, they'd probably think her baby is too.

"It's been so long since we cared for a kitten, twenty-two, nearly twenty-three years." Luna says lightly. "Gosh, I wonder if we still have your old baby stuff."

"Mom, please calm down. We're not even sure if I'm actually having a kitten yet." Catra points out to which Luna laughs softly at.

"No, I guess we don't." She says. "How would you feel if you were?"

"I don't really know how to feel..." It's a terrifying thought. If she is pregnant what does that even mean for her? Does she tell Adora? Her moms think her mate *died.* But she still exists. She just doesn't *want* Catra. Adora is all about her stupid mission, that's all that's important to her. Would Adora even care that she's the mother of a baby? Or would she use that against Catra too? Catra hates this entire thing. When she thought of her meeting her mate, *none* of this had been the way she thought it would go.

"Would you... want to keep them?" Luna asks after a moment.

"Yes." Catra answers without hesitation. She wants to keep their kitten if it turns out she is pregnant. She would make sure that they are loved, and cared for, so that they could get the happy life her mate didn't get to have. She would give Adora the life she deserved through their child.

It was rare for a Magicat to come out of grief but maybe... Maybe Catra being pregnant was actually the best thing that could happen for her. "You answered pretty quickly there, Little One. I guess I can understand that." Luna replies.

"You do?" Catra asks softly, looking up at her mom. Luna purrs and gently nuzzles her daughter.

"Of course, I am a mother after all." She says playfully. "And if I had been the one to carry you, and Cy had..." Luna trails off for a moment. "I would have kept you without hesitation too." Catra laughs softly.

"I would hope so. Thank you, mom."

"You are like a mini version of Cy," Luna comments. "But you have me in you too. If you're pregnant, your kitten will be a combination of you and your mate."

"I hope so." Catra really hoped that if she were carrying a kitten that they would have Adora's blue eyes - she always loved those blue eyes of her's, they were beautiful. But it didn't really matter what her kitten looked like to her, all that mattered to her was that they were born safe and healthy - that's if she really *was* having a kitten.

"Cy is out today, doing royal duties and such, we'll have to talk to her when she gets back."

"Maybe we'll have the results before she gets back." Catra says.

"Mhmm... and if they're positive? Do you want to tell her?"

"I think I'd have to, at least, eventually. Since I'll have to step down from fighting if that really is the case." Catra can't exactly go into battle if she's carrying a *baby* after all. Luna laughs softly at her.

"I suppose you would, though usually you're the strategist anyway." She says fondly. "Glimmer was suspicious of Lord Adora's lack of... anything... recently. The Fright Zone has been quiet but she fears something may be brewing."

"What does she think is going on?" Catra asks, worried about the possibilities. Catra knows that Adora can have a temper, especially when she's upset. She knows Adora won't remain dormant forever but Catra can't imagine fighting against her - or even helping the Princesses fight against her with her strategies for that matter. She wishes that Adora would just come to her senses before all of that. "Has there really been *nothing* coming from the Fright Zone?"

"The Horde has been silent, not so much as a bot has been noticed. No battles. Nothing. It's... eerie... kind of like an unofficial ceasefire." Luna says with a frown. "That, or Lord Adora really is planning something big."

"That's possibly really scary or really worrying." Catra gnaws at her lip, eyebrows furrowed. "Let's hope that maybe... Maybe it *is* a ceasefire."

"I find it strange. I doubt it's a ceasefire, Lord Adora doesn't seem like she'd give up for just no reason." Luna responds. Catra has to agree there. Adora is nothing if not persistent. She is incredibly focused on her goal and she will do *anything* to achieve it. That makes her *dangerous* . Even if Catra loves her, she knows how dangerous Adora really is and she's under no illusions otherwise. She doesn't underestimate her.

"Still, let's hope for the best." Catra says trying to push down the ache she felt from merely discussing Adora.

"You're right." Luna says softly.

The pair talk and pass the time before the doctor returns to the room, a file in his hands. They sit down in front of Catra and take a deep breath - Catra takes that as a *bad* sign. "Well, we didn't need to run any more tests. You're pregnant, Princess C'yra." The words come crashing down on Catra all at once. She feels so many things at the same time. Happiness at the thought that she was having a kitten. Sadness that her mate may never get to meet them. Concern at the possibility that everyone will find out who the other parent is. And so much more that she gets so overwhelmed that she starts to cry.

"Mom... mom, I'm… *pregnant* ... I'm gonna be a *mom* ..." Luna softens and wraps Catra in a tight hug.

"I know baby, I know." She kisses Catra atop her head and starts purring in an attempt to calm her down. Catra leans into her mom's embrace, crying heavily but a smile on her face because she was happy about the revelation. Despite *everything* , she was actually happy.

"I'm gonna be a mom... I'm having a kitten..." Catra whispers to herself, closing her eyes. *We're having a baby, Adora.* She thinks to herself, wishing that she could tell the blonde the news in person.

"My concern," The doctor says, trying to draw their attention back. "is that you've been under an *extraordinary* amount of stress recently. We need to try to minimise that, you're in a fragile position that could... well... you could lose your baby if we don't." Those words make a wave of coldness wash over Catra. Her smile immediately falls.

"Oh..." She whispers, her eyes saddening at the thought of losing her kitten before she even got to hold them in her arms. "What do we do then?"

"Well, you've already made some steps, we just need to keep your level of distress down." They say. "I know you're in mourning over your lost mate, and there's no fix for that, but I encourage you to just take it easy. Find distractions, peaceful hobbies, things that relax you."

"Okay, hobbies, relaxing things. Got it." Catra nods, sighing softly. She isn't sure she's had a relaxing hobby since she was probably five. The war didn't exactly allow for such things but if she had to lay off fighting for a while in order to protect her kitten, then she damn well would. "Thank you, doctor, am I clear to go?"

"Sure, we'll need regular appointments for your prenatal treatment but you're not sick, so you're free to go." The doctor smiles happily at Catra. Catra nods, thanking the doctor again before standing up from the bed with her mom's help.

"Can we go get some food please?" Catra asks and Luna looks at her with surprise.

"You... You actually want to eat?"

"I *need* to... for my kitten."

"Okay, yeah, absolutely, we can eat."

"Thanks, mom." Catra gives her a small smile, letting her lead the way to the kitchen. "I wonder if there's any foods I can't eat while I'm pregnant?" Catra asks curiously.

"Some things but most are okay to eat. As long as the food is cooked correctly, you should be fine."

"And what are those things?"

"You should try to avoid certain cheeses, untreated milk and certain oily fish. Magicats don't really drink coffee, but that should be limited too, and as long as any meat you eat is thoroughly cooked, you'll be fine, kitten." Luna explains. Catra nods, taking that all in. Catra decides *not* to tell C'yra just yet, she'd do it later when she was feeling less overwhelmed and also not so bogged down in grief. Catra felt… a little better. She felt like this might be the light at the end of the tunnel, a possible way out of the eternal darkness. She decides to focus on getting that food and taking care of herself for the time being.

* * *

Catra takes a deep breath in. Her mom had encouraged her to tell her mama, *and the rest of the Rebellion,* that she was carrying a kitten and that she wouldn't be able to join them back out on the battlefield as a fighter until the kitten was born. She was afraid of how they would react, but she hoped that they wouldn't ask too many questions. The last thing she needed right now was to be reminded of her lost mate.

She wished that she could have just stayed in bed, but Luna was guiding her towards the meeting room where everyone else was waiting for them. "Don't worry, Little One," Luna says gently. "The sooner we get this over with, the sooner you can go back to your nest, okay?"

"Okay, mom..." She murmurs, biting her lip. She wishes she didn't have to tell them at all. She misses Adora, being away from her hurts so much, but Adora didn't want her. Catra sniffles at the thought, trying to take a deep breath to calm herself down. Her grief was still fresh, though it had been getting better. "Is... Is everyone there, mom?"

"The entire Rebellion, yes." Luna answers, "but don't be too scared, you've faced this crowd a million times before, remember?"

"Yeah..." Catra sighs. It wasn't the same though. She had to tell them that she was *pregnant* . That's something that she's never had to do before. Battle plans were easy, even enjoyable, but this?

Her nerves only become more heightened when they step into the meeting room, all eyes on them. "Hi guys..."

"Catra!" Glimmer exclaims. "Are you okay? We haven't seen you in a while?" C'yra stands from her seat to kiss her wife in greeting and then nuzzle her daughter affectionately. Catra purrs at her mother’s affection.

"Why don't you take your seats and we can start the meeting?" Angella asks with a gentle smile.

"I'm okay." Catra answers, uncertainty in her voice as she sits down. "There's... something I have to tell you all." She sees Spinnerella and Netossa's eyes widen - probably thinking Catra was about to reveal the true identity of her mate.

"What is it you have to tell us?" C'yra asks, turning her head to the side.

"I have to step down from fighting, per the doctor's orders."

"Doctor's orders?" Glimmer makes a face before her eyes widen. "Are you sick?"

"Is it the grieving?" C'yra asks.

"No." Catra shakes her head slowly. "I'm not allowed to fight for the next nine months because I'm... I'm pregnant." Her voice shakes at the end, worried about how everyone will react.

There's a long stretch of silence before Mermista breaks it. "Holy shit!"

" *Mermista* !" Bow gasps dramatically, leaning over to cover Frosta's ears. Spinnerella and Netossa look at each other and then at Catra knowingly - they know *exactly* who the other parent of that baby is. C'yra sits up straight and the whole room is in some variation of being shocked.

"You're... pregnant?" C'yra asks with a frown. "But... Who the hell is the other parent so I can kick their ass?" C'yra asks angrily. Luna glares at her but it doesn't stop everyone else who bombard Catra with the same question. *Who's the other parent? Pregnant with whom? We didn't even know you were seeing someone? But the worst one...*

"Wait, but you're in like... grieving... does that mean the other parent is dead?"

Catra's ears pressed against her head, her body slowly sliding further down into her seat as everyone, including C'yra, her own mother, started yelling at her with a ton of questions. Tears begin to fill her eyes. She sniffles softly before tears fall rapidly as someone asks the final question. *No, but she doesn't want me.* She thinks to herself as she buries her face in her hands. Too many questions that Catra can’t answer and too many questions that remind Catra of *her* .

Luna bangs her hand against the table to gather everyone's attention and they all stop talking at once. "That is enough." She states firmly. "Who the other parent is, doesn't matter. What matters is that Catra *is* pregnant, she needs to step down from active battlefield duty, she can still help you guys plan if she feels up to it, but she needs a stress free environment and yelling at her all at once is not helping. No more questions about the other parent." C'yra looks ashamed as she probably remembers that Catra had lost her mate. The scent of grief fills the room as Catra cries.

"Come here, kitten... I'm sorry." C'yra pulls Catra close and rubs her back, purring to try to soothe her.

"C-Can I go back to my nest now?" Catra asks through her sniffs and cries.

"Of course kitten." Luna says gently. Luna goes to stand but Spinnerella and Netossa interrupt.

"It's okay," Spinnerella says with a smile. "We'll walk Catra back. I'm guessing, Queen Luna, you can answer any question while Catra is absent?"

"I..." Luna looks at her daughter, reluctant to leave her alone. "I don't want to leave my kitten."

"I'll... I'll be okay, mom." Catra assures her, giving her a watery smile. "I'm gonna go lay down, please continue the meeting without me." She nods and excuses herself, walking out of the meeting room, still crying.

Spinnerella and Netossa hurry after Catra, leaving the meeting room behind while everyone starts to ask Queen Luna multiple questions at once. "Catra," Netossa says. "Are you okay?" Of course Netossa and Spinnerella were the only two who knew who the other parent was.

"Not really." She answers softly. "I miss her, so much. I didn't think that I would... That *we'd* have a kitten." Catra whimpers, biting her lip as she places a hand on her abdomen. "At least... At least I get to have a little piece of her."

"Have you... thought about telling her?" Netossa asks hesitantly. Catra shakes her head.

"She probably won't listen. She was... We had a really bad argument before I left." Catra doesn’t like to think about that argument because it still felt like an open wound on her heart every time that she did. Spinnerella places a hand to Catra's shoulder and smiles gently at her.

"Maybe you could try calling her?" She suggests. "Maybe she's changed her mind? I mean, the Horde has been extremely quiet the past few weeks."

"I... I don't think I can. I can't handle if she rejects me again. I think my heart will shatter."

"Catra... You said you mated with Adora?" Netossa asks. Catra nods slowly, settling into her nest and purring quietly as she curls up. "Is the Horde quiet because... she's in grieving too? Can someone who isn't a Magicat even grieve?"

"I don't know... It's not often Magicats mate with someone that isn't another Magicat."

"Frankly, I find their silence deafening." Netossa says. "It's been almost a month and nothing." Catra shrugs, hiding under her blanket.

"I don't wanna think about it."

"Are you..." Netossa hesitates. "Keeping the baby?"

"Yes." There's barely a breath between Netossa's question and her answer. "Yes, I'm keeping them."

"Even though the mother is Adora?" Spinnerella elbows her wife.

"'Tossa." She scolds.

"Yes, because I love her. And... And even though she doesn't feel the same, I want to have this kitten. It's a part of the two of us, I want to give them a good home and a happy life."

"But... we're at war?"

"'Tossa, what is wrong with you?" Spinnerella asks.

"I'm just saying..." Netossa puts her hands up in defeat. Catra bites her lip and closes her eyes. She knows it's a valid question, and that Netossa doesn't mean any harm by it, but she… She can't explain it, but she already feels a *connection* to this baby.

"You two can go back to the meeting. I'm not going anywhere." Catra says.

"I'm not trying to be mean," Netossa says. "And I know you're in grieving, and you're pregnant, and the Horde may have been quiet recently, but you told us once that if you had to fight Adora again, you would. Is that still true? The Horde haven't reached out to make peace or anything, it's a very real possibility."

"I don't know, I don't know anymore, Netossa." Catra admits weakly, her heart squeezing painfully in her chest at the thought of possibly having to hurt Adora. "I hate the thought of hurting her."

"You might be the only one who can stop her."

"I can't go onto the battlefield, 'Tossa. You know that."

"I do know that," Netossa says. "Don't you think Adora will be confused when she sees a mini her running around after you give birth?"

"Maybe? I'm not sure she'd care." Catra bites her lip. "It might be easier to talk to her that way though, so she doesn't think I'm lying or something." It would be hard for Adora to deny that Catra had her baby if they were physically there.

"Lying about what?"

"About being pregnant." Catra sighs. "I told her how I felt and she didn't react well." Catra wonders if Adora thought she was lying about her feelings too. Spinnerella sighs and sits on the edge of Catra's bed.

"You said she didn't react well, how did she react exactly?"

"Yeah, I mean, she's the Horde Lord, maybe she was just caught off guard?" Netossa suggests.

"She thought that she was just a project to me." Catra laughs tearfully. "She wanted me to stay because I told her I love her, but when I told her that I couldn't just abandon all the other people I care about. She never said she loved me too, she let me go."

"You know, sometimes it's easier to let someone go than to admit that you love them." Netossa says.

"Yeah, I guess." Catra shrugs. "It hurts though, she didn't even try."

"Let's stop focusing on Adora and focus on you having a *baby* . That's pretty amazing." Spinnerella comments. Catra smiles a bit, placing a hand on her stomach.

"It is pretty amazing. I... I love them already."

"Maybe we should think about having a baby?" Spinnerella comments and Netossa almost chokes.

"Ah-ha... Maybe we settle for being godparents for now." Catra laughs at the couple.

"I think my kitten would love someone to play with."

"Oh my gosh... I bet Magicat babies are *adorable* ."

"They are." She smiles, thinking about it. "I hope they have her eyes."

"You do?" Netossa asks curiously. "I thought your eye thing was inherited because C'yra has the same just opposite eyes."

"They are inherited, but I think they'd look very cute with her eyes."

"What colour are Adora's eyes again?"

"They're the prettiest shade of blue, they look like a slightly clouded summer day." Catra smiles and purrs. Adora’s eyes were beautiful pools of blue that she could stare into forever. Netossa and Spinnerella look at each other. Netossa mouths a 'wow' at her wife and Spinnerella nods in agreement - Catra has no idea what *that* is about.

"We'll let you rest Catra," Spinnerella says. Catra looks at them confused for a moment before nodding in agreement, she could use the rest anyway.

"Okay, you two should head back to the meeting anyway. Thank you for staying and chatting with me." She says appreciatively, curling back up in her nest.

"If you need anything, and I mean *anything* , don't be afraid to ask." Spinnerella says. "I know we're the only ones who know that... Adora... is the other parent. That must be hard."

"I know. Thank you both so much for sticking by my side through all of this." She tears up as she says it. "I don't know what I would do if I had no one to support me."

"Hey, everyone here supports you," Netossa says. Catra sighs.

"You know what I mean. You support me even though you *know* who the other parent is. I'm afraid that *they* might not once I find the courage to tell them." If she's honest, she isn't so sure she'll ever tell them the truth. The likelihood of her parents supporting her, and the rest of the Rebellion for that matter, if they knew about her affair with Adora were next to none. Catra was a little worried they might even take *drastic* measures.

"Why tell them at all?" Netossa asks curiously. "Sure, they all may want to know, but it's none of their business if you don't want to tell them. Maybe you shouldn't. Especially if the Horde has lost their... nerve."

"It's hard though, to never be able to talk about the woman I love. To lie to my friends and family about it." Catra bites her lip in thought. "I want to tell them one day, but it's scary."

"We can understand that," Spinnerella says softly. "Who knows what the future holds. Maybe things with the Horde will improve and it won't be that big of a deal?" Catra shrugs.

"One can hope. Maybe one day things really will improve." Catra says hopefully. "The people of the Horde aren't bad. Most, if not all of them, were simply misguided by Hordak and Shadow Weaver."

"And by Adora?" Netossa adds with a raised brow. Catra shakes her head.

"No. Adora herself was misguided." Really, Catra could blame all of Adora's trauma, the way that she is, on her upbringing by Shadow Weaver.

"But her misguided-ness led to *more* misguiding of the Horde." Netossa points out. Catra sighs. She knows that Netossa is kind of right but she also doesn't know the extent of Adora's background. She also knows that Netossa and Spinnerella have become more sympathetic to Adora, they pretty much just call her Adora now - they've changed their minds about her through talking to Catra about her.

"Not necessarily." Catra sits up, grabbing her blanket and snuggling it close to her chest. "Adora hasn't been in charge that long. Not as long as Hordak and Shadow Weaver were. I'm not saying that she didn't do bad things, but the majority of the influences that misguided the people of the Horde came from Hordak and Shadow Weaver, and it showed, in our battles and even before Adora and I..." She pauses, eyes saddening. "Adora was always more cautious about making sure innocent people didn't get caught in the crossfire, even while fighting against us. She became even more cautious once I pointed out to her that we can't always get everyone out in time at Princess Prom."

"That's... true..." Netossa says. "In fact, battles kind of stopped, other than when she was trying to kidnap you."

"I know." Catra pulls her knees to her chest. "It was nice to spend time with her."

"It's hard to imagine Adora being nice." Netossa comments. Catra sighs.

"She's actually incredibly nice. She's a big sweetheart in private."

"Really?"

"Yes. She loves cuddles, she loves kisses too." Catra smiles and her tail swishes happily. Adora is actually a giant softie, she just refuses to see it.

"You really love her, huh?" Catra nods.

"I do. I think I fell in love with her very early on." *If not the very first night* . Spinnerella smiles sadly.

"You need your rest, with the grief and the... baby. We'll let you sleep."

"Thanks." Catra says gratefully, curling up on her bed happily.

"We'll head back to the meeting." Spinnerella says while guiding her wife towards the door. Catra watches them go, closing her eyes as she rests her hand on her stomach.

"One little kitten, that's all I have left of you... I promise to cherish and love them and give them the happy life that you didn't get to have, my love." She murmurs to herself (and Adora). An unheard *promise* .

* * *

Netossa and Spinnerella return back to the meeting, with Catra gone the Princesses had gone back to speculating on who the other parent was. "Do you really have no idea Luna?" Luna shakes her head at Angella.

"Anytime I asked her if she would like to talk about them, she started crying and her grieving scent grew stronger." She taps her fingers on the table. "She was worse before, her grieving lessened when she found out she was having a kitten with her mate."

"It's just... *weird* she never told us anything about them." Glimmer says. Luna didn't fully understand that if she was being honest. She could understand Catra maybe not wanting to share that she was seeing someone to her *mothers,* but not telling her best friends too? That was strange.

"It is, but maybe we were putting too much pressure on her." Luna says softly. "C'yra and I kept trying to set her up, against her wishes."

"We knew about that," Glimmer says. "But even if she didn't tell you guys, I thought she'd tell Bow and I." Luna sighs, lacing her fingers together.

"I'm not sure of her reasons why she didn't tell anyone, Glimmer. But right now isn't the best time to ask her about it either. She's lost her mate, and grieving can be fatal to a Magicat." She inhales sharply at the thought of losing her kitten - Luna would rather die herself instead. "She seems to have stabilised somewhat after having learned that she's carrying her mate's child. The best that we can do right now is give her time and support."

"Okay, yeah," Glimmer agrees.

"Aside from Catra," Angella begins. "We've been keeping an eye on the Horde but it's been... silent."

"I told you, you should just let me teleport in and take out Adora."

"Absolutely *not* , Glimmah." Angella says firmly. "Even if things have been silent, it's best not to risk it."

" *Ugh* , but wouldn't it, like, be easier to just go in and get it over with?" Mermista interrupts, looking at her fingernails. Bow shakes his head.

"It's too risky. There's too many factors that we need to take into account. It's possible that the Horde may have just stopped fighting? Battles have lessened overall in the last few months, have they not?" Bow asks. Glimmer snorts.

"The Horde? Stop fighting? That's bullshit. They're planning something."

"Glimmah, language." Angella scolds her daughter before sighing. "We need to take all possibilities into account in this case. While it is highly unlikely that the Horde just stopped fighting, the possibility is still there."

"Did everyone just forget about the spy?" Mermista asks. "You know, the person Catra warned us about like ages ago?"

"That's... right... Has anyone been able to figure out anything?" Angella asks, looking at everyone. Everyone glances at each other and shrugs.

"It's not like it matters anyway," C'yra says. "We haven't had to make any battle plans as of late."

"It's interesting," Glimmer says. "The Horde stops attacking right when our strategist, the person they kept kidnapping to prevent our battle plans, is out of commission."

"Let's just hope that it stays that way, okay?" Bow says nervously. "It's good that they're not attacking, right?"

"I'm just saying, it's weird coincidental timing."

"Well, there is about a sixty-seven percent chance that the Horde could be planning something big if we really do have a spy in our midst." Entrapta speaks up. "However, the news of Catra's pregnancy is much too soon to have been a deciding factor in the decision. So it is highly unlikely that the time is anything but merely a coincidence."

"See, Entrapta knows," Bow says. "Although... I don't like the Horde planning something big thing."

"None of us like the idea, but we don't have anything to work off of since we haven't really been fighting for months." Frosta grumbles.

"I'd say we need to come up with a strategy in case the Horde really is planning something. We need to be ready for anything." Angella says, taking the floor back.

"How do we even do that?"

"That... is a tough question to answer."

"I still think teleporting in, just to see what Adora is up to, couldn't hurt." Glimmer argues.

"Glimmah, I told you *no* ." Angella repeats. "It's too dangerous."

"But *moooom* ," Glimmer groans. "I'll take Bow, we'll be fine."

"You're not going and that's final. Understood?" Glimmer huffs and sits back in her seat, arms crossed.

"Glimmer... has a point." C'yra says and Luna looks at her wife. "Seeing what's going on inside of the Horde would be very beneficial to us."

"C'yra, you and I both know that that would be far too dangerous. Even more so since we have no idea what they're planning." Angella frowns with concern. Luna can understand her concern as a mother, she wouldn't exactly feel comfortable sending Catra to the Fright Zone either.

"I'm not suggesting we send Glimmer, maybe something else?" C'yra suggests.

"The only person who has inside information about the Horde is... Catra." Glimmer says hesitantly. That is true, the amount of times Catra has been kidnapped by the Horde Lord is almost a concerning amount. Luna had been worried that Lord Adora's intentions for her

daughter had been less than honourable but Catra had never said anything to the contrary, just that when she was kidnapped it usually took her a little while to figure out an escape route but she always ended up finding a way out - eventually. Still… it was weird how many times Catra had been snatched by the Horde Lord.

"And she's currently unable to do anything that puts her and the kitten at risk." Luna speaks up, eyebrows furrowed. She didn't know if Glimmer was suggesting sending Catra to the Fright Zone, or something similar, but that was completely out of the question. Angella sighs and rubs her face.

"We're not going to get anywhere here today. Let's call it a day and meet up and talk about plans in the near future?" Angella suggests. "Catra can still help if she feels up to it but no active field duty."

" *If* she feels up to it, Queen Angella. But remember, she just lost her mate and found out she's pregnant. She's under a lot of stress, and I'm not putting her at risk for any reason. She's been through enough." Luna says firmly, staring at her friend. She didn't want Catra to be hurt by anyone, for any reason.

"Of course," Angella says. "I'd never want to put Catra or her baby at risk."

"Good. Thank you." Luna nods.

"So... meeting adjourned? For now?" Glimmer asks.

"For now." Angella confirms. "We'll just hope that the Horde stays quiet."

"We'll hope." Luna repeats, looking at her wife. "If you could please excuse us, we're going to go check on our daughter."

"Of course," Angella nods. "Everyone is dismissed." Luna stands up, grabbing her wife's hand and the two of them walk out of the meeting room together.

"Do you think we put too much pressure on her?" Luna asks, biting her lip in worry.

"On C'yra?" Cy asks curiously.

"Yeah... She couldn't even tell us she found a mate, Cy." C'yra sighs as she takes her wife's hand, kissing her palm.

"I... I don't know why she wouldn't tell us… Unless she thought we wouldn't approve."

"You think it's because she thought we wouldn't approve?" Luna purrs softly at the kiss, her ears drooping slightly. C'yra is loving, though she can be harsh sometimes, that comes with her years as Queen and being at war. Luna loves her, however, with everything she has. C'yra is her mate and she knows that if she were to lose her the pain would be unimaginable, a pain that her daughter is experiencing *right now* .

"That's the only reason I can think of." C'yra replies. "I mean, we were a little overbearing with the suitors. If C'yra had found one of her own and wanted us to back off then you'd think she'd tell us, unless we wouldn't approve. And her scent... now that we know she was mated... It *had* changed recently."

"I just don't understand how we never noticed that it changed until... until *this* happened."

"C'yra wasn't always here, she was busy a lot. And we were busy as Queens too. Besides, we raised our kitten to be independent. And she's an adult, we don't police her life, we *trust* her." Luna sighs softly at her wife's words.

"I know, but something like that is so important in the life of a Magicat if they choose to take that step. We couldn't even be there for her when she met her mate." She takes her wife's hand, her thumb gracing over the wedding ring on it. "Do you think maybe we were a little *too* busy?"

“I... I don’t know,” C’yra admits, purring at her wife’s gentle touches. “She didn’t want to tell us for some reason.”

"It hurts a little that she won't tell us. But maybe she has a good reason." Luna sighs. She wonders why Catra is so reluctant to talk about her mate at all. She figured that it might be too painful for her but nothing? Not at all? It was strange and Luna couldn't help but wonder if they’d done something to make Catra feel like she couldn't share that part of her life with them.

“We can just be there for her now. The kitten might be enough to bring her out of grieving.”

“I hope so." Luna looks at her wife. "She seems to be... happier, at least."

“She’ll have a part of her mate with her.”

"Yeah, which I'm glad about." Luna smiles a bit. "The little kitten saved our daughter before they were even born."

“They really did.” C’yra says with a smile. “Our little heir.”

"Our little grandkitten." Luna smiles wide, kissing her wife. "Let's go be with our daughter."

* * *

Where was she?

The metal…

The Fright Zone.

Catra probably shouldn't be here. How did she even get here in the first place? "Well, well, well," Catra turns sharply and her breath hitches. "What are you doing here, Kitten?" Adora asks. *Adora.* She looks… *good* . She has her arms crossed over her chest, that Lord scowl is absent and instead she's smiling softly. In fact, she looks completely relaxed. *This is wrong. Something is off.*

"You…" Catra trails off. She wants to run to her, to be swept off of her feet, spun around and to *kiss* her but something is stopping her. "I'm mad at you." Catra says. Adora steps towards her and Catra tenses.

"Why?" Adora asks and Catra loses her train of thought as her back hits the edge of a metal table. "Don't you want to be with me, Catra?"

"So that's it?" Catra asks. "Is this really all I was to you?" Catra shoves her shoulders a little but Adora barely moves - she's built like a house. "I'm not just some fleshlight you can stick your strap into and fuck whenever you want to Adora." Catra was angry with her but she also *loved* her. Adora pauses and turns her head to the side - *why is she like some big blonde puppy?* It's not fair. Adora is cute, soft, and *beautiful* . What kind of gene lottery did Adora win?

"I was under the impression that you enjoyed *every second* of that." Adora whispers and Catra is suddenly pinned against a table, Adora pressed up against her. *Did Adora get taller?*

"I did, but you still act as if I'm a fleshlight that can fit an unlimited amount of your cum inside of me." Catra looks up at her with a scowl and Adora smirks down at her. Catra used to find cockiness extremely unattractive (and annoying) but it really works on Adora. She's like some sexy, smouldering, tall, muscular, blonde, goddess - like Catra said, it wasn't fair.

"Well, you can hold a *significant* amount." Catra rolls her eyes at Adora.

"That's literally because you make the strap so thick that it's basically a fucking plug." Adora laughs, although she stops when Catra glares at her.

"... I thought you liked it."

"I do like it." Catra admits. *Of course* she likes it. She enjoys every second of it, just like Adora had said, but still, she wanted it to mean *more* to Adora. "I'm just saying, I'm usually unable to move afterwards for a couple of hours."

"I'm hearing you complain about a lot of things you seemed to like." Adora points out.

"I'm not complaining. I'm just saying." Catra huffs. Adora leans against the wall. She crosses her arms again and Catra's eyes zone in on those biceps of hers.

"You're saying you like it but you think that I... what?"

"Nothing, never mind." Catra says dismissively. She doesn't think she wants to admit to Adora that she actually *very much* enjoyed every single moment they spent like that. Maybe Adora had thought it was just sex but she was *incredible* in bed, everything that she did drove Catra completely wild.

"No, tell me." Adora says. "Do you feel like I used you?"

"... It's hot." Catra mutters, feeling herself blush as she does so. Adora laughs at her.

"Wow, okay, so you want me to use you more?" Adora asks. Catra licks her lips, cheeks hot as she nods. "Oh, I am *more* than happy to do *that* , Kitten." Catra looks lustfully at Adora, eyes moving up and down her tall frame.

"Yeah? Maybe you should do it then." Catra challenges. Adora grins and picks Catra up, clearing the table before she places her on top of it.

"You know I enjoy using you as a *fleshlight* ."

"Do you?" Catra's eyes widen, feeling the wetness already pooling at the show of strength. "You should do it... use me... use me."

"Wow, you're really into this, aren't you Kitten?" Adora asks, whispering in Catra's ear as she grabs the sides of Catra's pants and just *tears* them - when Catra tells you that almost got her off alone, she means it. "You want me? This?"

"Hell yes. I want you so badly, Adora." Catra moans, parting her legs a bit. She wraps them around Adora's waist to pull her closer. "Touch me, Adora." Adora smirks and leans in to press her lips to Catra's throat. Her warm breath brushes over Catra's skin as Catra tangles her fingers into those blonde locks.

"What if I don't?" Adora asks smugly. Catra whines, her claws on her free hand digging into the table as she does her best to not just simply tackle Adora.

"Guess I'll have to go take care of myself." Catra says, pushing Adora away a little - two can play at the game that Adora is playing.

"I don't think you will." Adora says with a low chuckle. "Weren't you just saying you wanted me to *use* you?"

"You aren't doing anything now." Catra retorts in frustration. She wants Adora *now* . Adora sighs and then *pulls* on Catra's underwear, tearing them away - *fuck me* .

"I got you." Adora whispers. Catra whimpers in excitement, her pussy becoming even wetter with arousal at Adora's strength and words.

"Can I ride you?" Catra asks.

"Absolutely, you can *definitely* do that."

"Right now?"

"You want to do it now?" Adora asks with a grin - why is she so *hot* , who gave her the right? "Or later?"

"When do *you* want me to do it? You're in control right now. I said I wanted you to use me, sir. Is that okay?"

"Well, I really want to *fuck you* against this table first." Catra's pretty sure she gets a second heartbeat in her pussy at those words.

"Then do it." Catra replies, giving Adora a heated look. Adora backs up only long enough to change out of her clothes and to put her strap on. She *manhandles* Catra by pulling her off of the table and instead bends her over it, Catra's front pressed to the metal - it's kind of cold but Catra is *excited* .

"How hard do you want it, Kitten?" Adora asks. Catra shudders when she feels Adora's front pressed to her back, her strap rubbing her below while her breath brushes her ear.

"Fuck me hard, sir. Make sure my body fully knows that it belongs to you. That I belong to you. " Catra was almost *desperate* for Adora.

" *Definitely* ." Adora says before she thrusts *in* . Adora does exactly as Catra wanted her to do and fucks her *hard* , not bothering with warm up thrusts before she starts *driving* into her. Catra didn't even need the warm ups. Her body was wet and ready for Adora to take her, to *wreck* her. As soon as that strap slipped inside of her, she could already see stars as the movements rubbed her walls in ways that she knew would leave her incoherent soon.

"Hey Catra?"

"Y-Yes?"

"For the Honour of Grayskull!" That's the only warning Adora gives her before she transforms herself into She-Ra, everything getting bigger - including the *strap* . Catra feels her mouth go dry as her lips part. She could feel how the strap inside of her filled her every crevice *perfectly* . Her eyes go wide as she's literally fucked *into* the table.

"You're so big, holy fuck." Catra gasps. Adora had stopped momentarily during her transformation but Catra knew that wasn't going to last long.

"Thank you for noticing." Adora responds and Catra can hear the grin in her tone. "Now hold on Kitten. You said you wanted me to *use* you and that's *exactly* what I plan on doing." Catra nods, her claws digging into the metal of the table as she prepared for the blonde to have her way with her. Nothing could really prepare her for when Adora starts thrusting.

Adora doesn't hold back and, with the strength of She-Ra, Catra was feeling *everything* . Adora's thrusts are calculated and precise but also hard and fast that the table below them creaks in protest but Adora doesn't seem to care. Her thrusts become erratic as she starts to build up to her peak and continues to *pound* into Catra.

Adora always leaves Catra completely *satisfied,* Catra is pretty certain there has never been a night they've shared together where Catra has felt like something is missing. In fact, Adora's fucking strap is *tailored* to fit Catra *perfectly* - and is about the scale of Adora's ego (i.e. *big*).

There is something completely erotic about being taken from behind by an eight foot tall muscular lady who could literally probably end you with one thrust too hard. And Adora *is* going *hard* . The table, *which is bolted to the floor* , starts *moving.* Her hips slam right up against Catra and the *sounds* that were coming from Catra's pussy were downright *sinful* .

Catra was loving *every second* - just like Adora had said.

Catra squeals as she feels a large hand wrap around her tail and hold it still, Adora chuckling quietly. "You're about to knock me out with this thing, Kitten." Adora says and amusement is

clear in her tone. Catra couldn't formulate a coherent sentence if she wanted to so, instead, she simply mewls, dragging her claws down the metal of the table and leaving marks against its surface.

" *Harder* !" Catra manages. Adora slows her thrusts for a moment and Catra makes a noise of protest. She feels Adora lean over, pressing her front to Catra's back and sandwiching her between the table and She-Ra's fucking *abs* . Adora fucks her shallowly but Catra needs *more* .

Trust Adora to tease her and drag this out.

" *Mine* ." Adora whispers into her ear. Her free hand, the one currently not holding her tail, grabs a fistful of Catra's hair and then she pulls her head back. If Catra wasn't wet before (she absolutely was) she certainly was now. "Is this what you wanted Catra?" Adora asks as she gives a couple more *deep* thrusts. "For me to use you until you begged for release?" Catra gasps as Adora *bites* her *neck* . Usually Adora was pretty good about not leaving marks where others could see, but she didn't seem to be adhering to that rule right now. Bites were also pretty special to Magicats for various reasons that Catra couldn't think of right now.

Adora's breath was *hot* against Catra's neck and it was only turning her on more. Adora starts moving her hips again and she bites Catra's neck one last time before she leans back. Her large hand lands on Catra's head and she moans at being pushed into the metal of the table. Maybe Catra was more into rough sex then she originally assessed. To be fair, Adora was the only person she'd ever really done this with. Her past flings had been quick, half-dressed, unsatisfactory events. Catra had *never* felt what she feels with Adora before. Adora has pretty much ruined anyone else for Catra, she can't imagine taking anyone else's strap.

Now Adora really doesn't hold back. Catra hisses a little as her hips are rammed into the metal ridge of the table but she doesn't want Adora to stop, not when it feels this *incredible* . Catra can feel herself climbing that peak, her stomach feels tight with pressure, her claws scratch at the table, she hasn't stopped calling out Adora's name since she started. It's a perfect storm, and Catra can feel herself hurtling towards her end.

Her orgasm hits her so powerfully her claws extend automatically and scrape into the metal below her. She almost screams in pure pleasure as her walls clamp down around Adora's strap. She doesn't stop. She keeps going, ramming into Catra over and over again until another orgasm rips through Catra. In fact, Adora doesn't stop until she's a panting mess

herself - the fact that *She-Ra* was out of breath says it all really. Catra can feel her cum inside of her and Adora's heavy body on top of her. "I love you." Adora whispers and every nerve ending in Catra's body *lights on fire* . Those words… they're *everything* Catra wants to hear.

Catra lifts her arm up and taps Adora on her shoulder. She feels the blonde roll off of her and now suddenly they're in Adora's bed. Catra buries her nose in the pillow. She was dreaming. That made more sense. It wasn't that surprising. At first the dreams had been comforting but now her brain was just being plain cruel. She moves to lean on her side and look at Adora.

She looks just as perfect as Catra remembers her being, her blonde hair is down and splayed across the pillow, her biceps are on show and her blue eyes sparkle in the low light. Catra also notes that she's *Adora* now, not She-Ra. All the jumping around, her being here, a dream is the only thing that made sense. Catra moves to cuddle up to her side, resting her head against her chest. "Adora… this isn't real." Catra whispers against her chest. There's a moment of silence before Adora (or *Not* Adora) responds.

"I know Kitten." She whispers back as her hand gently runs up Catra's spine. "Is this what you want?" Adora asks.

"I want *you.* " Catra says quietly - she even *smells* like Adora. Catra wonders if her brain just knows Adora's scent so well that she can replicate it even in her dreams. "I dream about you every night, I think about you all the time. I miss you… *so much* … Why don't you want me Adora?"

"I'm here now."

"But you're not!" Catra sits up sharply and shoves her. Adora sits up beside her. She reaches her hand out and gently cups the side of Catra's face and Catra leans into her touch. It all feels so *real.* "Was this really just sex to you?" Catra asks.

"I can't answer that." Adora says and Catra sighs, purring softly at her gentle caress. "But what do you think?"

“I think…” Catra pauses. “I think you were afraid, and confused, and you were taught that your destiny was to destroy the Rebellion. But you’re so much *more* than that Adora. You don’t have to follow a destiny set for you by Hordak and Shadow Weaver. You can make your own destiny. This can’t be what you want.” Catra opens her eyes and she meets those beautiful baby blues with her own gaze. Adora does *that* smile, the half smile, the cute one that Catra absolutely adores.

“Don’t give up on me.” Adora whispers.

“Never.” Catra replies. She doesn’t think she’s capable of giving up on *Adora* . Adora will always make her *hope* . She goes to reach for her but instead she jolts suddenly, her body moving.

Catra wakes up. Adora is gone. Her bed sheets have been *clawed* . She sighs as she rolls over to see the empty sheets beside her. She’s sweaty and sticky and she *totally* came in her sleep. Figures dream Adora would be just as satisfactory as real Adora. Catra presses her hand to her stomach and takes a deep breath. She can’t escape Adora anywhere, no matter how hard she tries, not even her dreams are safe - now she’s having *wet* dreams about her? This seems almost unfair. She wonders if this is affecting Adora like it’s affecting her? As her mate they are *bonded* , which explains why Catra can’t escape Adora anywhere. Still, it seems unfair that she can so vividly dream of Adora it literally makes her cum in her sleep.

Catra sits up. She wishes she could tell Adora about their baby, she wishes that dream was true. She misses Adora beyond belief. She places her hand on her stomach. “Well Little One… I should get up anyway.” Catra doesn’t know how much more of this she can take.

* * *

Catra walks down the halls of Bright Moon. She was feeling significantly better than she had the past few weeks. She was still grieving but ever since she found out about Finn she had been getting better. She places her hand to her abdomen and smiles. She already had a name for the little kit. It hurt her to be away from Adora but now she had someone else to care about, someone else to worry about. She wasn't alone anymore.

Catra passes by the War Room and her ears twitch when she hears voices from inside. She pauses just outside the half open door to listen in on the low voices speaking. "Bow, I'm

telling you, I could teleport there and back, take Lord Adora out and then *boom* no more war. Why won't my mom listen to me?" That was Glimmer.

"Glimmer, come on... you'd need to recharge to make the second jump back, it's too risky. Queen Angella is right." *Bow* responds.

"I've been spying on the Horde." Catra frowns at Glimmer's words. She doesn't like whatever it is that Glimmer is implying. Spying on the Horde? That's trouble waiting to happen.

"Spying how?" Bow asks with alarm clear in his tone. Catra smiles a little. She always did like Bow, he always looked out for his friends and when Glimmer had confessed that she had a crush on Bow, Catra had already known, they just made *sense* . They were cute together, Bow was definitely the entirety of Glimmer's impulse control too.

"Just... watching, from a distance. They're planning something Bow. Someone said Lord Adora hasn't been spotted in weeks, until recently. And apparently she's... not in the best mood. Do you know what happens when someone like Lord Adora has a bad day? People die! Or, at the very least, get hurt. We can't let her do that." Catra's ears twitch at the mention of Adora's name, she'd almost forgotten that the Rebellion called her *Lord* Adora; she was so used to just calling her by her name.

"Maybe we should wait. You know, like Angella said. We need Catra." Bow argues.

"What do you need me for?" Catra asks as she knocks on the door before entering the War Room, making her presence known. "You rang?" She smiles. She was a little tired from her restless nights, and her expression definitely showed that, but she was in much less pain than what she had been before.

"Catra!" Bow squeaks as he jumps and turns the papers over on the desk in front of him in a completely *unsubtle* manner. "We were just... just talking..."

"I want to teleport to the Fright Zone and kick Lord Adora's butt, you in?" Glimmer deadpans.

"It's too dangerous, Glimmer." Catra shakes her head. The last thing she wanted was for Glimmer and Adora to hurt each other in any way. "If you go in by yourself, you have no idea who you'd end up facing. You could get ambushed. Plus, your teleports are limited and you do get a little trigger happy sometimes... a lot of the time." Glimmer sometimes forgot that her teleports were *limited* , Catra often had to remind her, as the tactician of the Rebellion it was practically her job.

"I do *not* !" Glimmer yells defensively.

"Uh... yeah you do, Glimmer." Bow says and Glimmer rolls her eyes at him, shoving his chest playfully.

"Come on! It'll be fun! We used to get into all kinds of trouble back in the day, don't you remember?" Glimmer asks. "My mom used to get so mad at us when we went out on a mission without telling her."

"It's one thing to get in trouble when we were kids and it’s another to walk right into the middle of danger with the only plan being to slap A- *Lord* Adora and teleport away without any backup plan." Catra shakes her head in a motherly manner. "I hate to say it, but this is not a good plan, whatsoever, Glim." Glimmer gasps dramatically and then looks at Bow. She looks back at Catra.

"Wow... and here I thought you'd *love* to teleport into the Fright Zone just to slap Lord Adora's dumb face."

"Look," Bow says. "Catra's right, plus, I'm pretty sure Adora would kick our butts. She's a highly trained Horde soldier, remember?"

"I remember Bow."

"Yeah, well, even if I want to, I can't do that." Catra says. She *doesn’t* want to slap Adora, at all. "And Bow's right, she's the leader of the Horde for a reason. She took down the other

two, right?"

"Well, *you've* gone toe to toe with her in the past. We could take her, all three of us, no problem." Catra almost wants to groan at Glimmer. It’s true that Catra *has* won Adora in hand-to-hand in the past, that all seemed so long ago now. She could never hurt Adora now and she hasn’t fought her seriously in *months* .

"Glimmer, I can't fight her." Catra means that in the way that she’s pregnant and also that she simply doesn’t know *how* to fight Adora anymore.

"Right, right, you're pregnant." Glimmer waves her hand dismissively. "Fine. But we need to do *something* because I'm going crazy. Do you have any idea how long it's been since I punched a Horde soldier?" Glimmer asks before her eyes light up. "Oh! What about we all go to Mystacor?"

"Mystacor? I don't know how I feel about jumping onto a floating rock to get there." Catra places a hand on her abdomen. She knows it's perfectly safe for her normal self, but she has no idea how Finn would be affected.

"Ugh," Glimmer complains. "I'm going stir crazy. Between nothing from the Horde and-" Glimmer stops, biting her lip as she looks at Catra's stomach before she looks away - *what was that about* ? "You know... everything... I just want to spend time with my two best friends."

"We can still spend time together, Glimmer." Catra smiles softly, hugging the other. "We just have to stay a little closer to home, okay?"

"Okay... sleepover?" Glimmer asks.

"Sleepover!" Catra agrees. Truth be told, she has missed both Glimmer and Bow, she’d be happy to spend time with them.

"Hell yeah!" Glimmer says excitedly. "Oh... I don't know how teleporting affects you now that you're pregnant so maybe you and Bow go ahead and I'll go grab the food?"

"Thanks for being considerate. Do you wanna meet in my guest room here?" Catra asks with a small smile.

"Yeah… Maybe I'll take Bow, he can help hold things." Glimmer says.

"Are you using me for my muscles?" Bow asks. Glimmer squeezes his bicep.

"Don't you know that's why I'm dating you?" Glimmer teases. "We'll meet you in your room?" Glimmer asks Catra. Catra misses teasing Adora about things like that - she misses teasing her about her big forehead. Catra's heart throbs in her chest.

"Meet you both there." Catra waves at them. She watches them wave back at her and then leave. She sighs, wishing Glimmer wasn't so impulsive.

She didn't know how long she could do this for. Adora wasn't her enemy anymore, she was just *Adora.* And hearing her best friends talk so casually about hurting her mate wasn't helping. The thing was, she could understand where Glimmer was coming from. The silence from the Horde *was* extremely concerning. Catra was beyond worried. Ever since she'd started recovering from her grief she had found Adora's silence and lack of activity very worrying. Adora wasn't one to just sit back and Catra had to wonder what the hell it was that she was planning and about how she was going to face her again.

Catra arrives back in her room and makes herself comfortable by changing her clothes. She tidies up the place a little more before there's a knock at her door. She goes over to it to see Glimmer and Bow standing there with armfuls of treats. She helps them inside and sets the food down on the ground as they make their usual sleeping fort from various blankets and cushions.

They settle in but it's not long before Glimmer circles back to the topic of the Horde. Or well... not the Horde *exactly* . "So... how come you never told us? About your... you know." Glimmer gestures to Catra's stomach.

"I found out recently about Finn if that's what you're referring to." Catra answers. And she wasn't lying. She hadn't exactly expected for her and Adora's escapades to result in a kitten - she hadn't really thought She-Ra cum could do that. Guess magic really does solve everything, or, in this case, makes things more complicated.

"No, I mean, I figured that was a new development." Glimmer says, picking up a cake. "I meant... you having a secret lover." Catra's smile immediately falls from her face, her eyes becoming glassy.

"It... It doesn't matter anymore anyway." It's not like she could ever be with Adora again.

"Did you not trust us?" Glimmer asks. "I mean, we're your best friends, and we never... you never told us anything."

"It's not that! It's just... I guess it never felt like the right time to introduce her to anyone because of... well, you know." Catra shrugs. That wasn't exactly a lie, the war was a huge factor to Catra's inability to share who her mate was - namely that she was the leader of the *opposite* side. "There isn't much introducing that can be done anymore anyway." Glimmer gives Catra a look.

"That... doesn't make sense."

"She's gone, that's all that matters." Catra whispers. Adora wasn't dead, but the way her heart gripped painfully in her chest at the thought of her, sure made it feel that way. She was gone from her reach, from her life. Their love was forbidden by the side that Catra was part of because of who Adora was. She loves Adora, so much, but it would hurt her to lose everyone else she loves and cares about too. Bow offers a tissue silently and with a gentle smile.

"Don't you want to tell us about her?" Glimmer asks. "I guess we'll figure it out when the baby is born..." Catra takes the tissue Bow offers her gratefully, wiping her eyes. Luckily, there are a lot of people who have blue eyes and blonde hair, so Catra wasn't too worried about people jumping to conclusions if Finn happened to share those characteristics of Adora. What *would* be concerning is if Adora saw them and figured out that Finn was her child. She doesn't know how Adora would react to this kind of thing, she doesn't even know if Adora

wants kids, or how she feels about them in general, they never talked about this kind of thing. Still, she *wants* to talk about Adora, even if it’s in vague terms.

"She's... She's beautiful. She's so strong, and caring, and loving. She's protective of me, it was really sweet. She'd do so much to make sure I felt comfortable and happy whenever I was with her." Catra smiles at her memories of Adora. They had all been *good* , right up until she broke her heart.

"She sounds... pretty amazing." Bow says. "Was she a Magicat?"

"Was she killed by the Horde?" Glimmer asks angrily. "It's time we took those assholes down."

"She wasn't a Magicat." Catra shakes her head. "No, she wasn't killed by the Horde."

"So what happened to her?" Glimmer asks. Catra's lip wobbles and tears well up in her eyes. She can't answer, the words are choking her. Bow moves to wrap Catra in a hug.

"You don't have to tell us." He says softly and glares at Glimmer in warning. "Let's just change the topic, yeah?"

"Okay, okay." Glimmer holds her hands up in defeat. "Sleepover things. How was your day, Bow?"

"Oh! Good! Do you want to see the new arrows I made?" He asks excitedly.

"Yes, please. What did you add to them?" Catra asks, her voice cracking a bit. She can only think about Adora for so long and Bow showing off his trick arrows would be a welcome distraction. Bow grabs his quiver and then pulls out various arrows.

"This one squirts water. I know there's probably easier ways, but you never know when you might need it." He says happily. "This one is my sonic arrow," Glimmer snorts and Bow glares at her before she holds her hands up with a fond smile. "This one shoots confetti!"

"That's really cool, Bow. You've always been so smart." Catra says with a little chuckle. Trust Bow to make her feel better, he was always good at that.

"Thank you," Bow smiles. "How are you? Do you need anything?" Catra shakes her head.

"I'm okay, thank you for asking. I could be better." Catra admits. "But I'm happy to spend time with you guys."

"Group hug?" Bow asks but doesn't really give Catra much of a chance to protest before both Glimmer and Bow tackle her in a hug. Catra smiles and purrs, doing her best to hug them back in the position she was in.

"I love you guys. Thank you for being here with me." Catra whispers. She really does love them and she hates that she's been lying to them for so long for someone who doesn't even love her.

"Of course. We're the best friend squad," Bow says. "Nothing we can't do." Catra beams and hugs them tighter.

"Thank you so much. So, what do you two want to do?"

They spend the night telling jokes and eating junk food and, though Cata thinks about Adora, no one brings up the Horde again for the evening. It's just them spending time together. It's nice and *normal* and just what Catra needed. She just hopes that if her friends and family were to ever find out who Finn's other parent was, that they wouldn't hate her - even if they probably would. Catra falls asleep sandwiched between her two best friends and purring happily. She has a good dream about Adora that night.

* * *

Adora stares at the table in front of her that was littered with papers. Things had ground to a halt in the Fright Zone and Adora was *cracking* . The only reason it was even semi functioning was because Scorpia had taken on most day to day running. She came by to check on Adora frequently but Adora was never in the mood for visitors - whoever came to see her, Adora practically bit their head off - and to top it all off, Adora couldn't even look at her fucking sword without thinking of *her* .

Catra had... broken her heart. She left her. She told her that she loved her and she still left her. Why was Adora never good enough? Why did everyone use her? Hordak, Shadow Weaver... She tried so hard... and she *failed* ... she kept failing, she was *still* failing. The Horde was crumbling, they were *losing* , all because Adora had been *weak* .

Goodbye Horde Lord.

Horde Lord.

Adora has never felt so cold than when Catra had said those words to her; when Catra called her by her title and not her name.

Adora brings her fist down on the metal table in her anger. She feels... out of control, and she *hates* feeling out of control. Her emotions are everywhere, all at once: anger, hurt, betrayal and she... Adora leans against the table. "Shadow Weaver was right," She says to herself. She can see her reflection in the shiny metal of the table and she takes a long pained sigh. She looks, in a word? *Shattered* . She was distracted, and confused, and she'd allowed herself to lose focus.

She closes her eyes and tries to push the anger down, she can feel She-Ra clawing under the surface of her skin. Adora has never been *fantastic* at controlling her anger. She's like a bomb just waiting to go off. Her throne room was a disaster from her fit of rage the day Catra had left her and she hadn't allowed anyone near her to clean it up.

"What are you looking at?" Adora speaks to her reflection. "You're pathetic, you know that? Falling for a Princess? What kind of Lord are you? You're weak, worthless, you... you're *nothing* ." Adora punches her reflection, reveling in the way her knuckles protest. She lifts her fist to see her knuckle out of place and she pops it back in.

The pain is nothing in comparison to the pain she felt without Catra being here. She never thought she could ever feel such *hurt* .

Adora pulls her sword from her waist and starts hitting her table with it until the thing breaks in half and Adora is a panting mess. "Oh man, I just organised that paperwork this morning." Adora whirls around to see Scorpia standing not too far from her, holding a plate of ration bars.

"What are you doing here?" Adora asks. "Get out!" Adora gestures with her hand to the door, glaring at Scorpia who simply just stands there and stares at her.

"Nonsense! I brought you food, Boss Man, you still need to eat." Scorpia says and Adora stares blankly. Scorpia was completely unafraid of her, had that been any other Horde soldier, they'd be cowering and running out of the throne room. Adora stares at her as she sets the plate down on Adora's throne. "Oh boy, you sure did a number in here." Scorpia says. "We can clean it up, no worries."

"No. I want you to leave." Adora says. She sheaths her sword and moves closer to Scorpia. "Get the hell out of here! Get. *OUT* !" Adora was inches from Scorpia's face and she didn't so much as flinch.

"You may be angry and upset, but you don't get to treat me like that." Scorpia says and Adora straightens her back up. She hadn't expected Scorpia to fight back like that. "I'm not your punching bag, you can throw a tantrum, break things, but I'm your *friend* , you're being a *bad* friend." Adora deflates and turns away. She balls her bruised knuckles into a fist.

"I'm sorry," Adora says quietly. "I... You're right. Will you leave me alone, please? I'm not ready to face anyone right now." There's a long pause of silence before Adora hears Scorpia move again.

"Sure thing Boss, make sure to eat the food I brought. When you're ready, tell me." Adora just nods. She waits until Scorpia's boots echo as she leaves.

Adora was never good at sitting on her hands either. Anger. Inability to sit still. Pain. Hurt. Loss. It's a dangerous mixture for Adora, and she's very close to making a *very* bad decision.

Adora sits down on the ground, cross legged. She drops her face into her hands and sighs. She misses Catra so much it hurts her physically. It feels like someone scooped out her insides and dumped it on the ground before kicking Adora repeatedly. She never should've let Catra get that close. No strings? There were *so many* strings. They had gotten tangled in those strings probably from about the second night they slept together.

Adora lies on her back and stares up at the ceiling of the throne room. Being alone was probably a bad idea. Whenever she was alone she got ideas, *bad ideas,* and her anger got the better of her.

She stands, her cape fluttering behind her as her feet take off. She bounds down the steps where her throne was and out of the room. The guards at her door startle at the sight of her. Adora is aware she looks... somewhat deranged. She has dark circles under her eyes, her hair is crazy, her bangs fall into her eyes, her uniform is creased, and nowhere near its usual crisp neatness. She takes off, ignoring her men, her heavy boots thud against the metal floors of the Fright Zone. She knows *exactly* where she's going.

It takes her very little time, before she knows it, Adora is standing in front of *her* cell panting and feeling like a *wild animal.* "Shadow Weaver." Adora states.

"Adora." She responds with a bored tone. "Look at you child, so broken, did the Magicat betray you?"

"Shut the fuck up Shadow Weaver." Adora snaps. She paces back and forth in front of her cell. Why did Adora even come here? Shadow Weaver *never* makes her feel better. She tuts and Adora looks at her.

"Look at your uniform, you're a *mess* child." Shadow Weaver scolds. Adora looks down. She knows she looks terrible, almost unhinged, but Shadow Weaver pointing that out only pisses her off. "Why are you here Adora? I told you to not come crying to me if she broke your heart." Adora stops pacing and turns to face Shadow Weaver head on.

"She... didn't break my heart." Adora says with a little laugh. "I... I realised the *truth* . The Rebellion... it has to go." Adora runs her hands through her hair, pulling it back and tying it up - though her bangs still fall in her eyes. "My mission."

"Your *mission* ," Shadow Weaver hisses. "was to destroy and crush the Rebellion. You're failing."

"I know."

"You're distracted."

"I know."

"And you trusted a Princess when you shouldn't have."

" *I know* ." Adora grits out. She should've known Shadow Weaver would berate her right now but she feels... She feels a *darkness* within her, and Scorpia, and the others, they don't deserve to be suffocated by it, but Shadow Weaver? She deserves *everything* .

Adora hesitates before she punches the code into the keypad at the side of the cell. The forcefield falls. Even though she's wearing a mask, Shadow Weaver's surprise is obvious - and her *fear* . "I... I need you." Adora says.

Shadow Weaver looks at her for a long moment and Adora stares at the ground, her head slightly bowed. She feels cold fingers press under her chin and cup her jaw. She looks up at Shadow Weaver. "Poor child," She coos and Adora, against her better judgement, leans into her touch. "She was using you."

"What do you mean?" Adora asks. She knows this is stupid, Shadow Weaver cannot be trusted, but she's also the closest thing Adora has ever had to a mother. It's *complicated* . She hates her but she was *raised* by her. She still seeks her approval and comfort... and part of her still loves her - and that's the part of her that Adora hates. She doesn't understand. *Why does what Shadow Weaver thinks of her mean so much to her?*

"Think about it, Adora," Shadow Weaver says as her hand strokes the side of her face - the side where Adora's scar was. "Why would the Magicat sleep with you in the first place?" She asks.

"Catra... She said she was curious." Adora answers.

" *Or* , she saw how *lonely* you were." Shadow Weaver says and as she speaks Adora feels a frown form on her face. "She's the Rebellion's tactician, you were just another tactic to her, a plan to take the Horde down by sleeping with its leader." Adora looks at her boots. "She planned to make you *soft* , to open you up, that's all you ever were, Adora. A *means* to an *end* ."

"No... Catra... she... she wouldn't." Adora shakes her head, trying to deny Shadow Weaver's words but the more she thought about them, the more she felt herself doubt.

"Of course she would," Shadow Weaver says. "She's a *Princess* , or did you forget? They're *manipulative* , they'll do anything to win. She opened her legs for you so you'd let your guard down, she *used* you, Adora." Adora's breath quickens and her hands ball into fists at her sides. She feels fresh tears sting her eyes. *Could it be true? Did Catra keep sleeping with her in the hopes of taking the Horde down? In the hope that she could make her Horde problem disappear by softening their leader?*

Adora looks up at Shadow Weaver. "I... What do I do? I... She-Ra... I could use her..." Adora thinks about it. She's more comfortable with She-Ra now and, as a result, far more knowledgeable on her strength. She-Ra could definitely be what she needs to take down the Rebellion. "But even she... I'm not sure she's enough."

"The Black Garnet." Shadow Weaver says and Adora turns her head to the side. "If you combine the Black Garnet with She-Ra you will be unstoppable, child. Let me place a shard of it to your chest and then I can bind it to you with magic."

" *Dark* magic." Adora scowls but... if it could give her the power she needed... it was worth considering at the very least.

"It will give you power beyond anything you've ever *imagined* ." Shadow Weaver coos. Power... Adora needed that if she wanted to beat the Rebellion. This plan of Shadow Weaver's was starting to sound like it was *exactly* what Adora needed.

Adora sinks down onto her knees in front of Shadow Weaver. She's broken. She needs Shadow Weaver's help. "The Magicat has corrupted you." Shadow Weaver's voice is silky, like a serpent slithering it's way into Adora's mind. Adora looks up. "She has *distracted* you from your *mission* . Broken you." Adora clenches her hands into fists against her thighs. "I can *help* you Adora, let me help you."

Adora stares at her for a long moment. She swallows thickly. She *had* become distracted. *Weak* . Maybe Shadow Weaver could help... Adora raises her hands and wipes at her eyes. She steels them before she pushes herself up to her feet again. "Okay." She says. "Help me *crush* the Rebellion, once and for all."

* * *

Catra laughs and snorts at something Glimmer says. They were sitting in the War Room, mostly just chatting, although Catra had also been overlooking some intelligence. There wasn't a whole lot of it, just some vague descriptions of sightings of Lord Adora and other Horde activity. Apparently Adora hadn't left her throne room a whole lot, and when she *had* been spotted the description on her paper read: 'erratic and confrontational'. Catra bites her lip at that.

Adora being erratic and confrontational wasn't exactly unexpected, Catra kind of figured that's how she had been before Catra had started coming to visit. In fact, she had been confrontational plenty of times with Catra *present* . The more concerning part was the erratic part. Adora was a planner. She was careful, she was smart, she liked things under her control,

she was rarely one to relinquish control, if she was acting erratically that could only mean one thing: Adora was *out* of control.

Catra has never seen that side of Adora, that side of Adora was rare and only when she was experiencing severe emotional turmoil. At least, that's what Catra pieced together from her fear of She-Ra and losing control. That's why Adora has the tendency to come off cold, it's not that she's emotionless, she simply reins them in, the only emotion she lacks control in is anger. Catra has seen her anger, directed mostly at her soldiers, or when someone tried to hurt Catra. Adora has two different anger levels, she has her scary calm anger where she's like a ticking bomb and then you have the aftermath of that when she explodes. Catra had been trying to help her with those anger issues but now... she's *worried* to say the least.

Truthfully, Catra finds Adora hard to read sometimes. She knows Adora finds it hard to be honest about how she's feeling, she knows feelings make her feel awkward, she knows that Adora has empathy and understanding and that she can feel so *deeply* but she's also entirely too good at covering it up; at denying it or ignoring them simply because they make her feel uncomfortable. She loves Adora, but she won't let herself be hurt for her.

Catra sighs and her tail flicks, hitting the back of the chair she was sitting in. "So we're back at square one," Glimmer says. "We have no idea what Lord Adora is up to." Catra sighs. She takes her crown off of her face and brushes her hair back with her claws before she puts it back in place.

"Do you want my strategic input?" Catra asks and Glimmer nods. "We should wait. Adora said once that we were more reactive than proactive and there's a reason for that. We're *defending* Etheria, it's the Horde's job to attack it."

"Wait," Glimmer looks at Catra incredulously and like she just realised something. "Since when did you start calling Lord Adora, *Adora* , all casual like that?" Glimmer asks. "And when did Lord Adora say that to you?" Catra rolls her eyes.

"Her name is Adora, isn't it? Lord Adora is such a mouthful." Catra easily excuses. "And she has talked to me before, Glimmer. Sometimes she doesn't know how to *stop* talking." Catra has learnt that the best lies have a kernel of truth to them. Adora really doesn't know how to stop talking sometimes - especially when she's nervous, though her getting flustered is really quite cute. Catra has also learnt that she’s somewhat of an expert liar - who knew?

Glimmer still seems somewhat sceptical but she shrugs. "We attack the Horde, not Etheria." She says.

"No." Catra shakes her head. "We wait. It’s the best course of action." And also, Catra doesn't want to have to fight Adora until she absolutely has to.

" *Ugh* , fine." Glimmer grumbles. "Maybe we should get some food?" Catra is about to respond when a panting Bright Moon guard comes running into the War Room. Catra can smell their fear and anxiety rolling off of them and she instantly tenses.

"Princesses!" They say, clearly relieved and out of breath. "Come quickly. It's the Horde. They're here!" Catra is standing before she can even register in her head that she told herself to do that.

"How many?" Catra asks.

"Too many." The guard says with great concern. "They move on Bright Moon-"

" *What* ?! How did they get so close without us noticing?" Glimmer asks.

"The woods must be helping them, Princess Glimmer." Catra pinches the bridge of her nose. She-Ra. She's supposed to protect Etheria. It makes sense that Etheria would try to protect her too - or the person who carries her sword anyway. "Lord Adora she... she's leading the attack."

There's a long stretch of silence before Catra breaks it.

" *Fuck* ."

Chapter End Notes

Some of you managed to guess what was going to happen regarding Catra! So congratulations on that. But as we all know, anyone talking to Shadow Weaver is never good... -M

Can't wait for y'all to read the next update ;) -S

A few extra things, we made a twitter to interact with Lord Adora stuff and also set up a Curious Cat to answer questions and share further headcanons and stuff because we have constant brain rot over Lord Adora, you can check that out @ceolordadora feel free to follow and come say hi!

We also have a Lord Adora playlist for this fic which you can find here: https://open.spotify.com/playlist/1Qvz4uFjDU34HggXiwLgSj?si=lN-c80FXTnC8ktNZhgQYRQ&utm_source=copy-link

All's Fair

Chapter Summary

All's Fair in Love and War.

Chapter Notes

Happy Friday and happy update day!! Quick note before this chapter starts. This one is a little different to the other chapters, we do switch POVs in chapters but this time it's quite rapid. We've put the name at the beginning to show the shift in POV. This is the only chapter we do it this rapidly because it really suits the pacing of the chapter and the scenes that are occurring. Anyway, we will see you again at the end!

Warning, Violence, Injury, Blood

See the end of the chapter for more notes

ADORA

Adora looks grimly out across the battlefield where she could see the Rebellion forces assembling. "Hm," She lifts her hand to her chest where the shard of the Black Garnet rested. Shadow Weaver had told her that she would be unstoppable as She-Ra with the added power of the Black Garnet but she felt... strange. Her emotions were all out of whack, she felt *unbalanced,* but she was clinging to her anger and her *hurt* to keep her present.

"M-My Lord." Adora turns her icy gaze to the soldier who just addressed her. No one has seen She-Ra - no one except *Catra* - and the soldier is visibly afraid. *Good* . "The Rebels are getting ready."

"I can see that." Adora answers flatly. "Get ready to attack." The soldier salutes and scurries off to whatever line they were from.

Adora looks out. She wonders where Catra is, if she'll even be here - *she'll be here* . Despite everything, Adora is *conflicted.* She doesn't know what she's doing here, she doesn't know if she wants revenge, or to hurt Catra, or if she simply just wants to see her again. She just

knows that this war needs to end, one way or another. Can she really blame Catra for saving herself from Adora? She had looked so *pained* when she had run from the Fright Zone that night. Was this not Adora's own fault? It’s too late to turn back now, or to second guess herself.

The shard at her chest pulses and Adora’s doubts are washed away with a spike of anger and hurt. The Black Garnet seems to only heighten Adora’s spiralling emotions rather than her stabilising ones. Truth be told, Adora is aware she has hurt Catra as much as Catra has hurt her, but she’s not willing to admit to any of that.

Adora sighs as she hears Scorpia step beside her. "Are you sure about this, Boss?" Scorpia asks.

"The war ends today," Adora states steadily. "I am going to *crush* the Rebellion, like I should've done long ago." Adora's eyes burn with her silent rage and Scorpia knows better than to push her. She looks sad but Adora doesn't have the energy to care. She *has* to do this. She’s allowed herself to become too distracted for far too long. Catra can’t stop her from reaching her goal.

Adora advances, and her troops follow, but no one in the Rebellion could hope to stand up to *She-Ra.*

* * *

CATRA

Catra hardly registers anything around her, but she forces herself to for the sake of the Rebellion; for the safety of everyone and for her own safety. She hoped that this battle wouldn't escalate, that Adora wouldn't take things too far now that everything was over between them. An ache fills her chest at the thought of her mate. The one who hadn't wanted her. The one who didn't feel the same. Even through everything, she still loved her so much. At least she would have a piece of her despite them being apart.

Catra sighs, placing a hand on her abdomen as she positions herself out of view from everyone else. She was just there to provide strategies to make sure the Rebellion could defend against the Horde. Catra was under strict instructions not to join the battle - like she had any intentions to do that. *What the hell was Adora planning?* It was a bold move to attack Bright Moon like she was, she must have something up her sleeve.

Rebellion forces whiz past Catra's position. She's out of view, which means her view of the battle is slightly obstructed, but Catra can see everyone's positions with her com-pad in her hands and her earpiece in place. She sits, ready to provide commands. She can hear her friends talking to each other in slight panicked tones. Catra has faith in them. Catra was expecting this to go how most battles went: either the Rebellion or the Horde retreating until a future battle again. That is until a chilling message is spoken to her by Glimmer.

"Catra! She brought out She-Ra!" Catra's heart all but stops and a chill runs down her spine. There was no way. Adora *hated* the idea of She-Ra. She had sworn to herself that she would never use her in battle. *Did Adora really want them... want **her** gone so badly?*

"Glimmer, *everyone* , *please* be careful out there. Do *not* engage She-Ra alone. Try to avoid her as much as possible." Catra orders strictly. Her eyes scan up to the field as she spots what Glimmer had talked about. Except... She-Ra didn't look *right* .

* * *

ADORA

Shadow Weaver was *right* . Adora felt *powerful* and she was *unstoppable* .

The Rebellion foot soldiers avoid her like the plague after the first two squads were dispatched and fled from Adora the first time. She's like a demon in battle. She recalls old Horde bedtime stories about heroes, stories Shadow Weaver would tell her about, great heroes of the past who were incited by rage and lay waste to cities - maybe there was a girl involved too. Now that she thinks about it, those are strange bedtime stories to tell a *child* but relevant now. Adora was that so-called Hero, laying waste to a Kingdom and *no one* could hope to match her.

"We need back up!" A Rebellion soldier says. "Princess Glimmer? *Anyone* ?!" Adora almost laughs.

"Your Princesses won't save you now." Adora says. "You should run." An arrow comes whizzing past her head and Adora - *She-Ra?* - snatches it from mid-air, snapping it in half. Her eyes search for the perpetrator and she spots the Master Archer staring at her with wide eyes.

She-Ra raises her sword. She pauses when she notices that she looked... different. In the blade's reflection it almost looked like her eyes were red and not blue. *Who am I? She-Ra? Adora? Something else?*

Who am I?!

She *has* to keep fighting. Her mission. *What was her mission? Crush the Rebellion.* ***Crush the Rebellion.*** She looks back at the Master Archer. "You should definitely run for that!"

* * *

CATRA

Catra bites her lip, stating orders as quickly as she can to the soldiers to make sure they were safe. Her heart nearly stops when she sees her mate looking at Bow with a crazed look. "That's not her..." She whispers to herself. That wasn't how She-Ra looked *at all.* Gone where the soft whites and blues and bright golds. It was all covered in blood red and black, even Adora's eyes seemed to glow a terrifying *red* .

Something is terribly wrong and she can't just sit here and watch her… watch the woman she *loves* kill one of her best friends. Adora looks… She looks like she's in *pain* . She-Ra's usual soft glow is red, her usual golden armour looks similar to the usual Horde armour, instead of her golden symbol at her chest sits what looks like a black stone with a tint of red, it's encased within the chest plate - even She-Ra's *veins* look red. *Is Adora even in there?*

She remembers what Adora said to her in her dream. *Don't give up on me. Never.* Catra doesn't know if she can help Adora right now, like this, but she damn well will get Bow *out of there* before Adora does something she can never take back. The thing about them being mated means their souls are bonded. Catra isn't certain how that works for Adora but for Catra it means when either one of them is in great distress she can *feel* it. Adora is completely out of balance, she's in *turmoil* . Catra has to help her, and she has to help Bow.

Catra acts without thinking. She drops her com-pad, moving out of her hiding spot and rushing over to try to give Bow a chance to escape. "Bow!" She calls out, gathering the attention of the archer - and of the *Horde Lord.*

* * *

ADORA

I know that voice.

She-Ra turns her head to see... *Catra* running out into the thick of the battle. She loses all interest in the archer, her eyes fixed on Catra. *My Catra.* The Black Garnet shard on her chest pulses a little, sending a spark of red electric through Adora. *Ow, that hurts.* Shadow Weaver had said it might hurt but that Adora should keep going.

She should keep going.

* * *

CATRA

"Catra? What- You need to go back!" Bow yells, drawing another arrow and pointing it at She-Ra. Catra notices that Adora has her gaze fixed entirely on Catra and *not* Bow but she seems frozen to the spot.

"Bow, you need to run." Catra speaks calmly as she takes a step back. Her eyes land on the red shard that rests against Adora's chest. *Is that? It was!* It was a piece of a runestone, a corrupted one for that matter. It has to be the Black Garnet, it's the only runestone the Horde has, that has multiple implications. She-Ra already has a runestone (in her sword), another Princess using the runestone of another element seems like it *would* negatively impact a Princess. Adora has probably and purposely made herself unbalanced even if those weren't her intentions.

Catra is aware of the person who used that runestone. *Shadow Weaver.* It technically belongs to Scorpia but Catra knows, because Adora told her, that Shadow Weaver harnessed the power of the runestone using dark magic and that she *used* it against *Adora* on multiple occasions. The red shock that fires from the shard and makes Adora wince tells Catra all she needs to know. The lightning scar on her side, the pain she's currently in, Adora talked to Shadow Weaver. Her claws extend at the thought of the witch. She probably tricked Adora into this.

Catra realises that Bow is still there and he's pissed Adora off which is never a good thing. "Bow... *Go* !" Catra repeats, her eyes never leaving Adora's.

"What? No!" Bow yells. "I can't leave you alone with her! Look at her!"

"Bow, go!" Catra yells again, not leaving room for discussion. If she can save Bow from Adora's wrath then she will consider that a success. Herself on the other hand… that is a complicated thing. "That's an order!"

"I-" Bow goes to protest but, at that moment, Glimmer asks for back-up. "Take your own advice, Catra, and don't engage her directly." He looks worried and he clearly doesn't want to leave Catra alone with She-Ra. "Go back to your position." He says as he runs off to go help Glimmer.

Catra bites her lip, nodding at Bow and hurrying away from She-Ra in an attempt to get out of sight quickly. He's right. Catra is fast and that is her *only* advantage over She-Ra. She is nowhere near as strong as her - Catra does have experience with her strength after all - she's also not predictable at this point. Catra has no idea how that shard is affecting Adora, she can only feel her inner turmoil and rage but those emotions already make Adora unpredictable.

Adora's usual fighting tactic is *punch hard* and that's about it. She is strong and she hits *hard* but her speed could never hope to outmatch a Magicat. Adora is also somewhat clumsy *except* when in battle. In battle she gets a laser like focus and she is one of the few people that can match Catra pretty equally. Catra doesn't really feel like getting punched by *She-Ra.* The only tactic she has is to run.

* * *

ADORA

Adora can see Catra staring at her and she wants to know what she thinks. She looks just as good as she usually does - even if the way she holds herself shows fatigue. Her clothes are a little looser than usual, typically Catra likes to wear tight clothing, it makes her more streamlined and makes it easy for her to move more quickly - a Magicat's strongest skill. Her tail is whipping back and forth and Adora doesn't remember what that means again. Catra is either anxious, or she's excited… Or did it mean something else?

She's talking rapidly with her archer friend. *The archer* . He tried to *kill you.* Adora's fist clenches around her sword. The archer looks at her with great concern, she can't read his lips but she can see from the way Catra has her hand on his chest that she's willing to throw herself between Bow and Adora's sword if she has to. Adora feels jealousy grip her insides, the Black Garnet shard seizes upon that emotion and doubles its intensity.

Catra turns after the archer runs off somewhere else. She starts to run away and Adora feels a part of herself push past that dark feeling. She feels her heart beat rapidly. "Catra..." Adora isn't totally sure who is who anymore, or what is what, or who is in control, but she sees Catra and she is *familiar* to all versions of her. She frowns and takes off after her. " *Catra* !"

* * *

CATRA

Catra instinctively skids to a stop, her mate's voice calling to her. She slowly turns around, gnawing at her lip nervously as she faces the person that she really doesn't know wearing her

mate's face. "Adora..."

It hurts. Catra isn't sure if anything Adora has done could hurt her more than this. She has purposely hurt herself in the pursuit of some stupid mission that Catra *knows* isn't what she really wants. *She's such an idiot.*

It isn't Catra's job to fix Adora but she also knows she can't just leave her like this either. Maybe she can help her.

Adora, or She-Ra, or whoever is looking at her, is looking at Catra in a way Adora *never* looked at her but Catra can still see the hint of blue in her eyes; she can see Adora's gentle soul being smothered by the darkness that the shard is stirring up inside of her. It isn't fair that Adora was abused, it isn't fair that she has never known anything aside from the Horde, it's not fair that she really believes that everything she has done has been to help Etheria, it's not fair that she was taught to follow orders and not question them. None of this is fair.

It's not Catra's job to *fix* Adora. But she doesn't need fixing. She just needs help. Everyone needs some help sometimes.

"Where are you going?" She-Ra asks. Even her voice is different, low, almost feral like her crazed smile. "Are you too afraid to face me?" Catra almost wants to scoff at that but truthfully the answer is *yes.* This version of Adora is *terrifying* . This is *not* the same woman who would make the cutest sounds whenever Catra fed her sweets. This is not her mate and yet it is. It's not Adora but it *is.* Catra has to *try* . She loves Adora too much not to.

"Adora, please, this isn't you." Catra whispers desperately, slowly backing up again.

"You're wrong!" She-Ra laughs and extends her hands wide, a big grin on her face. "This is *exactly* who I am. I'm going to *win* , finally. You, you're a *distraction* ... You hurt me... Adora... whatever." Adora winces as the shard lets out another electric current through her. Catra winces in sympathy to Adora's cringe of pain. The blonde lifts her hands to her head. It looks like her head hurts - *a lot* - and Catra can feel her inner turmoil become *worse* . "You either submit or... or..." Adora hesitates and her eyes flicker. *Interesting.*

"Adora, please! This isn't you!" Catra begs and instead of backing up, she steps *forward*. She'd noticed that when Adora was hesitating, the piece of the runestone placed against her chest had flickered. At that point, she knew that she *needed* to get that fragment away from Adora if she wanted *her Adora* back.

* * *

ADORA

Adora- *She-Ra* raises her sword when Catra takes a step forward, perceiving it as a threat. There's something that she's learnt over the years, and that's that sometimes *words* can cut deeper than any knife. "You told me you loved me, remember that?" Adora's head *really* hurts. She's losing her train of thoughts as fast as they come.

She places her hands to her head briefly and groans before she lets out a huff of frustration. *Hurt. Revenge. Anger.* She just had to remember that. Her *mission* . "I *hate* you. Just like I hate every other Princess." Adora states. Her eyes harden as she looks at Catra but there is *something.* She can feel that doubt swirling in her mind. She doesn't want to hurt Catra… *does she?* She doesn't know anymore, and the more she thinks about it the more her head hurts. It feels like someone has hit her over the head with something - even her ears ring.

Catra looks hurt by her words. She looks up at Adora with her mismatched eyes and Adora can see tears in them. It makes her pause. Adora is very much not in control right now, and she hates that, but she still has a goal. *But this is* ***Catra*** *,* some part of Adora's brain screams at her. She is *everything* to Adora. She doesn't *want* to hurt her. Adora is at war with herself more than with anyone else.

* * *

CATRA

Catra's eyes water as she takes another step forward, hands held up in surrender, her claws completely sheathed. Adora's words had cut deeper than any knife ever could. To hear Adora tell her that she *hates* her… But it *wasn't* Adora, not really. "I do love you, Adora. I never

stopped loving you." She whispers as she takes another step forward. "I know you're in there. Please..." Catra wants to reach out for her, but not yet. She can’t risk spooking her.

Adora freaks out anyway. She doesn't seem to believe Catra and, even if she did, Adora didn’t exactly react well to a love confession the first time around - it wouldn’t be surprising if she reacted just as badly this time as she did the first time. Adora looks so deeply conflicted and confused. Catra doesn’t know what she’s thinking but knowing Shadow Weaver suggested this tells Catra all she needs to know. Shadow Weaver has *never* had Adora’s best interests in mind - Catra wouldn’t be surprised if she fully intended for this to hurt Adora if not *kill* her.

She edges closer to Adora, her eyes set on her chest.

* * *

ADORA

"What are you doing?" She raises her sword. "Stay back!" She-Ra's eyes glow red for a moment. "You don't love me, you never did, you were using me." *Catra* . Adora feels like she's three people all at once and all the conflicting emotions are becoming too much for her. "Fight me!" Fighting and violence are simple and base emotions. Those she can focus on instead of all the confusing emotions swirling around in her head and her chest.

"I'm not fighting you! I was *never* using you, Adora." Catra takes one more step forward and then a few more to close the space between them. Adora just watches her. She doesn’t know what game or tactic Catra is playing here but she’s on full alert. "I can't fight you, not again. I really *can't* ." She-Ra can see Catra getting closer and she doesn't like it one bit.

She decides to act.

She grabs Catra by her wrists, squeezing *hard* . She stares directly into Catra's eyes, despite the height difference between them. Catra has always been shorter than Adora but She-Ra *towers* over her. "Maybe I was using *you* ," She-Ra almost growls. "it was only ever sex Catra. That's all it was." That will hurt Catra. A lot.

It’s a lie!

Shut up!

* * *

CATRA

Catra bites her lip, her eyes shimmering as tears fall down her cheeks. She winces at how harshly Adora had grabbed her wrists, yelping out in pain, but that pain is *nothing* compared to what she’s been feeling these past few weeks being apart from Adora - they’re nothing to the pain those words Adora just said causes. "Maybe it was... but that doesn't change how I feel about you.” Catra says softly. She doesn’t know how Adora really feels but she knows deep down that she can’t mean whatever it is that she’s saying right now because this *isn’t* Adora.

“Adora, I know you're not a bad person, you are one of the sweetest, most caring people I have ever met -even if you struggle to show that. This... This isn't *you* ." Catra looks directly into Adora's eyes, meaning those words fully. She glances down at the runestone shard for a moment, seeing that it was within reach - if she could just pull her wrists out for a moment.

"I love you. I will *always* love you. You're my one. The person that I *click* with. The person that I want to spend the rest of my life with, Adora." Catra feels herself choke a little. All this time being unable to tell people how she feels about Adora. She *is* the *one.* There is no one else that Catra wants to be with. She’s her *soulmate* . Even with their differences, they were meant to be together, she’s sure. Catra will do *anything* to save Adora from herself.

* * *

ADORA

Adora hesitates and she blinks her eyes, the red disappearing from them briefly. She raises her sword, on autopilot, the tip of it pointed to Catra's stomach, but she doesn't move to do anything else to Catra. She stares at her and her hands loosen around her wrists a little. "I..." She shakes her head. Something about Catra's words had gotten to her and she was left speechless. "I... Why aren't you attacking?"

It doesn't make sense! She should be attacking! She-Ra screams in Adora's head.

"Because... I love you, Adora. And I *never* want to hurt you, not ever again." Catra whispers before hurriedly grasping for the shard of the runestone to try to take it off of Adora. Adora's eyes widen and her hand moves at the same time that Catra lunges forward at her. She-Ra doesn't hesitate and her sword finds its mark.

Except, Catra moves down so the sword strikes her chest instead of her stomach as she reaches for the shard. Catra finds her mark too. Adora looks down to see that Catra hadn't harmed her, she'd merely broken the Black Garnet shard that had been at her chest.

The relief Adora feels is almost immediate and she automatically transforms back to herself. She groans, leaning over and dry heaving. There was ringing in her ears and her head felt like it might explode but now that the shard was no longer on her she didn't feel like she was being torn apart at the seams. She didn't feel like she was a ball of unbridled rage and being torn between three different voices and personalities. She was back to just Adora.

It takes Adora a moment, but she manages to compose herself before she turns to Catra, a thanks on the tip of her tongue. Except… Catra is on the *ground,* and she's bleeding - *a lot* .

Adora rushes over to Catra, landing on her knees. She scoops her up into her arms, looking at her beautiful face. There was blood at the corner of her mouth - *so much blood everywhere* . "Catra..." Adora's voice breaks a little. "Catra, please, no... you can't... please, Catra." Adora moves her hair from her face. "Catra, wake up! Hold on!"

* * *

CATRA

Catra's breathing was shallow before she began to gurgle and choke as blood came up. She hardly felt the pain of the sword impaling her chest. All she had felt at that moment was the relief of getting that runestone away from Adora and getting to see those baby blue eyes one more time.

She could hear the desperation in Adora's voice, and Catra wanted to tell her that it was okay, that it wasn't her, that she hadn't meant to do it, but she can hardly make out Adora's face anymore. She can feel Adora's strong hands holding her and it's nice. For the first time in a long time, Catra feels *complete* - even if she is dying - just being *near* Adora is *enough* . She's missed her so much.

Suddenly, Catra remembers something and she grabs Adora by her shirt. She forces her eyes to open for a moment, panic filling her voice as she speaks weakly. "A-Adora... Finn... sa... save... Finn..." She struggles out before finally falling unconscious.

* * *

ADORA

Finn? Who was Finn?

Adora frowns, but she's far too emotionally devastated to think too hard on that. "Catra?" Adora asks in a broken tone. "You can't go... don't leave me... please." Adora is crying and she can't seem to bring herself to care that people can see her. She lets out an agonised scream that echoes across the battlefield. Those nearby stop. The Horde, knowing that Catra was important to their Lord, freeze, causing a brief ceasefire in the middle of the battle. "Catra, please... I *love* you, I'm so sorry… You can't die..."

Adora knew that now. She knew that she was in love with Catra, but it was *too late* . She was such a fucking idiot. Why does everything she touches go up in flames? Adora would do *anything* for Catra. Catra *loved* her, even when Adora never did anything to deserve it, and all Adora did was *hurt* her. She didn't deserve to be dragged down by Adora, she didn't deserve to be caught in her inevitable fiery rage, she didn't deserve *any* of this - just for loving the Horde Lord.

This was a whole other level of hurt that Adora had done to her. She'd *killed* her. Adora's fingers tangle in Catra's hair at the back of her neck as she tilts her head back and kisses Catra on the lips *desperately* . She hoped that it was a dream, she hoped there was still time, but she doesn't even detect so much as a breath of air. Adora is too unbalanced to even summon She-Ra to do anything more. *What has she done?!*

Adora was clinging to Catra desperately. *She needed help, she needed to* ***get*** *Catra help, but how?* The scream had been enough to cause a ceasefire and to alert nearby Rebellion members - those being Spinnerella and Netossa. They rush over to Catra and steal her away from Adora who watches numbly, standing back to her shaky feet as Spinnerella uses her cape and Netossa uses her nets to try to stop the bleeding. "No, no, Catra! Come on, you can't just go like this!" Spinnerella rips off her cape, wrapping it around Catra's chest, trying to stop the blood from flowing. "If this keeps up, she might lose the baby, or we might lose them both!"

"B-baby? What baby?" Adora asks with wide eyes. Spinnerella and Netossa hardly register what Adora asks, focusing on trying to stop the bleeding.

"The baby... *your* baby." Netossa spits out, glaring at her. Adora feels like her world has just been tipped upside down. Catra was *pregnant?!* With her child? "Spinny, you can use your wind. Go get Glimmer, Catra needs help, *now* ." Spinnerella nods, glaring at Adora as well.

"She loves you. I never understood why she would love someone like you. But we supported her anyway because you made her happy. I hope you know, if she doesn't make it, that you made her final days a living *hell* and made her *suffer* ." Spinnerella hesitates for a second before using her magic to run through the battlefield rapidly, trying to find Glimmer.

Adora's eyes widen at their words and she kneels down beside Catra again. She feels *awful* and like she might throw up. "She's... She's pregnant? With *my* baby?" Adora gently caresses Catra's face with her hands. She feels *cold* .

"Don't touch her!" Netossa roars, slapping Adora's hand away. It startles Adora into doing just that, dropping Catra from her hands. "Don't touch her. You don't deserve her. Not after all the pain you put her through."

"Don't touch *me* !" Adora yells in distress - she doesn't like being *touched* , not without her permission. "I didn't mean to! I thought… I thought it was for the best!"

"For the best?!" Netossa glares at her. "Catra's hardly been able to function since she came back from the Fright Zone! She's been *grieving* losing you, for fuck's sake, because she somehow bonded to you as mates! She's been in distress for *weeks* ! The only thing that was keeping her going was finding out that she was having your kid!"

"I..." Adora frowns. "We were enemies! I didn't... I thought it was better to hurt her a little now, than to hurt her more in the future."

"Well, congratulations, you broke her. And if your damn soldiers continue delaying Glimmer, she *won't* come back." Adora ignores Netossa and lifts Catra's head up again. She cradles Catra to her chest. She's too still, even her tail was *limp* .

"I... I didn't mean to..."

"The fuck do you mean that you didn't mean to!" Netossa slaps Adora across the face. "You don't just *accidentally* stab a fucking hole into someone's chest!" Adora's head snaps to the side with the force of the slap. *She probably deserved that.* She turns back to Netossa with a fiery rage in her eyes. Adora has *never* been good at controlling her anger, the evidence is lying right in front of them.

"You should be careful who you slap, Princess." Adora almost growls.

"Go ahead. Try to hurt me. You've done a great job hurting Catra."

"Shut up!" Adora covers her ears for a moment before she pulls her hands away. "She... She moved... I wasn't- I didn't mean to go for her chest!"

"Don't you get it?! If she hadn't moved, where would that sword have gone?!"

"I didn't know she was pregnant either!"

"You shouldn't have fucking tried to stab her to begin with! She wasn't even fighting back!"

"I..." Adora hangs her head. "I was just... so... angry..." She really *fucked* up. *Why did she listen to Shadow Weaver?*

"Your anger doesn't excuse you hurting the people that you care about!" Netossa yells again, clearly distressed at this point. She moves one of her hands, the blood having soaked through Spinnerella's cape, she checks for Catra's pulse. "Fuck! Fuck, *fuck* ! Spinnerella! Where's Glimmer?! She's losing too much blood!"

As though Glimmer heard her, she materialises out of nowhere. She immediately narrows her eyes at Adora. " *You* ." Glimmer grabs her shirt collar and pulls her towards her, her fist sparkling. She was about to hit Adora, who had gone limp in her hand, when Netossa's voice interrupted her.

"No time Glimmer! You need to take Catra back to Bright Moon, *now* !" Glimmer stops. Glares at Adora and then turns to Catra. Glimmer looks undeniably concerned as she gathers Catra up in her arms. She nods at Netossa and then teleports out of there, leaving Adora and the others behind.

Adora looked like a ghost, she was that pale. "Fuck..." She whispers. "What have I done…?"

"Why would you do that to her?" Netossa asks, now that Catra was getting help. Adora stares at her hands. They're covered in scarlet red. *Catra's* blood. Adora wants to cry again. She wants to be the one who was stabbed. She's the one who *deserves* it, not Catra.

"I didn't mean to... I..." Adora *really* feels like she might throw up.

"You what? Looked her in the eyes, hit her at her weakest, and now you don't want to take the blame?" Netossa spits out. "You're a coward! She *trusted* you! She *loved* you, more than she's ever loved anyone before. I have never seen her as happy as when she came back from being with you... And you do *this* to her?! So tell me, was it just a game to you? Did you simply just use her for your own advantage? Did you always intend to throw her away like trash?!"

"What? *No* ! Of course not! I... I didn't mean to hurt her, I *never* wanted to hurt her..."

"Then why did you?!" Adora swallows and looks at her hands again that *still* had Catra's blood on them - like it would *magically* disappear or something.

"I... I was angry... and I... Shadow Weaver... she... I shouldn't have listened to her... She said Catra was only using me, that this was her plan all along..."

"Are you kidding me?" Netossa looks conflicted between punching Adora in the face again and crying. "She could possibly *die* because you threw a tantrum? Because someone lied to you and you chose to trust them over *her* ?!" Netossa furiously rubs her tears away. "She never gave away anything that could possibly cause you harm... to *anyone* . Not even to us. She only ever told my wife and I of all the good, sweet, moments you two shared." Netossa stands up. Spinnerella appears at her side and holds Netossa steady, hugging her as well. "Call off this battle. The very least you can do is let all of her friends say goodbye to her."

" *Goodbye* ?! No, she... she'll be okay." Adora’s eyes widen and her body shakes with distress.

"We don't know that! She had a gaping hole in her *chest* , you jackass! We don't know how much blood she's lost! We don't even know if the damage is repairable with magic..." Netossa shakes her head. "Spinny, we need to go. I don't care if we're in the middle of a battle. Get the others, we need to go to Bright Moon."

"Wait I," Adora pushes herself up to her feet. "I..." She sighs, trying to blink back tears. "I never meant to hurt Catra... I *love* her... can you... if she's okay, can you tell her that?" She asks, practically *begs* . " *Please* ?"

"Okay, *fine* ." Spinnerella strikes Adora as a usually kind person but her tone is *cold* . "'Tossa, let's go."

Adora feels like *shit* but she picks her bloody sword up off of the ground and gestures for the retreat to be enacted. She rarely wishes she knew how to use She-Ra's powers but she finds herself wishing she knew how to use her healing ones. It takes all of Adora's strength to walk and she knows when she gets back to the Fright Zone she will collapse on the ground in her throne room and *sob* .

Well, right after she pays *someone* a visit.

Chapter End Notes

I'm still crying over all the art that I've been seeing, so I know we're all crying for entirely different reasons. I hope you enjoyed this chapter because we sure as hell enjoyed writing all the pain that came with it. -M

Oh my gosh, I wanna say how cool it is that y'all are liking this so much that it's inspired art like??? I literally scream and die of happiness when I see it. Thank you all so much for your support!! We really appreciate it all. This chapter really said angst though... I swear, I saw everyone talking about the angst of if Adora/Catra had stabbed each other in canon and was like *standing person emoji* because we had this planned since before that sdfghjk Anyway, see you next week hopefully! -S

Come yell at us on our twitter @ceolordadora and CuriousCat

In Front of Us

Chapter Summary

> "Boss?" Scorpia asks quietly as she peeks into the throne room. "Can... Can I get you anything? Do you need a hug?"
>
> "Leave me alone. I want to be alone. Forever." Adora was lying on the floor of her throne room. She'd been there for hours, so far as she could tell, and she never wanted to move ever again. She wanted to stay there and die.

Chapter Notes

> Happy update day!! Coming at you with another update. I hope you all enjoy and that you're all keeping well <3
>
> Please read the warnings for this chapter!!
>
> Warning: Panic Attack, Anxiety, Suicidal Thoughts, Blood/Injury
>
> If any of these tags worry you, you can dm us @ceolordadora on twitter for further info!

See the end of the chapter for more notes

The Horde soldiers part way immediately for their Lord who storms through the Fright Zone like a woman on a mission. She storms right to Shadow Weaver's cell. She knows she should probably not do this, that she should try to calm down, but it was *Catra* and she was still covered in her *blood* .

"Adora-" Shadow Weaver sounds surprised and Adora almost wants to laugh. "You're here..." Adora laughs darkly as she punches in the code to her cell.

"What? Did you think the Black Garnet would kill me?" Adora asks.

"Of course not-"

"Because it killed *someone* ." Adora steps into the cell. She doesn't plan on letting Shadow Weaver get away with whatever sick and twisted plan she had had for her. "And now, I'm going to kill *you* ."

Shadow Weaver stands quickly, backing up. Despite Adora's height, she's about six foot tall, Shadow Weaver still towers over her. She used to be intimidated by that, to be in her shadow as she looked down at Adora, emotionless, a tool for her to use and abuse. Shadow Weaver would praise her whenever she did something right, she gave Adora her ego, made her think she was special, but she's *not* special. She isn't *anything* . She is, however, extremely angry, and she plans on avenging Catra if it's the last thing she does.

Adora steps towards her and Shadow Weaver backs up right into the far right corner of the cell. "Adora, child, please, we talked about this." She says. Adora narrows her eyes and her hands clench by her sides into tight fists. "She was a distraction, she was using you, she-" Shadow Weaver's words are cut off when Adora's fist connects with her mask. Adora's eyes widen.

She's fought Shadow Weaver before, but she'd held back. Despite everything that the woman has done to her, she is still the closest thing Adora has ever experienced to having a mother. She doesn't feel that restraint this time. She is so fucking *angry* .

She grabs Shadow Weaver by her shirt and pulls her down and then Adora pounds her face over and over again with her fist until she goes limp. Her mask cracks under the force of Adora's knuckles which turn bloody and bruised, bursting open with the impact of her fist against the mask. Adora doesn't even think she can stop, not even when Shadow Weaver is clearly knocked out cold.

In the end, she doesn't have to stop herself. Someone grabs her and pulls her back. Adora loses her grip on Shadow Weaver and she yells out in distress at being torn from her punching bag. Shadow Weaver falls to the ground, limp but *still breathing*. That is too much of a mercy. She should be dead. In what world does Shadow Weaver get to live and Catra gets to die?

Adora fights against her restraints but they're far too strong and she sees the tell tale pincers that tell her just who exactly had the nerve to pull her off of Shadow Weaver. "Let me go!"

Adora yells. To her surprise, Scorpia does let her go, but she yanks her cape causing Adora to lose her footing and tumble to the ground. That was kind of really embarrassing, but Adora tries to stand back up quickly only to be restrained by Scorpia again.

"She's had enough, Adora." Scorpia says calmly. Though her face is serious, Adora can see the worry. *But it's not enough!* Adora can feel herself becoming overwhelmed, she can feel herself starting to *cry* .

" *No* !" Adora shakes her head. "It's not enough until I kill her!"

"You don't want to do that Adora." Scorpia says firmly.

"Yes, I do!" Adora yells. "I want to kill her! I want her dead! I want... I want..." Adora chokes on her emotions that were clogging her chest and she lunges for Shadow Weaver again only for Scorpia to shove her back. Adora hits the wall hard and it knocks the air right out of her lungs. Sometimes she forgets how strong Scorpia is but it has its effect.

The fight completely drains out of Adora. She slides to the floor in the corner and *cries* . She hugs her knees to her chest and just *sobs* . She hasn't done this in so long. She hasn't cried since she was a cadet, since Shadow Weaver told her crying was for babies, and that it was weak, and that Force Captains didn't cry. She cries so hard it's hard for her to breathe, and then Adora realises she isn't *just* crying, she's also having a panic attack.

She used to have those a lot too, they got better after she took Shadow Weaver out but Adora has always been an anxious person. Her anxiety makes her chest feel tight, her breathing speeds up to dangerous levels and, with her vision being blurred from crying, she can't calm herself down. Scorpia talking to her is *too loud* and Adora buries her head between her knees, covering her ears with her hands.

Too much. It's too much.

Too many feelings and emotions, too many tears, too much sound, not enough oxygen for her to breathe.

She feels like she might *die* and her entire body *shakes* . She feels Scorpia touch her and quickly take her hands away when Adora yells at her not to do that. She doesn't like to be touched, not by anyone, not without her giving permission - unless they're someone she trusts and, while she trusts Scorpia usually, her body is perceiving everything differently currently. She needs no one to touch her. She can get through this on her own.

It takes her a little while but she eventually manages to calm herself down enough that her vision refocuses. She can count in her head, see objects, hear the buzzing that the Fright Zone has. She's okay.

Then she sees the blood on her hands and she doesn't know if it's Catra's, or Shadow Weaver's, or her own, but she feels herself fall. She falls into a pit of depression.

"Adora." Scorpia says. "Come on, I can-"

"Don't touch me!" Adora winces and sinks back against the wall, away from Scorpia. *Shit* . She's still experiencing sensory overload, she's overwhelmed and her hands are shaking. Her knuckles are fucked up, maybe even broken, but she doesn't feel the pain. She's numb.

She glances over at Shadow Weaver who was still breathing but out cold. She knows she almost killed her. She can't even blame Shadow Weaver. This is all her own fault. *She* stabbed Catra, Adora, *she* took Shadow Weaver's advice, *she* chose to use She-Ra, *she* attacked the Rebellion when she didn't have to for a mission she doesn't even believe in. It's all her fault.

Adora sniffs and then pushes herself to her feet. It takes a lot of effort, especially when Adora refuses Scorpia's help. She wouldn't hurt her if she touched her but Adora thinks she might have another panic attack if someone touched her right now.

"The woman that I... the woman I..." *What is wrong with her? Why can't she say it? Even now?* Maybe she doesn't deserve to say it. What kind of person stabs the person they supposedly love through the chest? And she was pregnant...

Adora bends over suddenly and she throws up. She braces her hand against the wall and retches. The taste is awful and the bile burns her throat as her stomach empties itself. She killed Catra, and she killed her own child. *Fuck* . Adora is a *monster* . She is... She's the lowest of the low.

Once she's done throwing up, Adora wipes her mouth and straightens up. "I... I'm going back to the throne room." She tells Scorpia, turning and stumbling. "Get her some help." Adora mumbles as she walks out of the cell.

There are soldiers standing outside and they all stare at their Lord who probably looks broken - Adora certainly *feels* broken. "Move." Adora says, because she can't speak much and she can't shove her way through people because she doesn't want to be touched which means she can't touch others. The crowd part and Adora walks through them like a broken soldier. She's weak now. *Destroyed* . She limps down the hallway covered in blood, her hair has become dishevelled and her hand is *fucked* .

Adora figures it's probably the least she deserves.

* * *

"Boss?" Scorpia asks quietly as she peeks into the throne room. "Can... Can I get you anything? Do you need a hug?"

"Leave me alone. I want to be alone. Forever." Adora was lying on the floor of her throne room. She'd been there for hours, so far as she could tell, and she never wanted to move ever again. She wanted to stay there and die. She was still in her bloody clothes, she hadn't attempted to clean up even a little bit. Her knuckles probably required some kind of medical attention but Adora didn't think she deserved that.

"Boss, Catra wouldn't want this." Scorpia says. She's probably right but Adora isn't in the *mood* .

"Yeah, well, Catra's dead, probably, so who cares?" Adora asks.

"We don't know that, Boss! Don't say that!" Scorpia steps into the room, wrapping Adora into a tight hug. She has to pick Adora up from the ground to do it and Adora *hates* it. "You're not alone, buddy."

"Scorpia. Please." Adora squirms. "Leave me alone, *please* . If Catra were alive... she... she would've come to see me." *Probably. Maybe.* Adora can't be certain. She's not entirely sure how Catra will feel about the fact that Adora literally stabbed her in the chest, but she expected Catra to at least reach out - even if it were just to tell Adora to fuck off and leave her alone.

"Maybe she just needs to heal first! You need to give her a little time, Boss. Now, let's get you cleaned up, into some new clothes, I'll get something from the snack pile, and you can go to bed."

"No! I don't want to, I don't deserve to."

"Yes, you do. Come on." Scorpia lifts her up, dragging her along to her bedroom and heading to the shower *unwillingly* .

Scorpia deposits Adora down on the toilet, since Adora was being petulant and refusing to stand or use her body in any way, shape or form. If Scorpia wasn't pure muscle, Adora would have been impossible to move with the way she had made herself a dead weight. Unfortunately, Scorpia is more than capable of lifting Adora. "Can you please at least wash yourself off, Boss?"

"No."

"Well, can I clean you up then?" Adora sighs. She doesn't understand why Scorpia is helping her. She knows that Scorpia calls her her best friend but some part of Adora never really thought it was true. She's not used to people *actually* caring about her. She also knows that Scorpia really liked Catra. Adora really doesn't deserve her care or attention.

"Please, leave me alone. I don't want to shower, or... to do *anything* . I just want to wallow in self-pity, I think I'm allowed."

"Nope. First you shower, change, then eat and then I'll let you wallow in self-pity." Adora pouts at Scorpia.

"I don't want to do all that other stuff."

"Too bad. Shower first. Then pyjamas, food and then you can curl up in bed."

"You can't make me." Adora crosses her arms in defiance. Scorpia sighs at her and turns on the water of the shaower. Adora watches her cautiously and curiously, wondering what it was that Scorpia was doing.

Before Adora knows it, she's being placed under a flowing stream of water still *fully dressed.* "I'm not gonna let you stop taking care of yourself. You're my friend." Scorpia says with a determination Adora has never really heard when someone has spoken about her before. Adora scowls under the water but, well, she's here now.

"This classes as torture, I'm pretty sure." Adora would try to fight Scorpia but that would require too much effort and strength she doesn't have. "Catra and I used to shower together..." Adora closes her eyes at the memories. She *loved* showering with Catra, every second of it, Adora had never expected showers to be so *intimate.*

"Yeah?" Scorpia asks as she gently washes Adora's hands. She was clearly trying to not be too invasive. Adora's knuckles were sore but her hands were also the main source of blood, other than her clothes, washing it away turns the clear water a light red. Adora has to look away.

She nods tearfully at Scorpia. "Mhmm... I would wash her tail and... *everything* . What have I done, Scorp?" Adora asks desperately.

"You… let your anger get the better of you. But it wasn't entirely your fault. You went to talk to Shadow Weaver before the fight... right?" Adora nods.

"Yeah but I... I should've *known* better than to listen to her. I'm the one who deserves to be dead right now, not Catra." Adora tightens her hand into a fist and whimpers as pain shoots through her hand.

"Adora, Catra wouldn't want you to say that. We don't know if she's even dead." Scorpia sighs as she turns the water off. Adora was about as clean as she was going to get. Scorpia grabs a towel and helps Adora take off all of her wet clothes and wraps her in the towel. "You and the entirety of the Fright Zone know that Catra is one of the strongest people we've ever met. She'll make it."

"I *stabbed* her Scorpia, in the *chest* . I'm no doctor, but that is never a good place to get stabbed." Adora sighs. She has little hope that Catra may survive.

"But the Rebellion has magic! And I imagine also better medical care. Maybe that'll help." Adora whines.

"I... I used to feel... I felt... *something* , when we were apart, and now... I don't feel anything..." Adora frowns in distress and lifts a hand to her chest.

"You used to feel something?" Scorpia looks curiously at her as she helps Adora dry off and get into new clothes.

"It was like a *connection* . I don't know." Adora couldn't explain it but she swears she had been able to feel Catra, even when they were apart. There was just this *feeling* in her chest, right where her heart was.

"Huh... *Oh* ! I mean, Magicats do form bonds, I think."

"Bonds?" Adora asks with confusion.

"Yeah! Like soul bonds. It's how Magicats connect with... with their chosen mate."

"Mate..." Adora looks mildly distressed. "Are you saying... Catra chose *me* as her *mate* ?”

"I- I think so?" Scorpia doesn’t sound sure but that would explain a lot actually.

"Fuck..." Adora goes and flops on her bed. "She was pregnant too..." So not only had Adora stabbed Catra in the heart metaphorically she’d also done it *literally* . She’s read only a little on the Magicat mating lore, as far as Adora can tell, being separated from their mate is extremely painful. *How was Adora so blind? How was she so stupid? Why did she let her anger get in the way?* She’d hurt the woman she loves in the most unimaginable way possible. *Twice.*

" *What* ?!" Scorpia exclaims in surprise. *Should Adora have told Scorpia about the baby?* Not like it mattered much now anyway.

"That's what the net Princess and wind Princess told me." Adora's voice is a little muffled by the fact she has her face *smothered* in her pillow.

"Oh... Oh wow... that's a lot to take in."

"You're telling me."

"Yeah... but, hey, I'm sure she'll be okay, Boss." Scorpia disappears for a moment, Adora sits up on her bed.

Scorpia returns a moment later with a first aid kit in her pincers. Adora remembers being a cadet and having to sneak out to go get medical supplies to repair an injury. She’s starting to see what Catra meant when she pointed out how fucked up the Horde is. *What kind of place withholds medical supplies from it’s people to teach them some kind of lesson?*

Adora got rid of that, It made much more sense to her to have soldiers admit they were injured and to get treated then to have them hide it and perform less because of said injury. She'd also been a soldier and she didn't want people to limp-sneak their way to the med wing in pain just to treat injuries like she had done one too many times. She'd even been caught by Shadow Weaver once, she never got caught again.

Adora comes back to reality and looks up at Scorpia who was wrapping her hands up in bandages. "Just put me out of my misery, please." Adora says.

"No! I'm sure she'll be okay, Boss!"

"Even if she is, she'll *never* forgive me and I don't *deserve* to be forgiven." Adora sighs. "I love her, Scorpia..."

"Oh, Boss, I'm sure she will if you just explained it to her. I'm sure she'll understand and once she's healed up, she'll come see you."

"Or she'll hate me and next time she sees me she'll claw my insides out."

"Don't think like that!" Scorpia protests as she finishes wrapping Adora's knuckles up.

"I wouldn't blame her if she did."

"She wouldn't do that."

"You don't know that." Adora deadpans. Scorpia pouts at her.

"Okay, maybe I'm not one hundred percent sure about it. But it's *Catra* , she cares about you."

"She *cared* about me, that was before I... maybe killed her and broke her heart." Adora hangs her head.

"Come on, Boss, please don't think so negatively. She's *alive* . Say it with me."

"Will you leave me alone now?" Adora asks. She’s in clean clothes, no longer covered in blood and she’s in bed. Adora just wants to be left alone.

"Okay, fine. I'm going to go get you something to eat and then you can rest." Adora waves her hand dismissively.

"Can you... clean my sword too... *please* ?" Adora can barely look at it, especially when it's still coated in Catra’s blood.

"Of course." Scorpia leaves and Adora heaves a sigh of relief. She was *never* going to recover from this.

* * *

Catra groans weakly, feeling the heaviness that had veiled itself over her slowly withdrawing. She shifts slightly against the warmth surrounding her, wincing when she makes an attempt to open her eyes but the brightness of the light leaves her unable to do so from how long it had been since she had opened them. "Where...?" She looks around confused and clearly disoriented.

"Princess C'yra," A doctor - Catra assumes from the red cross on their arm - comes over and carefully places their hand to her shoulder. "Just take it easy, you've been through a lot."

"Where am I?" She asks, her voice cracking from disuse. "I thought..." She sits up, looking tired and upset as she begins to realise exactly where she was. "Why am I here?" The doctor

hands her a glass of water and helps her sip it.

"You were injured in the battle Princess."

"Oh..." Catra carefully sips at the water. "Did... Is everything okay? Is Finn okay?" Catra asks, worried more about Finn than her own well-being in that moment. She feels panicked suddenly but the doctor smiles and gestures to Catra's bump. Catra rests her hand to the bump - she swears it had been smaller than that the last time she saw it.

"Your baby is perfectly healthy. It was touch and go for a while, we had to put you in a coma to help you both heal and take some stress off of your body." The doctor explains. *A coma?*

"I see..." Catra sighs in relief, incredibly grateful that Finn was okay at least. "I'm glad, I was worried for a moment there. How long will I need to be here in the infirmary for?"

"Hard to say," The doctor answers. "You were very close to dying Princess. The only reason you didn't was because of Princess Glimmer's quick thinking. She teleported you here and we had to use both medicine and magic to keep you alive." They explain calmly. "Your recovery may be quicker due to your Magicat physiology but I'd prefer to keep you mostly on bed rest with physical therapy until you're ready to deliver."

"Okay, yeah, that's understandable. I'll definitely keep that in mind." Catra nods in agreement, wanting to do everything to make sure that her little kitten would make it through alright - even if Catra hated sitting on her hands. "Is it okay if I go back to resting now?" She was still tired, despite having been in a coma for god knows how long.

"Do you recall what happened?" The doctor asks.

"Do I recall what happened?" Catra echoes.

"At the battle." The doctor clarifies.

"I... was stabbed."

"Do you know who?" Catra nods slowly at the question as her memory sharpens.

"Lord... Adora..." *Adora* . Catra was certain she hadn’t meant to stab her.

"That's right, although, she was She-Ra."

"I remember." Except, she *wasn't* She-Ra. Not Catra’s She-Ra. She really hoped that Adora was okay. She wants to see her again, to reassure her that she's fine and to kiss her one more time.

"Your moms were here but they returned back to Half-Moon to perform some royal duties." The doctor informs Catra. "I believe Spinnerella and Netossa wanted to speak with you when you woke up, I can contact them?"

"Yeah, go ahead. You can send them in." Catra says with a small nod, shifting around in her bed, pausing for a moment. She feels for the sharp object pressing into her skin and grabs the very piece of the Black Garnet that she had saved Adora from, a small smile on her lips. She really hoped that Adora was okay. She has no idea how the Black Garnet has affected her.

The doctor nods and walks towards the exit to go retrieve the Princesses. It doesn't take long for Spinnerella and Netossa to arrive at the infirmary, worried expressions on their faces. "Thank the Gods, you're okay!" Spinnerella says - and it's about as close as she's ever been to cursing. Catra chuckles a little.

"I'm great. Doctor said I'm recommended to be on bed rest with physical therapy until Finn is born. But otherwise, I'm doing okay. Are you two alright?" Catra smiles at them, gesturing for them to come close as she gives them a hug.

"Are *we* okay?" Netossa asks. "Catra, you got *stabbed* ! You were literally bleeding out!"

"And I'm *okay* . I promise."

"Yeah, well, I slapped Adora." Netossa says, crossing her arms. Catra frowns a little. She doesn't like hearing about Adora being hurt - even if it was just a slap. "I can't believe she stabbed you." If Catra was honest, neither could she. She hadn't expected Adora to react that way at all but at the same time, Catra understood. Adora, or She-Ra, had perceived Catra's movements as a threat and she had reacted accordingly. It was instinct.

"Except... she didn't." Catra opens her hand again, looking at the runestone. "The She-Ra you guys saw wasn't her. That's not how She-Ra looks. She got corrupted." Catra explains, holding up the piece of the Black Garnet.

"Nuh-uh, don't you go making excuses for her." Netossa says, shaking her head. "I don't care if she was corrupted, she fucked up. Big time."

"I'm not excusing what she did, Netossa. Obviously I'm upset. But I know that wasn't her who did it." Catra looks thoughtfully at the crystal. Truthfully, Catra wasn't even that upset. She just needed to *see* Adora, to clear the air, that's all. "I heard her... She screamed and she was holding me when she realized what she did."

"You heard that?"

"I did. She was telling me to hold on, I think." Catra tries thinking back to those few moments where she could just say register what was happening around her but they're fuzzy. "I need to see her. To show her that I'm okay."

" *What* ?! Are you insane?" Netossa asks. "Absolutely no way!"

"Please, 'Tossa. I need to make sure she's okay. To *show* her that I'm okay." Catra knows that Adora would never believe it unless it came from Catra herself and if she could *see* it for

herself.

"Catra, you're not fully recovered." Spinnerella points out. "And..." She glances at Netossa for a moment. "The Horde has been silent since the battle." Right, Catra still isn't sure how long ago that was.

"I *need* to see her." Catra protests, trying to sit up but her chest protests as she pulls on her stitches.

"Can't you contact her on your com-pad?" Netossa suggests instead.

"I can try, but I just... I need to see that she's okay too." Catra frowns. "Her scream sounded so... *pained* ." Their bond is quiet. Catra can't feel Adora and she's not sure why that is but she's *worried* . She needs Adora to be okay because, if she were to lose her all over again, Catra is certain she wouldn't survive the pain.

"She almost *killed* you, I'd hope she'd be in pain." Netossa deadpans. Catra rolls her eyes.

"I know you're upset, but it really wasn't her. She... She wasn't in control, she was struggling. The Black Garnet was controlling her."

"No offence Catra," Netossa says. "but you don't exactly think clearly when it comes to Lord Adora." *Why does every sentence that starts with 'no offence' almost always mean that person is about to say something offensive?*

"Offense taken, but I'm the one that knows Adora best, and I'm telling you, that seriously wasn't her in control." Catra frowns in thought. Adora had looked all kinds of wrong. That wasn't *her*.

"Okay, maybe it was," Netossa concedes. "but are you forgetting the fact that she broke your heart as *Adora* ?" Catra's ears pin back at the reminder.

"Even then, she's my mate. I need to make sure she's okay, for my sake too. I don't care if she broke my heart. I still love her and I care about her. I need to know that she's okay." Catra doesn't back down, looking directly at Netossa and Spinnerella instead. She has to see Adora. There is no other option here and Catra will accept no other option.

Netossa and Spinnerella exchange glances before Netossa sighs. "Fine. I wasn't going to tell you this but... Adora knows you're pregnant, Catra, she also said... She said she loved you."

"She knows...? She *did* ?!" Catra's eyes widen and her ears perk up at Netossa's words. Catra's heart was thumping wildly in her chest at the idea of Adora admitting that she was in *love* with her. Still, she needed to hear it come from Adora herself, she could never believe it unless she heard those beautiful words come from Adora's own lips. Maybe Adora did want her after all… Or maybe she was just so distraught she blurted that out to Netossa. Whatever the reason, Catra *had* to see her, sooner rather than later. She has missed Adora like crazy.

"She did. And she seemed... well... she seemed regretful, and upset, and not in a good place."

"Then that's even more reason for me to go see her!" Catra exclaims. She sits up again and her tail that was hanging down the side of the bed curls anxiously. Adora *needs* her, she can't just sit here and do nothing while her mate is in pain.

"You said she was bad at controlling her anger," Netossa points out. "Look, just... maybe you should try contacting her *remotely* first."

"If you said she was in a bad place, she probably won't answer." Catra frowns deeply, crossing her arms. "I need to see her." She isn't going to budge on this, bed bound or not.

"What about her friend?" Spinnerella suggests. "Her right-hand... Scorpia, was it? She dragged Adora off of the battlefield." Catra smiles a little. Adora was in good hands with Scorpia at the very least.

"Fine.” Catra concedes. Spinnerella and Netossa are probably right anyway. “Do you have my com-pad?" Spinnerella goes over to the pile of Catra's things and digs the tablet out. She walks back over to Catra and hands her it. "Thank you, Spinny. Can you make sure that the others don't come in?" She asks.

"Yeah, yeah, we'll guard your door." Netossa says, pulling her wife back to the door and outside to stand watch.

Catra looks at the date first. It’s been about three weeks since the battle. Catra had not been expecting that. She must have really been close. She ignores that as she looks for Scorpia's contact and dials it, hoping that the other will pick up. It takes a few rings but eventually Scorpia picks up. "Oh my gosh, Wildcat! You're okay! Adora will be so relieved!" Catra can’t help but smile at Scorpia, Adora isn’t the only person she’s missed. Weirdly, she has missed the *Fright Zone* .

"Hey Scorpia. Yeah, I just woke up a while ago. The doctor told me I'm supposed to be on bed rest and physical therapy until the baby is born, but I'm doing okay. How's Adora holding up?"

"Oh, um..." Scorpia scratches the back of her neck and Catra’s ears perk up in alarm. "She's... fragile."

"Fragile?" Catra whispers, immediately letting the smile that had come on her face drop. "Can I talk to her?"

"Oh..." Scorpia looks off to the side. "I don't know, Wildcat, she's... She barely eats, and she only showers when I force her to, she's also *very* grumpy. She won't let anyone see her who isn't me."

"Please, could you try? I just... I want to go in person to see her but I'm on bed rest and I don't know how soon the doctor will clear me to walk around." Scorpia looks reluctant but Catra knows she probably doesn't want to let Catra down too.

"Okay, I can try, but no promises, okay?" Scorpia gives in and Catra breathes a sigh of relief.

"Thank you. Do you want me to wait on the call?"

"Yeah, wait there." Catra watches as Scorpia begins making her way to the throne room. She pauses at the door before she enters. "I wonder where she is today. Sometimes she's in bed, other times she's just lying on the ground."

"On the ground? Gosh, I really want to see her." Catra's heart ached knowing that Adora was hurting too. She hated to know that Adora was suffering.

"Oh..." Scorpia trails off for a moment. "She's on her throne." Catra hears as Scorpia begins climbing the steps and stops at the top.

"Scorpia? Why are you here? *Again* ?" Adora asks. "You made me eat not that long ago, okay? Leave me alone." Catra's heart nearly jumps up her throat at hearing Adora's sweet voice. *Her Adora.* Catra almost whimpers at the sound. She has missed Adora, *so much* , this isn't corrupted Adora, it is simply just Adora - albeit she sounds *down* but alive and not crazed.

"Okay, well, first of all, it's been at least twelve hours since I made you eat and two days since you last showered, which we really need to fix," Scorpia says, "and also, I have this for you." Scorpia presents the tablet to Adora so Catra could see her - although Adora was paying little attention to it. Adora was sat on her throne but, instead of her usual intimidating position, she was curled up in a ball, hugging her knees to her chest. The sight of Adora, her voice, Catra feels like she might burst at the seams with the amount of love she feels filling her veins.

"Adora? Adora, can you hear me?" Catra calls out. Her heart does break a little when she sees the pitiful sight of the blonde. "Oh baby... Are you okay? Scorpia was telling me that you weren't doing too well." Adora's eyes snap to the tablet and she *sees* Catra. Catra smiles a little as Adora sits up and grabs the tablet from Scorpia.

"Catra..." Adora says her name like a whispered prayer and then her relief is quickly replaced by anger. She stands from her throne and shoves the tablet back into Scorpia's claws. "What

the hell is this?! Who is that? Is that Double Trouble?" Adora asks angrily. "I don't like being tricked, Scorpia. It doesn't make me feel better!"

"Adora," Scorpia says. "Calm down."

"I will not-" Adora stops mid-yell and takes a deep breath - that's kind of impressive actually. "You're right, I'm sorry, but, *please,* I know Catra is dead, so please will you leave me alone?" Adora sounds *broken* , and she looks it too.

"Adora!" Catra yells out, frowning softly. "I'm not dead, you big doofus! Grab this damn tablet back, dumbass." Adora does not do that and instead covers her ears and sits down where she stands, closing her eyes tight.

"No... *please* ..." She begs and she hugs herself. Catra's heart breaks at the sight. She knew Scorpia had said she was fragile but to believe this was all a trick? And Double Trouble? Who was Double Trouble? Catra is suddenly reminded of something. The spy. The Horde spy. Adora had thought that Catra was this Double Trouble person, and thought that she *wasn't* Catra, which means this Double Trouble person was more than likely a… *shapeshifter*. Catra almost wants to laugh at the fact she never considered that. Adora had outsmarted her there.

She's drawn back to the situation at hand as Scorpia speaks again. "I'm sorry Wildcat, I don't think she believes it." Catra sighs sadly, biting her lip.

"I'll find out how soon I'm cleared to walk and I'll make a trip over there. Thanks for taking care of her in the meantime, Scorpia." Catra would go to the Fright Zone as soon as she could and she would kick her ass but also kiss her.

"Of course, what are best friends for?" Scorpia beams. "I'm glad you're okay, Wildcat."

"Thank you, Scorpia. I'll see you soon." Catra smiles again before hanging up. "Spinny, 'Tossa! You can come back inside! "The two princesses re-enter the room and come back over to Catra.

"How did it go?" Spinnerella asks.

"She's basically having a breakdown and believes that I'm dead and that my calling was someone impersonating me."

"Oh... so bad?" Netossa asks.

"No shit." Catra deadpans. "I need to go see her."

"We don't think that's a good idea." Spinnerella says with concern. "At least wait until you're steady on two feet."

"Fine. I'll wait until the doctor clears me to walk around. I just... I'm *worried* about her. She looked *really bad*." Catra has never seen Adora so emotionally distraught before.

"So let her feel bad," Netossa shrugs. "She did almost kill you, Catra." Catra grunts in frustration, running her fingers through her hair.

"She didn't mean to!" Catra yells. No one wants to listen to her. Adora would *never* have done that to her had she been in control. Adora had purposely set rules to her soldiers for Catra to *not* be harmed. Catra knows that Adora never meant to hurt her the way that she did. Netossa sighs.

"I'm not going to convince you that Adora is a bad person, am I?"

"No, you're not. Because you don't know her the way that I've come to know her." Adora is a *good* person, even if no one else wants to accept that reality. She made a mistake, she is a traumatised child soldier, Catra thinks she deserves a little more sympathy than what people are crediting her with.

Spinnerella places a gentle hand on her wife's shoulder. "Adora said she loved you," She says softly - that statement alone manages to knock the air out of Catra's lungs. "I... I believe her. Despite what she did, she was clearly in distress. When you're able, we'll cover for you so you can go see her."

"You have a problem though," Netossa adds. "Glimmer, she's suspicious to say the least."

"Glimmer? Suspicious?" Catra bites her lip. "Shit, that could pose a problem..." She whispers softly to herself. Like a *huge* problem. "What made her suspicious?"

"What made her suspicious?" Netossa asks incredulously. "Maybe the fact that the *Horde Lord* was distraught and cradling you in her arms?" Well, yeah, that ought to rouse some suspicion Catra supposes.

"Right... Well, I'm not planning to stay over there forever, just enough to show Adora that I'm alive and okay." Catra explains.

"Fine, then we'll cover for you." Catra looks gratefully at the pair, nodding at them.

"Thank you so much, you have no idea how much I appreciate that."

"Are you planning on coming clean?" Spinnerella asks. Catra considers that question. Glimmer was suspicious, Adora was miserable and possibly in love with Catra too, that meant that something was going to give. Either she had to admit to the people who were her friends and family that she'd been sleeping with the enemy and was carrying her baby, or she ran away to the Fright Zone and let them figure it out while she got to be with Adora. Both had their pros and cons but the biggest con was that there was no way in hell the Rebellion were just going to be okay with the fact that Catra had been sneaking off to the Fright Zone in order to go be fucked by the Lord of the Horde.

"I don't know. I probably need to, but-" Catra places a hand on her stomach, closing her eyes. "I'm so scared of what will happen. The others hate Adora as it was, even before she stabbed me, and they're probably not gonna listen if I try to explain what really happened during the battle."

"Probably not," Netossa admits.

"You're worried about Finn?" Spinnerella asks, gesturing to Catra's hand that was on her stomach.

"Yeah, I'm worried that Finn will be caught in something that they're completely innocent in." Catra whispers. "Everyone here hates Adora, even you both, but you were at least willing to listen to what I had to say." Catra is under no illusions. Spinnerella and Netossa had slowly started to see Adora as more of a *person* and now, after what happened, Catra can tell they've gone back on that view. They at least *listen* to Catra when she tells them the reality of what happened.

"I hate to say it Catra but..." Netossa trails off for a second. "What has been done has been done." She says grimly. "Your choice of mate is your choice. People will have problems with it but... I have a feeling Adora is at a crossroads. She can prove why you didn't make a mistake, if she tries."

"The question is, will anyone even be willing to listen? To give her a chance?" Even if Catra went to Adora, told her she loved her and Adora said it back. They still have countless hurdles in their way - namely Catra's moms will probably want to tear her apart.

"I guess that's a risk that you both have to be willing to take."

"I'm just afraid that they'll hate me." Catra admits. She is so scared of what her family and friends will think of her all because she fell in love with the Lord of the Horde.

"They're your family, I don't think they'd hate you." Netossa reassures.

"Blood doesn't always make you a family. I just… I worry that their hatred for Adora will win over their love for me." Catra sighs, biting her lip. "I don't know when I should tell them."

"Look, you don't have to tell anyone right now, how about you focus on getting better and then maybe you can talk to Adora about telling people?" Netossa suggests.

"Okay, thank you." Catra gives them a weak smile. "I really do appreciate you both."

"Don't thank us yet, you still have to face Glimmer."

"Oh goddess, is she coming now?"

"As soon as she learns you're awake, yeah."

"I'm gonna go back to sleep then. Doctor says I need rest anyways." Spinnerella and Netossa both laugh.

"You can't avoid her forever. But yes, you should rest." Catra giggles and sighs afterwards.

"Believe me, I know, but I think I'd prefer being able to talk to Adora first about this before having to talk to Glimmer. You know how... *intense* she can be."

"Intense is putting it lightly." Netossa comments. "We can run interference?"

"Interference?"

"Netossa is suggesting we tell Glimmer of problems that aren't really problems and send her on a wild goose chase to keep her away from you." Spinnerella clarifies. That kind of sounds perfect actually but Catra isn’t really sure.

"I... You sure you want to go through that once she realizes that you were lying?" Catra asks, raising an eyebrow. She wasn't lying when she said that Glimmer was intense.

"We can handle Glimmer, Catra." Catra looks concerned anyway.

"I know, I just worry. You guys have helped me a lot as it is, I'd hate for you to get in trouble because of me." Spinnerella and Netossa had been vital to Catra keeping her relationship with Adora a secret and going.

"We're big girls," Netossa says dismissively. "Besides, we never encouraged your relationship with Adora, we just never said anything... and helped you cover it up... Whatever, it'll be fine." Catra doesn't stop looking worried but she nods nonetheless. She knows if - *when* - this all comes to light, Netossa and Spinnerella could be in serious trouble for helping Catra.

"Okay, seriously, thank you both. This means a lot." Catra means that completely and utterly.

"Yeah, yeah, get some rest." Netossa says dismissively. Catra smiles and lays back down, hand on her abdomen as she rubs it gently, purring to soothe herself to sleep.

She *will* see Adora again.

* * *

" *No* !" Adora jolts awake in a cold sweat and panting for breath. *That dream. Again.* She's been having a recurring nightmare for weeks now, ever since the battle, she just keeps reliving that scene over and over and *over* again. Her stabbing Catra in the chest, the blood, the unimaginable pain at harming the woman she loves. Adora takes a shaky breath and swings her feet over the side of the bed. She runs her fingers through her hair, swooping her bangs back.

She stumbles her way to the bathroom and to the sink. She grips the edges of it with her hands before she splashes her face with some water. Her breathing was just starting to even

out by the time Adora manages to fully wake herself up. She doesn't know what time it is, what day it is, she hasn’t left her room in days, possibly even *weeks,* and the Fright Zone makes the progression of time almost impossible to decipher anyway - it's not like they have windows in the throne room to show the progression of daylight.

Adora stares at herself in the mirror. These past few weeks she hasn't been eating and it's starting to show. Every little movement exhausts her, her cheeks are a little more sunken in, her finely trained muscles are still present but they're a little softer than usual from disuse. She leans her weight on the edge of the sink and takes a deep stuttering breath.

What the fuck was that call before? Catra was dead. Adora stabbed her. It was all her fault. *So who the hell did Scorpia show her?*

Adora turns the tap on if only to distract herself long enough to ignore the stinging in her eyes and the loud thoughts in her head. Even if Catra was alive, she probably hated her and Adora wouldn't even blame her. She glances down at her knuckles which were now healed but her skin was still a yellowing colour, showing bruised tender skin.

Adora sighs. "Why am I alive?" Adora asks no one in particular. She grabs the glass she keeps on her sink and fills it with water before she downs the whole glass. Maybe she should hand herself over to the Rebellion. She'd deserve the beheading they'd give her.

She swallows thickly and places the glass back down. She looks at her sword sitting against the wall and she sees flashes of it covered in red, in *Catra's* blood, that she has to look away. She doesn't even recognise the person looking back at her and the person, whoever they are, makes Adora feel sick to her stomach. "You should be dead." Adora spits at her. "It should be *you* and not her. You disgust me."

Adora snatches her sword up by the handle and turns it towards herself. She's crying as she presses the tip to her chest. She wants to die. She'd do anything to be the one in Catra's place. But She can't... She's a *coward* . She can't do it. No matter how much she wants to, she is *afraid* of dying and she subjected Catra to that.

She drops her hand, the tears finally falling freely down her cheeks. She feels like she's dying anyway. She's slowly killing herself by refusing to eat. Scorpia has to force her sometimes, or Adora surely would have died already. *Have you ever wanted to die but lacked the nerve to*

actually go through with it? Adora isn't even sure what the feeling is, only that it's like a shadow constantly hanging over her. She quite literally just wants to cease to exist. She doesn't want to be here anymore. Not without Catra.

She stares at the sword in her hand and then she makes another rash decision. She lifts the blade up, right to her ponytail and then she cuts. She slices it right off and her blonde hair is free, her bangs fall in her eyes but Adora doesn't stop there. Her vision may be blurred by tears but she starts cutting her hair even shorter, cutting it down until it’s medium length, short and shaggy, with blonde hair all over her bathroom floor.

Once she's done, Adora drops her sword. It clangs against the metal floor and she runs her fingers through her short shaggy hair. It hasn't made her feel better, maybe lighter in a literal sense, but she still doesn't like what she sees staring back at her. Adora half wants to punch the mirror but someone opening her bathroom door distracts her from that.

She straightens up, expecting to see Scorpia but instead seeing Lonnie. "What the hell is wrong with you?" Lonnie asks and Adora frowns. She turns around. She feels vulnerable like this, she's in only her uniform and it is not in its usual pristine condition. She feels emotionally raw too, a state she is unused to people seeing her in.

"Excuse me?" Adora asks. She doesn't like the accusatory tone to Lonnie's voice. The woman scoffs at her and Adora narrows her eyes.

"Why am I even surprised? You're still Shadow Weaver's little *pet* ." Adora tenses. She hasn't fought Lonnie properly in her life. Sure they trained together, but never seriously fought, just trained. Adora has never hurt Lonnie *seriously* . There have been close calls, usually when Shadow Weaver was observing their training - Adora could never let herself fail in front of her - but she’s never wanted to fight her seriously. That being said, Adora feels anger shoot through her like hot lava injected right into her veins.

"What the-" Adora doesn't get to finish her sentence because Lonnie grabs her by the shirt and slams her against the wall.

"Don't you get it?!" Lonnie asks. "Shadow Weaver wanted Catra gone. And you just did what she wanted, like you always do, because you *always* have to please her!" Adora blinks.

Lonnie is about the same height as Catra, maybe slightly taller, but Adora towers over her at six foot, yet she feels *small* under Lonnie's scathing words and eyes.

Adora pushes her back so she is no longer pinned to the wall. "Don't you think I know that?!" Adora asks angrily. She feels on edge, ready for attack.

"We're *tired* , Adora!" Lonnie yells. "We're tired of fighting. When you were fucking Catra, that was the happiest the Horde has ever been. Can't you see? No one in the Horde wants to fight anymore. The Princesses are *nothing* like Hordak said they were. That farm, having food, not fighting. You took that away because you're *selfish* ."

"Get out." Adora says calmly yet firmly. "Leave me alone." Adora goes to walk past Lonnie but she *trips* her. Adora goes face first to the ground, though she manages to catch herself. It stings her pride and embarrasses her more than anything. She has to take a deep breath in order to calm herself from exploding.

"We're tired of fighting and we're tired of you throwing your tantrums. You might be the Lord but we're not fighting for you anymore, Adora." Adora swallows hard and turns over to look at her friend. She sits up and sighs, hanging her head. Lonnie seems to soften a little but she doesn't attempt to comfort Adora - Adora wouldn't accept it anyway. "Look, you know the people of the Fright Zone trust you to protect us, and we will protect you back, but we won't fight and put our lives on the line for a war that you could've stopped months ago if only you'd accepted your feelings for Catra sooner." Adora stays quiet and Lonnie sighs. "If the Rebellion tries to hurt you, we'll protect you."

"I don't deserve it." Adora says, pushing herself up. All fight is gone from her, she's tired, like Lonnie and the rest of her soldiers. "Why do people follow me?"

"Aside from the fact you killed Hordak and got rid of Shadow Weaver who were basically abusing us?" Lonnie asks and Adora rolls her eyes.

"It's not like I'm any better."

"You are, actually." Lonnie says and Adora pauses. "You can be an asshole, you have your anger issues and, sure, you can be harsh, but you're *nothing* like Hordak or Shadow Weaver. You were one of us." Adora smiles a little as she walks into her room, out of the bathroom. Lonnie follows behind her. "You care, even if you pretend like you don't, you do. Did you ever see Hordak fighting battles?"

"... No." Adora answers.

"No, because he didn't care. We were expendable to him. He didn't care enough about his cause to even fight for it properly. And Shadow Weaver... don't even get me started on her." Adora snorts. *Shadow Weaver* really says it all. "You have *got* to stop listening to her. She used you to remove Catra."

"I know." Adora says and she glances at her knuckles. "I... I won't ever listen to her again."

"So you and the furball, you're in love with her?" Lonnie asks. Adora frowns.

"Don't call her furball," Adora warns. Adora can't imagine Catra liking that nickname very much. "It doesn't matter how I feel about her. I killed her."

"Didn't Scorpia-"

" *Don't* ." Adora says, cutting Lonnie off. Adora couldn't hope, because if she hoped and found out that it was false… She thinks she'd probably have a breakdown and never recover. "I'm sorry about the farm, I'll make it better when I'm better." Lonnie gives her a look and Adora gets it. She's unlikely to ever get better, not unless Catra magically appeared again. "Fine, you can fix it when the Horde rises up and kicks me off the throne for being depressed."

"Shut up." Lonnie says, rolling her eyes. "Get better, Adora. We don't know what's coming. If Catra really is dead, the Rebellion will want blood."

"Didn't you just say the Horde won't fight for me anymore?"

"I also said we'd protect you."

"Touché." Adora says with amusement. She sits down on the edge of her bed and rubs her face. "I love her." Adora whispers. "I should've listened to you. And now... it's too late." Lonnie pats her shoulder awkwardly.

"Maybe not." She offers but it doesn't help. Adora isn't convinced.

"Can you leave me alone now? I want to curl up on my bed and not move." Lonnie rolls her eyes but walks towards the exit of Adora's room.

"Hang in there Blondie. By the way, your haircut doesn't look too shabby." Adora laughs a little for the first time in weeks. She runs her fingers through her hair. She lays down on the bed again and curls into that ball she was talking about. She had no energy, and she just wanted to sleep, but not even her dreams were free of Catra.

* * *

Catra laughs nervously as the doctor scolds her for going on a run without anyone else there and breaking open a stitch. She apologizes and promises to be more careful this time as the doctor helps her settle into the wheelchair she had to use for the next two weeks. Thankfully, she didn't have to push since it floated on its own and she could move it with just a button.

It’s not like she intended to push herself beyond her limits but she wanted to see Adora more than anything and she was sick of sitting around in bed all day. Adora was out there and she was *grieving.* Catra can’t be certain, because for some reason her connection to Adora is fuzzy (she suspects it’s due to the fact they’ve been apart for so long and Catra was in a coma for a period of time), but she’s pretty sure Adora is grieving Catra as a loss. She wants to get better so she can go to the Fright Zone and see Adora again. She misses her. She *needs* to get there.

With one more apology and a thank you to the doctor, Catra leaves the infirmary and heads down the hall, wondering where everyone else was. It was late, sure, but usually there were people milling around about this hour - guards at the very least - but it was silent.

" *Pssst* , Catra."

Catra nearly jumps out of her seat when she hears the voice, looking incredibly confused. "Am I... imagining things? Maybe the pain medicine the doctor gave me is messing me up..."

"Catra, it's me," Adora says. *Adora.* "Will you come in here before someone else, who isn't you, sees me?" Catra looks around *frantically in her chair, her eyes landing on the blonde. She can hardly believe this. Did Adora get her message? Did she finally come to her senses and believe that Catra was alive? …* That *idiot* !

"Adora!" She whispers loudly. "What are you doing here? You need to get out of here!"

"It's fine, Bright Moon security sucks."

"It's *not* fine. Adora, you need to go. You could get hurt. Please."

"I came to check on you, I was worried." She says. "Come here?"

"I... Adora, you need to go." Catra repeats, though she wanted nothing more than to jump into Adora's arms and to kiss her senseless. "It's not safe for you to be here."

"Catra, I can handle myself." Adora gestures with her hand. " *She-Ra* , remember?"

"Even then! You need to go." Catra moves the wheelchair forward, trying to nudge Adora. "Right now isn't the time, okay?" Catra wants to kiss her so badly, she wants to drag Adora

back to her room and just bury her nose in her neck and scent her and make love with her but this is neither the time nor place. If Adora gets caught here *with* Catra, they're both finished.

Adora sighs. "Can I at least get one kiss?"

"I shouldn't move too much. Please, I'll see you soon, promise. But right now, you really need to go." Catra repeats. It worries her how persistent Adora is being. Maybe she really did miss her, but Adora was putting them both at risk with what she was doing right now. Adora can be pouty when she doesn't get kisses but Catra had never thought she'd risk them being caught out for one.

Adora laughs and the sound of it sends a sliver of ice down Catra's back. "Really? No kiss? Not that it helps your case much."

"... What?"

"Darling, everyone already knows whose pants you've been in." She responds flippantly. "Whose baby you carry."

"I- You... You're not Adora..." Catra breathes out, fear sinking into her very soul. "What are you talking about?"

"Oh darling," They crouch in front of her and boop her nose. "You knew there were spies in the Rebellion. Lord Adora tricked you. She had me spy on your little Rebellion for years, months recently. Until the poor little Lord hurt you. She stopped paying me, and refused to see people, and, well, I have to eat. So I brought my services, and my *information,* to the Rebellion." They explain. "No hard feelings but I figured the Rebellion deserved to know it had a traitor in its midst."

"I... I never..." Catra's breathing speeds up. "I didn't betray them! I never used any information against them!" This must be the shapeshifter: Double Trouble. Catra was terrified knowing that if Double Trouble told the Rebellion what Catra thinks they did, that the Rebellion would be furious with her. "I never betrayed them, why would you tell them that I did?!"

"You really think that matters?" They laugh as they transform back to their form, no longer looking like Adora. "Kitten, you've been sleeping with the enemy, you carry her *child* , that's a betrayal in itself." A tear streams down Catra's cheek, many more threatening to follow suit. *This can't be happening.* Catra wasn't ready.

"It... I need to explain to them... I... *fuck* ." Catra's hands were shaking as she begins to panic, trying to figure out what to do. "They're not gonna listen... I-I was gonna tell them... they're gonna hate me..." She whispers to herself, taking in shaky breaths. She doesn't even register the other sets of footsteps that were beginning to head in their direction.

"C'yra." C'yra speaks first, behind Catra, her voice stern and *serious* . Catra tenses up as soon as she hears her voice.

"Mama..." Catra starts off weakly. "Mama, please... I can explain..." C'yra holds up her hand, cutting Catra off.

"We didn't believe Double Trouble at first, but hearing..." She trails off. "You betrayed *everyone* ."

"How could you, C'yra?" Luna asks, looking visibly upset.

"If you would just let me explain." Catra says desperately, hoping that at least *one* of them would let her tell her side of the story. Of course Spinnerella and Netossa had left only just yesterday, she had *no one.* "Please?"

"What is there to explain?!" C'yra asks angrily. "You... You're a *traitor* ... my own daughter." Catra could feel her heart breaking in two at her mama's words.

"I didn't betray you all!" She yells out, distress and pain visible on her face. "I never told Adora anything!"

"You think that matters?!" C'yra yells. "You've been lying to us for... months, nearly a *year* , how are we supposed to trust anything you say?!"

"What did you want me to say?! I knew that you wouldn't listen to me!" Catra sobs, hands still shaking. "I knew that this is how you would react."

"C'yra..." Luna says. She doesn't look angry, well, she looks angry but she looks more upset, disappointed, *hurt* , than anything else. "You've been sleeping with the Horde Lord... You... She has been destroying Etheria, hurting innocent people... You're no better than the Horde. You're just as guilty." Catra's heart shatters. She knows her moms aren't going to listen to her, no matter how much she pleads - even Luna.

"What do you want me to do then?" She asks weakly, looking down at her hands, tears hitting her skin.

"You're under the arrest of Half-Moon for the charge of... treason." C'yra says. "And I don't see how we can help raise a baby that is half of the Lord of the Horde."

"What?" Catra lifts her head up, placing a hand on her abdomen. "What... What are you saying, mama?" Dread begins to fill her, her blood runs *cold* .

"I'm saying, either you give your baby up now, or in the future, or they're disowned." C'yra says stoically.

"Cy-" Luna says but her wife quickly cuts her off.

"They won't have a title, no royal baby can be the spawn of someone like Lord Adora." C'yra's claws extend on instinct. She was angry, angrier than she's probably ever been in her life, Catra has never seen her so angry. Her eyes burn with hatred and Catra doesn't know if she hates *her* or if it's directed at Adora. Immediately, Catra's fur stands on end in fear as C'yra finishes her sentence. She wanted to take Finn away from her. She couldn't let that happen.

Bow manages to push his way to the front past the Princesses, standing between them and Catra. "Wait, wait, wait, maybe we should all calm down? Okay? Catra asked to explain, maybe we should let her." Catra looks at her moms, terrified and heartbroken even as Bow moves to stand between them. Tears fall down her cheeks as she takes in a shaky breath that almost chokes her.

Before anyone, even Catra herself, knew it, the brunette was on her feet and sprinting down the hall and out of the castle. She didn't know where she was going, but she needed to get away. They were trying to take her kitten from her and she couldn't let that happen. Maybe... Maybe she could go to Adora? But Adora wasn't okay either and she couldn't reach Scorpia.

Catra feels a sharp pain in her chest, the stitches holding her wound together breaking apart from her vigorous actions and bleeding through. Blood drips down her loose clothes, red coating her feet as she leaves a trail behind her. She only stops when exhaustion and dizziness from blood loss kicks in.

She stumbles onto a nearby bench from an abandoned town, sitting down before breaking down crying. She had lost *everything* . Her own moms hated her, her friends saw her as a *traitor* , Adora thought she was dead...

She had nowhere to go.

* * *

The Rebellion breaks out into arguments between themselves as Bow steps between them. "Catra why don't you- Catra?" Bow asks.

"Where did she go?!" C'yra yells angrily, looking around. "We need to find her. She probably ran off to that *bitch* that got her pregnant with the demon Horde spawn."

"C'yra. Enough." Luna speaks over her, her disappointed expression having shifted to worry as soon as they realised Catra was gone and she catches the lingering scent. "She's grieving again." She whispers, ears pressed against her head. Bow frowns, his eyebrows furrowed.

"Again, but didn't she almost..." He stops, not wanting to say the words. "... Leave us… when she first went into grieving?" Luna sighs.

"We have to find her. She was injured already, and all this stress, it can't be good for her." She scowls at her wife. "Did you really tell her she'd have to give up Finn?"

"We are not letting her have the demon spawn. Luna, that is not our grandchild. Not when they're from the bloodline of that *monster* ." C'yra turns to face her wife, hands clenched tightly.

"You can't be serious right now?" Luna asks. "I'm upset too, but that child is *innocent* and they're half C'yra too. They're half of our little girl..."

"Well, that little girl became a *criminal* and a *traitor* as soon as she opened her legs for the Horde Lord!"

"Listen to yourself," Luna says, her tail whipping back and forth behind her. "You're acting like she isn't our daughter. You need to calm down and we need to find her before she gets *hurt* ."

"Fine. She's probably with that bitch anyway." C'yra growls softly. "Let's go get her."

"Hey, wow, you want to go to the *Fright Zone* ?" Bow squeaks. "We can't!"

"I can teleport us." Glimmer says.

"No, I'm serious, look, you guys need to calm down. I'll take some guards and go look for Catra myself. You said it yourself, she was injured, she couldn't have gotten far."

"You're not going alone!" C'yra says. "We're all going so we can make sure that we don't get attacked and we're dragging Catra *back* ."

"No." Bow states and he has his serious tone. "Absolutely no way. I'll look for her, no one is going to the Fright Zone, okay? Not even me. I'll just look around the woods."

"You seriously think she didn't run back to that bitch?" C'yra narrows her eyes at Bow. "That's the first place she'd go. So that's where *we're* going."

"No we're not!" He yells. "You're all angry and charging in there angry isn't going to help anyone!"

"And who exactly gave you authority to order anyone around?"

"Hey," Glimmer interrupts. "You may be a Queen but don't talk to Bow like that." C'yra huffs.

"Fine. We'll check the woods."

"Uh..." Bow says nervously. "Where did Double Trouble go?"

"For fuck's- We lost another one!"

"Cy, calm down. I sent them to go look for C’yra since everyone was arguing." Luna speaks up, sighing tiredly. "Let's go as well. We need to find her."

Bow walks over to Glimmer and sighs. "I'm worried Glimmer."

"Me too." Glimmer admits, even though she's angry at Catra. "She's hurt and she looked... really scared when her mom was yelling at her." She whispers.

"We were bad friends." Bow replies. "We should've said something. Catra is our *best* friend... We're the best friend squad..."

"Why didn't she tell us?"

"Maybe because of what just happened?" Bow suggests, exasperated. Glimmer sighs.

"We need to find her. If Luna is right, and she's really gone into grieving again, we need to hurry."

"Yeah..." Bow says. "Glim... what if... what if the only person that can save her is... you know..."

"Then we'll need to get her. Even if I hate the idea." Glimmer licks her lips nervously. "If it means saving Catra."

"Catra is smart... It doesn't make sense that she'd fall for the Horde Lord if... if there wasn't *more* to her, you know?"

"Yeah, you're right, but didn't Double Trouble say that Lord Adora was out of it?"

"Sure but I mean... What are you saying?"

"What if Lord Adora can't help?" Bow looks *worried* . His brow furrows and he looks off ahead.

"I don't know... I hope she can. If she loves Catra then... I'd hope she would be able to." Glimmer looks just as worried as Bow.

"Here's hoping.” Bow says nervously. "We should go look now."

"Yeah, let's go." Glimmer nods at Bow, turning to C'yra and Luna.

"Should we inform the other Princesses immediately? We probably need everyone we can get to help find Catra."

"That's a good idea, Glimmer." Luna says softly, glancing at her wife. C'yra clicks her tongue.

"Yes, contact them and let them know everything. We'll head out first, I suppose."

C’yra and Luna start walking in tense silence as Glimmer teleports away with Bow to go inform the Princesses who were not present of the current situation. Luna was disappointed in how they had all handled that situation but she was especially angry with what her wife had said. "You're sleeping on the couch tonight." Luna says, staring ahead.

"What?! Luna!"

"Don't give me that." Luna says. "You're acting like you don't even care about our daughter."

"Luna, she *betrayed* us!"

"I don't care!" Luna snaps. "She was already on bed rest! She was *stabbed* , she almost *died* , she got better from her grieving, which almost killed her too, and now we've pushed her right back into it!" Luna seethes, she was angry at herself too. "No matter what she does, she's still our child Cy." Luna yelling at C’yra seemed to make something click in her wife’s mind. C’yra’s anger somewhat fades away from her features.

"You're right."

"Of course I'm right." Luna huffs. "We said... *horrible* things to her."

"We did." C'yra sighs, taking a deep breath. The grieving scent was lingering heavily in the air still. "We should start searching. I'm still not happy about what she did, or about the baby, but you're right, she's our daughter. We need to make sure she's okay."

"Maybe Double Trouble has found something." Luna says hopefully.

"Maybe. We'll need to wait to see if they contact us." C'yra exhales heavily, clearly frustrated with the situation.

"C'yra never told me about her mate but... she clearly loved her, Cy." Luna says cautiously. It had been clear in the way that Catra had reacted and the way that when she did speak of her mate she seemed to light up; she clearly held a deep and significant love for them - her going into grieving was proof of that alone.

"How could she love someone that caused everyone so much pain, Luna?" C'yra throws back, rubbing her temples. "It doesn't make any sense."

"I don't know." Luna admits. "She was so happy when she found out she was pregnant. She... She does love Adora, she wouldn't be C'yra's mate if she didn't, she wouldn't have gone into grieving."

"What if the Horde Lord tricked her? If she's supposed to be our daughter's... mate, then why did she nearly kill her?"

"I don't know." Luna admits with a frown. "What if Adora loves her too?"

"Then why did she stab her?" C'yra shakes her head. "If the Horde Lord loves her, then she has a lot of shit to answer for."

"I don't disagree, but attacking our daughter won't help anything."

"I know." C'yra sighs tiredly. She stays quiet for a moment, trying to figure out what to say. She doesn't have to though, as Luna's com-pad goes off with a message.

Chapter End Notes

Ouch *kneeling emoji* -M

Okay, real talk, as someone who suffers from panic attacks and anxiety it was kind of therapeutic to write it down as Adora. I will also admit that I had a dark time these past couple of weeks and that may have reflected upon Adora jsdhksjdf Anyway, we will hopefully see y'all next week with the next update, thank you for reading! -S

Come say hi @ceolordadora on twitter and our CuriousCat is always open! You can also find me (S) on tumblr @sherasswordstrap

Broken and Breaking

Chapter Summary

> As funny as it was, Adora was glad she had decided to kidnap Catra that day at Princess Prom.

Chapter Notes

> Happy Friday and Happy Update Day!! I hope you enjoy this update and we'll see y'all again next week!
>
> Warning, Blood and Injury

See the end of the chapter for more notes

Catra was tired. She was tired, and scared, and she had never felt more alone in her life than what she had in this moment. She never thought that Double Trouble would have been the reason that her mothers and friends found out about Adora and how Finn came to be. She never thought that she would need to *run away* from her own mother, the person who always told her that she could lean on her for anything and everything.

It hurt to even think about. The way that everyone had looked at her when Double Trouble revealed that she had been… that she had caught feelings for Adora and that she was having her child. Everything hurt. Her chest felt heavy and her vision was blurred as she tried to force down the tears. She was trying to think rationally, but the voices in her head were so *loud* .

" *Hey Catra~* " Catra's ears perk up as she hears the familiar voice. Her eyes water as she turns around and sees the love of her life standing there.

"A... Adora?" On some level, Catra knows it can’t possibly be Adora, but a part of her hopes. She wants her there so desperately. She *needs* her. She can feel herself slipping away, she’s right on the edge, all it will take is one little push and the entire world will come crumbling down on top of her. She’s still bleeding...

"Wow... are you just wallowing out here on your own, Kitten?" Catra stands up from the dirty bench she had been sitting on despite her wound. She turns around, a hopeful expression on her face.

"Is that really you? What are you doing here?" Catra asks. They look so much like Adora… Maybe it's the blood loss, or maybe Catra just really *wants* Adora to be here, but a part of herself buys it. She really thinks that maybe, just *maybe* , Adora has come to save her; her knight in shining (black and red) armour.

"What am I doing here?" They ask. "Why, looking for you of course." Adora steps closer to Catra, circling her for a moment. "What are you doing here? Wallowing in self pity doesn't suit you, Kitten."

"I..." Catra looks directly at Adora, sniffing gently before tearing up. "You... You're not Adora." She whispers, not recognising the scent that was coming off of the person. She was an idiot. Why did she have to hope? It shatters Catra right to her core, that final stage of grief, the one that leads to a Magicat's mortality, she could feel it ensnaring her in its trap.

"No." Double Trouble lifts their hand and grabs Catra by the chin firmly. "But you still want me to be, even after everything she's done to you." Catra looks at Double Trouble, her heart breaking into pieces once again. It hurt. It was too much to the point where she could hardly breathe and then: just numbness and *cold* .

She lets her head drop in DT's hold, unable to hold herself up anymore. She was tired. She had lost… *everything* . She couldn't do this again. "Why?" She forces out weakly.

"Why what, Kitten?"

"Why did you do that?" They exposed her to her friends and family, they wore the face of the woman that Catra loved, they were *cruel* .

"Why does anyone do anything?" DT answers cryptically. "You realise that dear Adora was using me to spy on the Rebellion? Or at least, she *was* ." Catra can't stop the sob that comes out of her. She feels as though she's drowning and no one was there to pull her out.

"Please stop." Catra had known there was a Horde spy, she should've known they might be a shapeshifter. She feels weak and shaky from the blood loss. She's covered in scarlet red and she doesn't know how DT hasn't noticed.

The loss of all her friends and family hurts almost as much as the loss of Adora; it's pushed her right back into grief. And Adora… beautiful, sweet, Adora, she thinks Catra is dead. She looked awful in that brief glimpse Catra had seen of her, she was probably suffering just as much as Catra was. Catra *needed* her. She hadn't even gotten to say hello to her again, to take her scent in, she never fully recovered from her grieving because she was never *physically* reunited with Adora.

Maybe she was told how Adora felt but being told by other people and actually *hearing* it from Adora? Getting to touch her? Smell her? Scent her? Kiss her? *Be* with her? Catra had had none of that, and her body still felt like she had lost a mate, combining that with the loss of every other loved one in her life… Catra was *destroyed* .

"Did you honestly think Adora loved you?" DT asks. "Adora is incapable of loving anything." Catra's breath hitches at DT's words. Her entire body just seems to weaken and she barely manages to lift her head as she looks directly into DT's eyes.

Now she was being told that Adora didn't love her? Her mate? Catra couldn't make heads from tails, the woods around her seemed to be spinning. *Her mate didn't love her? Didn't want to be with her?* The blood loss was making her confused. DT was wrong. Adora *is* capable of love, she was capable of *so much* love… but…

"I've lost everything... please... just let me go in peace at least." Catra says weakly. She can *feel* it. The grief is catching up with her, she can't stop it, and her heart is beginning to slow down, weak from trying to keep blood to her vital organs while she lost so much of it.

"Let you go in peace?" DT frowns. "What on Etheria do you mean?"

"No one needs me, everyone hates me now." Catra whispers quietly. Adora will get better. She isn't a Magicat, she won't *die* from the grieving, even if she is suffering. She *will* get better. Catra is a little sad that she won't get to see that however. "Everyone's left me... There's no reason for me to stay." All of her family. Her friends. She had no one. Not even Adora believed she was alive.

"Catra, aren't you, you know, pregnant?"

"Doesn't matter. Where would I go? Adora thinks I'm dead and, according to you, doesn't want me. My moms wanted me to get rid of my baby, the rest of the people I know hate me now." Silent tears stream down her face. "There's no point in bringing a child that will be unloved into this world when their own mother is hated by everyone that is supposed to love her." Her mom wanted her to get *rid* of them. *Her baby!* Nowhere is safe for either of them. Catra lays a hand against her bump, her words slurring from the blood loss.

"They wouldn't be unloved." DT says hesitantly. They can clearly see now how delicate of a situation Catra is in. " *You* would love them. And Adora."

"I don't have the strength to love them... Not anymore. I can't care for them when I can't even care for myself. I have nowhere to go." Catra laughs weakly. "Adora thinks I'm dead and she doesn't love me. Why would she want Finn? Why would she want *me* ?"

"Come on Kitten, it was for the drama of it all, I didn't mean that. Adora loves you, of course she does." DT says.

"Please... Please don't lie to me anymore. I can't take it." Catra's brain is mush, she has no idea what is reality and what is not.

"I'm not lying, Kitten," DT says. "After you ran away, your moms and the rebels, they thought you went running back to Adora. But you and I both know that poor Lord Adora has been in *pieces* since that battle. Why, I bet she'd even get angry at them for mistreating you and then offer her surrender to them only after they found you."

"Please stop lying to me, Double Trouble. You've lied to me enough. I've lost enough, I can't go through this again. Please, just go away." Catra whispers, looking away from the other. "Leave me alone." Their words meant little anyway. They were a hypothesis at best. Adora would *never* surrender.

"No way," DT says. "I admit, I was a little mean, but now that I've found you, I can bring you back to the Rebels and I'll surely be handsomely rewarded for bringing back the runaway Princess." They sigh. "Besides, Catra, do you *really* want to harm that little kitten you're carrying?"

"Leave me alone." Catra whispers, no longer registering anything DT was saying. Her mind had gone blank. She had stopped listening, her body giving up. She has had enough, she was tired and she... She just wanted to rest now.

She stands, lifting her hand to her chest. *Adora… she stabbed her… did her stitches open? Where is she? Was she dead?*

"How about I call Queen Luna right now? I happen to have her number." Catra doesn't answer, not hearing what DT had just said. Her body slowly sways in the wind from how tired she was. She felt as though she was being weighed down. She allows her eyes to close, too exhausted to keep them open for much longer. She begins to fall to the side, not responsive as she falls to the ground.

* * *

Double Trouble rushes over to Catra when they see her collapse. They pick her up a little to check her over. She was breathing, though it was shallow and her head was cold. DT didn't know what to do. So they do the only thing they can think of and call Luna. "Double Trouble?" Luna asks. "Did you-"

"Hold it right there, Your Majesty," DT cuts off. "I need you to come to these coordinates right the hell now."

“You found her?” Luna asks.

“Yes, and she isn’t doing so hot, she’s got… blood all over her and she seemed confused.” Luna’s eyes widen in alarm. She looks to her right.

“Glimmer, teleport me, Cy, go to Half-Moon and get our royal physician as quickly as you can.” The Queen hangs up and in the next second she’s there *physically* . “Go get Adora, *now* !”

“But-“

“ *Go,* Glimmer!” Luna orders. Glimmer disappears in pink sparkles and Luna quickly makes her way over to her daughter, applying first aid to her. She was so thankful that her father had been a doctor.

* * *

It takes a long moment, but Adora appears with Glimmer. Adora dashes forward first and skids on her knees as she drops down beside Catra. She scoops her up in her arms. "Catra..." She presses her nose to the side of her face. "Catra... it's me... come back to me." Catra doesn't so much as twitch, her head lulling off to the side as Adora holds her. She's still breathing, but it's slow and her skin is cold and clammy.

Luna was kneeling down beside her, tears welling up in her eyes, she’d clearly stopped the bleeding but Catra still didn’t look good. "Glimmer, we need to get Catra to a medic, now. She's entered the last stage of grieving and the blood loss is making it worse." Luna says, gently grabbing her daughter from Adora and hugging her close as Glimmer comes up to them and places a hand on her and Adora's shoulder. "I'm so sorry, kitten. I should have fought harder to stop you from leaving." She whispers to her daughter. Adora watches with wide eyes. She couldn’t go through losing Catra *again* .

"What is a medic going to do?" Adora asks, she feels... she feels *She-Ra* itching under her skin - in fact, she's pretty sure she's even glowing.

"We need to make sure she's physically stable." Luna explains as Glimmer teleports them to Bright Moon. "When Magicats reach the last stage of grieving, they begin to shut down."

"How do we get her *out* of that?!" Adora was *panicking* . She had thought Catra was dead and now she might *actually* be dead.

"I... I'm not sure." Luna admits, grimacing as she leads Adora to the infirmary. She hands Catra off to one of the doctors for them to help her. "We need to focus on getting her through the night first."

"But..." Adora looks over at Catra. "I'm here... Shouldn't that help?" Adora said she had been expanding her readings. If she was Catra's mate then her scent should help her immeasurably, and yet she still looked… well… she looked *dead.* Adora's nerves were wrought and she didn't know what to do, she just wanted to help Catra.

"It's a little more complicated than that when Magicats enter the final stage." Luna whispers, escorting Adora out of the infirmary to allow the doctors to do what they needed to do. "Magicats are rarely responsive once they've reached the final state. It's rare in itself for a Magicat to be grieving while their mate is still alive, unless their mate is incredibly close to dying, so it's harder to dictate how Catra will respond... and *if* she'll respond at all." That wasn't what Adora wanted to hear *at all.*

"I need to be in there *with* her, not out here," Adora tries to push back into the infirmary. "This is all my fault. I can't... I can't live without Catra." Magicat or not, Adora feels exactly the same about not being able to carry on if Catra were to be gone for good - she basically shut down when she thought she'd killed her.

"Adora, we need to let the medics stabilise her first. Let them do their job and then you can go in and be with her. Maybe it'll do her some good to be surrounded by your scent." Luna comforts, patting Adora's shoulders - it doesn't make Adora feel better. "I should probably go get C'yra. She's still upset about… You and Catra, and her running away. I sent her to get our royal physician, it's probably best she finds out what's going on from me." Adora has never been patient.

"I don't want to wait. They can stabilise her *around* me."

"Adora. They need the room to move around. If you're in the way, the longer they'll take." Luna pets her hair gently. "Take a breath, child, Catra's always been strong, she'll get through this, okay?" Adora huffs and then stands against the wall, her leg bobbing up and down. If she was honest, she felt like crying but she didn't want to do that in front of Catra's mom.

"Fine..." She says, not looking at Luna. "I'll wait here." Truth be told, Adora was sure she probably looked like a mess - at least today had been one of the days Scorpia had forced her to eat, shower and change her clothes, otherwise she'd be stinking up the hallways with her own grief and funk.

"Do you need a hug, dear?" Luna's question catches Adora off guard.

"What? No. I... I'll be... fine..." Adora says dismissively.

"You sure?" Luna asks softly. "This has been hard on all of us. But I imagine you feel it more because of your bond, she's your mate after all."

"I just... I love her... and I never got the chance to tell her that... And I hurt her." Luna hums softly. Her eyes carefully looking over Adora's face to try to read her. Adora *hates* it.

"Why don't we get something to drink and sit down for a minute? I'll talk to C'yra later."

"I don't... I don't want to go anywhere. Can you just... leave me alone, please?" Adora *really* doesn't want to cry in front of Luna but the longer she lingers the harder that's getting.

"Adora, it's okay to cry. I'm not going to judge you for hurting." Luna reassures her, placing a hand on her shoulder. "I definitely won't judge you. You can cry, okay?" Adora looks away before she falls into Luna. She feels the weight of everything crushing her as she hugs Luna, clinging to her and burying her face against her shoulder as she shakes with her tears.

She thinks about how strange this is. They're technically mortal enemies yet here they are, hugging, sharing grief… Adora hadn't even met Luna until right now. She is the *Horde Lord* to Luna, and yet she has been nothing but kind to her currently - holding her while she cries. *Does Adora really look that broken?*

"It should be *me* not her." Adora says between sniffles. Luna smiles sadly, patting Adora's back and gently rubbing - probably in an attempt to try to comfort her.

"It shouldn't be *anyone* , dear. We all had a part in getting her to this point."

"But Catra is a *good* person." Adora argues.

"Did you mean to hurt her?" Adora was not expecting that question at all.

"I- No, but... but... I've hurt other people too."

"Do you regret hurting her? Do you regret hurting other people?"

"I regretted hurting Catra as soon as I did it. Other people... I do now, but I never used to, because I thought I was right, that I was doing *good* , I was *wrong* ." Adora says grimly.

"You did it out of good intent but you were misguided when you thought you were doing good. My daughter helped you figure that out, didn't she?" Luna asks softly. Adora nods slowly.

"Yeah, Shadow Weaver told me I was unlovable... and here Catra is... loving me." Adora laughs bitterly. "She deserves better."

"Then work to become better, Adora." Luna smiles softly. "A bonded Magicat only stays bonded if they truly love their mate, and if their mate loves them in return."

"I do, I love Catra, I love her... *so much* ..." Adora couldn't wait to say that to Catra's face. After everything, after she left her, after She-Ra stabbed her, after… Just, after *everything,* all Adora wants to do is tell Catra that she loves her.

"I know, now show her that you mean it. Love her like you never have before."

"I know C'yra wants me dead." Adora says. She's putting herself at risk by being here, not that she'd fought Glimmer when she showed up in her throne room, but this was different. She didn't have a single ally here, and the only ally she may have had was knocking on death's door. Adora could be detained - or *killed* - for being here. She doesn't have her sword. All she has is the clothes on her back and herself.

"Except, that likely will be impossible to do without hurting Catra more." That much was true at least. This whole grieving thing was from losing her mate, if they took Adora out, Catra would lose her mate for real this time. They needed Adora as much as Adora needed them right now. A mutual understanding.

"So I agree to help Catra and you agree not to kill me?" Adora asks with a small nervous chuckle.

"Just because you came to help Catra, and you're here in Bright Moon, does not automatically mean we're going to send you to your death, Adora. I'll talk to my wife and the others. Clearly... Clearly, Catra loves you, and you love her, and you both have a child on the way, we can't take that from you."

"I wouldn't blame you if you did." Adora had been slowly killing herself since she hit Catra. Not eating, not sleeping, not showering, cutting her hair, staring into space for hours. She was a *mess* . And she was aware that she had lost significant muscle mass, she was skinny, a little gaunt, weak, she was *not* in fighting shape. Not only was she an easy target, she felt like she *deserved* it.

"Except that I wouldn't do that. After seeing you worry over my daughter. After seeing you scramble to her side and hold her. After seeing you cry in front of me wishing that you could take her place." Adora stands up straight and wipes her face. "It wouldn't be right."

"Right." Adora says. "I don't care about me, I only care about Catra."

"Care about yourself too, okay? Because Catra would want you to do that." Luna pats Adora's shoulder. "Let's check with the doctors to see if you can go in now. Once you do, lay down with her, talk to her and tell her you're here, okay?" Adora nods.

"Okay." Luna nods back at her and walks over to the infirmary door, opening it up and speaking to whoever she was able to catch first. She receives confirmation that Catra had been stabilised and sighs in relief, letting the doctors know that Adora would be staying with Catra.

"Go on inside, I'll join you soon, okay?"

"Okay." Adora nods and heads inside. She walks to Catra's bedside. She hesitates for a moment before she climbs onto the bed beside her, she grabs her hand and kisses it. "Catra... I'm so sorry..."

* * *

Luna looks softly at the pair, sighing before quietly closing the door. She never thought that she'd be okay seeing her daughter with the Horde Lord but she *is* . Adora had been so worried and apologetic and she'd clearly been punishing herself for what she had done to Catra. She looked unsteady to say the least - she really was taking a risk just being here.

Luna needed to contact her wife. She sent her to get the royal Magicat physician but she hadn't told C'yra anything since she had left for Half-Moon. Luna takes her com-pad out and dials her wife's extension. It doesn't ring for long before it connects. "C'yra, are you there?" Luna asks.

"Luna?" C'yra asks. "Is everything okay?" Luna can see the *worry* reflected in her wife's eyes but Luna was nervous - she was worried how C'yra would react to Adora being here and with their daughter.

"We found C’yra." Luna says and she sees her wife’s eyes widen.

"Is she okay?" C’yra asks urgently. At least C’yra seemed concerned for Catra’s well-being. Luna knows how stubborn her wife can be but she also knows that Catra is their entire world, she is their *daughter* and they would do anything for her - no matter what.

"She's still grieving." Luna answers and she frowns. "She's... You need to come to Bright Moon. *Now.* "

"I'm on my way now," C’yra says. Luna can see that that’s true. She could make out the doctor beside her wife as she walked. They’d probably need Glimmer to teleport them here to get them here faster but Luna knew that Glimmer was currently held up talking to Angella. As soon as she was free, she would go retrieve C’yra and the doctor. "Adora... Is she there?" Luna sighs at the question.

She knew it was coming but she still wasn’t sure how her wife was going to react. Luna had only seen Adora and Catra interact for a moment and even in that moment she could tell that the Horde Lord cared deeply for their daughter. She didn’t worry that Adora might do something, she weirdly *trusted* her not to hurt her daughter despite the fact that Adora is technically their enemy. As far as Luna was concerned, Adora had proven herself simply by risking her safety by coming here. "She is. She's with C’yra right now." Luna answers.

" *What* ?! You let her near our daughter?" C’yra asks in alarm. Luna knew that that wasn’t going to go down too well but she had been hoping that her own wife would trust her decisions.

"C'yra. She's her *mate* . You need to understand that, even if you hate her." Luna sighs, biting the inside of her cheek. "I would never have left them together if I thought that Adora would harm C’yra. Plus… She needed her."

"No one needs that woman." Luna pinches the bridge of her nose and then gives her wife a *look* .

"C'yra, she *needed* her! For fuck's sake, our daughter's on the last stage of grieving right now.” Luna says angrily. She doesn’t understand how her wife can let her anger overshadow the well-being of their daughter. Luna knows all the hurt that the Horde has done, but if the Horde were the only people who could help her daughter then damn right she was going to let Adora help. “They just managed to stabilise her a minute ago." Luna tells C’yra.

Luna watches as C'yra takes a sharp breath in and then she lets out a shaky exhale. "I guess the least Lord Adora can do is help bring Catra back when she's almost killed her *twice* .” Luna rolls her eyes. “First by breaking her heart and then by stabbing her."

"We're to blame too, don't you get that?" Luna asks angrily. "We made her feel unwanted when we found out who her mate was. C'yra, you told her she needed to get rid of her child! The only thing that was helping her stay! Adora isn't the only one to blame, we all are. So get your head out of your ass and focus on our daughter's well-being first instead of your need to be angry."

Luna watches as her wife falls silent. She can see C’yra thinking, her ears twitching slightly as the silence between them stretches on - she even looks half guilty. "Why did she bond with *her* ? I don't understand."

"And we might not ever understand if we don't all work on how to figure out how to bring our daughter back, Cy." Luna sighs. She does understand where her wife is coming from. *Lord* Adora, of all the people for Catra to choose as her mate, it had to be the one person who had been destroying Etheria. But Catra was smart, Luna knew that she wouldn’t choose a mate if they were a horrible person. There was clearly *more* to Adora than any of them realised and she figured, so long as Catra wasn’t being hurt, she could give Adora a *chance* . "It doesn't matter if you hate who she chose as her mate right now. What matters is making sure that our daughter is okay and makes it through this. Got it?"

"Fine." C'yra sighs. "But if Adora speaks to me, I can't be held responsible for my claws that may or may not scratch her."

"You *will* be held responsible because the last thing we need is you attacking our daughter's mate when she needs her the most." Luna says sternly, narrowing her eyes at her wife. "Stop acting like a child."

" *Ugh* ," C'yra groans. "Fine, for C'yra, I will... tolerate... Lord Adora's presence. For now."

"Good, now come to Bright Moon as soon as you can. We need to figure this out."

"I'll be there soon." C'yra promises. She pauses for a moment. "Have you seen them together?"

"Seen them together? Adora is currently snuggling our daughter if that's what you're asking." Luna admits. She can see how much C'yra does *not* like that statement.

"Snuggling her..."

"Mhmm, trying to scent her to see if it'll help her become more responsive again." Luna informs her. That was her hope. Luna hoped that Adora's scent would be enough for her to recover - *it had to be* - the other option was not an option that Luna was willing to accept.

C'yra sighs and pinches the bridge of her nose. "I... I suppose." She concedes. "I'll see you soon, Love."

"See you soon, Cy." Luna nods at her wife and hangs up the call. She stands in the hallway for a moment. She needed to keep Adora safe, not for Adora's sake but for *Catra's* . If the Rebellion hurt Adora then that could mean that Catra never woke up, or, if she did wake up and found out her mate was gone for real… Catra could go right back into grieving again and the stress would likely be too much for her. She would die. Luna sighs.

She has to *protect* the Horde Lord.

* * *

Adora was lying against Catra, making sure that the brunette's head was pressed against her chest so that she was surrounded by her scent and she could hear her heartbeat. Catra wasn't

responsive whatsoever, her skin remained clammy and the only sign of her being alive was the machines surrounding her beeping steadily with her heartbeat and her chest going up and down with each breath.

Adora's heart aches. She looks at the scar on Catra's chest and lays her hand over it. Adora doesn't have her sword, and she doesn't know if she can heal without it, but she wishes she could. She keeps her palm pressed gently there and closes her eyes, allowing herself to concentrate, to *feel* her magic that she so often felt itching under her skin to get out. She-Ra. Adora had spent so long being afraid of her that she hadn't bothered to learn anything about her - nothing beyond what Shadow Weaver taught her anyway. She knew the basics: tall, strong, powerful, able to change her sword into whatever she wanted - which was a handy skill since she could do that as *Adora* and didn't need She-Ra to do it. Adora had heard the legends, she knew She-Ra could heal, but, well, Shadow Weaver never needed She-Ra to heal, she just needed her power, so she never taught her. Adora had no idea how to do it and she wishes that she had spent more time doing so.

Her eyebrows knit together as she feels her magic swirl. Adora is She-Ra, even without her sword. *She could do this* . A knock at the door completely throws Adora off and she loses that concentration she needed. She turns to see that it was Luna who had knocked on the door to catch Adora's attention, entering the infirmary and looking sadly at her and Catra.

"Anything?" Luna asks softly. Adora has always wondered what it would be like to have a mother, to have someone who would do anything to protect you and to love you unconditionally. She used to think Shadow Weaver was like her mom but, if Adora had been where Catra was right now, Shadow Weaver wouldn't care about losing *Adora* she'd care about losing her *weapon* . Adora glances back at Catra and withdraws her hand, instead cuddling her.

"No." Adora answers sadly. She holds Catra a little closer and gently brushes strands of hair from her face. "The doctors stitched up her wound at least… The wound *I* caused." Adora can't believe she almost killed Catra - twice now considering she had been basically killing her when she told her she didn't feel the same. Adora buries her face in Catra's neck.

I do feel the same. I love you. And I need you to wake up so I can tell you myself and you can tell me that I'm an idiot. Please. Stay.

"At least she's stable." Luna says softly as she closes the door behind her. "She still has a fighting chance, okay?" Adora isn't much of a silver lining kind of person. She's a: *this is the worst outcome that will probably happen* , kind of person. She can't live without Catra. She refuses to. But she still appreciates Luna's gentle words.

"I wish... I wish I knew how to use She-Ra's healing powers." Adora whispers as she kisses Catra on her nose. "What happened? I mean, is this because of what I did?" Adora isn't entirely sure what happened. She knows she hurt Catra, but that was weeks ago and if that video call really was real then… Catra *had* been doing better. Not to mention the Rebellion knew about them. That was a new development.

Adora glances at Luna and she looks ashamed. "No, it's not your fault. It was ours." Adora watches as she sits down on a chair beside the bed. Weirdly, the infirmary was kind of homey. It was warm, the light of the moon streamed in through the windows and, other than the beeping of the machines, it was quiet. Adora always did like quiet. "We... We were informed about yours and Catra's relationship and we reacted badly. So Catra ran."

"Reacted badly..." Adora echoes. She looks at Catra. "What... What did you say to her?" There must have been a reason that Catra would run. She remembers what she told her when they had first started their arrangement: how Catra stood to lose so much and Adora stood to lose nothing if they were found out. Adora hadn't really understood. She'd never really had a family and, while she considers Scorpia and her squad family, it isn't the same. They're not Princesses, their family understanding isn't the same, and they've known about Catra since about day zero even when Adora was obsessing over Catra before they ever slept together.

Adora smiles a little. She's had a crush on Catra since she set eyes on her. The first time they met she had flirted with Catra and Catra had kicked her in the face. Adora had been stuck on her ever since. She never thought Catra would ever reciprocate those feelings, she certainly never thought she'd have a three day sex-a-thon with the Princess and she *definitely* never saw her falling in love with her. But she had, and Adora had fallen in love with her too. *The Princess and the Horde Lord . Who would have guessed?* As funny as it was, Adora was glad she had decided to kidnap Catra that day at Princess Prom.

"I... I didn't say very much. I did say I was disappointed... It was my wife who said very harsh things that I didn't agree with." Luna's voice brings Adora back to the present and she looks back at Luna with a soft scowl.

"What did she say?" Adora wasn't angry but she did feel... *heated* . Her voice was low but controlled. There is only one reason Adora will ever allow herself to get angry for anymore: Catra. If someone hurt her… Adora would tear the world apart simply to protect Catra. She would do *anything* for her, and hearing about people hurting her when she wasn't present… Adora was working on her anger issues, but she would *always* snap if someone was hurting her mate.

Luna bites her lip. "She called her a traitor. She asked why we should even help raise a baby that is half Horde. She threatened to disown the kitten if Catra didn't get rid of them."

"She said all of that to her?" Adora asks, turning towards Luna to look at her with a shocked expression. "I... I knew you guys wouldn't be happy, but I never thought you'd make her get rid of her baby just because it was half me." Adora isn't an expert on mothers, but she's pretty sure that they shouldn't threaten to disown your unborn child just because of who the other parent is.

"I don't agree with my wife, Adora. That was a horrible thing to say to her. I wish I would have spoken out sooner." Luna looks at her, a distressed look on her face. "She said that and I was shell-shocked. She... Catra ran before any of us could do something."

"You scared her." Adora says. She presses her hand to Catra's stomach, gently. She wasn't surprised Catra ran if it was to protect her kitten - *their* kitten. She sighs and leans against Catra more. She'd been away from her for so long. She had *missed* her, so fucking much, and knowing she could lose her again... It was just as painful the second time as it was the first.

"Catra was so worried about coming clean, or getting caught." Adora admits. She sees Luna look at her with surprise.

"She talked about that to you?"

"It was one of the main reasons she was hesitant to keep things going." Adora says softly, pressing a soft kiss to Catra's temple, wishing she would react in any way to show Adora that she was still here. This was Adora's fault. In a lot of ways. So many ways. Even from the beginning, she should have just let Catra go, she shouldn't have pursued her, shouldn't have offered the enemies with benefits arrangement, she should have left Catra alone and she'd still be alive right now - she *never* would have gotten hurt.

"Oh, I can understand why she didn't want to tell us when we... treated her the way we did." Luna replies.

"She didn't betray the Rebellion," Adora says. Calling Catra a traitor, when she *isn't,* is wrong. Catra had been nothing more than loyal. Sure she had been fucking the Horde Lord, but Catra *never* told Adora anything that would hurt the Rebellion. "Do you really think the Rebellion would still be standing if she had?"

"She... She tried to tell us that too." Luna frowns. Adora can see the guilt crushing her more and more as Adora speaks. She knows that the Rebellion probably feels bad - or at least *some* of them - for hurting Catra, and *good* , they *should* feel bad, but she doesn't want Luna to feel too bad; she has been welcoming to her so far, plus, Adora knows what making a mistake in the heat of the moment feels like. "That she never told you anything." Luna clarifies.

"She didn't," Adora whispers as she kisses the base of Catra's ear. "I didn't tell her anything either. There was no war when we were together. I wasn't *Lord* Adora, I was just Adora. And she was just Catra."

Adora can see Luna watching the exchange. Adora doesn't really care, she knows Catra loves it when Adora kisses and pets her ears, she'll do it in front of Catra's mom too. "I came to warn you." Luna purses her lips. "C'yra and the others still want to... to punish you for what you did as Horde Lord once my daughter wakes up. I'll try to stop it, but... they're too set on it." That's not surprising to Adora, she never expected the Rebellion to forgive her, she came here for Catra, to help her, no matter what.

"I'm not leaving."

"Adora, I know you want to stay. But if you do, you're putting your life on the line. If not to save yourself, then for my daughter. She'd be devastated if you were..." Luna doesn't finish her sentence but the words are clearly communicated to Adora.

"I can't leave." Adora says. "She hasn't improved, what if she..." Adora can't even finish that sentence. "I thought she was dead because of me, I can't leave if there's a chance I can help bring her back."

"You have time. They won't do anything until Catra wakes up. That I can assure you of. But I wanted to at least warn you."

"Thanks." Adora says, gently caressing Catra's face. "I know I have a tendency to blow up sometimes, I don't mean to, I'm getting better at it since... since my anger got the better of me in a very *bad* way." Adora confesses. She doesn't know why she's telling Luna this but Luna is giving her an understanding gaze and nod as she speaks.

"It's good that you're improving. That's always something important to control."

"Catra helped me before. I guess it didn't stick when she left."

"Things like that take *time* , and you were hurt too." Adora is slightly surprised if she's honest, she never really expected understanding from Catra's *mom* .

"I was... but I never should have listened to Shadow Weaver." Adora whispers. She still can hardly believe that she did. Shadow Weaver was still alive, but Adora had no intentions of ever going back to see her ever again - she could rot in that Horde cell like she deserved.

"What happened exactly?"

"I..." Adora hesitates. "I was angry, and I took advice I shouldn't have taken, that's all." She's not entirely sure she can bear her trauma on her sleeve to Catra's mom. Shadow Weaver will always have some hold over her but Adora doesn't have to let it control her.

"I see. Sometimes, when you're experiencing intense emotions, you do irrational things. I am not innocent either. No one in the Alliance is innocent right now." Adora sighs. *What a mess* .

"Catra saved me." Adora admits.

"She did?"

"She snapped me out of my rampage, and I repaid her by stabbing her."

"Was it really you?" Luna asks gently. Adora still isn't sure if she's honest. She had felt so… out of control. She had felt like three people jammed into one brain, it had been disorienting, all she remembers is feeling *rage* .

"It was... instinct. She moved and I... My head perceived it as her attacking me, and my hand moved before I could stop myself."

"I see." Luna frowns softly. "But you would have stopped yourself had you been able?"

"I..." Adora looks at Catra. "I never wanted to hurt Catra, but I did anyway." Luna hums softly at Adora's words. It was true, Adora had *never* wanted to hurt Catra, she hadn't for the longest of time.

"Okay, you should get some rest too. No one will bother you, I'll do my best to make sure of that. There's a bathroom right in the room and I'll have someone bring something to eat. Take care of her, okay?"

"Don't bother with the food, I won't eat it anyway." Adora mumbles as she sinks against Catra. *Gods. She has missed holding Catra.*

"Adora. You need to eat too."

"I'm fine." Adora says dismissively, waving her hand. She hasn't been eating anyway, she's not entirely sure she'd be able to keep it down.

"Fine. I won't force you. But there are snacks in this drawer here for patients. You can eat those if you get hungry, alright?"

"Okay." Adora says, settling down beside Catra and closing her eyes. "You trust me enough to leave me alone?" Adora asks curiously.

"I can tell you don't want to hurt her. Your eyes tell me that." Luna whispers. "You care for her, and I know that you won't hurt her again. I need to try to convince the others to not to try to attack you." Adora laughs a little.

"Good luck with that." Adora says sarcastically. She doesn't have high expectations of Luna being able to achieve that. Still, Adora isn't going anywhere.

"Thanks." Luna laughs nervously. "Hopefully I won't need luck, but knowing how stubborn my wife is I probably will."

Adora wasn't paying much attention anymore, far too focused on Catra. She couldn't lose Catra, not again.

* * *

Luna watches how Adora looks at her daughter, smiling sadly. At least she knew that Catra was in good hands while she dealt with her wife. Seeing the way that Adora looked at her daughter, there was no doubt in her mind that Adora loved her very much. She steps out of the infirmary, wondering where everyone else had gotten to. No one had come by the infirmary while Adora was there and the halls seemed empty too.

"Queen Luna," Glimmer says as Luna turns the corner right by the infirmary. "We're having a meeting, in the War Room."

"Right, thank you for telling me." Luna says, following Glimmer to the War Room. She doesn't like that the Rebellion is meeting *now* . It can only mean bad things.

Luna enters the war room behind Glimmer and examines the room. "What is everyone talking about right now?" Luna asks. Everyone looks up at her question. Bow looked distressed about something and everyone else had sombre expressions - Spinnerella and Netossa were absent but probably on their way back if Glimmer informed all of the Princesses of the current situation.

"How about the fact we have the literal Horde Lord in Bright Moon?" C'yra asks as she enters the room behind her wife. "It's the perfect opportunity."

"Not right now it’s not." Luna says back, turning around to face her wife. "C'yra, is that really your priority right now?"

"The doctors said that C'yra was stable, so yes. My priority is to remove Lord Adora while she's vulnerable."

"Are you *kidding* ?" Luna looks at her wife, horrified. She has no idea what has gotten into her wife’s head but she hoped that she could change her mind. Removing Adora was a bad idea, it would cause way more harm than good. "Cy, just because the doctor said she's physically stable doesn't mean that she can't slip back at any moment. She hasn't even woken up." Luna points out - not to mention Adora might be the only reason Catra is stable in the first place.

"C'yra will be fine." Cy says dismissively. "I went to get the royal doctor and I brought the royal guard too, plus the guards in Bright Moon, and all the Princesses here? Adora doesn't stand a chance." Luna *swears* this isn't the woman that she married at that moment. An imposter must have replaced her, that had to be it. She was willing to risk their *daughter’s* life just to capture Lord Adora. Luna was angry.

x"You have got to be kidding me right now. You can't be putting your daughter at risk like this after what happened. The doctor stabilised her *minutes* ago." Luna hisses. C’yra seems slightly taken aback but that doesn’t stop her.

"I'm not putting her at risk, I'm protecting her from..." C'yra trails off. "Did you leave her *alone* with her?"

"You're protecting her from what? Waking up?" Luna looks at her, angry at her wife for wanting to take un-calculated risks with her daughter's life. "Yes, I left her alone with her because, right now, she's the only thing keeping our daughter from slipping back into the final stage of grief."

"You didn't have to leave her *alone* with her!" C'yra cries. "All C'yra needs is her *scent* , we can detain Adora and give C'yra something of hers. Glimmer already told me how weak of a state the Horde Lord is already in."

"She is. She's way less muscular, and kind of shaky..." Glimmer butts in, frowning in similar anger to C'yra's. Clearly she too wanted for the Horde Lord to be punished for what she had done.

"You're really willing to bet that all Catra needs is her scent and put our daughter at risk?" Luna shakes her head in disbelief. "I can't believe you right now."

"Catra doesn't need the Horde Lord."

" *Yes* ! She does right now! Do you hear yourself? You're putting our daughter's life at risk with a guessing game of whether or not she only needs her mate's scent or not!" Luna was extremely angry. She didn't really know Adora, but she did know that she clearly cared about her daughter, and she was here - helping - Catra needed her and Luna wasn't about to risk Catra's *life* on the chance that she didn't need Adora physically.

"I'm a Magicat and she's my daughter. I think I know what she does and doesn't need."

"She's my daughter *too* and, considering I've actually seen the state she is in, I think I can say what she does and doesn't need better than you do right now." Luna wasn't going to back down. She knew that if they took Adora away now that Catra would simply just fall back into grief again, and she couldn't let that happen. She especially wasn't going to gamble her daughter's life on the chance she *might* just need Adora's scent.

"Fine." C'yra looks away from her wife for a moment. "But as soon as the doctors say she's okay, I'm arresting Lord Adora."

"Fine." Luna sighs in relief. It would give her time to figure out how to get Adora out of there before they tried to do a trial at least. "What else needs to be discussed?"

"How about Catra herself?" Glimmer asks.

"Yeah, she did kind of, like, betray us all." Mermista points out.

Luna takes a seat, pressing her lips together, she folds her arms over each other. "As angry as we may be, we did not handle finding out about her... relationship... with the Horde Lord in a fair and just way. It would be unjust of us to discuss any chances of her being punished without her input considering she's not even awake and has not shown any signs of waking as of this time." They deserved to give Catra a chance to explain herself.

"I'd rather keep her punishment to me." C'yra says. "Or us. Under *our* authority."

"What I mean, is that it wouldn't be fair to punish her without hearing her side." Luna clears up, looking at her wife. "If... *When* she wakes up, it's the least we can do."

"What?" C'yra looks at her wife. "You know I love C'yra... but she... I didn't mean what I said about her baby, I was angry, but her betrayal is real. She won't be seeing the Horde Lord ever again after this."

"You're not listening to what I'm saying, Cy. I'm saying that we should at least hear what she has to say since we didn't even do that before you went screaming about her baby." Luna frowns. "Just out of basic decency for the state we put her in."

"I don't want to hear about how she came about opening her legs for the Horde Lord."

" *C'yra* !" Luna scolds, her mouth falling open a little.

"I don't want to hear it, Luna." C'yra says, pressing her ears against her head. "You really want to know how she let herself get pregnant by the Horde Lord?"

"I want to at least let her explain herself. We owe her that much." Luna says firmly. "We owe her that much after she recovers from her current state."

"I don't *need* an explanation, it was poor judgement, she let herself be... charmed... by Lord Adora." Luna almost sighs in irritation at her wife's stubbornness but manages to catch herself. Luna doubts that Adora did anything that Catra didn't want too. They can't sentence Catra without giving her a chance to explain herself.

"Cy, we need to let her explain herself, otherwise who are we to call ourselves just rulers if we can't can't let our own daughter explain her side?" Luna asks.

"I can't imagine an explanation that would make what she's done okay." C'yra retorts with a scowl.

"Perhaps not, but we can at least understand what was going through her mind." Luna offers.

"I don't *want* to understand it." Luna shakes her head. It was clear that her wife wasn't even going to give her daughter a chance to say her side. She would have to keep trying at a later date.

"Fine, but at least tell her that she doesn't have to get rid of her kitten."

"Of course she doesn't." C'yra says. "But I'm not allowing Lord Adora anywhere near her ever again, even as the other mother or not."

"Then make sure to let her know that if... when she wakes up." Luna sinks back in her seat a little. She was worried for her kitten and it seemed like she was the only one who was.

"She *will* wake up." C'yra says. "But I swear to the goddesses above, if I see Adora... so help her."

"Then don't go into the infirmary for now." Luna sighs. She hopes that the others would at least consider letting her daughter say her piece but by their expressions that didn't seem to be the case. She especially didn't want C'yra *harming* Adora while she was here.

"Maybe," Bow starts. "If Adora is going to be here for a while we should... Can we really expect her to just stay in the infirmary?"

"She won't be here a while. As soon as C'yra is stable and fine, I'm going to throw her in the deepest, darkest, prison we have that no one will ever find her again." C'yra says dismissively. Luna shakes her head a little.

"I doubt Adora can do much moving around right now. She looks... frail." Luna says, ignoring her wife. "And there's a bathroom in there and snacks. I think she'll be okay to stay put."

"She looks frail?" C'yra asks.

"Didn't Glimmer already tell you that?"

"Yes, but *how* frail exactly?"

"Not... great." Luna answers her wife.

"Like she couldn't stand a slap?"

"C'yra, no. I'm not allowing you in there in the meantime." Luna says firmly. She couldn't believe her wife right now. She knew that she would probably be angry but she wasn't expecting her to let it blind her from the well-being of their daughter. Catra needed Adora right now, whether C'yra liked it or not. C'yra rolls her eyes.

"Fine." She says.

"That aside. Is there anything else that we need to talk about since we're all here?" Angella questions.

"Not unless you can think of anything else?" C'yra asks her wife. Luna holds her gaze for a moment before she shakes her head.

"No, not that I can think of right now." Luna says softly.

"Then I guess we just wait until the doctor says C'yra is okay, then we can get rid of our Horde problem once and for all." Luna stays quiet at that point, watching as almost everyone there seems to buzz with agreement and excitement at the thought of finally being able to capture the Horde Lord. She definitely wasn't in agreement. Just having had the opportunity to speak briefly with Adora showed her someone entirely different from who she expected the Horde Lord to be. She obviously knows that Adora needs to have some repercussions for what she's done, but not what the majority in this room wants to happen.

"Ironic, isn't it?" C'yra asks Luna. "C'yra will be the reason that we end the war by capturing the Horde Lord." Luna looks at her wife, staring into her eyes and trying to read what was in her gaze. It was clear that her choice would always seem to lean on punishing the Horde Lord over their daughter's well-being.

Luna stands up without a word, walking out of the meeting room. "I can't believe you right now, Cy." She whispers to herself once she's out of earshot. It really was like she was looking at a whole other person. Sure she had been disappointed at her daughter's choice of mate, but her wife had gone way too far in so many decisions through this entire thing since they found out.

Luna doesn’t get very far before she hears her wife call out from behind her. "Luna... where are you going?" She asks. Luna sighs and her tail twitches with slight irritation. She wants to be *alone* , clearly her wife isn’t going to support her through the trauma of almost losing their daughter because she’s so focused on killing her mate.

"On a walk. We're done with the meeting, no?" Luna asks stiffly and mostly rhetorically.

"We are," C'yra comes up beside her. "You want company?"

"No. I don't." Luna says firmly.

"No?" C'yra asks. "Is something wrong?"

"I'm trying to figure out where the woman that cared about our kitten went." Luna looks up at C'yra, sorrowful eyes locked on her. "I'm trying to figure out where my loving wife went. Because, right now, you aren't her." She shakes her head, turning around. "I need time to think."

"Time to think?" C'yra asks. Luna can detect a hint of panic, or *something,* in her voice. "To think about what? Luna..." C'yra takes Luna’s hand. "I do care about our little kitten, I'm trying to *protect* her."

"By what, C'yra?" Luna pulls her hand away. "By completely disregarding how she feels? By not letting her explain herself? By telling her to get rid of her kitten? I don't care if you didn't mean it, you still said it." She clenches her hands at her side. "You're so focused on capturing the Horde Lord that you're completely dismissing our daughter's well-being. You were ready to risk our daughter falling back into grief so long as you could get rid of the Horde Lord despite me warning you." She shakes her head. "I don't know where the loving, compassionate, woman I married went, but you aren't her. Where did she go, Cy?"

C'yra stops and sighs. "Luna, I love you, and I love our little girl..." She reaches her hands out to gently cup Luna’s face. "As soon as she's okay we can apprehend the *Lord* of the *Horde* .

Don't you want that?" Luna pushes C'yra's hands away.

"As soon as she's okay? You think she's going to be okay if we just go down the route that you want, C'yra?" She takes a step back. "You're not even thinking how any of this could impact our daughter. Not at all." Catra went into grieving when Adora was *alive* never mind if she actually died. And if they killed Adora? Catra would *never* forgive them.

"I... I hate her." C'yra says. "I *hate* Adora, why should I- I care for our daughter, of course I do, but I can't understand why she'd *ever* fall for Lord Adora."

"Do you though? Because right now, it doesn't really sound like you do." Luna looks at her with disappointment in her eyes. "Considering every decision you've made so far would have negatively impacted our daughter had I not stepped in."

"You act as though our daughter isn't snuggling our worst enemy right now."

"And you're acting as if that isn't the only thing keeping her stable and alive after what *we* did to her. After what *you* did to her." Luna says, anger peeking through in her words. C'yra laughs, though it's void of any kind of genuine humour.

"I can't believe you're blaming me." She turns away. "I'll go remove the Horde Lord right now if I have to."

"Wh- *C'yra* !" Luna's jaw drops. "I... You really aren't the woman I fell in love with anymore..." She looks away sadly. "I can't believe you. I thought you would care more about our daughter, but clearly you don't."

"So what? You don't love me anymore?"

"I do love you. But I don't recognise this... this *version* of you that you're acting as right now."

"One of us has to! I can't believe you're vouching for the *Horde Lord* !"

"I am trying to keep our daughter's well-being in mind because clearly that's only a passing thought to you."

"It's not a passing thought to me! I just..." C'yra stops. "Forget it, go for your walk."

"You just what, C'yra?!"

"Never mind." She says dismissively. "As soon as C'yra is better, I'm arresting Lord Adora. End of story." C'yra turns and walks in the opposite direction of her wife, flexing her claws as she goes. It wouldn't be long before she could get them into Adora.

Luna looks troubled before turning around and walking away from her wife. Something she never thought she would have to do when she married her. Luna didn't think Adora deserved a get out of jail free card but she didn't deserve to be executed in cold blood either - ambushed when she's at her most vulnerable. She deserved a *chance* . Luna was going to give it to her. For Catra. For Adora. And for everyone else.

* * *

A few weeks had passed since Catra was brought back to Bright Moon, Adora remained by her side through the entirety of it. For most of that time that she was there, Catra provided no response to outside stimuli despite Adora's attempts to encourage her to wake up. The doctor had said to consider the possibility that Catra may not mentally recover from her condition which was why she had remained unconscious despite being physically well.

It was a while before Catra's hand twitched in Adora's hold, squeezing weakly when she heard the blonde murmur her name. That had been the first sign of awareness that the Magicat had shown in quite a while. It was a miracle in itself, since the doctor had said not to get their hopes up with how long she had been in a comatose state for, but Adora was clinging to it.

Adora was watching the Magicat doctor checking Catra over. She hated to admit it, but Bright Moon wasn't too bad and she was enjoying being with Catra - even if she wasn't conscious. Adora was starting to get *comfortable,* which was probably a mistake, but her concern remained on Catra. "So she's getting better?" Adora asks the doctor. They turn to face her.

"Yes, Lord Adora, it seems like it might be working." They answer.

"But you're not sure?" Adora asks.

"No, we're not sure. Not even as a Magicat. Now, if you'll excuse me, I need to go speak to Queen C'yra." They bow a little, which Adora finds somewhat amusing since she didn't technically carry any authority here, before they exit the room.

Adora sighs and takes Catra's hand in her own. She presses a kiss to it before she detaches her cape and lays it gently over Catra. Adora had eaten a little more than usual, being around Catra helped, though she was still in distress. She was a little more steady on her feet as a result. Adora had taken Luna's warning seriously. She knew she needed to get her strength back even if just a little.

Catra purrs softly when Adora lays the cape over her and her hand gently holds the fabric in her weakened hand. Adora's eyes widen. She hadn't seen Catra do anything like that in *weeks* . Was it possible that Catra was waking up? Adora hears muffled voices outside the door that sound like Luna and the doctor speaking before the door opens to the infirmary. "Adora, if the doctor tells my wife that Catra is starting to respond, I need you to be prepared to run." She says as she quickly closes the door. "She's planning to imprison you as soon as my daughter recovers enough that she deems it safe. Once that happens, the rest of the Rebellion members are planning to slam this door down and drag you off."

"Wow..." Adora almost misses what Luna says, her attention focused entirely on Catra. "She just purred, did you hear that?" Adora knows that Luna couldn't have possibly heard it, but she also can't believe she heard it herself. She leans down and kisses Catra on her nose.

"She purred?" Luna asks softly. She sounds relieved but Adora can hear the hint of worry in her tone too. Adora finds it kind of funny that Luna is worried about *her. Who would've seen that happening?* "You heard what I said, right?" Luna asks. Adora sighs.

"I heard what you said, yes." She turns to look at Luna. "Unlucky timing that I left my sword at home."

"Yeah... I needed to at least warn you. I know that if they capture you, all it's going to achieve is breaking my Little One's heart." Luna whispers, walking beside Adora and petting Catra's hair gently. "I'm still trying to convince the others to not go through with this, but they're too focused on taking you down to see how this will hurt Catra in the long run. My wife especially, unfortunately."

"I can't blame them for hating me." Adora says. "But also... I do have a few choice words I'd like to say to them." Adora knew she had messed up, but at least she had the guts to admit it. The others were still parading around here like they weren't the reason Catra was fighting for her life right now.

"You and me both, but they're not really listening to me either. I'm trying my best, but every time I try to bring this up to my wife she shuts the conversation down."

"I don't want to leave Catra." Adora admits. "But... it's not in her best interests for me to be captured - not right now anyway." Being captured was unhealthy for herself *and* Catra. Adora didn't want to leave Catra, she wanted to stay by her side and help her out of this, but she had no choice. If the rebels got their hands on her she was toast and then Catra was also toast. Adora had made her peace with atoning for her mistakes, and she is more than okay sacrificing herself, but she is *not* okay sacrificing Catra. She *couldn't* let herself get captured.

"No, it's not. So make sure you get out of here as soon as you can." Luna says, patting her back gently. Adora looks at her. C'yra is the one who looks most like Catra, but Luna's gentle nature, her heart, that's all Catra. Sometimes Adora forgets that Catra is *pregnant* with *her* child. She's going to be a *mom* . That kind of freaks her out, but she's holding off on any major freak outs until she can talk to Catra about it. "I'm still trying to understand why C'yra chose you, but... thank you, for caring for her."

"I don't think she meant to." Adora replies. "It just... kind of happened." Neither Catra, nor Adora, had been planning for any of this to happen. Adora isn't even sure *when* she fell in love with Catra, she suspects it was very early on, just that it happened and they were here now.

"Just happened? I guess love can be like that." Luna says.

"Catra talked about finding the person she clicked with. Right before... you know..." Adora looks at the wound on Catra's chest. "She told me that was me." Adora thinks about all the times Catra had told her that she hadn't chosen a suitor yet because she was waiting for 'the one' and Adora had felt so *jealous* but she had decided to chalk it up to her grieving the loss of their arrangement. The reality was, she had been in love with Catra. She remembers them dancing on the rooftop together. Adora never believed in that stuff before but… Catra i *s the one* . She always has been.

"She did?" Luna looks up at the ceiling for a moment. "She talked to us about that too. Every time we tried to set her up with a suitor she'd say she hadn't found the one she clicked with. I guess she had, but she just couldn't tell us."

"I don't think Catra knew then," Adora says. "I think we were both in denial for a long time."

"Which is understandable considering who you two were supposed to be to each other."

"Enemies..." Adora looks at Catra's face for a moment. "Truthfully, Catra hasn't felt like an enemy in a long time."

"Yeah?"

"Yeah." Adora looks at Luna. "Pretty much since the first time we were together."

"Since the first time?"

"Ha..." Adora laughs, a little nervously, wondering how much details she should give away. "Yeah, we were enemies but... it didn't feel like it. We were laughing and cuddling and kissing, all since the first... nights... we were together."

"That's... Fairy-tale like when you say it like that." Luna says. Adora blushes a little. She's not sure Luna would feel the same if she were to tell her *exactly* what it was that they did together.

"I never thought about... uh... marriage and stuff. I thought that was a Princess thing, Catra said it wasn't and that I deserved to find someone like that. Kind of funny when you think about it now." Adora says. The Fright Zone doesn't have marriage but Adora would marry Catra in a heartbeat. Catra is the one. She is *it* for Adora, Adora doesn't want anyone else. Only Catra. Forever.

"It is kind of funny." Luna smiles a bit. "From the first night... I guess she found the person she clicked with in the most unexpected place. I just wish there was a way for you two to be together without the complications, but, well, you know."

"You... *want* us to be together?" Adora asks with surprise. She hadn't exactly been expecting to receive Luna's *blessing* .

"Look, Adora. I disapproved of my daughter's actions when I found out. I was disappointed. But my main focus will always be to make sure that she is happy and well-cared for by her mate of choice." Luna looks at Adora. "You're here, trying to save her, even though you could be arrested at any moment. You care for her, and you love her, and clearly she loves you too or she wouldn't even be responding right now. I just want my daughter to be happy." Adora smiles a little.

"I'm glad Catra had moms growing up that cared for and loved her." Adora says. Catra deserved that. Adora knows now that she would never want Catra to be raised in the Fright Zone, at the mercy of Shadow Weaver. Adora shudders. No, she was happy Catra got to grow up happy, safe and cared for.

"We tried our best." Luna sighs. "Though right now, I don't think everyone is being great."

"You can't really blame C'yra." Adora smiles sadly and kisses Catra's hand again.

"It's one thing being protective and then there's acting how she's acting right now."

"Didn't you get the memo? I'm the *evil* Horde Lord." Adora says sarcastically. "I just... I do understand where she's coming from." Adora does. She understands that C'yra is angry and betrayed but she would much rather she take that out on Adora and not Catra. Catra didn't deserve that. She deserved to have her mom.

"I got the memo and, from what I can see so far, that memo isn't accurate." Luna replies. "The thing is, her decisions are hurting C'yra and she's not even thinking about it. She wanted to imprison you before Catra started showing signs of waking. As soon as the doctor said she was physically stable."

"I-"

" *You* ." Adora turns to see Queen C'yra at the door and a select few other Princesses standing behind her.

"Me?" Adora asks incredulously, lifting a hand up to her chest.

"C'yra, stop. Don't do anything rash." Luna says and Adora raises her eyebrows. She guesses she may have impressed *one* of Catra's moms at least.

"Luna, I told you I was going to arrest Lord Adora as soon as C'yra showed signs of improvements." Adora looks behind her at Catra. The way she was buried into her cape sends a smile to her lips. She couldn't get arrested. Not yet. If Catra woke up and found out she'd been captured, there was no telling what would happen to her.

"Not to worry, I see I've overstayed my welcome, I'll just be going now." Adora says, stepping away from the bed to face the rebels. She hopes her cape and her scent on it is enough to bring Catra the rest of the way out of her grieving.

"Going? The only place that you're going is straight to prison." C'yra says, making a move as though to get ready to make her way over to Adora to handcuff her.

"C'yra, it's still too risky!" Luna calls out, standing in front of Adora. She has a hand behind her back, pointing at the window. "Improvement is great, but there is still a risk of Catra's improvement declining before she wakes up." Adora follows Luna's finger and sees her escape route, but she has a few things she wants to say before she makes that escape.

"You know, you're being a bad mom." Adora says to C'yra. "And I would know, I'm like the poster child for suffering at the hands of a bad mother." C'yra looks taken aback before anger completely takes over her features.

"Why, you little- Who the hell are you to talk to me about being a bad mother?! Guards!" Adora feels her anger spike a little and she *knows* she starts glowing - she even feels a little taller.

"And you're all being bad friends! You're mad at Catra? For what? Falling in *love* ? It's not her fault that she fell in love with the Horde Lord!" Silence falls upon the room as the glow fills the area. Everyone knew exactly where that power was coming from. Having witnessed the rampage that She-Ra had done on the battlefield last time, no one knew what to say at that moment, clearly too worried about triggering the Horde Lord to go off in an explosive rage. *Good* . Adora intended to use their hesitance against them.

"Look," Adora backs up towards the window, feeling herself calm down a little. She glances at Catra. "You can punish me, one day, probably, but you shouldn't punish Catra." Adora smiles a little as her back hits the wall. "Catra is... perfect, and good, and loving, and kind... and she... she deserves better. From all of us." Luna turns around to watch Adora, smiling softly when she hears her words. *Go* . She mouths to Adora, urging her to hurry out before anyone snapped out of their stupor. Adora smiles a little. Luna *liked* her. Adora considered that a major win at least. Adora spares one last glance at Catra before she levels the rebels with a look.

"Anyway, I really must be going, who knows what Scorpia is up to." Adora says. "Oh, Sparkles, you should definitely not follow me, otherwise..." Adora *hated* using this threat but she needed to not be followed. "I'll... use She-Ra."

"You don't have your sword."

"Who said I needed my sword?" Adora asks. She does, but they don't know that.

"How are you even-" Before Glimmer can finish her sentence Adora slips out of the window.

She laughs as she climbs down. She lands on the ground and sees the people of Bright Moon staring at her in shock. "Uh... hi." Adora greets. She sees the guards moving from the castle entrance. "Bye!" Adora turns and *runs* . Adora wasn't exactly in the best shape of her life but she had enough energy to at least make it to the Whispering Woods and lose them in there.

Catra will be okay... She *has* to be.

* * *

"That just happened." Luna comments, acting surprised that Adora had jumped out of the window.

" *Ugh* ! Where are the guards?!" C'yra cries out, opening the infirmary door to try to get the guards to chase after Adora. Luna was tempted to walk over to the window and check if Adora managed to escape, but she knew that would seem suspicious.

Instead, she chooses to sit beside Catra, her ears perk up at the quiet whimper that comes from Catra, as though she sensed Adora's absence at her side. It was possible that she actually did. "Oh, kitten... Come on, wake up." Luna pleads softly.

"She got away?! How did she get away?" Luna sighs as she hears her wife’s angry voice yell from out in the hallway. Luna was half impressed. Adora had been eating more but she was hardly in top shape, she’d still managed to evade Bright Moon’s guards.

"She's... very fast... my Queen."

"Go find her!" C'yra yells as she comes back into view in the doorway of the infirmary. Luna can feel her wife’s eyes land on her. "Did you... help her?"

"How could I have helped her, C'yra?" Luna doesn't even look up at her wife, too busy focusing on Catra whose soft look from earlier had turned into a grimace. "She literally tossed herself outside of the window." C'yra huffs.

"I can't believe she jumped out of a window."

"Me neither." Luna says absent-mindedly, concerned for Catra. "She's frowning again..."

"Take the cape off of her, I want to burn it."

"No." Luna says immediately, stepping between her wife and their daughter.

“No?”

"You-" Luna doesn't say anything. Instead, she grabs the cape and pulls it off of Catra. "Look." She points at their daughter's face which had twisted into a distressed expression as her mate's scent was pulled from her. "I'm not taking the cape away." She says as she places the cape back over Catra. Luna purrs softly to try to soothe her distress. *Hang in there C’yra, Adora will be back.*

"Fine. But as soon as she wakes up." C'yra says. "This room stinks of that bitch."

"Again, no." Luna deadpans. C'yra frowns at her.

"She ran away Luna!" C’yra says that like Adora wasn’t *forced* to run away.

"You're not taking the cape away from our daughter and that's final. Understood, C'yra?" Luna stands up against her wife. "You could see with your own damn eyes that that's what’s keeping our daughter stable since *someone* couldn't want until our daughter even woke up before trying to rampage in here." C'yra shakes her head.

"Fine." She sighs. "Tell me when she wakes up, I can't stand the stench of the Horde Lord."

"We'll see..." Luna murmurs, tending to Catra again. She pets her hair gently, trying her best to soothe her kitten as much as possible. C'yra stops at the door for a moment, turning her head towards her wife and daughter, her ear twitching before she takes off.

Luna sighs. Catra would make it. Luna really hoped that was true.

Chapter End Notes

Hope you enjoyed the pain -M

Well, Adora has the approval of *one* of Catra's moms... Maybe. And she left her cape :O! She loves that thing!! But she loves Catra more. -S

Come yell at us on twitter @ceolordadora and on CC! You can also find my tumblr (S) @sherasswordstrap

The Princess and the Lord

Chapter Summary

> "I'm starting to think... I am She-Ra.” Adora says carefully. “I mean, I know I am, but I mean, like she's a part of me. Rejecting her... isn't possible." Rejecting She-Ra has only caused Adora, and the people she loves, pain. It’s time she stopped trying to deny her and it’s time she learnt how to live with her, how to use her, how to make peace with the fact that she’s a Princess whether she likes it or not. Maybe the Princesses weren’t what Hordak said they were, but She-Ra is powerful - incredibly so - Adora needed to learn how to reconcile the two parts of herself she had tried so hard to separate, or else she would destroy not just herself but the people that she loved.

Chapter Notes

> Happy Friday and happy update day everyone !! This is another chunky chapter and I hope you all enjoy this chapter as much as we enjoyed writing it :)! Without further ado, Chapter 16

See the end of the chapter for more notes

Warmth surrounds her and a familiar scent rushes through her senses. It's comforting. It's *safe* . It was the scent of the one she missed so dearly. It was the scent of Adora. *Her Adora.* Catra's eyes slowly begin to open as she groans weakly from the dull pain in her chest. She wasn't sure where she was, her vision was still coming to, but Adora's scent was enough to make her purr.

"Adora..." Catra murmurs weakly. Catra could tell she wasn’t actually here, but her scent alone was comforting. Catra sees someone turn at the sound of her purr, the person’s ears twitch. They see Catra slowly trying to sit up and quickly rush over to her side.

"C'yra... Don't try to sit up, Little One." *Luna. Her mom.*

"M-Mom?" Catra flinches a little upon seeing Luna. She whimpers when the flinching causes a sharp pain to go up her chest. She was afraid of her mom; the heavy look of disappointment

and distrust from when they had found out about her relationship was burned into her mind. In fact… Catra was clearly in the infirmary of Bright Moon. *How did she get here?*

"It's me, yes." Luna says hesitantly as she helps guide Catra back down. "You opened your wound when you ran kitten, and you... you went back into grieving." Luna explains calmly and softly. *Oh. So that explained why Catra felt like she had been run over by a skiff.* Luna lifts whatever was draped over Catra further up her to keep her warm. Catra looks down.

"Adora... Adora was here..." Catra says softly, her hands grab onto the cape weakly. She nuzzles her face into the soft fabric, purring at her mate's scent. *Adora.* She has missed her scent so much. It clings to the fabric, which was unsurprising given how much Adora loved this thing, and she left it. Catra suddenly feels panicked and she looks at her mom, feeling her throat contract in pure worry for Adora's safety. "Did… Did you arrest her?!" Catra asks urgently. Luna stays quiet for a moment.

"No." She answers. "She ran back to the Fright Zone, but she was here, yes." Catra sighs in relief - and the relief was surely very evident on her face. They hadn't been able to get their hands on her mate. She had been so scared when she realised where she was and whose cape covered her. Still, Adora *had* been here.

"She was here?" Catra asks, looking at the red cape. It was somewhat worn with age but still a rich blood red. Adora had told her that she had been given it by Shadow Weaver and, while Adora's feelings for Shadow Weaver are undoubtedly complicated, the cape means a lot to her. It shows how far she's come, where she's been, where she's going, it makes her feel confident, and powerful, and, Catra isn't ashamed to admit, sexy as all hell - Hordak could never.

"Yes," Luna answers. "I knew her scent might be the only way to get you back." Luna explains as she looks at the cape. "She came to help you but had to leave when..."

"When?" Catra prompts. She knows in her heart that Adora would never leave her if Catra needed her. Luna sighs and presses her lips together.

"When C'yra and the rest of the Rebellion came to arrest her. She knew getting captured would hurt you, and do you no good, so she ran away back to the Fright Zone." Luna explains.

"They were going to capture her... While she tried to save me?" Catra asks, both horrified and angry. "That's... wow, how amazing to see how little I really mean to them now." She comments quietly, her ears drooping. They knew that Catra could *die* without Adora and they still chased her off. Catra feels her claws extend a little. Her family and friends, the people Catra had known her *entire life*, had little to no regard for her life apparently. Catra almost wants to scoff.

"C'yra thought you were getting better. She thought you only needed Adora's scent and not Adora." Catra frowns at her mother. Even if she was getting better, it was *because* of Adora and her own mother wanted to risk her life on a *maybe* , on the *possibility* that she didn't need Adora physically. *What if she had needed her?*

"I was getting better because I felt Adora." Catra deadpans, gently taking a sniff of the cape. Adora's scent calms her down only a little. Luna looks genuinely apologetic at least.

"I'm sorry, kitten. Adora wanted to stay. She came willingly, even though she was defenceless." Luna says. Catra sits up straight a little.

"What do you mean defenceless? What did they do to her?!" Catra asks in a panic.

"Nothing! Nothing." Luna reassures. "They wanted to," She admits. "Adora didn't have her sword, and she was in less than... ideal health. She was an easy target, but still fast enough to make it to the Whispering Woods to evade Bright Moon's guards." Catra breathes in with a shaky inhale.

"Adora, you idiot... You shouldn't have put yourself in danger." She whispers to herself, holding the cape close to her. Her mother saying Adora was in less than ideal health also worried her a great deal. "I miss you, so much." Catra purrs in distress as she holds the cape to her nose.

"You're awake." C'yra appears in the doorway of the infirmary room. Luna turns to look at her wife with a scowl. "I agree, Adora is an idiot. And lucky." C'yra walks further into the room. Catra tenses up immediately upon seeing C'yra. Her hands cling to the cape tighter.

"I am. And don't call her that." Catra protests. Only *she* can call Adora that. Catra *never* means it in a malicious way, Adora is *incredibly* smart, just a huge dork, but that's not how C'yra means it.

C'yra doesn't say anything as she steps up beside Catra's bed and next to her wife. There is obvious tension between the two of them as well as the room as a whole - the elephant in the room sits ignored. "You said it, I just agreed."

" *You* don't get to call her that." Catra murmurs, trying to shift away from C'yra. Distress filling the air as the other grew closer.

"Is that reserved for her *lover* ?"

" *Cy* ." Luna scolds. "She just woke up." Catra whines, even more distressed at the coldness in C'yra's voice. She stays quiet, instead covering her head with Adora's cape to try to use her scent to calm down to some extent. She can't even look at her *moms* right now. She *never* thought she would ever be in this position.

"Are we not going to talk about the fact that you've been fucking the Horde Lord behind everyone's backs?"

"Cy, she literally woke up a minute before you walked in. Is now really the time?" Luna asks before Catra could speak.

"It's not like you want to listen to me anyway. You wouldn't give me a chance to explain before." Catra says quietly. C'yra huffs and her ear twitches as her tail flicks.

"Not much to explain, C'yra. You've been sleeping with *Lord* Adora. You let everyone believe you were being *kidnapped,* when you were really in the Horde Lord's bed. We were worried sick every time you were 'taken'. And it was all *lies* ." Catra winces a little. Catra had felt bad about the lying. She knew that her moms in particular were worried whenever Catra was

‘kidnapped’. They were worried Adora was… Catra feels bad for that, she does, but their reaction shows *why* she did what she did.

"There's so much more to explain than just that if you would just let me explain, mama." Catra peeks up from beneath the cape, her eyes looking at C'yra with a pleading gaze. "None of you would have let me see her if I told you who I was seeing."

"Of course we wouldn't have!" C'yra snaps in disbelief. She reaches out and grabs the cape. "I should burn this like I burnt her clothes the first time you came back here smelling of her."

" *No* !" Catra cries out in distress, almost hyperventilating at having the single piece of Adora taken away from her. "No, don't take it!" She grips it as tightly as her hands would allow - though it wasn't very hard since she was still hurt. Catra was not about to let C’yra take the only thing she had of Adora.

C'yra pauses at Catra's outburst, staring into her eyes with a *hard* gaze. "Cy, Adora is C'yra's *mate* , she's still in distress. You don't want to send her back into grieving, do you?" Luna asks. C'yra reluctantly lets go of the cape before she scoffs.

"I can't believe this." C’yra says. Catra almost cries when C'yra let's go of the cape, her hands holding it close to her face as she snuggles into it. She closes her eyes, trying to take deep breaths to calm herself down.

"Don't take this from me too."

"I'll take more than a cape from you." C’yra says ominously.

"W-What?" Catra asks weakly, looking at her mother in fear. Catra has never been afraid of her moms but she is now. She is *terrified* of what C’yra will do to Adora, or to *her*.

"Lord Adora," C'yra says, "She's weak. And if you think I'm ever going to let you see her again... No. It's over between you two."

"No... No, no, no! Please don't hurt her, mama! Please don't take her from me!" Catra begs, trying to sit up, the stitches on her chest pull as she does so. "Don't hurt her!"

"Why shouldn't I? She hurt *you* ."

"Don't hurt her, *please* ." Catra begs. "I can't lose her. I *need* her, mama."

"Need her? You have to be kidding me." C'yra says, exasperated. "Lord Adora is a *bad* person, she's... *corrupted* you. Did you forget about everything that she did? How could you... How could you ever be with a woman like that? She's been *destroying* Etheria, and hurting you and the entire Rebellion!" C'yra shakes her head. "I don't care if you need her. *Etheria* needs her gone."

"She isn't a bad person! And she didn't corrupt me! She was misled!" Catra yells desperately. "If you would listen and let me explain, you'd realise why I love her!" C'yra straightens up, going still from the tips of her ears to the tip of her tail.

"Love her?" C'yra laughs in disbelief. "You don't love her. Lord Adora is *not* someone you love."

"I love her... I love her so much, mama. I love her even with all of her mistakes, because I know she didn't know any better, it was all she knew." Catra felt like she had been shoved off of a cliff. She was falling, hurtling to the ground, and there was nothing and no one there to catch her.

C'yra scoffs and looks at her wife. "Do you hear this?"

"Yes, I hear what she's saying, Cy. I'm right here. And maybe our daughter knows more about Adora than we do." Luna purses her lips, watching C'yra's expression.

"The only thing she knows is whatever lies Lord Adora has been whispering to her in her bed."

"Or, she may have gotten to know her outside of the whole Horde Lord thing? Cy, you've always been the one to consider many possibilities, you have to consider this one too." Catra watches as her moms… debate. They're not arguing, or yelling, but the tension between them is palpable. Catra isn't sure she's ever seen them that way before.

"Who's side are you on?" C'yra asks. Luna sighs.

"I am on the side that gets everyone to communicate properly, if possible. I'm trying to make sure our daughter doesn't go into grieving again, while trying to get *you* to not make any rash decisions." *Was Luna… **defending** Catra and Adora?*

"I'm not being *rash* ." C'yra protests. "Lord Adora is the leader of the Horde! Did people forget that? Not only that, but she's almost killed our daughter *twice* . I will do, whatever I have to do, to protect our daughter. Even if *you* won't."

"Cy, do not, and I will fucking repeat, do *not* , ever accuse me of not doing what's best to protect our daughter." Luna says, rage laces in her voice despite how calmly she was talking. "I understand that Lord Adora is the leader of the Horde. But I also know our daughter isn't stupid. I want to know exactly what happened to try to figure out what we should do next instead of acting without thinking." C'yra closes her eyes for a moment, Catra watching, her tail swishes with agitation. It was clear that she felt the anger in Luna's tone but she was also incredibly stubborn.

"If you wanted to protect her, you'd agree with me."

"If you want to protect her, you need to stop and listen to her so we can know exactly what went down before making any decisions." Luna rebuttals, keeping her voice steady. "You already hurt our daughter with a rash choice of words earlier, Cy. One time is enough, you need to listen."

"I'm not going to stand here and listen to how she *thinks* she's in love with Lord Adora! She's brainwashed her! Even if she believes it, it's not true." C'yra seethes. "For all we know, this is some plan of Adora's to impregnate our daughter so she'd be safe from us retaliating for sleeping with her! Well it's not. I'm not going to let her get away with it."

"You can't determine our daughter's feelings, Cy. She's her own person, and you have to understand that." Luna replies, being the calmer one between the two of them right now - despite her obvious frustration. They were talking like Catra wasn't even there. "It is unlikely that Lord Adora brainwashed her. If that had really been the case, why in Etheria would she put herself at risk to save our daughter?"

"I don't pretend to know the plans of evil women, Luna." C'yra says.

"Then don't pretend to know our daughter better than she knows herself. She's trying to communicate with us, but you're not listening."

"I'm not doing this right now."

"Doing what?! Listening?! Yeah, I can see that, Cy." Luna yells, finally annoyed at her wife's stubbornness. Catra has been yelled at only a couple of times by Luna, she has to be *significantly* frustrated to actually snap - usually it was when Catra put herself at risk.

"I'm not going to argue with you over this. C'yra is *never* going to see Lord Adora ever again. My decision is final. And if I ever get my claws on her, so help me."

"Cy, you're being more stubborn than your father when you told him you wanted to propose to me."

"That is nothing like this! You weren't a *war criminal* !"

"No, I was a lowly peasant healer who was in way over her head when she fell in love with the Princess of Half-Moon." Luna crosses her arms. "I'd said it's pretty similar in which your

father didn't want to listen to you say you were in love with someone outside of royalty."

"That was different. You *healed* people, you didn't hurt them." C'yra protests. "I'm not stopping C'yra from being with Lord Adora because she's not royal, but because she's the literal leader of the organisation that is responsible for the death of my parents, that you so happened to bring up, not to mention countless other people." Luna hums softly.

"I'm not saying the situations are the same. Of course the circumstances aren't the same. What I'm trying to say is that you would have wanted your parents to give you a chance to tell your side, right? Regardless of the situation. Why can't you do the same for our daughter?" Luna asks. Catra's eyes widen. At least *one* of her moms sounded like they were willing to hear her out.

"Because I don't trust her. Not with this." Catra's ears press back against her head. She wasn't expecting it to hurt so much to hear her mom say that she didn't trust her but it did - it hurt a lot actually.

"Cy, she's a young adult. She can make her own choices. She can tell us how she feels. We need to give her a chance."

"No."

" *Cy* !"

"I'm *not* , Luna. She should've thought about that before she opened her legs for the Lord of the Horde." Luna's mouth drops open for a moment. Silence falls over the infirmary. Catra wants to disappear below Adora's cape.

"C'yra D'liruth the Second. Did you seriously just say that? Without letting our daughter say her piece?" Luna asks. Catra really just wants to disappear.

"Did you really just use my full name and title?" C'yra asks.

"Yes, I did! Because you're acting like a child right now."

" *I'm* acting like a child?" C'yra asks. "I'm keeping our daughter safe, that includes protecting her from herself."

"Oh my gosh, Cy. You're so damn stubborn. To protect her, if that's really your intention, you need to hear what she has to say! Otherwise it's just you doing whatever you want!"

"And that's why I said I'm done." C'yra turns on her heel and leaves out the door.

"Cy! We're not done, get your behind back here!" Luna calls out, turning back to Catra apologetically. "Will you be okay, kitten?" Catra shrugs silently, not really knowing how to answer. She hadn't been expecting to see that argument, she hadn't expected to hear her own mother say that about her, but she also hadn't expected to be defended either. Luna purrs a little. "I just need to talk to Cy, she's not thinking clearly."

"Sure, whatever." Catra murmurs, knowing that C'yra wouldn't listen. She knew her mom's stubbornness - that's where she had gotten hers from - but C'yra was far more stubborn than Catra was. She knew it was going to be a hard time to change her mind.

Luna frowns a little before she sighs and exits towards the door. "Oh... Spinnerella, Netossa. Did you see my wife?" Catra's ears perk up when she hears those names.

"She stormed off down towards the War Room." Netossa answers.

"Thanks." Luna gives them a tight lipped smile before she slips by them.

Netossa and Spinnerella exchange glances as they enter the infirmary and come towards Catra's bed. "You're awake." Netossa says with surprise.

"We're so sorry we weren't here Catra." Spinnerella says, looking sad. Catra doesn't care, nor does she blame them. She knows they had important business to attend to. She wonders if the Rebellion knew that the wives had been covering for her or if Double Trouble had kept that out when they had exposed her.

"It's fine." Catra says dismissively. "You wouldn't have made much of a difference being present anyway. Not with what she said and not with the looks they gave me."

"We knew about Lord Adora and made our peace with it a while ago." Netossa says. "Just give the Rebellion time."

"You knew, but at least you didn't tell me to get rid of Finn, or say you wouldn't help care for them, or that they'd be disowned." Catra says flatly. She felt numb and uncertain, she didn't know *how* to feel.

"They said that?!" Netossa asks, looking appalled.

"C'yra did, and no one else said anything against it, so..." Catra shrugs, ears pressed against her head. Her eyes were filled with sadness as she hugs the cape close to her chest. "Mama wouldn't even listen to me." Spinnerella gives Catra a sad look and lays a gentle hand to her shoulder.

"I see Adora was here?" She asks curiously, glancing at the cape.

"She was. But she had to run because of ma… *C'yra* was going to arrest her while I was still unconscious. Even though I needed her." Catra feels anger now, hot through her veins. She had every right to be *angry* , every single right, because her own mothers had put her life at risk for what? Revenge? Retribution? Whatever. Catra deserved better dammit.

"Coming here was a pretty ballsy move." Netossa comments, crossing her arms over her chest. "Maybe the Horde Lord isn't who everyone thinks she is after all."

"She's so much more than what she's shown in battle. I just wish others would listen to me." Catra sighs. Adora, the big softie and dork, Catra wanted people to see *that* side of her, rather than the Lord figure they had built up in their heads.

"The fact she came shows how much she cares about you." Spinnerella says gently.

"I know. I miss her... I love her so much. But C'yra thinks I'm brainwashed and refuses to even let me explain myself." Netossa looks around for a moment.

"Have you talked to Adora?"

"How? I don't have my com-pad. I think C'yra might have taken it." Catra replies.

"Oh, wow, the Rebellion really has been busy." Netossa says, looking at her wife.

"I can see that. Maybe you can borrow one of ours?" Spinnerella suggests. Catra presses her lips together.

"I'm not sure that'll be enough. Plus, I'm not sure when C'yra will come back." Catra points out. Netossa sighs.

"So Adora knows you're pregnant, she came here to help you, apparently she didn't look too good… Things are kind of a mess." *That about sums everything up, yeah.*

"Yeah, I know. But I don't know what to do. I want to go to her, to be with her, but I know C'yra and the rest of the Alliance will rain fire on her and the people of the Fright Zone if I do." Netossa and Spinnerella look at each other for a long moment.

"We... We could cover for you?" Spinnerella suggests. "But not for long. A day at most, twelve hours at least. Enough for you to go to the Fright Zone and show Adora you're alive and to talk to her." Catra's eyes shine with hope and she nods.

"Could you please? I have to go slow because of my injury but... I *need* to see her." That confirmed that the Rebellion didn't know about Spinnerella and Netossa's involvement but, after this, they would. This would be the last time that they could cover for Catra. One final time to be with Adora.

"I'm sure we can keep everyone distracted long enough." Netossa says. "We'll say you're resting again. Besides, I'm sure Adora misses her cape." Catra smiles, holding the cape close.

"I'm planning to keep the cape. It's mine now." Catra says, purring. Netossa raises an eyebrow but laughs.

"Sounds like *someone* who steals my sweatshirts." Spinnerella rolls her eyes at her wife and gently slaps her arm.

"Adora loves that cape, but I'm willing to bet she loves you more."

"Yeah, I think so too." Catra purrs softly, holding the cape up to her nose and taking in the comforting scent. "I just hope C'yra doesn't take it from me when I'm asleep."

"I'm kind of surprised she hasn't already if I'm honest." Netossa comments.

"I screamed at her not to."

"Do you want to heal a little before you go see Adora?" Netossa asks.

"That would probably be the best idea." Catra says with a small nod. She could wait a little while so she was mostly healed before she went to see Adora - that made sense.

"How's Finn?" Spinnerella asks curiously. Catra places a hand on her stomach.

"They're okay, according to the doctor. All of the damage was inflicted on me."

"That's good that they're okay." Spinnerella says with a smile.

"Yeah, I'm glad they're not hurt. I was really worried." Catra doesn't know what she would do if she lost Finn too. She imagines it would probably be *bad* .

"We'll help you keep cover. We know you've been through a lot recently. It'll be nice for you and Adora to sort your stuff out." Catra nods at Netossa.

"I would really appreciate that." Catra whispers as she rolls over and curls into a ball. She was going to see Adora again. After so long… She needed to be held by her, she needed to *be* with her. Netossa and Spinnerella were willing to expose their involvement in keeping Catra's cover just so she could see her mate one final time. Catra owed them big time. For now, she was just going to heal up a little more and wait for her opportunity.

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It takes a little while. They have to time it between when both C'yra and Luna are needed back in Half-Moon. Catra had opted to stay in Bright Moon and, though her moms had looked reluctant to leave her alone (for two very different reasons), they had left for their kingdom to carry out royal duties and such. Catra huffs out a little laugh. She didn't even consider it her kingdom anymore. No one other than Spinnerella, Netossa and her moms had come to see her. Catra assumed Glimmer was probably especially pissed, and all the other princesses probably felt the same. Everything was a mess, and yet the only thing Catra wanted to do was run into Adora's arms.

It had been so long since she last saw Adora, not including the battle of Bright Moon, it had been *months* . Catra missed her so much, and the cape had been a clear message: *if you survive, I love you.* Catra was itching to finally get to talk to *Adora* . She wanted to kiss her stupid face again.

Truthfully, Catra was also a little nervous. Adora hadn't looked so good when she had seen her last, and Catra worried that she had only gotten worse. She places her hand to her chest. Magicats heal quickly, she had rested and been treated enough that the wound on her chest had pretty much healed - she'd probably still have a scar for the rest of her life however.

Catra walks into the Fright Zone completely freely. The soldiers greet her with surprise but also warmth. Catra smiles at them. It was weird that the Fright Zone was being more welcoming of her than her own home but the Fright Zone had been pretty much entirely okay with Catra since the beginning. Catra was also wearing Adora's cape, it was a little long on her, so she'd had to pin it up a little to keep it from dragging on the floor, but Catra understood Adora's strange obsession with the thing; it made her feel *important* and *powerful* . Lord Adora's cape was a pretty clear message to the Horde soldiers if they didn't already know (they did): Catra was Adora's and she was to be treated like their Lord.

Catra enters the throne room after greeting the door guards. She finds the space eerily empty. The Fright Zone has become familiar to Catra, which she hardly expected it ever would. It's almost like a second home to her now. She looks at the empty throne which is highlighted by a beam of light streaming from *somewhere* . It shines, the blood red Horde symbol standing out and, if Catra squints, she can make out where the throne has been repaired - *wonder how that happened* . Catra remembers her first time with Adora, she remembers being bent over that throne, sat in it, knelt in front of it… Gods, Catra has missed Adora in more than one way.

Ignoring her horny, Catra turns away from the throne. If Adora wasn't on her throne, or in the throne room, then she must be in her bedroom. Catra makes her way over, following the familiar path until she reaches Adora's bedroom door. She pauses for a moment. She was about to see Adora again after so long. She was about to get to touch her again, kiss her, *be* with her, so long as that's what Adora wanted too. Catra's heart was pounding so hard she could hear it in her ears and it was rattling her ribs. *Here it goes* . Catra knocks before she enters Adora's room. She doesn't know what she expected but what she sees wasn't it.

"Adora? Are you here?" Catra asks as she enters the bedroom. The room was kind of musty, and not in the typical Horde sense, it was like the room had had continuous occupation for several days, the air was stuffy, overcome with carbon dioxide and not much oxygen, Catra decides to *not* close the door behind her for the time being. Her eyes scan the room, which was just as neat as usual, though it seemed gloomier and darker than normal, and her eyes land on the bed. "I see you curled up under the blanket, can you come out?" Catra asks, with a little amusement.

"Great... Now I'm hearing her voice." Adora's voice comes out a little muffled but the *sound* of her *voice* . Catra has missed Adora terribly. Her entire body reacts to it, she feels like Adora's voice could put her under a spell, she shivers and has to stop herself from jumping on top of the curled up blonde and rubbing her scent all over her. Adora can be dramatic sometimes, but she didn't know she could brood this hard.

"You'd be looking at her too if you took the blanket off of your face." Catra points out fondly. Adora doesn't move. Catra sighs and walks into the room. She places the items she had in her hands down and walks over to the bed. She grabs Adora's blanket and pulls it off of her, hands on her hips as she lets the blanket fall to the floor. She *expects* Adora to see her and realise her mistake but, instead, she stays curled up in a ball, her face buried in her pillow.

"Please, leave me alone." Adora begs softly. Catra's heart contracts a little to see Adora in so much pain. She doesn't look too good, but she doesn't look as awful as Catra had been expecting her to - she's sure she has Scorpia to thank for that.

"Nope, no sulking. I brought food and I want snuggles." Catra states firmly. Adora lifts up a little and turns over onto her back. She blinks up at Catra and Catra's heart soars to the heavens above when she looks into those baby blue orbs. Adora still looks beautiful. Also the hair? Sexy as hell.

"Are you a ghost?" Adora asks. "Have you come to haunt me?" The question is absolutely ridiculous but also heartbreaking at the same time. Adora clearly hadn't been sure Catra would pull through before she was forced to flee - she thought Catra had *died* .

"Why would I be a ghost?" Catra pinches Adora's arm. "Come on, sit up, dummy. You need to eat. I brought you food since *apparently* you haven't been eating right."

"Ow..." Adora frowns. "I didn't know ghosts could pinch people." Catra rolls her eyes.

"That's because I'm not a ghost, idiot."

"That sounds like something a ghost would say."

"Do you need me to smack you?"

"I doubt you can." Catra can't believe that Adora actually believes she's a ghost. *Well, if she needs irrefutable proof* … Catra grabs Adora by her shirt, lifting her up and full on slapping her across the face.

"Yes, I can. Now, food?"

" *Ow* ! What the-" Adora's words die on her tongue as she clearly realises something. "Wait you're... you're *alive* ?!"

"Yes. Been trying to say that for the last few minutes." Catra laughs as she gently rubs Adora's slightly red cheek. She hadn't slapped her exceptionally hard but she had slapped her hard *enough* .

"But I saw you die… Twice."

"I didn't die." Catra pauses. "Okay, maybe a little. But I'm okay." Catra reassures softly as she gently caresses Adora's jaw. She's *touching* her, *finally* . Catra has the impulse to pin Adora to the bed and rub her scent all over her, to finally re-establish their bond that has been put under so much strain; she fights it, giving Adora time to process.

"Catra..." Adora pauses for a long moment, just staring at her, before she grabs Catra around the waist and drags her into a bone crushing hug, pressing her ear to her chest so she could hear her heartbeat. It makes Catra feel warm all over to finally be in the arms of the woman she loves after so long.

"I'm so sorry!" Adora sobs. Catra looks down in surprise. She *never* thought she'd see the day that Adora *cried* . Catra knew that Horde soldiers thought expression of emotions like that was weak, but there Adora was with wet cheeks and bluer than usual eyes.

"Hey..." Catra whispers, hugging her close and purring softly to try to soothe her. Adora sniffles. "I'm okay. Thank you for the apology, Love. Are you okay?"

" *Me* ?! You're the one who almost died! More than once." Adora hugs her closer that Catra finds it somewhat hard to *breathe* . "Why are you being nice to me?" Adora asks sadly and Catra's heart aches in her chest. She gently wipes at Adora's tears with her thumbs and kisses her softly on her cheeks. She hates to see Adora in such distress.

"Because I love you, idiot." Catra says fondly. Adora is still crying, her lower lip out in a sad pout, she looks adorable, but also incredibly sad, maybe even guilty. "And I wanted to make sure you're okay."

"You... You still love me?" Adora asks. It's a ridiculous question to Catra. She would *never* stop loving Adora. The world could end, she could die, or anything, and she would still be madly in love with her. She will *always* love Adora, forever. The moons would explode before Catra stopped loving Adora.

"Of course I do, dummy. You love me too, don't you?" Catra asks softly. "Netossa and Spinny told me you said that."

"They told you that?" Adora asks as she rubs her face. She reluctantly lets go of Catra - which Catra is kind of thankful for, Adora may have lost a little muscle mass but she is still *strong* . Plus Finn was probably getting crushed by their mom's bear hug.

"She did." Catra confirms, stroking her fingers through Adora's short locks. "When I woke up after the sword incident. And… You left your cape, that told me everything I needed to know." Adora loves her cape. Leaving it had been as much a declaration of love than Adora actually saying the words which she had not said to Catra herself.

"You're wearing it." Adora reaches her hand out and rubs the fabric between her thumb and finger. "It suits you."

"It does, doesn't it? I thought we could use it for our kitten." Catra says with a purr. Adora half smiles and Catra feels her entire body soften. She has never had whole body reactions to

someone before, yet here she is. Adora. She is *everything* to Catra.

"Are they okay?" Adora asks, looking at her bump. Catra nods softly.

"Yeah. They didn't get any of the damage, so they were okay." Catra means both by Adora's sword and from her distress. She was lucky, and she should really avoid stressful situations, but her entire situation currently is stressful - not when she's with Adora though. Adora is the only place she feels completely *safe* .

"I... When did you find out you were pregnant?"

"About two and a half weeks after I went back." Catra answers hesitantly. She was worried that Adora might be angry that she kept it from her, but the blonde simply nods. She looks so *sad* . She's lost muscle mass, she looks a little skinnier, her hair is short and Catra doesn't mean this in a mean way but she smells. Plus the entire atmosphere in here reeks of depression. Catra can also *feel* how deep of a depression Adora is in with their connection now re-established.

"How did you find out?" Adora asks.

"About Finn? Oh... I... I started getting ill. Everyone thought it was because I was in distress. And while that had some part in it, it wasn't the only reason."

"Finn… Is that the name you chose?" Adora asks. Catra nods in answer. "I like it." Adora smiles before her face falls again. "I'm *really* sorry Catra." Catra shakes her head.

"I'm sorry too." Catra whispers as she sits down on the bed and hugs Adora.

"Why are *you* sorry?" Adora asks and Catra almost laughs at how Adora clearly finds that ridiculous.

"For making you feel as though I was using you." Catra clarifies. She's referring to what Adora said to her on the battlefield and before that, when she had broken her heart. Adora had thought that she was using her to bring an end to the Horde, that she had never loved her, or that Catra had been sleeping with her to trick her into something. She had never wanted Adora to feel like that.

"I... No you... I was an idiot. I know you wouldn't do that." Adora shakes her head and Catra smiles softly at her.

"Hey, you weren't an idiot, just misled and afraid. Trauma does that to people and, while it doesn't make it okay, it does explain your actions." Catra says calmly as she takes Adora's hand in her own and kisses her knuckles. "Plus you apologised for it as soon as you saw I was okay." Catra smiles and ruffles her hair. "I know what Shadow Weaver did. *She* used you, in order to hurt me and yourself. I need you to do something for me, okay?"

"What? Anything."

"I need you to stop listening to her, okay? Everything she's ever said or done, even before we met, has been to hurt you and to control you." Catra pets her hair. "I want you to free yourself from that." Adora pauses for a moment before she hugs Catra again. Catra purrs at the affection. The next words that leave Adora's mouth cause Catra's heart to almost burst from her chest.

"I love you, Catra."

It's everything that Catra has been waiting to hear. The words wing their way to her ears, they twitch as she lets every syllable and tone of Adora's voice and words sink in, deep, right in the centre of her chest. She feels a warmth flood her entire body, she closes her eyes as she feels tears of pure happiness fill them. She has *waited* . She would have waited a thousand years more for Adora to be ready to say those words, but she's here. She said them. *Adora* ***loves*** *her!*

She opens her eyes again to see Adora's beautiful face right in front of her. Goddesses, she loves Adora more than she has ever loved anything in her entire life. "I love you too, Adora." Catra closes her eyes and purrs softly. "I was cleared to walk around by the medic and I asked Spinny and Tossa to cover for me."

"Yeah?" Adora tugs on Catra's arm and pulls her down onto her bed, lying her down next to her. "Can I kiss you?" Catra so wants to say yes to that, but Adora needs to do a few things first.

"Not until you get up and have a shower." Catra kisses her cheek before turning around and sitting up. "You need to take care of yourself first."

"Are you saying I smell?"

"Love... You *do* smell."

"I... Really?" Adora sniffs her armpit - Catra cannot believe that Adora is still this huge of a fucking *dork* . "Oh... Maybe I do." She smiles a little sheepishly and Catra laughs softly.

"Yes, you do. So do you want to shower first, or eat first?" Catra asks.

"I'll shower first. I'm kind of gross... and I want to kiss you."

"You get a kiss after you shower *and* eat. Now, off you go." Catra watches as Adora swings her feet over the side of the bed and pauses. She sighs and rubs her face.

"I don't understand why you don't hate me. *I* hate me."

"I saw how you looked when you realised what you did, Adora. You were… *horrified* . You were acting on instinct, fuelled by Shadow Weaver's lies. If there's anyone that I hate, it's her."

"Catra... I don't want to fight anymore." Catra looks at Adora curiously. She doesn't know what exactly Adora means by that, if she means she doesn't want to fight Catra anymore, or

if she just doesn’t want to fight in a war she was born into anymore.

"So what do you want to do?" Catra asks gently.

"I don't know... But I don't want to fight you, or…” Adora trails off. “I don't really care about what Hordak wanted anymore. Everything I've been taught is a lie, the Horde, *everything* . I just... I want to be with you. That’s all I want." Catra smiles a little at the confession.

"Adora, this decision falls onto you now. The Rebellion hasn't attacked because the Horde hasn't attacked. You get to make the choice." They can make *peace* . Catra… She isn’t sure that is entirely possible given her mother’s feelings on Adora, but they can *try* . The Horde backing down would be a step in the right direction at the very least.

"I'm tired..." Adora confesses quietly. The words are spoken so softly that even Catra’s enhanced hearing almost misses them. Catra looks at Adora. She *looks* tired. Adora has never really *lived* . She grew up in an army, as a *soldier* , she went from fight to fight. Catra grew up in a war too, but nothing like Adora. Catra had good food, she had friends, she got to explore Etheria, she had people who loved her and took care of her, sleepovers, laughing until she cried. Adora had none of that.

"I know,” Catra says, gently petting her jaw. “Babe, let's continue this conversation after you've showered and have food in your stomach, okay?"

"Yeah... Yeah, okay." Adora stands, wobbling a little on her feet. She goes to her bathroom and closes the door behind her.

A moment later Catra hears the shower turn on. "Dork..." Catra shakes her head fondly. She turns her attention back to Adora’s room. Although it was as neat as usual, it could use a little TLC. She grabs Adora's sheets, taking them off of the bed and changing them with fresh ones. The room had aired out by now and Catra closes the door again to give them some privacy. She tosses the dirty sheets to one side - she'd need to send those to the laundry room to get them cleaned later.

She sets about unpacking the food she brought for Adora and then looks around. "Okay… Food is good to go, as is the bed for sleep, Adora's showering, good." Catra sighs happily as she sits down on the clean sheets. Clean not just for sleeping in- Catra shakes her head. She couldn't get distracted by *that* , she was here to spend time with Adora, however that may be. She hears the shower turn off and awaits the return of the woman that she loved.

* * *

Adora stands under the water for a while, washing away all the grime that had built up over the days of her not showering. Maybe that was gross but she really hadn't been in the place to take care of herself - except for the times where Scorpia literally dragged her into the shower. She stands in the stream of cold water, letting it not only clean her body but also clear her mind. Catra is here and she is *alive* . Adora hadn't been sure she'd ever see Catra alive again. Sure she had been getting better before Adora had had to leave, but she didn't know if Catra would recover all the way without her. She *was* here. And she didn't hate Adora.

Adora grabs her soap and starts lathering up her body as she thinks. She was beyond happy that Catra was here, but so much had changed, she wasn't sure where they stood. They had confessed their love but Adora wasn't sure that was *enough* . She didn't expect forgiveness, nor did she really want it, but she wasn't sure what Catra wanted either. Love does not always mean a person will stay with you after you *stabbed* them - even if that had been an accident.

Adora finishes rinsing herself down. She turns the water off and then steps out of the shower, she grabs a towel, drying her hair off, and then wraps it around herself. She exits back into her room, noticing the clean sheets that Catra was sitting on."Did you... Did you change my bed?" Adora asks, raising an eyebrow.

"Mhmm, figured that you'd be happier getting into a clean bed after showering. But first, food! I brought you different things, I hope you like them." Catra purrs as she opens the containers. "So I brought rice, some chicken, a salmon fillet and some pasta." Adora frowns as she crosses her room to her drawers. She hadn't expected Catra to take care of her after everything.

Adora drops her towel to the ground. She feels Catra's eyes on her and she smirks a little at the attention. Catra's attraction to her is what got them into this. Well, *both* of their attractions, but Adora is pretty sure Catra never would have slept with the Horde Lord if she wasn't seriously attracted to Adora.

Adora grabs new clean clothes, pulling a shirt over her head and fatigues onto her legs. "Sounds good, I'll eat anything." Adora says, and she really would. Her appetite had suddenly come back to her.

"Good!" Catra smiles and purrs - *Gods, Adora missed that smile and purr so fucking much* . She feels significantly better now that she's clean and Catra is here. Catra… She's standing there, her tail wiggling back and forth, her expression soft and in *Adora's cape* . Adora lets herself think about an alternate universe where they get to be together leading the Horde, a universe where they don't have to be in this weird middle ground state. Catra is still as beautiful as she ever has been - maybe even more with that baby bump of hers. Adora moves towards her and Catra's tail stills as her ears perk forward.

"Can I kiss you now?" Adora asks, breathless from Catra's body. She wants to *touch* her, to kiss her, *finally.* She just wants to feel Catra's lips against her own, it's been so long.

"I said *after* you eat." Catra says and Adora pouts. She just wants to take Catra into her arms, shower her in affection and kiss her. "Food first."

"Did Scorpia tell you to baby me?" Adora asks lightly.

"Nope. She just told me that you weren't doing well. I'm the one that decided to baby you because I love you."

"If you loved me, you'd kiss me."

"If you loved me, you'd make sure that you took care of yourself first because I want the woman I love to be healthy."

"I'm perfectly healthy." Adora protests, crossing her arms over her chest. Catra gives her a look that Adora knows she's about to lose this argument.

"And have you eaten today?" Catra asks. Adora scowls at the ground.

"... No..." Adora admits quietly, like a kid caught with their hand in the cookie jar.

"And it's the afternoon. So, you're eating first. You're not allowed to argue." Adora laughs a little at Catra. Adora guesses this is her life now. She'll do anything that Catra tells her to do.

"Yes ma'am." Adora agrees.

"Good. I love you." That almost knocks the wind out of Adora's lungs. Some part of her still doesn't believe that someone like Catra could love someone like Adora. She doesn't know why, or how, Catra loves her but she does apparently; Adora doesn't want to hurt Catra ever again. Still, Adora isn't used to being in love, she doesn't know if she knows *how* to be in love, and she is *terrified* of ever hurting Catra again.

"You keep saying that." Adora mumbles.

"It's the truth, dummy."

"I love you too... I'm just... I'm not used to it, I guess." Adora admits. She feels awkward about it. *What kind of person doesn't know how to love?* Adora *has* loved, she knows she's in love with Catra, that she has been for a while now, but knowing and actually being in love are two different things to her. Adora isn't sure how to do it, how to prove to Catra that she loves her, or how to act. Catra gives Adora a soft smile and Adora feels instantly soothed.

"I know, and that's okay. You can learn." She smiles and takes Adora's hand. "You learned to be soft, you learned to be tender, and caring, and sweet. Obviously you're not going to unlearn everything that you were ever told right away, but, Adora, you deserve love too." Adora smiles a little and squeezes Catra's hand, kissing it gently. She can *learn* to be in love.

"So," Adora starts. "The Princesses know about us, huh?" Catra gets a dark look on her features and her ears press against her head. Yeah, Adora didn't expect that to be a *good*

thing. Catra stays quiet for a long moment.

“Yeah,” Catra answers. “They all hate me. And I hate that they won’t listen to me. They’ve known me my entire life, and they called me a traitor and won’t let me tell my side of the story.” Adora looks at the ground.

“I’m sorry.” Adora says quietly and then Catra hits her shoulder. “Ow!”

“Shut up,” Catra rolls her eyes as she grabs Adora by her shoulders and pushes her down onto the seat in front of the food she had spread out on Adora’s desk. “It’s not your fault. They chose to react like that.”

“Yeah but… they reacted like that because it was *me* who you were seeing.” Adora points out. “If you had fallen for anyone else then none of what happened would have happened.”

“Nuh uh,” Catra chastises. “Don’t start that shit with me Adora.” She squeezes Adora’s shoulders. “Stop blaming yourself. You didn’t force me to fall in love with you, that was my own decision. I love you, and that’s all that matters. The Rebellion, and especially my mom, can get over themselves.” It doesn’t stop Adora thinking it’s her fault but she doesn’t want to argue with Catra right now. “Besides you’re my- Uh… you know.” Adora smiles a little.

"You can say mate Catra." Adora says fondly. Catra stays quiet for a moment.

"You know?" She asks quietly.

"Netossa told me. And Scorpia said something about a bond." Adora explains. She leaves out the fact that she can feel it too.

"Oh." Catra blushes slightly. "Yeah, we... We're mates."

"Are we? What does that mean? Like, how did that happen?" Adora asks, turning to face Catra now. She's read a little but Adora still isn't entirely *sure* about it all. She feels strongly for Catra, *very* strongly, like she would burn down the world if Catra asked her to, but she still didn't really know how they got here or what being mates really meant.

"Uh... It was unconscious." Catra explains. "I think we bonded before we realised it because we fell in love, even though neither of us knew it then."

"Is that why you used to... You started... scenting me?" Adora asks.

"Yeah..." Catra answers. It's so *cute* . Catra almost looks embarrassed by that fact but Adora had loved every second of it. She loved that Catra had marked her as hers the same way Adora had marked Catra as her own too. They belonged to each other.

"I always thought that was adorable." Adora admits.

"You did?!" Adora laughs at Catra's obvious surprise.

"Yeah! You rubbing your cheek against me? It was so cute. Not to mention the *purring* ." Adora really loved it when Catra purred - plus the idea that Adora was covered in *Catra's* scent was a nice thought.

"I liked scenting you.'

"Wanna do it again?" Adora asks. Catra's tail lifts up.

"Yes, please!" Adora laughs.

"Go ahead." Catra purrs happily as she throws her arms around Adora and nuzzles her cheek and her neck.

"Mine." Catra mumbles. Adora doesn't protest anymore and hums in agreement.

"Yours." Adora replies as Catra's short fur brushes against Adora's skin. "You are so *cute* ."

"So are you, and I love you." Catra replies and Adora *beams* . After a moment, Catra stops rubbing herself against Adora but she carries on purring. It's *nice* . It's beyond nice, it's *perfect* . Adora holds Catra by her waist, and runs her hand up her back. She presses her other hand to her stomach.

"I can feel them." Adora whispers. Her eyes glow for a moment. She could *feel* Finn. Maybe it was because they were made by using She-Ra's magic, maybe Adora had some connection to them. "She-Ra baby."

"Not She-Ra baby, *our* baby." Catra corrects gently. Adora appreciates that, and she looks up at Catra.

"Conceived with She-Ra's sword." Adora says.

"It helped, but *we* made them." Catra gestures between them and Adora smiles. They sure as shit did. They made a baby. Adora was more than willing to make another one too, but maybe another time.

"I'm starting to think... I am She-Ra." Adora says carefully. "I mean, I know I am, but I mean, like she's a part of me. Rejecting her... isn't possible." Rejecting She-Ra has only caused Adora, and the people she loves, pain. It's time she stopped trying to deny her and it's time she learnt how to live with her, how to use her, how to make peace with the fact that she's a Princess whether she likes it or not. Maybe the Princesses weren't what Hordak said they were, but She-Ra *is* powerful - incredibly so - Adora needed to learn how to reconcile the two parts of herself she had tried so hard to separate, or else she would destroy not just herself but the people that she loved.

"Are you okay with that?" Catra asks gently.

"I... I think I am." Adora says. "I spent all this time fighting her but... I think it's time I just accept her."

"Okay... I love you."

"You really keep saying that." Adora beams. "Part of me still thinks this is a dream."

"Well, it's not." Catra smiles and grabs a set of images off of the table that Adora hadn't noticed before. "Here, it's the ultrasound."

"Wow..." Adora says with amazement and then, after a beat, "wait... Where are they?" Catra giggles and points at different areas.

"This, right here, is their head. This is their hands that are slowly forming." Catra explains. Now if you asked Adora, those just looked like a bunch of smudges, but she wasn't about to say that to Catra - that was their *child* .

"Wait, so this is a picture of your... you know?" Adora says.

"Of my...?"

"You know, where babies go?" Adora frowns. "Sex education isn't great in the Fright Zone, everything we learn is self taught and we definitely don't have born babies here." Adora gestures to Catra's stomach.

"I..." Catra looks mildly concerned before sighing. "Okay, yes, it is where babies grow. They grow in the womb, Love. They're not a baby yet, but they're growing to be one. In a few months, we get to meet them."

"They look just like you." Adora teases, holding the picture up.

"They're a fetus! What are you talking about?" Catra yells but she looks mildly amused rather than offended. Adora laughs.

"I don't know, call it a hunch."

"Sure, dummy." Catra laughs and shakes her head. She playfully shoves Adora's head. "Now eat. Stop delaying the food eating."

"Are you staying?" Adora asks hopefully.

"For tonight. But I do have to return home... to face everyone."

"Face everyone?" Adora asks with a little concern. Catra sighs.

"I have to… talk to people. I need to convince them that I didn't betray them. They've been assholes to me, but they are my family. Even if they're not willing to give me a chance, I'm willing to give *them* a chance to come around, you know? Bow already tried defending me when everything happened. I know some of the others will come around too." Catra explains. "Glimmer… the Horde killed her *dad* , I know she's probably pissed at me the most out of the Princesses."

"You don't just want to stay here? Write a letter?" Adora asks. She'd happily have Catra in the Fright Zone with her.

"I can't do that, Love. You'd be chased down."

"I have a feeling that'll happen either way." Adora says with a nervous laugh. The Rebellion knows she's been sleeping with Catra, there's no way the Rebellion just let that slide. If Catra

stayed in the Fright Zone though… Catra is right. Not only would she be chased down, the war would erupt again in order for the Rebellion to get their ‘stolen’ Princess back.

"Maybe, but it's better that I'm with them and can try to talk them down."

"Whatever you think is best." Adora says.

"It’s going to be complicated, and hard, but it's worth it. *You're* worth it." Catra says. Adora’s heart swells. She’s not entirely sure she is worth it. She doesn’t feel worthy of Catra’s love, she doesn’t feel worthy of the sacrifices that Catra has made just to love her. She wants to be, she wants to be worthy of Catra more than anything, and she damn well *will* be.

"You... I can't believe you still love me." Adora says, a little breathlessly as she gazes up at Catra in wonder.

"Is it really that hard to believe?" Catra asks and Adora scoffs.

"After what I did? Yeah."

"Okay, yeah, that's fair."

"Do you have a scar?" Adora asks.

"Just a little one. Magic healed most of it." Catra answers.

"Can I see?"

"You sure?"

"Yeah. Show me." Adora nods. She sees Catra hesitate for a moment before she nods and slowly peels her shirt off. It's not very large, but there is a scar in the middle of her chest.

"See, it's small." Catra whispers. Adora leans forward and examines the scar closely. She sighs and presses a kiss to it.

"I'm so sorry." Adora whispers, she feels tears welling up in her eyes again. Adora did that to her. To *Catra* . The woman that she *loves* . She *hurt* her.

"I know. I'm okay though." Catra grabs Adora's chin, gently bringing their lips together. *Finally* . Adora gets that kiss she's been longing for. Adora pushes up a little to take full advantage of the kiss. Catra's lips taste just as sweet as they used to, they're just as soft as Adora remembers. The kiss stays chaste by their standards but it still manages to leave Adora completely breathless. They part after a moment. "I'm healed, and I'm here, and I'm safe." If Adora could purr, she would have purred at that.

"I'm still half convinced you're a ghost, but that slap *really* hurt." Adora jokes lightly. "Maybe I asked to see your scar because I just wanted you shirtless." Adora moves her hands up Catra's bareback. Her touch feels hot, like she was touching something she shouldn't be touching, but she had missed it. She had missed touching Catra so much. She sighs hotly as she feels the building tension and heat in the room and inside of her.

"We both know that you love being face first in my boobs, so I'm not surprised." Catra teases, pinching her cheek - it was like she was oblivious of Adora's growing desire, or she was ignoring it. "Not that I mind you seeing me naked."

"I'm *intimately* familiar with you being naked." Adora says with a proud grin.

"I know you are. That's why I'm carrying your kid." Catra says but Adora ignores her. Instead she presses kisses down Catra's stomach, wrapping her arms around her. She was just relieved that she could even kiss Catra like that, even if Catra said no to going further, Adora would be sated with getting to touch and kiss her like this.

Catra purrs loudly at the sweet kiss Adora had just given her and when Adora looks up at her, her pupils are blown wide. "Another one?" Catra asks.

"Another kiss?"

"What else could I be asking for?" Adora rolls her eyes but kisses Catra's stomach again. She hums against her stomach.

"I'd… really love to make love to you." Adora confesses.

"I wouldn't mind if you did." Catra replies quietly.

"Really?" Adora asks with surprise. She hadn't expected Catra to want that too. In fact, part of Adora was amazed that Catra wasn't repulsed by her.

"Yeah." Catra confirms. That's all that Adora needs.

"Catra..." Adora looks up at Catra like she was her entire world - and she *is* . "Okay... Bed? With me?"

"What would you like to do, Love?"

"I just... I want to be with you. I want to go slow and... loving." Adora confesses. She feels her desire building but also her longing, her love, she wants to prove to Catra how much she loves her, she wants to take care of her. She wants to make *love* to her.

"I would love that." Catra replies, her hand gently stroking Adora's hair. Adora stands and picks Catra up gently, she walks her to the bed and lays her down in the sheets before joining her. She presses soft kisses along Catra's jaw before pecking her on the lips.

"No sword, just me... Is that okay?" Adora asks. She wants to *feel* Catra, to bury her fingers in her and never leave.

"That's more than okay." Catra smiles lovingly, her hands gently caressing Adora's cheek before pulling her in for a kiss. "I love you."

"I love you too," Adora murmurs against Catra's skin. She moves her lips to her neck, pressing hot open mouthed kisses there. "So much." Adora is considerably more gentle than she has ever been before. Instead of their usual fast and hard routine, she's soft and slow, and gentle, and somehow it's almost more sensual.

"You... It makes me so happy to hear you say that." Catra sighs and closes her eyes. Adora can tell that Catra is loving every second of this just as Adora is loving it. She's *touching* Catra. *Finally* ! This is everything Adora could have hoped for and more.

Adora moves down to Catra's breasts, kissing her way there. She makes a point to kiss her small scar before she begins to suck on her left breast, using her right hand to massage Catra's other breast, because, even if they were going slow and gentle, foreplay was still important - plus maybe Adora liked boobs, Catra's boobs specifically, sue her.

Even so, she's still much more tender than she had been previously, she kisses her without the intention of marking her because she doesn't need to, not anymore. They belong to each other. Adora doesn't have to prove that anymore, or lay territorial claim to Catra. She is hers and vice versa.

"Where did you learn that?" Catra asks softly, a happy smile on her lips as she lovingly brings Adora's face to her lips. "You're doing amazing."

"I think I know how to touch you by now, Catra." Adora responds with a grin.

"I know, but you're being so sweet... It's so nice." Catra purrs happily, kissing Adora again.

"I... It's how I feel." Adora kisses Catra on her cheek and sweeps her hair out of her eyes. "Does that make sense?"

"Yeah, I think it does." Catra purrs more and nuzzles Adora. "The look in your eyes is different."

"Is it?" Adora asks, raising an eyebrow.

"Yeah, you look... softer. Not as guarded." Catra explains.

"Because I am. This is different. We're... making love, not just fucking." Adora blushes a little as she says that but Catra simply smiles at her.

"Yeah. Yes we are." Catra replies. Adora goes back to sucking on Catra's breasts. Her thumb brushes over her erect nipple and Catra *whimpers* . " *Ah* , Adora… they're… they're sensitive." Adora can *see* that.

"They're bigger than usual." Adora comments but she doesn't hold back in her touching and Catra *squirms* under her. She *clings* to Adora's shirt, her claws scraping along Adora's skin. Adora has never seen Catra so affected by Adora simply touching her boobs.

" *Fuck* ," Catra moans and she *mewls* . "Pregnancy tends to do that." Catra says and there's a hint of amusement in her tone but it's almost drowned out completely by how *turned on* Catra is. Adora is so glad she got Catra to take her shirt off.

Adora continues to give attention to Catra's boobs. She often spent a long time there but, given how this was clearly doing something for Catra right now, Adora was more than happy to stay there longer. Catra's reaction was insane, she was practically *writhing* with pleasure. She lets out a sound that almost resembles a *sob* as she angles her hips up in an attempt to grind against Adora's thigh that was between her legs. "Good kitty," Adora coos as Catra's back arches. Catra groans as Adora laps at her breasts happily. Her hands tighten and with every sound Catra makes, Adora grows wetter.

“ *Adora* !” Catra gasps. “Fuck! Red!” Adora immediately stops and pulls back in worry. Catra’s eyes are screwed shut, she tenses up and her claws slice the fabric of Adora’s shirt to dig lightly into Adora’s skin. Catra was *panting* and her tail was lashing wildly behind her against the mattress.

After a moment, Catra slowly calms down. “Did you just…?” Adora questions in pure amazement, her eyes sparkling.

“Nearly,” Catra says, a blush colouring her cheeks. “Fuck, that… that was *really* intense.” Adora *loved* every second of that. She could totally get Catra off simply by sucking on her boobs. *That was awesome!* She smirks smugly and Catra huffs. She shoves Adora’s face playfully. “Get that smirk off your face.” Catra demands before she covers her own face with her hands, hiding her scarlet cheeks.

Adora gently grabs her wrists, pulling her hands away from her face and then Adora kisses her jaw. “Catra… That was really fucking hot.” Catra gasps as Adora cups her breast again and kisses her hot on her lips.

“Take your fucking clothes off,” Catra demands as her hips rock. “Inside. *Now* .” *So demanding.* Adora grins as she leans back to pull her shirt over her head. She tosses it to one side. Catra clearly decides Adora is taking too long and her claws extend to slice away Adora’s pants. Adora looks at Catra with raised eyebrows.

“Guess I’m going to have to accept that I’ll never own a piece of clothing that isn’t a victim to your claws.” Catra rolls her eyes.

“Shut up and hurry up.” Catra says and Adora laughs.

“Patience Kitten,” Catra softens and Adora assumes it’s at Adora using her affectionate nickname on her again after so long. “Where’s the fire?” Adora asks as she pulls Catra’s pants down and off. Catra seems happy to be undressed at least but she frowns up at Adora. Adora simply smiles.

She grabs Catra's hand and kisses her palm. It starts innocently enough and then Adora deploys her evil plan. She starts sucking at Catra's fingers. Catra's breath hitches and Adora smirks as she laps at Catra's fingers. She presses that spot she learnt about in her readings that causes a Magicat to extend their claws and then she delicately uses her tongue to suck on them. " *Adora…* " Catra says and her words are more like a breathy moan. "You're such a tease." Adora resents that accusation - though it's not *unfounded* .

Adora stops after a moment and then she hovers over Catra as she presents her own fingers to Catra. "Care to help me out here?" Catra stares at her before she opens her mouth. Adora should not be this giddy to have her fingers sucked on but she *so* is.

Adora carefully pushes her fingers into Catra's mouth as Catra stares up at her with an intense look in her eyes. Adora feels Catra's sharp fangs graze her skin and she shudders. Once her fingers are in, she looks into Catra's eyes as Catra *sucks.* Adora thinks it's kind of amazing how much that turns her on. She's reminded of one of the first times they did this, the time when Catra sucked on her strap as Adora rutted into her mouth mindlessly. This isn't as rough. Adora used to think she needed the roughness to feel something, but she was *wrong* . This is *perfect* .

Catra's tongue feels amazing and it moves expertly around Adora's fingers. Her intense gaze grows lustful as Adora shudders, using her arm to keep herself upright and from collapsing. *Should this really be this much of a turn on?* It's kind of gross when you really think about it, but Adora does so enjoy being coated in Catra's fluids - if Catra heard her say that, she would probably call her an idiot.

Once Adora is satisfied she pulls her fingers out of Catra's mouth, coated in her saliva. She moves to lie beside Catra, laying on her side as Catra rolls on her side to face her. Adora grabs Catra's leg and throws it over her hip as she shuffles closer. "Are you ready?" Adora asks softly. Catra nods eagerly.

"Been ready since you sucked on my tits, Adora." Adora laughs at that but moves her hand down Catra's body, listening to Catra's soft gasps. Adora takes her time despite that. She tangles her fingers in the longer fur that leads down to Catra's pussy, her fingers grazing over her slick folds.

"You're such a good kitty for me." Adora whispers and Catra whimpers. Adora moves her fingers to part Catra's pussy before she moves her fingers through her soft folds. She's *finally*

touching Catra, after so long of *not* doing that. Catra moans softly and moves her hips.

“I’ve missed those fingers of yours- *ah* …” Catra pants softly as Adora presses her fingers to her clit and *rubs* . Catra lets out a moan of relief to finally be touched in a way that sparks pleasure through her, and Adora smirks. Catra’s eyes are closed but her ears are perked *up* in attention and Adora can see how happy she is to be touched by her. “They’re perfect.” Catra murmurs in a sigh.

“ *You’re* perfect.” Adora whispers back. Catra huffs a little. Adora knows that Catra probably doesn’t believe her, just like Adora doesn’t really believe Catra when she calls her beautiful, but it’s true. Catra is *perfect* . She is everything that Adora could want and more and she wanted her back! Adora was probably the luckiest person on Etheria - not to mention that Catra let her touch her like *this* .

Catra grabs Adora’s wrist and then guides her fingers down. Adora smirks a little at Catra’s obvious impatience but also the guiding. “What do you want, Kitten?” Adora asks quietly. Catra looks up at her and leans forward to kiss her gently. The kiss is so soft that it takes Adora’s breath away.

“Inside, please.” Catra says against Adora’s lips.

“Anything for you.” Adora responds. Slowly, tentatively, Adora works a finger into Catra. Catra gasps and clings to Adora’s shoulder. Catra practically sucks her in, liquid heat surrounds Adora’s finger and she easily adds another. Catra’s walls are like velvet around Adora’s fingers and Catra clearly hadn’t been lying about the fact she’d almost gotten off before because her slick allows Adora to practically glide her fingers in and out. Adora has *missed* this.

Adora curls her fingers, hooking them into that sweet spot right at the front of Catra’s walls. Catra mewls and she leans forward to bury her nose into Adora’s shoulder. “Harder Adora, faster… I need *more* .” Adora isn’t one to refuse Catra. She follows her instructions, making her thrusts steady and firm which has Catra’s toes curling. “Right there…” Catra purrs. Adora drinks in Catra’s response, she has wetness spilling into her palm, but Adora doesn’t much mind - she takes it as a physical sign of Catra’s desire.

Adora is so happy that they're even here. Part of her expects to be woken up from a dream. Catra is here and she is *alive* and Adora gets to *touch* her. Adora hadn't been sure Catra would survive, now she was making love to her… Funny how things turn out.

Adora wants to tell Catra that she loves her, whisper it until she believes it, but for some reason her jaw feels tight and she can't seem to speak. Catra just clings to her as Adora fucks her with her fingers. Adora stretches her thumb to Catra's clit, and presses, and Catra starts purring uncontrollably. " *Yes!* " Catra calls out as she rolls her hips and Adora feels the resulting wetness coat her fingers.

"I got you Kitten," Adora coaxes gently. "Cum for me?" Adora asks. It takes a few more curls, stroking and swipes over Catra's clit but she's cumming soon after Adora's question. Catra tenses up and Adora feels her release in her palm as she continues to work Catra over.

Adora only stops when Catra taps her shoulder. She pulls her fingers from Catra and wipes them on the sheets so she can cup Catra's sharp jawbone and tilt her head up to kiss her passionately on the lips. Catra was purring heavily and Adora was loving everything about this. "You're… really… good… at that…" Catra says between kisses. Adora smirks as she slips her tongue into Catra's mouth. Catra moans as she pushes back against Adora's lips and Adora lets her.

Adora lands on her back against the mattress as Catra climbs on top of her. Adora is used to naked Catra but she's not entirely used to a naked Catra sitting on her stomach. Adora can *feel* her heat pressed against her hard stomach. Adora sits up a little to meet Catra's lips. "I want…" Adora trails off as she kisses down Catra's jaw to her neck.

"What?" Catra asks, tilting her head back to allow Adora access to her neck. "What do you want, Adora?"

"I want…" Adora doesn't even know how to express it. "I want to become *one* with you." Adora says. "I just… I want to be with you, completely, forever, I want to take care of you-"

"Let me take care of you." Catra says softly. She pulls back and her eyes sparkle. Her tail swishes behind her as she waits for Adora's confirmation. Adora wants to be vulnerable with Catra, because she *trusts* her, she knows Catra would never hurt her. Maybe it's time she let her.

Adora nods and Catra’s resulting smile makes everything feel like it’s okay. Catra pushes her back again and starts kissing her softly on the lips before she peppers kisses along her jaw. *Fuck* . Adora has missed Catra so much. Getting to hold her like this, under her hands, it’s almost enough to make her cry - *again* . Catra purrs and moves lower and Adora suddenly feels panicked. She gently tugs on Catra to get her attention.

"Catra, before we..." Adora trails off. "You know I'm happy for you to touch me, I mean, you've gone down on me before." Adora says, sitting up a little. "I just... I'm not... I've never..." Adora doesn't know why this is so hard. It's Catra, it *should* be easy. "I've never really been a fan of... penetration." Adora mumbles. "I... I mean, I've done it, but it's kind of... painful... and uncomfortable... it's why I usually prefer to use my strap that rubs me just right, and I get to pleasure you at the same time." Catra reaches her hands up and gently cups Adora's face. Adora sighs and kisses her palm. "I love you, and I trust you, and I want to give up control to you... but... can you use your tongue?" Catra laughs softly.

"Adora, I can do whatever you want me to." Catra says. "And whatever you don't want me to do, I won't."

"You're okay with that?" Adora asks.

"Of course? What kind of shitty person would I be if I forced you to do penetration when you don't really like it?"

"I have liked it before though..." Adora says. "I thought you'd think I was weird." Adora looks away briefly. It's also one of the other reasons, beyond her need for control, that Adora likes being on top. She enjoys pleasuring Catra way more than she enjoys pleasuring herself. Catra's tongue feels *amazing,* and Adora more than enjoyed her going down on her that one time.

Sex with Catra is good, it's the best, it's how they ended up in the shit together, but Adora also... She *doesn't know!* And it *frustrates* her, she just doesn't like being penetrated, but she still gets horny, exceptionally, to the point she craves that relief, but it's more in the way of her imagining what she can do to Catra than what Catra can do for her.

"Adora," Catra says gently, bringing Adora back. "You're not weird for not liking something, I can go down on you, Hot Stuff, no problem." Adora laughs a little but she still looks and feels anxious.

"You're not disappointed?" Adora asks. Catra smiles at her.

"Why would I be disappointed about going down on you? I'd love to." Catra asks and Adora lets out a small huff of laughter.

"It's not... I don't know," Adora is frustrated with herself more than anything. "It's not like I've never done it before? I have... to myself... but never... deeply... tongues are soft and comfortable, yours is kind of textured, and it feels... *fantastic* ." Even when Adora does touch herself, however, she usually focuses on her clit.

Adora doesn't know what her point is anymore and she's kind of losing it. "I don't know... It's weird."

"It's not weird, Adora, stop saying it's weird." Catra scolds and her tail twitches at the tip. "So you're a giver rather than a taker, and you prefer to not be penetrated? There's nothing wrong with any of those. It's called *preferences* , and they can change at any time. If you say you don't like something, but later say you do, that's completely valid and understandable." Adora doesn't know what she did to deserve Catra.

"I seriously love you." Adora says as she leans in to kiss Catra.

"I love you too dummy, now are you really okay with me going down on you?" Catra asks and Adora smiles so wide she might actually get stuck that way if she wasn't careful.

"Please do." Adora is *really* glad she showered.

Catra kisses her and it's slow, and nice, and Adora feels her entire chest *heat* up. She feels butterflies in her stomach when Catra rolls on top of her again. She's nervous, and she doesn't

know why. It's not like this is their first time. Except... it kind of is. It's their first time doing this, aware of how they feel about each other - which makes it just like a first time when you think about it.

Adora's hands must tremble because Catra pauses, pulling back a little. "Safe word, remember?" Catra asks, her eyes glow in the dim lighting of Adora's room and Adora feels herself relax a little. She nods in acknowledgement. "I know what you like, and what you don't, and I'll only do what you like, I promise. Don't get in your head about it too much, okay my Lord?" Adora swallows at the 'my Lord' that slips from Catra's lips. Catra gently pokes her forehead and Adora sighs.

"Okay," Adora shakes her head a little. "Okay, I'm ready." She knows Catra will stop if she says ‘red’, and she trusts Catra - she really does.

Catra smiles sweetly and Adora's eyes lock onto her tail which wiggles behind her. Adora feels herself relax even further. Catra is still adorable, and she's alive, and she *loves* Adora - even after everything. "Catra... just call me Adora, please?" Catra's eyes soften and she purrs lovingly as she nuzzles the side of Adora's face. It tickles but Adora loves it. She told Catra that she loved her purring because it was cute but it was more than just that. She loved that Catra had a tell. Sometimes Adora struggles to distinguish the feelings someone is having, but when Catra purrs, she knows *exactly* what that means.

"Adora, *my* Adora." Adora nods as Catra's fingers slide into her short hair. It had grown since but was nowhere near as long as it once had been. Catra scratches and Adora's eyes flicker closed, a satisfied sigh escaping her lips.

"Yours... Your Adora." Adora confirms.

"I love you, Adora." Catra whispers as she kisses Adora on her jaw. Adora feels like she might cry. Her lip trembles a little, her hands land on Catra's hips and squeeze softly. *She's such an idiot.* There's no way she's going to cry and ruin this whole thing.

"I love you too." And they've said this a lot to each other since they've seen each other again, but Adora *means* it. She means it so much she can hardly bear it. Her chest feels close to bursting; she's so in love. She thinks she fell in love with Catra the moment they met. She thinks... She understands why people call it falling in love. It feels fast, and scary, but Adora

has Catra to catch her, every time, and she's *never* going to give that up again. She loves her too much.

Adora has a plan, a plan she can't tell Catra, but a plan nevertheless. Because she can't live without Catra. She doesn't *want* to.

"Still into fangs?" Catra asks playfully and Adora rolls her eyes.

"Yes, I still find your sharp teeth hot."

"Mmm, what about my claws?"

"Still a masochist Catra." Catra snorts and her tail thumps against the mattress in amusement - *she's so fucking cute.* Adora moves one of her hands and holds the base of Catra's tail, gently scratching her fingers through the fur and Catra arches her back in response. Adora smirks smugly and Catra huffs in response.

"No getting me off until I get you off." Catra scolds leaning down to kiss Adora's neck.

"I can get you off just by stroking your tail?" Adora asks. "... That's kind of hot."

"You're a fucking dork."

"Don't be mean, I've been going through a lot recently."

"You're still a dork." Catra snorts against Adora's neck and Adora laughs as it tickles her. She's about to give another smart ass comment back when Catra opens her mouth.

Adora's breath hitches as Catra's sharp *fangs* nip at her skin. Adora moans as Catra bites her and *sucks* . She moves her thigh between her legs and Adora eagerly takes her invitation to grind against her thigh. Adora has never felt out of breath during sex, but she's not exactly in the best shape of her life right now, and every touch of Catra is taking her breath away.

She's already slick with want, especially with Catra's teeth scraping over her neck, right over her pulse point. She gently trails her claws down Adora's face. Adora shudders and moves her hips more. "Touch me, Catra, please." Catra smirks against Adora's skin.

"Patience Adora." Adora wants to protest that Catra is using Adora's lines against her but her protests die in her throat when she feels Catra's somewhat rough tongue press against her nipple.

" *Fuck* ! Catra-!" Adora chokes on another moan as Catra makes another swipe. *Fuck, her tongue feels* ***so good*** . Adora *squirms* under Catra. She's so happy she decided to let Catra lead this time.

Catra is good with her tongue, Adora can admit to that. She rakes those sharp fangs of hers over Adora's erect nipple and Adora thinks she might cum from the pressure of Catra's thigh against her core, and Catra's mouth sucking on her tits, but she manages to keep a handle on it.

Adora trails her hands down Catra's back, her blunt nails digging into her skin and short fur. "Catra, fuck, please..." Adora says. She finds it somewhat amusing that she used to find it so difficult to say please to Catra, she used to refuse, and now she's said it about three times in less than an hour.

Catra hums and the vibrations feel *fantastic* against her nipple. Catra looks up at her, her mismatched eyes *gleam* and Adora wants to kiss her - she wants Catra's mouth in three different places at once. Catra knows what Adora wants, Adora can tell that she knows, but she's clearly not finished with Adora's boobs. She sucks, and she licks, and she *marks,* and Adora is a writhing mess under her.

Catra *finally* moves down. Adora feels her stomach flip flop nervously as the woman's lips kiss down her body. Catra kisses her stomach, which was still hard and toned but less so due to her months of missing meals, she slides down to her thighs and kisses along the inside.

"Are you still okay with me using my tongue?" Catra asks. Adora pushes herself up, resting her weight on her arms so she can look down at Catra.

"More than sure, stop stalling." Adora says, lifting her hips. "If I don't have your tongue on me in about five seconds I'm going to explode." Catra laughs and Adora's heart feels full again. Adora quickly falls back down onto the mattress when she feels the first swipe of Catra's tongue.

"Holy-" Adora covers her mouth with her hands as she hits the mattress again. She forgot how good Catra's tongue felt. It was hot, and wet, and a little *rough* . Adora likes things rough as a general rule, pain has always given her great pleasure, but Catra's tongue against her clit, directly, without much of a warning, is almost *too* much.

She grabs Catra's hair as a loud moan escapes her lips and she tugs gently. "T-Too much..." Adora whimpers. Catra hums and pulls back from Adora's clit - though not from her pussy.

Adora's tight grip in Catra's hair relaxes a little and she sighs happily as Catra licks her tongue through her folds. Magicat tongues are usually rougher than your typical Etherian tongue, designed for light grooming of themselves, it feels *incredible* but Adora wasn't ready for it to be directly pressed to her clit - she needed the build up.

Catra goes slower now, being more exploratory with her tongue so Adora could get used to the sensation. Adora moans softly, pressing her hips up to begin a lazy grind against Catra's tongue. Catra lets out a purr and the resulting vibrations cause a spike of pleasure to shoot through Adora. " *Fuck* !" Adora tightens her hand in Catra's hair, pushing her closer. "Do that again." Adora begs as Catra *does* . She continues to purr, right into Adora's pussy, and Adora's head lolls backwards in pure ecstasy. If Catra kept that up, Adora was going to cum in seconds.

Catra looks up and Adora catches her eyes, her mouth is still against Adora's core but she *swears* she can see the smirk in Catra's eyes alone. "Good girl, Adora." Adora's breath hitches and she feels the resulting wetness from Catra's words before Catra's tongue hits her clit again.

Adora feels like she might explode. She's so overcome with pleasure. Her hand tightens in Catra's hair and she starts grinding *hard* against her mouth, rutting in the pursuit of release.

"Catra... *ah* ... I'm gonna- *Ah* !" Adora's words get cut off when Catra starts purring again, sending those vibrations right against Adora's clit.

Adora loses all ability to speak coherently, she becomes a whimpering mess, falling back into the mattress, one of her hands stays firmly locked in Catra's hair while the other clenches the sheets below her. Every swipe of Catra's hot, rough, tongue, was pushing Adora right towards the edge. She could feel her stomach tightening, her hips moved without a thought as she tried her hardest to push herself that little but further.

In the end, it's Catra that gets her there. With a purr, and a strong swipe of her tongue, Catra digs her claws into Adora's hips and moves them down, marking her. All of that mixed into one is a perfect cocktail, and Adora cums with Catra's name hot on her tongue. Adora cums so hard she almost stops breathing.

Catra stays, licking up Adora's release as Adora slowly comes down. She was sweaty, boneless and completely spent. After a moment, Adora tugs on Catra's hair to tell her to stop - even if the sight of Catra between her legs, and her tail swishing around in the air, was kind of adorable and, at the same time, hot.

Catra lays on top of Adora and purrs as she gently nuzzles her face under Adora's neck. Adora sighs happily as she wraps her arms around Catra and just holds her. She could hardly believe that Catra was actually here.

They stay like that for a long moment, Adora gently tracing her fingers over the stripes on Catra's lower back while Catra purred and kissed Adora's neck. "Thank you." Adora murmurs quietly. There's a stretch of silence before Catra laughs quietly.

"Did you just thank me for making you cum?" Catra asks lightly. Adora rolls her eyes fondly.

"For that and... for not hating me." Adora says. Catra softens, Adora *feels* it.

"I could never hate you, Adora." Catra says. She leans back so she can kiss Adora on her jaw and look her in the eyes. "I love you, dummy." Adora smiles at her and leans up to kiss her on

the lips.

"Was that good for you?" Catra asks and Adora's smile grows into a grin.

" *Absolutely* ." She says. "You should go down on me more often."

"Uh huh," Catra rolls her eyes but she's smiling. "whenever you want babe."

"I didn't know you could be so... authoritative." Adora says.

"I know you prefer being on top, and in control," Catra shrugs. "I enjoy it too, but you don't have to always do that, Adora. I'm more than happy to take the reins."

"Noted." Adora says with a smile. She sighs and falls back down against her pillow, closing her eyes. She felt so good, she could just drift off to sleep in this position.

"Can you do me a favour?" Catra asks and Adora opens her eyes to look at her. "Can you get your sword?" Adora swallows nervously.

"I... I don't..." Adora looks away, her words dying in her throat. She feels like she's going to cry again. She feels Catra grab her chin and move her face back towards her.

"Adora..." Catra says, so softly, so gently, it feels like a warm blanket being wrapped around her. "Look at me." Adora does as she says and she lets out a shaky breath. "You've been inside of me already, I've gone down on you, your sword isn't that big of a deal." Adora lets out a wet laugh.

"I hurt you with it." Adora sniffs and Catra kisses her. Catra is on top of her and her weight is comforting, her skin is soft (even softer thanks to her short fur) and Adora loves it, she loves *Catra* , but she doesn't know if she can give her what she wants. Every time she looks at her sword, she's reminded of what she did. With Hordak, she had kept her sword as a reminder of

her losing control, of the power she was capable of, but with Catra... Adora could barely look at her sword anymore.

"Yes, you did." Catra says and Adora takes a sharp breath in. "But I forgave you, Adora. Now, I want you to fuck me with your sword, will you please fuck me with your sword?" Adora laughs again before she nods.

"Yeah, okay, can you get it for me?" Adora asks. "It's under the bed." Catra nearly throws herself over the edge of the bed and Adora grabs her to keep her from falling.

She laughs in amusement as Catra wiggles her bare butt in the air, her tail almost hits Adora in her face a few times. "Geez, Kitten, you really are eager." Catra comes back up, sword in her hand.

"It's been *months* , Adora." Catra says, and then she holds the sword up. " *For the Honour of Grayskull* , please fuck me." Adora laughs and then takes the handle of the sword. She stares at it for a moment before it flashes in bright light to the thing that Catra wanted it to be.

"Mind putting it on for me?" Adora asks. "And being on top? I don't want to hurt the baby." Catra moves back and slides the harness up Adora's legs.

"I'm more than okay with being on top." Catra says.

"I want to be close to you." Adora adds, grunting as Catra tightens the straps of the harness in place. "Do you need me to-" Adora sits up, only to be shoved back down into the mattress.

"I'm already worked up from getting you off, *significantly* ." Catra looks at her with a heated gaze and Adora's eyes widen a little. She nods her head in understanding.

"Okay, if you're sure." Adora runs her hand along the shaft of the strap and then looks at Catra. Catra smirks and then she begins to position herself.

Adora settles back into her pillow, her head propped up. She watches contently as Catra sinks down onto her strap, inch by inch, while Adora whispers soft assurances and praise. Her thumbs rub gentle circles into her hips. Catra lets out a shuddering moan, she'd closed her eyes at some point and she blinks them open in order to glance down at Adora who, she was sure, was looking up at her in amazement.

Catra blushes and she moves her hand to place it to Adora's chest, right between her boobs. "That all you got Adora?" Catra asks and she grins, flashing those canines.

"You want bigger, Kitten?" Adora asks with a smug smile. Catra nods her head and, who was Adora to refuse her? She grips her hips and concentrates on her sword. She can't see it but she *feels* it shift - and she *definitely* sees Catra's reaction.

The brunette gasps and lets out a loud moan, her claws extend, as though on instinct, and the tips of them graze over Adora's skin, digging in only gently and not enough to mark. It still turns her on immeasurably. "Fuck," Catra says as she starts moving her hips. "I much prefer you using your sword like this on me." It's a joke, Adora knows that, but she must freeze because Catra pauses. "Bad joke, sorry." She says with a gentle smile and Adora breathes a sigh.

Adora pushes up and wraps her arms around Catra's hips. She grinds into her, slow yet firm, as Catra moves her hips up and down. "I want to make you feel good." Adora says earnestly. She moves her lips to Catra's neck.

"Adora..." Catra whispers, her breath hitches as she somehow sinks deeper, taking Adora's strap right to its hilt. "Bite me." Catra says and Adora raises an eyebrow at her. "Do it, hard, on my neck." She says.

"Are you sure?" Adora asks with hesitation. If the Rebellion saw that... They already know about them, but that didn't exactly give Adora a licence to give Catra a hickey on her neck.

"It's special... When Magicats bite each other's neck, when we mark and scent mark. So I'm sure, please, mark me." Adora nods and puts her mouth back to Catra's neck. She parts her lips and kisses Catra's neck first, moving until she reaches her pulse point.

She opens her mouth and *bites* as hard as she can with her non-fangs. Catra moans loudly and Adora's eyes widen as she hears Catra become *wetter* . Adora keeps her teeth on Catra's neck and then soothes the mark with her tongue. "Adora..." Catra was practically panting, simply only from Adora biting her. "Fuck me, please, I want you."

Adora has been gentle and loving but she also wants to give Catra whatever it is that she wants. She rolls Catra over and onto her back, adjusting so she wasn't crushing her bump. Catra wraps her arms around Adora's neck and pulls her down as Adora thrusts into her. "Like that baby... *harder* ..." Catra says between moans. "Make me yours again." Adora wants nothing more than to do that.

Adora starts to glow, which she doesn't exactly intend to do, but she also doesn't know how to stop it either. Catra gasps softly and Adora looks at her in concern, worried that she was hurting her, but Catra was *smiling* . "You're glowing." Catra says and then she giggles and Adora can't help but laugh with her.

Adora thrusts into her gently and at a steady pace. She knows Catra usually can't get off on penetration alone, but she's also been pretty damn close before too. Still, with their current speed, and Adora not wanting to go too hard in case she hurt Catra or Finn, she wasn't going to get Catra off like that - even if Catra was mewling, her claws flexing and running up Adora's bare back.

Adora moves her head so she can whisper in Catra's ear. She knows it's unnecessary, Catra's hearing is exceptional, but she likes the way her ear flickers when Adora's hot breath brushes across it. "I'm yours." Adora says and Catra's breath hitches. Adora smirks a little. What you say to someone during sex makes a huge difference, and Adora has every intention to whisper sweet nothings right into Catra's ear. "I belong to you and only you." Catra's claws flex and the tips of them bite softly into the skin on Adora's back. It doesn't hurt, but it does cause Adora's hips to stutter.

"Keep going, Adora." Catra encourages and one of her hands slips down to Adora's ass to push her down and back into her. *Fuck. That was hot.*

"I love you, Catra." Adora pants and Catra moans, throwing her head back into the pillow. Her claws extend further and Adora feels them *slide* down her back. Adora feels her pleasure

spike at the pain. The pressure on her clit is *perfect* every time she grinds down against it between thrusts. Adora could feel her peak quickly approaching, but she wasn't- Adora's thoughts are stopped in their tracks when Catra lets out a long and loud moan of Adora's name and Adora feels the walls of Catra's pussy clench around the strap.

Adora looks down at Catra with wide eyes as she clearly peaks, every part of her curls, from her toes to the tip of her tail. "Did you just…?" Adora trails off. Catra laughs, the bubbly high pitched, squeaky one, and Adora feels her heart hammer in her chest with complete and utter fondness.

"I did." Catra says after she manages to stop laughing.

"I can't believe you came, I didn't even- I usually have to-"

"I know," Catra says, patting Adora's shoulder. "What you said, it pushed me the rest of the way." Catra is blushing and Adora can't believe how pretty she is. Adora is probably the luckiest woman in existence, she's pretty sure. She gets to kiss, cuddle and make love with *Catra* . She doesn't know what she did to deserve that. "Keep going, I know you were close." Catra encourages, rocking her hips.

"Are you not sensitive?" Adora asks, arching a brow.

"Adora, fuck me until you cum or so help me." Adora's eyes widen but she nods and does exactly as Catra said to do. Adora was already pretty close, but every whimper, every claw in her back, every twitch around her strap, it's a matter of *minutes* before she crashes right over the edge with Catra, calling out her name. That felt different, and more intense this time, and Adora can't quite place why.

She stays like that for a moment, buried in Catra, until Adora musters the strength to pull out and roll over. Catra whimpers as the strap slides out of her but she still sits up breifly to do her cute little post-sex wiggles. "Doesn't your body already know you're pregnant? Also, I didn't cum inside of you this time." Adora says fondly with a big smile. She's missed this. She's missed Catra, she's missed the way her hair sticks to her neck from post-sex sweat, the way her tail always gives away how she's really feeling, *all* of Catra she has missed.

"Shut up." Catra says, opening an eye to peek at Adora. "It's a Magicat thing, we do it after sex all the time."

"Oh, I am well aware, Kitten. This isn't my first time having sex with a Magicat." Adora says fondly as Catra stretches into a downward dog position, her tail swishing about. Adora laughs and wiggles out of her strap, dropping it off the side of the bed.

"Is that so?" Catra asks, dropping down on the bed beside Adora. "I was completely unaware of that. Are you cheating on me?" Adora snorts.

"Magicats. So dramatic. Or maybe that's just you?" Catra shoves her at that and Adora laughs, protesting with a half hearted 'hey' before pulling Catra in for a cuddle.

They're face to face, their legs tangled together, Adora presses her palm to Catra's stomach, gently touching her bump. "How many months are you?" Adora asks, because she's not entirely sure - she's gay, not a mathematician.

"I'm not sure," Catra admits. "I found out about them a few weeks after we... you know." Adora looks away at that before Catra reaches out to gently cup Adora's face in her hands. Adora starts trying to calculate in her head but it's *hard* .

"So they're... three to four months? Five?" Adora asks.

"Give or take." Catra responds. Adora brushes her hand along Catra’s side, down to her hip, where she kneads her thumb into Catra's hip bone. Catra purrs and Adora smiles. She *adores* when Catra purrs. Adora would guess that, right now, Catra feels happy, and satisfied, and *relaxed* .

Adora moves her lips to Catra's neck and kisses the mark she had left there. "You said that was special?" Adora asks curiously. Catra's tail rises and moves to rest across both of them. Adora takes it in her fist, moving her hand along it to pet it softly, which only makes Catra purr harder.

"Means you're mine." Catra mumbles between purrs. She's starting to fall asleep, which Adora isn't too surprised about, but the exhaustion and huskiness of her voice is both sexy and really cute. Adora finds Catra's voice highly attractive - her voice alone could probably get Adora off if she's honest. That gives Adora an idea, but later, when she isn't exhausted.

Adora leans down and pulls the blanket over them so they wouldn't get cold in their sleep. "You're mine." Adora says.

"We're each other's." Catra confirms, leaning in to nuzzle gently at Adora's throat. Adora's breath hitches and she goes completely still when she feels Catra's hot tongue press to her neck, her hand coming up to thread into the short blonde locks of Adora's hair as she purrs. Catra isn't really doing anything; Adora has no idea what Catra is doing, but she suddenly feels like she wants her to go down on her all over again. Catra simply has her tongue pressed to Adora's pulse point, and her fangs are softly pressed into Adora's skin. It doesn't hurt at all and almost feels like Catra is showing Adora that she can trust her not to rip her throat out - which she could easily do with said fangs.

After a moment, Catra pulls back and simply just huffs out a breath as she settles her face against Adora's chest and under her chin. *What the hell was that?* Adora decides to just forget about it.

"That felt different." Adora whispers.

"You said it yourself, we were making love, not just fucking." Catra points out which is true but it felt like *more* than even that.

"It... No it... It felt..." Adora trails off. Catra looks up.

"How much reading did you do on Magicats exactly?"

"Well I... I didn't read *everything* ." Adora blushes a little and Catra rolls her eyes.

"You read the sex books didn't you?" Catra asks. Adora stays quiet for a moment. "Adora!"

"What?" Adora says defensively. "It's how I knew about that sweet spot right at the front of your walls, that I just..." Adora gestures with her fingers and Catra's tail lifts up for a moment, the fur standing on end as she flushes bright red. Adora smirks smugly and Catra scowls at her.

"Well, if you'd read about the bond between mates, then it'd make a lot more sense to you, Lord Horn Dog." Catra pokes Adora right on her forehead, with her nail, and Adora tries to follow her finger before she looks back at Catra.

"You love it."

"I love *you* ." Adora's breath catches. They've said it a lot since reuniting but Adora still isn't used to it. She can't believe someone actually loves her and they don't want anything from her. Catra doesn't love Adora for what she can do for her, she loves her simply because she *does* . And that is something Adora has never experienced before.

"The bond between mates is special." Catra carries on, like Adora wasn't looking at her like she hung the moons in the sky. "I'm not sure how it works, since you're Etherian, but we have a soul-bond. We can feel each other when we're experiencing strong emotions, when we... make love..." Catra blushes a little and Adora kisses the base of her ears affectionately before the brunette sighs. "It's more intense because of our connection."

"I have felt..." Adora trails off. "When you first left... I felt... I don't know... Angry? Sad? Pained? It was so confusing."

"My grieving probably affected you without you knowing it." Catra says. Adora knows a little more about that since she went to help Catra out of it. She hadn't known she'd caused Catra such intense pain.

"I'm so sorry Catra." Adora says again, her voice breaking a little. "I never wanted to hurt you. Not like I have. I just... I was confused, and scared, and I... I should've just taken a breath to figure myself out."

"Hey," Catra grabs Adora by her face, forcing her to focus on her. "No. I don't blame you, Adora. Do I wish things could've been different? Maybe. But we're here now. I wouldn't change that for the world." Adora takes a shaky breath and then she presses her lips to Catra's in a gentle yet desperate kiss. Her heart thumps in her chest, clunky and loud, and it hurts a little, but Adora can't ignore it. She is so in love with Catra it *hurts* her, she feels her heart *squeeze* , ache, she loves her and Adora doesn't plan on ever stopping.

"I plan on telling you everything I love about you," Adora says as Catra settles back down against her. Adora has shared a lot of intimate moments with Catra, but sometimes she thinks the most intimacy comes from this: being naked and pressed up against one another, tangled limb for limb and sharing their warmth. Adora runs her hands along Catra's back. "Every inch of you. I love everything about you. *Everything* ."

"Sh." Catra says, suddenly placing her *entire hand* over Adora's mouth to silence her. *Rude* . Adora frowns at her but Catra really is falling asleep. She supposes that she can let Catra sleep now and tell her later. Adora shuffles closer and buries her nose into Catra's neck until Catra's softly purr snoring.

"I love you, so much, Catra." Adora whispers into her hair. "I'm sorry. For everything. I *promise* , I will make it up to you."

She *vows* it.

Chapter End Notes

Have some softness and gayness for the rest of the next few chapters ;) -M

This chapter was one of my favourites to write. I've missed writing them together so much !! I guess Adora didn't get to eat that food after all, but she did get to eat pussy >:) See y'all next week!! -S

As always you can follow us on Twitter @ceolordadora which is the same as our CuriousCat and you can follow me (S) on Tumblr @sherasswordstrap !!

Promises

Chapter Summary

> "I know. I hate it so much. I hate being away from you." Catra turns her attention back to Adora. "I wish we could pretend they didn't know, that it was just us again and no one else."
>
> "Well... Hey, even when we're apart we're still together." Adora says.

Chapter Notes

> Happy update day and Friday people !! Also, Happy She-Ra Anniversary tomorrow ;)! I hope y'all enjoy this update and we'll see you again next week!

See the end of the chapter for more notes

Adora looks over to her right at Catra who was currently purring and curled up beside her asleep. She could still hardly believe that Catra was alive, never mind that she had forgiven her, made love with her and now they were *cuddling* . Adora was more than happy to keep lying there with Catra but her stomach had other ideas. It makes a loud, *horrible,* noise of protest. Adora laughs a little and blushes when Catra turns over, her ear twitching at the sound. "Did that wake you up?" Adora asks, moving in closer to kiss Catra on the mark on her neck.

"I was partially awake already, but yes." Catra smiles a little. "Are you hungry, Love? I can make something for you?" She suggests, rubbing Adora’s stomach.

"I think I'd rather just stay and cuddle you-" Adora begins, but then her stomach makes another sound of protest, interrupting her. "Traitor." She mumbles, glaring at her stomach. Catra giggles, and presses a kiss to Adora's temple.

"We can go back to cuddling after you get something to eat, okay? Think you can make it to the kitchen? Or… I did bring stuff." Catra looks over to the desk but Adora’s pride is slightly insulted by the insinuation that she can’t make it to the kitchens.

"I'm not that frail, did you forget the fact that we just went multiple rounds?" Adora asks with a grin. "I can make it just fine. But you should get dressed first."

"I was planning to get dressed, obviously." Catra snorts and sits up, putting her loose pants and shirt back on. "You ready to go?" Adora takes a deep breath and then sits up. She ignores the small spell of dizziness she feels and swings her feet over the edge of the bed. She grabs her discarded clothes and pulls them on one by one.

Okay, no biggie, next step is standing.

She stands, using her sword for support before she turns to Catra. "Now I'm ready to go." Catra nods, smiling at Adora and offering her hand.

"What would you like to eat? I do have to see what ingredients you have though."

"Oh uh..." Adora trails off but she takes Catra's hand, threading their fingers together. "Maybe we should wait and see..." She can't imagine it's a lot, since she kind of destroyed the artificial farm, and she hadn't exactly been running the Horde as much as she's been lying around and moping. She doubts people have been making supply runs. Maybe she should just admit defeat, and tell Catra before they walk all the way to the kitchens, but Adora suddenly feels tongue tied and embarrassed.

Catra seems to sense the drop in mood that Adora has, but she doesn't comment on it - which Adora is thankful for. She instead guides Adora along to the kitchen, opening the door and greeting the cooks who look surprised to see her - Adora isn't surprised by their surprise if she's honest. "Hi guys! Can I take over your kitchen for a little while?" Catra asks.

"Princess Catra? You're alive?" They ask with surprise. "And... Lord Adora?" They say. Adora nods in acknowledgement at them before she leans her chin on Catra's shoulder. She doesn't say much else. "Of course you can take over the kitchen." Catra smiles at them.

"Alive and well, thankfully. Thanks again, I wanted to cook for this dork here since her stomach just growled like hell earlier." Catra says. Adora doesn't understand how Catra communicates with people so easily. Don't get her wrong, Adora can communicate, but sometimes… It feels *exhausting* . She finds it easier with certain people, other people she sometimes has no idea how to do it. It makes her feel flustered, and she hates it, so instead she stays quiet. As a cadet, that sometimes got her in trouble when she'd be mute to superior officers. As Lord, she just had a brooding silent thing going, no one ever pressured her to speak against her will.

"Of course, we're glad to see you're okay." The cook says with a smile. "And that Lord Adora is okay, we haven't seen her for a while."

"Thank you. I'm happy to see you all as well." Catra beams. "Is that so? Huh, well, she's here now, and so am I. Let me see what we have and what I can make." The cooks nod happily and Adora stands up straight - although, she keeps her hand pressed to Catra's back.

"Sir, are you okay?" A soldier asks.

"I'm fine." She waves her hand dismissively.

"Are you sure? You look a little... pale..."

"I said I'm *fine* ." Adora says, narrowing her eyes at the soldier. Catra turns around and looks at Adora critically.

"You do look a little pale, Love." She comments out of concern. "Why don't you have a seat? I'll get you some water and I can check what we have to cook, okay?"

"If it'll make you feel better, but I really am fine." Adora says. She wobbles - *only a little* - as she walks over to a stool and sits down. She does feel better to be sitting rather than standing. Catra looks at her for a little longer before nodding and getting her that glass of water.

"Here. Drink all of it, okay? But slowly. Take your time." She gives Adora a sweet kiss on her forehead before going to the ingredients cabinet to see what she could find. Adora knows it probably isn't a lot and, given how Catra stands there for a solid five minutes, Adora feels her anxiety peak as she sips on her water. "Hey, is there any way we could get more ingredients? I can make something for everyone that way." She asks the cooks and Adora. The cooks glance at Adora and Adora rubs the back of her neck a little guiltily.

"Well I-" Before Adora can say anything, *Scorpia* comes bounding into the kitchen.

"Oh my gosh! Boss! And Wildcat!" Scorpia picks Catra up off of the ground and Adora straightens up a little in alarm.

"Careful Scorpia! She's pregnant! Remember?" Adora asks.

"No worries Boss, only gentle hugs, you got it." Adora almost facepalms because Scorpia simply isn't aware of her own strength to do that.

"It's fine, Adora." Catra laughs and gives Scorpia a hug back. "Good to see you, Scorps. How are you?"

"Oh, good!" She says enthusiastically as she places Catra down onto her feet again. Adora relaxes a little at that. "I'm glad you're okay, I mean, I knew you'd get through it. Boss thought you died after she had to leave you before you got better, but I tried to remind her how strong you are."

"Well, at least I know for certain now that you're not a ghost or a figure of my imagination from depression and also hunger." Adora comments as she sips her water. Now not only had Catra been acknowledged by the cooks, but also Scorpia.

"Speaking of hunger. Scorpia, any chance we could get more food supplies? I can make something for everyone but there isn't much in the storage room." Catra says, waving her hand in that general direction.

"Oh. I can make a supply run? We kind of went back to just eating rations after..." Scorpia glances at Adora.

"Really? Should I ask?" Catra asks, raising an eyebrow. Adora sighs.

"After I destroyed the artificial farm in anger." Adora says. "You can say it, Scorpia. It's my fault we have to eat ration bars again."

"You were upset Boss." Scorpia says. "No one blames you."

"Scorpia can make a supply run, or have someone else do it. We have plenty of money." Adora says. Which is true, by the way, the Horde is extremely wealthy. They conquer places, they get money, but they have no economy, there aren't exactly things to *buy* in the Fright Zone, which means they have excess wealth.

"Okay, could you please make a supply run, Scorps? I'll take care of cooking today." Catra says with a smile. Catra sends a soldier back to Adora's room to go retrieve the food they left on her desk. They return a moment later and Catra takes it before she sets it down in front of Adora.

"Here you go. It's not much, but I hope you enjoy it." Adora looks at it and then back up at Catra.

"I..." She swallows. "I don't deserve to eat it."

"Yes, you do. Eat your food, Adora."

"Or what?" Adora asks with a little amusement. "You'll make me?"

"Exactly."

"You'd make me? How?" Catra pouts at her.

"Please? For me?" She gives Adora sparkly eyes and Adora immediately caves - she can't resist those eyes.

"Fine, for you." Adora stares at the food for a moment before she picks it up. "Are you really okay?" Adora asks.

"For the most part. Doctor cleared me for some light walking and stuff. I'm healing okay though." Catra answers.

"Light walking? You didn't think to mention that when we were having sex?" Adora asks, raising an eyebrow in slight disbelief. Catra giggles.

"We went slow, for the most part. And I missed you way too much." Adora nods. They *had* gone slow, all things considered.

"So everyone knows about us?" Adora asks. "I can't believe you sneaked out to come here just to see me."

"I sneaked out because I *missed* you, and I wanted to make sure you were okay." Catra says. Adora laughs a little and takes a bite of her sandwich.

"You realise that your mom will be *so* mad if she finds out you were with me, right?" Which she is entirely likely to find out given the fact that Adora literally *bit* Catra.

"Yeah, I don't really care." Catra shrugs a bit. "She's not exactly being a good mother right now anyway. So she can fuck off." Adora looks at Catra with surprise.

"Did you just... tell your mom to fuck off?" Adora asks.

"I did."

"She was intense when I came to help you. I could tell she only let me because Luna told her how bad you'd be if I didn't help." Catra sighs at Adora’s words.

"Luna was right. I wasn't well, and you saved me. Not that C'yra seems to care about what happens to me anymore." Catra mumbles.

"I'm sure she cares, Catra." Adora reassures. "I understand her reluctance to trust the Horde Lord."

"It doesn't feel that way at all." Catra says, shaking her head. She seems *down* to say the least.

"Come here," Adora says, lifting her arms up and making grabby hands towards Catra. Catra smiles and moves towards Adora, falling into her embrace.

"I love you." Catra whispers.

"I love you too." Adora says back, kissing her bump. "But you can't stay."

"I want to... I want to stay with you so *badly* , Adora."

"I know, and I want you to stay too, but we both know that C'yra would burn down the Horde to get you back and... I'm done fighting for a war I don't believe in." Adora pauses. "But I'd fight for you. If you really didn't want to go back. I would fight for *you* ." Catra shakes her head.

"I'm tired of wars. I don't want to restart another one, which is why I'm still adhering to their rules over there. But I hate it there right now."

"I wish you could stay, I really do." Adora says with a smile. "Or that we could run away together… But we can't." Adora places her hand to Catra's bump. "For so many reasons... But we'll find a way to be together again, I promise." Catra gazes into Adora's eyes and nods.

"Okay, I trust you. You better keep that promise."

"I always keep my promises." Adora says with a grin. She had the beginnings of a plan in her mind, not that she could tell Catra said plan, but a *plan* . "I need to help the Fright Zone, and myself, first before I can do anything. No point in standing up to the Princesses when a strong wind can knock me over. I don't even know if I can transform into She-Ra like this."

"Yeah, make sure to take care of yourself." Catra boops her on the nose. "And take care of the others as well." She smiles a bit, kissing Adora's cheek.

"I... I want to protect *you* ." Adora says. She doesn't want to make Catra go back to the Rebellion where she is going to be mistreated.

"I know."

"It's not fair." Adora pouts and Catra shakes her head.

"It's not, but there isn't much we can do." Adora smiles reassuringly before she finishes off her food.

"You're right. I wish you weren't though."

"I know." Catra sighs, dejected. "How are you feeling? With the food, I mean."

"Better. Thank you, for taking care of me." Adora says. Catra beams.

"Of course. You don't have to thank me for that. But you're welcome." Catra kisses Adora on her nose and Adora feels herself smiling again. She always smiles with Catra. She considers how often she smiled before Catra - it was probably very little - but whenever she is with Catra, she is *constantly* smiling.

"I *really* missed you." Adora confesses.

"I missed you too, my love." Catra leans down and places a kiss on Adora's hair. "You look a little less pale now. I'm glad."

"Yeah? Think you can go another round?" Adora wiggles her eyebrows playfully.

"You're resting for now and that's final." Catra says sternly with a roll of her eyes. Adora pouts and grabs Catra by her waist, pulling her further into her lap.

"You know, I did sometimes go a week or two without eating because of Shadow Weaver, I'll be fine in no time." Adora assures.

"That doesn't exactly make me feel much better about the fact that you haven't eaten." Catra frowns, hugging her tightly. "You need to rest and you need to eat."

"I will," Adora whispers. "I'm more worried about you."

"I'll be fine, I promise."

"Yeah? How's the pregnancy coming along?" Adora asks. "Do you get weird cravings? I heard that's a thing. Is it painful? Or...?" Adora doesn't really know much about pregnancy

but she has heard things before - she should probably find a book on that.

"It's not painful. Sometimes it's just tiring, but it's coming along well." Catra smiles, taking Adora's hand and placing it on her abdomen. "The doctor has been making sure Finn is healthy." Adora beams and leans up to kiss Catra when they're *rudely* interrupted.

"Whoa, PDA alert." Adora groans and pulls away to look at the person she knew had just spoken.

"Lonnie." Adora says. "Since when did we get so much foot traffic to the kitchens?"

"You're never here blondie, you wouldn't know."

"I'm here... sometimes." Adora grumbles.

"Lonnie! Hi!" Catra grins, clearly happy to see more of the people she had come to know with the months of being in the Fright Zone with Adora. "How are you doing?"

"Catra," Lonnie says. "I should've known you were here, only you get Adora to leave her cave." Adora rolls her eyes. "I'm good. And you're... pregnant. Wow... I thought Scorpia was kidding." Catra laughs and shakes her head.

"Very pregnant. Scorpia was not kidding in any way. This dork here did that." She tilts her head towards Adora, who looks proud. "I'm glad you're doing well. It's been quite a while since I've seen... almost all of you, actually." Catra continues.

"We missed you around here. Things have been kind of... gloomy." Lonnie glances at Adora. Adora will admit, she has been especially broody lately.

"Well, it's good to be back. At least for today."

"You have to go?" Lonnie asks, turning towards her. "Are you sure? You know that no one would mind if you stayed, right?"

"I know that. It's not you guys. It's... the Alliance." Catra sighs. "I don't want them to start another war if I don't go back. I want to keep you all as safe as possible."

"Huh..." Lonnie looks at Adora who buries her face against Catra - Lonnie is one of the few people who knows her very well. "I mean, we all appreciate that, but we can kick Princess butt. You don't have to do anything to keep us safe."

"I know you can, but I want to protect them as well. As much as I hate how they're acting right now, I still care about them. It's to keep everyone safe." Catra says with determination. Adora doesn't like it, and she knows that Lonnie can read that all over her expression. She knows Catra is right, and Adora finds her determination to keep everyone safe (even the Horde) admirable, but she doesn't like the idea of Catra suffering to do it.

"Catra has to go back." Adora says anyway. "Even though I want her to stay, and probably the whole Horde does too, and... it'd be kind of cool if we were rulers of the Horde together... but she *has* to go."

"Sounds like you want her to stay." Lonnie points out.

"Of course I want her to stay!" Adora exclaims. "But it makes more sense, and is better for everyone in the long run... probably... if she leaves." Catra looks at Adora sadly, nodding in defeat.

"It's best for the Horde... and for Etheria. You guys can take this time to rebuild, and to recover, and maybe even grow into something more." She sheds a tear and Adora feels her heart contract. "As much as I want to stay, it's for the best of everyone." Adora reaches her hand up and gently swipes the tear away with her thumb before she kisses Catra again.

"Well, this isn't goodbye forever though... *right* ?" Lonnie asks.

"I..." Catra words get stuck in her throat. Adora can tell that Catra isn't sure. From what Catra had told Adora, from the way that the Rebellion were treating Catra, it was unlikely that once Catra returned after this little visit that she would come back. "I... don't know." Catra answers finally.

"It *won't* be." Adora answers for Catra. Catra looks up at Adora and nods.

"It won't be." She echoes, obviously trying to make herself believe those words.

"I won't let it be." Adora promises.

"I gotta run, Scorpia needs help," Lonnie says, checking her com-pad. "maybe the rest of the squad will swing by."

"Hopefully. I'll see you later, Lonnie. Tell the others I said hi." Catra waves at Lonnie, watching her exit the kitchen. "Adora..."

"Yes?" Adora asks, kissing Catra on her jaw.

"You really mean what you said?"

"I've said a lot of things," Adora replies, turning her head to the side. "But I can't think of anything I've said recently that I didn't mean." Catra's eyes soften completely and Adora can practically *feel* as Catra's heart skips a beat in her chest. It's weird that she can feel certain things that Catra aslo feels (if it's intense enough) but it's also nice - it tells Adora that they're on the same page.

"I love you, please never forget that." Catra says softly.

"I love you too." Adora whispers back. "I won't forget it, if you don't forget it."

"I could never forget it, Love."

"I can't believe I was such a big idiot." Adora says after a moment.

"I always did call you dummy." Catra says with nothing but fondness.

"I know," Adora laughs softly. She pauses in thought. "What do you want for us Catra?"

"I want to be able to be happy with you. That's all I want." Catra whispers, resting her head on Adora's chest.

"You, me and Finn, together? That's all you want?" Adora asks.

"Yes, that's all I want."

"Can you imagine if we just had our own house in the middle of nowhere? No war, no Princesses, no Horde, just us. Living our lives together." Adora says wistfully. She so wants that. A home that is just their own, lived in, they could mark Finn’s growth against the doorframe of one of the rooms. Just *be,* in their own space.

"That sounds fantastic. I wish we could do that." Catra says longingly.

"Me too." Adora beams. "Maybe one day we will." Catra gives her a small smile and nods.

"One day." She whispers hopefully.

"So, uh, I hate to be that person but, you're not seeing suitors anymore, right?" Adora asks. She imagines the answer is no but she also needs to be reassured. She hadn't really heard anything about suitors recently, but things had kind of been insane the past few months.

"No, I'm not. Even if C'yra and Luna tried to make me, I won't do it." Catra says and, well, that's a little bit of a relief to Adora.

"Does that mean we're *exclusive* ?" Adora asks, her smile growing into a grin.

"Mhmm, we are. You have my heart, Adora." Cara says. Adora feels the same, *completely* .

"So you're not marrying anyone else?" Adora asks, just to make sure. Catra shakes her head.

"Not planning to marry anyone unless it's you." Adora's eyes widen. She hadn't at all expected Catra to say that.

"M-Me?" Adora asks. "Your mom hates my guts." A.k.a. that would *never* happen.

"I know, but still. I don't want to marry anyone else aside from you."

"You... want to marry me?" Adora asks in disbelief. Catra nods.

"I do. I want to marry you."

"Marriage... huh... I never used to think I could have, or even wanted that." Adora says in amazement. She never thought anyone would even *want* to marry her, never mind *Catra* wanting to marry her. She looks back to Catra. "Anyway, let's make this food when the supplies get here and then we can spend some time together, sound good?" Adora asks.

“Sounds perfect.” Catra confirms, smiling before she kisses Adora again.

* * *

Once Catra had finished making dinner, and they had spent time with the troops, they had retired back to Adora’s room for some alone time together. Adora was feeling significantly better now that she had eaten her fill and seeing how happy her troops had been to see her *and* Catra had provided her with a significant boost to her morale. Adora hated letting people down, and she had felt like she’d been a bad Lord the past few months.

Now they were in Adora’s room, Catra was lying on her stomach, naked, due to Adora asking her to, and Adora was sitting on Catra’s legs, her thighs either side. Adora wanted to try something new but, currently, she was distracted by Catra’s ass if she was being completely honest. Adora gently rubs Catra's ass, enjoying how it feels under her palms. "You really do have a great ass." Adora comments. Catra looks over her shoulder, raising her eyebrow at her.

"We're not doing anal."

"Wh- I never-" Adora stumbles. "I'm just complimenting your ass!"

"Uh huh, you do that a lot." Catra says, turning back around. "What are you doing anyway? You know, lying on my stomach for long periods of time is kind of uncomfortable, and I'm not sure it's worth it if your intentions are just to feel up my ass."

"Okay, well, first of all, I'm pretty sure that's worth it." Adora argues with a small grin. Catra's tail wacks her on the jaw. " *Hey* !"

"Dork." Catra snorts and Adora rolls her eyes fondly.

"That's not the new thing I wanted to try," Adora begins. "We'll get there. For now, just relax, I'll take care of you." Adora says. Catra doesn't reply, but she doesn't have to, she drops her

chin to the pillow on her arms and sinks into the mattress, relaxing.

Adora moves her hands up, though she's slightly sad to move them away from Catra's ass, she runs her fingers over the stripes on her back, mapping them out in her head. She slides her hands further up Catra's back to her shoulders; she gently hooks her fingers into her muscles and begins massaging them. "Fuck." Catra says in a sigh. "That feels *amazing* ." Adora smiles a little as she continues to massage Catra's shoulder blades. Catra felt a little tense but, under Adora's hands, she melted like butter. She moves down to Catra's toned bicep muscles, rubbing them gently with her fingers. "Where did you learn to do this?" Catra asks.

"Sometimes when I pull muscles I massage them." Adora explains. "Happens often actually, sucks ass."

"Sounds like you want to suck ass." Catra comments and Adora pinches her. " *Ow* !"

"Don't tempt me." Adora jokes lightly. Catra moves her tail again but this time Adora manages to catch it. She wraps her hand around it and tugs gently. Catra lets out an audible gasp.

"What are you doing?" Catra asks and Adora smiles smugly as she sees Catra's hands curl into the fabric of Adora's sheets.

"That thing I wanted to try?" Adora asks as she moves her fist down Catra's tail. She reaches the base of it and then presses her fingers right where her tail and spine connected. Catra lets out a moan this time, arching her back up from the mattress. "This is what I meant." Adora says; her voice is lower, more husky as she talks to Catra. "I want to make you cum from touching your tail alone." Adora starts massaging again and Catra *squirms* under her, her hips jerking as though she were searching for something.

"Fuck... Adora... please..." Catra whimpers. Adora feels her lips tug up at the corners in a smirk.

"How does it feel?" Adora asks as she applies more pressure, hooking her fingers into the fur of Catra's lower back. It was thicker there, thanks to her tail. Catra gasps and moves her butt up as though to get Adora to go harder.

"I-Intense..." Catra says between mewls. "Our tails are... basically... an extension of our spines..." Catra explains. She simultaneously becomes like jelly but also manages to shove her ass up for Adora to go harder. "They're crazy sensitive. The nerves... they're most intense... at the base." Adora presses harder and feels her arousal grow as Catra's claws extend and she digs them into the sheets.

"You like that, don't you, Kitten?" Adora asks, adding just a little bit of taunting to her voice. Catra gasps as her claws dig deeper. "Are you getting wet, Kitten? Do you need your Lord to take care of you?" Adora asks. She wasn't expecting to use her title right now, but watching how Catra grinds her hips down against nothing, and *whimpers* , she thinks it was worth it. "Can you feel it without me touching you?" Adora whispers. “My fingers touching you, rubbing your clit, pressing into your entrance, fucking you until you scream my name."

" *Adora* !" Catra lets out a yelp of surprise of Adora's name. Adora can feel her getting hot, see the tell tale tensing that tells Adora that she's *close* . "Touch me! Please! Y-You’ve proven you can get me off by my tail alone, but please," Catra pushes up a little and she's honest to god *panting* . Adora's eyes widen at the sight, she had no idea Catra would get so turned on just from her touching her tail. "Touch me, *please* , Adora, I *need* you. Touch me while you massage my tail, *please* ." Catra begs incoherently, her hips are moving on air. Catra has begged before, but Adora has never heard her beg this much just for her to touch her.

Adora isn't cruel, and she's more than willing to touch Catra. "Anything for my Kitten." Adora murmurs as she snakes a hand around Catra's front and then she delves into her folds.

Catra is significantly wet, and Adora shudders as her juices cover her fingers. "Fuck, Catra... you're so *wet* ." Adora can *hear* how wet she is as she spreads her fingers through her - that gives Adora an idea as her mouth waters.

She withdraws her hand, fingertips still covered in Catra's slick, Catra makes a desperate sound of protest but she quickly stops when Adora places her hand under her chin, lifting her head up and squeezing softly on her throat. "Cum for me Kitten." Adora commands. Catra shakes her head, her hands are gripping the sheets so tightly they're white with effort.

"I- I can't! Need you to... t-touch... please!" Catra begs but Adora refuses.

"No." Adora says sternly. "If you cum from this, then I'll go down on you. But first you need to cum, Kitten." Adora speaks softly as she continues to touch Catra at the base of her tail. Her words obviously affect Catra because she gasps softly and arches further into Adora's touch. "Don't you want to be a good kitty for me?" Adora coos. "Don't you want your reward of my tongue on your pussy?" Adora asks, her voice dripping with her own arousal at the mere thought. Catra lets out a shuddering breath as she nods her head feverishly.

Truth be told, Adora wants to touch Catra just as much as Catra wants her to touch her, but she meant what she said. "Good girl, Catra," Adora whispers into her ear. "You're mine, all mine, no one is ever going to touch you like this other than *me* . You're my good kitty, you love it when I fuck you, don't you?" Adora asks. She doesn't even know what she's saying at this point, she's just trying to push Catra over the edge.

Catra chokes on her words for a moment before she nods again. She's getting more and more tense, Adora can practically *feel* that orgasm growing. Catra's claws pierce the quilt at the same time that she cums, *hard* . Adora watches in amazement as Catra calls out her name, her eyes screwed shut, her tail spasms behind her, almost hitting Adora a few times, and Catra tenses up for at least five minutes before she releases a breath and calms down.

Wow . That was clearly intense. Adora looks at the sheets and sees some of Catra's cum on them. She smiles as she dips her fingers in the warm liquid and then she flips Catra over slowly.

Catra looks up at her, blinking slowly as she comes down from her high. "That was really intense." Catra says, and she sounds like she just ran in a race - she's that breathless. "Now, keep your promise." Catra lifts her hips up and Adora laughs.

"That eager, huh?" Adora asks as she moves herself down Catra's body. She kisses her stomach affectionately, which Catra purrs at, before her legs practically trap Adora in a headlock.

"Yes I fucking am, I need your tongue on me, *now* ." Adora looks at Catra's shining pussy, it's wet and waiting and her mouth is already watering at the mere thought of getting to touch Catra with her tongue again. So she does. Adora doesn't see the point in waiting, Catra wants her, Adora wants to taste her, it's a pretty easy decision for her.

She dives in, lapping at Catra eagerly, she's rewarded with Catra tightening her legs around her neck, pushing up more, and screaming in pleasure. That isn't even Adora's favourite part - though it's up there. Her favourite part is the *taste* , it's the getting to explore every *inch* of Catra's dripping pussy (that was wet for *her)* , it's her getting to draw undeniable pleasure out of Catra as she licks, swirls and even uses her *teeth* . Catra is gone, she's a *mess* , she may as well be in a different universe, and Adora is proud of her ability to drive Catra so crazy with just a few swipes of her tongue.

Adora practically has Catra lifted up off of the bed - she's honestly kind of impressed she still has the strength to do that. Adora enjoys the feeling of Catra's folds against her tongue as much as she enjoys exploring them with her fingers. She's not entirely sure how to describe it, it's weirdly addicting, she could stay buried in Catra's pussy with her tongue forever and die happy.

" *Adora* !" Catra yells through gasping breath. "Right there! Fuck, fuck, *fuck* !" *I know.* Adora smirks into Catra's pussy as she continues doing what it was that she was doing. Catra tastes *incredible* . Adora will never get tired of tasting her. It's heavy and heady and it's *intoxicating* . Adora never wants to leave, but she does want to make Catra cum again.

She doubles her efforts and focuses her attention on Catra's clit, using the entire surface of her tongue, alternating between soft and hard, slow and fast, it was clearly driving Catra absolutely *wild* . She could no longer speak, just move her hips and moan Adora's name. She plunges two fingers inside and she’s met with *zero* resistance.

Adora delves into Catra's liquid heat with pleasure, keeping up her movements with her tongue while she thrusts into her with her fingers. Adora hooks her fingers almost immediately, scratching that sweet spot at the front of Catra's walls, and then she cums. Catra's legs tighten even further, she screams Adora's name and tenses. Adora laps at her juices until Catra taps her on her arm. Adora lowers Catra to the bed, swiping once or twice more with her tongue before she pulls away. She licks her lips and moves up Catra to hover over the top of her.

Catra opens her eyes slowly and gazes up at Adora, her eyes sparkling. "Holy shit..." Catra says. "That was... *wow* ..." Catra moves up a little to kiss Adora. "You look... so hot right now?" Catra says, turning her head to the side. It sounds like a question more than a statement.

"Why's that?" Adora asks, raising an eyebrow. Catra lifts her hand, her thumb pulling Adora's lip down for a moment.

"Seeing me all over your mouth." Catra whispers. "Kiss me." Adora is more than happy to do that. Adora lowers herself down and kisses Catra, laughing as the brunette starts licking her, and not in a kissing sense, literally just licking her mouth.

"You're so gross." Adora says, chuckling and smiling so wide she might get stuck that way.

"I like tasting me on you." Catra says dismissively, licking Adora one more time before she falls back down. "You really went for that there. I felt like I literally ascended to another plain of existence."

"Why thank you, ma'am," Adora says with a smug smile. "You're feeding my ego." Catra moves her hand up Adora's back. They just enjoy each other's company for a moment before Catra stirs.

"Can we go to your throne?" Catra asks.

"My throne?" Adora asks and Catra nods. "Yeah, sure, of course." Adora stands up, she was still dressed, but Catra wasn't.

She helps Catra up and then she picks up her cape and wraps it around Catra's shoulders, so she was covered. Catra purrs as soon as the fabric touches her and then she walks to the throne room. Adora follows after her. She climbs the steps to her throne and sits on it, patting her thighs for Catra to come join her. Catra nestles herself happily into Adora's lap and Adora smiles softly.

“Do you remember that thing we did that one time?” Catra asks. “When you hit me?” Adora wasn’t expecting that question but *of course* she remembers that. “What would you say to doing that again?” Adora looks away for a moment. She *wants* to, but Adora just doesn’t know if she *can* .

“I…” Adora trails off. She works her jaw from side to side as she considers what she’s about to say. “I have no desire to hurt you, Catra. Ever since… Ever since I… stabbed you… I know we’ve done impact play before, and I *really* loved it, I just don’t think I could ever do that again after what I did.” Adora feels a little breathless after her confession but Catra listens patiently.

Adora chances a look at Catra. She was staring at her attentively, her ears perked forward and her lips pressed firmly together; when she noticed Adora looking at her she offered her a gentle smile. “It’s okay.” Catra reassures. “I enjoyed it, I *really* liked it, I’d be more than willing to do more stuff like that with you, Adora.” Catra purrs softly as she rubs her cheek against Adora’s. “I understand that it’ll take time, but I like being… I trust you enough to give myself to you, completely. You don’t want to hurt me, I know that, just like I don’t want to hurt you when I use my claws. It’s not about hurting each other, it’s about *trusting* each other.” Adora’s heart soars a little at Catra’s words and she nods in total agreement with her. “And it *really* turns me on.” Adora laughs at that and presses her nose to the side of Catra’s face as she affectionately nuzzles her.

Catra was right, it would probably take Adora time to reconcile the trauma of that event to allow herself to ever hit Catra in a sexual sense ever again. “What if I’m never ready?” Adora asks nervously. Catra rolls her eyes fondly but Adora doesn’t feel the least bit insulted. Catra kisses her on the cheek.

“Then that’s okay, Dummy.” Catra reassures. “I love taking your strap even when you haven’t hit me first.” Adora lets out a breathy laugh but she bites her lip in worry. “What are you thinking?”

“I’m thinking about all the things I want to do to you but… I don’t know if I’m ready.”

“Why don’t you tell me what those things are?” Catra purrs and Adora shudders.

“You want to know my fantasies?” Adora asks quietly. Catra nods and presses a kiss to Adora’s lips. Adora smiles into the kiss. She hums for a moment, thinking about what she wanted to say. Catra asked her, *right?* She should just tell her. “Lots of things,” Adora whispers. “I want to tie you up, I want to make you cum until you can’t take it anymore, I want to make you *mine* .”

“Fuck, Adora…” Catra says breathlessly and Adora can tell by her tone that she’s *turned on.* “Keep going.”

“I want to use She-Ra on you, I want to hit you again, I want… I want to bury myself in you, fingers and strap, and never leave you.” Adora’s voice was laced with desire but as she spoke she started to *think* and Adora has a terrible habit of overthinking.

Catra is clearly riled up but she also seems to sense Adora’s inner turmoil. She pokes her on the forehead playfully and Adora huffs out a laugh. "Stop thinking. You're allowed to just *want* , Adora." Catra says. Adora smiles weakly and then Catra kisses her jaw, gently cupping it with her hand. "What if I took care of you?" Catra offers and Adora raises her eyebrows. "Give up control to me, Hot Stuff. I'll take care of you, I promise."

Giving up control terrifies Adora, but she also trusts Catra not to take advantage of her while she is in a vulnerable state. Adora looks down where her strap is and then up at Catra. “I figured you wanted a ride.” Adora says, cocking her head to the side.

“Who says I don’t?” Catra asks.

She stands up from the throne and drops the cape draped around her shoulders. Adora takes a sharp breath in at the sight of Catra’s naked body - Adora’s favourite sight. Adora wants to *worship* her. Catra extends her claws and slices away Adora’s clothes and Adora doesn’t protest; she simply allows Catra to undress her. “You are so gorgeous.” Adora whispers. Sometimes she can’t believe Catra chose *her* .

“You’re not too bad looking yourself.” Catra replies playfully and Adora rolls her eyes fondly. Catra picks up Adora’s strap and then she starts to step into it *herself* . Adora’s eyes widen and she suddenly feels very *alive* . She sits up a little on her throne and Catra’s ears twitch as she picks up Adora’s sudden movements. “Okay,” Catra says, laying her hands on

Adora's shoulders. “This is what I'm thinking. You get this strap nice and wet and then I can fuck myself on it.” Adora swallows thickly.

“Y-Yes.” Adora nods. “I *really* want to do that.”

“I have rules.” Catra says as she runs her hand along the length of the strap. Adora never knew that she'd be so turned on by Catra wearing her strap but she really fucking is. She could get used to this sight if she wasn't careful. “If you touch, you lose your rights to *see* and *touch* ,” Catra says and her voice sounds different, it's insanely *sexy* . “Understood, Adora?” Adora nods; Catra gives her a *look* .

“Yes, yes, understood. No touching.” Adora says. She's excited but she never really thought about how hard *not* touching Catra would be for her. Catra nods and then she comes towards Adora again.

Catra stands up on the throne, using the back of it to support herself. Adora looks up at her and then down to the strap with a little bit of nervousness. Okay, that's a lie, a *lot* of nerves. "I-I've never done this, Catra." Adora says as she stares at the strap. She *has* done this, but she's never been the one to suck on it. Catra looks down at her with soft eyes.

"It's okay baby, I know," She says. "You won't be able to talk, so if you tap my leg twice, I'll stop immediately, I promise." Catra reassures and Adora believes her. "I won't go too hard either, you have my word." Catra's word is all Adora needs. Her stomach still feels a little queasy with worry but she feels *safe* with Catra. Letting Catra take control is fine, she won't hurt her.

Adora blames Shadow Weaver for this. It's hard to let go and enjoy submitting to someone you love when the thought of how this could end in Adora being captured - or worse - runs rampant through her mind. But she *trusts* Catra, so she nods.

Adora looks at Catra's pussy, she can't see it fully, since it's covered by the strap, but she can see she's wet already. Adora reaches up, intending to touch but Catra grabs a fistful of her hair and yanks her head back to make her look up. Adora's pupils blow wide when she feels the wonderful sense of pain - maybe she did enjoy being manhandled by Catra, just a little. "No touching," Catra warns. "Or your looking rights will be revoked, remember?" Adora nods.

She is completely captivated by Catra. She is perfect. In every sense of the word. Her skin is flawless, her eyes sparkle and the blue-yellow of them are vivid and beautiful, her hair is a little ruffled from their activities but still impeccable. Catra has her baby bump right now, but before she had had toned abdominal muscles, and abs that Adora would be more than willing to run her tongue over, and her boobs? Adora had loved them before but now they were bigger and they were oh so tempting.

Catra raises an eyebrow and Adora shakes her head a little to clear her massive lesbian thoughts. "What?" Adora asks. Catra laughs softly and her grip in her hair turns to gentle petting.

"I asked if you were ready, babe?" Catra asks and Adora makes an 'oh' sound. She looks back at the strap before meeting Catra's eyes.

"I'm ready." She says, hardening her eyes into one of determination. Catra laughs a little.

"You always like to be the best at everything you do, don't you?"

"I *am* the best at everything I do." Adora says with a smug smile.

"You talk too much, Lord Adora." Catra moves forward, placing the tip of the strap to Adora's lips. She stays there, seemingly waiting for Adora's permission again.

Adora holds Catra's eyes as she parts her lips and slowly eases the strap into her mouth. Adora moves slowly while Catra remains still. She's never really thought about what her strap feels like - or what it tastes like - before, she's never really had to. It's firm, definitely, but also soft, almost like skin. It tastes sweet with a little twist of salt that is weirdly addicting.

Adora knows Catra isn't moving because she wants Adora to adjust before she tries anything. Adora moves her mouth experimentally before she decides she's ready. She looks up at Catra and nods, her mouth still around the strap.

Catra purrs and moves her hips a little, she threads her fingers through Adora's short locks and then she starts *thrusting* . Adora's eyes widen, she wasn't exactly expecting the strap to almost hit the back of her throat. She gags a little before she starts to concentrate, getting a hold of her faculties and easily adjusting to Catra's movements.

True to her word, Catra doesn't go too hard but she isn't too gentle either. She's just right. Adora becomes comfortable, after a while, moving her tongue and stroking the underside of the strap with it while sucking. She lifts her hands to grab Catra's legs and bob her head back and forth. She hears Catra's breath hitch as she does so and the brunette's hips move harder. Adora *relishes* in it, especially when Catra grabs her hair and lets out a long moan of pleasure.

"Good Adora," Catra breathes. "Take me." Something about Catra telling her to take it makes Adora flush with desire. An uncontrollable need to please Catra. She opens her mouth more and squeezes Catra's legs in a silent plea for her to go harder - as hard as she wants.

Catra takes her hint and speeds up, driving the strap to the back of Adora's throat. It burns, and it hurts a little, but she wants to take *all* of Catra. Adora groans and Catra grips her hair tighter before praise fills Adora's ears. Things like ' *good girl* ', ' *you're doing so good* ' and hisses of *'yes'* in pleasure, is music to Adora's ears. She likes to be praised, she always has, figures it would be a major kink to her.

Catra stops after a moment, pulling out of Adora's mouth. Adora is almost disappointed by that. A string of spit connects her to the strap and her breath is somewhat laboured, her throat sore and her cheeks flushed but she feels proud of herself. Catra pets her hair lovingly as her legs *shake* . Adora wasn't one to toot her own horn (she was) but *she* did *that* .

After a moment, Catra hops down and lands in front of Adora. Adora smiles up at Catra and she stares down at Adora. "... What? Did I do something wrong?" Adora asks with sudden anxiety.

"No..." Catra says, before she kisses Adora on her lips. "You look beautiful after sucking my strap." Adora isn't sure what it is, but those words *wreck* her. "But you touched, so now I revoke your seeing and touching rights." Catra says and Adora raises her eyebrows.

"Is that so, Kitten?" Adora asks. Catra nods and then she walks over to one of the Horde symbol banners and pulls it down. "Are you destroying my throne room?"

"Oh no, my dear Adora, that's not what your punishment is going to be." Something about Catra talking about punishing her is a *significant* turn on.

Catra saunters back over, her hips swaying, Adora's eyes fall to the strap that Catra is *still* wearing. "Shuffle forward, Commander." That was a new title that Adora was not expecting but she complies without argument. "Hands behind your back." Catra orders and Adora does as she's told. She feels Catra tie the fabric around her hands, tight enough to hold her but not too tight to hurt her.

Catra then comes back around and presents more fabric. "Are you okay with this?" Catra asks. Adora appreciates that Catra asks her if she's okay with all of this but the answer is *hell yes* . Adora nods and then Catra brings the fabric up to her eyes and ties it in place behind her head. Adora feels excited, which she never thought she would in a situation like this: she's restrained, she's naked, she's lost her sight, she is at the *complete* submission of Catra, but she's not afraid, a little nervous, sure, but not afraid.

Adora listens patiently to the jingling of the harness as Catra takes the strap off. "Okay," Catra speaks, and somehow it's more enhanced than usual. Adora figured the loss of sight meant that her other senses were more acute. Catra starts pulling the strap up Adora's legs. "Sit up a little." Adora does as she's told and lifts up so the strap can sit right where it needs to sit. "You got this strap nice and wet for me, didn't you?" Catra asks and Adora nods.

Not being able to touch or see is kind of killing her. Adora *loves* to touch Catra and she *especially* likes to watch her. Adora feels Catra climb into her lap, her hands flex as though to grab Catra before she realises *she can't* . Next moment, she feels Catra's breath brush against her lips. "I love you, Adora." Catra whispers and Adora's lips part in a silent gasp as Catra moves closer to her and kisses her. Adora happily takes the opportunity to kiss Catra and she will *always* happily kiss Catra.

The kiss starts soft, but quickly turns heated as Catra swipes her tongue along Adora's lips and then slips her tongue into Adora's *mouth* . Adora moans softly as she allows Catra to have her way with her, moving her lips against Catra's but not fighting her for dominance.

Catra purrs and pulls back, leaving Adora a panting mess. Adora isn't sure how one kiss can leave her feeling ragged and wrecked but she thinks maybe that's just a Catra thing. She is *destroyed* by the most simple of things that Catra does. "I think you left something out of your fantasy that you haven't admitted yet." Catra says. Adora turns her head to the side in silent question. "We'll revisit that another day, right now, I want to ride you until I cum." Adora takes a sharp breath in at Catra's words.

"You're not allowed to cum until I say so, understood Adora?" Catra asks.

"Y-Yes ma'am." Adora answers.

"Good girl." Adora can hear Catra's grin in those words.

Adora can feel Catra shifting but she can't *see* her. She knows *exactly* when Catra starts to lower herself on the strap, not only because of the sudden pressure of the strap pressing down against her clit, but also the *sounds* . Catra uses Adora's shoulders to keep her steady, clinging to her. Adora sees flashes of Catra's pussy being split in half by her strap in her mind and her hips jerk up.

Catra gasps and then her claws dig into Adora's shoulders in a warning. "Easy there, or I'll have to punish you more." Adora groans but complies, keeping completely still as she listens to the soft sighs and gasps that escape Catra before they *meet* . Catra takes a moment, her arms loop around Adora's shoulders and she scratches softly at the base of Adora's neck, just at where her hair met her neck. Then she starts *moving* .

" *Fuck* ! *Catra* !" Adora moans at the same time Catra does. The sounds are *wonderful* , the sound of *wetness* as Catra glides up and down Adora's strap - not to mention the sounds Catra was making with her mouth. Something about the sound is hotter than anything Adora has ever seen or heard before. She thinks she could listen to Catra get herself off and it would push her to the edge.

Catra wraps her arms tighter around Adora's neck and speaks right next to her ear while she continues to pleasure herself on Adora's strap. "You're doing so good, Adora," Catra moans. Adora can *feel* Catra's wetness drip down the strap and onto Adora herself.

Adora moves her hips in an attempt to fuck Catra herself and it results in her finding a rhythm and pressure against her clit that feels *amazing* . She whimpers and Catra kisses her to swallow the sound. "You're mine, my Lord, my commander, my sir, my *Adora* . All *mine* ." Catra says and Adora nods quickly.

"All yours..." Adora says, choking on a moan as Catra plunges down on the strap at the same time Adora thrusts up. "I belong to you, and only you."

"Damn right you do." Catra growls as she says that and Adora whines in response. She's enjoying this way more than she ever thought she would.

"Please..." Adora actually *begs* . "Let me touch you, Catra." Adora pleads. "I want to touch you."

"No." Catra refuses and the refusal both deflates and elevates Adora's desire and mood. "You've been a bad girl, Adora, you have to prove to me you're good." Adora nods, her mouth falling open in a silent moan as Catra roughly jolts down on her strap.

Catra starts cursing and moving erratically, Adora can barely keep up with her thrusts but she drives up into her at every opportunity that Catra drives down onto her. "Fuck... I'm so close..." Adora hears being whispered in her ear. Adora feels overcome with determination to make Catra cum.

She moves as hard as she can with no hands to keep Catra steady, using the back of her throne for support. Catra's resulting moan of pleasure tells Adora all she needs to know. She keeps that up, and Catra withdraws her hand - probably to rub at her clit. " *Yes ... Adora ...* right there..." Catra pants between moans and then Adora *feels* Catra clamp down around her strap and her fluids drip down the strap as they wet Adora's lap.

Adora isn't finished.

She feels a surge of power and feels her body shift, Catra gasps as Adora transforms into *She-Ra* . She's never done that before, transformed without her sword, or saying the words - she

supposes that her sword is *technically* attached to her. She breaks the binds on her hands easily and she pushes forward, scooping Catra up and landing her on her back on the ground.

Adora grabs her blindfold off so she can finally see Catra's pretty face. She looks flushed and Adora doesn't know if it's because of She-Ra, or because of Adora breaking her restraints so easily. It feels good to finally feel She-Ra again, to be able to become her and stay in control. She hadn't intended to transform, just that she wanted to break her binds and She-Ra's strength was needed for that, she hadn't even thought she *could* transform - seems like that issue was fixed now.

Adora adjusts Catra, pushing her legs back while Adora crouches over her in a mating press. Catra wraps her legs around Adora's waist and blinks up at her slowly. "Fuck me, Adora." Adora doesn't wait to be told twice.

She drives into Catra without hesitance and without reluctance. Adora was determined to pull another orgasm out of Catra as she met her own peak. Catra claws at Adora's back as she becomes a stream of moans and curses. Adora becomes aware of the fact that she's clothed due to her transformation but she doesn't care. " *Adora* !" Catra gasps. "Cum inside of me." Adora feels her arousal peak at that. She fucks Catra good and hard and it's not long, with Catra being so sensitive, that she tips her over the edge yet again.

The way that Catra's walls clamp and grip Adora's strap allows her to hit her clit just right. She glows as her strap grows hot and she spills into Catra, her cum hot and thick. Catra practically *yowls* as she cums yet again, her claws no longer holding back and digging into Adora's back. Adora's back has practically become a scratching post by this point but she isn't really complaining.

They stay there for a long moment, panting and hot as they come down from their highs. Eventually, Adora pulls out and rolls over onto her back. Catra sits up to do her wiggles without a second thought. "Holy shit..." Catra says after a moment, falling down beside Adora on the floor, turning over to cuddle into her chest. "She-Ra's power..." Catra trails off but her purr really says it all.

Adora feels She-Ra slipping away and she transforms back so that it's just her, Adora, lying on the ground of her throne room, naked, in her strap, staring up at the ceiling with Catra beside her. "I really enjoyed that." Adora mumbles. Her throat is a little husky off of her moaning and yelling, and it *aches,* but it was totally worth it.

"I think we need a shower." Catra comments with a chuckle.

" *You* definitely do," Adora teases. "You're leaking all over my floor."

"I think you'll find, that's completely your fault."

" *Cum inside me, Adora.* " Adora imitates and Catra hits her chest.

"Shut up." Catra rolls her eyes but her cheeks are rosy. Adora smiles happily. She feels satisfied and content. "You made me cum about five times in one session." Catra murmurs quietly and, yeah, that totally makes Adora's ego skyrocket a little.

"I've really missed doing that with you." Adora comments.

"Me too." Catra agrees but she sounds like she has more to say. She waits a moment before she speaks again. "You don't... Do you still view our relationship as... just sex?" Catra sounds nervous, a little insecure, and Adora turns her head to look at her. Catra looks beautiful, she *always* looks beautiful, but the way her sweat makes her hair curl more than usual, the way her chest rises and falls as she catches her breath. She looks so pretty after being completely wrecked by Adora.

Adora turns on her side and cups Catra's face in her hands. "Catra... The sex is amazing but... No." She answers. "I love you for you, not for the way you feel around my strap." Catra rolls her eyes and she pokes Adora on her stomach. Adora giggles a little at the sensation which makes Catra smile. Adora *loves* making Catra smile, so she'll take the win.

"The sex is pretty amazing." Catra admits. "I love you too, Dummy."

"It's a good thing you're already pregnant," Adora says, leaning up to peck Catra on her lips. "Or we would've made a second baby."

"We need to figure that out, because you cumming inside of me is really fucking hot, and I'm into it, but I'm not into being impregnated accidentally on multiple occasions." Catra sits up and stretches. Adora watches her, from the way her back arches, to the way she moans softly as her muscles find relief.

Adora wraps her arms around her waist and drags her down again, like a lion pouncing on its prey. Catra lets out a wonderful yelp of surprise. " *Adora* !" She scolds playfully but she's laughing.

"How many kids do you want?" Adora asks curiously. Catra turns around in her arms to look up at her. She kisses Adora on her jaw and, if Adora could purr, she'd be doing it right now.

Catra's tail coils around her ankle and Adora knows they're lying on the ground, not exactly the most comfortable place to lie, but she doesn't want to move for a second. "I don't know," Catra yawns and every time she yawns it's *amazing* . It's so dramatic and not at all needed, a cross between a moan and a yowl - it also shows off all rows of those sharp teeth. "I never even thought I'd have *one* ."

"Really?" Adora asks.

"Mhmm... Never really thought about it before until it happened." Catra says. "I love Finn already, but I never really... I don't know, kids were always a maybe, in the future, kind of thing. Sometimes they're cute, sometimes I see kids and I think, never will I ever want one of those, but I guess it's different now that I'm mated and with someone I love on a level that literally can't be explained." Adora smiles softly and she kisses Catra on the nose. "Anyway, maybe two? I was an only child, and it was nice I was the only one when it came to getting my moms' attention, but... It could be lonely, you know? As a royal, I was friends with Bow and Glimmer since I was basically in diapers and, on some level, they are my family. But I don't know, sometimes I think it would be nice to have had a little brother, or sister, or sibling."

"I like the idea of a big family." Adora admits quietly. "Don't get me wrong... I'm freaked out I might be a bad mom," Adora sees Catra frown at those words but she powers on through. "But growing up in the Fright Zone, your squad was like your family, you know? I think three or four kids would be nice."

"Are you planning on sharing that burden?" Catra asks lightly.

"Well, only She-Ra can make the cum we need." Adora replies just as teasingly. Catra rolls her eyes and falls silent. It's nice to picture a future, but little do they know if they'll ever actually get to experience a future together.

"We should get cleaned up." Adora says, hoping to scare away the shadow that had fallen over Catra's features. Catra nods and Adora stands. She shimmies out of her strap and transforms it back to her sword, she rests it against the throne and then helps Catra to her feet. She starts leading her back to her room and then they head straight for the shower, kissing each other at every opportunity they got.

Catra sighs as she leans against the sink. "I have to go back." She says. Adora pauses what she was doing (hanging towels) and turns to face her. "I don't want to..." Catra admits quietly and then she laughs bitterly. "I never thought I'd never want to go home, but I don't."

"Catra..." Adora looks at how *sad* Catra looks and her heart aches. "If you want to stay, then you should stay. I would wage a thousand wars just for you to be happy." Adora steps towards her and Catra smiles slightly which Adora takes as a major win.

"As noble as that is," Catra begins. "I can't. I don't want to keep fighting a war, and I especially don't want you to get hurt."

"I'm very constitutional, I could take it." Adora says and Catra shakes her head. She grabs Adora by her wrist and drags her into the shower.

"I don't want you to, Adora." Catra says. "I can handle my family, they won't kill me, I don't know what they'd do to you... And I don't intend to find out." Adora smiles a little as Catra guides her under the shower and starts to wash her hair. "They need to get over themselves and listen to me, and I don't intend to let you get caught in the crossfire in the meantime." Catra whispers quietly. "Besides, I think Luna might like you."

"I'm very charming." Adora says with a grin as Catra lathers up her hands and works the shampoo into Adora's short hair. Catra rolls her eyes but a smile tugs at the corners of her lips. "Before you go, after we shower, we can nap and I want to take you somewhere, if you'll follow me?"

"Always." Those words warm Adora's heart and she rinses her hair as Catra begins touching her body, soaping her up. "I've technically stayed longer than I already should have." Catra admits. "I owe Spinnerella and Netossa my life. They're the only reason I'm here, but if I don't go back soon, my mom will probably storm the Fright Zone." Adora rinses off the soap as Catra's finger traces her back. "I scratched you up pretty good..."

"It felt good." Adora says. "It *always* feels good."

"Why do you think you like pain and pleasure so much, Adora?" Catra asks gently. Adora pauses and then she turns to face Catra again.

"Probably because I grew up with pain... I don't know. It just works for me." Catra hums and passes Adora the shower supplies. She starts with washing Catra's hair, being extra gentle with her ears, cupping them and running her fingers up and down the backs of them. Catra starts to purr and her eyes fall closed as Adora gently fondles her ears.

"That... feels... *sogood* ..." Catra sighs and Adora smiles. She could stay here all day, touching Catra's ears, but, when they flick and gently splash shampoo off of them, Adora lets Catra carefully rinse the soap out.

Adora begins to lather her hands up with soap and presses Catra up against the tiled wall of the shower, she then begins to work the soap into Catra's body and fur. Catra isn't completely covered in fur, it's just thicker in places that Etherian people's hair is: like down her stomach leading to her pubic hair, a little on her spine, specifically where her tail meets, her elbows and she has sideburns, which are so cute and that Adora terms as her ‘cheek fluff’, also her stripes. Catra's skin is also extremely soft and she's practically Adora's walking sensory dream.

Adora sets about meticulously cleaning Catra. This is secretly one of her favourite things, she's not sure why, she just likes touching Catra and showering together is the perfect opportunity and excuse to do that. "This takes me back." Adora comments, remembering

when they'd showered together all those months ago. She'd loved that entire experience so much. Catra purrs in answer, her tail swishing.

Adora turns her around so her front was pressed to the shower wall instead. She begins to wash her tail, scratching at the base of it. "Remember how I got you off doing this just a little while ago?"

"Adora," Adora is sure that's supposed to be a scold but it comes out more like a moan. "No starting anything, you already made me cum five times."

"What's a sixth?" Adora teases. Catra huffs and turns back around.

"Not right now." She says as she rinses herself under the water, washing away Adora's hard work. "I want to nap with you, then we'll go wherever it is you want to go, and then... I'll have to leave."

"Sounds like a plan." Adora admits and then she steps forward, kissing Catra under the stream of water. *Like we're kissing in the rain.* Adora remembers saying that to Catra when they'd first done this, it still felt like that. They finish up showering, dry themselves down and settle into the bed to cuddle before they'd have to eventually say goodbye.

* * *

Adora pulls herself up the rest of the way to see Catra already sitting at the ledge. Adora smiles a little at the sight. Catra looks ethereal against the backdrop of one of Etheria's moons and her tail swishes behind her contently. Adora walks towards her, her boots making heavy footfalls to alert Catra to the fact that she had finally caught up to her. Even pregnant Catra was still a fast climber and, while Adora had been doing better after eating and actually taking care of herself, she still wasn't fully up to her normal fitness levels.

Adora sits down silently beside Catra, dangling her feet over the edge of the tower. She's all too aware that this might be their final time together, or that they might not see each other again for a while after Catra leaves again. "You wanna tell me what you're thinking?" Adora asks after a moment, not wanting to sit in silence for the few moments they might have left.

"I'm thinking about how I wish we could stay like this." Catra replies, eyes up at the sky as she enjoys the gentle breeze that caresses her skin. "I don't really want to go back... I want to stay here with you."

"I want that too." Adora says as she bumps her shoulder gently against Catra's. "But you were right, your mom would start another war if you stayed."

"I know. I hate it so much. I hate being away from you." Catra turns her attention back to Adora. "I wish we could pretend they didn't know, that it was just us again and no one else."

"Well... Hey, even when we're apart we're still together." Adora says. "Which I realise makes little to no sense but I just mean... Even if we're not physically together, we're still together, you know? I feel you, right here." Adora pats her chest with her finger, indicating where her heart was.

"I feel you too, but being away from you hurts." Adora feels her heart drop a little to hear the hurt that lines Catra’s tone.

"It hurts me too." Adora says quietly as she looks out over the Fright Zone.

"Do you think one day we'll get to be together, Adora?"

"I sure hope so." Adora still hasn't told Catra the beginnings of the plan that's been forming in her mind, and she was unlikely to. She knew Catra would likely not approve of it and she didn’t want to worry her until there was something to worry about.

"Sometimes I find it hard to believe, what with how the Alliance has been acting." Catra murmurs. Which is fair, they hadn’t exactly been the most supportive.

"If I let the alliance stop me from doing things then... Well, my entire existence is dependent on me refusing to do as they say." Adora tries for a gentle joke and it results in Catra rolling her eyes at her.

"You're not wrong." She giggles, holding out her hand. "Technically we came from that too." Adora takes Catra's hand and then kisses it.

"This isn't the last time we will see each other, Catra. I promise."

"You can't promise me that, Love."

"I can promise you anything I want to promise you." Adora replies.

"Adora..." Adora turns to face Catra, giving her a look of determination.

"This *won't* be the last time we see each other. We have a *baby* , and we love each other. I'd move Etheria, the moons, to be with you." Adora vows. She means every single word. There is not a single thing that Adora would not do to be with Catra. She would move mountains.

"Adora..." Catra gasps softly. Her eyes widen at Adora’s passionate declaration. "That's so... romantic." Adora smiles and then stands, offering her hand to Catra for her to take.

"Feel like dancing? Before you have to go." Adora offers.

"Just like our first date?" Catra asks, smiling softly. Adora laughs a little and helps Catra to her feet.

"Just like our first date." Adora confirms. "I plan to kiss you enough to last me a while before I can kiss you again."

"Please do." Catra smiles happily, letting Adora pull her in. Catra rests her forehead against Adora's and Adora *drinks* her in. "I want to enjoy this moment for as long as I can."

"Have I mentioned how much I enjoy touching you?" Adora asks with a soft smile as her hands gently caress Catra's back.

"You've said it quite a few times, Love." Adora hums as she enjoys just being close to Catra.

"Well I mean it."

"I know. I love you." She whispers, hugging Adora close and purring. "Adora... could you say it again? The promise?" Adora leans back a little to look at Catra. She kisses her on her lips, softly and full of love, before she whispers against them.

"I *promise* , this won't be the last time that we're together." Adora says quietly, like a secret.

"Thank you." Catra whispers back. Adora smiles and then she scoops Catra up off of her feet - struggling only a little. She'd regained significant strength the past couple of days thanks to her appetite finally returning.

"I'd steal you away if I could." Adora confesses. "I wish I could carry you off to bed again... but I doubt we have the time."

"We really don't have time. I'll have to return back to Half-Moon soon." Adora spins Catra around and then kisses her again.

"Can I ask you something?" Adora asks.

"Anything." Catra smiles into the kiss, holding Adora's face gently. Adora pauses for a long moment, trying to decide if she really wants to know the answer to the question or even if she wants to ask it in the first place.

"Are they hurting you?" Adora asks quietly, holding Catra's gaze. Catra stays silent for a while. Looking as though she was considering how to answer.

"Not directly. They're just breaking my heart with how they're being." Catra answers. Adora's brows stitch together in a soft frown. She didn't like Catra being hurt, in any shape or form, she wanted only happiness for her.

"You know that if anyone lays a hand on you I'll kill them, right?" Adora asks, clearly not joking. Adora would literally rip them apart. "If anyone hurts you, I don't care if I'm not allowed in Rebellion territory, I will kill them, I'll storm the castle if I have to."

"I know, babe." Catra smiles, her eyes sparking a little. "It makes me happy to see how protective you are of me."

"I'd protect you with my life." Adora whispers as she gently bumps her nose against Catra's.

"I know."

"I'm sorry Catra." Adora speaks quietly. She knows she's already apologised, but she wants Catra to hear it again. "I never meant for all of this to happen. I don't want to be the reason you lose your friends and your family. I never wanted to hurt you. Do you ever think about what would have happened if you hadn't offered to sleep with me that night after Princess Prom?"

"I wouldn't have found the woman that I love." Catra quickly interjects. "Adora, I have met so many people that my moms have tried to set me up with. None of them have ever made me feel the way that you did. You're mine, and I'm yours, it was always meant to be that way."

"It's weird when you think about it," Adora says with a small smile. "Always meant to be, but we were enemies. You'd think it was never meant to be."

"You would think so, but we fell for each other so hard and so fast."

"What if you had stuck to your guns and refused to sleep with me again?" Adora asks. "What would've happened then?"

"I honestly don't think I would have been able to hold strong and not do it again." Catra admits with a flushed face. That does manage to inflate Adora's ego somewhat.

"You're pretty weak for me." Adora teases. "It's okay, I've seen how I look in a mirror, I get it."

"Idiot, what I mean is… You remember that kiss before I left the first time?" Adora knows *exactly* what kiss Catra is talking about. The one where she had lifted her cape to shield them from everyone else.

"Of course I do," Adora says. "How could I forget? It's also the first time we kissed outside of the bedroom."

"In that moment, I almost didn't leave, Adora. It was... I don't know how to describe it." Adora's eyebrows lift in surprise. She hadn't been expecting *that* .

"You almost didn't leave? After I kissed you?" Catra nods.

"It just felt so... *perfect* ." Adora slowly starts to smile at Catra's words.

"Wow..." Adora says. "So what you're saying is, I'm a very good kisser."

"Oh my gosh, get your head out of your ass. You almost didn't let go of my hand that day."

"I-” Adora gives Catra a mock offended look. "I think you have that twisted, you almost didn’t let go of *my* hand that day. Clearly you wanted more of those kisses."

"So what *I'm* hearing is, you weren't the one begging me to come back for a second spin?" Catra raises an eyebrow.The edges of Adora's lips quirk up and her eyes shine with amusement.

"I wouldn't say begging." She says. "Besides, I could tell you wanted to go for more than a second spin."

"Sure, asshole." Adora laughs lightly and shakes her head in fond amusement.

"I know what you mean." She finally admits. "I knew after that kiss that I couldn't stay away from you."

"Yeah?"

"I wanted... I don't think fighting you again ever crossed my mind. I just wanted you back in my bed."

"And back in your arms?"

"With me." Adora confirms. "To kiss you, hold you, touch you." Adora moves her hand up to gently cup Catra's face. "I was fine pretending to fight you because it wasn't real. But after that first time, I don't think I could have ever actually seriously fought you again." Catra nuzzles Adora’s hand, she places her hand on top of Adora’s to keep it against her cheek.

"I know what you mean, I really do. In those three nights, I got to know you more than I ever thought I would, and I couldn't see myself harming you anymore." Adora laughs a little.

"You know, in a way, Shadow Weaver was right." Adora sees Catra's expression change at that and she hurries to explain. "I just mean, she taught me love was weakness... She was right. I didn't have the heart to fight you anymore, but I still believed in the Horde's mission." Adora says. "Except, I couldn't even execute that mission because I was too busy with you. I knew that if I did seriously attack the Rebellion, that you'd probably be mad at me, and I didn't want you to be mad at me." Adora sighs. "I guess you could say it was a weakness in that way, but it also gave me strength. Look how far I came with She-Ra because of you."

"I don't think she was right." Catra whispers, caressing Adora o her cheek. "Love isn't weakness. You just happened to find strength in other things outside of the mission you were force-fed since you were little. Strength isn't always physical, Adora. You know that, no?" Adora blinks.

"Uh... Totally. Totally know... that..."

"Dork, strength isn't only physical. You can be emotionally and mentally strong too."

"But it also makes you vulnerable." Adora argues. "Look how you're being treated just for being in love with me."

"Perhaps... but it's a choice I'm making. I'm choosing to stay because I don't want you, or anyone in the Fright Zone, to be hurt if I were to come here, or run away. I want to keep you all safe. Vulnerability isn't bad. After all, it's how we got to know each other."

"Is it?" Adora asks. "I thought we got to know each other because of sex."

"Well, yes and no. We could have had sex and I could have left immediately after, but I didn't. We stayed and opened up to each other about different things, Love."

"Huh... I guess we did..." Adora squints a little. "I never thought of it like that."

"It isn't really something you think of at first." Catra giggles and pats Adora's cheek. Adora rolls her eyes and then kisses Catra before she sets Catra down. She crouches down in front of her.

"Well, Finn, I guess I should say goodbye to you too, since I don't know when I'll next see you. Hopefully before you're born." Adora speaks to Catra's bump. "Catra will take good care of you." Adora kisses Catra's stomach and then she stands back up, looking at Catra.

"Adora, I love you, so much. Please make sure to take care of yourself and the others from now on, okay?" Catra requests, throwing her arms around the blonde and holding her close. "Finn and I need you."

"I will, I promise." Adora says, kissing Catra on top of her head. She guides Catra to the edge and they climb down together.

As they walk towards the hanger where the skiffs are kept, Adora is overwhelmed with reluctance. She doesn't want Catra to leave, not even a little bit, maybe she should kidnap her for real and keep her here. But she knows she can't. Catra is right. That will likely start up the war again and the Fright Zone is in no position for that - though Lonnie had said they'd defend her from the Rebellion if need be.

She sighs and stops at a skiff, turning to face Catra. "Adora, my love. No matter what happens, know that I will always love you, okay? No one, and I mean no one, could ever make me feel the way you do." Catra takes her hands, squeezing gently. Adora suddenly feels panicked as she squeezes Catra's hands back, gripping them.

"I-" She stops, her tongue feeling like lead. "No. This isn't goodbye, Catra."

"I know, I just want to make sure that you know how much I love you." Catra whispers, lifting the blonde's hands to her lips and kissing her knuckles.

"It's a see you later." Adora says, though her hands don't loosen to let Catra's hands go. "I love you too. I've never... I've never felt this way about anyone before. You're the only person I ever want to be with."

"Me too," Catra bites her lip. "Adora..."

"Yes?" Adora asks, looking at Catra's face rather than their interlocked hands.

"Kiss me?"

Adora half smiles and she lets go of Catra's hands to grab the edge of her cape. She lifts it up to shield them from any prying eyes as she grabs Catra by her shoulder and pulls her in. Adora kisses her like she did all those months ago when they first kissed like this. She kisses her like it might be the last time, but hoping that it wouldn't be. She communicates everything that she feels for her in that kiss, the things Adora still couldn't bring herself to say.

" *Mmm* ... Why the cape?" Catra asks, glancing at the lifted fabric that shields them. "We don't have to hide here, dork."

"Maybe I'm nostalgic," Adora whispers against Catra's lips, brushing her own against Catra's before she kisses them again. "Humour me."

"Okay..." Catra whispers, kissing Adora back gently. "It's really nice to kiss you like this."

"You must have kissed me a thousand times by now." Adora comments with a little amusement. It was nice to know that Catra still enjoyed kissing her.

"Your point? I'll never grow tired of your kisses, Love."

"That's kind of gay." Adora says with a grin as she kisses Catra again. "I don't want to ever leave this moment." *Can a moment last forever?* Adora doubted it, but she was determined to try.

"I don't want to go..." Catra murmurs, hands holding onto Adora tightly. "I'm afraid, Adora..." Catra left her sentence unfinished but her words were clear as day: *I'm afraid that if I go, this will be the last time I'll get to see you.* Adora was afraid of the same thing but seeing Catra's eyes looking at her with such *fear* and her *clinging* to Adora… It stirred something in Adora.

"Promise that if you need me, you'll find a way to tell me?" Adora asks. "Your friends, Spinnerella and Netossa, I know they're not fond of me after what I did, but they're the only people who will tell me if you need me. They'll help you." Adora reassures. "Don't be afraid. There isn't a universe in existence where I don't end up with you. In any life, in any world, it's always meant to be me and you. We will see each other again. I swear it." There was no way in *hell* that Adora would ever accept them being kept apart.

"I... Okay, I promise." Catra whispers and Adora breathes a small sigh of relief.

Adora reluctantly lets Catra go and then she steps back. "Well, you're definitely not walking back to the Rebellion. Take a skiff."

"Thank you." Catra says, kissing Adora on her cheek again. "I love you."

"Catra?" Adora speaks softly as her hand lands on Catra's hip to stop her for a moment. Catra stops and turns to look curiously at Adora. Her ears were turned fully towards Adora to listen to her fully. "What's the Rebellion to 'meant to be'?" Adora asks. "To soulmates? C'yra and the Rebellion can't keep me away from you, nothing can. Except for death himself and maybe not even then." Catra's jaw drops and she stares at Adora in silence. Her tail swishes back and forth and Adora is slightly impressed by her ability to render Catra speechless.

"You... You mean that?"

"I've never meant something more."

"You're making it harder to go back, Adora."

"Maybe that's my intention." Adora says with a smile, she wiggles her eyebrows playfully.

"Adora... You know I can't." Adora sighs and then hands Catra some keys.

"I know." She says. "It's just hard."

"Believe me, I know. But it has to be done, otherwise things will go more to shit than they already are." Catra says.

"I'm trying to track Double Trouble down for the shit they pulled. But I think they know how unhappy I am with them and they've gone to ground." Adora reveals.

"Well yeah, but they're also kind of the one who found me? Even if they were an asshole about it." Catra explains. Adora is slightly surprised that it sounds like Catra is defending DT.

"I'm not letting them off the hook." Adora shakes her head. She wouldn't let *anyone* off the hook for hurting Catra.

"Which is honestly fair." Catra shrugs.

"I also... I'm sorry about spying on you guys... war and all... ha..." Adora says nervously. She felt awkward about it and she wasn't sure how Catra would feel. She had *never* spied on specific Princesses, only used them for an advantage in battle plans. Still, Adora was worried that Catra would take it as a breach of trust.

"It's okay. I will say, I was kind of... sad when I found out. But DT did tell me that you forgot about them, so..."

"It wasn't anything personal." Adora says awkwardly. "Double Trouble used to spy for Hordak too. Their skills come in handy. I... I just used spies for intelligence."

"I figured, dork." Catra boops her nose and Adora smiles a little. "It's fine, I understand."

"You'd be happy to know all Horde spies have been recalled... Although... Now I'm wondering if that was a good idea." Adora frowns.

"It's too late to send them back now. It would look suspicious. It's best not to risk it, Love." Catra says. She's probably right but Adora would like to have a spy in the Rebellion to keep an eye out for Catra if nothing else.

"But..." Adora sighs. "You know, it's too bad DT is in hiding. They could pretend to be you and you could stay here."

"I doubt they'd fall for it. Our scent is different."

"Curse Magicat senses." Adora says. She honestly hadn't considered that - it's not something you mention when you don't have the scent ability. "Did they pretend to be me? I told them to stop doing that."

"They did, to show the Alliance what was happening between us." Adora sees Catra wince a little as she says it and she rubs her bicep with her hand. Adora frowns and sighs.

"I'm sorry, Kitten." Adora says again. She has done a lot to hurt Catra both directly and indirectly.

"It's not your fault. DT made that choice, not you." Catra assures.

"But they... The only reason they did that is because *I* didn't pay them."

"No. They could have chosen to tell you that you forgot to pay them. They made the choice to not do that and instead cause harm to me." Catra looks… Not mad but she looks serious, like she wouldn't accept Adora blaming herself for this.

"Well, when you put it like that." Adora concedes.

"You know I'm right." Catra says, crossing her arms over her chest and smiling smugly.

"I don't know if I'd go that far." Adora jokes gently.

"Bullshit."

"Nope, no bullshit."

"Yes, bullshit."

"You're so sexy when you say stuff like that to me." Adora says with a playful grin.

"Oh my gosh, you are so gay, Adora." Catra says shaking her head in total amusement as she gently shoves Adora's chest.

"That's good for you though." Adora points out and then kisses Catra on the lips. She is going to miss Catra *terribly* . "Are you sure there's not enough time for us to go one more round?" Adora asks.

"Unfortunately, no. They're bound to figure out that I'm missing soon."

"Not even five minutes?" Adora asks, giving her best puppy dog eyes.

"You know that with us, five minutes is never a thing." Catra says as she walks towards the skiff. Adora trails after her.

"You're right," Adora grins. "We go for *hours* ."

"Which leads into *days* ." Catra rolls her eyes fondly. "It's best not to start anything now.

""Fine," Adora concedes. "But next time we're together, five days of love making, deal?"

"Five days?"

"Or a week."

"You're really going for it, huh?"

"Going for it would be two weeks."

"I-" Catra stops and blinks and Adora smiles then kisses Catra again.

"I love you." Adora whispers. She knows they've said it a lot but who knows when they'll get to say it again?

"I love you too, babe." Catra purrs and kisses Adora back.

"Now. Get going." Adora encourages. Catra climbs up onto the skiff and starts the thing up.

"I'll see you again soon, my love." Catra says and Adora smiles.

"I'll see you soon." Adora confirms.

Adora sees Catra hesitate and then Adora realises that she was still wearing her cape. She begins to unfasten it from her shoulder guards but Catra shakes her head. “Keep it, Adora.” She says. “You can give it back to me one day.” Adora smiles so wide at that because that meant that *one day* they *would* be together again. “Besides, I know how much you love that thing. My mom would probably just burn it.” Catra shakes her head as she goes to the steering stick. Adora fixes her cape back in place and they hold each other’s eyes for a long moment before Catra nods and Adora nods back at her.

She leaves.

Adora watches her longingly until she disappears over the horizon and then some. Adora sighs. She remembers that ridiculous little poem that people would say: *If you really love something, set it free. If it comes back, it’s yours. If not, it wasn’t meant to be.* Or something. *Fuck that* , Adora thinks. If you love something, hold onto it with all of your might. She wasn’t giving up on this. She had a plan to put into action, and *nothing* was *ever* going to keep her away from Catra. Adora wasn’t going to wait. She was going to get what she loved and she was *never* going to let her go again.

Chapter End Notes

The way our chapters are always longer with smut. We figured we'd give you something good in the midst of the pain. Enjoy it while you can. ;) -M

Gonna try to reply to comments again, a lot going on right now in life and stuff so I haven't been able past few updates. Anyway, Adora being a romantic sap :') Also, the smut was real fun to write this chapter. Hope you all enjoyed! -S

As always you can find us on twitter @ceolordadora and our CC is the same! You can find me (S) on Tumblr @sherasswordstrap

Barricade

Chapter Summary

> "You really thought I wouldn't want to speak with you, my love? Do you have any idea what I would give to be able to see you in person and kiss you?" Catra asks.
>
> "No, I didn't really think you wouldn't want to talk to me. I know you find me irresistible." Adora says with a big goofy grin. Catra rolls her eyes. She can't believe she fell in love with the biggest dork on Etheria - and that said dork was Lord of the Horde.

Chapter Notes

> Happy Friday and happy update day!! Welcome back to Lord Adora shenanigans!! We hope y'all enjoy :)!

See the end of the chapter for more notes

Catra enters Bright Moon cautiously, a few people throw her dirty looks but she chooses to ignore them as she enters the castle and begins making her way inside. She already missed Adora greatly, and part of her wanted to go back to the Fright Zone and never leave ever again. Her heart ached being so far from the love of her life. Unfortunately for her, she manages to walk into the one person she had been hoping to avoid for as long as possible. Her mom, C'yra, blocks her path.

She stands in the hallway with her hands on her hips and a serious look on her face. "Where the hell have you been?" She asks. Nothing seemed chaotic, Catra figures that Spinnerella and Netossa must have done an *exceptional* covering for her because it seemed as though C'yra was only just now noticing she had been missing. Still, Catra wasn't in the mood for her.

"Where the hell have *I* been?" Catra asks back to her. "I find that it's none of your business where I've been. But I'm sure that you can probably tell." C'yra pauses and then she gently sniffs the air. Catra can tell the exact moment that C'yra smells Adora on her because her eyes narrow.

“Why on Etheria did you go there?!” C’yra asks in confusion - she even had the audacity to look *hurt* , as though Catra had betrayed her all over again.

"To be with my mate." Catra answers plainly - she figured that was pretty obvious. C’yra stares at Catra in utter disbelief and then she seems to notice the mark on Catra’s neck that Adora had given her.

“You let her bite you?!” C’yra exclaims, completely scandalised. “She is *not* your mate.” Catra narrows her eyes at her mom, mirroring her stance by crossing her arms over her chest and staring her down.

"You don't get to decide that." Catra says in defiance.

“The hell I don’t! I’m your *mother* !” Catra inhales sharply, biting her tongue. She looks at C'yra with disdain.

"You stopped being my mother the second you asked me to get rid of my kitten. You lost that right when you wouldn't even give me a chance to explain myself. You lost that right when I haven't even seen you in the infirmary when I was recovering after what *you* caused." Catra replies angrily. She was tired. She was tired of being pushed around, of doing whatever her mom wanted, of just taking whatever the hell C’yra threw at her. No more. She was her own person, and she was going to stand up for herself.

“What *I* caused?” C’yra asks. “ *You* caused this yourself when you decided to bed that... *Horde scum* .” C’yra gestures with her hand in vague anger. “You’re not seeing her again, you’re under house arrest, you’re not allowed to go anywhere without a guard.” Catra can’t *believe* this. C’yra is too damn stubborn. She doesn’t seem to care that what she’s doing is hurting Catra. Keeping her away from her mate, making her submit to rules, to punishment, it’s only damaging their relationship, but she clearly doesn’t care about that. Her own mother doesn’t even trust her, and Catra doesn’t trust *her* .

"Oh, so it wasn't you screaming at me and threatening to make me choose between my home and my child?" Catra snaps back. "You probably don't even care that you're part of the reason I'm like this, do you?" The anger and sadness inside of her was cascading from her lips, the previously happy scent having become a simple memory. C’yra had taken the warmth and the love she had felt from being with Adora and she had trampled all over it. "You probably only

saved me so that you wouldn't look like the bad person. Not because you *actually* cared. You probably would have been happy getting rid of me and Finn in one go!" Catra was *upset,* but she figured she had a right to be given the circumstances.

“C’yra...” C’yra blinks. “Of course not! You’re my *child* ! But that doesn’t change the fact that you betrayed *everyone* . I don’t want you gone, or worse, I’m trying to *protect* you! From yourself and certainly from that... woman. She almost killed you! *Twice* ! Adora is a bad person, she’s hurt you! Corrupted you... If you can’t see that, then I have to take it into my own hands.“ Catra shakes her head in disbelief.

"Betrayed everyone by *what* ? Falling in love?! By being with someone that I love! You wanna know what's so fucking ironic? You chose to believe the actual spy over your supposed child that you wanted to protect!" Catra cries out. "You don't know anything about us, considering none of you would even let me explain, because all you want to hear is the stupid fucking narrative that Adora is evil! You say you want to protect me from her, and from myself, and yet *she's* the one who saved me when you, and everyone here, are the reason I almost died again!" C’yra scoffs at her and Catra has to try *really* hard not to extend her claws.

“A necessary evil, Adora’s scent was the only thing that we could hope would bring you back because you were stupid enough to fall for someone’s lie and deceit. And I would have had her detained here right now had your other mother not helped her escape.” C’yra almost growls. “You fell in love with the Horde Lord, what isn’t clicking about that being a betrayal?! You realise she’s been destroying Etheria, right?! I don’t want to know anything about your relationship because it’s not happening. Not anymore. I forbid it.”

Catra looks coldly at her mom. She *never* thought they would end up here. She had hoped that C’yra would let her explain, but that was clearly not happening. She glares at her mom. "Fine."

“Fine.”

Catra clenches her jaw tightly, turning away from her mom as the scent of grief trailed behind her. "As you wish... *C'yra* ." She spits out. Catra sees C’yra recoil visibly in the corner of her eye when she calls her by her name rather than mama. The Queen runs her claws through her hair and turns to the Magicat royal guards near her.

“Follow her and make sure she doesn’t run off to the Fright Zone again.” The guards nod quickly and hurry after the Princess while C’yra storms off in the opposite direction that Catra was headed.

Catra hardly pays attention where she's going, and is grateful when she gets to her room without anyone stopping her. She slams the door closed, tears falling down her cheeks as she slides down to the floor. She had *never* felt more alone than in that moment. She regrets not staying with her mate - with *Adora* . Catra didn't even hear the guards before she had slammed the door shut. She had curled up at the door, still crying, and her grieving scent palatable through the door. She didn’t think that she could do this. She couldn’t lose Adora again and yet this time this had been a wilful loss, a necessary one, yet all Catra wanted to do was be held by the blonde.

Catra doesn’t know how long she sits there, knees pulled up to her chest and weeping when she hears the sound of shuffling through the door. Her ears twitch as someone knocks gently on the wood of the door. “C’yra... are you in there?” Catra recognised the voice as belonging to her other mother, Luna. Luna had been more… accepting, or at least open, but Catra wasn’t in the mood to deal with her.

"Go away..." Catra says weakly, but she knows that Luna will hear her thanks to her keen Magicat hearing.

“What’s going on? Why are there guards out here and why are you... grieving?” Luna asks. Catra is just so damn tired.

"I said, go away!" Catra yells and sniffles. "It's not like you'd care once you hear the reason anyway."

“Of course I’d care, kitten.” Luna says sadly. “Please let me in?”

"You didn't care when C'yra was yelling at me and calling me a traitor before! Leave me alone!" Catra buries her face in her hands trying (and failing) to stop her tears from flowing.

“Oh... Kitten...” Catra hears Luna sit down against the door, leaning against it. It was like they were leaning against each other, even if it were through a piece of wood. “A lot has happened between then and now. I... I reacted rashly, and said terrible things that I regret saying. Tell me what happened?”

"You think I trust you now?" Catra asks through the door. In fact, Catra found that she trusted very few of the Rebellion members. "Why don't you ask your wife what happened? Since she feels like she has the right to control everything for me." Luna takes a deep breath.

“C’yra and I don’t see eye to eye on this,” Luna admits. “and she’s your mother, not ‘my wife’. C’yra... I don’t expect you to trust me, but you do realise I’m the one who let Adora go, right?” Luna asks. Catra sighs and lifts her head up. She did know that, but it was still hard.

"She stopped being my mother when she said what she did." Catra whimpers, wiping her tears with the back of her hand. "And that doesn't change what you said. It doesn't make it hurt any less. Thanks for letting her go and making sure C'yra didn't kill her, but none of this would have happened had you all given me a chance to *explain* ."

“So explain it to me now.” Luna says softly. “I talked to Adora a little. She didn’t look too good. And she might not be a Magicat, but she had all the markers of a mate being separated from their mate. Of grieving. I could tell she loved you, a lot, enough to risk herself by coming here.” Catra probably shouldn’t get her hopes up, but she does anyway.

"Will you actually listen?" Catra asks hesitantly.

“Of course I will, kitten.” Luna answers softly. “I told you that I regret what I said to you at that moment, I’ve changed my mind and I... I never agreed with what Cy said about your kitten. I was going to stop her from saying anything else, but you were gone already.”

"I… I went to see her earlier. I missed her, and I wanted to make sure that she was okay." Catra starts off slowly. "I came back after I got to be with her and to make sure she was taking care of herself. Then C'yra came, yelling at me, demanding to know where I had been. She still won't let me explain anything and continues to say my feelings are a betrayal to everyone and, as you can probably tell, I'm on house arrest. She had the nerve to say Adora

isn't my mate and forbid our relationship." Catra sniffs. "I should have stayed with her. At least then I would have been happy."

“I see.” Catra hears Luna stand on the other side of the door. Catra knew that she couldn’t send the guards away, they’d always follow C’yra’s orders over her - since C’yra was the born royal Magicat, Luna was only royal by marriage. “You did the right thing by coming back, staying would have sent her on a warpath. I’ll talk to Cy and see if I can convince her to change her mind.”

"She won't." Catra sighs, certain. There was no reality where C’yra accepted her and Adora’s relationship. "It's not like she cares about me anyway. She won't even listen to what I have to say. She says she does, but all it feels like to me is her trying to control me to be what she wants me to be. Not what makes me happy. I don't want to be here. I miss Adora." Luna sighs and presses her hand against the door. Catra feels her ears press against her head.

“I will try, kitten.” She says. “I actually liked Adora. She really mouthed off to everyone for hurting you despite her being in danger, it was impressive.”

"She did that?" Catra asks in surprise. Luna laughs a little.

“Yes, she did.” Luna says. “We’d seen Adora’s anger before, and I thought she might get angry again, but she just took a deep breath and then told us all off before she marched on out.” Catra smiles a bit. “Or, well, right before she jumped out of a window.” Catra laughs for the first time since she left Adora.

"I love that dork so much." Catra whispers before frowning a bit. "Adora was a victim to the Horde's lies too." She finally starts to explain. "She was raised by the Horde since she was a baby."

“I know. She told me.”

"She did?" Catra asks with surprise. She supposes she still doesn’t know how much Adora actually talked with her mom before she was forced to leave.

“She told me that you made her realise that the Horde was bad, and that... someone called Shadow Weaver...? Told her she was unloveable, and yet you were there, loving her.” Luna explains.

"Shadow Weaver was her commander in the Horde. She tricked Adora into taking Hordak out so that she could control the Horde instead. She was... extremely abusive to the people that she was supposed to take care of." Catra presses her lips together, standing up and slowly opening the door. "Especially Adora, because she had 'higher expectations' of her." Luna raises her eyebrows.

“Higher expectations?” She asks.

"She could tell Adora was She-Ra before even Adora herself knew. She wanted to mould that into what she wanted." Catra explains slowly. Shadow Weaver had *used* Adora, ever since she had been a baby, and no one wanted to listen to that. No one wanted to recognise the trauma that Adora had clearly undergone being a literal *child soldier* for the Horde. It’s not as though Adora invented the Horde, she didn’t wake up one day and decide she wanted to conquer Etheria, she didn’t *make* the Horde, she’s only been leading it solely for *three years* , she is a *victim* , She was raised to believe in the Horde and it’s like no one cares about that.

"Yikes..." Luna says. "Shadow Weaver... why is that name so familiar? ... *Oh* ! Light Spinner..." Luna's eyes widen. "She... Oh..."

"Yeah." Catra opens the door wider, gesturing for Luna to come inside. "She basically taught Adora that she wasn't worth loving, and told her that she could never know how to love. She made her unable to sleep at night without sleep fighting when she's alone. She made her think that being ambushed in your sleep for 'training' reasons was normal. Adora suffered a lot, but no one wants to acknowledge that, nor do they want to acknowledge that she was raised with a whole bunch of propaganda. She didn't even know that one of her old squad mates had escaped because the Horde told her that they were sent to Beast Island as punishment!" Catra yells in exasperation. Luna steps inside of the room and Catra closes the door behind her.

"Unfortunately, that's because of her rank." Luna says. "You know we've helped ex-Horde soldiers who have defected before, you've even helped some yourself, we know that they're brainwashed child soldiers, but when Adora took on the title of Lord, she took on all the sins

of Hordak and Shadow Weaver. And people have unfairly forgotten that she is also a child soldier, brainwashed, just like everyone else."

"I know, and no one wants to listen that she's just as much of a victim as those other Horde soldiers. In reality, she's never caused as much damage or fatalities as Hordak and Shadow Weaver. And most of those fatalities weren't even planned, like Hordak and Shadow Weaver had done. They were crossfire fatalities." Catra sighs. "I pointed it out to her the first time we were together."

"And what did she say?" Luna asks gently.

"She seemed surprised. She had assumed that we were able to get everyone out safely." Adora may have been a little ignorant, but Catra couldn't really blame her. She had been born into ignorance but at least now she was starting to think on her own, she was *learning* , she was getting *better* . Catra had always seen that Adora had a good heart, she cared, she felt so deeply, and now she was starting to express it.

"Adora has caused a lot of damage still. I understand that she was misguided but... people will want justice." Luna replies.

"I know. But people want her head for many things that she didn't even do. The only reason she even stepped up as Horde Lord was because Shadow Weaver filled her head with a whole bunch of lies."

"What is Adora planning to do? Do you know? She, correct me if I'm wrong but, she doesn't seem like she cares about the war anymore."

"We didn't really talk about it while I was there. I just... We were focusing on spending the time we lost together. And I was making sure she ate." Catra responds. She hadn't really thought to ask that - maybe she should have, considering it was *Adora* .

"She did seem significantly malnourished, even by Horde standards." Luna says and Catra frowns slightly.

"She thought I hadn't made it, since she wasn't allowed to stay to see me mostly recover. So she was still grieving too." Catra had had no idea that Adora could go into grieving, but it was the only thing that really made sense.

"Well, all eyes are on her then." Luna says.

"I just hope that people actually listen when the time comes." Catra says. She couldn't imagine losing Adora, the thought made her feel completely helpless. She knew that if Adora died, she would *never* recover. She would never *want* to recover. She can handle the pain of separation but she can't handle Adora being killed or worse.

"That's... going to be an issue." Luna admits. "No one is going to want to listen to *Adora* , but maybe they'll listen to the people who stand up for her."

"And who's going to stand up for her?" Catra crosses her arms. "People aren't going to listen to me."

"Spinnerella and Netossa maybe? I know they knew, they told me." Luna says. "I did *not* tell Cy that, I covered for their covering of you. We could get some ex-Hordies maybe... Bow possibly? He always sees the best in people... and... me..." Catra's eyes widen a little at the end of Luna's sentence.

"You'd really do that?" Catra asks.

"You're right, Adora was a victim of the Horde, I'm sure you can make Adora's case for her, you'd just need her and some back up." Luna says. "Kitten," Luna sighs and hesitantly reaches her hand out for Catra. "I really am sorry for the things I said, and for what happened. What matters is that you're happy, and taking your mate away… That will not make you happy in the slightest. After meeting Adora, I don't hate her, I actually have a lot of sympathy for her, she even cried in front of me, and I could tell it was hard for her to let herself do that."

"She cried in front of you?" Catra asks in clear surprise.

"Yes, yes she did."

"That... holy shit." Catra comments - for lack of a better word.

"I'm guessing that was big for her?" Luna asks. Catra nods.

"She's, to put it simply, emotionally constipated with everyone except a select few." Catra smiles a little in fondness. Adora views feelings like that as a weakness, the fact that she cried openly in front of Catra's mom really says a lot about where she was emotionally and how she felt about Catra.

"You were dying, C'yra. She was distressed."

"Yeah, well, I know how that feels. But no one seemed to care about that either, once they found out about Adora, so..." Catra sighs and shrugs. "I sensed her..."

"You did?"

"I did. I felt her close, I felt her holding me." Catra presses a hand to her chest, closing her eyes. "I could hear her calling me back." Catra sighs. "And then I woke up and C'yra tried to steal away the *one* thing that was basically a lifeline to me." Catra's ears press back against her head and she feels both angry and deeply, *deeply* , hurt.

"It hurts me to hear you call her C'yra." Luna says.

"Yeah, well, it hurt for her to call me a traitor, to tell me to get rid of Finn, and then force me into house arrest and tell me she'd never approve of me wanting a relationship with Adora. That, and also her trying to blame Adora for me nearly dying, when she's also to blame, and not taking responsibility for it." Catra was having none of C'yra's shit or her excuses. She

was being a bad mom, that was the be-all and end-all of it. Catra shouldn’t have to call her mom, or the like, when she isn’t acting like one. Luna sighs.

"I know, I just… never thought I'd be between the two people I love most." She says sadly.

"I'd say I was sorry, but I won't ever say I'm sorry for loving Adora. Even if it means starting conflict." Catra says. "If I had to choose, my kitten and my mate will always be first to me, mom."

"And I understand that." Luna says. "And I'll try to make Cy see the light but... boy that's going to take a lot of work."

"Well, good luck I guess." Catra shrugs a bit, not having any expectations. C’yra was extremely unlikely to bend. She was like a tree, rooted to the spot and resisting the wind. Catra knew, however, that trees that don’t bend to the wind may find themselves torn out root and stem.

"I can't dismiss your guards, they listen to Cy, and she's unlikely to lift that any time soon. It might be a while until you see Adora again." Luna says.

"I know." Catra had known this before she had left the Fright Zone again but it still *sucked* to hear.

"But that doesn't mean you'll never see her again." Luna says and Catra feels her heart clench. She walks over to her bed and sits down on it.

"Yeah, well, who knows." She says, eyes downcast. "C'yra definitely wants to make sure I never do. As do others in the Rebellion."

"There's a difference now though, Adora knows you're alive, and she isn't heartbroken anymore." Luna says. "I have a feeling she'll fight for you."

"I hope so." Catra gnaws her lip nervously. "I'm just afraid. It's hard enough as it is basically losing almost everyone I care about." Luna sits down beside Catra.

"It'll be a long road, and it won't be easy, but..." She pauses. "Adora is She-Ra..."

"I know. I don't see how that's relevant to this conversation though?" Catra asks with a frown. Her mom had kind of gone left field with that one.

"She's *She-Ra* , she's a Princess. There are stories about She-Ra, about how she would come to us when Etheria needed her the most. She's... a legend..." Luna says. "But, I mean, she's kind of terrifying..."

"You guys didn't meet She-Ra." Catra admits with a sigh.

"What?"

"That wasn't She-Ra." Catra repeats. "She was corrupted by magic."

"How do you know that?" Catra blushes a bit at the question.

"How do you think Finn was made?" Luna opens her mouth and then closes it before opening and closing it again.

"... She-Ra?"

"Yeah..."

"You got pregnant by She-Ra?"

"Mhmm." Catra bites her lips. She couldn't believe that she had basically admitted to her own mother that she had been railed by the Princess of Power.

"I have so many questions, but I don't want to know any of the answers." Luna admits. "Okay, so She-Ra isn't normally red, scary and evil?"

"No, she's not. She's white, and gold, and blue, and she glows softly. Not red, or scary, or evil." Catra answers, pressing her lips together. "She had a piece of the Black Garnet corrupting her."

"Dear goddess..." Luna pinches the bridge of her nose. "Adora kind of alienated all of the Princesses when she did that. No one had ever seen She-Ra before, and had you not done... whatever it was that you did before she stabbed you, there may not have been a Bright Moon left standing right now."

"I know. I knew the moment that I saw her that something wasn't right." Catra looks at her mom. "That's why I went onto the battlefield, despite putting myself in danger to do it. I *had* to get the piece of the Black Garnet away from Adora to bring her back."

"I don't think Adora is a bad person but… She has made bad choices that she has to be willing to own up to." Luna says. Catra rubs her face. She knows that her mom is right. There is no scenario where Adora just happily makes peace and the Rebellion just let her off the hook. There has to be blame, responsibility, there has to be some kind of punishment, Catra isn't naive to think otherwise. She isn't asking they just all forget that, she just wants Adora to be given a *chance* , that's all.

"That's up to her, but I think she will." Catra *knows* she will. Adora is almost a completely different person. She looked so tired. She no longer believes what he Horde taught her, there was no way she was going to continue to do their bidding.

"We'll see," Luna leans over to kiss Catra atop her head before she stands. "For now, sit tight and focus on keeping your kitten happy." Catra purrs a little from the affection of her mom

but her mood quickly drops.

"I won't be happy until I can be with her." Catra says.

"I know, and I'll try to have that happen as quickly as possible, but it may be a while." Catra nods slowly.

"Mom... Thank you for apologising and for listening to what I had to say." Catra says and she *means* it. Maybe her mom was right, maybe she had more allies here than Catra knew.

"Of course, Little One. I just wish I had done that sooner."

"Yeah, me too." She frowns softly. "Better late than never. At least I have one parent who's willing to be there for me."

"I'll talk to Cy, like I said I would." Luna promises.

"Okay. See you soon I guess. It's not like I can go anywhere." Catra flops back onto her bed, looking up at the ceiling. Luna sighs softly and pauses at the door.

"I suppose you can't go anywhere, but these guards," Luna looks at them. "better keep you safe too, or they'll have me to answer to." Catra looks up a little to see the guards look at Luna and slowly nod at her.

"I'll be fine, mom. Just... go do whatever you need to." Catra says from her bed, waving at her.

"Hmph," Luna steps out of the room. As a child, Catra was always able to slip her guard, but now that she was pregnant, Catra doubted she'd be able to do that. "I'll talk to you later."

"Yeah, later." Catra sighs, resting a hand on her stomach. "Little kitten, my little Finn, I'll do my best to make sure we can be with your mama one day, okay?" She whispers softly. She was determined to keep them safe and to prove C'yra wrong. Adora was a *good* person, and she would be with her again.

* * *

1 Month Later

Things do not get better. In fact, they get so much worse. Catra can't go anywhere without guards escorting her, in both Bright Moon and Half-Moon, she basically spends all her time in her room, the balcony in there had been sealed off and she spends her days just yearning to be reunited with Adora. She hasn't spoken to her in so long that her heart *ached* just to hear her voice. Catra would give *anything* to be with her right now but, instead, she's in some dumb meeting that has no signficance whatsoever. "You know what's so funny?" Catra interrupts. She smiles, though the smile definitely doesn't reach her eyes.

"What's that?" C'yra asks. The smile drops from Catra's face as she looks at C'yra.

"That the Horde has treated me better than the people who have known me all my life." Catra deadpans.

"Don't be ridiculous," C'yra says dismissively. "The *Horde* ?"

"You think I'm joking?" Catra laughs. "Yes, *the Horde*. You know what they did when they found out that Adora and I were together?"

"What did they do?" C'yra asks and she couldn't sound more uninterested if she tried. It irritates Catra. She's pregnant, quite far along, and she's without her mate. She's had *enough* . She can't bear the thought of Adora not being there when she gives birth.

"They welcomed me. They were happy to have me there. They didn't care that I had been their enemy." Catra looks at C'yra, hurt by her disinterest. "They were happy that I made Adora happy. They were excited for us when I told them we were having a kitten. They have

treated me better than any of you have this entire time, despite the fact that I was their enemy at one point." She stands up, slamming her hands on the table. "You all pride yourselves on being the good guys, on treating people fairly, and being kind and just. But all you've shown me is how much that's actually bullshit." C'yra scoffs, the other Princesses all stare at Catra with varying degrees of expressions from shock, shame and anger.

"Don't be ridiculous, the *Horde* ? If they welcomed you it was so they could figure out something about the Rebellion." C'yra says dismissively. Catra wants to *scream* she's so frustrated, but she doesn't want to give C'yra the satisfaction.

"You would think that, right? Except they never, and I mean fucking *never,* asked me anything about the Rebellion pertaining to the war! Not even once!" Catra yells.

"You expect us to believe that?"

"Of course I don't expect *you* to believe that." Catra rolls her eyes. "Since you like to pick and choose who to believe."

"What is that supposed to mean?" C'yra asks.

"Exactly what I said. You like to pick and choose who you listen to and who you believe as long as it fits the narrative you want to believe." Catra expands on her statement. "You refuse to let people tell you additional information because you want to continue being angry and in control. Isn't that right, *C'yra* ?" C'yra frowns at her when she uses her name as opposed to mom.

"When it comes to the Horde, and Lord Adora, I know everything I need to know." She states. "Unlike you, I'm not ensnared by my poor judgement of character and... passion... for the Horde Lord. How has the Horde treated you better?"

"Ensnared by my poor judgement? Oh, that's rich coming from the woman that can't make an unbiased decision because she's angry." Catra huffs. "And you just proved my fucking point! I literally already told you why moments ago!" She shakes her head in disbelief. "You want to know how they've treated me better? They actually cared about my happiness and well-being.

They were accepting of me. They made me feel like I was *safe,* and cared for, since this whole shitstorm started! I regret coming back here because this is obviously not my home anymore!" Things were getting heated, and maybe Catra had started this fight but she was damn well going to finish it.

"You regret coming back..." C'yra's eyes narrow. "Clearly you do lack good judgement, you opened your legs for the Horde Lord and then you let her get in your head!"

"I regret coming back because all I've gotten here is being stuck in my room all day, getting glares, and being called a *whore* , and getting told that I can't even make decisions for my fucking self!" Catra yells back. "I wish you hadn't found me when I ran! Maybe you would actually respect and care about me if I was dead!" C'yra takes a sharp breath in. Her tail whips back and forth behind her and her ears press back against her head. Everyone else was simply sitting and watching the Queen and daughter arguing, not willing to step in on behalf of either of them.

"You'd rather be dead than here?"

"At least I'd be happy that way." Catra says softly, her eyes glistening with tears. "At least I wouldn't have my own family pretending to care when they're only hurting me. At least I wouldn't have the people that called themselves my friends glaring at me any time we're in the same room because of who I love. At least my child wouldn't have to grow up in a place where they're clearly not wanted. At least that way I wouldn't have to suffer the pain of being away from my mate every single day."

"I told you, Adora is not your mate." C'yra says. Catra can’t believe this. "And you've earned that mistrust, you lied to everyone, you slept with the leader of the Horde, multiple times! This is all your own fault."

"All my fault, huh?" Catra sniffles, tears streaming down her cheeks. "So I guess you can control who I'm bonded to, right? Because you're the one that's dealing with grief, right? Then if she's not my mate, you're not my mother." Silence fills the room in that moment. "You lost that trust by being cruel and controlling. So congratulations, you got what you wanted. Consider me not the Princess of Half-Moon anymore. Consider me not your daughter anymore. Consider Finn not your grandkitten since you hate the monster spawn that I'm carrying so damn much." Catra says, an eerie calmness in her voice.

She remembers something, her hands go up behind her neck to unfasten the necklace that she had been given by her moms when she had become of age. She takes it off, dropping it onto the table with a loud clunk as it hits the surface. "I always wanted to be like you growing up. I admired you, I *loved* you. But if this is how you want to be, then I hope that I never put my own kitten through this kind of heartbreak. I hope that I never push my own kitten to want to be dead, to be able to escape the prison of my making. I hope that I never make my kitten cry, and I hope I never push them into grief. Because I don't want to be like *you* ." Catra was calm even if she felt completely *devastated* . She loved her mom so much, and that's why this hurt her. She knew that their relationship was forever changed because of this.

"You're being dramatic C'yra," Cy says, though her ear twitches. "Can't you see that I'm trying to do what's best for you? Adora is the Horde Lord, you should never have bonded with her in the first place. It wasn't meant to be. You never should have slept with her. *Never* . You shouldn't be carrying her child, you shouldn't feel sympathy for that woman, she's evil. If I have to be cruel to protect you, then I will be."

"Dramatic, huh? Trying to do what's best for me? Or are you trying to do what you want of me?" Catra grabs the necklace, tossing it at C'yra. She can't believe her mother just dismissed her feelings like that. "This is exactly what I meant by you not wanting to hear information that goes against what you want. Of course, I'm going to feel sympathy for a victim of child abuse. I'll have sympathy for anyone raised by Shadow Weaver. Of course I'm going to have sympathy for the orphan that got indoctrinated by Hordak. Because I actually got to know Adora, and the people of the Horde as individuals, rather than a whole entity that was presented by Hordak."

Catra looks at C'yra tiredly. She wishes she could make her mother *see* , to just understand, or to at least be *willing* to understand. "You say you want what's best for me, but all you're doing is making every choice that makes me feel like a prisoner in my own home and life. That makes me *unhappy* . Stop acting like any of this is you actually caring about me and not me making you, and the fucking Half-Moon crown, look bad. You don't care. You weren't even there when I was on my deathbed, when I got brought back! And yes, I do fucking know who was there because the doctor was kind enough to tell me!" C'yra stands up abruptly, her chair scraping against the ground.

"The Horde is the reason my parents are gone! They're the reason you don't have grandparents! I never wanted you involved in the war in the first place! You *never* listen! Maybe Adora wasn't the one responsible for that, but she has caused plenty of damage of her own! How many families has she taken parents from? Children from? How could you *ever* love someone who could do something like that?"

"You act as if we're innocent."

"What are you talking about now?" C'yra asks in exasperation.

"Of course you haven't looked at the reports. We're not innocent. People have gotten caught in our crossfire too. *We're not innocent.* Don't act like we are. We've caused damages too. And you trying to put the blame of grandma and grandpa being killed on Adora doesn't make any sense since it happened when her and I were both five years old!" Catra was panting with anger and she was face to face from her mother, both of them staring intently at each other. The rest of the Princesses were silent but the tension in the room could be cut with a knife.

"Go to your room."

"Thank you so much for proving me correct, C'yra." Catra says with an exasperated laugh.

"How dare you compare us to the Horde?" C'yra asks. "The Horde want to conquer Etheria, they're selfish and hateful, we fight to *protect* Etheria. We are not the same. You really have lost all sense of loyalty."

"Again, you don't want to listen to information that contradicts your own narrative." Catra snorts. "You want to know what Hordak taught them over there? That Princesses were violent instigators. That what the Horde was doing was making Etheria more orderly and peaceful. Now please tell me how the hell were they supposed to learn otherwise if that is all they ever knew?!" She lets out a breathy laugh again. "It's hard to be loyal to the people that showed that they don't care about me."

"Go to your room!" C'yra demands again and Catra curls her hands into fists.

"You mean my prison?" Catra shakes her head. "Fine. It's not like anyone wants me here anyway." C'yra sighs and grabs the necklace Catra threw at her.

"No one wants to hear you defend the Horde, or their Lord, no."

"I think," Bow speaks up, his voice squeaking a little, obviously nervous to be interrupting the heated argument. "Catra has a point. We've helped ex-Horde soldiers before, Adora has been sole Lord of the Horde for only like... three years? She took Hordak out at eighteen, Shadow Weaver kind of held the reins those two years before she disappeared... Adora was raised as a soldier."

"Bow." C'yra says calmly. "Now is not the time." Catra glances back a bit, looking at Bow in surprise before softening as she mouths a ‘thank you’ to him before facing away again.

"It's never gonna be the time because you don't want to hear it." Catra says as she walks out of the room, closing the door behind her before it all comes crashing down on her and she sobs. She sobs audibly enough for the meeting room to hear and the sounds slowly fade away as she's escorted back to her room by the guards.

* * *

Silence falls over the table. C'yra glares at the necklace. Luna was gonna be *mad* but Catra just didn't want to *listen* . "Well, that went... *fantastic* ." Mermista says sarcastically.

"Don't you think you're being a little harsh, C'yra?" Spinnerella asks. "Catra is miserable."

"Don't tell me how to reprimand my own daughter." C’yra responds through gritted teeth.

"Is it really reprimanding if all you're doing is making her suffer?" Netossa cuts in, clearly upset at how C'yra was handling the situation.

"What's your answer? Let her gallivant around the Fright Zone with the Horde Lord?" C’yra asks.

"Obviously not, but definitely not this. You're treating her like she's a stranger, C'yra."

"She's treating *me* like a stranger," C'yra argues. "How would you feel if you found out your daughter had been sleeping with your biggest enemy? That she lied about it and, on top of all of that, was carrying her baby?"

"Don't you think she has a reason to treat you like a stranger, C'yra?" Netossa asks. "How would you feel if your own mother called you a traitor, told you to get rid of your child, and is refusing to listen to anything you have to say?" Netossa groans in irritation. "I obviously don't like who she chose as her mate. But, at the end of the day, it was her choice. Not yours. And you pushed her at arm's length the second you told her to get rid of her baby, the only life line that was keeping her here when she wasn't with Adora." Netossa tries to explain as calmly as possible. "And since then, all anyone has been doing is alienating her. She's had almost zero support throughout this whole thing. She feels *alone* , C'yra. She has no one to even talk to. When have you ever seen her come out of her room? Aside from going to get checkups? Have any of you gone to see how she was doing since she woke up?" The room falls silent, no one having the answer to that question. Glimmer decides to break it.

"What are we going to do with Lord Adora?"

"So we're just not going to address the situation with Catra?" Netossa asks in disbelief. C'yra sighs.

"What is there to address? I'm not lifting her guard, and I'm not letting her go back to the Fright Zone. End of discussion." Netossa shakes her head.

"C'yra, you need to address this situation or you're going to lose your daughter entirely."

"I never restricted people from visiting her, if they haven't, that's their choice I'm assuming."

"Are you- C'yra, you really think your behavior is encouraging to others?" Netossa looks at her, astonished. "You're her own *mother* and you're treating her as though she's an incompetent child and a monster."

"So what do you suggest I do? Hm? Let her run off to be with Lord Adora? No."

"That's not what I'm suggesting at all. But at least try to listen to her. Try to understand her side of things." Netossa shakes her head again. "If you keep blocking her off and shutting her down like this, you're really gonna lose her." She looks around at everyone else. "You're hurting her, each and every day, and you don't seem to care at all. That's concerning." She stands up. "If you will excuse me, I'm going to go check to make sure she's okay. Spinny, do you wanna come?" She asks her wife.

"Of course I do." Spinnerella answers, standing with her wife.

"Wait, me too." Bow says, standing.

"Bow!" Glimmer protests.

"No Glimmer, it's our fault. Catra's supposed to be our *best* friend. We're being *bad* friends."

"She was a bad friend by lying to us!" Glimmer yells at him. Bow shakes his head.

"With the way everyone has been treating her, I don't blame her for not telling us. She made valid points with what she said. And she's my friend, and I'm going to make sure she's okay, because that's what friends do." Bow faces away from everyone else, nodding at Spinnerella and Netossa who smile softly at him and the three of them walk out together.

"What changed your mind?" Spinnerella asks softly as they make their way down the hall.

"I..." Bow rubs his fingers together. "Nothing changed my mind. I tried to stop everyone before when they were yelling at her. Catra is smart, she wouldn't fall for someone if they were 'evil'. Plus, she really seems sad."

"She is." Spinnerella frowns softly. "We've been accompanying her as much as we can, but we're not always free. You should see the way she lights up when we go spend time with her."

"I kind of suggested maybe we could talk to Adora a while ago, I don't think Glimmer took me seriously." Bow says.

"You want to go talk to her?"

"Yeah, I think I'd like that."

"We can try to figure out how to do that once we make sure Catra's okay." Netossa says softly. "We're almost to her room." Bow sighs.

"You know, Adora hasn't attacked us in months, not since... since she used She-Ra... And I don't think she will ever again."

"I doubt it, she was very distraught when she came to after that fight." Spinnerella words carefully. She stops in front of Catra's bedroom door, gently knocking. "Catra, sweetheart. Are you there?"

* * *

Catra looks up for a moment at the door. "C-Come in, Spinny." She struggles to speak through her tears, her eyes bloodshot from how much she was crying. She hadn’t expected all of this to happen today, she was already kind of unbalanced because of hormones. They all enter together.

"Oh... sweetie..." Spinnerella coos. *Bow* moves forward to give Catra a hug.

"Bow? What... What are you doing here?" Catra asks weakly, but clings to her friend who she's missed dearly as she cries again. She has missed Bow so much, she always loved his hugs, he was like Scorpia like that. He was strong and firm and he gave *great* hugs. She hadn't expected him to come too.

"I'm so sorry Catra," Bow sobs, crying himself. His voice is wobbly and full of emotion, he clearly means it. "We've been such bad friends to you. You deserve better." Catra shakes her head, burying her face in his neck, her tears wet the shoulder of his crop top.

"I-I'm sorry too. I was afraid of what would have happened if I told you all that I had lied to you, and I'm sorry. But I-" She sobs, hugging him tighter. "I missed you so much! I missed my best friend!"

"I missed you too." He says, squeezing Catra gently, being mindful of her bump. "You... You were right to be afraid. We reacted horribly." Catra finds this almost comical how they're both clinging to each other, sobbing, it's like something out of a bad drama, but she means it. She has missed Bow's comfort. She's known Bow just as long as Glimmer, they've been best friends since they were literally children, she had no idea how painful losing them would be until it happened.

"Yeah." Catra sniffs a few times, purring softly. "I'm just happy at least one of you is back."

"I'm sorry," Bow says again, pulling back. He smiles a little, though he looked like he might start crying again at any moment. "You're not alone Catra."

"Thanks, Bow." Catra actually manages to smile a little - though it's a very wet smile.

"Okay," He takes a deep breath. "So, tell me about Adora?"

"You want to hear about Adora?" Catra asks with surprise. She knew Bow was sorry but she had no idea he would want to hear about Adora.

"Yeah," He smiles a little and accepts tissues that Spinnerella hands them. "We kind of skipped that, you know? When we were younger we'd talk about crushes and stuff, and… we didn't really have the chance to gossip about Adora like that." Catra laughs a little, remembering those times when they were kids. They were simpler times, it was also when Catra had learnt about Glimmer's crush on their mutual archer friend.

"Yeah, um, what would you like to know about her?" Catra asks.

"I guess... What's she like? What do you like about her?" Bow asks. "I'm forgetting that she's the Lord and just thinking of her as your mate."

"She's a giant, romantic, clingy dork." Catra answers with a smile - a genuine smile, a smile she hasn't done in a month. "She's a cuddle bug too."

"Really? Huh, I didn't see that coming." Catra's smile drops slightly.

"No, I suppose not. But she really is. She's actually incredibly sweet and caring. There was this time when she had a whole picnic made for us, and we were on a tower over there where we could see *everything* . We danced together after we ate."

"That's... so romantic." Bow says in wonder. Catra nods and purrs softly.

"It is. It was so sweet." She sighs, getting a loving look in her eyes at the thought of Adora. "She'd let me wear her clothes because I loved her scent, and she'd let me walk around with her cape because she'd find it really cute when I did." Bow smiles.

"She sounds... Nice..." He frowns a little. "And you love her?"

"I do. I love her so much, Bow." Catra says with so much meaning she knows there is no denying how much she loves that big blonde goofy dummy that is the Horde Lord.

"She loves you too?" Bow asks. Catra hums.

"She does." She smiles. "I went to visit her, to make sure she was okay, she told me she loved me and that she was sorry for what she did. That she doesn't want to hurt me ever again." Catra whispers, looking out of the window towards the direction of the Fright Zone - too bad there were literal *bars* over them, like Catra could scale the castle while five, nearly six, months pregnant. "She held me close, kissed me softly, and told me she was relieved that I was okay." Bow smiles for real this time.

"Good." He says. "I'm glad she's treating you right."

"She has. She does." Catra sighs, yearning to be with Adora as she continues to keep her gaze fixed through the window. "I miss her so much. And C'yra won't let me see her."

"I'm sorry," Bow winces a little. "I... I'll try to keep you in the loop on whatever they decide to do with the Horde."

"Thank you. I appreciate that." Catra takes a deep breath in, looking back at Bow. "I... I just want to at least be with her one more time. It's hard being away from her as it is. But knowing how many people want her gone... It's hard not thinking that I might never get to see her again. That our kitten will never get to meet her." A single tear falls down Catra’s cheek at the thought. Bow glances over at Spinnerella and Netossa.

"We... Maybe we could sneak her in? You know? One last time?" He suggests.

"You would do that?" Catra looks at them hopefully before saddening again. "I... I don't want you guys to get in trouble. I think one person being hated and called a traitor is enough. I don't want to bring you all down with me."

"Psh," Bow says, standing up. "Who are you talking to?" He asks. "Tech Master and Master Archer of the Rebellion. I think, maybe if I get Entrapta's help too, we could disguise Adora pretty well to sneak her in here."

"Do you think Entrapta would help? She's not exactly the best at keeping secrets, Bow." Catra points out. Bow chuckles a little.

"No, she isn't, so I won't tell her exactly *who* we're disguising, but she'll be more than happy to accept the challenge anyway." Catra bites her lip.

"I... I think it would be best not to. Keeping things from people obviously didn't work out for me as it is." She sighs. "Could you just... maybe get a com-pad to Adora, please?"

"Didn't you have yours confiscated?"

"Oh... right." Catra frowns again. "Never mind."

"I could give you one too? But I really think we can sneak Adora in."

"I... Don't get me wrong, I want to ask you to sneak her in. But I've had enough of getting yelled at." Catra says. Besides, she's already put Netossa and Spinnerella in a difficult position, she didn't want to put Bow in one too.

Bow pulls out his trackerpad and hands it to Catra. "Here."

"Are you sure?" Catra asks in amazement.

"Sure," He says, "but I'll want it back when Adora is here physically." Catra looks at the trackerpad and then at Bow. She puts the trackerpad down safely and then throws herself at him, hugging him tightly.

"Thank you. Thank you for trying to let me explain when everyone else wouldn't. Thank you for coming. Thank you for listening and for caring. Thank you for being my friend. Thank you for being supportive. You're the best friend anyone can ask for, and I love you." Bow

laughs softly and wraps Catra in a tight hug - Yeah, Bow really always did give the best hugs.

"It's the least you deserve after everything. You don't have to thank me, Catra."

"I do." Catra murmurs into the hug. "You have *no idea* how much this means to me, Bow. I... I really thought I had lost everyone." She cries softly. "Spinnerella and Netossa have been the only ones I had." She lifts her head up, looking at the wife duo tearfully. "We weren't always the closest, but you two have been the only stable people I've had in this. Thank you." Spinnerella smiles sadly.

"C'yra is blinded by her anger to see clearly, though Luna tries, I imagine she would've said something at that meeting if she had been there."

"Yeah, I guess." Catra shrugs a bit, snuggling Bow. "Thank you, I mean that."

"You mentioned Adora broke her com-pad," Netossa says. "But you can contact Scorpia, right? And she can put Adora on?"

"I can try. I'm not sure if I memorised Scorpia's contact information. But I think so."

"That'll probably be easier than sneaking a com-pad to the Fright Zone." Bow says.

"Probably. Let me try." Catra picks up the com-pad again, trying to remember Scorpia's contact information before typing it in and dialling. It rings for a moment before Scorpia picks up, probably not recognising the number but recognising the face when she answers. Catra has missed the way Scorpia *lights up* whenever Catra is there.

"Wildcat! Oh wow! How are you?" She greets cheerfully.

"Scorpia." Catra could cry at the sight of the other. "I could be better, not doing too great. I'm really happy to see you though. Are you doing okay?"

"Oh, I'm doing good, you could use a Scorpion hug, huh?" Scorpia asks with a frown at Catra's words. "I was actually just about to go see Adora."

"Yeah, I could use a scorpion hug." She smiles. She never thought she'd miss the person who *stung* her at Princess Prom, yet here she was. "Could you let me talk to her please? Is she okay?"

"She's been doing a lot better! I no longer have to force her to eat and shower." Scorpia says with a smile. "Seems all she needed was you." That warms Catra's heart a little.

"I'm glad. I was worried when she nearly fainted while I was there." She sighs in relief, her heart skipping a beat. "It's really good to hear that she's taking care of herself." Scorpia nods as she enters what Catra recognises as the throne room, climbing the steps to the throne.

"Hey Boss-"

"Scorpia, good, you're here," Adora says, off camera. Catra's heart almost leaps out of her chest at the mere sound of Adora's voice. "Do you know what the scrap metal we have here is? And what metal is best for walls?"

"Uh... metal?" Scorpia shrugs.

"Ah, yes, metal, thank you for your wise input." Adora laughs a little. "I guess that's the engineers problem."

"Adora!" Catra's voice echoes from the com-pad in Scorpia's hand. "Let Scorps speak, you dummy. And I'm pretty sure it's steel." Scorpia lifts the com-pad up and Catra gets to see Adora's eyes widen as she hears Catra's familiar voice. Her eyes lock onto the com-pad in Scorpia's hands.

"Catra..." Adora steps towards Scorpia and takes the pad in her hands. "You're... It's you." Catra beams when she sees Adora fully on the screen.

"It is. You're looking much better, Love. How are you?" Catra asks. And she really did look better. Less like she hadn’t been eating and more like her old self, her hair had even grown a little.

"I'm fine," Adora says dismissively. "Not to worry, Kitten, I'll have my muscles back to carry you around in no time." She jokes lightly before she gets a more serious expression. "Are *you* okay?" Catra can’t lie to Adora.

"I'm... I'm better now that I get to see you." Catra whispers. "I miss you. I'm… not great, but I'm doing a little better now. I'm with Spinnerella and Netossa right now, and my friend Bow."

"Oh, Wind and Net Princess and Arrow Guy?" Adora asks. "I miss you too Kitten. I wish you were here, or I was there."

"Mhmm, them." Catra giggles softly at the nicknames. "Be nice, Love. I wouldn't even be able to call if not for them." She sighs. "Me too. I haven't been able to sleep well at all."

"Yeah," Adora sighs as she leans against the metal table. "I know what you mean. Soon, we'll be together again."

"Soon?" Catra asks, narrowing her eyes.

"Well, maybe not *soon* soon, but I have a plan."

"A plan?" Catra asks, raising an eyebrow at her mate. "Adora… please don't do anything that will put you in danger." Adora waves her hand dismissively through the air.

"Fixing my mistakes means fixing the Fright Zone first. I did a number on it in my anger and absence." She admits. "And... I need my strength back fully before I can really do anything. You'll be happy to know we have real food once again, I'm serious about getting my muscles back to carry you around." Catra laughs softly.

"Dork… It's good that you're taking care of yourself. But I'm serious, don't you dare do anything that will put you in harm's way." She licks her lips nervously. "Make sure to eat properly. Tell the others that I said hello and that I miss them as well." She smiles again. "Keep me updated on how fixing the Fright Zone goes, okay? Are you doing the thing that I suggested before?"

"Y-Yeah," Adora says, lifting her hand up to run her fingers through her hair. "It was a good idea. And we're not exactly planning on fighting anymore so..."

"I think everyone will be really grateful for getting their own rooms over there." Catra purrs softly. "Yeah, I figured. Adora, I'm happy that you're making positive changes over there. I really hope I get to see it one day."

"I... Uh... Yeah, me too..." Adora says. Catra *knows* Adora, and she can tell that there is something up that she isn't telling her, but she doesn't want to press her on it - especially when they have an audience.

"I love you. So much." Catra whispers softly. "Make me proud, Love."

"I love you too, Kitten." Adora smiles softly and then she looks at Scorpia before she kisses her finger and presses it to the camera, blushing as she does it. It's entirely too cute and Catra smiles so wide it almost *hurts*.

" *Aw* !" Bow gasps with wide sparkling eyes. "That was so *sweet* !"

"You saw that?!" Adora asks, looking embarrassed. Catra giggles and moves her camera to the side to show Bow.

"He did, this is his trackerpad. Mine got confiscated when I got put on house arrest."

"You're on house arrest?!" Adora asks.

"Yeah." Catra answers, feeling her mood dip a little at the reminder.

"I… I don't like that." Adora says. "But I can't do anything about it right now." She sighs. "Some things... are out of my... control... and that's... okay..."

"Oh my- You did it Boss!" Scorpia exclaims happily, picking Adora up in a big hug, lifting her up off of the ground which causes Adora's eyes to widen. Catra laughs at the display.

"Yes I did! Put me *down,* Scorpia!" Catra smiles, her eyes sparkling at Adora's control of emotions.

"I'm proud of you. I'm so proud of you right now, Adora. If I could, I would kiss you."

"It's not that big of a deal," Adora blushes as she's set back down on her feet. "but I would take that kiss."

"It is a big deal. I'm proud of you." Catra blows a kiss through the screen. "You're doing great, babe." Adora laughs before her smile falls a little.

"You're not though... And I do wish I could make that better."

"Hey, just getting to speak with you makes me feel better. I haven't been able to speak with you in awhile."

"I know. How is my other baby doing?" Adora asks. Catra smiles.

"Finn is doing great. The doctor said they're healthy and growing at a steady pace." Adora hums.

"Well, they have mine... or She-Ra's... genes. I wonder if they got your tiny gene."

"I'm not that tiny." Catra pouts at Adora. "She-Ra is just giant."

"You're tiny, Kitten, but it's *adorable* ."

"Shush, you. I'm not tiny." Catra sticks her tongue out and Adora grins before she closes her eyes.

"I wish you were here. I just want to hold you." Adora says longingly. Catra sighs softly, also closing her eyes.

"I wish I were there too. It's hard being without you, without your warmth, and your kisses, and your love."

"Mhmm..." Adora hums softly. "I can't stop thinking about the last time we were together - and I wasn't even at my best." Catra snorts a little.

"I know." She opens her eyes. "I hope we get to see each other soon." Adora swallows a little, diverting her eyes. Catra’s eyes narrow again.

"Yeah, me too."

"Babe, why aren't you looking at me?" Catra asks.

"I... I am looking at you."

"You aren't, my love. What's wrong?" Adora looks back to the camera and at Catra. There looks like there might be something there but it’s gone too quickly for Catra to fully grasp.

"Nothing is wrong, Kitten, I promise."

"Adora… Are you sure?"

"I'm sure," Adora says, placing her hand to her chest. "Promise." Catra was unconvinced, and she probably looked it too, but she sighs softly and gives in with a small smile - she could bring it up later.

"Alright, you promised, you dork." Catra reminds her.

"Ha... I did promise." Adora says. "Hey, I got a new com-pad, Scorpia can send you the new number."

"I-" Catra stops, looking at Bow. "Is it okay if I save the number on your trackerpad?"

"Sure, why not?" Bow asks with a nod. Catra smiles and thanks him before focusing back on the tablet.

"Okay, have Scorpia send it to this contact info."

"Does that mean you want to talk to me more?" Adora asks with a smile

"Adora, that was a dumb question. *Yes* , I want to talk to you."

"Oh good," Adora says. "that's a relief." Catra rolls her eyes at Adora - she really was a huge *dork* .

"I don't think I've seen Catra this happy in awhile." Bow notes. She *hasn't* been this happy, but Catra was too focused on Adora to really pay attention to Bow and the others in the room to comment upon that.

"You really thought I wouldn't want to speak with you, my love? Do you have any idea what I would give to be able to see you in person and kiss you?" Catra asks.

"No, I didn't really think you wouldn't want to talk to me. I know you find me *irresistible* ." Adora says with a big goofy grin. Catra rolls her eyes. She can’t believe she fell in love with the biggest dork on Etheria - and that said dork was *Lord* of the *Horde* .

"Your ego is getting quite big there, babe." Catra pokes fun back.

"You like my big ego."

"Maybe I do. Just as much as I like your big forehead." She teases.

"You-" Adora stops and then huffs. "I want you here."

"And I want to be there." Catra sighs. "You were busy though, I'll talk to you tonight?" Adora looks *reluctant* to say the least.

"I... Yeah, although, I really don't want to hang up."

"I don't want to hang up either."

"I love you."

"I love you too." Catra softens significantly. She hasn't looked or felt as relaxed and happy in weeks then she does right now. "I do have Spinny, ‘Tossa and Bow here though. What would you like to do?"

"Uh..." Adora seems to realise that they're *not alone* and she shakes her head. "What did you have in mind?"

"I don't know, I just like talking to you." She says. "Wanna tell me about what changes you're making over there with the repairs?"

"Oh," Adora says. "Well, the farm is operational again, we're doing the thing you suggested, I got some people looking into the whole smog thing." Adora says. "I just want the Fright Zone to be okay before-" Adora stops. "Before... I don't know, before the Rebellion decides to make us a priority again?"

"You're doing good, Adora. I'm proud of you." Catra purrs softly. "Do you want me to send over some recipes for the cooks to use?" Adora smiles and then nods.

"Yes please, Kitten, I'm sure they'd like that." Catra practically *glows* when she smiles.

"I'll write some simple ones down and I'll send them to you then." She looks at the other three in the room sheepishly. "Sorry for not paying attention to you three."

"Don't be," Spinnerella says. "I think this is exactly what you needed."

"It is." Catra nods. "It really was what I needed."

"You needed me?" Adora asks. *She's such an idiot . I love her.* Catra nods, a soft blush on her cheeks.

"Yeah, it's hard to be without my mate." Catra admits quietly.

"You had to go back, we both know that, your mom never would have let you stay here." Adora says. "We'll be together again, I promise."

"Okay. I'm holding you to that promise." Catra says, purring softly when she sees the look of determination on Adora's face.

"You're sure making a lot of promises, Lord Adora." Netossa says, popping into frame.

"Oh, the Net Princess. So many Princesses, it's like I'm at prom again." Catra giggles at Adora's snark.

"Hey, be nice." She scolds fondly. "And back at prom, I most certainly didn't know what kissing you would be like, nor did I think I'd fall in love with you, so I don't think it's like prom at all." Adora laughs - it's still one of Catra's favourite sounds.

"Now I'm wondering what would have happened if you had kissed me at prom."

"I think there might have been a rampage. Apparently we had sexual tension back then." Catra lets out a little squeaky laugh at the thought.

"You did." Spinnerella comes up behind Netossa and waves. "I think anyone who looked at you two thought you were going to make out on the dance floor."

"I would have had Catra not insulted my forehead."

"You kept flirting! And it was annoying me at the time." Catra says. In her defence, she had been insanely attracted to Adora at Prom, she had looked entirely too hot in that fitted red suit, but they were *enemies* then, she couldn't exactly make out with Adora on the dance floor.

"You say that like a few hours later you didn't proposition me." Adora comments and Catra facepalms.

"Okay, but that was because I was trying to find the fastest way out without needing to start a fight." She rubs her face, laughing softly.

"Wait, is that what happened?" Bow asks.

"Yeah, I figured that Adora was attracted to me, and thought I could use it to my advantage. Neither of us would have thought it would end up like this. Then again, we were literally kissing by the end of the night."

"I had to carry you to my bed."

"You did. You're a very nice pillow."

"I like touching your tail and your ears, and hearing you purr." Catra purrs loudly at Adora's words.

"And I like playing with your hair, and getting to trace patterns on your skin."

"You're going to tempt me to sneak over there."

"Don't. I don't want you to get caught, Adora, I'm already on house arrest. I don't want to think what they'd do to you." Catra shudders at the mere thought. Adora sighs and runs a hand through her hair again, the short tresses tangling for a moment around her fingers.

“I know. It’s just… difficult. I want to be there with you.” Adora looks up at Scorpia. “Hey, you’re not the only one that can make plans, Kitten.”

"Believe me, I know, I want to be there too. I want to be with *you* , Adora." She raises an eyebrow. "What plans are you making?"

“Wouldn’t you like to know.”

"Duh, that's why I asked."

“I can’t tell you yet, it’s top secret.” Catra pouts at her mate.

"Top secret?"

“Uh-huh. I have to go, Kitten. I’ll talk to you later?” Adora asks. Catra's ears press against her head.

"Can you call me tonight? I wanna be able to say good night."

“I will call you whenever you want me to call you.” Adora promises.

"Okay, talk to you tonight." Catra blows a kiss to Adora one more time, giving her a small wave before hanging up. She sighs, hugging the trackerpad to her chest and purring. "Bow, thank you for letting me call her."

“I haven’t seen you this happy since before everything.” Bow comments, slightly distressed.

"That's because I haven't been happy since that happened. Except when I went to see Adora, but that quickly got ruined." She sighs, placing the trackerpad down. "I can't exactly do anything about it."

“What do you want to do?” Bow asks curiously.

"I want to be able to leave this room and take a walk that isn't to the medic without getting glared at, or hearing murmurs about me on the way." Catra says bitterly. She has Magicat hearing, she knows all too well what people say about her under their breath.

“Oh... that’s... a tall order.” Bow admits sadly.

"I know." She shrugs. "C'yra doesn't want me leaving this room anyway. She yelled at me to come here, in case you forgot. It's not like there's anything for me out there. I only have you guys."

“It won’t be like this forever. It *can’t* be.” Bow says.

"I don't want to get my hopes up, Bow." She murmurs. "My heart is already broken enough as it is. I don't want to deal with more pain than necessary."

"Adora promised you'd see each other again."

"I know that! But there's so many people here that would literally attack her the second she came here." Catra says.

"She sounded so sure." Bow says thoughtfully.

"I know, it makes me worried."

"Worried?"

"That she'll do something stupid."

"I'm sure she won't do anything stupid. I mean," Bow laughs nervously. "What could she do?" Catra looks Bow directly in the eyes as she answers him.

"Try to sneak in and get caught by the guards and end up arrested without me knowing." Bow winces a little.

"Well, I suppose she could try that… but if we heard anything like that, we'd tell you, right guys?" Bow asks and Spinnerella and Netossa nod.

"It's still concerning to me." Catra sighs tiredly. "But I guess I'll have to trust her in this."

"We'll let you rest if you're tired." Spinnerella says. "You shouldn't worry until there's something to worry about."

"Yeah, well, this place hasn't exactly given me a reason to relax." Catra points out.

"Adora is out of reach right now. Spinny is right, you shouldn't worry until there's something to worry about. And you have direct contact with Adora now." Netossa says.

"Just, make sure you hide my trackerpad." Bow adds. "Mad C'yra is scary..."

"Mad C'yra is a heartless bitch." Catra mumbles angrily. "But you're right, I can speak to Adora now. I'll make sure to hide it. Thanks again. I know I've been saying it a lot, but... I

mean it."

"I'll talk to Glimmer." Bow says.

"Okay, let me know how that goes. See you all soon?" Catra asks. Honestly, Catra didn't have a lot of faith in Glimmer coming around too soon. Glimmer viewed the Horde as purely evil, which tends to happen when they're the cause of the death of your father.

"Definitely." Bow confirms. Catra nods as she curls up on her bed, snuggling the trackerpad close to her chest. She could speak to Adora now, whenever she so pleased, she hadn't felt this happy in over a month. She hears the three of them exit her room and Catra sighs happily, purring in her little curled up position.

* * *

As the trio are exiting, they look back at Catra who really seemed significantly happier than she had for months simply after just talking to Adora. "She... They really are in love." Bow says with big wide eyes.

"They are." Spinnerella nods at Bow. "They have been all this time. It's too obvious to try to deny it."

"We can't take Adora away from Catra." Bow says.

"Not without breaking her heart and making her resentful for the rest of her life towards the Rebellion... And also possibly putting her and Finn's lives at risk."

"And Adora, she seemed… Nice. Maybe all we really need to do is talk." Bow says, crossing his arms over his chest in thought. "But C'yra is so mad, she won't even listen to her own *wife* ." Spinnerella groans softly at that, pinching the bridge of her nose.

"We'll have to wait and hope that C'yra gets her head out of her ass with time. Ideally *before* Finn is born."

"That's... I don't know... Catra's kind of far along already, what with the months she spent in a coma after the battle with She-Ra, recovering from nearly dying from her grief and now the months under house arrest."

"I know, but we can hope." Spinnerella exhales heavily. "It sucks. Catra's really been going through it, and no one else is even thinking about the consequences it has on her at all." Netossa squeezes her wife's shoulder.

"At least she has us. But you're right. We can't always be here, so we don't really know how Catra's physical and mental states are unless she tells us." The three look at each other with great worry.

“We’ll try our best to protect her.” Bow says and they all nod in agreement.

* * *

Having Adora’s number makes the weeks a little more bearable. Catra gets to speak to her whenever she pleases and Adora *always* picks up. Maybe it wasn’t the same as having her there physically, but it was something at least. It was getting late and Catra knew it was unlikely anyone would be coming to see her tonight - not that they came to see her anyway - which meant she could dial Adora and speak to her happily.

She calls her number and waits for Adora to pick up - which she does after only a few rings. “Kitten,” Adora greets happily. “You just missed me doing press ups, how sad for you.” Catra laughs and shakes her head at Adora when her eyes finally take in all that she was seeing. Adora was a little flushed, which meant she probably had been working out, and she wasn’t just saying that, but what was catching Catra’s attention the most was her *collarbones* .

“Are you…” Catra swallows thickly. “Are you naked right now?” Catra asks and Adora’s goofy smile turns into a smug smile.

“Do you wish I was naked right now?” She asks and Catra blinks at her in disbelief. Adora is the *worst* but in the best way possible - Catra really can’t put it better than that. Part of her wants to say *yes* but she also doesn’t want to give Adora the satisfaction of knowing that that’s what she wants. When Catra doesn’t say anything further, Adora hums. “If you really must know, I’m in my standard Horde issued sports bra.”

“So you’re shirtless?” Catra asks, licking her lips. Adora’s smirk only grows. Adora is sometimes irritatingly smug but, for some damn reason, it really fucking works for her.

“Want to see my abs?” She asks and Catra rolls her eyes before she considers.

“Yeah actually.” Catra says and Adora raises her eyebrows. She moves the camera so Catra can see her abs and Catra’s tail raises of its own accord. Adora really is *sweaty* and Catra can see the waistband of her boxer shorts. She was working out in her *underwear* , Catra swears Adora knew she would be calling her and this was *entrapment* . Gods, Catra wants to reach her hand out and run her fingers over Adora’s abdomen. So she does the next best thing.

“Can you… touch your abs?” Catra asks. She can’t see Adora’s face at this angle but she’s sure that she’s smirking. She hears the blonde let out a huff of laughter before she moves her free hand down and runs those long fingers of hers over her stomach. *Fuck* . Catra isn’t sure what it is about this that is turning her on but *it’s turning her on* . Catra bites her lip. “Okay… now can you… Can you take the sports bra off for me?” Catra asks, readjusting her position on her bed. She wasn’t exactly expecting to do *this* with Adora, yet here they were.

Adora lifts the camera back up to her face. She has her eyebrow raised in fond amusement. “Catra are you,” She gasps dramatically. “Horny?” She asks. Catra huffs in slight annoyance. *She really fucking was* .

“Adora…” Catra says with a groan. “Yes I am, okay? It’s been a while since we… You know… And pregnancy, surprisingly, sometimes makes me feel more horny than usual, and I don’t have you here to help me take care of it.” Catra says and maybe she was *slightly* sexually frustrated, and this was coming out more aggressive than she planned, but Adora just listens patiently. “So… if you’re willing… I really want you to fuck me.”

“Oh, *absolutely* , Kitten.” Adora says. “You want me naked though? For me to walk you through touching yourself?” Catra huffs.

“Maybe I just want to see your tits, sue me.” Catra says. Adora lets out a laugh of amusement and then the next second she’s pulling her sports bra over her head.

“Fair’s fair, Kitten.” She says. “You too.” Catra is more than eager to get undressed - she’s already wet just simply from looking at Adora’s abs. She wiggles out of her clothes with a little difficulty, thanks to her growing bump, but then she settles on her bed again, propping the com-pad up so Adora can see.

Adora takes a sharp breath in when she sees *all* of Catra and then she gets that *look* , the look she always gets before sex. “I wish I was there,” She says, her voice coming out a little husky with her desire. “Touch your boobs for me, Kitten, like this.” Catra’s pupils blow wide when she sees Adora start to touch her own breast. Catra follows her action, rubbing and fondling her boobs in her hands, imagining that Adora was above her and doing it to her rather than it being her own hands. “Pinch your nipple.” Adora demands. Catra’s breath hitches as she *pinches* . She feels like she could cum off of this alone. Her boobs have only gotten more sensitive with her pregnancy, and the way Adora has her touching them now is driving her absolutely wild.

“ *Adora* …” Catra pants, more like whimpers, as she feels a spike of pleasure shoot through her. Her hips jolt upwards and when she opens her eyes she sees Adora’s intense blue eyes staring at her as she licks her lips.

“Just like that Kitten,” Adora encourages. “Keep going.” So Catra does, *eagerly* . She keeps going until she is practically *writhing* on her sheets, a mess of mewls and pleas for her mate to *finally* touch her - or to at least give her *permission* to touch herself. She’s almost certain that the sheets below her are wet with her desire and if Adora doesn’t say something soon, she will literally explode.

“Okay, Kitten,” Adora says. “Touch yourself now.” Adora demands and Catra is more than willing to do that. She still keeps one hand on her breast, teasing her nipple as she snakes a hand down to her folds. She runs her fingers through her wet, slick, lips, groaning at finally feeling *something* down there and actually *moaning* when she presses her fingers to her clit. “That’s right…” Adora coos. “Just like that. Fuck yourself like I would fuck you.” Catra is

practically dripping from those words and she gathers up her wetness before she slides her fingers into her entrance.

She’s met with no resistance whatsoever, and she immediately adds two fingers - it seemed Adora knew how to work Catra up even virtually. Catra touches herself without abandon, she moves her hips, fucking herself down on her fingers as Adora watches on. She imagines this is Adora touching her, moans her name, listens to Adora’s laboured breathing that comes over the microphone. She almost has herself fooled. *Almost* . But then she starts to get into her own head.

Catra starts to become aware of all the things that are different to how Adora touches her. Her fingers just aren’t the right fit, her movements aren’t as precise as Adora’s, even Catra doesn’t quite know how to hit that *spot* on the front of her walls that Adora so skilfully seems to be able to hit with every single thrust that she does. Catra’s thrusts begin to stutter as she starts to get into her head about it. "My fingers aren't as long as yours." Catra whines. She can hear Adora laugh and her ears perk up at the sound.

"Don't get hung up on the specifics, just imagine I'm there, touching you." Adora says smoothly. Catra tries, she really does, but it's just not the same.

"I just... I wish you were really here." Catra complains, stilling her fingers. She peeks an eye open to see Adora watching her intently.

"Me too Kitten, believe me, I *so* wish I was there, but this is as close as we can get right now." Adora says gently. "I wish I was touching you myself."

"Did I kill the mood?" Catra asks and Adora laughs - it manages to warm Catra’s insides all the way up.

"The only mood to kill is your own. So, I guess, it's up to you."

"Keep talking to me." Catra says, adjusting and lying back again.

"About what? The weather?" Adora asks and Catra looks at her with an unamused expression. Adora laughs. "Wow, don't mess with mama cat."

"Adora, I don't appreciate your jokes when I'm finger deep." Catra deadpans - although she is somewhat bemused by the blonde. Adora rolls her eyes and she moves her position. She lowers her voice and Catra's ears perk up to catch the sound.

"You're so cute," Adora notes. Catra is about to protest when Adora's eyes get a little darker. "I wish I was there. Close your eyes again, Kitten." Catra follows Adora's commands and closes her eyes.

"What would you do to me if you were here?" Catra asks as she starts moving her fingers again. She lets her mind and her body relax, imagining it was Adora pressed up against her back and not just pillows.

"Touch your clit," Adora orders and Catra reaches her thumb up to play with her clit. "Good girl, Catra."

" *Fuck* ..." Catra feels a fresh coat of wetness gush onto her fingers at Adora's words. She could imagine it now, Adora behind her, her legs open and Catra pressed up to her back, both of them naked, Adora's hand around and working Catra up *expertly* . Catra isn't new to touching herself, who could fuck her better than herself? But Adora... Adora somehow manages it. "Keep talking to me..." Catra says. She can tell Adora is fumbling by the way it takes her a moment to respond.

"I-" She stops and Catra whimpers, her ears pressing back against her head. "If I was there, I would... I'd touch you exactly how you're touching yourself right now, right until you came, I'd kiss your jaw, scratch that spot, *take* you."

" *Yes* ..." Catra moans quietly. She's aware there are guards posted at her door, not that it's any of their business what she gets up to privately, but she doesn't want anyone walking in on this. Not only would she die of embarrassment, they'd see *who* she was talking to.

"Then I'd take my sword and take you again." Adora's voice is low and laced with desire. The thought of taking Adora's strap immediately turns Catra on to the max. Her walls clench around her fingers and she lets out her loudest moan yet. She's already pretty damn close now.

Her hips begin to move more rapidly as she pumps her fingers in and out of herself. Catra can hear Adora's breath picking up the same way Catra's picks up as she pushes herself closer and closer to orgasm. She no longer cares if people can hear her, she's too damn close to care. Her whimpers and moans come out loudly and Catra simply prays that the thick wood of her door is enough to stop the guards hearing *too* much. " *Adora* …" Catra whimpers, opening her eyes to look at those beautiful blue eyes. Adora's expression is soft, flushed a little with her desire, but soft, open, caring, her face is framed by those short blonde locks of hers and her face is only encouraging. It has the red hot coil in Catra's stomach almost burning her alive.

"That's right Catra, right there, good girl." Adora encourages softly. "I'm right here with you. You can cum for me, all for me." Catra can't hold back. Her orgasm hits her like a freight train when Adora's soft words reach her ears. She has to stifle her moan with her free hand and she feels her walls practically suction cup around her fingers she cums so hard. She falls back into the pillows of her bed, panting and sweating as she slowly yet surely comes down from her high.

After a while, Catra opens her eyes again to see Adora looking at her with an expression of wonder and *love* on her face. "Let me get you." Catra says, blinking her eyes open.

"No need Kitten, you came, mission accomplished for me." Adora smiles as she shifts her position. "I'm good, promise." Catra hums. She feels light and floaty and the best she's felt in literal months. She wished she had Adora here to cuddle her now. "You needed that, huh?" Adora asks.

"I need *you* ." Catra says and Adora gets a sad expression on her face.

"I know, Kitten. I need you too." She says. Catra hums as she grabs the trackerpad - gods, if Bow knew what she was doing with this thing … She curls up in her soft sheets after doing little wiggles and lets out a long satisfied sigh.

She curls her tail between her legs and she grabs hold of it as she positions the trackerpad against one of her pillows as she lies down. She begins to pet her tail, just how Adora does it, and her purrs start up almost immediately. Adora smiles at her and Catra opens one eye lazily. She knows it's only a matter of time before she drifts off to sleep but she wants to take in all of Adora's face before she does. "What are you planning, Adora?" Catra asks. Adora looks caught off guard but she quickly fixes her gaze.

"I'm planning on making sure the Fright Zone is okay." Adora answers cryptically but Catra can tell that there's *more* , something that Adora isn't telling her.

"Before you leave?" Catra asks. Adora sighs on the other end and Catra watches as she lies down in her own bed, getting comfortable. They've done this many nights now, fallen asleep while on call to each other, just listening to each other's breathing as they fell into a deep sleep across from each other - even if it was virtually.

"Before something happens," Adora answers. "I don't know what the future holds, plans don't always work out… But I want the Fright Zone to be well taken care of, in case of *anything* ."

"You know I won't let anything happen to you." Catra says and Adora lets out a small huff of laughter.

"I'm not sure it will always be entirely up to you, Catra." Adora says gently. "Can you promise me something?" Adora asks and Catra peeks an eye open - which she hadn't even realised she had closed until now. Catra nods for her to continue, not making any promises until she heard what it was that Adora had to say. "Promise me that if anything did happen to me, that you would… You would stay. For Finn. They need you." Both of Catra's eyes open and she pushes herself up a little to look at her mate.

"They need you too, Dummy." Catra says. She feels a little panicked. She doesn't know what the future holds, but she does know that she *can't* lose Adora again. It would *destroy* her.

"I know," Adora smiles sadly. "But you're not public enemy number one, half of Etheria, maybe more, doesn't want you dead. Even if peace were successful… The Rebellion, civilians, *everyone* , except the Horde, hates me. I put you, I put *Finn,* in danger just by

existing. So many people want me dead, Catra, we have to consider the fact that maybe, *maybe* , someone might just succeed."

" *No* ." Catra shakes her head. "Absolutely not."

"Will you just promise me that? It would make me feel much better." Adora says and Catra sighs. She doesn't want to promise that because it feels too much like giving up, but, if it'll make Adora feel better, then she will.

"Fine, I promise. But it *won't* happen." She deadpans and Adora smiles softly in response.

"That's all I wanted to hear." Adora says. Then she lets out a groan as she stretches on her bed. "Time to get some shut eye I think."

"Yeah, you exhausted me." Catra jabs lightly.

"It's what I do best." Adora responds and Catra rolls her eyes. She gets back into her comfortable position and lies down on the bed again, curling up. She had no intention of having to keep that promise because she would never let it happen in the first place. *Never* . Slowly, Catra drifts off feeling satisfied and listening to her lover's gentle breathing beside her.

* * *

1 Month Later

Adora sighs as she enters her throne room. She misses Catra. It's been a couple of months since she had to return back to Bright Moon to avoid causing another war outbreak and Adora still didn't know if, or when, she was going to see Catra again in person.

The video calls helped, but it was nothing like having Catra *physically* in her arms. She knows from their previous calls that Catra wasn't doing so well, but she always seemed to cheer up whenever she talked to Adora. Adora's heart clenches in her chest as she thinks about that. Catra gets happy talking to *her* . She still could hardly believe that.

Usually, Catra will call her, but Adora was done for the day. The artificial farm was back up and running and Adora had been eating so well again that she'd regained that muscle mass that she'd lost in the months she hadn't been - she also didn't threaten to pass out just walking to the kitchens. She was also working on her anger issues with Scorpia's help. All of that was a wonderful distraction from the absence of Catra, but she was *always* missing her, constantly, like a dull ache in her chest.

Adora pulls out her com-pad and dials Catra's extension, hoping she'd pick up. It takes a few minutes but eventually Catra does in fact pick up, her tired but happy smile in full view of the camera. "Adora, Love. How are you doing?" She asks, already purring at the sight of Adora. Adora sighs happily and presses her cheek to the screen of com-pad unconsciously, like she was physically nuzzling Catra.

"Gods, I've missed your voice." Adora says, moving back to look at her screen. "I'm okay. I miss you. But I'm more worried about you." Catra smiles at Adora's affection and she does the same - despite the fact Adora wouldn't be able to feel it, she still loves it.

"I've missed you too. I'm... okay. I'm doing better now that I get the chance to talk to you. You have no idea how much I've missed you, Love. It's hard being away from you."

"I know," Adora says as she climbs the steps to her throne. She sits down on it with a grunt. "It's hard being away from you too. But how are the rebels treating you?"

"They're..." Catra stays silent for a moment, seemingly debating her answer. "They're the same, I guess." She says with a small shrug. "How's the farm going?" Adora raises her eyebrows.

"The same?" She asks, unconvinced. "Why do I get the feeling you're downplaying that?"

"They're still being jerks, Adora. Is that what you want me to say? I can hardly go outside this... this *prison* of a room without hearing people talk shit about me behind my back, or without them glaring at me." Catra says, a bit of anger in her voice. "Sorry, I'm just... tired... and scared. I don't know who I can trust, aside from Spinnerella and Netossa and Bow, the rest of them have been pretty horrible." Adora shrinks back a little in her throne at Catra's angry tone.

"I'm sorry, Kitten, dumb question." Adora runs her fingers through her hair. "The farm is good, and I'm good. It won't be long until this is all over. I can... do something then. I don't like that you're alone."

"It's okay, I'm just tired is all. I'm sorry for being angry, it's not directed at you. I promise." Catra says softly. "I'm glad the farm is going good." She pauses. "Please don't do something stupid, Love. I don't want anyone getting caught in the crossfire."

"Doing something stupid is my middle name."

"I know that, but I'm begging you not to."

"I'll leave the doing something stupid thing to you. Also known as me. I'm the stupid something that you should do." Catra giggles.

"I wish. I would love to be there with you."

"Me too." Adora says, bringing her knees up to her chest. "You don't deserve this, just because you love me."

"No, I don't. But the ones who think they're being righteous are the ones hurting us, hurting *me,* the most." Adora closes her eyes briefly.

"What I wouldn't give to be there with you right now." Adora says quietly. "I want to cuddle you."

"I know." Catra whispers, her finger tracing Adora's face on the screen. "I wish you were here to hold me and tell me things are gonna be okay."

"Things *are* going to be okay. I promise."

"You really mean that?" Catra asks softly. Adora can tell that Catra wishes those words to be true more than anything.

"Of course I do." Adora says. "How is Finn?" Catra smiles.

"Still inside my tummy. Growing and waiting to get to come out. Just a few more months."

"Kind of crazy that in a few months we'll have an actual real life baby." Adora says. She never once thought about the possibility of becoming a parent one day - let alone to a *Princess* .

"I know, it's shocking but it makes me happy. Our little kitten." Catra purrs and, Adora can't see but she's pretty sure, Catra rests her hand on her stomach lovingly.

"Catra..." Adora hesitates for a moment. She's not sure if she should bring this up now but it's a very real anxiety that she has and she feels like it might be best to express said anxiety to Catra now rather than when Finn is born."What if... What if I'm... What if I... How do you know if I'll be a good mom?" Adora asks, forcing the question out. Catra smiles softly at her.

"Because you want to make sure Finn and I are happy, because you're willing to give so much for our kitten."

"What if I'm like Shadow Weaver?" Adora asks. She doesn't think that she would ever treat her child the same way that Shadow Weaver treated her but Adora was worried she would do

it subconsciously or something - that she wouldn’t realise she was mistreating her child because she was just used to Shadow Weaver’s parenting.

"You want to know why you won't be like Shadow Weaver?" Catra asks. Adora hesitates for a moment before she slowly nods for Catra to continue. "Because you're worried about becoming like her. You don't want to be cruel. You don't want Finn to be a soldier. You want Finn to be happy, because you love them. You don't have any intent to use them for your benefit. That's why."

"I-" Adora pauses. "I don't... but what if... What if I don't mean to, but I do end up hurting them? Like I did with you. What if I mess them up?" Adora asks, looking at Catra with deep worry. She was *terrified* of hurting Finn, but also of hurting Catra.

"You won't." Catra whispers reassuringly. "And even if you do, you would apologise and do everything in your power to make up for it. That's another difference between you and Shadow Weaver. When you hurt someone, you say sorry and try to fix it. She tries to *justify* it."

"I don't deserve you." Adora says with a soft expression, her heart feeling *full* .

"You do. I love you, Adora."

"I love you too." Adora says with a gentle smile.

"You've got to be kidding me." Glimmer cuts in. Adora sees Catra jump and hold the tablet to her chest.

"Glimmer… What are you doing here?!" Catra asks with surprise.

"I came... Doesn't matter why I came! Are you seriously talking to Lord Adora?" Glimmer asks, and Adora can hear the frown in her voice alone. "Where did you even get that?"

"No... I'm not." Catra says, holding the trackerpad closer to her chest. "And it's none of your business."

"The hell you're not! I just heard her!"

"Well you're imagining things! Now get out!" Catra yells. Adora hears a struggle and then she sees Glimmer scowling as she grabs the trackerpad off of Catra.

"You're still lying." Glimmer says with disappointment as she sees the Horde Lord on the screen. "And you're still talking to *her* ? Why?!"

"Give it back!" Catra cries out, trying to reach for the trackerpad. Adora's heart practically jumps up into her throat at the sound of desperation in Catra's voice. "She's my mate! I miss her! What did you expect for me to do? I have no one else to talk to! Now give that back!"

"No!" Glimmer refuses angrily, lifting the tablet above her head. "Sit down before you hurt yourself."

"Give it to me! It's not like you care if I hurt myself anyway!" Catra yells, jumping up to try to grab the tablet, hand on her stomach to hold the weight. "Glimmer, don't take it away!" Adora was *worried* to say the least.

"Maybe you two should both stop that." Adora says. "Before one, or both of you, get hurt. Not that I care about Sparkles getting hurt, but I do care about Catra and my unborn child."

"Stay out of this, Lord Asshat!" Glimmer hisses. She teleports away from Catra's grasp, across the room, still holding the tablet.

"She's gonna take the trackerpad away!" Catra whimpers, rushing over to Glimmer to try to grab it but the Princess teleports away again. "Don't take it from me... *please* ..." Adora feels

her heart break in her chest at the sound of Catra's desperate pleas.

"Do you know how *insane* your mom would be if she found out you were still talking to Lord Adora?" Glimmer asks. Adora has a pretty good idea.

"I don't care! I *need* her. I miss her, Glimmer." Catra looks at her with pleading eyes. "Please give it back to me. This is all I have." Adora sees Glimmer hesitating for a moment. She looks at Catra, and then down at the tablet where Adora sits up a little to look at her. Glimmer stares at the Lord for a long moment with a scowl before she looks back at Catra.

"I can't." She says. "I have to give this to C'yra."

"Glimmer, *please* !"

"You should've thought about that before you decided to talk to her again." Glimmer retorts. A sob spills from Catra's lips as she tries to reach for the trackerpad again. Adora knew that she couldn't lose it, that it was the only thing that was making her happy right now.

"Don't take it from me. Don't take my only way to communicate with my mate away from me."

"Like I'm going to let you keep talking to Lord Adora." Glimmer scowls. Adora watches as Catra falls onto the floor, sitting there with her legs beneath her as she cries and *cries* . Adora's heart *shatters* in her chest at the sight and she feels her anger spike. They were *hurting* Catra and they were *justifying* with their hate for her. Adora knows that these few talking sessions were the only thing keeping Catra going, now she had lost that too.

Adora loses her visual of Catra when Glimmer teleports away from her. She sees the Princess' face when she raises the pad up to look at the screen again. "You're hurting her." Adora says simply. She sees Glimmer about to open her mouth again but she quickly cuts her off. "I understand that you hate me, but do you really hate Catra that much? You didn't have to tell C'yra, *you're* destroying your friendship." Glimmer remains silent as she stares at Adora. "Just, reconsider your priorities, Sparkles. Catra is a *good* person, and she doesn't

deserve to be mistreated by the people who are supposed to care about her. Now, if you excuse me, I have an empire to run."

"Don't call this number ever again." Glimmer spits. Adora spares one last glance at Glimmer. She gives her her most chilling look she has.

"Wasn't planning on it. Be seeing you soon, Sparkles." Adora hangs up and sinks back in her throne with a sigh. She really wishes she hadn't called Catra now.

* * *

It's late and Adora can't sleep. She's thinking about Catra in a way that she feels like she *shouldn't* be thinking of Catra. She hadn't heard from Catra since Glimmer interrupted their last talk and Adora figured she was probably unlikely to. It was okay though, she has a plan.

Her mind drifts to less innocent memories. Memories of Catra below her, *squirming* in pleasure as Adora had her way with her. Adora shifts her legs, feeling her thighs rub together and the corresponding wetness that has started to pool between her legs. "Fuck…" Adora grabs her pillow and positions it against the bed before she pulls her pants down. She keeps her boxers on, finding the friction of the fabric provided her with *amazing* stimulation and also protected her pillow from getting any fluids on it.

She lands on top of it and almost immediately begins to rock her hips. She lets out a low whimper in the quiet of her bedroom. Adora was never really one for penetration, she'd much rather focus on her clit, and this was *perfect* .

She lets her mind wander, letting it think about the pillow below her being Catra. She thinks about how Catra would grip her shirt as Adora thrusted into her. " *Ahh…* " Adora moans. *Shit.* Catra isn't even here and Adora is unbelievably wet and ready for her. She *wishes* she was here, that she was using her strap on her and making hard love to her.

Adora's breathing becomes laboured as she feels the slow buildup of pleasure and pressure building inside of her. It's been a while since she's had actual sex, though she had came close

to touching herself after that certain video call with Catra, but she refrained, instead passing out on her bed to Catra's soft purrs from her com-pad.

Sex with Catra is great. It's the best. Adora can't believe she ever thought she could be satisfied by anyone else before Catra. She's never reached the heights of pleasure she has reached with Catra with anyone else before. Adora doubles her efforts. Thinking about Catra is *all* Adora needs. It doesn't take her long at all. When she starts to feel the perfect pressure, pace and her mind is full of Catra, *Catra, Catra* . Adora is cumming within minutes.

She fists the sheets below her as she cums and she lets out a loud and long moan of pleasure. She collapses onto her pillow and just stays there for a moment as she comes down. Adora feels a little guilty, she imagines Catra is absolutely miserable right now after their conversation was so rudely interrupted by the sparkly Princess. She wishes she could just go to Catra, but things are falling into place, it wouldn't be long now. The Fright Zone was close to not needing her, Adora's strength was almost entirely returned, she could perform her plan without worrying about the future of her people.

Adora stands up and heads to her bathroom. She strips off her clothes, her underwear in particular being sticky, and she gets into the shower. She had a *plan* . *Soon* , Catra and her would be together again, the Rebellion be damned.

* * *

3 Months Later

Luna was on her way to go retrieve her wife when she saw a commotion. It seemed as though everyone was busy with something, guards were rushing around, Luna could feel *something* in the air and she wasn't sure why it unsettled her. She finds the woman in question in the War Room with the other Princesses - Spinnerella and Netossa excluded since they were currently with Catra. "What is going on here?" Luna asks, looking at her wife with utter confusion.

"We're getting ready to attack the Horde." C'yra answers simply. Luna couldn't believe what she was hearing, but then she takes in the entirety of C'yra's appearance. She was dressed in her war armour, crown atop her head and her hair tied back.

“You can’t be serious.” Luna says in disbelief. “I came here to tell you that our daughter is in *labour* !”

“I know.” C’yra responds. “Which is why we need to go now, Catra can’t do anything while she’s giving birth.”

“Do you even hear yourself right now?!” Luna yells, horrified by her wife’s words. “You… You waited until now, didn’t you?” Luna shakes her head. “I wondered why you were waiting, letting the Horde build up their strength, it was because you were waiting until our daughter was *giving birth* before you decided to attack. I can’t believe you!” Luna was appalled by her wife. She knew she was angry, she knew that she hated Adora, but to do something so callous, while Catra was unable to do anything about it, was extremely cold hearted.

“It’s better this way,” C’yra says dismissively. “This way C’yra won’t be hurt by doing something stupid like trying to protect her mate.”

“We don’t execute in cold blood.” Luna says. “Or have you forgotten that? We *always* give a fair trial.”

“Some things can’t be helped, especially if she resists.” C’yra says coldly. Luna stares at her. She can’t believe that this is the same woman that she married. C’yra is completely driven by anger and betrayal - she isn’t *thinking* .

“This is low, C’yra.” Luna says.

“Nothing is too low for me,” She says as she stands up straight. “Especially when it comes to protecting our daughter. Now, you can either join me, or step aside.” Luna looks around the room at the Princesses.

“Glimmer?” Luna asks and the Bright Moon Princess simply averts her gaze. “Angella?” She looks at her long time friend who at least has the decency to look guilty.

“We took a vote… the majority voted for this, Luna.” Queen Angella says. “It’s out of my hands.”

“And where the hell was my vote?!” Luna exclaims. “Netossa’s? Spinnerella’s? Bow?! How did the majority win here?!” Luna couldn’t let them do this, she couldn’t. If Catra came out of labour and she found out Adora had been killed… There was no good outcome for that.

“This is happening, Love-” C’yra begins but Luna holds her hand up.

“Do *not* call me that when you’re planning on doing what you are.” She seethes. She laughs in disbelief. “I can’t believe you, I really can’t, I thought better of you C’yra.” She angrily grabs her wife by her armour. “I’m coming with you.”

“But you-”

“ *I’m coming with you,* to make sure you don’t execute that poor girl.” Luna says with a growl. “I’m going to make sure she gets a *fair* trial, I’m going to *protect her* from *you* .”

“You realise she’s the Horde Lord, right?” C’yra asks and Luna can tell she’s angry by the sparkle that’s in her eyes but Luna *doesn’t care* . She will protect Adora, for her daughter, but also for Adora herself. She doesn’t deserve to be killed in cold blood.

“I don’t care, C’yra.” Luna says, releasing her. “I’m coming with you, even though we should be *here* , while our daughter goes through the scariest moment of her life.” C’yra’s ears press back against her head a little at Luna’s words. *Good* . Luna knows that C’yra knows how labour feels, considering that she gave birth to their own daughter, but she still went ahead and made this plan anyway. Not only did Catra not have her mate with her, she didn’t even have her own *mothers* with her. Luna couldn’t even begin to imagine how alone and afraid she was. But she had to go with C’yra. For Catra, and for Adora, and for *Finn* . She *had* to.

“Please forgive me, kitten.” Luna murmurs under her breath. She feels as though she is abandoning her child in her greatest hour of need, but it’s a necessary evil. She just hopes,

and prays, that the presence of Spinnerella and Netossa will be enough.

“Very well.” C’yra says. “Then we march on the Horde, and we end this, once and for all.”

Chapter End Notes

For those of you who have made it this far, hang in there. It will get better... probably. Maybe. I can't really say ;) -M

I basically spent all of today editing this for update day. I got to say, I do kind of adore Adora's sense of humour and I hope y'all do too sdfghjkl she is a giant dork and I love her <3 Anyway, get ready for Adora's plan! >:) -S

As always, you can find us on Twitter @ceolordadora and our CC is the same. You can find me (S) on tumblr @sherasswordstrap

So it's gonna be Forever

Chapter Summary

> Adora's peace is rudely interrupted by Scorpia bursting into the throne room urgently. "Adora," She calls, hurrying up the steps to the throne. Adora looks at her curiously as she stops just a few feet from the throne. "The Princesses! They're here!"

Chapter Notes

> Happy Friday !! And Happy Update Day :)!! We hope you enjoy this chapter and we'll see you again next week !!
>
> Warning: Violence, blood and injury in this chapter

See the end of the chapter for more notes

Adora was sitting on her throne. She wasn't sure what it was but she could feel something happening, today felt… *different* , to say the least. Something had possessed her to get completely dressed, in her armour and all. She had been feeling a little on edge. She hadn't seen Catra for *months* and it was like she was going through withdrawal. She missed her so deeply. Adora has been through a lot, she's been literally *tortured* , but nothing is as painful as being separated from Catra for this long.

She thinks it's almost ironic. What was it that Shadow Weaver used to say? That she was unlovable and incapable of loving. She knows that's wrong now, knows it couldn't be more wrong. She loves Catra with everything that she has, and Catra loves her back just as much. They will be reunited, soon, if Adora had to guess - *very* soon.

She hasn't really thought about Shadow Weaver much. She knows that she's still alive, Scorpia told her as much, but she hasn't been to see her since after the battle. Some part of Adora feels guilty about what she did to her, she took her anger out on her, she reacted violently and emotionally, just like she so often did, but she was different now. She had changed. A lot. And she had no intentions of going back. But maybe it wouldn't hurt to go see her one last time? Just so Adora could put this to bed once and for all before it was too late.

Adora stands from her throne, her cape feels heavy as she descends down the many many stairs. “Lord Adora.” Her door guards greet her and Adora smiles as they bow at her. She gives them a greeting back before she carries on down the hallway to her destination.

She trails her hand over the metal wall of the Fright Zone. She misses this place already. She’s going to miss everything about it, from the whirring machinery, to the thudding her heavy boots make on the steel flooring. Adora could navigate this place with her eyes closed, she has wandered the hallways that many times.

In fact, Adora lets her eyes close as she allows herself to *think* . She has spent twenty-four years in the Fright Zone, she has been here since she was a baby. She has seen very little of Etheria, despite living on the planet. The only parts she has seen has been while travelling from battle to battle, and that didn’t exactly account for much. She has had all her firsts in the Fright Zone. She remembers kissing girls against walls and in closets away from the prying eyes of commanding officers in her teen years. She remembers her first time as a senior cadet, eighteen and fumbling her way through the action in a musty supply closet. She remembers kissing girls in her bunk in the barracks and Lonnie throwing a pillow at her to knock it off. She remembers limping down these hallways when injured, sneaking to the med wing for medical supplies. You know, typical Horde pass times.

All her firsts have been here, even with Catra. First time she kissed her, the first time they ended up in bed together, the first time they said goodbye, the first time they said they loved each other. Despite all the pain that she has endured in the Fright Zone, it is home. Or, it was. There’s somewhere else that Adora feels her home is, and that’s Catra. Catra makes her feel everything the Fright Zone makes her feel and more. The Fright Zone is familiar, Adora is allergic to change as a general rule, she despises it, but she *has* changed and she needs to *keep* changing. Things are *going* to change. The Fright Zone will always hold a special place in her heart, she has loved and been loved here, she has grown up here, she was *made* here, but it’s no longer her home. It isn’t where she belongs.

Catra is her home now. She is her future. There is nowhere else that Adora wants to be other than with Catra. She’d already talked to Scorpia about everything and, though she’d had her doubts and reservations, she was on board (for the most part) which meant that Adora could focus on putting that plan into action as soon as the opportunity presented itself. She loves and cares about the Fright Zone, which is why she has helped fix what she broke, and why she is confident that leaving it in the care of Scorpia is the best option. Hordak took the Fright Zone from the Scorpion Kingdom, Adora was giving it back.

This chapter of Adora's life was coming to an end. She *hoped* she'd get the chance to have another chapter in her life but… She opens her eyes and shakes her head. She couldn't let herself think about that. Her friends, her *family* , would be safe in the Fright Zone with Scorpia. Lonnie had somewhat called her an idiot for her plan, but then she'd said she was proud of her - which only told Adora that she was making the *right* decision.

She remembers the first time she met Catra. When she had been eighteen, freshly promoted to Lord after taking Hordak out, it was when she had attacked Thaymor on Shadow Weaver's orders, believing (falsely) that the town was a dangerous rebel fortress. Catra had been *pissed* and Adora had spotted her helping civilians escape and approached her which, frankly, was pretty damn stupid of her. She had been trained by Shadow Weaver on the Princesses before the battle and she recognised Catra as Princess C'yra of Half-Moon - also known as Catra. She also knew her greatest strength and danger were her claws. " *Magicats are fast and strong, their claws are sharp, you should avoid them at all costs.* " That advice from Shadow Weaver seems almost ironic now that Adora has had those claws of Catra on her in many *many* ways.

At the time, Adora has been kind of… bold, definitely a little gross and forward with her flirting. She had offered for Catra to get on her knees for her. She just… She found Catra's reactions kind of funny. She had backed her up against a wall, flirted obnoxiously with her and Catra had put her claws to her throat in warning but she still didn't do anything. Catra had claimed that it was because the Princesses didn't kill, but Adora's pretty sure it was because Catra *liked* her - even if she violently protested against that at the time. She remembers Catra asking her to stop the attack, begging really, and Adora could see that clearly Thaymor was not what Shadow Weaver had told her it was, but she could never go back to Shadow Weaver as a *failure* . Even the thought of that *now* filled her with panic and she hasn't been under Shadow Weaver's control for *years* . She had allowed the Princesses to evacuate the civilians but she had taken the town anyway because she was so afraid of failing.

Adora sighs. She is afraid that Shadow Weaver *will* always have a hold over her, no matter what, there will always be some part of her that is terrified of failing, of letting people down, of not meeting impossible expectations that people may or may not have for her, an incurable need to please people. Catra would probably call that *trauma* but Adora would just call it life. She was afraid she'd unintentionally hurt Finn by being like Shadow Weaver, but Catra was probably right. She doubts Shadow Weaver *ever* worried about how she was treating Adora, the fact that Adora was so worried was a *good* sign. Plus, she wasn't alone. She had Catra. That's all she really needed.

Adora arrives outside of her cell and she cautiously pushes the door open. Shadow Weaver was sitting on the ground and she doesn't bother to stand when Adora enters. Adora's not

sure what she expected if she's honest, Shadow Weaver rarely cared when Adora came to see her anyway but she did expect some kind of reaction, maybe a mocking greeting, instead she just sits there silently. Her mask is cracked, a lasting reminder of the damage Adora's fist did, her silky black hair is limp and she looks… well, she looks almost broken. Adora half feels bad. "Shadow Weaver." Adora says as she comes to stand in front of the green forcefield.

"Adora," Shadow Weaver says back. "Did you come here to gloat? To finish what you started? Or some other reason?" She asks. Adora still can't figure this woman out, she doesn't think she ever will if she's honest. Adora doesn't answer her immediately, instead, she sits down in front of her, crossing her legs under herself and making sure she doesn't sit on her cape.

"I just… I don't know." Adora says. "I wanted to close this chapter of my life." She falls silent for a moment before she decides to ask Shadow Weaver something she's always wanted to know. "Why did you do what you did?" Adora asks. "Why me? Why… everything?" Shadow Weaver glances at her fleetingly. Adora is stunned by how unbothered she is by it. She no longer cares about what Shadow Weaver thinks, maybe she will always have the trauma she inflicted upon her but she will never feel obliged to please Shadow Weaver by being someone she is not.

"Hordak tried opening a portal many years ago but when he got there, there was nothing." Shadow Weaver begins and Adora frowns softly. She isn't entirely sure how that's relevant to what she asked but she can also tell Shadow Weaver isn't finished. "Except you." Shadow Weaver continues. "He found you and brought you back to the Horde, he was going to put you with the others but I… I felt your power, your *magic* , I knew you were special."

"I'm not special." Adora interrupts, shaking her head.

"You *are* ," Shadow Weaver says sternly. "As much as you may deny it, you are very special, Adora. You were destined for greatness, I could *feel* it." Adora huffs and shakes her head but she chooses to allow Shadow Weaver to continue. "You are She-Ra, there hasn't been another She-Ra for a thousand years, she is the Princess of *Power* , you are Etheria's protector, your magic is the strongest on Etheria. I knew all of this when you were just a *baby* . I knew the day would come when you discovered your true power, I made you loyal, I made you exactly what I wanted you to be. When you found that sword, you could have run, but you came back here, to me, you told me everything, and I turned you against Hordak." Adora sits silently as Shadow Weaver speaks. She feels almost sick as she listens. She really was just a pawn to Shadow Weaver, she never cared, she never loved her, she was an object of power for her to use as she pleased and Adora played right into it.

“Children are so malleable, you were *my* soldier, absolutely loyal, you would do anything for me. The perfect, dutiful, loyal, ruthless, soldier. And then you changed.” Adora’s eyes narrow a little as Shadow Weaver drones on. “You started noticing that I was lying to you, you still didn’t want to let me down though, did you?” Shadow Weaver asks. “You started talking to that… *Princess* . Catra. She’s always been a thorn in my side, you’ve always been distracted by her, even when she was a complete stranger. You would purposely go to her in battles, and that was before you let her into your bed.” Adora wishes she could deny that but Shadow Weaver was right. She had talked to Catra many times in the past, she was one of the reasons she started to notice that Shadow Weaver was being less than honest. “Honestly, Adora, you were my attack dog, and I could tell you were starting to turn on me.”

“Is that why you attacked me?” Adora asks. She knows when she tells people the story she always says that she ‘removed’ Shadow Weaver, the truth is… Adora had had no choice *but* to remove Shadow Weaver. Their relationship (if you could even call it that) had become strained, Adora knew Shadow Weaver was lying, Shadow Weaver knew Adora was questioning her loyalty to her. It had been a pretty bad time, tense, and it had built up until they clashed. Adora remembers the blood from her scar getting into her eye, blinding her. She had been hurt by Shadow Weaver before, but that scar is a reminder of the worst moment of her life and it’s on her *face* .

“You put dangerous dogs down.” Shadow Weaver says simply. Adora *should* be hurt by that - and she is a little - but she isn’t surprised by it. That’s all she was to Shadow Weaver and Adora has come to accept it; a ruthless cutthroat soldier who would do *anything* to prove herself to her. But Adora knows now that she is so much *more* .

“So… Everything you did was just so you could have power?” Adora asks. She isn’t sure why she ever thought it might be different.

“I encouraged the worst parts of you.” Shadow Weaver says. “You’ve always had an anger in you, you hate being told you’re wrong, you get so defensive, you lash out. You’re egotistical and a sore loser.” Adora winces a little because Shadow Weaver is right again. “As a child, you were hyperactive, easily distracted, loud, I trained those out of you, for the most part. The ego was annoying but not detrimental, and your anger was useful sometimes, and an obstacle at other times. You were a *difficult* child, I did my best to mould you into an obedient soldier.”

“I remember,” Adora says. “The punishments for getting distracted, for failing, for not doing readings, not learning techniques, withholding my food when I got into fights with other cadets when they did something to… trigger my anger.” Adora huffs. “I was never really a kid.”

“You weren’t, no child in the Horde is a child, they are soldiers, these behavioural issues have to be… trained out of them.” Adora laughs without the humour.

“Kids deserve to be kids,” Adora states. “There was nothing wrong with me as a kid, there is nothing wrong with me *now* .” In fact, for the first time in her *life* , Adora actually feels like she is in actual, complete, control; she feels… at peace. She isn’t trying to be anything she isn’t, she isn’t trying to please anyone, she is simply just Adora. Not Lord, not really, not Force Captain, not a soldier. Even She-Ra, she is at peace with herself now. Adora knows what she wants and what she is for the *first time* in her entire life. She can see with complete clarity.

“Not in the Horde.” Shadow Weaver responds back just as sure as Adora. “I raised you for greatness, you never would have become Lord without me.”

“That’s probably true,” Adora admits. “But I would’ve been a hell of a lot happier if I *hadn’t* become Lord.”

“You wouldn’t.” Shadow Weaver says simply, so sure of herself. “You can never sit still, Adora. You *always* wanted more. You were never satisfied.”

“ *You* were never satisfied.” Adora fires back. “I was just trying to please you.”

“You wanted power just as much as I did. You have a hunger in you, a *need* to prove yourself, I just fed that hunger until you reached Lord, then you turned on me too. You are just like me.”

“No.” Adora says flatly. “I am *nothing* like you. None of the things you say about me are true. I don’t believe a single thing that you say to me. You don’t have power over me anymore, Shadow Weaver.”

“I suppose I don’t,” Shadow Weaver says. “But you still let me live. Why?” Adora takes a deep breath and she stares at the ground in front of her for a long moment as she gathers her thoughts.

“Because I loved you,” Adora says quietly. “Even though you hurt me, even though you never loved me back, I loved you. You were… You were my Commanding Officer, but you were also like a mom to me. You were there from the very beginning, I would’ve done *anything* for you, even though you hurt me.” Adora smiles sadly. “I guess I believed that no one could love me back because not even you loved me. Isn’t that what every child craves? To be loved by the person who is supposed to take care of them?” Adora lets out a wet sigh before she levels Shadow Weaver with a heavy gaze. She is tired, but this is the most honest conversation she has ever had with Shadow Weaver and she wasn’t finished.

“I still love you,” Adora admits. “Some part of me… A part of me I just can’t…” Adora trails off, struggling to articulate her words. “I want to believe that somewhere in your cold *cold* heart, that you can change, that you can love me back too, even if that’s impossible. I have hurt people, I have made mistakes, and I’m willing to accept whatever punishment that requires, you will *never* do that.” It almost makes Adora sad. “As much as I love you, I love Catra more, I always will. So I choose her. I choose happiness. I will *never* be what you want me to be, what you *made* me to be, because it’s not who I am and it’s not who I want to be.”

Adora looks at Shadow Weaver but she makes no move to say anything else, so Adora stands up from her sitting position. She dusts herself down and fixes her cape before she turns her back on Shadow Weaver. “There are things you don’t know.” Shadow Weaver says. “I know what you’re planning to do Adora, you’re giving up.” Adora pauses at the door to the cell.

“I’m not giving up,” Adora says. “Hordak found me as a baby, I was never meant to be here. No one belongs in the Horde, everyone here was taken. I’m not following your destiny anymore. I’m making my own. I grew up, Shadow Weaver, I’m not a kid anymore. Sometimes the best option is to stop fighting.” Adora lingers for a moment longer before she steps out of the cell room. She knows she was trained to never give up, to *fight* , but Adora is choosing her own path now. The door closes behind her, another chapter closes.

Adora walks back to her throne room feeling lighter than she has in *years* . The Fright Zone is flourishing, she talked everything out with Shadow Weaver, she’s ready. Adora sits down on her throne, running her hands along the armrests. She is going to miss a lot of things about this place, but she has to believe that it will be worth it.

Adora's peace is rudely interrupted by Scorpia bursting into the throne room urgently. "Adora," She calls, hurrying up the steps to the throne. Adora looks at her curiously as she stops just a few feet from the throne. "The Princesses! They're here!" She says, slightly out of breath from her rushed movements. Adora stays silent for a moment as she stares at the door of her throne room.

"I thought they'd be here sooner." Adora admits. She kind of thought this would have come months ago. Adora was well back to her old strength, the Fright Zone was just as strong, the Princesses should've attacked when she was weaker, but they didn't. They had waited for some reason, some reason that Adora couldn't figure out. *Why now?* Adora looks to Scorpia who was looking at her expectantly. "You know the plan, we stick to it."

"You…" Scorpia stops, she looks like she might cry. "Are you sure, Boss?" Adora *isn't* sure, but she's going to do it anyway and hope for the best.

"I'm sure." Adora says anyway. Even if she doubts, she can't let Scorpia know that. "No matter what. We stick to the plan. Understood?"

"Yes sir." Scorpia salutes her and Adora smiles sadly. She stands and hesitates.

"You… You can hug m-" Adora doesn't get to finish that sentence before she is lifted up *off of the ground* and Scorpia is crushing her in her big strong arms. Seriously, Scorpia might be stronger than even *She-Ra.* Adora pats her back as Scorpia hugs her tightly.

"You were the best Lord." Scorpia says emotionally and Adora laughs softly.

"And you were the best right hand." Adora says back. "Now, please put me back down." Scorpia places her back down onto the ground. She looks like she's about to burst into tears. "Go on," Adora says. "Go make sure everyone else does as they're told." Adora sits back down on her throne.

"Are you *sure* ?" Scorpia repeats.

“I’m sure.” Scorpia lingers for a moment before she nods and hurries down the steps. Adora releases a long sigh and sits back in her throne, her hands sliding along the armrests, her fingers curling over the ends.

Here it goes .

* * *

Catra has been in a lot of battles, she has been injured, shot at with lasers, hit with stun batons, *stabbed* through the chest, and yet none of those come even close to how *this* feels. She was currently gripping Spinnerella’s hand as Netossa tried to track down her moms. Catra knows things have been kind of bad with her and C’yra recently, but she finds she still wants her to be here. She wants her moms.

Netossa comes back to the room and Catra sits up a little, hoping to see her moms but not seeing *anyone* with her. “Where are they? Did they leave for Bright Moon?” Catra asks, her ears drooping when she sees that no one really is with Netossa.

“I…” Netossa begins and she looks at her wife. “I’m not sure. From what I gathered, they left to lead an attack.”

“An attack?” Catra asks urgently, trying to sit up more but being scolded by the Magicat doctor to lay back down. Catra feels another contraction and she squeezes her eyes shut as she grips Spinnerella’s poor hand. Once Catra manages to make it through that contraction, she looks at Netossa expectantly.

“On the Horde, Catra,” Netossa says carefully. “They’re leading an attack on the Horde.” Catra feels her heart sink in her chest at the realisation that her mothers had abandoned her to go attack her mate.

“Adora…” Catra whispers. She lets out a pained groan as she feels another contraction. Her moms had left her, she was alone, and goddess knows what they had planned for Adora. “I

need her.” Catra whimpers. “I need them, and they…” Catra stops for a second, feeling tears well in her eyes. “They left me.” Catra always knew it was probably likely Adora wouldn’t be here for this, but she thought she’d at least have her moms for one of the scariest moments of her life.

“It’s okay,” Netossa says, coming around to the side that Spinnerella wasn’t on. “We’re here. You’re not alone, Catra.” Catra looks at both of them as they squeeze her hands and give her reassuring looks. Catra feels like she’ll totally start bawling in the next five minutes.

“Thank you…” Catra breathes, and they nod at her.

“It’s time, Princess C’yra,” The Magicat midwife says. “You need to start pushing.” Catra takes a deep breath. She looks at both Spinnerella and Netossa before she nods at them and looks at the midwife with a look of determination. Just a little bit (a lot) of pain, for a *lifetime* of happiness. Soon, she would have her baby in her hands. Adora would be okay, she’s *always* okay, she can handle her moms and the Princesses.

“Let's do this.”

* * *

Adora isn't sure what she's expecting really, but she certainly isn't expecting for the Princesses to just bust into her throne room. She stays sitting on her throne, watching as they charge in like they were expecting to be greeted by She-Ra and not Adora sitting on her throne. She makes no effort to move, sitting up right, her legs crossed and her hands still gripping the armrests. She never thought not fighting would be so difficult, but it surprisingly is.

The Princesses climb the stairs, Glimmer has her sparkle fists, C'yra has her claws drawn, Luna looks displeased to say the least, Bow looks disappointed, the water Princess just looks bored, maybe slightly annoyed, and the flower one looks... conflicted. "Sure took you guys long enough." Adora comments, sitting back in her throne.

"Excuse me?" C'yra says, narrowing her eyes. It really is gnarly how similar C'yra looks to Catra, it's almost unsettling to see such hate in familiar looking eyes.

"I was expecting you guys way sooner." Adora responds casually. "So glad you could join me."

"You little-" C'yra steps forward but Luna grabs her by her wrist and glares at her. They stare at each other for a long moment before C'yra sighs. "We're taking you in."

"I expected no less." Adora says. The Princesses all look at her in shock. "Why do you think no one tried to stop you on your way in?"

"What do you mean by that, Horde scum?" Glimmer spits out, glaring at her. Adora sighs and trails her finger along one of the claw marks on her throne. She really is going to miss this place.

"I *mean* , it's been literally *months* since I last attacked, I thought I would have heard something from you all by now." Adora says. “I’ve been waiting, I mean, really? You guys can’t give a girl a warning?” Adora asks sarcastically. She can tell that she’s pissing some of them off - C’yra especially - but they should get used to it; this is exactly what Adora is like. “I told my men not to attack, to let you come, unresisted, I had no intentions of fighting you when you finally came for me.” Glimmer looks at her with great confusion. Adora can tell that the Princesses are caught off guard from that admission and their varying looks of shock and gormless confusion is almost funny for her to look at.

"Were you not planning something?" Glimmer asks. She’s lowered her fists by now which Adora is kind of thankful for - the last thing she needs right now is a fist of Sparkles in her face. Adora glances at her briefly, pursing her lips.

"I don't know about you guys, but I'm tired of fighting." Adora admits, sinking down in her throne. She really was tired, she didn’t want to do it anymore. "It almost cost me the woman I love." Adora says. Maybe she shouldn’t be saying that, maybe the Princesses wouldn’t believe her, but Adora didn’t care. She wasn’t going to fight anymore.

"Are you… doing what I think you're doing?" Luna looks scandalized or, at least, extremely surprised. "Lord Adora, what are you saying?" Adora takes a deep breath. She stares at the ground for a long moment before she looks up.

"I hereby surrender myself to the Rebellion." She says. She never thought she would *ever* say these words, but this has been her plan for a while now. Surrendering herself is the *only* way to achieve peace, to move forward, to ensure the safety of everyone - just maybe not her own safety.

"This isn't a trick, is it?" Perfuma whispers softly as she looks at Adora. Adora meets her gaze with a tired expression. She's felt like dead weight for a long time, ever since she stabbed Catra through the chest. She is *ready* to start a new chapter in her life, or for her story to come to a close. She doesn't know what will happen to her, she is giving up her control, but this is the only option she has. "Are you coming willingly for a trial?"

"Yes, but I have a condition." Adora holds her finger up. "I want to see Catra, I haven't seen her in... a while... If I only have so long before my fate is in the hands of you guys, I just want some time with her before that happens." Adora says. One final goodbye before she might have to go forever.

C'yra frowns at her and crosses her arms over her chest almost immediately. "Absolutely n-" She begins to say but Luna holds her hand up in front of her wife's face, making her pause in her words.

"You may do so, so long as a guard is outside and the doctor is keeping an eye on you."

"Doctor?" Adora asks with a frown, suddenly concerned. "Is she okay? She seemed okay the last I saw her."

"She's okay. She's actually… giving birth to Finn as we speak." Luna explains softly.

"She's giving birth?!" Adora stands suddenly from her throne. She needs to be with Catra! *Right now!* "I... I... I *have* to see her then!" Adora says desperately. She notices that the Princesses seem on their guards again and she realizes it's because she had moved suddenly

from her relaxed sitting position. They're threatened by her, afraid of her, but all Adora wants to do is make sure that Catra is okay.

"And you *will* . So long as you come willingly." Luna assures, stepping forward with some handcuffs. "May I?" Adora looks at the handcuffs and, for the first time, she has second thoughts. But no, she could give up control for Catra. She *has* to. She nods and extends her wrists.

"You *promise* that you'll take me to Catra first?" Adora asks, looking Luna in her eyes. Luna (and Bow) were about the only two people she trusted here right now.

"I promise." Luna nods and whispers softly. "She'd be really happy to see you. That's all I want for my daughter to be. I don't agree with everyone else's decision about how to handle this." Luna explains as she puts the cuffs securely on Adora's wrists. Adora laughs a little.

"Well, if I'm going to die, at least I get to see Catra one last time." Adora has made her peace with that being a possibility. She could be dead come tomorrow but at least she will get to see the woman that she loves one last time - if the Princesses kept their word at least.

Luna frowns slightly at Adora's words. "I won't let that happen, it would hurt my daughter, and your kitten, if we did that."

"I'm afraid you may be outnumbered with that opinion." Adora says, glancing at the other Princesses. C'yra in particular was giving her a cold stare and would probably be happy to rip her guts out right here, right now, if it weren't for Luna. She wonders what would have happened if Luna *wasn't* here. Adora would probably already be dead.

"Maybe, but I'll try my damn hardest to make sure my Little One's heart isn't broken." Luna nods at Adora before guiding her towards the exit. "Let's go back. We're keeping our word. Lord Adora will be allowed to see Catra, and then she will be placed in the prison until her trial."

"You actually meant that?" C'yra asks. "You want to let her see our daughter?"

"It's the least we can do." Luna says back.

"The least we can do?" C'yra asks. "I am *not* leaving her alone with our daughter."

"No offence, Queen C'yra, but I have been alone with Catra on *several* occasions and not once did I hurt her." Adora says because she feels grumpy, *okay?* It was probably a bad idea to bring up the fact that Adora had slept with Catra on several occasions because C'yra glares at her.

"Except when you almost killed her." She replies coldly. Adora looks away at that.

"Like I said, she won't be alone. The doctor is required to be there, and a guard will be outside." Luna says with a sigh. "It's the least we can do for our daughter, who is literally giving birth, C'yra! She should be able to see her mate."

"I want to see my... Catra... and my child, for what might be the last time, *please* ." Adora actually begs, which makes her uncomfortable but, if she was going to die, she figured she could let some of her pride go. C'yra huffs.

"Fine. But the guard has to be inside the room." She says. Luna sighs in exasperation before nodding.

"Okay, fine."

"Wait, inside? No, no, no... I don't... Catra will get upset if she knows I surrendered, just... please... I won't hurt her..." Adora shakes her head desperately. She doesn't want to distress Catra - *especially after she just gave birth!* She wanted a *good* goodbye, not a one that ripped Catra's heart out of her chest.

"Fine. You better not, or I'm taking you out myself." C'yra glares at her before turning to the others. "Let's go." Adora sighs in relief. At least she could have some alone time with Catra before she was taken away, possibly for good.

"Okay…" Adora nods. "Wait, my sword, I... I need it." Adora pleads. She can't imagine leaving it behind even if she's not allowed it.

"Bow, get her sword please." Luna says, nodding at him. "Unfortunately, we can't give it to you after what happened. But we will bring it with us."

"That wasn't... That wasn't the real She-Ra." Adora says. She's not sure why it's important to her that they know that that wasn't what the real She-Ra did or looked like, but it was.

"Catra told me." Luna says. "Regardless, you cannot be trusted with the sword for right now, okay?" Luna asks her gently. "We won't do anything to it. But until the trial has taken place, we can't give it to you." Adora deflates but nods.

"Yeah, okay, that's fair." She sighs. It made sense, but, still, Adora wasn't aware how attached to her sword she really was. "Is Catra okay? It's been a while since I last saw her."

"She wasn't supposed to come see you." Luna explains. Adora figured as much, *knew* as much. "She was technically under house arrest after what happened. She snuck out to see you." Luna glances at Adora as everyone else gets ready to drive back to Half-Moon. "That, and the doctor said she needed to be on bedrest for the last few months to make sure she didn't have any complications." Adora didn't know *that* part. Still, she can't help but smile a little at the thought of Catra and their last meeting.

"I thought she was a ghost and she slapped me. We had a good night together." Adora realises that she's talking to Catra's *mom* and maybe she shouldn't be saying things like *that* . She blushes a little and clears her throat. "It kills me to be apart from her."

"Being away from your mate can feel like that." Luna smiles softly, getting Adora onto her vehicle with C'yra and sitting down. "She misses you. I know how important you are to each other, that's why I'm allowing you to see her."

"She misses me?" Adora asks. She misses Catra like *crazy.* She couldn't imagine how Catra felt.

"She does, her scent gives it away."

"Her scent?" Adora asks curiously.

"Magicats can tell what other Magicats are feeling based on scent." Luna smiles softly at Adora's curiosity as she explains.

"Oh, that sounds like a useful thing to have." Adora admits. She wishes she had a useful tool like that, sometimes she finds it so difficult to gauge people's emotions, being able to *smell* them might make that way easier for her. "I was always impressed by Catra's senses." Adora admits.

"Why is that?" Luna asks. They're moving now, towards Half-Moon. Adora glances back towards the retreating Fright Zone. Adora feels her heart clench in her chest. There really was no going back from this anymore.

"She can hear so far and smell all kinds of things." Adora says, coming back to the present. "It's just really cool. Plus, her ears are adorable and she used to let me touch her tail."

"She let you touch her tail?"

"I... yeah?" Adora asks with confusion. Should she tell Luna that? Maybe touching a Magicat's tail was against something? Little did they know that Adora had literally gotten Catra off by touching her tail alone.

"She must have really trusted you." Luna says gently.

"Really? Because I touched her tail?" Adora asks.

"You do realise that our tails can quite literally cripple us for a while if grabbed in a certain way, right?" Luna raises an eyebrow at Adora. Adora did know that Magicat tails are insanely sensitive, she also knew that they were an extension of their spines, so she can see why it could cripple them if grabbed in a certain way. The thought had never really crossed Adora's mind. She just liked to play with Catra's tail and Catra seemed to like it too.

C'yra nudges Luna with her foot. "Lu, don't tell her that." C'yra grumbles, focusing on driving. Luna rolls her eyes.

"It leaves us temporarily unable to move, which is why Magicats are so mindful of their tails during battles."

"I didn't know that." At least, not to that extent. "Catra let me touch her tail, like, the first time we were together."

"The first time?"

"Did she not tell you?" Adora asks. She supposes that Catra wouldn't have gone into the dirty details of their relationship - some things you just don't tell your mother she supposes.

"She didn't tell us anything about you two after... you know." Adora knew that things had been strained between Catra and her moms but she figured that was mostly with C'yra, not Luna. Luna frowns, her shoulders falling sadly. "I've been busy… I haven't been able to see her as much as I probably should have, trying to keep my wife from doing anything stupid, and I didn't even succeed at that."

"Oh..." Adora frowns a little. Catra has been isolated for so long. Even if Luna was on her side, her absence to keep her wife in check was probably felt by Catra - she probably felt abandoned. She had about three people who were totally supportive but Adora knew they couldn't be there constantly either. "Well, she did, she let me touch her tail the first night we were together, after Princess Prom, and it became a habit."

"I see. That's how long you've been together?"

"Princess Prom was the beginning, yes." Adora answers.

"Wow... And none of us suspected anything. Our daughter didn't feel comfortable telling us anything." Luna sounds so *sad* that Adora feels compelled to comfort her

"It's not... It's not that she didn't feel comfortable." Adora reassures. "She was seeing the *Horde Lord,* and we didn't exactly plan on developing... feelings... that just kind of happened. She told me how guilty she felt lying to her friends and her family. She thought she would let you down if you knew she was seeing *me* . We agreed to keep it a secret, and to break it off if one of us said so."

"And when did you realise you were catching feelings?" Luna asks. Adora bites her lip and looks away for a moment.

"I think... I unconsciously started to get feelings after our first time together. Then Catra broke up with me, and it broke my heart. I was so angry. And when I hurt her... I... I knew that I loved her, and I couldn't lose her." Adora confesses.

"I see. I wish things could have been different." Luna gives Adora a sad smile. "I'm sure you're a good person if my daughter loves you, just... the circumstances..."

"I understand." Adora says dismissively. She knows Luna can’t just magically fix things, make people forgive her, see her as anything other than the Horde Lord, but she’s also aware that C’yra can *hear* her. "I won't ever forgive myself for what I did to her. I don't know why Catra did. But I'd like to make it up to her, or try to at least."

"You want to make it up to her?" Luna asks softly.

"I'd like to *try* ." Adora smiles sadly. "Surrendering is the first step. Ending the war."

"You want to end the war?!" C'yra speaks for the first time, turning sharply to look at Adora with complete shock. Adora had kind of thought that was obvious from the fact that she had *surrendered* but apparently not.

"I said I was tired of fighting, the entire Horde is tired of fighting. Ending the war is for the best." Adora answers. Both C'yra and Luna look at Adora in surprise but, while C'yra looks away without saying anything more, a smile crosses Luna's features.

"Then maybe we can figure something out." Luna says. Adora smiles hopefully. She really *hopes* this won't be the end for her, but, also, Adora is kind of ready for it to be too. She's made her peace. Etheria is ready for a world without her if that's what is to happen.

"So, you're married," Adora begins, "how... how exactly does that come about?" Adora asks curiously.

"Well, as you might be able to tell, I'm Queen through marriage. C'yra was actually the one that was pursuing me when we were younger."

"Oh, does... does the future Queen have to ask the, uh, suitor?" Adora asks.

"Not exactly. But she does have to inform her parents of who she is considering as her suitor. I'm not from any royal or noble lineage actually. My dad was a doctor, and my mom was a mural maker."

"Mural maker?" Adora asks with surprise. "Catra... Catra is good at drawing too."

"Yeah, her grandmother was the one teaching her when she was younger." Luna smiles softly.

"Really?" Adora smiles. "That sounds nice. Having a family and what not."

"Do you not?" Luna asks softly.

"Hm? No. I'm an orphan, like most Horde soldiers." Adora is pretty sure that Luna knows this already but she's making a point by making Adora say it around *C'yra* . The Queen is practically *forced* to listen to Adora right now. "I guess Catra and Finn are my family now."

"So that was true, most of the Horde soldiers are orphans?" Luna looks at her with empathetic eyes. "That sounds harsh. I'm sorry you had to go through that."

"I got off easy." Adora shrugs. "I don't remember my parents, or where I came from, all I've known is the Horde and Shadow Weaver. I was there from when I was a baby. Some recruits are a little older." Older recruits remember sometimes. They remember the Horde invading their villages and towns and destroying their lives and then being forced to fight for them. Yeah, Adora always thought that was fucked up too. The Fright Zone's numbers hadn't really grown under Adora because she stopped the process of indoctrinating orphans as soon as she became Lord. Recruits were either soldiers already in training, or civilians who actually believed in the Horde and decided to join. Of course, some villages didn't even mind being conquered and some happily joined the Horde when they turned sour to the fact the Princesses hadn't bothered to try and save them.

"I can see why my daughter has always been kind to former Horde soldiers. We never got that many defectors, but she was always nice to them. She helped them."

"That's probably why she was so kind to me." Adora admits. "Because I was like every Horde soldier, and I was ignorant to the harm the Horde had caused. I haven't been Lord for that long, I was raised just like any other Horde soldier." Adora hears C'yra grunt but she doesn't say much else to that.

"It wouldn't be the first time she's done something like this, helped a Horde soldier to learn things outside of what they were told. But never has she caught feelings for them. Only you."

"Only me." Adora repeats, smiling.

"Mhmm, it's hard to imagine it but it really happened."

"We didn't intend to fall for each other but, part of me thinks, I was meant to be with Catra." Adora says with certainty. There were just too many signs pointing to them always ending up together. Adora really believes, no matter what universe, no matter what life, they would *always* find each other, always be together, they were completely and inexplicably connected.

Luna smiles a bit, humming quietly as she thinks. "How curious. You know, my daughter was always going on about finding the person that she knew she could love. It's just so intriguing that, despite everything, you two fell for each other."

"Believe me, I know." Adora says, lifting her handcuffed hands up. "She would talk to me about it and I'd feel... weird... I didn't like the idea of Catra seeing someone who wasn't me, but I never told her that." Adora had been *jealous* . Whenever Catra talked about her suitor situation, Adora would feel extremely jealous but she never felt like she could ever tell her that. So she just got super possessive when they had sex instead. Probably not Adora's best plan of action but her plans, clearly, are not always the best.

"Why not?" Luna asks.

"I don't know... We mutually agreed that it was sex only, I didn't think I had the right to tell Catra to stop meeting with suitors."

"I see." Luna hums softly, looking up as the skiff comes to a stop. "Oh, looks like we're here." She says as she stands up and dusts herself off. "A guard will escort you to the infirmary, okay?"

"Okay." Adora holds her hands up. "Can you take these off for now?"

"The guard will be the one to do that before you enter the infirmary. I'll give them the key." Luna says, gesturing for a guard to come over and doing just as she said she would. "Follow them. They'll lead you to Catra." Adora puts her hands down.

"Thank you." Adora says genuinely.

"You're welcome, Adora." Luna gives her a smile before gesturing for her to go on.

Adora nods and begins following the guard who escorts her to where Catra was supposed to be. She looks at the castle. Catra lives here. She grew up here. That's kind of amazing if you ask Adora. The castle looks as though it's made from some kind of stone, like a natural occurring castle carved into the side of a huge cliff. The Magicats apparently have secret tunnels under their kingdom, an old built defence mechanism should the Horde have ever attacked them directly. Adora had read about them. They were apparently complex and so deep they were rumoured to reach the centre of Etheria (which was probably just an exaggeration). Looking at the castle alone, Adora believed it. The Magicats were obviously skilled architects, she could totally buy that the place was built on a series of tunnels that were built for safety.

She stares at her handcuffs for a moment. Catra would be upset if she knew that Adora had surrendered and yet... it was the only way out - at least, that's the only way Adora saw a way out. Either way, Catra won. No more her meant that Catra could finally move on, and, if Adora survived, that meant that maybe she could see Catra again in the future - if Catra wanted to see her again.

They stop just outside the infirmary. Adora lifts her hands expectantly and the guard reluctantly removes the cuffs. Adora sighs and then moves to the infirmary door. She takes a deep breath, trying to keep her emotions in check, before she knocks on the door. She doesn't wait for anyone to invite her in, she just opens the door. She glances at the guards beside her before she steps inside the room.

Adora's heart grows at least three sizes bigger at the sight that greets her. Catra looks tired, but she looks happy, she's holding a little bundle of joy in her arms that she's cooing softly to. Catra looks up and she seems to freeze when she takes in Adora's presence. Adora smiles, lopsided. "Hey Catra." She says softly, quietly.

"Hey Adora." Catra whispers, her eyes filled with nothing but pure love and adoration for her mate when Adora walks in. "You're here… Come look at them. They're... They're perfect."

She breathes. Catra looks down at them in her arms, her eyes only softening more in love. Adora smiles at the sight. This is her family. "Come hold them."

Adora steps further into the room and then stands beside Catra's bed. She smiles softly as she leans down to kiss Catra on her forehead. "How are you?" Adora asks. "I can't imagine giving birth is fun." In fact, Adora can think of nothing worse. She doesn't know a great deal about the whole thing, the Horde never exactly taught her, but she knows enough to know she's kind of glad she wasn't the one to carry.

"It was not fun at all, but being able to hold our kitten is more than worth it." Catra purrs. She closes her eyes and takes in the moment. "You have no idea how happy I am now that you're here with me. With us."

"Uh..." Adora smiles, deciding not to tell Catra how short that may be, as she places her hands out in front of herself. "So... How do I hold them?" Adora asks. "I'm assuming there's a certain way?" Catra nods.

"Don't worry, I'll help you. It's a lot easier than you think, and Finn isn't very fussy." She soothes, placing a soft kiss on Adora's cheek before carefully moving the newborn into her arms. "Careful, support the head, but don't hold it tightly." Adora gently takes Finn from Catra's arms and she looks at Catra with shiny eyes of love once she has them securely held.

"They're... They're so small." Adora could feel herself getting choked up at getting to hold her baby for the first (and possibly last) time.

"I know. Magicats tend to be born quite small." Catra whispers softly. "Though they're actually a little smaller than most. The doctor said the stress could have had an impact. But they're stable and healthy." Adora was relieved that Finn was healthy.

"Maybe they just inherited your fun-size height, huh?" Adora asks playfully as she sits on the edge of the bed beside Catra.

"Hey! I'm not that small." Catra huffs, shifting a little to let Adora get more comfortable. "I missed you."

"I missed you too." Adora says softly. "And I'm very pleased to meet *you* ." Adora says to Finn. Finn giggles and gurgles before wiggling a bit. The motion makes Catra laugh, her eyes shining with tears of happiness as she looks at Adora. Adora smiles at her. She knows Catra is probably emotional, and tired, hormonal maybe, Adora also feels emotional. She looks down at Finn and swears that she will protect them, no matter what. Catra and Finn were her entire world.

"I didn't think I'd get to see this. I'm so happy right now." Catra says quietly. Adora clenches her jaw a little as she looks down at the small baby in her arms. Catra's words kind of killed her. She knew it wouldn't last, but she could at least give Catra a few moments of happiness.

"I can't believe we made a baby." Adora comments.

"Neither can I. It's kind of like the proof of our love. We made this together, our little Finn." Catra smiles tiredly, resting her head on Adora's shoulder. "Our little miracle." Adora likes that. Finn is proof of their love.

"So," Adora begins. "How painful was it and am I banned from using my strap ever again?" Adora asks with a small grin as she leans her head down to kiss Catra on top of her head again. There’s a moment of silence before Catra bursts into laughter, grinning up at Adora.

"It was horrible, and, no, you're not banned from using your strap. We just need to figure out how to not accidentally make a baby when we use it." Adora nudges Catra gently with her shoulder.

"At least I'm not banned." She says with a smile. "Although, it couldn't have been too bad considering we got this little one out of it."

"That's true." Catra admits with a sigh. Adora carefully hands Finn back to Catra and then she begins to unclasp her cape from her shoulder guards. She lifts it up and Catra smiles. She takes the blanket Finn was currently wrapped in and then, *together* , they wrap Finn in the fabric of Adora’s favourite cape. Catra sighs happily as Adora takes Finn back from her. “I think that suits them.”

"I'm never going to get that back, am I?" Adora asks with a big smile. She honestly doesn't think she's ever felt this happy before.

"No, you're not. It's their blanket now."

"I love them," Adora announces. "They're perfect." She leans down to kiss them on their nose. "They certainly got my good looks, right Catra?"

"Mhmm, they do. They have my favourite thing about you, your eyes."

"That's your favourite thing about me?" Adora asks, raising an eyebrow. "Not my charm, my handsome good looks or my sense of humour?"

"No. Your eyes, because when you look at me, I feel loved." Catra smiles, cupping Adora's cheek. Adora blushes a little but she knows Catra is right, whenever she looks at Catra, she feels nothing but love, so of course her eyes reflect that.

"Sap." Adora comments, leaning down to kiss Catra on her lips. She wishes she could stay here forever. "I love you. You know that, right?"

"I do. I love you too." Catra purrs happily against Adora's lips. "I always will." Adora sighs and leans against Catra.

"And I'll always love you, no matter what." She says quietly. "You look beautiful. I'm sorry I missed it, I wanted to be here to hold your hand, and for you to scream at me."

"It's okay, It's not your fault that you couldn't be here, I'm just happy you're here at all." Catra nuzzles the blonde. "But... how *are* you here?"

"Well, there is a magical thing called walking." Adora says with a nervous chuckle. She knows Catra must be kind of out of it. She had hoped to come in here and slither out and not cause Catra distress. She should've known that Catra was more perceptive than that.

"Adora. How are you here without the guards slamming the doors down to get you?" Catra asks. Adora stays quiet for a moment and just stares down at Finn before she sighs, closing her eyes before opening them again.

"Can't we just stay like this for a little while longer?"

"Adora… What did you do?" Catra breathes, the heaviness of the situation setting in for her. Adora can hear the worry and the *panic* .

"I..." Adora keeps her eyes firmly set on Finn, not looking at Catra. "I made a deal."

"A deal?"

"I surrendered," Adora says. "And I asked if I could see you, and Finn, one last time before... Well, before the Rebellion does whatever they want with me."

"What?" Adora could practically feel Catra's heartbreak in the way her voice wobbles - it breaks her own heart. "Adora, are you *crazy* ? They'll.... I can't lose you. I *need* you."

"Catra..." Adora squeezed her eyes closed, she hated that she could hear Catra's hurt in her voice. She opens them and finally looks at Catra, offering her a reassuring smile. "It'll be okay. I promise."

"How can you promise me that when the people outside of this door want you dead, Adora?"

"I'm not going to die. I'm incredibly hard to kill." Adora protests.

"Adora."

“I mean, very durable. I’ve survived so many things.”

“ *Adora* .” Catra says in *that* tone of voice. Adora sighs and her shoulders drop a little.

"This was the only way," She says. "Even if I tried to negotiate peace, the Rebellion would never accept it after what I did to you. The Horde is okay now, it's safe in Scorpia's hands. The only way that I can convince the Rebellion that I'm not a threat, is by surrendering... *everything* ."

"Not your life." Catra says tearfully. "Adora, they're gonna... I can't do this without you."

"They're Princesses, they won't kill me." Adora says. "Not without a trial anyway, that's what you guys do, right?"

"Yeah, but... I don't know how many of them would even vote to *not* kill you." Catra whispers. "That's what I'm afraid of."

"I knew math would be my downfall."

"This isn't the time to be making jokes!"

"I'm sorry," Adora says, not looking at Catra. "I just want to make you laugh. I don't want you to be sad, Catra."

"I know, but I'm scared of losing you, Adora." Catra says quietly.

"Before, when you went into grieving for the first time, after I said I didn't feel the same, what kept you going?" Adora asks.

"My family and friends were helping a little, and finding out I was pregnant with Finn was what helped the most."

" *Finn* ." Adora repeats. "They're the reason you kept going. No matter what happens to me, you *have* to keep going, for them."

"Adora..." Catra's voice cracks. "Adora, I can't do this alone... if you..." She whimpers, biting her lip. "I don't know if I'm strong enough..."

"Are you kidding?" Adora asks. "You're *incredibly* strong. You're the strongest person that I know. Look at everything you've been through and you *still* managed to bring a baby into this world." Adora says. She pauses for a moment before she looks at Catra and half smiles at her. "You don't need me Catra. You don't. You're plenty strong on your own."

"I'm tired of being strong alone, Adora!" Catra cries out, looking down at Finn. "I can't do this alone. There *has* to be another way." Adora shakes her head.

"There isn't." Adora says. "The Rebellion came knocking on my door expecting a fight, they came to take me dead or alive, and I chose alive. No one fought them. I gave myself up so no one would get hurt. No one. Because I'm tired of hurting people... I've *never* wanted to hurt people. The only time it ever felt right was when someone hurt *you* ." Adora admits. "All those years, destroying things, hurting people in the name of Hordak... hurting you, hurting your friends... It never felt good, it never felt *right* . This... This feels right." She turns to Catra, keeping Finn secure in her arms. "I feel like I was meant to end up here. I was never meant to be a soldier, Catra, I don't want to be."

"And you don't have to be. I... I'll figure something out, okay? I promise." Catra swears. Adora almost wants to believe that. "You deserve to live your life, and finally get to explore what life is like without... without needing to fight. As do the rest of the Horde. I... You deserve to get to see Finn grow up too."

"I'd like that." Adora says, looking at Finn with a smile. "I get the feeling they're going to look a lot like you." She comments quietly. "I want to see them take their first steps, say their first words, make really dumb decisions as a teenager, but it's okay because we're there to pick up the pieces. I want to see them date for the first time, and threaten their significant other so they don't hurt our baby." Adora's heart squeezes, it *longs* .

"I want to see you do that too. I want to raise our kitten *together* ." Catra smiles a bit. "I'll figure something out. I promise."

"We need to stop making promises, it's starting to become our thing." Adora jokes gently.

"Yeah? What if I like it being our thing?"

"Is that a promise?" Adora asks with a smile. Catra smiles back up at her.

"Maybe it is." She responds fondly. Adora closes her eyes and leans her head forward to rest it against Catra's. She lets out a soft breath.

"Catra... I want a *lifetime* with you." She confesses quietly. "I want to love you, now, and forever. *Beyond* forever."

"Then do it."

"Is this you telling me to live?" Adora asks.

"Yes, it is. That much should be obvious, dummy." Catra gently moves her nose against Adora's in an butterfly kiss and Adora only smiles wider.

"I missed you calling me dummy." Adora says with a grin. "Kiss me?"

"Make sure not to drop Finn." Catra whispers as she leans in and kisses Adora on her lips. She's soft and gentle, taking her time to breathe Adora in and simply cherish the moment. Adora smiles into the kiss, doing as Catra said and making sure she doesn't drop Finn. She kisses Catra softly, yet firmly, moving her lips expertly, knowing *exactly* how Catra liked to be kissed by now. She pulls back a little after a moment.

"I think your mom would murder me right here, right now, if she walked in on this."

"Shhh... don't ruin the moment."

"Guess you should kiss me again to shut me up."

"Dork. Always with the odd excuses for kisses." Catra smiles and leans back in, doing as told.

"You love it." Adora says before she kisses Catra again. And again. And again. Before she finally manages to stop herself from leaning back in. She just couldn't help herself, the idea that any of these could be their last kiss was eating away at her.

"I love *you* ."

"I certainly hope so," Adora says. "Or that would make this awkward." Catra snorts. The sound warms Adora’s heart. She doesn’t want to make Catra sad, she is so glad she made her *laugh* .

"Seriously? I thought we were having a moment." Catra says with great amusement.

"We *are* having a moment," Adora says. "I love you too." Catra lets out a heavy sigh and then she moves to take Finn back. Adora lets her and then she kisses Catra on her head again.

“Adora,” Catra says carefully. “I can live without you, probably, but I don’t *want* to.”

“I don’t want to live without you either.” Adora admits. She hears a commotion just outside the door and she knows they’re going to come arrest her again. One more kiss. Adora leans forward and *kisses* Catra, she kisses her like it might be the last time - because it really might be the last time. And then she kisses Finn on their tiny head.

The door to the infirmary opens and the guards enter. “Lord Adora.”

“Yeah, yeah, I’m coming.” Adora says as she stands up from the bed. She extends her hands again and the guard places the handcuffs back on them. Adora turns back to look at Catra to see her eyes wide and full of *fear* . “So,” Adora says. “What happens now?”

“We’re taking you back to Bright Moon, the Princesses will decide your fate in a trial.” A guard explains.

“I’m a Princess, don’t I get a say?” Adora asks sarcastically as the guards grab her by the elbows. She sees Catra shaking her head in mild amusement and Adora would call that a great success if she can make Catra laugh even in a moment like this.

“I'm afraid not, Lord Adora.” The guards haul her out of there and the last thing Adora sees is Catra holding their kitten close to her chest and her mismatched eyes hardening into a look of determination.

Adora loves that woman so much.

* * *

Adora sighs. She was sitting in her glowy prison in Bright Moon, legs crossed and her eyes trained on the wall. It was dark but the moonlight coming in through the curtains cast shadows around the room. How the mighty had fallen. Stripped of her armour, her cape gone, she feels *bare* . If Shadow Weaver saw her now, she'd probably laugh at Adora's pathetic state, but this was *exactly* where Adora wanted to be. She had a kid now, and they were

beyond perfect. Adora didn't know if she'd survive to see their first birthday, but whatever happened now, happened.

She laughs a little. Maybe Scorpia's therapy was working. "Well shit..." The old Adora would've been freaking out. The old Adora *never* would have surrendered. She's made peace with her inner demons, nothing else matters to her anymore - nothing except Catra that is, and Finn.

Catra was right, Adora had been following someone else's mission, it was never what she wanted. She wanted *Catra* . She wanted to be with her forever. She'd do anything for her. She'd die for her. *Anything* .

Adora's thoughts are interrupted when the door to the room she was shoved into opens. Golden light from the hallway blinds her until the door is kicked back. A sliver of gold light cuts into the room. Adora's eyes adjust back to the dark and she sees a figure in a cloak, the hood up... pointy ears... and eyes that glow in the dark.

"Catra?" Adora asks, sitting up onto her knees. Except... no. Catra's eyes are the same colour but they're not *right* . The hooded figure pulls their hood down and Adora tries to not be too disappointed that the person standing in front of her is Queen C'yra. "Your majesty..." Adora glances at the door. It can't be good that C'yra came alone. "Can I help you?"

"Shut your mouth." Clear. Direct. Adora nods her head. She watches as C'yra sighs. If Adora is being honest, Magicats must age exceptionally well, and, if Catra looks like her mom in her youth, she wonders if she'll look like her when she's older. "I'm going to ask you questions." The Magicat Queen says. Adora watches as she begins casting a truth spell. She sits up a little.

"You have magic? Does Catra have magic?" Adora asks. C'yra lets out an annoyed huff.

"What the hell do you think the Magi in *Magi* cat stands for?" C'yra asks and Adora stares at her. The Magicat rolls her eyes and her tail twitches in irritation. "All Magicats possess a small amount of Magic."

"All of them?" Adora asks.

" *All* of them." She replies. "In some, it remains dormant, others usually specialise. Magicats tend to be exceptionally good at illusion magic."

"But Catra, does she?" Adora asks as C'yra casts the spell. Adora looks at herself as the blue glow hits her and then fades.

"What part of *all* Magicats do you not understand?" C'yra asks. She sounds pissed off but, to be fair, Adora's pretty sure C'yra hates her - so that's not that surprising. "C'yra has magic."

"But... she never... what?" Adora asks. C'yra sighs and rolls her eyes.

"I'm not here to tell you the ins and outs of Magicats, I came to ask you questions." Adora sits back down and then nods. She supposes she can ask Catra later - if she survives anyway.

"Okay," Adora lifts her bound hands. "ask me anything." C'yra narrows her eyes. C'yra is *intense* to say the least.

"Why did you surrender?" C'yra asks.

"For Catra." Adora answers easily. C'yra doesn't seem pleased with that answer.

"Tell the truth." She grits out, showing her fangs. Adora laughs, which is probably a bad decision on her part, but she can't help it.

"I'm under a *truth* spell. I'm not in pain. I'm not lying." Adora points out. "All of this is for Catra. Because I love her."

"I don't believe you!" C'yra yells. She steps forward and extends her claws. Adora gulps a little. "You're the Lord of the Horde, this has to be some kind of plan of yours. You've indoctrinated my daughter! I should *kill* you!"

"What? No, I-" Adora doesn't get the chance to finish her sentence because C'yra *slaps* her, *hard* , with her claws *out* . It stings like a bitch. Adora feels blood run along her jawline and drip off of her chin. She narrows her blue eyes. "I've had a lot worse than that." Adora says. Although, that kind of really hurt. That was definitely going to scar. Adora knows Magicat claws are sharp, Catra's have cut through *metal* before, C'yra just slapped her with those bad boys.

"Did you come here to learn the truth? Or did you come here just to hear what you wanted to hear?" Adora asks. "You honestly believe I forced Catra to sleep with me? That I did some... mind trick to convince her? Of course I didn't! I would *never* . Whatever we did, we did it because *both* of us wanted to." C'yra growls and grabs Adora by her shirt. She waves her hand and the glowy prison disappears. Then those sharp claws of C'yra's slice through the rope around Adora's wrists.

"Fight." C'yra says before she pushes Adora backwards. Adora loses her balance and she hits her head against the ground. Her ears ring a little with the impact but she regains her senses enough to roll out of the way before claws hit the ground where *her face* had just been.

"Queen C'yra, please." Adora lifts her hands up in front of her when she manages to get to her feet. "I swear to you, I *never* hurt Catra."

"Never hurt her?!" C'yra turns on her. She's downright furious. "You broke her heart! You sent her into grieving! You *stabbed* her in the *chest* ! You almost *killed* her!" C'yra grabs Adora by her shirt and Adora feels a fist connect with her face. Adora never once tries to hit C'yra back. She meant it when she said she was tired of fighting.

"I know..." Adora says weakly. She spits the taste of metallic blood out of her mouth and looks at those mismatched eyes which were *burning* with anger. "I know... I hurt Catra then, but before... I never hurt her. I promise. I... I..." Adora's eyes water as she becomes overwhelmed with her hurt and grief and guilt. C'yra punches her again.

Adora hits the ground again, and she hits it so hard that the air is knocked out of her lungs. She gasps and her vision blackens for a moment. "Admit it, *Lord Adora* , you took advantage of my little girl. You... *tainted* her. Poisoned her mind. Admit it!" C'yra punches her again. "Fight back!" C'yra yells in frustration.

"No." Adora shakes her head, even though her face hurts - *a lot.* "I won't." C'yra hits her again and Adora grunts.

Well, if I'm going to die, at least I tried.

Adora closes her eyes and she *thinks* . She thinks about everything. About Catra, about Finn, about every moment they spent together, about her anger, about Shadow Weaver and Hordak. Adora did a lot of bad in her life, but Catra was the one thing she did good. The one right thing she ever did, the one good thing she did was give herself to the Rebellion. It was all for Catra. She would do anything for her, to be with her.

"I'm sorry." Adora mumbles. There's a whole lot of nothing and then she feels herself being lifted up by her shirt. She blinks her eyes open.

"Why are you sorry? What are you sorry about?"

"For *everything* ." Adora says. "For hurting innocent people, for hurting Catra, for falling in love with someone who deserves... so much more. For being the Lord of the Horde, for not seeing how wrong I was about everything, for believing Hordak and Shadow Weaver, for not questioning anything, for blindly following whatever I was told because I... I was afraid, and a coward. I couldn't bring myself to see." Adora smiles a little. She isn't sure she's thinking clearly, after sustaining such injuries, but she can't seem to stop her mouth from moving.

"It's like, I saw the world in black and white. And then Catra came along and I saw in colour for the first time. Shadow Weaver said I was confused, and distracted, and maybe I was, but it wasn't for the wrong reasons, it was for the *right* reasons. I needed to see the colour, I needed to be confused, and distracted, because everything I did was wrong. I *needed* Catra. And she shouldn't have had to deal with me, she shouldn't have gone through what she did, she should have left me, given up on me... but she didn't." Adora takes a deep breath. "I love her. I love her so much that I won't fight you. I won't fight anyone ever again unless they threaten her."

" *Liar* !" C'yra yells as she places her claws to Adora’s throat. The skin on Adora's throat is punctured by those sharp claws when she swallows.

"You put me under a truth spell, I can't lie." Adora says, looking into C'yra's eyes. "I'm not lying."

"You *are* !" C'yra picks her up and then *slams* her into the ground again. *Ouch* . Adora figures she probably deserves this beat down after what she did, but boy was she getting her ass handed to her. Still, she refuses to fight back.

"I'm not." Adora says confidently, without a shred of doubt. "I love Catra... I love her so much... You can hit me, beat me, kill me, but that won't change how I feel about her." Adora feels her eyes release tears that fall down her cheeks - they sting the claw marks on her jaw. "I won't fight you back. I don't want to fight anymore. I want *Catra* . I want to be *worthy* of her love. She... She shouldn't love me, but she does. She showed me the truth, she has *never* given up on me, not even after I hurt her. She is... She is *good* , so good... I... I want to be worth it all. I'm not lying. And I'm not going to fight you. So... if you want to kill me, go ahead." Adora closes her eyes again, ready to accept her fate.

Except, it never comes. C'yra drops her and Adora grunts. She hears the Magicat snap her fingers and the truth spell is lifted. "I'm going to send healers in to fix your face." C'yra says, walking towards the exit. "Your trial is in the morning." Adora sits up long enough to see C'yra slam the door before she collapses back on the ground again.

She stares up at the ceiling and brings her hand up to her jaw. She hisses in pain as it stings. She was bloody and bruised but still *alive* . She laughs a little. She has no idea how she survived that. Now all she had to do was survive her trial.

Easy-peasy. *Right?*

Chapter End Notes

Perhaps here is where things begin to look up. Who knows? ;) -M

Honestly, the scene with Shadow Weaver and Adora was so cathartic to write?? It felt like therapy asdfghjfgh I hope you all enjoyed this chapter! And yeah, Adora still gets those cheek scars -S

As always, you can find us on Twitter @ceolordadora and our CC is the same. You can find me (S) on Tumblr @sherasswordstrap

Crime and Punishment

Chapter Summary

Adora's face falls a little when she's denied any news on Catra but she nods in acknowledgement.

"Glimmer, cast the spell will you." C'yra says as she slides into her seat next to Luna. Glimmer stands and begins casting the 'spell' that Adora recognises as a truth spell.

"You know, if truth spells are done wrong, it can be very painful." Glimmer taunts.

"Didn't know you were into torture, Shimmer." Adora comments. Glimmer huffs and then casts the spell, pink light washes over Adora and then fades just as quickly. "Ugh... magic..." Adora hates magic being used on her.

"The spell is so you can't lie." C'yra explains. "Which I'm sure you'd probably try."

"I wouldn't lie." Adora says and people look at her in surprise. Ha, truth spell. "I was genuine when I surrendered. Now can we get this show on the road?"

Chapter Notes

Happy Friday !! And Happy Update Day !! We hope you enjoy this update and we'll see you again next week for another update :)!

See the end of the chapter for more notes

Adora groans as she hears rustling and jingling. She sits up and rubs her head. She's a mess. Turns out, the Rebellion may not have any prisons, but their glowy magical traps are hard to sleep in. Plus, Adora had a little bit of blood staining her shirt from Cyra's beat down. Adora hadn't seen her face, some healers had come in to 'fix' it, though Adora doubted they really did anything considering her jaw still stung like a bitch, it wouldn't surprise her if they wanted her to suffer.

She pushes herself to her feet as people enter her room. At first, she thinks it might be Catra, but it's not, it's C'yra - probably the person who hates her the most on Etheria. "Your trial is now." She says simply. Adora has learnt how to read Magicats pretty effectively, and the whipping around of C'yra's tail tells Adora that she's annoyed.

She holds her hands out and cuffs are slapped onto them, even her feet are cuffed - like Adora could outrun a *Magicat* . Adora wants to ask for a moment to fix her hair, and her clothes, but she's being dragged out of the room before she can even say good morning.

She walks down the halls of Bright Moon and squints. She doesn't know how these Princesses stand this decor, especially this early in the morning, it's all so bright. On her way to who knows where, they walk into Luna who stops them briefly. "What in Etheria happened to your face?" Luna asks and she actually looks genuinely concerned. The Magicat reaches her hands up and gently cups Adora's face in her hands to examine her. Luna is short, and it results in Adora having her face dragged downwards.

"Uh…" Adora glances at C'yra who lets out an annoyed huff before she looks back at Luna. "I… fell on it?"

"You fell on your face?" Luna asks, raising an eyebrow in disbelief. Adora shrugs her shoulders, standing back up straight.

"Sure did." She confirms. She knows it's a flimsy excuse at best but something was telling her to not tell Luna that her wife basically beat Adora up. Luna sighs and looks at her wife briefly.

"And into my wife's claws?" Luna asks, with little amusement, but Adora has a feeling that that's more directed towards her wife than Adora herself. Adora looks at Luna.

"... Yes…." She answers, unconvincingly. Luna sighs in exasperation.

"I'll see you in there," She says to Adora. "I can't believe you." Luna adds as she passes by her wife. They stand there for a moment and Adora watches as C'yra looks almost *hurt* before she seems to snap out of it. She gestures for them to carry on along to the guards.

Adora is shuffled into a room. Around a table in the middle all the Princesses are sitting silently and stoically. Adora knows it was a long shot that Catra would be there, especially

after just giving birth, but she still kind of wishes she was. "Morning Princesses, everyone is here, how nice." Adora says as a guard behind her grabs her shoulders and pushes her forcefully into a seat. "O- *kay* ..." Adora says - there was no need for the man-handling honestly.

"Horde Lord Adora." Angella begins, her voice steady and booming despite being at a perfectly normal volume - *is that just how Queens speak?* "You stand before the Princess Alliance in trial for the many crimes that you have committed against Etheria. However, we will be as just and fair as possible and allow for individuals to speak up on your behalf, as well as allow you to explain yourself to the Alliance. Understood?"

"There are individuals who want to speak for me?" Adora asks with surprise. "I mean... Okay. Where's Catra? Is she okay? The baby?"

"That is none of your concern." Angella answers. "As for the individuals that wish to speak on your behalf, we have former members of the Horde that informed us that they would like to speak in your defence. The Alliance has come to an agreement to allow them to plead your case." Adora's face falls a little when she's denied any news on Catra but she nods in acknowledgement.

"Glimmer, cast the spell will you." C'yra says as she slides into her seat next to Luna. Glimmer stands and begins casting the 'spell' that Adora recognises as a truth spell.

"You know, if truth spells are done wrong, it can be *very* painful." Glimmer taunts.

"Didn't know you were into torture, Shimmer." Adora comments. Glimmer huffs and then casts the spell, pink light washes over Adora and then fades just as quickly. "Ugh... magic..." Adora *hates* magic being used on her.

"The spell is so you can't lie." C'yra explains. "Which I'm sure you'd probably try."

"I wouldn't lie." Adora says and people look at her in surprise. *Ha, truth spell* . "I was genuine when I surrendered. Now can we get this show on the road?"

"Fine, *Horde Lord* . What are your intentions of being here?" Glimmer asks to start off, arms folded across her chest and her eyes narrowed. Adora is sure that it’s meant to be intimidating, but it’s really *not* .

"My intentions?" Adora raises a brow. "My only intention is to end the war." Glimmer frowns, clearly not having expected that answer.

"Very well.” Angella speaks now, tearing Adora away from her staring match with the Sparkle Princess. “How long have you led the Horde for?"

"Uh..." Adora shuffles uncomfortably. "Depends. I took Hordak out... five years ago? I was eighteen. Shadow Weaver was there until I was twenty and then I took her out too. So five or three, take your pick." Glimmer looks surprised for a moment, but quickly changes her face back to a neutral expression.

"Tell us, why did you take Hordak out? Why did you take down Shadow Weaver?" Adora straightens up. She had been expecting these questions but she's tempted to lie, or not tell the whole truth anyway, but the spell she's under compels her otherwise. Still, she didn't feel comfortable expressing her trauma to a room full of people who hated her, and also only believed her because she was under a spell. It was *nothing* like telling Catra.

"I... Hordak..." Adora's brain feels scrambled for a second before she gets a grip on it. "Hordak, because Shadow Weaver told me he was a shit leader, which is an understatement by the way. She also lied to me, or she didn't, I don't know. She told me horror stories about Hordak, made me angry, I tend to lose my temper often, if you haven't noticed, and it was just after I found my sword, I didn't have control over She-Ra, I lost control, when I came to, Hordak was dead. Shadow Weaver because I figured out later that she was using me as her little pet soldier, she only wanted me for the power I gave her, she used me to get rid of Hordak, she kept using me, lying to me, until I'd had enough. Not to mention the fact she literally attacked me when I started to show signs of disloyalty."

"You’d had enough? What does that mean exactly?" Angella asks, leaning back a bit in her chair and crossing her fingers.

"I'd had enough. What more does that mean? Have you ever been controlled your entire life?" Adora doesn't mean to get angry, but she does. She takes a breath. "I didn't want to be a chess piece on her board anymore, but I carried on the Horde's mission, because it's all I knew, and I still believed everything I'd been taught."

"You believe everything you've been taught? What was the Horde's mission?" Glimmer asks, glaring. Adora sighs. She knows the Princesses will probably never understand her position on this, they'll never understand why Adora believed in a mission like what the Horde had - sometimes Adora even wonders why *she* bought into it.

"The mission? Save Etheria from the Princesses, basically conquer the planet." Adora shrugs. "Princesses were evil, that's what I was told, that's what I believed."

"That's what you believed? Past tense?"

"I obviously don't believe that anymore, I wouldn't be sitting here if I did." Adora answers sharply. They seem to forget that Adora has been in a relationship with a Princess for *months* now.

"Then what is it that you believe now?" Luna asks softly from her seat. "You said you were here to stop the war. Why?" Adora looks down at her hands. She knows what she's about to say is probably not going to be well received by about 90% of the Princesses.

"For Catra..." A small silence fills the room for a few seconds as Adora speaks those words.

"For Catra. What an ironic answer considering what you did." Mermista says sarcastically. Adora glances at her to see her rolling her eyes.

"Why for her? There has to be more than just that?" Perfuma asks, clearly trying to be a little kinder. "Why for Catra?"

"Why?" Adora asks. She looks at them with a frown. "I never meant to hurt Catra, I *never* want to hurt her ever again. I... I love her."

"No you don't!" C'yra roars, clearly angry at hearing the Horde Lord say that. Adora sighs heavily. *Some people just can't accept the truth even when it is given under a truth spell* . True, Adora was trained to resist them, but not even her can do that for long - Glimmer was right, the pain is extraordinary. "Glimmer, are you certain that the truth spell was done correctly?" C'yra asks.

"Yes! I casted that perfectly!" Glimmer says, sounding offended by C'yra's words. Adora laughs a little.

"Is it really that hard to believe that I love Catra?"

"Yes, it fucking is since you *stabbed* her." C'yra glares at her.

"C'yra, enough." Luna places a hand on her wife's shoulder and shakes her hand. "We need to handle this as unbiased as possible."

"I... I didn't mean to." Adora says, looking down. "I was angry... I... I didn't mean to. I *hate* what I did to Catra. I don't know why she forgave me, but she did. And I don't plan on wasting her forgiveness."

"So, why?" Perfuma asks. "Why did you do it?"

"Do you really want me to answer that? Does it even matter? I did it, that's all." Adora doesn't mean to snap but she does. She hates being questioned, in fact, a trial is about the worst thing Adora could think of. Perfuma frowns at Adora's answer.

"Do you need a moment to reflect on what to say?" Adora sighs and lifts her hands, pushing her short bangs back.

"I took bad advice, advice I never should have taken, I was emotionally compromised. She-Ra reacts to my emotions, sometimes I don't have control of her, but it was worse because... because of the advice I took. She-Ra was compromised. I wasn't in control. If I was, I *never* would have hurt Catra like that. I never would have said what I said to her." Adora knows she has left some information out of that but is it lying if she omitted certain truths? Or if she said it in a way that is slightly confusing but still the truth? The truth spell seems to think she did just fine.

"I don't have any more questions for right now. Does anyone else?" Perfuma asks as she sits back in her seat. Well, at least Perfuma seemed satisfied with Adora's answer. The members of the Alliance shake their heads and Angella nods.

"Very well. Then let's have the individuals that wish to speak on Lord Adora's behalf come in and say their piece. Perhaps we will gain a better understanding this way before we make a final decision." Angella says.

Adora clears her throat and sits back in her seat. At least now she could relax a little and let others do the talking. She wonders if she should ask for a glass of water or if she'd just get yelled at. Maybe a poisoned glass of water?

The doors open and the first person speaking for Adora enters. She assumes they're ex-Horde by their walk and they have the air of a Horde soldier. "Sir," They say to Adora who smiles a little. They take a seat. Adora watches them as they walk on in. She feels the familiar air that comes from them and their face does remind her of someone she knew once. "Jessie, right?" Adora asks, receiving a small smile in return from the former Horde soldier.

"Yes, sir." Jessie says before turning around to face the Alliance. "Your majesties. Thank you for letting me speak in this trial, it is an opportunity I will not take for granted. I understand your desire to immediately imprison and possibly dispose of Lord Adora as soon as she was within your grasp. However, I believe that that would not be the most ethical act to choose based on my own experiences." They say, taking a small pause.

"As you know, I was also once a Horde soldier, also blinded by the firm teachings of the Horde, and it took me years to realise that what I was doing was wrong. It took even longer to realise and find the courage to leave and believe I would have a safe place to turn to if I

came here. Despite Lord Adora's advancement in power, her situation is much like mine. Except that the Horde sank their claws even deeper into her." Adora is impressed by their diction. You can tell they're ex-Horde by the way they speak, they still have the discipline of a Horde soldier, someone raised in a strict military upbringing. They probably still have the respect of the rank.

"Why did you leave the Horde?" Angella asks the soldier. "Was Adora your Lord? And what do you mean by 'the Horde sank their claws deeper into her'?"

"I left the Horde right after Lord Adora became Horde Lord. I used the transition of power as the best window of time to escape." Jessie explains. "However, I was there to witness both the taking out of Hordak and Shadow Weaver and, from what I was able to see during the brief period that Lord Adora did take command, she was nothing like those two."

"And how was Lord Adora as Lord of the Horde?" Anegella asks - Adora wasn't aware she was under a yearly review here.

"She was kinder, even when she was upset. Her punishments were *nothing* like Hordak's or Shadow Weaver's. She gave intensive physical training as punishment. Never any torturing, or isolation, or no food, like the other two used to do."

"Hordak and Shadow Weaver did that?" Glimmer asks with a frown. Adora scoffs.

"Is that really that surprising? Shadow Weaver would always withhold food if I didn't beat my times in training, or meet her expectations. I would never do that to someone." Adora says. Jessie nods to confirm Adora's words.

"She wasn't the only one that Shadow Weaver did that to, but she was definitely the one she did it to the most."

"Look, you know..." Adora sits forward. "I used to think that what they did prepared me to be a soldier, and maybe it did, but Catra also said it made me paranoid, which it did. The Horde was cruel, I attempted to be less cruel." Jessie smiles at Adora.

"Princess Catra taught many of us who defected that. She was the most supportive to us out of everyone. I can understand how she was able to connect with you too, Lord Adora. Though for you, it's obvious you both connected at a much deeper level. Thank you for making the Horde less cruel."

"Deeper level..." Adora says. She looks down at the table and closes her eyes, unable to stop the smile that tugs at the corner of her lips. She misses Catra so much, and she loves her. She remembers the last time they were together and she hopes that it isn't the last. "Yeah, well, after Catra and I-" Adora stops, though the spell she's under compels her to keep going. *Don't say had sex. Don't say had sex. Don't say*- "Started... seeing... each other... I know she helped around the Fright Zone too." *Dodged a bullet there* .

"She helped the Horde?!" C'yra asks, upset. Adora frowns.

"She didn't help us against you. She'd cook food for my soldiers and gave me advice on improvements to make the Fright Zone a better place. Like the artificial farm so we could grow our own food." C'yra's anger lessens ever so slightly and she stays quiet. Luna, instead, asks Adora a question.

"To grow your own food? Did you not have that before? She would cook there?"

"We only had ration bars which, let me tell you, after tasting *real* food, they're pretty bad. Catra would cook stuff, like soup, sometimes for everyone, sometimes just for me. She'd bring me lots of things." Adora explains happily.

"What would she bring you?" Luna asks softly. She looked genuine and curious to hear about Catra and Adora's relationship. Adora was under a truth spell, so she couldn't exactly *not* answer her, but she appreciated that Luna at least appeared to consider Adora a non-threat.

"Food." Adora says. "Sometimes treats, she said I had a sweet tooth. Donuts, sometimes whole meals if she'd had the time." Luna hums softly, looking at Adora with an understanding look.

"And she encouraged you to make the Fright Zone better?"

"Yeah, the changes I made were mostly her recommendations. Now soldiers have private rooms, and we're actually growing stuff. After... a minor setback." Adora winces a little as she remembers the artificial farm that she left in ruins. People were really attached to that thing, surprisingly - some Horde soldiers liked to farm as it turned out.

"But why did you listen to her?"

"Because... because she's *Catra* ." Adora says. She struggles to fully articulate it to herself. She remembers when Catra had first made the suggestion, Adora had almost been insulted, she wondered why Catra even cared, but as they spent more time together… Adora saw that Catra *did* care, and she had made good points.

"Oh?" Luna blinks, raising an eyebrow - clearly *Catra* wasn't enough of an answer.

"I wanted to make her happy... and she was happy whenever I did something she suggested." Adora answers. That's all she's ever really wanted: to make Catra happy. "And her proposals made sense, and they made my soldiers happy too." Luna smiles a bit at that.

"I see. Thank you for answering." Luna says softly. Angella nods in agreement.

"Yes, thank you. Jessie, do you have anything else to add?" Angella asks.

"Adora may have been Lord of the Horde, but she was a soldier before any of that." They say. "If she had found her sword and left, would it be the same story? Circumstances and... chance... led to Adora leading the Horde, but she was just like any of us. And you gave me a chance, I think she deserves one too." Angella slowly nods at their words.

"Thank you, we'll take your words into consideration. We appreciate your time and presence here today, Jessie." She says kindly, gesturing towards the exit. "You may go now if you wish." Jessie stands from their seat and they bow respectively to the Princesses and then to

Adora . Adora smiles at that. It’s nice to know she still commands authority even when she looks like a mess. Jessie takes their leaves and Adora’s attention turns back to Angella.

“Do you know if there is anyone else that wishes to speak on her behalf?" Angella asks Glimmer. Glimmer goes to open her mouth but, before she can, someone clears their throat, interrupting the Princess. The sound of wheels against flooring is audible in the silence.

"As her mate, I think I am more than entitled to having a say." Catra says, a small bundle in her arms as the medical assistant brings her in. Adora whips her head around and she moves, only to be grabbed back into her seat.

"Catra? What are you-" Adora begins but the violent jerking of her being pulled back down into her seat interrupts her.

"You shouldn't be here, C'yra." C’yra says, her voice bordering on anger.

"Let me rephrase that, as Adora's mate, and *Princess of Half-Moon,* I'm entitled to be part of this trial. Unless you've disowned me already, C'yra? In which case, I'm still her mate and wish to participate on Adora's behalf." Catra speaks confidently and calmly and Adora stares at her with amazement. She never expected for Catra to be here, she can’t believe she actually *is* here. The Princesses all fall silent.

"Catra, aren't you recovering?" Adora asks with a concerned frown. "Should you be here?"

"Any trial that takes place to convict someone must have all royals of the Alliance present in order to be considered legitimate in its ruling." Catra says firmly before she looks at Adora softly. "Pretty sure that’s why *C’yra* had them attack the Fright Zone while I was in labour, since I’d be unlikely to be able to help you. Not that they would have known I went into labour, or cared for that matter. I needed to be here."

"My babies..." Adora says, looking softly at Catra and the bundle in her arms. She wants to hold them both, but every time she moves she's yanked back into her seat.

"You're kind of considered a biased party here, Catra." Glimmer points out.

"Not really. I'm here to tell you the information that you're missing from this entire situation." Catra says back, looking at Glimmer coldly. "Because, unlike the rest of you, I know Adora personally. As did that former Horde soldier that just left."

"You'll say anything to save her." C'yra says. "You shouldn't be here at all."

"Yet here I am, as the law allows for me to do." Catra replies calmly. "It's sad how low you've come to think of me, C'yra. It really is. But I'm not surprised." She clenches her jaw for a moment, taking a deep breath. Adora watches her so closely. She isn't sure how she came to feel this way about Catra, like her heart might burst out of her chest at the mere sight of her, but she does and she just can't stop looking at her. "What are Adora's charges?"

"Well, she's a war criminal for one." C'yra says.

"Ha, I am." Adora agrees. *Kidnapping is a war crime, right?*

"She's killed people, so she's a murderer."

"That's true, I have killed people." If you consider Shadow Weaver and Hordak, people. Catra looks at Adora and briefly facepalms. Adora doesn't know what the big deal is anyway, the Rebellion has totally killed people before too. They're in a *war* and people *die*, on both sides.

"What else?" Catra asks after she drops her hand.

"Am I charged with being in love?" Adora asks sarcastically. When you think about it, that's kind of the whole reason Adora was here. For love. C'yra clearly doesn't find that as amusing as Adora does.

"Glimmer, take the spell off of her, she's starting to get loopy and run her mouth." C'yra says, pinching the bridge of her nose.

"She's not being loopy." Catra rolls her eyes. "She's a giant dork, that's why she's saying that." Catra says, stopping Glimmer from taking the spell off. Well, Catra isn't wrong. "Adora, what was the mission that the Horde taught you all? And why did you follow it?"

"My mission? The Horde's mission? It was to protect Etheria from the Princesses, their powers are too strong, and they're violent instigators who can't control their powers. Like She-Ra, she's too powerful. I followed because I believed that." Adora answers and Catra nods a little.

"You believed it because that's all they ever told you, and that's all you ever saw through your end on battlefields, is that right?" Catra asks. Adora purses her lips before she nods.

"Princesses are mean, they hurt me and other Horde soldiers." Adora states. She has been hurt significantly by Princesses in the past. She isn't naive, she knows that the Horde have hurt people too, that *she* has hurt people, but it was *war* . The Princesses hate Adora because she hurt them, Adora hated the Princesses because they hurt her, it was a vicious cycle and one Adora wished to end.

"We hurt you and your soldiers?! You-" Glimmer stops, looking angry when Catra raises her hand to make her stop yelling.

"You were raised with the mentality that Princesses were evil, and you inherited a war that you shouldn't have had to be a part of. It makes sense that when you took control, you wanted to continue the mission, because you truly believed that we were evil people hurting those that you knew. Am I right?" Catra asks - Adora is seriously in awe of her.

"You're not wrong." Adora nods.

"Much like how the rest of us were raised to believe that everyone in the Horde is evil, when that simply isn't true." Catra smiles a little, though it doesn't quite meet her eyes. Adora looks around the room, the Princesses look like they don't totally agree with Catra's assessment of

the Horde not being totally evil. "How long were you in control of the Horde, Adora? Because it wouldn't be fair for you to be punished for crimes that were not committed under you."

"Three or five years, depending how you define it. We established this already Catra, but your cute face wasn't here." Adora pauses. "Did I say that outloud?" Catra giggles softly and nods.

"Yes, you did. Continuing along, could you clarify for us what you mean by three or five years?" Catra asks. Adora doesn't know where Catra is going with this, she kind of already answered these questions, but Catra *knows* her, so Adora figures she probably has an agenda with her questions.

"I took Hordak out, Shadow Weaver was there for a couple of years. I was her puppet Lord." Adora says bitterly.

"Puppet Lord?" Catra asks, even though she already knows the answer. Adora knows that Catra is only asking because she needed the others to understand that Adora was as much of a victim of the Horde as any other soldier had been, but she still doesn't like speaking about it.

"I mean, I was technically the Lord of the Horde, but I did what she told me to because I wanted to please her." Adora explains.

"Why?" Catra asks softly. "Why did you want to please her?"

"Because..." Adora hesitates. "She… She was my superior officer, but also… she was like my mom. And every time I let her down, or disappointed her, I felt bad. When I was a cadet, she'd punish me for it, but it was my fault for not being... good enough. Being distracted." Adora dislikes having to speak this to a crowd, she finds talking about feelings hard enough already as it is but having to speak it to a room who hates her? She just concentrates on *Catra* . Catra frowns softly.

"It was not your fault, Adora, I hope you know that. She was horrible. She told you so many lies, knowing that you had nothing and no one that could tell you otherwise, while she

controlled you." Catra says softly. Adora sees the longing in Catra's eyes, she can tell that Catra wants to comfort her but she is restraining herself. "Could you please tell us a little more about what she's done to you?"

"I don't like to..." Adora says, looking down.

"Adora, please, Love?" Catra requests gently, leaning in so she is closer to Adora. "I need them to understand what you went through." Adora could never say no to Catra. She sighs.

"She... trained me. She'd attack me in my sleep, so I was prepared for an attack at any time, she'd punish me in different ways. She did this," Adora lifts her shirt as best she can to reveal some of her scars and then points to her eye. "Tortured me, used me, convinced me Catra betrayed me."

"I figured that's why the attack had happened." Catra whispers. "Do you understand why I was trying to get you all to listen?" She turns around to face the Alliance. "I wanted to explain, to show you the Adora that I got to know, she's as much of a victim in this as anyone else in the Horde."

"That doesn't excuse what she's done." C'yra says.

"Perhaps not, but it also shows how she shouldn't be faulted for the actions taken by Hordak or Shadow Weaver." Catra responds. "It's also unfair to deny the way in which the damages from the Horde have decreased since Adora took control."

"Catra has a point." Bow says in support. "Damages have decreased, especially recently, ever since Adora became Horde Lord."

"We've also seen Adora interact with Catra, she's... different." Spinnerella says.

"I witnessed it too, until you chased her away, C'yra." Luna adds. Adora can't believe this, she has *Princesses* standing up for her - well, Princesses plus Bow.

"I was intending to arrest her for her crimes. I didn't *chase* her away, she *ran* away." C'yra huffs, glaring at Adora. "And can't you see she's just bewitching my daughter to use her as a shield."

"Oh, shut up already." Catra calls out. "You need to stop that narrative already. It's not true at all."

"Bewitch?" Adora snorts. "Catra doesn't do anything she doesn't want to do. She wouldn't even admit she's cute when I told her she was."

"I'm not cute." Catra grumbles, adjusting Finn in her arms. "You can put me under a truth spell too, if you wish. Since you seem to have it in your mind that you think I'll lie all the time because of who I love."

"Catra is adorable." Adora says, ignoring the current topic.

"You are pretty cute, Catra." Bow says. "Your ears especially."

" *Right* ?!" Adora asks excitedly. "See! And Arrow Guy isn't one of my soldiers, Catra." Adora beams happily, finally having another source that is *not* under her influence to agree with her. Catra blushes a little in response - which is *cute* .

"Don't encourage her. She won't stop with the compliments."

"It's true." Adora says proudly - and she would *never* stop with the compliments anyway.

"We can't put you under a truth spell." C'yra interrupts. "You just gave birth, it’s too dangerous."

"Me being hurt didn't stop you from causing me pain before. Just do it." Catra says, shrugging as she calls out her mom bluntly.

"No," Adora says. "No hurting you for me." Adora doesn’t want to hurt Catra and she doesn't want Catra to be hurt *for* her.

"It's for *us,* and I'm agreeing. Plus, it's not like I'm gonna lie." Catra shrugs. "I have no reason to."

"Glimmer?" C'yra says. The Princess hesitates, which she hadn't done with Adora, before she casts the spell. Adora looks nervously at Catra.

"Are you okay?" Adora asks.

"I'm fine, Adora. I promise." Catra smiles softly. "Just tired, since I gave birth to Finn a few hours ago." She faces the Alliance again. "Do you have any questions for me?"

"Did the Horde Lord seduce you?" C'yra asks. Adora’s eyebrows raise a little at that - C’yra certainly didn’t waste any time.

"No, she didn't seduce me." Catra answers. Adora looks at her and Catra looks right back at her. One side of Adora’s lips quirk up in a small smirk. “Idiot.” Catra says with a playful roll of her eyes.

"So why did you sleep with her and why did you *keep* sleeping with her?" C’yra asks, drawing both of their attentions back.

"Seduction wasn't what happened." Catra answers quietly. "First time we were together, it was because we made a deal. She was interested, I figured I'd use that to my advantage. We... *clicked,* in a way neither of us were prepared for. I liked being with her, in and outside of the bedroom."

"So it was just sex?" C'yra queries.

"At the time, yes it was." Catra nods. Adora isn't sure that's a good thing to confess.

"When did it change?" C'yra asks. Catra pauses for a moment.

"I think it started changing after that first time. Though neither of us would admit it then." She smiles as she turns to look at Adora. "I think we should have known after that kiss before I had to leave, huh Adora?"

"You mean when I hid you with my cape?" Adora asks. "Yeah… After the first time... Things just fell into place." Adora can't believe she didn't see it sooner. When she had hooked up in the past she'd had very strict rules - like no kissing - she'd had no rules for Catra, except, of course, *please don't claw my eyes out while I'm naked.*

"They did." Catra looks lovingly at Adora. "We seemed to fit so perfectly with one another. Conversations were easier than ever before. Being with Adora made me happier than I ever thought I'd be."

"I was confused," Adora says. "I didn't know what I felt, but I knew Catra was important to me. It broke my heart when she left, but I understand why she did it." Adora didn't blame Catra for leaving, staying would have hurt her more. Adora had been so blind, she'd needed Catra to leave to kick her ass into gear and make her *see* . Catra nods and Adora knows that Catra understands why Adora did what she did too.

Catra looks back to her mom. "What other questions do you wish to ask?" She asks.

"I don't understand." C'yra says. "Why Adora? Why the Horde Lord? She's *evil* ."

"She's not evil." Catra says with a frown. Adora would debate that fact but she doesn't exactly have the highest opinion of herself. "I used to think that before. I used to think that Adora was this heartless monster that didn't care about who she hurt. Except, that wasn't true at all. Adora isn't a monster, she isn't heartless and she isn't evil. She's a person, like you and me, who grew up in an abusive environment, being told that she couldn't be loved and that she was only worth something if she followed the Horde's mission. She was told that what she was doing was the right thing, and she truly believed that because those previously in charge of the Horde made it so that her and the other members of the Horde wouldn't question their orders."

"You really love her?" C'yra asks, unamused. "Of all the people to fall in love with, C'yra."

"I do love her. I love her with all my heart." Catra confirms, unashamed. "I fell in love with her because she's the one I've been searching for, the one that I clicked with, that makes me feel... *loved* and cared about. She makes me laugh, and is protective, and loving. I *love her*."

"I love you too." Adora says softly. "I love you so much, I never thought I could love someone like I love you." Catra faces back to Adora, gesturing for the medical assistant to wheel her closer.

"I love you too, Adora."

"Ugh, this is nauseating." Mermista says.

"Adora was distraught when I saw her with C'yra. She was *worried* , and she wanted to help her. She *was* helping her." Luna turns to her wife. "I think we can allow her some leniency. If you care for me and our daughter, you'll finally listen to me."

"So what do you propose we do, Lu? Let her off without any form of punishment?" C'yra's brows furrow in irritation.

"I never said that, but killing her in cold blood does no one any good."

"Angella? Any ideas? Since Luna is so opposed to mine." C'yra says. Angella sighs.

"My husband died fighting the Horde. You know I hate them, but... Adora isn't responsible for his death. Glimmer was so young, and Adora seems to be around her age. We can't blame all of the sins that the Horde has committed on one sole person. Hordak was responsible, from the beginning, Adora already took him out, and she acknowledges she did wrong. Given how detrimental her death would be to Catra, some other form of punishment is the logical option." Angella says. Adora's heart starts to beat wildly in her chest. If she had convinced Queen Angella, maybe not all hope was lost.

C'yra bites her lip. She looks at Adora. Adora knows that C'yra hates her, she can *see* it, but Adora does her best to look sincere. Her ear twitches and her tail flicks. "Fine, any of you have any ideas of what to do?" C'yra opens the floor up to the other Princesses.

"I do." Catra speaks up. "Allow Adora to assist with repairs for Etheria."

"I was thinking more along the lines of life imprisonment, no parole, she rots in a prison cell for the rest of her life." C'yra deadpans. Adora winces a little at that thought but at least it wasn't death, right?

"No." Catra shakes her head. "Because all you're doing, by choosing to do that, is proving to the Horde that their teachings about us were right."

"I think we should still kill her honestly."

" *No* !" Catra yells desperately. Adora feels her heart clench at hearing Catra's desperation. "Absolutely not!"

"If you did, you'd make the Horde *maaad* ." Adora interjects. Catra nods.

"If you killed Adora, you would just start the war all over again. She's right."

"They really love you that much?" C'yra asks.

"Scorpia isn't the war type, but Lonnie? My other soldiers, *someone* would step up and the war would resume again for killing me." Adora says. She remembers what Lonnie told her, that the Horde had her back, even after everything. Maybe Adora was harsh but she knew that the Horde loved her, they respected her, trusted her to keep them safe and after improving the Horde these past few months, they'd be seriously upset if Adora was just executed by the Princesses. Adora can't say for sure of course, but she's pretty sure they would retaliate for killing her.

"Plus, they know I'd be devastated too." Catra adds. "I can't lose Adora, being away from her for so long hurt enough. Losing my mate again, permanently, would kill me." She frowns sadly. Adora wants to comfort her but those *damn* guards.

"You have Finn now, you'd be fine." C'yra says dismissively.

"Stop that!" Catra yells in anger. That is exactly what Adora had said to Catra, that she had Finn now, that if Adora died, she'd have something - *someone* - to live for. Seems Catra wasn't too fond of that idea. "You act as if Luna didn't have to deal with the same thing when you almost died in battle! Stop dismissing it as if it's something that's easy to get over. You cared when I was hurting when you didn't know who it was and, now that you do, you don't care about how it would hurt me! Or my kitten!"

"Of course I cared before I knew you were sulking over the *Horde Lord!* " C'yra yells back. Adora has never seen Catra look so angry. Catra covers Finn's ears so as to not disturb them.

"And why does who it is matter when it would still hurt me?!" Catra roars back. "You are really quick to use Adora hurting me when she was under Shadow Weaver and the Black Garnet's influence as an excuse to damn her, but when it comes to your own choices hurting me, you don't seem to give a fuck in any degree!"

"My choices *protected* you!" C'yra yells angrily.

"No offence C'yra," Netossa interjects. "but your choices only hurt Catra. She was miserable, and under house arrest, separated from her mate. Her mental health plummeted, you didn't even care. Your hatred for the Horde Lord blinded you to your own daughter's suffering." Catra looks at Netossa gratefully for speaking.

"Netossa's right." Catra states.

"She is right," Adora says. "I talked to Catra on the-" *Fuck* . Adora probably shouldn't reveal that, but she's under a truth spell and now that she's said it she *can't* lie. "Tracker pad… When we… did things… She was isolated and alienated from everyone she loved, and you didn't care." Catra's ears become droopy as Adora speaks, pressing back against her head.

"And then I got isolated again when Glimmer confiscated my tracker pad. I was alone, with only three people to talk to." Adora feels sadness wash over her. She lifts her hands up, the cuffs rattling. She aches to reach out to Catra but she *can't* , so she just looks at her meaningfully. Unfortunately, that moment is interrupted by C'yra.

"You did that to yourself." C'yra says. Catra looks at C'yra like she had just been slapped in the face.

"I... I did that to myself?"

"You're the one who decided to carry on seeing Adora."

"So that makes me deserve to be alienated?" Catra asks. Adora can tell that she's *hurt* by her mom's words and Adora turns her gaze onto C'yra. There will always be one thing that Adora will get angry at: someone hurting Catra. "Good to know that's what you think."

"No, I... I just meant that I was forced to protect you from yourself."

"Protect me fr- that's *bullshit* ! Did you hear nothing that we just said?" Catra asks, clearly exasperated. Adora lets out a huff. C'yra looks at her now, meeting Adora's blue eyes. She

looks like she’s searching for something, and then her eyes narrow. She rubs her face in frustration.

"I stand by it."

"Well, it's not true!"

"Allegedly."

"I'm *telling* you! I know my own mental health better than you do." Catra’s fangs flash as she speaks, like a snarl.

"I'm never going to be okay with you loving the Horde Lord." C’yra says, pointing her claw at Adora. Catra doesn’t look, she keeps her fiery gaze on her mom.

"That's not what this is about!"

"Then what is this about?!"

"You're ignoring how much you're hurting me!" Catra yells.

"What do you want from me C'yra? An apology? You're not getting one."

"I can't believe you." Catra says in disbelief.

"Why would I apologise for trying to keep you safe?" C’yra asks. Adora does really think that C’yra believes that she was really just trying to protect Catra. She’s ignoring the harm she caused and justifying it by saying she did what was best - what *she* thought was best. Adora is sure she wouldn’t be happy to hear this, but they are a lot alike like that.

"Because you're not keeping me safe! All you're doing is hurting me!"

"Ah!" C'yra swipes her hand through the air. "This is about Adora, not you."

"It's about us both! She's my mate, C'yra!" C'yra looks away and stays silent, ignoring Catra.

"Can I hold my baby? One more time before, you know, I could potentially die." Adora asks. The atmosphere is thick and tense but if Adora is about to be sentenced to death, she wants to at least get to hold her baby one last time.

"Let her go, please." Catra asks the guards, looking at them pleadingly. "At least let her have this."

"No." C'yra says. "Her cuffs stay on."

"Please, let her hold our kitten." She begs again, and the guards look unsure. "She's not going to go anywhere, and neither am I. I'm still under the truth spell, I can't lie." The guards look to Angella who nods at them after a moment.

They begin to take the cuffs off of Adora and she reaches her hands out to Catra. The entire alliance was watching them with tense expressions. Catra bites her lip, pushing herself up with one hand from her wheelchair and immediately melting into Adora's arms with Finn snuggled between them. "Sorry... I... I need this too." She whispers, purring quietly. There's a sharp intake of breath that more than likely comes from C'yra, but she doesn't say anything.

Adora smiles and lifts her hand to cup Catra's jaw as she gives her a gentle butterfly kiss. "I missed you too, Kitten." Catra purrs louder at the butterfly kiss, mewling quietly and bringing Finn into view.

"Look at our kitten. Our little Finn."

"They're so cute... And small." Adora beams and kisses them on their head. "Guess they really did take after you, huh?" Adora asks playfully. Catra smiles and laughs - Adora will always love to make Catra laugh.

"As if. They have your eyes, you can see them better now. They're adorable." Catra whispers. "They take after both of us."

"Look at their little ears..." Adora closes her eyes as she leans against Catra. "We made the cutest baby."

"I know." Catra whispers back, closing her eyes as well, feeling Finn purring at being warm. An asteroid could have hit Etheria right then and there and Adora wouldn't have cared, as long as she was with Catra, nothing could be wrong. "They're purring, they're a happy kitten." Adora opens her eyes, seeing Finn smiling. Adora laughs at the same time Catra does. "I think they know they're with their moms." Catra comments.

"Oh..." Adora says softly. She looks down at herself to see she was glowing, which had been happening a lot more recently, ever since she accepted She-Ra being a part of her. She wonders if Finn can sense She-Ra's magic - considering they were made from her magic. "They *are* purring. You really think they know?"

"I'm certain." Catra says with a smile, her eyes sparkling and showing how happy she was to have Adora and her kitten close to her.

"I love you, Catra..." Adora whispers as she gently caresses Catra's jaw. "I don't want to die." She confesses, her eyes shining with unshed tears. She thought she had accepted it but… Seeing Finn, seeing Catra. Adora thought she had nothing to lose, but she has *everything* to lose. She feels slightly panicked, her hands tighten around Catra, ready to cling to her. She can't imagine never getting to see Finn grow up, to never get to grow old and grey with Catra, she can't imagine her life with her family being cut short.

"You won't. I won't let them. I promise." Catra whispers, resting her forehead against Adora's. "You're my mate, and I need you. They can't take you away from me."

"That's enough." C'yra says, interrupting their moment. The Guards drag Adora back and away and cuff her wrists once again. Adora mourns losing her contact with Catra but she resigns herself to sitting back in her seat. Catra whimpers as Adora is shoved back into her seat. "Glimmer. Take the spells off of them. I think we can conclude this trial and deliver a sentence." C'yra orders.

"Yes, Queen C'yra." Glimmer nods, casting the spell which unbinds the truth spell.

"So," C'yra says. "those in favour of the most severe punishment?" Mermista, C'yra, Glimmer and Frosta raise their hands.

"Really Sparkles?" Adora asks in slight disbelief. "You're going to vote for me to die? Why?"

"The Horde killed my dad." She replies coldly. Adora laughs and shakes her head.

" *Hordak* killed your dad, or Shadow Weaver, whichever the case, *I* took them out," Adora says. "You should be *thanking* me, not punishing me. I was a baby when your dad died, or still in diapers, and yet you still blame me? Seriously?"

"I-" Glimmer stutters before she drops her hand. She stays quiet for a moment before she looks at Queen C'yra. "I abstain from the vote." Adora supposes that's better than her voting *for* .

"Against?" C'yra asks now. Luna, Bow, Perfuma, Angella, Spinnerella, Netossa and Catra raise their hands. Adora could hardly believe it. Even without Catra, she'd won the majority of the Princesses over. C'yra frowns. "Very well, majority has ruled for a less severe punishment. What does the majority believe will be a proper punishment for the Horde Lord to receive?"

"Can I... say something?" Adora asks. "Before you decide?"

"What is it, Adora?" Luna asks.

"I know I did bad, and I know I can't excuse my actions, and I don't expect forgiveness, I just... I'm asking for a chance." Adora says. "Maybe I did this for Catra, but it's for everyone else too. This war has gone on for far too long, and for a false mission that isn't even true. The Horde are tired of fighting, *I'm* tired of fighting, I'm sure your people are too. Both sides have lost people but we can move forward now, we can make amends, we can... bridge the gap. I want to be worthy of Catra's love, and of your clemency. I want... I want to be *happy* , finally. And I want... I want to learn more about She-Ra, and to help people." Adora finishes. Her blue eyes sparkle a little as she looks at each and every Princess, making sure they knew she was serious.

Luna looks surprised, and almost happy to hear Adora's speech - if her smile was anything to go off of anyway. "That was quite the speech you had there, Lord Adora. You must understand that it will take time for people to trust you. However, if you really mean those words, then I hope to one day see that amends are truly made."

"I do, I do mean them. I know She-Ra can heal, I just don't know... how." Adora says with a frown. "I could've helped Catra if I did, and she's supposed to protect Etheria, which I thought I was doing, but turns out I wasn't. I can protect Etheria properly now."

"We'll figure out what to do with She-Ra once we are certain you are trustworthy." Angella says. "In the meantime, take this time to prove your trustworthiness to us."

"Okay," Adora nods. "I'm ready for your judgement, and punishment." Adora really was ready. *Here it goes* .

"Lord Adora, you are being required to step down as Lord of the Horde, you must sign a ceasefire and ensure that no other attacks continue upon you stepping down. You are to participate with any rebuilding effort assigned to you and you will see it through unless we state otherwise." Angella looks at C'yra who seemed to be seething. "If you are not accompanied by a Princess, you must be accompanied by a guard at all times. This, of course, does not ring true in the privacy of the bathroom and bedroom. Though Catra cannot be that Princess, as she is considered too biased in this circumstance." Adora glances at Catra before she nods. “You’re also mandated therapy to help rehabilitate you and process your…

trauma.” *Oh, so her trauma was obvious? Fantastic* . She nods again in acknowledgement of these terms.

"What about my sword?" Adora asks.

"Your sword will be taken away and locked away temporarily. Until we are certain that you can be trusted with She-Ra."

"B-But I need my sword... for... reasons..." Adora coughs a little.

"And what would those reasons be?" Angella asks. Adora glances at Catra.

"Uh... doesn't matter..." Adora says while blushing. Catra blushes too, clearing her throat.

"Doesn't matter indeed." Catra states. Angella raises an eyebrow, clearly not needing much else to figure out what it was used for.

"I'm sure whatever the reason is that you'll find an alternative." Adora almost laughs at that line. Angella could say that again, but she really *liked* the feeling of her sword.

"Any other conditions?" Adora questions. "Because I have a proposal."

"You have a proposal? What sort of proposal?" Angella asks. Adora looks at Catra and then the Princesses. She's aware this may not be a popular idea, but it's worth a shot.

"Catra told me about marriage. I know you want me to sign a ceasefire thing, or whatever, she also told me marriages can be political. What's a better way to consolidate this new treaty than with a marriage?" Adora asks. She glances at Catra in time to see Catra's eyes widen.

"Adora… Are you doing what I think you're doing?" Catra asks. Luna's eyebrows go up in shock.

"And what marriage do you propose, Adora?" Luna asks. Adora thought it was pretty obvious but she guesses she has to spell it out.

"Catra and I are in love, we have a baby together. I'm sure Sparkles isn't interested, she clearly has a thing for Arrow Boy, I just think... it makes sense, doesn't it? For Catra and I to get married?" Adora asks. No sooner does Adora stop talking than C'yra starts yelling.

"Absolutely *not* !" C'yra refuses in a matter of seconds. Those words seem to be the only thing she could say when it came to Adora and Catra. Catra beams at Adora anyway.

"She's right, it makes the ceasefire more valuable. The Horde listens to Adora, and to me too." Yes Adora was in love with Catra, and yes Catra was in love with Adora, but it also made good political sense, the Princesses couldn't deny that. It solidified their peace terms.

"The Horde loves you." Adora says with a smile. "They'd probably be upset if I *didn't* marry Catra."

"Then let's do a vote to see if perhaps we can allow this proposal to take place. All against?" Angella starts off, the vote is exactly the same as before with C'yra, Frosta, and Mermista being against it. "All in favour?" The hands that were raised represented so much for them - Glimmer abstained yet again. "The majority agrees to move forward with the proposal that was put forward by Lord Adora." Adora *beams* .

"So I... we're engaged?!" Adora asks with great excitement.

"I mean, have you proposed to me yet?" Catra smiles a bit at Adora's enthusiasm.

"I'm supposed to propose?" Adora asks. Luna laughs a little.

"Guards, Lord Adora's terms have been set. You may take her restraints off of her." The Guards take the cuffs off of Adora's wrists and her feet and she rubs her skin in relief.

"I don't have a ring? I need a ring, right?" Adora asks as she turns to Catra.

"Maybe later for a ring? We can choose one together, and make sure it fits properly." Catra grins as she sits back down in her wheelchair.

Adora looks around before she moves. People seem to tense, but only *certain* people. She gets down on one knee in front of Catra and takes her hand that wasn't holding Finn. "Catra... I love you. I want to be with you forever and always. You are... *everything* to me. And you're *it* for me. I want you. I choose you. Will you do me the absolute honour of becoming my wife?" Catra's eyes water as she nods quickly.

"Yes... *Yes* ! I'll marry you. Yes, I want to be your wife, Adora. I love you so much, you giant romantic dork." Adora smiles so wide her cheeks *hurt* . She looks up at Catra with so much love. She gets to be with Catra forever, they get to be wives, forever, Adora never thought she would ever be someone’s wife.

C'yra rubs her face in frustration. "I didn't give permission for my daughter to be used as some... *bargaining chip* to cement a peace treaty I don't even want!"

"I'm my own person, and Luna gave permission. As did the majority of the Alliance, myself included. I'm consenting to this engagement and agreeing to this peace treaty between the Horde and the Alliance. The war is no more." *The war is no more* . Adora believes Catra wholly and completely. Adora smiles and she pushes herself up so she can kiss Catra, not caring that they were in a room full of people. She hasn't been physically with Catra since their night together all those months ago before Finn was even born.

"Adora's terms have been set-" Angella begins, only to be cut off.

"Actually, I have one more." Glimmer says. Adora pulls back from the kiss to look at the Princess.

"A *public* apology and swearing of allegiance in front of everyone." Glimmer says smugly.

"Fine. Done." Adora says, kissing Catra again. She doesn't care, she'll do *anything* to be with Catra - even embarrass and humiliate herself to the entirety of Etheria. Catra giggles happily and purrs as their lips meet again, Finn also laughs as they're gently squeezed between them. Adora is so happy right now. She lived! She gets to be with her family, forever potentially. She gets to marry Catra. Sure, she has things she needs to do to make amends and things will be hard, but she can do it... for Catra and for Finn.

"Am I free to go?" Adora asks. "I'm worried about Catra, she shouldn't really be here."

"Guard, please follow Adora as she escorts Catra back to the infirmary." Angella requests, nodding at a Guard that had once held Adora's shackles. The Guard nods and stands at the ready in case they were needed.

"I still need to stay in the infirmary for a few days." Catra whispers to Adora. "Doctor wants to monitor me."

"I wish we could be alone." Adora whispers back.

"Me too, but the doctor wants to make sure both Finn and I are okay since I had a stressful pregnancy."

"Well, your well-being is important to me, even if all I want to do is snuggle you." Adora smiles. "Mind if I push you?"

"I don't mind at all, please do." Catra smiles, snuggling Finn in her arms. "Snuggles sound great. I've missed you holding me." Adora stands, ignoring the glare C'yra sends her way as she begins to wheel Catra out of the meeting room. The Guard follows behind them.

"You're going to have to give me directions." Adora says. "Yeah? How have you been sleeping?"

"As well as you can imagine. I was doing okay when we were able to at least talk with the tracker pad, but when Glimmer took it away..."

"I know what you mean." Adora says. "I found it hard to sleep without you too."

"First thing on the list, taking a family nap." Catra smiles at her fiancee. "Sounds good?"

"Sounds *perfect* ." Adora says with a smile. She pauses for a moment. "I'm sorry for not telling you about my plan."

"I would say it's fine, but I am kind of upset at you for not telling me." Catra says quietly. "At least I would have had some type of warning with this." Adora feels that familiar guilt wash over her.

"I thought you might try to stop me, or talk me out of it."

"I would have, because I wanted to keep you safe, you idiot. You made me worried when you showed up at the infirmary."

"I know... I'm sorry... I know that was already a stressful situation for you. Your mom said you were labour, I had no idea until then."

"Yeah, no one but Spinnerella and Netossa were there with me." Adora feels bad about that too. She missed the birth of her own child. She wanted to be there to hold Catra’s hand, to kiss her on the head, to let her scream at her.

"I can't believe you showed up today after giving birth not so long ago." Adora says as she threads the fingers of one of her hands into Catra's hair. "You always have to one up me in being a badass, don't you?" Catra grins.

"Duh. I'm the badass of this relationship, thank you." Her grin drops a bit. "I needed to make sure that they wouldn't try to go through the trial without listening to your story fully. I had to be there, even though I'm recovering and the doctor used a spell to temporarily soothe the pain."

"You're in pain?" Adora asks, alarmed.

"Not right now. But in a few hours, probably. The spell wears off over time. I'm in a wheelchair for a reason, dork. But I'm okay, I just can't strain myself too much." Adora's hands tighten, her knuckles turning a little white. She doesn't like Catra being in pain, but she imagines labour probably is painful.

"I wish I had been here." Adora says wistfully.

"Me too, but you're here now. To snuggle me and give me kisses while I heal."

"I think Angella figured out what I use my sword for." Adora says with amusement.

"Oh, she totally did. You weren't subtle at all."

"I think I was a little subtle."

"Not *at all* ."

"A little. Otherwise your mom would've clawed my eye out."

"Please don't call her that." If Adora is honest, she feels a little bad and guilty about Catra's relationship with her mom. She feels like the cause of the deterioration between them.

"Right, sorry, Queen C'yra." Adora corrects.

"It's okay. And Adora, it's not your fault. It's hers." Adora doesn't know how Catra knew *exactly* what she was thinking, but she did.

"It *is* my fault." Adora says quietly.

"Did you tell her to act like an asshole?"

"No but I... Double Trouble... I should've kept better tabs on them. Everything that happened... all of it... it was all my fault." Catra sighs.

"Adora, look at me, please?" She requests gently. "You didn't make Double Trouble tell everyone else, that wasn't your fault. You didn't force the others, including C'yra, to act the way they are acting now. That's their choice. I tried to explain things to them, and only some of them listened during the trial and the rest didn't care. That's on them. Not you, not me." Adora knows that what Catra is saying is true, but she also can't help but feel responsible. It's a *disease* . Whenever something bad happens, Adora always feels responsible for it.

"I wish I could do more." Adora whispers.

"You being here with me is more than enough, Adora."

Adora wheels Catra into the infirmary and then kneels in front of her, looking up at her. "I... I know... I just... I can't help but feel... responsible..."

"You're not responsible, Adora." Catra whispers softly, reaching to take Adora's hand. "I pleaded for them to give me a chance to explain, but they refused to. They don't see how

they're hurting me, or rather, they're refusing to acknowledge it. That's on *them* ." Adora kisses Catra's hand and then the doctor appears.

"Oh, Lord Adora, good to see you again. Would you mind taking baby Finn while I help Princess C'yra into bed?" The doctor asks.

"Oh, I... uh... sure." Adora says. "I've only held them once, you'll have to show me again." Adora looks at Catra. Catra smiles. Adora had met the doctor when she had been to the infirmary while helping Catra before - which was probably why they weren't acting nervous around her.

"Here, you hold them like this." Catra says as she passes Finn off to Adora. "Support their head, okay?"

"I got them." Adora says with a gentle smile. "Oh wow... I'm going to protect you from everything, little one. No one is *ever* going to hurt you." Adora vows quietly as Catra is helped by the doctor back into bed. Adora looks at Finn in her arms. She meant that vow completely. She would protect Finn with her life, as she would with Catra too. She was so relieved that she would get to see Finn grow up.

"Adora, come here." Catra calls. Adora looks up and then walks towards Catra. Stopping just at the edge of her bed.

"Yes, Love?" Catra looks as though she melts at hearing Adora say that.

"I love you, and I'm happy that I get to be your wife."

"I'm happy I get to be your wife too." Adora smiles. "Think you can scoot over?" Catra nods and makes a little room for Adora to settle down beside her.

"Gosh, I've missed this so much." Adora chances a glance at Catra and sees her eyes are glassy with unshed tears.

"Please don't start crying, or I'll start crying and ruin my reputation." Adora says lightly as she kisses Catra atop her head. She adjusts Finn so they could cuddle into both of them.

"Fine, I'm too tired to cry anyway." Catra murmurs with a purry yawn. "Time to sleep for now. It's been a long day for us both, and for Finn."

"No kidding. I'm sorry my clothes are kind of... Well, I'm kind of gross because they just threw me in a magical prison for the night and then marched me to the trial the next morning."

"It's fine, you can shower tomorrow. We'll figure out the clothes situation then. For now, let's just rest and enjoy this time we have together." Adora relaxes against Catra fully and then sighs happily.

"Good night. I love you."

"I love you too, Adora." Catra smiles, lifting her head a little to deposit a kiss on Finn's head. "We love you too, our little Finn."

"Our little Finn." Adora echoes with a smile.

"Mhmm..." Catra smiles as she lays her head back down, closing her eyes. Adora's heart felt completely full and she could tell that Catra was listening to her heartbeat by the way her ear was placed right over her chest.

Adora holds Catra close. She was happy. She had Catra back, and they had a baby. She knew whatever they had to face from now she could do it, she could do anything with Catra by her side. They fall into a silence before Catra lifts her head a little. "What happened to your face?" Catra asks. Adora freezes at the question.

“Oh… I…” Adora stumbles and Catra narrows her eyes - that’s all it takes for Adora to cave. “C’yra, C’yra happened to my face.”

“I can’t believe her.” Catra says as she reaches her hand up. She gently caresses the side of Adora’s face that still slightly stung from the claws that had slashed her skin open. “She *marked* you.”

“It’s okay,” Adora says. “Chicks dig scars, right?” Adora asks with a half-smile hoping to make Catra laugh. Catra just huffs and lies her head back down against Adora’s chest.

“No one touches my mate.” Is all Catra says before she starts purring. Adora kisses Catra on top of her head. She didn’t know how things with C’yra would ever get better, but at least Adora had her family now.

Maybe things are starting to look up now.

Chapter End Notes

This is one of my favourite chapters drama-wise, I hope you enjoyed reading it. Catra is the strongest bitch in the Rebellion. -M

Adora may have made peace but there's still a lot of shit for them to solve - plus she's still pretty hated, by *everyone*. See y'all next week! -S

Some more news! M and I are looking to start a podcast where we talk about Horde Lord Adora and other stuff!! You can find out more info on our twitter @ceolordadora and when we post the podcast it will be announced there! Feel free to also drop questions on our CC.

You can also find me (S) on tumblr @sherasswordstrap

Forever and Always

Chapter Summary

> “Who do you take me for?” She asks and Adora grabs hold of her tail before it can hit her in the face again.
>
> “My fiancee,” Adora answers. “Soon to be wife, mother of my child, light of my life-”
>
> “Uh huh, suck up.” Catra interrupts.

Chapter Notes

> Happy Friday y'all and happy Update Day !! Sorry there was no update last week, M and I both took a much needed break, but we're back here this week with a new update and a chunky chapter for y'all !! We hope you enjoy :)!

See the end of the chapter for more notes

Adora blows out air from her cheeks as Perfuma asks her how Catra is. "Aren't we here to talk about me?" Adora asks, confused as to why Perfuma was bringing up Catra.

"We are." Perfuma confirms as she pours a cup of tea and hands it to Adora. Adora blinks but accepts the cup with a quiet thanks anyway. When the Rebellion had mandated therapy for her, she’d had no idea it would be sitting on the floor, cross-legged, while drinking tea. "Catra is a big part of your life, is she not? She seems to be an important topic for you."

"So what do you want to know?" Adora asks, sipping her tea. It tastes good but Adora silently admits that Catra makes it better.

"Does she trigger your trauma?" Perfuma asks and Adora stops halfway to her mouth with her cup. Adora looks at Perfuma trying to see what the hell she meant by that. Her confusion must be obvious because Perfuma expands. "Do you have anxiety relating to Catra?"

"I always have anxiety." Adora points out. She places her tea in front of her and sighs. "I feel safe with Catra, and happy, she's about the only person that gives me that comfort - except for Finn. I know they both love me, and I don't have to worry about them manipulating me."

"So why did you pause?" Perfuma pushes and Adora sighs. She taps her fingers on her thigh, trying to decide if she really wanted to tell this or not. It’s practically required of her, she has little choice. Adora doubts it, but Perfuma could tell the other Princesses that Adora was withholding from therapy and that would give them a reason to break the pardon they'd given her.

"I... It's not... It's me, what I did to her." Adora finally admits. "I have nightmares..."

"Nightmares?" Perfuma asks. Adora never sees Perfuma ever make any notes during these sessions - which Adora is happy about, because it means none of her darkest, most deepest trauma could possibly leak by a paper trail - but she does wonder how Perfuma remembers all of these sessions with such clarity.

"Of when I... When I stabbed her." Adora scratches the back of her head. "It's recurring, it... It's horrible... It makes me have panic attacks in my sleep, but Catra is always there to calm me down when I wake up." Adora could feel her breaths quickening simply from the memories of those dreams, but the memory of Catra's comfort is there too. She remembers the first time it happened, she knows she probably freaked Catra out but she'd set that aside to comfort her until Adora calmed down enough to confess what her dream had been about. Whenever it happened again, Catra snuggled right up to her and purred.

Adora smiles a little. She's learnt a lot about Magicats recently and she knows that purring is often a way for Magicats to calm other Magicats who are in distress - Adora isn't a Magicat but she still finds Catra's purring profoundly calming and soothing. Usually it ends with Adora curled up in Catra's arms, her nose buried in her neck and her hands running along her soft back while Catra purred sleepily until they both fell back asleep together.

"How does Catra feel about that?" Perfuma questions, bringing Adora back. Adora frowns.

"About what?" She asks.

"The fact you have nightmares about it? And that you stabbed her?" Perfuma clarifies and Adora still isn't sure she fully understands.

"Well I-" Adora pauses. They have talked about it, kind of. When Catra snuck out to the Fright Zone, Adora apologised, and Catra has told her (and others) on multiple occasions that it wasn't Adora who stabbed her and that it was the Black Garnet's fault. But how does Catra *feel* about it? Adora isn't totally sure. "I don't... I don't know? I guess she... She forgives me?"

"Have you two talked about it?" Perfuma prods and Adora huffs. She dislikes disclosing personal things but she guesses that's exactly what therapy is.

"We have." Adora answers sharply. Perfuma is, at least, one of the less annoying Princesses. Adora imagines if she'd been assigned C'yra and how *that* would've gone and she visibly winces. "I feel guilty." Adora says suddenly. "I feel as though I'm the reason Catra and C'yra aren't really talking. She told me it wasn't my fault but I guess... It's hard to believe."

"Why don't you believe her?" Perfuma asks. So many questions. Adora stares at her cup of tea for a moment.

"I don't know." Adora shrugs. "I just... Catra's life would have been so much easier if she'd never fallen in love with me." Adora lets out a breath and takes a sip of her tea which was quickly becoming room temperature by now. "We've talked about it, she told me that C'yra made those decisions herself, and I understand what she means, but... She made those decisions because of *me* , Catra was hurt because of what *I* did, her mom was trying to protect her from *me* ."

"So you agree with C'yra?" Perfuma asks.

"What? No." Adora scrunches up her nose. "I just mean... I'm the reason that C'yra did the things she did, so... I feel as though it's my fault that Catra suffered."

"But you don't agree with what she did?"

"She hurt Catra. I will never agree with something that hurts her." Perfuma nods and Adora relaxes a little. Adora keeps the peace between Catra and C'yra mostly because she doesn't want to be the reason that Catra is forced to cut off her own mother, even if Catra insists that it's C'yra's fault. Adora loves Catra, so much, she doesn't want to be the reason she loses her mom.

C'yra doesn't like her. That much is obvious. Adora has the scars on her face to remind her. Often Catra will reach her hand out and trace her fingers over those scars. They're a reminder not just to Adora about C'yra's protectiveness, but also to Catra about what her mom did to her mate.

"How are things with Catra? Do you spend a lot of time together?" Adora frowns at the question.

"I already told you, I'm not telling you things about Catra." Adora says, a little annoyed. "What is this? Half a couple's therapy?" Perfuma's eye twitches a little and Adora prides herself on drawing out that reaction.

Perfuma is one of the more level headed Princesses, sometimes her patience is too good, but Adora prides herself on being able to annoy pretty much any Princess - her mere presence manages to do that, though less so when she has Finn in her arms. That's probably all due to Finn's cuteness, the little charmer.

"I'm not asking about Catra, you don't have to tell me anything about Catra's thoughts or her feelings." Perfuma says. "But I'm asking for you." Adora doesn't really understand what that means so she simply shrugs. "Adora, I was tasked with making sure you adjust healthily to your new life, that includes how you interact with your relationships. You spend a lot of time together?"

"Of course we do?" Adora replies with confusion. "Catra and I are fine."

"You've both suffered significant trauma recently, spending so much time together... I worry that you may develop a codependency on each other that isn't totally healthy." Adora scowls

at that. "Are you not worried she may be using you as a sort of safety blanket?" Well she wasn't, *until now.*

"Catra isn't using me for anything. She loves me." Adora flat out refuses to believe that. "You sound like Shadow Weaver." Adora mumbles. Perfuma knows all about Shadow Weaver, that was practically their first session. Turns out, Shadow Weaver was the root of all of Adora's problems and trauma. *What a shock* - ***not*** .

"You and Catra share a special connection." Perfuma begins carefully. "But it's also important to have other friendships and to spend time apart."

"We know that." Adora says. "Catra and I don't spend every second together. Sometimes I'm with Luna, or, you know, helping rebuild, Catra is busy with stuff too and whenever she needs some alone time I look after Finn and vice versa." Adora says. "We don't spend all our time together, and I don't like you implying that my relationship is unhealthy. Catra and I are going to be married, of course we spend a significant amount of time together, and we depend on each other, but we are not unhealthily codependent that we can't spend five minutes apart." Adora clenches her fists. She was angry but could you really blame her? Perfuma at least has the decency to look a little ashamed.

"I certainly didn't mean to imply that your relationship with Catra is unhealthy, I just want you to keep it in mind."

"Yeah, well, noted." Adora says shortly. Her anger has been getting better but sometimes it gets triggered. Adora hates it when she does, feeling so angry that she loses control is now a huge fear of hers. Still, she may be angry right now but she is not out of control. Her tea is cold though, and she feels bitter about this line of questioning. "Was this a plan to break us up? I know you Princesses are probably dying for a way to break us up." Adora says bitterly.

"And why do you say that Adora?" Perfuma asks. "Are you paranoid?" If Adora were Catra, her fur would have stood on end. Instead, she bristles, visibly recoiling from the question.

"I am *not* paranoid!" Adora yells before she huffs angrily. "I thought therapy was supposed to be good? Not cause more harm than good?" Adora asks.

"I'm simply asking a question." Adora scoffs.

"The Princesses *hate* me, don't pretend like they're not just waiting for the opportunity to break Catra and I up." Adora says. "That is not paranoia, that is fact."

"They're Catra's friends."

"Hardly." Adora bites her lip before she laughs - though it lacks humour. "Catra has few friends because of me."

"Because of you?"

" *Yes* !" Adora yells. She is getting frustrated from the questions which is sparking not only her anger but triggering her other issues. "Catra's friends did what they did because she wanted to be with me! No me, they'd still be her friends."

"Have you talked about this with Catra?" Perfuma asks softly and Adora sighs a little at her tone. It is gentle enough that Adora feels a little more at ease.

"Yes."

"And what did she say?"

"She said that wasn't my fault either."

"But you still feel like it is?"

"Of course I do!" Adora clenches her hands and then uncurls them. "It's not... Catra... She'd still have all her friends if not for me. So of course I think it's my fault." Adora explains.

"How do you feel, Adora? Really?"

"I'm scared!" Adora bursts and her eyes sting with tears. She takes a stuttering breath but now that the floodgates are open, Adora just *talks* . "I'm scared of letting Catra down. I'm scared of not being enough." Adora slumps, looking at her hands. "I'm scared of failing her."

"Failing her." It isn't a question and Adora hates it. She fiddles with her fingers for a moment before she sighs and looks up at Perfuma.

"I love Catra, so much, and I love Finn, but I am... I'm terrified of failing them, of being a failure." She admits. "It always comes back to her, doesn't it?" Adora asks, referring to Shadow Weaver of course. "I was always so scared of failing her, of losing her love *because* I failed her."

"And you think you'll lose Catra's love if you fail?" Perfuma asks and Adora nods. "How could you fail her?" She asks. Adora frowns in confusion as she looks up to stare at the Princess.

"What?" Adora asks because she really has no idea what that means.

"How can you fail someone by loving them?" Perfuma asks.

"By hurting her," Adora answers. She had thought that was a pretty obvious answer but apparently not. "Or letting her down."

"But how?" Perfuma repeats. "The only way you could probably fail Catra now is by going back to your old ways, telling her you don't love her or by abandoning her and Finn." Adora winces a little at the mere thought of that. "You can never fail someone by loving them. People make mistakes, Adora, that doesn't make them a failure. You might make mistakes, but Catra won't think you're a failure, more than likely she will forgive you, especially if you apologise." Adora knows that Perfuma is right.

"But... I don't want to make mistakes."

"It's human." Perfuma says with a smile. "We all do it, you shouldn't be afraid."

"I'm not afraid I..." Adora struggles to find the words. "I just don't want to. I want everything for Catra to be perfect." Perfuma sighs.

"You need to lower your expectations," Perfuma says and that feels a little harsh to Adora but she listens anyway. "You need to stop being so hard on yourself. It'll take you years to get there, I know that. When you spend the entirety of your life with someone, as you are with Catra, you *will* hurt each other, even if you don't mean to. The only thing that matters is that you apologise."

"But I don't want to."

"No one wants to hurt the people they love, Adora." Perfuma says. "If you did, then I'd be concerned. Communication is key, so long as you have that, you could never fail Catra." Adora takes a deep breath. She knew what Perfuma was saying made sense but she also couldn't quite accept it. She was right, it would take years for her to unlearn all the shit Shadow Weaver did to her, but she could at least start.

"I want you to make a list." Perfuma says and Adora looks at her with a raised brow. "A list of things you want to accomplish. What's something you want to do?" Adora thinks about it for a moment.

"Well, I did want to learn more about She-Ra, but the Rebellion has my sword." Adora points out. "But... I wonder if I can figure out how to transform into her without the sword." Adora says.

"Ooo! Perhaps meditation will help you." Perfuma suggests. Adora doubts it but she guesses it's something she could try if all else fails. "It will help you connect with your inner-self,

your inner-spirit, She-Ra." Perfuma says enthusiastically. Right. Adora just gives her an awkward thumbs up.

"Are we done here now?" Adora asks. Perfuma nods her head. Adora stands and makes her way towards the door before she pauses. "You know, I think Scorpia would like you a lot." Adora says before she exits the room.

She's immediately flanked by guards as she walks down the hallways. It still feels weird to walk without her armour or her cape, she was still dressed in her Horde fatigues, the red symbol bold on the back of her white shirt, marking her out as *Horde* . Adora didn't really care. She liked her fatigues, they were comfortable and familiar, but she still felt like an impostor, like she was walking in enemy territory, like she didn't belong.

They hadn't left Bright Moon since the trial simply because Catra had been healing and Adora still had to swear her allegiance publicly. They stayed in Catra's room - which is where she stayed while visiting apparently. Someone had removed the bars across the balcony, which was kind of them (sarcasm), Finn slept in a cot in their room when they weren't sleeping on Adora. Catra apparently still had Princess duties despite the fact she gave birth about two weeks ago - maybe a little more.

Whenever she had to do things, Adora was left alone with Finn. She loved that baby so much, she didn't think it was possible to love something so much. Adora smiles at the memory of her changing the little kit and blowing raspberries on their stomach to make them laugh when Catra had come in. Adora had told Catra that they were her favourite. "They're our only child." Catra had said and Adora had grinned. "They're still my favourite." Catra had called her a dork after that. Adora may not be the Lord of the Horde anymore, but she would do anything to protect her family. They'd been through hell to get to where they were, they could finally be happy together.

Adora pauses before she turns to the guards. "Will you show me to the gardens?" She asks. "I have some time before the... thing... And I'd like to spend it meditating." Adora figured she could give Perfuma's advice a shot. The guards look at each other before they nod. Adora follows them towards the gardens. She really wanted to figure She-Ra out.

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Adora admits, when Perfuma had first suggested it, she had thought it was a pretty dumb idea. But now, as she sat under a tree in the Bright Moon gardens, listening to the gentle breeze around her and the sound of gentle flowing water, Adora felt a strange kind of peace. Maybe meditating wasn't such a bad idea after all. She was trying to connect to her inner-self, to transform into *She-Ra,* without her sword. She'd done it before (kind of) and she wanted to try to do it again. It required her full concentration and she was enjoying the tranquillity.

That was until something just dropped in her lap and started *purring* . Adora's eyes flicker open to see Catra had just plonked herself right into her lap. "Whatcha doing?" She asks and Adora huffs.

"I'm trying to *concentrate* ." Adora says pointedly. "Did you really have to sit right in my lap?"

"Sure did." Catra says, unbothered as she boops Adora on her nose with her tail. Adora sighs and closes her eyes again, but she's very aware of the Catra sitting in her *lap* .

"Where is our child?" Adora asks, eyes still closed but she could feel Catra purring and her tail kept hitting her jaw.

"Oh, I abandoned them, obviously."

"Wait, really?" Adora asks, opening her eyes.

"Of course not, dummy!" Catra exclaims. "Who do you take me for?" She asks and Adora grabs hold of her tail before it can hit her in the face again.

"My fiancee," Adora answers. "Soon to be wife, mother of my child, light of my life-"

"Uh huh, suck up." Catra interrupts. Adora sighs as she moves her hand down Catra's tail. "What are you doing exactly?" Catra asks curiously. Adora stays quiet for a moment, just

playing with Catra's tail as she contemplates if she should tell Catra or not.

"I want to… When we…" Adora clears her throat a little. "When we had sex that one time and I was able to transform into She-Ra, do you remember that?" Catra nods her head. "I didn't use my words, you know, For the Honour of Grayskull, and I guess I did have my sword on me… *technically* . I just want to know if I can maybe summon She-Ra without it. I mean, I have been glowing a lot recently. Perfuma suggested meditating, getting in touch with my inner-self."

"Correct me if I'm wrong," Catra says. "But you glow whenever you're feeling something… intense, right?" Catra asks and Adora nods. "Then maybe meditating won't work. How do you feel if we try something else?" Catra asks. Adora purses her lips before she shrugs. She guesses she could let Catra try something else.

"Close your eyes for me." Catra instructs. Adora raises an eyebrow, because she's pretty sure she just had her eyes closed not so long ago, but she follows Catra's instructions and closes her eyes for her. Adora waits for further instructions but they never come, all that comes are Catra's *lips* .

Catra *kisses* her and Adora lets out a soft moan of satisfaction to be allowed to kiss her fiancee. That reminds her, she totally has to introduce Catra as her ex-girlfriend and mother of her child at some point. It was technically true, they were ex-girlfriends, fiancees and soon they would be wives. *Concentrate Adora* ! Right, she was kissing Catra. Adora *loves* kissing Catra.

Adora lifts her hands to gently cup Catra's face as she moves her lips softly against Catra's. Catra leans back a little. "I love you Adora," Catra whispers, her hot breath brushes against Adora's lips as she speaks and Adora instinctively licks her lips in response. "I love you so much." She murmurs. Adora goes to return the words but Catra *tugs* on her ponytail and shushes her. That shouldn't turn Adora on as much as it does. "Good girl, Adora." Catra coos and Adora shudders. When Catra kisses her again it's a little more *roughly* . She nips at Adora's bottom lip with her sharp fangs and Adora moans. "My Lord." Adora doesn't know if this is Catra's plan, but she feels like she's purposely trying to turn her on.

Catra skilfully slides her tongue into Adora's mouth and pulls her hair. Adora always loves the way that Catra tastes, that is never going to get old. Catra pulls back and kisses Adora along her jaw before she moves down to her neck. At first, she just brushes her fangs over her

skin before she *bites* Adora right on her pulse point. “ *Holy shit* -” Adora gasps before Catra lifts her hand to cover Adora’s mouth. She bites *harder,* and sucks, and Adora knows absolutely that it’s going to bruise but she’s pretty sure that’s what Catra’s plan was all along: to *mark* Adora.

Catra pushes Adora backwards and Adora lands with a soft ‘ *oof* ’ in the grass as Catra continues to bite her neck. She stops only to run her tongue soothingly over the mark and then move to another spot on Adora’s neck to mark. She moves her thigh between Adora’s legs and Adora lets out a sort of strangled sound of surprise and arousal. Adora’s breathing has gone up exponentially. They’re so exposed out here, all it would take is for someone to glance out of the window and see them, and something about that *excites* Adora. Then everyone would know that Catra is *hers* .

"I love you, Catra." Adora says, now that her mouth isn't *full* , and Catra can't pull on her hair - Adora can actually speak. Catra does bite her harder though, nipping skin between her teeth. Adora *squirms* as Catra's thigh presses her in just the right way and her hands tangle their way into Catra's hair. Adora really can't believe that she got here. Who would've thought at Princess Prom that she'd end up at Bright Moon getting pleasured by her fiancee who was also a Princess? Past Adora never would have seen this coming.

Catra’s tongue licks over Adora's skin on her neck before she pulls back. "My Adora." She whispers, nibbling along Adora's jawline. "Be a good girl for me." And Catra does that sexy thing she does with her voice where she *purrs* her words. Adora is practically soaked by this point. Catra really knew how to work Adora up.

Adora felt a little… weird as Catra continued to kiss her and Adora rocked her hips up to grind against her thigh. She felt tingly all over, but it was a good feeling, if a little intense. "Like that Adora," Catra encourages, her voice low and laced with a low rumble that has Adora bucking her hips. "Just a little more." Catra whispers, her tail wrapping around Adora's leg. Adora doesn't know what Catra means but she feels hot suddenly and then the next, Catra stops.

Adora blinks her eyes open to see Catra looking down at her with a smug smile. Adora tilts her head to the side in question as Catra's smile turns into a sharp grin. "You did it." She says. Adora raises her eyebrows.

"Not yet I didn't, I needed at least a few more minutes." Adora says, only a little annoyed.

"Not that, Dummy." Catra says, poking Adora on her forehead playfully. "She-Ra." Adora looks down at herself to see that she was no longer in her Horde fatigues but was in the soft white and gold of She-Ra. She looks back up at Catra in amazement before she frowns. She rolls them over so Catra is below her.

“Did you really just edge me to get me to transform?” Adora asks in disbelief with Catra pinned below her, looking up at her with a grin.

“It worked, didn’t it?” Catra asks. “I’d finish you off but… we’re in *public* .”

“I don’t care.” Adora says quickly and Catra laughs.

“I am not making you cum in the Bright Moon gardens with guards literally standing right over there, watching.” Catra says, inching her head towards the guards who were actually *not* watching. Adora sighs and then sits up, pulling Catra so she was upright too.

"I can't believe you." Adora says, shaking her head.

"Relax, I'll finish you off some other time." Catra says, patting Adora on her cheek playfully. "But, wow, you really were close weren't you?"

"I want a divorce."

"We're not even married yet!" Catra protests and Adora smiles a little.

"Fine, then maybe just kiss me again." Adora says. "As reparations." Catra rolls her eyes and then lifts her hands up. She grabs the golden wings of She-Ra's helmet and then drags her down to kiss her again.

Adora doesn't know how long they spend there, just kissing, but it's a while. The kisses aren't as hot and heavy as the ones Catra was doing before, these are soft, gentle, kisses you're meant to *feel* . Once Catra is done, she leans back and Adora gives her a dopey smile. "How long until I can touch you again?" Adora asks. Catra lets out a soft breath somewhere between disbelief and amusement.

"Couple more weeks, maybe more, not sure." She answers as she pulls She-Ra's crown off of her head and places it on her own head. "You do realise we have a baby too, right? We can't just have sex whenever we want."

"We just *had* sex." Adora reminds her and Catra rolls her eyes. "Sure, you didn't let me finish, but sex all the same."

"Finn is being watched by Spinnerella and Netossa." Catra says as she loops her arms around Adora's neck. "Are you okay?" She asks. Adora tilts her head to the side in silent question. "Was therapy okay?" She clarifies. "And are you ready to… fully surrender, officially?"

"I'm okay, Catra," Adora says quietly. She squeezes her hands around Catra and kisses her on her jaw affectionately. "I have to do this to cement our alliance and… therapy was good, boring, you don't need to hear about it." Adora also doesn't want to tell her about it. It's not that she distrusts Catra, or anything like that, she just doesn't want to burden Catra with all of that… stuff.

Catra looks at her for a long moment before she shrugs. Her hands reach up to thread their way into She-Ra's hair. "Your hair as She-Ra is a lot longer, kind of the length your ponytail was as Adora before you cut your hair." Adora smiles a little before she melts into Catra's touch.

"I love you," Adora whispers. "Please never forget that." Catra pauses and her eyes flicker to Adora's.

"Are you planning on going somewhere? Or doing something stupid?" Catra asks. Adora smiles as she leans down to kiss Catra again.

"How can I do anything stupid? I have you." Adora says with a gentle smile. Catra laughs a little.

"You do have me."

"Forever."

"Always." Catra confirms. "Promise?" Catra asks, looking up at Adora.

"I promise." Adora whispers. At first she hadn't really been sure about marriage, she didn't exactly know what it was, but it was basically just like a big public promise, and that was something Adora could do and that she wanted to do.

Catra picks She-Ra's crown back up and places it back on Adora's head. "Thank you," Adora says. "For helping me."

"Even if I edged you?" Catra asks with a sly grin and an eyebrow wiggle.

"Oh no, I'm totally going to get you back for that." Adora says nonchalantly. Catra looks at her.

"No you're not." She states, so assured. Adora stares at her in disbelief.

"Why not?"

"Because you're incapable of edging someone, Adora," Catra says with a laugh. Adora is slightly offended if she's honest.

"That's not true, I've edged you before." Adora says defensively. Catra seems to consider that.

"True," She admits. "But you've never denied me." Adora scoffs a little at that. She leans forward to kiss Catra again. Catra was probably right, Adora isn't sure she could deny Catra anything.

Adora sighs and leans back. She closes her eyes and feels herself relax. When she opens her eyes again, she's back to her regular self. Catra reaches her hand up and traces her fingers over the scars on Adora's jaw. Adora leans her face into Catra's hand and then she kisses her palm. "I'm okay, Catra," Adora says. "It really didn't hurt that bad."

"She's such a hypocrite." Catra says as she drops her hand. She looks angry but that isn't really that surprising when the topic is C'yra. "She talks about the evil Horde, but I doubt you guys beat up prisoners." Adora stays quiet for a moment.

"Not… Not usually." Adora says. "But I… I did kind of… almost kill Shadow Weaver after the battle here."

"That's *different* ." Catra says. Adora doesn't want to argue with Catra so she simply just shrugs her shoulders. "How can she expect peace to last if she isn't willing to see how you've changed? If she won't stop hating you."

"It'll take time, Catra," Adora says, remembering Perfuma's words at their therapy session. "But things will get better. We just have to be patient."

"Since when have you been patient?" Catra asks, a little playfully. Adora lets out a soft laugh.

"I don't know what it is," Adora speaks slowly as her fingers touch the grass below her. "Maybe it's the fact that I'm a mom now, or maybe it's that we can finally be together, but I feel… I feel balanced, free? I feel… Good. I'm *happy* ." Catra smiles and kisses Adora on her cheek.

Their moment is interrupted by the guards approaching them, clearing their throats loudly to signal their approach. "Lord Adora," They say. Adora admits that she likes that she is still recognised as *Lord* Adora, she thinks she would miss the title. "Princess C'yra, it's time for Lord Adora's official and public surrender." They say. Adora sighs. Catra stands from Adora's lap and then offers her hand to Adora.

"You ready?" She asks. Adora stares at her hand before she takes it, standing up.

"Ready." Adora nods at Catra. Catra pulls her close. Catra is so small compared to Adora's height and Adora *loves* it.

"I love you, Adora," Catra says quietly. "I'll be watching you the whole time. You can do this." Catra's words of encouragement are all Adora needs. She knows that Catra knows how hard this is for Adora - for her to submit to the Rebellion fully. There was no going back after this, and that was slightly terrifying. But she really was ready. It was time to close this chapter once and for all and start her new one as Finn's mom and Catra's wife.

Adora nods again and then Catra turns towards the guards. "Look after her, or so help me." She says as she walks past them. Adora *beams* . She loves Catra so much.

She could do this. She *could* .

* * *

Adora huffs as she's led by guards towards where the Rebellion Princesses were waiting. People had come to see the mighty Horde Lord submit. Adora didn't really understand why Glimmer, or the others, wanted all of these theatrics when they'd already let her wander the castle, albeit under guard, but she supposes it's probably to humiliate her in front of everyone else.

People boo at her, some even manage to shove her, before Adora's 'guards' can restrain them. Adora's very aware that pretty much everyone in that crowd wants her dead, but the sooner

she gets this over with, the sooner she can start her new life, with Catra.

Catra .

Adora is deposited in front of the Princesses, Glimmer and Angella at the front. She's shoved onto her knees, which she grunts at, before she looks up. Glimmer looks far too smug for Adora's liking. "Princess Shimmer- I mean, Glimmer, Queen Angella." Adora greets as the guards unlock her cuffs. "Fancy seeing you two here." Glimmer narrows her eyes at Adora, clearly wanting to insult her but she manages to bite back her tongue when her mother places a hand on her shoulder.

"Lord Adora." Glimmer starts off, loud and clear to get the attention of everyone in the crowd. "You stand before Etheria with the promise that you will swear your allegiance to the Alliance. Your past transgressions were taken into account during the trial and, due to additional information provided, you have been allowed to live." Glimmer pauses. Catra watches from the balcony, biting her lip as she looks at Adora. Adora was slightly worried that someone in the crowd would do something. It was obvious that they all held disdain for her. She just hoped that Glimmer would get this over with quickly.

"However, in order to do so, you have been placed under multiple conditions. One of which consists of you pledging your allegiance to the Rebellion and to the Alliance. So please, begin your pledge." Glimmer says. Her eyes are full of smugness and Adora hates this. She hates this so much. It is *embarrassing* and *demeaning* but it’s also *necessary* .

Adora sighs. She could do this. She could do this... *Right* ? Adora looks at Glimmer with a scowl. She was taking far too much enjoyment out of this. Adora pushes herself up a little so she’s kneeling on one knee rather than both. Truth be told, she felt exposed without her cape and her armour. That stuff wasn't just for protection, it gave her status, authority, and now she was just... plain old Adora.

Adora looks up and she catches sight of Catra on the balcony, watching. She feels herself relax, she smiles. *She could do this.* Catra was worth more than her pride, she wanted to be with Catra and that meant making peace with the Rebellion. Besides, everything that she had been taught by the Horde was a lie. Catra is the truth, Catra would never lie to her. Why should she hold herself to a lie when she can move forward in truth and honesty with Catra. She loves her, and that's all that matters.

Adora looks back at Glimmer. "I..." She starts, then pauses. "I, Lord Adora, pledge my loyalty to the Rebellion. From this day forward the Horde will no longer attack Rebellion land. I pledge peace and friendship and surrender myself to your terms." Adora speaks confidently, clearly and then she looks at Catra again. Her heart picks up in her chest as she holds *Catra's* gaze.

"I promise I will never hurt you... all... again. I will be the best I possibly can be, I will give myself entirely to you, for the rest of my life because I..." Adora pauses, realising she wasn't exactly supposed to be speaking to *Catra* , though that's what she'd strayed into doing. "I trust the Rebellion, and I realise now that I was wrong." She says before looking back at Catra. "The Princesses are not violent, they're not dangerous. They are kind, and soft, and understanding, and patient, and… *forgiving* . I want to learn to be more like that. And I... I pledge my sword as She-Ra." Glimmer watches Adora smugly before she seems to look angry. She'd clearly noticed that Adora's pledge had not been to the Rebellion, but to Catra, and that obviously displeased her.

Catra smiles brightly at her Adora anyway, showing how proud of her she was in that moment. Adora wanted to kiss her, to hold her, to promise these things to her in whispers, but she was stuck here. Catra seems to be longing too and she turns away and heads off of the balcony.

Adora looks at Glimmer when Catra disappears and her smile falls just a little. She can't tell if Glimmer is angrier than before or not. "Adora," Angella says and Adora looks at her. "Please stand up." Adora stands to her feet and looks at the Queen in question. "The Rebellion welcomes second chances, as She-Ra, you are a Princess, we hope that you will keep your word."

"I will." Adora says, without a doubt. "I swear it." Plus, Adora was going to *marry* Catra, she couldn't exactly break her word even if she wanted to. But she doesn't. She actually *wants* to make peace. Adora is tired of fighting, she's been tired of fighting since Shadow Weaver used her to take Hordak out, she deserves to be happy with the woman she loves.

"Very well," Angella says. She turns to Bright Moon and Adora steps beside her, turning to look out at the crowd. "From this day forward Lord Adora and the Horde are no more, the Lord has agreed to help repair what she broke, and other just punishments have been placed on her. From this day forward, the war is no more." The crowd cheer for their Queen despite obvious hesitance towards accepting Adora.

Once Adora is given the go ahead she leaves Angella and the others and goes to track down Catra. She doesn't need to do much tracking down though. Catra herself had made her way towards where they had been, so it simply was a matter of turning around. "Hey Adora." She says with a sweet smile. Adora's eyes widen and then she smiles.

"Catra..." She picks the other woman up in her arms and spins her around a little before kissing her. Catra laughs happily.

"Dork, put me down." She says, purring softly as their lips meet. "I'm really proud of you. You did great, love." She places a kiss on Adora's forehead, holding her close.

"You think so?" Adora asks. "I think Glimmer was liking that a little too much. Feels wrong to get on my knees for anyone who isn't you." Catra rolls her eyes at Adora’s innuendo.

"You know how she is. You did really great though." She whispers, nuzzling Adora. "I heard you loud and clear. What you did was so romantic. Even if you didn't do it intentionally."

"There you go calling me romantic again."

"You are. You're becoming so romantic. I love it."

"I meant it.” Adora says seriously. “I want to spend the rest of my life with you. I want to be with you forever and beyond."

“I know. I love you so much." Catra whispers, cupping Adora's cheek and bringing their lips together again in a soft kiss. Adora’s heart feels completely full. They were here, they’d made it. Adora had made peace with the Alliance, there was no more war.

"How soon do you want to make another baby?" Adora asks playfully.

"Adora, we're still in public."

"Huh, so we are." Adora says. "My question still stands."

"When Finn is a little older."

"Okay," Adora kisses Catra again. "I... Can we talk?" Adora asks.

"Yes, of course. Do you want to go talk in private?" Adora nods as she places Catra back down onto her feet. "Okay, then let's go, my love." Catra kisses Adora's cheek and offers her arm. Adora takes her arm happily and begins walking away with Catra.

"Guess I'm officially a Rebel?" Adora says.

"It wouldn't really be considered a Rebel since the Horde is gone now. So just my fiancee." Adora feels butterflies in her stomach whenever Catra calls her her fiancee. She never thought that this was ever going to happen. Adora was going to be a *wife* .

"I suppose that's true." Adora admits. She'd rather be Catra's fiancee than a Rebel anyway.

"I don't think that's too bad though, right?" Catra asks quietly.

"No, not too bad. I feel bad for you though, you're stuck with me."

"You feel bad for me? If anything, I'm pretty lucky, I'd say." Catra responds. Adora pauses for a moment as she considers if she should bring this up. This was the thing that Adora wanted to talk about. She glances at Catra before she decides to just talk to her. Adora is getting better at talking about things anyway.

"Catra... People will probably judge you for marrying me." Adora begins.

"And? Let them judge. I want to be with you, Adora. I love you, no one can stop me from loving you." Catra says without hesitation. Adora smiles before she looks away anxiously.

"I just worry." Adora says. "You're a Queen, or you will be, I worry that your people will... hold it against you that you married the Lord of the Horde." It was a valid concern if you asked Adora. She was worried that the people of Half-Moon might even *reject* Catra's rule because of Adora. She had already taken so much from Catra, she didn't want to take more.

"Look, I know it'll take time for people to warm up to you. I'm fully aware of that. It took me time to warm up to you at first too. But I won't become Queen for quite a while, I'm sure that'll give them enough time to get to know you without the armor on." *Time* . There was that word again. Time heals all wounds, or something like that.

"It took you time to warm up to me?" Adora asks with a raised brow. "I hope you're not suggesting I sleep with your people to win them over." Adora jokes.

"Of course not! I mean that it took me time to get to know you. Not the Horde Lord you that was all about fighting. I got to know that softer you. The loving you. The caring you. It'll take time for others to see that too." Adora still doesn't think all of that is true, but she's learnt that disagreeing with Catra on those kind of things is often futile.

"I still don't understand how you fell in love with me, but I'm glad that you did." Catra smiles at her.

"You know, I don't think anyone, not even ourselves, would have ever thought that we'd fall in love with each other. But love works in weird ways."

"You spent all that time talking about finding the person you click with and... I mean, we'd spent so much time together, I figured if you felt that with me, you would've said something." Adora says.

"I think that I was in denial about it for a while. It's like, what was going on through my head was, 'She's my enemy. There's no way that what I'm feeling is anything but sexual.' It took me a while to understand my own feelings." Catra explains. Adora smiles a little at that.

"I can understand," Adora says. "because I thought the exact same thing." Catra snickers.

"We were both in denial. I think everyone that knew about our... affair, had figured it out before we did." Catra comments. That was true. Adora remembers Lonnie calling her out on her feelings. And Catra told her about what Netossa and Spinnerella said to her. They had been in such deep denial.

"Where's Finn? I miss their chubby cheeks." Adora says, changing the topic.

"They're with Spinny and ‘Tossa right now." Catra reminds Adora before she smiles a bit and then frowns. "They're the only ones aside from Bow that I trust with Finn right now."

"After everything? I don't blame you." Adora says, leaning down to kiss Catra on her cheek. Catra purrs softly.

"Yeah. At least we have some people here that we can fully trust. Spinny and ‘Tossa were the ones who helped me see you and kept things a secret when they found out." She whispers softly. "And Bow... I remembered him trying to get my moms to listen when they flipped out, when Double Trouble told them everything." Adora clenches her jaw at Catra's words. That was when she had almost lost Catra.

She stops walking for a moment, stopping in the hallway. She looks around to see that they were alone. "I wanted to talk about that… about our future."

"Of course, what is it?"

"Well, the Horde is improving, but the Fright Zone isn't exactly the best place to raise a baby. Things are tense with your moms and, like you said, you won't be taking over as Queen for a

while. We could stay in Bright Moon but, again, tensions, and the fact that pretty much everyone here hates my guts." Adora says. "I figured, maybe we could make our own home? Somewhere which is just ours?"

"You want to... move out?"

"I want to live with *you* , wherever." Adora says, kissing Catra's hands. "You are my home. Wherever you are. But it would be nice to have our own place."

"I'd like that." Catra responds after contemplating it for a few seconds. "A place to call our own. A place where Finn can grow up where they'll be happy and know they're loved."

"Mhmm..." Adora says with fondness. "We can mark their height on a door frame as they grow up."

"That would be adorable." Catra whispers, hugging Adora. "When would you like to start planning it out?"

"I mean, as soon as possible." Adora says. "Unless Glimmer wants to put an ankle monitor on me."

"I would hope not. Let me see what I can do and where we can move into."

"Now, can you take me to my other baby? I could use kitten cuddles." Catra giggles and grabs Adora's hand, pulling her along to where Spinnerella and Netossa were staying.

* * *

Catra was so proud of Adora, she had fully surrendered, she'd made peace, swore her allegiance and now she wanted to make them a *home* . After everything they had been

through, things were finally starting to look *up* . She leads Adora along the hallways towards where Spinnerella and Netossa were staying. She knocks on the door, waiting for them to tell them to enter and then opening it. "Hey Spinny, hi ‘Tossa. We're here to pick up Finn."

"You'll have to wrangle them from Spinny." Netossa jokes. Adora laughs a little as she walks into the room. She walks straight to Spinnerella who was holding Finn in her arms.

"You two sure make incredibly cute babies." Spinnerella comments with a big smile as she passes Finn over to Adora. Adora sighs happily when she has Finn in her arms and Catra watches lovingly. That’s her *family* .

"That's all Catra." Adora says. "Finn got all of Catra's cuteness." Adora gently cradles her baby in her arms with a happy smile. "They're going to be a heartbreaker in the future." Catra smiles tenderly as she looks at her girlfriend holding their kitten so gently. It always made her heart skip a beat at the sight.

"Thank you for taking such good care of Finn while we were busy, Spinnerella, Netossa. It means a lot to us." Catra says gratefully, nodding at them. "I felt a lot more comfortable knowing that Finn was safe with people we trust."

"Of course, Finn is an angel." Spinnerella says. "They're so well behaved."

"And we knew you were both otherwise engaged. So we were happy to watch them." Netossa watches Adora carefully and then leans in to whisper to Catra. "She really is a gentle giant, especially with Finn."

"I know, I just wish more people would see that." Catra smiles sadly as she says that. Adora is one of the sweetest people that Catra has ever met, her heart is so big and she loves so deeply. No one wanted to see that though. "Thank you for giving her a chance, and for being so supportive and accepting."

"We'll help you guys out as much as you need." Netossa says. "Besides, I believe Adora wants nothing more than to be with her family. I mean, look at her." Catra nods, watching her

fiancee tickle their kitten, making Finn burst into happy giggles. Catra doesn’t think there is anything more heartwarming on Etheria than that sight.

"I know. You should have seen her when she was pledging her allegiance. It was really sweet because it was more directed towards me." She whispers, her cheeks covered in a happy flush. "Her and I... We're actually considering moving out, into our own home until I have to take the throne."

"That's probably a good idea actually." Netossa admits. "A lot of people don't like Adora, even after her apology and pledge. Being away from people so you three can be safe and happy is smart. Plus, if you're close to Bright Moon, Adora can easily perform her little punishment terms."

"I know, that was one of our concerns. That and making sure Finn actually has a loving environment to grow up in." Catra frowns, looking away sadly. "That's something that they won't be able to have fully living in any castle."

"Not strictly true," Netossa says. "The Horde loves Adora, and you. They'd love Finn too. And, as Adora makes up for her actions, the others will come around and all this tension around Adora will slowly fade away, and Finn can grow up without a worry and be loved no matter where they are."

"The Horde loves Finn." Catra says, eyes on her mate playing with Finn and Spinnerella making funny faces at the kitten. "I imagine they’d probably treat them like the heir. I know the Rebellion likes to think Adora is a heartless monster, but she cares about her people, and they care about her. I bet they’d be thrilled to have us there, unlike this place." She whispers. "We didn't get anything from here, aside from you guys and Bow giving us something. I think my mom tried but mama didn't want her to." She shrugs.

"Kids… Babies can easily pick up on behaviour like that. When the people around them don't care for them, they know. I don't want them to ever have to feel that if I can avoid it, Netossa. That feeling of not being wanted for something you can't control. It sticks with you." Catra says, her eyes glassy as she recalls what happened before she ran off. Adora was the perfect example too, all her trauma from a maternal figure as a child. Catra wanted Finn to feel nothing but love.

Netossa smiles sadly and places her hand on Catra's shoulder, squeezing in a comforting way. "Things will get better. Your moms, they love you, so do the rest of the Rebellion. They just need some time to... understand your choices and to get to know Adora better."

"I know, but sometimes it really makes me wonder if I want their love if it's conditional." Catra murmurs, shaking her head. "They can have all the time in the world now to figure it out when Adora and I move out." Adora comes over to Catra with Finn in her arms and beams.

"Catra, look, they have their tiny hand wrapped around my finger." Catra's glassy eyes shine from *happiness* this time.

"That's so cute. Look at our little baby, so precious." She purrs happily, stepping towards Adora and giving her a kiss. "Wanna go to our room so Finn can play with their toys?"

"Yeah," Adora says and then she pauses. "Are you okay?"

"I'm okay. Thank you for asking though." Catra answers. She kisses Adora on her jaw.

"Look at them," Adora says with a smile. "Can you believe we made them?"

"If it weren't for the fact I carried them for nine months, probably not." Catra laughs, giving Finn a kiss on their little forehead too. "Shall we go?"

"We shall." Adora says with a smile. "Thank you, Netossa and Spinnerella, for taking care of our little one."

"Of course. Whenever you need us to take care of Finn, just let us know." Spinnerella smiles at them. "Have a good day, you three." Adora nods and exits the room with Catra.

"Are you sure you're okay?" Adora asks. "Do you need kitten cuddles?" Catra lets out a soft laugh at that question.

"Kitten cuddles would be great." Catra holds her arms up to receive Finn. "Our little baby. I love you, Finn."

" *We* love them." Adora says as she places her hand to the base of Catra's spine - it sends sparks shooting up and down Catra's back. "I'm really glad they exist."

"Me too."

"Hey uh..." Adora awkwardly shuffles a little. "Your mom wants to have dinner with us."

"Is that a joke?" Catra asks in disbelief.

"No... Luna asked me."

"When?" Catra asks as she holds Finn close to her. She thinks it's messed up that she can't even believe that her moms just want to have dinner with her. It's messed up that Catra is *afraid* to have dinner with them.

"She said sometime next week." Adora answers. Catra raises an eyebrow.

"Why can't I believe that?"

"Catra... I don't want to be the reason that you don't talk to your moms."

"You aren't the reason." Catra interrupts. She's told Adora this before but she never seems to believe her. "Forgive me for not wanting to speak to the parent that demanded I abort the

child that I'm currently holding in my arms. That's not something you easily forgive." Adora stays silent for a moment, just staring ahead. So Catra decides to carry on. “She wanted me to get rid of ‘the monster spawn’ if I was to stay in Half-Moon. So, I found it hard to believe that my moms want to have dinner with us."

"Monster spawn..." Adora repeats with a frown. "Still, I mean, if we want things to get better we should make an effort too, right? It's just eating some food." Catra sighs. She loves Adora, but sometimes she is dense on things like this. But she is right. Adora is right that nothing will get better unless they try too - unless *Catra* tries, Adora is already trying her best - but Catra needs that effort to be returned by C’yra.

"Fine. But I'm only going because you're suggesting we go." Adora smiles and kisses Catra on her temple which almost makes it worth it.

"Okay babe." Adora says fondly. Catra purrs softly.

"Did you tell them what day?"

"I wanted to see if you'd even agree."

"I'm agreeing... kind of. I'm not happy about it, but I'm doing it for you." Catra wants Adora to feel welcome here, and for that to happen Catra needs to set her mommy issues aside and get through dinner with them. Still, Adora hadn’t set a date, so she still had time to change her mind if she wished - or not go at all.

"I love you." Adora says happily. "What day works best for you, love?"

"Any day should be fine. Since we're not really doing much aside from taking care of Finn at the moment." Catra responds. “But… Maybe give it a few weeks.”

"I think we've earned the right to just look after our kitten." Adora says. "I'll look into setting up a date."

"Yeah, we have, and our little kitten needs us to be here for them.” Catra says. After the past few months, Catra was enjoying just being a family with Adora. Things weren’t great with her family, or even her friends, but things with Adora were… Amazing. It was everything she wanted and more - minus the guards that followed them everywhere.

"Hm..." Adora says thoughtfully. Catra doesn’t know what she’s thinking but she can see her eyes light up in thought. Catra smiles a little at that before Adora turns to her. "So, our room?"

"Yeah, our room. We can cuddle with our little Finn." Catra says and Adora kisses her again. Things weren’t perfect but Catra didn’t care. As long as she had Adora.

* * *

“Princess C’yra!” Catra turns when she hears her name being called out, along with her title. She was currently on a walk with Finn and she hadn’t expected to be interrupted - especially not as loudly as she was being. It was a guard, but not just any guard, *Adora’s* guard, one of them anyway. “It’s Lord Adora, she’s been hurt-” Catra doesn’t hear the rest of the guard’s words after that. Everything seems to blur together as her legs start moving and she runs to where she knew Adora was working that day.

This was her worst fear. She knew it was risky, usually Adora was with Bow but Catra knew that Bow was busy today so it was just Adora and the townspeople. Her guards don’t care about her. The worst case scenario comes to her mind, the thought of Adora possibly being *dead* spurs her on quickly. She wakes Finn from their slumber with her erratic movements and she can hear her heartbeat pounding in her ears.

When she reaches the clearing where construction was being done she sees a huddle of people and a guard standing between them and she can see Adora’s boots. “Adora?!” Catra yells desperately. The crowd art for the Princess as Catra pushes her way through them.

“Catra?” Adora looks up with a wince and a whimper. Catra breathes a sigh of relief as she sits down beside her. She had a black eye and a small cut on her head, she was possibly concussed but other than that… She was *okay* . Finn was crying in Catra’s arms and she

handed them carefully to Adora who seemed dazed but still capable of holding their baby correctly.

Catra reaches her hands up to inspect Adora's injuries. "What the hell happened?" Catra whispers, still panicked. Adora shushes Finn and then she smiles at Catra reassuringly but it doesn't quite meet her eyes.

"I'm okay," She says. "Can you help me up?" Catra wants to point out that if she was really 'okay' then she wouldn't need help standing but she chooses to not point that out and just help Adora to her feet. She wobbles a little before she straightens up. Catra whirls on the crowd angrily.

"Now... who wants to step up and tell me to my face that they've hit my fiancee?" Catra asks angrily. All the townspeople shuffle and murmur and Catra narrows her eyes at them. This is *exactly* what she was afraid of: sure the Princesses had to play nice, they were practically bound to by the treaty but that didn't mean that others would. Adora wasn't *safe* here.

"They don't have to do that, really, I'm sure it was a mistake." Adora says, playing with little Finn in her arms who was still sniffling from their crying.

"A mistake wouldn't have caused those bruises or that cut, love." Catra says, without looking at Adora. "Need I remind you all that Adora is under the protection of the Princess Alliance while she works to make up for her actions. The reason why she is here is to help with reconstruction, not to be your punching bag." Catra smiles sweetly at the townspeople, though there was a very strong anger peeking through. "And need I remind you, putting a hand on her is treason to the crown of Half-Moon as she is my fiancee and has royal protections. Don't let this happen again." A villager steps forward.

"We didn't agree to that, that was the *Princesses* . Why should we forgive the person who destroyed our homes? Even if she's making up for it, it doesn't change what she's already done." They say. "People are *angry* , and they want *real* justice."

"I'm not saying that you have to forgive her now. Obviously forgiveness on your part will take time. I'm not stupid." Catra crosses her arms as she relaxes slightly. "I understand that you're angry, but hurting Adora isn't going to make a difference. It isn't going to bring back what is gone, and all you're doing is starting the cycle of violence all over again. She is trying

her best to be a better person, but you all have to be the ones to give that chance too." She sighs. "Real justice is allowing the person that was misguided to learn and to grow and to make up for their actions as best as they can. Not to slaughter them like you all wish to do."

"What punishment has she undergone?" They ask. "She gets to live with you, in a *castle* , and so what if she helps build a few houses? What kind of punishment is that for what she did? For all the people she hurt, or even the people who *died* because of her."

"Adora…" Catra begins, feeling her voice waver just a little. "Go home, tuck Finn in for their nap please. I'll be there shortly." Catra says, frowning deeply as she looks directly at the villager.

"You want to know why she's not being punished in the way you all wish for her to be? Because she regrets what she did. Because she's suffered enough growing up abused by the hand of the Horde, having been an orphan and being fed lies since she was as young as our child. She's had to live through being deprived of food if she failed, of having to live afraid of ambushes in her sleep, of magic being used against, being told that she was unlovable and that all she was good for was fighting. For goodness sake, when she and I finally sat down to talk, she didn't even know what the hell an apple was, or what chocolate was, because they didn't have any of that. She didn't know any better because she was a *victim* too, which is why she's helping with rebuilding, and to also help rehabilitate herself. You really think that if she wasn't regretful of what she did that she would have let you all beat her up and then try to excuse you all by saying that it was probably just a mistake?!"

"Catra..." Adora gently tugs on Catra's arm. "It's okay, really, She-Ra will fix it."

"It's not okay, Adora." Catra says. She can still see the blood along her hairline, staining her golden hair. She looks ragged and it is just *so Adora* to brush it off like it's nothing and to tell Catra that she's okay even if she isn't.

"I'm fine." Adora reassures. Catra shakes her head.

"Adora, you're all bruised up." Catra frowns, nuzzling her fiancee's cheek and mewling sadly. "You can't just let them beat you down like this." Adora kisses Catra's forehead and begins glowing - *literally* . She transforms into She-Ra, holding Finn securely in her arm. Once she's transformed she looks much better and Finn giggles happily.

"See? Good as new."

"She-Ra..." One of the villagers says in awe. "She-Ra was supposed to protect Etheria."

"And? Like I said, she was raised as an orphan and didn't know any better. For that matter, she never used She-Ra during the war until the end, and even then it was directly with the Rebellion and not any villages." Catra looks at the villager. "But in a way… She *did* protect Etheria. The war is over after all. We're in an era of peace now."

"I've been working with the sorcerers of Mystacor to help me figure out She-Ra's healing powers. I can use her to help heal all of Etheria." Adora looks down at Finn. "I'm sorry. For hurting you, for hurting a lot of people, Catra included, and I don't expect forgiveness, that's not why I'm helping. I'm helping because I want to right what I did wrong." Catra smiles softly at Adora, hugging her.

"I'm proud of you. Come on, let's go home, you deserve a break for today after that." Catra grabs She-Ra's large hand to pull her away but they're stopped in their tracks.

"Wait, we..." The villager trails off. "We're sorry for hurting you, we won't do that again. We don't like you, and we don't forgive you, but I guess… We can give you a chance." Adora nods gratefully and holds Finn closer.

"Thank you." She says and Catra smiles in relief, purring softly.

"Thank you. I still think we should go home for today. You can continue with construction tomorrow, okay?"

"Yes Princess." They bow respectively as the pair walk away.

Adora stays quiet for a moment before she snorts. "Attacking me is treason, huh?"

"It is, actually." Catra answers, glancing at Adora. She’s so much taller as She-Ra, Catra really doesn’t know how she took her. *Those thoughts aren’t helpful right now* . If Catra wasn’t healing… She’d happily take She-Ra for a whirl.

"It is?" Adora asks and the confusion on her face is super cute.

"Mhmm. I was serious when I said it. Since you're soon to be my wife, you have the same protections that I do." Catra explains.

"Well I... I guess that's true." Adora stops. "Catra, I... I was so focused on the Horde that I never considered what it means that I'm She-Ra."

"You didn't, but who could have told you?"

"But there must be a reason that I'm She-Ra, right? I don't know anything about her."

"If you really want to find out, then we can work together to figure it out." Catra smiles, squeezing Adora's shoulder. "We're in this together."

"In this together." Adora repeats with that smile of hers. Adora could light up any room with that smile. She is *warm* in every sense of the word, and soft, she is *everything* , and they were going to be together for the rest of their lives. If Adora really wanted to find out more about She-Ra, then Catra would help her. "There are stories of She-Ra, about what she does, the old She-Ra. I guess, I don't know."

"Hey, we'll figure it out one day. Don't overthink it, Love."

"Have you met me? I always overthink things." Catra laughs a little at that. A truer statement has never been said before.

"I mean, I know. But try not to focus on it too much. Let's focus on what's important now." Catra reassures. “You need to rest after that bump on your head. I know She-Ra heals you but you still need to rest. We can snuggle with Finn in our room, and then, we can read and research all about She-Ra. Hey, you know, Bow’s dads are kind of experts in She-Ra and other history of Etheria. Maybe we could ask them?”

“Yeah?” Adora asks as she transforms back to her usual self. Catra still isn’t used to seeing Adora without all her armour and cape. She almost misses it. She always looked *hot* in her uniform. She still wore her Horde uniform *now* - Catra really needed to fix that. She was walking around with a literal target on her back. “What are they like?” Adora asks curiously.

“Lance is like Bow with Glimmer’s energy,” Catra answers. “George is a little calmer. They’re nice though, you’ll like them.”

“Noted,” Adora says as she snuggles Finn. Catra smiles softly at the sight. “In the meantime, let's go for that nap.”

“Please.” Catra says as she glances behind them at the guards. She sighs. She’s getting really tired of being watched.

* * *

Catra knew that Adora was with her mom, Luna. So Catra was making herself busy. She was passing by one of the meeting rooms in Bright Moon. Not the War Room, just a room where people could discuss things privately. Catra knew her mom, C’yra used it as a sort of study while they were in Bright Moon and Catra *sees* her. She was standing by a desk, reading some paper, dressed in her royal Magicat robes and her crown. Catra glares at her.

She feels that familiar anger in her stir up at the sight of her mother. All she can see is the scars on Adora’s jaw, scars that her own mother gave to her mate. It fills her with irrational anger. *No one touches my mate* . Catra knows it's a protective instinct, but she can’t believe that C’yra really did that to Adora, knowing she probably would not suffer any consequences for it.

Catra enters the room, not announcing herself but knowing that C’yra hears her. She glances at her but other than that, she pays little attention to Catra. “You scratched my mate.” Catra states firmly, angrily. C’yra slowly looks up, dropping her paper down.

"Maybe she fell on her face and scratched it." C’yra says with a shrug. She was playing ignorant and it was only making Catra angrier.

"C'yra, I know you think I'm stupid. But I'm not blind. I know claw marks when I see them." Catra seethes, stepping closer to her mother. C’yra doesn’t so much as flinch. She’s taller than Catra by two inches. Catra used to like that they looked so alike, now it only pains her to be like the woman who caused her so much suffering through her stubbornness. The worst part is that C’yra doesn’t even think she did anything wrong.

"Then maybe Adora walked into my claws, what can I say?" C’yra asks.

"You do know that makes zero sense, right? Like most things you say nowadays." Catra bites back. C'yra takes a deep breath and then turns to Catra.

"Fine, I scratched her. She's lucky that's all she got."

"I see." Catra smiles, though her eyes remained cold as she slaps C'yra roughly across the face - keeping her claws *in* , she wasn’t so cruel as to do otherwise. A loud *‘SMACK’* sounds through the room but Catra feels nothing but satisfaction. "Never touch my mate again." She glares, her smile falling the second her hand had come in contact with C'yra's cheek. "Understand?" Her voice was icy, filled with hardly controlled anger beneath.

" *C'yra* !" Luna exclaims as she comes into the room, Adora beside her. Luna crosses the room to her wife and takes her face in her hands, gently examining her. C'yra huffs and turns away, marching off without another word. *Typical* . Catra expected nothing less. Luna turns to Catra. "That was unnecessary." Luna’s voice is disapproving, like it was whenever Catra did something she wasn’t supposed to as a kid, but she isn’t angry.

"Unnecessary? I'd say it wasn't enough. She's the reason why Adora has those scars on her face. And don't think I didn't notice the other bruises that weren't fully healed that I know

damn well that she inflicted upon my mate before the trial." Catra says bluntly. "Tell her to keep her hands off of Adora, and we won't have a problem. I'm not blind or stupid, but she sure as hell was acting like I was."

"That was before-" Luna sighs in exasperation. "You don't slap your mother, C'yra. I understand that she hurt Adora, and you, but..." Luna takes a breath, she was clearly upset at the fact her daughter and her wife's relationship had deteriorated so significantly that Catra was now *slapping* C'yra, but Catra held little sympathy for C'yra. "I'm going to go check on her." Luna walks out of the room, leaving Catra and Adora alone.

They stay silent for a moment before Adora breaks it. "Did you really have to slap her?" Adora asks, coming up beside Catra.

"I did. She needed to get it through her thick skull that what she did didn't fly over my head and that it wasn't okay regardless of the circumstances. What I did was less than what she did to you." Catra says, eyes still narrowed in the direction in which C'yra and Luna had gone in. "And what Luna doesn't seem to understand is that C'yra stopped being my mother the second she started treating me the way she has been. Like a whore that can't make decisions for herself with an unwanted grandchild as a bonus." She turns away and walks in the opposite direction.

"Catra," Catra hears Adora follow after her. "Don't say those things."

"It's what she thinks! She's been showing that since she found out." Catra says, upset but taking a deep breath. "Adora, I love you, but you didn't have to handle almost an entire pregnancy being locked away and treated like some untouchable creature because of her decision to put me on house arrest. Plus, how she's acting towards me affects everyone else, okay? Most of them were acting the same except for the people that speak to us now in a friendly way."

"I- I know I wasn't here and I... C'yra kind of terrified me that night before the trial, but I understand and I'm not mad about what she did." Adora says. "I'm upset about how she treated you, of course I am, but you don't have to be upset about how she treated *me* . I actually deserved that." Catra really loves Adora, but she can't hear what she's saying right now.

"No, you didn't. And even if you did, you don't get to call yourself the 'good guy' and hurt you like *she* did." Catra shakes her head in frustration. "I don't want her near you or Finn. Even less so now that I know what she did to you. She's given me every single reason in the book to not trust her and to disown her as my mother."

"Catra..." Adora pauses. "I don't want that."

"I felt that way even before I found out what she did to you, Adora. She just reinforced it today." Catra says, trying to calm Adora's worries about it being her fault but feeling *angry.* She was worried that anger might get the better of her and she might start yelling at Adora. "One can only take so much about being mistreated by the one that's supposed to call themselves your parent before they don't see them as such anymore. She's hurt me enough, before the house arrest and during it. She doesn't care what happens to me so long as what she says goes, or at least that's how it feels like. I had to put my foot down for what she did to *you* ."

"Catra... Look, I know she hurt you, but she did it out of love." Adora stops walking and places her hands on her hips. "She made mistakes, and she... she did things... but it was to protect you, right? She's not like Shadow Weaver." Catra freezes. She turns to look at her fiancee in a mixture of disbelief and hurt. Catra knows Adora feels responsible, she's trying to *fix* , but this is something she cannot fix, and Catra doesn't like Adora comparing her situation to Shadow Weaver. It feels almost like a belittlement, like: 'what you went through was bad but at least it wasn't Shadow Weaver bad'. Catra doesn't need her mate defending her mother. Hurt is hurt.

"Protect me?" Catra would have laughed in Adora's face if it wasn't for the other overwhelming feelings of anger and sadness she was experiencing currently. "Adora, I told her that she was hurting me. I asked to explain to her the situation multiple times. She *refused* to listen to me. She wasn't there for any of my appointments. She wasn't there for Finn's *birth* . She didn't even respect my presence when I was there at your trial hours after having given birth." She rubs her face, letting out a soft noise that she couldn't quite identify.

"It's one thing to say that you're doing something out of love and to protect someone. But when that person tells you multiple times that you're hurting them? There has to be a line somewhere, Adora. And she crossed it ages ago for me." Catra's breath hitches for a moment. "She doesn't understand how much she's hurt me. I don't think even *you* fully do, Love. I know you're trying to do your best to be supportive, and to try to get along with her, but she's refused to even communicate properly because anytime I try to tell her one thing, it goes out the other ear. I've had it. I'm done. I'm tired. I can count the people that I can trust on one

hand because of her, because of *them* refusing to listen to me and try to understand after months of alienating me. Don't make excuses for her. She doesn't deserve it. Not with the way she's been acting, not with the way she wanted to kill you had the majority sided with her, and not with the way she was treating us both and our kitten who wasn't even born yet and is fully innocent in all of this bullshit."

Adora sighs and drops her hands from her hips. She comes towards Catra and gently takes her arms in her hands. "I know she hurt you. But I'm saying, as the person who almost killed you *twice* , that she had every reason to hate me. I hated me, I will never forgive myself for what I did to you, Catra. And if someone pulled the shit I did on Finn... I would never forgive them either." Adora kisses Catra's cheek.

"The first time you didn't know we were bonded because I didn't tell you, and the second time you weren't in control because of the corrupt Black Garnet shard, Adora. It's not the same. And you didn't know I was pregnant either. You immediately regretted it as soon as you realised that you hurt me. She hasn't, she *doesn't* . I've told her multiple times she's hurting me and she won't listen to me at all." Catra whines softly, her eyes watery as she looks into her mate's blue eyes.

"I guess it's different. I know Shadow Weaver was a bad mom, because she used me my entire life. Maybe that's why to me C'yra's actions don't seem that bad, because it's relative. I'm guessing C'yra was a good mom for most of your life?" Adora asks. Catra takes a deep breath.

"She was a good mom for most of my life, true. I guess that's why it hurts even more that she's not acting like the mom I knew. She's treating me like a prisoner. I hate it so much. I wish she would stop, but she won't. She won't consider it no matter how much I try." Catra drops Adora's hands. She feels like she wants to run. When she was younger, she used to climb things when she got this overwhelmed.

"Okay." Adora nods. "Okay, you know I got your back, no matter what." Adora lifts her hands and gently wipes Catra's tears away that Catra didn't even know she was spilling. She feels better with Adora's support and her words. "Tell me everything. About how she treated you, how you felt, the trial, *everything* ."

"Can... Can we go to the room first please? To get Finn?" Catra asks.

"Of course we can. Whatever you want and need." Adora says wholeheartedly. Catra murmurs a ‘thank you’ and takes Adora's hand, pulling her towards the infirmary to get Finn from the little crib where they were being monitored for a little while to make sure they were healthy. The doctor gives them the all clear and Catra takes Finn into her arms, holding them close.

"I think the thing that hurt the most was her telling me I needed to give Finn away, or get rid of them, or they'd be disowned. She doesn't even see our kitten as her grandchild. It makes me wonder if she even sees me as her daughter anymore or if she just uses the title to have power over me." ‘You’re my *daughter* so I know what’s best’. That’s what C’yra did.

“Luna told me about that,” Adora says. “What did she say exactly?”

“She said why should Half-Moon provide for them when they're Horde. She called me a traitor too, though I guess that started to hurt me when she wouldn't even look at me without some sort of disgusted gaze in her eyes. I wonder if she knows that she does that. I wonder if any of the Alliance know that they do the same as well." Adora shuffles uncomfortably.

"When... When C'yra... When she came to see me, she didn't... She seemed to believe it was entirely my fault, like I'd brainwashed you into sleeping with me. She didn't seem to think it was your idea." Adora says and Catra lets out a little laugh of disbelief.

"I know. And she doesn't want to listen to me when I tried to tell her it was consensual because it wasn't what she wanted to hear." Catra sighs, adjusting Finn's blanket to make sure they're snug. "Whatever, it's not like it matters anymore, I guess. I don't intend to talk to her unless it is absolutely necessary. Don't feel like wasting my breath anymore now that I know you're safe and Finn is safe." She knows Adora had hoped for them to go to dinner together but Catra no longer felt like doing that anymore - maybe Adora would convince her again, who knows?

"Don't you want to try and fix things?" Adora asks.

"I've tried. I've tried this whole time, Adora. You think I didn't want to have my moms, and the people that I once called my friends', support me during my pregnancy? I did. But all they

did was spit in my face. I'm done, Adora. If it weren't for the fact that the war would probably restart, I would have just left with you somewhere far away where they can't reach us. It's easier now that you're here, but these past few months I've felt like a bird stuck in a cage with no room to flap her wings at all."

"I didn't know. I'm sorry." Adora frowns, clearly upset with the true and full knowledge of how Catra had felt.

"Like I said, you being here with me makes things better. At least I get to be with the woman I love now." Catra says, gently cupping her jaw. Catra stares at those scars. They were a constant reminder of what C'yra did to her mate.

"I love you too." Adora says, pressing herself up against Catra's side in a comforting way. "I want you to feel happy, and safe, and not like a bird stuck in a cage."

"I know, but there isn't much I can do without making things more complicated."

"Are we okay Catra?" Adora asks suddenly. "I feel like... Ever since I surrendered, things have been moving so fast."

"We're okay." Catra smiles, leaning her head onto Adora's. "I promise, we're okay."

"You're not... mad at me... for anything?"

"Of course not!" Catra exclaims. She doesn't really know why Adora would think that she was upset, it's not like Adora had done anything to upset her - except maybe surrender herself without giving Catra a warning.

"Really? Not for anything? Not even before I- I stabbed you? When I... When I basically told you I didn't have feelings for you? Even though I broke your heart? You're just... okay with all of that?" Adora asks. Catra winces a little at the reminders.

"Of course I wasn't okay, it hurt to hear you say that. But I had to respect it. I couldn't just force you to have feelings for me. You're entitled to your own feelings."

"But I did have feelings for you." Adora says. "I was just an idiot and then, even though I was the one who pushed you away, I... I got angry when I should've just admitted it."

"Hey, you didn't exactly know how to process your emotions, and love is something you hadn't really known. Plus the only type of 'love' you had was parental and even then it wasn't really love." Catra says. Not to mention, Catra knew that Adora regretted all of that.

"Still, I was an idiot." Adora presses her lips to the side of Catra's face. "I hurt you."

"You did, but you regret it and you were hurting too."

"Sometimes I think you're too understanding."

"And sometimes I think you're a little too hard on yourself." Catra replies, moving Finn in her arms.

"I'm not." Adora responds. "If anything, I'm not hard on myself enough." That is the biggest shit that Catra has ever heard come out of Adora’s mouth.

"Adora, you kick your butt about things everyday. You literally let C'yra beat you because you felt guilty. You're too hard on yourself."

"I feel like it was the least I deserved." Adora says. She gently takes Finn from Catra's arms and holds them herself. She smiles down at them as she gently touches their face with her finger. "You know, I was ready to die. I really thought she was going to, but then she stopped. She stopped when I told her I was sorry, and why I was sorry, and what I was sorry for."

"At least you can admit you're sorry when you know you're wrong." Catra points out. Something C’yra can never do.

"So it's because she hasn't said sorry?" Adora asks. "What if she did?"

"Then she'd need to prove she really means it, like you're trying to do. You're going out of your comfort zone to show that you're truly sorry. She isn't even pretending that she's sorry." Catra looks at Finn. "She's acting as though she's in the right and expects for me to wordlessly follow what she says as though I'm not the one being impacted by her choices and not her."

"Right." Adora says. "It's what she said about Finn that bothers you the most, isn't it?"

"That's what pushed me to run when I was injured, yes." Catra takes in a shaky breath. "I... I was already done. I was hurt, and I was missing you, and Finn was the only thing keeping me around. They were giving me strength to push through the hurt, along with my family and friends being there. But when Double Trouble told them, and she told me to get rid of Finn... I ran. And everything *hurt* . They... What they did was the reason I almost died and almost took Finn with me, not you. And none of them want to acknowledge that."

"Well, C'yra does seem to think I'm like the Devil's spawn or something." Adora says. "Still, what she said..."

"That's what she thought Finn as too." Catra murmurs softly. "So I'm not surprised she called you that."

"It's not true," Adora says. "Finn may have my DNA, but they have every shred of *good* that is in me."

"I know it's not true, Dummy, but she doesn't seem to think that at all." Catra responds. Adora sighs and reaches her free hand up to gently sweep Catra's hair from her face. Catra purrs at the action.

"They just need time."

"How much?"

"I don't know," Adora admits. "But, time."

"Time.” Catra repeats. “Months have passed." Catra sighs. "I... I don't know if I can learn to trust them again after this."

"Do you trust me?"

"It's not the same, Adora."

"Why isn't it the same?" Adora asks. "And I'm not trying to annoy you, or anything, I just... I want to know why you trust me again after everything I did, but you don't trust the others."

"Because you actually seem to care about how I feel!"

"I do care about how you feel, of course I do."

" *They* don't seem to care at all! That's why I don't trust them. I'm communicating to them how I feel, and yet they refuse to listen because they think I don't know what I'm feeling." Catra explains.

"Okay, yeah, I see what you mean." Adora concedes. "Some are trying though, like Luna."

"Hardly, we've talked like three times." Catra says.

"She's been nice to me." Adora says. "And I think C'yra distracts her a lot."

"She's hardly been a mom to me during this too. It doesn't feel like *enough* ."

"All I'm saying is, maybe don't discredit her so soon." Adora says. She remembers Luna talking to her. Still, her absence had been hurtful too.

"Maybe she's trying," Catra admits. "but the others definitely aren't, aside from the usual." Adora sighs and turns to walk out of the infirmary. She sees the guards follow them as they leave.

"Maybe," Adora says. "Why don't we go to this wedding planning meeting and we can talk about this later?"

"Fine, okay, I just hope they actually listen to my input, unlike what they've done with everything else."

"It's Bow, Spinnerella and Netossa, they should listen just fine." Adora says. "Will you take Finn again? I think they want you." Adora says as the little kitten makes a small mewl. Catra nods and takes Finn into her arms, she's more relaxed knowing that it's just the three that have been by her side through this.

"Okay, that's good, I was worried that the others would try to be involved." Catra admits. Adora laughs a little.

"Kitten, I knew you'd probably end up scratching someone if that was the case."

"Probably." Catra has to admit that the thought of scratching her mother back was a satisfying thought. "I just don't want them to mess up our small ceremony to celebrate our love. That's why I want to have it in the Fright Zone and not here."

"You want to get married in the Fright Zone?" Adora sounds surprised.

"Yes, it's our home." There is something ironic about how Catra has felt more at home in the *Fright Zone* than she does in her actual home. Adora smiles a little.

"No, it's not. You're my home. And the people in the Fright Zone were what made it feel like a home, they're my family, but that place is not home."

"Then I want to celebrate it with our family. The people of the Fright Zone." Catra clarifies.

"Okay." Adora concedes.

"Okay," Catra smiles at her. "Finn can be part of the ceremony too."

"A baby?" Adora gives Catra a puzzled look. "How?"

"Well, someone we trust can hold Finn and help them be the ring bearer. They bring the rings to us during the ceremony."

"Sounds adorable."

"It does. And we can get them a cute little tux made." Catra says, snuggling Finn close.

"They'll look so cute." Adora says in awe.

"They will, just like their blonde mom." Catra says, smiling at Adora.

"I am not the cute one between us."

"You are cute."

"Not as cute as you." Adora denies. Catra huffs at her.

"You are very cute." Catra protests.

"Still not as cute as you with your tail and your ears." Catra giggles at her, rolling her eyes.

"You and my ears and tail." Catra comments. Adora has always been fascinated with her ears and tail, not that Catra minds. She likes whenever Adora scratches her ears or pets her tail. Not to mention that one time that Adora literally got her off by touching her tail.

"They're cute! Finn is cute too because of their cute little ears and their tail. They make me want to cry, they're so cute." Adora says.

"You are such a loving dork. I love you." Catra says, her eyes softening when she looks at her mate.

"I love you too, forever and always." Adora responds. Catra purrs and she places a kiss on Adora's jaw.

"Forever and always."

"I'd be with you until the end of the world."

"Hold the vows till our wedding, dork. But me too." Catra smiles, giving Adora a gentle kiss. She really would follow Adora anywhere, right to the end of the world, but those really could

wait for the vows.

"Alright, fine, I'll save my sap for our wedding."

"Good. Then we shouldn't keep Spinny, ‘Tossa, and Bow waiting too long."

"You're right," Adora offers her elbow. "Shall we, my dear Princess?" Catra takes her offer, adjusting Finn in one of her arms and beams.

"We shall."

Adora leads Catra along the halls of Bright Moon, although she gets confused a couple of times but Catra keeps her on track. They enter a meeting room where Bow, Spinnerella and Netossa were waiting for them."Spinny! ‘Tossa! Bow! How are you guys? Thank you so much for being here." Catra says happily.

"Catra," Netossa greets. "We're good, how are you?" She asks. "And you Adora?"

"I'm fine." Adora answers, pulling a chair out so Catra could sit - such a gentleman.

"Thank you, Love." Catra smiles, taking a seat, setting Finn against her chest. "So, what do we need to discuss today?"

"Just some things about your wedding." Netossa says. "How you want it to be and stuff."

"I was mentioning to Adora that I wanted to have it in the Fright Zone with the others. A ceremony of people we trust that have supported us."

"The Fright Zone?" Netossa asks.

"That's not exactly the prettiest place." Spinnerella adds.

"I don't care." Catra says. "I just want to be with people that we can celebrate with. We can decorate it to make it look nicer. But the people there are what matter to me."

"Okay." Netossa says. "But... who will officiate? Or walk you down the aisle? C'yra should really do that as Queen of Half-Moon and your mom."

"She's not officiating anything. I don't want her there." Catra says. If it wasn't for the fact that she was holding Finn, her claws would be out.

"You don't want her there?"

"Why would I?" Catra asks. "I don't care who officiates, as long as it's anyone but her."

"You're a Princess, you can't be married by just anyone." Netossa responds.

"I don't give a damn. A chicken can marry me for all I care. But not *her* ."

"I don't think chickens can officiate weddings babe." Adora chimes in. Gods, Catra loves that blonde dummy. Sometimes she doesn't get sarcasm.

"And?" Catra asks.

"So we can't have a chicken...?" Adora says with great confusion. She is… so adorable.

"Anyone else." Catra repeats.

"Catra," Adora glances at Bow. "You want our wedding to be official, right?"

"Yes, I do."

"Can we be married by anyone else?" Adora inquires.

"There is Angella, or Luna technically." Bow answers.

"Ugh..." Catra sighs. "I hate this right now." The worst part is that Catra doesn't know. She doesn't think anyone from the Rebellion will agree with her union to Adora - save the members currently present. So she really doesn't have an answer here.

"Catra." Spinerella gets her attention. "Luna... Luna can do it."

"What?"

"Luna, she can do it." Spinnerella repeats. "She's been trying to convince C'yra this whole time. Actually, when you were... When you nearly died the second time from the grieving, I kind of thought her and C'yra were going to... They were not in a good place, they disagreed a lot. She's stood up for you a lot of times against C'yra."

"You know, Luna did help me escape, and also she was really nice to me when I surrendered." Adora admits."What do you want to do Catra?" Catra looks at the two of them in surprise before softening and nodding.

"Okay, then mom can officiate the wedding if she's willing to do so." Catra decides. Luna was the only mom who Catra trusted.

"Can you guys leave me and my wife alone please?" Adora asks.

"She isn't your wife yet, but sure, give the little Lord a kiss for us." Netossa says, standing with her wife. Adora smiles down at Finn.

"Little Lord, I like that." Adora whispers. Catra smiles at her as the door closes behind the exiting Princesses.

"Little Lord is very cute." Catra confirms. Adora looks at Catra.

"I was going to ask," She says, shuffling closer. "Do you want to go to the Fright Zone for a few days? Am I even allowed to go to the Fright Zone?"

"I’m not sure. But yes, let's go. We'll deal with them being grumpy about it later." Catra says, sighing in relief. "There's not hostility over there, so it'll be more fun."

"Yeah, and Scorpia can meet her godchild." Adora laughs a little. "Everyone can meet their Little Lord."

"For sure. They'd love our little kitten."

"You seem like you could use the break." Catra nods tiredly, slumping against Adora.

"Yeah, thank goodness you noticed."

"Are you okay Catra?" Adora asks gently. "You gave birth, you came to defend me not long after, before all that you were practically being held prisoner by your own family, everything has been one hundred miles per hour for you, I want to check in."

"Am I okay?" She repeats. "I don't think I've been okay for a long time now, Adora. I'm better now that you're here and I know Finn is okay, but-" Her voice cracks, her hold on Finn

tightening ever so slightly. "But no, I'm not okay.” Catra admits. “I'm so tired of them, of being here with all the stares and the whispers from people I thought I knew and could trust no matter what." Adora pulls Catra's chair forward and towards her before she lifts her hand to gently caress her face.

"Anything they said wasn't true." Adora says and then she smiles reassuringly. "The Fright Zone would be a nice break, you know no one there will have any issues with any of this."

"I know it's not true, Adora. They don't understand, they don't *want* to understand, and that's what hurts." She whispers and leans into Adora, her body language showing how tired she was. "When can we go?"

"As soon as I get permission, I guess." Adora says. "What have they said to you?"

"They don't say it to my face but I think they forget just how sensitive a Magicat's hearing is. It's a whole bunch of insults, I don't wanna repeat them."

"Cowards." Adora grumbles. "You realise if anyone says anything while I'm around I'll punch them, right?"

"You can't, not without possibly making a whole conflict. They don't like you, Adora. They want to get rid of you, don't give them a reason to."

"I don't care, I'm not going to let people bad mouth you."

"Adora, no! Don't give them a reason to take you away." Catra begs softly.

"Catra," Adora gently kisses Catra on her nose. "I love you, I'm not just going to stand there if people say untrue and bad things about you."

"I love you too. And I don't want people to be given any reason to try to reconsider your sentence, Adora. Please. You and Finn are what's helping me through this."

"Well, that's a risk I'm willing to take."

"Adora, please don't." Catra begs. Adora frowns. Catra knows that Adora means what she says, she won't just stand there if someone says bad things about Catra, no matter who they are, and that's what Catra is worried about. "Adora, please." She says softly. "Let them say whatever they want. But I don't want you to give them a reason for them to take you away from me and Finn."

"Catra..." Adora sighs. "How would you feel if you heard people speaking badly about me?"

"Obviously I'd be upset, but this isn't the same situation!"

"It is exactly the same."

"Babe, it's not." Catra sighs. "But, fine. Just be careful about it." Adora smiles and pecks Catra on her lips.

"I really do want to protect you Catra." When so many of Catra's 'friends' and 'family' didn't stand up for her, Catra knew that Adora would always stand up for her.

"I know, I love you so much." Catra purrs and moves her seat closer to Adora. "Do you think we can ask a couple of our friends from the Fright Zone to help us build a home?"

"Why just a couple?" Adora asks. "I'm... Well... Glimmer took my title, but I'll always be their Lord. I'm sure all of the Fright Zone will be happy to help."

"But I want them to *want* to help us. Not because you order them to, dork."

"That's why we'll ask for *volunteers* ."

"Fine but no pressuring them though. If they don't want to, then they won't have to." Adora glances towards the doors where her guards were standing. Usually Adora didn't need them if she was with a Princess, apparently Catra didn't count. Catra sighs.

"Bright Moon has become somewhat suffocating and I haven't even been here that long." Adora states.

"Somewhat is an understatement." Catra murmurs, glancing at the guards herself. "Bright Moon and Half-Moon are both suffocating. It's hard to do anything without having a guard breathing down our necks."

"Why are they here anyway? What am I going to do? Turn a lampshade the wrong way?" Catra snorts at Adora’s joke.

"Like I said earlier, they're waiting to find a reason to-" She does a cutting motion over her neck. "Or they're trying to find a reason to rub in my face that you're a horrible person and that C'yra was right." Adora's eyebrows lift a little.

"They're trying to find a reason to kill me?"

"That's what they wanted to do initially, Adora."

"I know that, but I guess... I don't know... I thought people were okay after they agreed what my punishment should be instead of that."

"I wish that were the case. But most of them aren't." Catra says.

"Who do I ask permission to go visit the Fright Zone?" Adora inquires.

"Probably my mom. Luna would be the best person to ask if Spinnerella and Netossa were telling the truth."

"Luna... who's usually with C'yra?" Adora grimaces and then gives a thumbs up - *dork* . "Fantastic."

"Well, the other person would be C'yra so... I'm under their jurisdiction." Adora coughs a little.

"Jurisdiction?"

Catra shrugs. "I haven't been able to make decisions like I normally would since they found out. I can make decisions for Finn's sake, but when it comes to going out places, and the like, I need their permission. I was honestly surprised they're letting us make decisions for the wedding."

"Right..." Adora frowns softly. She obviously doesn't like that Catra has to ask permission to do things. Catra really needed to get out of here, at least for a few days. "Why don't you go pack a few things? I still have stuff at the Fright Zone so I'll be okay. I can go ask Luna now." Catra perks up a bit and nods.

"Okay, let me grab a few changes of clothes. I still have some of mine over there anyway. Meet up in the room?" She asks.

"Sounds like a plan." Adora kisses Catra again and then Finn before she stands. Catra watches her leave and sighs. She loves Adora, but she needs to get out of Rebellion territory. Something Catra never thought she would feel: she *misses* the Fright Zone.

* * *

As Adora walks out of the room she's tailed by her two guards. She sighs. Adora hasn't even been here that long and this is annoying to her, she can't imagine Catra had it any better under *months* of being guarded like this. She manages to track the two Queens down and she bows to them as she enters. "Queen Luna, Queen C'yra. Greetings."

"Adora, how are you?" Luna jumps in before her wife can. Adora realises, too late, that she should have greeted C'yra first. "How's the wedding planning going?" She glances over at her wife. Adora follows her line of sight and sees C'yra's hands clenched at her side. Luna quickly slaps them and shakes her head.

"Well, to both of those questions." Adora answers. She didn't think it best to bring up Catra's objections to C'yra being their officiator, or not allowing her to walk her down the aisle, appropriate right now. "I actually wanted to ask you a question."

"A question?" Luna raises an eyebrow. "What is it?"

"I think Catra needs a break," Adora begins. "from everything. I'm worried about her. I was thinking we could return to the Fright Zone for a few days? They haven't met Finn yet and Catra could... She's been... She just needs a break."

"A break?" Luna's eyebrows go up. She looks into Adora's eyes, trying to read her intentions. Adora doesn't know what she sees but she sure hopes that it's enough. "Okay, just make sure to come back safe."

"I just think- Wait, you said yes?" Adora asks, wondering if she had misheard. Luna nods.

"I did and I agree. She needs a break. Make sure she has fun and that Finn and her are safe."

"Of course, your majesty," Adora bows again. "Thank you." She turns and walks out of the room to track Catra down again.

* * *

"You're letting her take our daughter to the Fright Zone?" C'yra asks once Adora is gone. "No guards? Nothing?"

"Yup." Luna replies, turning to look at C'yra "Problem?"

"I have several problems with that." C'yra says. Luna just shrugs at her.

"I see, I see. Oh well."

"Oh well?" C'yra looks at her wife. "That's it? You don't care about my concerns?"

"Do you care for our daughter's well-being?"

"Of course I do." C'yra frowns at her wife. She hasn't stopped caring about Catra's well-being. It had hurt her when Catra slapped her, and not just physically.

"Then you noticed how stressed out she is, right?"

"Stressed out?" C'yra asks. "Why would she be stressed out? She has her stupid mate, even though I tried to stop *that* from happening."

"Tell me something, Cy. Where has our daughter gone since the start of this?" Luna asks. C'yra has no idea what she means with that question.

"Bright Moon, Half-Moon, her room?" C'yra answers. Luna looks at her and she doesn't seem to be surprised by C'yra's response.

"Where has our daughter gone since we found out about her mate? Name all the places she's gone to."

"What do you mean?" C’yra asks with great confusion.

"How long has it been?" Luna waits for C’yra’s answer. C'yra sighs.

"But you want her to go to the *Fright Zone* with no guards or anything? I don't trust Adora. What if they don't come back?" C’yra asks. The Princesses may have voted to spare Adora, but C’yra was never going to accept her - especially not as Catra’s mate or her *wife* .

"You really think that Adora is going to risk our daughter and their kitten? She knows that you, and like half of the Rebellion, would break the Fright Zone to pieces if she tried that." Luna says in disbelief. "If anything, our daughter would probably be the one who wants to stay there."

"I don't see why she'd want to stay there."

"Because she wouldn't be trapped like she is here, C'yra."

"She isn't trapped, that's ridiculous, she can go wherever she wants now." C’yra protests. She had lifted Catra’s house arrest.

"Without a guard? Getting to do what she wants? She feels like if she makes a wrong move that she'll lose her kitten, or Adora."

"She'd only lose Adora if *Adora* did something wrong." C’yra responds coldly.

"You say that, but have you given her any reason to believe that? To believe you?" C'yra shakes her head and stands at her wife’s words.

"Well it looks like you made this decision for the both of us."

"Would you have agreed?" Luna stands up, staring down C’yra. C’yra loves Luna’s strong spirit, she likes it better when it’s on her side. "I'm trying to do what's best for our daughter without making her feel like she has zero control over her own life, Cy."

"No, I wouldn't have agreed. I would have had a guard detail with her at the very least." C’yra replies.

"And what the hell do you think she needs a break from?!"

"I don't want to talk about this anymore, you've clearly made your mind up."

"You never want to talk when someone else is right."

"I don't think you're right."

"Of course you don't. You also didn't think I was right when I said we should let our daughter explain herself either, and look where that got us." Luna says, poking C’yra on her chest.

"It got us a daughter who was safe and not with the woman who *stabbed her in the chest.* " C’yra fires back.

"It got us a daughter who hardly spends time with us or the people that she called friends. It got us a daughter that feels uncomfortable being in the same room as us." Luna pinches the bridge of her nose. "C'y, you can't keep doing this to her. Our daughter has always been a free spirit. Even when she was a kitten. She's gonna feel restricted."

"Uh huh."

"And being made to feel restricted can mess up your mental health."

"I already lifted her protection detail, the only person the guards follow is Adora, per her agreement at her trial." C'yra points out.

"And who does she spend the most time with?" Luna asks.

"Maybe she should spend less time with her then." C'yra argues. Catra doesn't have a guard, *Adora* does.

"C'yra, she's her mate." C'yra sighs and turns to her wife.

"You already told them yes," She takes Luna's hand. "She gets her 'break'."

"Don't you dare send guards to follow them." Luna warns. C'yra doesn't know how Luna read her mind, she guesses it's the fact that they've been married for so long.

"I wasn't going to... anymore."C'yra says. Luna looks at C'yra and shakes her head.

"Or any spies. Or *anyone* for that matter. Let them have a few days where they don't have to deal with all of this."

"Well they wouldn't know if there was a spy, otherwise they wouldn't be a very good spy." C'yra points out.

"C'yra, if you do that, I'm going to make you sleep outside of our bedroom when we get home."

"What?" C'yra asks in disbelief. "That's... You'd kick me out of bed?"

"If you don't let our daughter actually have a break then yes."

"Fine, I'll let her gallivant around the Fright Zone with her baby mommy for a few days." C'yra concedes. She's learnt over the years to listen to Luna sometimes - she *means* that threat about making her sleep outside their bedroom.

"Good." Luna says.

"Good." C'yra repeats.

"Promise you'll actually let her be this once? Mate's promise?"

"You know I can't break a promise to you." C'yra replies.

"I know. So, mate's promise?" C'yra sighs.

"I promise I'll leave her be." C'yra swears.

"Thank you." Luna smiles and kisses C'yra on her lips softly.

"I love you, Luna." C'yra whispers.

"I love you too."

"Good, you had me worried." C'yra says, breathing a sigh of relief.

"Worried?"

"Things have been... tense... between us." C’yra clarifies. In fact, there had been a couple of moments C’yra thought she might lose Luna.

"That doesn't mean I don't love you. You're just a stubborn idiot." Luna teases shoving C’yra’s head gently but affectionately.

"Seems I passed that on to our daughter." C’yra comments.

"Stubborn, yes." Luna agrees.

"Not the idiot part?"

"Definitely not."

"Do you really think I'm being a stubborn *idiot* ?" C’yra asks. Luna raises an eyebrow.

"I do think that, yes." She confirms. C’yra rolls her eyes and then wraps her arms around the waist of her shorter wife. She doesn’t enjoy hurting her family, she doesn’t enjoy hurting her *daughter* . In the end, it had all been for nothing anyway. Adora was here, she was pardoned and she was going to marry Catra anyway. Everything she had done was for nothing.

And now she was going to let her daughter willingly run off to the *Fright Zone* for a *vacation* . Everything about this was *wrong* .

Chapter End Notes

Things are getting better, but obviously won't be that great for quite a while. Good luck, y'all! -M

I'm sorry if there are mistakes in this chapter asdfghjkl I spent basically my whole day editing this (from when I woke up to just like an hour ago) so it'd be ready in time for tonight. I hope you all enjoyed and we will see you again next week! Also, poor Adora, she is so horny for her Kitten -S

As always you can find us on twitter @ceolordadora and our CC is the same, and you can find me (S) on tumblr @sherasswordstrap

Return to the Fright Zone

Chapter Summary

"Do you really think my cape is uncool?" Adora asks.

"Usually." Catra replies.

"I want a divorce. Immediately." Adora states. Catra rolls her eyes. Adora is so dramatic.

Chapter Notes

Happy Friday and Happy Update Day !! We hope you all enjoy this chapter :)! Until next time!

See the end of the chapter for more notes

Adora steps down off of the skiff and then extends her hand to Catra for her to take. Catra takes her hand and steps down beside her, holding Finn. Adora smiles softly and extends her elbow for Catra to hold onto. They were in the Fright Zone again. Despite everything, Adora had missed this place - even the smog. They had stopped just outside of the front doors of the main structure of the Fright Zone; Adora could make out two guards posted at its entrance.

“Did you tell people that we were coming?” Catra asks.

“Yeah, I let them know we were coming.” Adora answers. “But don’t worry, I’m not expecting them to throw some big welcome-” Adora’s words are cut off when the doors to the Fright Zone open and thousands of soldiers all cheer. Two loud bangs go off, scaring Adora half to death, when pieces of tiny scraps of paper fall on them - *confetti* .

Adora laughs in disbelief as she sees all the gathered people. They were all happy to see her and it warmed her heart. Hanging from the top of the ceiling, above them, was a banner that read ‘WELCOME HOME FINN’. Adora glances at Catra with a wide smile to see her eyes were watery and glassy. Adora’s smile falls a little at seeing Catra’s expression. She *really* needed to get away from Bright Moon - that was exceptionally clear right now.

The squad comes over to them. "Y-You all really did this for Finn?" Catra asks emotionally. Scorpia looks at Adora who smiles a little awkwardly as she places her hand to Catra's back.

"For Finn, and you, and Adora," Scorpia answers. "But mostly Finn, yeah! Are... Are you okay?" Catra nods, letting out another sob as she gives the Horde crowd a big smile.

"You have no idea how much this means to me. This is the sweetest thing you could have done, guys. Thank you." Catra thanks them. Adora knows that it is a Magicat tradition to throw a party for a new heir, due to the circumstances surrounding Finn, they hadn't gotten that, and may even never get to have that, but the Fright Zone were providing one for their heir instead.

"It was Scorpia's idea." Lonnie says, punching Scorpia's bicep. "But they're a Horde brat too, so they deserve it." Catra purrs happily.

"Thank you, everyone. This is something that I'll never forget. Now... Why don't you all come and meet Finn, our little kitten!" She says as she holds Finn up for them to view. Scorpia rushes forward with the other Squad members.

"Can I hold them?" Scorpia gasps. "Oh... but my claws." Catra smiles, stepping closer to Scorpia and letting Finn put their little hands on one of her claws.

"Is that okay, Scorps?" Catra asks.

"They're so cute!" Scorpia says as they all coo at Finn. Adora watches in amusement and fondness.

"Guess they get that from Catra and not Adora." Lonnie comments.

"Hey!" Adora protests. "But you're right about Catra being cute, and Finn."

"They do look like a perfect combination of both me and Adora. At least I think so." Catra smiles as Finn giggles and claps at the attention.

"They're precious." Kyle coos next to Scorpia, his eyes bright at the sight of the adorable baby.

"Finn," Adora says, resting her hands on Catra's shoulders. "This is your aunts Scorpia and Lonnie, and your uncles Kyle and Rogelio."Finn looks at them curiously before grinning and giggling, clapping their little hands again.

"Looks like they're happy to meet you all as well." Catra says to them, lifting her gaze up to the group. "I'm glad."

"So," Lonnie starts. "How are things at the Rebellion?" Catra's smile seems to fall in a matter of seconds at the question. Adora doesn't blame her.

"Let's not talk about that right now." Catra says.

"I'm surprised Adora is still alive." Lonnie says. "I definitely thought it was 50/50."

"You and me both." Adora says, shoving Lonnie a little. "So... Are you in my room Scorpia?"

"Oh no, I'm still in my Force Captain quarters. It felt wrong to stay in your room." She says, still slightly distracted by Finn. "And the throne room is yours too, we're fixing up Horror Hall, the old throne room of the Scorpion Kingdom. Hordak's... Your throne is all yours still."

"I expect you all to still call me Lord." Adora says.

"As if we did in the first place." Lonnie responds.

"Well, as per usual, you can still call me Catra." Catra laughs at the interaction. "How about we all go inside and maybe I will take over the kitchen today. How does that sound?" She offers.

"You don't have to. As much as we love your cooking, you deserve a break. Today is about you and Finn, not us." Lonnie interrupts, shaking her head. Adora smiles. The Horde really do love Catra, all of them, and Adora can tell that this is a well deserved break for Catra already and they've only been here for about five minutes.

"You act as if I hate cooking for you all. I swear you all started approving of me when I cooked for you the first time." Catra says with amusement.

"That's definitely what won me over." Adora says lightly. "When you fed me food." Catra's eyebrows go up.

"You're kidding. That's what won you over?"

"Sure, if you want the PG version." Adora says as she playfully pats Catra on her butt. Catra gasps and playfully glares at Adora.

"Babe, not in front of the others and definitely not when I'm holding Finn." Catra scolds playfully. Adora holds her hands up in mock surrender and Lonnie rolls her eyes at the pair.

"Trust me, half the Fright Zone knows the non-PG version. You two were *loud* ." Lonnie says. "If you really want to cook, you can. But we've been getting better at it."

"I know, but that doesn't mean I need to punish you all with more noise." Catra says with a half nervous laugh. "Like I said, I want to, as a thank you for doing this celebration for Finn."

"We're not going to punish them with more noise?" Adora asks.

"After they did this whole surprise for us? No, babe." Adora pouts at Catra.

"Really?"

"Yes, really. Now, let's go inside. It'll take me a while to get everything ready for the food and I don't want everyone to eat too late. Plus, I imagine everyone else wants to meet Finn too." Catra says. Adora stays put.

"Not even a little noise?" Adora asks.

"Adora is..." Lonnie glances at Finn. "H word, surprise, surprise." Adora rolls her eyes at her friend.

"Before we go in, they have another surprise, ordered by yours truly." Adora says with a smile. It had been hard to organise the surprise considering Adora was pretty sure the Rebellion monitored her calls in case she was conspiring against them. She had been worried Catra might find out about it, but she was confident she hadn’t.

"Another surprise? Adora, you know you didn't have to ask them to do anything." Catra pouts at her and Adora grins. "What is it?"

"Scorpia." Adora says. Scorpia turns and a Horde soldier steps forward. "Okay, so, I know you noticed my suit at Princess Prom, so I had the same department make something for Finn." Adora says as Scorpia presents the little onesie with the small cape attached to it. "Ta-da." Adora smiles as she gestures to the suit. Catra blinks. Then she blinks again before a big grin crosses her features.

"Oh my gosh, is that what I think it is?" She asks.

"I'd say they match me but they stole my cape anyway." Adora jokes. They were currently wrapped in said cape.

"This is the cutest thing ever. I can't wait to see them with it on." Catra purrs, adjusting Finn and grabbing the onesie to take a closer look.

"They're going to look adorable." Adora says as she gently pets Finn's brown hair atop their head.

"Even more adorable than they do now, if that's even possible." Catra agrees.

"Here, gimme them." Adora makes grabby hands. "I'll change them." Catra hands Finn over to Adora carefully.

"You just want to be able to present them, huh?"

"Maybe." Adora says as she unwraps Finn from their ‘blanket’. She tosses it over her shoulder as she begins to undress Finn. Adora hands Catra their old onesie and then dresses them in the new one. Once she's done changing them, she lifts them up proudly. "Look at them, they're my little Lord."

"Awww, I love them so much." Catra's eyes shine with happy tears as she looks at their kitten. The joy of her life, of *both* of their lives.

"What about me?" Adora asks, wrapping Finn back up in their blanket. Catra looks at her.

"I love you too." She whispers, giving her a kiss. "Very much. Always and Forever."

"I love you too." Adora says, kissing Catra. "Go to the kitchens." Adora says, beginning to walk. "I have a Finn to show off."

"Make sure they're not too fidgety or they'll start crying!" Catra calls after her.

"I think I know how to look after my own baby." Adora responds. Catra rolls her eyes.

"Just get your cute butt moving and show our kitten off. I'll be in the kitchen, okay?"

"Yes ma'am." Adora says as she grins and holds Finn up, disappearing into the crowd of Horde soldiers.

* * *

Catra watches Adora disappear with Finn, her heart full. She could hardly believe that the Fright Zone had gone through so much effort for Finn. What had the Rebellion done for them other than try to take Adora away from them? "You really trust Adora not to drop that baby?" Lonnie asks, interrupting Catra's thoughts. She can tell Lonnie is *mostly* joking.

"Yeah, I trust her. She's carried me around more than enough times. I'm sure she can handle a 6 pound baby." Catra says with a chuckle.

"Sure, but Adora is pretty clumsy sometimes." Lonnie says. Catra can't deny that that is kind of true, but she knows Adora has it handled.

"It'll be okay." Catra glances over where Adora had been. "She'd throw herself to the floor first before letting Finn get hurt." Lonnie laughs.

"You're probably right," She admits. "You know, if you want some alone time with Adora, I'm sure one of Finn's aunts or uncles would gladly look after Finn."

"Maybe later. We're staying for a little while. It's nice to finally get away from there." Catra sighs with the relief she feels at just not having guards watching their every move,

"That bad?" Lonnie asks, gesturing in the direction of the kitchens.

"Terrible." Catra frowns. "I'm surprised they didn't send anyone to spy on us."

"Yikes," Lonnie says. "I thought Adora's plan was stupid. But it looks like it worked out?"

"Yeah, almost didn't though." Catra bites the inside of her cheek as she and Lonnie enter the kitchen. "The Princesses decided it would be fair to conduct the trial hours after I went into labor."

" *Hours* ?" Lonnie asks, whistling. "Wow, that's cold."

"The doctor had to use a magic wheelchair to help me get to the throne room." Catra adds as she begins grabbing ingredients. "And they almost didn't let me vote in the decision for Adora's case."

"How close did she come to losing her head?"

"Too close for my liking." Catra mutters.

"Adora knew what risk she was taking by surrendering," Lonnie says. "Even when we tried to convince her otherwise. It was the only way she saw you two being allowed to be together."

"She was putting her life at risk, and I was terrified." Catra says. She really wishes that Adora had given her a heads up warning about that.

"She didn't care about her life." Lonnie says carefully. Catra shakes her head.

"No, she didn't. I was so scared I was going to lose her, Lonnie. And C'yra had hurt her before the trial too."

"The scratches on her jaw? I noticed. That was C'yra?" Catra closes her eyes at the thought of the scars on Adora's jaw.

"It was. Even if she tried to play me for a fool and act as if she didn't do it." Catra almost growls at the thought, but she manages not to.

"I imagine Adora thinks it was worth it."

"Probably. Did I agree with it? No. But it can't be changed now."

"You know, in all her years as Lord and Force Captain, Adora has never put her life on the line like that. Sure, she'd go to battles and fight, but she'd never go into a battle to *die* . That's kind of what she did for you." Lonnie says. "At least it worked out."

"I'm relieved that it worked out. I don't know if my heart could have took losing her." Catra places her cooking utensil down for a moment. "I'm so glad I even had the strength to get up for that trial."

"No kidding, you popped a kid out *and* saved Adora's ass?" Lonnie asks. "That's impressive, you know, for a Princess." Lonnie teases. Catra snorts and rolls her eyes.

"I would hope so. I think I had literally finished giving birth two hours before Adora came to see me."

"She let the Princesses storm in here and arrest her, it was all very dramatic." Lonnie says. "We would've fought against them to protect Adora but she told us not to."

"Adora... Gosh, she's such an idiot. I love her, but I'm gonna smack her for doing that." Catra knew that Adora had surrendered but hearing how she just let the Princesses stroll in here and arrest her, and how *south* that all could've gone… Catra was lucky Adora was still alive.

"The Horde really is happy you're okay though, all three of you." Lonnie says. Catra stays silent for a while.

"I'm glad you're all okay too." She replies. The Horde very well may have suffered when Adora surrendered, but they hadn't, and now there was no war anymore. No one got hurt. Adora is the luckiest person alive, Catra is sure.

"You know, if the Rebellion, or whatever they call themselves now, are being assholes, you always have a home here."

"I know, believe me, I want to stay here. But I'm worried that the Rebellion will start up the war if I do." Catra sighs in exasperation. If only the Rebellion would let Adora out of their site, they may get to actually *live* and not be treated like the enemy.

"You really think they would?" Lonnie asks.

"They haven't given me any reason to trust that they wouldn't." Lonnie goes to respond when Adora walks into the kitchen, shushing a crying Finn.

"Catra, I think they're hungry." Catra looks towards Adora and holds her finger up.

"Give me a minute to wash my hands and I'll feed them." She says, going to the sink and washing her hands. She dries them off before taking Finn into her arms and adjusting her shirt to feed the hungry kitten. "How was the showing off our kitten tour, Love?"

"Everyone loves them, obviously." Adora answers. "Lonnie, look away." Adora orders. Catra rolls her eyes.

"Adora, I'm just feeding Finn. Stop being dumb." Catra scolds.

"Your boobs are for my eyes only." Adora says. Catra snorts. She loves that cute dummy so much.

"I'm *feeding* Finn. Stop being stupid, babe. Or I'm not gonna make chocolate cake for you later." Catra threatens lightly.

"Fine, fine," Adora says, kissing Catra on her head.

"You look weird without your cape." Lonnie comments.

"I feel weird without it."

"But it looks much cuter on Finn, don't you think?" Catra asks, holding the fabric in her hand. Lonnie nods.

"For sure. And now she can't do that stupid cape swish thing that she thinks is cool." Lonnie says.

"I- Excuse me? That cape swish thing is cool, right Catra?" Adora looks at her and Catra freezes. Adora looks so offended, and she really did love that cape.

"Well..." Catra says awkwardly.

"What do you mean well?" Adora turns to her and she looks extremely offended - it’s kind of cute honestly.

"The cape swish was cool when we kissed." Catra admits.

"But you don't think it was cool other than that?"

"Not really. I like your cape more for the grabbing purposes." Catra shrugs. She liked grabbing Adora and dragging her in for kisses. She admits that the cape did really work for Adora, and she knows that it was important to Adora. Adora just stares at Catra.

"I can't believe this," She says. "I'm deeply hurt and betrayed."

"You're being very dramatic, you baby." Catra rolls her eyes.

"No," Adora says, putting her arms out. "Give me my child."

"As you can see, they're still eating. You know they take a while. They inherited your appetite."

"Damn right they did." Adora says proudly. "Babies sure do eat a lot."

"They have to. They're growing rapidly and need all the nutrients to do so." Catra explains.

"Do you really think my cape is uncool?" Adora asks.

"Usually." Catra replies.

"I want a divorce. Immediately." Adora states. Catra rolls her eyes. Adora is so dramatic.

"You're married?" Lonnie asks.

"Engaged." Catra answers. "Wedding is in a few months once we get the planning underway. We're kind of hoping to have it here."

"You want to get married here?" Lonnie asks. "Seriously?"

"I do," Catra is aware that it's probably unusual to *want* to get married in the Fright Zone. "Is that okay?"

"I mean, it's your wedding," Lonnie says. "It's just surprising, that's all. Never really saw the Fright Zone as wedding material."

"It's because I want you all to be there. And that wouldn't be possible if it was in Half-Moon." Catra answers. Not to mention, Catra isn't really sure how she feels about Half-Moon anymore.

"Would your honeymoon be here too?" Lonnie asks. Catra looks uncertain.

"That... I'll need to figure it out." Catra admits.

"What about Mystacor?" Adora asks. "Or Somewhere else if that's not good."

"I doubt Mystacor would let us in." Catra says. Most likely because Micah's *aunt* is basically in charge of that place.

"Maybe somewhere else then?" Adora suggests. "I don't think the Fright Zone is... honeymoon material."

"Probably not, but I feel like we could make the best out of anywhere we go." Catra says. Adora smiles a little.

"I have a lot of plans for our honeymoon."

"I imagine." Catra laughs. "I imagine most of said plans aren't kitten appropriate?"

"Nope." Adora pops the 'p'. "Which is why I said no more. Because you get mad at me for saying things in front of Finn even though they can't understand me."

"Because little kids learn quickly and the last thing we need is saying inappropriate things around them."

"I'm getting better at not saying inappropriate innuendos." Catra raises an eyebrow at Adora.

"Yeah, not really." Catra replies.

"Yes I am." Adora protests. Catra looks at Lonnie and then back at Adora.

"We'll have to agree to disagree on that subject."

"Ignore Lonnie, why don't you tell me what I've said?" Adora asks.

"I can't say them with Finn here." Catra points out.

"You have no evidence, therefore, I win, and I'm right." Adora says, crossing her arms over her chest with a smug grin. What a fucking dork.

"Uh huh, whatever floats your boat, babe." Catra says, rolling her eyes.

" *You* float my boat." *That* is a sexual innuendo, but Catra's pretty sure Adora already knows that and that's why she said it.

"Which I can't do for at least a month, by the way." Catra says.

"A month?! What? But you said..." Adora drops her arms. "You said... You should be healed by now, right?"

"You do realise I pushed an entire being out of me not too long ago, right?" Catra asks with a raised brow.

"It was like a month ago, that's so much time." Catra shakes her head at her fiancee.

"Unfortunately, all the stress from during the pregnancy is causing me to heal slower." Catra pats Adora on the top of her bicep.

"I can't tell if you're messing with me. Are you messing with me?"

"You seriously think I'd joke about my healing process?"

"I don't know. Maybe?"

"Yeah, I'm gonna... I'm gonna go," Lonnie says, excusing herself. Catra watches her go. "Looking forward to the food Catra!" She calls before she exits. Catra turns her attention

back to the big pouty blonde. Adora looks back at Catra before she leans against one of the counters.

"Why didn't you tell me?" She asks.

"About the healing thing?"

"Yeah about the healing thing." Catra exhales heavily, adjusting her hold on Finn.

"Because we were trying to figure out the whole trial thing first and then coming to visit the Fright Zone." Catra explains. She didn't exactly want to sit and talk to Adora about why they couldn't have sex yet.

"Okay..." Adora frowns a little. "Are you in pain?"

"Mostly sore. Nothing too bad. But the doctor said I'm not allowed to do any strenuous activities. Hence why I asked to take the skiff here."

"Strenuous activities? As in...?"

"No heavy exercise. No running, or jumping. No heavy lifting. Definitely no... intimate activities for a while. Anything that could risk the sutures from tearing really." Adora makes a sound and winces a little. That is exactly why Catra didn't talk to Adora about this.

"Tearing..." She says before she sighs and comes towards Catra. She wraps her arms around her, being mindful of Finn. "I mean, I'm a little disappointed, I won't lie, but your well-being is more important to me. It's not like I have my sword anyway." Catra purrs and snuggles into Adora.

"Thank you for being so thoughtful. I love you and I'm grateful." Catra says. She gently pats Adora on her cheek and the blonde hums.

"You did give birth to my child." Adora says. "I guess I'll just have to service myself for now." Catra could totally be into watching that if she's honest. She licks her lips before she turns to look at Adora better.

"I mean, I could still use my mouth." Catra points out. She sees Adora freeze and her breath hitch. Catra smirks a little. Sometimes it's nice to know that Adora likes Catra doing things to her as much as Catra likes Adora doing things to her.

"Did your doctor say when you'd be fully healed? Because it's killing me a little that I can't touch you like that in return." Adora responds. Catra chuckles and leans up to kiss Adora on her cheek.

"Within the next few weeks. But they said it would be best to wait a month to ensure that I completely heal." Catra knows that a month is a long time, and she misses Adora's touch as much as Adora misses touching her, but what can she do? She needs to *heal* . Besides, sex isn't everything - even if she really misses it.

"Do you know how long it's been since I last touched you like that?" Adora asks. She sounds and looks upset.

"A long time. You don't think I know that, Adora?" Catra asks in disbelief.

"It's been five months, *six* when you're fully healed." Adora says. "Because we were separated. And it's not your fault, it's not my fault either, and I know it's probably a stupid thing to be upset about, I mean, we have a baby, so I didn't expect it to be like how it was when you came... well... here. But... I guess... I'm just... frustrated that all that time was stolen from us, time we won't get back, and I can't be intimate with you like that."

"I know, Adora, I'm frustrated too." Catra whispers, looking down at Finn as they finally pull away and snuggle against her with a big sleepy yawn. "I get your frustration. But there isn't anything we can do about it, alright?"

"No, it isn't, I hate that," Adora says. "I thought I was getting better at letting things go, but I guess not."

"To be fair, losing nearly half a year of time together because of people being assholes is hard to let go." Catra certainly hadn’t let it go yet.Adora lets out a soft breath of laughter. It isn't funny, but the way Catra phrases it makes her laugh anyway.

"Fine, I guess I can wait, but when I can finally touch you... You're going to need water and food on standby." Catra smiles.

"Understood, I'll make sure to ask Spinny and ‘Tossa to take care of Finn for a few days." Catra says.

"So what do you want to do in the Fright Zone if not that?" Adora asks. "I kind of thought that was why we were here." Of course she did. Catra isn’t even slightly surprised by that.

"I wanted to get away from Half-Moon and Bright Moon."

"Yeah, that's understandable," Adora says, reaching her hands out for Finn so Catra could continue cooking. "It's nice not having guards breathing down my neck."

"Or not have people glaring at you all day." Catra turns back around after giving Finn to Adora, fixing her shirt before continuing cooking. "Or having to be wary of everyone around you."

"At least the townspeople seem to be warming up to me." Adora says as she begins to burp Finn.

"After I snapped at them for attacking you." Catra still couldn’t believe that they had *attacked* Adora.

"I'm the Horde Lord, did you expect people to just accept me?" Adora asks.

"No, I didn't. But they didn't need to put their hands on you."

"I admit it caught me off guard," Adora says before she frowns. "Shadow Weaver would be so disappointed." Catra turns around, stuffing Adora's mouth with a piece of chocolate.

"No."

" *Mmm-* !" Adora mumbles before her eyes light up at the taste. She happily chews and swallows before she looks back at Catra. "Not that I don't like chocolate, but why?"

"Distraction from you getting stuck in your negative thoughts again." Catra answers simply as she turns back around to continue cooking.

"She's here. Do you think we should do something with her?" Adora asks cautiously. "I feel... Not bad, but... I don't know. If I can be better, maybe she can too, you know?" Catra freezes mid-chop before sighing. She thinks it’s endearing that Adora thinks that, she really does, but it is extremely unlikely.

"Adora, I understand that she's the woman that basically raised you, but she did it for the purposes of using you. She has no remorse for her actions, Love. She won't change." This says a lot coming from Catra. She will be the first to stand up for ex-Horde soldiers, but some people are just *evil* , some people don’t deserve the chance or a redemption, Shadow Weaver is one of those people.

"But what if she could?" Adora asks. Catra inhales sharply.

"She won't."

"You sound very sure."

"I am." Catra answers, continuing what she was doing as she tries to keep her anger in check. She gets why Adora was hoping that Shadow Weaver would change, she does, but she is only setting herself up for hurt. Shadow Weaver *won't* change. Catra just wants to make sure

"Really wish you weren't holding a knife right now for what I'm about to say," Adora laughs nervously. "I want to go see her."

"Why?" Catra asks with confusion. She's pretty sure that they both mutually agreed that Shadow Weaver was *not* good for Adora. Adora sighs as she rocks Finn in her arms.

"You know I've been trying to learn more about She-Ra. Shadow Weaver raised me, since I was a baby, if there's anyone who knows about me and She-Ra... it's her." Adora answers. Catra hates that that actually makes a lot of sense. Catra sighs.

"Adora, you do realise that this is a really bad idea, right?"

"Look, I promised you that I wouldn't listen to her anymore, and I haven't, not even when I went to see her before I surrendered. If you're with me, she can't do anything." Adora pauses. "But you can say no, I wouldn't want to subject you to her. She can be really mean... and cruel... She's said things about you before that made me angry."

"Will this give you closure, Love?" Catra asks.

"I don't know... I hope so."

"Then, okay." Catra concedes.

"Okay?" Adora asks. "Okay, yeah, tomorrow?"

"Yeah, we can ask Lonnie and Scorpia to watch Finn in the meantime. I don't want to let that woman anywhere near our kitten."

"Agreed." Adora says as she leans against the counter beside Catra. "I love you." Catra smiles, leaning towards Adora and kissing her lips.

"And I love you, dummy. Do you want another piece of chocolate? I was making dessert first, so the cake can cool while I make everything else."

"Obviously I want more chocolate, who are you talking to?"

"To my soon-to-be wife, obviously."

"Can you believe Perfuma implied our relationship might be unhealthy? Pffft." Adora rolls her eyes as she takes a piece of chocolate. Catra blinks.

"I'm sorry, what?" This was news to her. Her fur stands on end a little.

"At one of my therapy sessions," Adora says, not noticing Catra's reaction. "I told her she was crazy, and to mind her business, but she said she was worried we might develop an unhealthy codependency on each other, since we spend so much time together, and also because pretty much everyone hates my guts who isn't you with the exception of a few others." *Oh* . That actually made a lot more sense.

"It's a valid concern." Catra admits after contemplating it for a few seconds. "But we've been apart from each other for nearly half a year, so I think it makes sense why we want to keep the other close."

"Wait, you think that's a valid concern?"

"A little. What I mean is, Perfuma wasn't saying that with any ill intent. She's a therapist for a reason. She's just worried that we might get to the point where we can't function without the other being nearby." Catra explains.

"Is that a bad thing?"

"It can be, yes. But I think we're okay right now. Like I said, we were apart for a really long time and we just got to see each other again after... a lot." Catra smiles softly in an attempt to soothe Adora. "Though maybe it's a topic of discussion to bring up when you go to Perfuma next time."

"Okay..." Adora says after a moment. "So what are you making?"

"Well, I was planning to make a big batch of spaghetti for everyone. It's a lot easier, especially since you guys were able to have noodles here too." Adora smiles a little.

"You talk like I'm still the Lord."

"You kind of are. They still treat you that way. Only difference is they aren't terrified of you because they realised you're a big softie." Catra teases gently.

"I'm not..." Adora stops. "Maybe a little bit." She sighs as she thinks for a moment. "I'm not Lord anymore, that's... weird to think about."

"I can only imagine, Love. I mean," Catra rests her head on Adora's shoulder, leaning up and kissing her jaw. "You're the Lord of my heart." Adora blushes for a moment before she bursts out into laughter.

"That is the cheesiest thing you've ever said to me."

"Okay, that can't possibly be true." Catra shoves Adora - gently, since she was holding Finn.

"The Lord of your heart?" Adora asks. Catra blushes a little. Now that Adora had said it back to her, yeah, she could hear how cheesy that was.

"It's the truth." Catra winks before straightening back up.

"I just... I feel useless." Adora confesses.

"You aren't useless, babe." Catra shakes her head. "But why do you feel that way?"

"I don't have a... goal?" Adora says. "You know, I spent twenty four years of my life with a single goal: destroy the Rebellion and the Princesses." Adora sighs before she smiles as Finn lets out a purr in their sleep. "And I'm happy making you and Finn my priority but... I don't really *do* anything. I mean, I help rebuild, but people don't like me and they think I only do that because it's part of my punishment. I just... I want to help more, or do something more... I need a *purpose* ." That all makes a lot of sense to Catra. Adora is a very driven person, without something to drive towards, it makes sense she would feel as though she was failing or being useless.

"I see. Then maybe we can try to figure out things that you enjoy doing?" Catra suggests. "Like hobbies. Maybe finding one you like will help you figure out what you'd like to do?"

"I'd like to do you." Adora mumbles.

"Aside from doing me, babe." Catra says, rolling her eyes, smiling softly at the comment. Weirdly, Adora’s sexual innuendos can sometimes be very romantic. It’s an Adora thing.

"I'll consider it."

"Good. You're a detail-oriented person. Why don't you try something that requires you to focus on a lot of little details?" Catra suggests. She has no idea what that is, but she has faith

that Adora will figure something out.

"I know you're not trying to be sexy right now but you *are* being sexy." Adora says. Catra laughs in amusement.

"Babe, I'm trying to help you out here."

"I know, I just don't know what that could be."

"That's why we'll take some time to figure it out, yeah? Or you could even ask Perfuma for some ideas as well." Adora smiles and then moves in to kiss Catra on her jaw, kissing her along the bone, it makes Catra *shiver* .

"Have we got time to make out?" Adora asks quietly.

"We can't really make out when you're holding Finn, babe." Catra points out.

"Sure we can," Adora says, adjusting Finn carefully. "All you gotta do is kiss me." Catra shakes her head at her fiancee.

"You know how we get when we try kissing each other." Catra giggles, giving Adora a few soft kisses on her lips anyway. "We get… distracted." The last thing Catra needed to do right now was burn down the Fright Zone.

"Distracted is one way to put it." Adora whispers before she kisses Catra on her lips again. She pauses, after a moment, before she rests her forehead against Catra's. "I can't believe we got here. After everything. It's a miracle we're both still alive."

"I'd say we were meant to be here." Catra closes her eyes, humming quietly. "We jumped through a lot of obstacles to get to this moment and we made it."

"We made it." Adora repeats.

"And now, I think we can say we're the cutest couple in all of Etheria." Catra says with a grin.

"Damn right." Adora agrees.

"And we have the cutest kid in all of Etheria." Catra nuzzles them gently in Adora's arms.

"You and I made a baby, obviously they are the cutest baby in existence." Adora says.

"True." Catra admits. Catra is not above admitting that Adora is exceptionally good looking, she had good genes. "This is random, but I wonder how different things would be if we were born in a different place in life."

"You know, Hordak found me as a baby," Adora says. "I ended up in the Horde just by being in the wrong place, at the wrong time. Talk about bad luck, huh?"

"Yeah, that is kind of bad luck." Catra frowns. "It really sucks."

"Could you really see me being a Princess though?" Adora asks. Catra looks at her, humming softly. She imagines Princess Adora, Adora growing up in the Rebellion, knowing love and acceptance and being free from pain.

"Yes, actually." Catra says - maybe more hopes. Adora deserved that upbringing.

"Really?" Adora asks, clearly unconvinced. Catra nods.

"You're a giant softie."

"Is that the criteria for being a Princess?"

"Hmm, to some extent."

"What's the other criteria?" Adora asks. " *Sparkle* ?" Catra snorts at her fiancee. Typical Adora jokes. Catra doesn't point out that she's a Princess and she doesn't 'sparkle' as Adora said.

"As if. Honestly, there are too many Princesses to really put into a single criteria." Catra responds.

"I think you would've made a good Force Captain." Adora says, surprising Adora. It's not something Catra has ever really thought about. Her? A Horde soldier? A *Force Captain* ? That was just… Catra looks at Adora.

"Huh, that is such a weird thought." Catra admits.

"Maybe," Adora shrugs. "There's a reason I kidnapped you though. You're very smart, tactical, you'd make amazing battle plans, which is great Force Captain material. You're driven... And pretty."

"You're flattering me, my love." Catra smiles, feelings and looking a little flustered - especially at the pretty comment. "Hey, when do you think you began to fall for me?"

"Unofficially? When we first met. Officially? Probably those first few days. But when we danced on the tower, that's when I knew something had changed." Adora answers.

"When we danced, that's really romantic." Catra purrs at the memory. That was essentially their first date together and Adora had been a giant romantic without realising she was being

a giant romantic.

"What about you?" Adora asks.

"Unofficially? When I had the chance to get to know the real you. Officially? The time we spent together before I asked you if you had feelings." Adora winces a little.

"Right..." She says, awkwardly. Catra knows that Adora regrets how she reacted that day. "Are we going to address that we fraternized before Princess Prom?'

"Why don't you start that conversation off?" Catra asks, paying attention to what she was currently doing.

"The fact that you kissed me that one time at a battle, what was that about?" Adora asks. Catra clears her throat.

"Here I thought you forgot about that." Catra mumbles. It had been… A weird day. Catra had absolutely not meant to kiss Adora that day, yet it had still happened. There has always been this magnetism between them, an inevitability, an attraction. Catra just never thought they would get *here* .

"I remember every time you've kissed me." Adora says. That is weirdly romantic of her.

"Dork.” Catra teases. “I think at the time it was a rush of emotions and a… misjudgement, you could say."

"Kissing the Horde Lord? Probably." Adora grins. "You really did panic after that."

"You thought I wouldn't have panicked after kissing my supposed enemy and practically making out with her in the middle of battle in a place where anyone could have stumbled upon us?" Catra deadpans, raising an eyebrow. Adora rolls her eyes.

"Sure didn't panic when I was strap deep in you at a later date." Catra snorts.

"We were in *private* , and I was attempting to seduce you to get you to release me."

"Seduce me? You *liked* me." Adora says.

"Maybe I did, but I sure as hell wasn't gonna admit it then." Catra replies with a smile. She had liked Adora, she was weirdly charming, even when she was supposed to be Catra's enemy.

"And I gave you the option to leave with no sex. You chose to stay." Adora points out.

"I was curious!" Catra protests.

"You can say that again."

"I was curious." Catra says, sticking her tongue out.

"I was curious too." Adora admits. "We had fun though, right?"

"Yeah…" Catra smiles wistfully. "We had a lot of fun. I felt like I had gotten to know a side of you that I had never known existed."

"I think you were the first person to see that side of me."

"And I was surprised to be the first person."

"Really?" Adora asks, raising an eyebrow. "It's very rare I let people close to me."

"I know, but I guess I thought... others might have had the opportunity first." Catra shrugs a little.

"Romantically?" Adora asks. Catra laughs softly.

"In general." She clarifies.

"Scorpia maybe. And the Squad. But even they..." Adora trails off. "They're Horde, so I guess a lot of me they see as being normal, but you, you pointed out when things that happened to me were messed up."

"I remember." Catra murmurs, looking a little sad. "It was concerning to see how much you thought was normal that wasn't." Adora used to think that being *tortured* was normal. She thought the abuse she suffered by Shadow Weaver's hands was perfectly normal. It had taken Catra a while to convince her that wasn't true.

"I can't imagine treating this little one like that." Adora says, snuggling Finn closer.

"I know. Finn deserves the world." Catra watches her little family with a soft purr. "So do you."

"I don't know about me," Adora says. "But you sure do too."

"You do, you deserve the world, Adora. You deserve to be happy." Catra says. Adora smiles a little before she kisses Finn.

"You should talk to your mom." Adora says suddenly. Again with this. Catra appreciates that Adora is just trying to be supportive, but she really doesn't feel like talking to C'yra, or 'fixing' anything.

"I'm not going to do that." Catra frowns deeply. "It's not worth it."

"It's not worth talking to your mom?"

"No, it isn't." Catra sighs. "It would be a waste of time."

"You don't know that."

"Yes, I do know that. Why? Because my supposed 'mother' refused to even acknowledge that what I was trying to tell her was the truth. I'm not going to talk to her. She couldn't even believe you despite putting you under a truth spell, Adora." Catra points out. Adora means no harm, but she needs to accept this now.

"In fairness, I was taught how to resist those."

"In all fairness, she can go eat sh-" Catra pauses, glancing down at Finn. "She can choke on her stubbornness and denial." Adora sighs and then sits down on a nearby stool.

"You really want to get married without your moms there?" Adora asks.

"It's not that I don't want them there. But they won't approve anyway. I don't want to deal with the judgement, or C'yra possibly doing something to mess up the wedding." Catra bites the inside of her cheek. "It's supposed to be a happy day for us, I don't want her to ruin it."

"Okay," Adora clearly decides to drop the subject of Catra's moms being at their wedding, not wanting to upset Catra. "Do you ever think you'll forgive her?" Adora asks carefully. Catra sighs.

"I don't know.” Catra admits. “Maybe when she actually shows some sort of guilt for what she did and said."

"That's fair." Adora concedes.

"Yeah, but, in the meantime, she's not allowed near Finn."

"Just C'yra, right?" Adora asks nervously. Catra nods at her. "Oh good," Adora says. "Because I've definitely let Luna hold them."

"That's okay. Luna... wasn't terrible."

"She… Wasn't terrible?" Adora asks, looking confused.

"You heard me." Catra huffs softly.

"Luna was great." Adora says with confusion. "Wasn't she?"

"She... was absent." Catra explains. It had mostly been Bow, Spinnerella and Netossa supporting her. She knew that Luna had at least tried however, and that she had been trying to restrain C’yra, so she wasn’t totally mad at her. Still, it was hard to see all that. Sometimes Catra had just wanted to cuddle her mom.

"She did a lot to protect you." Adora says. Catra remains quiet for a time.

“Maybe it'll be worth talking to Luna." Catra murmurs to herself as she moves around the kitchen. "Can you hand me the big pot please?" Adora moves over to one of the cabinets and adjusts Finn in one arm to grab the pot with her free hand. She walks back over to Catra.

"Was that a ploy to get to see my muscles?" She asks. Catra grabs the pot from her and rolls her eyes.

"As if I don't see them most of the times anyways." She giggles. "I need to make the sauce for the pasta."

"This is nice," Adora says, leaning against the counter. "It makes me think about us living together. Which we really need to do, as soon as we can convince your mom I don't need to be in Bright Moon and Half-Moon, under guard 24/7."

"Good luck to the both of us trying to do that. I doubt C'yra will really ever let us do that. Not without having some sort of tracking spell or something on us." Catra sighs. "I kind of wish we had run away sometimes, but I didn't want to leave the rest of the others here to deal with our mess either."

"I know." Adora says. "Who knows what would have happened if we'd ran away. I'd probably be accused of kidnapping."

"Yeah, probably, it would have been messy. Rather messier than how things are now." But they would have been *free* . Sometimes Catra thinks that would have been worth that.

"We have to believe it'll get better." Adora says. Catra shrugs.

"I think you may have to believe that for both of us."

"Then I will."

"Which is good. One of us has to." Catra offers a tired smile. "And I'm still trying to get used to being out of Bright Moon and Half-Moon, so it's going to take me a while." Adora sighs a little.

"Okay, yeah." She leans forward to kiss Catra on the jaw. "This is like a vacation, we don't need to be on guard here, you can relax."

"Yeah, relax." Catra purrs softly, taking a deep breath before exhaling. "Thank goodness."

"Yeah, relax," Adora repeats with a grin. "You can kiss me as much as you please."

"That- you're such a dork."

"A dork that you love and you're gonna marry."

"That's very true." Catra's tired smile grows into a happier one. "I get to marry you. I really get to marry the person I love."

"Yes you do, and I get to eat your food for the rest of my life."

"Is that why you're marrying me?" Catra teases.

"And I get to eat you too." Adora wiggles her eyebrows. Catra pauses. *Is she for real?* This is exactly just like Adora. She makes Catra *laugh* , and she loves that about her.

"Oh my gosh, Adora." Catra says, hitting her gently on her shoulder.

"You love me, you can't take that back now."

"Somehow." Catra says fondly. "Don't push it, dummy."

"Do you need help?" Adora asks. "Or am I on baby holding duty?"

"You're absolutely on baby holding duty." Catra looks back at her. "Last thing I need is for you to accidentally hurt yourself and I end up having to soothe both you and Finn."

"Pffft, I wouldn't hurt myself."

"Uh huh..." Catra says, unconvinced.

"I wouldn't!" Adora protests. Catra stares at her blankly, raising an eyebrow in question. "Okay, fine, *maybe* . But the kisses would be worth it."

"I can give you kisses without you getting hurt, Adora."

"Yeah? Prove it."

"Come here. I have my hands busy, but you can get your kisses." Adora smiles and shuffles closer to Catra. Catra kisses her, gently cupping one side of her jaw with her hand. "I love you." Catra whispers against her lips.

"Really? This is brand new information." Adora jokes - seems she’s full of jokes today.

"Brand new? You must have forgotten quite a bit if this is new information." Catra says, rolling her eyes before turning back to her cooking. Adora chuckles and nudges Catra with her shoulder.

"I'd never forget the first time you told me you loved me." Adora says.

"Hmm, is that so?"

"Sure, and then I blew up our entire relationship because I panicked."

"You didn't blow up our relationship, Love."

"You went into grief and almost died." Adora deadpans.

"Hey, you didn't know that would happen." Catra points out. She didn't blame Adora for that at *all* .

"Still." Adora shrugs. "Did you know that would happen?" Catra presses her lips together.

"I... kind of." Catra admits.

"Kind of?"

"Well, grieving usually happens when a Magicat loses their mate. Like... their mate passes." Catra explains.

"So why did you go into grieving?" Adora asks. Catra bites her lip.

"I think it was because I felt like I lost you and I knew I would never be able to talk about it with anyone because of who you were." Catra explains. "I couldn't even think back to our more tender moments without wanting to cry." She had known she was bonded to Adora, knew that being mates with her would destroy her if she said she didn't feel the same way.

"I know what you mean," Adora says sadly. "Not the 'not being able to talk about it' thing, but whenever I thought about... us... I just felt... angry."

"Angry?" Catra asks. Adora sighs.

"I don't know? Confused? Which made me angry." Adora says. "That's why I destroyed the farm. You know punching things is therapy in the Horde."

"Not the best kind of therapy, but go on." Catra encourages.

"The only emotion I felt... safe... expressing, was anger. I was angry, but I don't think it was at you. It was aimed at myself. At *everything* . When I stabbed you, I snapped out of it." Adora says.

"Yeah, I know." Catra stops cooking for a moment, focusing her full attention on Adora. "I remember hearing you."

"Hearing me?"

"When I was semi-conscious."

"You heard me talk?" Adora asks.

"Kind of. I don't remember what you said, but I heard your voice." She recalls Adora screaming, she had sounded so *pained* . She knew that she had succeeded in freeing her from the Black Garnet’s corruption, and she had made her peace dying if it meant that Adora was okay. Adora looks at Catra.

"I told you I loved you." She says. "And I told you to hold on."

"And I did."

"Sort of," Adora says. "I'm pretty sure you stopped breathing at one point before Glimmer snatched you away."

"Well, I'm here." Catra reminds her. "And I'm okay."

"The only thing that stopped me giving myself to the Rebellion and letting them kill me was Scorpia." Adora admits.

"Oh..." Catra frowns a little. She hadn't really known that Adora was that close to giving up.

"She was convinced you'd live." Adora says.

"I've always been a stubborn person. I'm not surprised." Catra responds.

"You can say that again." Adora mumbles.

" *Hey* !" Catra cries out, pretending to be offended.

"What? You are stubborn." Adora grins, clearly aiming to tease Catra.

"As if you can talk." Catra says with a roll of her eyes.

"I can, thank you very much."

"You're just as stubborn."

"Not as stubborn as you." Adora responds. Catra laughs.

"As if."

"See, you're being stubborn right now." Adora says.

"No I'm not." Catra says, shaking her head. Adora laughs with amusement.

"Uh huh."

"And why are you laughing?" Catra asks Adora, feeling herself smile at how happy Adora seemed to be right now.

"Because you are being stubborn, and by saying you're not, you are." Adora explains.
"Irony." Catra grumbles.

"It's not ironic."

"You're cute when you're grumpy."

"And you're cute when you're not teasing me." Catra fires back at her.

"I'm always teasing you." Adora points out

"Exactly." Catra says, grinning.

"I-" Adora stops. Catra cackles at Adora’s offended and bewildered expression before she kisses her on the lips. She really does love this woman with all of her heart. They keep teasing each other like that, Catra shoving Adora playfully, Adora somehow gets spaghetti in her hair, but for the first time in a while, Catra feels lighter. She’s *happy* . She couldn’t be happier. She just hoped that didn’t change.

* * *

Adora walks back to her room after having given Finn over to Lonnie and Scorpia's care since both she and Catra had agreed that it was best Shadow Weaver didn't meet them. Adora stops in the doorway of her room and leans against it. She lets her eyes take in the entirety of Catra's figure. She was as beautiful as ever. Adora couldn’t believe that she was going to *marry* her. "I left Finn with Lonnie and Scorpia," Adora announces. "You look very beautiful, have I told you that before?"

Catra lifts her attention from the mirror she had been using to help style her hair and focuses on Adora, a smile on her face. Catra had gotten dressed in Adora’s absence and after helping Adora get Finn ready to be left in Lonnie and Scorpia's care. "You've said it quite a few times, yes. How are you feeling?"

"I feel fine." Adora responds, even if she doesn't really feel that way. She steps inside of the room and walks towards Catra, bending down to kiss her. "Better when I have you." She confesses. Adora is pretty sure that she could face anything so long as she had Catra by her side. Adora hesitates, thinking for a moment. "Maybe you should stay here." Adora says. She didn’t want Catra to be hurt, and Adora knows that Shadow Weaver can hurt people with more than just her magic - her words are just as hurtful.

Catra returns her kiss, pulling back to kiss Adora on the forehead as well. "Not a chance. I'm not letting you face that woman alone, Love. You need support, and I'm going to be there for you.” Adora lifts her eyebrows a little before she swallows nervously. “And I can tell you're nervous. I don't want you to feel like you have to do this by yourself."

"I feel as though I'm purposely..." Adora pauses as she thinks. "I'm putting you in danger? Exposing you to pure evil."

"You're not putting me in danger." Catra pinches Adora's cheek and Adora pulls a face in response. "Are you forcing me to go with you?"

"Well, no… But this was my idea, and of course you want to come, because you're you." Adora replies. Exposing Catra to Shadow Weaver seems like a cruelty. Adora feels as though she should probably go alone.

"You're focusing on the wrong thing here, Love. You're not forcing me to go with you. I want to go because I want to support you while you try to get closure from your past. I want to be there for you because I love you." Catra says. Adora sighs and stares at Catra for a moment before she turns and walks away.

"You don't understand," Adora says as she walks into the throne room. "I love you too. I know I've told you things about her but," Adora turns back to look at Catra. "She is... You've never met her before. She has a way of getting under your skin." That was putting it mildly. Shadow Weaver was quite literally possibly the worst person on Etheria.

"And that's why it's good that we're *both* going. To make sure we bring each other back if she does managed to do it somehow." Catra leans up, grabbing Adora's hand and pulling her back towards her. "Please, Love, let me be there to be your support."

"I have to tell you something." Adora says, looking at their joined hands. "Something I did." Adora says carefully. She's worried, worried that after she tells Catra what she did that she will think less of her.

"Okay, then tell me. I'm listening." Catra looks soft and open, as she usually does, and Adora is so rarely afraid to tell her things but she is afraid. Adora is *terrified* that Catra will one day realise how much of a terrible person she is and leave her.

"After the battle," Adora says slowly. "The battle at Bright Moon, when I was... Corrupted." Adora winces a little at the memory. "When I came back here I... I almost killed Shadow Weaver." Adora confesses. She watches Catra closely as she tells her.

Catra stays quiet for a few seconds, probably thinking about how to answer. She pulls her hands away from Adora's, causing Adora to panic a little, but she only reaches up and cups Adora's face. "I don't blame you." She whispers. "I know that you're still struggling to acknowledge this to the fullest extent, but that woman abused you since you were a little kid, my love. She mistreated you, used you, made you into this angry shell of a soldier that she wanted you to be. She wanted to destroy all of the soft sides of you because you... You're kind, and you would not have stayed under her thumb for so long had you realised the true extent to what she wanted you to do and be." Catra explains, as best as she can.

"That anger was building up for a while because you felt a sense of betrayal when you realised that she was using you, but you still saw her as a maternal figure of some sort, right? I think that image broke when you finally came to and realised what she tricked you into doing. You were hurt, and she was to blame for what happened. In reality, you probably aren't the only one that she has hurt and she probably deserved it. So please don't think that I see you as any less of the beautiful, loving person that I fell in love with." Adora lifts her hands and wraps them around Catra's wrists to slowly bring her hands down from her face.

"You should probably think less of me," Adora says. She has never felt so angry before, she wouldn't have stopped punching Shadow Weaver if Scorpia had not intervened. "Are you never afraid that I'll hurt you?" Adora asks quietly. She thinks she would *break* if Catra was ever worried that she would hurt her.

"No, I'm not afraid." Catra answers Adora's question without hesitation. "Because I know that you love me. I know that you care about me. I know that you're doing your best to grow, and to be a better person, and I can see that effort each and every day that I spend with you."

"I was angry," Adora admits. "But I still shouldn't have done what I did. Almost killing her? Does that not make me like her?" Adora feels like it might. What kind of person beats a person almost to death? She had felt so numb while doing it. Adora has killed people before but they've always been attacking her too, she's never almost killed a defenceless person, not directly anyway, until that day.

"No, it doesn't make you like her. What she did to you… She had no valid reason to do it. Perhaps you shouldn't have handled it the way you did, but she deserved it after all the pain she put you, and who knows how many others, through." Catra purses her lips. "What I mean to say is, you aren't like her, Adora, by any means."

"You're biased." Adora says but she smiles a little. She takes Catra’s hand and begins to lead her out of the throne room. "I... She tried to make me like her."

"Maybe, but I call things as I see them." Catra smiles. "You didn't become like her." Catra squeezes Adora's hand. "You're better than her. You outgrew her, Love." Adora doesn't say anything else as they walk down the hallways of the Fright Zone. Catra is probably right, but Adora doesn’t really want to dwell on it anymore.

"Are you enjoying being away?" Adora asks. Catra seems to know that Adora doesn't want to continue talking about the topic, so she drops it.

"I am, it's nice to be able to walk around freely.

""More than just freely," Adora says. "We're practically royalty here." Adora smiles as passing Horde soldiers nod at her respectfully. "I miss it."

"Honestly, me too." Catra sighs. "It's nice being here where everyone is okay with us being together."

"Sure, that," Adora agrees. "And *respected* . I'm not respected in Bright Moon, I'm not *anything* in Bright Moon."

"I'm sorry about that. I wish things were different but..." Catra looks away, obviously feeling a little guilty about the circumstances.

"It's not your fault," Adora points out, kissing Catra on the side of her head. "I just miss... I miss being the Lord of the Horde, I guess."

"I know. Honestly, I wish we could just find somewhere to move to where we could just be us." Catra purses her lips. "Like, imagine we could move the Fright Zone somewhere where the Rebellion can't reach us, where we could just live like we're our own little kingdom." Adora smiles a little at the thought.

"One day we will be. You're still Princess of Half-Moon, you're the heir, one day your moms won't be here anymore." Adora points out. She admits, she sometimes forgets that Catra is the heir to an entire Kingdom. Catra bites her lip.

"That's not..." Catra sighs. "Sometimes I wonder if I should even keep the title, you know? Like, I don't even know if the people of Half-Moon would accept me as their Queen when the time comes and I honestly don't know if I want to."

"Who would rule Half-Moon if not you?" Adora asks. Catra shrugs.

"I guess, I don't really know. Nor do I really care." She purses her lips. "I loved Half-Moon growing up. It was great, everyone was friendly, and I was excited to be able to lead such a great Kingdom, but things change." She smiles a bit, shrugging. "Besides, I'm pretty sure a good amount of them don't want me as their Princess anymore." Adora isn't so sure that's true. Sure, people look at Catra differently due to their relationship, but Catra has been nothing but good to them, and Adora is sure that they'll eventually come around again.

"That's..." Adora frowns. "I don't think you mean that."

"Maybe a little. But I think I just need some time to consider." Catra replies. Adora would support Catra in whatever she decides.

"Finn, they're heir to Half-Moon too." Adora says.

"I know, but that'll only happen if both Queens acknowledge that to be so."

"What?" Adora pauses for a moment. "You don't think they'll… But I thought they were okay with them?" Adora asks. She had never considered that C'yra or Luna would have an issue accepting Finn as their heir. She knew they had an issue with Adora, or at least C'yra did, but she didn't think she had a grudge against Finn. Catra sighs.

"Luna is, C'yra is the complicated one, and I can't really tell what she wants to do. It's hard to believe that she wants to accept Finn when she was the one demanding I give them away, or get rid of them at first. Sure, she didn't make me do it in the end. But those kind of words… stick." Catra responds. Adora can't deny that that's true - they certainly stuck with Catra.

"We can never tell Finn that." Adora says. "It would break their heart."

"I know. I wasn't planning to. I'm concerned someone else will tell them, like what happened to me."

"You think someone would tell them that?" Adora asks. "The only person who would be so cruel is probably Shadow Weaver, and she's locked up."

"It's hard to say if someone will." Catra shrugs. "I mean, Double Trouble told the Rebellion about me, so... It's hard to not consider it a possibility."

"I'd be more concerned about them finding out who I am." Adora says, carrying on walking.

"I mean, maybe we should tell them one day then? Maybe it's better that we tell them instead of a complete stranger."

"Tell them what?" Adora asks. "That I almost killed their mom, twice, and also led the Evil Horde that destroyed Etheria? They'll hate me." Catra shakes her head.

"What I mean is, we can explain *everything* . Not just the bad. They'd know the good side of you for all their life, Adora. We can take the time to gently explain what happened. Better us than someone with malicious intent doing it." Adora has to admit that Catra has a point.

"Like your mom?" Adora asks. She sighs. "You're probably right, I just... I worry that they'll hate me, and I don't think I could take them hating me. I love them, so much, they're my baby."

"I don't think they'd hate you, because we'd teach them to be understanding, and we'll make sure to never make them feel like Shadow Weaver made you feel, or what C'yra did to me." Catra says. Adora glances at her. She looks sad and Adora gets it. C'yra had been a good mom to her for most of her life, and then she turned against her. Adora had accepted now that she couldn't fix their relationship, she couldn't make Catra forgive C'yra, and she didn't want to. It was Catra's right to feel hurt by what her mom did, and it was her right to forgive her or not, Adora shouldn't feel guilty about that.

"I did a lot of bad things, Catra." Adora points out.

"Because that was all you knew, Adora."

"You sure do defend me a lot." Catra huffs at her.

"Is it defending if it's just the truth?" Adora nudges her with her shoulder.

"I appreciate it." She says, smiling. "I appreciate *you* ."

"I appreciate you too." Catra replies with a smile, nudging Adora back.

"So," Adora says as they walk to the Fright Zone prison cells. "Not far now." She comments. "Recognise this place?" Catra smiles a bit.

"I remember it like it was yesterday. I still can't believe that you almost said no to sleeping with me." Catra says. Adora laughs. She couldn't believe that Catra had *offered* to have sex with her in the first place.

"I wanted it to be fully your decision," Adora says. "Having sex with you in exchange for me letting you go is... Dishonourable." Adora knows honour seems like a strange thing for a

Horde soldier to have, but sleeping with Catra in exchange to let her go felt slimy. She wanted it to be wholly her decision.

"You enjoyed it very much." Catra comments, smirking a little. Adora rolls her eyes at her.

"If I remember correctly, so did you."

"I did, very much so."

"And every night since?" Adora asks. Catra purrs.

" *Absolutely* ." She says. That does inflate Adora's ego a little if she's honest.

Adora chuckles as she leads Catra to the deepest parts of the Horde prison. She helps her down the steps and then stops at the locked door. The guards at the door bow and begin unbolting it before they open the heavy door. Adora turns to Catra, deciding to give her one more warning before they enter. "Don't trust a single word she says." Catra nods and then Adora walks into the room and down to the cell, stopping at the green force-field. "Shadow Weaver."

"Ah, Adora. I see you brought your little... pet." Shadow Weaver speaks quietly, too calmly for someone who had nearly been injured to an inch of her life by the person standing in front of her. She looked like she had last time, with her limp black eel like hair and the cracked mask on her face with the soulless empty white eyes. "To what do I owe the pleasure of this visit?"

"Catra isn't my *pet* ." Adora says angrily. "She's my soon to be wife. Show her some respect."

"Soon to be wife? I can't believe you've gotten so weak, Adora." Shadow Weaver seems to roll her eyes behind her mask. Catra almost wheezes at Shadow Weaver's attempts to disrespect her. Adora has *no* idea how these two will interact and it almost makes her nervous. She had never seen these two parts of her life coming together like this.

"Seems a certain prisoner really seems to forget that she's no longer in charge." Catra bites back.

"Seems a certain Magicat *slut* forgets her place." Shadow Weaver says, briefly looking at Catra. "That's what your people call you, is it not? The Horde Lord's whore." Adora shuffles uncomfortably beside Catra, rubbing the back of her neck. The thing was, Shadow Weaver wasn't wrong. People had called Catra some *terrible* names after their relationship had been exposed.

Catra hums, clearly not reacting in the way Shadow Weaver intended for her to. Adora knew that she meant to set her off, anger her, upset her probably, but Catra seems unbothered. "Perhaps they have, I am soon to be her wife though, so that's what my title is." She reminds Shadow Weaver, placing her hand on her hip. "I do have to say, even in the Horde, I hold more power than you ever did. Why? Because I'm not a heartless bitch that feels the need to abuse innocent children and use them as soldiers." Shadow Weaver laughs, though it's clearly not genuine.

Adora watches the pair carefully, Catra seems completely unbothered by Shadow Weaver's words but Adora wasn't. She'd felt angry, and protective, but she knew Catra could hold her own. Still, she places her hand to the small of Catra's back to let her know that she was with her. "What about your soon to be wife then?" Shadow Weaver asks. "Is she a heartless bitch for using Horde children in her army?"

"Hmm, no. She isn't. Want to know why?" Catra asks. "Because she's as much of a victim as those children. And if you must know, she actually changed the rules when she kicked you off your high-throne so that those that are under a certain age can't be soldiers." She reveals. "And, unlike you, the soldiers like her, and she doesn't starve them or lock them away or, you know, use magic to mentally scar them like you did."

"Then she's weak and pathetic, just like you." Shadow Weaver hisses. "Why have you come here? Surely it wasn't to harass a poor, defenceless, old woman?" Adora scoffs at that. Shadow Weaver is *never* defenceless.

"Honestly, the fact that you had to rule the Horde using fear tactics is what makes you pathetic. Those soldiers *never* respected you in any way." Catra smiles coldly. "But no, we

came simply to tell you that *you lost*, Shadow Weaver."

"I didn't lose," Shadow Weaver says, unperturbed. "Look at Adora," Adora's eyes widen a little. She'd felt like she may have sunk into the background a little while Catra and Shadow Weaver spoke, so to be called on so forwardly kind of shook her a little. "She was my ward, I know her better than anyone, even you, Magicat." Shadow Weaver pushes herself slowly to her feet. "I trained her to be a cutthroat soldier, she is full of ambition, Adora will never last long sitting on her hands, she has an itch she just can't scratch, isn't that right Adora?" Adora glances at Catra before she looks at Shadow Weaver.

She shrugs her shoulders, trying to feign nonchalance, but she knows she must look tense - her jaw aches with how hard she has it clenched. "She has a hunger in her that just can't be satisfied. She'll grow tired in her position as... wife. With no goal, she'll feel useless, and Adora hates feeling useless." It's true, Adora had told Catra as much, but Adora doesn't want to give Shadow Weaver the satisfaction of her being right.

"I have a goal." Adora says. "Protect my family."

"That isn't enough, not for you. You were destined for *greatness* , you can play house all you like, but you can't deny what you are."

"And what am I?" Adora asks, narrowing her eyes.

"A weapon." Shadow Weaver answers. Adora frowns softly, her eyes widening a little. "You can use a spear as a walking stick, but it does not change its nature. Adora's nature is that she is a weapon. My weapon, the Horde's weapon, your weapon," She looks at Catra. "Before all that, she was a weapon for the First Ones."

"She isn't a weapon!" Catra yells at her. "She's a *person* ! You made her a weapon. And guess what? She made the choice that she's not going to be what you want anymore." Catra takes Adora's hand, bringing it to her lips and kissing it to reassure her. "She's allowed to find happiness. You weren't giving her the chance to do that." She hisses, her tail fluffed up as she lets go of Adora's hand, stepping closer to Shadow Weaver. Adora tenses seeing Catra so close.

"And yet your reaction seems to say otherwise." Shadow Weaver hums.

"You would think that, right? But Adora doesn't have to be a weapon. It's going to take time, but she'll find something to work towards, aside from caring for our family and supporting our kitten."

"Believe what you want to believe." Shadow Weaver responds.

"I want to know more about She-Ra." Adora says. "Where did I come from?" Adora asks. She has wanted to know for so long, Shadow Weaver is the only person that Adora can think of that can give her any sort of answer to this question.

"I told you that Hordak found you when he went to find a portal." Shadow Weaver says and Adora nods. "You came from that portal. I don't know where you're from, I just felt your magic and I took you as my ward."

"I came out of a portal?" Adora asks in disbelief, looking at Catra with complete confusion.

"Yes you did." Shadow Weaver confirms. Adora's head spins with this new information. *Was Shadow Weaver lying?* Catra turns to her, shrugging a bit.

"It's possible, though a little hard to believe. Then again, we made a kitten with your magic so..." Catra trails off. Adora would have laughed at that if her world wasn't currently being turned upside down. ' *We made a baby with your magic strap which is unbelievable so is you being from a portal any less unbelievable?'* It's funny when Adora thinks about it because Catra is right. Nothing ever seems believable when magic is involved.

"She-Ra," Shadow Weaver says. "She's a First One's invention. There's a reason there hasn't been one for thousands of years before Adora. She-Ra left when the First Ones left, and she came back when you came back."

"Huh..." Catra turns to look at Adora. "I mean, that doesn't make a difference to me. I still love you all the same."

"I'm a First One?" Adora asks.

"Yes you are," Shadow Weaver coos. "Didn't you think it strange that you could read the First One's writing?"

"I never really thought about it." Adora admits

"Of course you never." Shadow Weaver says. Adora frowns a little and looks at Catra.

"You're really okay with this?" Adora asks. She’s not entirely sure it really matters that she’s a First One, but that means she isn’t even *Etherian* . Did that make her an alien? This was all so confusing to her.

"You're still you, Adora. That doesn't change anything for me." Catra says dismissively. That makes Adora feel a little better.

" Really?" Adora asks, taking Catra's hands. Catra smiles and nods, squeezing Adora's hand backs. Her gaze is honest, loving, and tender as she looks up at the blonde.

"Yes, really. I love you so much, you dork." Adora smiles at Catra and leans in to kiss her, but she's interrupted by Shadow Weaver.

" *Ugh* ," She complains. "This is sickening. Why are you two in the Fright Zone anyway?" She asks. "It was my understanding that Adora surrendered. Oh, wait, is it because you and your relationship will *never* be accepted by the High and Mighty Princesses?"

"How funny of you to say that, considering her and I are getting married." Catra purrs.

"But your mother doesn't approve, does she?" Shadow Weaver asks. Adora tenses. She knows this is a sensitive topic for Catra, Shadow Weaver is highly skilled at twisting the knife emotionally as much as she is physically. "Maybe even your friend Glimmer." She continues.

"You know what ..." Catra whispers softly. She looks at Adora and nods towards the control panel. Adora hesitates before she nods and presses it, bringing the green force-field down. Then Catra steps closer to Shadow Weaver before she slaps her as hard as she possibly can. "Perhaps she doesn't. But guess what? I don't care, because I get to be with the woman I love." Adora's eyes widen and she inches forward, putting Catra just behind her shoulder, protectively, when Shadow Weaver stands up a little taller. She recognises it, but Shadow Weaver has no magic here. Her eyes flicker to Adora and then she sighs dramatically.

"I can help with that." She says.

" *Explain* ." Adora demands, her eyes narrowing.

"Princess Glimmer hates the Horde because she believes that we killed her father, correct?" Adora turns her head to the side a little before she slowly nods. "Micah is not dead, he was sent to Beast Island."

"Beast Island *is* a death sentence." Adora points out angrily.

"Perhaps. But Micah was a powerful sorcerer, if anyone could survive, it's him." She says. "I should know, he was once my pupil, like you Adora." Adora frowns a little. She'd had no idea that *Shadow Weaver* once taught *Glimmer's dad* . Talk about a weird coincidence.

"Why should we trust you, Shadow Weaver?" Catra narrows her eyes at the woman, claws sharply out in case she tried anything.

"You have no reason to," Shadow Weaver says. "But, like I said before, I know Adora's nature. You want to go, don't you?" Adora holds Shadow Weaver's gaze before she turns her

head a little towards Catra. She nods at Catra.

"I do..." She says quietly. "Micah might be alive-"

"Always a people pleaser." Shadow Weaver cuts in. Adora takes a sharp breath in. Maybe Shadow Weaver does know her nature, she knows exactly how to get Adora to do something.

"Adora, this is something we'll need to talk about later, okay?" Catra runs her thumb along Adora's knuckles. Adora nods. "Anything else you want to say before we go back to our room?"

"No." Shadow Weaver says before Adora can say anything. "Just enjoy her while you have her." Shadow Weaver warns ominously. Catra clenches her jaw, grabbing Adora's hand.

"I wasn't talking to you, Shadow Weaver. I was talking to my fiancee." Adora glances at Catra before she looks at Shadow Weaver.

"No... I've said everything I need to say." She pauses. "Anything you want to say?" Adora asks Catra.

"No, all I want to do is slap her again honestly." Catra says. Adora laughs a little as she puts the force-field back into place.

"You should be careful, Magicat, Adora likes to play hero." Shadow Weaver says. Catra huffs, choosing to ignore Shadow Weaver.

"Shall we go, my love?"

"Yeah," Adora says, turning Catra towards the door so she could keep her eyes on Shadow Weaver. "I'm done with you." Adora tells Shadow Weaver. "You can rot here for the rest of your miserable life."

"So you say, and yet you keep coming here." Shadow Weaver points out.

"Come on, Love. Let's go." Catra encourages her, gesturing towards the door. "Guards, please lock her away as you did before. Thank you."

"Yes Catra." The Horde soldiers say as they step out of the prison cell. Adora looks at Catra and sighs.

"So... What do you think of the woman who raised me?" Adora asks.

"She's a bitch." Catra deadpans.

"She sure is." Adora sighs, catching her breath. Will it always be like this? She had thought she had put her Shadow Weaver business to bed and yet she still manages to make Adora feel this way. "Do you want to go get Finn? Or talk?" Adora asks.

"I don't know. Maybe we should talk about what you want to do before getting Finn."

"What I want to do?"

"About Micah." Catra clarifies. Adora purses her lips before she starts walking.

"I want to go get him." She says simply.

"You do realise that I'm not letting you go by yourself, right?" Catra asks.

"You do realise that I'm not letting you come, right?" Adora asks back. Catra places her hands on her hips.

"And you do realise that I could lose you if you go alone? Adora, Beast Island is *dangerous* , you said so yourself, and to go alone would be a terrible idea."

"I can't bring you with me," Adora says, shaking her head. "It's too dangerous. Besides, Finn needs you here with them, and they *definitely* can't come."

"Then why are you planning to go by yourself if it's too dangerous! I can't lose you, Adora." It’s sweet, but Adora needs to do this, and she can’t bring Catra. Endangering her? That was off of the table.

"I'll be fine," Adora says dismissively. "I'm She-Ra."

"I don't care if you're She-Ra, Adora! I can't lose you! I can't lose you again! I just got you back, Adora." Catra looks at her so desperately that it’s almost too much. Adora looks at her boots to avoid Catra’s gaze before she sighs.

"You're not coming. You can't come. I'll be okay, I promise."

"No! I'm not letting you go alone, Adora!"

"You don't have a choice." Adora says flatly, turning to walk back to her room.

"Are you serious?" Catra asks in disbelief. She sounds mad, but not yell-y mad, angry that Adora was saying no.

"Yes, I'm serious." Adora responds coolly. Catra frowns deeply.

"I'm gonna go get Finn." She murmurs. She was clearly upset with everything, but Adora wasn't going to change her mind on this. There was *no way* Adora was going to bring Catra to Beast Island.

"Without me?" Adora asks, stopping in her steps. She puts her hands on her hips.

"You don't have a choice." Catra repeats Adora's own words back coldly, turning around to walk down the hall where she and Adora had left Finn with Lonnie and Scorpia. Adora frowns as she sees Catra walk away.

"That's completely different Catra!" Adora yells after her. She sighs and rubs her face. She knew Catra just needed some time, they could talk about it later, better to give Catra space in the meantime. Adora could use with blowing off some steam herself. She walks in search of the training rooms.

* * *

Catra can't *believe* Adora.

Okay, maybe that's not totally true. She *can* believe Adora and that's what she thinks is the worst part of all of this. She knows that Adora wants to do good but going to Beast Island alone? That is recklessly stupid. It's like she has a death wish or something. And for her to deny Catra joining her? Who did she think she was? So Catra was *pissed* but she didn't want to argue with Adora, not yet anyway, so, instead, Catra went to go get Finn.

She knocks on the door of the small central living quarters that the Fright Zone had added later on in the remodelling of the Fright Zone. "Lonnie, Scorps. Are you guys here?"

"Wildcat!" Scorpia exclaims happily.

" *Sh* !" Lonnie shushes. "Little brat just fell asleep."

"Oh... right! Sorry..." Catra smiles when she sees Scorpia giving Lonnie a guilty look. Unusually, Finn slept like a rock - kind of like Adora actually.

"They didn't cause you both too much trouble, right?" Catra asks. Her mood has lifted, but only slightly.

"Not at all," Scorpia answers with a cheerful smile. "Lonnie just likes to call them a brat." Catra offers a small smile and nods. She isn't sure that she should be allowing people to call her baby brat but she figures it can't hurt. Plus, they kind of are a brat sometimes, they get that from Catra.

"Thanks for taking care of them while we were busy. I can take them off of your hands now." Catra says gesturing for her baby. She could really use the cuddles if she was honest, especially if she was to stop herself marching back to Adora and hitting her upside the head for being such an idiot.

"Where's Adora?" Lonnie asks, handing Finn over to Catra. "She's usually stuck to your side."

"She's in our room, I think. We had a bit of a disagreement on a matter and I needed a breather." Catra sighs when she has Finn in her arms. She purrs at the little kit and they purr in their sleep. It brings a smile to Catra's lips.

"A disagreement?" Lonnie asks. "Adora will likely be punching something then." Lonnie says with a laugh. Catra hadn't considered that but Lonnie was probably right. Adora was a punch her feelings out kind of person.

"What did you disagree on?" Scorpia asks gently.

"Shadow Weaver informed us that Micah, Glimmer's father, was sent to Beast Island and is possibly still alive. Adora wants to go get him, but she wants to go alone and I don't want to let her." Catra explains. It leaves a sour taste in her mouth just talking about this. Why was

Adora like this? She hadn’t even met Micah! And Shadow Weaver could be lying. She was going to risk her life on a *maybe* at best.

"She thinks she's protecting you." Lonnie responds. "Typical. You know, Adora was Lord for a while, but I was in her Squad. She'd always try to protect us too whenever we did drills."

"I get that. But I don't want her to go alone. I almost lost her once before, and I *just* got her back." Catra bites her lip. "She doesn't seem to understand that she doesn't have to do things alone anymore." They are *partners* . What doesn’t Adora get about that?

"I'm sure that's not true," Scorpia says, laying a comforting claw to Catra's back. "She's just trying to keep you safe, that's all. She knows she doesn't have to do things alone."

"It doesn't feel that way considering she literally told me I didn't have a choice." Catra sighs. "I want to keep her safe too. I want to go with her. I know we have Finn, but I can't deal with her going alone. What if something happens to her?" Catra asks. She knows Adora wants to protect her, but she wants to protect Adora just as strongly. Adora should understand that. Besides, she doesn’t get to dictate Catra’s choices. If she wants to come, she comes.

"Did you say Beast Island?" Lonnie asks. Catra nods and Lonnie exchanges glances with Scorpia. "Adora is an idiot." Lonnie says. "No one comes back from Beast Island, the Horde would tell us bedtime stories about it that caused nightmares just to scare us into not betraying the Horde and being sent there."

"I know. She told me about it. That's why I don't want her to go by herself."

"It's hard," Lonnie says. "You know, if you wanted to go with her, I'm sure we could watch Finn for you. But I'm guessing the issue is that Adora won't let you?"

"You got it. She doesn't want me to go with her." Catra nods. Won’t let her, as though she’s some weak submissive wife. Catra doesn’t have to do as Adora tells her, nor does Adora have to do as she tells her. Trying to protect her or not, Catra is her own person who makes her own choices.

"She probably won't change her mind about that." Lonnie says.

"No, probably not. Which is why I'm not in the happiest of moods right now." Catra smiles sadly as she soothes Finn in her arms.

"You should talk to Adora," Lonnie says. "But maybe later. Talking to Shadow Weaver always messes her up, for obvious reasons."

"Yeah, I know, that's why I came to get Finn. To give us both a little bit of space." Catra knows when to take a step back from a topic, when to give Adora and herself space. Some people think confrontation is better, but that would only result in Adora getting defensive.

"She'll come around." Lonnie reassures, awkwardly patting Catra on her shoulder. Catra smiles gratefully at Lonnie.

"Thanks. I hope so. I'm just worried that I'll fall asleep and the next day she won't be there." Catra's heart cliches in her chest at the thought. Adora is the kind of person to do that. In order to save Catra from joining her, she would sneak away.

"Oh uh..." Lonnie looks at Scorpia. "Adora does seem like the type to sneak away in the night, doesn't she?" The fact that Lonnie agrees only furthers Catra's concern.

"She's very good at it too." Scorpia says happily, like she isn't confirming Catra's worst fears. "She was the most successful cadet at attaining medical supplies she stole from the infirmary."

"Right..." Catra says, feeling a little… unsettled by her current thoughts.

" *Scorpia* ," Lonnie mumbles, nudging her. Scorpia's eyes widen.

"I mean, I'm sure she wouldn't do that to you!" Scorpio exclaims.

"I hope not, but I'm still worried."

"Talk to her, tonight." Lonnie says.

"I'm planning to. I just hope that I can change her mind." Catra says, growing slightly. Changing Adora's mind on things like this is hard.

"Ha... Good luck." Catra's ears fall a little at the tone in which those words are said.

"Thanks, I think I'll need it. I should probably take Finn back to the room anyway. I imagine they would be happier being in a more familiar area of the Fright Zone." Catra turns to walk away but Lonnie stops her in her tracks.

"Hey, you know, if you want something to pass the time, Scorpia and I are going to the old throne room of the Scorpions to oversee the construction. Maybe you could come and give them some advice?" Lonnie suggests.

"You know what, I think I would like that. Thank you." It was way better than sitting in their room worrying about this. It would keep her busy.

"No problem," Lonnie says, gesturing for Catra to follow. "Adora will be punching that punching bag for a few hours." Catra laughs a little, adjusting Finn to make sure they could sleep comfortably.

"Yeah, I imagined. But I figured that Finn and I could rest in our room while we waited for her to come back." This was better though. Catra was always happier putting her brain into action than sitting around idly. Plus, she was happy that the Fright Zone seemed to respect her opinion enough to trust her suggestions. It was a nice change of pace, and a perfect distraction from her Adora troubles.

"We've made a lot of progress, I can't believe some of the old structures still exist from before Hordak brought all this... metal... here." Scorpia comments.

"I'm glad that you've been able to work on restoring the Fright Zone to how it should be, Scorpia. It's your home, and you deserve to have that." Catra says, smiling softly at her.

"It's strange," Scorpia admits. "I'm not sure I'm much of a leader. Adora was really good at it." Catra hums. Adora was a good leader, she's a natural born one. Maybe the Fright Zone wasn't perfect, but Adora had always tried her best. Now she had left it in the hands of Scorpia. Being a leader wasn't always about leading, sometimes it was about knowing when to step down and who to hand the reins over to. Adora had made the perfect decision with Scorpia.

"You're doing great, Scorps." Catra encourages, smiling at the taller gal. "Besides, if anyone can bring the Fright Zone to the former glory of the Scorpion Hall, it's you."

"Thanks Wildcat." Scorpia smiles happily.

"Of course, Scorpia. I'm just simply stating the truth."

"Maybe if it's repaired enough you could get married there." Scorpia suggests.

"I... I like that idea a lot." Catra whispers as she follows the pair. Married to Adora. Naive, good, *heroic* , Adora. Catra sighs. She's going to kill her if she tries to leave without her. But, for now, she can concentrate on this.

* * *

Adora comes back to their room later with aching knuckles from punching the punching bag for so long. She had stopped by the infirmary to wrap them up before heading back to her

room. When she comes back to their room she sees Catra standing inside, holding Finn. "Hey." Adora says, walking into the room.

"Hi." Catra whispers softly, eyes still locked on Finn who was slumbering easily in her arms. Adora walks further into the room and sits down on the bed. She starts taking her boots off, not knowing what to say to Catra but feeling the tension in the room."How was training?" Catra asks.

"Good." Adora answers. "My knuckles hurt though."

"You should probably ice that, no?"

"I'll be okay," Adora says. "I wrapped them up, see." Adora holds her hands up. Catra glances at Adora, nodding slowly before turning back to look at Finn. She hums softly, making sure that the little kitten remains asleep. "Catra..." Adora drops her hands and then sighs. "Do you want to sleep?" Adora doesn't really know what to do here. They haven't really had a disagreement since… Well, *everything* .

"Maybe later, I'm not really tired right now." Catra replies. She isn't looking at Adora and Adora wonders how long it's going to be before they address the elephant in the room.

"We can cuddle?" Adora suggests.

"I don't want to move. Finn is still sleeping at the moment."

"Okay..." Adora says. She lies back on the bed and closes her eyes.

"You're really planning to go, huh?" Catra asks. Adora sighs and opens her eyes again. She knew it was coming, but she thought *maybe* Catra would drop it. She sits up and turns to look at Catra.

"Yes, I'm really planning to go." Adora answers simply.

"You know I'm not okay with it." It’s not a question, it’s a statement.

"I know."

"Because I'm afraid."

"Why are you afraid?" Adora asks. She doesn’t know why Catra is so afraid of something happening to her. Adora can take care of herself. "I told you that I'd be okay."

"You can't promise me that, Adora." Catra finally turns to look at her. "You can't promise me that you'll be okay. I'll still worry, I'll be scared that I'm going to lose you, to lose the love of my life again. I'm afraid that Finn will lose their other mom because she decided to go somewhere, known for being dangerous, *alone,* without any support, on the possibility that Micah *may* be alive after nearly 2 decades of being thought dead." Adora sighs and then sits up to look directly at Catra.

"Catra, I'm a highly trained Horde officer, and I'm She-Ra. I can promise you that I'll be okay. I'm probably the only person who *can* bring Micah back... you know... if he's actually there." Adora frowns a little. She is well aware that Shadow Weaver could’ve lied just to get Adora out of the picture, but she has to *try* . She can’t not try. She *can’t* .

"No, you can't. Because no one knows what the hell is out there on Beast Island. You could be the most trained person on the whole damn planet and I still wouldn't want you to go by yourself, Adora. Because I love you, and I want to know that you're safe, and that you'll come home." Catra says. Adora admits Catra has valid points, but she just can’t let her come. She will *never* be the reason Catra is hurt ever again. Her staying is the best way to protect her.

"I *will* come home." Adora says. "Don't you believe in me?"

"My gods, Adora, that's not what I mean. Of course I believe in you, but that doesn't make me any less worried." Catra frowns, looking away again. "What if you need help? What if something happens?"

"Exactly!" Adora winces a little when she sees Finn stir. She lowers her voice the next time she speaks. "What if something happened to *you* ? I can't lose you. Keeping you safe means you staying *here* ." Adora doesn't begrudge Catra's protests, in fact, she completely understands them, but she cannot and will not put Catra in that kind of position.

"And what about me wanting to keep you safe?" Catra asks.

"You... You don't have to keep me safe." Adora says.

"I want to. Don't you get it? I want to keep you safe, because I love you more than I have ever loved anyone in my life, Adora." Catra says. Adora sighs and looks at the bedspread below her. She understands that, she really does, she knows Catra wants to protect her as much as Adora wants to protect her, but, for some reason, Adora just can't let Catra do this for her.

"I love you too," Adora says. "So I want to keep you safe by keeping you *out* of danger, and you want to keep me safe by putting yourself *in* danger? Those aren't compatible, Catra."

"No, I suppose they're not." Catra sighs. "So what are we gonna do?"

"I don't know." Adora says. "You... I don't want you to come."

"Yes, I know. And I don't want you to go by yourself." Catra clenches her jaw. "We've always been stronger together, Adora. We can handle anything when we stick together."

"I know," Adora sits on her knees. "I know. But you can't, Catra... I can't put you in danger, even if it is for my safety."

"You're not putting me in danger. It would be my own decision to go with you." Catra points out.

"It would still be putting you in danger." Adora replies.

"Okay, but you can't control my choices either. If you go, I go." Catra says stubbornly. Adora almost wants to laugh.

"You're not coming." Adora says, shaking her head.

"Yes, I am."

"No, you're not."

"Yes."

"No."

“Yes.”

"Catra-" Adora huffs in frustration. "Look, you're my partner in life, in *everything* ... except this."

"That's not how that works, Adora." Catra stands up from where she was sat, walking over to the little crib that the others had built for Finn and carefully tucking them in so that she could talk to Adora properly. "I'm going and you can't stop me, Adora."

"I can absolutely stop you." Adora says. "I'm very strong." Catra narrows her eyes, stepping closer to Adora. Adora is sure that it's meant to be like her staring her down but it just has the effect of Adora being able to *smell* Catra, distracting her.

"You can't stop me for long. You know that I'd go after you." Catra's voice is low as she speaks - it's a very sexy tone.

"You'd have to catch me first." Adora says, glancing at Catra's lips. They always look so kissable. The tension in the room doesn't really feel like anger anymore, it feels like something *much* different, but still just as thick.

"And you act as if I haven't done that before." Catra whispers. She's so close… Adora could just lean in…

"You're not coming, Catra." Adora says quietly. "I'm not afraid to pin you down."

"I *am* going, and you can try, but I'll find a way to you. I always do."

"I can't tell if we're flirting or arguing." Adora admits. She grabs Catra by her waist and drags her down onto the bed.

"Both, probably." Catra wiggles a bit to adjust herself to fit more comfortably against her. "It's hard to stay mad at you for long."

"You're not coming." Adora says again. "But you can kiss me."

"I'm not kissing you until we come back home from Beast Island together."

"Until *I* come back home from Beast Island."

" *We* ."

"Sure," Adora says, rolling Catra over and lying beside her. "If that's what you want to believe."

"It's what's going to happen." Catra growls softly. "Alright?"

"Nope, not alright."

"Yes, alright." Catra responds. Adora laughs and kisses Catra on her neck.

"You just don't quit." Adora had no intentions of letting Catra come, but she was also clearly not going to budge. This is exactly what Adora meant when she had called Catra stubborn, but, she suspects, this is also what Catra meant when she had called Adora stubborn. Adora had plans to leave, and she just wanted to spend time with her fiancee before that. She's also sure Catra had no intentions of letting Adora go by herself too.

"Don't try to sneak out, Adora." Catra says, catching Adora off guard. She isn't sure when she became so readable to Catra.

"I-I wasn't..." Adora clears her throat. "You'd hear me anyway."

"As if you weren't gonna try. Your face said it all."

"My face said nothing."

"We both know that's bullshit." Catra huffs.

"Please kiss me." Adora says.

"I told you. I'm not kissing you until both of us come back from Beast Island." Catra really is incredibly *stubborn* , but Adora sure does love her.

"So you're never going to kiss me?" Adora asks. Since she was never going to let Catra come.

"Hm, we'll see." Catra replies. Adora sighs.

"What if I did sneak out and you never kissed me before I left?" Adora asks.

"Then don't sneak out." *Damn* . Catra is *good* . Adora sighs.

"Can we at least cuddle?"

"I don't know, are you leaving without me?"

"Not right now." Adora jokes - *mostly* .

"That's not funny." Catra deadpans. She doesn't even seem slightly amused by Adora's words.

"I think I'm pretty funny." Adora says with a playful smile.

"Not with that joke you weren't." Catra replies, shoving Adora's face gently. Adora lies down against the bed.

"I'm not planning on going anywhere right now."

"You keep saying '*right now'*." Catra is perceptive, Adora can admit to that.

"Because, right now, I'm lying on our bed-" Adora's words are interrupted by someone knocking on the door. "Come in." The door opens to reveal a Horde soldier standing in the doorway.

"Lord Adora, sorry to disturb you," They say. "You said you wanted to know if we had any soldiers who had done the routes to Beast Island when we still used it?" Adora nods at them. "That would be me."

"Okay, great, thanks, you can go now." Adora says dismissively, waving her hand at them to disperse. They turn and walk away, the door closing behind them. Adora turns to Catra to see her press her lips firmly together as she pulls away from Adora, sitting back up again on the bed. Adora winces a little. "Okay... That looks bad, I admit that." Adora sits up, reaching her hands out for Catra.

"No shit, Adora." Catra wraps her arms around herself, her back facing Adora.

"Catra… Please."

"Please *what* ? Stay quiet while you risk your life because of something Shadow Weaver told you? Without there being any certainty of it even being true?" Catra asks angrily.

"Look, I know she might be lying." Adora says. "But I have to try. If Micah is still alive on Beast Island... This will win the Princesses over." Adora frowns a little. "And no one deserves to be left alone on Beast Island."

"I'm not trying to stop you, Adora. I just don't want you to go by yourself."

"I'm not going by myself, I have these guys." Adora lifts her arms up, showing off her biceps. Catra stares at her blankly. That joke clearly didn't land either.

"You know that's not my point."

"I love you." Adora says. "I can do this. I won't be alone. I need someone to sail me there."

"And then you're gonna plan to get off that ship and go on foot by yourself. I know you, Adora. I'm not stupid."

"I know you're not stupid." Adora says. She shuffles to the edge of their bed and starts pulling her boots back on. "I'm just trying to keep you safe, Catra."

"So why can't I do the same for you, Adora?"

"Because Finn needs one of us and they don't need me!" Adora yells. She glances at where Finn was sleeping, holding her breath in case they started crying. They don't.

"What the hell are you talking about?" Catra asks. Adora looks back to her.

"If I... die... Finn will be okay, they have you, but if you die..." Adora trails off. "They need you way more than they need me."

"That's not true, Adora. Finn loves you. Haven't you noticed that? Finn needs you. *I* need you."

"I put them at risk just by being their mom. They'd probably be better off without me." Adora says. She wasn't wrong. The only reason Finn was in danger was because of their Horde Lord mom.

"No, you didn't. Literally none of that is even your fault. Adora, stop that." Catra says, trying to keep her voice down. "Stop doing this whole self-sacrificial act again!"

"I'm not... I'm not!"

"Yes, you are!"

"Forgive me for trying to keep you safe."

"That's not what this is about. Not entirely, at least. You're doing this out of guilt."

"Out of guilt? What... What?" Adora frowns in confusion.

"You wanting to get Micah. Saying that Finn doesn't need you. Saying that they'd be better off without you. You feel guilty." Catra says. She's probably right, she always is. It's not like Adora cares what the Princesses think of her, but she still wants to do this.

"That's just the truth, Catra." Adora says, sitting down beside her fiancee. Adora slumps in defeat. "You're like... Being a mom is natural to you, I don't... I don't feed them, I barely know how to change them, the only thing I'm good at is making them laugh, which is adorable, but not the point."

"Adora, that's not true at all." Catra shakes her head. "Being a mom isn't natural to me. The doctors were teaching me to make sure I would be okay basically being a single mom since... The circumstances were not ideal. You didn't have the time to learn, but you're trying to now. Being a parent is a process. I'm still learning too, and I need you with me, so does Finn."

"I'm right here."

"So stay..." Catra whispers. Adora kicks her boots back off and shuffles onto the bed. She gestures for Catra to come closer.

"Cuddle me? I'm tired, and I just want to sleep with you."

"Fine, okay." Catra sighs, looking defeated as she slides into Adora's arms. Adora smiles happily as she feels Catra's weight against her. She kisses Catra along her jaw and then on her forehead. She was still planning on sneaking out later, but she didn't want to kill the current mood. She'd wait until Catra was asleep.

* * *

Later that night, when both Catra and Finn are sleeping. Adora carefully packs up her things. She kisses Catra on her forehead and kisses her fingers, pressing them to Finn's little head. She'd be back, but, for now, she would track down that Horde soldier and make her way to Beast Island.

If she had bothered to look back, she might have noticed the pair of ears that twitched and the blue-gold of her eyes in the dark.

Chapter End Notes

Adora's a dummy, but we all knew this. I wonder what will happen next. Stay tuned everyone! >.> -M

Adora is still Adora. She really is just trying to protect Catra, but her way of doing that probably isn't the best. Maybe one day she'll realise that she doesn't have to be a hero alone. -S

As always you can follow us on Twitter @ceolordadora, and our CC is the same! You can find me (S) on tumblr @sherasswordstrap

We also have a podcast that you can listen to on Spotify for extra Lord Adora content! It's called 'Get Down with S and M', here is the link for those interested: https://open.spotify.com/show/2NH0KuzNDKmMnNmMhnOTjt?si=6PPQEyceR2O4EcjvGzxM0g&utm_source=copy-link&dl_branch=1

Beast Island

Chapter Summary

"This is definitely Glimmer's dad." Adora whispers.

"Geez, what gave it away?" Catra asks sarcastically.

"The sparkles and the general," Adora gestures vaguely to Micah. "Chaotic-ness."

Chapter Notes

Happy Friday and Happy Update Day !! We hope you enjoy this chapter and we'll see you again next time :)!

Warning: Fighting, Mentioned and Implied Child Abuse and NSFW ahead

See the end of the chapter for more notes

It takes them two weeks to make the voyage to Beast Island. Adora had had no idea it took them so long to sail to and from Beast Island. In a way, it's a comfort to know this island is so far away from them, but it's inconvenient to say the least. Two weeks there, two weeks back, Catra's mom, C'yra, was going to *kill* her. Especially since Catra had decided to *sneak* on board. Adora couldn't really be mad at her, that would make her a hypocrite but she was… frustrated, to say the least.

Catra had apparently taken the time between them being apart after talking to Shadow Weaver, when Adora was busy punching a punching bag, to arrange for her to be away on Beast Island with Adora. According to her, she had pumped milk for Finn to drink and if they ran out there was always the option of regular milk rather than breast milk. Catra had left them with Scropia and Lonnie with the instructions to give them to Spinnerella and Netossa after a week. Finn was safe basically, Catra had made sure of it. In hindsight, Adora shouldn't have left Catra alone, she never would've been able to sneak on the transport if she hadn't.

Adora sighs as the transport makes its way over the water, towards Beast Island. She looks back over her shoulder at Catra and scowls. She looks ahead again. "You shouldn't have come, Catra." Adora states.

"You act as if I was just gonna let you come here on your own. Hell no." Catra says, shaking her head. "I'm not letting you deal with this on your own, especially knowing what you're trying to do, Love. I know you're trying to get the others to warm up to you. That's why I came, to make sure you don't do something stupid." Adora wasn't going to do anything *stupid* . Her plan had been simple, go to Beast Island, get Micah, leave. She wasn't planning on sticking around.

"You don't understand." Adora says. "We're going to *Beast Island* . You could die." Adora couldn't bear that thought, and she especially couldn't bear it being her fault, because it would be. The only reason Catra was here, apart from maybe because of Micah, was because of Adora. If she died? Ergo, Adora's fault. Not to mention, it would literally destroy her to lose Catra.

"And so could you. I'm here to stop you from getting yourself killed." Catra responds coolly. She crosses her arms over her chest as she stands beside Adora.

"What if we both die and we orphan our child?" Adora asks. "What then?"

"We're not gonna die! Stop saying that!" Catra grabs Adora's face suddenly. Adora stares into those beautiful mismatched eyes that Catra has. She still doesn't understand how she got to be so lucky. "Stop talking like that. We're gonna go back to our child." Adora sighs and gently takes Catra's hands off of her cheeks.

"You should have stayed at home." Adora repeats. She means it. Especially the orphan thing. Adora putting herself in danger was okay by her standards, but Catra putting herself at risk? That would never be okay with Adora. It's not that Adora doubts Catra, she doesn't, she couldn't believe in her more, but if she lost Catra… Adora is *terrified* of the person she would become.

"And let you be by yourself with your lovingly self-sacrificial ass? No way. I'm making sure we *both* get home to our child." Catra replies. Adora smiles a little at Catra's words before her face falls again.

"The chances of King Micah being alive are very slim." Adora points out.

"You mean, as slim as us falling in love?" Catra raises an eyebrow with a smile.

"You always this optimistic?" Adora asks, turning towards Catra with an amused smile. Her clothes rustle a little with her movement and she reaches her hands out to run them gently down Catra's arms.

"I mean, it's good to be optimistic, no?" Catra asks.

"I wouldn't know," Adora says. "I'm more of a, ‘this will probably go wrong in every conceivable way’, kind of person."

"See! This is exactly why I came with you. You're over here just jinxing for the worse to happen." Catra smiles. Adora rolls her eyes fondly.

"Do you even know what Beast Island is?" Adora asks, turning back to the water. She still didn’t have her cape, at least Finn would have some part of her nearby, but she didn’t exactly know the weather on Beast Island, so she’d dug out her old Horde uniform jacket. The thing still fit her surprisingly, if just barely, she had clearly grown since she was eighteen.

"Yes, I do. I did some research. Scorpia gave me the files. I wasn't gonna walk in blind, Dummy." Catra answers. Seems Catra had been very busy in those intervening hours. Adora wasn’t surprised. Catra was smart, she was extremely intelligent, she had been the Rebellion’s tactician, she was *brilliant* at hatching schemes and plans. Adora really should have known better, she’s *never* been able to outsmart Catra.

"So you know about the razor sharp teeth and the really scary monsters?" Adora asks. "And you still feel optimistic?"

"Duh, I'm with you." Catra smiles, kissing Adora's cheek. That would be sweet, if Adora was feeling more confident about their chances of surviving. "Together, we can handle anything."

"Gods, if we weren't going to our possible doom, I'd make love to you right now." Adora comments. And she wholeheartedly means that. It has been so long since.

"You're always so horny. Geez." Catra laughs. "We need to focus, Love."

"I'm perfectly focused, I might even focus better if you kissed me."

"One kiss and then we really need to be more cautious, babe."

"Uh huh..." Adora says, gently grabbing Catra by her shirt and pulling her closer while her eyes flicker closed. Catra purrs, giggling softly as their lips meet.

"I love you." Catra says quietly.

"I love you too." Adora whispers as she presses her lips gently to Catra's, kissing her carefully and allowing herself a moment to take it in. She leans back from the kiss and pecks Catra one last time. “Didn’t the doctor order you no strenuous activities?” Adora asks, raising an eyebrow.

“Technically, but it’s been two weeks,” Catra points out. “I’ve been resting for so long now, and I think the doctor was being overly cautious given everything that happened to me. I think I’ll be okay to kick Beast Island’s ass.” That was true at least, they had been resting a lot, not much to do on a boat. The first week Catra had been mad at Adora, she had made her sleep on the *floor* rather than in their bed on the transport, but then eventually she let Adora cuddle her again. Adora still couldn’t tell if Catra was mad or not still.

"You're right," Adora says, straightening up and placing her hand on her utility belt. Without her sword, she had resorted to Horde weaponry, but Adora felt reassured that she could bring She-Ra out if she needed to even without her sword. "So long as we're together, we can handle anything." Adora says, looking out and seeing they were approaching some land in the distance. "Just promise me you'll stay behind me if we run into trouble?"

"No promises." Catra pouts. "I want to protect you too, Adora."

"But you're so small, I'm nearly a foot taller than you, Catra." Adora says lightly, holding her hand above Catra’s head.

"Adora, I've kicked your ass before." Catra deadpans.

"You- *Ha* ! In your dreams, maybe." Adora shoves her shoulder a little and Catra rolls her eyes.

"You literally told me you liked it when I kicked your ass."

"I do find that very attractive." Adora admits. "That's not what I meant anyway. You don't make a very good shield Catra, you're tiny." Catra being almost a foot shorter than her meant that Adora would have to crouch to shield herself. A very ineffective shield.

"Size has nothing to do with my ability to fight." Catra huffs and steps on Adora's foot. Adora laughs softly and pokes Catra on her stomach.

"You realise I'm wearing boots, right? I can't believe you're shoe-less when we're going to Beast Island." Adora scrunches up her nose. If Catra aimed to hurt her by stepping on her foot, which she probably didn’t, she failed. Adora really doesn’t know how Catra walks around shoe-less all the time.

"I work better without shoes. Shoes make me feel off balance while fighting." Catra explains.

"Uh-huh," Adora says, stealing another kiss from Catra. "I really hope Shadow Weaver wasn't lying." It had been eating away at her ever since she decided to come here. It was the perfect opportunity to get rid of Adora - and Catra for that matter. Adora knew she probably shouldn’t, but she did believe Shadow Weaver was telling the truth about Micah, she just couldn’t figure out what her game was. Shadow Weaver doesn’t just do things for the sake of

doing things, she must have some kind of plan and it was killing Adoora not knowing what it was.

"I hope so too." Catra whispers, ears twitching. Adora's eyes soften at the action. She loves Catra's ears, they move sometimes without Catra even knowing that she's doing it. They just automatically track sound, like satellites. "You know, if Micah is anywhere near as stubborn as Glimmer, I'm one hundred percent sure he's alive." Adora may not know Glimmer as well as Catra does, but she absolutely sees what Catra is saying about her being stubborn.

Adora sighs and helps Catra down from the transport. The small crew of Horde soldiers were busying themselves with securing the transport. Adora felt confident leaving them on the beach; she assumed most of the 'beasts' of Beast Island were probably hiding in the thick forest. She looks around their surroundings. Beast Island was like a portal to another world. Adora wasn't even confident they were still on Etheria anymore, not even the Fright Zone was this gloomy. It was dark, even though Adora knew that it was daylight time, but it was lit up by blue lights on shards of huge metal structures. "This place gives me the creeps." Adora admits. "What is all this stuff anyway? It looks... familiar." Adora pauses in front of one of the weird looking pillars with the blue lights. "Huh..." She runs her hand over the text on the thing. "I can't fully read it, it's kind of degraded."

"It looks like First One's writing." Catra says. Adora looks at Catra briefly. If what Shadow Weaver had said was true, the reason Adora could read First One's writing was because she was a First One, as was She-Ra. Adora looks back at the pillar.

"Hm..." Adora hums curiously. "Something, something, waste material... I have no idea what that means."

"Maybe it's talking about things being thrown away here." Catra says. That would make sense as to why this place had massive shards of metal just dumped here. Some kind of First One's dumping ground. Maybe even the 'beasts' were failed First Ones tech, too dangerous to keep on Etheria that they had been dumped here.

"Maybe..." Adora looks around, shuddering. "We should keep moving. I feel like we're being watched." Adora felt a weird kind of sense. Like something was crawling on her skin.

"Okay," Catra whispers, taking hold of Adora's hand. "I feel it too." Catra murmurs quietly for Adora to hear. "Keep your eyes sharp."

"I'll keep my eyes sharp if you keep your ears sharp." Adora says, attempting to lighten the mood as she gently squeezes Catra's hand.

"Sounds like a plan." Catra responds, laughing quietly.

"This is kind of exciting, in a weird way." Adora makes sure to keep her voice quiet as she speaks. "We're on a mission... *together* ... I never thought that would ever happen. We've fought each other before, but we've never fought as a team, in a battle sense anyway." Was it weird that Adora was excited to be on Beast Island simply for the fact that she got to fight with Catra? Maybe a little, but Adora has *missed* fighting. Shadow Weaver was right, she is *terrible* at sitting on her hands, she likes to be in battle, she likes the feeling of it, the way it lights up her mind with *action* . Adora has never been good at ‘relaxing’, and she’s *excited* to get to fight again - this time against actual enemies rather than against Princesses and for a false mission.

"You're right, surprisingly. But we never had a reason to fight as a team after the war ended." Catra points out. "And we had Finn to care for, so..."

"I know, but it feels good to fight *with* you, rather than *against* you." Adora says. "At least I won't have to worry about dodging those claws." Adora jokes. Catra grins.

"You happen to like my claws though." Catra teases.

"Are you flirting with me?" Adora asks with a playful smirk.

"Perhaps I am. What are you gonna do about it?"

"On Beast Island? Nothing. When we get home," Adora grins. "I guess you'll find out."

"When we get home, are you gonna give me another one?" Catra asks.

"Another what?"

"Nothing..."

"Are you really going to leave me hanging?" Adora asks, glancing at her fiancee. She really can't wait to marry Catra. Everyone already knows that they are a thing, but nothing will beat the satisfaction of seeing Catra wearing a ring and everyone *really* knowing who she belongs to. Not that Catra *belongs* to her, Adora can be possessive, sure, but she knows there are limits. Catra is her own person, but it will still be nice to solidify their relationship with vows and a ring.

"Yup, for now." Catra replies. Adora likes this side of Catra, the playful cheeky side, it interacts well with Adora's own goofiness.

"For now..." Adora repeats before she pouts. "You're really not going to tell me?" Catra grins at her.

"If I tell you, you might just drag me home now." Adora raises her eyebrows at that.

"Is that so?" Adora asks.

"Mhmm. "

"Now I really want to know what you were thinking about. Did you mean a baby?" Adora asks. Catra stays quiet for a moment before she looks up at Adora and grins.

"Maybe." She admits.

"W-" Adora blinks and does a double take. "You want to make another baby?!"

"Hm, who knows?" Catra asks.

"Wow... you really do have a breeding kink." Adora comments. Catra shoves her shoulder and Adora almost trips form the force.

"As if you don't!" Catra complains. Adora smirks a little.

"Oh, I *totally* do." It's not like it's any secret. Adora really (*really*) enjoyed spilling her load in Catra as She-Ra. Catra bites her lip and blushes a little.

"I know, I still remember the mating press very clearly." Catra says. So does Adora.

"We should do that again, when we get home."

"You think we're ready for a second kitten?" Catra asks. Adora does not think that actually. She stays quiet for a moment. It's too soon for her, but in the future, she wouldn't be opposed to it. She doesn't think she could handle another pregnancy so soon, especially when she's still not even fully used to thinking of herself as a *mom* with Finn yet. She definitely doesn't think she could handle another one right now. Finn is perfect, they're all she needs right now.

"I think I'm ready to be strap deep in you again." Adora says instead and Catra snorts. Adora doesn't know if she picks up on Adora's *real* answer, but she supposes that they can talk about it later.

"Perhaps some other time." Catra responds.

"Or, right now? I could go for a tryst in the middle of Beast Island."

" *Adora* ."

"That's my name."

"We're not going to get naked with the possibility of getting ambushed, or of Glimmer's dad seeing us." Catra flicks her bicep and Adora smiles a little. Catra has a point, Adora isn't sure she would survive them being seen by Glimmer's dad. That would be crazy embarrassing.

"Fine, fine, but when we get back... And if I'm not maimed from some terrible beast." Adora says.

"Don't say that!" Catra yells in distress.

"I'm just saying!"

"Don't say it." Catra gives her a *look* , a look that Adora recognises as her 'Don't you dare argue with me' look. Adora never has stopped even when Catra looks at her like that.

Adora opens her mouth to give a snarky response when something catches her eye. She moves her hand out and stops Catra from walking any further. "Sh." Adora says, straining to listen.

"What is it?" Catra whispers back, narrowing her eyes to try to see further towards the sound. Catra's ears twitch again.

"We're being stalked." Adora says, her free hand landing on her utility belt. Before she got her sword, Adora's favourite weapon was her Horde issue staff. It felt right that she should bring one on this mission.

"Are they human?" Catra asks. She crouches down a little and Adora notices that her claws are *out* . Adora knows it’s probably inappropriate at this current moment, but something about Catra fighting is a serious turn on. Maybe this is why they ended up here, Adora just finds Catra completely irresistible, *especially* when she fights.

Adora pauses for a long moment when a creature slithers out of the dark. It looked kind of like a dog, and it stops, sitting on its back legs, as it looks at them. Its glowing red eye stares at them. "Gonna go with no." Adora says, moving so she was back to back with Catra. "We need to move. *Now* . That thing is a pooka and they hunt in packs." Adora explains, trying to keep her voice calm as she stared the thing down. "I got your back if you got mine?"

"Always." Catra looks at Adora and nods before turning her eyes back to the pooka. Adora sees her scan their surroundings and Adora trusts her to get them out of this situation. "On three. One... two... three!" Catra yells before she grabs Adora's hand and pulls her away from the pooka's eyes that had been staring at them. "Move quickly and quietly."

"I ever tell you that it's very attractive when you give me orders?" Adora asks quietly as she unsheathes her staff. This place is so *dark* , Adora wished that she had her sword, that thing had a natural glow.

"Yes, you have actually. I think we managed to get away. I don't see any red eyes."

"They *stalk* ." Adora says. "We're probably being watched. Hopefully not lured into a trap."

"Hopefully not. Maybe we should go left so that we don't stay in the direct path we were on?" Catra suggests.

"Is this why you're the brains and I'm the brawn?" Adora jokes. She looks over her shoulder to give Catra a playful smile. That was a *mistake* . Adora wasn't watching and she slips, not realising there was a hill. She tumbles down said hill and lands at the bottom with a groan. "Ow..." That definitely goes into the top ten embarrassing moments of her life, for sure, and in front of the woman she *loves* ? That’s just cruel. Adora would never live this down.

"Are you okay, babe?" Catra asks, carefully sliding down the hill and offering her her hand. "You need to be more careful." *Like that wasn't obvious.* Adora thinks Catra might be enjoying this a little too much.

"I'm just... gonna lay here... for a second." Adora says, looking up at Catra. She wasn't hurt, maybe a little bruised, but her ego was more bruised. Seriously, who does that? Sure, Beast Island sucked because of the beasts trying to attack them all the time, but she thinks she'd take that over the embarrassment of face planting the ground in front of Catra.

"No time. We can't stay in one place, Adora." Catra says, wiggling her fingers. Adora lifts her hand to grab Catra's when something catches her eye again. She drags Catra down at the same time something leaps over her. Adora rolls Catra over, so she is below her and Adora looks up to see not one but a whole bunch of red eyes in the dark, watching them.

"Shit... We uh... we might need to run." Adora looks down at Catra pinned below her. "Huh, this position is familiar." Adora comments with a smirk.

"Are you serious?!" Catra asks. "You're horny right now? Get off of me, idiot." Catra rolls her eyes and shoves Adora off of her. Adora stands to her feet at the same time that Catra does. They go back to back as they're surrounded by the creatures.

"You know what… they're kind of cute." Adora comments and then one growls at them, revealing their big sharp teeth. "Never mind! I retract my statement!" She can feel Catra shaking her head behind her. Adora extends her staff and she hears Catra extending her claws, ready to fight.

"Babe, do I need to remind you that you can transform into She-Ra without the sword?" Catra asks. *Right* . There are too many of them, but She-Ra would give them the edge that they required. Adora closes her eyes, which is probably dumb, but she does it to concentrate.

Adora reaches out to She-Ra inside of her but… Something isn't right. She just can't make that connection. Her eyes open when she hears Catra grunting, fending off one of the pookas. Adora starts to *panic* . She can't feel She-Ra. Was she gone? Was it because she didn't have the sword? Maybe she was too far away? "Now is not the time for performance issues," Adora mumbles to herself.

“Adora?” Catra asks, her voice is calm but it has an *edge* to it. Adora doesn’t want to let Catra down, she doesn’t want to *fail* her, but she doesn’t think she can make that connection she so desperately needs to transform.

“I can’t transform!” Adora yells, hitting away one of the advancing pookas with her staff. They were getting closer and braver. “I don’t know why but… I *can’t* .”

"Fuck... run!" Catra yells. All of a sudden, someone comes zooming out of the woods, running in front of them and creates a large burst of light to blind the pookas, surprising both Catra and Adora. Adora's eyes widen.

"Magic..." She says in amazement.

"Wait, is that-"

"Get up and move!" The person orders, his hood falling down.

"Is that...?" Adora has no idea what King Micah looks like, other than his murals, it does look a lot like him though. Adora doesn’t know what he looked like before Beast Island, but now his black hair is streaked with grey, like a salt and pepper look, it’s long and falls on his shoulders, his beard too is black and long and streaked with grey. He looks older but not *old* , with his hood removed he was shirtless and Adora could make out large scars over his chest and on his shoulders.

"Come on, my camp isn't far away, I have wards set up there. You'll be safe." His voice is deep but also strangely comforting.

"King Micah!" Catra exclaims. So that confirms this man was indeed Micah. He looks at Catra and seems to recognise her.

"You look a lot like Queen C'yra." Micah says.

"I'm her daughter, C'yra the III. I also go by Catra. And this is my fiancee, Adora. We came to get you off of this island." Catra introduces herself and Adora.

"Oh!" Micah smiles happily - how is he *happy* right now? "You're baby C'yra? Oh wow... you were as small as Glimmer the last time I saw you." He comments. "And you're Adora... Why are you dressed like a Horde soldier?"

"Oh... uh... I... long story," Adora laughs nervously. "Can we talk about this at your camp?" pointing out that they were currently *ambushed* . Micah looks around and stamps his staff on the ground. The pookas all flee at the sight of magic, whimpering into the woods. Adora really wishes she had her magical eight foot alter ego right now - especially if the beasts were sensitive to magic.

"Right! Right this way ladies." He clicks his fingers and then hurries along, like they hadn't just almost been killed. Adora looks at Catra and shrugs as she hurries to catch up with the King.

"So... King Micah. How are you doing at the moment? I imagine seeing us is a lot to take in, no?" Catra asks, catching up with them easily. Micah turns and then he *squeezes* Adora's *face* , which she is not expecting at *all* .

"I was worried you weren't real." He admits and Adora makes a noise of protest before Micah releases her face. "If you're grown then... How long have I been here?"

"For a long time, your majesty. But Queen Angella and Glimmer will be really happy to get to spend time with you now that the war is over." Catra answers.

"The war is over?" Micah asks with surprise. "How did that happen?"

"Well, your majesty, meet the former Lord of the Horde, Adora." Catra introduces. Adora looks nervously at the king as Micah stops walking and turns. He narrows his eyes at Adora.

"You're the Horde Lord?"

"Former." Adora corrects.

"She stopped being the Horde Lord a while ago." Catra adds.

"What happened to Hordak? Shadow Weaver?" Micah asks. Adora swallows.

"I uh... I killed Hordak. And Shadow Weaver... she's in a cell." Adora answers.

"Oh..." Micah doesn't look like he knows what to say for a moment. "And how did you stop being the Horde Lord?" Adora sighs.

"It's complicated." Adora responds. "I'd prefer to answer that when we're in your camp and my fiancee is safe."

"Right, we're almost there. Just a few more feet." Micah nods at Adora, keeping an eye out for more pooka. Adora falls back a little so she can talk to Catra.

"Are you okay?" She asks her.

"I'm okay. You don't have to worry about me, Love." Catra whispers. "A little worried for him. He really doesn't know how much time has passed."

"No kidding." Adora says, glancing at the King. Micah seems almost… like he's been stuck in time. He was surprised to learn that Catra was grown up now. How do you tell a dad that

he’s missed twenty-two years of his daughter’s life? "And, I'm always going to be worried about you." Adora adds, looking back to Catra.

"I know, but I'm alright." Catra reassures. Micah disturbs them by zapping a bug and then making to go eat it before he pauses.

"Bug?" He offers.

"Can't be worse than ration bars, but I think I'm good." Adora declines.

"No, thank you. That being said, are you ready to go, Micah? We have a ship ready to head back to Bright Moon." Catra points out. "We need to get to the shore."

"We can rest for a moment at my camp and then make a move for the shore." Micah says cheerily. How is Micah so cheerful right now?

"This is definitely Glimmer's dad." Adora whispers.

"Geez, what gave it away?" Catra asks sarcastically.

"The sparkles and the general," Adora gestures vaguely to Micah. "Chaotic-ness." Catra giggles.

"I think it's mainly his... inability to interact with other people that is causing a lot of the chaotic-ness, as you say." Catra points out. Adora knows that being left alone on an Island as long as Micah has been, must really mess with someone’s social skills and how they function back in civilization. She can forgive Micah that. In a way, Adora completely understands it.

"What's Glimmer's excuse?" Adora asks, raising her eyebrows. She’s joking but also not. Glimmer is intense, to say the least. Adora doesn’t dislike her however. Sure, her hating her guts has thrown a permanent wrench into them ever being friends, but Glimmer is brave, and

she is strong, and she’s protective… and stubborn. Adora doesn’t doubt that she is a good friend, and it makes sense that she and Catra get - or *got* - along so well.

"Good point." Catra says with a chuckle.

"Say, Micah, what have you learnt here?" Adora asks.

"My camp is just up here." He says, gesturing and ignoring Adora’s question. They enter the 'camp' and Micah lights a fire almost immediately with the click of his fingers.

"Wow..." Catra looks at the light. "I forgot that he could do that for a second." She smiles. "Your majesty, do you have anything from here that you would like to take back with you?"

"I just have a few supplies. I suppose if we're leaving they won't be needed." He says, rubbing his chin with his finger and his thumb. Adora turns to Catra.

"Should we stay here for a little moment or leave right away?" Adora asks. Catra seems to consider the question as she pushes some debris with her foot. She goes to respond when Micah interrupts her.

"We should avoid the vines." Micah says suddenly. "They can be hard to escape if they capture you."

"I'm sorry, the *what* ?" Catra asks exactly what Adora was thinking.

"The vines," Micah says desperately, grabbing Catra by her shoulders. "They get in your head, try to make you give up."

"What? Your majesty, are you okay?" Catra asks, laying her hands on his arms. At that moment Adora winces when she hears an almost wailing sound in her head.

"What... is that sound?" Adora asks. The thing was giving her the worst headache. She places her hands over her ears but it does *nothing* to shut out the noise.

"What sound?" Catra asks, her ears twitching, as though she were attempting to pick up the sound. Adora is only slightly - *very* - concerned that *Catra* can't hear it.

"You hear it?" Micah asks.

"Yeah..." Adora says, looking around. She starts to walk towards where she thought the sound was coming from.

"Adora." Catra calls out, grabbing Adora's wrist. "Be careful. You shouldn't go towards things here. It could be dangerous."

"Don't worry about me," Adora says, gently removing Catra's hand from her wrist. "I'll be careful, promise."

"I'm obviously gonna worry about you, dummy. I love you."

"I love you too." Adora leans forward to kiss Catra gently on her lips before she smiles reassuringly. She starts walking again, Catra and Micah following after her. She can feel Catra's worried gaze on her back as Adora walks. She feels weirdly drawn to this sound, even if it is giving her a splitting headache.

"Micah, what does the voice say?" Adora hears Catra ask.

"It's... I don't know what it is." Micah admits. "It gets louder the longer you're here, eventually, you'll hear it too. Adora... She seems unusually sensitive to it."

"Is... Is it bad?" Catra asks in concern.

"I've avoided it." Micah says. "I don't know what it is but... I get a bad feeling."

"Adora, maybe you should come back now." Catra calls out to her, probably hoping that Adora would turn back. Adora ignores Catra and carries on walking towards the sound.

"In a minute." Adora says dismissively, pushing her way through the vines. This place is so densely forested. Her sword really would have come in handy right now.

"Adora, please come back." Catra begs softly. Adora pushes her way into a clearing.

"What if… What if this is where I belong?" Adora asks. "Beast Island." She feels *hopeless* suddenly, like a darkness has seeped inside of her and is slowly poisoning her.

"Okay, no." Catra says indisputably, walking over to Adora and grabbing hold of her face. "We need to go back home, Adora."

"But..." Adora's eyes dim a little. "I've hurt so many people... Don't I deserve to be here? Wouldn't everyone be better off if I just... stayed? If I was punished?" Adora asks. She has the urge to lay down and never get back up again. This could be the end to it all. The Rebellion would be happy that she was gone *permanently* , justice would be served, Adora would be punished. Catra would be free. She should stay.

"No!" Catra yells out. "You don't deserve to be here. You've done so much to make up for the hurt that you've caused when you were misled! You didn't know any better for most of it! And the rest happened because Shadow Weaver messed with your mind. Please Adora, we need to go home..." Adora looks up at her. She's crying. *She's crying again . All I do is hurt her* .

"You deserve better, Catra..." Adora whispers weakly, she feels her strength being sapped from her, it's getting harder and harder to stay standing. Her vision is blackening at the edges

a little.

"Catra," King Micah says, "around her foot, the vine, remove it." Catra's eyes go down to the vine wrapped around Adora's foot and she quickly cuts it away.

"No..." She whispers. "Adora, listen to me. I have never, and I mean *never,* loved anyone more than I have loved you. You are my other half, you are the soulmate that I never knew I had been searching for until I got to be with you without the walls between us. *I love you* . Please listen to me. We need to go home... to our kitten, to our little Finn." Catra pleads, cupping Adora's cheek. *Finn* . Adora couldn't stay here. Staying here wouldn't make right or fix the stuff that she has done wrong.

Adora stands up a little taller, feeling her strength come back to her. She blinks a couple of times before she wraps her arms around Catra and kisses her on her jaw. "I love you too. Let's get off this island and go home." Catra sighs in relief and hugs her tightly back.

"You scared me, dummy. Let's go home." Catra confirms.

"So we can make that second kitten?" Adora jokes. Catra blushes, glancing at Micah.

"Adora, don't say that in front of Glimmer's dad. That's weird."

"Oh," Adora glances at Micah. "My apologies, your majesty."

"No need!" He says dismissively. "You both clearly love each other very much." Catra blushes a little more, but nods and offers a shy smile.

"We do." Catra confirms. She takes Adora's hand and pulls her close, as though she were afraid Adora may change her mind and try to stay here still.

"Is this how the war ended?" Micah asks. "I assume, as the former Horde Lord, and that Catra is a Princess." Catra nods slowly.

"Yeah, that's basically how it ended. Kind of. It's a long story that we can tell you on the ship while we head our asses back to Bright Moon." Catra says and Adora laughs a little.

"Very well!" Micah says enthusiastically. "Please lead the way ladies." Adora smiles.

"You know, I like him." Adora admits quietly as they begin to make their way back towards the shore. Adora doesn't know how long they've been here, thanks to the gloom, but she definitely feels like she could lie down for about a week now - especially after that whole vine situation.

"Yeah? That was fast." Catra replies with a laugh.

"Call it a hunch." Adora says with a shrug. Catra bumps her shoulder against Adora's.

"We should hurry. There are other beasts on Beast Island, other than the pooka." Micah warns.

"Okay, yeah. Let's hurry." Catra agrees.

And hurry they did. They made it back to the shore relatively quickly but, unfortunately, they were still being stalked by the pooka. They fight them off on the beach, Micah gets injured at some point and Adora tells Catra to get him back to the ship, leaving her alone. She faces them with her staff, all by herself. "Here we go." Adora murmurs to herself. Adora *loves* fighting, there is nothing like the adrenaline rush she gets from it. Adora sometimes has difficulties concentrating but when she fights? She is completely focused.

Adora swipes with her staff, knocking pooka back and away. She spins the thing laughing with only slightly crazed glee as she hits pooka after pooka. She thinks she's doing pretty well, until one of those things manages to bite her leg. Adora falls on one knee in pain, using

her staff to hold herself up. Another jumps on her back and bites her *again* . Adora yells out in pain and she hears Catra call her name desperately from somewhere behind her. “No.” Adora says, feeling that *connection* . She closes her eyes. Catra wouldn’t leave without her, Adora *had* to protect Catra. Adora feels She-Ra again, she feels her reaching for her, and Adora grabs onto it.

It happens so suddenly, Adora is sure, but it feels as though time slows down. Adora feels *hot* and she sees the glow of magic as she transforms in a blinding white light. Adora - no, *She-Ra* - grabs the pooka on her back and throws the thing with little effort and it goes *flying* . The other beasts all cower at Adora as she stands up. She-Ra had healed her wounds and Adora was strong both physically and magically. Adora grins as the things run from her, cowering. “Ha.” Adora says. “You better run!” Adora yells.

“And you better get your ass on this ship!” Catra yells. Adora turns to see Catra standing on the transport, her hands on her hips. Micah is stood beside her with a look of amazement on his face, using his staff to keep himself upright. Adora transforms back. Then, as Adora, she runs over to the ship.

Once she’s on board, she looks at her men. “Get us the hell out of here.” She orders. The soldiers quickly spring into action and then they’re sailing away.

“Are you okay?” Catra asks, coming over to Adora and checking her over for injuries.

“I’m fine,” Adora says with a smile. “She-Ra healed me.”

“You transformed.” Catra points out and Adora nods. She doesn’t know what was causing the disconnect before, maybe it was /adora’s anxiety of failing Catra, but she was glad that she had gotten her back.

“You’re She-Ra!” Micah says in amazement. “That’s incredible!”

“Thanks?” Adora says, a little unsure. “Are you okay, your majesty?” Adora asks, pointing to his leg that was bandaged up.

“Just a scratch, Catra is quite proficient at patching people up.” Micah compliments.

“My mom taught me.” Catra says quietly, referring to Luna of course. Catra sighs and sits down on the deck as Micah too sits down on a box. "Ready to see Glimmer and Queen Angella, your majesty?" Catra asks.

"I can't believe I'll be going home." Micah says, getting emotional. Adora can only imagine what it is that he’s feeling. Adora had only missed Finn’s birth and that had devastated her, she couldn’t imagine missing half of their life - or, well, a good chunk of it anyway.

"Glimmer might even hug me." Adora says lightly.

"Glimmer hugging you would be a miracle." Catra points out nervously. "But we're glad we were able to find you, it has been quite a while since you were last in Bright Moon."

"You're an adult now," Micah says, squinting. "The last I saw you, you were this high and just starting to walk." He holds his hand out to show how small Catra was. Adora resists the urge to make a joke about Catra’s height right now.

"Now we have a baby." Adora comments. Adora shrugs her jacket off and places it over Catra's shoulders and Catra purrs as Adora's scent washes over her. She gets comfortable as Adora sits down beside her, smiling.

"You have a baby together?" Micah asks.

“Yeah, they weren't planned, but we love them with our entire being." Catra answers.

"Well, I'm excited to meet your Little One once we get back to Bright Moon. Is there anything else I should know about?" Micah asks.

"Just... Please don't let others sway you. About half of the Alliance doesn't like Adora. C'yra included." Catra explains. "You seem really nice, and it would make me sad if you sided with them."

"They don't like you?" Micah asks, looking at Adora. "But you risked your life to come save me?" Adora looks at Catra and sighs.

"I was Lord of the Horde, that's reason enough for them to hate me." Catra frowns at her.

"It really isn't though. They're refusing to acknowledge that while Adora was the Horde Lord, she was as much of a victim as the soldiers we were helping reintegrate into the rest of Etheria when they defected." Catra says.

"Victim..." Micah repeats. "You removed Shadow Weaver?"

"Sure did." Adora answers.

"And she was your teacher."

"Yup."

"She was my teacher too." Micah admits. Adora's eyes widen - so Shadow Weaver hadn’t been lying about that either. That was kind of *very* surprising.

"She was?" Adora asks, wanting to know more from what she considered a trustworthy source.

"Yes, she was, so I can understand how you might be a victim to her." Micah says. Catra looks just as surprised as Adora to learn that Shadow Weaver really hadn’t bullshitted about that.

"Oh, then yeah, you can definitely understand." Catra sighs in relief. "That's what I've been trying to tell them, but they only see the bad and refuse to see the good, or the trauma. It sucks."

"How did the war end?" Micah asks. "If they still don't trust Adora?" Catra sighs, biting her lip.

"Adora surrendered." She answers.

"You surrendered?" Micah asks in surprise.

"I did." Adora says. "For Catra, and our baby, but also... I was tired of fighting in a war that I didn't believe in."

"Adora was raised to believe that Princesses were the evil ones, she didn't think that how her and the others were being treated was bad until we got to talk outside of the battlefield." Catra explains. If Adora is honest, she’s not sure she ever would have come to that realisation without Catra.

"I suppose if that's all you've ever known, it would be deceiving." Micah says.

"Exactly! But none of them are even trying to listen when I tell them that, especially not C'yra. She's the main one that wanted to kill Adora when she surrendered." Catra shakes her head, her jaw clenched. Micah laughs a little, which Adora is sure Catra isn’t expecting because her eyes snap back to him.

"I'm afraid that might just be... motherly protectiveness." He says. "If I remember C'yra correctly, she was very stubborn, but brave, and strong. She fought in the battle that I was taken in too. I guess she got away though."

"Yeah, she did, and what she did isn't motherly protectiveness. I'd say more, but... I don't want you to lose your friendship with her either." Catra shrugs. "There's a reason why I'm calling her C'yra though."

"I see," Micah rubs his beard in thought. "I'm sorry she hurt you. Both of you."

"Thanks, I appreciate that, your majesty." Catra whispers, pulling Adora's jacket closer to her. "Please don't let her fill your mind with a whole bunch of bullshit, okay?"

"Adora saved me, and she protected you, and she wanted to stay on Beast Island because she felt so guilty." Micah says. "Besides, I know exactly what Shadow Weaver is like, I think my mind would be hard to change by now." Catra nods slowly. Adora was right about her hunch. She likes Micah, he's kind and understanding.

"Alright, just... just making sure because... yeah." Catra says.

"So, how is my baby girl? Glimmer?" Micah asks cheerfully. "And Angella? Are they both okay?"

"They're both okay. With the war over, they've just been focusing on reconstruction. Not that I talk to them that much, but according to what Spinerella and Netossa told me." Catra answers.

"You two aren't friends?" Micah asks.

"Not at the moment."

"Oh..."

"Yeah." The air suddenly feels very awkward. Adora does not do well in awkward situations.

"I'm sorry." Micah says with a frown. "Seems like, while your relationship has ended the war, it's also created a rift." Catra shrugs.

"Perhaps, but in the end, I chose the woman I love, and our kitten. That's what matters to me most of all. It was the others' decision to act the way they are right now. I tried to ask them to let me explain and they refused, I've given up at this point. In reality, the only reason I'm here is because of Adora." Catra glances at Adora and Adora shuffles closer, lifting her arm to let Catra snuggle against her.

"Sounds like a lot of... stuff... has happened." Micah comments.

"Yeah, a lot."

"But it's okay," Adora says. "We're managing. I just feel bad that Catra has lost people she loves because of me."

"Hey, like I said, it was their choice. You didn't force them to do anything." Catra takes Adora's hand and kisses her knuckles.

"It wouldn't surprise me if C'yra believes I've kidnapped Catra. Even though I told her to stay at home." Adora gives Catra a disapproving look and Catra just rolls her eyes.

"Yeah, that's true." Catra sighs. "We should stop by Spinnerella and Netossa's to get Finn first."

"I miss my baby." Adora pouts.

"I do too. I imagine they miss us too."

"I want to kiss their chubby cheeks." Adora says with a fond smile. "And nap with them again." Catra purrs and moves closer to Catra, snuggling further against her.

"Me too. I can't wait to get home to them."

"I can't wait to have more in the future."

"Yeah, me too."

"But Finn is our first born, so they're unofficially our favourite." Adora comments.

"Yeah, no. We need to make sure we love them all equally." Catra says, squeezing Adora's hand.

"I was kidding!" Adora protests. "Mostly."

"Uh huh..." Catra says, unconvinced.

"So we can't have favourites?"

"Nope." Catra shakes her head. "We need to show them love equally."

"Fine, fine." Adora says. "Finn is my favourite, right now."

"Dork." Catra laughs and shakes her head fondly. "They're our only kitten right now."

"Exactly. And they're my *favourite* ."

"I guess that's okay to say for now." Catra concedes.

"Adora has dad humour, I like that." Micah says and Adora grins.

"Hear that Catra?" Adora asks proudly.

"I heard loud and clear." Catra giggles. "She's always had that kind of humour."

"You love it, right Catra?" Adora asks.

"I love *you* . Your sense of humour is... alright."

"Only alright?" Adora asks, offended. Catra pats Adora on her cheek. Sometimes Adora thinks Catra likes teasing her like this.

“Perhaps we should rest? We have a while before we get back.” Micah says. Adora nods in agreement and snuggles closer to Catra, resting her chin on top of her head. She feels unbelievably lucky to be marrying this woman. That she gets to love her forever. Adora drifts off to sleep cuddling her future wife.

* * *

Adora sighs as she sees them approaching Bright Moon. Adora had gotten to know Micah pretty well on their journey home and she was confident that he was an ally to her. She was still worried. Catra’s moms had given her permission to take Catra on a one week vacation to the Fright Zone, not nearly a *month* vacation to Beast Island. Adora worried about Finn too, but knew they were safe with Spinnerella and Netossa.

Adora hears someone stand beside her and turns to see Micah. “I believe that you love Catra,” He says. Adora has no idea where this is heading, but she’s curious, so she stays quiet. “When I was younger, I was a promising young sorcerer,” He begins. “Shadow Weaver, she wanted to destroy the Horde, but her methods were… She wanted to use dark magic.” Adora tenses a little at the memory of *dark* magic. “The council denied her. At the time I wanted to help her, she said all the right things, I just wanted to further my skills, I never thought the spell was *bad* , she has this skill for making you believe you’re doing right, even if you’re doing wrong.”

“Yeah,” Adora agrees. “She has a way of doing that.”

“Did you truly believe in the Horde’s mission?” Micah asks. Adora sighs, feeling her shoulders sag as she lets her hands curl over the railing. They were close to Bright Moon now.

“With all of my heart.” She answers. “Can I tell you something?” She asks and Micah nods in response. “I liked being Lord of the Horde,” Adora admits sadly. “I liked having a purpose. Maybe it’s self-centred, but I liked being important too.” Adora stares at the water. “Shadow Weaver said that I have ambition, that I’ll never be happy as just a wife and I… I’m worried that she’s right. Catra says we can find a way for me to be useful, that I can find a hobby but… I was raised to be a soldier… I haven’t felt more alive than when we were on Beast Island, fighting. I *miss* it.” Adora rubs her face in frustration. “I don’t want to keep fighting the Rebellion, obviously, but I don’t want to stop fighting either. That's all I know. It’s so *stupid* , I survived, I’m *free* , and I am tired of fighting… but I guess I was tired of fighting for something I never really believed in.”

“So find something to fight for that you do believe in, Lord Adora.” Micah lays his hand on Adora’s shoulder and squeezes softly. Adora turns to look at him in question. “You don’t have to wage wars to fight for things,” He says easily. “You mentioned you wished to learn more about She-Ra? That can be your purpose for now, and caring for your family.”

“I guess I’m worried that it won’t be enough.” Adora admits. “That it’ll *never* be enough. That nothing ever will be. That I can never be satisfied with what I have.”

“Because of Shadow Weaver,” Micah huffs and lowers his arm from Adora to cross his arms over his chest. “Pardon my language, but Shadow Weaver is full of shit. Don’t let her get in your head.” Adora smiles a little at Micah’s words.

“I know,” She says, Catra has said as much herself too. “I know… But she *is* in my head. It’s hard. I know people think I’m stupid for listening to her, they think it’s obvious, they think… I don’t know what they think. Catra finds it frustrating too, I know she does. She was upset when I tried to sneak off without her to come to Beast Island to rescue you off of Shadow Weaver’s words.” Adora sighs as she presses her hand to her chest. “But it’s *hard* for me. It’s so complicated. I hate her, but I love her. I have some twisted… *faith* that she can be better, even though I know that’s probably impossible.” Adora doesn’t think she will ever be able to fully articulate how she feels about Shadow Weaver. “I’m an idiot.”

“You’re not an idiot.” Micah says, patting her on the back. “You’re a victim, like Catra said. You have… a kind of Stockholm syndrome.”

“What’s that?” Adora asks.

“It’s complicated but essentially… You sympathise for your abuser,” Micah explains. “I assure you that no one thinks you’re stupid for your complicated feelings towards Shadow Weaver, she raised you, emotionally and physically abused you, anyone who is not sympathetic towards those circumstances are heartless. Or they severely lack the ability to understand it, maybe they even refuse to accept it,” Micah shrugs. Adora thinks of C’yra and how she refused to listen to anything Catra had to say about Adora and her upbringing. “It takes time and work, it’s important that you’ve already accepted that Shadow Weaver is not who she says she is and that you question what she tells you, instead of following it blindly.” Adora nods.

“I suppose so.” Adora responds.

“And it’s never stupid to hope that people can get better,” Micah says with a kind smile. He looks so much like Glimmer, it’s strange for Adora to see such kindness in Glimmer’s likeness directed at her. “That just tells me that you’re a good person.” Adora smiles back at him. “Besides, no one can take your title from you, Lord Adora.” Micah says, turning back to the land ahead. They were so close now that Adora could make out the shadows of moving bodies working the night shift at the Bright Moon docks. “You’re a Lord, own it.”

“A war Lord maybe,” Adora says with a laugh as she too turns to look out at the shoreline.

“Your title has weight, even if you technically don’t own it anymore.” He says. “Lord Adora *means something*.”

“Means something bad.” Adora says back.

“So make it mean something *good* .” Micah says simply. He makes it sound so simple, but maybe he has a point.

The Horde soldiers call out as they approach the dock and Catra emerges from their cabin, coming to stand beside Adora. She looks at her with concern for a moment before Adora smiles at her. Catra seems to relax. They disembark off of the transport and begin to make their way up to the castle. The guards don’t even try to stop them, some even look shocked as they clearly recognise the long lost Bright Moon king with them.

Adora and Catra enter the throne room first and are immediately ambushed by Glimmer. “Where have you been?!” Glimmer asks in alarm. “We thought Adora kidnapped you! But then Netossa and Spinnerella, and the Horde soldiers, said you’d gone to Beast Island! Queen C’yra has been going *crazy* ! She went back to Half-Moon a few weeks ag-” Glimmer’s words die in her throat and Adora sees her eyes widen in complete shock. “D-Dad?” Glimmer asks. She looks completely caught off guard, which, normally, Adora would be bemused by, but Glimmer looks close to tears and Adora is just glad that she’s no longer yelling. “Dad!” Glimmer exclaims.

Glimmer rushes forward, pushing between Catra and Adora and pauses just in front of Micah. “Glimmer,” Micah says and his smile, his eyes crinkling. “Uh… Hi, I’m your dad.” Micah puts his hand out, as if to shake it, and Glimmer *laughs* before she throws her arms around his neck.

“What is all of this racket in my throne room so late at night?” Queen Angella enters the room and stops in her steps when her eyes land on them. “Micah?” Queen Angella gasps and covers her mouth. In the next instance she slides over to them and the family have a very tearful reunion.

After a moment of watching them, Angella turns to Catra and Adora. “Lord Adora, thank you, and you too Catra.” The Queen thanks.

“Yes, thank you *Lord* Adora.” Micah repeats, winking at Adora playfully. Adora laughs a little at him.

“I think… You deserve a reward.” Queen Angella says. “Your sword,” She gestures to a guard and they disappear. “You can have it back.” Adora’s eyes widen. She hadn’t been expecting *that* . The guard reappears a moment later with her sword and Adora hesitates only for a moment before she takes it by its handle.

“Oh… I have missed you.” Adora says before basically hugging the thing. The family go back to hugging each other and Adora fixes her sword back into place at her hip. Catra grabs Adora by her hand and starts pulling her away.

“Let's give them some privacy.” Catra explains but Adora feels… *something* as Catra drags her away from the scene. Adora pays little mind to the hallways of Bright Moon as Catra leads her along. Weirdly, Bright Moon has become familiar to her, something Adora never thought it would. Adora is dirty and grimy from their trip, she can’t wait to shower and get into bed.

When they reach the door to their bedroom Catra grabs Adora by her wrist, stopping her in her steps. Catra kisses her hot and hard, pushing her backwards and into their bedroom. "Um, Catra," Adora manages between kisses. "I should shower."

"Sh," Catra says, pushing Adora back. "You got your sword back, we survived a near death experience, I'm healed and I haven't been touched by you in months." Adora's knees hit the back of the mattress and she falls backwards onto it. "I need you to *fuck* me." Adora nods as Catra climbs on top of her.

"Yes ma'am," Adora says, wiggling her eyebrows. Catra lowers herself down and *kisses* Adora. They haven't done this in so long, sure they’ve kissed, but not like this, and the intensity almost takes Adora's breath away. Catra isn't wasting any time, she extends her claws and slashes through Adora's shirt to expose her torso. " *Whoah* ..." Catra pulls the shreds away. "You're really excited for this." Adora comments.

"Adora," Catra purrs her name and Adora can't help but shudder. Catra's mouth is suddenly on her neck and she *bites* , sucking on skin and most likely bruising her. "Do you want this?" Catra whispers into her ear. Her breath is hot and it makes Adora shiver as it caresses her ear.

" *Absolutely* ." Adora answers. Catra smirks a little. Gods, Adora has waited for this for too long. She's practically already soaked through her underwear from the moment Catra pushed her down onto the bed.

They're not wasting time here, that much Adora knows. Catra pulls Adora's sports bra over her head and then unfastened her pants, scooting up to let Adora kick them the rest of the way off. She wants to undress Catra too, but Catra seems to have other plans.

Adora *feels* Catra's fingers way before she sees her hand down her underwear. Adora's breath hitches and she wraps her arms around Catra. "Fuck..." Adora arches back into the mattress at the same time Catra's fingers touch her clit. " *Catra* !" Adora gasps the second that Catra's fingers move. Catra knows how to touch Adora by now, she knows what she likes, and what she doesn't like, and she executes it with precision. Her fingers move down Adora's folds, dipping into her wetness before she moves back up to apply pressure to Adora's clit. " *Ah* ..." Adora moves her hips to meet Catra's rubs. "Harder... please..." Adora begs softly. Catra obliges, adding pressure that has Adora a whimpering mess.

Adora remembers when she used to find this so hard. She'd never beg, never whimper so openly, never let someone... dominate her, but that's no longer true. Adora has no issues doing this with Catra now, she has no issues being vulnerable with her, with letting Catra take control, she even enjoys it. Adora can already feel her climax building, her stomach feels tight and she clings to Catra's warm body above her. "Good girl Adora," Catra *purrs* and Adora feels that tightening grow to almost impossible highs. Adora has always been susceptible to praise.

Catra's mouth opens and her *fangs* come to the pulse point on Adora's throat at the same time she spreads her fingers, rolling Adora's clit between her knuckles as she moves fast and hard, Adora squirming against her in the throes of pleasure. Adora is sticky and sweaty and she's breathless, feeling her climax growing and growing. Catra *bites* Adora right on that point and Adora feels a spark of pleasure shoot through her and a resounding loud moan of approval. She knows Catra marks her, and something about that is so hot. Biting necks is important to Magicats, it also feeds into Adora and Catra's possessiveness, especially when Catra whispers *'mine'* once she's done biting.

Adora topples over the edge pretty quickly after that. Her eyes screw shut and she pulls Catra against her as she calls out her name. "I love you!" Adora, as a general rule, tries to avoid saying that during sex, but she just can't stop the words slipping her lips as she hits her peak. Her hips buck a few more times before she stops.

Adora isn't sure where she goes but when she comes to again she is very aware of the purring Magicat on top of her, nuzzling her neck. Adora was still slightly winded but she runs her hand down Catra's spine to let her know that she was back. Catra's purring only increases. She moves her mouth to where she had marked Adora and then she soothes it with her tongue. "Holy shit…" Adora says. She feels beyond satisfied, and like she could sleep forever. "How long have you been wanting to do that to me?" Adora asks.

"Since you transformed into She-Ra on Beast Island," Catra answers. Adora hears the gentle thudding of something and she looks to see Catra's tail hitting the mattress. Adora smiles at it. "We should do this more often." Adora has to agree with that. Adora pushes herself up onto her elbows.

"You can do anything you want to me." Adora declares - within reason of course.

"Maybe later," Catra says. "I have so many things I want to do, and we are totally going to take advantage of this night without Finn, and the morning when we wake up, but I want your strap. And… She-Ra." Adora raises her eyebrows. Catra really must have been thinking about this since Adora transformed on Beast Island.

Adora rolls Catra off top of her and begins to undress her slowly and carefully. With every inch of newly exposed flesh, Adora presses her lips to, kissing her. Catra melts under her touch. Adora has *missed* this. She had felt like an idiot getting upset about not being able to be intimate with Catra, but this was why. Adora loves spending time with Catra, always, but being intimate with her is also extremely important to her. It isn't everything, but it's important.

Adora lifts her hand and cups Catra's breast in her hand as she kisses Catra on her lips. She opens her mouth and they tussle momentarily for dominance with their tongues before Adora comes out on top. They kill like that for a while, every now and again Catra lets out a moan as Adora's slightly callused thumb brushes over Catra's erect nipple. Adora moves up and grabs for her sword that was on the ground. She transforms into She-Ra and then transforms

her sword into the familiar strap. “Man… it has been far too long.” Adora says. Cara’s eyes flutter open and she stares at the strap.

“Maybe we should start a little smaller, babe.” Catra says. Adora blushes and makes the strap smaller. She steps into the harness and fastens it into place. She then walks towards Catra. She spreads her legs apart and tentatively works her fingers inside of her. Catra gasps.

“Does it hurt?” Adora asks and Catra shakes her head.

“N-No…” Catra says. “No, that feels really fucking good.” Adora smirks as she works her fingers in further, thrusting gently and making sure to coat her fingers and palm in Catra’s slick. Catra squirms under her and her moans are like music to Adora’s ears. She-Ra’s fingers are much thicker than Adora’s, and even longer, she doesn’t add anymore than two, not wanting to stretch Catra too much and too far too quickly. Adora pulls her fingers off and then uses Catra’s slick to coat her strap.

“Oh yeah, you’re definitely ready to take me, Kitten.” Adora coos. She lines her strap up with Catra’s entrance and then, very slowly, she pushes inside of her. Catra’s hands fly up and they grab hold of Adora’s - *She-Ra’s* - hips, wanting something to hold onto. Adora always feels far more connected and much more pleasure when she uses her strap as She-Ra, she doesn't know how to explain it other than it feels very *real* .

Catra was positioned on the edge of the bed and the second that Adora is buried in her down to the *hilt* , she leans over Catra. Catra wraps her legs around Adora’s waist and Adora already feels her claws on her back. “Red is stillour safe word,” Adora reminds Catra. “I’m still not totally used to She-Ra’s strength, so if you need me to stop, or *anything* , just tell me, yeah?” Catra nods.

“Just fuck me, Adora.” Adora isn’t one to be told twice. She starts slowly, still worried she might hurt Catra, but it doesn't take her long before the bed is *creaking* with the force of She-Ra’s thrusts. Adora half worries the entire thing might collapse when she really gets into the rhythm of things. Catra’s claws scratch at her back in her pleasure and the room is filled with her cries of pleasure. " *Adora!* " Catra cries. She practically *yowls* with pleasure. Something is hitting something, Adora doesn't know what, maybe the bed against the wall. That's when Catra seems to freeze below her.

Adora has learnt to read Catra pretty well, so she slows her thrusts, worried she was hurting her. "Oh my-" Adora's eyes completely widen when she hears the voice behind them. Catra looks the shade of a tomato, but she's at least covered mostly by She-Ra's hulking frame - Adora can't say the same for her *ass* . Adora glances over her shoulder to see Glimmer standing there, her hand over her eyes.

"Oh," Adora says. "Welcome Sparkles, are you just going to stand there or join us?" Adora asks. She's joking, obviously, but Adora can see Glimmer's blush even from her current position.

"Sorry!" Glimmer squeaks. "Sorry! I… I heard the noise but I didn't… And I just teleported… *Holy shit* ." Glimmer says, clearly embarrassed. Adora laughs.

"Why are you still standing there?" Adora asks. "I'm currently in the middle of something." *Literally* .

"Sorry!" Glimmer teleports away and Adora laughs, turning back towards Catra who was hiding behind her hands.

Adora gently removes her hands from her face. "You okay Kitten?" Adora asks. She can't help but laugh - she found that really hilarious actually.

"No!" Catra yells. "Pull out." Adora follows her command immediately and pulls out. "That… Was mortifying."

"Hey, Glimmer seemed really into it." Adora says and Catra scowls at her. *Bad joke* . Catra rolls over and then crawls up the bed. *Okay, so they're not finishing, good to know* . Adora takes her strap off and transforms back to her regular self. She climbs onto the bed and joins Catra, cuddling her from behind.

"I can't believe that just happened." Catra says.

"Yeah, I said Shimmer should really learn to knock." Adora points out. "This was bound to happen eventually."

"Well, I think she learnt her lesson." Catra responds. "I really can't believe this."

"That kind of killed the mood for you didn't it?" Adora asks. Adora could still go if she was honest. Growing up in the Fright Zone meant that Adora didn't really get embarrassed by stuff like that.

"Damn right it did!" Catra yells. "Yes I tell Glimmer everything, but I don't want her to *see* everything."

"I'm sorry." Adora says quietly. Catra sighs and turns over to face Adora.

"It's not your fault." Catra responds. "I was close too." Catra admits.

"Me too." Adora says back, kissing Catra on her lips. "Glimmer probably prevented our accidental kid number two." Adora jokes lightly - Catra actually laughs.

They fall into silence. Adora kisses Catra until she calms down. She knows the mood has passed and that they likely won't be doing anything else tonight. There was always tomorrow morning anyway. Adora decides to ask another question, since she still wasn't totally sure. "Are you still mad at me?"

"A little." Catra answers.

"Can I make it up to you?" Adora asks hopefully. Catra frowns a bit.

"I think this one is just gonna take some time for me to get over, Adora."

"Really?" Adora wasn’t aware it was that serious - especially considering what they were just doing.

"Yes." Catra sighs. "I don't know what you expected would happen."

"I thought you'd see my cute face and forgive me." Adora says, pointedly giving Catra her best cute smile.

"And I'd thought you'd keep your promise and yet here we are." Catra fires back. Adora looks at her fiancee in confusion.

"What promise did I break?"

"You promised you wouldn't listen to Shadow Weaver again."

"I-" Adora frowns a little. "I didn't... I mean, I did... but... we got Micah back." Adora wasn’t sure that counted as listening to Shadow Weaver. Sure, their intel came from her, but it’s not like Adora could have just stayed in the Fright Zone and not investigated.

"You still broke the promise." Catra purses her lips. "After I begged you not to go alone and had to sneak onto the boat to save your ass."

"I was trying to keep you safe."

"And I was trying to do the same for you, Adora."

"I said I was sorry." Adora repeats.

"I know, but I still need time, okay?" Catra asks. Adora sighs before she nods.

"I promise I won't run off without you again." Adora swears.

"Okay." Catra says after a moment. She kisses Adora on her cheeks.

"So… Do you still want to do this?" Adora asks, just to be sure.

"No, I'm not in the mood anymore."

"Okay," Adora shuffles closer to Catra, holding her securely in her arms. "I really am sorry." And she was. Adora never intended to hurt Catra like that, her only intention was to protect Catra.

"I know." Catra whispers back. They both stay close together, Catra begins to purr and it's not long before she falls asleep. Adora stays awake just a little longer, thinking about their night together. She still had to face C'yra again and explain to her why they had gone on some secret mission without permission, but Adora wouldn't trade holding Catra in her arms like this for anything in the world.

"I love you Catra," Adora whispers into her hair. "I always will, no matter what."

Chapter End Notes

For anyone worried about Finn, Catra was obviously gonna make sure that Finn had everything they needed while her and Adora were gone. -M

Again, I'm so sorry if this chapter has more mistakes than usual, I was literally editing and writing today and only finished a few minutes ago in time to post for update day. I hope y'all can forgive any mistakes. Also, Glimmer walking in on them during sexy times is so funny but omg poor Catra. Adora really has no shame though. Hope you all enjoyed!! -S

As always you can find us on Twitter @ceolordadora and our CC is the same !! You can find me (S) on tumblr @sherasswordstrap

M and I have a podcast where we talk about Lord Adora and other stuff which is called 'Get down with S and M' on Spotify. You can find it here: https://open.spotify.com/episode/29w8qI9ZK55uzJUdaTp911?si=vaUmRlkQSaG-WNtsqhNH0A&utm_source=copy-link&dl_branch=1

Lord Adora

Chapter Summary

"Adora!" Catra yells in disbelief. "I can't believe you!"

"You love me." Adora says with a goofy smile. Catra rolls her eyes and kisses her.

"Unfortunately, that's true." Catra says before she splashes Adora. “I’m going to kick your ass.”

“Jokes on you,” Adora bites back with a grin. “I’m into that.”

“You’re the worst.”

Chapter Notes

Happy Saturday !! And happy Update Day !! So sorry it's a day late but this took me a lot longer to edit than expected but hey, it's here! Please enjoy this chunky chapter as M and I have decided to take a brief hiatus between this chapter and the next :)!

WARNING: NSFW (Like, immediately) (Also, SPOILERS FOR CHAPTER EVENTS: some of the smut of this chapter features a brief mommy/daddy kink, nothing too big but it is in there, just be warned, it's within the smut for the dinner scene as a heads up)

See the end of the chapter for more notes

Adora rolls over and reaches her hand out to feel empty sheets. She blinks her eyes open slowly, and lifts her head to see that Catra was nowhere in sight. Adora sighs and lets out a soft huff. She was naked and alone. After their interruption last night, Adora had fallen blissfully asleep with her catgirl future wife in her arms. She had expected to wake up the same way, but clearly Catra had other plans.

Adora felt bad. She knew that Catra wouldn't just be okay with her attempting to run off without her, she even kind of expected her to be mad, but hearing her say she was actually *still* mad filled Adora with guilt. Her intentions had been good, but her execution had hurt Catra. She was going to work on that, though she knew it would take her time - like Micah had said. Adora lets her head fall back down on her pillow and she closes her eyes. She was willing to sleep a little more - at least before she got up and busied herself for the day.

She was suspended between that place of being awake and asleep when she heard the door to their bedroom cracking open. She peers out of one eye to see the familiar shape of Catra. Adora sits up, blinking her eyes open more. "Good you're-" Adora stops mid-sentence when she sees what Catra is wearing. Adora is fully awake now.

Catra drops a package in her hands on the chair beside the door and Adora sits up to look at her more fully. Catra was wearing some kind of skin tight bodysuit and Adora recognised it as a Horde uniform. Adora blinks so many times trying to see if she was imagining what she was seeing in front of her. "I- What... What are you... Have you had that since we left for Beast Island?" Adora asks dumbly. Honestly? It's a miracle her brain is even still functioning and her nose isn't bleeding right now. Catra looks *incredible* and the boob window is a very good design choice if you ask Adora. Catra smirks. *Oh* .

"You woke up late today, Lord Adora." Catra says firmly, hands on her hips. "You know the rules, and yet you've broken them. What do you have to say for yourself?" Adora doesn't know what to say. Her mouth suddenly feels very dry.

"Are we sure I'm actually awake?" Adora asks, dumbfounded. She wasn't entirely sure this wasn't some vivid sex dream. Catra looks mildly amused.

"Yes, you are fully awake." Catra walks over to her, her hips swinging in a seductive manner. She grabs hold of Adora's chin, pulling it harshly to bring her closer. "Again, what do you have to say for yourself, Lord Adora?" *Are they role playing right now? Is this role play?* Adora doesn't know, but she's been turned on since her eyes landed on Catra in that uniform.

"I uh..." Adora gulps a little, her eyes lingering on Catra's lips. "I'm... a bad girl?" Adora's eyes flicker up to Catra's while she raises an eyebrow.

"That's right, you're a very bad girl." Catra whispers, hovering her lips over Adora's before releasing her chin and letting her fall back onto the bed. "And bad girls get punished." Adora's eyes widen a little from both Catra's words and her roughness.

"You have me a little scared and a lot horny." Adora admits as she looks up at Catra. "And who's gonna punish me exactly? You?" Catra grins ferally and takes her claws out, gently

gliding them over Adora's thigh without cutting into the skin.

"That's right, me." Catra purrs. "Your Force Captain." Adora's breath hitches as her head falls back against the pillows.

"Catra... fuck... I..." Adora trails off as her throat closes. She feels inexplicably aroused by what Catra just did. She doesn't know what she wants, only that she does *want* . "What are you going to do to me?" Adora asks. Catra chooses to not answer and instead climbs on top of her, straddling her hips.

"Good Lords take their orders," Catra says. "Don't they?" She asks and Adora's eyes rake over Catra's body, up and down. Adora is very aware that she is naked herself, but she wants to do whatever Catra wants her to do. Adora nods and then Catra grabs her chin again. "Yes what?" She asks. Adora can't explain it, but whenever Catra does take control like this, it's like a switch gets flipped, even her voice changes, and it makes Adora shudder with arousal.

"Yes, Force Captain." Adora responds. Adora watches as Catra's eyes light up. For someone who was never actually a Force Captain, she sure does seem to enjoy that title being used for her.

"Good girl," Catra praises and Adora lets out a barely restrained strangled noise at the words. Catra grins as she slowly starts to rock her hips against Adora's hard stomach. Adora's breaths come harshly through her nose as she tries to focus on anything but the wetness she already feels pooling between her legs. Adora has found she rather likes being subordinate to Catra sometimes, she likes taking orders from her. She no longer has issues giving up control to her, she will beg Catra freely, she will let Catra do whatever she wishes to her, and she loves it. She loves to please Catra, whether that's below her or not.

"This is how things are going to go," Catra says - that authoritative tone of voice already has Adora squirming under her. "I'm going to pleasure myself, I'm going to *use* you." Adora's pupils dilate. "I'm going to ride your face, and then your cock, I'm going to do anything I want to you, but you're not allowed to cum without my permission." Adora whimpers at the thought. This is going to be hard, but she wishes to please Catra, so she simply nods her head. Catra places her hand around Adora's throat and Adora's breathing becomes ragged when Catra applies only the slightest of pressure. " *That's* your punishment. You're not allowed to cum without my say so, understood?"

"Yes, Force Captain." Adora repeats, her voice coming out heady with lust.

"What a good Lord." Catra says, her hips are still rocking and Adora looks up at her with *awe* . Catra blushes a little. "Remember the safe word?" Catra asks and Adora nods. She wants to touch Catra, but Catra hasn't exactly given her permission yet, so she refrains. "I went to see the doctor this morning, he says I'm fully healed." Catra reveals as she places her hand flat on Adora's chest, just below her breasts. "And I have *so* many plans for you." Adora swallows at Catra's words. She says them lazily as she carries on rocking her hips.

Catra moves her hands to Adora's biceps, her claws extending ever so slightly as she trails them over Adora's supple skin. Adora grins smugly. She's built a fair amount of muscle over her time helping rebuild (and with a significantly better diet) and she appreciated that Catra noticed.

Catra's head tilts back a little as she carries on grinding against Adora's hard stomach. Adora watches her with great interest and her eyes find that she has a growing wet patch beginning to show through her leggings. "Can I touch you?" Adora asks, her fingers flexing at her sides. Catra peers an eye open but then nods her head a little in response.

Adora brings her hands up to Catra's hips. She lifts her ever so slightly and then pulls her down to grind against her harder. Catra lets out a wonderful sound of approval at that. Her hips jerk down harder and she hisses a *'yes'* as the fabric, combined with Adora's hard stomach, must rub her in just the right way.

In hindsight, Catra and Adora really should've seen their relationship as dooming them both from the start. They are physically attracted to each other on a level Adora doesn't know how to explain. She always has been. She's never felt this raw attraction to someone, she's never been plagued with the thoughts of someone like she had been with Catra. Their first night together, they doomed each other. Adora would still do it all again. Despite all the hurt, all the pain, everything, Adora would do it all again to be with Catra. She would do *anything* .

"Is it really fair that I'm naked and you're not?" Adora asks and Catra huffs. She was clearly enjoying herself right now. "I mean, skin on skin contact will probably feel better, right?"

"Lord Adora," Catra says, her voice is a little strained with pleasure and Adora shivers when she hears it. "I'm in control here." She gently grabs hold of Adora by her chin, forcing Adora to look her in the eyes. "You'll do exactly what I tell you to do. And I'll do whatever I want. Got it?" Adora gulps but nods anyway.

Catra stands and then begins to remove the bodysuit. Adora watches her very *very* intently. Catra reaches for the stockings but Adora grabs her hands. "Keep them on?" Adora pleads. Catra raises an eyebrow but concedes - something about Catra in just stockings is really working for Adora.

"Lie down Adora," Catra commands and Adora does as she's told. She adjusts the pillows behind her and then looks up at Catra. Catra positions herself above Adora and pauses. "Ready?" Adora nods eagerly and reaches her hands up to Catra's hips.

Catra slowly lowers herself down until she's sitting comfortably above Adora's face. Adora has never done this like *this* before, she can already feel her oxygen supply becoming *heavy* , but she's just found a new favourite position. There's just something about having your future wife's pussy right on your mouth.

Adora starts first, burying her tongue in Catra. She teases her clit first, swirling and licking roughly with her tongue and alternating her strokes so that she has Catra *mewling* above her. Then Catra starts moving her hips. Catra wasn't kidding when she said she was going to *use* Adora. Catra *fucks* her face - roughly. Somewhere along the way, she stopped caring that Adora needs oxygen to *breathe* - but not even Adora cares if she’s honest. She could die doing this and she would consider it an *amazing* way to go.

Adora pushes her tongue *inside* of Catra and uses her grip on her hips to grind her down onto her tongue. Catra *yowls* at that, her hips moving harder. Adora is *significantly* wet from the mere sounds. " *Yes* ! Adora…" Catra encourages. "Keep going." Adora had no intention of stopping.

Adora can *taste* how wet Catra is from the amount of fluids spilling into her mouth, and she groans happily at the taste. When Catra cums, not only does Adora feel it around her tongue, and not only does she taste her release, but Adora almost suffocates from the way that Catra tenses and then collapses on her face, panting.

When Adora gets really concerned that she might pass out, she tentatively taps Catra's thigh. Catra moves down and Adora drinks in the air, enjoying the way the oxygen expands in her lungs. Adora can feel the cool air on her face from herself being coated in Catra's shine. She licks her lips and Catra laughs a little, gently taking Adora’s chin in her hand. "You look so pretty being covered in your Force Captain." Catra *purrs* . Adora has *never* felt so turned on in her life.

"You taste *incredible* ." Adora says, slightly dazed.

"You always say that." Catra grumbles, blushing slightly.

"And I always mean it." Adora smiles up at Catra and Catra lets out a loving sigh.

"Transform into She-Ra." Catra orders, picking up the sword by the side of the bed.

Adora stares at the blade before she takes the handle in her hand and transforms into She-Ra. Catra makes quick work of her clothes, tossing the shreds to one side and Adora transforms her sword into their favourite play thing. Catra takes it and pulls it up She-Ra's long legs and then tightens it into the *perfect* position. Even just the pressure *now* is giving Adora pleasure. Catra collects some of her wetness and then dips her fingers into Adora's mouth before she uses that to coat the strap. They both know that Catra is by far wet enough to take Adora - *She-Ra* - but she does that anyway.

Catra lines herself up and then, slowly, she lowers herself down on Adora's strap. Catra stills when she meets Adora's hips and she breathes slowly. Then, she begins moving. The pleasure Adora feels is inexplicable, she grips onto Catra's hips and her head falls back into the pillows behind her.

Catra slowly builds her pace, thrusting up and down on Adora's strap. The visual is just as pleasurable as the sensation. Catra takes Adora's hand and places her fingers to her clit and Adora happily circles her fingers at the same time that Catra keeps moving. Her thrusts increase and it becomes difficult for Adora to concentrate as pleasure overwhelms every sense she has.

Adora thrusts her hips *up* , meeting Catra half way, desperately, chasing her own release while also giving Catra what she wanted. " *Ah* ! *Adora* ! Right *there* !" Catra calls out, she doesn't seem to care about how loud she's currently being - but neither does Adora if she's honest. "Good Adora, keep going." Catra encourages slamming her hips down. Adora can feel her own slick against the strap at the praise, she's so close to cumming, the pressure of Catra pushing down on the strap is rubbing her in all the right places - not to mention the buzzing of her cock that is a constant pleasurable experience.

"Catra I'm-" Adora chokes off into a loud moan as she clings for Catra. She focuses her breathing as best she can but she's right on the edge.

"No .″ Catra says sternly but her hips *keep moving* . Adora doesn't know if she can follow her demand. "You don't have my permission." Catra says. Adora groans and her hands leave Catra to instead grip at the sheets.

"Please," Adora begs, moving her hips and scrunching her eyes closed at the pleasure she feels. She's so close, that feeling in her stomach, the red hot coil, is so close to *snapping* . "Catra please, I'm so close, please-" Adora can do little but beg and move her hips feverishly. Catra growls and shakes her head.

"No, if you cum now, you'll be doing it without my permission, you'll be a bad Lord, and you want to be good for me, don't you Adora?" Catra asks. Adora doesn't really know if she fully catches what Catra says but she whimpers out some kind of response. Catra adjusts herself. " *Don't you fucking cum.* " Catra warns and then, without warning, she moves fast and hard.

Adora clings to the sheets, her grip is so hard she swears she hears a *crack* of the bed below them. Catra is moving fast and hard for her own pleasure, but it also increases Adora's tenfold too. Adora thinks she might just pass out from holding her breath as she focuses on *not* giving in.

Catra cums and Adora *feels* it, her walls tighten around her strap and she screams out Adora's name. Adora barely hangs on, she's sweating in her effort and part of her thinks maybe giving in will be the better option here, she'll endure Catra's punishment in retaliation, anything to relieve herself of this.

As a result, Adora doesn't stop her hips, she speeds them up and she hears Catra gasp in response. " *Adora* !" She calls but Adora isn't listening, she's searching for her own release. Adora feels a stinging in her hips and she realises that Catra has her claws dug into her, pinning her hips, stopping her from thrusting. "Not *yet* ." Catra says sternly. Adora whimpers. Moving her hips causes Catra's claws to sink deeper, which consequently *does* give her pleasure, but she doesn't have enough room to work herself up to a release.

"Catra, please, I'm begging you, please, *please* , I can't... please, *please* ..." Adora says please more times than she can count and she almost sobs when she feels Catra pull off of her strap.

"I said not yet, Lord Adora." Catra growls and she pins Adora's shoulders to the bed, her claws digging into Adora's skin. Adora knows as She-Ra she could totally get out of this, but she does want to be good, as Catra said, so she takes the moment to regroup. She feels absolutely *wrecked* . Even as She-Ra. Being so close to the edge, and then almost violently jerked back, is almost too much for her. She needs to cum soon or she might actually explode.

After a long moment, Adora's breathing evens out and she feels one of Catra's hands gently petting her hair. She blinks her eyes open and looks at the love of her life. "What... Is this my punishment for sleeping in or is this my punishment for trying to sneak off to Beast Island?" Adora asks. Her voice is hoarse from her begging and lack of water. Catra laughs at her.

"Maybe a little bit of both." Catra admits. "I have a plan for something else now, you're still not allowed to cum without my permission though, got it?" Adora nods her head. She's not entirely sure she can take more of this edging but she's here now and she did agree to this.

Catra moves herself and then she grabs Adora's cock in her hand. Adora's eyes widen but, before she can say anything, Catra starts moving her hand up and down it. The motion causes the strap to pulse and every time Catra's hand moves down it presses right to Adora's clit. "Holy-" Adora chokes down a moan. "Fuck, *yes* ... Yes..." Adora moves her hips slowly, closing her eyes to stay concentrated. She was aware that she wasn't allowed to cum, and she was going to fulfil Catra's request if it was the last thing she did.

Catra picks up speed and Adora opens her eyes to watch. The visual is just as hot as the pleasure she gets from the action, if Adora is completely honest - especially when she realises that Catra's hand glides over the strap so effectively because it's coated in *Catra's cum* .

Adora is sitting on the edge of the bed, Catra between her open legs, standing in front of her. Catra runs her clawed hand through Adora's loose blonde hair and she kisses her on the temple. "You're so good Adora." Catra praises quietly. Adora gasps softly as she wraps her arms around Catra. "I love you." Catra purrs and Adora feels her heart almost leave her chest with love and pleasure all at once. Adora likes this, she likes that she can be vulnerable with Catra and not fear it, it means their level of intimacy only grows.

Catra's thrusts come harder and faster and Adora can do little but whimper in pleasure. She loses her ability to speak coherently and instead just loses herself to the sensations. She clenches her jaw as the strap hits her *just right* every single time. "Catra..." Adora pants. "I'm close..."

"Not yet." Catra says firmly. Catra works her right up to that edge again and then she stops. Denying Adora what she really wants. Adora thinks this might just be sexual torture at this point. And she's *totally* into it. Adora has been pushed to the brink so many times now, she's felt that coil grow so hot it burns her up inside and then Catra just stops. It's driving Adora *insane* , but in all the right ways.

"Still green?" Catra asks when Adora has calmed down a little. Adora nods her head slowly and swallows her spit. "Hm... Maybe I'll leave you like this?" Catra phrases it as a question. Normally, Adora might find the edging sexy as hell, and she'd be more than willing to submit to it, but she needs this release more than life itself by this point.

"Catra..." Adora whines. "Please, no... I need you... please... I can't." The thought of walking around all day, swollen, wet, the ache of denial between her thighs, is an attractive thought, but Adora needs her release today.

Catra seems like she contemplates it before she hums. She reaches for something and Adora watches as Catra drops a pillow between Adora’s legs on the ground. Adora's eyes widen. *Was Catra about to do what Adora thought she was about to do?* Catra kneels on the pillow, adjusting herself until she is comfortable and then she moves closer to Adora's strap. "Okay, I'm going to rock your world." Catra says. Her hand moves to Adora's strap and she makes a fist around it at the base. "You have my permission to cum, Adora, but I want you to do something for me."

"Anything." Adora says without hesitation.

"Cum *in* my mouth." Catra deadpans, her heated gaze holding Adora's eyes steadily. Adora's mouth goes almost completely dry.

"Y-You mean…" Adora trails off, not sure if maybe she was wrong.

"I mean in, Adora." Catra reassures. "I want to taste you." Adora has never done that in Catra's *mouth* before, but *holy shit* if that doesn't have her going already. Adora nods hastily and Catra smirks.

Catra still clearly feels like teasing her, she grinds the base of Adora's strap into her with her hand as her tongue slowly licks at her tip. Adora's strap was still coated in *Catra,* and the fact that Catra was tasting herself on Adora's strap while taking her length in her mouth? Adora almost cums there and then. It’s a total tease, and it is definitely working.

It really doesn't take Adora long, she's been worked up so many times, she's sure that if the wind hit her in just the right way she might cum - never mind Catra bobbing up and down on her *cock* . Catra flattens her tongue to the base of the strap and moves her head rapidly, taking all of Adora's length. Adora's hips jerk up and she lets out a strangled moan. Adora can feel her strap slipping down the back of Catra's throat and the brunette gags a little.

Adora tries to stop herself but when she does, Catra just digs her claws into Adora's thighs and gives her a look that tells her to keep going. Adora is pretty sure she's going to fuck Catra's throat *raw* , but Catra is asking her to keep going. So Adora does.

Catra sucks and moves her hand all at once to drive Adora *insane* . "Catra… I'm… *close* ." Adora gasps as her hips twitch more. She places her hand at the back of Catra's head and pushes her deeper. The only response Adora gets is Catra's claws digging deeper into her thighs. She has her permission, and Adora can just hear Catra telling her to *let go* .

So she does.

Adora blissfully reaches her peak and topples over, screaming out Catra's name as she cums. She feels her strap get hot and then release. She barely has time to take in the sight of Catra drinking it up because Adora loses her strength, falling back on the bed. Adora *swears* she sees stars, maybe even an entirely different universe if she's honest. At some point, her grip on She-Ra slips and Adora goes back to being herself again.

The thing that brings Adora back is the feeling of Catra marking the inside of her thighs. Adora pushes herself up on her forearms to look down. Her skin is already bruised where Catra just bit her with her fangs, but Adora almost feels proud (?) that Catra has marked her like that. That's when Adora notices a white liquid down Catra's chest and a little at the corner of her mouth. Adora's eyes lock onto it and she feels arousal shoot through her at the sight. Catra snorts.

"I can smell you, Dummy." Catra says, probably reading how Adora's mood just went back to horny like that. Her voice is a little rough from taking Adora so far down her throat. "You cum a lot with that strap, we probably should've known I'd get pregnant."

"Kiss me, please?" Adora asks. Catra laughs and pushes herself up. Adora kisses her hungrily, using her tongue to taste the almost salty taste of Adora's cum. *Huh , not how I thought that would taste like* . After a moment, Catra pulls back.

"Come on, we need to get cleaned up." Catra says, patting Adora on her thigh as she stands up from the ground. Adora opens her eyes, that she had closed while kissing Catra, slowly and then looks at her fiancee. *How did Catra just have her a whimpering mess and now she's walking around like it was nothing?*

Adora pushes herself up, her legs shake a little as she takes a few steps. "You need to wear that uniform again and more often." Adora comments. "And we need to do *that* ," She refers to what they did at the end there, "more often." Adora says as she walks over to the waterfall in the room. Not only would it prevent any accidental pregnancies, but it was also totally *hot* .

"Adora, what-" Catra doesn't get to finish her sentence before Adora wades into the water, the cool water feeling nice after her temperature had risen dramatically under Catra. "I told you those waterfalls were for decoration, they're not meant for showering." Adora grins.

"I'm aware."

"It's cold."

"You should join me here." Adora says and Catra rolls her eyes.

"Yeah, no thanks, I'd much rather have a hot shower." Catra says, her tail flicking. Adora actually enjoyed cold showers, probably because that's all the Fright Zone had.

"Fine..." Adora glances at her fiancee. "Help me out?" Adora reaches her hand out and Catra takes it. Adora is sometimes a little shit (often actually) and she takes this opportunity to pull Catra into the water. Catra squeaks and they both tumble into the shallow water of the waterfall. Catra sits up and Adora cackles.

" *Adora* !" Catra yells in disbelief. "I can't believe you!"

"You love me." Adora says with a goofy smile. Catra rolls her eyes and kisses her.

"Unfortunately, that's true." Catra says before she splashes Adora. “I’m going to kick your ass.”

“Jokes on you,” Adora bites back with a grin. “I’m into that.”

“You’re the worst.”

* * *

It turns out that Catra hadn’t just visited the doctor that morning. The parcel that she had placed on the chair by the door was Adora’s new outfit. They had agreed at some point that she couldn’t wear a Horde uniform for the rest of her life. So Catra had given Adora’s

measurements to a tailor and she had requested Adora's new clothes. Looking at herself in the mirror, Adora couldn't have loved the outfit more.

She was still wearing similar material to her Horde uniform because it was comfortable, in fact, the pants were identical, but her shirt had no sleeves, showing off her biceps and the cuffs of the sleeves were golden and the rest of it was white. Adora's boots were the same too, her pants were tucked into them but instead of red, they were the same shade of blue as Adora's eyes. She still had her belt at her waist but instead of her Force Captain badge was some golden winged pin. On her shoulders were golden shoulder guards that looked somewhat similar to She-Ra's and looked as though something attached to it. Adora slides her sword into her holster at her hip.

"Almost forgot," Catra says, holding up something. It takes Adora a moment to realise that what she's holding is a *cape* . Adora gasps as Catra attaches it to the golden shoulder guards.

"Oh I've missed you," Adora says with sparkly eyes as she swishes the thing. It's so strange how a piece of cloth can make you feel so important. The cape was blue, like her boots with golden patterns along the edges. It was like the perfect touches and reminders of She-Ra while incorporating the comforts of the Horde uniform that Adora had become accustomed to. "Wow… I got to have sex with my future wife this morning *and* get a cape all in the same morning? Are we sure I'm awake?" Catra snorts.

"Dork," She comments. "Yes, you're awake, I thought you'd enjoy having a cape back." Catra says softly. She steps up behind Adora and places a kiss to her cheek. Adora's heart has never felt so full.

Adora turns and takes Catra in her arms. "I love you so much." Adora confesses, like it was the first time but it must have been the thousandth - at least.

"I love you too." She says, kissing Adora gently on the lips. "Now, we better go retrieve our child, it's been so long since we've seen them-" A knock at the door interrupts them. Catra sighs. "Come in?" Catra calls. The door opens hesitantly.

"Princess C'yra," A Bright Moon guard greets. "Lord Adora. King Micah has called a meeting in the War Room, he requests both of your presence."

“Thanks.” Adora says dismissively and they bow their head a little before they leave the room again. “Do we go? Or do we go get Finn?”

“Might as well get this meeting over with, whatever it is.” Catra says. She sounds tired, Adora notes, and Adora makes it her personal mission to make it up to Catra as best she can. “Come on.” Catra says, taking Adora’s hand and pulling her out of the room.

They walk down the hallways of Bright Moon castle, hand in hand. Adora sees Micah and Glimmer standing just outside of the War Room. “Ah, Lord Adora,” Micah greets brightly with a warm smile. He looked different, Adora notes but, she supposes, she does too. Micah was wearing more kingly looking clothes that fitted him well, his beard had been trimmed and his hair he wore in a top knot with the other black strands falling on his shoulders. It looked as though he’d had a trim in its length but it remained long, his scars on his biceps from his time on Beast Island were still visible but, otherwise, he may as well have been a completely different man. “My dear friend.” Adora stops beside him and he clasps her forearm in a strong greeting. Adora can’t help but smile.

“Your *friend* ?” Glimmer asks, who was standing beside her dad. Micah glances at Glimmer as he releases his hold on Adora’s arm.

“She saved me from Beast Island, I think that puts us on a certain level of friendship.” King Micah says. Glimmer only lets out a soft sigh but she says nothing more - part of Adora thinks she might even be embarrassed about what she walked in on last night.

“You called a meeting, King Micah?” Adora asks curiously. Catra is standing beside her but she’s mostly silent, her tail swishing from left to right. She’s clearly trying her best to not look at Glimmer right now.

“Yes, I apologise, I believe you were about to go retrieve your child,” He says. “No need, Princess Spinnerella and Netossa are here.” He says, gesturing to the War Room.

“Excuse me,” Catra says, clearing her throat. “I’ll go get them.” Adora smiles at her soon to be wife and kisses her on her forehead before she disappears into the War Room to go retrieve Finn. Adora could sense that Micah wished to say more.

“I believe you wanted to make more demands, Lord Adora?” He asks, raising his eyebrows at her. Adora stares at him blankly. *She did?* “Something about the Rebellion not being too fair to you in your original submission.” Adora hadn't told Micah this at all. She wonders briefly how he heard. *Maybe from Angella? But why would Angella tell him such a thing?* Adora raises her eyebrows.

“I did?” She asks and he gives her a look that says ‘trust me’. Weirdly, Adora has known Micah only for two days, but she does trust him. She really does. “I mean, of course, yes, I did.” Adora nods and Micah breaks out into a giant grin.

“Perfect!” He exclaims happily. “I will see you in there.” He pats her on the back before he enters the War Room, leaving Glimmer and Adora standing in the hallway together - *alone* . Adora hasn’t been alone with Glimmer pretty much ever - unless you count their brief talk on the tracker pad when Glimmer seized it from Catra that one time.

Glimmer still won’t look at her, but she speaks anyway. “Sorry about walking in on you guys,” Glimmer says. “It wasn’t my intention.”

“I mean, I hope not.” Adora grins a little, letting the humour into her tone of voice. “Catra is mine.” Glimmer actually *laughs* .

“Yeah,” She says. “I suppose she is.” Glimmer looks at her finally before she seems to blush. “That’s… The first time I’ve seen She-Ra, except for when you were… Corrupted I guess.” *Huh. That was true.* Adora almost wants to burst into laughter with this information.

“What did you think?” Adora asks. “Impressive?”

“You’re very… big.” Glimmer says and her blush is only getting worse - it’s kind of cute honestly. “I can see why Catra…” Glimmer doesn’t finish that sentence, but Adora gets the gist of it. She raises an eyebrow at her.

“Are you flirting with me, Princess Glimmer?” Adora asks, a hint of smugness seeping into her voice. Glimmer looks *appalled* by that suggestion.

“ *No!* ” She exclaims and Adora can’t help but laugh.

“Right, Arrow Boy.” Adora notes as Glimmer lets out a huff of frustration. “It’s okay if you have a crush on me, lots of people do.”

“You’re very arrogant.”

“It’s part of my charm.”

“It’s annoying.” Glimmer states and Adora simply grins at her. Glimmer stares at her and only after a long moment does she slowly start to smile. “You’re actually… A person.”

“Thank you?” Adora says, confusion colouring her words. Glimmer sighs.

“I just mean…” She pauses for a moment and Adora can practically see her collecting her thoughts. “I don’t know. For the longest time you were just the Lord of the Horde.” Glimmer says. “My dad likes you, you saved him, and Catra…” Glimmer sighs as she looks at her boots. “Catra has a big heart, she’s a lot like Bow in that way, I thought maybe she was wrong about you. I thought… How could *you* be good?” Glimmer’s eyebrows pinch together and then she looks up at Adora. “I never saw you as a person, just Lord of the Horde, the reason I didn’t have my dad, and now? Now you’re the reason I *do* have him.” She purses her lips. “My dad says that he understands you, I don’t know what that means but… I know what C’yra said isn’t true. I was… wrong…” Adora’s eyes widen at the words. Glimmer admitting she was *wrong?* That was huge!

“I am a person,” Adora says, “I have feelings. I have… *stuff* , just like anyone else. I don’t hold it against you for wanting me dead, if I was you, I’d probably want the same, but you hurt Catra. That I cannot forgive, not until she forgives you at least.” Adora pauses. “But, if it makes you feel better, I have some experience with Catra being upset with me, you just have to listen to her and talk to her. Something you didn’t do before.” Glimmer hums.

“I think it might be too late for that.” Glimmer says.

“Catra is a very understanding person, maybe *too* understanding.” Adora notes. “Just talk to her.” Adora pats Glimmer on her shoulder and the pink haired girl glances at her.

“I just hope I stop having the image of your *ass* burnt into my memory whenever I look at you.” Glimmer comments and Adora almost chokes on her laughter.

“No promises, Catra tells me it’s a pretty nice ass.”

“Gross.” Is all Glimmer says before she teleports away - probably into the War Room for the meeting.

Adora waits outside. She’s suddenly thankful that Catra had gotten her new outfit this morning. No longer was she wearing the Horde symbol like some outsider, she still had a uniform, a comfort to Adora, admittedly, but she was no longer Lord of the Horde. Though she’d be damned if she wasn’t a Lord anymore. She remembers Micah’s words. No one can take that title from her. She will always be Lord Adora. It was time she showed the Rebellion who Lord Adora really was.

She strides into the room full of confidence and people fall silent as soon as she does. Except for Catra who was currently *purring* at their baby in her arms. Catra looked so happy to be reunited with them. Sometimes Adora could hardly believe that she and Catra made an entire being together. Adora ignores the stares and awkward silences and walks over to her future wife and her child. She leans down to kiss them softly on their head and they purr harder in their sleep. Catra smiles as she looks up at Adora and Adora smiles right back at her. Adora takes her seat beside Catra.

Adora notices that two seats are empty. They’re the Queens of Half-Moon of course, though Adora doesn't doubt that the news of their return has probably reached them by now, and they’ll be on their way back to Bright Moon to see that Catra was still in one piece. The usual empty seat beside Queen Angella is taken by her husband and Micah smiles at her reassuringly. Everyone was waiting for her to speak, Adora realises. Adora clears her throat before she begins speaking.

“I realise now that in my haste to surrender to you all, I didn’t make any demands of my own.” Adora says carefully. She isn’t sure her ‘demands’ will be well received. “Other than my request to see Catra before you arrested me, I made no other demands, I only asked what *you* wanted. I think I’ve proven myself to you all.” No one is saying anything, but Adora takes it as a good sign that no one has yelled in defiance of her words. “My people, the Fright Zone, they need help.” Adora thinks about all the things they’ve achieved over there, how successful they’ve been, but everyone needs help. Right? “Scorpia, she’s a Princess, I move that you allow her to be involved in the Princess Alliance, that you provide the Fright Zone with materials they may need, obviously in a fair trade. The Fright Zone has technology, we have a whole lot of materials in relation to metal, we have information. We should share.” Adora pauses.

“I also… I know not everyone in the Fright Zone may want to stay there, and maybe some Etherians are interested in joining Princess Scorpia’s kingdom,” Adora says, glancing at Micah. “We should let people leave and settle on Etheria from the Fright Zone, and we should let Etherians live under Scorpia if that is their wish.”

“What about you?” Mermista asks. “You want more?”

“No,” Adora says, shrugging. “I mean, it wouldn’t hurt if you guys lifted my guard detail. It’s hard to be romantic when we have a bunch of guards breathing down our necks.” And harder to be *intimate* , but Adora thinks maybe that might be too much information.

“I think those are reasonable demands.” Micah speaks up. “Lord Adora wishes to look out for her people, besides, it’s time the Princess Alliance was complete, can’t do that when one of those are missing.” Adora knows she kind of just dropped Scorpia into that, but she’s pretty sure Scorpia won’t mind. She was a Princess, she deserved to be involved. “The Fright Zone has been separated for too long. The war is no more, as I understand it, so why is there still division?”

“Shadow Weaver,” Adora says suddenly. She sees Micah’s hand tightening on the table. Catra seems to freeze beside her. “She’s too dangerous. I know she’s been locked up in the Fright Zone for years now, but knowing where she is, is… It’s like a constant… well, a constant shadow hanging over me.” Adora confesses. “Is there some other permanent solution to her presence?” Adora asks. “A spell to take her magic?” A magic-less Shadow Weaver would still have her mind tricks, but at least she wouldn’t be able to hurt anyone with

her spells anymore. “Her connection to the Black Garnet has long since been severed, she still has dark magic, but it’s not as strong as when she uses that runestone.”

“I can contact my sister in Mystacor to see if there is a possible spell.” Micah answers. “But I can’t promise anything.” Adora nods in agreement. She could work with the maybe.

“My main point is,” Adora begins. “We’re supposed to be at peace, to have a peace treaty. I don’t have much experience in those, but I’m pretty sure they’re not supposed to be one-sided, right? I’ve helped you guys rebuild, you can help the Fright Zone do the same.”

“All those in favour of Lord Adora’s demands?” Queen Anegella asks. *Everyone* raises their hands. Adora can hardly believe that the Princesses are all on her side. “I see,” Angella says. “Of course, for the vote to be valid, we’ll have to take Queen C’yra and Luna’s votes, but even so, without them, you have the majority.” Adora smiles happily. “So it is decided that Bright Moon will help the Fright Zone, Adora’s guard detail will be lifted and Princess Scorpia will be invited to join the Princess Alliance." Everyone nods their heads at Queen Angella's words and Adora beams at Catra. "I think we can dismiss this meeting." Angella says and the Princesses stand.

Adora turns to her future wife. "So, how was that for being Lord of the Horde?" Adora asks.

"I'm proud of you, Adora." Catra says quietly. That actually means the world for Adora to hear. "Now, I think you have building duty, so give me your cape, I don't want that thing getting dirty already." Adora laughs and kisses Catra. She did have rebuilding duty to do, but she takes some time to be with Catra and her child first.

* * *

Catra was standing on one of the many balconies of Bright Moon’s castle that overlooked the town below them. She could see Adora working away down there, laughing at something Bow just told her. Catra was glad that Adora seemed to be settling in now. At the meeting it had been like Adora had found a new purpose, she seemed more like herself. And she was, she was becoming a better version of herself, she was going to therapy, she was still a fantastic lover and partner, she was making *progress* . Catra, on the other hand, felt *stuck* .

She had no particular feelings towards her title as Princess of Half-Moon anymore, no desire to take her throne, and her relationship with C'yra laid in ruins. Not to mention her so-called friends. She had barely any anymore - though they did seem to be coming around now if the meeting they'd had not so long ago was anything to go by. They were finally starting to warm up to Adora.

Catra's ears twitch a little as she hears someone come up behind her. Catra doesn't need to look to know who it was. Catra feels herself blush and her tail whips back and forth in anxiety. "Glimmer," Catra says. "What do you want?" Catra asks cautiously. Glimmer hums behind her. Catra realises her questioning may be a little…. direct, but she figures she's allowed to be.

"You remember what I walked in on last night, right?" Glimmer asks. Catra winces a little at the reminder. Catra has never felt more embarrassed in her life. Before, she never had to worry about someone walking in on Adora and Catra mid-sex. They usually did it in the Fright Zone, and people knew not to enter whenever Catra was there. Now that wasn't the case anymore. Catra really needed her own place with Adora, she'd literally *die* if one of her moms walked in on that.

"Yes, I remember." Catra replies tensely.

"I tried to embarrass Adora a little and she just talked about how good her ass was." Glimmer comments. Catra's breath gets caught in her throat and then she just bursts out laughing. She laughs so hard she's worried she might wake Finn in her arms and it brings tears to her eyes. She finally turns to look at Glimmer who was giving her a strange look.

"Oh my gosh. Look, I'm sorry for laughing. Not really. But Adora is not embarrassed about being naked in any way. They didn't have privacy over there." Catra explains.Trying to embarrass Adora? *Adora?* The only thing that could embarrass Adora is proving her wrong in front of people.

"Does she get embarrassed about *anything* ?" Glimmer asks. She breaks out into a playful grin and Catra almost forgets that she's fighting with Glimmer - or, well, that they're not really friends currently.

"Not really." Catra shrugs. "She'd probably walk around while naked if you let her. She's not ashamed of her body." Catra really doesn't know where Adora gets her confidence from, but she guesses it makes sense considering her upbringing. Princesses are far more modest, the Hordies couldn't care less.

"She'd walk around naked? Really?" Glimmer asks in disbelief.

"Uh huh. She's attractive and she knows it." Catra responds. Adora is *extremely* attractive. Catra has always known this information, raw attraction is probably why they ended up in bed the first time to begin with.

"Well, she is pretty attractive, I can admit that." Glimmer confesses. Catra doesn't know if she should be worried that Glimmer finds Catra's *fiancee* attractive, but she's not really threatened by it.

"Mhmm, she is." Catra agrees. "Is that all?" Catra asks carefully. She knows Glimmer didn't come here just to talk about how attractive Adora is.

"I guess, I just... I'm wondering how you are?" Glimmer asks. Catra shrugs again.

"Does it matter?" Catra asks tensely. How she's doing hasn't mattered for *months* , why would it matter now?

"It matters." Glimmer says. "Adora... She... clearly really likes you."

"And I *love* her. She loves me too." Catra says softly. "Is that all you wanted to say?" Catra asks.

"I'm sorry." Glimmer says quietly, but Catra's ears are impeccable and she easily catches the words. Catra's eyes widen.

"What...?" She found it incredibly hard to believe that Glimmer was actually *apologising* .

"I'm sorry, okay? Adora isn't who I thought she was and I'm sorry I tried to kill her... a few times." That would almost be funny if it didn't remind Catra of all the times she came close to losing her mate.

Catra presses her lips together, looking away from Glimmer as she contemplates what to say. "Do you really mean that? You're not just saying it?" Catra asks. She has trust issues, but can you really blame her? No one has made an effort to apologise to her like this - not even her own mother!

"I do." Glimmer says. "I didn't really believe you could love someone like Adora but... I see now that the Horde Lord isn't all that she is."

"Glimmer…" Catra pauses for a moment. "That means a lot." She whispers, her shoulders relaxing slightly. Catra hadn't even noticed when she had tensed up, but she knew it was because she had her guard up around everyone aside from a handful of people. "It really does."

"Yeah, well, I've kind of been a jerk. Adora has been... She's been doing good."

"Kind of?" Catra scrunches up her nose.

"Fine, major jerk."

"That's more accurate."

"And also... Adora has a very big strap, I see why you slept with her." Glimmer comments. If Catra had been drinking a drink, she would have spat it everywhere. Glimmer wasn't exactly wrong, but Catra wasn't expecting her to say *that* either.

"Oh, she can change the shape of it." Catra says, offhandedly.

"She can... what?" Glimmer asks. Catra freezes to the tip of her tail.

"Never mind. I didn't say anything."

"She can change the shape of it?!" Glimmer asks and then she looks curious. "How?"

"You don't wanna know." Catra says dismissively.

"I feel like I really *do* want to know now."

"You really don't." Catra is *not* about to describe her fiancee's magic transforming sword-strap.

"Wait, so is that how you got pregnant?" Glimmer asks. Catra remains silent, blushing bright red. "I don't want to know that either?"

"Most definitely not."

"Well... I really can see the temptation she presents." Glimmer admits. "She's like a tall glass of water in the desert."

"That's honestly how it felt when I first spent the night with her." Catra admits. Adora was forbidden fruit, she was… Like a tall sexy goddess that Catra was never going to refuse having a spin with.

"Like she was a tall glass of water in the desert?" Glimmer asks with a laugh. "Like, seriously, look at her." Glimmer gestures to Adora from their spot on the balcony where she

was currently lifting something very heavy. Catra looks at Adora and sighs dreamily, resting her chin in the palm of her free hand as she looks at her flexing biceps. Adora really is incredibly sexy.

"Yeah... But not just because of her looks. Though, that was a definite bonus." Catra admits. Yes, Adora was good looking, but she was also so much more than just her looks.

"Not just her looks? Really?" Glimmer asks curiously.

"Mhmm, it was after we were together. It was so... unexpected. You would think that after sleeping with your enemy that you would just leave them there, right? That you aren't supposed to care for them? But she carried me to her room, cleaned me up. She got me water after I rested, and held me while I did. And we just chatted. It didn't feel uncomfortable at all, it was really nice." Catra tells Glimmer. She hasn't really thought about this memory for a while now, but Adora had been sweet from the start. She'd also been the one who had wanted to keep their affair going.

"She took care of you?"

"Incredibly well." Catra smiles softly. "She even went to find food in the collected contraband stuff since the ration bars they ate were gross. So I introduced her to some foods. Her reactions were really cute."

"I've noticed she seems to be... growing... I swear Adora never used to be this tall."

"Oh, for sure. Those ration bars weren't made to be filling. They were made to keep them alive and strong enough to fight. I suggested to Adora for them to make an indoor farm, which also helped with the air quality." Glimmer hums and they both watch as Bow and Adora talk.

"Bow likes Adora." Glimmer says. "They get along really well." Catra smiles a little at the pair below them. Adora and Bow *do* get along exceptionally well, they're even probably friends.

"Bow was willing to listen. Adora is more than her previous title of Horde Lord." Catra smiles again. "The only reason she even became Horde Lord was because of Shadow Weaver wanting to use her as a puppet. Otherwise, she would have just remained a soldier, knowing only what she was told about Etheria and not what actually was. Adora was willing to listen to what I had to say, and let me show her that things weren't what she thought they were, and she did the same for me."

"She showed you that the Horde wasn't what we thought it was?"

"Yeah, they... Hordak and Shadow Weaver were horribly cruel to everyone there. Many of them are orphans, or were born into the Horde. They didn't know anything outside of the Horde, and they were taught that we were cruel beings. So I imagine that even if they did want to leave, they were afraid they wouldn't have somewhere to go." Catra explains. It's easier to stay with the devil you do know than the one you don't. Catra is sure that is the reasoning of most, if not all, Horde soldiers for why they remained with the Horde and in those conditions - though Adora had improved those.

"Well shit," Glimmer comments. "Adora seems to be... She's adjusting remarkably well."

"She's learning. Bow helps teach her different things, as do Spinnerella and Netossa, they're helping her adjust. I am as well. Though there isn't much that we can really do." Catra sighs. "She deserves to experience so much…" Catra trails off, feeling her exhaustion peek through. "Can I tell you something?" Catra asks.

"Of course." Glimmer encourages.

"It was hard... It's *still* hard to be able to simply exist now." Catra's hands clench a little as she looks out at Bright Moon. She wasn't sure she should say such a thing to Glimmer, especially when the other *just* apologised, but maybe that'll help her understand how she felt - how she *feels* - being so unable to control her own life.

"Bow told me a little." Glimmer admits. "He was kind of angry with me. He's still kind of angry with me, and Bow being angry with you... sucks."

"At least it's just one person and not almost everyone you've known for almost your entire time being alive." Catra bites her lip. Maybe that was a little harsh. She sees Glimmer wince a little beside her. "What did he tell you?" Catra asks. Glimmer pauses and bites her lip for a moment.

"Just... how hard it was..." Glimmer takes a deep breath. "I'm sorry I took the trackerpad away when I found it."

"It was really hard." Catra whispers, her voice breaking a little. "Can we sit?" She asks, gesturing towards the seats on the balcony. Glimmer shows her approval and Catra nods before she takes a seat across from Glimmer, resting Finn in her arms. "Thanks for apologising about the trackerpad." She whispers. "I..." She sighs. "I don't know where to start with this. Everything was hard, I guess, and no one was listening. No one seemed to care about how it hurt me."

"I think we were all blinded by who Adora was, or who we thought she was." Glimmer explains. "Harder to hate someone who is actually human."

"I used to hate her too, you know that." Catra says. It is still so strange for her to realise this fact. She used to hate Adora, or, well, she disliked her a lot because of who she was: *the Horde Lord* . But after getting to know her? Catra had fallen so deeply in love with her. It's still weird for her to think that there was a time that she used to enjoy punching Adora in her face. "I used to think of her as this evil heartless monster that didn't care about letting the world around her burn. But that wasn't the case at all." Catra looks off into the horizon. "I thought that my friends and my family would let me explain, that they would listen to me over the person that was really the spy." Her eyes shimmer with tears, one falling down her cheek. "I guess it was too much to hope for."

"We... We thought you'd betrayed us."

"By falling in love?" Catra asks quietly. "I told you all that I never let Adora know anything about Alliance plans, and that was the truth."

"I know," Glimmer says. "It was just hard to believe before that. I mean, you'd been *sleeping* with the *enemy* . It seemed like... like you *had* been betraying us, that maybe you were the spy and were feeding Intel to Adora. We... I know that's not true now, but I didn't at first." Catra looks at Glimmer.

"None of you would let me explain. Not even me nearly dying because of Double Trouble, because of *everything* , was enough to get you all to listen." She looks away. "That hurt, it *still* hurts. It's hard to trust anyone anymore."

"I'm sorry." Glimmer says, hanging her head a little. "Not even your mom seemed to believe you." Catra shrugs, her ears pressing back at the mention of her mother.

"She still doesn't." Catra says bitterly.

"Yeah, she really doesn't like Adora."

"I know." Catra responds. "I don't talk to C'yra anymore. The only time I do is during meetings."

"You don't talk to her?" Glimmer asks with a little surprise. "I've seen Adora talking to Luna around Bright Moon, but whenever she talks to C'yra she seems... more on edge than with others. The scars on her jaw, that was her wasn't it?"

"She attacked Adora before the trial." Catra reveals. She still feels anger flash in her at the memory. Every time she looks at those scars, she's reminded of what her mom did. "And no, I don't talk to her. She stopped being my mother the second she threatened me to get rid of Finn."

"I kind of..." Glimmer winces. "I kind of knew about that. C'yra really gave Adora..." Glimmer stops. "I don't know what got C'yra to stop, but whatever it was, it probably saved Adora's life."

"I wouldn't be here if she hadn't stopped. I wouldn't even be here if it wasn't for Adora."

"What do you mean by that?" Glimmer questions. Catra takes a deep breath in.

"What none of you seem to understand is that Adora is my *mate* , I'm bonded with her. Being away from her hurt. Losing her entirely..." Catra sighs. "When I ran away, after C'yra threatened to not support Finn, and to disown them if I didn't give them away or get rid of them, I was bleeding. My wound in my chest had reopened because I had over exerted myself. But it wasn't fatal. What did me in was knowing I was alone, I had no one. Adora wouldn't know where to find me. I was too weak to make it to the Fright Zone. Double Trouble was the one to find me. I was ready to give up, they gave the final push. They showed up as Adora. I was out of it from the blood loss. They told me that there was no way she could love me. I felt like I had lost *everything* . I just... I wanted to be gone, Glimmer."

"Oh... wow... that's... a lot." Glimmer says. Catra almost wants to laugh but she can see Glimmer’s sincerity and horror on her face. She doesn’t really have to say anything else. "I don't know how Magicat bonds work, I do know that if anything happened to Bow..." She looks off. "Yeah."

Catra lifts a hand, pressing it against her chest, her heart beating steadily. "Magicats' bonds are deep, a lot deeper than many others of Etheria. Magic is in our name for a reason. When we choose our mates, our souls become one. We’re connected. Losing your mate is fatal for Magicats usually. It's as though a piece of our souls have been ripped apart and the rest of us was left in shreds." She explains. "It was hard enough being apart from Adora, thinking that she didn't love me, but at least I had Finn and I had all of you. But when... When that happened, I couldn't... I wasn't strong enough.” Catra sighs as she looks down at Finn. The worst part? Her moms knew all about the Magicat mating bond, yet C’yra still chose to act the way she did.

“I told myself, why should I stay? Everyone I love and care about hates me, Adora thought I was dead, and I wasn't in any state to make it to her. I didn't want Finn to be born in a world where they wouldn't know love, so even they weren't enough to keep me going at that point." Catra reveals. Catra is aware she is laying a lot out for Glimmer right now.

A silence falls between them before Glimmer speaks again. "You've been hurt, in a way you didn't deserve, and a lot too, but you have Adora now, things can get better." Catra smiles a little, remembering Adora’s words.

"They are better, technically, but it's still hard." Catra looks at her hand. "This… Everything that's been done... I started going to therapy, though only a few people know. The usual people."

"You started going to therapy?" Glimmer asks with surprise.

"I had to." Catra glances at the other Princess. "I have PTSD and anxiety from... from the house arrest and the... and the way everyone was... *is* treating me." Catra can tell by the way that Glimmer looks at her that that was probably the last thing that she expected for Catra to admit. Catra hadn't exactly intended to go to therapy, but when Adora had suggested it, citing her own improvement as evidence, Catra had changed her mind. She shared everything with Adora, and she with her, but sometimes you just need to share the burden a little.

"Shit..." Glimmer whispers and Catra lets out a huff of laughter.

"Yeah." She looks back at Finn and smiles, purring at the kitten.

"Can... What can we do to help?" Glimmer asks. Catra appreciates that she even bothered to ask that question, but Catra doesn't really know where to begin.

"I don't know." Catra finally replies after a few minutes. "Like I said, it's hard to trust anyone anymore. I honestly don't even know why I'm telling you all of this. Maybe I'm hoping you'd really listen?" She lets out a soft laugh. "I really wish I knew what to ask you to do to help, but the trauma is still there. I guess... Just please don't glare at me when I enter a room?" Glimmer gives Catra a look.

"Did... Did I do that before?"

"Most of you did." Catra says, running her tongue over her fangs. "Either that or you all looked at me like I was... this *thing* you didn't want near you." Catra answers, staring at the ground. "Like I was some monster that needed to be rid of."

"I'm sorry we did that." Glimmer says. "I didn't even realise we *had* done that." Catra smiles sadly.

"I'm not sure the others noticed it either, but it's very obvious when you're on the receiving end. Thanks for apologising." Catra did feel better now that Glimmer had actually said sorry. Of course that didn't mean she was automatically forgiven, but it was a step in the right direction.

"So Adora, you're happy with her? Perfuma told me she's been going to her mandated therapy." Glimmer changes the subject back to Adora, and a much happier topic for Catra.

"I'm happy with her. She makes me very happy. She's supportive, and loving. She always does her best to make sure I'm okay." Catra smiles at the thought. Adora is actually the perfect wife, even if they're not technically wives yet. "She is going to her mandated therapy sessions, to help her heal from childhood trauma and from the battlefield incident."

"She has problems with what happened on the battlefield?" Glimmer asks. Catra nods slowly.

"She... She gets nightmares sometimes. About when she wasn't in control because of the Black Garnet shard." She still had those nightmares. It may have been months, but Catra knew that Adora was *never* going to forgive herself for it. Sometimes she would brush it off as nothing, other times she would just hold Catra and kiss her, and make sure she was okay. Catra knew that with time, it would lessen, but she also knew that the memory would forever plague her future wife.

"Huh, interesting." Glimmer says, peering over at Adora. "It's weird, you don't really think Adora would be affected by that."

"She is. She's in a place where she's facing hostility everyday, dealing with years of abuse and trauma, plus that. She's doing that all for me and Finn." Catra explains. "That's another reason why she's going to therapy, so that she can make sure she's a good mom to Finn. And she's been amazing." Adora had had so much anxiety about if she would be a good mom or

not. Therapy was helping her deal with that anxiety, and her issues so that she *could* be a good mom.

Glimmer smiles a little. "I've seen her with Finn, she loves that baby a whole lot." Catra looks at Finn, sleeping soundly in her arms and she beams. *Me and her both* , she thinks. Adora really does seem to have a special bond with Finn though, she loves taking them wherever she can. She remembers Adora calling them her favourite - *fucking dork* .

"She does. She *adores* them, pun intended. She'd do anything for them."

"Yeah, even surrender herself to a bunch of people who wanted her dead."

"Yeah," Catra whispers - that isn't her fondest memory. "Is there anything else you want to know? Or ask me about? Since we're... talking again, I think?"

"I..." Glimmer looks like she thinks for a moment. "I don't think so? Just... Can we try again? Not to forget what I did, but to try to move forward?"

"We... I don't know, maybe?" Catra rubs her neck. "It's... I guess we can start things slow. I don't think I can call you my best friend anymore, but we can at least see if we can get along again."

"Oh..." Glimmer sounds a little hurt by Catra's words, but she also seems to understand them - which Catra is grateful for. "I'd like that." Catra smiles.

"Okay, then, maybe you should also try talking to Bow. He'll listen to what you have to say."

"I will, and I'll talk to Adora too."

"I can't believe it took you walking in on me and Adora... being in bed together, for this to happen." Catra says with a laugh. It's completely *ridiculous* but, also, so *them* . Glimmer

snorts.

"Yeah, I thought she was hurting you. That was clearly *not* the case."

"I promise you, Adora's a giant softie when it comes to aftercare. If we do anything close to being rough, she'd make sure I was okay." Catra giggles. "But no, she wasn't hurting me." She was actually giving Catra a good fucking after so long of them *not* being intimate. Catra's embarrassment had outweighed her horniness, but she sure got her own back in the morning.

"She's a giant softie, really?" Glimmer lifts an eyebrow.

"A *giant* softie. Since the beginning."

"She doesn't seem like a softie."

"She is. She used to carry me around the Fright Zone simply because she liked holding me." Catra smiles with the memory.

"Wow that's... gay." Glimmer comments and Catra snorts.

"Mhmm. She also greets me with forehead kisses when we've been apart for a while."

"That is sweet."

"She's sweet."

"And she's very... She doesn't really have a filter, does she?" Glimmer asks. Catra laughs.

"No one in the Fright Zone does. They didn't grow up with much privacy, so they're not afraid to say things bluntly." Catra used to blush whenever Adora was so… blunt with her words. Now she's completely used to it - though she does sometimes say *inappropriate* things around people that Catra is slowly trying to get her to *stop* doing.

"Yeah, she's very open." Glimmer agrees.

"I know. It's kind of funny." Catra says with a grin. Glimmer chuckles.

"A little. I get the sense that Adora doesn't lie, at least, not to other people. Maybe to herself." Glimmer has *no* idea. Adora is terrible at lying, but an expert at making herself believe a lie she has told herself (like her being useless, or deserving to be punished).

"She's really shitty at lying." Catra says with a fond smirk.

"Really?" Glimmer asks. "She's a highly trained Horde officer and she can't lie?"

"Uh huh. She has a tell. She gets fidgety." She also stutters. Catra can instantly tell when Adora is hiding something from her, it's how she had known in the med room when she had surrendered herself.

"Fidgety? You mean like how your tail gets twitchy?" Glimmer inquires. Catra nods. "It's nice actually, refreshing, she doesn't bullshit." Glimmer says. Catra hums, looking at her mate and purring.

"I know."

"And you're totally in love with her."

"I am. I love her *so much* , Glimmer."

"Wow, I never thought you'd admit to that." Glimmer admits. Catra raises an eyebrow.

"Why wouldn't I admit that? I'm not ashamed of being in love with Adora. That love is what gave me strength, that love gave us Finn. That love makes me happy. I *love* her." Catra says with conviction.

"I can see that." Glimmer says. "I just mean... I haven't really heard you say it before."

"I suppose that's true." Catra smiles. "Adora!" She calls out to get her mate's attention. Adora looks over to the balcony before she smiles and waves. She jogs over to the pair, looking up at them.

"This feels like one of those stupid romance books you have on your bedside table." Adora says. "The balcony and all."

"You act as if you haven't been reading them when Finn and I take naps." Catra says fondly. Adora enjoys reading, even if she often takes a while because she does other things *while* reading, she says she can't just sit and read, she has to be doing other stuff too in order to concentrate, but she reads anything, *including* cheesy romance novels. "Just wanted to tell you that I love you."

"Really?" Adora asks as she looks around for a way to climb up. "You love me? I'm shocked."

"Stop trying to climb up here, Dummy." Catra giggles, watching Adora's eyes move around. "You're such a dork. You just left Bow there."

"Bow is a big boy." Adora says dismissively and then she finds her way up, using her upper body strength and putting it to use - Catra looks *respectfully* . "I love you too." Catra grins as Adora gets closer to the top of the balcony and gives her a kiss on the lips once she makes it.

"You didn't have to come all the way up here like that. I just wanted to say that I love you." Catra says with a giggle.

"I wanted a kiss, you couldn't kiss me all the way down there." Adora says. "Oh, hey Shimmer..."

" *Glimmer* ."

"She apologised." Catra whispers, helping Adora get over the rail as best she can while holding onto Finn. "Be nice please."

"I'm always nice." Adora says dismissively - that's not strictly true actually but Catra chooses not to point that out to her. "Fine, *Glimmer* ." Adora reaches her hands out to grab Catra by her waist. "I missed you." Catra purrs, wrapping her arm around her, and resting her head on Adora's shoulder.

"I missed you too. Did you have fun with Bow?"

"I did." Adora whispers. "He was helping me rebuild. People are still skittish around me." Bow had started accompanying Adora to give her a little more protection while she rebuilt. Gods forbid they had a repeat of what happened that one time.

"I know, I'm sorry, I wish I could make the transition easier on you but..."

"Psh," Adora moves her hands up to cup Catra's face. "don't worry about me, worry about yourself."

"You know that I'll always worry about you too. You're my mate, Adora. I care about you."

"I know. But don't make yourself ill worrying about me. I can take care of myself, have you seen my biceps? They're pretty impressive." Adora flexes for good measure and Catra rolls her eyes. She knows that Adora is just being a goof, but Catra is serious about her worry.

"Let me worry about you. Villagers already attacked you before, and the guards didn't do anything, so of course I'm going to worry." Catra pouts.

"Yeah, but you told them off." Adora smiles a little. "So don't worry too much." Adora glances at Glimmer. "So you two are... hanging out?"

"It was unplanned, but yes we're... talking right now." Catra answers.

"That's... good?" Adora looks at Catra with her brows raised. "Right?" She was asking Catra if she was really okay with this, it was sweet of her, and it brings a smile to Catra's lips.

"I'd say so, yes."

"Good." Adora nods, satisfied that Catra was in fact okay. "I don't know if I told you, Princess Glimmer, but if anyone says anything to hurt Catra, I'm going to kick their ass, so be careful."

"Duly noted." Glimmer responds. "We... I was an asshole." Glimmer says, not even getting upset at the threat like she would have in the past, knowing what they had pushed Catra to was probably enough to offset that anger.

"Yes you were." Adora agrees. "At least you recognise it now."

"Yeah, it took a while though." Glimmer says, a little sheepish. "Adora... Did I... Did we all really... glare at Catra?" She asks, clearly needing confirmation beyond Catra. Adora purses her lips before she nods once.

"Yes." Adora answers. "C'yra usually glares at me *now,* but I imagine before she probably glared at Catra. Plus people whisper... terrible things about Catra too, things that aren't true."

"Wait, what?" Glimmer asks softly. Adora covers Catra's ears - which is pretty pointless since Catra can still hear her anyway.

"Stuff like, Horde Lord's whore, things like that." Adora says. It comes out muffled but Catra doesn't think Adora fully understands just how enhanced her hearing really is.

"You're... You're not joking." Glimmer whispers, looking at the way that Adora was currently covering Catra's ears - even if it wasn't working.

"Of course I'm not joking." Adora says. "Guards and civilians. Not that you Princesses did anything to correct them." Adora gently massages Catra's ears, causing her to purr, and then kisses her gently on the nose.

"The guards too?"

"The guards *especially* . And they were supposed to be looking out for her." Adora says. Catra sighs softly.

"The guards had been openly insulting me since I was put under house arrest. Only time that they didn't was when Spinnerella, Netossa, or Bow were visiting." Catra answers.

"Did you just hear everything I just said?" Adora asks.

"Yes." Catra says and she pecks Adora's cheek when she winces. "But valiant effort, you tried to protect me."

"I can't believe the guards were saying that to you." Glimmer says in disbelief. "What..." Glimmer glances at Adora. "What did they do? Say?" Catra grimaces at the question, unsure

where to start.

"It started with the Horde Lord's whore, and then it was them complaining about guarding someone unimportant, a few were saying that they could probably go a few rounds with me since I'd open my legs to anyone. Things like that." Catra feels when Adora stiffens up, her back going straight and obvious tension in her muscles.

"What?" She asks. "You never told me that they said that last thing. Who said that? Tell me their name so I can kick their ass."

"They got moved by Spinnerella, thankfully." Catra sighs. "And I didn't tell you because the last thing I need is for C'yra to have a reason to try to get your sentence reversed."

"That's..." Glimmer trails off. "That's the only reason you haven't done anything, isn't it?" Glimmer asks Adora that question and the blonde slowly nods.

"Because Catra stops me from going all 'Horde Lord' and kicking their assess since C'yra will take any excuse for my head? Yeah. Otherwise you'd have about half of your guards in the infirmary right now."

"Half?"

"Yeah, about half. Not all of the guards have been cruel. But they haven't exactly tried stopping them either." Catra shrugs a bit. "I didn't really expect them to try."

"We'd never have this in the Fright Zone by the way." Adora comments.

"Yeah, well, the people of the Fright Zone actually like me."

"That's the thing though," Adora says. "They *do* like you, a lot, even though you're a Princess. No one in the Fright Zone has mistreated you. Granted, you were with me, but,

even though they were weary at first, they've just... accepted us. So I guess you Princesses aren't as good as you might think." Adora looks at Glimmer when she finishes that sentence. Catra sees annoyance flicker over Glimmer's features, but she doesn't say anything. Adora has a point, the Fright Zone accepted them pretty much without any issues, the Princesses? Good and bad wasn't as cut-and-dry as the Alliance liked to think.

"I don't even know if by the end of all of this I'll still be a Princess." Catra admits. "I wouldn't be surprised if C'yra just suddenly disowned me." Catra says, scrunching her nose.

"C'yra isn't going to do that." Adora says, looking at Catra.

"I wouldn't be surprised if she did. Let's be honest, the only reason she probably hasn't is because I'm the only heir Half-Moon has since I'm an only child."

"I don't know Catra..." Adora says. "I think it might be more than that."

"Yeah, well it sure feels that way." Catra looks away. "Anyway, Princesses aren't that great in my eyes right now either."

"I didn't know all of this." Glimmer says.

"I didn't say anything. I didn't think anyone that sided with C'yra would listen... or care." Catra points out.

"We've been... bad friends." Glimmer says regretfully. "I did kind of want Adora dead."

"Join the line." Adora quips.

"But... not anymore."

"Thanks." Catra gives her a tired smile, her hands a little shaky. "I'm... sorry, I... Adora, I think I'm o-overwhelmed." Adora's eyes widen and she gently takes Finn in her arms, coming around to face Catra.

"Okay, why don't you breathe with me?" Adora asks gently, showing Catra and taking a few deep breaths. Catra nods weakly, looking into Adora's eyes and taking in small breaths as steadily as possible. She just put a lot out there to someone she hadn't trusted in months, she didn't expect her reaction. She hadn't been prepared at all. Adora smiles lovingly and counts until Catra's breaths become more regular again. "I love you." Adora says softly and Catra feels more relaxed.

"I love you too. Sorry about that. I think bringing everything up just... yeah." Catra was a little embarrassed but she also knows that Adora has experience with panic attacks - she actually gets them quite regularly and she has the tools to help Catra effectively.

"No need to apologise." Adora says dismissively, placing Finn back in Catra's arms. "If you can calm me down after a nightmare, I think I can calm you down from this." Catra steps forward and nuzzles Adora under her chin.

"I wish neither of us had to deal with it, with the trauma." Catra says quietly.

"Me too." Adora glances at Glimmer. "How about we go have a nap with our kitten?"

"Yeah please? Could you..." Catra gestures, waiting for Adora to lift her up. It was a little childish perhaps. But she liked being close to her mate, it brought her comfort, especially after moments like that - plus Adora was strong, Catra could easily hold Finn while being carried by Adora.

"Of course." Adora says happily as she scoops Catra up in her arms. Catra adjusts her hold on Finn a little. "Anything for you." Catra purrs softly, curling up in Adora's arms and closing her eyes.

"Thank you." She murmurs. "Sorry Glimmer, we'll be going now."

"Yeah, Of course." Glimmer says. "I'll talk to Bow."

"Oh, tell Bow I'm sorry about leaving him but... you know..." Adora moves her head towards Catra.

"Yeah, no worries. I'll tell him. You two go on." Glimmer nods, waving them off. “Oh, and, you should know, Queen C’yra and Luna arrived in Bright Moon not too long ago.” Catra’s heart rate picks up at this new knowledge but she decides to remain silent. Adora nods back before she walks off with Catra in her arms.

"Feeling okay, Kitten?" Adora asks.

"A little." Catra answers, purring to herself to try and calm down more.

"How come you and Glimmer started talking?" Adora asks curiously.

"She came to tell me that she tried to embarrass you and I started laughing." Catra answers. Adora laughs a little.

"Oh yeah, she did. It didn't work."

"I know. That's why I laughed." Catra starts to smile at the amused tone her fiancee was currently using.

"She didn't try to embarrass *you* , did she?" Adora asks, an *edge* to her voice. Adora is very protective of her, it warms Catra’s heart a little.

"No. I did tell her you'd probably walk around naked if allowed." Adora chuckles at that.

"Yeah, probably."

"She thought I was kidding at first."

"About me walking around naked? I'll do it now."

"Don't do that. That's *mine* ." Catra says, a little possessively - Glimmer is still one person too many who has seen her Adora naked. Adora raises a brow.

"Yours?" Adora asks.

"Mhmm. *My* Adora."

"You're all mine too."

"I am. I'm yours." Catra smiles, pressing her lips to Adora's jaw.

"Damn right you are."

"I know. Now let's get back to our room so we can snuggle Finn." Catra says, looking down at the kitten in her arms.

"So you don't want to see me naked?" Adora asks in a mock hurt tone.

"Later, when I'm not emotionally wrecked."

"You sure? You don't have to get naked, but I think boobs significantly lift anyone's mood."

"Later." Catra giggles. "Finn snuggles first."

"Fine, Finn cuddles are probably just as effective." Adora admits. She nods and takes off in the direction of their room. She knew the way pretty well now thanks to having been there quite a few times.

On their way, they walk into Spinnerella and Adora places Catra down on her feet to allow Spinnerella the opportunity to coo over their baby. "They look so much like Catra it's almost crazy." Adora says to Spinnerella. "Look at their little tuft of brown hair coming through." Finn was not blonde, they had Catra's hair, from what they could tell anyway.

"They have your eyes though, and your cute little nose."

"They do have my eyes." Adora says with a grin. "They sleep like me too."

"You mean, an extremely heavy sleeper when comfortable?" Catra smiles, placing a soft kiss on Adora's lips and then kissing Finn's forehead.

"Yup." Adora says with a laugh. "They also sleep really well when you purr."

"Purring is comforting for Magicats." Catra reminds her.

"Not just for Magicats." Adora says. Catra knows that Adora finds her purr extremely soothing. "Actually, I meant to ask you something."

"What is it?" Catra questions.

"All Magicats have... magic?" Adora asks. Catra blinks a few times and then nods. She doesn’t know who told Adora that.

"Yes, we do. Though for some it's more dormant than others. Why?"

"You never told me you had magic." Adora says, frowning a little. "C'yra told me."

"Oh! I rarely use it, that's why."

"But you *do* have magic?" Catra isn’t sure she likes how Adora asks that question but she nods anyway.

"I do have magic. But I use it so rarely that I honestly forget sometimes." Catra’s magic isn’t super strong, but she does possess some, as all Magicats do.

"What magic?"

"Well..."

"Well what?" Adora asks. "Did you use magic on me before?" Catra is not expecting that question *at all* . She doesn’t hold it against Adora, she knows her relationship with magic is complicated, but still, hearing her ask that kind of hurt Catra a little.

"What?! Of course not! I never even used magic on the battlefield. I *never* used it while with you in the Fright Zone." Catra reassures and Adora relaxes a little.

"Oh..."

"I know you're not comfortable with magic, so I never used it. Not that there was any need to." Catra reassures her. Adora has a huge mistrust of magic, which makes sense given, well, *Shadow Weaver* , Catra never really thought it was a good time to be like *'hey, you know that thing you're afraid of and have deep seeded trauma with? Yeah, I have a little bit of that.'*

"But what magic do you have?" Adora questions.

"Well..." Catra looks off to the side.

"Well…?" Adora raises an eyebrow.

"The royal Magicat family is technically more aligned with illusion magic." Catra admits.

"So you can make illusions?" Adora looks *worried* . If Catra knows Adora, and she does, she's pretty sure Adora is worrying that perhaps she is living in an illusion right now. Adora can be paranoid sometimes, but Catra can hardly blame her.

"I could but I don't. Unless it's to entertain someone with something funny." Catra answers, kissing Adora's jaw. Adora seems to relax more after that.

"Does that mean Finn will have magic?" Adora questions. "Wait, will they have double magic? With She-Ra and stuff?"

"That's... actually a really good question." Catra blinks, looking down at Finn. "I'm not sure."

"I don't know if She-Ra is hereditary."

"I don't know either. The last anyone heard of She-Ra was one thousand years ago, until you."

"Well, one thing’s for sure, She-Ra has magical swimmers. who would've thought it?"

“Adora,” Catra rolls her eyes, shaking her head. This is exactly what Catra meant when she said that Adora has a tendency to say inappropriate things. “Finn is here. And so is Spinnerella.”

"Finn is *asleep* ." Adora points out. "And it's not like they'd understand me."

"Kids are impressionable. They like to say things people say around them."

"Finn can't even talk yet," Adora says dismissively. "And I know Spinny was curious."

"Didn't need to know the specifics, Adora." Spinnerella says.

"Maybe we should go back to our room." Adora says. Catra shakes her head again.

"Yeah, let's go before you make Spinnerella need to bleach her brain." Catra says, giving her friend an apologetic smile. Spinnerella just smiles back at her with amusement, lighting her eyes before she gets a look of concern.

“Are you both okay?” She asks. “You seemed a little… shaken.” Catra wasn’t aware her emotion was that easy to read. She pauses for a long moment before she answers the other woman.

“Glimmer apologised.” Catra reveals quietly. Spinnerella’s eyes widen comically and Catra laughs a little. “It’s shocking, right?”

“Glimmer is really… stubborn.” Spinnerella agrees. Catra really hadn’t been expecting it if she was honest.

“I know, but she apologised. She didn’t know a lot of what everyone was doing. I told her about therapy too.”

“Wow… So you two *talked* .” Spinnerella says with a low whistle. Catra nods.

“Yeah, we did. Maybe a little too much since I got a little overwhelmed.” Spinnerella gives her a sympathetic look before she looks at Finn in Adora’s arms.

“I assume that’s why you two are off to give that little one snuggles?” Spinnerella asks and they both nod in answer.

“Though, I kind of wish they were awake so we could play.” Adora admits. "Magicat babies are so cute when they play." Adora says. "Although, their baby claws are kind of really sharp."

"Yeah, they don't know how to hide them away." Catra giggles. "So it's little scratches everywhere."

" *Everywhere* ." Adora says. "Were you like this?"

"I think so." Catra shrugs, her smile dropping a bit.

"Are you okay? Did I say something wrong?" Adora asks worriedly.

"No, no. I'm okay." Catra tries to brush off. She should’ve known that wouldn’t work with Adora.

"Catra..." Adora doesn't look convinced at all. Catra sighs.

"The only people who'd be able to answer that question about the scratches would be... them." Catra says, referencing, of course, her moms.

"We could ask Luna." Adora suggests trying to be helpful, but Catra isn't sure that helps if she's completely honest.

"Maybe." She says softly.

"Anyway, we should be going." Adora says, turning towards Spinnerella. "We'll see you later?"

"Of course, any time you guys need." Spinnerella confirms. "We'll look after that Little One any time too." Adora thanks her before they both take their leave.

"Yeah, I think a family nap would *definitely* be good." Catra says, feeling *exhausted* . She'd had a heavy day after all.

"Let's go back to our room." Adora suggests gently.

"I... I wonder what Glimmer is thinking about now." Catra says curiously. Adora clears her throat when a guard brushes by her.

"Hopefully about how incompetent these guards are." Adora murmurs. "You realise if any of them said what you said they said, about going rounds with you, I'd absolutely punch them no hesitation, right? Hell, I'd punch them as *She-Ra* ."

"I know, but please don't. I really don't want to give C'yra a reason to try to get rid of you, Adora. She's waiting for that." Catra frowns deeply.

"I'd be happy to." Adora says. "I'm serious, if someone said that when I was around... C'yra wouldn't be able to stop me."

"I know, let's not worry about that right now, okay?" Catra asks. She'd rather just forget about it anyway. The Rebellion had agreed to lift their guard detail too, they wouldn't have to deal with them anymore.

"Yeah, yeah, but I mean it." Adora sounds *angry* . It's rare for her to get angry now, but she still does whenever it comes to Catra's well-being.

"I know you do, love." Catra replies.

"Okay. Just like I did with that Horde soldier who tried to hurt you." Adora reminds her. After they had tried to hurt Catra and Adora stepped in, they never did again.

"At least with your soldiers it was because they were trying to keep the Fright Zone safe."

" *Hmph* ," Adora lets out an annoyed sound. "I guess."

"It's true, Love." Adora looks away. If C'yra cared enough she could stop the guards, Adora knows that, Catra knows that - especially considering no other Horde soldier ever attempted to harm Catra after Adora's orders. C'yra ordering her guards not to treat Catra like garbage was likely to make them stop.

"Can't we lay down? We can play with Finn when they wake up." Catra says tiredly.

"Fine, but I'm not letting it go."

"I know, just... let it be for a little while."

"I don't like that." Adora responds quickly. Catra sighs.

"I know. But what can we do? The guards don't listen to me anymore and C'yra isn't going to do-" She covers Finn's ears. "She isn't going to do shit about it because she doesn't care."

"Does she even know?"

"Who fucking knows?" Catra says angrily. She doesn't know why this is suddenly Adora's biggest concern. She had managed to soothe her anger before in relation to her mistreatment by the guards, but now she seemed outraged by it. "She doesn't seem to care enough to be around anyway, except to have a screaming match." Catra was shocked she hadn't already tracked her down to scream at her about Beast Island yet.

"Maybe I should tell her." Adora says.

"Why waste your breath? I'd doubt she'd even listen. She'd probably say you were lying." Catra points out.

"I'd make sure she believed me." Adora says determinedly. Catra has to give her points for determination, that's for sure.

"Uh huh, if you want to try, you can. I'm not gonna waste my breath. But good luck, Love."

"Take Finn back to our room." Adora says. Catra glances at her. She hadn't expected Adora to do this *now* .

"Okay, I'll see you there?" Catra asks, raising an eyebrow. She didn't like letting Adora go off on her own but she didn't want C'yra around Finn and she definitely didn't feel like arguing with her so-called mother right now.

"In a minute, yeah." Adora answers. Catra nods softly, holding Finn close and continuing to walk towards their room. Adora… She's such an *idiot* . A big, kind hearted, *protective* , idiot.

* * *

Adora frowns to herself as she turns and walks towards where C'yra and Luna usually stayed when they were in Bright Moon. She knocks on the door and waits. As she does, she turns to the guard that was with her. Since they couldn't pass the no guard detail thing without taking C'yra and Luna's votes, they were stuck with the guards until said vote was concluded. Bureaucracy. Adora hates it. When she was Lord of the Horde, decisions were pushed through so much easier - especially since Adora could do whatever she wanted. "You're not one of the guards who treated my wife badly, are you?" Adora is aware that Catra isn't technically her wife yet, but semantics.

The guard raises an eyebrow and shakes their head. "I've known Princess C'yra since she was small. I wouldn't disrespect her like that. Are some of the guards doing that?"

"Yes. Yes they are." Adora pauses. "The other guard, the one who stayed with Catra, what are they like?"

"They're one of the newer guards. They've been here for a couple of months. They haven't said anything disrespectful while I've been around, but I'm not sure if they've said something when we have different shifts."

"Hm..." Adora frowns a little before she hears someone telling her to enter the room. She walks inside and bows a little when she sees C'yra and Luna. "Your majesties." The difference in reaction to Adora's presence was very obvious. Luna actually smiles and greets her, while C'yra simply glares at her intensely.

"Adora, hello. What are you doing here?" Luna asks, gesturing for her to come further in. "Is something the matter?"

"Uh, kind of." Adora says. "Did you know that some of the guards have been mistreating Catra?" Luna's eyebrows go up.

"What? What do you mean they're mistreating her?"

"Saying things to her." Adora says, glancing at C'yra.

"What things?" Luna asks, following Adora's gaze and looking at her wife.

"Well, Lord Horde's whore for one, that she's unimportant, someone apparently said that they'd go a few rounds with her because she opens her legs for anyone." Adora recounts, placing her hands behind her back.

"What?!" Luna's mouth drops open. "Do you know who it is?"

"No, she wouldn't tell me their names, probably because I'd tear them in half." Adora says angrily. And she was angry, she thinks she has every right to be angry. She knew about the guards mistreating Catra, but she had thought that had stopped with Adora's arrival, apparently they were still saying things about her.

"I can see why. How long has this been going on?" Luna asks.

"Since you put her on house arrest." Adora looks directly at C'yra now. Luna frowns but C'yra seems completely unbothered.

"That long... And I had no idea. C'yra, did you know this was going on?" She asks, turning to her wife.

"Not to that extent, no." She answers.

"But you knew?" Adora asks.

"I knew people were upset, but I wasn't going to leave her unguarded."

"C'yra... What do you mean not to that extent?" Luna asks, looking stressed.

"I knew that people were upset," C'yra explains. "Makes sense that that would include C'yra's guards also. I didn't know what they were saying specifically."

"You didn't know..." Luna bites her lip, sitting down on their bed. "Goddess... we're horrible parents, Cy."

"None of them have harmed her physically." C'yra says quickly. Adora is sure that's meant to comfort her distressed wife, but it just sparks anger in Adora.

"That's where you draw the line?!" Adora asks in alarm. "Just because they haven't *physically* harmed her, doesn't mean they haven't hurt her! Next time someone says something like that to Catra, I will punch them right in the face." Adora is edging her words there. She will literally tear them apart, but she restrains herself from saying that.

"Cy... Did you really just say that?" Luna asks. "You know better than anyone that C'yra is a sensitive soul, you've already been making her feel trapped in her own home since the beginning. Is physical pain really where you draw the line? She's been suffering in silence with this for months." Luna shakes her head. "Is there anything else that she hasn't told us, Adora? Please, I... We need to know." She pleads softly, hating the thought of Catra suffering, but Adora knows she doesn't have the final say.

"Well," Adora thinks for a moment. She has to be careful not to share things that Catra wants to keep private. "You've all kind of been horrible to her ever since you found out. You didn't let her explain, you glared at her when she walked into rooms, you let the guards that are supposed to protect her abuse her, you made her feel isolated and alone."

"Oh..." Luna looks heartbroken when Adora says that. "Cy, we… I think we should vote yes with the other Princesses."

"How do we even know they have been saying those things?" C'yra asks Luna. "And *you* ," C'yra turns to Adora. "You're supposed to be working on your anger issues, yet you come storming in here."

"Of course I'm angry if the woman I love is being hurt!" Adora protests.

"Cy! She has a right to bring up her concerns. She *is* working on her anger issues, but how would you feel if the guards were doing that to me, huh?" Luna stands back up. "She's just trying to protect her mate from being hurt." C'yra glares at Adora as she speaks.

"Well you wouldn't be stupid enough to sleep with the Horde Lord and to mate with them, would you?"

"I know you did not just use that as an excuse to allow the guards to verbally assault our daughter." Luna rubs her temples. "I know that you didn't just say that." Adora can see how tense Luna looks even from here, she clearly couldn't believe her ears. Adora is pretty sure C'yra doesn't mean what she said, she's just saying things out of anger and aiming to provoke Adora. She won't bite. "You know what. No. I'm putting my foot down."

"What?" C'yra looks at her wife, tearing her intense gaze off of Adora. "Putting your foot down?"

"Yes, I'm putting my foot down. I am sick and tired of you disregarding our daughter's well-being just because of who she mated with. Forgive my language, but just because she loves Adora doesn't give you a fucking excuse to allow guards to verbally abuse her for months! You knew! I don't care to what extent, but you knew!" Luna was upset and it clearly showed on her face. "You don't seem to care about our daughter anymore, C'yra. And don't tell me that you do because, right now, that's not showing at all. I've been letting this go for too long, and I'm partially to blame for not being as aware, but for fuck's sake. Our daughter couldn't even come to us to let us know what she was going through, C'yra. Don't you get that? She couldn't come and tell *us* that this was going on. And why?!"

"Because of *her* !" C'yra yells, pointing at Adora. "She doesn't even call me her mother anymore, and that is *all. Your. Fault.* " C'yra growls. "I should've killed you when I had the chance!"

"Stop that!" Luna yells. "Stop trying to blame Adora for *our* mistakes! Do you know why she doesn't call you her mom anymore? Because, as Adora is trying to tell us, we've been mistreating her! We've been letting her get verbally abused by the guards for months, you haven't even listened to anything she's had to say! *Once* ! She's hurt, C'yra. We've hurt her, and that's why she won't talk to us anymore!"

"I'm not sorry for trying to protect my daughter."

"We're *not* protecting her! Don't you get that?!" Luna grabs her wife's shoulders, forcing her to focus on her. "We haven't been protecting her in a long time, C'yra. We haven't been protecting her since she nearly died when she ran from us because of you telling her she needed to get rid of her kitten. Stop being delusional, Love. We've hurt our kitten enough. We've lost her, and you don't even seem to care so long as you get to be angry at her mate. I need you to *stop* ." C'yra's fight seems to drain out of her when she focuses on her wife and actually listens to her words.

"Get out." C'yra looks at Adora. "Get out." Adora hesitates before she complies, sensing the Queens needed a moment alone. Catra was waiting for her return anyway. Adora bows one last time before she heads out the door.

* * *

"I don't know what to do." C'yra admits to her wife once Adora is gone.

"What do you mean you don't know?" Luna asks.

"I mean, I don't know!" C'yra says. "I don’t agree with lifting Adora’s guard. I know she brought Micah back but… I still don’t trust her."

"Then at least consider our daughter instead. She’s with Adora all the time, and I feel like there's a lot of stuff that's happened to her that Adora hasn't told us.” Luna says. C’yra

swallows as she sits down on their bed. “I can understand why she hasn’t. We haven't exactly been the kindest people to Adora, or our own kitten recently... or their kitten either."

"The guards are for Adora, not C’yra." C’yra responds.

"It sure doesn't seem like it with how I've seen the guards hover over her."

"They... don't trust her." If C’yra is honest, she isn’t sure she trusts her daughter either.

"Then you need to order them to back up. Because if what Adora says that they've said is really true, then I'm afraid for our kitten's sake."

"You think they'd hurt her?" C’yra asks in alarm.

"I don't know." Luna admits. C'yra sighs.

"I'll talk to the guards."

"Cy, I really think you should agree with the Princesses and call the guards off entirely."

"Entirely? No way."

"Why not? Adora has been a model *guest* since her trial."

"She's not a guest."

"She's basically a guest."

"Not to me she isn't." C’yra shakes her head. Adora never would be, Adora would never be anything to her. Nothing other than the Horde Lord anyway.

"C'yra, we need to start treating her as a guest. She's our daughter's mate, if we want any chance of reconciliation with our daughter, we need to give Adora a chance." Luna says sternly. C’yra knows on some level that Luna is right, but it’s just hard for her to hear.

"I hate her. That's not going to change." C’yra says, feeling that hatred ignite in her as she thinks of the Horde Lord.

"Do you hate our daughter?" Luna asks and C’yra’s eyes widen.

"No! Of course not!"

"Then do it for our kitten, Cy. Because, right now, she feels alone, as though she has no one but her mate in her corner.” C’yra wants to point out that’s not strictly true, Catra has a lot of people other than just Adora in her corner. “C'yra, she gave birth to Finn alone because of us. We didn't even give her a baby shower. Finn didn't get a celebration... Did we even celebrate her birthday with her? What day is it?"

"We missed it." C'yra confesses. She had known it had come up, but she didn’t really think Catra would want to celebrate.

"Fuck, Cy, this is what I'm talking about. We've... We've *abandoned* her because of who she loves. We can't keep doing this, not to our kitten." Luna's scent is filled with distress as she begins to cry. "When our daughter needed us most, what did we do? We abandoned her, we made her feel alone and unwanted. This isn't what we promised ourselves we'd do when C'yra was born."

"Fine." C'yra says, gently touching her wife's arms to help calm her. "I guess... being civil with Adora won't hurt." C’yra gently wipes her wife’s tears away with her thumbs and kisses her on the nose. Luna sighs and sniffles.

"We need to do more than that, Cy. We messed up. *Royally* ." She steps forward, burying her face in C'yra's chest. "I don't know if C'yra will ever be able to forgive us."

"Maybe we could... invite her to dinner?" C'yra suggests. "You seem to be... cozy with Adora."

"Cozy?"

"You two get along."

"Because I'm civil with her and try to actually get to know her as a person rather than her previous title." Luna bites back and, yeah, C'yra probably deserved that. Luna takes a deep breath before she nods with determination. "Yes, okay, I'll invite them to dinner tonight, you go submit our votes to the Princess Alliance as being in favour. We need to make this *right* , C'yra." C'yra nods. If she's honest, she still isn't convinced, but she does miss her daughter, and it pains her to see her wife in such distress.

"Of course, my Queen."

* * *

Adora had figured that they would probably have an awkward dinner with Catra's moms when they had asked them to come - Netossa and Spinnerella had volunteered to babysit Finn for them since Catra felt uncomfortable letting them be around C'yra. Catra was on good terms with pretty much everyone by now. Maybe 'good terms' was too strong of a word. She was talking to Glimmer now at the very least, though she clearly didn't trust the Princesses - excluding the few that had been kind to her.

The most tension, however, was between C'yra and Catra. C'yra still clearly disliked Adora, even if she had apologised, and Catra was still tense around her mom. Things were uneasy to say the least, but Adora was not expecting Catra to pull the stunt that she pulls.

They were waiting for their food when Adora felt a hand land on her *thigh* . She almost yelps in surprise but is silenced when she sees Catra's intense gaze. Adora goes crimson as the woman starts *stroking* the inside of her leg, chatting to Luna about something that Adora was just too gay to understand - i.e. she has Catra's *hand* rubbing *between her thighs* , she's not listening. Adora swallows and goes to grab her water so she can douse the flames of desire she feels burning under her skin.

She had wondered why Catra had insisted she wear the strap under her clothes. Adora had figured that Catra wanted to have some fun when they got back to their room, not that she wanted to do things here, *right now* . "Catra." Adora coughs a little which draws the attention of the Magicats in the room anyway - it's hard to be subtle around their ears.

"Yes," Catra has that grin on her face, the one that means *trouble* . " *daddy* ?" Catra whispers it so others can't hear, but Magicat hearing is *exceptional* . Adora sees as C'yra's ears twitch and then she scowls right at Adora, like it was her who told Catra to call her that. Speaking of...

Adora hadn't been expecting it but the name causes a spike of arousal to shoot through her. Adora turns to look at Catra with wide eyes as the brunette inches her hand further *up* . "C-Catra, we're at dinner." Adora whispers hurriedly, feeling her cheeks redden even further.

"Bathroom." Catra states simply. Her tail flicks behind her and hits Adora's bicep. There's absolutely *no way* Adora can resist that invitation.

Catra moves first, pushing her chair out so it scratches against the floor and makes the table fall silent. She drops her napkin on the table out of her lap and as she stands she squeezes Adora's crotch causing her to squeak a little - Catra does all of that in one fluid motion, it's so fucking hot. "Excuse me. Bathroom." Catra says, her tail purposely teasing Adora as she walks around her and to the bathroom. Catra's moms stare at Adora for a moment and she laughs nervously, taking a sip of her water. Adora knows Catra is probably doing this as a 'fuck you' to C'yra, but if Adora gets to have sex with Catra in the bathroom? She's absolutely going to follow.

Adora waits about exactly two minutes before she leaps up. "I... uh... bathroom." She stumbles. "I mean, I'm just... I'm just going to check on Catra, she doesn't... she doesn't like to

be alone, ha! Yeah... ex-excuse me." Adora almost trips with how quickly she runs out of there.

The second Adora closes the bathroom door she's being pinned against it - front first. "Took you long enough." Catra quips and her tongue laps at Adora's ear. Adora shudders, feeling Catra's front pressed up against her back. "Did you like that Adora? What I called you?" Adora swallows in arousal as she feels Catra's hand move around to her front and run down her abs. Catra leans up and whispers into her ear, slow, hot and seductively. " *Daddy* ."

Adora turns, not allowing herself to be pinned to the door any longer. Catra looks pleased and she grins as Adora cups her face and pulls her in for a rough kiss. "You are such a *brat* ." Adora says with a low rumbling chuckle as Catra starts untying her belt.

"Oh yeah?" Catra asks as Adora pulls on her hair so she can bite Catra's neck. "Are you going to punish me?" Catra asks.

Adora's knees almost give out at the question. She grabs Catra's wrists in her hands and unbuckles her belt herself, pushing Catra towards the counter. "You can't rip my clothes, Adora, my moms. And we need to be quick." Catra reminds her. Adora wants to point out that they were both less than subtle when they made the runner from the dinner table, but she's a little busy thinking about how she wants to fuck Catra against the counter.

"Who's Adora? I thought I was your… daddy?" The word comes out a little awkwardly - Adora has never said it before, sue her! - and Catra pauses her frantic fisting of Adora's clothes for a moment. There's silence, before Catra bursts out laughing and Adora immediately blushes. " *Hey* !"

"I'm sorry, I'm sorry!" Catra says. "Babe, please, it's just... You're such a dork. Kiss me?" Adora rolls her eyes fondly but kisses Catra much more gently now.

Catra reaches up and pushes Adora's suit jacket off of her shoulders and Adora pulls it off the rest of the way. Adora wasn't really big on clothes. She grew up in fatigues. She felt most comfortable wearing a t-shirt, trousers and boots, but apparently that wasn't appropriate for dinner. Catra had taken her to a tailor and Adora had grimaced at the frilly Princess dresses. Catra had laughed before she had handed the tailor a sheet of paper. Turns out her soon to be wife had sketched out a suit design for her. Catra had told her she'd taken the colours of She-

Ra, but also a little touch of red for the Horde and Catra's crown that she wore - they were matching. For that reason, Adora loved this suit.

Catra's hands squeeze softly at Adora's biceps and then Adora lifts Catra up, carrying her to the counter where the sink was and setting her down on the edge. Catra's hands slip in Adora's pants and they never once stop kissing. Catra's hand finds Adora's strap that she was packing and she starts *stroking* it. Adora's hips move automatically. "Who's a good girl, Adora?" Catra whispers right into Adora's ear. Adora whimpers a little before she catches sight of herself in the mirror. *Wait a second.*

"Hey, you're not switching this around on me." Adora says. "I'm the one who's going to fuck *you* against this counter."

"Hmm," Catra says and that grin of her's comes right back. "Or maybe *I'll* let *you* fuck me against this counter. Will you be a good girl for mommy?" Adora's mind goes completely blank. Catra's hand keeps stroking her strap and Adora looks at her before she nods. "What's that?"

"I want..." Adora trails off for a moment. "I want to be a good girl for you."

"Good girl for me, what?" Catra asks. That grin. Adora narrows her eyes but Catra stays calm and collected as she moves her hand up to the back of Adora's neck and gently scratches her nails into Adora's short locks.

"I want to be a good girl for you... mommy." Adora swallows. She still sometimes finds it hard to submit like this, but with Catra she doesn't mind. She doesn't mind being vulnerable with her. She feels safe, she loves and trusts her to never hurt her in this position.

Catra purrs and moves her hands away so she can push her own pants halfway down her legs. "Good girl, Adora. Get on your knees for me." Adora turns her head to the side. "I want you to eat me out first and then fuck me. You're not allowed to cum until I do, understood?" This was a bad idea, not because Adora isn't loving this but because she *is* . They're supposed to be at dinner, Adora should've known a quickie could never be quick with them.

Adora slowly sinks to her knees anyway. She has never really been good at denying Catra. “I want you to get me wet and then I want you to fuck me, got it?” Catra asks as she tugs Adora closer, threading her fingers through her blonde locks. Adora would have to fix that now before she went back out. “And Adora?” Catra asks and Adora nods. “Make it quick, we don’t have a lot of time.” Something about that is a significant turn on.

Adora yanks Catra’s tight black pants down, her red shirt becoming untucked before she dives between Catra’s legs. Adora doesn’t waste time, Catra had told her to basically get a move on anyway. Catra is already *wet* and Adora moans happily when she tastes her familiar slick on her tongue. Catra curses above her and wraps her legs around Adora’s shoulders, keeping her in a headlock and trapped between her thighs - not that Adora is complaining.

This is one of Adora’s favourite places to be: between Catra’s legs. Adora focuses on Catra’s clit first, circling her tongue lazily and sloppily, Adora shudders at the sounds that are made as she sucks on Catra’s clit. Adora glances up to see Catra with her head thrown back in pure ecstasy. She delves inside of her, thrusting with her tongue. "Adora…" Catra pants quietly. Catra says her name like a whispered prayer, and Adora soaks it up.

Adora explores with her tongue to her heart's content and then Catra tugs on her hair when she gets too close. "Okay," She says, her breath steadying a little. "Now fuck me, Adora." Adora isn't about to say no to that.

Adora stands and goes to pull her pants down when Catra stops her. "Through your zipper," Catra says, licking her lips. Adora's pupils dilate and she nods eagerly. Something about seeing her strap through the zipper of her suit pants as she fucks Catra against the counter is so *unbelievably* arousing.

Adora does as Catra orders and then she begins to ease herself inside of her. She pushes until their hips are touching and Catra wraps her arms around Adora's neck. Adora begins thrusting shallowly. They're both trying to be quiet and, as a result, their hot breaths and soft gasps mingle in the tiny space between them. Adora gives slow but hard thrusts that has Catra's head lolling back. It hits her right, *both* of them right, every single time. It feels *incredible* .

Adora looks up at some point to see her reflection and somehow that is only more arousing, to see herself fucking Catra. It gives Adora a *great* idea. She pulls out, ignoring Catra's

puzzled mewl and then she pulls Catra off of the counter and bends her over it instead. Adora pushes back in immediately and Catra lets out her loudest moan yet.

"Look Catra," Adora says, her voice thick with arousal. She grabs Catra by her hair and makes her look at their reflection. "Watch as *daddy* fucks you." Adora smirks as she sees Catra's eyes widen in the mirror. *Yep, Adora didn't mess that line up that time* .

" *Fuck…* " Catra says breathlessly and then Adora *does* fuck her. She isn't gentle anymore, her mission is to make Catra cum and for them to go back to dinner as quickly as possible. But she still plans to give Catra the best quick fuck of her life. " *Adora* !" Catra yelps and her claws come out as she scrambles to hold onto something, their sharp tips scratching the counter.

"Sh, Kitten," Adora warns. "Wouldn't want people to know how good daddy is fucking you."

"Adora-" Catra chokes. "Holy fuck-" Adora knows that whole thing had probably been a bit to piss off her moms, to spite them, but Adora was taking it and running with it.

Adora moves her hips fast and hard, grinding into Catra perfectly. The sounds filling the bathroom are sounds of wetness and soft grunts and pants of pleasure. When Catra cums, she does so quietly, but Adora feels her tense up and *sees* it reach even the tip of her tail as well as the feeling of her walls clamping around Adora's strap. Adora follows soon after.

Once they've both come down, Adora pulls out and Catra stands up straight. "Wow… Maybe we should use that more often." Catra comments.

"My strap?" Adora asks as she walks over to one of the stalls. She takes a handful of tissues so she could wipe it down. "We use it all the time."

"Not that," Catra says and Adora can hear her rustling around, fixing herself up. "The daddy thing… And the mirror honestly." Adora has to agree with the mirror thing, that was far too hot for its own good.

Adora steps out of the stall, strapping her strap down in her pants. She zips up her zipper as she looks at Catra. Catra looked completely normal now, like Adora hadn't just fucked her against the bathroom counter, and she was smoothing out the fur on her tail. "You should go first," Adora says. "I still need to wash my face." Catra laughs and kisses Adora on her cheek.

"I'll see you." Catra says and Adora smiles. She does wash her face and she straightens out her clothes before fixing her hair too. She looked organised again, and ready to face Catra's moms.

Adora returns to the table. She sheepishly clears her throat as she sits down in her seat beside Catra. "Your shirt is untucked." C'yra comments. Adora looks down with wide eyes, blushing like crazy, to see her shirt was not, in fact, untucked.

"Stop teasing her." Catra cuts in. Adora just had the most amazing, mind blowing, orgasm of her life. Going from that to this was weird to say the least.

"Where's Finn?" C'yra asks. Adora tenses beside Catra.

"With their aunts, Spinnerella and Netossa." Catra answers quickly, the only sign of her irritation is her tail swishing back and forth behind her.

"You didn't think to bring them?"

"I wasn't planning to bring them here since the beginning, C'yra." Catra grits out. Adora can already feel the tension building - and not the sexy kind.

"That so?" C'yra asks. "Why is that?"

"Why in the world would I bring them to a place with people I don't trust?"

"Oh that's your reason?" C'yra asks. "Here I thought it was because you wanted to sneak off with your... fiancee... and be inappropriate at the dinner table." Catra sucks her teeth, rolling her eyes.

"You know what, C'yra, if you're gonna start this bullshit, I'll happily go back to have dinner with just my fiancee and our kid."

"I'm just saying," C'yra comments. "You two were less than subtle. This is neither the time nor place."

"And I give a fuck because?" Catra raises an eyebrow. "I don't know if you understand this, C'yra, but let me break this down for you. I have zero respect for you. I don't care what you think, and I don't care what you want. As a matter of fact, my respect for you, and desire to even talk to you, is in the negatives. The only reason I'm here is because Adora, my fiancee, thought we should agree to your request to have dinner together." Adora coughs and clears her throat.

"Anyway..." She begins. "I'm sorry about... that... but we can just eat now. Right Catra?" Adora asks.

"Yes, I suppose so. Let's get this done and over with." Catra responds. Adora scowls a little at Catra before she leans over to kiss her on her cheek.

"How was Beast Island?" C'yra asks. "You know, since you two were only supposed to visit the Fright Zone for a week and then basically disappeared off of the face of Etheria."

"It was fine. We brought back Micah and now Glimmer has her dad back. So that's something." Catra answers shortly.

"I suppose it is." C'yra says, her tail whipping back and forth. "Do you enjoy putting my daughter in danger, Lord Adora?"

"Wh-" Adora splutters on the water she just took a drink from. "I... I tried to get Catra to stay, but she refused!" Adora protests. Catra suddenly stands up from her seat.

"C'yra, last time I checked, I told you that you weren't my mom. Don't call me your daughter. And for that matter, Adora's telling the truth. She was planning to sneak off on her own to go save Micah." Adora won't lie and say she doesn't appreciate Catra standing up for her, but she hadn't been expecting it.

"And the last time *I* checked, I gave *birth* to you. So, yes, you are my daughter." C'yra responds. Adora lifts her hand and tugs on Catra's wrist, wanting to defuse the situation.

" *That's it!* " Luna hits her hands on the table, startling everyone. Luna is normally pretty passive and quiet, but the anger in her tone was prominent. "C'yra, *sit down* ." Luna orders her daughter. "Cy, stop running your mouth and be nice for once! I am *tired* of you purposely antagonising both C'yra and Adora."

"But-"

"No buts!" Luna interrupts. C'yra huffs but says nothing else. Catra sits back down, murmuring under her breath.

"See, I knew this would just be a waste of time." She says to Adora, frowning softly. "Can we go?"

"Not a total waste of time, given what we did in the bathroom." Adora whispers back with a small smirk. Catra lets out a small huff of laughter that makes this worth it. Adora wasn't really kidding, what they did in the bathroom was *totally* worth it.

"C'yra," Luna begins. "Why don't you tell my wife how badly she messed up?" Luna prompts. Catra looks at her mom suspiciously.

"Luna..." C'yra mumbles.

"No, you're going to sit there and listen, or so help me."

"Why should I waste my breath?" Catra asks. "I tried telling her what was wrong multiple times. And what does she do? Find every chance to throw some bullshit back in my face because she's pissed I'm not doing what she wants." Catra throws her arms up in frustration. "She *never* listens, and I'm done trying to talk to her."

“She’ll listen now, won’t you C’yra?” Luna looks at her wife with a *look* . It’s clear they had discussed this beforehand. C’yra sighs and looks at her daughter before she nods.

“I’ll listen.” C'yra says. Catra looks unconvinced, just as Adora feels unconvinced too.

"I don't see the point of this." Catra says tiredly.

"The point is that I'm stuck between my wife and my child and I don't want to be." Luna says. "The point is, C'yra owes you an apology, but, before she apologises, I want her to hear everything you went through."

"She's not gonna apologize, mom. She's not planning to do it."

"How do you know that?"

"Because every time I told her that I was hurting, all she did was throw a fucking excuse in my face!" Catra yells suddenly. Adora stares awkwardly at the table, not really knowing what to do. Catra was understandably upset, but there was little Adora could do to help, at least right now.

"I know that," Luna says with a frown. Adora imagines it probably hurts her to be yelled at by her child. "But she's going to listen *now* ." Catra takes in a deep, heavy breath of frustration.

"Fine. You want to listen to me repeat everything I tried to tell you for months now, be my guest." She says, visibly upset. "I have never felt more alone in my entire fucking life. I was at my most vulnerable, having been injured, having nearly died, carrying my kitten, and I had to endure that alone. What did you do when I tried to tell you that? You told me it was my fault that I was alone. You told me that I *deserved* what was happening to me, that I deserved the pain I was going through because of who I loved and because of who my child was."

Catra's voice wavers as the emotions she had been holding inside of her for months begin to rear their heads. "I had *bars* on my bedroom window. I couldn't go outside of my room without hearing whispers and receiving glares from the guards and the Princesses who I once thought were my friends. I had to go to the doctor during my fucking pregnancy because I sprained my wrist when one of the guards pushed me to the floor when I went to get food. But I bet you didn't know or care to check what the guards were doing anyway. I had to go through labour *by myself,* stand up hours later to save my mate because you literally used the fact that I was in labour to capture Adora and make her go through a trial. My kitten couldn't even get a proper welcome to Half-Moon because my supposed 'mother' was treating them like a monster, treating me like a fucking inconvenience, and the people of Half-Moon see that, so they treat me the same way!" Catra looks angrier than Adora has ever seen her before. Her eyes sparkle a little with tears of anger and frustration, but Adora was proud of her for getting it all out. "There! Are you happy?!" Catra asks.

"I..." C'yra looks at Catra with wide eyes. Adora places a comforting hand to Catra's back to try to soothe her a little. "I don't think Finn is a monster, and I don't think you're an inconvenience." C'yra says, frowning deeply.

"You literally told me to get rid of them! To my *face* ! Because they were part Horde!" Catra yells at her, clearly distressed. "You treated me like one! You didn't even come see me through anything after I was put under house arrest! None of my appointments, never came to chat unless it was to try to get information out of me to use against Adora!"

"You betrayed me!" C'yra yells suddenly. Adora feels like face palming. C'yra's anger rivals Adora's sometimes. C’yra has a tendency to let her anger control her, Adora has learnt that that usually leads to bad decisions and hurt for others. "Of course I was upset! Of course I didn't come to talk to my daughter who had been sleeping with the woman who had killed so many of our people! I'm sorry C'yra, okay? I only told you to get rid of Finn in the heat of the moment, I never meant it."

"I betrayed you, huh?" Catra whispers. "My gosh, you're kidding, right? I was going to tell you, you know that? I was trying to figure out how to tell you who the other mom was. But I knew that you wouldn't be happy." She says, her eyes watery as she looks at C'yra. "I was *terrified* of telling you, and I was right to be scared. I was on the verge of a panic attack when Double Trouble revealed who they were. When you all showed up and believed the spy that had actually betrayed you instead of your own daughter. The same spy that *pushed me into grief again* !" She roars.

"You never let me explain what had happened. You never listened to anything I had to say, and that hurt. You can't just say you said it in the heat of the moment when you know you meant it. You wanted Finn gone because you didn't want to take care of anyone that was Horde. You're not sorry, C'yra. You're just saying that because Luna is making you." She sobs. "There were times where I wished I had just died that day. Where I wished Double Trouble had just left me there to die. It would have been less painful than all of this."

"I honestly believed I was protecting you." C'yra responds. Adora winces a little at that response, knowing that wasn't what

"That's bullshit! I told you multiple times that you were hurting me! So fuck off with that lie!"

"I still believed it!" C'yra says and Adora believes her. she knows C'yra really believes that, even if it is untrue. Adora kind of feels like she's intruding on this discussion, like she shouldn't be there, but she's there to support Catra only. "I thought Adora had... Corrupted you. I thought you had some kind of Stockholm syndrome. I didn't believe your feelings for her were genuine, no matter how much you insisted they were."

"You could have literally put a truth spell on me to check." Catra points out with a frown. "But you weren't even listening to me and kept trying to control me the entire time. I literally felt trapped. I felt more trapped here in what used to be my home then when I was first captured in the Fright Zone!"

"That's because you *weren't* trapped in the Fright Zone, clearly." C'yra says, frustrated, before she takes a breath. "Look, I believed that you believed that you loved Adora. But I didn't believe it myself, and I just wanted to protect you from her." Catra remains silent and C'yra rubs her forehead. "What do you want from me C'yra?"

"I want you to stay away from me and my family." Catra states coldly.

"Is that really what you want?"

"Yes, because all you've done is cause us hurt." Catra replies softly, her expression tired. "You separated me from my mate, threatened to kill her, hurt her before her trial. I didn't want to come here. You haven't given me any reason to even want you as part of my life. If I'm being honest, the only reason I haven't renounced my title as Princess of Half-Moon is because *Adora* asked me to reconsider." Adora laughs nervously as both Queens glance at her. Adora just thinks Catra would make an amazing Queen, but if she really wanted to renounce her title, then Adora would support her. C'yra sighs and stands from her seat.

"Very well," C'yra says. "I'll leave you alone." She pushes her chair back and pauses. "I realise you no longer want to stay in Half-Moon or Bright Moon, I've lifted Adora's guard detail as the Princess requested. So long as she fulfils the other conditions of her probation, you're free to move out together." With those words said, C'yra turns and walks out of the room.

Adora watches as Catra watches C'yra leaving the room silently. Catra looks… unreadable, which is rare to Adora, but Adora can't place the emotion she's feeling. Catra stands up. "Come on, Adora, let's go."

"You... Want to go?" Adora asks. These events at dinner were not how she saw this night going at all.

"Yes. I want to go. We're done here." Catra offers her hand. "I want to go pack my stuff from my room and then go get Finn." Adora glances at Luna who just looked downright *sad* , before she stands up.

"Thank you, for dinner." She bows a little and then takes Catra’s hand. Catra squeezes her hand before guiding her out of the room, heading towards their room to go retrieve their things. Adora isn't sure what she expected from that dinner, but this wasn't really it.

* * *

Luna sits in her seat at the dining table for a little while. Her eyes locked on where her daughter had just sat. The expression on her face was devastated, she's sure. She *felt* devastated. She had hoped that this dinner would have at least helped her wife and her daughter to start to make amends, but it seems that wasn't going to happen.

She gets up from her chair, leaving the dining hall in silence, heading to her and her wife's bedroom where she imagined C'yra would be. "Luna," C'yra says when Luna enters the room. "Why are you here?"

"C'yra left." Luna states, not giving much of an explanation. "And it's my room too, Cy."

"No, I know, I just..." C'yra sighs. "What more can I do Luna?" Luna bites the inside of her cheek.

"I don't know, Cy." She enters the room completely, closing the door behind her. "Based on everything, I think it might be too late to do something."

"Too late?" C'yra asks with alarm. "I... I don't want it to be like this forever."

"What did you expect would happen?" Luna asks, crossing her arms over her chest. She loves her wife, but sometimes she can be so dense.

"I don't know! Not this." C'yra has her head in her hands. Luna has never seen her wife look like that before. Luna sighs.

"I tried to warn you, Cy. But you refused to listen to me. C'yra was right. She gave you multiple chances, but all you did was step on her and her autonomy." Luna gives it to her wife straight (ironically). Tough love with C'yra is the only way to get through to her.

"Then I'll just do what she said and stay away from her and Adora, and... Finn..." C'yra's ears droop at the mention of their grandchild. "I guess I'll just have to make my peace with that."

"Do you really regret what you put her through, Cy?" Luna asks gently.

"I regret... damaging our relationship to this extent."

"So you don't regret what you did to her?" Luna asks in disbelief.

"How can I regret trying to protect my child?"

"That's *not* what I'm asking." Luna frowns. "I'm going to repeat the question. Did you regret what you made her go through, Cy? Because, and I am going to call you out on this, you were making her *suffer* . As were the Princesses on your side in the matter."

"I regret hurting her." C'yra says finally. "And I regret... making her feel that way, even if it wasn't my intention. I regret using underhanded tactics to capture Adora."

"Yet you never showed her that you regret it, Cy." Luna explains with exasperation. "Any time you saw her, or Adora was with her, all you did was antagonise them both. Every *single* time."

"Because... I don't like Adora." C'yra says. "I never will."

"It doesn't matter if you don't like Adora. Is your dislike for her more than your love for our daughter? Because that's what it seems like."

"I don't dislike her," C'yra corrects, sitting down on their bed. "I *hate* her."

"Your point, Cy?" Luna frowns, hands clenched at her sides. "Is that stronger than your love for our daughter? Because I can already tell the answer." C'yra sighs.

"No..." C'yra says incredulously.

"No? That wasn't what it seemed like this entire time. Including at dinner tonight." Luna says, exhausted. "I seriously don't know how you could have expected C'yra to want you in her life after everything. She tried to tell you, Spinerella and Netossa tried to tell you, Bow tried to tell you, *I* tried to tell you. But you never listened." Luna has known C'yra is as stubborn as an ox, but she didn't realise she'd give into ignorance just to be right.

"C'yra is my daughter, of course I love her more than anything." C'yra rubs her face. "I just... I don't know Luna."

"Don't know what?"

"I mean I don't know," C'yra says, clearly frustrated. "I don't know how to fix it, I don't know how to make it up to her, I don't know how to look at Adora without wanting to claw her eyes out. I don't know!"

"I don't know what you want me to tell you." Luna says softly. "She might not ever come back, Cy. She went to go pack her things after you left."

"Maybe... We let her go?"

"I know, I'm not planning to stop her. I'm just..." Luna presses her lips into a thin line. "I'm upset, Cy."

"I'm upset too." C'yra says. She looks at Luna for a long moment before she sighs. "The issue was that I trapped her before, right? Trying to make her stay now..."

"That's not what I'm upset about. She has the right to leave, and I'm glad she's finally able to travel again. I'm upset that I didn't get to spend time with her." Luna can smell her own grief in the air. She feels as though she's lost her daughter, and that's hard on her. C'yra tries her best to comfort her, but their relationship has been strained due C'yra's role in Catra pulling away from them.

"Well, she still likes you." C'yra shrugs. "You can see her whenever you like." Luna can't believe her wife just said that.

"You know, if you weren't feeling sorry for yourself already, I would punch you." Luna says calmly. "I didn't get to be there for her when she needed us most because I had to make sure that *you* wouldn't do something stupid."

"I'm sorry Luna." C'yra says, her ears pressing back against her head. She curls her tail around herself. "I guess I hurt everyone I love." It's hard for Luna not to cave and tell C'yra that it's okay, she wants to comfort her, but she needs this reality check more than anything right now.

"Sorry doesn't bring that time back, Cy. So I need you to get your behind up and stop feeling sorry for yourself." Luna huffs. "If you want to start making up for what you did to C'yra, then how about you start with gifting her something for Finn?"

"What gift would I get them?" C'yra asks. "And what's to stop C'yra from throwing it out too?"

"Things that they can actually use. Like we should have gotten for them since the beginning." Luna frowns, looking away. "The things we would have gifted C'yra and Finn at the celebration they should have gotten." Her ears press back sadly.

"I didn't think C'yra wanted that celebration, given... *everything* ."

"Did you think to ask her at all? Instead of assuming everything like you've done this entire time."

"Well I..." C'yra pauses. "I didn't... no..."

"I imagined not. We need to start somewhere, Cy. I don't know if C'yra is going to reject the gifts. But it's worth trying if you really want to make up for what happened."

"Okay," C'yra looks up at Luna. Luna's breath catches a little. C'yra is beautiful, but war has changed her. She used to be so much like Catra, more open, still stubborn, but willing to break the rules - she broke the rules marrying Luna after all. She used to be kind and caring, and Luna can't imagine a young C'yra ever pulling what she's recently pulled. She's changed, but Luna can hardly blame her. She lost her parents to the war, she has scars, almost lost her own life and their daughter's. When Catra joined the Rebellion, C'yra had been against it but allowed it anyway, and now she was an (future) in-law with the Horde Lord. Luna understood her frustration, and she still loved her wife despite it all. That didn't mean she agreed with her, or supported her decisions however. "What do you suggest?" C'yra asks softly. *This* is her wife: soft, careful, thoughtful and *collaborative* .

"Maybe we can get… No, they already have that. Um..." Luna hums thoughtfully. "I... I'm not sure... they... after I spoke to Spinnerella and Netossa, they told me that the Fright Zone actually gave them most of the supplies they needed as gifts."

"What about clothes? Babies can't have too many clothes, right?"

"I suppose not. It would be nice to get Finn some clothes." Luna remembers how many onesies C'yra went through as a little kit - claws tend to do that.

"Magicat clothes, which they should have." C'yra says with a grin. Luna narrows her eyes at her wife.

"Just regular clothes, right?" Luna asks, suspicious of C'yra's words.

"Why not royal Magicat baby clothes?" C'yra asks. Luna stares at her in disbelief.

"Did you seriously not listen to what C'yra said? She was considering renouncing the title of princess. I doubt she wants a reminder of everything. But I'll ask her if she's okay with getting royal clothes for Finn.” It wouldn’t be anything spectacularly extraordinary, but it would mark them out as a royal Magicat and an *heir* . Luna wasn’t sure Catra wanted that.

"Even if C'yra renounces her title, Finn is still the heir to our throne. In fact, it even passes to them." C’yra points out. Luna facepalms - there she goes being dense again.

"Cy, why would C'yra want Finn to come back here? Where... Where the people mistreated their mama? Where even *we're* not sure if the people will acknowledge Finn as the heir." Luna sees C'yra think for a moment before she stands up.

"We have to accept them. Publicly."

"You do realize that's not going to be enough, right?"

"Why not?" C'yra asks. "We accept Finn publicly. We present them to the Kingdom, with C'yra and... Adora... People see that they're not so bad, right?"

"Cy, it's been months. Rumours fly, and if the guards really were mistreating our daughter, who is to say what other rumours they may have spread." Luna understands her wife’s plan, she just thinks it’s flawed. C'yra frowns.

"The best way to C’yra is through Adora,” C’yra says slowly. “I… I can’t believe I’m about to say this but, I need to talk to Adora.” Luna lifts her eyebrows. “Ugh, goddess guide me.”

“I love you, Hairball.” Luna says fondly with a chuckle. C’yra gets a soft expression on her face.

“You haven’t called me that in a very long time.” C’yra say, kissing Luna on her cheek. It was a nickname from their youth. “I love you too.” Luna was optimistic about C’yra mending bridges. She was, believe it or not, quite good at getting people to forgive her.

* * *

The last person that Adora expected to see coming to her was Queen C’yra, and yet, that is exactly who was standing in front of her, asking Adora for advice on how to make things with Catra better. "So what can I do?" C’yra asks. Adora normally wouldn’t help. Catra had made her position and feelings on C’yra pretty sparkling clear, but just because Adora wasn’t going to get involved with that anymore, didn’t mean she couldn’t offer the Queen some friendly advice. Adora would never suggest to Catra to forgive C’yra again, but she could give C’yra the tools to make it better on her own.

"Apologize to her for a start." Adora says simply. "And *mean* it."

"And then what?"

"And then you put in the effort." Adora says with a shrug. "You really hurt her, like *really* hurt her. You can't expect everything to be okay just because you said you were sorry." C'yra grimaces as she looks at Adora.

"I was trying to do what was best for her." C’yra says and Adora sighs. That excuse was getting old. Still, it’s strange for Adora to feel how she feels about C’yra. C’yra and Catra are almost perfect copies of each other - physically anyway - and Adora finds it weird to be angry with someone who looks so much like her future wife.

"I know you believe that, but you weren't." Adora states firmly. "She told me everything. All you did was hurt her, and dismiss her feelings. It's not that surprising that she doesn't trust you when all you did was yell at her and make her a prisoner in her own home while refusing to hear her out. I know you didn't like me, *don't* like me, whatever, but that was no excuse to treat Catra the way you did." Adora wasn’t mincing her words and C'yra seems to shrink in on herself the more Adora talks. *Good.* She deserved to know *exactly* how she made Catra feel.

"I couldn't trust her after the ill-advised decisions she had made. Sleeping with the enemy? Getting pregnant by the enemy? Running off to see the enemy during her house arrest? She kept breaking that trust back-to-back."

"But you didn't even listen to her." Adora points out. "Look, I know it must have been difficult to learn that Catra was seeing the Horde Lord, but she wanted to explain it to you so you could understand, and you never even gave her the chance." Adora sighs as she rubs her forehead for a moment. "Catra's decisions weren't 'ill-advised', she had her reasons, reasons she wanted to tell you, but you refused to listen. Then she just gave up, and you can't blame her for that."

"What was there to explain? She slept with you, by some chance, and you can't really expect me to believe she fell in love with you when she used to loathe you." C'yra responds. Adora laughs and shakes her head.

"Wow... You still don't get it." She sighs in exasperation. "There was a lot to Catra and I's relationship beyond the fact that we slept together, and I don't know how or why, but she *did* fall in love with me. You know, we actually kissed a long time ago, back when I was just getting my bearings as Horde Lord. Catra's always been attracted to me, even if she did hate me, and she's always been afraid by what that meant. She didn't act on any of those feelings until that one night and then... we fell in love. My point is, we've always had this *connection* , even if we were enemies." Adora doesn't know how to explain it. She thinks maybe she and Catra were always meant to be.

"How did it happen?" C'yra asks. "Where did the... love even start?"

"It just did." Adora shrugs. "Things went from sex to love naturally, we talked, we laughed, we kissed and cuddled, confessed things to each other and... we just fell in love with each other. Catra is... *amazing* . I used to think I was incapable of love but I would tear down the entire universe if she asked me to, to save her, I'd do *anything* for her." Adora means those words wholeheartedly. There wasn't anything she wouldn't do for Catra.

C'yra rubs her forehead, running her fingers through her hair. "You... really love her that much? Is that why you came and surrendered?"

"Of course that's why I surrendered. Everything I ever did, I did for Catra." Adora confesses. At least C'yra seems to be listening to her now.

"What... What else did she tell you?"

"About you?" Adora asks with a frown. "She... She told me how awful it was being here. I'd honestly not be surprised if she has some kind of PTSD from the experience." In fact, Adora knew that Catra did in fact have PTSD from the whole thing, but she didn't want to give that knowledge to C'yra, just make her consider it, that was Catra's choice to tell more or not.

C'yra cringes at the words, her ears pressing against head. "PTSD?" She asks.

"Well, it was a very stressful and traumatic experience for her to be held prisoner by her own friends and family, not to mention how people mistreated her around here, and she was isolated and basically alone. That takes a toll on a person." Adora points out.

"Shit." C'yra whispers. *She could say that again* .

"You were a bad mom, and that's coming from someone who had *Shadow Weaver* as a mother." Adora says. Maybe she's being a little harsh, but C'yra probably responds to tough love far more than any kind of love. Besides, she deserved it - at least a little. C'yra bites her lip.

"I was trying to do what was right." She murmurs, more to herself than to Adora but Adora hears it all the same. Now that her anger had cooled off, all of the things she had done to her daughter seemed to be slapping her in the face all at once. "I was trying to protect her from being tricked... but fuck, I'm so stupid."

"Yes, you are stupid." Adora agrees. "I tried to defend you, you know? Because I understand that you were trying to protect Catra from me, and I knew why you didn't want to listen to Catra, and I didn't want to be the reason you guys had a bad relationship, but... You did fuck up. You hurt Catra, and I *hate* that you did." Adora isn't blind, she can see that Catra is affected by what her moms did to her.

"I fucked up really badly."

"So stop saying you were just trying to protect her, that doesn't make her feel better." Adora says sternly. If anything, it just sounded like an excuse to inflict trauma onto Catra.

"Fine!" C'yra yells suddenly, making Adora jump. She dislikes loud noises. "I wasn't trying to protect her! I was trying to stop whatever the hell was going on between you two, because it wasn't right. She shouldn't have fallen in love with someone like *you* and she definitely shouldn't have mated with you!"

"Someone like me?" Adora asks, raising an eyebrow in disbelief. "You don't even know me." C'yra hadn't even *bothered* to get to know Adora. Maybe if she had, she wouldn't think the way that she does now.

"I think attacking Etheria and nearly killing my daughter is more than enough, don't you think?" C'yra asks. Adora sighs.

"Not really," She shrugs. "You don't know me at all, you don't *want* to know me. Attacking Etheria was just what I was taught to do, I was a *child soldier* , and Catra... I never wanted to hurt her, that was an accident, and I wasn't in control. Do you think Catra would forgive me if I had purposely tried to kill her?"

"I don't know! Forgive me for finding it hard to trust the leader of the group that killed my parents and nearly killed my daughter!" Adora resists the urge to roll her eyes at that. She had nothing to do with C'yra's parents.

"You..." Adora shakes her head. "I don't blame you for not trusting me, but you'd think you'd trust your own daughter."

"It's hard to trust her when I had to find out from the spy that you hire that you were fucking her." C'yra hisses, narrowing her eyes at Adora. "For months, might I add."

"You can see why she didn't tell you given how you reacted." Adora responds, her eyes narrowing right back at C'yra as well. "And yes, we were fucking, for months, Catra was pregnant with my baby, you can't hold this against her anymore."

"I wouldn't have reacted this badly had she told me herself! I had to find out from someone else! Do you know how it feels to find out that your own daughter was sleeping with the enemy for months under the guise of getting kidnapped?! While we were worried sick for her safety, she was over there getting a baby fucked into her by the Horde Lord!" C'yra yells. Adora feels anger seize her in that moment at C'yra's words.

"Do you even hear yourself?!" Adora yells suddenly. She had been getting better at not getting angry, but when it came to Catra... "Don't talk about her like that. I mean it. And don't kid yourself, you would have reacted *exactly* the same way had she told you herself." C'yra needs to learn to get a handle on her own anger, or she's just going to drive Catra away again.

"I wouldn't have!" C'yra protests. Adora scoffs.

"Yeah, right. You hate me, period. You wouldn't have been okay with Catra seeing me whether she told you or not."

"I would have been more understanding." C'yra says firmly. "Because it would have been *her* being honest with me and not me finding out from the spy that had been feeding you information about the Rebellion."

"Oh my-" Adora curls her hands into fists before she releases them. "Do you think Catra wanted you to find out like that? She wanted to tell you herself, but Double Trouble beat her to it. And yes, they had been spying on the Rebellion for me, for *years* , but the reason they turned was because I was so distraught over what happened to Catra that I forgot about them! It was *war* , it was just a tactic, Catra didn't know they were a spy until they exposed her." C'yra growls before taking a few deep breaths.

"Okay." She says simply.

"Okay?" Adora asks.

"I'll apologise. As much as I hate to admit it, you're right." Adora's eyes widen when she hears C'yra admit that Adora was right. "I treated C'yra like... like... really badly. The least that I can do is say sorry." Adora would argue that was an understatement, but at least she seemed to finally recognise the damage she did

"Are you actually sorry?" Adora asks. C'yra's ears droop.

"Yes. I miss my little kitten, okay? I know I fucked up. More than I thought for that matter. I want to at least try to make things right."

"Okay... Good." Adora nods. "I'll talk to Catra about it, but you shouldn't expect her to accept your apology."

"I'm not..." C'yra whispers, sounding dejected. "I just... I want her to call me mama again."

"That might take a while." Adora doesn't want to give C'yra any false truths here. It will likely take Catra a long time to fully forgive C'yra - if ever really - never mind call her mom again.

"I know." C'yra presses her lips together. "When she called me C'yra, I felt like someone had slapped me. I thought you had prompted her to do it." Adora doesn't know if she should be offended by that or not.

"No." Adora says carefully. "I've actually been encouraging her to hear you out. I didn't want to come between Catra and her mom."

"You've been what?" C'yra seems surprised and Adora can't help but chuckle.

"I've been encouraging her to hear you out, which, honestly, you don't really deserve."

"No, I suppose I don't."

"You don't." Adora says firmly. "But I hate feeling like I... Like I came between you two. I want to fix it."

"It's not your job to fix it, it's mine."

"Damn right." Adora says before she chances a question. "Does this mean you like me now?"

"No." C'yra rolls her eyes. "I still don't like you. But I appreciate you trying to help." Adora didn't have high hopes of getting a yes, in fact, she kind of considered that response a success.

"Will you ever like me?" Adora asks.

"Probably not. But perhaps I can grow to tolerate you."

"I can work with tolerate." Adora says with a grin.

"Good, because that's all you're getting."

"I really do love Catra, you know?" Adora says because it feels important for C'yra to know that Catra is, and always will be, her greatest love.

"I know." C'yra says after a moment. Not even C'yra could argue that Adora didn't love Catra, she had proven it on several occasions. "As much as I hate to admit it."

"And I love Finn."

"I can see that."

"Catra and I might have more kids, in the future." Adora comments.

"And now you're overstepping for the level of conversation we just had." C'yra says, giving her a warning look. Adora snorts.

"That's what I do, I overstep." Adora says. It was true, on several occasions she had overstepped. It's not like she even meant to, sometimes Adora just didn't understand social limits.

"Yes, it is." C'yra hums.

"Hey, look, I think you like me already." Adora jokes lightly.

"Keep telling yourself that." C'yra rolls her eyes before sighing. "But thanks for trying to help."

"I'll talk to Catra, but no promises." Adora replies. C'yra nods slowly.

"Okay..." C'yra says quietly. “I heard from the Princesses that you want to take Shadow Weaver’s magic,” C’yra brings up. Adora nods in answer. “Maybe I can help you, you know, since I have magic too.” Adora’s eyes widen.

“You’d help me do that?” Adora couldn’t hide the surprise in her voice. “Why?”

“You said I had to prove it right? And mean it? Helping you proves that.” C’yra says. “Besides, I’ve never liked Shadow Weaver, she’s *definitely* responsible for the death of my parents, I’d gladly take her magic.”

“Then yeah, I could use all the help I can get.” C’yra nods and then she hesitates for a moment before she turns and walks away from Adora. Adora sighs. Now she just had to figure out how to ask Catra to give her mom another chance when C'yra really didn't deserve it.

Still, whatever Catra chose to do, Adora would support it.

Chapter End Notes

The way that Glimmer really thought Adora was hurting Catra but was not, makes me cackle every single time. -M

Me to M: It is a *crime* that Catra hasn't sat on Lord Adora's face before ... Putting this in immediately. I hope you all enjoyed the spice, it feels like it's been a while. No Glimmers were traumatised in this chapter :) See y'all next time -S

As always you can find us on Twitter @ceolordadora and our CC is the same! You can find me (S) on tumblr @sherasswordstrap

M and I have a podcast where we talk about fics and specifically Lord Adora called 'Get Down with S and M' which you can find here: https://open.spotify.com/show/2NH0KuzNDKmMnNmMhnOTjt?si=X60lzanUQ5eWybHxbIGxIw&utm_source=copy-link&dl_branch=1

Till Death Do Us Part

Chapter Summary

> “Because… I don’t need to annoy you.” Adora shrugs. “You kiss me now without me annoying you into it.”
>
> “You would annoy me to get me to kiss you?” Catra questions, raising an eyebrow. Adora nods slowly.
>
> “Worked every time.”
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> “Your arrogance was highly annoying.”
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> “You still kissed me.” Adora says, grinning up at Catra. Catra huffs at her before she grabs Adora gently by her chin.
>
> “I kissed you because you’re stupidly attractive.” Catra says and Adora smirks lopsidedly.

Chapter Notes

> Happy Friday and happy update day !! We took a little break but we're back. Just wanna give a heads up that we now have an estimate of how many chapters are left. While we love Lord Adora so much, all good things must come to an end at some point. Also !! I have updated some of the tags, so please take notice of those before you read this chapter !! Hope y'all enjoy.
>
> Warning: NSFW ahead (SPOILERS FOR CHAPTER: there is butt stuff this chapter and light BDSM, I've put *** in bold before this scene starts and where it ends if you wish to not read that, but here is your heads up as well as in the tags !!)

See the end of the chapter for more notes

Things had become hectic to say the least. Catra had packed their things up, which really was more of her things than Adora’s, since she didn’t have an awful lot of possessions anyway, and they hadn’t been back to Bright Moon or Half-Moon for several weeks - other than to meet with Spinnerella and Netossa and Bow and a select others for their wedding planning. Catra had refused to speak with C’yra again, and Adora didn’t blame her and she wasn’t going to advocate for the Magicat Queen either, but their wedding was fast approaching, the

construction of their house was almost complete, Adora had visited Bow's dads in the woods to borrow some books from their library on She-Ra, things were coming together.

"Catra?" Adora asks, turning around to see Catra playing with Finn. Catra hums, half distracted and Adora allows herself a moment to enjoy the sight. Catra looked so *happy* , she always did whenever she looked at Finn, they never failed to make her smile and purr. Catra's tail was swishing behind her as she blew raspberries on Finn's belly, making them giggle and grab her hair. Catra had stopped wearing her Rebellion fighting clothes after the first couple of weeks of them coming to the Fright Zone, instead, in a twist Adora didn't see coming, she had taken to wearing Horde colours and clothing. Adora wasn't sure how to take that.
"What's a horse?" Catra looks over at her.

"You don't know what a horse is?" Catra asks. "Right, you guys only use skiffs here. It's an animal, usually you ride them."

"You ride animals?" Adora asks, raising an eyebrow. That just sounded strange, and tactically inept.

"I really don't know how to explain horses to you without showing you." Catra says. "Why are you asking anyway?"

"Bow," Adora says as she holds up a piece of paper. "He suggested I ride in on a horse like a… prince, or a knight in shining armour." Catra snorts as she begins to change Finn's diaper. Adora settles on the bed beside her, distracting Finn with her finger as Catra changes them.

"Of course he did," Catra says. "I think you'd look incredibly handsome, but maybe you should see a horse first before you agree to that." Finn manages to catch her finger, for such a small baby, they sure move fast, their tiny little claws dig into Adora like needles but she's entirely used to them now - she has scratches everywhere. "All done." Catra says, placing a kiss on Finn's tummy. Adora smiles as she picks the small kit up in her arms.

"My little baby," Adora says affectionately as she tickles them under their chin. They really were growing at an exceptional rate, the doctor suggested it may have something to do with Adora's - or more accurately, *She-Ra's* - magic. "My family." Adora says with a smile. She leans forward to kiss Catra on her forehead, causing her to purr, before she kisses Finn too.

“Our home will be completed soon, we’ll be able to move in after our wedding.” Catra sighs and lies down on their bed.

“I just want to marry you already.” Catra admits. “I don’t even know why we’re having a ceremony, we should’ve just eloped.”

“You’re the Princess here,” Adora says lightly. “Marriage doesn’t even exist in the Fright Zone, not really anyway, it’s a Princess thing, and so are all these… traditions. Am I really not allowed to see you the night before our wedding?” Adora asks. She didn’t like the thought of having to spend such a long time apart from Catra. Catra chuckles a little.

“It’s so we save sex for the wedding night, Adora.” Catra says.

“What’s the point? We’ve had sex many, *many* , times.” Adora says.

“Maybe we should put an embargo on that too, no sex until the wedding.” Catra comments.

“We already haven’t, except for a few quickies here and there.” Adora points out. They haven’t had the *time* , not since leaving Bright Moon anyway. As a result, Adora was very much looking forward to their wedding night. Catra rolls her eyes.

“Are you marrying me for sex?” Catra questions. Adora smirks a little.

“No, but it’s very good and I am more than happy to spend the rest of my life getting to do that with you.”

“You’re unbelievable,” Catra says, but her voice is full of amusement. “Please don’t talk about that in your vows.” Adora mock gasps.

“In front of all your Princess friends? I would *never* , don’t want people to faint.” Adora gently rocks Finn in her arms. They were slowly drifting off to sleep, their little tail flicking

every so often. When Adora looks at them, she sees so much of Catra. There are hints of herself, sure, their blue eyes are like hers, their tail is a little lighter than their hair, like a mixture of Adora's blonde and Catra's brunette, but the hair on their head is brown like Catra's, their nose, Catra had claimed was like Adora's, but everything else was just… Catra. They made a whole baby. Adora still couldn't quite believe it. Part of her thinks maybe she died and didn't know it.

"At least the Fright Zone has hot water now," Catra comments, changing the topic, and Adora laughs a little. Hot water was essential for babies, turns out they're very… Well, they're kind of gross and require regular bathing. Adora still preferred her cold showers, but Catra liked them hot. The only time Adora had a hot shower was when she showered with Catra which, surprisingly, was not that often. "But, as much as this place has improved, I just want to live in our own home." Adora couldn't agree more. Since her time spent in Bright Moon and Half-Moon, Adora had become accustomed to more… She isn't really sure. The Fright Zone used to feel familiar, no matter what, now it feels like somewhere she just exists while they wait for their *home* to be built.

"Do you think we should go on more dates?" Adora asks. "Have we ever been on a date before?"

"We've been on dates." Catra replies and Adora raises an eyebrow. "When you took me up the tower with a picnic and we slow danced, that was a date, Adora."

"Okay, name another." Adora prompts.

"Well…" Catra pauses. "Huh… I… I don't think… Well, shit." Adora snorts. She's not really sure they require dates at this point anyway, and you could probably class their secret rendezvous in the past as dates, besides, Adora isn't sure why they have to do stuff together; every moment Adora spends with Catra are the best moments of her life, she doesn't need to be doing an activity on a 'date' to forge a connection with her.

Adora gently places Finn down on their bed. "I'm going to tell you a bedtime story, Little One." Adora says.

"They're already asleep." Catra says, but her voice is full of affection.

“I’m still going to.” Adora says dismissively. She makes her voice low and soft, so she wouldn’t wake Finn up. “Once upon a time, there was a beast who fell in love with a beautiful Princess-”

“Seriously?” Catra interrupts. “You’re hardly a beast Adora, I wouldn’t have slept with you if you were.”

“Shhh,” Adora scolds. “My story, your quiet time.” Catra rolls her eyes with a smile but she falls quiet at Adora’s prompting. Adora continues her story. “Once upon a time, there was a beast who fell in love with a beautiful Princess. At first, they were bitter enemies, their lands plagued by war. The beast one day captured the Princess and took her to their scary castle and Kingdom. The Princess became curious about the beast, and decided to… talk to them.” This was definitely the PG version of their story.

“By talking to the beast, the Princess discovered that the beast wasn’t really a beast after all.” Catra interrupts, taking over from where Adora had left off. “They were just a person, like her. They started talking more, and getting to know each other, and they both fell in love.” Catra says, looking at Adora with love in her eyes. Adora can read it so clearly now, she can’t believe she didn’t notice before.

“The beast surrendered and ended the war for their love,” Adora says. “And slowly, over the time of them being together, the beast became less beastly.” Catra shakes her head a little but she kisses Adora on her cheek. “And together, they made a beautiful baby and lived happily ever after.” Adora is aware that there are a few more bumps in their journey - particularly in relation to Catra’s moms - but Adora had no doubt that they had their happy ending.

“I love you, dork.” Catra says and Adora grins.

“I love you too, Kitten.” Adora says.

“Gods, I remember when I hated you calling me that.” Catra says. Adora laughs quietly as she picks Finn up very carefully and transfers them into their cot. She comes back to their bed, lying down beside Catra.

“That’s why I kept calling you it,” Adora admits. “At first, it was just to annoy you, and then you seemed to really enjoy it, and didn't mind when I called you that in the bedroom.”

“There’s something about you calling me Kitten when you’re between my thighs, yes.” Catra admits, pushing Adora’s shoulder so she falls back on their bed. Catra climbs on top of her and Adora’s eyebrow goes up in question. “You use it less now.”

“Because… I don’t need to annoy you.” Adora shrugs. “You kiss me now without me annoying you into it.”

“You would annoy me to get me to kiss you?” Catra questions, raising an eyebrow. Adora nods slowly.

“Worked every time.”

“Your arrogance was highly annoying.”

“You still kissed me.” Adora says, grinning up at Catra. Catra huffs at her before she grabs Adora gently by her chin.

“I kissed you because you’re stupidly attractive.” Catra says and Adora smirks lopsidedly.

“Why thank you, my lady.” Adora says. “You’re just as attractive to me.” Adora really had been attracted to Catra from the moment she had seen her - it was almost impossible for her to not be. Catra rolls her eyes fondly. “I have to go to Half-Moon next week.” Adora says. Catra gets a *look* before she sighs and rolls off of Adora.

“Why?” Catra asks.

“Luna asked me to.” Adora admits. “She wanted to do something for me for our wedding, she wouldn’t say more than that.”

“I should go with you.” Catra says with a frown. “I don’t trust that to not be a trap.”

“Luna? Luna wouldn’t do anything to me.” Adora says. She watches as Catra rolls onto her side, her back to Adora, her tail curls around herself and around her ankle. It’s kind of adorable, but Adora also knows it’s what Catra does when she feels sad. “You should go to Bright Moon and ask the Princesses who is actually coming to our wedding,” Adora prompts. “The Snow Princess? The little one? I don’t know if she is. Glimmer is cool now… but I also don’t know if she is. Perfuma is, she pretty much told me so in therapy. The water one? I don’t know. Micah is, so Angella likely is… But it’d be nice to know, you know?” Adora asks gently. Catra huffs.

“Who cares?” Catra asks. “I don’t really feel like a Princess anyway. Whoever shows up, shows up.” Adora raises an eyebrow and then spoons Catra from behind, wrapping her up.

“Catra-”

“ *Fine* .” Catra interrupts. “Don’t give me the speech.”

“I wasn’t going to give you a speech.” Adora says with slight amusement. “Scorpia is my best man.”

“Bow is mine.” Catra responds. Adora smiles a little.

“Okay… Feel like a nap?” Adora asks.

“I’d love a nap.” Slowly, Catra uncurls herself and melts into Adora. They fall asleep spooning on Adora’s bed in the Fright Zone.

* * *

It was weird being in Half-Moon without Catra but Adora also didn't mind it too much. Sure, she was being looked at kind of funny by the Magicats for being there, but, otherwise, she was fine. Adora was with Queen Luna, who had said she wanted to surprise her with something and that something was apparently clothes. They weren't just any clothes though, they were wedding clothes and specifically traditional Magicat wedding clothes. "We had to stitch up the tail hole," Luna says, "and we added a cape, because you seem to like them." Adora smiles a little.

She examines herself in the mirror. She was wearing white, accented by patterns of gold, the colours of She-Ra. They were traditional Magicat robes ,only they were even fancier and more expensive due to their nature of being for a wedding. Her cape had delicate chains of gold attached to each side, holding them in place. Adora liked it a lot, she didn't really have an opinion on this kind of stuff, on clothes, or on hair, most of the time she just chose what she found comfortable - she didn't care about looking pretty - but something about her wedding had her wanting to look good. Her blonde hair had been growing out for a while now and it was long enough that Adora could tie it back into a low ponytail. She looked *good,* and she wasn't mad about it.

Adora turns to Luna and smiles at her. "Thank you for doing this." She says. "I had a talk with C'yra, she seems as though she's coming around."

"One can only hope," Luna says with a sigh. "My wife has a tendency to get defensive when she's called out, and she needs to not do that and have a serious and honest conversation with my daughter." Adora couldn't agree more, but that was easier said than done. "I thought… Since we can't be at your wedding, maybe helping you dress like an actual Magicat bride would be something."

"Catra is too," Adora says. "She was hesitant but then… I convinced her to dress in the robes, with the royal Magicat colours, but she refused to wear her crown which I think is fair." Adora looks at Luna, she looks sad, but she nods anyway.

"This is a mess," Luna says, sitting down on a nearby stool, Adora does the same, sitting close by her. "Things with C'yra are so messy because my wife can't apologise when she's in the wrong. Do you have any idea how difficult it was to stand by her side through all of this?" Adora stays quiet. She understands why Luna did, but she also considers what she

would have done if the roles were switched. If Catra (though she would *never*) had put Finn through what Queen C'yra had put Catra through, Adora isn't sure she would have stayed with her but, then again, Adora may experience their bond as mates, but it isn't as intense as Catra or another Magicat. They're bonded by their souls and, while Adora can go into grieving, it is unlikely to ever kill her like it could for a Magicat. Luna leaving C'yra, her mate, would be excruciatingly painful for them both, but maybe C'yra needed that wake up call.

"You should come to the wedding." Adora says suddenly. Luna gives her a *look* , her green eyes sparkling a little in the light. Adora admits, everyone in Catra's family are extremely pretty, but Luna has more laugh lines than C'yra, she seems softer in her expression as she is as a person. "Just you," Adora says, "I don't think Catra would like C'yra being there." Well, Adora isn't sure if she's honest. She knows that Catra wants her moms at her wedding, and Catra is far more open to having Luna around than she is to having C'yra around, Adora thinks that maybe Catra would regret not having at least one of her moms there.

"I actually think Queen Anegella volunteered to marry us, you know, as a Queen or whatever." Adora says. Luna's face falls a little. Adora knows that if this wedding was a real traditional Magicat wedding, it would be one of the Queens of Half-Moon that would have wed them - since Catra is a Princess, it's only right she's married by a Queen.

"I'm not sure C'yra would want me there, Adora, but thank you for inviting me." Luna says, placing her hand on Adora's knee. Adora stays quiet for a moment.

"You're wrong," Adora says, "Catra wants you there more than anything, she just doesn't want to admit that she wants you there, but of course she does! Everyone wants their parents to be at their wedding, she just wants at least one of you guys to accept her marriage. You should come." Adora repeats. Luna looks hesitant.

"I'll consider it." She says finally and, well, that was good enough for Adora. "You do look rather dashing in that, I have to admit." Adora beams.

"Why thank you," Adora responds, adjusting the cape on her shoulders. "I think Catra is going to love it, thank you for doing this. Catra deserves the closest thing to a normal wedding I can give her. If this is what I would have traditionally worn, then I am more than happy to wear it."

“You’re a good wife,” Luna says suddenly, “I can tell that you care about my daughter more than anything… You’ll take care of her for as long as you’re married.”

“I will.” Adora says. “It’s funny, for someone who doesn’t even know what marriage really is, I’m excited and looking forward to getting to marry Catra once and for all. Till death do us part.” Adora liked the idea of Catra being hers forever, and of her being Catra’s forever too. She was more than willing to promise herself wholly and faithfully to Catra and, she thinks, she has been for a while.

Luna smiles softly at her. “I’m glad,” She says, “my daughter seems to have found a woman that cares deeply about her, and who loves her above all else, I could ask for nothing more.” Adora nods her head. When Adora leaves, she has her Magicat wedding robes and the blessing of at least one of the Magicat Queen’s who she also invited to their wedding. Like nothing could go wrong there… *Right?*

* * *

When they arrive in Bright Moon, Catra is carrying Finn, which turns out to be a good thing because Frosta comes launching out of nowhere and punches Adora right in her jaw with an ice fist. “Ow!” Adora yells. “What the hell?!” Catra has to resist the urge to laugh at the scene and instead steps in front of Frosta.

“Frosta!” Catra scolds. “Why would you do that?”

“She ruined Princess Prom!” Frosta yells. “And I never got to get my own back. Consider that payback, Horde Scum.” Catra sighs. Frosta had been busy in her Kingdom, which meant she hadn’t been around a lot during Adora’s probation period in helping rebuild Bright Moon. Catra turns to look at her fiancee who was slowly pushing herself back up to her feet.

“Adora has been fulfilling her punishment, you can’t just punch her out of the blue for old grievances.” Catra doesn’t hold it too much against the Princess. Frosta is just a kid, and she’s angry, but, still, she can’t just punch Adora for mistakes she’s been making up for. Catra sighs and hands Finn over to Adora who takes them with a grumble. Her cheek was a little

red, but she'd probably be okay. Catra crouches in front of Frosta. "I know you're angry and upset, but Adora is on our side, okay?" Frosta frowns, glaring at Adora. "Trust me."

"Queen C'yra said you can't be trusted when it comes to Lord Adora." Frosta responds. Catra's face falls a little at the mention of her mother. "She said you betrayed us. And *she* ," Frosta points at Adora, "nearly destroyed my castle!"

"I know," Adora says. "And I'm sorry." Frosta looks surprised by that. "I realise that I never apologised to you for the trouble I caused at Princess Prom, I really am sorry, if you require my assistance in repairing the damage, I can help." Catra smiles proudly at her fiancee before she looks back at Frosta.

"See?" Catra asks, raising her eyebrows. Frosta still seems hesitant but then she huffs and nods.

"Fine," She says. "I guess that's okay. I managed to repair the damage myself with my runestone."

"Your powers are very impressive." Adora comments. Frosta's tough guy act drops immediately at Adora's words and her child-like excitement replaces it instead. Catra laughs softly, standing back up to her feet.

"Can I see She-Ra?" She asks excitedly. "I heard she's really cool!"

"Uh… Maybe later kiddo." Adora replies, gesturing to Finn as her excuse.

"Frosta, why don't you go ahead, okay? We're all meeting in the War Room in a few." Catra encourages.

"'Kay!" Frosta yells excitedly before she runs off into the castle. Catra turns to Adora and walks up to her, kissing her gently on her cheek where she was punched.

“You okay, Love?” Catra asks, trying not to laugh.

“If she wasn’t a child, I would have punched her back.” Adora mumbles grumpily. Catra snorts a little.

“Hold still, my mom taught me a few healing spells.” Catra says as she lifts her hand. Healing magic is not her speciality, and she’s kind of bad at it, but she can at least soothe a bruised cheek. Adora had done well not to lose her temper, in fact, she rarely did lose her temper anymore - only when it came to Catra’s or Finn’s safety. Catra presses her palm to the side of Adora’s face and whispers the spell. She watches as the angry red fades back to Adora’s regular skin tone. “Come on, let's get this meeting over with.” Adora wanted to know who exactly was going to be attending their wedding, which Catra didn’t see the point in going all the way to Bright Moon to find out, but here they were.

They enter Bright Moon’s castle. If Catra is honest, she has kind of missed this place, she didn’t really realise that the Fright Zone felt so different until she was back here. They make their way to the War Room, all the Princesses were there, apart from Catra’s moms, she had made sure not to invite them and pick a day they were not visiting so she wouldn’t have to see them. They take their seats and the Rebellion all turn to look at her curiously. Catra clears her throat. “So, as you know, Adora and I are getting married soon. We came to see who of the Princesses would be attending?” Catra asks.

“Well I’m definitely coming,” Micah says, “I wouldn’t miss it for the world.” He grins happily and Angella beside him chuckles.

“I suppose I’m his plus one.” Queen Angella comments. “And I did agree to marry you both.”

“I’ll be there!” Perfuma says happily.

“Are kids allowed?” Frosta asks. Catra laughs a little.

“Finn will be there, so yes.” Catra answers.

“Then count me in.” Frosta says.

“Fine,” Mermista groans. “I guess I could go, Sea Hawk can be my ride.” Catra is pretty sure ‘ride’ is code for date but she chooses not to comment on that.

“I know I have been absent from many meetings,” Entrapta pipes up, “but I would very much like to check out the Fright Zone. I will attend your wedding.”

“You know I’m in.” Bow says, nodding at Catra with a smile.

“Us too.” Spinnerella and Netossa say. Catra smiles at them. They had supported her this entire time, Catra hadn’t really doubted that they would come.

“Is your wedding in the Fright Zone?” Queen Angella questions.

“Kind of,” Catra answers, “we decided to have the ceremony just outside the Fright Zone and then the reception will be in the old Scorpion Kingdom’s Horror Hall, it’s been reconstructed and it’s really… pretty. It’s perfect.” Queen Angella nods in understanding. That just left one other person. Catra looks at her.

Glimmer was staring at the table instead of at Catra. She slowly looks up. “Before I answer,” She says. “I have something to show you, Bow and I do.” Glimmer stands up. “Give Finn to Spinnerella and Netossa for now.” Catra glances at Adora who frowns before she does as Glimmer instructed her to do, handing their baby over to Spinnerella and Netossa. Glimmer stands and then teleports all four of them outside of Bright Moon castle.

“Glimmer-” Catra begins, but she’s cut off by Adora gasping and grabbing her by her arm.

“What. Is. *That* ?!” Adora asks, pointing at something. Catra follows the direction of her finger to see a horse, not just any horde, but one of the finest Bright Moon royal horses, standing there.

“That’s a horse, Adora.” Catra answers, laughing a little at Adora’s reaction. Sometimes Adora is the cutest person alive for a person who’s goal had once been to conquer the planet.

“It’s *majestic* .” She says in amazement.

“It’s yours.” Bow says.

“Well, it was supposed to only be for the wedding for you to ride in on,” Glimmer says. “But you can keep him, he’s yours, consider it a wedding gift.” Adora’s eyes widen. Catra has to admit, she likes how happy this has made Adora.

“You wanna meet him?” Bow asks.

“What? Yes! No! I don’t… what do I say?” Adora asks. Catra can hardly believe Adora’s reaction. She’s never seen her like this before - not even flirting with Catra got her acting this way. Bow grabs her wrist gently.

“Come on,” He says, pulling Adora towards the horse. Adora protests a little but as soon as her hand is placed on the horse’s snout she gasps and her eyes become wide and sparkly.

“This… is… the… best… day… of… my… *life* .” Adora says, a little breathlessly.

“Save something for our wedding day, babe.” Catra says with amusement. She watches as Adora pets the horse and eventually Bow helps her climb onto his back to ride a few laps on him. Catra watches with so much love in her heart at Adora’s excitement.

“I’m coming,” Glimmer says suddenly. Catra glances sideways at her, her tail swishing back and forth behind her. “I’d… I’d really like to be best friends again.” Catra looks out at Adora riding a horse, at Bow laughing at her, Glimmer was part of the reason Adora was so happy right now, and she *had* apologised.

“Me too.” Catra admits, her tail brushing Glimmer’s hand. Glimmer smiles a little. “It’ll take some time for us to really get there,” Catra says, “but I would like to *try* .” Catra’s voice breaks a little. Catra misses her best friend after all. There was a time when they were promised to each other in *marriage* , Princess stuff, but they’d always just been friends, best friends, since they were babies, Catra missed her, of course she missed her. Glimmer takes her hand and squeezes it.

“We’re the best friend squad,” Glimmer says, her eyes shining. “Ain’t nothing we can’t do together.” Catra laughs, wiping her tears as Glimmer does the same.

“Gods, Bow is the best.” Catra comments.

“He really is.” Glimmer agrees. “I love him, a lot. We talked it out, we’re okay now.”

“I’m glad,” Catra admits. “You two have been so disgustingly in love for so long it was hard to be around you two sometimes.” Glimmer bumps her shoulder against Catra’s playfully. They fall silent as they both watch their significant others in front of them. “I’m going to ask Bow to be my best man, I hope you don’t mind?”

“He deserves it.” Is all Glimmer really has to say, because Bow does deserve it.

“I’ve honestly never seen Adora react that way before.” Catra admits. “Who knew the big bad Horde Lord was a horse girl?” Glimmer laughs.

“Wow… I can’t believe we spent so long fighting a girl who loves horses and calls them *majestic* .” Glimmer jokes and Catra grins. It is kind of funny when she thinks about it. “Adora is *nothing* like how we thought she was.”

“No,” Catra says, watching her future spouse on a horse. “She’s not.” After that, Catra asks Bow to be her best man and he cries. Adora doesn’t stop talking about horses their entire trip home, but Catra knows now that the Princesses all accept her marriage to Lord Adora. All of them were coming to her wedding. Too bad about her moms.

* * *

Catra stares at herself in the mirror. She never thought that she would have the chance to walk down the aisle and to marry the woman that she loved. She never thought that her kitten, despite how small they were, would get to be the ring bearer at her wedding (with the help of Bow, of course). She sighs softly, fixing a strand of hair that had gotten out of place. She was wearing the traditional colours of Magicat royalty, red, and other earthly warm tones, while she waited for Spinnerella to come and get her.

It was a well-sized ceremony, closer to the Fright Zone with many of the attendees being the former soldiers of the Fright Zone who had become her and Adora's family as well as the Princesses who had come around. She was grateful knowing that they were there supporting their union and happiness. She just wished that... Catra shakes her head. She couldn't allow negative thoughts to ruin her special day, she had to be positive.

Someone, who Catra assumes is Spinnerella, knocks gently on the door before she enters. She pauses as soon as she enters. "Oh... You look beautiful, Catra." She says softly. "You haven't seen Adora, right?"

"Thank you, Spinny. And no, I haven't. Though, she did try to come in here earlier." Catra laughs softly, thankful for the distraction. She really did miss Adora, she hadn’t seen her for about twenty four hours. Catra was starting to think this tradition was less about the no sex and more about being sure that when you see your life partner standing there, waiting for you, that you feel nothing but joy at being reunited with them after missing them for so long. "How is she doing?" Catra asks.

"Nervous, but a good nervous. I think it'd be weird if she wasn't nervous at all." Spinnerella answers as she steps further into the room. "She also looks very... dashing. I think you'll be pleased. But how are you doing?"

"I'm okay, happy to get to marry Adora." Catra smiles at her reflection but saddens a bit. "I just wish that..."

"You wish that...?"

"Nothing, it'll just ruin the happy mood if I bring it up." Catra dismisses.

"Better to let it out now," Spinnerella says. "Trust me, you're going to be pretty emotional shortly, better to let anything that's bothering you now, out." Catra sighs. Spinnerella is probably right, bottling up emotions is never a good idea.

"I just... wished this day could be a little different, you know?"

"Different how?" Spinnerella asks gently.

"I wish my moms…" Catra sighs sadly. "I wish they would be here on my special day, but... yeah."

"Then... You might really have a surprise waiting for you." Spinnerella says cryptically. Catra raises an eyebrow.

"What?" Catra turns around to face Spinnerella, looking at her confused. "What do you mean?"

"Well..." Spinnerella turns to the door and sighs. "You can come in." She says. The door opens slowly and then *Luna* pops into frame, coming inside of the room to see her daughter dressed for her wedding.

"Oh my... Kitten.. You look..." Luna smiles at her daughter, her eyes glassy with tears. "You look *perfect* ." Catra's eyes widen before watering as she looks at her mom in shock.

"You're here. You're really here." She whispers, trying to wrap her head around it. "Thank you..." She beams at her mom, holding out her hands to her. "You're here..." Catra knows she's repeating herself, but she really can't believe it. She needs to *feel* her mom to know she's actually standing in front of her and Catra isn't imagining this.

"I wouldn't miss this for the world." Luna says, taking Catra's hands and squeezing them gently. *She's real.* "Wow, you're really... Adora is very lucky." Luna says softly, her eyes watering a little. "You're all grown up."

"I'm really lucky too, I get to marry the woman I love. My kitten gets to be part of the wedding, and at least you're here too." Catra says, purring a little. She hadn't said it to Adora, but it was really upsetting to her at the thought of neither of her moms being present at her wedding.

Luna smiles sadly. "C'yra would be here too but... I don't think she wanted to ruin your day." Luna replies. Catra's smile drops a little before she shakes her head.

"It's fine, She... She wouldn't have been happy for me anyway, or she would have tried to attack Adora during the ceremony. Who knows?"

"I think she's done with that now," Luna says. "We talked. Or, well, I yelled at her and she listened, for once." Luna lifts her hands up to Catra's face and cups it gently. She was shorter than Catra, so she had to tilt her head down to make her look at her. "I don't know if you know this, but a royal Magicat must give you away for your marriage to be valid in Half-Moon. C'yra would have done it, but she wouldn't come without your permission, so I came."

"She wouldn't have done it, even *with* my permission." Catra murmurs. It's hard for her to believe C'yra will ever be accepting of her marriage to Adora, but she appreciates at least that Luna is present - it means their marriage will be legitimate *everywhere* . "But really, thank you for being here. Just knowing you're here to support me on my special day makes me happy."

"Yes, well, I already saw Adora and she gave me a hug." Luna says, releasing Catra's face. Catra smiles at that. Adora has become so affectionate, even with strangers, she's always had

a big heart and now she finally gets to express it as much as she pleases. "She's gotten... stronger." Catra knows Luna means Adora's muscles and Catra has to agree.

"She has. The Fright Zone got the farm back up and running again." Catra smiles and purrs. They did it a while ago, but they hadn't used it when they had been in Bright Moon and Half-Moon post Adora's trial (for the most part). "Plus she's been eating real food and exercising again too." All the muscle mass that Adora had lost after Catra had almost died had come back and then some.

Luna smiles softly at Catra. "Are you ready?" She asks.

"More ready than I've ever been." Catra closes her eyes. "Adora is my soulmate, I've known this for quite a while now. She makes me happy, and she loves me, I love her too."

"I know." Luna says, offering her elbow. "I've known since she came willingly to help you that one time." Too bad C'yra didn't look at it like Luna did. "I trust Adora to look after you." Luna admits. "To care for you, in all the ways that marriage means. In sickness and in health, all of that."

"And she *has* , even before marriage. Even before we knew that we had feelings. She took care of me when we were together." Catra smiles and sighs. "I'm really relieved to hear that you approve, mom."

"I even like her." Luna says. "She's had a rough life, but she's still... I'm not even sure what she is. There's something about her, and I'll be happy to call her my daughter-in-law."

"She has a heart of gold. But she hadn't been allowed to show it, she's learning." Catra responds. Adora has always just been *good* , even as the Lord of the Horde, she has a giant heart - and she's the biggest dork Catra has ever met.

"Will you let me walk you down the aisle?" Luna asks. Catra's eyes water again and she nods.

"Please... Please do." Catra says, her lip wobbling. Luna smiles and turns to Spinnerella.

"Is Adora ready?"

"If she went when I told her to, then she should be waiting." Spinnerella answers.

"Okay, and you're ready?" Luna asks Catra. "Because I'll support you, no matter what." Catra sniffles and hugs Luna tightly, laughing a little. She knows that if she wanted to (and she really doesn't) Luna would help her run away, but she's going to walk her down the aisle to the person that Catra was going to spend the rest of her life with.

"Thank you, for being here, for offering to walk me down the aisle, for keeping your promise that you'd be there for me. Thank you." Catra says, she can't help but purr she's that happy.

"Of course, Little One. Though, I suppose, you're not so little anymore." Luna says quietly as she nuzzles her daughter and hugs her back.

"I'll always be your little one, mom." Catra relaxes in her mom's arms, trying to keep herself from crying. She didn't want to look like a *total* mess before she reached Adora, and it was true, she would always be her mom's Little One, just like Finn would always be her Little One. "I missed this." Catra admits as she hugs her mom. Luna lets out a deep sigh, both of them purring at each other.

"Me too..." She says. "And, yes, you will always be my Little One, even if you're taller than me and have been since your teen years." Catra laughs a little. "I know things have been hard, especially for you, but hopefully things will start to get better now."

"I hope so, I want things to be good for Finn, that's all I want. I don't want Finn to have to go through any glimpse of what I did."

"They won't." Luna says firmly. "I've seen Adora with them, and I've seen you with them, they'll be the happiest and most cared for kitten on Etheria."

"Not from us." Catra clarifies. "From... everyone else." Luna sighs.

"I think... I think people will see the truth. Adora has been helping, she's doing better." Luna says. In fact, people *are* seeing the truth, the Princesses are proof enough, but given the stigma that arose around Adora and their relationship, Catra still worries there are people out there who may wish to harm her wife and child.

"I know she is. But will people admit that to themselves? That Adora could be a good person and give her a chance? Because C'yra sure didn't."

"I don't know C'yra," Luna admits. "I guess, only time will tell. Adora is helping, she's been going to therapy, she attends Princess meetings, even if she does nap in the corner with Finn, everyone can see that she's trying. She's kept her word and she's helping to rebuild. People will see that she's a good person, it'll be hard for them to deny." Catra presses her lips together.

"I guess I'm afraid to keep my expectations high because a lot of things didn't come out how I expected. It'll hurt less that way." Catra has no hopes that her mom, or people who don't bother to get to know Adora, will accept her. Hoping for that can only end in heartbreak.

"That's... One way to do it." Luna says. "But Adora will technically be... Well, she'll be like me, married to a royal Magicat, Queen one day with you. And she's She-Ra, if she keeps doing what she's doing, I have faith."

"Thanks, mom. I'm happy someone has faith in other people. Because I really don't."

"Which is understandable given what you went through." Luna says as she walks towards the door with Catra. She sighs. "Adora is so much more than the Horde Lord, and people need to stop seeing her as that, especially when she gave Scorpia her kingdom back."

"I know, but people refuse to, and they'll continue to do so even more if the people who are leading them can't even do that. You think the people of Half-Moon, my own people, will

accept Adora when their own Queen doesn’t?" Catra asks.

"I love seeing Adora with Finn, she loves that baby so much." Luna says with a smile. "Maybe people just need to see her like that?"

"Maybe." Catra sighs. "I'm hoping for the best, but it's hard to hope after everything." She shakes her head. "But this conversation is best saved for another day."

"You're right, only happy thoughts right now." Luna says as they walk to just before where the aisle starts. Catra hears the music begin to play that signals her entrance. "Ready?" Luna asks.

"Always." Catra purrs and simply glows as her mom guides her to where the ceremony was being held, making sure Adora didn't see her. She could hardly contain herself.

"Okay." Luna says, Catra could hear the emotions in her voice and Catra was hoping, just as her mom probably hoped, that her tears would stay put until they made it down the aisle. "Here we go." Luna steps out with Catra, walking her down the aisle and towards Adora.

The music begins to play as soon as Catra sets foot onto the carpet that they had rolled out for the ceremony. She grips the bouquet of flowers that were in her hand, a large smile on her face as she meets Adora's eyes. Her cheeks become flush as she sees how the blonde looks at her as she walks towards her, heart fluttering in her chest.

This was the beginning of the rest of her life.

* * *

Adora's head turns immediately when she hears the music begin to play to see Catra walking down the aisle. Adora couldn't believe it. Catra looked *stunning* and, pretty soon, she was going to get to call her her wife. They stop for a moment as Queen Angella asks who was

giving Catra away. "Queen Luna of Half-Moon." Luna answers as she deposits Catra at the end. Adora smiles at Luna and Luna gives her a quick hug before she takes a seat.

Now that they were, well, not alone but no one could hear them - except for those that were closest - Adora chooses to speak quietly to Catra. "You look... *incredible* ."

"So do you," Catra breathes, taking Adora's hands in her own as Angella instructed her to do. "Wow… Magicat clothes really suit you."

"You think so?" Adora asks with a wide smile. "I even got a cape, the fanciest cape I've ever seen."

"It looks really good on you, my love." Catra grins back at her, looking at Adora with eyes that were filled with nothing but love.

"I can't wait for our honeymoon." Adora confesses. Catra giggles.

"That's your focus?"

"Absolutely." Adora says, nodding. "Spinnerella and Netossa have Finn, we're alone, just married... I'm *very* excited."

"Me too." Catra finally admits, despite her gentle teasing earlier. "I'm excited to spend time with you." Adora smiles happily and she squeezes Catra's hands. She goes to kiss her but she's stopped by Queen Angella.

"Whoa, not so fast there, Lord Adora. That'll come after you've said your vows." Catra laughs.

"She got a little eager." She says playfully, making everyone present laugh. "You were saying?" She encourages Angella to continue. Adora pouts but leans back anyway - she'd get

to kiss Catra soon enough.

"I was welcoming everyone." Angella says. "We've come to witness the love between Catra and Adora on this day, and nothing can be stronger, or more right, than the bond between two people who love each other." She says. "Adora, would you like to give your vows first?" Adora looks at Catra and then nods.

"Catra, I have loved you since before I even really knew what that word meant. You have believed in me, you've never given up on me, even at my worst," Adora smiles softly as she gazes into Catra's eyes. "I love you so much, and I will spend the rest of my life loving you, caring for you, being with you. You're... *everything* to me. I never want to lose you, ever again. So I promise, I will always love you, and be here for you, no matter what." Adora smiles, her words coming directly from her heart. She loves Catra so *so* much.

"Catra?"

Catra takes a deep breath, composing herself, before she starts speaking her vows. "You're my soulmate, Adora. I know I've said it before. At one point in my life, I thought that I would never find you, that I would never get the chance to marry for love. But I found love in the most unlikely of places." She squeezes Adora's hands gently and Adora feels her heart squeeze in her chest at the same time. "I can't imagine a life without you, Adora. I want you to know that you're my everything, and that I want to live everyday by your side, getting to love you, getting to hold you and kiss you and just exist with you. This is my promise to you. I'll always make sure that you never forget that you have my heart wholly. That I'll be here for you for as long as you'll have me, no matter what happens." Adora feels her heart swell, she doesn't think she's ever felt so loved in her entire life. She feels exactly the same way.

"Can I kiss her now?" Adora asks hopefully, reluctantly looking away from Catra to look at Queen Angella. The people present laugh a little.

"Not yet. The rings?" She asks. Bow steps forward with Finn in his arms and the rings.

"Right here." He says happily as he hands the rings to both Catra and Adora. Adora gives Finn a little kiss on top of their head, and Catra purrs as she sees Finn, giving the kit a little nuzzle, before Bow moves away again.

"Adora." Queen Angella gestures.

Adora lifts Catra's hand and, as she slips the ring onto her finger, she speaks. "This ring is a symbol of my undying love for you. Never-ending love. Forever and always. Till death do us part." Adora pauses for a moment. "Though, I think even beyond death. Wherever I end up, I want it to be with you."

Catra waits for her turn, grabbing hold of the ring, slipping it onto Adora's finger. "This ring is a symbol of the love that grew into an unbreakable bond. As you said, it is never-ending, and I'll love you always. It represents our union and our trust. Whatever happens from here on out, we're in it together." Adora smiles so wide her face almost hurts when the ring is slipped onto her finger.

"And with the power vested in me, as Queen of Bright Moon, I now pronounce you wife and wife. You may now ki-" Angella doesn't even finish her sentence before Adora leans forward to crash her lips against Catra's like she'd been wanting to do since she set eyes on her. Adora can feel Catra smiling into the kiss, telling her that she was just as happy to be kissing Adora as Adora was to be kissing Catra.

"I love you... my wife." Catra whispers and Adora shivers at the fact she was officially Catra's *wife* . Adora smiles as she pecks Catra on the lips in quick succession, holding her face in her hands as people cheered for them.

"I love you too." Adora says. "I can't believe I'm someone's wife... I can't believe *you're* my wife!"

"I can hardly believe it either, Love." Catra whispers, hugging Adora close. "We did it, we're married."

"We're married!" Adora says excitedly. "Wow... We're married."

"We are. How are you feeling?"

"Happy." Adora says with a smile. "I'm married to the woman I love." Catra purrs and rests her forehead against Adora's forehead.

"It's official." Catra says quietly. "Remember when you used to be so against me calling you mine?" Adora laughs a little as she kisses Catra again.

"I was scared of what that meant." Adora admits. "But now, nothing makes me happier than to know I am wholly and completely yours." Catra falls into Adora's arms with a happy purr, completely relaxed.

"Good... Just making sure you haven't changed your mind." She whispers playfully.

"And you're mine. Forever now."

"Yeah, forever and always. Now, I believe it's time to start the reception?"

"Yes," Adora says, turning to Bow to take Finn back. Adora turns back to Catra and offers her free hand. "Lead the way?"

* * *

Adora feels *great* . As it turns out, the wedding reception was actually a huge *party* . Adora had never really been to one, but if they were all like this, she could get on board with those. Sure, she had crashed Princess Prom, but that was nothing like this. Adora was sufficiently *buzzed* . At some point she had gotten into a drinking contest with a pirate that was the water Princess' Not Date and Glimmer had been sliding Adora drinks all night - part of Adora suspected it was because it made her tongue a lot looser than usual.

This only became a problem when the first dance was announced. Adora had almost tripped over her own feet. No one had bothered to tell her that there would be a first dance. Luckily, Catra was prepared for this and currently they were slow dancing in the middle of the empty dance floor, Catra had her arms around Adora's waist, holding her up, while Adora had her

arms around Catra's shoulders. They weren't so much dancing as they were occasionally swaying to the gentle music. Adora felt warm, both from Catra and the amount of alcohol she had consumed.

"Adora… You're so drunk." Catra says. Adora laughs and snorts.

"Nooo…" Adora says, her words kind of slur together as she speaks. "I'm not drunk."

"You're drunk." Catra repeats with a laugh. "There's no way we can have sex when you're this drunk."

" *What* ?!" Adora asks in alarm. Catra shakes her head in amusement. "Why not?"

"Because a) consent and b) I'm not convinced you won't throw up." Catra says lightly. Adora is a little disappointed, but Catra's probably right. "In fact, are you ready to call it a night?" Catra asks. Adora nods. She's had her fill of alcohol, food and dancing. Now she just wants to go to bed with her *wife* .

Once their dance is over, they bow to the cheering and clapping crowd and then they make their way over to Spinnerella and Netossa. Spinnerella was already holding Finn in her arms. "Bye my little baby," Adora says, full of fondness as she takes Finn into her arms. She gives them a sloppy kiss on their forehead and then Catra takes them. Catra is a lot quieter with her affection - probably because she isn't drunk and the room isn't spinning to her.

Catra presses her head gently to Finn's and purrs. Sometimes Adora is jealous of their ability to communicate using only sound, but Finn and Catra purr plenty enough at her - she just can't return it. Catra kisses them and then hands them tentatively back to Spinnerella. "It's just a week." Catra reminds them. "We'll miss them."

"Don't worry, we have everything we need to look after them." Spinnerella reassures. "Enjoy your honeymoon with your wife."

“I just hope blondie there will be able to remember she even married you.” Netossa comments, an amused smirk on her face. Catra laughs and looks behind her at Adora who beams at her happily. That’s her *wife* . Adora couldn’t be happier.

“Me too,” Catra says, standing up on her tiptoes to kiss Adora on her cheek. Adora’s eyes close at the soft affection and she wraps her arms around Catra, causing her to squeak. “You sure are handsy and clingy when you’re drunk, Adora.”

“You’re a very pretty kitty.” Adora murmurs. Catra’s cheeks practically set on fire, they’re that red. Adora hears Netossa suppress a laugh under her breath.

“Stay here, dummy, I’m going to go say goodbye to the others and then I’m taking you to bed.” Catra says.

“Oh yeah?” Adora asks, smirking.

“Not like *that* .” Catra deadpans. “Gods, handsy, clingy *and* horny.”

“You can’t blame her,” Netossa says. “She’s never been drunk in her life before.” Catra laughs a little.

“Look after her for a moment.” Catra says. She disappears to go say goodbye to their friends for the both of them. Adora stands and waits for her return, talking idly with both Spinnerella and Netossa about nothing and everything all at once.

When Catra gets back, Adora smiles at her. “You look like my wife.” Adora comments and Catra rolls her eyes.

“I *am* your wife, dummy.” Catra says, grabbing her by her arm to keep her upright and steady. Catra says goodnight to Spinnerella and Netossa again and then they leave Horror Hall. The reconstruction job had been pretty significant and they had restored some of the Fright Zone back to the old architecture of the Scorpion Kingdom.

It’s a short walk back to their room and when they get inside, bypassing Adora’s old throne, Catra deposits Adora down onto their bed. “I’m hot.” Adora complains as Catra disappears into the bathroom. She returns a moment later with a glass of water and hands it to Adora.

“Drink it. All of it.” Catra orders. Adora isn’t about to refuse her wife’s order. She downs the water quickly, feeling refreshed by the coolness. Next thing Adora knows is that Catra is stripping her clothes off of her - not that Adora minds.

“I thought we weren’t going to have sex?” Adora asks with a smirk.

“We’re not.” Catra responds. “But you need to get out of your clothes so we can sleep.”

“Boo.” Adora pouts and Catra lightly hits her upside her head. Adora grumbles as she sets her glass of water to one side. She stands to help Catra undress her and once she’s in her underwear, no bra, or anything else but her boxers, Adora collapses back on the bed. She hears Catra giggling behind her.

“You’re such a dork, I can’t believe I married you.” Adora hears Catra say. Catra picks the empty glass back up and comes back with another full one. “Drink this. You’ll thank me in the morning.” Adora does as she’s told and downs the water. Catra disappears again and returns with another glass of water but this time she places it down on the nightstand. Adora watches as Catra undresses. Truthfully, she’s kind of exhausted, and there’s always the morning for them to have some fun.

When Catra slips into their bed, she’s naked and Adora shuffles forward to wrap her up in her arms. She buries her nose in her neck and kisses her there. “My wife.” Adora mumbles. She can feel Catra purring in response to her. Sure, they could have been having sex right now, but there is something infinitely more intimate about them being naked and being pressed up against each other instead. “I love you.”

“I love you too, Adora.” Catra replies quietly. “Now go to sleep. We have tomorrow.”

“And the rest of our lives.”

“And the rest of our lives.” Catra confirms. Adora smiles as she slips into unconsciousness.

* * *

When Adora wakes up, she feels *wrecked* . She groans as she lifts her head up. She grabs the water from the dresser and downs it. Once she’s downed the water, she sets the empty glass back down. She turns to where Catra was lying as she runs her fingers through her hair, pulling her ponytail out. “Morning Princess.” Catra says with a grin, her tail twitching back and forth behind her. Adora wonders how long Catra has been awake, and if she’s been watching her sleep.

“That’s not funny.” Adora deadpans, sitting up and turning over onto her back so she can face Catra.

“It’s technically true since you married a Princess,” Catra says, taking Adora’s hand in her own and lifting it up to kiss her ring. “Plus, I’m pretty sure She-Ra is a Princess, per your invitation to *Princess* Prom.”

“Shut up.” Adora grumbles shoving Catra playfully so she falls back in the bed. Adora sighs, sitting up a little, propping her pillow up so she could lean her head against it comfortably. “Did you undress me?” Adora questions, noticing she was naked.

“I helped you undress last night and you kicked your underwear off in your sleep.” Catra says casually, examining her nails. “Get your strap.” Catra orders. Adora blinks.

“What?” Adora asks, she isn’t fully sure she heard Catra correctly.

“I didn’t get to be with you last night because you got so unbelievably drunk, so put your strap on.” Catra says, pointing at Adora’s sword which sat propped up against her nightstand.

Adora stares for a moment more before she grabs the hilt of her sword, transforming her sword into her desired object.

Adora pulls the harness up her legs and fastens it in place. She looks at Catra. She looks almost *bored* as she waits for Adora. *Why is that a turn on* ? “Do you want to be on top?” Adora asks.

“Adora,” Catra says, dropping her hand as she turns over, climbing onto Adora and straddling her hips. “I think we both know that I’m always on top now.” Adora goes to protest that but it’s too late, Catra is kissing her the next second. "Warm me up, Princess."

"That is *not* becoming a thing." Adora says as she moves her hand down Catra's body. Catra just smirks into the kiss that she plants on Adora's lips next. Adora decides to take her time, moving her hand down to Catra's ass and squeezing. She leans up to kiss Catra on her neck and then uses her free hand to fondle her breast. Catra’s breathing gets quicker and she practically *melts* on top of Adora. Adora smirks against Catra’s skin. She loved seeing Catra react this way to her, it *never* got old.

Adora bites Catra’s skin, leaving bruises and marks in her wake. Catra shudders. "Touch me, Adora." Catra says firmly. " *Now* ." Adora chuckles a little and moves her hand that was gripping Catra’s ass around her hip and down. Part of Adora wants to be there with her mouth, but Catra seems as though she has plans to ride her strap - this is just preparing her for such a thing.

Adora touches her clit first, two fingers pressed against the sensitive bundle of nerves. Catra's reaction is almost instantaneous, her claws come out immediately and she arches out of range of Adora’s mouth. " *Right there* ," Catra encourages while moving her hips. Adora focuses on Catra’s clit for a long moment, rubbing her and listening to the wonderful sounds she makes in response to the stimulation.

"Remember that time I made you squirt?" Adora asks. "We should do that again." Adora repositions Catra so she is behind her strap and then she works her fingers inside of her. Adora tries to recall what it was that she did that time and just decides that if she makes Catra cum that'll be a job well done and anything more will just be a bonus.

It takes both of Adora’s hands, she thrusts into her with her fingers, making sure to curl, and *scratch,* and Catra mewls in response, her claws digging into Adora’s shoulders as Adora uses her other hand to rub her clit. "Such a good Kitten," Adora praises. "Aren't you? What was that about you being on top?" Adora questions, smirking. Catra peeks an eye open and looks like she's about to respond when Adora adds a third finger, stretching Catra around her.

Catra continues to feel amazing. Adora’s fingers are *soaked* and she can hear the wetness with each of her strokes. She knows that Catra could easily ride her strap now, but she'd much rather make her cum from this first. "Come on Kitten, I know you want to do it, do it for your Lord." If there is anywhere that Adora enjoys still using her title, it's in bed with Catra. Catra gasps and her hips falter a little in her rapid thrusting.

Adora stops moving her fingers, letting Catra do all the work while she strokes the inside of Catra's walls, massaging them and stimulating her clit. " *Adora*- ! Adora, I'm gonna-"

"Do it." Adora demands. "Do it, Kitten. Cum for your Lord."

" *Holy*- " Catra's words get cut off when she lets out a loud moan. Her body tenses up and Adora watches in amazement as a lot of liquid comes from Catra, coating the base of Adora’s strap as well as the lower half of her body. Mission successful.

Adora stays buried inside of Catra, moving her fingers only ever so slowly until Catra regains consciousness. "Out." Is all she says before Adora pulls her fingers out. She's drenched, but that was totally worth it.

There's a moment where they're both just panting, trying to regain their breaths, before Adora speaks. "Catra…" Adora begins. "Hurt me." Catra looks at her with confusion.

"What?"

"Hurt me," Adora begs, she isn't sure what it is, but she craves it right now. "Punish me."

"With my claws?" Catra asks.

"Anything," Adora says desperately. "Hit me, scratch me, claw me, just *hurt* me. *Please* ." Catra's eyes soften.

"Maybe later, okay?" She says, gently taking Adora's face in her hands. "Right now, I just want you to feel good. We can do that later." Adora swallows before she nods.

Catra takes a moment, seemingly assessing where Adora was, before she adjusts herself. She lowers herself down onto Adora's strap, the juices coating it make it so easy, and Adora lifts her hands to hold onto Catra's hips. She lets Catra set the pace, grinding up into her every now and again. Adora revels in the small sounds Catra makes, she almost enjoys this gentle fucking as much as she had enjoyed their frantic fucking. "Gods… I want to make more babies with you one day." Adora says, Catra laughs.

"Maybe not so soon, but me too, Adora." Catra says. Adora watches in amazement as Catra thrusts herself up and back down onto her strap. The sounds it was making was as arousing as the sensation the strap was creating every time Catra ground down against her. Catra leans forward and takes Adora's face in her hands. "Adora…" She says breathlessly. "I love you."

"I love you too." Adora responds. Catra lets out a moan and she falls forward, her hands gripping Adora's shoulders to give her leverage. Catra doubles her efforts and Adora gasps. She can already feel herself approaching the edge, and she knows Catra was sensitive from their previous session too, it wouldn't be long until they were both cummig.

Sure enough, all it takes is a few more thrusts and the pair of them topple over the edge together. Adora wraps her arms around Catra, holding her close before she rolls over, pulling out of her. Catra whimpers a little before Adora settles back against her. They stay like that for a long moment before Adora kisses Catra on her temple. "How does breakfast sound?" Catra asks. Adora laughs a little.

"Sounds perfect," Adora responds. "You don't want to go another round?" Adora asks.

“We have all day.” Catra says. “Besides, I have a surprise for you.” Adora raises an eyebrow and Catra smirks. “You have to do a little prepping though.” Adora was intrigued now, but excited. Breakfast would be interesting.

* * *

Adora was standing near her throne, examining the old posters of herself that had been torn down, per her own orders, and put in here. She remembers posing for them, but what catches her attention the most is the poster that Catra had drawn on. She picks it up, seeing the word ‘dork’ across her forehead, her frown made into a smile and 'property of Catra' across her body. She flips the poster over just out of mild curiosity and sees more writing on the back. In the corner, in small handwriting, are the words 'I love you'. Adora's eyes widen. She hears the main doors of the throne room close, but she doesn't immediately turn. "Catra… You wrote `I love you' on the back of my poster?" Adora asks.

"Well, I could hardly tell you to your face." Catra says with a chuckle. Adora turns and immediately drops the poster.

"You… Oh…" Adora says. "Force Captain Catra is back."

*** "That's right, Lord Adora." Catra says and she unfurls a *whip* . *Where the hell did she get a whip from?* Adora's eyes lock onto it, she feels the resulting wetness in her underwear at the sight of it. "Are you ready for your punishment?"

"Are you going to…" Adora trails off. She may have lost her desire to engage in impact play when it comes to her hitting Catra, but Adora has not lost her appetite to be hit *by* Catra.

"Get on your knees, my Lord." Catra orders. Adora does as she's told. She has a desire to please Catra, whether when she's dominating or submitting - plus she's a soldier, she follows orders exceptionally well. Once she's on her knees Catra puts a collar around her neck with a leash. Adora swallows *hard* at the tightness, at the way she feels *claimed* by it. They've talked about this stuff before, they have their safe words, they know what they're doing, but talking about it and actually fulfilling the fantasies are very different.

"Now," Catra says and Adora immediately snaps to attention at her voice. "Bend over your throne for me." Adora's eyes widen and she stands, walking over to her throne. "Wait there," Catra orders. "Take your clothes off first, will you? No fun hitting you with barriers between your skin." *Holy shit.* Adora thinks she might implode already.

She does as Catra orders, stripping off her clothes so she's left in nothing but the collar and the leash. She then bends over her throne as instructed, dropping to her knees and using her arms to keep herself propped up. Catra moves towards her, Adora hears her, and then she starts playing with the plug in Adora's ass. She had wondered why Catra had asked her to wear it, she had been prepping her for *this* . Gods, Adora was so happy she married Catra. There was no shame in this, Catra never made her feel ashamed by her wants and desires, just pure pleasure.

She removes the plug and then Adora feels a finger being shoved inside of her. She gasps at the feeling, this was nothing like she had ever felt before but something she had always wanted to try- she had only ever trusted Catra enough to do it with though. It was a little painful, but that was pretty much guaranteed when it came to anal, and it was one of the reasons Adora was pretty confident she'd enjoy this. "Such a dirty Horde Lord, aren't you?" Catra asks. "I'm going to hit you with this, you're going to thank me, and tell me you're mine after each one, and then I'm going to fuck you using your own strap. Got it?" Catra asks. Adora nods furiously, she was already dripping at Catra's words. "Oh, I almost forgot, put your hands behind your back." Adora does as instructed and then she feels leather being tied around her hands intricately. When Catra is done, Adora finds she's restrained. This is beyond hot to Adora.

Catra pauses for a moment and her voice takes on a much softer tone. "Are you okay?" Catra asks.

"Yes, Force Captain." Adora responds. Catra lets out a soft laugh. Adora is far into sub space by now that any other response was almost impossible for her.

"Remember our safe words," Catra reminds her. "Colour?"

"Green!" Adora responds. "Gods, please, hit me, punish me, please." Adora begs.

"Okay, my Lord, as you wish." Is the last thing Catra says before she takes a step back. Adora waits, she almost thinks Catra isn't going to do anything when she hears a sudden *crack* and the explosive pain in response. Adora cries out, but she remembers Catra's instructions and quickly thanks her before she tells her that she is Catra's.

Catra is skilled, and she knows that Adora requires a build up, so she does just that. They start slow, and build it up until Adora is raw and she has to ask Catra to stop. Catra definitely fulfilled Adora's desire to be hurt. She was pretty sure she wouldn't be able to sit on her ass for days now. "Colour?" Catra questions.

"Yellow…" Adora pants. She rests there for a while, trying to regain her breathing. She rests her cheek against the seat of her throne, letting the cool metal bring her back. Eventually, Adora lifts her head up. "Green."

"You sure Princess?"

"Are you really making this a thing?" Adora asks in disbelief. Catra laughs a little, her hand coming to the base of Adora's spine that makes her stiffen from the activation of her nerves there. Catra runs her claws over her back. The next thing Adora feels is something cold and metal being placed into her tied hands.

"Transform your sword, Lord Adora." Adora's eyebrows lift up. She concentrates, imagining what she wanted to transform her sword into and then she feels it being taken from her. "This'll be fine for me to use on you, right?" Adora swallows thickly. She doesn't know what it is, but something about Catra fucking her with her sword strap is a really big fucking turn on.

"You should be okay." Adora answers. If she's honest, she doesn't really know, she's only ever used her sword on others, never someone using it on herself, but she was about ninety percent sure she would be fine.

"And you're okay with this penetration?" Catra asks. Adora smiles a little at her question. Adora knows that Catra just wants to be sure that she's absolutely okay with this, given that Adora doesn't typically enjoy certain penetration, but Adora has never been more sure about anything in her life.

“I’m sure, Force Captain.” Adora responds. Catra hums. Adora strains to listen, she hears Catra step into the harness and secure it in place, Adora hears other noises too and realises Catra is probably applying a lot of lube, before she feels her line up behind her.

“Okay, we’re going to take this slow,” Catra says. “If you want me to stop at any point, you know the safe word.”

“Yes, Force Captain,” Adora says. “Now, please, fuck me.”

Catra does go slow. Adora will admit, it is slightly painful, but the lube and the way that Catra prepped her, not to mention the way that Catra slowly and carefully enters her, makes it an almost pleasant burn that has Adora’s eyes rolling back in her head.

The real pleasure starts when Catra starts having her way with her. Adora is beyond turned on to be used this way by Catra as she mindlessly ruts into Adora; she mentions how the strap really does rub her in all the right ways and how she understands why Adora enjoys wearing it, and all Adora can do is whimper back at her. Adora’s hands strain, tightening around her restraints so she has something to hang onto as she’s *used* by Catra.

At some point, Catra moves her hand around, rubbing Adora’s clit while also thrusting into her and using her other hand to pull on the leash. The sensations drive Adora wild. She has no other thoughts but pleasure and she submits completely to Catra - this is what she missed out on being too afraid to be vulnerable, but no more.

Right when Adora is on the edge, she begs Catra to use her claws, to dig them into her skin and drag them down her back, and Catra does just that. Adora can’t see them, but she certainly *feels* the sting. She imagines they must draw at least a little blood and Adora cums so hard she almost passes out. She hears Catra call her name at some point, also falling over the edge, and when Adora comes back from her near blackened out state, Catra is leaning against her back, they’re both panting like crazy and sweating.

Catra slowly pulls out and tosses the strap away. Adora was motionless against her throne, unable to move. “Colour?” Catra asks.

“Yellow, Force Captain.” Adora answers. “Can you…” Adora trails off but Catra seems to understand what she’s saying and she carefully helps her sit up. Adora’s back honestly hurts more than her ass currently - which is really saying something - but it’s a pleasant pain, a constant pulse and burn that Adora loves and craves in situations like this.

Catra sits on the throne and Adora sits between her legs on the floor. She leans her head against her thigh as she slowly manages to calm herself down. She kisses Catra’s knee. “Was that good for you Adora?” Catra asks.

“Yes, Force Captain.” Adora responds automatically. She knows she’s incredibly far into sub space, but she’s not ready to exit it yet. “What else would you like me to do, Force Captain?” Adora asks. Catra stares at her, her eyebrows stitching together a little in concern.

“Adora,” Catra takes her face in her hands. “Are you really okay?” Catra’s gentle voice makes Adora snap out of it a little and she nods.

“I’m okay, promise,” She responds. “You’re just not entirely used to this side of me.”

“No… I guess I’m not.” Catra lets out a breathy laugh. “One more thing and then we call it?”

“Yes ma’am.” Adora nods in agreement.

“Okay…” Catra says before her eyes light up. “Colour?”

“Green, Force Captain.” Adora answers and then Catra tugs Adora forward by her leash causing Adora to grunt in surprise. “Use your mouth.” Catra orders.

“My hands.” Adora points out. Catra looks at her and then she unfastens the bottom of her suit, rolling it down a little.

“Use your teeth.” She says, shrugging. Adora licks her lips. She is honestly quite turned on and excited by the challenge. She moves forward and uses her teeth, as Catra had instructed her to do so, moving the material down and out of the way. She hovers by the gap in her thigh highs, kissing along her thigh, *marking* her. Catra suddenly yanks on her leash. “No teasing, I’m in charge here, Lord Adora.”

“Yes, Force Captain.” Adora says before she moves her mouth to her core. There is no activity Adora enjoys more than getting to bury her tongue in Catra - and that is never going to change. She loves the way she tastes, the sounds she makes, the way Adora can feel Catra clench around her tongue, the way Catra is almost choking her with how hard she’s pulling on the leash to keep Adora in place.

Adora likes to think she is highly skilled with her tongue, and she knows she’s doing a good job when Catra buries her hand in her hair and pulls a little, calling her a good girl. Adora doubles her efforts, swirling, circling and sucking, even using her teeth, until she feels Catra spill into her mouth - Adora also knows Catra was pretty worked up already. Catra practically screams and her moans echo off the metal walls of the throne room. Adora stays in place until Catra slackens.

Adora feels float-y and happy after that session, she pleased Catra and got punished herself. She doesn’t feel fully present, however, and it takes her a moment to come to, but, when she does, slipping out of that sub space, it’s to Catra kissing her and gently praising her. Catra had removed the collar and was gently massaging Adora’s throat with her hand. “You did so well,” Catra praises. “Come on, let's get you cleaned up, healed up, and in bed.” ***

“I love you.” Adora says, taking Catra’s hand and kissing her ring. “Thank you.”

“I love you too, dummy.” Catra says, smiling back, kissing Adora’s ring on her finger. “Now come on.” Adora takes her hand and follows her, just like she always would.

* * *

“Last gift.” Catra says to her wife who was currently lying on their bed. Catra glances over at Adora who was lying on her side of their shared bed in the Fright Zone. She had complained that she wouldn’t be able to sit on her ass for days, so Catra had told her to lie on their bed.

The bed, unfortunately, had been a recent casualty of their sexcapades - or, at least, the frame had been.

“How many times have we had sex here and not managed to break the bed?” Adora questions. Catra snorts. Their ‘bed’ was now just a mattress on the floor - not that it mattered really, they’d be moving into their home soon enough.

“Can you focus on the *gifts* , you know, the ones I’m opening?” Catra asks. Adora rolls her eyes and then nods. Catra picks up the rather large package and freezes. She recognises the packaging almost immediately. Her mom. It was obviously from Half-Moon. Adora seems to notice Catra’s reaction and she shuffles closer.

“Are you okay my love?” Adora asks gently. Catra closes her eyes, her ears pressing down against her head. She takes a breath before she opens her eyes again.

“I have you,” Catra says, kissing Adora’s ring and then her own. “How could I not be?” She turns back to the gift. She extends her claws, carefully tearing the paper to get to the items inside of it.

Inside was a bundle of fabrics with a little note on the top in perfect handwriting that Catra recognised as C’yra’s. ‘ *For my Little Ones* ’. Catra scoffs at it before she tosses it to one side. She picks up one of the fabrics and realises that the bundle is *baby* clothes, not just any baby clothes, actual Magicat baby clothes, ones that accommodate their tail and everything, made in Half-Moon. Catra swallows the lump in her throat. One of the baby onesies was one made of the Magicat royal colours, it would mark Finn out as part of the Royal Magicat family. This was the *first time* C’yra had ever acknowledged Finn as being the heir to the throne, as being a legitimate heir, part of Catra couldn’t believe it, and she was *moved* . *Dammit* . Catra was still angry, of course she was, but something about the gesture was making her… emotional.

Catra passes the clothes to Adora and allows her to admire them while Catra turns her attention back to the box. She notices some more objects in the corner, hidden by the clothes. She picks up one of the boxes and opens it. Catra can’t hold in the gasp that escapes her when she sees what’s inside. It was a tail bracelet, but not just any tail bracelet, one that was passed down generation after generation. After a Magicat wed, the pair would usually wear a bracelet on their tails that showed other Magicats they were married, sure, they had their rings, but jewellery on their tails was a common practice too - and something about having

your marriage announcement on your tail, for all to see, was *intimate* . It was a longstanding Magicat tradition, but Catra never expected C'yra to pass the heirloom along. This had been in her family for generations, Catra kind of thought C'yra would never accept her marriage, this was a clear message that she did.

"What is it?" Adora asks softly. Catra realizes that her tail is swishing uncontrollably and her eyes have started to water. She sniffles as she wipes her nose on her sleeve. She grabs her tail.

"It's…" Catra trails off as she carefully opens the bracelet. She places it on her tail, gently closing it and securing it in place. She admits, C'yra has managed to win some points with this gesture. "It's a Magicat tradition to wear a certain bracelet on your tail when you're married… This is my mom's, it's the Royal Magicat marriage jewel, I never thought she'd…" Catra suddenly remembers the other box inside the package.

She turns and picks it up, opening it to see an almost arm brace type object with the same exact jewel. "Oh…" Catra could cry. Usually Magicats matched their marriage bracelets, Adora didn't have a tail, so C'yra had made it into something she could wear too. Catra holds it up to Adora who takes it and slips it on.

"Cool." Adora comments. Then she seems to reconsider as she looks at Catra. "I mean, not cool? I shouldn't wear this." Catra laughs at her *wife* . She still couldn't quite believe Adora was her wife.

"I don't forgive her but…" Catra bites her lip, looking at her tail. "This was a nice gesture." She looks back at the box to see another letter with her name on it. She picks it up and opens it, reading it.

' *Dear C'yra,*

I hope these gifts find you well. I apologise for being unable to attend your wedding, but I did not think you would like my presence there, nor did I believe I deserved to be there. I have so many things I wish I could talk to you about, but they're best to be spoken in person. Just know that Half-Moon has formally and publicly accepted Finn as a legitimate heir to the throne. When you are ready, which may never be, I understand, I would like to speak with you. I don't want to write my apologies on paper, you deserve to hear them, if you are willing.

~~*Love,*~~

Best Wishes,

~~*Your Mother*~~

Queen C'yra of Half-Moon'

Catra couldn't believe what she was reading, but, to be fair, she could hardly believe that her mom had actually given her the bracelet either. She places the letter back into the box and then puts it with the other empty gifts. She turns back to her wife who was currently watching her very closely. "Feelings?" Adora asks.

"I don't know…" Catra admits. "It's a step in the right direction at the very least." Adora nods in agreement. Catra moves up to kiss Adora on her lips. "How are you enjoying your honeymoon, my Lord?" Catra asks.

"Honestly?" Adora asks. "It's kind of been a pain in the ass." Catra bursts out laughing at her huge, big, goofy, *dummy* . Gods, she loves Adora more than she has ever loved anything in her entire life - excluding, of course, Finn.

"How long have you been sitting on that?" Catra questions because, Catra has learnt, Adora is quite witty and funny when she wants to be, but she also often thinks of her jokes later. She gives off the biggest dad energy of anyone Catra has ever met - on the same level as *Micah* .

"Is that another joke?"

"You are insufferable."

"Too bad, you're stuck with me forever." Adora comments and Catra shakes her head, smiling in amusement. Honestly, Adora is the only person Catra *wants* to be 'stuck' with for the rest of her life.

They're disturbed when someone knocks on their bedroom door. Adora frowns at Catra who shrugs in answer before Adora calls for the person to come in. Catra isn't sure who she expected to walk in through the door, but it was not Perfuma and Scorpia. "Perfuma?" Adora

says, the surprise Catra felt colours Adora's words too. "I figured therapy would be suspended while I was on my honeymoon?" She asks.

"Oh no, I'm not here for that," Perfuma says with a smile. "I came to see Scorpia." Catra and Adora both look at Scorpia who was blushing and scratching the back of her head with her pincer. Catra and Adora glance at each other, both of them raising their eyebrows. *Here to see Scorpia? Interesting* . "I thought I'd come to you guys and offer Plumeria as your honeymoon destination, the Fright Zone… I'm sure it has improved, like you said Adora, but it's hardly a honeymoon destination, and… what happened to your bed?"

"Nothing!" Catra says quickly. "Nothing…" She blushes furiously. There's an awkward silence that hangs between them. Catra knows she totally just exposed herself there, but what has been done, has been done. "Plumeria…" Catra says, glancing at Adora who shrugs.

"You can enjoy the spa! Or the meditation sessions, the flower gardens, and have an actual bed." Perfuma says, clapping her hands together. Catra admits that doesn't sound too bad actually, and she is right about the Fright Zone not being the most honeymoon friendly destination.

"Okay, yeah, I wouldn't mind that." Catra says. "How soundproof are your rooms there?"

"Uh…" Perfuma blushes a little. "Enough." Catra raises an eyebrow. "You'll be okay."

"Okay then… I guess we're going to Plumeria for our honeymoon?" Catra looks at her wife who nods. Catra would think about talking to her mom some other time. For now, she just wanted to spend time with her new wife for the remainder of their honeymoon.

Chapter End Notes

In reality, this episode is more courtesy of S because my brain has said no thoughts, just vibes -M

Butt stuff, brought to you by S. ASDFGHJKL I fully did not intend for this chapter to be this H word but here we are. I hope y'all enjoy and we have another 5 chapters to go.

Some development with C'yra too as well as Catradora wedding !! We'll see more of C'yra next time and we'll see y'all next time too. Until then, I wish you all the best! (Yes I should have been working on my dissertation but here I am writing lesbians having sex jskdhskjfh) -S

As always you can find us on twitter @ceolordadora and you can find me (S) on tumblr @sherasswordstrap

Closure

Chapter Summary

"Yeah," Adora nods. "I think she secretly likes me."

"She literally just said she's probably never going to like you."

"I recall you saying something similar."

Chapter Notes

Happy Friday and Happy Update Day !! We hope you all enjoy this update :) See y'all next time !!

See the end of the chapter for more notes

After their honeymoon, Catra and Adora's house was finally completed. It was quite a large house, situated in the Whispering Woods. At first, that had been kind of a hazard. The Whispering Woods had all kinds of dangerous creatures, but Bow had pointed out how his dads had happily lived in the Whispering Woods for years, and it also meant that they were perfectly situated between the Horde and Bright Moon. The house was quite big from the outside as it was inside.

"Wow… My Horde soldiers may deserve better recognition for their construction and engineering talents." Adora comments. The house immediately felt *homely* , made from timber and other materials, the space was kind of perfect. No metal of the Fright Zone, not as public as the castles of Bright Moon and Half-Moon. This was *their* space. There was a big book case in the living room with books Adora couldn't wait to read, a comfy couch, the kitchen was open plan and you could see from the kitchen to the living room. Adora loved it.

They head upstairs next. Scorpia had asked them how many bedrooms they wanted and Adora hadn't been totally sure and just went with four. That meant, there was the master bedroom, Finn's room and two other rooms, plus a bathroom. She had insisted upon an en-suite bathroom for the master bedroom, however, that was likely to come in handy later on in their life.

They arrive in Finn's room first, Adora only knows this because there is a plaque on their door with their name on it. The room was space themed, which was endlessly adorable, and against the far wall was their crib with a mobile above it. There were also various toys and decorations around the room. "I love this." Catra says.

"We should measure them against their door frame." Adora says and Catra nods. They move to the door and Adora carefully stands them up against it. "Do we measure from the tips of their ears or their head?" Adora asks curiously.

"Head, dummy." Catra says. "Otherwise I'd be five four and not five two." Adora snorts a little and then grabs her marker pen. She marks Finn's height on the doorframe, writing their name and their age.

"There we go," Adora says. "And so begins the rest of our lives in this place."

"It's not so bad," Catra says. "At least it has windows." Adora snorts and gently nudges Catra's shoulder as they stand back up, Catra now holding Finn in her hands. The other bedrooms were simple, clearly just there if they had guests or if they had more kids, a blank canvas for them to decorate as they pleased.

They move on to find the master bedroom. Adora immediately jumps onto the bed and Catra laughs. "Seriously?" Catra asks. Adora bounces a few times.

"Got to make sure it's suitable." Adora says with a smirk. Catra rolls her eyes. "Hey, we managed to break the bed in the Fright Zone, I thought those things were indestructible." Adora says before she lies on the bed with a heavy sigh. "I love this bed, it's so big, and perfect levels of soft and firm to suit us both."

"Yeah, yeah," Catra says. "Now, if you're done, there's a surprise I want to show you." Adora raises an eyebrow.

"Finn is still awake."

“Not that, Adora.” Catra says, shaking her head. “Follow me, Dork.” Adora reluctantly pushes herself up and follows after Catra.

She follows her wife out into the hallway, she takes her to a trapdoor on the ceiling and then she pulls the cord, lowering a wooden ladder. Adora raises an eyebrow and then Catra gestures. “You go first.” She says. Adora hesitates only for a moment before she begins climbing.

When she reaches the top, she takes a breath in in surprise. “What…?” Adora says in surprise. In front of her was her throne, Adora has no idea how they managed to get that thing all the way up here. In front of it was a large table, full of supplies for making *maps* . Not only that, but there was a circular stained glass window on the far fall, casting the room in pretty colours, giving it a warm glow. Adora hears Catra pop her head up from below.

“So,” Catra says. “What do you think?” She asks.

“How did you know that I liked making maps?” Adora asks.

“You never specifically told me, but you used to pour over maps and tell me cute details about them all the time. I put two and two together.”

“The maps in the Fright Zone sucked,” Adora says. “I can make better ones.”

“Yeah, well, this is your study.” Catra says. “Make all the maps you want here.” Adora smiles as she crosses to her throne and sits in it. It was nice to have her throne, even if it was tucked away all the way up here. Catra climbs the rest of the way up and then comes and sits in Adora’s lap.

“This reminds me of things.” Adora says. She remembers yelling at her soldiers when Catra came and sat right in her lap. She traces her fingers over the scratches on the armrest. “Now we just have to deal with Shadow Weaver and we can finally live our life.”

“Yes we can,” Catra says, kissing Adora on her jaw. “I love you.”

“I love you too.” Adora says back. Her heart feels ready to burst from her chest. This was their home, and Adora was ready to settle down with Catra.

* * *

“Ah, Queen C’yra,” Adora greets. “Welcome to the Fright Zone.” Adora gestures for the Queen to follow her and she does. “You came alone, that’s surprising.” Adora comments - she half expected Queen C’yra to bring a whole battalion with her for ‘safety’.

“Why? Are you planning on attacking me?” The Queen asks dryly. Adora snorts.

“You sound like Catra.” Adora says. She glances behind her to see C’yra’s tail swishing back and forth and her eyes fixed on the ground. Adora supposes that maybe she hit a nerve there. Adora looks forward again. Horde soldiers look at them, some of them doing double takes when they realise that Adora was not with Catra.

At first glance, you could easily mistake C’yra for Catra, but Adora knows Catra so intimately that she would never make the mistake. C’yra is slightly taller than Catra by a couple of inches, her hair is pretty identical, favouring the long wild locks as Catra did, Luna typically braided her hair, C’yra also has more scars than Catra and, while Catra typically dressed in tight fitted Rebellion clothing, Queen C’yra dressed in typical Magicat warrior robes, with her crown fixed upon her face. Queen C’yra also lacked the freckles that Catra had on her cheeks, something she must have gotten from Luna. C’yra was also quite clearly a *Queen* , it was so easy by the way she carried herself, it was the same authority Adora used to feel while marching around the Fright Zone in her Horde Lord get-up.

“How is she?” C’yra asks suddenly, disturbing Adora’s train of thought. When Adora gives her a look of confusion, the Magicat Queen sighs. “C’yra, how is she? How was your honeymoon?” The Queen clarifies. Adora blushes a little at the mention of their honeymoon. They had *definitely* made the most of that alone time together, Plumeria had been nice too, Adora had come back from it feeling refreshed. She was happy now, she just had to get Shadow Weaver dealt with and then she could move on with the rest of her life.

“She’s okay,” Adora answers. “She was really touched by your gifts.” Adora lifts her hand up, showing off the brace that C’yra had given her for their wedding. She sees the hint of a smile on the Queen’s face before it quickly fades.

“I’m sorry for almost killing you, Adora.” C’yra says and Adora blinks. She stays quiet for a moment. She hadn’t expected C’yra to apologise for that, but she never really thought she’d come around like she has.

“It’s okay,” Adora shrugs, offering a half smile to the Queen. “I probably would have tried to kill me too if I were you.” The Magicat Queen shakes her head but Adora *swears* she actually got a small chuckle out of her. C’yra may never like her, but at least she doesn’t seem to hate her like she used to. “Besides, I don’t care about me, I care about Catra. I probably deserved everything you did to me, but she didn’t. You hurt her the most.” Adora pauses. “Are you helping me for her?”

“Yes.” C’yra says simply and Adora can’t fault her for her honesty. “Well, yes, and no.” She says. “I’m not doing this for you, but Shadow Weaver… She deserves to lose her magic as punishment for all that she’s done. And my daughter would feel much better if the woman who had such… influence over you, no longer has the ability to hurt you, physically that is anyway.” Adora appreciates that C’yra specified the physical damage - Shadow Weaver’s always been especially good at emotional damage too.

“Good enough for me.” Adora responds. She never really expected C’yra to do anything for her, she still didn’t, if she was doing this to stop Shadow Weaver from ever hurting anyone again, and for Catra, Adora was okay with that.

As they walk through the hallways of the Fright Zone, Adora can tell it catches C’yra’s attention by the way her tail is up and her ears keep twitching, moving in different directions as she attempts to track the various sounds of the Fright Zone. It’s kind of cute actually. “You really lived here your entire life?” Queen C’yra asks, her nose wrinkling up a little in distaste. “Between the smog and the lack of windows, how are you not severely vitamin D deficient?” Adora laughs a little.

“This is actually an improvement,” Adora says. “If I’m honest, I think they put all of the necessary nutrients into our ration bars.” Adora shrugs. Ration bars are far from filling, and

they taste terrible, but when you're raising an army you feed them the bare minimum - enough to keep them fit but not too much or too little lest they have an unhealthy army on their hands.

“Starting to understand why you were so grumpy all the time.” C’yra mumbles and Adora laughs. She used to be very grumpy, not so much anymore.

They make it to the prison cells. Adora leads C’yra all the way through them, trying to keep her blush off of her cheeks when she sees the cell where Catra propositioned her all that time ago. They go down into the deeper cells, Adora pauses at the door to greet the guards before she opens it and enters, letting C’yra follow behind her. Adora approaches Shadow Weaver first. “Ah, you’re back, you just can’t stay away, can you child?” Shadow Weaver asks. Adora crouches in front of her.

“I’ve had enough of you,” Adora says, “you don’t have power over me anymore. Your reign of terror over me, over Etheria, over *Micah* , over everyone who you hurt, ends today.”

“You need me, Adora-”

“No,” Adora interrupts, cutting Shadow Weaver off. “And no one ever will. I’m going to make you feel useless. I’m going to take the one thing you actually care about.” Shadow Weaver’s eyes widen, Adora takes great satisfaction in seeing that, before they seem to catch on something behind Adora. She laughs coldly.

“Catra doesn’t know how to take power.” Shadow Weaver says. “She barely knows how to use her magic.”

“Then good thing I’m not Catra.” Queen C’yra steps closer. Her eyes, which had been glowing vividly in the dark, give way to reveal the whole of her. Adora hears Shadow Weaver gasp a little and Adora turns back towards her with a smug smirk.

“Queen C’yra,” Shadow Weaver hisses, “what a surprise.”

“I’m very sure it is, Shadow Weaver.” C’yra greets. If Adora wasn’t mistaken, it almost sounded like C’yra disliked Shadow Weaver more than she disliked Adora - and that was saying something. “I agreed to help Lord Adora take your magic, and I will be *happy* to help.”

“Still holding a grudge I see,” Shadow Weaver says, sounding bored. Adora stands to her feet and sees C’yra ball her hands into fists. “You really ought to get over that.”

“Ha! Like I’m the one who lost?” C’yra asks, snarling at the sorceress. “Oh wait, no, that was *you* .”

“You still weren’t able to save your parents though, were you?” Shadow Weaver asks. Adora glances at C’yra to see she had frozen, she wasn’t moving an inch, even her tail was still. Adora looks between the two women.

“What… What do you mean?” Adora asks. C’yra lets out a sigh.

“The Horde, when you and C’yra were young, probably about five for you, C’yra was four.” C’yra begins as she suddenly becomes animated again. “The Horde attacked Half-Moon, my parents were killed, the Horde almost kidnapped my daughter, it was the same battle that I was injured in and that Micah went missing in, assumed dead.” C’yra explains as she gestures to the forcefield keypad. Adora moves towards it and places her palm to it, taking the barrier down that was currently between them. “After that, Half-Moon constructed the tunnels that lay beneath our kingdom, it’s a backup, in case the Horde ever tried to attack us again. Many Magicats suffered and perished in that battle, my own parents… Almost your wife, Lord Adora.”

“She would’ve made a very good hostage,” Shadow Weaver says. Adora is *horrified.* Catra was almost taken prisoner by the Horde when she was *four years* old. “We would have used her to destroy the Magicats once and for all, there was nothing you wouldn’t do to save your daughter.” C’yra lets out a breath. “And now she hates you.” C’yra’s claws extend and Adora grabs her by her wrist, stopping her.

“What are you doing?” C’yra asks. “I slit her throat, I take her magic, either way, problem solved.”

“No.” Adora states firmly. She glances behind her at Shadow Weaver before she focuses entirely on C’yra. She hasn’t been this close to C’yra since she attacked her that night before her trial. “Look, I hate her as much as you do, but we can’t kill her, it isn’t right.”

“Magicats don’t care like the other Princesses,” Shadow Weaver says. “Queen C’yra would happily kill me as she almost did you, Adora.”

“Ignore her,” Adora says. “Killing her in cold blood makes us *exactly* like her and, I don’t know about you, but she is the *last* person I want to be like.” C’yra’s eyes move behind Adora before they focus back on Adora’s baby blues. She purses her lips before she nods. “Besides, she’ll be powerless soon enough.” Adora releases C’yra from her grip and turns back to Shadow Weaver.

“I’m surprised you’re helping the Lord of the Horde,” Shadow Weaver says, looking at C’yra. “Did you know she’s also a First One?”

“What?” C’yra looks at Adora with shock and Adora shuffles.

“Apparently I came through a portal when I was a baby, Hordak found me and brought me back here, to the Horde.” Adora explains. “She-Ra is descended from the First Ones, she was… made by them… I’m not entirely sure, Catra and I were going to go talk to Bow's dads some more.”

“She is,” Queen C’yra says. “The First Ones and the Magicats were some of the first settlers of Etheria.” She explains. “In fact, there are stories of She-Ra helping us, the She-Ra of old anyway. The First Ones were… not good people. The old She-Ra, the She-Ra before you, some old carvings named her Mara, she was fighting against the First Ones who turned on all of Etheria.”

“The First Ones also nearly destroyed Etheria?” Adora asks.

“Not all of them,” C’yra points out. “Mara tried to save Etheria, in fact, I think it killed her. You’re She-Ra, like she was, she protected Etheria. It was one of the reasons I was… disappointed with you being Lord of the Horde. You were never destined to do the Horde’s bidding.”

“You were disappointed?” Adora asks with surprise.

“You must understand,” C’yra says. “She-Ra was a hero, you were not who we were expecting to be the next She-Ra.” That makes sense, she supposes She-Ra being the Lord of the Horde was not what anyone was expecting. “Anyway, I don’t really care that Adora is a First One, or that she was Lord of the Horde, or even that she’s She-Ra, my goal right now is to take your magic.” C’yra says. She kneels down in front of Shadow Weaver and begins drawing what Adora recognises as runes.

Shadow Weaver suddenly looks alarmed and she looks at Adora with an expression Adora can only describe as desperate - even behind her mask - Adora can practically feel her desperation rolling off of her. “Adora, please,” She says. “Don’t let them do this to me.” Adora hesitates, looking at Queen C’yra who was currently focused on her magic.

“You brought this on yourself.” Adora says simply.

“You really want to help her?” Shadow Weaver asks C’yra.

“I owe her one, for almost killing her.” C’yra says dryly. Adora feels her mouth lift up at the corner a little in amusement. “Now stop moving, or this will be more painful than it has to be.” C’yra lifts her hands, which start glowing, and then she places them either side of Shadow Weaver’s face. Adora watches in amazement, and also slight horror, as Shadow Weaver lets out a screech that sends a chill right down Adora’s spine. She has to look away. She hates that she feels sympathy for the woman, but she does. Some part of Adora will always think of Shadow Weaver as a mother figure, and seeing her in pain was… hard to watch - even if she had been nothing but cruel to Adora.

After a long moment, Adora feels a hand being placed on her shoulder. She turns around to see C’yra looking at her. Adora’s eyes flicker over to Shadow Weaver, who was sitting on the ground looking … *destroyed* . “What have you done?” She asks Adora. “You betrayed me.” Adora swallows thickly.

“Now you can’t hurt me or my family,” Adora says, “and you never will.”

“ *I* was your family.” Shadow Weaver says. “You will regret this.”

“No,” Adora says, “I won’t. You’re going to live here for the rest of your miserable life and, if by some miracle you do get out of here, what are you to She-Ra? If you threaten my family, I will *kill* you.” Shadow Weaver laughs.

“You don’t have the guts,” Shadow Weaver says. “You’ve always had a soft heart.”

“ *Soft* ?” Adora asks, stepping forward angrily. C’yra catches her by her arm.

“Leave her be, Lord Adora,” C’yra says. “She’s a sad woman grasping at straws, she has no power anymore.” Adora looks at Shadow Weaver before she looks at C’yra and nods. Adora goes to the panel and puts the forcefield back up. Adora pauses momentarily.

“It didn’t have to come to this, Shadow Weaver, but you made your choice, now you have to live with it.” Adora says before she turns and walks away, Queen C’yra following after her. When they reach the doors, the guards lock it and then Adora begins walking away. Whenever she talks to Shadow Weaver, Adora is aware that she gets somewhat *weird* - she just can’t help it. Shadow Weaver will always affect her.

Adora doesn’t even realise that Queen C’yra is still following her until she speaks. “That woman raised you?” She asks. “No wonder you’re the way that you are.” She comments.

“Should I be offended by that?” Adora asks, turning to look at the Queen.

“I don’t mean offence,” C’yra says. “I suppose I forgot how horrible of a person Shadow Weaver is, I can’t believe you survived being raised by her. It explains a lot about you actually.” She pauses for a moment. “Are you okay?”

“I’m fine,” Adora says with a sigh. *Did she and C’yra just bond?* Adora has never been this amicable with C’yra before. “I just need my wife and my baby.”

“C’yra is here?” Queen C’yra asks.

“Of course, she would never let me come here without support, especially when facing Shadow Weaver.” Adora answers. Catra knows better than anyone else what Shadow Weaver does to Adora. She sees C’yra look away. “Hey… you should talk to her.”

“I don’t want to bother her.”

“She seemed open to talking to you,” Adora says dismissively, “especially after the gifts. Plus, I read your note. You said you wanted to apologise in person, so you should.”

“Okay… Okay, yeah,” Queen C’yra nods. “Lead the way, Lord Adora.” Adora smiles and does just that.

* * *

Catra is relieved when she sees Adora walking towards her with her big goofy smile on her face. The first thing Adora does is kiss her on the lips, right in front of C’yra. Catra can’t help but smile as she pulls away from Adora before glancing over at C'yra. Her smile drops a bit before she nods at the other brunette in acknowledgement. C’yra looks kind of awkward just standing there. "C'yra." Catra greets coldly. Adora raises an eyebrow as she turns to look at the Queen. C'yra simply nods back at Catra. The tension in the air is... less than pleasant.

"Did... Are you okay?" Adora asks. "Finn?"

"I'm alright. Finn is in the other room playing with their toys. They really love that new toy train that they got from Glimmer."

"Oh... Well I um... I should... go see them." Adora says awkwardly. "You know? I'm just... I'm gonna... go... leaving... two people... alone..." Adora laughs nervously. "Bye!" She slips away. C'yra huffs out a laugh.

"She's not very subtle, is she?"

"Not at all. But subtlety has never been her strength." Catra says with a small grin as she watches her wife walk off.

"C'yra..." C'yra begins, trailing off for a moment. "Can we talk?"

"About what exactly?"

"Us... Our family, our relationship." Catra sighs, closing her eyes for a moment. She knew this was a very real possibility when she agreed to come with Adora, but a part of her still wasn't really expecting C'yra to actually want to speak to her.

"Alright, what do you want to say then?" Catra asks simply.

"I have a few things I'd like to tell you, to explain to you why I... reacted the way I did." C'yra says. "Can we go sit somewhere?"

"I guess I could listen to what you have to say." Catra responds. "Sure, let's go sit." C'yra nods and follows Catra to a place where they can sit together and talk. C'yra was clearly nervous, obvious by the way her tail betrayed her. Her note had sounded genuine, and she was willing to hear her mom out, so long as her apology was vocally genuine too.

When C'yra takes a seat, she sighs. "When you were younger, you were almost taken by the Horde."

"I know." Catra says softly. "I overheard your conversation with mom before."

"You... What?"

"When I was younger, I overheard you and mom talking about it." Catra repeats. "It was one of the reasons why I hated the Horde." Magicat hearing is especially keen, Catra had easily heard her parents discussing her almost abduction when she was younger. She knew the Horde was responsible for the death of her grandparents, she's always understood her mother's hatred of the Horde, she just hasn't understood how that could blind her so much that she makes her own daughter suffer.

"Oh..." C'yra says, blinking - she clearly hadn't been expecting that. "Well, you probably don't remember the Horde attack, it's the one my parents were killed in, Micah was taken in, though we thought the Horde had killed him, and you were almost taken too." C'yra explains. "I know, rationally, that Adora was not the cause of that, she was around your age, but... Her being the Lord... that's all I saw. I was blinded with my rage and I... spiralled I guess."

"I noticed." Catra inhales and then exhales heavily. "I know what happened to you, C'yra. I wasn't trying to discredit your experiences, but I also wanted you to not discredit *my* experiences."

"I... I hated Adora... Maybe I still do, I honestly don't know." C'yra sighs. "She... She's not who I thought she was. I mean, it's a miracle she's who she is when she was raised by Shadow Weaver."

"I know, I was surprised too when I began to get to know her properly." Catra laughs a bit. "I used to hate her too. Though it was pretty easy to see she wasn't anything like Hordak and Shadow Weaver from a single conversation."

"She's a good wife. She probably balances you out, like Luna does with me."

"She does. She's... chaotic, and open, and dorky, and I love her." Catra says with a fond smile. She loves Adora so completely, she is literally bonded to her with her soul.

"I know I hurt you, C'yra," C'yra admits. "And I should've listened to Luna, or Spinnerella and Netossa, or Bow, or... Well, you. I know I can't defend what I did, even if I thought I was doing what was best for you, I hurt you, my own daughter." C'yra looks away for a moment. "Adora told me I should apologise and mean it but not expect you to accept it, and she's right. I'm sorry, C'yra. I really am." Catra's ears twitch and her tail swishes behind her. She can't believe her mom apologised and *meant* it.

"Thank you for actually apologising, C'yra." Catra whispers, her voice a bit emotional. "It means a lot. This apology is something I thought I would never get. However, Adora is right. I'm not accepting that apology, not until you show me you're actually sorry. Words are meaningless unless your actions reflect them." It would be far too easy for Catra to roll over and just let C'yra completely off of the hook - she had caused far too much damage for that.

"Okay," C'yra nods. "I know that. Your mom, Luna, you shouldn't be so mad at her. She was furious with me, I'm pretty sure the only reason she didn't leave me was because of our mating bond, and the fact that she kept me from doing irreversible damage. I'm very afraid of what I would have done if she had left." Catra pursues her lips at that, looking away.

"I want to set something straight with you, C'yra. I'm only doing this because Adora is asking me to see your side of things and I *deserve* your apology. But you already caused irreversible damage." Catra says sharply. C'yra really has *no idea* the kind of shit she actually put Catra through. "I have to go to therapy two times a week because I have *PTSD* and anxiety from the house arrest. I have the scars from the times I nearly died on my skin." Catra presses her hand to her chest. "I went through a rough labor, and nearly lost Finn to begin with, because of you. You caused *irreversible damage* to me, even if you don't see it. And don't pretend that my wife doesn't have the scars of your claws permanently etched into her skin from before the trial." Catra hisses before taking a deep breath.

"The only reason I'm talking to you, and even giving you a chance, is because I don't want to be you in any way, shape or form. I know that your irrational anger is what caused your actions, but I'm still angry. Adora, she was literally possessed by the Black Garnet, you were acting on your own accord. You have no excuse. So I'm giving you *one* chance." Catra finishes, giving her mom a steely gaze. C'yra winces a little from Catra's harsh tone.

"I know... I'm sorry." C'yra says quietly. "I have caused irreversible damage, you're right, including to our relationship. You don't even call me mama anymore, not that I blame you." She says. "I'm sorry for attacking Adora before the trial, I almost killed her. If I'm honest, I

only stopped because... She said she was sorry... and... I believed her." C'yra looks at her daughter sadly. "I don't expect forgiveness, but I'm thankful you're giving me a chance anyway."

"You stopped being my mother the second you demanded for me to get rid of Finn, C'yra. Those are words you can never take back. Maybe one day I'll use that title again, but any time soon... Don't hold your breath." Catra sighs. Maybe she was being a little harsh, her mom's ears were firmly pressed back against her head, but Catra figured she had every right. "Thanks for sending the care package, by the way, Finn loves their new onesies." C'yra closes her eyes and lets out a breath, smiling a little. She opens her eyes again.

"I'm glad. I see you're wearing your tail bracelet, and Adora is wearing hers when I saw her."

"Well yeah, it's the first time you've ever acknowledged that Adora's my wife." Or acknowledged her relationship with Adora at all.

"Hm... Well, she isn't a Magicat, so I had to make some adjustments."

"I noticed, thanks for that." Catra smiles a bit. "But back to the topic at hand. Once I see that you're making attempts to right the... very many wrongs you committed, I *may* let you see Finn every now and again." C'yra ears perk *up* at that.

"Really?" She asks. "I haven't really met them."

"Because I've been keeping you away on purpose." Catra says as she shakes her head. "Why would I want you near my kitten after everything you did? That's why I need to see your actions reflecting your words before I even allow you to *look* at Finn."

"Okay... What about your title?" C'yra asks.

"My title?"

"Princess of Half-Moon," C'yra says. "Last time we talked, you mentioned how you weren't sure you even wanted it anymore... to be Queen." Catra hums, lifting her head up to look at the ceiling.

"I'm still not sure." Catra admits. She doesn't know if she will be any time soon. "It's hard to want to be Queen when I know a good amount of those people and the guards were ready to insult and hurt me and Adora. Even more so when I know many of them won't even accept Finn as the heir."

"They are the heir." C'yra says. "We've accepted them as such. My hope was that if our people see how I've changed my... actions, they'd be willing to see and accept that Finn is the heir and Adora is your wife."

"I'm scared it might be too late. It's been nearly a year of that behaviour, C'yra." Catra responds. It's been so long, during her pregnancy and beyond, so many people in the Rebellion have treated her badly, Catra doesn't expect people's attitudes to just change.

"Time heals all wounds." C'yra says. "Eventually they'll have to accept that Finn is their heir. Besides, Luna and I can't reign forever. Magicats have a longer life expectancy than other Etherians, but we're not immortal."

"And what if I choose to not want the title?"

"That's your choice," C'yra says. "It'll go to your children, or, if they don't want it, someone else. I don't have many extended family members but... there's probably someone it would fall to."

"I see, at least there's options." Catra says. Truthfully, she doesn't know if she will ever be willing to take the throne, it's kind of been ruined for her.

"I'm sure Luna and I have many years left in us yet, you have time to... consider."

"Right."

"You know, Luna and I only had you because we felt we didn't need anything more." C'yra says. "We could've given you a sibling but... You were our everything. Our little kitten. I really am sorry for what I did, C'yra." Catra looks off to the side. She wants to believe her mom, she wants to start moving forward, for things to not be so hard, but it's still all so *raw* . It'll take time for them to ever be 'normal' again. At least Catra had closure as Adora did with Shadow Weaver.

"Your everything... That's hard to believe now." Catra says.

"You know, I never wanted you to join the war in the first place." C'yra says. "But you and Glimmer, you convinced the Alliance to band together again." After the attack on Half-Moon, and Micah's disappearance, the Rebellion went into an almost unannounced ceasefire against the Horde. The Kingdoms kept to themselves rather than banding together against the Horde. After so much loss and tragedy, that's what they decided was best. It was only when Glimmer and Catra came of age that they decided that this wasn't good enough and they re-formed the Princess Alliance.

"I had to, for the sake of Etheria." Catra crosses her legs, leaning back in her seat. "We needed all the help we could get when Shadow Weaver was running things."

"Shadow Weaver..." C'yra says. "And Adora."

"And Adora, though Shadow Weaver was much more destructive for the sake of being destructive." Catra says, laying C'yra's protest to rest. Yes, Adora was Lord of the Horde, but she never knew the truth of the Horde; Shadow Weaver was very aware that everything they had been feeding their orphaned army was lies. All Shadow Weaver wanted was absolute power, all Adora wanted was to keep Etheria safe, and that was a forgivable offence. Adora has always been *good,* just misguided and lied to her entire life. Could you really blame her for mistrusting the Princesses and raging a war on them if what she was taught was that they were heartless destroyers? No.

"Adora told me that you two kissed once? When she was pretty new to being Lord? Before your... affair... I mean." C'yra says. Catra was not expecting this line of questioning at all - way for Adora to expose her.

"Yes, we did. Surprisingly, no one saw us when it happened."

"Have you always liked her like that?" C'yra questions. Catra considers that.

"I… I think I was physically attracted to her when we met. Hence the kiss, though I flipped out in a panic when it happened. But when it came to the emotional connection... it was a later development." Catra answers. She's always found Adora attractive, she has *eyes* , she can see how attractive Adora is, she always thought it was a shame the Horde Lord was so attractive yet so evil.

"Physically... I suppose I can see why." C'yra says, wrinkling her nose up a little. Catra snorts. In a way, her mom just acknowledged how attractive Adora is, even if she seemed diturbed by it. "It's not like I can't see the appeal of a star crossed lovers relationship. Luna and I weren't technically supposed to be together, but when you know you know."

"That's basically what happened." Catra says. "It was a slow thing. Like, after the first time we... *ahem* , slept together, we laid there, just chatting about random things, and it was nice, and I wanted to see her again, and she wanted to see me too." C'yra's tail flicks a little.

"I just... Do you think this would've ended up happening had she not kidnapped you at Princess Prom?" C'yra asks. Catra bites her lip a little in thought. If she was being honest, her being with Adora felt *inevitable* . Catra doesn't know how, or why, or when, but in some way, she would have given in to Adora and they would have ended up together.

"You know, I think so."

"You do?"

"Yeah, she was flirting with me from the beginning." Catra admits. Adora had always obnoxiously flirted with her, Catra just paid her no mind - even if she had been tempted - one of those times, Catra thinks she probably would have given in.

"She was?"

"Uh huh, she was. I was flattered, but obviously pissed because, you know, Horde Lord. But it became a banter kind of thing." They had always teased one another on the battlefield and maybe Catra had flirted a *little* back at Adora.

"And you think that eventually, even if she hadn't kidnapped you at Princess Prom, that you would've ended up with her?"

"Yeah, I'm pretty sure."

"The Horde Lord?"

"Mhmm, believe it or not, we did talk while fighting out on the battlefield. Obviously not to the extent that we did while in her room, but yeah." They actually talked a fair amount when they were on the battlefield.

"I guess I didn't think Adora was really your... type." C'yra says. "Well, not that I know what that is, but she always seemed... arrogant."

"The arrogance was more of a facade." Catra explains.

"A facade?" C'yra turns her head to the side. "I don't know, she still seems pretty cocky sometimes."

"Well, cockiness and arrogance are two different things when it comes to her." Catra laughs a little. "She's cocky when she's being playful, or teasing, but she's not arrogant. She was just

taught that being in charge meant being in control of everything and making sure everyone knew you were the strongest." Catra explains. Adora *is* cocky, Catra can't deny that, but her arrogance was more when she was Lord. Adora's cockiness is simply her being a dork now, a dork with *confidence* .

"I suppose I see the difference," C'yra hums. "She certainly cares about you, a lot. I suppose that's all I can ask of her."

"She's been taking care of me since our first encounter." Catra says, smiling at the memory. Adora has always taken care of her.

"Yeah?"

"Yeah, back when the Fright Zone only had ration bars, she went through the stash of contraband to make sure I had something more palatable to eat. And she made sure that I was okay every time."

"Sometimes I forget Adora is a person with feelings," C'yra admits. To be fair, she isn't the only person who's done that. "It's so easy to see her as the Horde Lord, as a heartless destroyer."

"She's not heartless." Catra says firmly. Adora has a *giant* heart, possibly bigger than anyone Catra has ever met. "She thought that we would make it in time to evacuate the villages that were attacked. She cares so much about the people of the Fright Zone. Adora has *never* been heartless, she's just been… forced to act a certain way due to the title she holds."

"Well, that's... something..." C'yra says. "I accept Adora as your wife and your mate, that's why I gave you the bracelets. And, while I don't think I'll ever like Adora, she is part of our family."

"I know. You don't have to like her, but you need to at least treat her with respect." Catra says seriously. She would not accept C'yra bad mouthing her wife. She never needed her mom to hold hands with Adora and sing songs, she just wanted her to accept her and respect her as a person.

"I can do that."

"Can you?" Catra asks, raising an eyebrow. C'yra sighs.

"I can. I have been today." She pauses for a moment. "You know, sometimes I forget that Adora was just a kid, brought up in the Horde. She's about the same age as you, I can't imagine what it's like to be raised by someone like Shadow Weaver. My parents were strict and traditional, but at least they didn't torture me for making a mistake." C'yra was *finally* getting it.

"You know, it could have been me in Adora's place had they managed to kidnap me." Catra points out. C'yra may have little sympathy for Adora, but Catra is sure that she can understand Adora's hurt if she suggested what it would be like if Catra had been in her position. C'yra's ears perk up before they press back again.

"I'd never let that happen. They weren't going to take you unless they killed me first."

"What I'm saying is, you didn't think about that when you were angry before."

"No... No, I didn't." C'yra admits. Catra nods. "Thank you," C'yra says again. "For giving me a chance."

"You're welcome. And in reality, you should thank Adora." Catra says.

"We're thanking me?" Adora asks, appearing out of nowhere, holding a Finn in her arms and startling Catra. For someone so clumsy, Adora sure got the jump on two Magicats somehow - to be fair, Catra had been pretty distracted.

"Adora!" Catra exclaims in surprise.

"Catra?" Adora smiles at her wife.

"What are you doing here? Why did you bring Finn?" Catra asks, glancing at her mom.

"I wanted to see how you were doing and I didn't want to leave them." Adora says. "They're very clingy."

"Sounds like a certain someone I know." Catra comments, rolling her eyes.

"Me? Do you mean me?" Adora asks.

"I very much mean you." Catra responds dryly. Adora rolls her eyes fondly.

"I've been trying to get them to say mama but... they're still not talking."

"Sometimes it takes some babies a little longer." C'yra comments.

"That's true. But I'm sure that they'll say it soon." Catra reassures. She felt on edge. She didn’t like C’yra being around Finn.

"So... how are things going in here?" Adora asks cautiously, adjusting Finn. C’yra was right about one thing: Adora really has no subtly.

"They're... fine." Catra answers her wife.

"I should get back to Half-Moon," C'yra says, standing. She glances at Adora and Finn briefly, making Catra tense, before she looks away. "Thank you for listening." She says to Catra.

"Thank you for apologising." Catra responds casually.

"Of course," She says. "Adora."

"Your majesty." Adora says in acknowledgement. She watches as C'yra leaves before she looks back at Catra. "Are you actually okay?"

"I'm... fine?" Catra looks in the direction of where C'yra went off to. "I'm surprised she actually apologised and meant it. Like, she seemed genuinely sorry. Not like the other times." Adora smiles, obviously relieved that C'yra had taken her advice and apologised and meant it.

"I'm glad." Adora says. "She seemed like she was ready when she talked to me."

"Yeah? You think so?"

"Yeah," Adora nods. "I think she secretly likes me."

"She literally just said she's probably never going to like you."

"I recall you saying something similar."

"That's true, but the circumstances were pretty different, babe." Catra rolls her eyes in amusement. It’s not like Adora can romance her mother. "How's our kitten?"

"They're good," Adora says with a wide smile. "Isn't that right, Finn?" Adora asks. "Come on... you can say mama... or yes... or... anything really." Adora encourages.

"Mm..." Finn whines before giggling and patting Adora's cheek, the sight warms Catra’s chest.

"Guess not yet, huh?" Catra says with a purr.

"They're getting there." Adora says, kissing them on their head. "I sometimes wonder who taught me to talk... Imagining Shadow Weaver doing that seems improbable."

"Yeah, I highly doubt she did that." Catra shrugs, patting the spot next to her. "I wonder who."

"Maybe I just picked it up?" Adora says with a frown as she sits down beside Catra with finn in her lap. "Finn can talk like a champ, I just know it, isn't that right buddy?" Catra laughs.

"Babe, just leave them be for a bit."

"Alright, alight," Adora says. "Things went well with Shadow Weaver. Although, she was really laying into C'yra, I kind of thought C'yra was going to claw her eye out instead of taking her magic." Catra looks mildly concerned at that.

"What exactly happened during the whole... magic sealing thing?"

"Shadow Weaver has always said... Mean things about you. Horrible things. Usually to get under my skin, but she did it with C'yra too." Adora explains. "And then she brought up your-C'yra's parents. C'yra was uh... talking about how she managed to beat Shadow Weaver before, and Shadow Weaver said that she failed to protect her parents." Catra winces a little.

"Ouch... yeah, I'm not surprised that monster went there." Catra frowns. She knew her mom never got over the loss of her parents, it was one of the reasons she hated the Horde, and Adora, so much. "Good thing her magic is gone now."

"She can't hurt you or Finn with magic anymore." Adora says. "Or anyone else for that matter."

"Or anyone else. Is she being locked away for good?"

"Well I'm not going to let her out," Adora says. "She can die a sad, sad, magic-less witch in that prison cell. She was an evil bitch."

" *Adora* ! Finn can hear you. Don't say words like that, you dummy." She hisses softly. "Babies pick up words like sponges."

"I think we've established that they can't talk yet." Adora says dismissively.

"And they'll still remember it later on." Catra scolds.

"You really think Finn is going to remember me saying bitch and say it at a later point?"

" *Adora* !"

"Alright! I'll censor my words." Adora says. "Shadow Weaver was an evil b-word."

"Good, thank you. And you're right, she was."

"A real ass."

" *Adora* ." Catra deadpans. Adora grins.

"I'm sorry, it's just, your reaction is really funny." Adora says. "Besides, Finn can't speak and they're probably not even listening." Adora says as she gently scratches their little ears.

"You'd be surprised how much babies listen." Catra whacks Adora on her jaw with her tail.

"I don't think Finn is listening. They're just sitting here looking cute, isn't that right Finn?" Adora asks, moving them to her other lap.

"Bi." Finn babbles, making Catra's eyebrows go up in concern.

"If Finn says a curse word because of you, I'm making you sleep on your throne for a week." Catra threatens.

"Ha... they just said bi." Adora says with a nervous laugh. "Like Glimmer and Bow... Does that count as their first word?"

"Technically no? Since it's not the full word."

"I think your *mama* ," Adora stresses the word as she talks to Finn. "Would murder me if your first word was a curse word, so let's not do that, okay little kit?" Finn looks cutely at Adora before bursting into laughter and leaning in for nuzzles. "We made the cutest baby." Adora says, her eyes sparkling a little as she kisses Finn and snuggles them back. "I love them." Catra smiles lovingly and nods in agreement.

"I kind of want to do a family photo shoot one day."

"A photo shoot?"

"Yeah, as a keepsake." Catra explains.

"I suppose they won't be little forever." Adora almost sounds sad with that realisation. Catra gets it, she also wants Finn to stay little forever, but it was inevitable.

"Exactly, it'll be nice to have."

"I want them to be little forever." Adora says and Catra laughs a little as Adora voices her exact thoughts.

"Unfortunately, that's not possible." Catra says.

"You sure?" Adora asks. "We can't get Entrapta to make something?"

"Adora, no. Finn is their own person. They should be allowed to grow up." Catra says, leaning over to kiss Adora on her cheek. It was cute that Adora didn't want their baby to grow up. Adora pouts.

"I know that, it's just..." Adora lifts them up and looks them in their eyes as they smile at her, their little tail wiggling happily. "They're my baby." Adora says, kissing them on their nose. "And I don't want them to become a moody teenager."

"Well, If we do our best to be good parents, we can maybe limit the moody teenager stage." Catra says, patting Adora on her bicep. "Now come on, I want to go home."

* * *

Catra was in the kitchen with Finn, trying to decide what to eat, when there was a knock at the door. Catra looks at Adora and raises an eyebrow, shrugging. Neither of them had been expecting anyone to drop by but who ends up being at the door is the *last* person Catra expected to rock up at her front door.

The first thing that alarms Catra is the sound of a commotion that her ears easily pick up, the next is her wife snarling ‘ *you* ’. When Catra looks up, she sees Adora has Double Trouble pinned to the wall by their shirt. Catra’s first reaction is to calm Adora down - or this could get very ugly. She knows that Adora was still *pissed* at DT, and so was Catra, but she didn’t need Adora killing DT in their home and giving them a haunted house with a ghost who just *lives for the drama of it all* . "Love, relax, I'm okay now. No need to commit slaughter." Catra says, touching her arm.

"You have to be joking..." Adora says, still pinning DT to the wall by their shirt. "They're the reason you almost died! And then they just... *disappeared* ."

"This really does remind me of some of the times we spent together, my Lord, but you're stretching my shirt."

"Shut up Double Trouble." Adora huffs, looking at Catra - probably to gauge her emotions. Catra is well aware that DT and Adora have had flings before.

"Adora, let them go." Catra repeats. "Now please. We're not staining our new floorboards for an idiot." Adora scowls but slowly releases Double Trouble from her grip.

"I resent being called an idiot." DT says, dusting themselves down.

"And you don't get to resent anything when you're the one showing up to my home uninvited, Double Trouble. Or would you prefer I let my wife, She-Ra, fling your behind out of here?" Catra asks, raising an eyebrow.

"Alright, alright, kitten, relax." DT says, waving their hand.

"Don't call her Kitten."

"Right, that's your pet name for her, my bad." Double Trouble says. "I just dropped by because I heard the Horde made nice with the Rebellion. Figured I couldn't be in hiding

forever, although you guys generally don't come near the Wastes, you should consider changing that." They say. "Can't have a Horde and Rebellion bounty on my head, that would be unhealthy for me, and everyone knows the big bad Horde Lord is not my friend anymore."

"Your protection is gone." Adora says before she shakes her head. "Figures you're here for something for yourself." Catra glances over at DT, her expression not giving anything away.

"My question is, why exactly are you here, Double Trouble? We didn't invite you. No one has heard from you in months. So why are you suddenly here now?" Catra asks suspiciously.

"Wouldn't believe me if I told you I came here to visit some old friends?" DT asks, running their hand over Adora's chest. Adora frowns and crosses her arms over her chest, glaring at them, Catra narrows her eyes at them. "Yikes, it's colder in here than the Kingdom of Snows, and I would know, I was at Princess Prom."

"If you would be so kind as to *not* touch my wife." Catra hisses coldly. "And second of all, we're not your friends. Especially not after what you did."

"Fine," They huff. "I came to make nice. I could always disguise myself around you guys, but where's the fun in hiding-"

"We all know you like to be centre stage." Adora interrupts, rolling her eyes.

"That I do." Double Trouble agrees. Finn makes a sound in Catra’s arms. "Oh, your little brat is here, how cute."

"Don't. Even. *Look* at them." Catra hisses. Her claws come out on instinct as she glares at DT. "You don't get to come in here and ask to make nice when you're the reason I nearly died!"

" *Me-ow* , relax kit-" They stop in their sentence when they see Adora narrow her eyes. "I'm here to apologise. It was never anything personal, darling, just business. The Rebellion paid

me for betraying Adora and you. Adora, the hunky Horde Lord, hadn't been paying me. A shapeshifter has to make money some way, not all of us have *Princess* money."

"Adora... take Finn please. Take them for a walk or something." Catra says, her voice shaking with how angry she was feeling.

"Uh..." Adora looks at her wife and then at Double Trouble, suddenly unsure, before she goes and picks Finn up. "C'mon little kit, mama wants some alone time." Adora says, walking towards the back of the house and outside.

Catra waits until she hears the door close and Adora takes a few steps away before speaking again. "You nearly killed me. Do you have any idea how much I suffered because you told them before I was ready? Do you have a-any idea how painful it still is?!" Catra yells, stuttering over her words only a little. She was *pissed* , Double Trouble was the reason everything had gone the way it had.

"I'm sorry kitten, it was never anything personal." Double Trouble says. "I didn't know they'd be so brutal."

"Don't call me kitten when you made me nearly lose mine!" Catra yells, swiping her claws through the air. Double Trouble sighs.

"I never meant for that either," They say. "I thought it might be fun, I never knew how close you were to... the edge."

"That it would be fun making someone suffer?! Yeah, how fucking fun I imagine that was for you!" Catra pants, clearly angry. "I... I nearly lost Finn... I got put under house arrest, I lost most of my support group for the majority of my pregnancy, I was verbally abused by the people that were supposed to guard me and I couldn't even speak to Adora. I was isolated, tired and lonely. Even with the three people, almost four, that supported me, I was hurting so much that I wish I had died that day, Double Trouble. I wish I had died and I still struggle with those feelings even now." Catra laughs tearfully. "I don't know why I'm telling you this, you probably don't even care."

"I do feel bad, darling," Double Trouble says. "Truth be told, I was angry at our favourite blondie. I know she was going through something, but she was ignoring me. So I decided to turn on her. I always go with the side most likely to win, that was not going to be Adora. I know I have a tendency to go too far, I didn't mean to push you so hard."

"Yeah, well you did. You pushed too far. So congratulations, you chose the winning side." Catra says bitterly. If Double Trouble came to apologise, they were doing a very bad job of it.

"Look, I can't have you and tall blonde and handsome angry at me." Double Trouble says. "So what do you need for me to make it up to you?"

"You can't make this up to me, Double Trouble." Catra shakes her head. "You went too far and because you went and opened your mouth, I ended up getting hurt in so many ways."

"There's nothing you want?" DT asks. "Not even with my special talents?"

"No. There isn't." Catra growls. In fact, she has everything she could ever want: Adora and Finn. DT sighs and runs a clawed hand through their hair.

"Fine, then an apology?"

"Honestly, not really. An apology doesn't undo all the damage. If I haven't even forgiven the woman who gave birth to me, why would I forgive *you* for causing the whole chain reaction?" Catra asks.

"Honestly kitten, you should be thanking me." Double Trouble says. "I got the truth out for you, you were never going to tell your dear friends, and then it was just going to get worse the longer you waited. "Catra freezes, hands clenched tightly into fists to the point her own hands bled.

"Double Trouble... You better be glad I didn't tell Adora to fling you." She takes a deep breath. "I will never, *never* , thank you for doing what you did. You're not sorry. You don't

feel bad. You were just acting because you don't want a target on your back. Well you can fuck off. Stop wasting my time and get out of my house."

"You're probably right," They say. "I'm loyal to the highest bidder. The Rebellion paid a lot of money for my information, but I really did not mean to push you so hard that second time, in the town, the way you talked... I realised I had gone too far."

"Get out of my house, Double Trouble. You don't get to come back after I suffered the consequences that left lasting scars and say you ‘feel bad’." Catra hasn’t felt this angry at someone in a long time, not since C’yra.

"Very well, darling," They say with a sigh. "I thought we could make up."

"You thought wrong." Catra loosens her fists. "Even more so after suggesting that I should have thanked you."

"Sometimes people have to be pushed so they can fly."

"Shut up!" Catra hisses. "You literally did it when I was still recovering from a fucking *stab wound*!"

"Well, yes, that is true, but you seem well enough now. It all worked out for the best."

"I have to go to therapy every week, Double Trouble! I nearly *died* ! My relationship with the person I once called mama is *shattered* because of what you did!" Catra yells.

"Okay, so maybe for the *best* is a strong word." DT says. "But you have Adora at least."

"She has trauma too." Catra frowns. "And C'yra nearly killed her."

"She did?"

"Yes, before her trial."

"Yikes… Well I didn't know all of that was going to happen," DT says.

"Then maybe next time you do something, think about the consequences." Catra says, pointing them on their chest with the tip of her claw digging into them.

"I will," They say. "There's really nothing I can do for you? Get revenge on your mom?"

"There's no point." Catra shakes her head. "I'm not gonna be like her and be cruel." Catra says - plus, she'd pretty much patched that up, no need to sink the same ship twice.

"You're a better person than most," Double Trouble says. "Did you even care that Adora had been using me to spy on the Rebellion for months?"

"No, I didn't, because it happened before we even confessed to each other that we had feelings." Catra had been upset about it, at first, but she knew now that it was just a tactic of war. Adora and the Horde had been using spies for many years.

"Interesting." DT says, stroking their chin. "She'd been sleeping with you for a long time before that though."

"And? Neither of us had realised that we had feelings at that point. And let's be honest, she probably asked for updates on me, didn't she?"

"Yes she did."

"I figured."

"Really," DT says. "Your fight isn't with me, it's with the people of the Rebellion who reacted so cruelly."

"My fight is also with you because of course they were going to act poorly if a complete stranger told them what you did!" Catra yells in disbelief. Double Trouble's denial of responsibility was impressive, if not frustrating.

"Okay, and how would they have reacted if you had told them?" DT asks.

"How would I even know?! I didn't get the chance to tell them, but hopefully it would have been better if I was the one telling them."

"I think you're being delusional," Double Trouble says. "Queen C'yra was never going to react well, you and I both know that."

"Yeah, but it wouldn't have been as bad had I had the chance to tell her myself." Catra really isn't sure of that if she's honest. She thinks, now, after everything, her mom would have always reacted the way that she had. At least if she'd been able to tell Glimmer and the others she would have been able to explain, instead, she had her whole world ripped violently out from under her.

"You really believe that?" DT doesn't sound convinced.

"I don't know, okay? Maybe things would have gone better if I had the chance to be honest with them instead of the spy telling them. For fuck's sake, they thought *I* was the one spying instead of you." Catra still couldn't believe the Rebellion had ever thought she would betray them like that.

"They thought you'd been whispering things in Adora’s ear during your pillow talk, yes."

"I wasn't."

"It would've been easy to think, given your proximity to the Lord of the Horde."

"I was literally rambling to her about books I read and telling her about my hobbies." Catra points out. She never had betrayed anything to Adora. Now, she told Adora everything, but they were on the same side now, back then… Catra had been with Adora, but she never told her something that would give her an advantage over the Rebellion - even if that's what they had thought.

"You can see why that'd be hard for the Rebellion to believe, no?"

"I was the one that said I was worried there was a spy! Why would I expose that there was a spy if I was the spy? That makes no sense!"

"What's that got to do with me anyway?" Double Trouble asks. "It's not like I told them you had betrayed them, they drew their own conclusions after I revealed your affair."

"Just forget it. You wouldn't understand." Catra rubs her temples. "Please leave."

"Will you at least tell that wife of yours not to murder me if she happens to see me again?" Double Trouble asks.

"Yeah, no. You can go ahead and tell her yourself. Since you felt it was your right to tell everyone my business." Catra says angrily. Figures Double Trouble only came here so they wouldn’t be punched by Adora if they happened to run into her.

"Really, kitten? You're going to stay mad? You don't know what it's like in the Wastes, so I guess it makes sense that you wouldn't understand." Catra shakes her head at them.

"Perhaps I would have been more sympathetic if I didn't nearly die because of what you did."

"That... is a fair point." DT admits. "I suppose I'll leave you alone then."

"Good." Catra growls out. DT bows and then exits out of the door.

"You'll probably never see me again, kitten, shame, really, I feel like we could've been *great* friends." Catra can't believe their gall.

"Yeah, well, friends don't out each other knowing that it could put the other in danger." Catra says through clenched teeth.

"Alright, you've made your point. You're never going to forgive me."

"Glad to know my point has been heard."

"You can call your wife back."

"Adora! You can come back now!" Catra says out loud, knowing the blonde didn't go far. Adora comes back into the house at the same time Catra slams the door in Double Trouble's face. She will be happy to never see them again.

"You okay?" Adora asks, walking over to Catra and offering Finn to comfort her.

"No, I'm pissed." Catra says as she holds Finn close. Finn made everything okay, as did her tall blonde wife. "They don't seem to understand all the harm they caused."

"That's... not that surprising." Adora says. "DT doesn't really care about people like that."

"I noticed." Catra grumbles.

“A really good spy though.” Adora comments and Catra scowls at her. Adora falls silent. “Too soon?” She asks with a nervous smile. Catra rolls her eyes. Sometimes, Adora really can’t read the room. "You should've let me punch them."

"No, it wouldn't have been worth it." Catra says with a sigh.

"Would've made me feel better."

"Me too, probably, but it's still not worth the trouble."

"Maybe." Adora says. "At least we have this cutie." Adora says, playing with Finn's hand.

"Yeah, I'm happy we have them." Catra smiles softly. "They really are the cutest little kitten."

"I'm pretty cute too, right?" Adora asks. Catra laughs and looks at her mischievously.

"Hmm, I don't know..." She says with a teasing tone to her voice.

"You don't know?" Adora asks. "You did marry me, or was it for my skills in the bedroom?"

"Hmmm." Catra says, not answering the blonde.

" *Hmmm* ," Adora mirrors back. "You're lucky you're holding Finn."

"And why is that?"

"Because I would have you pinned to the ground right about now."

"And done what exactly?" Catra asks with great amusement.

"You'll find out, when you put Finn down." Adora says. Catra can’t help but laugh.

"Then maybe I shouldn't put them down."

"You have to put them down eventually."

"Maybe later."

"Then maybe I'll get you back later." Adora says, poking Catra on her stomach, causing Catra to yelp a little. "Now... Let's eat?"

"Eating sounds like a good idea. Good distraction too."

"Yeah, and later you'll be my dessert." Adora says, winking at Catra.

"Adora." Catra would facepalm if she wasn’t currently holding Finn in her arms.

"What?" Adora asks. "It's the truth."

"Not in front of Finn."

"They still can't talk, they don't know what I'm saying."

“But they could pick it up and that is the last thing I want to happen."

"You worry too much." Adora says dismissively.

"And sometimes, my love. You don't worry enough." Catra says.

"I-" Adora blinks. "I don't think that's true, I worry a lot."

"I mean about what we say around Finn, dork." Catra says. It is true, Adora does worry a significant amount, but she still has zero filter when it comes to her words. Adora rolls her eyes.

"I don't need to, you have that covered." Adora assures.

"This is why we balance each other out." Catra says with a smile, leaning in and giving Adora a sweet kiss on her lips. Adora smiles and leans in to kiss Catra again, lifting her chin gently with her hand. Finn makes a sound almost like they were annoyed at the lack of attention on them.

"Don't worry Finn, I love you too." Adora says, kissing them on their head. Catra grins.

"They got your clingy-ness." Catra comments.

"Pffft, says you, you're very clingy."

"Do I need to remind you that our entire relationship started because a certain someone invited me into their bed for a second time?" Catra asks, raising an eyebrow at Adora.

"And you agreed."

"That I did, and I'm glad I did."

"Plus, you're the one who made me food." Adora comments. Catra laughs.

"Is that what sealed the deal for you?"

"Sure," Adora hums. "The donuts especially."

"Oh, for sure. The donuts were fun to make." Catra agrees. As soon as Adora smirks, Catra realises what she meant by that.

"Are we talking about the same donuts?" She asks.

"Are you serious?" Catra asks in disbelief. Catra really didn't know there were so many innuendos for sex before she started seeing Adora.

"What?" Adora asks innocently.

"You know exactly what I'm referring to."

"Yeah? And what are you going to do about it?" Adora asks with a cheeky grin. Catra narrows her eyes and then she walks behind Adora, pausing before she smacks Adora on her

ass. Adora lets out a yelp. “Hey!” She protests. “No fair! That’s very hypocritical of you, I’m not allowed to say innuendos but you’re allowed to slap my butt?” Adora asks.

“So you don’t want to continue this tonight?” Catra asks.

“Now hold on a second,” Adora says. “Don’t get crazy. I- Catra?” Adora asks as Catra walks away and towards the living room. “Wait! Yes, yes I do.” Gods, Catra loves that dork so much.

Chapter End Notes

Well, C'yra isn't gonna get killed off like a lot of you hoped. She is *starting* to make up for her actions. As you can see with her slowly getting along with Adora. We hope you stick with us for the next few chapters as Lord Adora will soon be coming to a close. Thank you for reading! -M

Things are starting to come together for them. They've been through a lot, they deserve their happy ending. C'yra is finally understanding the actions she took were bad and hopefully she'll make it up to Catra eventually. Also, Catra and Adora's banter is one of my favourite things about them :) See y'all next week! -S

As always, you can find us on Twitter @ceolordadora and our CC is the same !! You can also find me (S) on Tumblr @sherasswordstrap !!

The Best Friend Squad

Chapter Summary

Adora climbs the stairs of their house and comes to stop at the door of their bedroom. She pauses, leaning against the door and watching her wife. Catra's ear twitches and she turns to look at Adora. "Hey you-" Catra's eyes narrow a little. "Have you showered lately?" Catra asks.

"Yeah, not so long ago actually. I heard someone at the door after I got dressed and went to answer it and- What are you doing?" Adora asks, giggling a little when Catra walks up to her and starts rubbing her head under her chin.

"Marking you," Catra answers, rubbing her cheek against Adora while purring. Adora may be biased, but she's pretty sure she has the cutest wife in existence.

Chapter Notes

Hey y'all !! Here's the final chapter before the final 3 epilogue chapters! We hope you enjoy :)!

Warning, NSFW ahead.

See the end of the chapter for more notes

Adora climbs the stairs of their house and comes to stop at the door of their bedroom. She pauses, leaning against the door and watching her wife. Catra's ear twitches and she turns to look at Adora. "Hey you-" Catra's eyes narrow a little. "Have you showered lately?" Catra asks.

"Yeah, not so long ago actually. I heard someone at the door after I got dressed and went to answer it and- What are you doing?" Adora asks, giggling a little when Catra walks up to her and starts rubbing her head under her chin.

"Marking you," Catra answers, rubbing her cheek against Adora while purring. Adora may be biased, but she's pretty sure she has the cutest wife in existence. "Can't have you walking

around and *not* smelling of me." Adora chuckles as she wraps her arms around Catra, kissing her on her temple before she also plants a kiss to Finn's little head.

"Your friends are here," Adora says.

"Hm?" Catra hums curiously. "Glimmer and Bow? They're your friends too."

"Bow? Maybe. Glimmer? Probably not." Adora says. Catra hums as she takes a step back. Finn looks up at Adora and reaches their small hands out. Adora smiles as she takes them into her arms. "Will you go talk to them?" Adora asks.

"So long as you come with me, Dummy." Catra says, patting her bicep. Adora rolls her eyes and follows after Catra.

Things were good. Things were better than good, they were *great* . With the war over, the Horde receiving better accommodations from the Rebellion in their treaty, reconstruction of the Rebellion - and just general construction of the Scorpion Kingdom/Horde - things were finally settling. Everyone was pretty much okay with Adora, she still got some uncertain looks from villagers and civilians but most of the Princesses found her presence, at the very least, tolerable. Adora was glad, she had meant it when she had said she was tired of fighting - she also didn't have to worry about Shadow Weaver anymore.

Things with C'yra were better, but it was still a work in progress. Part of Adora wonders if Catra will ever fully forgive her mother, or if C'yra had permanently burnt that bridge. Catra had told Adora that she was willing to try, but she clearly didn't trust C'yra anymore - and the love lost there had been *significant* . They were, at the very least, talking again. C'yra never admitted she liked Adora, and she was unlikely to, but at least Adora didn't fear that she might get more scars from the Magicat Queen.

When they get to the front door, Bow and Glimmer are standing there. "Catra," Glimmer says. "How's married life?" She questions.

"Seems you'll be finding out soon enough," Catra says, raising an eyebrow. Adora follows her line of sight. *Huh* . Adora hadn't noticed that before. Glimmer was wearing a ring.

Glimmer grins and kisses Bow on his cheek causing the archer to blush.

“Damn right.” Glimmer states.

“ *Finally* .” Catra states and Adora rolls her eyes. “That’s been a long time coming.”

“I didn’t know Princesses could marry non-Princes or Princesses.” Adora comments.

“Catra married *you* .” Glimmer fires back.

“But I’m a Princess, Sparkles.” Adora says with a grin. “And a *Lord* . Catra’s been on her knees for me- *ow!* ” Adora is cut off when Catra elbows her in the ribs.

“Stop being crass.” Catra says, without even looking at Adora. Adora rubs her ribs and grumbles under her breath. “Why are you two here?” Catra asks, moving the topic along.

“We were going to Bow’s dads, and I recalled Adora wanting to visit them again to get more information on She-Ra,” Glimmer explains. “So I figured… What about a Best Friend Squad Road Trip, just like old times?”

“I don’t know if you guys noticed,” Catra says. “But we have a baby now.” Adora smiles as she looks down at Finn who was looking up at her with wide eyes. “We can’t just leave them, and I’m definitely not taking them. Old times means we’re going to run into trouble.”

“One moment,” Glimmer says, holding up a finger. One moment she’s standing there and then *poof* she disappears. They stand there for a moment, and the next Glimmer teleports back with Spinnerella and Netossa accompanying her. The wives seem startled but when they see who they’re with and where they are, they seem to quickly realise what’s happening. “Babysitters.” Glimmer announces proudly.

“Did it occur to you that we might have plans?” Netossa asks, crossing her arms.

“Finn!” Spinnerella says, already stepping forward to take them into her arms. “They’re so cute… We can definitely babysit our favourite godchild.” Netossa sighs. Adora knows that Finn’s cuteness is a huge weak spot for her as it is for anyone else. They’re just too cute to say no to.

“What do you think?” Catra asks Adora this time, looking up at her. Adora looks at Glimmer and Bow. Catra hasn’t exactly had a lot of opportunities to be with her friends, this is a perfect one, and one for Adora to maybe bond with Glimmer over. Adora smiles and kisses Catra on her lips.

“I think I would go anywhere with you.” Adora whispers. “Why not?” She asks. Catra lets out a soft breath and lays her fingers gently on Adora’s chest.

“Let's do this.” Catra says, nodding at Glimmer and Bow.

The pair get ready to go on an adventure. Adora makes sure to bring her sword - you never knew when She-Ra might come in handy - and Catra changes into clothes more suited for a trek through the Whispering Woods. She pauses for a moment, looking at herself in the mirror. “I’ve gained weight.” Catra says, pinching herself a little. Adora notices her deep set frown and walks over to her.

“Catra,” Adora says gently. “You carried a whole baby, it’s only natural.” Catra frowns, Adora’s words seemingly did not reassure her. “You’re beautiful, and perfect, and I love you so much.” Adora kisses her on her nose and Catra rolls her eyes but her tail swishes behind her, showing her true feelings. Adora *had* reassured her.

“I love you too, Dummy. Now let's try and not die.” Adora laughs as she releases Catra and they finish getting ready before they set off with Glimmer and Bow.

The Whispering Woods may be lived in by Adora and Catra but they had protections set up around their home, Adora assumed Lance and George were similar with their library. The Woods were dangerous, there were some *nasty* creatures out there, and there was a reason that the Whispering Woods had prevented an assault from the Horde for years. As She-Ra, it

is easier for Adora to navigate due to her connection to Etheria, but the Woods can still be dangerous.

As they were walking, Adora uses her sword and its faint glow to help them navigate the quickly darkening Woods. It was almost twilight, the forest was a soft blue with the moon highlighting the ground. “Please tell me why we chose to do this so late?” Adora asks. They should’ve left in the morning, not when it was pretty much night.

“What? Is the big bad Horde Lord *scared* ?” Glimmer taunts with a grin. Adora rolls her eyes.

“Not all of us can teleport away.” Adora grumbles.

“Even if we did this in daylight, something would go wrong,” Catra chimes in. “It’s the Best Friend Squad Curse.”

“What?” Adora asks.

“It’s like Murphy’s Law with us.” Glimmer says with amusement. “Anything that *can* go wrong, *will* go wrong. You should get used to it, you’re part of the Best Friend Squad now.” Adora feels warmth spread through her chest at Glimmer’s words. She’s never been a part of something like this before, and she’s more than happy to be included in this so-called ‘Best Friend Squad’. Glimmer even seems to *like* her now. Adora never thought they’d make it here. She has *friends* , and they’re *Princesses* , she’s *married* to a Princess. Sometimes she wonders how the hell all of this happened.

The Whispering Woods are mostly quiet. Every now and again, something catches Catra’s ear, but nothing they should worry about. Adora suspects that if there was something they should worry about, they’d all know it at the same time. Despite all that, Adora is enjoying herself. Maybe they’re being a little louder than they probably should, especially Catra and Glimmer who seem to be bickering - although Adora has been told that that is perfectly normal and ‘just how they are’.

As it turns out, they don't need Catra's enhanced hearing to know that something *bad* is happening. The first sign that something isn't quite right is when the ground starts to shake, causing all four of them to freeze in their tracks. Catra's tail goes completely still, right to the tip and her ears twitch like crazy as she tracks the sound (and danger). The next second, a big bug-like creature emerges from the surrounding woods. "Uh… What the heck is that?!" Adora exclaims.

"We should probably run-" Before Catra can finish that sentence the bug advances towards her, shaking Adora right into action.

"For the Honour of Grayskull!" Adora yells as she extends her sword above her head. She feels the familiar warmth of She-Ra's magic wash over her as she transforms and when she looks to her right she sees Glimmer staring at her.

"Wow…" Glimmer says, a blush colouring her cheeks. Adora winks before she leaps forward, meeting the bug's giant claw with her sword. She-Ra is strong, *incredibly* strong, and Adora easily manages to stop the creature from attacking her wife. Adora looks behind her at Catra, who was staring up at her. She knows it might just be the adrenaline of nearly being crushed by a giant bug, but Catra's pupils are wide and her tail is swaying around like crazy.

"Is She-Ra really that attractive?" Adora asks in disbelief before the bug pulls a *dirty* trick and knocks her feet out from under her. Adora falls, ungracefully, on her ass and Catra is quick to pull her out of the way. They just saved each other.

"We should *definitely* run!" Catra yells. "Glimmer!"

"On it!" Glimmer calls back. Adora also sees some arrows being fired at the bug.

"Come on hot stuff, on your feet." Catra instructs. Adora does what she's told almost immediately.

"What is Glimmer going to do?" Adora asks, holding her sword up. "Sparkle at it."

“That’s *exactly* what she’s going to do.” Catra says with a grin. Adora goes to ask what good that’s going to do when she hears the bug let out a sound of distress. When Adora looks over she sees that the thing is disoriented and *angry* .

“That’s our cue!” Glimmer yells as she teleports away, grabbing Bow’s hand and teleporting them over to Catra and Adora. “Well then? Put those *godly* long legs to use and run!” Glimmer takes off with Bow and Catra laughs, airy and free, as she follows after her. Adora can do nothing but follow after them. This is so chaotic.

“Is this what it’s like with you guys all the time?!” Adora asks, holding her arms out in disbelief.

“Pretty much, yeah!” Catra responds, and she’s *grinning* . Adora hasn’t seen Catra this alive in a long time. Well, not this type of alive anyway, not since Beast Island. There’s just something about having to run for your life. Adora finds herself *laughing* . Nothing gets the blood pumping like running from death. “Now keep up, *She-Ra* !” Catra taunts before she takes off full speed. Adora scoffs as she speeds up after her. Catra is *still* so fast.

And they do. They run. They run so much that Adora’s lungs *burn* . Adora doesn’t even know if they’re still being followed or not. At some point, however, Adora loses her footing and tumbles down a hill, landing in a heap.

Adora groans as she looks up to see what looks like a stone with glowing writing, writing that Adora can *read* . “First One’s writing…” Adora says in wonder. The place was illuminated in blue and Adora could read the writing - only partly, since it was worn down. This must be one of the First Ones ruins that litter Etheria.

Adora presses her palm to one of the pillars and jumps when a sudden hologram pops up. Adora turns, seeing the figure waving. She can’t understand what they’re saying but suddenly there are multiple ones. Messages, Adora realises. Messages from people that don’t exist anymore. Except, Adora. It’s almost sad.

Adora stands there, staring, until she hears the Best Friend Squad approaching. She feels Catra press her hand on her back and Adora sighs, melting under her touch. “You okay,

Love?" Catra asks gently.

"First Ones," Adora says. "I… I've been thinking of them as some… I don't know… I am a First One, according to Shadow Weaver, but it all felt just so… *unreachable* . But look at them," Adora extends her hand to the holograms. "They were just people… Sending messages for loved ones that never reached them." Adora sighs as she lifts her hand up to the stone and shuts off the holograms. "They can rest now. Be at peace." Adora says quietly.

"Come on," Glimmer says. "I think we lost that bug thing. Let's make camp for the night. I can set up some magical wards to keep us safe." Adora nods and then looks at Catra. She feels immediately at ease and takes her hand.

"Let's go," Adora says. "Before that thing finds us again."

"Agreed," Glimmer says. They all begin to walk off to find a spot to camp. "Wait, you're a First One, Adora?"

"Sure am," Adora answers. "I also wanted to tell you that I'm married, and you're an engaged woman, so you should stop looking at me like that." Adora grins playfully.

"Wh-" Glimmer splutters. "You asshole!" Their laughter echoes through the woods.

* * *

After setting up camp and eating some of the supplies Bow had brought with him, the couples had settled down to sleep for the night. Glimmer and Bow were a few feet away, far enough away that Adora felt more than comfortable to try and get lucky with her wife. Catra knows by now the signs of when Adora is hinting at sex, and she knows her current kissing of Catra from her lips, to her jaw, to her neck and the way her hands trail over the fabric of Catra's clothes. It's pretty obvious what Adora is feeling. "Adora, are you serious?" Catra whisper-hisses in the dark. "You're horny *now* ?"

"I'm always horny, but we've been so busy lately we've hardly had time to... you know." Adora whispers back.

"Glimmer and Bow are *right there*." Catra reminds her.

"So be quiet then." Adora says, grinning. Somewhere in the dark, Catra moves her tail so it hits Adora's nose. "Come on, Catra..." Adora says quietly as she moves her lips to Catra's neck. She bites the skin there before she sucks, marking the woman. Adora can hear Catra's breath picking up. Even after all this time together, Catra still can't resist Adora and Adora is well aware of this fact.

She hears Catra sigh before she turns around, readjusting herself. Catra's eyes glow in the dark. They're *beautiful* . "Okay," Catra says. "But *you* have to be quiet too." Adora raises her eyebrows at that.

"Well I plan to go down on *you* . So it really is just you who needs to be quiet." Adora sees Catra roll her eyes, even in the dark. There's a long pause before Adora feels Catra wrap her arms around Adora's neck and pull her down.

"Why are you still talking? Shouldn't you be using your mouth for other things?" Catra asks. Adora feels herself flush at Catra's words. There's absolutely no way she's going to *not* do that after Catra just said that to her.

Adora leans down to kiss Catra on her lips. She hooks her fingers in the waistband of Catra's pants and tugs them down. "What do you want, Catra?" Adora whispers against Catra's lips. "Ask me," Adora says. "Ask me to *fuck* you." Catra gasps.

"Adora…" Catra says, lifting her hips up. Adora can tell that Catra doesn't want to give in, but she will. She so often does. Especially for Adora's tongue. Catra lets out a short frustrated huff before she reluctantly says those exact words. "Fuck me, Adora. *Please* ." Adora's not going to say no to that.

Adora moves down Catra's body, pressing open mouthed kisses as she goes, even over fabric. It's dark to her, so when she finally reaches Catra's pussy it takes her a moment to map out

just exactly where she is. She reaches her hand up, squeezing Catra's breast in her hand as she swipes up between her folds. She knows when she hits Catra's clit because she lets out a loud mewl that quickly gets choked off. Adora decides to focus her attention there.

She does her usual routine, Catra knows it well by now, but Adora has a simple rule that she lives by: if it's not broken, don't fix it. Adora knows *exactly* what Catra likes, has spent literal hours between her thighs, she likes doing a good job and she's damn well not going to fail now. *Whoa… Fail…* Adora shakes her head a little. She is not about to drag her *trauma* into *sex* . No, she'll focus on pleasing Catra instead.

Catra is trying to be quiet but in the silence of the Whispering Woods, and with her nearby slumbering best friends, Catra's ragged breathing might as well be drums. Adora, honestly, doesn't really care if Glimmer and Bow hear, they'll get over it, so she pulls out all the big guns she has to push Catra closer and closer. She flattens her tongue to Catra's clit and sucks it into her mouth causing Catra to arch her back up and let out a small whine. Adora does that for a while, feeling Catra *squirm* under her before she moves down again.

Catra is practically dripping into Adora's mouth and Adora is *loving* it. She really meant it when she said this would never get old to her. She is more than happy to spend a lifetime making love to Catra, especially when she threads her claws into her blonde hair and pushes Adora closer. Adora presses her tongue inside of Catra, feeling Catra grind her hips down, whining a lot more *audibly* now.

So much for being quiet.

Adora works her jaw as fast as she can, trying to keep up with Catra's thrusts. Adora doesn't think there is any better feeling than feeling *Catra* all around her tongue, than being buried *in* Catra. This is her favourite place in all of Etheria. " *Adora* ," Catra says breathlessly, tugging Adora away from having her tongue between her legs. "I need you inside of me... please...." Adora's eyes widen and she nods. She knows Catra can see way better than Adora currently can and so Catra likely saw her nod in confirmation.

Luckily, Adora's sword always faintly glows, at all times, so finding it is relatively easier than Adora was expecting. She transforms it and pulls her trousers down until they're around her ankles. It's slightly harder getting the harness on because of the lighting, and Catra has to assist Adora with her expert vision to help Adora secure it properly.

Once it's in place against Adora, Adora moves her hand down to Catra’s entrance. She pushes her fingers inside of her, gathering up the wetness there on her fingers and then spreads it onto her strap. Catra lets out surprised gasps and small whimpers but otherwise remains mostly silent.

Once Adora is satisfied that Catra is absolutely ready to take her, and that her strap is lubed up enough, she begins to line herself up. She has to feel with her fingers, thanks to the dark, but once the tip of her strap touches the entrance of Catra’s entrance, Adora smirks in triumph.

She pushes in quickly, letting Catra get acclimated to having Adora's strap inside of her. That's when Catra makes her first loud noise. Adora moves towards her, once her strap is fully inside, she uses her forearms to keep herself upright but, otherwise, her body is almost entirely touching Catra’s, their breasts, their hips, their faces are so close together that Adora can *feel* Catra’s hot breath brush her face as it hits her own hot breath midway. It doesn’t matter that they’re mostly clothed, this is one of the hottest things they’ve ever done together.

"I got you, Catra." Adora whispers. Her thrusts aren't fast, in fact, they're more shallow than anything else, a firm fucking, but Catra is clearly still enjoying it. Her claws come out and they dig into the skin on Adora’s back. "Such a good Kitten, aren't you?" Adora coos. "My Kitten."

" *Holy shit*- Adora... I..." Catra goes quiet but the way her claws drag down Adora’s back and her head falls back, Adora knows exactly what Catra was about to say.

"Not yet, Kitten." Adora warns, thrusting harder at the same time that manages to draw a whine from the brunette before she quickly silences. "You can't cum without my permission, okay?" Adora asks. Adora can't fully make out Catra's expression, but she feels her annoyance in the way that her claws dig deeper. Adora smirks a little. She could spend all the time in the world edging Catra, she could go until dawn, but that was not a possibility due to their current surroundings and... company.

"I knew I fed your ego too much," Catra jabs before she gasps as Adora gives her a hard thrust in retaliation.

"I plan to have my way with you, Kitten," Adora whispers hotly against Catra's jaw. She has missed this. She knows that their relationship has developed far beyond just the physical stage, and sometimes Adora feels as though sex isn't that important to a relationship anymore, but maybe that's because they don't really have the time to do this recently - not when they have Finn. Being physical with Catra is one of Adora's favourite activities, she's been distracted lately, but it's moments like this where she remembers just how much she *loves* it.

Catra makes a sound of both disapproval and arousal. This is another thing Adora loves about these moments. When they had first started having sex it had been about being in control, Catra was her Kitten, their banter while having sex wasn't much, mostly it was just Adora being a smug asshole; not anymore: Catra will bite back. She's always been a brat, but even more so now that they truly understand each other.

Adora halts her thrusts for a moment and Catra lets out a soft whine of disapproval. "Why did you stop?" She whispers, a little breathlessly. Adora grins, she knows Catra can see it perfectly well despite the darkness.

"I'm just warming my strap up." Adora answers casually. *What was it that Lonnie told her it was called? Cock warming?* She shakes her head a little. Adora can't see Catra's face super well, but she can practically feel her disbelief, and maybe slight frustration, rolling off of her.

"Adora," Catra says, attempting to rock her hips to gain that friction. Adora grabs her hips and pins her still. "Are you serious?"

"What happened to your respect, Kitten?" Adora asks. "' *My Lord, sir,* '" Adora says in a poor likeness to Catra. "Where has all that respect gone? Do I have to teach you a lesson?" If Adora is honest, she's almost completely forgotten that Bow and Glimmer are somewhere nearby. Catra lets out a low laugh and Adora's cocky grin slowly slips off of her features.

"Oh Adora," Catra says, lifting her hand up to cup Adora's jaw. Adora stares intently into those blue and yellow eyes of Catra's. "We both know you *love* submitting to me." Catra's voice is practically a *purr* and Adora feels herself flush from it. Catra isn't wrong, and she knows it. "You were a soldier, you love taking my orders, you love pleasing me. I may be your Kitten, but you're *my* Lord, you do what I want, isn't that right?" Adora swallows thickly. Catra knows Adora by now, she knows she enjoys taking orders and pleasing Catra.

Adora, if she's honest with herself, has always preferred orders and praise to anything else. She enjoys giving too, she has with Catra before, many times, but there is just something about letting Catra take the reins, and instructing her as to what she wants and then praising Adora for it, that is almost more enjoyable. "Now," Catra says, patting Adora on her cheek. "Why don't you actually do something and fuck me?"

Adora hates that it works, but it does.

She does exactly as Catra instructed her to do and *fucks* her, hard. She drinks every bit of praise that Catra gives her; things like: " *Good girl* ", " *You're doing so good* ", " *keep going* ". Adora doesn't know why she loves praise as much as she does. She thinks maybe it's because her entire life she's tried to be the best at everything she does, and being praised for something means she's doing a good job. Whatever it is, it's not long before Adora is as close as Catra.

Catra, although she clearly took control of their situation after those words, does as Adora requested and holds off cumming before Adora is there with her too. "I love you, Catra." Adora murmurs against Catra's lips. Catra lets out a loud moan that almost makes Adora freeze. Catra is getting *louder* and Adora sees only one solution for that.

Adora brings her hand up to cover Catra’s mouth and to muffle her sounds. Catra's eyes widen a little and Adora can tell that that just seriously turned Catra on. Her breath is hot against her palm and the way it comes out laboured is making Adora spark with arousal herself. Not a moment later, Catra's eyes are rolling back in her head and Adora feels her walls clamp down around her strap. Adora doesn't last much longer.

When she cums, it's *loud,* but Catra perceives this and pulls Adora in for a bruising kiss, crashing their lips together as Adora peaks not long after Catra just did. Adora digs her fingers into the dirt and grass by Catra's head as wave after wave of pleasure washes over her. When Adora pulls back, they're both panting hot breath against each other's lips.

When their breathing stabilises a little more, Adora just can't help herself. "Wow..." She breathes. Adora hears Catra laugh and feels the brunette's fingers gently press against her jaw.

"Wow?" Catra asks, and her voice is nothing but amused. "Really?"

"I've missed that." Adora admits. Adora loves being intimate with Catra, she always has, but they've been busy. So yeah, that was *very wow* to her.

"Dork." Catra says, jabbing her free hand's fingers into Adora's side, causing her to jolt a little in surprise. "Pull out." Adora reluctantly does just that, pulling out of Catra. Catra does her adorable post-sex wiggles while Adora grins. She transforms her sword back and uses the soft glow of it to finally be able to see more than just shadows. Adora glances over at where Glimmer and Bow were and she's pretty sure they just got away with that.

They clean up as best they can and then settle in for the night. Catra turns on her side and Adora shuffles up next to her to spoon her from behind, wrapping her arms around Catra and holding her close. Catra is purring, and the sound warms Adora's insides. It's soothing, and it's soft, and it's one of Adora's favourite sounds that Catra makes. It means she's *happy* .

Adora kisses Catra softly on her neck, nuzzling into the back of her. "Goodnight, Catra." Adora whispers. Catra's purring only lessens in order to speak.

"Goodnight, Dummy." She whispers back and Adora smiles. She is so entirely grateful she got to marry Catra and that she gets to call her her wife.

* * *

When they're all awake, having eaten breakfast, Glimmer apparently just can't hold back from making a comment."Y'all couldn't keep it in your pants for one night?" She asks in disbelief. Adora laughs a little before the biggest betrayal (not really) she's ever experienced occurs.

"I blame Adora." Catra says.

"Hey! You agreed!" Adora says defensively. Catra pouts.

"You know I can't say no to you."

"We both know that's not true," Adora says, wrapping her arms around Catra's shoulders as she rests her chin on top of her head. Catra has said no to Adora on many many occasions. Catra purrs and nuzzles into Adora's neck.

"It's still very hard to say no to you, especially when you kiss me like that." Catra says. Adora is aware that Glimmer and Bow are right there, and that they're both *conscious* this time, but she loves having these kinds of… Discussions with Catra. It shows so clearly how much Catra actually likes Adora.

"So to get you to say yes to things I want I should just kiss you?" Adora asks with a grin.

"I am not answering that since I know you're gonna take advantage if I do." Catra retorts. Glimmer rolls her eyes at them.

"You could've waited until you got back home." She says.

"See, we have a baby at home, so not a lot of time to do that." Adora says, gesturing with her hand. Catra nods in agreement with her.

"Finn does limit the amount of time we get to spend together intimately." Catra agrees.

"Whatever," Glimmer says. "We should get going to Bow's dads. The only reason we had to camp was because of that... bug thing."

"I'm really not complaining about our camping for the night," Adora says with a grin. "I had a *great* time." Catra gently slaps her arm and rolls her eyes.

"I'm glad we were safe at least. But yeah, let's head back." Catra says.

"Ow," Adora complains, rubbing her arm, just to be dramatic.

"Oh, stop whining." Catra says.

"You hit me."

"I hardly *tapped* you, you've slapped my ass harder than that before."

"Oh my gosh," Glimmer says at the same time Adora straightens up at Catra's words. Did Catra have to bring up spanking *now* ? "Did not need to know that!" Catra laughs.

"You act as if I haven't told you what Adora and I have done before, Glimmer." Catra says dismissively. Adora raises an eyebrow at that. Glimmer and Catra having a heart-to-heart about what they do in the bedroom? This is news to Adora. Though, after Glimmer walked in on them she could tell Glimmer was at least a little curious about it.

"Oh really?" Adora asks, smirking. "Does Shimmer know you own a whip too? And that that really hurts when you use it?" Adora *loves* it though. She likes pain during sex and Catra knows that all too well.

"Gross." Glimmer comments though her cheeks are a wonderful rosy red - as are Catra's.

"I like it." Adora reassures, kissing Catra's neck. She wouldn't want Catra thinking otherwise.

"You know, I saw enough of you two that one time I walked in on you both." Glimmer says as she grabs Bow by his bicep and drags him off in the direction they were heading.

"No one told you to rush into my room that day!" Catra exclaims as she too drags Adora on like Glimmer had Bow.

"I didn't mean to!"

"You did that and, hilariously enough, that is how we started talking again, isn't it?" Catra asks. Adora snorts a little. It is very funny, and one of Adora's favourite things if she's honest, that the fact that Glimmer walked in on Adora railing Catra into her mattress is what bridged the gap between their friendship and was responsible for them making up again.

"Yeah." Glimmer says, laughing a little. "And it was also the first time I saw She-Ra." Catra smiles. Adora also finds it extremely funny that the first time Glimmer saw *not* evil She-Ra was when she was railing said wife.

"And the first time you began to understand why I chose Adora, and when you let me explain how I was feeling." Catra adds on. Funny how a naked She-Ra can suddenly make people realise why Catra liked Adora so much. Adora knows that Catra's interest in her is much more than that of course, but she also knows that in the beginning it was mostly their raw attraction to each other that fuelled their relationship - the deeper stuff came later.

"Yes, it was." Glimmer nods. "So are you two adding to your family?"

"Well, in the future, most likely." Adora answers. She would very much like to have more kids with Catra in the future. Definitely not yet, but at some point - plus, she would very much enjoy making them.

"I'd like to, but maybe once my therapist says I'm okay enough for another kid." Catra answers.

"You're not... *okay* to have another one?" Glimmer asks with confusion.

"It's not that, it's..." Catra sighs. "Okay, so I'm mostly physically okay to have another one if I wanted to. The doctor did say there was some possibility of having a hard pregnancy because of all the stress from the first one, and the hard labour, plus the fact that I didn't really get to rest very much after I gave birth. But I... I have trauma from the pregnancy." Catra explains. It pulls a little on Adora's heart to hear her express such things.

"Trauma from the pregnancy?" Glimmer inquires gently. Catra nods.

"It... The first few months of the pregnancy were fine, but after you guys found out Adora was the other parent, well, it was miserable for me, okay? And I didn't feel cared about, I felt like Finn wasn't wanted either. So... I get scared that it'll happen again, even though you guys have mostly accepted Adora and love Finn too." Adora wraps her arm around Catra's shoulder and kisses the side of her head in support.

"Is that part of your... PTSD?" Glimmer asks. Catra nods, leaning into Adora.

"Yeah, it's getting better but... The thought of going through that again still stops me from being able to want another baby when I really sit down and think about it."

"It's okay though," Adora says reassuringly. "We are in no rush to make another baby any time soon."

"I know, it just... sucks." Catra says. Her tail whips back and forth a little and Adora's eyes soften as she looks at her wife.

"You'd have me the entire time to take care of you." Adora says. And she fully means that. Adora has all the plans in the world to make sure Catra's next pregnancy, should they go through with it, is a much more enjoyable experience than her last one. She'd be there the entire time for it, part of Adora is excited about that since she wasn't with Finn. Catra smiles a bit.

"I know, Dummy. Thanks."

"I'd be at your beck and call." Adora says. "Whatever you want, I will make it my personal mission."

"Right now, I want you you kiss me."

"I suppose I can do that for you." Adora says, leaning over to kiss Catra on her lips. Catra purrs and kisses her back gently.

"You really are the greatest, I love you so much." Catra says and Adora smiles brightly. She knows Catra means those words completely.

"I love you too." Adora whispers, kissing Catra yet again. "Forever."

* * *

The rest of the journey to Bow's dads is pretty uneventful. They had agreed that Glimmer should teleport them at least partly back when they left again because Adora was not prepared to have another day away from home. She had asked why they hadn't done that this time, and apparently it was because this was all part of the Best Friend Squad Adventure. Adora thinks maybe they did it for her, to welcome her officially to the Squad, which is kind of sweet when she thinks about it - still, she wishes she hadn't had to fight some big bug in the Whispering Woods.

Bow's dads had given them free rein over the use of the library and Adora was currently sitting at a desk with several books open about She-Ra. She had discovered that one of the She-Ra's of the past had had a dragon for a steed which just seemed unfair to Adora. She would *kill* for a dragon. That would be so cool.

Adora sees Catra approaching out of the corner of her eye. She seems like she has something on her mind but Adora has learnt to just let Catra speak rather than prompt her for an explanation. So Adora keeps her eyes locked on the book in front of her, gently trailing her fingers over the delicate pages. Catra stops at the desk, turns and then leans her back against it. She stays quiet for a long moment, so long that Adora thinks maybe she actually doesn't have anything to say, before she speaks.

“I’m not taking my throne.” Catra states it so casually, but the statement hangs between them like a lead balloon. Adora glances at Catra, she closes her book, turning to face her wife. Catra is staring ahead, her body language gives nothing away, her tail is swishing, but in a calm way, and not the way that tells Adora that she’s irritated. She seems calm, content, as though this decision has been tormenting her for months and she’s finally found her peace.

“Are you sure?” Adora asks, only because she wants to know Catra is certain about this, she will support her no matter what.

“I know you think I’ll make a great Queen, and I remember looking forward to taking the throne and helping Half-Moon improve, in helping my people,” Catra says calmly. “But… I’ve lost all desire, all *drive* , for the throne. When I think about my future, it’s with you, in our home, in the woods. Just you, me, Finn and possibly more kittens in the future.” Catra pauses. “That’s all I know I really want.”

“You’ll always be the Princess of Half-Moon.”

“Maybe,” Catra admits. “But not the Queen. The only title that really matters to me, is that I’m your wife, Adora.” The words make her smile and she stands up to kiss Catra.

“The only title that matters to me too is that I’m your wife.” Adora says quietly. “I… I don’t want to be remembered as the Horde Lord.” Adora admits. She’s thought about this before. She is aware that being the Lord of the Horde is a part of her past, and she knows that one day she’s going to have to tell Finn about it, and any of their other children, even if the thought terrifies her, but she never wants being the Horde Lord to be her legacy. “I want to be remembered as She-Ra, as the wife of Princess C’yra the III of Half-Moon, as a mother. I don’t want my legacy to be one of hurting people.” Adora looks up at Catra who was smiling sweetly at her.

“And it won’t be, my love.” She says, placing her hands on Adora’s waist. Adora allows Catra to pull her in and she surrenders herself to Catra’s soft comforting embrace. “You’ve already helped so many people. I don’t think a lot of people see you as the evil Horde Lord anymore and if you keep doing what you’re doing, no one ever will again.” Adora sighs as Catra lifts her hands up and gently cups her face. Her eyes flutter closed and she simply just *melts* into Catra. “Just don’t hurt yourself by bending over backwards to help others. Take

care of yourself too. You have me too, we're partners, remember? For life. We support each other." Adora lets out a soft breath.

"I know." Adora says. She still remembers how Catra was hurt by Adora's decision to go to Beast Island without her, she doesn't want to hurt Catra by excluding her from things like that again. Adora may not like endangering Catra, but she's right. They're life *partners* , they're a team, Adora knows that she will have Catra's support for life as Catra has hers, she can't make decisions for the both of them like that anymore. Adora doesn't have to burden all of this *stuff* alone.

"Good," Catra says, patting Adora on her cheek. Adora rolls her eyes fondly. "I think Glimmer and Bow are telling Lance and George about their engagement. So we can probably expect tears of happiness from the living room." Adora half smiles and she notices Catra's eyes sparkling as she does. "That's my favourite smile." Catra confesses, her tail swishing happily. She purrs as she leans up on her tip-toes to press a kiss to Adora's lips. Adora smiles softly.

"So this is really what you want?" Adora asks. "Just you, me, Finn and our house in the woods?"

"I want you," Catra says, trailing her hands down Adora's chest. "I think… I know we haven't known each other for our entire lives but it feels like we have. You're the other half of me. I'm sure that you're all I really want, yes." Adora takes a deep breath at the confession.

"I… Did you know that I worked in the field before I became Force Captain or Horde Lord?" Adora asks. Truthfully, she wasn't Force Captain for a whole lot of time, but she had been one of the Horde grunts in the field. Shadow Weaver's idea, a way to test Adora's true skills in battle. She had been like any other soldier, having to wear the armour, including the *helmet* . Catra hums but doesn't say anything else. "I saw you, when I was just a grunt, and I immediately thought you were the most beautiful woman I had ever seen. I still think that." Catra stays quiet as she seemingly digests this information.

"Wow…" She says after a while. "You're so gay." Adora stares at Catra before she bursts out laughing.

“Is that really all you have to say?” Adora asks.

“You’re *really* gay?” Catra says, shrugging but her smirk is so… mischievous. Adora shoves her playfully and then suddenly they’re play-fighting. They grab each other playfully, trying to pin one another, at some point the touching turns less play-fighting and more hot and heavy until they’re panting and Adora has Catra sitting on the edge of the desk and Catra has her legs wrapped around Adora’s waist.

“You know,” Adora says as she brushes her lips along Catra’s jaw. “You reminded me of how much I enjoy spanking you… and how *long* it’s been.” Adora had never really had the desire to do that again after she had stabbed Catra, part of her felt guilty about the fact she had enjoyed it in the first place, but Catra had reassured her that she liked it and even wanted it, whenever Adora was ready again. She thinks she’s ready again.

Catra lets out a soft gasp that is absolutely *delicious* to Adora. “Yeah?” Catra asks, Adora feels her thighs press together, Catra seemingly forgetting that Adora is standing between them. Adora smirks a little at that. “You feel ready to do that?”

“If you are.” Adora replies. Catra takes a deep breath and slowly releases it. She doesn’t respond immediately but eventually she looks up to meet Adora’s eyes.

“I trust you,” Catra says, truthfully and Adora’s eyes immediately soften, as does her expression. “I would love to do that with you again. I guess we need to find Finn a babysitter sometime this week for them to sleepover.” Adora laughs softly, nodding in confirmation.

“I know I’m only twenty-four but the journey here was *exhausting* . I think I just want to go home and relax with you and get Finn cuddles.” Adora says.

“Being a parent will do that to you.” Catra says, full of fondness. “But, goddess, I agree. I want to get home and collapse in our bed and sleep forever.” Adora thinks, quietly, that they’ve earned this. They deserve to be happy. They deserve to have this soft, quiet, loving future. After everything, this is everything they could ever want and more.

“Then that is exactly what we shall do, my love.” Adora says with a smile before she kisses Catra softly on the lips. They have suffered enough. They deserve this.

* * *

After Adora and Catra have thanked George and Lance for their hospitality, Adora especially thanks Lance for his tea (it almost rivals Catra’s) and with a bag full of books, they finally get back home. Adora immediately walks over to Spinnerella, taking Finn from her hands. “My baby,” Adora coos as she picks them up, giving them kisses on their small cheeks. Finn giggles and purrs. Catra laughs as she comes up behind Adora.

“ *Our* baby.” Catra says. “Thanks for watching them, Spinny and ‘Tossa. It took longer than expected.”

“No problem,” Netossa says.

“Yeah, they’re an angel.” Spinnerella agrees. Catra smiles as Adora does. She has to agree with them, Finn is *perfect* .

“Come on, I’ll teleport you guys home.” Glimmer says, taking hold of Spinnerella and Netossa’s arms. In the next moment, they’re all gone, leaving Adora and Catra alone in their home.

Adora looks down at Finn and they blink up at her, looking downright adorable. They look so much like Catra, but their eyes remind Adora of herself. Their little tail is wiggling and they look at Adora with such interest. Kids are cute, Adora can admit that much. She never thought she’d be the mom type, Adora still isn’t totally sure she is, but Finn is… They’re everything. They are the cutest being in existence and Adora vows that she will protect them with her life.

“Mm… ma..mm...ma…” Adora’s eyes widen. “Mama!” Finn says properly now. Adora immediately looks at Catra, trying to confirm whether she also heard that or not. Catra is wearing the same look of shock as Adora.

“Holy sh-!” Adora cuts herself off before the two of them break into cheers, praising Finn softly that has the little kit clapping their hands and laughing. “That’s right Finn! Mama. They totally said that to me.”

“Now hold on a second,” Catra says. “I thought we agreed I was mama and you were mommy?” Adora pouts.

“You ruined the word mommy for me.” Adora says and Catra snorts.

“Mom, mommy, whatever. Therefore, they were talking to me.” Catra says.

“No way! They were looking at me!” Adora disagrees. They start bickering playfully between themselves and Finn wiggles in Adora’s arms.

“Mo...mm…” Finn starts, causing Adora and Catra to silence immediately. “Mommy!” They say and Catra and Adora praise them all over again. Adora has never felt pride like this before in her entire life but she practically *radiates* with it.

“I can’t believe they finally spoke their first words.” Adora says with amazement. “They finally did it.”

“The first of many,” Catra says, leaning down to kiss Finn on their little head while also purring. “I’ll get started on dinner.” She says as she walks towards the kitchen. Adora stares after her and she can’t help but feel like Catra’s words could mean so much more than just first words. This is their lives now.

This is the beginning of the rest of their lives and Adora would have it no other way.

Chapter End Notes

We are sorry about the delay for us writing this chapter. Both S and I have a lot going on at the moment but we hope that you're all looking forward to the upcoming epilogue chapters that we have planned! -M

Thank y'all for reading :)! I've been preparing for going back to uni (which will be in around a week's time) and also suffering writer's block so that's why it took so long to update this puppy. However, not to fret! Lord Adora *will* be concluded. Next 3 chapters are the final of this series and the epilogue chapters and I *really* hope y'all enjoy them -S

You can find us on twitter @ceolordadora and our CC is the same !! You can find me (S) on Tumblr @sherasswordstrap

Epilogue I: Finn

Chapter Summary

> “I found you arrogant and annoying at Princess Prom,” Catra states. “Sometimes I wonder why I felt so… drawn to you. We were enemies… I was supposed to hate you, and I think I did, but… You got under my skin.”
>
> “You hated me?”
>
> “Did you miss the part where we were enemies and you were the evil Horde Lord?” Catra asks, raising an eyebrow.
>
> “You still found me devastatingly handsome though, right?” Adora asks with a cheeky grin. “Irresistible. Incredibly attractive. Super sexy-”
>
> “Please stop,” Catra interrupts, rolling her eyes fondly.

Chapter Notes

> Hey y'all !! So sorry that this has taken so long to update but I have been extremely busy with university, since it's my final year, and M has been busy job hunting and then starting a new job and we just simply have not had the time on our hands to write like before. I wanna say that the updates may be longer but Lord Adora will have her conclusion so I really hope you can all just afford us patience with the final two chapters for this fic and know that it *will* be concluded even if it takes a while. Thank you, and please enjoy this chapter which is a very chunky boy for y'all :)
>
> These last three chapters are 'epilogue' chapters and will include various time skips throughout just an fyi. Tried to mark this out mostly by Finn's age and significant milestones in Catra and Adora's lives.
>
> Warning, NSFW ahead (including bdsm themes) !!

See the end of the chapter for more notes

Catra taps her foot to the beat of the ticking clock in the small room she was seated in. She sinks back in the comfortable couch cushions, the ones she had become so well acquainted with after so long. Therapy. Catra had been going ever since she had been released from her so-called house arrest. Adora was happy to see Perfuma, even if Catra had her reservations about that. Catra much preferred to go to an actual licensed therapist. It had been a condition

of Adora’s arrest that she saw Perfuma - after all, they needed a *Princess* to keep tabs on Adora and make sure she actually was improving. Adora had somewhat bonded with Perfuma and decided to keep seeing her.

Catra, on the other hand, had little trust in the Princesses, and she means this with complete love, but Catra isn’t sure Perfuma is the best therapist. Adora *is* better, but Catra thinks that she learnt that on her own, and from Micah, who has almost become like a father to her. She is open about her feelings now, she found her purpose, she’s *happy* . Happy wife, happy life. Catra smiles a little. She is happy that Adora is happy, but Catra still needs this support and Adora understands completely.

Catra’s therapist takes a seat across from her, flipping open her book. Catra still gets nervous about these sessions, she doesn’t really know why. "Okay," She says calmly. "So we're just checking in. How are you feeling generally before we get into the specifics?" Catra releases a breath as she thinks over her response. She’s also learnt that there is no rushing therapy.

"Today… I'm feeling alright. A little anxious, but nothing too bad." Catra answers, leaning back further in the familiar chair. She can do this. Her therapist hums for a moment.

"Let's start easy," She says with a smile. "How are things with Adora?" Catra smiles at the mention of her wife.

"Things with Adora are great. She's a sweetheart, as usual, and she always does her best to make sure both Finn and I are okay. She's making sure to go to therapy as well." Catra answers honestly. In fact, Adora has been a consistent good thing in her life. Catra won’t lie and say that they’re *always* good, that’s simply not true, they have argued before, it tends to happen when you live with someone else, but they always talk it out. Adora is her partner, and Catra knows she can always rely on her.

"And she's helping with Finn?" Her therapist inquires.

"She is. She *adores* Finn." Catra answers. Adora is a *great* mother, not that Catra ever really doubted that. She knows that Adora was *terrified* of that, but she’s perfect. Maybe perfect was strong, no one is really perfect at everything, though Adora certainly tries to be, but she’s great. She has bonded with Finn phenomenally, they are practically inseparable, two peas in a pod.

"How are you bonding with them?" She asks. Catra smiles softly at the thought of her baby.

"I love them. They're the sweetest baby anyone could have asked for." Catra says. The thought of Finn fills her heart with deep warmth. They walk like a champ now, and their speech is still mostly just baby babble, but they know mama, mom and select names and other words. Luna had told Catra not to worry, that some babies don't start with full sentences until they are three sometimes.

"And how are you dealing with your postpartum depression?" *Well shit* . They were diving into it now. Catra's smile lessens a touch.

"It... It still hits hard sometimes. Thankfully I have Adora to support me, but... with everything that happened, it became a lot more intense than I thought it would be." Catra says quietly. It had taken her a long time to admit she had it too.

"Given the circumstances of your birth, I'm not surprised." Catra's therapist says. "All the stress, and even before your birth. Lots of mothers deal with postpartum depression, but you've had an especially hard birth. I'm glad that you have Adora to support you, that's important."

"I know... I am grateful I have Adora. I don't know what I'd do without her." Catra confesses. Adora is her rock.

"Have you two discussed having any more children?"

"I- We have, but I'm still hesitant. I'm too afraid of what will happen again, even though I know it won't." Catra looks at her hands. She knows… It's been a year, C'yra wouldn't do what she did last time, so much is different now, but the thought of her last pregnancy, everything that happened, it haunts her. She's afraid. She knows it's the PTSD, and she knows logically that C'yra and Adora are amicable with each other, and everyone is accepting of them now, but it still gnaws at her every time she has considered bringing up the notion of having another kid.

"That's perfectly reasonable, given everything." She says sympathetically. "You're afraid? How else do you feel at the thought of having another child?"

"I... I do want another child, one day. But I-" Catra swallows thickly. "I'm still scared. With Finn I barely had anyone. I didn't have my mate, I didn't have my family, most of the people I had called friends turned their backs on me. It makes me scared to bring another kid into this world in fear of what happened during my pregnancy with Finn happening again. It makes me sad. But, either way, Finn needs our love and attention first and Adora and I want to make sure that they'll be okay with a little sibling."

"It seems you and Adora have thought this through a lot." She says. "Your points all make a lot of sense. I'm sure you have time to think about having another child and to prepare for them. We can keep working on your feelings around it until then and, if you were to become pregnant again, I'd recommend you have close monitoring and maybe even some anxiety medication." She takes a small pause. "This is a more difficult topic. How are things with C'yra?" Ah, the *mom* question. Catra presses her lips together.

"They're... fine? She hasn't really said or done anything recently to upset me. It's... Her *presence* upsets me. I try not to let it, because I know that she's trying to be better, but sometimes it's hard to control." Catra has tried, she really has, but she thinks C'yra permanently and irreversibly damaged their relationship. She doesn't feel the same way about her as she once did. There's always a tension between them, even when Catra technically forgave C'yra. Maybe forgave is a strong word, she at least put it behind her and chose to salvage whatever she could of their relationship.

"Has her relationship with Adora improved?" Her therapist asks as she scribbles something down in her book.

"I... They're civil?" Catra says. She wouldn't exactly call them *friends* , but it's a long shot from how they used to have glaring competitions across the table at dinners. C'yra even stopped saying degrading things to and about Adora as well.

"Civil?"

"C'yra isn't trying to chop Adora's head off, and she isn't glaring at her every second she can." Catra answers, extending her hands a little as she looks at her therapist.

"I see," She chews the end of her pen for a moment. "Would you like for them to be closer?"

"I just don't want them to fight." Catra says. "Or for C'yra to try to villainize Adora."

"How does Adora feel about C'yra?"

"She's... fine with her." Catra shrugs.

"Fine?"

"Yeah." Catra sighs. Truthfully, Adora is actually a lot more understanding of C'yra than what Catra finds strictly comfortable. She had even advocated for her in the early stages until she handed it over to Catra to choose what she wanted to do.

"Hm…" Her therapist makes another note. *Shit* . They're definitely revisiting that at a later time. "And how are things with Luna and the other Princesses?"

"They're... good. Mom is still trying to do things as a way to apologise for letting C'yra act up for so long." Catra sighs. She had had unresolved anger with Luna but they had talked it out. Catra had mostly been angry because she didn't understand how her mom could have stayed with C'yra with everything that she was doing, with how much she was hurting Catra. After they'd talked it out, Catra had felt better about it. "The Princesses... I'm okay with most of them." She uses most simply because sometimes things are a little more strained than usual, but mostly okay. Glimmer and Bow are both Aunt Glim and Uncle Bow to Finn, so not everything was lost.

"How are your PTSD symptoms?"

"I still have nightmares on most nights." Catra admits, wrapping her arms, and her tail, around herself. "Sometimes I blank out because of daymares. Adora usually guides me out of

them." Catra's ears press back. Adora. Sometimes she feels bad about it, but Adora kisses her and says to her 'for better and for worse, right?' with the goofiest smile. Catra feels herself perk up a little as Adora's voice echoes in her head. Plus, Catra returns the favour whenever Adora is having problems herself. Two halves that make each other whole.

"I'm happy to hear you have such a strong support system. That's truly important." She smiles at Catra. "As for your symptoms, medication is always an option. However, this kind of thing takes time to heal, and I have to say, you're making excellent progress. It's not a race though." She reminds Catra. "It's okay if you have days worse than others, we take it one day at a time."

"Yeah, I know. I... There's times I wish I didn't have to go through this." Catra confesses. "I know Adora had her own stuff to deal with, and I feel bad having to add to her burden." *Guilty* . She feels guilty adding to Adora's problems.

"Well, I don't know Adora's circumstances, beyond what you've told me, but I think she's coping significantly well." She taps her pen against her notebook. "It's important to have boundaries, however. You should tell her that it's okay for her to say it's too much, if it is too much for her, just like it's okay for you to tell her that it's too much for you if you feel that way." Catra nods.

"That's something I try to do." Catra says. "But she does have a bit of a habit of taking on more than she can handle. Which is why I talk to Bow, Spinnerella, and Netossa at times." Adora is incapable of putting others ahead of herself. It's almost sad and ironic. She was painted as selfish as the Horde Lord, as heartless and a destroyer, she's actually the opposite. Adora is so selfless it's almost unhealthy for her, she cares so much about others and helping them that she'd easily put her life on the line to do it. She was like that as Lord of the Horde too, they just never saw it because they didn't see what Adora was doing it all for, how she was with her people. Adora fought in most battles, Hordak didn't fight in a single one, that really says it all.

"That's good," She smiles. "I guess we've talked about everything we need to talk about. Is there anything else you wish to talk about?"

"Is there anything you recommend I do to help with the nightmares?" Catra asks.

"Why don't you tell me about them?" She asks. Catra sighs. She closes her eyes, her ears pinning back again.

"It's... It's C'yra making me get rid of Finn... and being isolated again. Them successfully killing Adora..." Catra cuts off, feeling her voice wobble as the images flash up in her mind.

"It can be hard, but if you can identify that you're dreaming you may be able to take control of the dream even while sleeping."

"But how? Every time I see it happen... I break down."

"Preventing dreams is hard," She admits. "But if you feel as though you may be dreaming, you can do the checks, like looking at a clock, trying to touch your finger through your hand, trying to read, you can then tell yourself that it's a dream, that it isn't real, that Finn is alive and well and so is your wife and change the dream to anything you want, or even wake yourself up." Lucid dreaming. Catra has heard of it before.

“Okay, I'll try that." Catra nods, unsure. It’s worth a shot at least.

"You have Adora with you when you wake up?"

"Usually, unless she's on a mission." Catra responds. Adora has been doing a lot as She-Ra. Catra is happy for her, Adora had struggled a lot with her purpose, her role in life, she finally seemed happy to accept her role as She-Ra and a mom.

"What do you do if she's not with you?"

“Grab her pillow and hug it?" Catra shrugs, blushing a little.

"You don't go to Finn's room?"

"No…" Catra says cautiously. "Because I tend to cry and I don't want to wake them up." She admits. She definitely doesn't want to upset her child with that. She's sure their cuddles would be comforting, but she'd take Adora's pillow, which smells faintly of her, over potentially upsetting Finn.

"How often is Adora away?"

"Not too often. Though sometimes she gets up a bit earlier than me and takes a walk." Catra answers. Adora typically sleeps pretty well, but somewhere around half way through their marriage, after having to rise for Finn through the night and early in the mornings, Adora's military upbringing, that had been programmed in her since *birth,* kicked in. That meant she often rose early. She said she didn't mind, that she was happy to let Catra rest and take care of Finn until she was fully rested, but Catra sometimes missed waking up to Adora beside her. Some days Catra will reach over and feel nothing but sheets and smell the lovely aroma of coffee wafting up the stairs of their home, telling her that Adora was still there.

"Is there anything Adora does that bothers you?" Catra frowns a little at that question.

"Not really, no. She's usually pretty self aware." Catra admits. Sometimes Adora can be a little dense, particularly in the feelings department, but she has come a long way, she knows mostly the things that trigger Catra and she's a perfectly attentive and caring wife.

"Have you told Adora everything about how you're feeling?"

"Not... *everything* ." Catra says. "I don't want to overwhelm her."

"Hm," She hums. "Look, nightmares can be hard to prevent, you can try the thing I suggested. You can also establish a regular sleeping schedule, talking about the dream and writing it down to rewrite the ending or process it. Comfort, however you take it, maybe even a light in your room may help."

"A light?" Catra asks, raising an eyebrow.

"Like a night light."

"Oh…" Catra says. She used to have one of those, as a *child* . "I'll consider it."

"It might help you come back faster when Adora isn't there."

"Yeah, possibly... Thanks for the advice."

"Is there anything else you wish to discuss?"

Catra purses her lips for a moment as she thinks about what else there is that she wants to discuss. "How do I deal with the tension of when I see C'yra?"

"Ah, see, that one really is going to take time." She answers. "Let me ask you this, are all your memories of C'yra bad?"

"No, they're not all bad." Catra says quietly. She still remembers her mama from before, the one who kissed her bruises and patched her up when she was an energetic kid, the one who would tell her bedtime stories and encouraged her to do anything she wanted to do. C'yra had always been protective, but she had taken it too far. "But the bad is over-powering the good."

"That's your problem," she says. "You need to try and remember the good over the bad to bring out a positive emotion around her."

"It's... hard." Catra admits. "I know she was a great mom when I was growing up. But when she found out my feelings for Adora, and that Finn was hers, C'yra became this monster that I didn't even recognise. And it was terrifying. It felt like... like my mama had died right in front of me that day." It had been *devastating* .

"I'm sorry she reacted so poorly... You deserved better." Her therapist says sympathetically, a sad expression on her face. "And I know it can be hard to see the good over the bad she did, but can you see that she's trying again now?"

"I know she's trying again! I know she's trying to be better, but that doesn't change the damage she caused me and Adora." Catra sniffs quietly. "She's trying, but it took her nearly a full year for her to even admit she was in the wrong. After *months* of causing me and Adora pain and letting me suffer."

"You don't ever have to forgive her for that." She says gently. "I'm afraid the tension between you and Queen C'yra will likely be... lifelong." Catra already knew that, but hearing it makes it all feel so *real* .

"I know." Catra says quietly. "But it sucks, because I know that mom and C'yra want to be part of Finn's life."

"Do you want them to be part of Finn's life?"

"I... don't know."

"You'd be perfectly justified if your answer to that question was no."

"I don't mind Luna being part of their life." Catra replies. "But when it comes to C'yra..." She trails off, she's pretty sure she doesn't need to finish that but her therapist prompts her to anyway.

"When it comes to C'yra?"

"I'm hesitant." Catra concludes.

"Have you let her hold Finn? Or be alone with them?"

“Not really,” Catra shrugs. She doesn’t see any reason as to why she would have to do that. Finn is *her* baby.

"You don't trust her alone?"

"I don’t trust her, *period* ,” Catra replies sharply. “She's the one who wanted to get rid of them first. Why should I trust her?"

"I understand why you wouldn't, but do you think you ever *will* ?" Her therapist asks her. Catra thinks about that question for a moment.

"I... I don't know for certain.” Catra admits. “She's trying, and I can see that, but... it's worrying."

"Worrying?"

"Yeah..." Catra says with a sigh. “You know everything, it’s hard to find a reason to forgive her and I’m worried that I never fully will.” Her therapist makes a humming sound and she clicks her pen.

"Do you think you'll ever tell Finn about what C'yra did?" She asks.

"We were considering it when they're older.” Catra admits. They knew they’d have to eventually explain it to Finn, and possibly other kids. They knew they’d have to tell them who Adora used to be, lest they find out from another source, Catra figured they might also be curious why Catra was no longer a Princess. There was a *lot* that they’d probably have to explain one day, but that day is not today. Finn was still little. That was a problem for future Adora and Catra.

"Things with C'yra are complicated to say the least. I wish there was some magic word or way for it all to just be okay, but that's unfortunately not how it works. Things with C'yra will take considerable time to mend." Catra scoffs a little. She knows it will take time, that's why she even goes to therapy, but this *is* helping her. Maybe she could afford C'yra a *little* more trust - she has been trying really hard.

"Yeah," Catra lies back, feeling the emotional exhaustion that comes after a session settling over her. "Time…"

"I think we can end this session here," Her therapist says, closing her book. "You're doing good, Catra. It just takes-"

"Time, I know, I get it." Catra says, sitting back up again. "I just wish it was faster." At least she gets to see her beautiful wife after this and kiss her stupid. She ends up leaving that office feeling lighter yet also heavier. Weird how therapy works like that.

* * *

Catra smiles a little, watching her wife sitting on the ground talking away to their baby. Finn is mostly doing their babble but Adora is talking to them like they are saying something very serious, responding to them by saying 'oh really?' and gasping when Finn gurgles. Her wife is a massive dork. Catra could hardly believe that Finn was already a year old. It seemed like just yesterday that she had given birth to them.

They had been celebrating in Half-Moon and were pretty beat from it. Her… C'yra had set up a celebration for Finn, one befitting an actual heir of Half-Moon. Catra had appreciated it, it really showed that they fully accepted Finn as Catra's and even the people of Half-Moon seemed to love Finn just as much. If Catra was honest, this was maybe one of the best things C'yra had done for her in recent times and maybe Catra owed her a little slack.

Catra purrs a little as Luna comes up to her, giving her a hug. Catra sighs, relaxing at hearing her mom purr back at having her close. At least she had a normal relationship with one of her mothers. "Adora," Catra says, noticing once again her wife and child. "Stop eating their cake."

“What?” Adora asks innocently. “Sharing is caring, Catra.” Adora takes another bite of the cake she had on a plate in her hand at the same time that Finn decides they’ve had enough of Adora’s antics. The baby sticks their fist into the cake and Catra snorts as they shove the cake in Adora’s face. “Hey!” Adora protests, laughing. Finn just laughs back at her. “That’s called playing dirty, Finn.”

“You were stealing their cake,” Catra points out. She sees that mischievous glint in Adora’s eyes and narrows her eyes at her wife. “Don’t you dare.”

“Revenge?” Adora asks with a grin.

“No,” Catra deadpans. “No shoving cake into our child’s face.”

“But-” Adora cuts off when Catra gives her a look and she makes a sound of defeat. Sometimes Adora acts like a child, Catra swears.

Catra turns back to her mom who was watching the exchange with a soft expression. That’s when Catra’s ears twitch, hearing the approach of someone on her left. When she turns her head slightly, she sees C’yra. Catra can’t help but tense up a little when she sees her. It’s like a reflex now, it just… happens. She knows C’yra notices it every time, but Catra just can’t help it.

C’yra watches Adora and Finn, her arms crossed over her chest, her tail swishing back and forth. She’s wearing her crown and typical Magicat robes. The picture of Magicat royalty. Everyone always used to say how Catra was her spitting image, Catra knew what they meant, she saw it too. C’yra had the sharp features that came with age, and she had more scars than Catra, but Catra knew they could have been mistaken as twins if you didn’t look at the finer details. She thinks it might be ironic that she looks, and is even named after, the one mother who hurt her the most.

Catra is reminded of the fact that this celebration was C’yra’s decision and that she got Finn robes that mark them out as an heir. Maybe she really has come a long way. She treats Finn like they’re her grandchild, and she clearly thinks of them worthy of her throne. Catra takes a

deep breath, moving her head a little towards C’yra so she can hear her clearly when she speaks. "Thank you for doing this... mama." Catra says quietly.

Catra sees C’yra’s ears flick and sees, out of the corner of her eye, that she does a double take, like she couldn’t believe that Catra had just called her that. If Catra is honest, she’s kind of surprised herself. Catra slowly turns her head to meet C’yra’s eyes. They’re wide in shock and disbelief and Catra would maybe find it funny if it weren’t such a serious situation. "Did you just... call me mama?" C’yra asks. Her voice sounds *raw* . It’s so rare for C’yra to sound so vulnerable. This is a big deal for her.

“Yes, I did." Catra says after a moment. C'yra's eyes start to water.

"I..." C’yra begins but she quickly trails off. Catra is stunned, her eyes wide. She’s basically *never* seen C’yra cry like that before.

"Are... Are you crying?" Catra asks in alarm.

"I... No... I... mean..." C'yra wipes her face with her hands, trying to hide her tears. Catra doesn’t know what to do. She didn’t exactly intend for this to turn into *this* - she didn’t do it to make C’yra *cry* - yet here she is.

"I- I don't know how to handle this." Catra admits, looking at her mom for help. She’s never seen C’yra like this, never mind being the cause of such emotion from her.

"I'm just... I never thought..." C'yra clearly gets too emotional to speak and stops. Luna stands up beside her wife and places a hand to her shoulder to try and comfort her. Catra watches the pair, standing there awkwardly, looking at her wife and then at Luna and C'yra.

"Do you need a moment?" Catra asks. Adora stands up from the ground, handing Finn to Catra as she wipes the cake off of her face.

"No I... I'm okay." C'yra says, sniffling.

"Right... uh..." Catra replies awkwardly. She decides to focus on Finn, smiling when they start purring in her arms. They're getting so big, part of Catra wonders if they're going to outgrow both Adora and herself.

"Can I hug them? You?" C'yra asks suddenly.

"I..." Catra winces a little at the question. "Maybe... Maybe not now." Things were getting better, but Catra wasn't sure she was at the level where she let C'yra hug her, or even Finn, yet. Things were still a little too… Catra wasn't ready for *that* yet, but she could at least start by calling C'yra her mom again.

"Oh..." C'yra says, looking away. "Okay."

"Sorry." Catra says. And she means it, she does, but she just… can't.

"Not even Finn?" C'yra asks. Catra looks down at her baby and feels a protectiveness seize her heart.

"No." Catra says, holding Finn close. "I... I still don't feel comfortable with that."

"O-Okay." C'yra says, looking dejected. Her ears press back against her head as her tail also droops. Adora clears her throat awkwardly.

"Thank you for the gifts, Queen C'yra and Luna, and for the celebration." Adora thanks. "We weren't expecting it." Catra almost scoffs at that. That may be the biggest understatement of the year.

Luna seems to look at her wife with sympathy before she glances back at Adora. "C'yra was actually the one with the idea to do all of this. I just did my best to help, but we're happy you like it."

"Was she?" Catra asks, surprised. She had been somewhat under the impression that this was a joint thing. Obviously she could see C'yra trying, and she was by no means being hostile, but some part of Catra had figured that Luna had just convinced C'yra to do all of this for Finn, not that she had suggested it herself. Strangely, the notion makes Catra feel a little warm and she looks at her mom with a less guarded expression, not holding Finn so close.

"Yeah," Luna says, bringing Catra back to the present. "She wanted to do something for you both, and Finn, after... everything." *Everything* . Everything was a lot, but this was a pretty big deal to Catra.

"Right... Thank you." Catra says. She hesitates before she places Finn down onto the ground, holding them until they are steady on their feet. "Okay kitten, we're going now, give your grandmas a hug goodbye, alright?" Finn looks up at Catra and then they waddle over to Luna who immediately crouches for a hug.

Catra turns to C'yra who was standing just a little ways off, separating herself. She seemed to have become almost shy, like she'd closed in on herself. Catra sighs. "And grandma Cy, Little One." Catra finally says. C'yra looks at her in complete shock, her ears perking right up. Catra just nods at her and then C'yra smiles, genuinely, at her before she crouches down to hug her grandchild. Catra tenses a little, but she feels Adora wrap an arm around her waist encouragingly and kiss her softly on her cheek. Catra nuzzles into Adora, silently thanking her for her support.

Once Finn has completed their goodbyes, Adora hugs Luna goodbye with a smile and then shakes C'yra's hand before she scoops Finn up and wanders towards the doors, waiting for Catra. Catra says goodbye to Luna as usual and then she turns to C'yra. "I really am grateful for what you did for Finn," Catra says. "I… I'd like for us to move forward." Catra steps towards C'yra cautiously, her ears pinning back.

"I love you, C'yra," C'yra says. "I really am sorry."

"I know," Catra says with a sigh. She does know. She knows that C'yra really is sorry, Catra still doesn't think she can forgive her, but she can try.

Catra moves cautiously, but she makes her intentions clear. She sees the surprised expression on C'yra's face before she closes the space between them, hugging her mom for the first time in over a year now. C'yra hugs her gently at first, probably unsure if this was actually happening, before Catra feels her arms tighten and a soft purr rumble in her mom's chest. *Shit* . Now Catra was going to cry. Catra buries her nose into the crook of C'yra's neck like she has ever since she was little.

Catra pulls away after a moment, unable to bear the strong emotions that she was feeling clogging her chest and making her feel *heavy* . She sniffles a little and looks away from C'yra when she sees her watery eyes. "Bye moms," Catra mumbles before she walks back over to her wife.

When she reaches Adora, Adora gives her a reassuring smile and offers Finn to her. Catra smiles a little as she takes them into her arms. Cuddles from Finn is just what she needs. She leans up and kisses Adora on her cheek. "Come on," Catra says. "Let's go home."

* * *

"Catra is going to love this," Adora says. She was standing in the throne room of Half-Moon, her hands on her hips, her cloak around her shoulders. She turns her head a little to look at the person standing beside her. Queen C'yra. For their one year wedding anniversary she had commissioned a mural of Adora and Catra to be made in the throne room of Half-Moon. It showed her officially setting aside old grievances and accepting Adora, *finally* and *wholly* . Adora was now physically present as a piece of their history: the wife of Princess C'yra III. "Thank you." Adora says. Even the cloak she was currently wearing was a gift from the Queen, it was Half-Moon colours, held together with a crescent moon symbol, fit for the wife of the Princess she supposes - though Catra still technically hadn't accepted coming back to the throne.

"I figured C'yra would appreciate it," C'yra responds. Her eyes are fixed on the mural. Adora turns back to look at it. It reminds her of the ones in Bright Moon, no facial expressions but it's pretty obvious who it is. Adora's sword is on her hip, Catra is in her old crown, a very small Horde symbol is present on Adora's belt, marking out who she *really* was. The Horde was always going to be a part of Adora's past, even if she sometimes wished it wasn't.

"I appreciate it," Adora says. C'yra finally looks at her. She makes a small sound of amusement.

“I find you tolerable, Adora.” C’yra says and Adora grins. Surprisingly, that might actually be one of the nicest things C’yra has ever said to Adora. “You make my daughter happy, that’s all I want for her. I never would have thought I would find you so… agreeable a year ago, yet here we are.” She pauses. “Luna and I won’t be here forever,” She says. “Goddess knows we’re not getting any younger… I trust you to take care of her.”

“How old are you exactly?” Adora asks curiously. C’yra raises an eyebrow.

“Magicats tend to live longer than most,” She says. “I imagine we have a while yet.”

“That didn’t answer my question,” Adora points out. If she had to guess, C’yra didn’t *look* old, but she’s learnt that Magicats age exceptionally well, and she may be older than she appears. Given Catra’s age, she would approximate C’yra was in her mid-fifties, if she had had Catra in her late twenties to thirties that was. Again, Adora was gay, not a mathematician.

“Weren’t you taught it’s rude to ask a person their age?” C’yra asks. Adora chuckles a little.

“Not really,” Adora shrugs. “Nothing is considered rude to ask in the Horde.”

“Clearly,” She says. “Do you ever wonder about your parents?” Adora sighs.

“Sometimes,” She admits. “And sometimes I wonder where the stars went… Maybe one day they’ll return.”

“You’re learning more and more about She-Ra,” C’yra says. “It’s almost impressive actually. That wasn’t a compliment before you let it get to your head.”

“Too late,” Adora says with a smile. C’yra rolls her eyes. It’s the same eye roll Catra does when Adora does something stupid but endearing. Adora is pretty sure C’yra secretly *likes*

her, she doesn't need the verbal confirmation, it's pretty obvious if you ask her. "I like helping people," Adora admits. "I'm not the type of person to sit on my hands, I think I'd go crazy, and finding the balance between that and my family was a little hard at first but Catra and I finally have it figured out."

"You're a good mom." C'yra comments. It means the world to Adora if she's honest. She spent so long thinking she might be an awful parent.

"Thank you," Adora says, genuinely.

"Maybe one day we can add one of Finn, or any other children you may have."

"You think we'll have more?" Adora asks.

"You don't?" C'yra fires back, raising an eyebrow. Adora snorts a little. C'yra is right.

They stand there together until Catra arrives. She had been dropping Finn off with their Uncle Bow and Aunt Glimmer, now married, so they could spend their anniversary together, and *alone* - for the obvious reasons. They had agreed to meet here first since C'yra had a gift for them, but Catra had left earlier to perform some errands, so Adora hadn't seen her for a while. Adora turns to her, excited to have her wife back, but her brain completely short circuits when she sees Catra.

"What?" Catra asks, the corner of her lip turned up in a small smirk. "You like it?" Adora's jaw must be on the ground if she's being honest. She just can't stop staring at Catra. She'd cut her hair short. It was definitely different, her short brunette curls looked fluffy and soft, it suited her almost too well.

"I… You… I'm…" Adora stumbles over her words before she swallows thickly. "Holy shit. Sorry C'yra." C'yra holds her hand up dismissively as Catra laughs and walks towards Adora.

“You look very handsome yourself in that cloak.” Catra says as she wraps her arms around Adora’s neck. Adora circles her waist in her arms in instinct and pulls her closer. “I’m guessing that was from you?” Catra asks, turning her head towards her mom. Adora keeps her eyes fixed on Catra. She doesn’t hear C’yra’s response before Catra stiffens in her hands. “Is that…” She trails off.

“Us,” Adora says, knowing that Catra had finally seen the mural. “It’s a wedding anniversary gift from your mom.” Adora whispers. She kisses Catra on her neck and smiles when she hears Catra purr.

“Thank you, mama.” Catra says, still holding onto Adora. Nothing else exists to Adora right now, she doesn’t even care that C’yra is somewhere near them, she’s far too focused on her wife right now to care. There is only Catra. God, Adora is going to enjoy their night together tonight. “Adora, you’re staring.” Catra says, not looking at Adora but still knowing Adora was staring at her anyway.

“I know.”

“My mom is right there.”

“Can she read minds now?” Adora asks. Catra shakes her head but when she finally looks at Adora she’s smiling.

“I won’t keep you two,” C’yra says. “I believe Adora had plans. Happy anniversary.” Adora thanks C’yra again and then takes Catra’s hand, leading her out of the throne room and towards where their skiff was waiting for them.

Adora drives them to the Fright Zone. It’s a miracle she doesn’t crash them with how much she keeps staring at Catra. The short hair really suits her, like *really* . “Why did you cut it?” Adora asks curiously. It’s not that she doesn’t like it, she kind of loves it actually, she’s just curious as to what Catra’s intentions were.

“People always say I look like C’yra,” Catra answers. “I thought maybe this would separate us a little… And… I wanted a change. After everything… I don’t know, it felt right.”

“Well, you look good.” Adora says and Catra laughs.

“Figured that when you looked as though you wanted to take me right then and there in the throne room where my mama was.” Catra says sarcastically.

“Oh, I’ll take you, just later.” Adora retorts, it makes Catra blush.

“Idiot.” She mumbles playfully.

It doesn’t take long for them to reach the Fright Zone. Adora is kind of shocked to see how much it has changed. She thinks maybe she should stop calling it the Fright Zone, it’s not anymore, it is Scorpia’s kingdom. She also doesn’t know if the Fright Zone is even a Horde invention considering the old Scorpion throne room had been called Horror Hall. For a group of people so cuddly and bubbly, they sure had some strange names for their buildings.

Whatever the case, the smog is practically non-existent, with help of She-Ra’s healing (which Adora had mastered with the help of Luna) as well as Perfuma’s powers, the Fright Zone was looking more green than ever. The ugly metal buildings were slowly being taken down and replaced, making it look less jagged and spooky and more like the other Kingdoms of Etheria. The scrap metal was being put to better use too. The Fright Zone was looking… pretty.

Fortunately for Adora, not all of the metal buildings had been taken down yet, mostly the larger buildings, which was perfect for her plans right now.

Adora leads Catra through the Fright Zone. She’s surprised by how many people still call her ‘Lord’, despite not being the Lord of the Horde for a while now. Adora doesn’t think she’ll ever really get rid of the title, her past is attached to her as much as her limbs are. She doesn't think she’ll ever really escape it. She doesn’t mind though, she likes knowing where she’s been, where she is and where she’s going.

Adora helps Catra upland together they make it to the top of their tower. At the top, Adora had arranged for a blanket and a picnic tobe placed at the top. It was almost exactly like their first date, and that was the point. “You are such a sap.” Catra says with a chuckle as she walks forward and sits down on the blanket, looking out across the Fright Zone. The sun was setting and with the smog gone, it was a pretty impressive view, Adora could even see all the way to the Whispering Woods.

Adora sits down beside her wife and smiles. “It’s our first anniversary, of course I’m a sap.” Adora replies. She grabs a bottle of champagne and pops the cork. It’s kind of a miracle they even made it here if they’re honest. Adora almost died many many times, so did Catra. Not only did they make it this far alive, but they’ve also been married for a whole year. Adora figured that deserved to be celebrated. Catra smiles as she accepts the glass of champagne that Adora offers.

Adora begins unpacking the food. Thanks to the improved diet of the Horde, they actually had edible foods, definitely more than what Adora had to offer the first time they were here. They make casual conversation as they eat, enjoying each other's company. That’s what marriage is, enjoying each other's company for the rest of your lives together.

Once they’re finished eating, Adora stands to her feet and offers her hand to her wife. Adora pulls Catra closer and begins slow dancing with her on their little spot on that roof. “Have you ever thought about how the major milestones in our relationship have been marked by us dancing together?” Adora asks.

“Have they?” Catra asks.

“Kind of,” Adora says. “Princess Prom, our first date, our first dance at our wedding and now.”

“I found you arrogant and annoying at Princess Prom,” Catra states. “Sometimes I wonder why I felt so… drawn to you. We were enemies… I was supposed to hate you, and I think I did, but… You got under my skin.”

“You hated me?”

“Did you miss the part where we were enemies and you were the evil Horde Lord?” Catra asks, raising an eyebrow.

“You still found me devastatingly handsome though, right?” Adora asks with a cheeky grin. “Irresistible. Incredibly attractive. Super sexy-”

“Please stop,” Catra interrupts, rolling her eyes fondly. She pauses for a moment. “You know I was attracted to you.”

“I was attracted to you too.” Adora says with a smile. “But you already knew that. You were the one who denied it.”

“Evil Horde Lord, Adora.” Catra repeats. “At least, that’s what I thought at the time. Sure, I thought you were hot, but I knew I couldn’t act on those feelings, not in a big way anyway, not until you kidnapped me.” Adora laughs softly. Who would have thought they’d make it here.

“I have a surprise for you too.” Catra whispers. The way that her voice drops a little has Adora shuddering. She has an inkling to what Catra is hinting at. “Close your eyes, Adora.” Catra whispers again. She’s so close to Adora’s lips that her breath brushes across them. Adora is tempted to kiss her, but she resists. She closes her eyes, following Catra’s instructions, waiting for Catra to do whatever it was that she was wanting to do.

First, Catra kisses her anyway. The intensity of it catches Adora somewhat off guard, she wasn’t expecting Catra to deepen it right away. She moans softly into Catra’s mouth and chases after her lips when she pulls away. “Time for your gift,” If Adora is honest, the kiss was a gift enough.

Adora hears Catra root around a little and then she feels her presence in front of her again. She feels Catra reach up, then she feels something soft wrapping around her neck. “Catra…” Adora gulps a little, feeling it catch on the thing around her neck. She lifts her hand up and feels *leather* . “Is this a *collar* ?” Adora asks, opening her eyes. She glances down to see a white weather collar around her neck, the material on the inside was soft, designed for comfort on the wearer. She glances up at Catra who was grinning.

“Yes it is,” She states and then she reaches up, grabbing the golden loop with her finger - Adora is pretty certain that it’s based on She-Ra’s outfit. “I have a matching leash too. Maybe if you’re a *good girl* , you’ll get that too.” Adora swallows thickly. She has the best wife in the entire universe and Adora is so insanely attracted to her that she can think of nothing better than being dragged off by her and *used* . “Take me to your old throne room, my Lord.”

“Fuck,” Adora mumbles. “Definitely.”

Adora almost falls down the tower she’s so eager. Catra just laughs at her the whole way to her throne room. When they get there, they see a no entry sign on the door. Something about it being under construction, Adora didn’t really read it if she was honest. It meant they were unlikely to be disturbed at least.

The throne room was *definitely* ‘under construction’. The thing was pretty bear, Adora’s throne was gone, in the attic of her new family home, all that really remained was the Fright Zone’s exposed metal tube architecture and her old table she used to have covered in paperwork. All that was on top of now was probably dust.

They climb the many stairs up to where the throne used to be and Adora grabs hold of Catra, pulling her in for a searing kiss. She could hardly believe that she would get to do this for the rest of her life. Catra loops her finger through the metal hoop on the collar around Adora’s neck and pulls her down. Just like that, Adora goes from being the one in control to being the one giving up control.

Some people get off on taking control, others giving it up. Adora happens to enjoy both, but she's learnt over the years with Catra that she especially enjoys giving it up. Adora has spent so many years of her life clawing for control of everything, she likes giving it up to her wife whom she trusts completely.

"Are you Force Captain Catra?" Adora asks. Adora knows that Catra enjoys that title, it's usually their go-to despite the fact that Catra has never been a Force Captain, nor been a part of the Horde - unless you count the fact that she took a lot of Horde soldiers under her wing while visiting during the early stages of their relationship (more like affair) or her marriage to the (ex) Horde Lord.

"No," Catra says. She tugs Adora around, by her collar, and looks around. "Hm..." She hums. Adora can see her thinking, see the spark in her eyes as she forms a plan. Catra's mind is beautiful, it's as beautiful as she is. Catra can think rings around Adora, this has always been true. Even when Adora was Lord, Catra always managed to out-think her, she's exceptionally cunning and Adora supposes that's why she used to be the Rebellion's main strategist.

"What are you thinking, Catra?" Adora asks softly. The anticipation is kind of killing her already, but, while Catra has her by her collar, they've not exactly entered that scene yet.

"Do you think that could take your weight?" Catra questions, pointing to one of the many metal pipes that the Horde has. Adora still isn't entirely sure what all the pipes are for, she supposes she doesn't have to anymore either.

"My weight?" Adora asks, confused.

"I want to suspend you from it, Adora." Adora's brain short circuits. This is not how she saw her night going whatsoever.

"Oh," Adora says dumbly and Catra laughs. Adora looks at her and lets out a huff in unamusement. Yes Adora is having many gay thoughts, but can you really blame her? "Let me test it." Adora decides after a moment.

"Wait," Catra says. "Take your shirt off first."

"Is that all I am to you?" Adora asks with a smirk as she removes her cloak and then grabs the hem of her shirt. "A piece of meat for you? Someone for you to oogle?"

"You certainly are nice to look at, yes." Catra says, her lips turned up in amusement. Adora rolls her eyes fondly as she lifts her shirt up and over her head leaving her clad only in her pants and a sports bra. Catra taps her on her ass for good measure which Adora chooses to ignore for now.

Adora hops a little in order to be able to reach the pipe and then she hoists herself up, performing pull ups. She grunts a little in effort but it's pretty clear to her that the pipe will absolutely hold her weight. "Keep going," Adora hears from behind her. Adora snorts but does as Catra instructs anyway. If she's honest, she likes Catra appreciating her strength.

Catra begins to circle her and Adora giggles a little when Catra brushes her stomach with her tail. "Where do you find the time to work out, Adora?" Catra asks.

"Maybe I want to be your trophy wife," Adora says with a grin, continuing her pull ups. She crosses her legs, feeling the pleasant burn in her biceps.

"You're definitely a trophy," Catra says and Adora can hear the clear amusement in her voice. "Okay, stop. Come down here." Adora does a couple more pull ups before she drops back down onto her feet. “You are… So fine.” Catra comments. “I feel like I don’t compliment you enough.”

“Because I can’t take a compliment,” Adora points out. It makes her feel embarrassed, that’s the best way that she can describe it. Adora gasps a little when she feels Catra’s claws on her. She runs them gently over her skin, it’s not hard enough to mark her, sure, but the sensation is enough to have Adora almost moaning.

“Pants.” Catra orders. Adora immediately responds to her tone of voice, standing up straight like a good soldier. Following orders, figures she’d be good at that. Catra’s claws move down Adora’s legs. “I could claw them off… But I think I’ve ruined enough of your clothes for a lifetime. Why don’t you be a good girl and take them off yourself?”

“Yes, ma’am.” Adora says immediately. She unbuttons her pants and then pulls them down and off. She has to wrestle for a moment with her boots but she manages. She goes to pull her underwear down too, but Catra grabs her wrist.

“Did I give you permission to take those off?” She asks. Adora’s eyes widen a little before she shakes her head.

“I just thought-”

“Oh, you *thought* ?” Catra interrupts. “Don’t speak without my permission, Lord Adora, and don’t presume what it is that I want you to do. I thought you were good at following orders?” Adora shuts up instantly and then straightens upright, awaiting Catra’s orders. Adora nods a little. Catra hums before she starts circling Adora again. Adora is starting to feel like prey.

Adora hears the sound of something very familiar hitting the ground. It’s instinctive to her, she doesn’t mean to move, or to turn, but she does it automatically. Her suspicions are confirmed when she sees Catra holding her whip in her hand, smirking, eyebrows raised. “Where did you even hide that thing?” Adora asks. Maybe Catra stashed it somewhere and Adora just didn’t notice until right now. Without speaking, Catra moves her wrist. Adora almost jumps out of her skin when she hears the thing crack in her ear, her eyes widen as she stares at her wife.

“You keep disobeying me, Lord Adora.” Catra says in a *very* authoritative tone. “I think you need to be taught a lesson.” Catra curls her whip back up and then attaches it to her hip. Adora just stares at Catra in complete stunned silence. “I’ve been practising.” She says simply, shrugging. “Now come on, Perfuma taught me a few rigging techniques for me to do this with you safely.”

“You’ve been talking to Perfuma about this?” Adora asks. She figures she’s safe to do so because Catra gently takes her arms in her hands for the time being. Her wife hums in answer.

“She has experience with it,” Catra responds. “I need your help, your height specifically.” Adora accepts the equipment Catra hands her.

“Good for Scorpia,” Adora comments as she follows Catra’s instructions. She’s still in her sports bra and underwear, she thinks if she were butt naked while doing this, Catra might have a hard time giving out her orders - then again, Catra always has had more self control than Adora.

Once Adora has helped rig the pipes up in the way Catra instructed her to, Catra instructs her to stand and place her hands in front of her. Adora does so eagerly and watches with keen interest as Catra stands in front of her. “It shouldn’t hurt you too bad,” Catra says. “I know you like that,” Catra hovers over her abs with her claws. “But I’d rather not have to take you

to the medics with a sex injury, I'd never live it down." Adora snorts and then grunts as Catra tightens the restraints. "It also needs to be able to hold all of your… muscle." Adora smirks a little. Sometimes she enjoys seeing how much Catra is attracted to her. "Shut up." She grumbles, booping Adora on her nose with her tail.

That's when Catra starts lifting her bound hands up to suspend them from the rigging Adora had helped put up. "Be a good girl and you'll get your leash." Catra purrs and Adora shudders. "Now, I need you to relax your weight, I need to be sure it can hold you if you become unable to stand." Adora raises her eyebrow at that statement but she does as Catra instructs her to. Her instincts tell her the opposite, but she does it anyway. The rigging easily takes her weight and Catra seems happy and satisfied with that. "Okay," Catra says. "Now we can begin."

And so Catra does begin. She hadn't been lying when she said she had been practising and Adora has to wonder when the hell she's had the time and also where the hell she's been practising *at* . Using a whip is not for the faint hearted, both the wielder and the receiver have to be extremely careful to not cause serious damage, the wielder in particular must be skilled and, boy, is Catra *skilled* . Catra alternates between her whip and her claws, the pain and the jests from Catra have Adora absolutely soaking; her legs do buckle a little under both the weight of pleasure and the weight of her body. Adora is pretty certain she cums at least once just from the overwhelming sensations of the pain and pleasure she was experiencing.

She's a panting mess by the time she hears Catra reining in her whip. Adora hangs there, suspended, already wrecked by her wife. Catra walks towards her and then kisses her tight shoulder muscles. "You're doing so well, Adora." She praises softly and Adora leans backwards to press herself to her wife, whimpering a little when she feels Catra beginning to purr. "Light?" Catra asks gently.

"... Green." Adora answers after a moment of hesitation. She wants to keep going and she can keep going. Catra doesn't react at first before Adora feels her pull away. Adora whines at being abandoned by her soft feeling wife until Catra appears in front of her instead. She examines Adora's face for a moment before she seems to find something that satisfies her and she nods.

"I can smell you, my love." Catra says as she gently grabs hold of Adora's chin. "You came, didn't you?" Adora thinks she *must* have at some point. Her underwear feels uncomfortably wet and she's sweating.

“Yes.” Adora answers. She happily accepts the water Catra holds up for her. *When the hell did she get water* ? Honestly, this whole thing has kind of been an amazing blur.

“Good girl.” Catra coos. She moves her hands down and then pulls Adora’s underwear down. Adora gasps a little at the sudden exposure before she moans, feeling Catra’s fingers press against her clit. “Do you like that, Adora?” Catra asks. Adora nods her head eagerly. Catra *knows* Adora likes that. “You really are wet.” Catra comments. She moves her fingers down and through Adora’s folds. “Penetration or no penetration?” Catra asks. Adora pauses. Over the year, she’s learnt she doesn’t mind it so much but she’d still much rather give than receive. Adora opens her mouth before she closes it again. She needs… *more* . That’s all she knows.

“I’m *yours* ,” Adora says earnestly. “Do as you please with me… my Queen.” Catra pauses at that, pulling back a little to look at Adora. She smiles a little.

“You are mine.” She says as she pushes a single finger inside of Adora. Adora squirms a little with the pressure she feels before she nods her head. Catra knows her well, she gives her time to adjust while whispering praise to her. She lifts her hand, showing off her ring. “All mine. Forever.” She says and Adora nods. Catra reaches up with her free hand and pulls Adora’s hair from its ponytail. Her blonde locks fall around her shoulders and down her back in a golden halo. “I’m going to fuck you until you’re spilling in my hand and then I’m going to make you cum again and again and again until you can’t walk. Is that clear?” Adora swallows thickly at that. *Fuck* . She’s pretty sure her walls just clamped down around Catra’s finger at that statement it turned her on so much.

“Yes, ma’am.” Adora croaks. And then Catra starts moving. The angle is strange and Adora’s squirming causes Catra a few problems but true to her word, Catra fucks Adora until she cums right into her palm, she practically feels her wetness coating the inside of her legs. Catra gets on her knees and *licks her clean* before she stands again. Adora isn’t sure how Catra is going to get her to cum again, twice is already a record for Adora, if Catra really wants to do it again, she must have a plan.

Adora feels something being pulled up her legs and she grunts a little. She’d gone all but limp when she’d climaxed that time, so she wasn’t really fully aware what Catra was doing, but it seems she put Adora’s underwear back on. “... That's it?” Adora asks, a hint of disappointment in her tone. She is enjoying being at the complete mercy of Catra, and by being fucked by her. Catra chuckles a little.

“Colour, Adora?” Catra asks.

“Yellow.” Adora responds. She just needs a moment to gather herself, she’s not entirely present at the moment. She takes slow breaths in and out, gathering herself before she slowly regains her strength. She finds her footing a little better and stands up a little. Catra doesn’t leave her in the cold, she gently holds Adora’s face in her hands and softly speaks comforting words to her. Slowly, Adora starts to feel better. “Green.” Adora finally says and Catra nods, smiling.

“Ready Princess?” Catra asks. Adora huffs at that nickname, and rolls her eyes, but nods anyway. Catra grins, flashing her fangs, before she takes a step back. She holds up a little remote in her hand and Adora looks at it completely baffled.

“Wha-” Adora’s words get cut off when she lets out a moan so loud it practically bounces off of the walls. Turns out Catra didn’t put her underwear back on, she put *vibrating* underwear on her. “Fuck, Catra!” Adora curses. Catra drifts closer to her and slips her fingers into her underwear, rubbing Adora’s clit between her fingers. “Holy sh… I- *Please* -!” Adora becomes a stuttering mess as her brain lights up with pleasure.

“You’re already going to cum aren’t you?” Catra asks. Adora’s only answer is her moaning and her legs wobbling. She sounds pathetic right now, but she doesn’t care. She is a *mess* . This is what Catra does to her. “It’s okay, babe. I know you’re already sensitive. I’m going to make you cum so many times, so do it Adora.”

“ *Fuck* !” Adora yells, feeling her walls contract. She cums and she feels pleasure run through her veins, overwhelming her. Catra turns the underwear down to a low buzz as Adora cums, then she removes her hand, smearing Adora’s cum along her abs as she places her hand on her stomach.

“Isn’t that a pretty sight,” Catra coos. “It’s like you were carved from marble, I swear.” Adora pants as she comes down from her high. She barely has time to get a grip on herself when Catra turns the remote up again. Adora almost *screams* . “I’m going to make you cum until you can’t stand, you remember that, right?” Catra asks. This is maybe a little sadistic, but hey, Adora is a masochist and this is really fucking doing it for her.

Catra is true to her word, she makes Adora cum at least seven more times before Adora gives up trying to stand. She falls to her knees, her arms stretched out above her as she hangs there. Catra turns the underwear off and sets about releasing Adora's hands from the rigging. She whispers words of praise as she gently massages Adora's sore muscles. Adora can do nothing but sit there on her knees. "Did I do good?" Adora asks when Catra crouches in front of her.

"You did so good, Love." Catra says before she places something in Adora's hands. "Transform." Adora looks up a little. It's her sword, but… Adora does as Catra instructs, like a good little sub, transforming into She-Ra. It's like she gets a second wind. As She-Ra her injuries are healed, including her muscle aches, she comes alive as her body is practically injected with adrenaline - handy in battle, and handy in sex, who would have thought?

"Collar…" Adora chokes, reaching up. Catra's eyes widen before she moves behind Adora and loosens the collar so she can actually breathe.

"Shit, I forgot how big you got as She-Ra." Catra says. Adora has been working on transforming in situations like this naked but she hasn't really mastered it, so she's now clothed. Adora stays kneeling before Catra helps her up.

"You… have a plan?" Adora questions. She assumes her wife has an idea because she doubts she'd ask her to transform if she didn't. Catra nods slowly.

"I… I once had a dream." Catra says slowly and then she blushes, like she's embarrassed. "When we were separated the first time around," She clarifies. "I had a dream with you where we… had sex on that." She points at the table. "You were She-Ra… We broke the table." Adora snorts.

"Of course we broke the table." Adora says with a cocky grin.

"Yeah, well, I don't feel like getting pregnant again right now, so make sure you don't… You know." Catra says as she grabs Adora's wrist. She reaches into her pocket and then pulls out that promised leash. Adora's pupils bow wide. She nods her head and Catra laughs as she reaches up and clips it onto the loop of Adora's collar.

“I want to please you.” Adora says. Adora has cum so many times, she really does not care for another, she just wants to make *Catra* feel good.

“Then do it.” Catra replies. Adora doesn’t have to be told twice.

Adora kisses Catra hard, she transforms her sword in her hand as she pushes Catra towards the table. Catra pulls her along by her leash, pulling it taught around her fist as she tugs on it. Adora grins into the kiss until Catra hits her lower back against the table. Adora lifts her up, she slips her strap on, eager to be buried inside of Catra already. She-Ra’s strength is Adora’s favourite thing when it comes to the fact that she can literally tear Catra’s clothes off of her body. She’d have to borrow some new ones before they left here.

Adora pushes two fingers inside of Catra as soon as she possibly can and Catra gasps. “Strap,” Catra demands, bucking her hips a little. “Watching you… I’m ready for it.” And she is, Adora can *feel* that with her fingers.

“Anything for you.” Adora says. She removes her fingers and then, without any build up, she slides her strap into Catra. Catra curses at the sensation and she pulls Adora forward by the leash she has in her hand. Adora really doesn’t care about the fact she is clothed, she is enjoying seeing Catra like this under her, being *inside* of her. This is her *wife* . “I love you, Catra.” Adora whispers hotly into her wife’s ear as she thrusts into her. Catra answers her with a moan.

It seems Catra is close already. Adora is pleased at least that it isn’t just her that gets off on that stuff, it makes her feel a little less like she’s strange for liking it. “Adora…” Catra moans. The sounds that are echoing around the hollow throne room have Adora shivering. They’re almost as intoxicating and arousing as the fact that she is buried inside of Catra. “Harder.” Catra demands and Adora is nothing if not obedient. The strength of She-Ra really is a wonderful thing.

“T…Turn me over,” Catra says. “Please, Adora, fuck me from behind.”

“Say less,” Adora responds. She pulls out of Catra and flips her over in one smooth motion. Catra grunts a little when her front presses against the metal table but as soon as Adora pushes back inside of her and begins thrusting she goes back to being a whimpering mess. Adora grips the edge of the table, feeling the metal bend under her strong grip.

“Yes,” Catra hisses. “Just like that… Keep going!” Adora wasn’t going to stop, but with the encouragement she really does keep going. Catra is close, Adora can feel it and Adora knows she only needs a few more hard thrusts. “Right- *Fuck* ! *Adora* ! Right there! *Please* !” Catra begs. Adora angles her hips up a little like she did on her last thrust and she feels Catra clamp down around her. Adora’s eyes widen. That’s the *spot* . Adora thrusts exactly like that, stroking that spot with each thrust which she easily hits from this angle. The table shakes under her and she thinks maybe Catra’s dream is becoming a reality because this table isn’t going to last very long, and then Catra crashes over the edge. She calls Adora’s name as she cums and Adora keeps going, working her over for as long as possible to give Catra the most pleasure possible.

Eventually, Catra goes still under her, and limp. Adora stops her thrusting and then slowly pulls out of her. Her strap is covered in Catra’s juices, practically dripping. “Well… We didn’t break the table.” Adora points out. And then, because the higher powers than Adora must have a sense of humour, the table gives out. Adora yelps as she falls, unable to keep her balance. She lands right on top of Catra.

For a moment, they stay still from the sudden shock, and then they both burst out laughing. Adora rolls over onto her back and Catra sits up a little. “You just had to say it, didn’t you?” She asks. Adora rolls her eyes as she places her hands on her chest. “You didn’t cum inside did you?” Catra asks as she sits up. She starts her cute post sex wiggles.

“I didn’t cum.” Adora responds. “That was all for you.”

“Huh…” Catra says, turning to look at Adora. She unsheathes her claws and then tears away the fabric of She-Ra’s pants. Adora’s eyes widen a little. “I just think I can finish you off, no? You’ve been so good. Plus, it won’t take long considering you’ve already cum… how many times was it?” *A lot.* It was a lot. Adora huffs.

Before Adora can come up with some smart response, Catra moves closer to her strap and *puts her mouth around the tip* . “Fuck…” Adora says, breathless. She already knows she’s *definitely* not going to last long. *Fuck it* .

Adora’s hand grabs the short curls at the back of Catra’s neck and she pushes her down on the strap. “Do it,” Adora says. “Make me cum again, Catra.” Catra moans a little and then she

sets about that task diligently. She lowers herself down onto the strap, taking Adora's inches easily. Adora supposes that she's pretty used to it by now. Catra also really knows how to work her tongue in a way that has Adora's toes curling. She's definitely not going to last long. Catra also puts her hand to use, placing it at the base of Adora's strap, using her wrist to twist and put more pressure on Adora.

At some point, Adora realises that her strap had been covered in Catra's *cum* and now it's in Catra's *mouth* . That thought alone has Adora absolutely turned on to the max. With a few more strokes with her mouth and her hand, Adora explodes - literally. Adora goes completely limp after that and transforms back to herself. Catra lifts her head up after a moment and then curls into her side. "Wow…" Adora breathes. "Still got it." Catra snorts as she lifts her hand to gently touch Adora's face.

"Were you worried we didn't?" Catra asks while raising an eyebrow.

"No," Adora says. "Well… Maybe a little. We haven't exactly had the time to… You know." Adora shrugs. "Nice to know we still make each other feel like that."

"You're an idiot." Catra says affectionately. "Of course we do. No matter how long passes between us doing this sort of thing."

"You're right," Adora says, turning on her side so she can cuddle Catra better. "Can we just lay here?"

"Grab your cloak or we'll get cold." Catra instructs. Adora stands and retrieves the discarded cloak before she comes back to Catra, laying the cloak over the top of them both.

"I don't think your mom had this in mind when she gave me it." Adora points out. Catra laughs gently as she snuggles up to Adora. "This was the best anniversary."

"Here's to many more," Catra mumbles sleepily. Adora smiles softly and kisses Catra on her jaw. To many more indeed, for many years. This was the rest of Adora's life and she couldn't be happier with it. Catra was beginning to do her little sleepy purrs, telling Adora that she was drifting off to sleep. Adora pulls her a little closer. She looks up at the roof of the Fright

Zone. Adora has come so far, and sometimes she feels she still has a long way to go, but she's here and here is more than enough for her.

* * *

"They're three," Adora says to her wife as she watches Finn from across the room playing with some of their toys that Glimmer had given them. "We could at least *ask* if they would like to have a sibling of some kind, just so we know their thoughts on it." It's not like they wanted to have a baby *right now* , but Adora had been thinking about it recently, and she definitely felt open to possibly having more with Catra - it *had* been three years.

"They're attached to *you* ," Catra says from beside her, her tail coils a little before it uncurls. "I don't know if they'd cope well with their mom's attention being on someone else."

"They're not that clingy," Adora protests, smiling as she watches Finn's little tail wiggle as they play. Beside her, Catra snorts in disbelief.

"Adora, they get upset when *we* cuddle without them." Catra says and Adora can practically hear the eye roll in her tone of voice even when she isn't looking directly at her. "You really think they'd be okay with you snuggling another baby?" Adora sighs. Fine, maybe she coddles Finn a little, but they're her only child, they deserve every second of it.

"That's why I'm saying we ask." Adora says instead and Catra hums.

"Fine, we can ask them." Catra gestures for Adora to go ahead.

Adora pauses for a moment, turning towards her wife. Catra was dressed in some tight red bodysuit with that boob window that Adora had been caught staring at on occasion. It was similar to the 'Force Captain' uniform she wore when she and Adora sometimes… role-played, but it was a little different. For example, one shoulder had a sort of cloak with golden chains keeping it in place, marking out her importance, embroidered on either side of her collar was the symbol of Scorpia's Kingdom: a Scorpion on a golden sunflower. The sunflower had been added later, as a symbol for her wife, Perfuma. They had married within

the year of meeting and had a baby just as quickly. Flora wasn't too much younger than Finn. The symbols matched well, like it was meant to be.

Gone was the old symbol of the Horde, it still remained on the armour Adora had packed away into a chest years ago, and on her cape that Finn still liked to use as a blanket. Catra had stopped wearing the symbol of Half-Moon, but, since her new job was as liaison between the Princesses and helping ex-Horde soldiers settle on Etheria, Catra felt it appropriate to wear something that marked her out. She may have given up being Princess of Half-Moon, but she was still involved with the Princesses in that role and often helped Scorpia out. In a way, Catra had weirdly ended up with the Horde

Catra looks *hot* . Catra has always been attractive, but Adora swears that every year, Catra just grows even more beautiful than previously. Her hair had grown back a little but now she preferred to keep it mid-length, more manageable apparently, and she currently had it tied back in a ponytail. Adora smiles at her wife and moves forward to kiss her, she feels Catra smile into the kiss. "Seriously?" Catra asks, leaning back a little from the kiss.

"I want to kiss my wife," Adora says, leaning back in to kiss Catra again. Catra's hands come up to rest on Adora's shoulders, her long nails digging into the soft fabric of Adora's shirt. Adora feels a low fire being stoked inside of her before Catra pushes her back.

"No," She says with a fond head shake. "Stop thinking about that."

"I'm not thinking about anything," Adora says, smirking. Catra rolls her eyes and gently pats Adora on her bicep.

"I know you, Dummy." She points out. "We want to ask Finn something, *remember* ?"

"It's hard to think when you have that boob window." Adora says. "My weakness."

"If I knew your weakness was boobs, I would've shown you mine a long time ago when we were enemies."

“You say that like it *wasn’t* how we got together.” Adora retorts, which earns her a bap from Catra’s tail. Adora rolls her eyes playfully before she follows Catra over to Finn where they could talk to them.

Adora sits down in front of Finn, sitting on her knees while Catra crouches beside her. Finn looks up at them curiously, their blue eyes sparkling in the sunlight coming in through the open blinds. “Hey Little One,” Adora says softly. “Can we ask you something?” Finn drops their toy and nods their head. Adora glances at Catra who just gestures for her to continue. “Your mama and I were thinking… Maybe we’d have another baby. What would you think of that?” Adora asks. Finn stares at her for a long moment, she can see them thinking before they shake their head.

“No.” They deadpan. Adora stares in disbelief. She blinks. She hadn’t thought a three year old could sound so absolute about something like that. Catra laughs in amusement - also because she now knows that she was *right* and wasn’t going to let Adora live it down.

"Guess no more kittens." Catra comments, tickling Finn under their chin with her finger. Finn laughs and swats at it.

"Wait, hold on, Finn, you don't want a little brother? Or sister? Or siblings?" Adora asks. She thinks maybe they didn’t understand what she was saying the first time around and maybe they got a little confused.

"No." They shake their head again.

"But why not?" Catra asks, still giggling but clearly curious. Her tail is swishing behind her, showing her amusement. Adora admits that it is pretty amusing, she didn’t expect Finn to be quite so possessive of them.

"Because you're mine." They say, crossing their arms over their chest and pouting. Adora laughs softly.

"You're still ours even if we have another baby." Adora points out.

"No, no baby. Only me." Finn responds. They look so serious. It’s positively the *cutest* thing Adora has ever seen.

"Kitten, you know we'll always love you. No matter what." Catra reminds them, bringing them into her arms and purring.

"But you and mom are my best friends," Finn says, purring in response to Catra. Sometimes Adora was a little jealous of the fact the two could communicate in a way she never could. "Would the new baby be your best friend?” Catra looks at Adora and smiles.

"Finn, we're always going to be here for you, even if you get another sibling. We're not going to stop loving or caring about you in the slightest." Catra reassures them.

"But you're *mine* ." They pout. "I don't want to share you." Adora laughs and looks at Catra with great amusement.

"Sometimes we have to share, bud." Adora says.

"No." Finn deadpans again. Clearly they got their stubbornness from Catra. Catra laughs again.

"Alright, alright, thank you for being honest with us about how you feel." Catra says, ruffling their hair gently.

"Mhmm." Finn says, standing up to go back to playing.

Adora turns to Catra. "So... we're not going to make any more babies?" She asks quietly. "Because I was kind of looking forward to that." Catra shoves her for that comment.

"Not for now. We want to make sure our little Finn is happy. Another kitten can wait until they're a little older." Catra says. Adora knows that Catra is right, but she *really* wanted to make a baby with her.

"I guess that's true.” Adora says with a sigh. “I totally blame this on you though."

"What? Okay, no. They got that possessive side from you."

"That's so not true," Adora denies. "They get it from you."

"You say that as if you weren't the first one saying I belonged to you." Catra argues. Adora rolls her eyes.

"You're the only, only child between us... kind of. You coddle them way too much, they're attached to you, of course they don't want a sibling to steal your attention away from them." Adora responds. Although, she knows that Catra isn’t the *only* one who coddles Finn. In fact, Adora is pretty certain she’s guilty of being the worst one between them for doing that, but it’s her *child* , of course she coddles them.

"They don't want *our* attention being taken by another sibling." Catra says, pointing a clawed finger at Adora. Her mismatched eyes narrow and her brow furrows. She clearly was having none of Adora’s blame game.

"Yeah, okay, it's possible they're also attached to me whenever you're not around." Adora admits. Catra looks at her knowingly.

"Yes, I know."

"What do you mean you know?" Adora asks.

"The others tell me how Finn likes to be with you in the room when you're working on maps, or in meetings, also that you carry them around in that chest baby carrier thing." Catra says. Adora blushes a little. *Who has been exposing her to her wife* ?

"They like to sit with me." Adora says defensively. "Should we not let them be so attached to us? Or is that something they just grow out of? I don't want them to grow out of it... I want them to be my baby forever."

"I... I think we need to slowly let them be on their own, so that they can gain independence from us." Catra says, kissing Adora on her cheek. Adora sighs. "We can't always be there for them, even if we want to." Adora knows Catra is right. Finn won't be little forever, but gods Adora wants them to be.

"But that doesn't have to start today." Adora says. "Finn? I need a hug." Finn immediately drops everything to come sit in Adora's lap and give her a cuddle. "Much better." Adora says with a loving sigh. To think there might come a day where Finn *doesn't* like to give her hugs. How horrible that will be. Catra laughs and looks at them both with shiny eyes.

"No, not today."

"Finn is my favourite." Adora whispers and when Catra *looks* at her she smiles sheepishly. "Well... they are."

"They're our only kitten, and we love them." Catra purrs, ruffling their soft hair.

"I love my moms." Finn says happily. Adora thinks her heart might explode. She's starting to understand that having a kid is like having a piece of your heart outside of your body at all times, just wandering around.

"We know, kitten. We love you too." Catra says, kissing their forehead.

"I'm going to be so sad when they start school." Adora says mournfully.

"I know, we'll miss them running around with us and having fun." Catra says with a sigh.

"School?" Finn asks curiously.

"Don't worry about it yet, little kit." Adora replies.

"It'll be a while before that even has to be on your mind." Catra purrs, snuggling her family. "How about we go make lunch together? What do you want to eat, Finn?"

"Peanut butter sandwiches!" Finn exclaims and Adora grins.

"That's my baby." Adora says proudly. Catra shakes her head at them.

"Dorks." She says, pushing herself up from the floor. "Okay, let's go make some peanut butter sandwiches." Adora joins her, holding Finn in her arms. Maybe Finn would grow up, but that wouldn't be for a while. They could enjoy having them like this for a while yet.

* * *

Adora has been thinking, and she knows that often gets her in trouble, but she hasn't been able to shake the thought ever since Finn turned five and she and Catra agreed to send them to a public school. She loves Finn so much, but she has to bear the fact that she might also be the reason that they suffer the most.

She sighs as she turns to her wife. Catra was leaning against the counter in the kitchen, reading some paperwork that Adora had no idea about. Adora hated paperwork, she hated it even when she was the leader of the Horde. Catra's tail sweeps across the floor every now and then but she seems relaxed. "Catra," Adora says carefully. She sees Catra's ears move in her direction and she hums to tell Adora to go on. "I don't think I should go with you to drop

Finn off tomorrow." Catra seems to freeze, she becomes motionless and then she slowly turns to face Adora.

"What?" She asks. Adora takes a deep breath. She and Catra barely fight, mostly they bicker about stupid things, but Adora can see this being something they fight about. Adora shakes her head and picks up one of Finn's toys.

"I don't want them to be treated differently because I was there to drop them off," Adora explains. "I… I want them to have a normal experience in school." Catra crosses her arms over her chest. Adora winces a little. She knows that stance.

"Finn will be devastated if you don't come." She states. Adora feels *horrible* at that thought, but she's pretty sure it's the best thing for them.

"I… Don't you think I know that?" Adora asks. "But a Magicat mom dropping off their Magicat kid? No one bats an eye at that. If I go… Everyone knows my face. Finn isn't just any kid, they're instantly the Horde Lord's kid."

"Hardly." Catra says. She seems unimpressed. "No one even calls you the Horde Lord anymore, Adora." Adora knows Catra is right, technically. The only people who really call her that are ex-Hordies and even then most have taken to calling her Adora. She's more known for being She-Ra than for being the Horde Lord. Still, her past plagues her. Adora is sure that to those villagers of the villages she destroyed when Horde Lord, she will *always* be Lord Adora. She doesn't want Finn to have to face that.

"Not to my face." Adora says. It's a weak argument, but a plausible one.

"Or in general." Catra retorts. "I would have heard it. A lot of people forget that Magicats have really good hearing." Adora sighs at that. Her wife is too smart for her own good. This is why Catra so often wins their arguments. Adora shakes her head, stepping past her wife to place Finn's stuffed toy down on the kitchen counter.

"I'm telling you," Adora says. "I don't want Finn to become a target because I selfishly wanted to say goodbye to them." Catra *kicks her* and Adora scowls at her wife.

“Don’t do that,” She scolds.

“Ow?” Adora says, lifting her hands up at her wife in a ‘what was that for?’ gesture. It wasn’t hard, but still.

“You’re being an idiot,” Catra replies, rolling her eyes. “It *isn’t* selfish. We are a family, we love each other, we want to say goodbye to each other. No one is going to care that Finn’s mom is the ex-Horde Lord, trust me. People are far more likely to like them due to the fact that their mom is She-Ra, who has been helping to repair and heal Etheria after making peace for *everyone* . You’re overthinking.”

“People hate me… Finn doesn’t deserve to be hated for *my* sins.”

“They won’t be, Adora.” Catra says. “People hated you, true, but that was a long time ago. I mean, there are literally monuments of you in Bright Moon and villages. People don’t hate you anymore, not after everything you’ve done to make it right. Stop trying to bear the burden of that guilt, you’ve been forgiven.” Catra pauses. “You have an Atlas Complex, I’m going to need you to stop trying to bear the weight of everything before you get yourself killed, Adora. I don’t want to be a widow.”

Adora falls silent, looking away from her wife. She wonders briefly how many people she made widows in her mission to conquer Etheria, how many people she made an orphan. Sometimes the guilt is crushing, Catra is right. Adora would do anything to put it right, Catra is also right that Adora would give her life to help people, sometimes she thinks that’s what she *should* do to be forgiven. Perfuma has insisted that to be forgiven does not always mean a person has to give their life. Forgiveness is earned through hard work, and the conscious choice to be and do better. Adora has tried, she keeps trying to do that.

This life, Catra, Finn, their home, everything. Sometimes Adora feels unworthy of such love. She worries that one day people will come to play judge and executioner and take her family out simply for being *her* family. She worries that she is a danger to them. Maybe it’s the cynical view the Horde put in her, but she thinks about it a lot, about her demons finally catching up to her and her family being caught in the cross hairs. She’s had nightmares about it, sleepless nights watching over Catra and Finn. She’s always worried about it, even if it has been half a decade.

Adora is brought out of her thoughts by the feeling of Catra's warm hand grabbing her own. Adora slowly looks up at her. "I'm not dismissing your feelings," Catra says gently. "I love you, I… If you *really* think that's what's best, then we can do that, but you're not alone, Adora. If there are any problems, we deal with them *together* ."

"Together," Adora repeats. She lifts Catra's hand and kisses it softly. "Nothing bad can happen so long as we have each other."

"Exactly," Catra responds softly. Adora pulls her towards her and wraps her arms around her wife, kissing her on the lips this time.

"Okay," Adora concedes. "I'll come with you." Catra purrs softly and Adora feels herself smile. "How did I get so lucky?" Adora asks.

"You didn't," Catra says playfully, gently grabbing Adora by her chin. "You annoyed me and were so arrogantly attractive that I decided sleeping with you again wouldn't be so bad."

"It was the best thing you've ever experienced, right?" Adora asks with a grin.

"Your ego really is still as big as your forehead."

"Hey!" Adora protests. Catra makes it better by kissing her.

"Come on, let's go to bed." Catra says, grabbing Adora's hand and dragging her towards their bedroom. "Show me that 'best experience of my life' again."

"Oh hell yes," Adora says, scooping Catra up to carry her off to bed.

That's how Adora ended up here, kneeling in front of Finn to say goodbye to them on their first day of school. "I love you, Little One." Adora says. She feels like she might be crying but she's trying her best not to. "When you finish, we'll go get ice cream."

"Promise?" Finn asks, their big blue eyes are watery too.

"Cross my heart," Adora says, making a cross over her heart. She smiles at her kid and then kisses them softly on their forehead. "You got your mama's brains, you're going to be the smartest kid in your class."

"Just try your best Finn," Catra says from behind Adora. "We love you."

"I love you too." Finn says and then they hug Adora tightly. Adora *really* feels like she might start sobbing if she isn't careful. Her little baby… They're growing up. It wouldn't be long before they were back-talking her as a teen.

"Okay," Adora says, pulling back from the hug. She looks up at the teacher who smiles. "Be good. Don't do anything I wouldn't do."

"But… That's not a lot." Finn responds and Adora actually laughs at that. She stands back up and ruffles Finn's hair.

"You're not wrong," She admits. "Just remember that you can do anything, Finn, your mom is She-Ra." Adora flexes her muscles a little and Finn giggles. "You can do *anything* ."

"I want to be like you," Finn says and Adora's heart almost bursts out of her chest. Never in her whole life did Adora think she'd be a *role model* for someone never mind her own kid. Finn wants to be like *her* . Adora can't help but pick them up for another hug, kissing them on their cheek.

"You can be anything you want," Adora says. "Don't tell your mom, but I'll get you a sword." Finn gasps.

“Really?” They ask excitedly, their tail wiggling from their excitement, and Adora chuckles.

“Adora,” Catra says from behind her. “Magicat hearing.” *Dammit. Busted.*

“Maybe a wooden one, Kiddo.” Adora says to placate her wife. “But I’ll teach you. It’ll be our thing.”

“Okay, mom.” Finn says happily. The teacher takes their hand with a polite smile and Adora stands to her feet.

“It’s always hardest on the parents,” The teacher says fondly. “Don’t worry, we’ll take good care of them.” Adora nods and then the teacher begins leading Finn away. Finn pauses a little at the door and turns back to wave at them before they disappear inside of the building.

Adora stands for a long moment before she turns around and sees her wife waiting for her. “You okay?” Catra asks softly. Adora walks towards her wife and sighs happily when she feels Catra wrap her arms around her, even her tail brushes against her leg.

“I will be.” Adora says quietly. “They’re growing up.”

“Wait until they're a teen,” Catra says. “I bet you were a horror.” Catra says fondly as she pecks Adora on her nose. Adora grins a little when Catra turns, brushing her tail against her hand in an indication for Adora to follow after her.

“Maybe a little,” Adora admits. “I was a bit of a lady’s… lady.” Catra snorts.

“You? I don’t buy it.” Catra says. “You’re a giant dork. I don’t think you got obnoxiously cocky and flirty until you became Horde Lord.”

“I was only ever obnoxiously cocky and flirty with you, babe.”

“How sweet of you.” Catra says sarcastically. Adora jogs a little to catch up to her wife.

“If I’m not mistaken, we have an empty house.” Adora says, wiggling her eyebrows.

“So we do,” Catra hums. “We can finally clean up.”

“I had other plans for something I wanted to put on our counters.”

“You’re disgusting.”

“You love me.”

“Unfortunately.” Catra responds fondly. Adora was feeling better already.

* * *

The years seem to fly by. As time goes on, more pictures are added to their walls, more achievements of Finn are put on the fridge and later framed. Adora almost forgets about the other kid they had discussed having. They concentrate solely on Finn, pouring every piece of love they have into their upbringing. Ten years barely feels like ten years, Adora doesn’t know where the years go if she’s honest, but here they are.

“Adora?” Adora jumps a little when she realises that Catra was speaking to her. “You didn’t hear a single thing I just said, did you?” She asks, raising an eyebrow.

“Of course I did,” Adora says. “But… Maybe repeat it again? Just so I know you know that I totally know what it was that you were saying and that I was listening.” Catra rolls her eyes

at her but she's smiling. Adora knows that Catra is pretty used to Adora zoning in and out of their conversations by now, so she knows Catra isn't actually mad.

Catra is standing at the stove, gently stirring the soup she was making for their dinner. They had been talking but, if Adora was honest, she doesn't really recall what it was that they had been talking about. "I was telling you about how the settling of Horde soldiers was going," Catra says. Even after all these years, Catra still looks out for the ex-Horde members that Adora liked to call Hordies. It was kind of ironic, their places had almost been flipped. Where Adora had embraced her role as She-Ra, becoming embedded within helping Etheria and the Princesses, Catra was more embedded in helping the Horde. "I was also telling you about Finn's science project they were building, that's probably when you zoned out."

"You know me," Adora says with a chuckle. She picks up a sliced bit of carrot that Catra had to spare, biting into it. "I'm not really that scientific. Entrapta is helping them, right?"

"Yes," Catra hums. "Although, I'm worried they're going to blow up the school with that project of theirs but… Entrapta is definitely more scientifically inclined than we are." Adora has to agree. She's more of the punching type and Catra has the brains but she's never really taken an interest in science. Adora looks over at the wooden sword that was propped up against the fridge. Finn had taken an interest in martial arts, like Catra, and also fencing, like Adora. They were quite the swordsman, and they were in the fencing club for their school even if they were young and still had a lot to learn. Everyone starts somewhere.

"They're growing up," Adora says as she looks back at her wife. "Nine, nearly ten…"

"Strange," Catra says as she lifts the spoon out of the soup to taste it. "I can't believe so much time has passed already."

"I know."

"You have a meeting with the Rebellion next week," Catra says. "And Adora, please stop taking on dangerous assignments." Adora grins.

“No promises.” Adora says as she stands, coming around the kitchen counter to Catra. Catra shakes her head. Adora chooses to ignore that and places her hands on Catra’s hips, moving them around to her stomach, holding her from behind. “My beautiful wife.”

“Flattery isn’t going to win me over.” Catra deadpans. Adora chuckles a little before she kisses Catra on her neck. Catra leans back a little with a deep sigh. “It’s not fair.” Adora smiles to herself before she gently lifts Catra’s hand and kisses her wedding ring.

That’s when they’re disturbed by Finn appearing in the kitchen with a bag that they dump on the counter that clutters loudly. Adora lets Catra go in order to inspect the thing, finding it stuffed with scrap metal parts. “Should I be worried about this?” Adora asks as she pulls out one of the metal objects, looking at Catra who just shrugs.

“Aunt Entrapta said she needed them so I asked Aunt Scorpia if she had any lying around in the Fright Zone,” Finn says, reaching up to take the metal from Adora. Adora raises an eyebrow but allows Finn to take it anyway.

“I think we gave you too much freedom to talk to your aunts.” Adora comments as she drifts towards the fridge.

“Don’t you dare,” Catra warns. “You won’t eat your dinner.”

“Come on babe, you know I’m like a never ending hole when it comes to food.” Adora says, pouting. Catra lifts her finger and points it at Adora. Adora sighs and lifts her hands in surrender. “So what’s your project?” Adora asks Finn. Every day they look more and more like Catra. Their brown hair is curly and bouncy like Catra’s though they’ve told Adora and Catra that they prefer their hair somewhat short. Whatever they prefer, Adora and Catra provide. They still have Adora’s blue eyes.

“We’re building a mechanical windmill!” Finn says excitedly.

“That doesn’t sound so bad,” Adora comments, glancing at Catra.

“Yeah, Aunt ‘Trapta said it’ll be *awesome* .” Finn says. “It’s going to be the biggest project anyone has seen.”

“This thing can fit inside the school’s building, right?” Adora asks.

“Well… Not exactly…” Adora stares at them in disbelief before she shrugs.

“You’ll definitely win that way.”

“You are such a bad influence,” Catra says with a laugh. “Just make sure you’re not breaking any rules, okay kiddo?”

“Mom said rules are made to be broken.” Finn says and Adora gasps.

“I did not!”

“Yes you did, when we had all those cupcakes before dinner last week.”

“That was supposed to be our secret, Finn.” Adora says, placing her hand over her chest. “You betrayed me.”

“You two are terrible,” Catra says fondly, shaking her head. “I agree some rules can be… bent, but most exist for a reason. Use *good* judgement.”

“Yes, mama.” They respond as they pull themselves up onto the seat beside Adora. “Can I… Ask you something?”

“Of course, kitten.” Catra says.

“Why haven’t you guys had any more kids?” Finn asks after a moment. Catra pauses and then looks up at Adora who was just as caught off guard by the question as Catra was.

“What do you mean?” Catra asks, looking back at Finn.

“Do you not want any more?” They ask.

“It’s not…” Catra trails off. “We asked you, when you were three, you made it *very* clear that you didn’t want any more siblings. Besides, we haven’t really had all that much time. We’re happy with just you.”

“Mmm… ‘kay.” They say, shrugging. “I was a kid though, I wouldn’t mind a sibling, I think it would be kind of cool actually. Just so you know.” Adora looks at Catra. They hold each other's gazes before Adora looks back at Finn. “I gotta get this to Aunt ‘Trapta.”

“Not before dinner.” Catra says. “It’ll be ready soon, go wash up.”

“Yes, mama.” Finn says, grumbling as they slip off of the stool. Adora looks back at Catra who holds her hand up.

“We’re not talking about that right now,” Catra says and Adora nods.

“Later then…”

“Later.” Adora agrees. For now, she’d enjoy the wonderful meal her wife had prepared for her.

* * *

Later that night, in the privacy of their bedroom, Adora locks their bedroom door - thank god to the Horde soldiers who had the foresight to install that - and crosses the room to sit down on the bed beside Catra. Catra is being unusually quiet, but Adora isn't too surprised by this fact. She can see Catra thinking, her tail is swishing back and forth behind her and Adora is more than willing to wait Catra out. Adora likes to think she's patient, but she knows that's not true. She starts tapping out a pattern on her leg that must annoy Catra, or interrupt her thinking, because she grabs Adora's hands with her own.

Adora looks up at her wife. Catra's eyes are full of… *something* Adora can't quite place. Adora decides she'll go first. "Do you want to have another baby?" Adora asks carefully. Catra lets out a soft breath and releases Adora's hands as she turns away from her again. It's been nearly ten years since they had Finn, but Adora knows that Catra still struggles with the trauma she underwent from C'yra and the other Princesses. "I know we're in our thirties," Adora says with a little chuckle. "But lots of people have babies in their thirties, right?"

"I'm not worried about our age." Catra says. If you asked Adora, Catra just seems to get even more beautiful with age. She is aging like a fine wine and, while thirty-three is not by any means *old* , Adora knows that Catra is only going to get even more gorgeous with time. "You know what it is that I'm worried about." Adora sighs. She does know, but she also knows that they are in very different circumstances than they were when Catra was carrying Finn.

"Okay," Adora says slowly. "Maybe I could carry them? Right? I mean, She-Ra is the only one who can.. you know…" Adora gestures with her hand, "with the strap, but there are lots of ways couples have babies on Etheria."

"Adora…" Catra looks at her in surprise. "Do you really want to carry a baby? To give *birth* ?" Catra asks. Adora shrinks a little under her gaze and from the question. Honestly? Adora could think of nothing worse. She never wants to experience childbirth. "I didn't think so."

"But we can adopt?" Adora suggests. "Or… I don't know Catra, all I'm saying is, you don't have to carry our next baby unless you are *absolutely* sure and you know you definitely want to." Catra turns to her and Adora half smiles at her - she knows that's Catra's favourite smile.

"You want another baby?" Catra asks gently. She has softened considerably and Adora takes her hand from her lap. "You really think we can handle more than just Finn?" Adora laughs at

that and kisses Catra's hand.

"I know that we can," Adora answers honestly. "You and me together? There's nothing we can't handle." Catra smiles at that and Adora knows, with all of her heart, nothing is more important to her on this entire planet than making Catra happy and making her smile - save for Finn of course. "And… I do want another baby with you," Adora confesses. "I never had a big family growing up, not like this." Adora squeezes Catra's hand, feeling her eyes water slightly. "I want to add more mini me and yous until we've had enough." Catra takes a deep breath, she closes her eyes briefly before she blinks them back open.

"I want to have another baby with you too," She confesses in a whisper, like someone might be listening in on them, or shame Catra for wanting such a thing. Adora simply encourages her to carry on speaking by gently squeezing her hand. "I know I had a hard pregnancy with Finn but… I really liked being pregnant- Goddess, I feel like a weirdo." Catra drops Adora's hand to rub at her face in frustration.

Adora reaches her hands out to stop her. "Why?" Adora asks. She's confused, she doesn't know why Catra would feel that way at all.

"Because," Catra says. "I had such an *awful* pregnancy, like, it could not have been worse, yet… I liked being pregnant with *your* baby. I liked carrying them." Adora nods her head.

"That's not weird Catra." Adora says. "I actually think it's really sweet." Catra scoffs and rolls her eyes as she drops back on their bed. She scoots herself over to her side and lays with her back facing Adora. Adora sighs as she moves herself so she is lying behind her wife. "Catra?" Adora asks quietly. Adora gets a tail flick and an ear twitch in response. "I really want to have sex with you." Catra lets out a laugh of disbelief but it gets her to do what Adora wanted her to really do: look at her.

Now that Adora has her attention again, she decides to talk about the real topic they were discussing before. "Think about it," Adora says quietly, she moves her hand to rest on Catra's stomach. "It would be just us," She whispers, "we could have a normal pregnancy. I would wait on you hand and foot, anything for my Princess." Adora kisses Catra at the base of her ear and she feels Catra shudder. "Plus… You being pregnant with my baby is really hot to me for some reason."

“Your breeding kink is out of control,” Catra says with a laugh.

“I think you’ll find that we managed to go ten years without accidentally having a baby, therefore, it is *not* out of control.” Adora points out which only makes Catra roll her eyes. As the goofy moment settles down between them, Adora lifts her hand and gently cups Catra’s jaw with it. “Catra, you know I would protect you.” Catra stares into Adora’s blue eyes with watery mismatched ones. Adora has always thought that Catra had the most beautiful eyes, and she still stands by this.

“What if you can’t?” Catra asks desperately, her hands grip Adora tightly and Adora’s heart almost breaks at how desperate her wife sounds.

“I would die before I let anything happen to you,” Adora assures. “I’m not going anywhere. I promise.” This seems to overwhelm Catra and she grabs Adora by the front of her shirt, leading her so Adora was on top of her. Adora can hear her trail thumping against the mattress.

“I love you so much,” Catra confesses. “Let's do it.” Catra nods her head in determination and Adora’s eyebrows raise.

“You’re sure?” Adora asks, because this is a *big* step and she needs Catra to be one hundred percent sure.

“I’m sure.” Catra says and Adora believes her. She knows how to distinguish when Catra is being serious or if she is lying, just as Catra is the only one who can tell when Adora is bullshitting her and calls her out on it. “Make love to me, *She-Ra.* ” Adora feels a shiver run down her spine at hearing her alter ego’s name being said like that by Catra.

Adora sits up and Catra begins to pull Adora’s shirt out of her pants where she had tucked it in. Adora smiles softly and lets Catra slowly undress her. “We’ll have to be quiet,” Catra says as her warm hands brush against Adora’s abs, Adora nods in agreement.

“That’s a challenge when we use She-Ra,” Adora notes. They haven’t done this with She-Ra in a very long time, the reason for that being that She-Ra can get Catra pregnant and they had

been trying to avoid such a thing from happening which meant She-Ra had taken a backseat in their bedroom life - except on rare occasions. Now, Adora has permission to basically let her loose. Catra gives her a warning glare and Adora winks.

Catra manages to pull Adora's shirt off of her and then she unbuttons the button on Adora's pants and then her zip before she pushes them down Adora's thighs. Adora goes to retrieve her sword but Catra stops her, drawing Adora in for a passionate kiss that steals Adora's breath away. "Wait," Catra whispers against Adora's lips. She nips gently at Adora's bottom lip. "Let me touch you first, before we use the sword." Adora's breath hitches a little with those words but she nods her head against Catra.

"I'd like that." Adora confesses. By now Catra knows exactly what it is that Adora *does* like, they know each other's bodies like their own.

Catra nods as she moves Adora's pants down further and Adora kicks them the rest of the way off. Now she is left in only her sports bra and underwear. Catra reaches her hand up and caresses Adora's cheek. Adora nuzzles into her palm. Catra touches her like Adora is made of glass, like she is the most precious thing in the entire world, and it makes Adora feel infinite warmth in her chest.

Catra reaches up and pulls Adora's golden hair from her ponytail. Her hair had long since grown out, she thinks cutting it even helped it grow more healthy than it originally was; Catra certainly seems to like it, her smile says it all. Catra kisses Adora on her jaw and then she whispers to her. "Beautiful," She says so genuinely that it makes Adora blush. "You are so beautiful, Adora."

Adora turns her head slightly, looking Catra directly in her eyes despite her embarrassed blush. "Touch me." Adora says, swallowing thickly. "Please?"

"Since you asked so nicely." Catra says with a smirk. She moves her hand down to the band of Adora's boxers and then slips her hand under it. Adora breathes a sigh of relief as soon as she feel Catra's fingers brush against her clit. "Who do you belong to, Adora?" Catra asks. Her voice is a little husky with her desire and that only makes Adora shudder with her own arousal. She's always found Catra's voice extremely attractive, but it's aways on another level whenever they do *this* .

“You,” Adora answers honestly. She has a ring on her finger that proves it - they both do.

“That’s right.” Catra purrs as she begins to actually move her fingers. The sensation makes Adora falter, her brain is only thinking about *pleasure* at that moment, she loses track of what she wants to say or do and is, instead, at the mercy of Catra. “Good girl, Adora.” It’s not fair. It’s not fair that only two words can make Adora so unbelievably wet, but they do. “Remember to be quiet, Princess.”

“I… thought…. We weren’t making that… a thing…” Adora says between quiet whimpers. She doesn’t really care about Catra calling her Princess, especially not in bed, but she still protests against the title - Horde programming is hard to override even after a decade of the Horde technically not existing. Adora is still impacted by her trauma, but it doesn’t control her anymore.

“I never agreed to that.” Catra says and Adora can hear the grin in her tone. “I think you need to work yourself up.” Adora is about to ask what Catra means by that when Catra *stops* what she’s doing. Adora lets out a whimper of disapproval and jogs her hips a few times. In her pleasure fogged mind, Adora didn’t fully compute what it was Catra was suggesting until Adora manages to get a grip on herself and realises just *exactly* what it was that Catra was suggesting.

Catra pulls Adora down and Adora’s eyes widen in surprise. She was now practically lying on top of Catra, and Catra still had her fingers pressed to Adora’s clit. “Get on with it, *My Lord* .” Catra winks as she says Adora’s very very old title. Even still, it’s effective.

Adora knows that Catra wants her to grind against her fingers, to essentially hump her fingers, and Adora is *definitely* going to do that. Other than her pillow, this is one of Adora’s favourite ways to touch herself. Catra knows this and she was using it against Adora. Adora really doesn’t care. She starts to move her hips, rubbing her clit up and down, against Catra’s palm. Adora’s eyes practically roll back in her head at the sensation.

“Harder…” Adora pants as she feels pleasure grip her insides, spreading from her gut to her brain.

“You’re in charge of the pace here, Princess.” Catra says. Adora huffs at the Princess title which makes Catra laugh. “Why do you dislike that so much? Do you think being a Princess

is a bad thing?”

“You’re the only legitimate Princess here.” Adora points out. She sees Catra pull a face. Adora had refrained from calling Catra Princess ever since she told her she no longer wished to be Queen of Half-Moon, sticking to her usual affectionate Kitten nickname - although even that had fallen into disuse after Finn.

“If you really don’t like it, I’ll stop.” Catra says. “I just want to know why.” Adora looks at Catra in slight disbelief.

“You really want to talk about this while we’re in the middle of sex?” Adora asks. Catra just gives her a look and Adora huffs, pausing her movements. “I don’t think being a Princess is a bad thing, I just… I don’t feel like a Princess, and I don’t like the connotations to it. Does that make sense?”

“Do you prefer Prince?” Catra asks with a purr. Adora shudders a little.

“Do *you* ?” Adora asks, raising an eyebrow. Catra blinks at her. It’s no secret between them that their gender, and their feelings towards it, are complicated. Adora much preferred being Lord of the Horde, she would have kicked someone down the stairs leading to her throne if they had called her Lady of the Horde, she does like being called Princess, and she likes dresses (even if she has not admitted this fact out loud before), she likes to look pretty, and she likes when Catra calls her beautiful *and* handsome. She has no particular preference with her gendered terms, except for the occasional times that she does - like with the Lord thing. It’s all very complicated to her. “Prince Catra of Half-Moon?” Adora asks. “Would you like to be called King? Or Queen?” Adora is asking hypothetically of course. Catra just grumbles at her.

“Shut up and keep getting yourself off against my fingers, will you?” Catra asks. Adora rolls her eyes.

“I’m serious,” Adora says. “If you want me to use different words, or anything, then I totally will.” Catra smiles at that, and she leans up to peck Adora on her lips.

“I know, Love.” Catra says softly. “I feel… The same way you do. I promise, if I wanted you to use certain words or pronouns, or anything, I would tell you. But I’m okay, okay?” That satisfies Adora and she nods in response. “Now, please, continue what it was that you were doing.” Adora laughs before she does just that. Maybe it’s unusual to talk about that stuff when you’re in the middle of sex, but nothing about their relationship has been usual to begin with.

Adora starts grinding against Catra’s palm again. She moves her hips feverishly, trying her best to work herself up. It’s not hard. Adora would be able to do it simply from rubbing but hearing Catra’s soft praise and being in control of the pace while Catra moves her fingers in certain ways to apply pressure in a particular way… Adora is so unbelievably close already.

“Don’t cum yet, Adora.” Catra orders. Adora whimpers, but does exactly as she’s told. Catra suddenly removes her fingers, taking away Adora’s friction. Adora wants to scream in protest but she doesn’t have the chance to even open her mouth before she’s suddenly flipped over onto her back.

“What…?” Adora blinks up at Catra as the brunette pushes herself up and off of the bed. “Are you really going to leave me hanging?” Adora begins to move her hand towards her clit so she can finish herself off, and find relief, but Catra immediately causes her to freeze.

“ *No* .” Catra says in an authoritative tone. It’s an *order* and Adora instinctively straightens up, her hand moving to her side. She hasn’t been taking orders (outside of the bedroom anyway) for years, but Adora supposes once a soldier, always a soldier. “I have plans for us, my Lord.” Adora adjusts the pillows behind her and lies back down against them as she watches Catra closely.

Adora thinks Catra totally planned this, she planned to edge Adora, a little sexual torture that Adora is 100% in to. Catra knows her well. She always planned to interrupt Adora. Catra is taking her sweet time, walking around their bedroom almost lazily. Despite her cocky and confident composure, Catra is a little ruffled. Adora spots liquid on her shirt and realises she probably wiped Adora’s fluids off on it. *That shouldn’t be as hot as it is.*

Catra undresses and she does it *slowly* . Adora realises that this is all part of torturing her. Catra is teasing her, turning her on without having to touch her, it’s not really fair if you ask Adora. Adora is insanely attracted to Catra, she *loves* her wife, seeing her naked right in front of her? Adora is obviously turned on by that.

Once Catra is undressed, and has *folded* all of her clothes, dragging this torture out, Catra moves over to their drawers. Adora's breathing picks up a little. Over the years, they had amassed an impressive collection of toys - especially since the She-Strap could make Catra pregnant. If they wanted to use She-Ra, which they rarely do, it was just safer to use her non-magical strap. Adora wonders what Catra is doing. Since they agreed to try for another baby, Adora figured they were using their favourite toy, which meant no non-magical strap, but she could be choosing a different toy, something to have *fun* with.

Catra turns around with a *wand* in her hand. Adora lets out a whimper that she fails to suppress and she sees Catra smirk. "See something you like, Adora?" No one says Adora's name quite like Catra does. Adora shudders and sits up a little more. "Yeah, you definitely do." Catra laughs at her as she climbs back onto the bed and on top of Adora, straddling her hips.

"What do you have planned?" Adora asks as she swallows thickly. Catra is teasing her more by making a show of inserting the batteries into the toy and then turning it on, pressing her fingers over the top of the thing. "Fuck…" Adora's mouth suddenly feels dry - while over areas feel very *wet* .

"I think I need warming up a little, so we can cum at the same time." Catra purrs. Adora's eyes are completely fixed on the toy that she almost completely misses what it is that Catra says. She slowly looks at her wife's face before she nods. Catra has a shit-eating grin on her face, she knows *exactly* what it is that she's doing. "Then you can fuck me with She-Ra." Catra says, grabbing Adora by her chin. It's absolutely *filthy,* but it totally makes Adora hot all over.

Catra keeps her eyes locked onto Adora as she takes Adora's hand and puts it over her own on the toy - Adora forgot how strong the vibrations on this thing were. She slowly moves it down and then presses it to her own clit. Catra lets out a relieved moan and Adora feels her mouth run even more dry as she watches pleasure take over her wife's features. "Talk to me, Adora." Catra instructs.

"Talk to you?" Adora asks, her brain is foggy, at best, that Catra's words feel distant, far away.

“ *Talk* to me,” Catra says as she rolls her hips. “You know what I want.” Adora’s brain scrambles. Really, it’s not fair. Catra knows what she does to her, of course Adora can’t concentrate on saying sexy things right now. This seems to only amuse Catra who laughs at her. “You’re such a bottom, I can’t believe this.”

“Hey!” Adora protests. “You know that’s not true.” Adora pouts. Catra is *smiling* so Adora can’t be too mad at her. “I am not.”

“No, you’re not.” Catra says, her breath hitching a little as Adora applies more pressure to the toy against Catra’s clit. “Why don’t you prove that to me and make me cum, Adora?” And just like that, Catra manages to activate Adora’s service top mode.

Adora sometimes finds it incredible how much their sex lives have evovled over the years. It’s almost more ‘vanilla’ now these days, they don’t exactly have the privilege of a kid-free life for it to not be, but their dynamics have completely changed. If Adora is honest, it changed that night in the Fright Zone when they first and officially made love, aware of their feelings for each other. Adora’s possessiveness, her… *hunger* for Catra, while still there, Catra was no longer someone Adora could not have, Catra is *hers,* and Adora feels less of a need to prove it to her now which means she’s settled into a service top role. Adora just wants to take care of Catra, she wants to make her feel good, it makes Adora feel good in turn. Adora would be happy to deprive herself of release if it was to make Catra feel good instead. Catra cums, Adora sees that as a job well done.

“I need the handle, Kitten.” Adora whispers softly as she moves her hand up. Catra keeps her own fingers pressed to the tip of the toy but Adora takes control of it. *Catra asked you to talk to her. Talk to her* . Adora’s brain reminds her. She’s now in full service top mode. She will do anything that Catra wants if it brings her pleasure.

“Adora…” Catra’s head falls backwards as Adora finally takes the lead, pressing the toy harder against Catra’s clit as the brunette bucks her hips a little, rocking against the head of the toy.

“I love you, Catra.” Adora says. Catra peeks an eye open to glance down at Adora. “You’re beautiful.” Adora’s voice is genuine, and full of the deep affection she feels for her wife. She knows it’s working because Catra actually blushes when Adora says that. Adora has a praise kink, that’s pretty obvious, she craves validation, but Catra does too. It’s slightly different

between them though, Catra likes gentle praise, Adora's is a little more *desperate* , a persistent need to know she's doing The Best.

"You're doing so good, Kitten, just like that." Adora encourages. Catra lets out a powerful purr as she moves to lean her front against Adora. Adora takes the opportunity to press hot kisses against Catra's jaw, nipping every so often. "You always take me so well. You are the best, and most loving wife, I love you so much."

"Fuck… Adora…" Adora grins a little as Catra calls her by her *name* and not by Princess. That's how Adora knows that what she's saying is working. Well, that and the fact that Catra is moving her hips harder and faster.

Adora moves her lips up so that she can whisper right into Catra's ear. "Let me inside of you." Adora begs quietly. Catra practically *whines* but nods her head quickly.

"Yes," She says verbally this time as she moves slightly to allow Adora the opportunity to slip her hand between her thighs while also being able to keep the toy in place. Adora is suddenly thankful that the Horde insisted upon making its soldiers learn to be ambidextrous - being able to use both hands was just tactically intelligent. Although, Adora tends to favour her right, she's also pretty good with her left.

Adora moves her fingers down. Pleasantly, she finds that Catra is more than wet enough to take her fingers. What they're currently doing, and maybe what Catra had been doing to Adora before, was clearly working for her. Adora cautiously presses her fingers into Catra, moaning slightly at the liquid heat she finds that practically sucks her fingers in. Catra lets out a soft mewl when Adora presses inside of her and curls her fingers, rubbing them against the front of Catra's walls. "Hm," Adora grunts as she settles her fingers there. Catra lets out a soft sound that is somewhere between a growl and one of her *'mrrp'* sounds she does when she's confused. "I think I'll wait here for a moment."

" *Adora* ." Catra *definitely* growls that time. It's a warning. She's telling Adora to *fuck* her but Adora likes to tease a little. Catra seems to be considering her words, which makes Adora slightly suspicious, but she makes no move to actually provide Catra with her relief. "I guess you don't know what you're doing." Catra says suddenly and Adora narrows her eyes at her wife. "You clearly don't know how to *satisfy* me."

“Excuse me?” Adora asks, offended. “I am *very* capable of satisfying you. How many times have you came while screaming my name?” Adora asks. She knows what Catra is doing - and *it’s working* . Adora hates to be told she can’t do something, she especially hates being told she can’t satisfy her wife. It awakens her competitive nature, her nature to want to prove to Catra that she is *wrong* by fucking her into next week, and Adora knows that’s exactly that Catra intended to do because she’s a *brat* .

“I guess you’ve lost your touch.” Catra says with a smirk as her tail behind her waves back and forth. Adora wants to hold out, she really does, but Catra hit *exactly* the right button. She pulls her fingers back and then rams them back into Catra. Adora revels in the gasp and the moan Catra lets out in response.

“What was that, Catra?” Adora asks, grinning.

“Just like that,” Catra says instead. Adora isn’t going to hold out anymore anyway. Catra broke her with only a few words, she knows exactly how to get what she wants from Adora.

Adora does fuck Catra, *hard* . She’s in the mode where she tries to prove Catra wrong, the best way to do that now is to make Catra cum. Adora knows that it won’t take Catra long, with Adora fucking her with her fingers and the pressure against her clit. It’s all so much sensation that Adora *knows* Catra is going to come *soon* . Distantly, she recalls Catra saying something about wanting to come *with* Adora. *Oh well* .

Adora is in the zone now, and she knows Catra is slowly losing herself to the sensations as she tilts her head back, moving her hips almost feverishly. “That’s right, Kitten.” Adora encourages softly. “Keep going, I want to feel your cum on my fingers.”

“Adora-!” Catra gasps. “Right there! Holy- *Fuck* !” Catra looks like she’s struggling. Adora can feel her *right* on the edge, just a few more thrusts and seconds of the toy against her clit and she’ll be *there* , but Adora slo knows that she really wants to cum *with* Adora, and Adora just wants what Catra wants. Catra’s walls begin to twitch around Adora’s fingers, and then: “Stop,” Catra manages to choke out.

Adora immediately stops, pulling the toy away and stilling her fingers. Catra lets out a noise of disappointment but she doesn’t ask Adora to keep going, so she stays completely still. Catra is panting, her eyes screwed shut tightly, Adora can feel her walls twitching around her

fingers, she's literally so close to the edge, and she's trying to keep herself from falling over. Adora glances up to see the head of the toy is *soaked* , practically dripping, from Catra's wetness. Adora is tempted to lick it but she refrains - if only for Catra's benefit.

After a long moment, Adora feels Catra settle and then she orders her to pull out when she knows that she's no longer in danger of coming. "That's some serious self-control." Adora comments. If it had been her, she would have let Catra make her cum and accepted the punishment of not being able (or unlikely being able) to cum with her wife later. Catra just huffs at her.

"Together," She says in response. "Or not at all." Adora doesn't know what it is, but that makes her mouth run dry.

"Kiss me, please." Adora begs softly and Catra smiles as she leans down to press her soft lips to Adora's. They've been married for a *decade* and Adora still loves the way that Catra kisses her. The kiss is not chaste, drifting into *heated* in a matter of seconds. Adora gives in to Catra, letting her slip her tongue into her mouth as she pins her to the bed by her hips. They're making out, it's hot and heavy but Adora is loving every second.

When they pull away, Catra holds her hand out. "Give me." She requests, waiting for the toy. Adora isn't about to say no to that order. She gives the toy, and the control, back to Catra and watches her eagerly. She still isn't entirely sure what it is that Catra has planned that is going to get them off at the same time, but Adora is eager to find out. "Ready, my Lord?" Catra asks, her voice taking on a purring edge.

"Yes." Adora answers without hesitation. She's been with Catra long enough now that she knows whatever she's about to do is probably going to be something she likes. If it's not, they have their safe words and Catra will immediately stop if Adora calls red.

"I think *you* may need warming back up again," Catra says as she flicks the toy on. The buzzing of it already has Adora inexplicably *wet* but what *really* does it for her is that she can still see Catra's wetness on the head of the toy and then Catra presses not only the toy to her clit but also her slick. The thought almost has Adora losing her mind and she lets out a loud moan that Catra has to muffle by covering Adora's mouth with her hand. " *Quiet* ." She warns and Adora whimpers under her hand.

“ *Please* ,” Adora begs, her words silenced a little by Catra’s palm. She’s already *desperate* and the shine in Catra’s eyes tells Adora that Catra is enjoying this.

“Together,” Catra says and then she moves the toy so that it’s *between* them. Adora’s eyes widen. Catra starts moving her hips as she holds the wand against both of their clits. Adora can’t be quiet now, she moans Catra’s name as they both surrender to their pleasure. It really doesn’t take them long, they’ve done the build up, now was the time for crossing the finishing line. The powerful vibrations push them both to their peaks pretty easily and they cum powerfully at the same time.

At some point, Catra switches the toy off and they just lay there for a moment as they both slowly come down from their highs. “Wow… We should do that more often.” Adora says and Catra laughs. She rolls off top of Adora and into their bed.

“Go get your strap.” Catra says and Adora grins. Slowly, she stands from the bed and goes to retrieve her sword, transforming it and herself. Adora slips on her strap and makes her way back over to Catra. She climbs on top of her, sighing in contentment when Catra leans up to kiss her gently on her lips. “I forgot how big you are,” Catra whispers against Adora’s lips, as she speaks, she runs her hand along the shaft of Adora’s strap - Adora knows Catra isn’t just talking about She-Ra’s height. “I haven’t taken She-Ra in a long time… Maybe ease her in?” Catra’s voice lowers into it’s sexy sultry tone as she runs her hand along the shaft. Adora shudders.

“Don’t you prefer when I *make* it fit?” Adora whispers into Catra’s ear. She feels Catra shiver under her and Adora smirks in satisfaction. Now was the time that Adora got to tease Catra back, take some of the power she relinquished before and make Catra beg instead.

Adora starts by positioning her strap so it is between Catra’s folds. She begins rubbing herself between them, enjoying the smooth glide that told her that Catra was already wet and ready to take her. Catra gasps and suddenly her hands are gripping Adora’s hips. “Holy…” Catra cuts off with a moan. “I forgot how warm you are too… how it… *thrums*... ” Adora smirks. She’s already got Catra mincing her words. “Careful, Adora… Wouldn’t want you to blow your load before you’re even inside.” Catra taunts and Adora snorts. Her wife is a *brat* - she always has been.

“I know what I’m doing,” Adora assures as she continues her gentle thrusting. If Adora is honest, she could do this all day. Just slowly fuck Catra like this, but her mission isn’t just to

make Catra cum, it's to make another baby. Still, Adora will have her fun. She angles her hips down just a little so the tip of her strap hits Catra's clit.

" *Fuck* !" Catra gasps.

"See?" Adora asks smugly. Catra glares at her but it kind of loses its meaning when she moans again and her eyes almost roll back. Adora decides to speed up again and she is wonderfully rewarded for that move when Catra wraps an arm around her neck and pulls her down.

"Adora… Fuck… *please* ." Catra begs and Adora laughs. She wasn't expecting Catra to break so easily - she really has missed She-Ra.

"Please what?" Adora asks with a shit-eating grin. Catra huffs but it's lost to the small soft moans she releases in pleasure. Gods, Adora *loves* this, she loves making love to her wife. She would do it all day every day if it were an option.

" *Adora* ," Catra grits. It's a warning, a ' *get on with it'* , but Adora is enjoying this. Unfortunately, Catra knows how to work Adora as much as Adora knows how to work her. "Come on, big bad Horde Lord," Catra says. "Show me what you can do," She moves her hips up and Adora hears the wonderful sound of wetness spread on the base of her strap that makes her eyes darken and her mouth run dry. "You have to prove you can still pleasure me, don't you? Worried you may have lost your touch."

"I *never* lose my touch," Adora almost growls. She knows what Catra is doing, she's done it before, and it works *every time* . Adora will always have a need to prove her worth to people, to prove she is the best, it's always going to be a part of her that exists.

"Yeah? Then *show* me." Catra demands. Her hand moves down, grabbing hold of Adora's strap in her fist. Adora lets her, feeling Catra guide her down towards her entrance. " *Fuck* me, Adora." Catra says. "Fuck me with the full strength of She-Ra, show me how storng you are, how fast you are, how much stamina I know you have. I want you to *destroy* me." Adora thinks Catra might be exaggerating with the 'full strength of She-Ra' thing, because that really would split Catra in half, but if she wants to be fucked *hard* , Adora is more than willing to oblige.

Adora knows Catra said to ease in at the start, but that was before she demanded Adora fuck her with the full strength of She-Ra - plus Adora knows for a fact that Catra can definitely take her fully. “Okay, Catra,” Adora says. “Hold on, *Kitten* .” Catra gasps a little and then Adora winds her hips back and *rams* into her. Adora has to cover Catra’s mouth, she almost yowls that loud. Adora knows that the Horde soundproofed their room for this exact reasoning (the throne room had been enough to convince them to do that) but she still gets paranoid sometimes.

She waits for a moment, listening, Catra squirming under her, pleading for her to continue. Catra is gone, she’s just a pleading mess now, ready for Adora to keep doing what she was doing before. When Adora is sure that they’re in the clear, she glances down. She’s still not all the way inside, just a little more to go.

Adora removes her hand from Catra’s mouth, letting her plead openly as she pushes further inside of her. “Holy…” Catra gasps. “Did you get bigger?”

“Thank you for asking,” Adora says with a grin, easing herself deeper inside of Catra until she’s buried to the hilt. “Such a good, Kitten.” Adora coos as Catra clings to her. “You’re taking me so well.”

“Adora…” Catra’s voice is almost far away. Adora loves hearing her name leave Catra’s lips in this way, like a prayer, like she is the most sacred being on the planet. It fills her with immeasurable pride, it boosts her ego tenfold.

“It’s okay, Kitten,” Adora says softly. She props her hand against the headboard of the bed, surprised a little when she sees how big She-Ra’s hand is to the wood. She curls her fingers around it, using it to support her weight a little. “I got you.” Adora promises. “Are you ready?”

“ *Yes* ,” Catra chokes out, her hips twitching. “Fuck, yes…” Adora can already feel her clamping down around her strap. “Fill me up.” Adora’s eyes widen at that instruction before they become hooded with lust.

“In due time, Kitten.” Adora coos. She starts moving slowly, enjoying the feeling of Catra stretched around her strap. She fucks her shallowly, moving slowly, enjoying the consistent buzz of pleasure she gets from it. Adora likes doing this, it’s not pleasurable enough for either of them to get off to it, but Adora enjoys just moving in and out of Catra at a steady slow pace for as long as possible, drawing their experience out. Unfortunately, Catra seems to think otherwise.

“Adora…” Catra says in a tone that Adora knows that she’s in trouble. “I know… what you're doing…” Catra lets out a soft moan and wraps her arms around Adora’s shoulders, pulling her closer. Adora feels a smirk pull at the corners of her lips.

“I have no idea what you mean.” Adora responds, her voice far too smug for that to be true - not that Catra would have bought it anyway. Catra huffs.

“You’re… dragging it out.” Catra replies, her voice showing only slight annoyance. “You know it’s not enough.”

“You’re right,” Adora says, dragging her strap out. “I *am* dragging it out.”

“You’re not funny.” Catra deadpans.

“I’m hilarious.”

“Why did I marry you?” Catra asks and Adora grins brightly.

“Easy,” Adora says. “Because you fell in love with me.”

“I’m starting to think that might have been a mistake.” Catra bites back. Adora rolls her eyes, purposely thrusting harder into Catra for that comment. Catra responds by drawing her claws, digging them softly into Adora’s skin and moaning her name. Adora knows Catra is kidding, but she’s probably right, she can only drag it out for so long and she’d had her fun with it already.

Luckily for Adora, It takes her little effort when she's She-Ra to absolutely *rock* Catra's world. Even half of She-Ra's strength is probably double of Adora's normal strength, it's not long before Catra is mewling her name and cursing in pleasure. Adora grins, moving faster and harder at Catra's demands. The bed is shaking under Adora's thrusts and she's half concerned about the headboard breaking under her hand, but she's in the *zone* now. There's nothing that's going to stop Adora until she does as Catra asked her to and fills her up.

After ten years doing this, Adora knows *exactly* what she's doing. This never gets old to her, it's as good, if not better, than the first time they ever did this together. Adora sometimes thinks about the first time they ever did this together and she finds it funny. Two enemies, having sex together, it really shouldn't have happened, and yet… Adora wouldn't change it for the world.

"Adora!" Catra calls. "Right there… Don't stop…" Catra encourages. Adora wasn't planning on stopping anyway. "Such a good Lord…" Catra praises and Adora feels immeasurable pleasure course through her. Catra is already clamping down around her strap, the sounds in their bedroom are downright sinful, the bed is probably approaching it's breaking point. Adora knows what to do to get Catra there. She's a gentlewoman after all, she can't finish until Catra does - even if Adora is generally easier to get off.

Adora presses her fingers to Catra's clit, rubbing her while also thrusting into her as hard and fast as She-Ra possible without hurting her. So much for being quiet. Adora is just glad that they soundproofed this room. " *Fuck* ! Adora-" Catra cuts off suddenly as she throws her head back, hitting the pillow.

"It's okay, Catra," Adora responds, she *knows* Catra is close because she can *feel* it. "Do it. Cum for me, Kitten." Adora demands. "You're *mine* ." That seems to be the tipping point for Catra.

Adora feels Catra clamp down around her, her claws dig into Adora's broad shoulder muscles and Adora watches in amazement as her wife cums around her strap. The sound is *wonderful* and Adora doubles down, feeling her own pleasure increase tenfold. The bed groans and creaks under her so much to the point that Adora fears momentarily that she might actually really break their bed.

“Do it, Adora,” Catra says. Her voice is a little slurred, probably from her hazy pleasure and it drives Adora almost insane. Her hand tightens around the headboard as she feels her peak quickly approaching. “Fill me up, Adora. *Make* me yours.” And that’s Adora’s tipping point.

Adora peaks so hard she thinks she loses consciousness for a moment. She feels herself spill *inside* of Catra and Catra’s resulting moan as she peaks again. Adora keeps going until she loses steam and collapses on top of her wife. She feels Catra purr more than she hears it until her senses start to recover. She feels sweaty and out of juice (literally) but so so good. Catra holds her close even though Adora knows that she must be crushing her with her weight.

Eventually, Adora rolls over and onto her back, panting as she slowly regains herself. She watches idly as Catra sits up, doing her little post sex wiggles. Adora laughs a little at it. “You are so cute.” Adora says and Catra rolls her eyes at her. Adora pulls her strap off and then she transforms back to herself. She also chooses to examine their bed. “Our bed survived… we may need to reinforce this thing.”

“She-Ra doesn’t usually miss, you think we need to do it again?” Catra asks, flopping down onto their bed.

“I think we need to do that again, and again, and again, and again-”

“You horny idiot.” Catra interrupts with a chuckle. Adora smiles a little.

“We can clean up in the morning, right? I just want to cuddle.” Adora says, looking at her wife with a small pout.

“Definitely.” Catra agrees.

They make themselves comfortable, Adora turns their bedside lamps off and they gravitate towards each other in the darkness. “Catra…” Adora whispers in the dark. She lifts her hand to gently cup her wife’s jaw, feeling Catra melt at her touch and purr softly in the darkness. “I love you infinitely.” Adora confesses. “I love you in this life, I probably loved you before, and I’ll love you after, and after that, and after that, and after that. No matter what universe,

no matter what place, or time, I love you with my entire being. I love you in this life and the next.”

“Forever and always.” Catra whispers back. “Till death do we part.”

“Not even then,” Adora says quietly. “I will love you beyond death.” Adora can’t see, but she’s pretty sure Catra is smiling.

“I love you infinitely too, Adora.” Catra whispers before she kisses Adora softly on her lips. Adora smiles, her ring around her finger feels heavier than usual, reminding her of their never ending love. Adora pulls her wife closer. This was the rest of her life, forever, and Adora wouldn’t change a single thing.

Chapter End Notes

Sorry for the delay. Both S and I have been super busy with school and work that we hadn't really had the time to wrap stuff up. Thank you for your patience and we hope you enjoyed this chapter! -M

I hope y'all enjoyed this chapter. The final chapters are kind of... a slice of life chapters I suppose. Just them settling after everything they've been through and their family/life. Again, sorry for the delay in updating but I really hope you enjoy the conclusion to this fic. Stay safe and I'll see you all next time. -S

Epilogue II: Family

Chapter Summary

> “I’m going to tear you apart with my bare hands,” Adora says as she advances.

Chapter Notes

> Lord Adora is back >:)
>
> So sorry this update took so long but life, you know? Anyway, so glad we'll be able to wrap this story up for y'all. This is the longest epilogue chapter at like 35K+? I can't remember exactly but it is long.
>
> Again, the epilogue chapters skip time here and there, and are snapshots of Catradora in the future, thanks!
>
> Warning, NSFW ahead

See the end of the chapter for more notes

Catra sighs as she stares up at the ceiling of the doctor’s office in Bright Moon. She was holding Adora’s hand which Adora was squeezing softly to reassure her and to let her know that she was there. Catra was relieved that Adora was here if she was honest, she isn’t completely sure she could do this without her. It’s so different from when they had Finn, Adora hadn’t been around for the majority of her pregnancy, now she is there constantly, doting on Catra like she’s made of glass. It’s cute, in a way. Catra isn’t going to turn her nose up to being cared for by her beautiful wife, but it’s also mildly inconvenient when Adora is *constantly* fretting over the littlest of things. Like the other day, when Catra had had a case of false contractions, Adora had been worried that Catra was *dying* . Catra supposes that’s what happens when you were raised by the Horde which instilled deep anxiety into you along with countless other trauma and a lack of medical knowledge.

Finding out that they - and Catra likes saying ‘they’ because it reminds her that she isn’t alone in this at all - were pregnant had been a mixture of joy and anxiety. Catra hadn’t really doubted it if she was honest. She’s pretty sure that She-Ra can never fail at doing that, it’s like she’s programmed to get it every time. Catra had cried a little, it had been just a bit embarrassing, but then Adora had kissed her and told her that everything would be okay. And now she’s here, getting another scan to make sure the baby was okay.

“Alright,” The doctor says. Catra sees them sit down on the stool beside the bed she was currently lying on, but she keeps her eyes focused on the ceiling. “Nothing to worry about, we’re just going to give you an ultrasound, make sure everything is okay, listen to their heartbeat, okay?” He asks gently. Catra isn’t used to doctors who aren’t Magicats, but *no way* was she going to go to Half-Moon for one. Not yet anyway.

“Yeah, I know the drill,” Catra responds. Her vision is suddenly invaded by Adora’s face. She looks concerned as she looks down at Catra. She mouths ‘You okay?’ and Catra smiles a little, squeezing her wife’s hand in response. She nods and watches as Adora studies her features, probably trying to decide if she was telling the truth or not. “Promise,” Catra says verbally. That seems to convince her worried wife.

“Okay, Catra, this may be a little cold,” The doctor says as he begins to squeeze the gel from the bottle onto Catra’s stomach. It’s only a little uncomfortable, but nothing Catra can’t handle. After that, he places the ultrasound probe to Catra’s stomach. “Let's see here...” He says quietly. Catra turns her head towards the monitor and feels her heart rate increase exponentially. That’s their baby. They really made another one.

“Wow…” Adora says in amazement. “I’ve never seen this before.” Catra’s ears press back a little at that. Adora never got to witness a lot of stuff when it came to Finn, this is all new for her. “Where are they, doc?” Catra smiles a little. She recalls Adora not being able to spot Finn on the picture she had brought to her in the Fright Zone.

“Here,” He points to the screen. Catra has to admit that they are a little hard to spot if you don’t know what you’re looking for. “Huh…” He says and Catra’s ears immediately perk up.

“What? Is something wrong?” Catra asks. She suddenly feels panicked. Sometimes she worries that she made a mistake by agreeing to have another baby, like maybe she can’t handle it, given all the trauma she went through with her first pregnancy, but she knows she wouldn’t be feeling so afraid right now if she didn’t wholly *want* this. Want *them* .

“No… Just… Something isn’t very clear,” he says. “We’re going to listen to the heartbeat now, is that okay?” Catra nods quickly. The doctor turns on the sound to the ultrasound and Catra’s heart yet again lifts up at hearing her baby’s heartbeat. She lets out a soft sigh and her

eyes fall closed when she hears the sweet sound. They're okay. Except… Is that…? Yes it is! Catra's eyes fly open. "Ah, yes, there's two heartbeats."

"Our baby has two hearts?" Adora asks from beside Catra. Catra can't help the laugh that escapes her lips at that. Her wife is so goddamn cute. And don't get her wrong, Adora can be incredibly *smart* , but she also says things like that. She's just… endearing. She's Catra's dummy.

"No, Adora," Catra says, turning to look at her wife. She's frowning a little in confusion, but she looks at Catra with such love that if Catra wasn't lying down she might have been swept off her feet by it. "It's two babies. Twins."

"Two… What?" Adora asks in disbelief. The look on her face makes Catra laugh again.

"Yeah, and you're not the one who has to push them out of you," Catra says with a teasing grin. Her spirits have lifted a little. This is good news, she has her wife, she's seen her baby-*babies* . Catra doesn't know why she was so anxious to begin with, well, she does, trauma, but she's so happy in this very moment that she could sing and dance.

"I'm *so* sorry," Adora says and Catra laughs again, pulling Adora down so she can kiss her stupid face. The kiss is a happy kiss. Catra doesn't even realise she's crying until she tastes the salt on her tongue. Adora pulls away a little, allowing Catra the opportunity to catch her breath. They're happy tears, they're *I-can't-believe-we-made-it-here* tears. Adora stays close, resting her forehead against Catra's to reassure her. It's exactly what Catra needs. Adora is good at that, knowing what Catra needs without her saying it.

Eventually, Catra feels composed enough to lean away from Adora. "Dork," she whispers to her wife before pecking her on her lips again. She turns back to the doctor who clears his throat awkwardly.

"Here," he says, pointing, "the shadow behind this one, I couldn't see it clearly, but that is the other baby. You are correct, Princess C'yra, you're having twins." Catra feels warmth in her chest at the sight.

“Huh. Buy one, get one free,” Adora says and Catra elbows her. “Ow!”

“Stop being an idiot.”

“You love it,” Adora says and Catra can hear the grin in her tone. Catra just rolls her eyes fondly. She does love it, but she can’t *encourage* it.

“I’ll just take some pictures and then go get these printed for you.” The doctor says. He does his thing before he stands, wipes Catra’s stomach with a towel and then leaves the room for the time being.

Catra turns towards her wife who is practically bouncing on her feet. She's so excited. Adora can never quite stand still even when she isn’t excited. It makes Catra wonder what she would have been like with Finn. Catra feels something unpleasant in her stomach at that thought. She’d never know. She was robbed of that by her own mother. “We’re having a baby!” Adora says excitedly. “ *Two* ! Two babies! Wow… I have just enough hands for that.”

“You’re so weird,” Catra says, purring. Her wife really is adorable. Whoever named Adora - and Catra has been told it was stitched into the blanket she was found in - got her name perfect. Yes she’s *adora* ble, but she’s also *adored* . She wins hearts so easily, and this is exactly why. Catra wishes others had seen this side of Adora sooner. Adora has always been gold hearted, she’s always been *good* , and loyal, and *bright* , she’s just been in an environment that smothered her light.

Adora stops her excited bouncing for a moment to come towards Catra again, still smiling wide like the big dopey dork she is. “We did it, Catra,” Adora says, her hands landing on Catra’s arms. “We made life… babies. We’re going to have little ones running around again. Finn is going to be a sibling.”

“Yeah,” Catra purrs loudly, unable to contain herself at Adora’s words.

“Are you okay?” Adora asks, more serious now. Catra sighs as she looks up at her wife. Adora knows her too well. They know each other inside and out. So of course she could sense that Catra was struggling.

“Yeah, I just…” Catra trails off for a moment. “I guess I feel a little resentful.” Adora turns her head to the side a little in confusion. “This is everything it should have been when I had Finn,” Catra finally admits. “I just can’t help but wonder how you would have been when I first saw Finn on that monitor, what we would have done together during the pregnancy, just… *everything* .”

“Oh,” Adora says quietly. She grabs the stool that the doctor had been sitting on and sits beside Catra. She gently takes Catra’s hand and kisses her knuckles softly. Catra sighs happily. Adora is great at making Catra feel so completely loved. Even the little things - *especially* the little things - they all show how Adora unconditionally loves her. “I won’t say that I don’t wish that I was there for your pregnancy with Finn, I even missed their birth,” Adora begins, “but we have another chance now. I’ve been with you and Finn for pretty much their entire life, I only missed the very beginning. I’m not planning on missing any of this, Catra. We’re a team.”

“I know that, Dummy,” Catra replies, smiling softly. She kisses Adora’s hand back. “I’m still upset about what could have been.” Adora is silent at that for a long moment. She sits on that little stool, holding Catra’s hand and thinking. Catra can practically see the gears turning in her head.

“I’m sorry.”

“It’s not your fault, Adora,” Catra sighs heavily. “It was my mom’s.”

“C’yra has been better,” Adora says. Catra gives her a look and Adora throws her hands up - the action makes her let go of Catra’s hand. “I’m not defending her,” she says quickly, “I’m just pointing that out.”

“I’m well aware,” Catra rolls her eyes and sits up with a sigh. Adora watches her the entire time. “Let me be mad at her. She made my first pregnancy hell.”

“This will be different,” Adora says, moving towards Catra now. Catra sighs when Adora stands between her legs, trapping her against the bed. Adora’s biggest love language is touch. She expresses her love through the fact she just can’t keep her hands to herself. It’s endearing

in a way. The Horde probably didn't encourage verbal expressions of love, but Catra knows physicality was a huge part of Adora's upbringing. It makes a lot of sense that she would express her love mostly through touch. "I'm going to be with you every step of the way."

Catra chooses not to respond right away. Instead, she decides to appreciate her wife up close and personal. Catra moves closer to her, trailing her nails along Adora's exposed biceps. Adora's muscles only get more and more defined. Catra appreciates that she often wears sleeveless shirts, and not just sleeveless but *tight* shirts. Catra bites her lip as she trails her hands down Adora's toned abs. Catra is pretty sure she married the hottest woman on Etheria.

She sometimes sees women flirting with Adora, but the blonde never seems to perceive it. Or, if she does, she just gets *really* awkward. It's funny because Adora has never really been shy, she used to flirt with Catra so unbelievably much even when they were enemies, and, though Catra would never have admitted it then, she was *good* at it. But now? She can't flirt to save her life. It's like she has a Catra-only setting. She can only flirt with Catra. And Adora is attractive, she's funny, and she can be smug sometimes, but she can only make it work with Catra. Anyone else and it's like watching an oblivious puppy.

"What are you doing?" Adora asks, interrupting Catra's thoughts. Catra looks up at her face to see Adora raising an eyebrow at her. Honestly, she's kind of feeling-up her wife in the doctor's office.

"Can't I admire my wife?" Catra asks, her tail flicking behind her.

"Sure, but you're giving me bedroom eyes in the doctor's office," Adora responds. Catra snorts a little.

"I don't have bedroom eyes," She pokes Adora on her forehead, right between her eyes. Adora grins.

"Sure you do," Adora says before she leans in to whisper to Catra. "They say, *take me right here, right now* ." Catra swallows thickly.

“Stop that,” Catra gently pats Adora on her jaw. She feels hot all of a sudden. Adora isn’t wrong, Catra *is* thinking about that, but she’s also thinking about how the doctor could walk back in at any- *Oh.*

Suddenly, Adora’s lips are on Catra’s neck. “Adora…” Catra breathes. “We can’t.” Even though Catra *really* wants to. Adora’s hands are suddenly on Catra’s hips. She squeezes her hands and Catra lets out an embarrassingly loud squeak. It would be easy. Adora knows how to work Catra so well, her fingers are like magic, she could have Catra there in minutes, but Catra isn’t willing to risk their doctor walking in on that. “ *Adora* ,” Catra repeats, more firmly now.

Adora pulls away, kissing Catra briefly on her jaw. “Okay,” she says, “later.” It’s not a question, it’s a statement. A statement that Catra is not at all opposed to. Catra gently pushes her away so the doctor wouldn’t be able to tell what it was that had almost occurred between them. “So when do you want to tell your moms?” Adora asks and Catra groans. *That* was something she was not at all looking forward to.

“I only want to tell Luna,” Catra admits. “She can tell C’yra.”

“Whatever you want to do, Catra,” Adora says, reaching her hand out to gently tuck some of Catra’s hair behind her ear. It was getting longer again, so long that Catra could pull it back into a small ponytail. “I’m with you.” Catra leans into her gentle touch.

“Do you ever think about how you almost died, Adora?” Catra asks, looking up at her wife. She sees Adora frown a little, her eyebrows turning down so her forehead creases. Her blue eyes sparkle in the light. Catra’s eyes fall on Adora’s cheek where those pale scars still mark her otherwise, aside from the scar on her eye from Shadow Weaver, unblemished face. They remind Catra of everything that happened, how close Adora walked to death by the hands of her mother.

“Not really,” Adora admits, “I’m just too happy to be here.”

“But you almost weren’t,” Catra points out, “and that’s my point. She almost took you away from me. And I know she’s done better… But I don’t think I can ever forgive her. Our relationship will never be the same, and those scars on your jaw just… they bring it back.” Adora doesn’t say anything. Catra knows it’s sometimes noticeable, even Finn has picked up

on the tension between Catra and C'yra, they just don't understand why, and Catra isn't in the position to fully explain it to them yet. How does one tell a ten year old their grandma once thought they were literally the devil's spawn? Catra doesn't want to lie to her child, but she also doesn't want to hurt them either.

"Catra… I support any and all of your decisions," Adora states. "If you can't forgive C'yra, if you don't want to tell her directly about the twins, then okay. I'm with you. And I'll be with you when we tell Finn the truth. All of it." Catra knows Adora is worried about that a lot. She thinks Finn will think badly of her because of her past, but Catra has seen the way Finn worships her. They would never think badly of Adora, just how Catra can't either. "Me and you, forever, until the end of the world."

"I love you," Catra says, unable to stop herself from smiling at her wife.

"That's why you married me, right?" Adora asks, moving so she was standing beside Catra rather than across from her. She bumps her shoulder against Catra's. "I love you too."

"I know," Catra says quietly. And she does know. She knows that Adora loves her wholly and completely. They complete each other, they feel so deeply about one another that it would pain either of them to be without the other.

"We can do anything," Adora says, "conquer the world if we really wanted to." Catra snorts.

"You didn't really succeed at that the first time around, babe," Catra retorts and she sees Adora give her a mock offended look. "Maybe you should focus on conquering the pile of dishes in our sink when we get home."

"Anything for my wife," Adora says. Catra shakes her head fondly, smiling. *Dork* .

At that moment, the doctor re-enters the office with the images from the scan. Adora takes them and together they look more closely at the babies currently growing inside of Catra. Catra found it adorable how Adora found that so unbelievable, about how a baby was growing inside of Catra *right now, this very second*. With Finn, Catra hadn't really shown that much until later. She wonders if carrying twins will mean a bigger bump.

“These are going on the fridge,” Adora proclaims proudly. Catra just smiles. She discusses some things with the doctor for a moment more and then they leave the office all aflutter with the news. Now, Catra just had to tell people. She was really only worried about C’yra if she was honest.

* * *

Catra sighs as she looks up at the big castle. It seems so much more intimidating than usual, but Catra figures it’s probably because of the news she’s harbouring. Luckily, her wife holds her hand the entire time as they both enter the throne room of Half-Moon’s castle. “C’yra, Adora,” Luna greets warmly, “how nice of you two to visit.” Her mom smiles at the pair and Catra feels her nerves settle a little. Catra glances at Adora and the blonde nods ever so slightly. They had discussed this, and they had agreed that Catra would tell only Luna, and they would leave Luna to inform C’yra. It was what made Catra the most comfortable, and Adora wanted her wife to be comfortable - which Catra was ever grateful for.

C’yra looks up from the papers she had resting in her lap when she hears Luna greet them. Catra feels her stomach flip flop when her mother’s mismatched eyes fall on her. Unfortunately, Catra knows what people mean when they say she looks like her mom. She does. When the trauma had been fresh, Catra had hated that. She had cut her hair to escape that fact at one point. C’yra is greying, but she still has brunette hair and her eyes are precisely like Catra’s. She had been told that the heterochromia was recessive but prominent in royal Magicats, hence why Finn didn’t have it, though it was possible that future children would. Unfortunately for Catra, she had inherited this genetic marker from her mother. Maybe if she had the green of Luna’s eyes she’d look a little less like C’yra. C’yra was still taller than her, around 5’2, only a couple inches, in fact, Catra was between both her mother’s height at an even 5’0. It still remained that in the genetic lottery, Catra’s looks had clearly favoured C’yra over Luna. They had differences, of course, but the familial resemblance was clearly prominent.

“C’yra,” C’yra greets this time - not to mention the sharing of the same name, Magicat royalty tradition. “Adora.” The way C’yra says Adora’s name has definitely changed. It used to be a lot more… terse. Now it is only a little short and said only a little like it leaves a sour taste in C’yra’s mouth. Adora and C’yra’s relationship has certainly improved, in fact, Catra even thinks that they had a lot of commonalities that they have bonded over, but Catra thinks C’yra will always hold some kind of resentment towards Adora simply because she once held the title of being the Lord of the Horde.

“Your majesties,” Adora greets. Catra can’t help the small smile that tugs at the corners of her lips at hearing her wife address the Queens of Half-Moon. Adora is a natural born leader, this is true. It has been proven by her leadership of the Horde, sure, but also in the way that she conducts herself in general. Catra knows that Adora can be a dork, she can be awkward, and weird, and say things that she shouldn’t say, but she is also incredibly smart, she would have made a good diplomat had the Rebellion and Horde ever tried to negotiate a peace treaty when Adora had recently risen to the throne. She also has an air of confidence around herself, even if she’s insecure about it. When Adora has a mission in mind, she will achieve it. It makes her a good leader, a good diplomat, and Catra believes that if she hadn’t been Lord of the Horde first, and had simply been She-Ra Princess of Power, she would have made an incredible Princess of her own kingdom. That, unfortunately, was not Adora’s fate. While she conducted herself well in her time as Lord of the Horde, she much preferred a more brute-ish way of ruling, sort of like an iron fist, and who could really blame her? It was what Adora had been taught was the most effective way of ruling, but if she had been given proper support, Catra *knew* she would have made an incredible ruler.

“Mom,” Catra says to Luna, “may I speak to you privately, please?” Catra requests. Luna seems surprised, which Catra can’t really fault her for, but she nods and stands to her feet.

“You’re leaving me alone with C’yra?” Adora asks playfully. “Are you sure that’s a good idea.”

“Be good,” Catra says, rolling her eyes at her wife. Adora smiles at her and it is one of her warm smiles, the smile that soothes Catra to no end and that makes her feel all warm and soft inside. Ever since Adora gave up her title as Lord of the Horde, ever since Catra had really gotten to know *Adora* , as opposed to *Lord* Adora, she has given Catra only the best of vibes. Comforting vibes. Good vibes. It’s how she knows she has her companion for life. No one could ever affect her in such extraordinary ways than Adora. Adora takes Catra’s hand, kisses her ring and then squeezes her hand in support. Catra appreciates it immensely.

“Always am,” She responds. They both know this is not true, but Catra will accept it anyway. She watches as her wife climbs the steps up to the throne, crossing Luna who was coming down, and makes her way to C’yra where they begin discussing something about some local village. Catra spares her wife one last long look before she turns and starts walking away with her mother.

Catra decides the best place to speak to her mom will be in one of the meeting rooms they have in the castle. In fact, she happens to choose the one where her moms had cornered her years ago about choosing a suitor, the one where Catra had had a mini heart attack when

C’yra had asked her about what had happened with Adora. She thought the irony was kind of funny. They enter the room and Catra takes a seat at the table at the same time as Luna. They’re sitting next to each other, Luna is leaning against the table in concern and Catra’s ears are far back against her head. She might as well get this over with.

“I’m pregnant again,” Catra drops. Luna seems surprised by this news. Her tail completely stills and her ears fly upwards while her eyes widen, but then her features quickly soften and she purrs in a way that Catra knows she’s *happy* for them.

“Oh, C’yra, that’s wonderful new-”

“I don’t want to tell C’yra,” Catra interrupts. Luna looks confused at this. She falls silent, her words dying on her tongue. They sit in a prolonged period of silence. Catra is having a difficult time meeting her mom’s eyes.

“I don’t understand,” Luna says gently, “I thought you and C’yra were doing… better?”

“We are,” Catra says, “to an extent. But… Being at the appointment a few days ago brought back a lot of bad memories for me, mom."

"What do you mean?" Luna asks softly. She’s always been the kindest person Catra has ever known. Except for that *one* incident, Catra is certain that that truly was a shock which resulted in Luna saying what she did. After that incident, Luna started standing up for her and Adora’s relationship and even got through to C’yra for Catra. Carta still frowns and looks away. She isn’t sure how anyone can really understand this pain that she experienced.

"At the appointment, Adora was worried, attentive and excited. It was,” Catra pauses, taking a breath, “the first she ever got to go to a doctor's visit with me to check if I was..." The word doesn't need to be said for Luna to understand what Catra means. "I didn't get to have that support for long from you all. And not at all from Adora because of… *her* ." Adora never got to come to a single appointment for Finn. Not one. It truly had brought back a lot for Catra.

"Oh..." Luna says, her ears fall a little at that. "Right... Adora wasn't here at all when Finn was... It's been so long, I'd almost forgotten." Luna pauses for a moment. Catra certainly

hadn’t forgotten. "But C'yra, Cy has come a long way since then."

"I know, but that doesn't make my feelings just go away, mom. And going through the appointment with Adora a few days ago, knowing she missed all of that with Finn because of mama, it brought the hurt back all over again. I just... Need some time to recollect myself before saying something to her. If you want to tell her first, that's fine, but I don't think I can do it myself." Catra is praying that Luna will just do it for her.

"It's your news to share, C'yra," Luna says, reaching her hands out to comfort her daughter. Catra doesn’t feel too comforted by those words. "I'll be there when you tell her, of course I will, and Adora too, but take your time and do it when you're ready. I promise you that C'yra will be supportive this time." Catra presses her lips together at that. Surely Luna can see that Catra does not want to do that at all.

“Can't *you* just tell her? I really don't want to be the one to do it. I was already working through the anxiety of the idea of having a kitten again,” Catra says desperately. Catra has a lot of trauma she needs to unpack. This is difficult for her, but she and Adora made the decision together that they were ready for another kid. That doesn’t make the trauma that occurred with C’yra any less though. Catra’s main fear, no matter how illogical it may be, is that her mother will react to the news of her being pregnant again the exact same way she did the first time even if the circumstances are so wildly different now. Luna sighs.

"What did Adora say about that?"

"About telling mama?" Catra asks.

"Yes," Luna nods. "What's her opinion on me telling C'yra your news?"

"She understands why I'm asking you to do it," Catra explains. "She's the main one that has had to deal with all my nightmares and panic attacks. She knows how hard this is for me right now... To tell mama this news."

"Don't you think Cy will be upset that it didn't come from you?" Luna asks. Catra simply shrugs at her mother.

"She'll be fine," Catra replies. And she will be. This is what C’yra gets for what she has done. Maybe she might be upset that it didn’t come from Catra herself, but she’ll still know that Catra is having another baby - babies, actually.

"Okay," Luna sighs a little. "I'll tell her, but you know she'll want to celebrate it, like... like she should have for Finn." Catra frowns at that. Finn never got their deserved royal celebration. Maybe they did later, but it was still much later than it should have been.

“Then she needs to wait until I've gathered my composure. I just need some time," is all Catra can really say to that.

"Okay, alright," Luna says, nodding. "We're going to be grandmas again, this is wonderful news!" Catra smiles weakly and nods.

"Yeah... Again..." She still feels a little anxious, but it is quickly subsiding. Luna is right, this is wonderful news, Catra gets to be a mother again, she just wished her bad thoughts would leave her alone.

"Have you told Finn?" Luna inquires. Catra shakes her head.

"Finn would have been overly excited and blurted the news out to everyone. They did say they wouldn’t mind a sibling though. Turns out they're getting two."

"Two?"

"Yeah... Twins," Catra smiles nervously. “Surprise…?”

"Oh... Oh wow," Luna laughs a little. "Three grandchildren."

"Yeah, three kittens," Catra smiles a bit. This time more fondly than nervously. "I can't even imagine how much bigger I'll get with two."

"I... I can't either," Luna admits. "Cy never really showed until towards the very end. Have you thought of names or anything?"

"Not yet. That's something I want to talk over with Adora when I'm doing better."

"That's smart," Luna pauses for a moment. "I'm not trying to pressure you or anything, and I'd understand if you didn't want to, but you know it's tradition to name the first born C'yra or Cyrus," Luna says carefully. "I understand why you didn't with Finn, but maybe just keep it in mind?" Catra honestly isn't really sure she *loves* that idea, but, from her vague memories of her grandfather Cyrus, he was a kind man. He was even remembered as Cyrus the Kind.

"I'll think about it," Catra says, mostly to placate Luna.

"Okay," Luna smiles brightly. "Twins... wow... that's... Are you worried?" Catra sighs tiredly. She's a little exhausted if she's honest. The crash after such high anxiety is so real and intense.

"I've been worried this entire time, mom. I've been anxious since we started heading this way," Catra confesses. She rests one of her hands on her stomach while Luna gives Catra a sad look.

"It makes me sad to hear that Cy... I'm sorry, C'yra," Luna apologises, sincerely.

"I know. It's not really your fault," Catra bites her lip. "Like I said, all of the anxiety and memories kind of came back all at once."

"That's not surprising given your original experience."

"Yeah," Catra sniffs a little. “I just... I wish my brain would believe that it's not going to be the same as last time."

"I know, sweetheart," Luna says softly. "I promise you it won't be. I know C'yra never says it, but I know she at least respects Adora now." Catra isn’t sure that is true. *Tolerates* is probably more appropriate than respects.

"Yeah," Catra agrees anyway.

"You should go home and get some rest, it must have been stressful," Luna says, squeezing her daughter’s hand. Catra squeezes back and nods.

"Yeah, that sounds like a good idea. Thank you, mom," Catra smiles now and Luna easily returns it.

"Of course, kitten," Luna says. She leans forward and kisses Catra on her forehead. "You know I'd do anything for you." Catra sighs heavily and gives a small nod. She moves her head forward and rests it against her mom’s. They both begin purring. Luna’s is clearly one meant to comfort her stressed out child, and Catra feels her heart squeeze in her chest. There is nothing quite like a mother’s love. Luna has been there for her for so long, even C’yra. They would kiss her booboos as a child, they put her to bed, read her stories, *raised* her. They had been good moms, it was just a shame that so much happened when Catra was an adult that wrecked so much of that relationship.

"Thank you, mom," Catra whispers again, ceasing her purring. She leans back, though their hands remain joined.

"If you need anything else, just ask," Luna says. Catra stands from her seat at the same time that Luna does.

“Thank you. I mean it.” And Catra really does mean it. Luna has always been the mom she’s come to for things. Luna has always been more naturally maternal, she’s always been the one who has cared the most. Not that C’yra was cold or anything, Catra has just always known

that Luna would never judge her for her mistakes, and that had been true even from when she was little.

"Go be with your wife," Luna says gently. And that is *exactly* what Catra plans to do.

* * *

Adora doesn't know if she's dreaming or not. It sounds like someone is calling her name, but she's not quite sure, too weighted down in unconsciousness to know if she was imagining it or not. "Adora..." Adora grunts a little in her sleep and then- *Ow* , that was definitely someone slapping her on her cheek.

Adora’s eyes flutter open and she comes face-to-face with her wife's glowing blue and yellow eyes in the dark. "Catra...?" Adora frowns a little. She's at that stage when you first wake up and you're not entirely sure where you are, or who you are, or what's real and what's not. She wipes her mouth a little with her hand, knowing she sometimes drooled in her sleep. "Sorry... Am I snoring?" Adora asks, still groggy from being woken from her deep sleep.

"No, well, yes, but that's not why I woke you," Catra says.

"Hm," Adora hums as her eyes close again. She snuggles back into her pillow, ready to fall back asleep.

"Adora," Catra says, hitting Adora gently, yet firmly, on her chest. Adora jolts a little and she sits up. "I'm trying to tell you something and you're just going back to sleep?"

"It's the middle of the night, Catra," Adora says defensively as she settles back down with her back to her pillow. She turns her head a little so she can see Catra properly. "Are you hurt?" Adora asks, suddenly worried. She was a little more awake now, and she rubs her eyes to clear the sleep from them. "Is it the babies?"

"No," Catra answers and Adora frowns.

"Then why on Etheria are you waking me up?" Adora asks. Catra is biting her lip and Adora recognises the expression on her face. "... You're waking me up for sex?"

"Shut up," Catra says, pushing Adora back by her shoulder. She swings her leg over Adora and sits on her stomach. "I'm carrying your babies, okay? I need relief." Adora snorts, looking up at Catra with a goofy smile. She's still half asleep, but if Catra needs it, Adora is more than willing to provide.

"Anything for my needy wife," Adora says. She leans up, pressing her lips against Catra's. Catra nips Adora's lip with her fangs, probably in retaliation for calling her needy, but Adora really doesn't mind, she kind of relishes in it actually. Catra is already whimpering and moaning, her hips grinding down against Adora. She must really be desperate for this relief. "What do you want?" Adora asks when Catra breaks from kissing her long enough for her to ask.

Catra doesn't respond for a long moment, happy instead to keep on kissing Adora. Her kisses are hot and she has Adora's face in her hands. Catra is completely in control of what is happening here and Adora is happy to follow her lead. She will follow Catra however she wants her to follow. "I want you to fuck me," Catra eventually whispers, her hot breath brushing against Adora's ear. *Fuck* . Adora shudders and nods rapidly.

"Wait," Catra says when Adora starts to shift. "No. I want to be in control of you, sir." Adora's eyes widen and her pupils blow wide.

"You're breaking out the 'sir'? Holy shit, you really are horny," Adora says, a little winded.

"Shut up."

"Make me."

"Fine," Catra lets out a long dramatic sigh. "Maybe you should occupy your mouth with other things."

"Oh hell *yes* ," Adora says, lifting Catra up and dropping her, gently, back into the bed sheets. Adora would love to go down on her wife, in fact, there is nothing she would like more. Unfortunately, Catra seems to have other plans.

"Woah there," Catra says, placing her hand to Adora's forehead to stop her going down. "That's not what I meant." Adora turns her head to the side.

"So you don't want me to go down on you?"

"I mean, yes, but not... Okay, we can start with that." Adora raises her eyebrow at Catra. Clearly Catra had other plans in mind, but Adora had changed her mind. Adora smirks. "Don't start getting cocky because I will be forced to humble you."

"Cocky? Me?" Adora asks as she pulls her wife's sleep shorts down her legs. "Never." Catra laughs at that, but not in a genuine way, no, it's a very sarcastic laugh. "But, you know, clearly you find my oral game the best and most mind blowing."

"Yes, I married you for your incredible tongue and ability to make me cum. Congratulations, you know where the clit is," Catra's tone is dripping with sarcasm, which really should put a damper on Adora's ego, but it inflates it. Maybe she's being sarcastic, but it seems to Adora that she's being at least a little bit genuine.

"I do know where the clit is," Adora responds. At that moment, she has Catra's panties around her ankles but she makes a point to press her finger tips to her clit, just to get her point across.

"I'm going to divorce you if your tongue isn't in me and on me in three seconds."

"But then who would you marry that knows where the clit is and has a tongue as good as me?"

"Glimmer maybe?"

"Take that back!" Adora pouts, frowning deeply at her wife who chuckles softly.

"I told you I'd have to humble you, Adora," Catra says. Adora continues to scowl at her. "Okay, I'm sorry for insinuating that Glimmer and I would have sex, you're the only woman I want to do that with."

"Promise?"

"I promise, you Idiot," Catra says, pulling Adora forward with her shirt. "I love you, I'm married to *you* . It's you and I until the end of the world." Catra kisses her then. This kiss is a little less loaded with lust and more loving. It soothes Adora completely. "Besides, you're about to show me exactly why I wouldn't want any other woman going down on me, aren't you?" Catra purrs. Adora will hand it to Catra, she surely knows how to motivate Adora. Adora kisses Catra again for good measure before she starts to move down.

She kisses down Catra's jaw, down to her neck, and then her collarbone. She pays attention to that for a moment, nibbling at the bone as Catra's hands slip into Adora's hair and she arches her back. Adora may have a map-making hobby, but her favourite thing to ever map out has been Catra's body. She knows everything there is to know about Catra's body, every single inch. She knows exactly the right buttons to press to get Catra moaning her name and doing those soft breathless moans she so often does. And then she moves on her way.

Catra hadn't been wearing a bra, she never does when she sleeps, and even sometimes just in general, so as soon as Adora takes her shirt off she has full access to Catra's goods - and by Catra's goods, she means her boobs (just, FYI, because they really are *good*). Someone should have told her years ago that marriage was just great sex with someone you love so deeply that you couldn’t imagine your life divorced from them and she would have been on board with this right from the beginning. "Adora..." Catra pants gently as the blonde runs her hot tongue over Catra's erect nipple. Her fingers curl in Adora's blonde locks and she tugs. Adora can tell that Catra is getting impatient from the way she keeps squirming under her, but Adora is going to spend as much time as she pleases getting to run her mouth all over

Catra's body, especially when she arches her back like that. What can she say? She loves to worship her wife's body.

And she does. She works Catra up a treat, covering her in countless love bites, kissing, nipping, biting, sucking, you name it really. She focuses mostly on Catra's boobs. With the right tongue movements, and such, Adora knows Catra can cum off of that alone, but Adora is feeling the desire to be a little bit of a brat herself. She's edging Catra essentially, and Adora knows she's pushed Catra to the edge several times by now but offered her no relief. Catra is clearly beginning to get frustrated with Adora, but Adora doesn't really care. She's good at this, and she's enjoying getting to kiss Catra's entire body.

She descends, moves her mouth down and down, she kisses down Catra's rounded belly and then to her hips. She presses brief kisses to each hip bone and then moves further down, pushing the blanket back. Catra's hand comes to the top of Adora's head as the blonde settles between her thighs, kissing the inside of each tenfold. "Adora…" Catra sounds only the tiniest bit irritated, but she also sounds breathy with love. Adora is going to service her wife to the best of her ability if only to hear her name whispered like a prayer by her. This is gentle fucking in Adora's eyes, and she's going to take her sweet time.

She moves to the spot that Catra really wants her, taking her time to get settled on the bed and slowly use her tongue to part Catra's folds. Catra's hand tightens in Adora's hair and Adora looks up at her wife while keeping her mouth exactly where it was needed. Catra looks beyond relieved. Adora feels a little pang in her chest, the kind she gets when she's doing a good job. Her praise kink has always been out of control. It's got a little bit of a messed up origin, the fact that she would try so hard as a cadet to win the praise of Shadow Weaver, but it doesn't change the fact that she likes being told she's doing good - especially when it's her wife and Adora is going down on her. It doesn't even have to be verbal. The praise is written on Catra's very face.

Adora decides that she won't push her tongue inside, she doesn't really need to, she'll just focus her attention on Catra's clit once she's worked her up enough. With her plan in mind, Adora sets about working Catra up. There is no roughness to this, and the gentle, soft, moans of Catra is just as encouraging to Adora as her screaming Adora's name. Adora has always loved their intimacy. It never changes. They never tire of each other. Catra is truly her intended life partner. Someone she will love forever easily. An easy love. That's all anyone can really ask for.

Adora feels two hands on her head and she looks up to meet those beautiful mismatched eyes which glow ever so slightly in their shared bedroom. Catra looks *stunning* , she always has.

“You’re beautiful,” Catra says, which makes Adora blush a little, “but please get to it, Adora.” Adora can’t help the small smile on her lips. Her strokes are sure, and she knows what she’s doing as she closes her lips around that wonderful little bundle of nerves as Catra arches back into her pillow, letting go of Adora’s face. Adora makes a sort of *slurrrp* noise as she releases Catra’s clit and then uses her tongue. “Just like that,” Catra says, her voice is a little strained with pleasure and it pleasantly makes Adora shiver.

There is something about going down on your wife in the middle of the night. It’s lazy sex, it’s gentle sex, it’s intimate sex. It’s *incredible* . “I’m going to use you now,” Catra says. Adora wants to ask what exactly she means but Catra’s legs are over Adora’s shoulders before she can. She loops her ankles and Adora feels her legs cross on her back. Catra’s hand moves to the back of Adora’s head. “Press your tongue to my clit, Adora.” Adora obediently follows her wife. She’s mesmerised by her. Catra then starts moving her hips, she essentially starts fucking herself against Adora’s tongue, and it’s the most wonderful thing Adora has ever experienced. She is more than okay with Catra using her this way.

Adora is covered in Catra’s juices and she helps as much as she can with her tongue, even if her jaw does ache a little, but Catra is working herself up. Her head is thrown back, and it isn’t long until Adora sees her wife cum. It’s quiet, but still noticeable. It sends shock waves right through her body and Adora feels her tense. She presses hard against Adora’s tongue and then just flops down on the bed. Adora smiles at that, it’s the cutest thing in the world.

When Adora is satisfied with her clean-up job with her tongue, she crawls up to her wife and kisses her happily. Catra wraps her arms around Adora’s neck and purrs softly and she gently nudges her. “How was that for you?” Adora asks with a smile.

“Perfect,” Catra responds. “Thank you. Now, put your strap on.”

“We’re not done?” Adora questions, her eyebrows raising. She kind of figured she’d give Catra one orgasm and they’d call it quits, but apparently not.

“Hell no, we’re not done. Strap on.” Adora follows Catra’s orders without hesitation. Adora reluctantly rolls away from the warmth of her wife and picks up her nearby sword that she had placed by the bed before they had climbed in. She concentrates on the blade and then converts it as she has done so many times before in the past. She stands from the bed and removes her sleeping shorts before she steps into the harness and secures it in place.

She returns back to her wife who pulls her down onto the bed. Adora props herself up on a pillow and watches as Catra reaches into their sexy drawer and pulls out the lube. “Not that I need much,” Catra comments as she coats the She-Strap with the stuff. Adora just idly watches.

“So this was your plan?” Adora asks as she watches her wife position herself. “To ride me.” Catra grins as she slowly lowers herself down onto the strap. Adora watches in slight awe. Her wife is so goddamn *hot* .

“Sure was,” Catra says, grunting a little. “Then you suggested going down on me, and I wasn't going to say no to that.” Adora’s ego is stroked a little by that.

Adora is still pretty amazed by her sword’s ability to allow her to feel *everything* . She feels Catra slide onto her, she feels her strap buried deep inside her, feels the way Catra fits around her, it is *incredible* . Easily the best feeling in the world, only improved when Catra begins to grind down against her. Catra begins a slow rhythmic pace, and Adora places her hands on Catra’s hips. Catra said she wanted to be in control of Adora, this is Adora allowing her wife to do whatever she pleased with her.

This isn't fast. It’s a gentle affair. It’s lazy fucking. There won’t be any fireworks in the sense of them screaming each other's names, but there will be fireworks in the sense that Adora can already feel Catra pulsing around her and being seconds from the edge herself. “Can I?” Adora asks through a strained voice. Catra opens her eyes to peek down at Adora.

“May as well,” she says, “I’m already pregnant.” That was true. Adora grins happily as Catra moves her hips a little more roughly. She’s so close. Both of them are. Adora had been impossibly turned on from the praise and going down on her wife, and Catra was already sensitive. This was going to be embarrassingly short, but when you’re married, sex is sex. Adora feels no need to draw it out. Plus, she’s really sleepy, okay? She just wants to cum and sleep with her wife again.

Catra is working herself up well enough, Adora just decides to help her by pressing her fingers to her clit and rubbing. Catra cums pretty quickly after that. Her walls clamp around Adora’s strap. She can make the strap cum as Adora if she *really* concentrates, as she does

now. The second Adora feels that pleasure crash over her, she imagines it very clearly in her head and her sword, the good obeyer it was, follows her mind's desires. Adora fills Catra up.

Catra flops forward against Adora's chest as they both come down from their highs. They're not seriously winded, but they are winded enough that they could use the time to recover. Eventually, Catra rises up and pulls Adora out. "What a mess," Catra comments as she lands on the bed beside Adora. Adora removes her sword strap and simply tosses it away. There really was a mess.

"Should we clean the sheets?" Adora asks.

"In the morning," Catra says, already curling into a ball. "I'm tired now."

"Was that everything you needed?" Adora asks. She spoons her wife, trying to lie around the stain in the middle of their bed. Thank god for mattress protectors.

"Mhmm… Good job," Catra gently pats her wife's cheek and Adora rolls her eyes a little, although the praise actually does feel good even if it isn't *huge* praise. Adora places a hand on her wife's belly.

"Goodnight, Catra," Adora says, kissing Catra on her cheek. Catra was already half-way asleep. Sex always did make them both sleepy. "Goodnight babies," Adora adds. As she slowly drifts off to sleep, she swears she feels a kick.

* * *

Catra was exhausted. She thought giving birth to one baby was hard, but giving birth to two right after one another is certainly hard. Whoever said giving birth after you had already done so once before was easier, she wanted to punch them in the face. But she had two healthy babies. Adora had suggested Mara for one, named after the past She-Ra before her. Catra thought the name was pretty and was more than willing to name their child after the legendary past She-Ra. According to Adora, Mara was an impressive She-Ra that saved Etheria from something - she was still researching all of that. The fact still remained that

Catra was downright exhausted. She wanted to sleep for at least a week straight. At least she had Adora to help, and she would be going home with her soon-ish.

Speak of the devil. Adora appears around the corner of her hospital door. "Hi wife," Adora says, smiling coyly from where she was standing. Catra raises an eyebrow at her. She knows when Adora is trying to cushion the news of something - or when she's nervous about something.

"Why are you greeting me like that?" Catra asks. She sits up a little, careful not to disturb the twins in her arms that were sleeping peacefully. She really could not deal with them waking up right now.

"Well... uh... You see..." Catra immediately narrows her eyes. For someone who used to rule the Horde, Adora is such a bad liar. Just the worst. It's how Catra knows she honestly truly believed in the Horde's mission. She can't lie to save her life, and she's endearingly awkward about it, but Catra is by far suspicious of her wife right now.

"Spit it out, Adora," Catra orders. Adora takes a breath and then comes to stand by Catra's bedside.

"Your moms are here to visit," Adora says gently. Catra's ears perk up at that. She doesn't understand Adora's nervousness about that until it dawns on her: moms, i.e. including C'yra.

"Oh," Catra says, her ears pressing back again.

"I can tell them to leave and come back another time? You did just give birth, I'm sure they'll understand if I tell them you're too tired for visitors." Catra looks at her wife. Adora looks genuine, her brow is pinched together in the way it does sometimes when she's concerned. She looks good for someone who hasn't slept for more than a few hours in the last couple of days, her clothes are ruffled, her hair is down, it had long since grown back to its usual length, although, she'd recently had an undercut shaved in, which only made her hotter if you asked Catra, her tank top meant her biceps were on show and her shirt was untucked in places. Adora likes to look clean and presentable, Catra thinks it's probably a side effect from her Horde days. She's never really adventurous with her style, she knows what she likes and she will wear it consistently. It's also just how she is. Adora can be particular because

otherwise it can cause her great discomfort. Others may call her style bland, repetitive, or whatever, but Adora finds it comfortable and comforting and that's all that really matters.

"No," Catra shakes her head. "Let them in." She'd rather get it over with anyway. Adora nods and disappears briefly. Catra rearranges the twins in her arms, making sure not to wake them but making herself more comfortable.

It doesn't take long for Adora to return. In tow are the Queens of Half-Moon, C'yra and Luna. Catra tenses a little when she sees C'yra but she's quick to smooth out her features so that she can't see Catra's emotions. "C'yra, you look..."

"Tired?" Catra asks. "Gross? I probably smell too."

"You look beautiful," Adora interrupts, stepping forward to kiss Catra on her forehead. Catra rolls her eyes fondly at her wife. Figures Adora would say that to her. "Radiant even, right?" Adora directs her question to the Queens who nod.

Adora reaches down and gently takes Mara in her arms. She turns to C'yra and Luna. "This is Mara," Adora introduces as she gently hands them off to Luna. Catra is grateful, she's a lot less stressed about the fact that Luna is holding her child than C'yra. "Mara was apparently the last She-Ra, according to my research, and it's a pretty name so we figured... why not?" Adora explains. Luna holds Mara gently in her arms, touching her face softly. That's when C'yra turns to Catra.

She comes towards her, Catra can't help the way her ears press back even more against her head. She's had nightmares like this. Nightmares where she was holding Finn in her arms and C'yra just snatched them away and Catra never saw them again. "May I?" C'yra asks softly. Catra takes a deep breath and then she nods, slowly sitting up to gently transfer their other twin from her arms to her mother's. "What's their name?" C'yra asks once she has them in her arms. She smiles down at the baby and purrs. Catra manages a weak smile at that.

"Cyrus," Catra answers. There's a long silence in the room, but C'yra's reaction is palatable. She looks up at Catra quickly, her ears perking forward and her tail flicking behind her. "After grandfather." And Catra's grandfather before that, not to mention the Queens that have been C'yra. Catra is the third. It's tradition. First born boys were named Cyrus, first born girls were named C'yra, just as Luna had reminded her so many months ago.

"You..." C'yra trails off, her tail really says it all with the way it flicks and her eyes are glassy. "You named them Cyrus?" Catra doesn't really know what to say. She's a little embarrassed simply from the way her mom seems so emotional from the choice. It's rare for her to see C'yra get so emotional - especially around Adora.

"It's tradition," Catra shrugs. She leaves out that Luna asked her to. C'yra smiles a little and holds Cyrus closer.

"My father would have loved to meet you," C'yra coos to Cyrus, "he had the same name as you. He would've been a wonderful great grandpa." Catra looks up at her wife when Adora places her hand on her shoulder, silently asking her if she was okay. Catra nods a little. If Catra is honest, she does have sympathy for her mother. C'yra lost her parents to the Horde, and Catra knows deep down she only ever wanted to protect Catra, protect her from the big bad Horde Lord, but she ignored Catra's protests and that's what hurts the most. C'yra didn't trust her enough to listen to her. Catra supposes it's water under the bridge now. "Their hair is…"

"Like mine, right?" Adora asks, smiling proudly. "I didn't think we'd actually have a naturally blonde kid, but Cyrus is definitely a close contender."

"They're like a day old," Catra points out, amused by her wife, "it'll probably darken."

"Nah," Adora says, "they're gonna be like me." Catra rolls her eyes. She leans back in her hospital bed and examines as her moms fuss over her two new babies. Catra never thought they'd be here after everything that had happened. In fact, when she had imagined this scenario, her having kids, being married, she never thought it would have been with the ex Horde Lord. Now, Catra can not imagine her life without Adora in it. Adora is truly her soulmate, in every single way. Maybe soulmates don't exist, but if they do, Adora is it for Catra. They've always had a connection, even when Adora was the leader of the Horde and they were enemies. Perhaps this was always meant to be.

"Do you want to sleep, Catra?" Adora asks, interrupting Catra's thoughts. Catra smiles tiredly at her wife.

“Maybe I’ll close my eyes for a little while,” Catra admits. Adora nods a little and leans down to kiss Catra softly on her lips. Catra’s eyes slowly close. She falls unconscious to the sounds of her moms cooing over her twins and the presence of her wife beside her. Maybe Catra had suffered through a lot, a war, an impossible love, the scorn of her friends and family, but she got here, and she would never give up this for anything. The bad was almost worth it.

* * *

2 Years Later

Catra is watching her wife. Well, kind of. She's watching She-Ra, but that is her wife. Technically. Adora is just fixing her golden braces on her arms, minding her own business, and Catra is becoming... flushed. "I can feel you staring, Kitten," Adora says, without looking up. Something about that is infinitely sexy to Catra. "I'll start to smell you in a moment."

"Shut up," Catra says but her thighs press together. They are alone... This is the perfect opportunity to take advantage. "Fuck," Catra breathes, "I... I want..." Suddenly, Adora's hand grabs Catra’s chin. She has such a cocky grin and, though she's She-Ra currently, it is so clearly her wife.

"Say no more," she says, her voice dropping a little into her sexy tone. "I want to, too," Adora says. Her left hand is at the waistband of Catra’s pants and Catra shudders.

"It's really not fair," Catra complains. Adora, She-Ra specifically, is like an eight foot tall goddess. Catra so wants to be fucked by her right now. She's already embarrassingly wet. "You're so... stupidly hot." Adora smiles.

"Is that your dirty talk?" She asks. Her fingers, her *big* fingers, slip below Catra’s waistband of her pants. They're not in their bedroom, in fact, they're sort of in public, someone could walk in on this, but that isn't deterring Catra if she's honest.

Catra moans softly and leans back against the workbench. Adora’s lips find hers and envelope Catra’s softly before it turns hot and heavy. It never really ever does take long for things to get steamy between them. They're far too familiar with one another, and Catra knows Adora’s plans, but that only serves to make her wetter.

Adora’s fingers trace over Catra’s underwear and Catra’s breathing instinctively picks up. Adora is good at a lot of things, such as leading, and chopping down wood, but she is especially good at sex. It's so fucking unfair if you ask Catra. She wants to know where she learnt all this from, other than the years they've been doing this of course, but she thinks maybe Adora studied some sex book in her Horde days. She'd learnt that Adora had been a studious soldier, though she had smirked and told Catra she also liked learning hands on. 'Hands on' at that time had been referring to the fingers she had buried inside of Catra. After all these years, Adora is an expert in making Catra cum.

"I want to taste you," Adora says. Catra feels a shiver run down her spine at the gentle husk of Adora’s words. She’s so effortlessly hot.

“Get on your knees then, Princess,” Catra instructs. Adora raises an eyebrow and then shakes her head.

“I had other plans,” Adora says as she takes her fingers out of Catra’s pants. Catra is about to ask her exactly what those plans are, but Adora is pulling Catra’s pants down already. Catra yelps a little and instructs her wife to make sure the door is locked. “Isn’t it hotter that someone could walk in on this?” Is all Adora says in response, and, *fuck* , yeah, it is.

“What are you planning?” Catra asks instead. Adora just smirks. It’s so infuriatingly sexy. Everything about Adora is infuriatingly sexy. She’s so effortlessly sexy. Sure, Adora is vaguely aware that she is hot, but she’s also occasionally extremely awkward about it. It seems to Catra that Adora’s ego and confidence is at its fullest when with her. Catra has seen women flirt with Adora and she hasn’t had a single clue that they were, and, when she has noticed, she’s practically turned the same red as her old cape with the realisation. Adora can be smooth, but only when she consciously tries. Sometimes a switch flips and she becomes a bumbling dork again. Catra adores it.

Adora doesn’t answer her, but she does kiss her. Catra melts into the kiss easily and lets out a surprised yelp when Adora presses her against the wooden workbench that was pushed up against one of the walls of the shed. They haven’t had sex in a while, okay? They’re horny. They’ve been busy, and they have children to care for, finding time to get freaky is substantially harder for them. One night they had been starting and then were interrupted by a knock on their door from Mara who joined them in bed because she’d had a nightmare. So that was a non-starter. Catra is so unbelievably attracted to Adora, and she just really needs to be fucked by her, okay? A girl has needs, and this is something Catra has needed for weeks.

Catra's butt ends up on the bench as Adora hoists her legs up and pulls Catra's pants all the way off. Catra feels her legs shake a little from anticipation. Gods, she loves being manhandled by Adora. She likes when the blonde takes the lead, it's *exciting* , and Adora is a great leader who Catra trusts entirely. Catra's underwear is slipped down her thighs by Adora and off. Adora's mouth is still pressed to Catra's lips and Catra's hands are gripping the material of Adora's (or She-Ra's) white shirt.

Adora leans back. "Are you ready?" She asks, grinning. Catra is immediately suspicious. She's about to ask what the hell Adora is talking about when she's suddenly being hoisted up. Like, literally lifted *up* . Catra ends up on Adora's shoulders, she grabs her head out of instinct and wraps her legs around her to hold onto her.

"Adora!" Catra yelps, feeling her heart beat out of her chest. Adora's hands are on the space where Catra's hips meet her thighs, and the feeling has Catra's stomach rumbling with butterflies. It's also kind of ticklish. Her fingers squeeze a little and Catra lets out an embarrassing moan before she recalls that she was in the middle of scolding her. "What the hell are you doing?" Catra asks.

"I told you I wanted to taste you," is all Adora says. Catra wants to point out that that has never involved Adora putting her on her *shoulders* , but Adora continues. "Relax, Kitten, I got you, promise. She-Ra can easily hold you." That was at least true, and the show of strength really had done something for Catra.

Catra relaxes marginally, though she keeps her hands atop Adora's head as the blonde pulls her closer. There is something very hot about being eaten out by your wife while sitting on her shoulders - *especially* when your wife is a eight foot tall warrior lady with a sword. "Alright, go," Catra says, once she's run through the pros and cons of this. Pros: Adora is hot, she's strong and knows how to use her tongue to make Catra cum. Cons: Catra might just end up being dropped on her ass from her wife's shoulders. Totally worth the risk. Trust her.

With Catra's permission, Adora wastes no time. Catra almost falls backwards from the first stroke of Adora's tongue, but Adora holds her firmly in place and Catra clamps her thighs together, squishing Adora's head. Adora must be hating that, she always did hate things touching her ears, she said it made them hot and it felt uncomfortable, but then again she's never really had an issue with that when it's been Catra's *thighs* crushing her head and she has a mouthful of pussy. Anything is bearable with a mouthful of pussy.

Adora is strategic, she always is, she knows all the right combinations to drive Catra insane and she *is* driving Catra insane. She-Ra's tongue is longer than Adora's, it reaches farther, *deeper* . Catra's claws come out and Adora grunts a little as she feels the sharp tips of Catra's claws dig into her scalp. Adora is *loving* this, and it's no surprise. She always has. The *sounds* she makes while fucking Catra with her tongue is almost more pleasure inducing then what she's actually doing with her tongue. Almost. But that tongue is amazing. Adora loves to give pleasure, Catra is more than willing to receive.

Catra has to be quiet, which is remarkably hard given the enthusiasm with which Adora is currently going down on her with, but the last thing she wants right now is some poor villager walking in on this and dying from shock. So Catra does something reckless, she removes one hand from Adora's head, covers her mouth and uses the other hand to fist Adora's hair and hold on. Adora *moans* , and the vibrations from her moan have Catra almost screaming. Catra moves her hips, feeling Adora's nose bump her clit and she decides to provide her wife with the encouragement she so needed. Aka. praising her.

"Just like that Adora," Catra says, removing her hand for a moment, "you're such a good girl. You know *exactly* what I want. Now be a good wife and make me cum." Adora's fingers tighten in a grip and Catra knows that her praise probably just turned Adora on tenfold herself. She moves back and then Catra feels a tongue on her clit. She has to cover her mouth again.

Adora goes to town. Her tongue moves in ways that Catra wasn't even sure it could move, and they have done this a *lot* . Driven by praise, and Adora's desire to be told she did a good job, Catra is sure she would be screaming around about now if not for the hand over her mouth. Adora's tongue presses, and swirls, it hits Catra's clit with precision and it is absolutely enough to get her off. Catra decides to help her out a little though by moving her hips. She abandons covering her mouth and uses her teeth to keep it closed instead. Meanwhile, she uses her hands on Adora's head to allow her the opportunity and leverage to move and rub her clit harder and at just the right angle to-

Taking her hand from her mouth was a bad decision. Catra calls out Adora's name and tenses. Her thighs actually do crush Adora's head, but it doesn't deter the blonde as she continues her strokes with her tongue. Catra feels the waves of pleasure crash over her, and then she feels all floppy. Her grip on Adora fades but Adora is by far strong enough to keep her in position. Catra just enjoys her wife lapping up her juices.

Adora lowers Catra down onto the bench eventually and Catra sighs with great satisfaction. She feels boneless. She understands why sex is considered a stress relief. She certainly feels less stressed after cumming that hard. Adora disappears from her vision as Catra closes her eyes, enjoying the gentle aftershocks of her orgasm. If she wasn't careful, she'd probably fall asleep there. The thing that keeps her awake is Adora.

Adora leaves her be for a moment, and Catra hears some rustling with Adora doing something, but she's too blissed out to peek, then her wife is leaning over her and giving her kisses down her jaw before she reaches her lips. Adora isn't very chaste about the kiss, and she doesn't pretend to be, her tongue is in Catra's mouth extraordinarily fast. Catra simply moans softly, but does not protest. Nothing to really protest about, she is absolutely down to make out with her wife.

Adora kisses her happily and Catra is allowed to taste herself on her wife's tongue. Gods, she's really fucking missed this. Catra honestly no longer cares if anyone hears this, they are technically in a shed in the woods, kind of, they're probably far enough away. Adora's hands are on her hips now, and she is kissing Catra feverishly. That's when Catra feels something press against her.

Catra pulls back from the kiss and slowly blinks open her eyes. Adora is flushed but she looks happy, her pupils wide and excited. Catra pauses, and then, "Are you wearing your sword strap?" Adora nods. "You want to go for another round?" Catra asks. Adora nods again. It's risky. Especially when Adora is She-Ra. Catra bites her lip and then she thinks fuck it, why not? She's horny, and who knows when they'll have another opportunity to fuck each others brains out again. The She-Strap is the only strap they have on hand and Catra *loves* it anyway. "Alright then, my Lord. Get on with it." Nothing turns Adora on or gets her moving then Catra instructing her to get on with something.

Adora must take Catra's instruction as her wanting to be manhandled a little because Adora flips her without any hesitation. Catra lets out a little yelp of surprise as she lands on her stomach and is pulled back by her hips by her giant wife. Adora kisses her shoulder blades as she leans over her and Catra shudders as she feels the strap slide between her folds. "You're ready for me already, aren't you Kitten?" Adora says in her low sexy voice that makes Catra shudder. "All mine for the taking." Catra can't help it, she moves her hips up, inviting Adora to do just that. To take her. Her dirty, *filthy,* words are only making Catra wetter, and Catra realises she desires nothing more than to have Adora buried inside of her.

Catra tilts her head back. "Are you just going to stand there or are you actually going to make me cum again?" Catra asks. Adora gets that little smirk on her lips that she always gets that

says ‘I love it when you’re being a brat’. Catra *is* being a brat, but that’s kind of her thing. Adora’s response to that is to grab Catra by her tail, roughly mind you, and to pull her *up* . It sure does hurt, but in a good way, in a way that sends a throb right through Catra as she imagines what it is that Adora is about to do. Adora is nothing if not a tease though.

Adora decides to rock her hips steadily. She has one hand on Catra’s hip and another wrapped around her tail to keep Catra’s tail out of the way. Her rocking hips move the strap through Catra’s folds and she gasps a little when the tip of said strap nudges her clit. Adora decides to set an agonising pace, and Catra whimpers pitifully. It feels *good* , but it is not nearly enough to get Catra entirely off and Adora knows. It’s *teasing* . “Where’s your please, Catra?” Adora asks, sounding way too smug for Catra’s liking. Unfortunately, she hits Catra’s clit *just right* so that Catra’s scathing remark is lost to her and she claws a little at the wooden table.

“ *Please* ,” Catra says. Fuck pride, she wants to be fucked good by her wife. Adora chuckles a little. Catra complains a little when Adora’s hips stop, but then she feels her line up behind her.

“You’re wet enough, right?” Adora asks. Catra is about to tell her *yes* but instead she feels a finger *inside of her* , then another. Catra falls down onto the table, helpless. Adora’s fingers hook and she gives a couple of thrusts. The resulting sound tells Adora, and Catra, that Catra is absolutely wet enough to take Adora. “Oh, Kitten, so wet… all for me.”

“All for you,” Catra confesses, breathless. She keeps her hips angled up and moans softly when Adora’s fingers exit her. She hears Adora unmistakably licking her fingers clean and Catra shudders.

“Perfect,” Adora comments and then she really doesn’t waste any time. Catra has only the tightening of Adora’s fist around the base of her tail, and the sharp pain of her fingernails digging into her hip, to warn her of Adora’s next move. Adora’s hips thrust and her strap enters Catra in one mighty push. Catra lets out a strangled cry and moan in one. Adora pauses for a moment, gives two gentle squeezes of Catra’s hip as Catra breathes heavily, pants really.

“Keep going,” Catra says after a moment. They still use the traffic light system but they’ve done this so many times now that they can communicate other ways: the way that Adora had squeezed her was her asking Catra if she was okay. “Go, Adora.”

Adora never has to be told twice. She does go, but she goes slowly at first. She’s obviously slightly concerned she’s being too rough, but Catra is honestly loving this. She always has loved when Adora fucks her hard. It was how she used to do it in the early days of their relationship, when they were so-called enemies. After a moment, Adora seems to be satisfied that Catra is okay with this and so picks up her pace. Adora’s grunts are almost as hot as the pace she slowly builds up to. It is a dizzying concoction of pleasure, pain and driving Catra insane. She wonders briefly if she already came, but Adora isn’t letting up even a little.

Adora pounds into her from behind. It's exhilarating. Catra has always found Adora fucking her from behind particularly hot because it’s almost like she's having her way with her, and that makes Catra feel absurdly wet. It's like her dream she had so many years ago, the one when they broke the table. Speaking of which, this workbench wasn't exactly the most stable and Catra claws at the surface when she feels Adora’s hips thrust just right.

"Adora!" Catra has descended into incoherent moans, but she manages to call her lover's name and Adora in turn leans down to kiss Catra’s shoulder blades.

"Such a good Kitten," She murmurs and Catra whimpers. She used to hate that nickname, though, granted, that hate had melted away every time Adora used it while fucking her. Now Catra is just used to it. It reminds her that she is completely Adora’s. She's at her submission. She's... Fuck, she's coming.

Her orgasm crashes over her unexpectedly but no less powerful than her first one. Catra grips the wood so tight she worries, in her pleasure mad mind, that she may have splintered it. Adora above her grunts and moves her hips more slowly yet firmly. "Good girl, Catra," She coos. "So tight, perfect." Adora is clearly enjoying the resistance as Catra’s walls clamp down around the strap so deep inside of her. Adora doesn't let up her strokes at all. "Mine, all mine," she whispers as her big She-Ra hands grip at Catra’s hips. Catra just lets out a pathetic mewl. They honestly haven't fucked like this in years, and it's clearly driving them both mad with lust.

"I want you to cum again for me, baby girl." Baby girl? When has Adora ever called Catra ‘baby girl’? She's about to comment on that when she feels two She-Ra sized fingers pressed to her clit and Catra lets out an almost animalistic yowl as pleasure overtakes her entire body.

She thinks for a moment that she just might cum right away but manages to cling on with all her might. Adora’s thrusts quicken into a dizzying and intoxicating rhythm. She's fucking Catra fast, hard and firm. In and out, in and out. Her fingers are working Catra’s clit and there is no fucking way Catra is going to last. *No way.*

"Mine," Adora growls out of nowhere. "Fucking mine!" She's *pounding* into Catra now with meaning. She's claiming Catra. She's...

"Fuck! Adora- Shit- I-" Catra struggles to form a coherent thought and sentence until finally, "just don't fucking stop!" Adora doesn't stop. She drives into Catra with the full force of She-Ra and Catra *screams* . She cums so hard she swears her vision turns black and she sees stars. And then... hot liquid. It fills her entirely up. Adora just came inside of her with her magic She-Strap. Catra can literally feel it fill her up and then some. Adora pretty much collapses on her back, panting like she does after she's finished a workout. She's spent.

For a long moment, Adora doesn't move, and Catra thinks maybe she's fallen asleep, but her breaths have regained coherency and they're not her sleeping breaths which means Adora is simply just frozen. Catra rolls her eyes. Only Adora would think that if she doesn't move Catra won't realise she just came inside of her. "Adora... Did you just...?" Catra trails off, leaving the end of her question open but clear for Adora to answer. Adora is quiet for a moment. Catra looks over her shoulder to see her wife giving her a guilty smile.

"... Maybe," She admits. Catra can't help but laugh at that. Of course Adora got a little too excited and managed to make her sword cum. This was the danger of using her magical strap and Catra allowing Adora to be She-Ra. "I'm sorry," She says, "I got... distracted."

"You were thinking about breeding me while fucking me and your stupid magical strap did just that," Catra says dryly, smacking Adora playfully on her forehead. Adora sighs. She hasn't moved since she spilled her load and Catra is kind of enjoying it - even if she is plugging it.

"I'm sorry," She repeats. "Uh... What do we do?" Catra gently looks at her wife. Maybe another kid wouldn't be so bad. Finn is already nearly a teen, and the twins were approaching three now, they could handle another baby, plus, Catra kind of liked the idea. Adora always did say that she wanted a big family. What's one more kid?

"No more kids after this," Catra says, gently tapping Adora's cheek. "Seriously."

"We don't know if-"

"She-Ra never misses." Adora laughs a little at Catra's words. She knows Catra is right. Catra feels Adora shifting behind her and then her wife slowly pulls out of her. Catra turns. She's *filthy* , she definitely needs a shower, but that's not easily accessible given where they are right now. Adora transforms from She-Ra to herself, transforming her sword into just a regular sword. It really isn't fair how Adora can just *whoosh* and she's clean and fresh. She hardly looks like she just fucked Catra in some work shed.

Catra pulls her pants up and runs clawed fingers through her curls in an attempt to look like she hadn't been doing what she had been doing just five minutes ago. Truth be told, the worst feeling was that her underwear was getting rather wet with She-Cum. "I need the bathroom," Catra announces as she tries to slip past her wife. She can at least clean up there.

"Wait," Adora catches her arm and Catra looks at her curiously. "You seriously want another kid?" Adora looks… unsure, maybe even a little vulnerable. Catra smiles easily at her big beautiful wife.

"I do," she says, leaning up to peck Adora reassuringly on her lips. "I know I don't have to, Adora, I know you did that accidentally, but one more kid to our current three sounds… nice. One more. One last one. Four kids to carry on our legacy. I'm more than happy with that."

"We don't need kids to carry on our legacy," Adora says fondly, "pretty sure no one can forget us for a very very long time." Catra gently pats her wife's cheek.

"I agree," she says, "but more kids to love? That sounds like a good thing to me. One more."

"What if it's twins?"

"Please don't jinx it, Adora," Catra says as she walks out of the shed. Adora follows after her and Catra smiles at the heavy familiar steps of Adora's boots.

“What if it’s triplets? What if it’s quadruplets?” Adora asks.

“Dear gods, I hope not,” Catra says. “Please don’t speak that into existence. *One* . Like Finn.” Adora hums. “Now I really need to get cleaned up, if you would please make some excuse as to why I’m running late from my errand to the villagers, that’d be greatly appreciated.”

“Yes ma’am,” Adora says, leaning in to kiss Catra sloppily on the cheek. She takes off soon after that, leaving Catra full of fondness. She really hoped it was just the *one* .

* * *

Catra sighs as she folds up a piece of correspondence from her mom C’yra. “Uh oh,” Adora comments from her spot in the kitchen. Adora was sitting at the breakfast bar, on the stool, leg crossed over the other. They had been quietly existing around each other for a while now. “Was that a bad sigh, or a good sigh?” Adora asks. Catra rolls her eyes at her wife as she places the letter down.

“C’yra,” Catra responds. Adora turns her head to the side in curiosity and Catra decides to elaborate. “She’s asking if I still wish to turn down being Queen.”

“Ah,” Adora says, hopping down from the stool. She comes over to Catra and examines the letter herself. “Can’t say I blame her, you’d make an incredible Queen.”

“I just… I have no desire for it anymore,” Catra admits. She bites her lip for a moment. “She… Asked about Finn…”

“Finn? Because she wants them as her heir?” Adora asks, raising an eyebrow. “I thought we agreed that we would allow our children to make that decision for themselves, if they desired to be rulers of Half-Moon or not?”

“Of course,” Catra responds, “but… Maybe I’ll have to step in while they decide. Mama and mom are getting older, and if they don’t make a decision then Half-Moon will be without a ruler.”

“You honestly think one of them will die soon?”

“I don’t know, Adora! I’m just… worried,” Catra says. Adora remains quiet for a moment as she reads the letter over. “Maybe it’s time we had that conversation with Finn?” Adora goes very still at that.

“About me being Lord of the Horde?” Adora questions. “I thought… I thought we were going to wait until they were a teenager?”

“They almost *are* a teenager,” Catra points out. “They’re nearly thirteen.”

“I meant like fifteen, sixteen, not *now* ,” Adora says. Catra lets out a slightly frustrated sigh and looks at her wife. Adora sighs and looks away. “I just don’t want them to think of me any differently.”

“They won’t,” Catra reassures, “we should tell them before they find out about it from some other source, or at least inform them about the conflict with C’yra so they have all the information they need to decide if they wish to be the leader of Half-Moon.” Adora reluctantly nods.

“Very well,” she says, “let's go speak to them.” Adora gestures for Catra to go first. Catra glances at her wife. Adora kind of looks like she’s going to be sick, so Catra reaches her hand out and places it to her chest.

“You’re their mom, Adora, they’re never going to think badly of you,” Catra assures her. Adora looks away from her.

“I guess we’ll see,” is all Adora says before she walks out of the kitchen. Catra sighs and shakes her head, following after the blonde. The twins were currently napping and Finn was in their room. Catra peers into the twins room to see that they were still napping soundly. She smiles a little at the sight before she closes the door ever so slightly and then they cross to Finn’s room. They knock gently and wait for Finn to call them inside before they enter.

Finn is sitting at their desk as they enter. Catra closes the door as Adora walks to the centre of the room. Finn swivels around in their seat. They seem happy at first, but then they seem to clock the weird mood in the room as their ears go down and their tail stills. “Have I done something bad?” Finn asks.

“Of course not, kitten,” Catra answers. She moves forward and places a hand to Adora’s back, between her shoulder blades. It’s meant to comfort her, but it only shows Catra just how tense Adora is. Adora loves all of their children, and it would devastate her if Finn changed the way they saw her simply because of her long dead past. “We just need to speak to you about something, if that’s okay?” Finn nods their head. They look a little more relaxed at least. Adora, on the other hand, is as tight as a rubber band. “Adora?” Adora sighs and Catra can see her thinking about how to phrase this.

“There’s something you need to know about me, Finn,” Adora says carefully. “About my past. Do you remember the Horde?” Finn frowns a little but then nods.

“They were called the evil Horde and they tried to conquer Etheria, but now… they don’t exist. Aunt Scorpia got her kingdom back, which is where they used to be. I think we’re gonna learn more about it in class at some point.” Adora looks at her wife. Catra shrugs her shoulders a little. It did make sense, the Horde were a massive piece of Etherian history. It was probably good they addressed this before Finn learnt about it while sitting in class.

“Well…” Adora turns back to Finn. “I used to be the leader of the Horde,” Adora says awkwardly, “I was the Lord of the Horde.” Adora winces a little. Finn just stares. They don’t say anything for a long moment, and then they laugh.

“You’re kidding, right?” They ask. “I thought the Horde was evil?”

“It was… Kind of…” Adora says. “I was the leader, Finn. Your old baby blanket,” Adora walks over to Finn’s closet, she rummages around inside of it and then pulls out the old thing.

She undoes it and presents the blood red cape that still has the Horde insignia on the back. Adora smiles a little at it. She really did used to love that cape - especially when she could give dramatic gay effect by swishing it. “This used to be my cape,” Adora explains, “the symbol on the back belongs to-”

“The Horde,” Finn finishes. They look shocked, which isn’t too unsurprising, but Catra can tell that it’s making Adora nervous. “I can’t believe I never noticed that before.”

“Well,” Adora says as she folds the baby blanket/cape back up, “you stopped using it a long time ago.”

“You were the Lord of the Horde?” Finn asks in amazement. Adora nods as she places the blanket back into the closet and closes the door. “I can’t believe it… You’re so… You’re not evil.” Adora’s eyes sparkle a little when Finn says that.

“We wanted to wait to tell you until you were old enough and could understand,” Adora explains. “This… Me being the Lord of the Horde, made Catra and I’s relationship extremely complicated, and it caused conflict between her and the Rebellion. Especially between her and Queen C’yra.”

“Conflict?” Finn asks curiously. Adora looks at Catra now. Catra presses her lips together and takes Adora’s hand.

“I was the Princess of Half-Moon,” Catra says, “and Adora was the leader of the Horde. We were technically supposed to be enemies, Finn. C’yra… Your grandma reacted badly when she discovered our relationship, and let's just say that things went badly. I decided I no longer wanted the throne, but now C’yra has no heir.”

"Is this why Grandma Cy asked me if I wanted to be ruler?" Finn asks. Catra sighs and nods.

"Yes, because I've stepped down from the position since you were born,” Catra explains to them. She was technically no longer Princess of Half-Moon, just Catra. “I... I didn't want to be the ruler of Half-Moon anymore. I'll always support your decisions, Finn. If you want to

be the heir and take the throne in the future, then that's great. If not, then we will always support what you want to do."

"You're our little miracle, Finn," Adora adds. "You... Almost never happened."

"Wait, really?!" Finn looks shocked. Catra supposes it's not every day you learn about how difficult your existence was before you were even born, and Finn definitely didn't have an easy existence, even if they don't remember any of it, even if it had happened mostly when they had still been in Catra's womb. Catra nods at her kid.

"There... You were a very hard pregnancy and I almost lost you a few times," Catra admits. Finn frowns at this information.

"Why?" Finn asks.

"That's..." Catra clenches her jaw. "That's something that would probably be best to tell you when you're a little older. But… It's safe to say that the environment I was in was very stressful, and stress isn't good for when you're carrying an adorable kitten." Catra pinches their cheek affectionately and Finn complains, gently swatting Catra's hand away. Catra feels her heart squeeze in her chest. Finn really is a miracle, and Catra loves them with her whole heart.

"Truthfully, we knew you didn't want to share us with anyone else, and that's one of the reasons we waited to have any more babies, but Catra needed the time too," Adora says gently. "It was hard, and that's why... Have you noticed how things are a little, uh, tense between C'yra and your mama?"

"Grandma Cy hurt you?" Finn asks softly, looking at Catra. Catra is sometimes surprised by Finn's eyes. They are so clearly Adora's, it always catches Catra off guard how Finn is both Adora and Catra.

"Yes, she did," Catra answers hesitantly. "And it took me a long time to heal from it." She was *still* healing from it if she was honest, but things were a lot better now.

"We don't want you to think badly of your grandma," Adora adds. "We just... We want you to know. We'll tell you more when you're older."

"We also didn't want you finding out what happened from anyone else before we had the chance to tell you," Catra hums. "At least we did it before your class covered the subject, huh?"

"Yeah..." Finn says, standing up from their desk. "I think it would've been awkward to learn my mom was the ex leader of the Horde in a classroom." Catra nods, smiling a little.

"Are you doing okay?" Catra checks.

"Are you?" Finn asks. "Mom looks like she's going to cry."

"I... I'm just happy you don't seem to hate me," Adora says, her voice coming out hoarse. Catra turns her head to see that Adora's eyes are glassy and her nose is a little runny.

"Hate you? I could never hate you," Finn says with a frown. "Honestly, if it wasn't you two telling me this, I wouldn't have even believed it. Mom... You're a huge softie." Adora smiles, tears in her eyes.

"That's what Catra always said."

"Your mom and I were worried about how you would react since we didn't exactly get good reactions from people before," Catra explains, "and you're our child, Finn. Adora was very worried about how you may react. That she might lose you." It's not every day you learn your mom was the leader of an evil organisation after all. Finn frowns at that.

"They should've known better," they say. "You wouldn't love mom if she was a bad person. And you raised me, I know both of you the best." Catra smiles at that and gently pulls them

closer to them.

"I know, Finn, but sometimes anger and fear is stronger and it sucks," Catra answers softly. "They eventually realised it, but it took a long time." Finn doesn't say anything immediately, instead choosing to wrap their arms around their moms and purr softly.

"It shouldn't be stronger than love," they say, their voice muffled by being buried against Catra's stomach. Catra gasps and hugs Finn close, purring when Adora wraps her arms around them too. Family hug.

"It shouldn't... It *isn't* …" Catra says. Love will always be the strongest emotion. "Otherwise me, your mom and you wouldn't be here. We love you so much, Finn. Thank you for being so understanding about this." Adora smiles and kisses Catra on her forehead before she kisses Finn on their hair.

"I love it when you two purr," she says affectionately. Catra rolls her eyes at her wife, but her purring only increases.

"You always say that, mom," Finn laughs and hugs them tighter. "I love you both so much. You've been the best moms that anyone could ever ask for."

"Now they're just purposely trying to make us cry," Adora comments to Catra. Catra laughs tearfully in response to her wife.

"Well, it's working," Catra admits, sniffling softly.

"Don't cry!" Finn says, their tail swishing harder as their purring also increases.

"We're crying because we're happy and relieved!"

"Well... Don't!"

"I can't help it!" Catra yells back. Except, she’s also smiling now. Adora laughs.

"Okay, we'll leave you to digest this information for a little while and then call you down for dinner later, okay?" Adora asks. They break up their hug and Adora gently ruffles Finn’s hair. Catra smiles wider at that interaction.

"Okay, thank you for telling me. I gotta get my homework done now, but I'll definitely be down for dinner," Finn hugs them one more time before letting them go.

"Good luck with your homework, kitten. We'll make your favourite today. Sound good?" Catra asks.

"Sounds perfect," Finn says with a smile. Adora heads towards the door, opening it for Catra - such a gentlewoman. They step out together and Adora pauses just outside after closing the door again.

"That went... really well," Adora says. She’s clearly relieved. She had been stressing about it ever since Catra suggested it, and even before then. Adora’s fear that their kids would reject her after they learnt the truth was one of her biggest fears.

"It did, it went really well," Catra takes Adora's hand, squeezing it gently. "How are you feeling?"

"Relieved," Adora says. "We have to do this with *all* of our children?" Catra sighs at that. At least two more times, possibly three.

"Yeah, but now we'll have Finn to help them understand as well. And we have a few more years before we have to go through this again," Catra reassures her wife. In fact, they had a lot of years, probably about another decade, if they stuck to the teenager rule.

"That's true at least," Adora says with a laugh. "Did you get the results from the... the pregnancy test?" Adora asks. "You know... After I accidentally... You know... Do we have a fourth on the way?"

"I'm actually supposed to get the results from the doctor tomorrow, love. I told you that," Catra reminds her wife. Adora can sometimes be scatter-brained, but it's become one of her endearing qualities to Catra.

"You know I forget things," Adora says. "Four babies... So many babies." Catra laughs softly at that.

"You can say that again. I think I may honestly get a procedure to stop having babies after the fourth one."

"It was an accident! It won't happen again," Adora protests. Catra raises an eyebrow at Adora.

"It sure won't because I'm getting that procedure after, dummy," Catra gently pats Adora on her cheek and then turns, walking off down the hallway. She baps Adora's nose gently with her tail on the way.

"Does that mean I could... you know... inside of you without getting you pregnant?" Adora asks as she follows after Catra. Of course that's where Adora's mind goes. She really does have a breeding kink - so does Catra if she's completely honest with herself.

"Mhmm…" Catra hums. "Okay, now let's go make dinner."

"That procedure might actually be a good idea," Adora says suddenly as they begin to descend the stairs together.

"I figured," Catra laughs. If there was any way to persuade Adora that that was a good idea, it would be telling her that she could use her She-Strap however she wished without worrying

about the risk of pregnancy. "I'll schedule the appointment if I get a due date from the doctor tomorrow."

"You think you are pregnant?"

"I... have a feeling.” Plus Catra meant what she said to Adora. She-Ra never misses. The chances of her being not pregnant were extremely low in her mind.

"Well, every time we've done that you've ended up pregnant," Adora says. "Let's hope it's not twins again, I don't know if we could handle five kids."

"Don't jinx it, you dork. Come on, dinner time."

"Did you know you get hotter every day?" Adora asks. Catra rolls her eyes and hums. Her wife has resorted to flattery now.

"So you like to tell me," Catra says. She knows what Adora is thinking now. Horny thoughts.

"A hot mama," Adora says. When Catra turns her head she sees a sly grin on Adora’s features.

"So you say." She rolls her eyes fondly.

"Did you know I overheard some of Finn's school friends who thought you were Finn's older sister?" Adora asks. Catra lets out a sound of surprise at that.

"Wait, what? You're kidding," she turns to look at her wife but Adora doesn’t look like she’s kidding.

"No," Adora says. "It's hard work being married to a woman who is so much hotter than you are," Adora jokes playfully. Catra laughs at that. "I didn't correct them though, I imagine Finn will."

"You're very hot, Adora. You're my very, very sexy wife." She answers, sealing the sentence with a kiss.

"You're still... You really do get sexier with age, it's almost unfair."

"As do you."

"Uh huh," Adora says. "Come on, I'll help you cook." Catra makes her way to the kitchen. Adora's idea of helping Catra cook is usually watching and stealing food. Adora is still a pretty terrible cook, but Catra enjoys her company.

"Hey," Catra says, looking at her wife seriously. Adora looks at her, and then gets a small frown on her face when she notices Catra's expression. "I love you." Adora's worry gives way to a genuine smile.

"I love you too." That's all Catra needed.

* * *

"Adora," Catra pauses when she sees the blonde. Adora looks at her wife curiously. She looks… exasperated. "Can you please take your boots off when you've been out in the woods before you come inside? You have dirt everywhere."

"Sure thing, boss," Adora salutes Catra, like, properly salutes her, in the way she used to to her superiors in the Horde. Catra just shakes her head at her but doesn't say anything else. Adora knows that Catra loves her, even her dorky mannerisms. She slips her boots off and sets them on the shoe rack by the door. She had recently taken up the odd job around local villages acting as a sort of lumberjack. Adora didn't do it for money, mostly to help with the

rebuilding, and also because hitting trees with an axe (which she could conveniently convert her sword into an axe) was very therapeutic for her. The wood was used for buildings by villages and for other things like fires, etc.

Adora makes her way to the kitchen where her wife had disappeared to and Adora comes around the counter. She places her hand on Catra's round belly. "How are my babies?" She asks, kissing Catra on her neck.

"Do not start with me, I need to wake the twins up soon or they won't sleep tonight when we put them down for real," Catra warns.

"I'm not starting anything," Adora says innocently. She kisses Catra's neck again and Catra lets out a dreamy sigh, tilting her head to one side to allow Adora more room. Unfortunately, Catra comes to her senses. She swats Adora away from her and Adora pouts. She picks up an apple from the fruit bowl and sulks as she bites into it.

"I really have no idea how you are always horny," Catra comments. She's in the middle of folding laundry.

"Easy," Adora answers, "have you looked at yourself in the mirror lately?" Adora asks and Catra rolls her eyes, but Adora can make out a soft blush on her wife's cheeks.

"Shut up," she grumbles. Adora just smiles in satisfaction. That's when Adora hears the front door open. Adora glances at the clock and figures it's probably Finn coming home from school.

Sure enough, Finn rounds the corner, their bag slung over their shoulder. Adora swears they're getting taller and taller all the time. They stop in the kitchen. Adora raises an eyebrow. "Okay there, bud?" Adora asks curiously. Catra turns her head to look at their child too. Finn looks… a little off if Adora is honest.

"We started learning about you in class," Finn explains. Adora looks at Catra who shrugs softly. "They told us about how you and mom met, and I realised when I was sitting there that you… that story sounded very familiar to me." Adora clears her throat a little.

"Well," Adora says, a little awkwardly, "I may have, possibly, told you that story as the 'Lord and the Princess' bedtime story that you loved to hear before going to bed." Adora used to tell Finn a vague story about a Princess who fell in love with the Lord of a kingdom, that their love was forbidden, but that they loved each other so much that they found a way to be together. It was the story of her and Catra, only kid friendly.

"That..." Finn looks at Adora, completely surprised. "That's really hard to believe."

"Well, Catra and I's story wasn't exactly PG, so you got the PG version," Adora says, taking another bite of her apple. Catra places a cup of coffee in front of Adora.

"What... What the heck does that even mean?" Finn asks, scrunching up their nose - it's the same way that Catra does, and Adora loves seeing them both do it. Adora hesitates for a moment. They've kind of covered this conversation with Finn already, but it was bound to come up again once Finn started hearing it from their teachers.

"Well," Adora pauses, "how do you think you were made?"

"Okay, ew," Finn gags a little. Adora snorts. She knows it must be difficult for Finn to reconcile the mom they know with the Lord they may see in their classes. Adora sighs and looks at Finn. "Question I actually want an answer to," Finn starts, "is the history chapter we were taught about in school today actually accurate?"

"Uh..." Adora looks at Catra before looking back to Finn. "That depends, what do they teach you?"

"Maybe it'd be better if you just showed us," Catra suggests, looking up from the laundry she was still folding. "Do you have the book with you, Finn?"

"It's history," Finn says as they go to their backpack, grab the book and open it to the correct page. "Right here," They slide it onto the counter and Adora leans over to look.

"Hey... that is me," Adora says. It was an old picture. Like, one of the banners that used to hang in the Horde, the ones that Catra used to make fun of her for looking so ‘serious’ in. That was kind of the whole point, to remind people that she was the Lord and that they should obey her.

"It is you. We're actually starting this chapter next week, so the class hasn't read it yet," Finn says. "That does *not* look like you though, mom."

"Really?" Adora asks. "Looks a lot like me, right babe?" Adora asks Catra. Catra smiles.

"It looks like the really grumpy you that you used to be," Catra fires back.

"I suppose I was a little grumpy," Adora concedes. "I was never really happy as the Lord."

"You were *very* grumpy, my love," Catra says as she goes back to her task. "If you ask all of our friends from the Horde, they would tell you the same thing." Adora rolls her eyes and turns her attention back on Finn.

"What do they say about me?" She asks. "That I was devilishly handsome and an incredible leader?" Adora asks. Catra snorts from where she’s standing. Adora looks at her to give her an offended look. Finn simply raises an eyebrow and looks at their mama.

"Is that true?" They ask. Catra giggles as she rolls up a pair of socks.

"Hmm, I don't know about devilishly handsome. She is a good leader though," Catra says as she takes a seat next to her wife. Adora smiles and leans over to kiss Catra on her jaw.

"Truthfully, I had a lot of help," she says. "I did, however, do a lot of bad things for the Horde. It took Catra to show me that everything I'd been taught was a lie." Catra purrs and shifts her chair closer to Adora, laying her head on her shoulder.

"It was a weirdly fast yet slow encounter that turned into mutual understanding and then love."

"Why do you say that?" Finn asks curiously. Catra clears her throat awkwardly.

"I'm sure they left this out of the textbook, but the reason why your mom and I are even together is because she kidnapped me and I offered to sleep with her in exchange for my release," Catra explains. Adora almost spits out her coffee that she had unfortunately just went to take a sip from. She was not expecting Catra to get *that* honest with Finn.

"You-" Finn stops mid-sentence. "What?"

"I told you I gave you the PG version of events," Adora supplies.

"She gave you the *very* PG version of events," Catra adds.

"Gross," Finn comments. "So mama is the reason that you're no longer the Lord?" Finn asks. "Does that mean you would still be Lord right now if she hadn't?"

"I..." Adora pauses. "I'm not sure... I never really thought of it like that..." Adora frowns. She really never had considered that. She couldn't imagine her life without Catra, the idea that this ended any other way, where they weren't together, was inconceivable to Adora. She does wonder what would have happened if Catra had refused Adora's offer to stay the night with her and just left instead.

"That's actually a really good question, but we can't give a definite answer on it. The circumstances that lead to our being together, and the war ending, were unique to say the least," Catra explains softly. "Adora has always had a good heart, she was just misguided when we met."

"How can she have a good heart when she was destroying innocent villages?" Finn gestures to their textbook. "You blew up Frosta's Castle?" Adora winces. She supposes that, although they had told Finn that Adora used to be Lord of the Horde, it's hard to truly know what that means unless you *see* what Adora had done in the past. Finn's history book was really putting that on blast.

"Just a little," Adora mumbles.

"More than a little. I was yelling at you for it, and for other things, during Princess Prom," Catra answers. "And, well, in her mind, she was thinking that fighting against the Princesses and defeating us would bring peace to Etheria. Your mom was an orphan raised by the Horde, so it was all she knew. She thought she was doing good, which is why I said she was misguided. She just needed someone to show her that." She kisses Adora's temple. "Princess Prom was actually when your mom kidnapped me the first time."

"You never mentioned the Lord kidnapping the Princess," Finn says, raising an eyebrow at Adora. No, she never did add that to their bedtime story.

"Well, that seems less romantic out of context," Adora argues. Strategic at the time. A beautiful tactic that Adora had been immensely proud of to actually execute, only it also led to Catra stealing her heart. So not exactly romantic, but also not not romantic, if you catch her drift. Catra laughs at that.

"She probably said something like, 'the Lord whisked the Princess away to embrace her and admire her beauty', or something along those lines, but, yes, she kidnapped me the first time. I was so pissed at her, but she had been flirting with me the entirety of Princess Prom so I figured I would use that to my advantage," Catra explains.

"Hey, you flirted back," Adora says defensively.

"That I did, thank you so much for noticing," Catra bumps Adora's shoulder playfully.

"And insulted my forehead."

“You deserved that.”

"And what happened next?" Finn asks curiously. Catra smiles.

"I asked your mom if she wanted to sleep with me and she basically short circuited," Catra answers.

"That's... Yeah, that's true," Adora says. "The first time was pretty amazing."

"You slept with the Horde Lord?" Finn asks.

"I mean, yes. Otherwise you wouldn't be here, kitten," Catra jokes. They obviously don’t want to tell Finn *too* much, but it is the truth, and they had agreed that they didn’t want to lie to their kids.

"I did give Catra the option to leave, but... she didn't," Adora looks at her wife and smiles a little. She’s very glad that Catra chose to stay that night. None of this would have happened otherwise.

"Why didn't you leave, mama?" Finn asks. Catra hums softly.

"I was curious. Anyone with eyes can see that your mom here is very attractive. I knew she was attracted to me, and sometimes you want things that you know you shouldn't. So my curiosity got the best of me, but I don't regret it."

"So, curiosity? That's it?" They ask. They don’t seem convinced by that.

"Hey, you should be glad that was enough or you wouldn't exist," Adora butts in. "Besides, I am very attractive, I've had a number of women tell me so despite the ring on my finger. And

in my youth? Even better looking."

"Actually, you look better now, babe," Catra points out. "You filled out once we finally had everyone eating real food and not Horde rations."

"You think I look better now? That's really gay, my wife," Adora teases. Adora does flex her muscles a little. Catra wasn't wrong, Adora really has filled out during her time post Horde.

"We're really gay, my love," Catra kisses Adora's lips gently. "That being said, it really was curiosity at first. Then we kind of kept wanting to see each other, except we were in denial to the fact that we were falling in love, but from that first time we, as I love to say, had clicked." Adora smiles at the memory.

"We were enemies, technically, but it never felt like that when we were alone," Adora confesses.

"So you just kept meeting up?" Finn tilts their head slightly.

"Basically, though it's a little more complicated than that," Catra says.

"We kept sleeping together is what your mother means by 'complicated'," Adora adds.

"While still being enemies. And no one else knew."

"Are you serious?" Finn asks.

"Uh huh, the first people to find out where Spinnerella and Netossa," Catra says, glancing at Adora.

"And what fun we had when we could sneak around even more, with them covering," Adora grins, wiggling her eyebrows at Catra. Catra rolls her eyes at Adora.

"Wait, they didn't tell anyone?" Finn asks in surprise. Catra shakes her head.

"I begged them not to tell anyone. They were worried that Adora was just using me, or that she was hurting me, which wasn't the case at all. They were also worried that I was catching feelings, which I told them I wasn't. That was a big lie."

"They're the reason Catra tried to end it," Adora says quietly.

"End it?" Finn looks at the two of them, confused. Catra sighs.

"They insisted that I should stop what your mom and I were doing before it went too far," Catra explains, "except it had already gone too far."

"You still ended it," Adora grumbles.

"I did. Because I never thought that you would have felt the same."

"I was a little... dense," Adora admits. "Things went kind of badly after that."

"Badly?" Finn looks between the two of them, seeing the grimace on their faces. Catra nods slowly.

"I had accidentally bonded with your mom. So parting from her sent me into grieving," Catra says. Adora gently squeezes Catra's hand. Adora too had gone into a major depressive state.

"And I used to have anger issues. I didn't really have control of them, and Shadow Weaver convinced me to do something that almost cost me Catra and you," Adora adds.

"Shadow Weaver?" Finn asks. Adora almost forgot that Finn had no idea who Shadow Weaver was. Shadow Weaver used to be such a big part of her life, for someone so close to her to have no idea who she was… was a little strange if Adora was honest. Catra growls softly.

"The bitch who raised your mom, pardon my language. She was very manipulative and hurtful," Catra answers.

"I used to think she cared about me," Adora tells Finn. She really used to believe that. "She never did."

"That's really sad," Finn comments. Catra nods a little.

"For sure, your mom used to think it was normal to be attacked in the middle of the night to 'learn how to sharpen your instincts', or whatever lie Shadow Weaver formed. I think the first time Adora slept without thrashing around was when we shared a bed. Am I right?" Catra asks her wife.

"You were warm," Adora says, smiling softly.

"She became a giant snuggle bug after that."

"You made me feel safe, and also it was hard to sleep-fight when my arms were wrapped around you," Adora adds. That's why she doesn't do it much anymore either. She's grown used to Catra's presence which is calming to her.

"That's really cute, mama." Finn whispers. "What happened after that?"

"After what exactly, kitten?" Catra asks.

"After the thing with Shadow Weaver?" Finn asks. Catra presses her lips together at that.

"A lot happened."

“A *lot* ," Adora echoes, "but that's all in the past now. We've all moved forward."

"We have. We've moved forward and we've grown," Catra smiles. "We had you, and that was a life-changing moment in itself."

"We're happy," Adora says. "And now people recognise me more for being She-Ra than the Lord of the Horde." Adora turns to look at Catra. "And now I’ve knocked you up twice more."

"Adora!" Catra scolds.

"What?" Adora asks. "It’s true."

"Yeah, but not in front of our firstborn who we've probably given way too much information to already," Catra is blushing, hard.

"Point taken," Adora says. "No more now though, right?"

“We'll talk about it."

"You say that like we talked about Finn before that happened," Adora comments. Catra sighs, burying her face in her hands.

"Kitten, I'm so sorry. Your mom has never been good at knowing when to not say things," Catra apologises.

"You love me," Adora supplies.

"Very much so, but moments like this make me wonder why," Catra fondly rolls her eyes. "She's done this in front of your grandmas before too."

"Okay, wait…" Adora pauses for a moment. "Yeah, I have done it a few times in front of them before, haven't I? I'm surprised C'yra has let me live this long."

"I am also surprised," Catra laughs under her breath. "Your grandma Cy used to hate Adora."

"Really?" Finn asks. "Hate? Isn't that a strong word?" It probably honestly isn't strong enough if Adora and Catra are being real.

"When I was pregnant with you, we were still at war, kitten. And the only ones who knew who your other parent was were Spinerella and Netossa," Catra explains slowly, licking her lips. "Everyone else found out through a spy that Adora had hired and forgot about. They decided to turn on her and work for the Rebellion for a quick buck, and they exposed what had been going on between your mother and I."

"Oh," Finn says, "yikes..."

"For sure yikes. It made things really complicated and tensions were incredibly high," Catra pauses for a moment. "A whole situation went down, but in the end your mom was allowed to stay after she surrendered. It took a really long while for C'yra to warm up to the idea of Adora being my mate."

"A *really* long while," Adora adds. "She still sometimes glares at me, but," Adora pauses, "she buried that hatchet a while ago. Pretty sure it took her about five years to actually call me her daughter-in-law, but we got there."

"With a lot of patience and effort." Catra laughs before quieting down. "I was actually not talking to her or your grandma Lu when you were first born, or for quite a while after. When they found out about me and Adora, they said some... not very nice things that hurt me a lot. So I lost a lot of trust in them. They've obviously made up for it and rebuilt that trust, but back then it was hard." Less Luna than C'yra.

"What exactly did they say?" Finn asks curiously. They already know about the tension that arose between C'yra and Catra, but they don't know exactly what occurred between them to cause such bad tension - other than that C'yra hurt Catra.

"Not nice things. I won't elaborate much on that. You don't need to hear them," Catra sighs, clearly not wanting to ruin the image that Finn had developed of their grandmothers even if she kind of had every right to. Adora offers her a supportive smile. "Let's just say that because they were upset with who I chose as my mate, they kind of kicked me when I was already down."

"That's… wrong," Finn frowns. "I'm sorry, mama."

"It's not your fault, Finn," Catra smiles at them, "but thank you."

"Listen, Finn," Adora says, "you're going to hear a lot of things about me in your classes. Some of it may be true, some of it may not be. I don't know what they teach. You're going to hear things about me from your classmates, a lot of different opinions on me, but I hope that you come and speak to me if you have any concerns or questions, okay? My past is complicated, and although I've tried to make up for my mistakes, there will always be people who think the worst of me, and they're entitled to that, but I don't… I just want you to ask me if you have any concerns, okay? I'm your mom before I'm anything else." Finn nods. They close their textbook and put it back into their bag.

"Okay, mom," Finn says. "I love you."

“We love you too,” Adora responds, smiling. So long as they communicated, they’d be fine.

“Alright, let's wake your siblings up and then make dinner,” Catra says, standing up.

“Hold on a moment,” Adora says, stopping her waddling and pregnant wife. “Finn and I can handle that, you stay down here and rest for a bit before dinner. What if we asked Glimmer to teleport us some food from the castle? That way you don’t have to cook?” Catra seems to think about it.

“Fine, but only because my back is killing me,” Catra says. Adora loves her family so much.

* * *

Catra is woken up when she hears her wife rustling around her room. “Adora… What are you doing?” Catra asks, half asleep. There is a long moment of silence before Catra hears Adora curse under her breath.

“Sorry,” She whispers, “I didn’t mean to wake you.” Catra’s eyes adjust and she sees Adora standing by her side of the bed holding their newly born baby. Catra sits up a little. They were only a few days old, and Catra was worried that she’d slept through them crying or something.

“What happened?” Catra asks. “Are they hungry?”

“I don’t think so, they were just rustling a little so I went to check on them and they’re so… *cute* ,” Adora says. She sits down on the bed and Catra rolls her eyes at her wife. Of course her wife picked them up out of their crib because they were cute.

“All of our children are cute,” Catra points out.

“Just like you.”

“I know it’s 2 am, but I’m not above murder at this hour,” Catra threatens playfully. Adora just smiles a little.

“Finally, a baby with your eyes,” Adora says. Catra looks at the baby in Adora’s arms. They were the smallest of all of their babies too. Finn had been pretty small due to stress, the twins had been relatively chunky but this one was just on the smaller side. They were still perfectly healthy, just small, and they did have Catra’s eyes, as in exactly her eyes. They had heterochromia like Catra. Whereas Finn had Adora’s eyes, Cyrus had the blue cyan of Catra’s blue eye and Mara had the yellow eyes of Catra’s yellow eye, this baby, their fourth baby, was the only one to actually inherit the heterochromia of Catra’s eyes, the same as C’yra too.

“I guess that is kind of cool,” Catra admits. She gently places her hand on their head. “We need to name them, Adora.”

“Actually,” Adora says, “I’ve had a thought about that.” Catra looks at Adora curiously. She looks… strange. Maybe not strange, but mischievous in some way. Like she’s about to suggest something silly. Catra cocks an eyebrow, indicating for Adora to go on. “What do you think of the name Calamity?” Adora asks. Catra looks at her blankly.

“Calamity? Seriously?” Catra asks in disbelief.

“I just think it’s kind of ironic,” Adora explains. “I mean, they’re not a calamity as in a disaster, but they were a surprise, kind of unexpected, it suits them. Plus we can call them Cal or Cali for short.” Catra opens her mouth, but then closes it again. She looks at the kid in Adora’s arms. Weirdly, it kind of suits them.

“I… Kind of like it,” Catra admits.

“Yeah?” Adora asks with surprise. “It’s kind of a cool name too.”

“Calamity…” Catra repeats then smiles. “And so it is.”

“Welcome to your family, Calamity,” Adora says and she receives the tiniest purr in response.

“Here,” Catra instructs, holding her hands out. Adora carefully hands Calamity over to Catra and Catra settles them there. Adora gets fully into bed now, putting her feet up. She cuddles into her wife’s side and Catra begins purring, not only for Calamity, who purrs back, but for Adora too. Adora has always loved it when Catra purrs, it calms her down exceptionally and it’s no surprise to Catra when Adora eventually falls fast asleep beside her.

“You’re going to be so loved,” Catra whispers to their baby. They were that big family Adora always wanted, and Catra wouldn’t change it for the world. She kisses Calamity on their little head and then moves them to a safe position to sleep, positioning them between both her and Adora where she falls swiftly asleep.

* * *

2 Years Later

Adora isn't sure what it is that sends Finn flying off of the handle, maybe she said something in the wrong tone of voice, but she thinks, more likely than not, Finn was probably just stressed about something (probably school work) and Adora asking them to pick up their bag was just the flame missing from the firework. They whirl around on Adora, surprising her a little, and the anger in their eyes startle Adora even further. "I was about to!" They yell. "Gods, is this how you ran the Horde, huh? I know you used to be the Horde Lord, but you're not in this house." The words catch Adora completely off guard and she tenses, freezing on the spot.

She can see the anger slowly fade from her child's eyes and their breaths slow down as they calm - she can also see the regret. "Mom, I... I didn't..." They trail off. Adora doesn't know what her expression looks like, she used to be good at hiding her emotions, but she's gotten used to wearing her heart on her sleeve over the years and she thinks maybe she looks hurt because Finn looks extremely sorry. It is pretty rough to be reminded of your worst mistakes randomly one afternoon. Adora also never thought Finn would use the Horde Lord knowledge against her, but she gets it, sometimes teenagers can snap, especially if they’re stressed.

Adora feels a tug on her pants' leg and looks down to see Calamity looking up at her with their cute mismatched eyes. Adora smiles a little as she bends over and picks them up off of the ground. "I can see that you're frustrated," Adora says. She can also feel Catra's eyes on them from the kitchen. She witnessed the entire thing. Adora isn't so mad at Finn, she's more embarrassed. She's never been good at handling being scolded, it's why she used to run herself ragged to meet Shadow Weaver's demands when she was a cadet - to avoid scolding. Being yelled at makes her feel hot and flustered and ashamed, but she's not about to dump that on her teenage kid just because they had a bad day and snapped. "So I'll give you some space. I just ask that you give me some too," Adora says before she walks to the living room with Calamity in her arms. She hears Finn start to talk to Catra but doesn't hear much of the conversation before she sits down on the couch, Calamity on her lap.

"Momma," Calamity says and Adora smiles at them. At least one of her kids is still a baby that she can coddle, and they can coddle her back too - although the twins are only five too. Adora knows it won't be long until Catra comes in here to talk to her, but she takes the time to cuddle with her baby in the meantime.

* * *

Catra watches her kid from the kitchen island. They stand in silence, seemingly unsure of what to do. It seems even Finn was shocked with their outburst. "Finn, what's wrong? What happened that pushed you to say that?" Catra asks. She moves away from the kitchen and into the hallway where Finn was standing. She stops just in front of them.

"I... I don't know... I was just... frustrated," Finn says, finally reanimating.

"About what?" Catra asks calmly. "Because what you said was… unwarranted." And a little mean, but Catra didn't want Finn to feel too bad, she understands that a person can have a bad day and say things they don't mean, she's done it plenty of times herself.

"I... I was stressed, about school, and anxious, and I know mom didn't mean anything by it, but her asking me to do something I was already going to do just pushed me over the edge and I snapped on her," Finn says, their tail whipping back and forth. "Do you think I hurt her?" They ask quietly. "She looked hurt..." Catra sighs softly at that. Adora was hurt, that

much had been clear, but Catra also knew she'd likely be fine. She just needed the time to cool off, same with Finn.

"Sit down with me," Catra says as she moves to the breakfast bar. She sits down on one stool and then moves the other stool out, patting the seat as indication for Finn to take it. She waits until Finn sits before speaking again. "The answer to your question is yes, you did hurt her," she admits honestly. "It's... Her time as the Horde Lord is not something she's proud of Finn, but she didn't exactly have a choice. Give your mom some time and then apologise to her, okay? And next time you're overwhelmed, or overstimulated, please let us know so we can give you some space. You know that we'll always be understanding about something like that. "

"I know, and I will," Finn says. "I'm really sorry for saying that to her."

"I know you are, kitten," Catra whispers, pulling Finn into a hug and holding them gently. She can tell that Finn truly feels bad for what they said.

"At least Calamity made her smile," Finn says, purring a little as Catra hugs them. "They came just in time I guess."

"Yeah, Calamity to the rescue," Catra says fondly. Calamity is already a character and they're only two years old. Finn sighs.

"I'll wait a little before I talk to her again," Finn says.

"Yeah, that sounds like a great idea, kitten," Catra replies. She gently moves their hair from their face and plants a soft kiss to their forehead.

"Will you tell her I'm sorry?" Finn asks. Catra smiles reassuringly.

"I will, kitten. I promise," Catra swears. That seems to relieve Finn because they let out a soft sigh.

"I'm going to go to my room for a little while, is that okay?" They ask.

"That's perfectly fine," Catra nods.

"Okay," Finn stands up and heads towards their room. They pause for a moment and pick up their bag along the way. Catra watches them as they disappear up the stairs. She lets out a long sigh and then hops down from the stool. Now she needed to check on her wife.

Catra makes her way towards the living room. Adora is sitting on the couch, talking to Calamity who is listening attentively to whatever it is that Adora is telling them. Catra smiles at the scene, and then walks into the living room and sits down beside her wife. “You okay?” Catra asks.

“I have Calamity here,” Adora says, “nothing could be wrong.”

“Adora,” Catra sighs, “that was kind of rough. If you were upset, it would be understandable.” Adora gets quiet at that. She doesn’t say anything for a long moment, and then she looks at Catra.

“I admit that it did hurt my feelings at first,” Adora admits, “but… I’ve also been a teenager before. They just need some time to cool off, I’m sure they’ll come and talk to me later.”

“They wanted me to tell you that they were sorry,” Catra admits, keeping her promise. Adora smiles a little, though it doesn’t quite meet her eyes. She goes quiet again. It’s a concerning quiet to Catra. Adora used to be incredibly hard to read, at least when she was the Lord of the Horde, but it was rare now that Catra didn’t know what it was that her wife was thinking. “What is it?” Catra prompts, because she can tell (at least) that Adora is thinking about *something* .

“I’m… worried,” Adora eventually admits. “I know that we told them that I used to be Lord of the Horde, and I know they said they were okay with it, but what if they're not? What if one day they use it against me like they just did? I love our children to the farthest moon of

Etheria and back. I can't imagine any of them hating me, or using my past as justification to… Yeah, I guess I'm just worried."

"You said it yourself, Adora, they're a teenager and they're in a mood. I don't think Finn could ever hate you, I actually think you're their favourite," Catra comforts. Adora rolls her eyes and then bumps her shoulder against Catra's.

"They don't have a favourite," Adora says quietly. "Although, I did say that about them before our other children were born. I've always felt… close to Finn, I guess, which is why their words hurt."

"And I'm not saying you can't feel hurt, you can, but don't think this is actually an accurate reflection of how they see you. They admire the hell out of you, it's just a bad day," Catra says.

"You're probably right," Adora says, sighing softly.

"Probably? When am I ever wrong?" Catra raises an eyebrow at her wife.

"It has been known to happen," Adora smiles again, but this time it actually reaches her eyes. Catra smiles back. She kisses her wife on her cheek.

"Anyway," Catra stands, opening her arms for Calamity. "Time to nap, bump." Don't ask why Catra calls Calamity that, it was a nickname they got into calling them when they were still inside Catra's belly and it's just kind of stuck. Calamity just sits clinging to Adora.

"I'll put them down," Adora says, standing. "You just stay here and look pretty." Catra laughs.

"Seriously?"

“What? Like it’s hard?” Adora asks, winking at her wife. Catra rolls her eyes as she watches Adora leave with their youngest. When Adora has been missing for about half an hour, Catra goes to check on her since it doesn’t usually take more than twenty to put Calamity down. When she gets to their room, she sees Calamity nestled up to Adora, sleeping soundly on her chest, blanket halfway over them. Catra’s heart nearly explodes from seeing her wife and baby napping together. She leaves them to nap.

* * *

Later, after dinner and when Adora is in her map making room, she hears someone climbing the ladder. She looks and sees two ears appear first and then two blue eyes. Finn. They silently climb the rest of the way up, their ears moving from being up to being pressed down. They look… apologetic. Adora gestures for them to come in. “What are you doing?” They ask curiously.

“Considering making a new map of the Fright Zone,” Adora says, “all mine are from when it was… From before Princess Scorpia took it back as her kingdom and made such extensive changes.” Adora watches as Finn looks around Adora’s little hobby room. She was sitting in her throne, the one from the Fright Zone, the one she used to lead from. It was just a chair now.

“I’m really sorry, mom,” They say suddenly. “I didn’t mean to say what I said. I was just stressed. I’m really *really* sorry.” Adora smiles a little.

“Thank you for the apology,” Adora nods at them. “I’ve said a lot of things I didn’t mean while angry and frustrated too, it happens, I understand, but Finn, seriously, if my past bothers you-”

“It doesn’t,” Finn cuts Adora off. “Really. In fact, I think you’re pretty amazing for what you’ve accomplished.” Finn looks around the room. “I like your maps, maybe you could teach me how to make them?” Finn asks. Adora turns her head to the side.

“Really? Your mama thinks it’s dorky,” Adora says.

“Oh, it is, but cool dorky,” Finn says and Adora snorts. “I want to be like you… I want to travel, and help people, discover new places, and make maps.” Adora smiles at that and her heart swells at hearing one of her children admit they want to be like her. Maybe Adora wasn’t as messed up as she first thought.

“So you’ve decided to pass on the throne?” Adora asks quietly. C’yra had been asking again recently. Finn was nearing fifteen, they weren’t quite there yet, but by this age Catra had already had extensive royal training, Finn had had none as Adora and Catra waited for them to make their decision about if they wanted to be C’yra’s heir or not. Finn slowly shakes their head.

“I think grandma Cy wants Cyrus anyway, he’s her favourite grandchild,” Finn comments. Adora frowns at that, though they aren’t completely off base with that. Catra had already gotten into it with C’yra about treating Cyrus with favouritism since he shared the name of C’yra’s grandfather, a royal Magicat name, it seemed C’yra wanted Cyrus as her heir over Finn. Finn was sort of just being asked about the throne because they happened to be the firstborn, otherwise, Adora thinks C’yra would have already been after Cyrus for her heir. “And… She hurt mama, and you. I’m not sure I’d feel comfortable taking the throne that mama is only passing on due to such mistreatment. Plus, C’yra didn’t even want me to be born, isn’t that right?” Finn asks.

“That’s… Who told you that?” Adora asks.

“No one, figured it out myself,” Finn shrugs a little. “You were still Lord of the Horde, C’yra hated you, mama had only recently been exposed. I doubt C’yra wanted me to be born.” Adora lets out a sigh.

“It was complicated,” Adora admits.

“Still, I think I’d rather do this,” Finn says. “I don’t want to be the leader of Half-Moon, I want to go on adventures, see Etheria, maybe see other places, who knows.” Adora smiles and makes her way over to Finn.

“You can do anything you want, Finn,” Adora assures them. “ *Anything* .” Adora places her arm over their shoulder and squeezes. “I can show you how to make them,” She says, “so you can make maps of all the places you go to.”

“So… you forgive me?”

“Nothing to forgive, bud,” Adora says, tousling their hair. “I love you, kid, you’re going to do incredible things. Now come on, be a dork like me.” Finn laughs at that and Adora knows that they’re going to be absolutely fine.

* * *

Finn looks at their grandma. C’yra was currently reading some important documents and signing them. Finn hadn’t exactly told their moms that they were coming here after school, but they just needed to hear from C’yra what they had already heard from their moms. They just weren’t too sure how to bring it up to her. Eventually, C’yra hands her documents off to another Magicat and they bow before they leave. C’yra turns to them and smiles. “To what do I owe the pleasure of your visit, Finn?” C’yra asks as she gestures for them to take a seat. The Magicat palace was so different from their home, it was hard to imagine their mom growing up here.

“Mom and mama told me some stuff recently,” Finn says, “about mom’s past… And about you.” C’yra’s eyebrows raise and she hums.

“I suppose they were going to eventually,” She says, “what did they say? Did they make me out to be a villain.”

“Not really,” Finn says, shrugging. “I mean, you didn’t come off *good* , but I guess I can understand on some level the reason why you reacted the way that you did. The only thing I can’t seem to reconcile is the fact that you said you hated me.” C’yra looks horrified by that.

“I never said I hated you,” She says firmly. “Who told you that?”

“Not in so many words, but you didn’t want mama to keep me. You wanted her to get rid of me. You said I was the devil’s spawn.”

“How do you know all this? Surely C’yra and Adora didn’t tell you this?”

“No,” Finn says, biting the inside of their cheek. “They wanted to protect me from the fact that my grandma apparently held such great disdain for me. I researched it. I got accounts from different people, and eventually I learnt what you said to mama about me, and mom.” C’yra sighs.

“You remind me of C’yra sometimes, though you’re certainly more like Adora,” C’yra says. She bites the inside of her cheek before she continues. “I hated Adora,” she admits. It’s so casual, like she isn’t even speaking to Finn about their *parent* . “I never hated you, you were part of my daughter, I could never hate you.”

“But you hated my mom so you hated part of me?” Finn asks. C’yra’s eyes sadden. They sit in silence for a period of time. Finn kind of thinks that C’yra will probably just leave it there, but she eventually speaks again.

“It was complicated,” she says quietly. “I know now, in retrospect, that I overreacted. C’yra didn’t deserve to hear those things from me, especially when she was in such a vulnerable state, I guess I just… I was so *angry* with her. Not that that really excuses it. I obviously feel differently now.” Finn presses their lips together.

“I don’t want to be your heir,” Finn states. C’yra’s eyes widen.

“You…” C’yra trails off. “Finn, I never meant to hurt you or C’yra-”

“You just think I’m the child of a monster?” Finn asks, cutting their grandma off. C’yra’s words die in her throat and she stares at Finn in slight shock. “I don’t think I want to anyway, I want to do what mama did and abstain. You can have your *precious* Cyrus.”

“I certainly do not favour them,” C’yra says quickly. “If your moms-”

“But you do,” Finn says, frowning. “You really think I wouldn’t notice? I’m not blind, C’yra.”

“ *C’yra* ?” C’yra asks, completely caught off guard. She looks offended by Finn’s referral to her by her name and not ‘grandma Cy’, but Finn was *mad* .

“That’s right,” Finn says, grabbing their stuff. “I don’t want to be your stupid heir. My mom is no villain, you are. You must lack complete empathy if you couldn’t see that she was trying to be better. I know it was you who scratched her face. You almost got my mama killed, almost got my mom killed, almost got *me* killed before I was even born. What loyalty do I owe you? What loyalty do I owe to this crown? None! I don’t want it. I want to be like my mom. She is strong, and kind, and… She’s *good* .”

“Finn,” C’yra starts, “of course I know that now, but at the time…” C’yra trails off. “I support your decision to remove yourself as heir-”

“Because you want Cyrus!” Finn yells. “They have the royal Magicat name, you love them just fine because they’re not the reason that mama left you. You will *always* resent me, even if it’s unconsciously. You don’t care for me like you care for the rest of my siblings.”

“Finn…” C’yra looks sad, but it's not untrue. C’yra has a bias, even if she isn’t conscious of it. Finn will always be the grandchild that tore her family apart, their siblings are blameless, brought into the world a decade after a happy marriage and reconciliation between Adora and Catra with the Rebellion members, but Finn? Finn will never be blameless in C’yra’s eyes. “Can’t we talk about this?”

“No,” Finn says. “That is my final decision. I don’t want to be ruler of the Magicats. Ever. I want… I want to choose my own path. I want to be like my mom and explore Etheria and help people. Because *that’s* what she does, *helps* people.”

“Finn, this was a really long time ago,” C’yra says. “Adora and I have made our peace. I would never dream of… treating you differently.”

“But you do, you’re just not aware of it,” Finn says as they sling their backpack over their shoulder. They sigh. “Look… I’m not saying I don’t want to see you anymore, but I need some time, and I won’t reconsider my stance on not wanting to be the heir.” C’yra stares at them for a moment before she lets out a heavy sigh and then nods.

“Very well,” She concedes. “I will support your decision.” Finn nods and then heads towards the exit.

“Please tell grandma Lu that I said hi,” Finn says over their shoulder. “And… I’ll let you know when I’m ready to start speaking to you again.” C’yra nods at them but doesn’t say anything. Finn is pretty content with their decision and starts on their way back to their home where their moms were no doubt already in the process of preparing dinner. They smile a little. Well, Catra probably was, Adora was probably on kitten wrangling duty. This decision was one of the first times Finn felt like they were growing up, and knew they’d have their moms support no matter what.

* * *

"Uh, mom..." Finn calls. "There's someone here who says they know you."

"Let them in," Adora calls back. No she doesn't know who it is, but she's currently got a diaper situation on her hands. She finishes fastening Calamity's diaper in place and then lets them sit up. "There we go," Adora says, smiling. "Don't worry, Little One, we all have accidents, nothing to be embarrassed about. After three babies, I've learnt how to do it efficiently." Calamity laughs at her and then they push themselves up onto their feet. They're wearing nothing but their diaper, they seem to prefer it like that. "You are so chaotic," Adora says with a big fond smile. "But I love you so much. You're so freaking cute." Calamity giggles as Adora scoops them up and gives them snuggles.

That's when Adora hears a whistling sound from behind her. "This place sure is a mess," Adora freezes at that voice and then turns around slowly. "Hey there, Lord Adora." Adora blinks and then she slowly places Calamity down on the ground.

"Finn," Adora says. "Please take your siblings up to your room."

"Mom-"

" *Now* ," Adora says sternly. Finn looks at their guest before they nod. They pick Calamity up and then grab Cyrus' hand.

"Come on Mara," they say and Mara follows after Finn, holding onto their tail. Adora has only a moment to appreciate how cute all her kids look before she turns back to their guest.

“Get out.” Adora deadpans.

“Now, now,” DT says, dramatic as ever. “Don’t you want to hear what I have to say, my Lord?” Adora picks up the nearest object to her, which just so happens to be the bag she put the dirty diaper in, and throws it directly at DT’s head. Unfortunately, they have quick reflexes. Adora is just glad she bagged the thing before she threw it. “Rude,” DT huffs. Adora is in no mood to deal with their shit right now. She was supposed to be taking care of her kids.

She watches as DT transforms right in front of her into… Adora draws her sword, which was sitting on the couch beside her and rushes at DT. She slams them against the wall of their living room and winces a little. Catra is so going to give her shit about trashing their home later. “Get out of my wife’s skin *right now* before I skin you myself,” Adora almost snarls.

“And here I thought you’d find this skin more to your liking,” DT coos. They never seem bothered by *anything* . They’ve always been like that. Adora narrows her eyes at them. They sound like Catra, and they look like Catra, but everything else is off. Adora is struck by how little DT actually knows her wife.

“I’m serious,” Adora says, stepping back. Slowly, they transform back to their usual appearance. “It’s a good thing I told Finn about being Lord of the Horde or they’d have some serious questions about why you called me Lord Adora.” Adora comments as she picks up the dirty diaper bag. She sighs as she starts cleaning up a little. DT was right, the place was a mess. Four kids would do that though, even if Finn was older than their siblings.

"I'm surprised you told the little brat about your chequered past," DT says. Adora chooses to ignore their continued use of 'brat' when referring to Finn - it's not like Double Trouble will listen to her anyway.

"Well, we didn't want someone just telling them out of the blue," Adora says, shrugging. "You know, like how you did with the Rebellion about Catra and I's relationship."

"Oh are you still mad about that?" DT asks. Adora frowns. They still don't really understand how bad what they did really was. "That was *years* ago, I thought you'd be over it by now."

"I'm not really mad about it anymore," Adora says. "I've always known you were out for yourself."

"Oh, but we sure did have some fun. Didn't we, my Lord?" Adora blushes a little and clears her throat. She chooses to not dignify that with a response.

“Why are you here, Double Trouble?” Adora asks. “Because I’m pretty sure Catra and I made it clear that you weren’t welcome in our home.”

“I need your help,” They say, catching Adora off guard. She turns to them and then lets out a laugh of disbelief.

“You must be joking, right? That’s a joke? I didn’t know you were funny.”

“Not joking, Lord Hot Stuff,” Double trouble says.

“You seriously need to stop flirting with me or my wife will probably murder you,” Adora comments. Is Adora considering helping Double Trouble? Of course she is. She may dislike them strongly after what they did to her and Catra, but she’s She-Ra, it’s her duty to help those that are in need. Plus, she doubts DT would come all this way, and to her specially, if it wasn’t something important. “What is it you need help with?”

“I went back to the Crimson Waste, I was having a lot of fun, providing my services, being paid handsomely after my sugar daddy Horde Lord cut me off-”

“Please never refer to me as your sugar daddy,” Adora says, interrupting DT while shuddering a little at their wording.

“Anyway, you have a Horde loyalist problem in the Crimson Waste, some zealots that want to prison break good old Shadow Weaver from her deep dark dungeon,” DT continues. “They wanted me to help them spring the old hag. I refused, naturally, even drained of every drop of magic she’s the worst.” Adora hums in agreement. “They didn't like that so much, they drove me out, and now I’m here.”

“How unfortunate,” Adora responds with an edge of sarcasm. “I’m missing the part where this is my problem?”

“I want my monopoly back, Lord Adora,” DT says, their tail curling a little. “Besides, wouldn’t you like to remove a bunch of so-called rebels who still believe Shadow Weaver can resurrect the old Horde, and who most likely want you dead? Not to mention your nice little family you have here.” Adora freezes mid-folding a baby onesie. She was fine with people wanting her dead, but she was not fine with people wanting her family dead. Her perfect, beautiful, *innocent* , family. She slowly turns back towards DT.

“They said this?” Adora asks.

“Well,” DT begins, “they said they wanted you dead for betraying the Horde and becoming a Princess sympathiser. It only makes sense that they’d also target your family.” This is Adora’s worst nightmare actually. Her chest feels tight and it’s suddenly hard for her to breathe. She takes a moment to calm herself down, taking slow and measured breaths.

“I can’t leave,” Adora finally says. “I have babies to look after.”

“So call the Sparkle Princess to watch them, or one of your many other Princess friends.”

“The Crimson Wastes are dangerous,” Adora protests, “Catra will *kill* me if she finds out I went running off there.”

“You’ll be back lickety-split,” DT argues. “Besides, you’re doing this *for* Catra.” Adora closes her eyes at that. Double Trouble is right, this would be to protect Catra, she’s just not so sure Catra will see it like that. Catra is probably going to kill her for doing this, but she can’t stop thinking that she *should* do something.

Adora opens her eyes again and walks over to the com-pad they kept in the house. She sends off a quick message to Glimmer and then walks back over towards DT. “If this is a trick, I will-”

“Yeah, yeah, yeah,” DT waves their hand dismissively, “you’ll rip my tail off, and skin me alive, blah, blah, blah. I got it.” Adora sighs and then Glimmer pops into the living room. Adora jumps a little, she’s still not entirely used to that.

“What’s going on?” Glimmer asks, eyeing DT. “Do I know you? I feel like I know you.”

“Double Trouble, darling,” DT introduces. Adora watches as Glimmer’s eyes widen. Adora quickly steps forward to intervene before Glimmer can drag them off topic.

“They need my help,” Adora says, “I need you to watch my babies.” Once upon a time ago, Glimmer would have been the last person that Adora would trust to look after her kids, but now, Adora and Glimmer are *friends* . They actually get along surprisingly well - Bow too. Adora is considered part of their Best Friend Squad. They’re also Calamity’s godparents. Each of their kids have different ones. Finn has Spinnerella and Netossa, the twins have Scorpia and Perfuma, the people who were supportive from the start, and Calamity has Glimmer and Bow. The point is, Glimmer *knows* Adora, and she also knows *Catra* , and that’s probably why she has her eyes narrowed at Adora right now. “Please?”

“You really think Catra would be okay with this?” Glimmer asks, raising an eyebrow.

“Probably not,” Adora admits, “but… I have to help, Glimmer.” Glimmer lets out a long sigh.

“Catra is going to kill me,” Glimmer says. “And you. Fine. I’ll watch your kids for you, but you’re taking the heat with Catra.”

“Thank you,” Adora says, smiling. She picks Glimmer up in a tight hug, which she protests at, and then she looks at DT. “You have a ride, right?”

“Well we’re certainly not going to walk all the way there, even if She-Ra’s legs are long,” DT responds. Adora isn’t sure why, but she blushes.

“Mom?” Adora turns to see Finn standing in the doorway. They eye DT suspiciously. They seem to be growing so fast, and *tall* . They’re only fifteen, but Adora swears they’re going to overtake her height soon. They look so much like Catra it’s kind of uncanny, the only real difference is their blue, Adora-looking, eyes. “Where are you going?”

“I… I have something I need to take care of,” Adora answers, smiling at her kid. “Aunt Glimmer here is going to watch you guys. I wouldn’t want to leave you alone with three rowdy kittens, okay?” Adora asks. “I’ll be back before you know it.” Adora walks over to her kid and smiles reassuringly at them while resting her hand on their shoulder. “Your mama will be home soon too.”

“Which is why you should *wait* ,” Finn frowns.

“Finn…” Adora sighs. “I’m She-Ra, this is what I do. I promise you that I’ll be okay. Stay here.” She gently ruffles their hair. Finn looks like they want to protest, but all they do is look away from Adora. Adora feels her heart clench in her chest a little. She’ll have to make it up to Finn *and* Catra when she gets back. “Let's go, DT.”

“Roger that,” Double Trouble slides out of the room and then out the front door. Adora gives Finn one last apologetic look before she follows after the shapeshifter. Adora just knew this was going to be a shit-show, and so did her kid apparently.

* * *

It takes them a while to get to the Crimson Wastes. Adora spends most of her time standing at the edge of DT's skiff, watching the desert sands pass by, arms crossed over her chest and thinking about her wife. Catra is going to be *mad* at her, Adora is already sure of this, but she at least hopes she'll be able to make it up to Catra. Adora sighs and looks up, checking their surroundings rather than just the ground. "Are you still brooding, Lord Adora?" Double Trouble asks from behind.

"Just focus on steering so we don't end up dying," Adora says dismissively. Double Trouble hums from behind her but doesn't say much else. The day moon is already setting, that means Catra was definitely home by now and knew about Adora's absence. "Sorry Catra," Adora mumbles before she focuses on the mission at hand. She couldn't afford to get distracted. The least she could do was come back alive for Catra.

They travel for a few more hours, the day moon is quickly setting, dousing everything in a gentle orange glow which will quickly turn silver when it's night. They stop at the edge of a cavern and Adora turns to DT. "Welcome to the Valley of the Lost," DT says, grinning.

"They're here?" Adora questions, looking over the edge. It seemed like a densely populated *civilian* place.

"No, darling," DT says as they swing the steering stick sharply towards the right and almost knock Adora off of her feet. "They're just a little further down to the East, in a separate cavern that's close by. You needn't worry your pretty little head about harming innocents even though you never really cared about that when you were Lord, did you?" Adora doesn't answer that question, but she does glance off to the side. DT was right. Adora used to hurt innocents a lot more often than she is willing to admit.

They travel east for a few more minutes before they reach a halt. DT hops off of the skiff and Adora reluctantly joins them. Her recent tasks have mostly consisted of using She-Ra to rebuild, not to fight, but it's like muscle memory, right? Adora is pretty sure she still remembers how to fight, even if it has been over a decade of peace. Adora peers over the edge. It is similar to the Valley of the Lost, only there are visibly less houses, just a few tents down on the base, and some other structure that Adora has never seen before in her life.

There are a few suspended bridges, probably used by people to descend to the bottom of the deep cavern; Adora didn't have that issue.

"They're here?" Adora asks. DT nods their head. Adora looks back down into the cavern and then sighs. "Very well," She says. She grabs her sword from her waist and utters those words that turns her into the eight foot tall warrior She-Ra. She looks at DT once she's transformed and finds herself blushing a little when they seem to be blinking at her in surprise. They do a low wolf whistle and Adora scowls at them. "See you down there." That's all Adora says to them before she steps over the edge of the cavern.

Adora free falls for what feels like at least a few minutes but what is actually probably seconds. Her stomach bottoms out and she feels giddy as She-Ra glows, like a falling meteor. She lands on her knee, resting her hands on the hilt of her sword as it digs into the ground. You could call it somewhat of a superhero landing she supposes. Adora stands up straight and looks up at the top of the cavern. She's so far down now she can only make out the vague shadow of DT at the top. "Show off!" They yell down at her and Adora grins. It was somewhat of a showing off she supposes. DT will have to take the long way down.

The pros of getting down the way she did: it was fast and looked cool as hell. The cons: she was *loud* . She alerted everyone's presence in the cavern who quickly started exiting their tents if they weren't already standing around. They are clearly ex-Horde. They still have their uniforms, and their weapons, and Adora spots some of the old Horde robots standing around. There were a lot more of them than she was expecting, but they look… ragged. Not really much of a threat. Still, Adora won't underestimate people.

Adora is quickly surrounded by a circle of ex-Horde soldiers. Some look more unsure than others, some look pissed, some seem surprised, some look afraid. "Hi," Adora says lamely. "Looks like you are here…" Adora needs to keep them talking so she can give DT time to join her - though she's not really sure what DT can bring to this fight. "Uh… Why?"

"It's Lord Adora." She hears someone say as the circle breaks out into muttering chatter. She can only pick up a few sentences: "What do we do?" "Are we about to die?" "Where is the commander?" "She's so *big* ." Adora is thoroughly confused as she pulls her sword from the ground.

"Alright," Adora says. "You've had your fun. Time to disband this little… resistance and go back to living your lives."

“What lives?” A Horde soldier asks, stepping forward. “You abandoned us! Look at you! You’re just a Princess now.”

“I didn’t abandon you,” Adora responds, “I *made sure* the Rebellion would take care of you. I *made sure* you would all be provided for, and my wife even leads the effort to settle you all into Etheria as a whole. You are the ones who have chosen to band together and try to spring Shadow Weaver, of all people, out of prison. She’s the *worst* .”

“At least she will finish what Hordak started,” A soldier sneers. “Unlike you, who was too weak and surrendered just because a pretty Magicat Princess asked you to.”

“It certainly wasn’t like that,” Adora frowns.

“You forget that the Princess wasn’t exactly quiet, my Lord,” another soldier says. He seems less hostile, but still angry. “We all heard you. We know the only reason you surrendered was because you missed fucking your Magicat Princess.” Adora scoffs. She feels anger seize her as she steps towards the soldier. Everyone collectively takes a step back.

“Do you want to say that to me again?” Adora asks. Her voice is dangerous, there is a threat laced into her words, and she knows that the soldier can hear it. He apparently decides that provoking Adora further is a bad idea because he only looks away from her rather than responding. “You all know how I was after I impaled Catra with my sword,” Adora continues. “I was *devastated* , and Lonnie had told me that the Horde was tired of fighting. I surrendered so that we might have *lives* . Haven’t you ever thought about how we were orphans forced to fight in a war we wouldn’t have even been in if we hadn’t been made orphans by the same organisation that took us in to be their soldiers? Their *weapons* ? We had *no choice* but to do Hordak and Shadow Weaver’s bidding. We were raised to believe the Princesses were evil, but I had discovered that that was false. And I was leading you all, I had the opportunity to allow you all the privilege of free will. To allow you all lives that were not controlled by anyone but yourselves. To not fight in a pointless war we shouldn’t have been fighting in the first place. And you choose *this* ?” Adora gestures around. “I did not fail you. You failed yourselves.” The cavern falls silent. It was dark now, the light was turning silver from the moon rather than orange, and no one was saying anything in response to Adora’s words.

“You’re still a Princess sympathiser,” someone says and Adora sighs.

“So what if I am?” Adora asks. “The Princesses only wished to defend innocent people from the Evil Horde-”

“So now we’re evil?”

“No,” Adora answers. “I never said that. We were doing what we thought was *right* , but we had been horribly misled. Now we have the opportunity to do the right thing for real, armed with the full knowledge that was kept from us. So, I’m asking, is this really what you want? To free *Shadow Weaver* and try to wage another war on people who just want to exist without violence?” The soldiers seem to shrink a little at Adora’s words. She knows she wasn't exactly the best leader. She used to get angry often with her men, and she knows they used to be significantly afraid of her, but she’s always wanted the best for them. “Look, I don’t want to fight you,” Adora places her sword at her side. “Come back to the Fright Zone, I can help you, and Princess Scorpia would be happy to help too.” Adora is convinced that the soldiers seem to be considering her offer. They look at each other, and she can *feel* the energy shifting, but then, unfortunately, they are interrupted.

“Liar,” A deep rumbling voice interrupts. Adora turns towards that voice and comes face-to-face with a familiar person who was pushing his way through the gathered crowd. “You deserve to die for your weakness.”

“Grizzlor?” Adora asks in disbelief. An ex-Force Captain. This must be the Commander that her soldiers had mentioned before. Adora notices a few of the soldiers shuffling on their feet, she’s pretty sure she’s convinced at least some of them, but others draw closer to Grizzlor. “You’re behind this? Seriously?”

“What place do we have among *Princesses* ,” He spits. “We can’t change into shiny pretty Princesses. We will *never* be accepted. And why should we bow down to them? I refuse to be under the leadership of a bunch of spineless prissies.” Adora places her face in her hand, literally face-palming.

“You are so fucking stupid,” Adora says. “Why is it any different from being under my rule when I was Lord?”

“Because at least you were strong!” He yells. “At least you were standing up for something! At least you didn’t treat us like we were less because we weren’t Princesses. We can’t say the same now though can we?” He asks. Adora looks around. She can see the group splitting. Some are moving behind Adora while others are gravitating towards Grizzlor. Grizzlor is *big* , he’s one of the more scary Force Captains, but Adora is pretty confident she can beat him.

“I don’t think I’m above anyone,” Adora says, lifting her sword. “None of… Okay, *most of* the other Princesses don’t either. You’re making your lives more difficult. But I *will* stop you from releasing Shadow Weaver. I would rather die than let her out.”

“Then die,” Grizzlor says, and he pulls *two* swords out from behind him and lifts them. It’s pretty cool actually, but unfortunate for Adora. “Once we’re done with you, we’ll move onto your precious little family. It will be my pleasure to gu-” He doesn’t get to finish that sentence because Adora launches at him and punches his face.

Suddenly, fighting breaks out. The soldiers Adora had convinced previously turned against the other soldiers, allowing Adora to focus on Grizzlor. The dude is big, and if Scorpia is as strong as She-Ra, then she’s pretty sure this big guy is too. That isn’t going to stop her from making him eat dirt. Adora has no idea where Double Trouble is, but she hardly needs them to win this.

Adora lifts her sword as Grizzlor *growls* at her. “I’m going to make you regret that punch, *Lord* .”

“Oh goodie, you remember my title,” Adora says, spinning her sword in her hand a little. “Maybe it would do you some good to remember *why* I was Lord of the Horde.” Grizzlor apparently doesn’t think that’s a very good line because he rushes at her. Fighting a guy who can lift boulders in his spare time, and who is armed with *two* swords, isn’t exactly Adora’s *ideal* opponent.

Adora meets his double strike with her sword. There’s a loud sound as they clash together and Adora grunts with effort. She really wishes she was home babysitting now. She’s getting too old for this shit. Adora moves her blade, forcing Grizzlor to one side and to lose his balance, allowing Adora to sweep her blade around and disarm one sword from him. The thing flies from his grip, spears through the air and lands in the sand. There is a reason Adora

was one of the top cadets in the Horde. She knows how to fight, and she and Grizzlor have the same training. Adora finishes the move off by kicking him in his leg. That just pisses him off more.

He lets out an annoyed growl and then lunges at Adora again. Grizzlor is obviously used to fighting two-handed, his swings are just *off* . Adora almost wants to laugh. This is a cake-walk for She-Ra. Adora can't believe she spent so long being afraid of She-Ra, she is her greatest advantage in any battle.

They continue their little dance, Adora is confident she's going to kick this dude's ass but then she hears a soldier call out and suddenly Grizzlor has both of his blade's back again. "Oh *come on* ," Adora complains. Unfortunately for her, some soldiers decide to pitch in on their little one-on-one battle. Adora hears the familiar crackle of electricity come towards her and grabs a stun baton just before it touches her. The only issue? There is another soldier that gets her right on her thigh. The volts fire through her and the familiar burning is no less painful than Adora remembers from her Horde training days. She lets out a yelp and, to make matters worse, Grizzlor rushes her, thrusting one of his blades towards her. It *just* grazes her, but it draws blood nonetheless, cutting through the white material of She-Ra. The wound immediately heals, but it still stings.

Adora doesn't really have time to recover before she's hit by another baton and then Grizzlor's boot hits her chest. Adora is launched backwards, at least several feet. She smacks into a boulder, smashing the thing in half and knocks the wind out of her lungs for a good moment. "Ow," Adora mumbles.

"Mom!" Adora immediately looks in the direction of that voice. It can't be. No fucking way.

"Finn?" Adora asks with great confusion, standing up. She frowns. "I swear, If that's you, Double Trouble…"

"It's really me, mom," Finn says, "I… followed you. Sorry." They laugh a little. Adora is *horrified* . She feels She-Ra slip away, her form flickers a little and then suddenly she's her regular self. *Shit* .

"Why would you-" Adora doesn't get to finish her sentence because she gets a fist to the face. Grizzlor hits her right in the eye and it *hurts* , especially when she doesn't have her

magical healing. His sword is next. Adora reacts quickly, kicking him right in his groin. Maybe that's fighting dirty, Adora really doesn't give a shit right now. She has to get her *child* to safety. The dude reacts predictably, though Adora doesn't get away fully unscathed. She gets a sword to her leg.

"Son of a bitch," Adora curses as she limps away from a howling Grizzlor and towards Finn. She grabs them by their shoulder and steers them towards a nearby boulder. "What are you doing here, Finn?" Adora asks with alarm.

"You're hurt," They say, eyes on her leg.

"Flesh wound, I'll be fine," Adora says dismissively. She sees their ears twitch. She knows what that means. Catra's ears have done that exact thing before. Adora's head twists in the direction their ears point and she sees the green of a canon charging and then being fired. Adora quickly turns and shoves Finn to the ground, shielding them from the blast. She feels She-Ra now. She doesn't even use her sword, she just summons her. She feels her skin stitch together on her leg and her eye turns to a dull ache - for now, though she knows She-Ra's healing only goes so far. Adora is still going to feel this later.

The cannonball hits her back, but as She-Ra she is more than capable of taking the fire. When the dust clears, Finn blinks up at her. "Wow…" They say. Adora frowns.

"You are so grounded," Adora says as she hoists them up. She drags them behind a boulder, out of sight. "Stay here."

"I can help!" Finn protests.

"Absolutely not!" Adora yells. "Your mother will murder me. You are staying here. Out of sight. Do *not* try to fight. Do you understand?"

"But mom-!"

“No!” Adora shuts them down. “This is for your own safety. And mine. I can’t fight if I’m worried about you, okay? So please… Just stay here.” Finn’s ears press back and they get a look of shame on their face before they slowly nod. Adora sighs. She’ll talk to them later. She ruffles their hair and then jogs back out from behind the boulder, ready to rejoin the fight.

“I see your brat is here,” Grizzlor says, recovered from his injury apparently. “Saves me a trip.” Adora feels an anger that she has felt only a few times before. The night before she lost control of She-Ra and killed Hordak, and the night she almost killed Shadow Weaver. It burns right in her chest and she notices She-Ra starting to glow brightly. She is going to *murder* Grizzlor for threatening her family. Shadow Weaver used to chastise her for fighting angry. A level headed soldier is a much better one than a one clouded by emotion, but Adora could care less. She is *pissed* and Grizzlor is going to feel the full force of her rage.

Adora yells and launches her sword at Grizzlor. The thing *sings* through the air and his eyes widen before he just manages to duck out of the way. He looks behind him to see Adora’s sword stuck in one of the supply crates. “Sloppy work,” He says. “You gave away your weapon.”

“I’m going to tear you apart with my bare hands,” Adora says as she advances. Grizzlor takes a step back. Adora is *scaring* him. *Good* . She-Ra seems to be only growing more golden the angrier Adora gets. She catches her reflection in one of the supply crate’s shiny casing. She-Ra’s blue eyes are glowing bright, narrowed in anger, she looks like a shooting star, she's so golden, and her raw power is palpable. Adora feels out of control, yet also in. “Lets fuck him up,” Adora says to her refelction.

She rushes Grizzlor, tackling him to the ground. He goes for his swords but Adora grabs his wrists, bending them back with little to no effort. He lets out a pained screech. Adora doesn’t *care* . She meant it when she said she was going to murder this guy. Threaten her family, and Adora will kill you. Lesson learnt. With his hands out of commission Grizzlor tries to free himself by kicking Adora but she uses her boot, merely stepping on the guy’s ankle before it cracks under her foot. He lets out another screech. The fighting that had filled the cavern is now dead silent as they watch the brutal fight. She grabs him by his shirt. “I give up!” He yells. “Please! I’ll… I’ll leave you alone, I promise! Just let me live! Please, I beg you, Lord.” Adora smacks him right between his eyes with her fist and he crumples. His nose definitely looks broken and it’s bleeding.

“No mercy,” Adora says as she stands up straight. She moves to his head and then puts her boot to his throat. She presses, choking him. He claws at her ankle with his broken hands but Adora pays him no mind. She meant what she said, she really did. There was a damn reason

she was the Lord of the Horde, there was a reason people feared her. It's scary. Adora hasn't felt this way in a very long time, but her rage is also familiar. Just a little more pressure…

"Mom!" Adora feels a chill run down her spine at the voice. She looks up. They are indeed surrounded by a circle of Horde soldiers, all looking on in horror, but what really gets Adora is that Finn is standing on the inside, having pushed their way into the circle. "What are you doing?" Adora's boot doesn't move.

"Look away, Finn," Adora orders. She can't traumatise her kid. She has been a traumatised kid, she doesn't want that for her own children.

"You can't kill him," Finn insists.

"He threatened you! And Catra! And your siblings!" Adora yells, her boot pressing just that little bit harder. "Why shouldn't I?"

"Because you're better than this," Finn says. "Please. For me." It feels like a cheap shot if Adora is honest, but it does cause her to hesitate. Slowly, she pulls her boot off of Grizzlor's neck and he splutters, coughing harshly. Adora bends down beside him.

"You're going to a cell like Shadow Weaver," She says coldly. "Be glad I'm feeling generous, otherwise you'd be very dead right now." She stands back up. The ex-Horde soldiers all stare at her. "Let this be a lesson, if you fuck with me, or my family, if you threaten them, I *will* kill you. Finn won't be there to save you every time." They all look at each other and then drop to their knees. It's all very dramatic. They bow their heads. Adora would be lying if she said that she hadn't missed this feeling.

She closes her eyes and then transforms back to herself. Finn runs at her and hugs her, almost knocking the wind out of Adora from the force of their run. She wraps her arms around them. She was so happy they were okay. She can't tell if the trick they pulled was a Catra trick or her own. Finn looks a lot like Catra, but they're a lot like Adora personality wise.

One of the ex-Horde soldiers steps forward and they shift. "How nice of you to finally join," Adora says sarcastically. Finn still has their head buried in her waist.

“Oh darling, I’m an actor, not a fighter,” DT says.

“No shit,” Adora scoffs. “So, you have your Wastes back.”

“And I thank you for your service. I will repay you by ensuring this one makes his way to a deep dark prison cell.” Adora would be inclined to not trust DT, but they do always make good on their debts - plus, they like betting on the strongest horse, Adora is clearly the strongest horse. Making an enemy of Adora is not in their interest. Adora nods at them.

“We’re sorry, Lord Adora,” one of the soldiers says. “We won’t attack you again.” Adora sighs.

“If you want to stay in the Wastes, you’re welcome,” Adora says. “If you wish to return to the Fright Zone, to Princess Scorpia’s Kingdom, then I am sure she will be happy to help you all settle. If your desire is to settle in some remote village, or another Kingdom, then I can help you all. I thought you all would know me well enough to know that I wouldn’t just abandon you. I can *help* , so can Catra, that’s what she does.”

“We know… Thank you,” One says. The circle slowly disbands as the ex-Horde soldiers go to tend to their wounds before they move on with their lives. Adora is sure they’ll be getting calls for help later, but for now the fighting is just over.

Adora squeezes Finn and pulls them away from the crowd. “I’m… I’m really sorry that you had to see that,” Adora says quietly. “Please tell me I haven’t messed you up for the rest of your life?” Finn slowly looks up at her.

“It’s… strange,” they say. “I’ve never seen you look so… angry. I know you told me that you were Lord of the Horde, and all that other stuff, but… you’re just so laid back at home.” Adora smiles awkwardly and lays her hands on their shoulders, squeezing. “It’s just… weird, I guess. Jarring.”

“I’m sorry you had to see that,” Adora admits. “I… I was just afraid for you, and the rest of our family. I want to keep you all safe.” Finn looks up at Adora and then nods their head.

“I know,” they say. Adora smiles and Finn smiles back. They’d be okay.

Unfortunately, their moment is interrupted. “It looks to me that that strange contraption there is a ship,” DT says. Adora turns towards it.

“Maybe…” Adora admits. “I’ll have some people come move it. I’m sure Bow’s dads would like the opportunity to study it, but I really need to get home before it gets too late to try and minimise my wife’s anger.”

“Of course,” DT says, “wouldn’t want to anger Kitten.” Adora frowns when she hears DT call Catra ‘Kitten’ but decides she doesn’t have the energy to fight with them on it. She wraps her arms around Finn’s shoulders and directs them back towards the skiff.

“Say, Kiddo,” Adora says, “how exactly did you follow us?”

“Skiffs are pretty easy to use,” They answer. “I… May have borrowed one from home, waited until you and Double Trouble were mostly out of sight, and then followed after you from a distance.”

“Well, at least that means your mom can’t follow after us,” Adora says. She helps Finn up onto their skiff and begins to start it up. Now she just had to survive her wife’s disappointment.

* * *

When they finally arrive home it’s late. The night moon shines bright in the sky, but Etheria is mostly bathed in darkness save for the silver moonlight. When they arrive home, Adora immediately spots that there is a light on in the kitchen. That means Catra is probably awake and waiting. Adora parks up and then hops down off of the skiff, cursing a little when her leg

protests. She looks at Finn who was sitting on the edge of the skiff, their legs dangling over the edge. They had been quiet pretty much the entire trip home and Adora would be concerned if she didn't know they were just thinking.

"You ready, bud?" Adora asks, offering her hand to help them down. Finn looks at Adora's outstretched hand and then looks up at her face.

"Will mama be mad?" They ask. Adora sighs.

"Probably," She admits, lying to Finn is probably useless. "But she'll be mostly mad at me, so don't worry."

"I don't want her to be mad at you," Finn says, frowning.

"Hey, I'm a big girl," Adora insists, "Catra has been mad at me many times before and I've always managed to win her over, okay?" Adora smiles reassuringly at them. If she's honest, she has a feeling Catra is going to be *really* mad at her, but not mad enough to cause anxiety for their kid. Finn smiles shyly back and takes Adora's hand, hopping the short distance down from the skiff.

"Okay, mom," They say as they begin to walk towards the house. Adora follows after them and then takes the lead. She's the first to open the door and she is immediately greeted by Catra who is standing by the kitchen island, hands crossed over her chest and a deep set frown on her face. As soon as she hears the door open, her ears perk up and her tail starts swishing in the way that it does when she's pissed off.

"Mama-" Finn starts but they are quickly cut off by Catra grabbing hold of their face as she inspects them. Finn has already outgrown Catra, so Catra has to pull them down to fully inspect them. "I'm fine!" Finn insists as Catra closely examines them. "Not a scratch. Mom made sure of that." Catra reluctantly releases them.

"Saying you're fine is Adora's line," Catra says. She hasn't looked at Adora *once* and Adora is a little worried by that fact. "Finn, please go to your room."

“But-”

“ *Now* .” Catra orders, but she doesn’t yell. Catra never yells at their kids, neither of them do, they believe in communicating appropriately, or removing yourself from a situation to cool down before discussing it again. That’s with their children though, Adora is a little worried Catra is going to club her around the head for being such an idiot. Finn looks at Adora and she gives them a nod, telling them that it was okay, and they seem to hesitate before following Catra’s order.

Adora listens to Finn's receding footfalls and then she looks at her wife's disapproving glare - at least now she’s looking at her. "Catra, not now, please," Adora says as she walks into the kitchen. She heads straight for the freezer, pulling out a bag of frozen peas to ice her aching injuries. She-Ra healed her, mostly, but she still had the residual aches - not to mention the hits she took as her regular self.

"No, we're going to talk about this now," Catra says, following after her. Adora sighs as she makes her way into the living room, groaning as she collapses into her armchair.

"Look, they followed me. By the time I knew they were there, it was too late," Adora says as she places the peas onto her eye, sighing happily at the cooling sensation. "I protected them. They're okay."

"And what about you?" Catra asks, sitting down in front of Adora. "You're banged up."

"I've had worse," Adora says dismissively. "Nothing a little rest can't fix."

"You're going to get yourself killed, Adora."

"I-"

"Shut up and let me be mad at you right now," Catra cuts in. Adora promptly shuts her mouth. She'll let her wife be mad at her for now and defend her actions later. She can tell Catra needs to get this off her chest.

Catra takes the frozen peas from Adora and leans in to hold it to Adora's eye instead. Adora sighs thankfully, allowing her wife to treat her injuries - her arm was starting to ache anyway. "You have to stop running off into danger. I don't care if someone needs your help. You tell someone. You tell *me* . You don't go off alone without telling anyone where the hell you're going, without backup, and fucking DT does not count as backup. I'm surprised they didn't sell you out to the Waste's criminals," Catra scolds. "You're not a lone wolf here, Adora. Not everything is your responsibility to do alone. We're *partners* . We do things *together* , or we don't do them at all. What if you had gotten seriously hurt today? I had no idea where you were. And Finn was missing, following after you, think of what you're teaching them by running head first into danger. I love you, I love you so much, but sometimes you seriously don't think." Catra takes a breath. It stings for Adora to hear this, she can feel herself starting to cry a little. She hates letting people down, she detests it, but it hurts so much more that she knows she's disappointed *Catra* . "Just... I don't want to lose you, Dummy."

"I'm sorry, Catra..." Adora whispers, breathless. "I'm so sorry..." Catra finally looks her in her eyes and Adora sees not disappointment, surprisingly, but fear. She had scared Catra today. "I promise that if I plan on doing something dangerous and stupid again, I'll bring you with me." That gets Catra to laugh, at least a little.

"That's all I ask," she says quietly.

They fall into silence. Adora is the luckiest woman alive. Catra moves the frozen peas to where Adora instructs her and they just bask in each other's company. That's when Adora notices the pillow and quilt cover on the couch. She looks between that and Catra. "Is that what I think it is?" Adora asks.

"Yup," Catra answers. "Your ass is sleeping on the couch until I'm not mad at you anymore."

"What?" Adora asks, barely resisting the urge to pout. "I can't sleep if I'm not cuddling you."

"Should have thought about that before you ran off alone," Catra comments. "Did we or did we not have this exact conversation before you left for Beast Island?" Catra asks. "This is

your punishment."

"It's cruel."

"So is you making me worry for several hours with no way to know if you're alive or dead in a ditch," Catra snaps back. That is fair, so Adora concedes defeat to the couch and Catra. She really hates sleeping on that thing though, and she hasn't slept without Catra in such a long time. Alas, this is her fate.

"I love you too," Adora says after a moment. Catra removes the peas and looks at Adora.

"I know you do, which almost makes this worse," she stands up and goes to the kitchen. The peas had started to melt so Adora knew they were losing their magic touch. Catra returns with a glass of water and some pills that Adora recognised as painkillers. She accepts them gratefully and guzzles down the water. "Stand up, Dummy," Catra orders once Adora is done and Adora follows her instruction.

When Adora is on her feet, Catra moves her hands to the bottom of Adora's shirt. She gently pulls it out from being tucked into her pants and runs her fingers along Adora's toned abdominal muscles. Adora swallows. Catra is undressing her, and she probably isn't intending for it to be sensual but it is all the same - or maybe that is exactly what Catra intends and she's punishing Adora by making her horny but not going any further. Catra hands trail up Adora's back and Catra's hands are *warm* and make Adora shudder. Adora lifts her arms and allows Catra to take her shirt off so she's in only her pants and sports bra. Catra turns her around and it's then that Adora realises what Catra is doing: she's searching for injuries.

"Take your bra off," Catra instructs. Adora has no qualms being naked in Catra's presence, and she's already managed to piss Catra off, so she thinks maybe just following her instructions is the best way to go. Adora grabs it by the hem and then pulls it up and over her head. She hears Catra gasp softly behind her and she smiles a touch. She does like that Catra still finds her muscles so impressive even after all these years. Catra's hand comes up to trail over Adora's broad shoulder blades. "At least you're actually fine."

"She-Ra heals," Adora reminds her, her back still to Catra. "You don't want to check my boobs out?"

“She-Ra heals,” Catra repeats. “Your attempt to get me to see your boobs is noted though.” Catra hands her a t-shirt over her shoulder and Adora accepts it. She pulls it on and then turns back to face her wife.

“Pants,” Catra orders.

“Is this some kind of punishment?” Adora asks as she unbuttons her pants. “Make me undress, and make me super horny, but have nothing happen?” Catra rolls her eyes.

“Just take your pants off, Idiot,” Catra says. Adora laughs a little as she steps out of her pants. Catra examines her legs for a moment before she hands Adora some shorts to wear. “Good. Now, goodnight.” Catra turns to go upstairs and Adora quickly grabs Catra’s hand.

“No goodnight kiss?” Adora asks - she knows she is definitely pouting this time.

“No, go to sleep, Adora,” Catra replies. Adora’s head drops and she hangs it in disappointment. She lets go of Catra’s hand.

“Oh,” is all Adora can really bring herself to say. Her sulking must get to Catra because she silently reaches over, lifts Adora’s head, plants a quick kiss on her lips and then starts heading up the stairs again. Adora smiles a little at the gesture. Maybe Catra was mad at her, and maybe Adora was going to have to work for that forgiveness, but at least Catra still loved her.

They’d be okay.

* * *

“What are you wearing and why are you holding a chicken?” These were words that Adora had never anticipated her wife saying to her and yet here she was. Adora was in their kitchen dressed in overalls and an old t-shirt. Her overalls were tucked into her rubber boots to

protect her somewhat from getting them extensively dirty. Adora grins, Catra just looks unamused to have a live chicken in their home.

“I wanted to start a little farm,” Adora says, “chickens seem like the obvious first choice. I’m building a coup outside. We can have fresh eggs, and… whatever else chickens do. Plus they’re cute, lookit!” Adora holds the chicken up, which was a lot more impressive in her head.

“I don’t want poultry in my kitchen, Adora,” Catra says. “Take them back outside.”

“I will, in a moment,” Adora says as she places the chicken down on the floor. It just stands there making chicken noises (you know, the noises chickens make). Adora looks at her wife who raises an eyebrow at her as she sips her tea.

“We have children,” she points out.

“Chickens don’t have diseases,” Adora responds, “I think…”

“Adora,” Catra just lets out a long sigh rather than finishing that sentence. Adora waves her hand.

“I just came in to grab some stuff, I’ll take them back out with me when I go out.”

“Where are the other chickens?”

“Outside.”

“So why did you bring this one in?”

“Honestly, I didn’t think you’d be in the kitchen,” Adora smiles sheepishly. Catra just gives her a look. “... Have I made you more mad with me?”

“Just get the chicken out of my kitchen,” Catra says as she walks out of the kitchen with her tea. Disappearing to probably go back to working while also watching their little beans.

Adora lets out a heavy sigh. “Well, Feathers, it seems my wife is still holding a grudge,” she says as she goes to the fridge and retrieves a bottle of water. “I bet she secretly loves you, but she can’t admit that when she’s supposed to be mad at me.”

"Mom," Adora startles a little when she hears Finn say her name. "Is mama still mad at you?" They ask. They sound guilty, as though it's their fault. Maybe Finn is a lot more like Adora than she thought.

Adora slowly closes the fridge and then turns towards Finn’s voice. She's about to reassure Finn about it not being their fault, but her words die in her throat and she only manages a jumble of vowels before they stop abruptly. Finn had been complaining about their hair getting lengthy, Adora figured Catra might cut it for them, but what she sees is not just a new haircut, which looks cool as heck if you ask Adora, it's shaved at the side in an undercut while still pretty lengthy at the other side and behind, but that's not what has Adora stopping in her tracks, or what has her close to tears. No, it's the fact that Finn's usual brown hair is now *blonde* , just like Adora's. "You- Your... Your hair..." Finn lifts their hand, brushing some of the longer strands through their fingers.

"Oh, yeah, mama cut it. Do you like it?" Finn asks. They look... nervous. Adora knows that they know that she definitely wasn't talking about the cut of their hair.

"You dyed it blonde?" Adora asks, blinking. "I... why?" Finn really looks nervous now. Adora doesn't mean to do that, she's just... stunned. They start to do that thing that Catra also does when she's nervous, where they grab hold of their bicep and rub it.

"I wanted..." They trail off. "I want to be more like you." They say. "I love you… Everyone says I’m like you, but that I look like mama. I just… wanted to be closer to you.” Adora feels like she might cry if she’s honest. She removes the gloves she was wearing and walks over to Finn. She rests her hands on their shoulders and squeezes.

“I’m honoured,” Adora says, her voice thick. Why is this making her so emotional? Maybe a part of her was worried that Finn might see her differently after seeing more of her Lord personality and past, but it’s the opposite. Finn loves her all the same. Adora clears her throat and wipes her face. “I love you too, Kiddo,” she says, “how about you help me with these chickens?”

“I did wonder why there was a chicken in here,” they comment with a laugh. Adora laughs too.

“Alright, lets get you some clothes that can get dirty or Catra will want to murder me more.”

* * *

Catra pauses in their living room. Sometimes she's struck with such love in her heart it's almost overwhelming. Adora is just sitting on the couch, the twins either side of her with Calamity on her shoulders as she reads a bedtime story to them. Catra’s babies are adorable, and they're listening intently to what Adora is reading even if they don't fully understand what it is she's saying.

"What?" Catra blinks, so distracted by the love in her heart that she hadn't noticed that Adora had stopped reading and she had the eyes of her kids and her wife on her.

"What?" Catra asks, blushing a little. Her kittens are all blinking up at her, not to mention the small smirk on her wife's face.

"You were staring," Adora states. She closes the book and turns to their kids. "Alright, little ones, that's enough for tonight. Go on and brush your teeth." The twins are big enough now to make it up and down the stairs unaided and they hop off the couch to go do just as Adora ordered, Calamity is a little smaller and she stays seated on Adora’s shoulders. “Does this mean you’re less mad at me now?” Adora asks. Catra huffs.

“Don’t push your luck,” Catra responds. “Why don’t you sleep in our bed tonight? I’ll take the couch, I know it's hurting your back.” Adora looks disappointed but nods.

“Let me put these ones to bed,” she says as she stands up, Cal still on her shoulders. Catra watches them go. *Goddammit* . Adora was right. It did mean she was less mad at her. Catra groans as she places the basket of laundry down. Still, she wasn’t going to let Adora be all smug about that.

Catra listens to her wife as she helps their kids get ready for bed and then she heads to shower herself. She waits until she’s sure that Adora is in bed, and possibly even falling asleep, before she admits defeat and heads up the stairs herself. She has missed getting to sleep with Adora. She’s missed her dearly. So maybe she’s giving in, but it was bound to happen at some point anyway.

Catra silently slips into their sheets, not saying a word to Adora. It takes Adora a moment, but she eventually turns and wraps her arms around Catra, spooning Catra from behind. Catra sighs, leaning into the warmth of her wife. "Welcome back," Adora whispers.

"Shut up," Catra whispers back. She feels Adora’s breath tickle her neck as she laughs.

"Does this mean you forgive me?"

"It means stop being an idiot that's trying to make me a widow," Catra fires back. There’s no response to those words for some time, and Catra thinks maybe she’s managed to silence Adora for once. Only that is quickly proven false.

“I love you, Catra,” Adora whispers. Catra turns and lifts her hands up to gently hold Adora’s face in her hands. “I’m not going anywhere, promise.”

“I hope you keep your promises,” Catra comments. “I just wish… You don’t have to prove anything to anyone, Adora. You certainly don’t have to get yourself killed to prove yourself.” Catra can make out her wife’s features in the dark. Adora is beautiful. Sometimes it hits Catra square in her chest just how pretty Adora really is, and looking at her now, even in the dark, she thinks she may have married a goddess. “I love you, Idiot,” Catra says back. Adora

laughs at that. Her warm breath caresses Catra's face and she sees her lopsided smile bright as always in the dark.

"Calling me an idiot? Wow, you really do forgive me," Adora says. Catra smacks her forehead and receives an exaggerated 'ow' from Adora in response.

"I'm serious." Catra deadpans. "Don't pull anything like that again." Catra squeaks a little as Adora decides to pin her to the mattress in response.

"Maybe I can pull something else?" Adora asks in that suggestive tone that tells Catra she's trying to make something horny - not to mention the eyebrow wiggles that Catra makes out.

"Your lines are the worst, it's a wonder I decided to sleep with you all those years ago," Catra responds. "Don't you have to be up early to tend to your chickens?" Adora smiles brightly and then it slowly falls away into a more serious expression. Catra reaches her hands up, holding Adora's face in her hands.

"Can I tell you something?" Adora asks quietly. Catra leans up and places a quick loving peck to her wife's lips.

"Always," Catra responds. And she means that wholeheartedly. Adora can *always* come to her, with whatever it is that she needs help with. Adora smiles softly and then sighs.

"I feel… guilty," She confesses. "I spent so long hurting people… I know you say I don't have to prove myself to anyone, and I certainly don't have to die to prove myself to anyone, but… I feel like I do." She leans back from Catra and Catra immediately misses her warmth. Catra sits up too so she can continue to look at her wife. "I feel… a sense of urgency, *always* . When I'm not doing things, I feel like I *should* be. I always feel like I should be doing *something* , and I do want to prove myself to people, even at a risk to my own health." Catra sighs softly.

"Shadow Weaver," Catra says quietly. Adora nods.

“She used to say I was special,” Adora whispers, “but only if I obeyed her. Only if I was exceptional at *everything* .”

“Willing to die for your mission?” Catra asks and Adora slowly nods again.

“I feel like I’m not doing enough if I don’t,” She confesses. “I really do want to help people. I guess self-preservation is just low on my list of priorities.”

“Well it’s high on mine,” Catra says. She almost snaps, but she *needs* Adora to know how important it is that she *lives* . “And for your children.”

“I know,” Adora leans forward until their foreheads press against each other. Catra stays there for a moment before she moves her head back and gently bumps their noses together in a soft nuzzle. “I’m working on it.”

“Just take me with you the next time you go on some dangerous mission,” Catra says. “I’ll make sure your ass stays safe.”

“My ass specifically?” Adora asks, a playful lilt to her tone. Catra rolls her eyes.

“Well… It *is* a very nice ass.”

“Thank you,” Adora responds, grinning. They enjoy a quiet moment, just leaning against each other. Catra closes her eyes. Adora is her soulmate. In so many ways. They were always meant to find each other. Catra is convinced that if there is such a thing as a multiverse, in every single universe it is her and Adora, always, they are meant to be together. “Want to see something?” Adora asks, interrupting Catra’s thoughts.

“Right now?” Catra asks, raising an eyebrow.

“Our kids are sleeping, and we can bring the monitor,” Adora says as she stands.

“I’m not exactly dressed for an adventure right now, Adora,” Catra points out.

“Just throw some pants on and come with me,” Adora offers her hand. Catra hesitates, but she already knows she’ll accept it. She will follow Adora into oblivion. Catra gives her wife a look and then places her hand in Adora’s. She takes a moment to observe their hand as Adora gently wraps her hand around Catra’s, their rings on their fingers next to each other. Their rings really were a symbol of their never-ending love.

Adora pulls Catra up out of bed. Catra is already wearing one of Adora’s shirts - they’re comfy, and they’re *big* on her which makes them nice to sleep in. She throws on some of Adora’s sweatpants to boot and notices Adora smirking a little. “What?” Catra asks as she picks up the nearby monitor. It was mostly for Calamity, the others were fine, and they’d probably let Finn know they were popping out. They were perfectly capable of handling anything for their siblings in their moms’ absence, though Catra wasn’t expecting them to be gone long.

“Nothing,” Adora responds. Adora, unfortunately for Catra, because her wife is *hot* , is wearing a tank top and shorts. She looks like a dad honestly, Catra is half convinced she gets fashion advice from Micah. Adora takes Catra’s hand again and they make their way out of the house. They do inform Finn of them leaving just so they were aware, but the kids are pretty good sleepers and Catra doubted they would wake up unless one had a nightmare.

They make their way through the Whispering Woods. It’s a pretty peaceful night, all things considered. Sometimes the Whispering Woods have scary creatures around, but since they lived there they haven’t really had many problems with it. Catra recognises where they’re going pretty quickly. Her wife takes her sword out and uses it to light their path. “Why are we doing this past midnight?” Catra questions as she falls into step beside Adora.

“Well, you only just started talking to me properly again,” Adora responds. Catra rolls her eyes at that but doesn’t say anything more. At least it’s a nice night. Catra lifts her head a little when a gentle breeze hits her. Maybe she can understand why people go on midnight walks.

Eventually, they make it to where they’re going. It’s the clearing where Bow’s dads live, their big library/house stands in the middle of the woods, but what’s new is the structure in the

middle of the clearing. “What… is that?” Catra asks as she looks up at it.

“We found it when we went to the Wastes,” Adora explains. “Bow has been working on it, with Entrapta, to see if they can find anything, there is something.” Adora offers her hand and Catra takes it. Her wife leads her towards the structure that she now realises is a ship. They walk up the metal door and onto the ship. Adora leads her into what looks like the control room.

“Wow…” Catra says as she looks around. Her hand trails over the seat in the centre of the room. Like a captain’s chair. She then drifts over to the panel of buttons and shapes and then looks out of the windows at the woods outside. It’s pretty.

Adora stands up beside her and then takes her sword out, she inserts the blade into a slot and then turns it. Catra hears speaking and turns. It’s a hologram, a message, with some woman sitting in the seat speaking. Catra hears her say Adora’s name. It looks… pretty horrible whatever is happening. “It’s kind of corrupted,” Adora says, “Bow and Entrapta are working on it, and I’m not sure what it fully means, but… It’s Mara, Catra.” Adora looks at her wife. Catra blinks in amazement. Mara. The last She-Ra. The woman their daughter is named after.

“What does this mean?” Catra asks.

“Not sure yet,” Adora admits. “I’m going to take it slow, but it’s clear she was afraid.” The hologram stops with Mara looking up from her seat, eyes wide. “She’s pretty, right?”

“Should I be jealous?” Catra asks, nudging Adora’s shoulder. Adora smiles a little.

“No one is as pretty as my wife.”

“Damn right,” Catra says. Adora turns to her and Catra slowly takes her eyes off of the hologram to face her wife too.

“You said I should tell you if I’m planning on doing anything,” Adora says, “so we can do it together? What about this?” Catra looks at the hologram and then Adora.

“I’m with you,” Catra says. They both reach for each other’s hand at the same time and move closer to each other. “Together.”

“I love you,” Adora says, smiling. Catra appreciates how pretty her wife is for a moment before she stands on her tiptoes to kiss her.

“I love you too, Dummy,” she says. “You and me at the end of the world, right?”

“You are my world.”

“Sap,” Catra says, shoving Adora a little. She looks back at the hologram. “Maybe we should just keep trying to construct the past before we try to do anything. Knowledge is power.”

“Nerd,” Adora comments. She walks back to the console and removes her sword. “But I agree. Especially for the sake of our children. I don’t feel like bringing a war into their lives, or whatever it was that Mara was resisting. It seems… intense.”

“No kidding,” Catra comments. “So, shall we?”

“Home,” Adora says, taking her wife’s hand. “Let's go home.” Catra smiles. They could figure all of this out later. Right now, she just wanted to snuggle her wife.

Chapter End Notes

Again, sorry this took so long but things have been hectic and I'll be starting my Masters in about 2 weeks. However, you'll all be happy to know that next chapter is written and ready to be uploaded next Friday. Thank you for all your patience with these final two chapters, there are some really nice lines in this chapter that I particularly enjoyed :) I

hope you all enjoyed too, and I'll see you next Friday with the final chapter of Lord Adora <3 - S

As S said, thank you for being patient with us. Both S and I have been going through hectic times in our lives and it took quite a while to piece the ending together from the bits that were previously written. We hope that you enjoy it and I look forward to hopefully seeing reactions for the final chapter next week :) -M

Find us on twitter @ceolordadora and me (S) on tumblr @sherasswords

Epilogue III: Princess Prom 2.0

Chapter Summary

> “Your plan was to kidnap me, have sex with me, send me back to the Rebellion, have sex with me several times after that, make me fall in love with you, you fall in love with me, conclude the war, impregnate me with four of your children and marry me?” Catra asks, raising an eyebrow.
>
> “And what a masterful plan it was,” Adora responds. This time Catra actually does smack Adora upside her head.

Chapter Notes

> Alright! After such a wait, here is the final chapter to Lord Adora. Sad that she's ending, but all good things must come to an end. I hope you all enjoy this conclusion to this *very* long fic, and thank you for all your support.
>
> I just want to say, I see no value in repeating events from the show. If you're reading this, in all likelihood, you've seen the show. You know what happens. This fic is about Catra and Adora's characters, what they mean to each other, and what they mean to themselves, and I think this brings a satisfying conclusion to those. I thank you all for reading.

See the end of the chapter for more notes

Catra sighs as she carefully rolls the sleeves up on her shirt. She examines herself in the mirror as she does so. Catra was dressed in black pants with golden stripes along the sides, she was wearing a lowly buttoned up red shirt and her white and gold blazer jacket sits on their bed. Catra smiles a little. The colours of She-Ra, her and her wife would be matching tonight. Speaking of, Adora was currently in the bathroom, getting ready, while Catra waited in the bedroom. She turns when she hears the bathroom door creak open.

Adora steps out of the bathroom dressed in a long white and gold dress. She looks awkward, fiddling with the fabric between her thumb and finger. Catra just stares at her, completely floored by how gorgeous her wife looks. She has never seen Adora wear a dress before and, while she thinks her wife always looks *incredible* , something about this is… phenomenal. Maybe because Catra knows that Adora had been unsure about it. She had said that dresses weirdly made her feel vulnerable. "I look stupid... I should change," Adora says after a

moment when Catra doesn’t say anything - she was far too distracted by staring at her gorgeous wife.

"No!" Catra quickly exclaims, halting Adora in her steps. "No. You don't look stupid," Catra says, crossing over to Adora. She takes her hands in her own and kisses her knuckles softly. "You look incredible." When Catra looks up at her, Adora is blushing. Adora had confessed quietly to Catra that she wanted to try wearing a dress, and Catra had only encouraged her. Things like this were probably way out of a Horde soldier's comfort zone, even though Adora hadn't been one for many years, Catra knows that wearing a dress is a big deal for Adora. Hell, even Catra finds dresses uncomfortable.

Adora drops Catra’s hands and walks towards the full length mirror. Catra trails after her. She can see Adora checking herself out, and Catra wraps her arms around her waist, kissing her shoulder blade gently. It’s a little awkward, because Adora is so much taller than Catra, but Catra catches Adora smiling softly in the reflection of the mirror. "I feel... pretty," Adora confesses in a whisper. Catra smiles.

"You are," Catra whispers back. "You're beautiful. My beautiful wife." Catra sees Adora roll her eyes but her smile and blush tells Catra all she needs to know.

"You can see my scars," Adora says. That's true, the dress has a low back, and you can see the many scars Adora has gotten over the years, particularly the ones inflicted by Shadow Weaver, and the ones on her biceps thanks to the sleeveless design. Catra kisses them, tightening her arms around Adora.

"You look *perfect* , Adora," Catra whispers against her skin. Adora rolls her eyes and turns around.

“Perfect? No,” she says, kissing Catra on her lips. “You on the other hand.” Catra is tempted to kick her in the shin for that. They both know neither are perfect, no one can truly be perfect, but to each other, they are perfection. And that’s what love is. Finding perfection in the imperfect. “We’re getting old,” Adora notes as she moves to the bed and picks up Catra’s jacket. Catra can’t disagree with that statement.

“Forty-two is hardly old,” Catra says, nudging her wife with her hip - even if Adora is technically forty-three.

“Finn is twenty years old… that’s kind of terrifying,” Adora confesses. “And our other kids, the twins are ten, and Calamity is almost seven. They’re getting older.” Catra smiles.

“They’re certainly getting bigger,” Catra says as she accepts her jacket from her wife. Honestly? Adora has become more beautiful with age. She has lines around her eyes from years of smiling and *happiness* . Her blonde hair has only touches of silver, age has made her features almost more pretty and Catra swears her blue eyes are still the same blue of a clear sunny day.

“Soon it’ll just be me and you again,” Adora comments. “How ever will you cope with just me?” Catra shakes her head fondly.

“Shut up, Idiot,” Catra says as she rests her jacket on her shoulder. “Come on, we’ll be late,” Catra extends her hand and Adora’s hand falls easily into it. Adora’s dress swishes a little as they sweep out of their bedroom and downstairs where they could hear their children talking.

“Mama,” Finn says as they come into view. “Please tell Calamity they can’t wear that to a *ball* .” Catra’s eyes move over to Calamity who was dressed in their usual overalls, stained with oil, and gods knows what else, as well as their goggles. They really were taking after Entrapta. Catra looks at Adora who shrugs a little.

“I’m sure it’ll be fine,” Adora says, ruffling Finn’s hair. Despite them now being an adult, Adora still does that. Finn grumbles and fixes their hair. That’s when Adora pauses. Catra’s ears twitch a little. “Are you wearing my old cape?” Adora asks. Catra’s eyes moved back to Finn, and, sure enough, they were wearing a red cape.

“Uh, yeah,” they say, “I just removed the Horde symbol. Is that okay?” Adora smiles.

“I’m glad she’s having a second life,” Adora says fondly. “Damn that cape still looks cool, right Catra?”

“You always looked like a dork to me,” Catra says as she moves over to the twins who were fighting. Catra separates them and smiles at Mara as she goes back to reading her history book.

“I was thinking of turning it into something else later, like a bandana,” Finn says. Catra walks over to her wife and oldest child. They had outgrown Catra a while ago, and they’d even outgrown Adora by a couple of inches. Adora said it was ‘She-Ra genes’ which Catra told her was ridiculous. “But we really need to get going or we’ll be late.”

“Yes we do,” Catra says, “Scorpia will kill us if we’re late to the first Princess Prom she’s hosting.” Technically, they had been considering holding it ten years previously, but they’d decided to let Memrista host that ball to give Scorpia and the Fright Zone ample time to complete their remodelling and building. Adora and Catra had not attended that Princess Prom, Catra still hadn’t totally felt comfortable, but this was a big deal for Scorpia, and Scorpia was important to both Adora and Catra. Plus, their kids really wanted to go to a huge party, who could blame them?

“I’ll wrangle the twins, you get Calamity,” Adora says as she heads over to Cyrus and Mara who were once again bickering. It was a twin thing. Catra moves to Calamity and hands them their little cube puzzle they loved so much before she holds her hand out for them. Calamity happily comes along and they all make their way to the skiff. Catra catches Adora’s eyes and both of them are shiny with love. This is their family. And they’re happy.

* * *

Catra is watching her wife and Calamity on the dance floor. Adora is telling Calamity something, probably telling them that they’re doing a good job and how to dance. Calamity has their feet on Adora’s and Adora is happily letting them dance on her feet so they are in perfect time with each other. It is adorably cute, and Catra feels her heart swell in pure happiness. Her eyes move a few inches over and she sees Finn dancing with Flora, blushing softly. Catra feels herself smile more. Finn has had an obvious crush on Flora, Scorpia and Perfuma’s kid, for a while now. Catra and Adora even tried to orchestrate a date for them by dropping subtle hints at a dinner they had invited Scorpia, Perfuma and Flora to. Unfortunately, Finn had not liked that so much. Seems they were making progress towards confession now though.

Catra looks around. The Fright Zone has pretty much completely changed since the last time Catra had seen it. The ball was being held in Horror Hall, the old throne room of the Scorpions. Some of the old architecture had been restored, including an old mural of Scorpia's family. It was nice that Scorpia's history hadn't been totally destroyed by the Horde. The Hall was decorated with flowers, thanks to Perfuma, and there was plenty of food on offer. It has been a nice evening so far. Bow and Glimmer were slow dancing together. Bow was the King of Bright Moon now ever since Angella stepped down to allow Glimmer to become Queen. They had two kids that were getting up to mischief with Cyrus probably. Catra could see Mara in a corner reading. She liked to keep to herself and read, Catra wasn't about forcing her children to socialise, or do anything really, if they didn't want to do that.

Catra's thoughts are interrupted when Adora is suddenly in front of her. Catra smiles up at her wife. There is a certain amount of deja vu with this. It reminds Catra of when they were in their early twenties, enemies, yet having an intense moment on the dance floor of a different Princess Prom. "May I have this dance?" Adora asks, her face is wide with a grin and Catra knows that Adora is feeling it too.

"I thought you'd never ask," Catra retorts as she takes Adora's hand. Adora's smile only grows. She leads Catra out onto the dance floor and they face each other. Adora's eyes scan behind Catra and she lets out a soft chuckle. Catra looks over her shoulder to see Cyrus and Calamity eating food in a very unseemly manner - when had Mara put her book down?

"They are definitely my kids," Adora comments.

"As if there was any doubt?" Catra asks, turning back to her wife. The music begins playing and both raise their hands. They hold them inches apart from each other, placing one arm behind their backs as they circle each other.

"This brings me back," Adora says as they step in towards each other, twirling closely together.

"Back to when you were a little shit?" Catra asks, raising an eyebrow. "And kidnapped me?"

"I just swept you away, that's all," Adora says, grinning. Catra rolls her eyes.

“You make it sound a lot more romantic than it actually was,” Catra points out. Adora just wiggles her eyebrows in that stupid way she does sometimes. Dork. “I suppose it did eventually end up being romantic.”

“Exactly,” Adora says. She finally takes Catra’s hands and moves her closer to her. Now they’re not really dancing, they’re just swaying to music and moving slowly. Catra can’t help the smile that falls on her face as she dances close to her big hearted wife. Catra can’t imagine her life without Adora. Part of her can hardly believe that Adora used to be the Lord of the Horde, she’s far too soft hearted for that to feel real. “You gave birth to four of my babies.”

“Don’t remind me,” Catra teases. “You’re welcome.” Adora smiles brightly at that.

“Lucky for you, I’m not planning on blowing up this castle tonight, or kidnapping you,” Adora says.

“I still don’t know how you came up with that plan,” Catra comments. Adora hums thoughtfully.

“Truthfully, I wanted to outsmart you, at least once,” Adora admits. “You’ve always been the tactician, your skills are… impressive, but at that time I was frustrated that you kept winning. I just wanted to wipe that stupid smug expression off your face, I wanted to make you look like you’d been caught with your pants around your ankles. Pretty foolish of Princess Frosta to extend invitations to Scorpia and I, even if we were technically Princesses. She probably should have known we were going to try something.”

“I tried to warn her at the dance,” Catra interrupts. “I knew you were planning something, I just didn’t know what.”

“Man, I loved seeing how surprised you were when I had managed to fool you,” Adora says wistfully. “You totally didn’t see the bombs or Scorpia coming.”

“Okay,” Catra says, shaking her head. “No need to get a boner over your past evil atrocities, Adora.” Adora rolls her eyes.

“You’re just mad I actually managed to beat you for once.”

“I wouldn’t consider that a win when only a few hours later you were railing me on your throne and I was going home forty-eight hours later.”

“That is a massive win for me,” Adora says, her grin moving from smug to downright shit-eating. Catra just shakes her head and has the desire to smack Adora upside the head for being such an idiot (affectionately, of course). “And now you’re married to me. Maybe that was my plan all along.”

“Your plan was to kidnap me, have sex with me, send me back to the Rebellion, have sex with me several times after that, make me fall in love with you, you fall in love with me, conclude the war, impregnate me with four of your children and marry me?” Catra asks, raising an eyebrow.

“And what a masterful plan it was,” Adora responds. This time Catra actually does smack Adora upside her head. Adora only smiles at her. Catra rolls her eyes. She leans in and rests her head on Adora’s chest, swaying slowly from side to side.

"Catra," Adora suddenly says. It's Adora’s serious voice, the voice she uses when she means what she's about to say. Catra leans back from her position of leaning her head against her wife's chest. "I'm about to say the sappiest shit I've ever said in my whole life," Adora admits, "but please listen." Catra slowly nods, she wraps her arms around Adora’s neck and places her hand to the back of her neck, gently stroking her with her thumb. Adora takes a deep breath. "I've never ever felt this way about someone in my entire life," She confesses quietly. Catra wants to tell her that Adora has told her that many times before, this isn't anything new, but she doesn't want to interrupt the blonde. "I know I've said you're my soulmate, and you are, but... it really is like we're one. Catra, if you died, if you didn't exist, my life would be a miserable existence. I will die for you, I will live for you, I will do anything for you. You and I forever, beyond forever, for an eternity, my soul will find yours always. I will rest easily beside you when my life leaves me." Catra opens her mouth to say something, but Adora gently shushes her. “In many ways, I think I was always meant to be your wife. And I know some people may think I’m being dramatic, that these are things that no one really feels or says, but I’m not bullshitting. You are my everything, and our kids of course. Without you, there is nothing.” Catra leans up on her tiptoes to kiss her beautiful wife on her dumb lips. When she pulls away, Adora is smiling.

“I love you, dork,” Catra says, “and I don’t think I need to tell you that I feel the same, but I do. There’s nothing we can’t do when we’re together. I’m very glad I met you, Lord Adora.” Adora lets out a soft sigh. They’ve stopped dancing now, Adora’s arms drop and she wraps them around Catra’s waist, pulling her closer.

“It’s been so long, I forgot what it felt like to hear that name,” Adora confesses quietly. The lights have dipped, they bathe Adora in a gentle pale blue light and her eyes shine despite the dark lighting. She’s as gorgeous as ever. Catra really never stood a chance. She was undone by a blonde with a lopsided smile.

“I still call you it sometimes,” Catra reminds her, winking a little. Adora lets out a soft laugh.

“You know what I mean,” Adora responds. Catra does know what she means, she hasn’t called Adora, Lord Adora, in a bad way in a very long time. She used to say that with such disdain, but that has not been the case for quite some time. Adora reaches up and cups Catra’s jaw. “We’ve come full circle, Catra.”

“A circle implies we’re back to the beginning, but this isn’t the beginning.”

“Isn’t it? Us, dancing at Princess Prom? That’s how it began,” Adora points out. Catra moves her head from side-to-side.

“Sure,” she concedes, “but that was different. I hated your guts back then, we were enemies, we haven’t gone back to the beginning, we’ve made a new life together. I never want to go back to the beginning, but I want my future to be with you.”

“So now you love my guts?”

“Sure, now I love your guts.”

Adora smiles softly as they move perfectly in sync. Catra looks up at her wife. She looks like she's at peace. They've spent a lot of years together, and Adora is right, Catra couldn't imagine ending up anywhere else. Catra looks over her wife's shoulder. "I think Finn finally told their crush," Catra comments. Adora cranes her head, completely unsubtly, which Catra finds a little funny - Adora is not at all capable of being subtle when she really should be. Behind them was Finn and Flora, and Catra had observed them with their foreheads against each other.

"Ah," Adora says, "young love. They're adorable." Catra has to agree. "Awfully ironic though, isn't it?" Adora asks. "If Finn marries Flora then technically they will be the heir to the Scorpion Kingdom which used to be the Fright Zone, which is technically my Kingdom, even though they turned down C'yra."

"That is ironic," Catra admits. "C'yra has started asking about Cyrus. I think maybe she's a little desperate."

"She is getting older," Adora comments. Catra frowns a little in concern. Despite everything, she doesn't want to think about a life where her moms don't exist - though she knows eventually that is bound to happen. "She needs an heir."

"It's hard to feel sorry for her after everything," Catra admits, "but I don't want the people of Half-Moon to suffer… Maybe I should consider taking it just while our children make a decision if they want to take it or not?"

"I'll support any decision you make," Adora says. She steps back and takes Catra's hands, squeezing them gently. "Come on, I'm hungry." Catra snorts at that. Adora is *always* hungry, but she follows after her anyway. Catra has never felt so completely content in her life. So many years ago, Adora kidnaped her at this event, and later stole her heart. Talk about a twist. At least tonight Catra would rest happily beside her wife, drifting off happily to the sounds of her breaths and the beating of her heart. It almost didn't feel real.

When they reach the buffet, Catra leans against the table and observes her wife who was already grabbing food from the table. After a moment, Adora notices her staring. "What?" She asks curiously. Catra smiles a little.

"Nothing," she says. "I love you, Dummy."

“I love you too,” Adora answers. “I can’t wait to take those clothes off of you.” Catra blushes at that.

“Figures you’d say that,” Catra grumbles. “Lord Horn Dog really is a good name for you.”

“I can’t help it,” Adora says, “have you seen you?”

“Whatever, Adora, eat your food,” Catra says, lightly smacking her wife on her bicep. Although, Catra was also looking forward to taking that dress off of Adora later too. Adora just stares at her with a smirk. “I hate you.”

“You literally just said you loved me about five minutes ago,” Adora says, and her voice is dripping with just pure cockiness. Catra doesn’t respond to her, just gently kicks her shin. They’d settle this later in bed. For now, Catra just wanted to enjoy the ball, preferably without the kidnapping this time, with her wife.

* * *

Five Years Later

Catra hears the front door of their house close and hears footsteps as Cyrus returns. He had been spending an awful lot of time in Half-Moon recently with C’yra. As it turned out, Cyrus said he would like to be the King of Half-Moon. Catra was worried about all the time he was spending preparing for that, but especially the time he was spending around C’yra. Adora didn’t seem too phased about it. Of course they both supported his decision, and it was rightfully his since he was the second oldest and Finn had abdicated, but Catra knows how stressful Princely duties can be.

That afternoon, Cyrus comes into the kitchen. He seems a little different, but Adora greets him warmly as she sips her coffee. Catra turns her head to the side. She can read her children extremely well, and she knows he has a question to ask. They had given Cyrus and Mara the Horde Lord speech when they had been thirteen, about two years ago, so Catra wasn’t sure

there was much damage C'yra could do. The only issue? Cyrus was a lot like C'yra. Catra had told C'yra off when Cyrus had been a toddler for her favouritism of him, but that hadn't really prevented Cyrus from bonding the most with his grandma. In a way, Catra supposes that she, Cyrus and C'yra are all the most like each other, which is funny because Cyrus is the only of their children that inherited Adora's blonde locks.

"Mama," Cyrus begins, speaking to Catra. Catra hums, indicating for them to continue. "I don't see why you gave up your throne for mom. That seems like it was a pretty dumb decsion." Catra was not expecting *that* . She looks at Adora who just shrugs a little.

"It's complicated," Catra responds.

"Not really, mom was the evil Horde Lord, and you gave up your throne for her. The enemy." Now that gets a reaction out of Adora. She freezes her movements.

"Cyrus... Go to your room please," Catra says, her voice tense as her hand clenches the spoon that she had been using to stir the soup base for dinner later.

"Why?" Cyrus asks. "It's true. I don't know why you and Finn both turned it down. For mom? For a grudge? It's irresponsible." Those are *C'yra's* words, not her son's.

"Cyrus. Go to your room, please," She repeats, her thoughts running a mile a minute as she turns the stove off and takes off the apron she was wearing. "Seems I need to have a little talk with C'yra," She spits out. It was moments like this that Catra wondered if it was always going to be one step forward and three steps back when it came to her relationship with the Queen of Half-Moon.

Cyrus turns and leaves and Adora looks over at Catra. Her wife releases a soft sigh. "You should probably calm down, Catra," Adora says. "Cyrus could never hate me, he's just... Thinking about things, considering why you did what you did, no biggie, and no need to burn bridges again." Catra scowls at her wife, hands clenched at her side.

"Calm down? The woman that harmed our family is doing it again by indoctrinating our child with whispers in their ear! About information that is only *our* right to tell them. Not hers! So

yes, I'm going to go see her and give her a piece of my mind," Catra growls as she abandons her dinner making. Adora doesn't look so convinced. In fact, Adora is taking this remarkably well considering her biggest fear is usually that their children will hate her for her past as the Horde Lord. Did Cyrus hate her? No. But C'yra was clearly not sugar coating it. Calling Adora the *enemy* , saying giving up the throne wasn't worth it? That was unacceptable.

"She's never liked me, she never *will* like me, it's not going to change. Sure, I'd prefer she didn't tell Cyrus things about me, but she probably doesn't even mean to," Adora shrugs a little and Catra scoffs in disbelief.

"Yeah, well. Her 'probably didn't mean to' is harming my family," Catra huffs, grabbing the keys to the skiff. "I'll be back," She says as she stomps out the house, to the skiff and takes off to Half-Moon at full speed. She was abandoning her wife for dinner, but she's sure she could wait a few hours for it.

* * *

When Catra arrives at Half-Moon, she storms her way towards the throne room. She's pissed. Maybe Adora doesn't see this as a big deal, but Catra does. C'yra should not be speaking to their son about Adora's past, she definitely shouldn't be putting shit in their heads that makes Cyrus think less of Adora, Finn or herself. She's about to argue with her mom after a long time of them being fine, but it's necessary.

Catra strides into the throne room. The person who sees her first is Luna. Luna smiles brightly at the appearance of her daughter, but that smile quickly falls away and is replaced by concern. Catra ignores her, storming on past her like a tornado and Queen C'yra is right in her destruction path. Luna steps out the way, but follows behind Catra to make sure C'yra didn't get murdered by their daughter. "C'yra! Where the hell are you?!" Catra yells angrily. She's pretty damn sure that's obvious.

Catra climbs the stairs to the two thrones and spots her mother standing with her back to her, though her ears are perked and her back is impossibly straight - C'yra has always had impeccable posture, even in her old age. Slowly, the Queen turns and her mismatched eyes land on her daughter who was stomping towards her. "C'yra?" C'yra asks, as though she's surprised by Catra's intrusion. That just makes Catra more pissed if she's honest.

Catra frowns deeply, her eyes narrowed in rage as she steps close to the Queen. "What kind of bullshit about my wife have you been whispering into my son's ear?!" Catra yells. She's rather close to C'yra, and she only just now realises that, while C'yra isn't much taller than her, she *is* taller, which is annoying because it's hard to stare someone down when you have to look up to meet their eyes levelly.

C'yra just blinks at Catra as though she hasn't a single clue what it is that Catra is talking about. "... What?" She asks incredulously. That only fans the flames of Catra's anger if she's honest.

"My son came into my home, after being here with *you* , talking about my wife having a sketchy past and commenting about how my giving up the throne for my wife wasn't worth it, and that they don't understand why Finn or I turned it down. So start fucking talking. What the hell have you been telling him?" Catra is aware that she's yelling, but she doesn't really care. She's causing a scene, but she's pretty sure she's allowed to.

C'yra frowns and Catra sees her glance over Catra's shoulder to look at her wife who was behind Catra. Catra turns a little and sees that Luna simply narrows her eyes and crosses her arms over her chest. "I haven't been telling him anything," C'yra says. "Just... The past. Adora *was* Lord of the Horde, that caused conflict between us, you chose to give up your throne, so did Finn, and I suppose Cyrus didn't think that the enemy of everyone was worth abandoning the throne for."

"The past to which you had no right to tell without my and Adora's permission! Because you sure as hell were leaving out a shit ton of context from said past. I *specifically* told you that anything pertaining to that part of the past was to be told by me and Adora when we thought our kids were ready," Catra snaps. "You overstepped. *Again* . Which you *promised* you wouldn't do after you had finally apologised for the damages you had caused my family. And then you pull this?"

"He asked me!" C'yra protests. "I gave him my version of events."

" *Your version* ? And which version was that, C'yra? Do be so kind as to tell me," Catra says, placing her hands on her hips. She's well aware what versions of the past C'yra has, most of them are false realities. Things she tells herself to make her feel better about the way that she treated Catra. C'yra sighs and shakes her head.

"It doesn't matter. Cyrus is very dedicated to being the King of Half-Moon, he's entitled to know my opinion on things. I'm his grandmother," C'yra argues. Catra grinds her teeth together.

"Yes, it does matter. I'm sure Cyrus would *love* to know that at one point his grandmother would have called him an evil spawn and would have wanted me to get rid of him. Just like she had wanted with his older sibling. Because that part is not an opinion, it's factual," Catra spits. She's a little bold and decides to point her finger at C'yra's chest, digging the tip into her chest a little.

"Now hold on," C'yra says, lifting her hand, "that was a heat of the moment thing! I never called Finn that to their face, nor did I ever actually believe it."

"A heat of the moment thing?" Catra laughs in disbelief. "And what about how you treated me through my pregnancy with Finn? The disregard and disrespect you had for me that entire time? Treating me as if I was an inconvenience and a pest and trying to use me as bait to lure Adora in so you could kill her!"

"You can't tell them that," C'yra says, her eyes widening. "None of them."

"And why not?" Catra raises an eyebrow. "Because it'll influence how he views you in a negative way? Like how you've been doing but towards his own mom?"

"That was when I hated Adora! I wanted her dead, I admit that, but Adora had done awful things, she certainly wasn't innocent," C'yra says. "You make me sound like a cruel monster."

"Because you were," Catra says, matter-of-factually. "You did awful things too when you found out Finn was Adora's. Or did you choose to blissfully forget about your wrong doings, but not Adora's?" C'yra huffs at that.

"Of course not," She says, "but Adora almost killed you. What if I told your children about how she stabbed you through your chest? What would they think of her then?" Catra shakes

her head a little. She couldn’t believe what C’yra was saying to her right now. Catra had thought this was all ancient history at this point.

"You almost killed me too. Or did you forget that? Planning to take away Adora when I was in a coma, knowing damn well that that was the reason I was still alive after you disowned me and cut me off from the majority of my support system! And of course you fucking leave out the fact that she was under the influence of the Black Garnet and was not herself when that happened! But you were... You were fully aware when you were making every single decision that hurt me, C'yra." Catra drops her finger, but she stares directly into C’yra’s eyes. C’yra’s ears wiggle a little.

"C'yra?" C'yra almost scoffs in disbelief. "We're back to ‘C'yra’ now? Where is your wife? I can't believe Adora ended up being the more rational one between you two." Catra laughs in disbelief.

"Yes, we're back to ‘C'yra’. And she's home with our kids, making sure they're safe and okay," Catra hisses. "And rational? You threw rational out the window the second you brought up when Adora was under the Black Garnet's influence."

"Maybe she was in that battle," C'yra says, "but she was perfectly in her right mind when she decided to attack Bright Moon, wasn't she? And all the other times she attacked villages, blew up Princess Frosta's Castle?! And all the other damages she did! I don't even hate Adora anymore, I just don't have a high opinion of her, and I never will, C'yra."

"Did you seem to forget that Adora had Shadow Weaver and propaganda from the Horde shoved into her head since she was a fucking baby? She didn't have a safe home or a normal childhood. But you did, and you still turned out to be needlessly cruel." Catra fires back. Maybe Adora had made the decision to attack Bright Moon without the influence of the Black Garnet, but it was certainly not without the influence of Shadow Weaver and all the other trauma she had amassed over her years in the Horde.

"I've apologised for all of this, you agreed to put it behind us, why are you bringing all of this up again?" C’yra asks.

"Because you're over here putting ideas into my child's head and making him to be like you!" Catra yells.

"Why is that such a bad thing?" C'yra asks. "You were like me."

"I was... Until I realised being like you was a bad thing," Catra says, frowning deeply at the thought. She and C'yra have always been pretty similar, it wasn't until events in Catra's early twenties that she realised they were actually worlds apart.

"Why?" C'yra asks. "All I wanted was to protect you. Why is that so bad?"

"Protect me?" Catra gives C'yra an incredulous expression. "You're the person that hurt me most of all. Out of anyone else, you're the one that broke my heart the most. Not Adora, not Glimmer or Bow, or mom. *You* did. You never protected me after you found out Finn was Adora's. Or did all those times I begged you to listen to me leave your memory too?" It was hard to believe now, but Catra had once been incredibly close to both of her moms. Now they felt worlds apart.

"This is old news, C'yra," C'yra sighs. "I promise I won't tell your children anything else, will that satisfy you?" Catra looks at her distrustfully. She purses her lips at that. *Was it worth dredging up the past like this? Did C'yra have a point?*

"Fine," Catra says after a while, "but if I find out you broke your word, you're not going to like what I have to say next time I come here." Catra gives C'yra a serious expression before she turns and walks out of that throne room. She knew her wife would likely be waiting for her return, and, more importantly, dinner. Catra just hoped that now C'yra had gotten it through her head. No one messes with Catra's family. And, while C'yra was technically her family too, Adora and her children *always* came first.

* * *

C'yra sighs as her daughter strides out of her throne room. She has the boldness to feel upset about it, like she hadn't caused this crater between her daughter and herself. C'yra really had been trying, and she hadn't been thinking how her words might sound to Cyrus. Perhaps she got a little too comfortable with them, forgot her place and crossed the lines that Catra had clearly set when Cyrus had announced they would like to be the next King of Half-Moon. She spent so much time with him that she honestly quite forgot that they were her grandchild

and not her actual child. She forgot that he was impressionable, and likely to relay her words to his mothers. She'd been careless, and a little bit of an asshole (admittedly).

When C'yra looks away from where Catra was retreating she sees her wife looking at her. Sometimes it's worse knowing you've disappointed your wife. Luna has been by C'yra's side through so much, and often she has not agreed with her decisions, but disappointing Luna is kind of like kicking a puppy - about one of the worst things you can do. She hates letting her wife down, especially when Luna is one of the few people who is kind and gentle right down to the bone, and who loves her - perhaps 'opposites attract' holds some truth to it. "Cy…" She sighs and C'yra's ears press back. "What were you telling Cyrus?" Luna asks softly and with concern.

"Does it even matter?" C'yra asks her wife. Luna nods at her question.

"It does, because I want to make sure I understand what really happened after this whole encounter. I haven't seen our daughter that upset since... Well, you know since when." C'yra does know since when. C'yra has some difficulty looking at her wife directly.

"Maybe I was a little harsh with my account and assessment of Adora," C'yra admits, always the perfect politician, she's been educated in the perfect way to hedge her words, "but I hardly think it warranted that reaction."

"I need specifics before I can make my own assessment of whether our daughter's reaction was warranted or not, Cy. Start talking. If you continue deflecting, I'm going to go ahead and assume that whatever the hell you said was warranted and side with our daughter." C'yra balks at that. Now there are sides?

"You always take her side," C'yra says, perfectly petulantly. "I'm always in the wrong. Can't I have opinions?"

"That depends. Are your opinions being said with the intent to harm someone or present a negative image of someone that doesn't deserve it?" Luna crosses her arms. "And you and I both know I've taken our daughter's side because you have been in the wrong, C'yra. Because she's right in saying that you hurt her. Because both her and I tried to get you to listen and stop being such a stubborn person about a situation that you were entirely in the wrong about

and had a chance to fix before causing irreparable damage. Does your opinion matter more to you than our daughter? Our family?" Luna has her there, C'yra has to admit.

"I'll tell you what I said because you're my wife," C'yra says. She turns for a moment and places her hand on her throne before she turns back to Luna. "Cyrus was curious about why C'yra and Finn had given up their throne, I told them that it was because C'yra and I had had a disagreement a long time ago before they were born. He asked me what that disagreement was, and I told him... I didn't agree with her decision to choose Adora, former Lord of the Horde, who had caused Etheria significant damage, as her mate and wife. I told him that we disagreed and had a falling out over... Adora... and basically that if C'yra had never been kidnapped by Adora, C'yra never would have ended up in a relationship with her, and she'd still be my heir, and Adora would probably still be the Lord of the Horde."

"You know, I kind of doubt they would have never met," Luna says softly. "Or rather, that they would have stayed away. When C'yra and I talk about Adora, she's told me of those times when Adora would flirt with her on the battlefield, even while they were still enemies. One of them would have fallen first, Cy. Fate is funny in that way. They complete each other. You and I both know that. If they didn't, they wouldn't have beaten the odds of being enemies, they wouldn't have beaten *death* ," She says. "That being said, if you had given our daughter a chance, like she asked of us, she would still be your heir too. She loved and admired you so much, Cy. And you stomped on that with your decision. The disagreement was our fault, not our daughter's. The only fault that our daughter had was falling in love and, well, she wouldn't even be standing here if that love hadn't been strong enough to keep her here." This is what C'yra means when she says Luna is kind and gentle to her bones. She is an idealist, C'yra is a cynic. Perhaps her wife has a point in pointing out that C'yra contributed to their daughter rejecting her crown and not just her relationship with Adora. Perhaps she was incorrect to incriminate Adora in that decision to her son.

"Maybe I overstepped," C'yra finally admits. Only ever to her wife. She sighs heavily and moves closer to her wife. "We're getting older, Lu, we won't be here forever, and I... I don't want to spend what time we do have at odds with our only daughter." Luna nods, clearly satisfied at the admission.

"Okay," She says. "Then what are you going to do to right your mistake?"

"I don't know," C'yra says. "It was a miracle C'yra forgave me before, and that was only because Adora talked to her."

"Cy... Why would you even discuss such a sensitive topic with Cyrus to begin with? One that C'yra specifically asked us not to discuss with him?" Luna asks. "And don't give me that crap about him having asked. You could have easily redirected him to speak with C'yra and Adora about it, but instead you told them your biased opinion."

"I guess... I was worried he'd do what Finn did," C'yra admits. She's already lost two heirs, and Cyrus has always been the one more likely to accept the throne. Finn has already rejected, Mara is far more invested in reading her books, a true scholar, and Calamity, they are chaotic at best. Cyrus is the most suitable heir after Finn, and if he knew the truth then he might just say no like Finn did.

"And in turn you put thoughts in his head that negatively impacted our daughter's family?" Luna raises an eyebrow. Okay, when her wife says it like that, it sounds bad, but it's not like C'yra actually intended to do that.

"I didn't want to lose another heir. Our dynasty is hanging by a thread. What would my father say about all of this?" C'yra asks. "He was always so kind... He never would have done what I did, and he... he never would have lost his heirs."

"Then don't you think that maybe you should try to follow in his footsteps as opposed to trying to walk down that same path that has our dynasty hanging by a thread, as you put it?" Luna asks. C'yra sighs.

"I can't," C'yra says. "He would have been an amazing grandfather, he even was for a little while, until he was killed by the Horde."

"Yes, you can," Luna says. "Be someone that your father would have been proud of, Cy. Mend the bridge that's been broken. Learn to forgive and stop rekindling a fire that we've been trying to put out for years now."

"My dad always did like you," C'yra says, gently touching her wife's cheek. Luna is always so smart and level-headed. It made her likeable to the old King. "Even when we weren't technically supposed to be seeing each other."

"I know," Luna laughs a little, leaning into her wife's touch. "He was always a kind man. He didn't particularly care about status, or bloodline purity, he just cared that you were happy and loved." C'yra smiles a little and then kisses her wife gently on her lips.

"Fine... I'll talk to C'yra later, and apologise, again, and talk to Cyrus when he comes tomorrow," C'yra finally concedes. She can admit to her wife when she is wrong - though it is often like pulling teeth.

"Good... I love you, Cy." Luna purrs quietly, kissing C'yra again. "And please, if she says something, listen to her and take it into account before getting defensive about it."

"You know that's hard for me," She says, "but I will. I love you too." C'yra often gets too defensive for her own good and then she says stupid things. She needs to learn to be less stubborn. The whole tree parable has never really been a lesson she's managed to digest. 'The tree that learns to bend with the wind will survive, the one that resists is pulled out by its roots'. C'yra needed to learn to bend with the wind or she too would be pulled out by the roots. She sighs and kisses her wife again. She will speak to her daughter tomorrow.

* * *

Catra was enjoying an unusual rarity: alone time in her home. All of her kids were out, most at school, though Finn was likely off somewhere with Flora. Adora was also out, helping a local village. So imagine Catra's surprise when she hears a knock at her front door. She had really been looking forward to a quiet night in, undisturbed. She opens the door, and she's not at all expecting to be greeted by her mother. "What are you doing here?" Catra asks, her displeasure evident in her tone. Whatever, C'yra has earned that displeasure.

"What a nice greeting," C'yra comments, dusting off her shoulder. "I came to speak with you." Catra hesitates. One part of her wants to close this door in C'yra's face, the other wants to know what it is that her mom thought was so important she came all the way down here just to talk to Catra about it.

"The kids are at school and Adora's off being a lumberjack for a while," Catra explains as she steps to one side. C'yra enters Catra's home tentatively. "What do you want to discuss?"

"A lumberjack?" C'yra asks, raising an eyebrow. "Interesting job for the former Horde Lord."

"She likes it. She gets to use her strength for something beneficial for everyone," Catra shrugs. Plus, Catra knew when she came home she'd be making some obnoxious comment about her biceps - something Catra pretended to hate, but seeing her wife flex was always a benefit in her eyes.

C'yra walks into Catra's home more. Catra watches as she looks at some of the pictures on the walls of her kids, Adora and herself. "I don't want to be at odds with you, C'yra, you're my daughter," She turns to her. "You're a mother, I know you know how it feels to love your child."

Catra doesn't answer immediately. She walks into the living room and sits down, tutting quietly. "Yes, I know how it feels to be a mother and to love your child. What are you trying to point out here?" Catra asks, because whatever it is that C'yra is trying to sell, Catra isn't buying it.

"I don't want to hurt you," C'yra sits down beside Catra and Catra tenses only a little. "You were like me, but I think you got a lot of Luna's softness too. I used to be more like that, before..." C'yra trails off. "My point is that I love you, I will always love you, no matter what, and I want to... make things right."

"You don't want to hurt me..." Catra almost laughs before catching herself. It was a little too late for that. "You know, what you did with Cyrus brought back so many old wounds so quickly."

"I know... I overstepped, I admit that."

"You did. You overstepped a lot," Catra sighs tiredly. She pauses for a moment before she continues. "Why do you keep hurting me and my family?"

"I don't want to," C'yra says. "I was worried Cyrus might... do what you and Finn did."

"And what if he did? It wasn't your decision to make," Catra says. "Instead you influence him to start turning his back on his family? Mama," Catra sighs as she calls her mother that. It was a habit, it was hard to keep calling her C'yra, even if she had pissed Catra off enough to revoke her mama privileges yesterday, she, unfortunately, would always be the woman who cared for Catra when she was a child, who gave birth to her. "You didn't even tell him the truth. Or, at least, you didn't attempt to be objective."

"Okay," C'yra's ears press back for a moment, "maybe it wasn't my finest decision. I was trying to be honest."

"Trying to be honest?" Catra asks, frowning at her mom.

"My opinion of Adora isn't very high, but, upon reflection, maybe I was more harsh than necessary."

"You were unnecessarily harsh to both Adora and me," Catra says firmly.

"Yes I was," C'yra admits. "And I'm sorry." That… Catra was not expecting. So rarely her mom admits she's wrong, even rarer still she says sorry.

"Thank you," Catra whispers. "There's something else we need to discuss though."

"What is that?" C'yra asks curiously.

"The whole... Refusing to really acknowledge your own fuck ups when you keep on not forgiving Adora's," Catra says. C'yra sighs deeply and looks at Catra. It hits Catra just how old her mom is getting. She's still ageing fabulously, you would never really know the woman was pushing her eighties, but it's becoming more apparent. Some part of Catra thought her mom would be around forever.

"I'm aware of my mistakes," C'yra says shortly.

"Then why don't you forgive Adora's? You keep saying you have such a bad impression of Adora as if you haven't done bad things too. Stop acting holier than thou," Catra says. C'yra may say she's forgiven Adora, and they may actually be able to exist in the same room together, but when push comes to shove, Adora will always be the villain to C'yra.

"It's... Adora is... I find her tolerable, isn't that enough?" C'yra asks after she clearly struggles to find appropriate words to describe her relationship with her daughter-in-law.

"Not really. Because you don't find her tolerable. If you did, you wouldn't have done what you did with Cyrus," Catra points out.

"I don't like her, C'yra," C'yra deadpans. "I never will like her." Catra frowns at that.

"And I don't particularly like you, but I still did my best to remain civil and to bite my tongue about everything you did to me," Catra points out.

"You don't like me?" C'yra asks. She sounds… hurt, actually, which is almost surprising to Catra. C'yra is usually the type not to care about such things.

"No... No, I don't," Catra shakes her head. "You shattered my trust for a second time with the Cyrus situation. The little bit of trust you had earned back from me. All the healing about what you had done... Got ripped to shreds with what my son said. With what *you* threatened to tell him when I made you face the truth about things you did. After calling you out on telling him just your version of what happened during the war." C'yra rubs her face, taking a moment before she responds to Catra.

"I can talk to Cyrus," She says. "I didn't think what I said was so bad."

"You never seem to think about the consequences of your decisions," Catra accuses.

"I suppose I don't," C'yra admits. "Can I fix what I broke?" She asks. "C'yra... We used to be so close..." Catra looks away at that.

"I don't know…" Catra says slowly. "Every decision you make, somehow it always hurts me or my family."

"I promise I won't anymore."

"It's hard to even begin to believe you."

"What about your mom?" C'yra asks. "You trust her more, right?"

"I... Trust her more," Catra admits. Luna has always been more supportive of Catra's relationship with Adora - she even saved Adora that one time. It's not surprising that she trusts her more than C'yra.

"Luna thinks that I can be more... She's encouraged me to be better, I would like to be," C'yra says slowly. Catra doesn't really believe that. She will, as some say, believe it when she sees it.

"Then do it. Be better."

"Maybe I'm being a little... Maybe I should give Cyrus a break," C'yra says suddenly. "He spends a lot of time with me, and maybe I've been neglecting my other grandchildren."

"Yeah, you have," Catra agrees without hesitation. She had already discussed with C'yra in the past the effect their obvious favouritism was having on her other grandchildren which had been one of the reasons Finn had turned down their throne. She *had* been improving on that, but then when Cyrus agreed to be her heir, it got bad again. C'yra barely spends any time with her other grandchildren. "You're always spending time with Cyrus. It also honestly felt like he preferred spending time with you than with his own moms." C'yra shakes her head a little.

"I'm sure that's not true, he's just very interested in the throne, and the history of our family, and the Magicats in general. Finn doesn't really care about that, they spend most of their time with Adora, Mara is quiet and likes to learn from books, and Calamity is still pretty young but plenty chaotic, they have more interest in science experiments than they do anything else," C'yra smiles a little. "I love their distinctive personalities. I see pieces of you in each of them... but I'm afraid I don't know Adora well enough to see her in them." Catra presses her lips together in silence for a moment. She allows the quiet to linger before making the decision to add onto that portion of the conversation.

"They all have traits from Adora," She starts off, "Finn loves exploring and helping people. They like spending time making maps with Adora of all the places they go to explore together. Cyrus got her appetite. If you were to see the two of them together at a table, you would think you're witnessing an eating contest," She giggles in amusement. "Mara got her curiosity and love for stories. Most of the books that Mara reads are about different Etherian creatures. She mainly does it because she likes having fun facts to make people smile. And Calamity... Well, they follow their namesake. They inherited Adora's chaotic side to the point where they sometimes put themselves into situations that they shouldn't." Catra smiles fondly. That trait is the trait that so often got (and still sometimes does *get*) Adora into trouble.

Catra looks at her mom and sees C'yra close her eyes and take a deep breath before she opens them again. "Maybe I should be... more open to making some kind of relationship with Adora. She is My daughter-in-law, I suppose, and she is an orphan. Shadow Weaver definitely doesn't count as a mother, and I've been a pretty terrible mother-in-law to her too."

"That's what I've been trying to get you to understand for *years* ," Catra says softly. "All of the mistakes Adora made, all of the things she's worked to make up for, were because she didn't have a proper parent. She didn’t have a good childhood, a safe environment to thrive where she was loved and cared for. She didn't have any of that. Yet you condemned her almost more than you did Shadow Weaver."

"Fine, maybe I could be open to... forgiving Adora, and being nicer to her," C'yra says. "I don't think she's a bad person, not really, I doubt you would love her if she was. I guess it's difficult for me given everything the Horde did, and with her being the Lord of the Horde... I kind of blamed her for things she probably doesn't deserve the full blame for."

"She honestly did the least amount of damage amongst all the people who have led the Horde," Catra points out. Not zero damage, obviously, but Adora's attacks were often non-starters. Catra suspects she'd lost a lot of hunger for conquering Etheria and fulfilling the Horde's mission long before she started sleeping with Catra, she just hadn't admitted it to herself.

"I guess Hordak was the worst," C'yra says quietly.

"Yes, he was," Catra confirms. It was Hordak who attacked Half-Moon, it was Hordak who was responsible for the death of C'yra's father, and Catra's grandfather, King Cyrus. Adora hadn't really been the Lord all that long by the time she stepped down. Sure, she still did her fair amount of damage, it was hardly anything when considered against Hordak who had destroyed so many things, even erased Scorpia's entire family.

"Maybe we could have a family dinner?" C'yra suggests suddenly. Catra frowns a little.

"A family dinner?"

"Yes, at Half-Moon."

"I... Would prefer not to," Catra responds. She still didn't really like returning to Half-Moon.

"Here then?" C'yra asks instead.

"I'll consider it," Catra concedes.

"Okay," C'yra reaches into her bag that she had brought with her and hands Catra a book. C'yra looks at it curiously. "For Mara, since she likes to read, it's the history of the Magicats, Cyrus will probably like it too. I wasn't sure what to get Finn and Cal but, uh, maybe you can let me know?" Catra stares at the book. It looked *old* , probably from the private vault that was reserved for only the royals and high librarians of Half-Moon. Mara would *love* this. She hadn't expected C'yra to actually nail a gift for a grandchild that wasn't Cyrus.

Catra slowly looks up at her mom. This wasn't just a book, and her question wasn't just a question. This was her really making an effort to actually mend what she broke. So Catra decides to help her out. "Just get Finn some new shoes that are durable, and Calamity would like some art supplies, or new safety goggles for when she helps Entrapta."

"Done," C'yra says. "I really am sorry, C'yra."

"Thanks for the apology," Catra says. And this time Catra thinks maybe they actually have made progress. C'yra is actually trying. This could be a new beginning for them.

* * *

"Catra, you're giving me whiplash," Adora says. She was looking at a report but she could see her wife pacing back and forth in her peripheral vision. "What's troubling you?" Her wife doesn't immediately answer her. Adora wasn't expecting her to, and she waits patiently for Catra to answer her.

"My mama… C'yra… I'm… concerned about her," Catra says slowly, like the words were being pulled from her like a tooth is pulled. "She keeps talking about how she's getting older, and how she doesn't have much time left." Adora looks up now, and leans her arms on the folder which was on top of the kitchen counter.

"Well," Adora says carefully, "that's because she is." Catra's tail whips a little at that. "She knows she won't be here forever, that is the unfortunate reality of mortals. She's concerned about who will inherit her kingdom, especially after your recent spat. She *is* getting older-"

"You're not helping, Adora," Catra interrupts.

"I'm just saying, her being concerned about all of that stuff explains why she's speaking the way that she is," Adora explains. "If you're so concerned… Maybe it would be worth spending time with her, and making your peace with her before… well… you know." Catra

sighs at that. She ceases her pacing and comes to stand beside Adora, leaning against her. Adora kisses her wife on her head.

“Spend time with C’yra? It’s been so long…” Catra says quietly. “But maybe you’re right. Are you okay watching the kids?”

“Do you doubt my ability after all of these years?” Adora asks with amusement.

“Well, you did run off that one time.”

“Never again, promise,” Adora says, wrapping her arms around her wife. Catra sighs a little. Adora is happy that she can provide comfort to Catra. Catra always becomes sort of boneless around Adora, and it’s a great experience. It means Catra is wholly and completely comfortable around her.

“Okay,” Catra finally says. She unfortunately untangles herself from Adora. “I guess I could spend time with my mom. I’ll be back tonight, okay?” Adora moves and stands to attention before she salutes her wife.

“Yes, ma’am,” Adora says. Catra simply rolls her eyes which Adora has come to know means ‘I love this dork so much’. Adora watches as her wife gathers her things, opens the front door and leaves. Adora goes back to reading her report. That is until she’s disturbed by one of her children.

"Mom... Can I talk to you?" Calamity asks as they walk into the kitchen. Adora looks up from her report - she was never going to get this thing done. She slowly closes the folder.

"Always," Adora answers, "but should we wait for your mama?" Adora asks as Calamity takes a seat on one of the breakfast bar seats across from her. Catra had literally just left, and Adora’s mom services were already being requested. Calamity shakes their head and Adora raises her eyebrows. Adora hadn’t expected this so soon after Catra had left. Now she had to parent alone instead of as a unit. "Okay, what would you like to talk about?" Adora asks gently. Calamity shakes their head again, running a hand through their hair. Their eyes are exactly like Catra’s, which always makes Adora smile.

"I... Sometimes I feel more like a boy than a girl, and sometimes I feel like a girl and not a boy," They say and Adora nods. "And sometimes I feel like Finn where I don't feel like either."

"Okay," Adora says, nodding. She rests her forearms on the counter top. "How do you feel right now?"

"Neither," They answer and Adora nods again.

"Have you heard of someone who's genderfluid?" Adora questions gently. "If sometimes you feel a certain way, if you want to present in a different way, anything, all you have to do is tell us." Adora smiles reassuringly at her kid. "So, how about, from now on, we have a pronoun and name check-in every day?" Adora suggests. "That way we know what you want to be called and referred to as, and if it changes then you just have to tell us. Sound cool?"

"Sounds awesome," Calamity says. Their tail is whipping back and forth and Adora can hear a low steady purr in their chest. "I like Cal when I'm using he/him pronouns, Cali when I'm using she/her and Calamity when I'm using they/them." Adora smiles softly.

"You got it, kiddo. I'll have to tell your mom, unless you want to talk to her yourself too?" Adora asks.

“Nah, you can tell her,” Calamity says standing up on the stool they were currently sitting on. Adora smiles.

“She’ll be fine with it, you know that, right?”

“I do,” Calamity says, “I knew you’d be okay with it too.” Adora smiles more at that. She loves that her children trust her so much.

“So, would you like some food?” Adora asks as she turns to the fridge. Adora could go for a snack herself if she was honest.

“Grilled cheese,” Calamity says.

“You read my mind.”

* * *

When Catra had shown up randomly to spend time with her mom, C’yra had understandably been surprised to see her and even more surprised that Catra apparently willingly wished to spend time with her. They had awkwardly tried to decide on an activity to do together until eventually Catra just suggested they go for a walk around the royal gardens, kind of like how they used to when Catra was little, but with less Catra getting into the flower beds and giving the gardeners a heart attack. It was peaceful, and it was beautiful, and silence was not unwelcome.

As they passed by loyal staff of Half-Moon, many seemed surprised to find the (ex) Princess walking the gardens with the Queen, and who could blame them? Catra stops every so often to sniff gently at certain flowers and C’yra waits patiently for her. They’re not really talking, but that means they’re not really arguing either, which is definitely progress. Things feel a little strange between them, but not necessarily bad.

C’yra has always been stoic, and she is no different now. Usually she used to be warm and loving when Catra had been small, the same way she looked at Luna now, her stoicism was reserved for those she was trying to hide her emotions from - such as ambassadors, or council members. C’yra was ‘strong’ because she never seemed perturbed by anything. Catra knew this wasn’t exactly true, lots of things perturbed her. C’yra was only ever honest with her feelings to her family, but now she had her royal face on around Catra, and Catra was finding it difficult to read her. She was the perfect picture of Magicat royalty, her back was straight, she looked regal and beautiful, she also looked *old* . Catra had maybe been avoiding admitting that, but her mom really was getting older. She was more grey than brunette, her ramrod straight back was a little laxed probably because it now hurt her muscles and she had an arm wrapped around her lower back as though to support it. Catra looks away.

“What was it you wished to discuss?” C’yra asks eventually, probably after a good hour of them just trailing around the gardens doing nothing. Catra sighs as she leans back from smelling some sunflowers.

“I just… I didn’t…” Catra stumbles for a moment. “The way you keep talking about your impending doom is scaring me,” Catra finally admits. “I just… want to spend time with you, okay?”

“Oh,” C’yra says, she moves closer to Catra and their shoulders brush, “you’re worried about me?” She asks. Catra avoids her mother’s gaze for a moment and then she looks up at her. C’yra’s features have softened considerably, and her stoicism has disappeared. She’s being vulnerable with Catra. Catra nods.

“Yeah, I’m worried about you,” Catra confirms, “I’m also worried that… I know our relationship will always be a little strained, and I can’t help that, but I don’t want to hurry you into the grave by causing you… stress.”

“Probably more than I deserve,” C’yra notes. “C’yra, if and when I go, it will not be your fault. Only time. Time is the only thing that we cannot overcome.” Catra scrunches up her nose.

“You always did like philosophy,” Catra says. Catra personally hated it. C’yra laughs a little.

“It’s not philosophical, kitten,” Catra swallows hard at that nickname, C’yra hasn’t called her that for years, and, while Catra may be a grown ass woman, it reminds her that she is someone’s daughter, she will always be C’yra and Luna’s ‘kitten’, “it’s fact. I cannot extend my life anymore than you can shorten it. We’re all allotted a certain amount of time to live, we just don’t know how long until it happens.”

“Are you sick?” Catra asks suddenly. C’yra shakes her head.

“Just old, C’yra,” she says gently. “I know I’m nearing the end of my life… It’s a feeling. I don’t want you to have to worry, or to feel responsible, or anything really, this is just… natural.” Catra can’t help the frown that crosses her features. C’yra affectionately pinches her

cheek. It's such a strange feeling to Catra, to have her mother be so motherly. It almost feels out of character, but if she's trying to settle her affairs before the end of her life, Catra supposes that the biggest regret she may have is the distance she caused between herself and Catra.

"You should come for dinner," Catra says suddenly, "and mom." Catra thought she had time, but now she thinks that maybe she overestimated just how much time she had. Now she wants to bridge the gap between herself and her mother, she wants to be a daughter again. Sure, their relationship would never be the same again, how could it be? But they could at least be amicable. They could make peace.

C'yra leans against a nearby planter pot. She looks a little tired and Catra debates asking if they should sit. C'yra probably wouldn't like that anyway, she wasn't one to be pitied. "How about you have dinner here tonight and Luna and I can come to your and Adora's home tomorrow?" C'yra suggests. Adora would have to fend for herself and their kids, but she probably wouldn't have anything against Catra spending time with her mom. Catra nods.

"I'd like that," she says, smiling a little. "I've missed Half-Moon cuisine."

"You don't cook it at home?" C'yra questions. Catra offers her elbow to her mother who looks at it for a solid minute before she decides to take it.

"Sure," Catra says, "but it's not the same. The kitchens here used to smell incredible. I'm not exactly a palace worthy cook." C'yra smiles a little.

"I've missed you, C'yra," C'yra confesses quietly. Catra presses her lips together and then sighs.

"Yeah, me too," Catra confesses. She's missed *home* . At least now she and C'yra could truly attempt to heal some of those old wounds, and dinner was the perfect place to start.

* * *

"Wait, so," Adora looks at Lonnie curiously, "you're in a throuple with Rogelio and Kyle?" Lonnie snorts.

"Not exactly," Lonnie says. "I'm dating Rogelio, who is dating Kyle, but I'm not dating Kyle, and I hate him." Adora laughs.

"Hate seems like a strong word," Adora points out.

"You know how it is," is all that Lonnie says. Adora does know how it is. They were in the same squad, they squabbled all the time when they were younger. Kyle wasn't a bad guy, but that didn't stop them from keeping him humble.

"Has he built any muscle in the past two decades?" Adora questions. Lonnie laughs.

"Of course not, he couldn't lift a twig. Luckily, I have the muscles."

"How strange, my entire squad is in some three-way relationship and I was excluded."

"One, you're a lesbian, so you'd only have me," Lonnie says. Adora doesn't see the issue with that. "Two, your head is so far up Catra’s ass, and always has been, no one else had a chance." Adora grins. She has missed hanging with Lonnie.

"How are things in the Fright Zone?" Adora asks curiously.

"Good... Scorpia has really transformed it. She's a great ruler too."

"Better than me?" Adora asks. Lonnie seems to consider that for a moment.

"Different," She decides. "You were never a bad ruler, Adora. You kept the Fright Zone safe and running effectively, and you were ten times the ruler Hordak or Shadow Weaver ever was, you were just kind of an asshole sometimes." Adora hums, she can't disagree with that. "Anyway, why have you brought me here?" Here, was the clearing just outside Bow's dads' library/house where Mara's ship was. Standing leaning against a nearby tree, was Adora's wife.

"We've made a lot of discoveries," Adora says. "Stay with me, because it's a lot." Lonnie raises an eyebrow, but gestures for Adora to continue. "So, turns out, the First Ones were huge dickbags. They rigged Etheria to basically explode and wipe out star systems because they were fighting the intergalactic Horde, which, I actually knew about, but I figured Hordak was bullshitting. She-Ra is the key to that, and I'm very glad we never connected Scorpia to her runestone or we'd all be toast right about now." Lonnie seems to be taking this all extremely well, though, like Adora had said, it is a lot of information to digest all at once. "Unfortunately, I don't want Scorpia to have to remain disconnected from her runestone, or her kids, so... I think I know a way to stop the Heart from activating."

"How?" Lonnie asks, crossing her arms over her chest. Adora glances behind her at her wife, and then she lifts her sword up that had sat on her hip for so long.

"By destroying my sword," Adora explains. "It's the key. If I destroy it, the weapon won't be activated and Etheria will be safe. I've managed to fully piece together everything that Mara left for me. This is the only way. She said she believed in me. All I want, is to keep Etheria safe." Which is terribly ironic considering Adora, for a good portion of her life, had been destroying Etheria. "I don't think we should leave Despondos, stars are pretty and all, from the projections I've seen anyway, but Mara moved us here to keep Etheria safe. Safe from the First Ones. We're also safe from the intergalactic Horde."

"Aren't you a First One?" Lonnie asks.

"Sure, but only by blood," Adora smiles. "Mara was too. Doesn't mean I agree with what they tried to do here, and what they probably have done to others. What matters to me most, is keeping our planet safe, keeping the intergalactic Horde away, and also keeping the First Ones away."

"You're not curious where you came from?" Adora sighs at that question. If she was being honest, her answer would be yes, but she has no desire to put her family in danger, so that

answer has to be no. Adora looks over her shoulder and sees her wife walking towards her. When Catra reaches her, she places a gentle hand on her shoulder blade and smiles softly. Adora smiles back.

"Sure," Adora admits, "but I have my family right here. My found family, my made family. They mean more to me than anything else in the entire universe." Adora moves her sword in front of her, she points the blade towards the ground. Lonnie looks at her suspiciously.

"Why did you ask me here? Surely you could have told me all of this over our com-pads?"

"This is going to be painful," Adora says, "I need you to keep Catra from trying anything." Adora can practically hear her wife's eyes roll and she smiles happily at the thought. "I'm going to destroy my sword... Destroy She-Ra. Catra insisted I shouldn't do anything stupid alone, so she's here, and you're here." Adora steps towards Lonnie. "Just... make sure she doesn't try to touch me." Lonnie nods.

"If you're sure," She says.

"Just give me a moment to speak to my wife," Adora says as she turns. Catra looks at her expectantly. Adora puts her sword away for a moment and decides to take her wife's hands, holding them gently in her own. She examines their rings on each of their fingers and then kisses Catra's. Catra is her constant, and this is important. She's still a little nervous.

"What if this kills you?" Catra questions.

"It's necessary, Catra, but it won't. I promise." Catra scoffs.

"You can't promise me something you don't know about," she points out. Catra has a point there, but Adora simply squeezes her hands reassuringly.

"I can do this," Adora assures. "I can do anything with you by my side." Catra lets out a long sigh.

"Okay," she finally agrees. Adora smiles, lopsided, as Catra releases her hands. Adora takes her sword out again, and then she retreats back from Lonnie and Catra who stand side-by-side. It's strange, they both very much remind Adora of the two parts of herself. Her past, juxtapositioned in two people. She wonders if Lonnie and Catra would have ever gotten along.

Adora points the blade of her sword down. She can do it. All she has to do is will it so. All at once she slams her sword into Etheria, falling to one knee. She transforms into She-Ra as she lands. For a terrible moment, nothing happens, but then Adora raises her sword again, above her head and then slams it down again. The blade cracks all the way along as though made from glass and not steel. It was peculiar. Adora lifts again, and once again smashes her blade into the ground. This time, it actually does shatter. The crack reaches up and Adora looks in horror as the stone stored in the handle of her sword, cracks right down the centre.

For a moment, Adora feels nothing, and then she feels excruciating pain as her entire body lights up. The sword shines so brightly that Catra and Lonnie have to cover their eyes from the blast, though Adora hears Catra yell her name before she's grabbed by Lonnie. It does hurt, but the pain is so much that Adora barely feels it. If that makes any sense.

Eventually, Adora comes to. She hadn't even realised she'd passed out. Kneeling beside her is her wife, peering down at her with worry clear in her features. Adora smiles. "Hey," she says. "That sure sucked." Catra laughs a little, and then takes Adora's face in her hands.

"Thank the gods you're okay. I was worried," Catra says. She sounds worried, but Adora is fine. Kind of. Maybe. It's complicated.

Adora sits up carefully and Catra watches her. She feels a little dizzy and disorientated, but fine. In her hand is the hilt of her broken sword which she lifts and stares at. It really is complicated. Adora spent a good chunk of her life hating She-Ra, of being afraid of her, but recently she had become... a part of herself that she was concerned to be without. Now she was just Adora. She looks at her wife who was watching her very closely and offers her a weak smile. "My head hurts," Adora confesses. She lifts a hand to her forehead and discovers her hair is now down. Weird.

"I can help you back?" Lonnie offers, looking down at the pair.

"Please, I'm sure I can walk just fine," Adora says dismissively. Her wife frowns at her but Adora is already standing to her feet. She's a little off balance, but Catra catches her and wraps her arm around her shoulders to keep her upright.

"I got her," Catra says, "thank you, Lonnie."

"No problem," She says, and, "take care, Boss." Adora just throws her a thumbs up.

They stagger through the woods together. Adora is unusually quiet because her brain just won't stop talking. She wonders what worth she has now, now that she's no longer She-Ra. What use is she? Catra looks concerned by Adora's silence, but she doesn't try to get her to speak which Adora is grateful for. When they get home, Adora retreats straight to bed. She sleeps for several hours, feeling empty inside.

* * *

When it had been about a week, Catra decided to confront her about it. Maybe confront is a bit of a strong word, but she clearly gets sick of Adora moping around in their bed. Adora had hit a serious depression, and Catra just wanted to bring her back to her usual happy self.

One night, she lies beside Adora and Adora slowly looks over at her wife's intense eyes. "Talk to me, Adora," Catra urges, taking Adora's hand and kissing her knuckles softly. Adora sighs.

"I miss her," Adora confesses. "I... I don't know who I am without her. I'm no good, Catra. She-Ra was the good part of me, the part of me that had something to offer. Now... I'm just the ex-Lord of the Horde."

"You did what you had to to keep Etheria safe," Catra reassures, squeezing Adora's hand. “Now Scorpia can connect to her runestone without the world imploding.” Adora smiles weakly as she stares at their joined hands.

“I… I’m glad that I saved Etheria, but I still need to take the Failsafe to the Heart to fully disable the weapon, and I can’t do it without She-Ra.”

“We’ll figure it out, Adora,” Catra says. Adora wants so badly to believe her, but she just can’t help but think how that might not be possible. Adora doesn’t say anything to her wife, so Catra takes that as a cue to continue. “What else are you thinking?”

“Etheria is safe in Despondos, I think we should stay here. I have no intention of contacting the intergalactic Horde, or the First Ones,” Adora answers, monotone. Adora figured that as long as they stayed exactly where they were, everything would be fine.

After that, they fall into silence. Adora feels pretty pathetic if she’s honest. She feels sorry for herself, and maybe she was having a major depressive episode, but she just isn’t sure who she is. No Lord title, no She-Ra. She has no value.

Catra moves closer to her and gently grasps Adora’s chin in her hand, moving her face down to her. Adora swallows thickly, blinking back tears. “You are worthy, Adora. You. Of everything. You don’t need She-Ra for that,” Catra reminds her. Adora’s heart contracts feebly in her chest. She leans down and kisses her wife. Kissing Catra always made everything better. “I love *you* . Not She-Ra, not the Lord of the Horde. You. You are my wife, my life partner, you’re everything I need.” Adora’s heart lifts with love as she continues to kiss her wife. Adora feels so much love that she forgets her depression at being without She-Ra, someone she’d gotten used to having for about thirty years, and can only think about Catra. Catra is her everything too.

Their kissing gets more intense. Adora’s hands grasp Catra, pulling her closer and Catra gasps softly. “Adora,” she whispers their lips inches apart, brushing together. Adora hums, but is too distracted kissing her wife to really pay attention. “Adora. *Look* .” Adora is confused, but parts her lips. She looks down, and is confused by what she sees. She’s *glowing* , but… how? Adora’s eyes widen and she looks up at her wife who smiles.

“Keep kissing me,” Adora says quickly, already pressing her lips to Catra’s. She feels all warm and fuzzy. Kissing Catra has always been *good* , but this feels… She can feel *something* building. Adora leans into the feeling, reaches out, grabs it, and it feels… *familiar* . Adora feels her limbs grow, she feels the warmth, the *power* , she feels her heart soar. *One*

week. One week without She-Ra had been enough. A blinding light fills their bedroom and, after a moment, Catra pulls back to reveal a smiling Adora, as *She-Ra* .

Her wife stares at her for a long moment, and then Catra laughs. “I guess She-Ra really is a part of you,” Catra comments. “You thought it was just the sword.”

“I did,” Adora confesses. “I thought she’d be gone without it… but she’s not. Catra, I *am* She-Ra.” Catra smiles softly and pecks Adora on her lips. “I need to figure out the whole sword thing, but she’s still here.” Catra places a hand to the centre of Adora’s chest, right on her heart.

“I know it’s cheesy, but love really is your greatest weapon,” Catra says. Normally Adora would call her a sap, but she has a point.

“Now I can take the Failsafe to the Heart and ensure Etheria is safe,” Adora says. “And if Horde Prime ever does find us, which he probably won’t since we’re in Despondos, and I don’t intend to open any portals, I will literally fucking obliterate him.” Catra lets out a soft sound.

“We’re doing all of that together, right?” Catra asks.

“Of course.”

* * *

1 Year Later

"Mom," Catra breathes when she sees Luna laid down in bed. She approaches her and takes her hand when Luna lifts it. Catra wraps both her hands around Luna's single one and presses a kiss to the top. Luna looks tired. Catra has never really seen her mom look like this. It's scary.

"She's gone," are the only words Luna seems capable of saying. Catra's heart squeezes in her chest. She already knew this fact before she'd arrived here, and she had spent most of the day conflicted by it, but right now her mom needed her.

"I know," Catra says softly. She sits down in a nearby chair so she can speak to Luna and hold her hand without having to awkwardly stand the whole time. She sits close to the edge and Luna watches her the whole time. Luna's eyes are pretty, sometimes Catra wondered how cool it would have been for her to have gotten her eyes instead of C'yra's. Catra knows she has some resemblance to Luna, but ever since she was little all anyone ever said to her was that she was a spitting image of C'yra.

"The mourning took hold pretty fast," Luna says, "as I'm sure you're aware." Catra grimaces a little. She remembers experiencing it when Adora had broken her heart, and Adora hadn't even died. She could only imagine the pain Luna was in, it had already rendered her pretty weak. Catra didn't want to lose her mom, but she also knew that most Magicats who were mated followed each other into the grave soon after one another. Dying of a broken heart was very real for Magicats. "I've spent my entire life with C'yra, or, at least, the majority of it, it's strange not having her here." Catra squeezes her mom's hand. "I wish you would remember the good of her." Catra looks away for a moment before she turns back to Luna and smiles.

"I do," She says quietly. "And I'm not not sad, I'm just... conflicted."

"You really are a lot like her," Luna says. "Just a tad bit less stubborn." Catra laughs a little, a sad chuckle, one that was dangerously close to a sob.

"Tell that to Adora," Catra says fondly. "She'd disagree with you."

"Maybe," Luna actually manages a small smile at that. "I'm glad you have Adora, I know she'll take care of you."

"Mom..."

"We both know I don't have long, C'yra," Luna says. She doesn't say it harshly but it is clearly a fact. Catra sighs. She knows it's true, but being without any of her moms is... unthinkable to her. “I know that C’yra did so much wrong to you, but she loved you *so* much.”

“I know,” Catra blinks away tears from her eyes. “She really did change towards the end. I… I forgive her.”

“Really?” Luna asks with surprise. Catra takes a long moment to consider. Luna’s shallow breaths are the only sound in the room, and her hand is only upright because Catra is holding it. Catra has aged with grace, as her moms have, sometimes she finds it hard to believe that she made it here, but she has. A child never really thinks about losing their parents, Catra thought her moms would live forever.

“Yeah,” Catra finally says. “She’d probably say something about how she doesn’t deserve it, and maybe she doesn’t, but I have. She really tried. She made things right with my kids… She deserves to rest easy.” Luna’s eyes flutter closed and Catra kisses her mother’s knuckles.

“Queen C’yra the Strong,” Luna hums. Strong fitted her mother if you asked Catra. “Her father before that was King Cyrus the Kind, and he really was. I wonder what epithet they will give you, and your son.” Catra shrugs a little.

“I won’t be Queen for long,” Catra points out. She had simply taken over to give Cyrus more time to prepare. He was only a teenager, hardly ready for the pressures for being a King. Catra had been Queen for only a few months, when C’yra had asked her to step in, when she had started to become weaker.

“You’ve still been a marvellous Queen for the time you’ve been in,” Luna shifts a little, pulling herself up the bed. Catra frets over her for a moment but Luna holds her hand up dismissively, insisting that she could do it herself. Once she’s settled against her pillows again, Luna looks at her daughter. The dark circles under Luna’s eyes are… deep, almost purple, like she’s been sleeping terribly these past few days - and she probably has. “C’yra was right… You were our shining future, you’ve always been intelligent, but also kind-hearted, and brave, a perfect Queen.”

“I’m not perfect,” Catra says dismissively.

“Neither was C’yra.” Luna’s lips push up a little. “When she was younger she was unruly. She pursued me when she shouldn’t have. We too hid our relationship from the King and Queen, though the King figured it out. I wasn’t the enemy, but I was just the daughter of the local doctor, hardly worthy of royalty, but C’yra didn’t care about any of that… She was so… bold. She never held her tongue, which was a good and bad thing, as you know. She always took care of me, as I took care of her. She was my soulmate, even if we were so different… She completed me, and now my soul is rushing to be reunited with her. How cruel that it wasn’t instant.”

“Don’t say that,” Catra frowns at the thought, though she can understand it to a degree. If Adora died, Catra too would not want to live long without her.

“You’ve really forgiven her?”

“Yeah,” Catra sniffs, “I really have.”

“I’ll tell her when I meet her again,” Luna says softly. Catra can no longer hold back her tears. She cries, and she suddenly feels like a child again, like she’s five years old and just scraped her knee and came running to her mom for comfort. Luna shushes her gently. “Come here,” she pats the spot by her side and Catra lies beside her mother.

“I don’t want you to go,” Catra admits through tears. “I didn’t want either of you to go.”

“And we didn’t want to leave you either,” Luna replies, gently brushing a strand of hair from Catra’s face, “but at least you’re not alone.” Catra laughs despite herself, but it’s pitiful, and wet. “Adora is your soulmate, she’ll keep your heart together and help you through this pain, just as C’yra helped me through mine.” Catra purrs softly out of instinct, she wants to provide her mother with as much comfort as she can, and when Luna purrs back it’s a little weaker than usual. “We’ll still be here, C’yra, if ever you need us.”

“Where?” Catra asks, her voice broken.

“We’re inside your heart, silly,” Luna’s hand presses to Catra’s chest. Catra lets out a long sigh. She curls up closer to Luna. At least she gets to say goodbye to one mom.

“Did mama ever hate me?” Catra asks suddenly. Luna’s purring pauses momentarily.

“She could never, kitten,” Luna says in a whisper. “C’yra has always been a headstrong, act now, think later, kind of person. Her hot temper has led her to many rash decisions, but she has never hated you, even if she disagreed with your choices strongly at first. She hated admitting she was wrong, even though she was, terribly.” Catra hums.

“Any regrets, mom?” Catra asks curiously. “Anything you want to say before you go?”

“Only that I regret any harm that befell you by mine and C’yra’s hands,” Luna says quietly. They are essentially cuddling now, and Catra *really* feels like her child past self. She hasn’t done this with her mom in years. She missed her warmth. There really is no comfort like a mother’s, and Catra was never going to get to experience it again. Catra disguises a sob by purring harder.

They drift off into an easy sleep. Catra’s crying had tired her out, and Luna had been exhausted long before Catra had arrived there. When Catra wakes up, her mom has gone. Catra stays there and cries for a very long time, and then she tells the appropriate people to prepare her mother’s body. After, she goes to hunt down her wife so she may cry more while being held.

* * *

Three Years Later

Half-Moon rarely ever changes and Catra finds that the most comforting. She stands in the throne room before the mural that C’yra had commissioned. She still missed her moms dearly, but the pain was less significant than when it had first occurred. Catra closes her eyes for a moment as she hears her wife step beside her. The ever present comforting feeling of having Adora near her. She loved it.

"Damn, we were that young?" Adora asks, breaking the silence. It makes Catra laugh. Adora is good at that, making Catra laugh. She's just such a dork, and some of the things she says are out of pocket. She isn't wrong though, they're definitely younger in that mural. Their children decide to gather around them at the same time.

"I can't believe it's been so long," Catra admits. It doesn't feel like it has been that long. It feels as though the years have simply flown by. Maybe because they've been some of the happiest of her life - sprinkled with some bad of course, it hasn't always been plain sailing. "Four kids and many years later. I still love you just as much as I did back then."

"Well, that's a relief," Adora says. "Imagine if you loved me less? That would make this very awkward." Catra laughs and shakes her head. There Adora goes, making her laugh again. Catra smiles and holds her wife's hand.

"I could never love you less," Catra says softly to her.

"I could never love you less either," Adora says, looking at the mural, "but... looking at that makes me feel tired. We're definitely not as... robust."

"No, I suppose we aren't," Catra says. She and Adora are definitely older, and of course they've slowed down with age - though Adora is still somewhat of a fitness freak.

"My stamina is still pretty good though, right?" Adora asks, nudging Catra with her shoulder.

"Adora, our kids are literally next to us," Catra deadpans, unamused. She knows exactly what her wife is insinuating but so do their children. It's almost worse that they're older because they *really* understand what Adora means.

"What's your point?" Adora asks.

"Her point is, gross, mom," Finn complains.

"What does that even mean?" Mara asks.

"Hey, I'm talking about how I can still do many *many* press ups," Adora says dismissively. It's a weak argument at best.

"You're a horrible liar, mom," Cyrus deadpans, very much in the same way that Catra does. Catra can't help but snicker in amusement.

"She really is, but we love her all the same," Catra leans up and kisses Adora on her cheek. Adora gives her a look, but it's mostly just a playful 'I'll get you back for this betrayal later' kind of look.

Calamity beams, dropping their goggles so they were around their neck and not on their face anymore. They move closer to Catra and Adora and hug them. "We do. We love you both," Calamity says, squeezing a little.

"My family," Adora says fondly, pulling all of them into a big hug. Adora has always given the best hugs, probably due to her impressive muscle mass. "All grown up."

"You look young in that mural, moms," Calamity comments, "less grey."

"Hey, watch what you're saying," Adora warns jokingly. "Everyone gets old, even She-Ra and Magicat royalty."

"It has been quite a long time since that mural was made. Your grandmas actually made this as Adora and I's anniversary gift," Catra explains. At the time it had almost been a peace offering between C'yra, Adora and Catra.

"When only Finn existed," Adora adds, "because they refused to let us have more babies because they were so clingy." Adora says while affectionately pinching Finn's cheek like they weren't in their twenties by now.

" *Mom* !" They complain.

"We should have another made of all of us," Adora suggests.

"I think maybe you're right," Catra smiles. "We love all of you. You're our pride and joy." This she directs to their children. Mara and Cyrus, their twins, the two look similar, but Cyrus' sunshine hair is so different to the browns of his other siblings. He already looks kingly, and they were here to start the proceedings to hand over the crown officially to him since he had reached eighteen, nearly nineteen. Mara looked soft. She had always been quiet, but recently she had become a serial academic and was mostly spending her days studying with one of Bow and Glimmer's kids, one that Catra was pretty sure she had a crush on, about the history of Etheria, especially about her namesake, and last She-Ra, Mara. Cali was their youngest and still in her late teens, she was in overalls, and also the shortest of her siblings, but her overalls were stained with oil and who knows what else. She loved inventing, and Catra was confident she'd do amazing things. As for Finn, their eldest, they were an adventurer, and they would soon be married to the Princess of the Fright Zone, heir of the Scorpion Kingdom (also ex Adora's kingdom, which was ironic yet sort of a full circle moment). Finn religiously wore that red bandana that had once been Adora's cape, and they had kept their hair dyed blonde, but it was more platinum than Cyrus' golden locks. Her children were all individuals, and Catra was so fucking proud of each and every one.

"PDA alert, children, I'm about to kiss my wife," Adora says, turning to kiss Catra on her lips.

"Ewww, moms!" Catra hears multiple of her children complain, but she doesn't care all that much if she's honest. Kissing her wife is all she really cares for. Catra smiles, kissing Adora back and pulling away.

"Come here, all of you. Family hug. Again." They all gather into a hug and Adora looks over at Catra with a sparkle in her eyes. Catra knows exactly how she feels just from that single look.

"You know, even after all this time, I love you *so much* ," Adora says. Catra beams at the blonde.

"I love you too. Getting to be with my family today is the best thing I could ever ask for."

"I must say, I don't like how Finn is taller than both of us," Adora says, turning to look at them. "I guess you grew with all that love we gave you."

"Mom..." Finn grumbles, embarrassed.

"It's true. You grew to be so big." They were even taller than Adora who was an impressive six feet tall. Cyrus was about the same height as Adora, but Finn was at least five inches taller than Adora. Adora had joked that they had gotten She-Ra's height, Catra isn't so sure she isn't wrong about that.

"I mean, it's not hard to beat Catra's height," Adora comments. "She's so smol."

"Hey! I will go for your knee caps," Catra threatens playfully.

"You'd have to," Adora says with a grin. "You can't reach anything else." Catra looks at Adora, completely unamused.

"You're an Idiot," Catra says flatly. Adora's grin only grows. It's her 'yes I am, but I'm *your* idiot' grin. Catra loves that woman so damn much.

"I'm your wife," is all that Adora says.

"That too," Catra responds. Adora rolls her eyes fondly.

"What're we going to do when all of you guys fly the nest?" Adora asks curiously. The only two who were really still in said nest were Mara and Calamity. Finn spent most of their time away, or with Flora, Cyrus was mostly in Half-Moon these days and would be from now on as King, Mara spent most of her time in the library and Catra and Adora would only see her when she remembered that she needed sleep, and as for Calamity, they'd been spending a lot of time with Entrapta, though they were undoubtedly the one that they spent the most time with these days. They were adults now, excluding Calamity at sixteen. They needed Catra and Adora less than they did as children, though they would always be there for them if and when they needed them. It was, unfortunately, life.

"They're growing up, Adora," Catra says wistfully. "We'll always be here for them, but they have their own lives to live as well."

"Hm... Too bad you're stuck with me," Adora says, nudging Catra and winking.

"You act as if I didn't choose to marry you," Catra points out fondly.

"You really did choose to spend the rest of your life with me," Adora says. The 'loser' is implied in the way that she says that. "Why would you do that?"

"Because I love you. Obviously."

"Really? This is *brand new* information," Adora says sarcastically. She's such a smart ass sometimes. Catra rolls her eyes at her wife.

"Hey kittens, do you want to go to that new restaurant that opened in the middle of Half-Moon today?" Catra suggests, having given too much attention to her dramatic wife.

"Hell yeah," Finn says as the others also agree.

"How about, Finn, you take your siblings and we'll catch up? I want to talk to my wife privately for a moment," Adora says. Finn being the eldest meant they were in charge. Finn

blinks but nods.

"Alright, we'll meet you guys there. Come on. Race you guys!" Finn takes off as the others do, pushing and shoving each other.

Catra waits until their kids rush off, smiling softly at their antics, before she focuses her attention on Adora. "Yes, love?" She asks curiously.

"Walk with me a second?" Adora asks while offering her hand. It’s strangely romantic. Of course Catra places her hand in Adora's, letting the blonde guide her along.

"What's up?" Catra prompts. Adora so rarely asks to speak to her alone, it must be something serious. Adora leads Catra along until they reach the throne of Half-Moon.

"I guess I'm just nostalgic, and impressed that we made it this far," Adora says. Catra hums, sitting in the throne while still holding Adora's hand.

"Me too. I'm... happy."

"Good," Adora says, taking Catra's face in her hands. "You look Queenly sitting there."

"Yeah?" Catra asks, smiling a little at her wife.

"My Queen," Adora says, kissing Catra. "Do you... miss being Queen?" Catra thinks about this for a moment. Technically, she had only not been Queen for about a few hours, but she understands what Adora really means. In a lot of ways, they’re similar to each other. Adora doesn’t miss being Lord of the Horde, but she does miss being the leader of something. Catra would miss helping her people, but her son was the rightful heir, and he would be a good king too. Catra couldn’t take that from him.

"No, not really," Catra finally answers. "I didn't want to be Queen after what happened. I only did it to give Cyrus some time, so he was more grown before he was saddled with such responsibilities."

"Mmm... And in the process you proved everyone who doubted you wrong," Adora says, "which was very sexy of you."

"Of course you think I'm sexy," Catra smiles. "But yeah, it's... weird to hear that I was one of the best Queen's Half-Moon had ever seen when at one point the people didn't even want me to ascend to the throne."

"Because of me," Adora says. "We always knew you'd make a great Queen."

"Yeah, I guess so. It's just... weird," Catra repeats.

"I'm sure it is," Adora says, kissing Catra on her cheek. "So... No fifth kitten?" Catra actually laughs at that.

"Other than the fact I physically can't after that procedure," Catra says, "I think we might be a bit too old for that, love."

"You're probably right, but it could be fun to try." Catra rolls her eyes at that. Of course Adora says *that* . Catra just gently hits her on the forehead in a soft scolding. Catra is all for 'making babies' in the sense that she's all for having incredible sex with her wife. She just doesn't need to be squeezing out another kid.

"It's weird sitting here too," Catra admits. She hadn't been sitting in the throne all that often. It was strange to think that her life had been heading towards this situation, to the fact that Catra would sit in this throne and *rule* . No more. No more than the few years she'd done anyway, and it was a peaceful rule.

"It suits you," Adora comments. Catra used to think the same when she saw Adora sitting on her throne. She peers up at her wife. Adora just looks soft now, wrinkles at the corners of her eyes and by her lips. Smile lines. Adora had lived a happy life and it was evident on her face.

"So you and so many others tell me," Catra says. "Including my mom before she…"

"You could've taken it, Catra," Adora says. "It'll pass to Cyrus after. The people of Half-Moon no longer care about who I was."

"Adora... It's not the same," Catra sighs. "Perhaps when I was younger I wanted to be a queen that the people of Half-Moon would love, but they disappointed me when I needed support the most, okay?"

"Look," Adora says, carefully lowering herself down to kneel in front of Catra, "they definitely don't deserve you, and I understand that you don't want to be their Queen because of what they did, but you're *so* good at it. You were *born* for it."

"Adora..." Catra looks at her wife and she sees that sunny blonde just smile back at her. It's incredible to think Catra once believed this woman to be evil. She's the most kind-hearted person Catra knows.

"Yes, my love?" Adora asks gently.

"Why do you want me to be the Queen of Half-Moon so much?" Catra asks curiously.

"I just want you to be happy," Adora says, taking Catra's hands and kissing them. "I don't want you to have any regrets. We're already getting older. You've been filling in as Queen already, doesn't it make sense to just take it and let it pass as it always does down our line of little heirs?"

"We already gave it to Cyrus," Catra reminds her, "he would be upset if we took that away from him. I don't want to do that."

“Maybe he’d understand-”

“No,” Catra shakes her head and then gently cups her wife’s jaw. “You want me to be happy? *You* make me happy. I don’t need or want anything else. Just our children happy, and to be with you.” Adora stares up at Catra for a long moment. She looks as though she might be searching for something, and then maybe finds it.

"Okay... Now help me back up? I'm not as young as I used to be," Adora says, smiling. "And we should get back to our kids, Calamity has probably blown something up by now." Catra smiles and helps the blonde stand up.

"Probably,” Catra says, laughing. “Goodness, Calamity really lives up to that name, huh?"

"It's revenge for calling them that," Adora says. "I thought it would be funny, but it really suits them perfectly."

"Yeah,” Catra can’t disagree with that. She knows Adora was kidding, but it was a genius name for their fourth unruly child. “Let's go?"

"Let's go," Adora confirms, extending her elbow. Catra happily links her arm through her wife’s. Catra had been through a lot, but she really was happy here. Her son was to be King of Half-Moon. Even if Catra had only ruled for a short time, it was enough. She would help her son, and that was enough for her. Now she just wanted to enjoy dinner as a family.

* * *

As they sit in their oddly quiet home, pictures of memories on the walls, and memories attached to every square foot, Catra is overcome with a sense of... nostalgia, and love. This is their home. They have four beautiful children who have left their nests, and Catra is confident will do amazing things, have already done amazing things, and all that's left is her and Adora. She couldn't have asked for a better partner in life, and to think she almost never had this is. That was inconceivable.

Adora extends her hand and Catra takes it, looking over at her wife who was smiling softly at her. "I guess now it's just us again," Adora says. Of course their kids will visit, and their friends, but, ultimately, it will just be the two of them from here on out. Catra's heart aches with the love she feels. Of course Magicats die soon after the loss of their most beloved. How could she go on without Adora? She could not.

Catra sits down beside her wife on their couch and curls into her side, seeking Adora's warmth and the comfort which it brought her. "Just us," Catra says, sighing as she sinks into her seat. Adora's arm raises and she wraps it around Catra's shoulders.

"Any regrets?" Adora asks, turning her face to look at Catra. "Especially now that you're all alone with me." Catra smiles at that. Adora is such a dork if she truly believes Catra could ever regret being alone with her. The truth is, Catra doesn't regret a single thing. If she had the choice to do it all again, the suffering, the pain, the rupture between herself and her mom, she would. She would do it all again because it meant she got to love and be loved by Adora, and that made everything worth it.

"Regrets? No," Catra answers honestly. Adora hums. "You?"

"Nah," Adora says without hesitation. "I think this is exactly where I was meant to be. How could I regret anything?" And isn't that what any person wants? To live without regrets. To find your one true love, the person who you gladly spend the rest of your life with. No, Catra has no regrets, and neither does her wife, and that's all that really matters.

"I love you, ex-Lord of the Horde, Adora."

"I love you too, ex-Princess C'yra of Half-Moon."

Catra grins at that and then kisses her wife. Happily ever after was real and this was it.

Chapter End Notes

There was also this little titbit that I couldn't find an appropriate place to slip into the chapter so I'll add it here. Here are the epithets for Cyrus' (C'yra's father and Catra's grandfather) dynasty, including Cyrus (Catra and Adora's son):
King Cyrus (II) the Kind
Queen C'yra (II) the Strong
Queen (Regent) C'yra (III) the Gracious
King Cyrus (III) the Great

Thank you all for all of your support for this fic. I really *really* hope you enjoyed this chapter and found it a satisfying conclusion. I'm so glad we could bring an end to this fic, even if it did take a decent amount of time dfghjhgf You will probably hear from M and I again in future works, but, until then, this is it - S

As S said, thank you so much for taking the time to read this incredibly long fanfic that we wrote. I really hope that you enjoyed this fic as much as we enjoyed writing it. We hope to continue writing some of our other AUs. See you all soon! - M

You can keep tabs on us on Twitter @ceolordadora and find me (S) on tumblr @sherasswords

End Notes

Sorry for any spelling and/or grammar mistakes! Feel free to leave kudos and/or comment! Thank you for reading :)! See you next time hopefully.

Please drop by the Archive and comment to let the creator know if you enjoyed their work!